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I.I The Gornahoor Project

Based on some exchanges lately, we feel the need to make clear the purpose of the **Gornahoor Project**. There is one distinction, and one distinction only: that between Tradition and anti-Tradition. Elaborating that distinction in its past and current manifestations is a legitimate topic for discussion. However, proselytizing for one religious form — be it Buddhism, Catholicism, Asatru, Brahminism, or whatever — is not legitimate.

A corollary to this is the distinction between principled and unprincipled. We are interested in principles only: that which is true always and everywhere. Hence, any arguments based on empirical, historical, personal, or other contingent factors are necessarily inconclusive.

Keep in mind the components of the Gornahoor motto:

Veritatem Loquor *Veritatem loquor* means “to speak the truth”, not “to speak one’s mind”. Not every, and more likely not many if any at all, thought that passes through the mind has any relation to Truth. So rather than expressing every passing thought, it would be better instead to trace

it back to its roots. You will discover that “your” thoughts are not really yours at all.

Scientiam Acquirere *Scientiam acquirere* means “to acquire knowledge”. Of course, we mean here metaphysical knowledge. This is direct intuitive knowledge, beyond religion, science, and history. Although empirical knowledge of the latter fields may be used to illustrate and make points, they must never be confused with knowledge itself.

Liber Esse *Liber esse* means “to be free”. Unlike Rousseau, who claimed man is “born free”, we claim that man must make himself free. He must transcend the spontaneous, determinative, and contingent factors that condition his Will in order to become conscious, creative, and free.

Posted on 2010-08-25 by Cologero

* * *

mleow on 2010-08-25 at 03:40 said:

I recently found “the gornahoor project”, and i am so far impressed by the content of this page and its authors, especially welcome is the translations of some more rare Evola passages.

It is also good that it avoids the currents of “political traditionalism” and “the new right”, which usually follows in the traditional milieu, and instead focus solely on the spiritual path.

My only “critic” would be that it would be nice to see more lengthier and indepth postings, quality before quantity, right?

Sati Shankar on 2010-08-26 at 01:46 said:

Yes it must adhere to its objectives.

1.2 Help Wanted

This is an appeal to those who can distinguish Tradition from Custom, those no longer willing to be on the outside looking in, and those who

hear a positive message in Tradition rather than a message of constant criticism and complaint. This is a project with relevance not only for now, but one hundred years from now, a thousand years from now.

As we have pointed out, there are two streams of influence: the corporeal and the subtle. The biological issue is the easier to deal with and at the same time the least important. What is necessary and primary is the world of ideas. This is our focus. To that end we are implementing a plan. Ideally, with collaboration, since the results will come more quickly and will be more accurate. Regardless, it will be done.

Symbols and Diagrams Traditional teachings rely on symbols and diagrams for their transmission, rather than texts alone. Rene Guenon, presumably because illustrators were not available, used geometric models to convey metaphysic ideas but only as text. These need to be drawn out. Thus we need people who can use Illustrator or mathematical modeling software to create these images.

Reference Work Traditional ideas are scattered across many books and essays by various authors. Therefore, we plan a Reference work to organize these ideas. This will be accomplished via an on-line wiki. Thus we need someone who can set up and maintain such a wiki.

Translations and Transcriptions There are several works that should be translated, primarily by Julius Evola. This is tedious work with little benefit. However, we plan a new approach. We will do a verbal translation of the text using voice recognition software. The result will be rough. Thus we need collaborators able to accurately transcribe the text and then redact it. This will make more translations available.

Posted on 2011-02-20 by Admin

* * *

Cologero on 2011-02-22 at 12:19 said:

POV ray is a free ray tracing program that seems capable of creating the many geometric models from Rene Guenon. This is an opportunity for someone with artistic talent and a metaphysical interest to combine the two. It is an interesting and valuable project. Please consider contributing.

<http://www.povray.org>

EXIT on 2011-02-23 at 10:07 said:

Much of this site seems to be rehashed portions of Guenon's work to which nothing is really being added, and as such leaves no interest to those who already know this material. Why not change the format to periodically appearing original articles as one would find in other traditionalist journals?

Cologero on 2011-02-23 at 19:18 said:

If you have an idea for an original article, send us an outline and we will publish it.

1.3 Charting the Course

Let the dead bury the dead.

I shall not dispute those who maintain a negative attitude toward the religious principle. I shall not argue with the contemporary opponents of religion, because they are right. I say that those who reject religion are right because the contemporary state of religion calls for rejection, because our religion is not what it ought to be.

In the coming months, Gornahoor will be proceeding on a more structured path. We have presented a mass of material, somewhat randomly, on many seemingly unrelated topics; nevertheless, there is a unity to them. The three blogs will each have a specific focus.

Gornahoor¹ The primary focus will be on metaphysics, that which is true always and everywhere, rather than on the ephemeral.

Specifically, we shall be commenting on **Vladimir Solovyov**'s *Lectures on Divine Humanity*. This will cover many of the themes we have addressed: the nature of the Infinite, the Logos, Sophia and the world soul, man as spirit, soul and body, the man-god, gnosis, and so on. We shall also bring in supplemental material from **T R V Murti**'s *The Central Philosophy of Buddhism*, which Solovyov characterizes as a *negative religion* in contrast to what he calls *positive religion*.

The Right Hand Path² The focus will be on the application of principles to the modern world. With its emphasis on political, economic and creative activity, this is intended for those with the tendencies of the kshatriya or vaishya.

We plan to address the important question — important both because it is the hallmark of a Traditional society and because of the conflicts that have arisen in the West over this issue — of the relationship between *Spiritual Authority* and *Temporal Power*. We have some texts in mind that address this relationship from the point of view of the dominant tradition in the West. However, we will bowdlerize the text, removing the specifically theological elements and extracting just the principles to be considered. The purpose is to exert influence on the “necessary transition for humanity from its religious past to its religious future” (Solovyov).

Meditations on the Tarot³ This will continue to focus on the methods for spiritual growth and development, without which, metaphysics will remain opaque.

To repeat, our constant hope is that young men with intelligence, creativity, and energy will be motivated to take up the themes that can only be partially developed on a blog and bring them to a wider audience. What is necessary is an “open conspiracy” of thinkers who will engage

in the “long walk through the institutions.” We encourage Gornahoor visitors to consider writing for one of these blogs; please contact me⁴ with any inquiries, suggestions or questions. I have many topics in mind that can be adapted to suit your particular interests, abilities, and talents.

Posted on 2011-11-19 by Cologero

* * *

charlotte on 2011-11-20 at 03:35 said:
young men, lol – I guess women know it all already :-)

Cologero on 2011-11-20 at 08:11 said:
We don't have too many women visitors here, Charlotte, for reasons perhaps you can explain. I've been trying stories with a love interest but that has made no difference.

charlotte on 2011-11-20 at 12:52 said:
I know, only kidding :-) it seems to be a bit of a pattern in many philosophical circles, not just here but throughout history, probably because traditional religions are very patriarchal – hence many women nowadays just flow towards the new age or, alternatively, stick to very rigid parameters. Perhaps it is also to do with the female mystery, which tends to be heavily veiled. Also, there is often a strong egotistic element with male philosophical groups that can be off-putting for women (not talking about you or anyone else in particular here, just generally) – just think of the explosive arguments there've been on some other groups we both know of that shall go unmentioned. I got used to it at university but a lot of women can feel intimidated by it.

1.4 Past, Present, Future

As we close in on the 1001 posts at which point Gornahoor will come to its natural end, it is time to focus more clearly on its goals. At the

⁴<https://gornahoor.net/cdn-cgi/l/email-protection#9dfaf2eff3fcf5f2f2efddfaf2eff3fcf5f2f2efb3f3f8e9>

current pace, that end will come in about 10 to 12 months. There are other projects envisioned beyond that, which have been languishing. For example,

- There is much more work to do with the Medtarot discussion list.
- The project to create graphical images for the various figures described in Guenon's Symbolism of the Cross is on hold. A few years ago, a mathematician from Notre Dame offered to help, but he has since moved on. Perhaps there is someone else who is familiar with ray tracing of mathematical modeling software.
- There are various translations projects pending, mostly of obscure writers.
- The Gnosis group, which is more important than any of the above, needs to expand.
- Finally, of course, there are my own personal meditations which cannot risk being lost in a sea of busyness.

Ultimate Goal The main point of Gornahoor is to explore Tradition including its social structures, metaphysical principles, and esoteric teachings, with the ultimate aim being its possible restoration. We are not promoting any specific religious teachings, although we will use them to illustrate the manifestations of Tradition. We have been focusing on the Medieval tradition for the practical matter that it is closer to us in time, customs, language, etc., so presumably it will be easier to grasp for the modern mind seeking to understand.

Now the authors that primarily interest us — **Rene Guenon, Julius Evola, Guido de Giorgio, Ananda Coomaraswamy** — all agree that the European Middle Ages, along with its spiritual teachings, constituted a valid tradition. We have endeavored to explore those. Our aim is not to

demonstrate their truth, since that is simply assumed. We have demonstrated that the Medieval tradition was in continuity with the preceding European traditions, although with a deepening understanding.

Properly understood, it provides a complete teaching, so there is no necessity to follow alternative, and alien, traditions. Nevertheless, the variety of religions, with their apparently incompatible claims to truth, has been a scandal to modern man. Science and rationalistic philosophies have not provided the basis for understanding the meaning of life. Various revolutionary movements have caused commotions without increasing human happiness.

At the right moment, then, Rene Guenon arrived with an intellectually and spiritually satisfying teaching. Commonality in symbols, rites, social organization, and metaphysical principles explain spiritual systems better than the alternatives from psychology and anthropology.

Nevertheless, we cannot stop there. It is one thing to announce the “transcendent unity of religions”; specificity is a different matter. Hence, that principle dictated the following subgoals

- To distinguish between exoteric and esoteric. One way is to show how theological concepts can be recast as metaphysical concepts.
- To show that the Medieval Church (or the Nordic-Roman tradition, in Evola’s terms) formed a legitimate tradition
- To highlight the differences between the Medieval and contemporary churches
- To show the continuity of the Medieval church with the historically prior pagan traditions
- To point out the homologies between the Medieval tradition and other traditions

- To show that the Hermetic tradition preserved the essential elements of the medieval tradition

The Fall We can use the “fall of man” as an example of a homology between various traditions. Sacred texts have higher interpretations beyond the literal, historical, or scientific interpretation. The esoteric understanding stands at a different level. This does not mean it is the “correct” interpretation in opposition to the “literal” interpretation; viz., it does not assume the literal meaning is false. However, for our purposes, it is primarily the esoteric meaning that is of interest.

So, in this case, the esoteric interpretation of the Fall involves the knowledge of one’s states of consciousness rather than the exoteric knowledge of the activities of the primal couple in the past. According to the Council of Trent, these are the lasting effects of the original fall, which persist to our own times:

- The intellect is darkened. It becomes difficult to grasp the true nature of the Man, God, and the World.
- The will is weakened. It is beset by concupiscence and negative emotions which guide it instead of the higher intellect

This is a simpler way to put it. The fall of man involves man in:

- Ignorance
- Desire

Put this way, this is the summation of Buddhism. The way of liberation begins with “right view” (the elimination of ignorance by seeing reality as it is) and ends with the end of excessive or disordered desire. Similarly, the Vedanta teaches that man is in a state of avidya (ignorance)

and limited to the desire for pleasure, worldly success, or sense of duty. The “antidote” is vidya and desire refocused on liberation.

That is not the whole story, of course, but it is the basis for a common understanding.

Regeneration and the Mirror of God The twin peaks of scholastic metaphysics were Saint Thomas Aquinas and **Saint Bonaventura**.

In his meditations on the *Soul’s Journey to God*, Bonaventura uses the six wings of the seraph from Ezekiel as a springboard to a series of meditations on God, similar to the technique used by Valentin Tomberg on the imagery of the Tarot. He begins with the knowledge of God gleaned from the created world. As such, it is a nature mysticism, which many poets, etc., have experienced. Unfortunately, it is usually considered the endpoint rather than the first leg of a longer journey.

It ends with meditations of God as Being and as the Good, before finally resting in God. These meditations are probably far from the typical believer’s understanding of God.

As far as I know, in the 8 centuries since Bonaventura’s meditations were written, the Franciscan orders have never developed a retreat format based on them. He is not describing a psychological process, as some commentators believe. They may advocate some techniques from cognitive psychology or other schools. Stay away.

The soul’s journey is also very unlike the “faith journey” that so many today want to dwell on. Bonaventure is objective, esoteric, and God-centered, whereas the faith journey is often maudlin, emotional, and self-centered.

Bonaventura’s journey is to lead back to the primordial state prior to the fall. Called “regeneration”, this is likewise the goal of Hermetism, not to mention Guenon’s frequent discussions on the primordial state. Another topic mentioned by Bonaventura is the necessity to “polish the mirror” of the soul in order for the soul to better reflect God’s image.

Again, this is the absolute starting point for Tomberg's meditations. So we see the Hermetic tradition has preserved the Medieval esoteric tradition. However, they diverged at some point, even reaching enmity. That rift must be healed.

That is because, in our time, Bonaventura's ideas are often forgotten. For example, what pope or bishop mentions the desirability of restoring the primordial state? Furthermore, it is simply assumed today that every human is the image of God without making the effort of "polishing the mirror".

Simony Simon Magus tried to purchase the power of the Holy Spirit. Simony is a perpetual temptation and is considered a serious moral failing. Nevertheless, the sale of "spiritual wisdom" is a big business today. People prefer to pay for some teachings that they can repeat back like parrots. True teachings are priceless, since they require a change in being.

Posted on 2015-10-06 by Cologero

* * *

Erasmus Seabert on 2015-10-06 at 23:27 said:

You're doing tremendous work, these posts are invaluable, thank you!

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-07 at 05:46 said:

As someone whose parents are both Catholic and Eastern Orthodox, I never felt animosity towards any of them, as it's usually a case with the Catholics or Orthodox church people. But I am baptized in the Orthodox church and I wonder are there any true Traditionalists among them?

I know about Serbian theologians like saint Iustin Popovic and saint Nikolai Velimirovic who were very antimodernist, but I'm not sure could they be considered Traditionalists or valuable for Traditionalist studies. In my opinion, Dimitrije Ljotic was a great example of an Orthodox author who could be valuable for some Traditionalists, although he had to focus much on the world politics and had to abandon more mystical pursue. In my mind he is a good example of a "bridge" between Catholicism and Orthodoxy.

Also, I read recently a critique of Dimitrije Ljotic by certain Orthodox author (forgot the book title), and although Church Fathers agree that “his heart was in a good place” and he was a “highly moral individual”, “he”, author continues, “seemed to have accepted certain Roman-Catholic ideas or practice of personal, mystic connection with Christ” which is, according to the author, not very Orthodox friendly, where great importance is in Church meetings or “savors”. I didn’t quite understand it, because isn’t hesychasm a form of solitary, mystical practice of meditation and unity with the Divine? I was pretty sure that Orthodoxy has its own share of more esoteric, solitary and mystical work.

I personally am not too fond of Church gatherings and crowds and find the practice of solitary, esoteric work much better, especially in these days. Also I have no problem reading saint Aquinas or other Catholic authors or authors who deal with Hermeticism, Oriental metaphysics etc. I basically grew up reading Franz Bardon, before finding Guenon or Evola. Just this would make me a heretic in the eyes of many Churchgoers. This is why I am now inwardly completely centered around Traditionalism as a whole, complete metaphysical system and care little about exoteric dogmatic separations of “world religions”.

I will now try to find works of de Giorgio and saint Bonaventura, since I haven’t read anything from them. Thanks for the recommendations!

Manwë on 2015-10-07 at 13:03 said:

Philip Sherrard argues that catholicism deviates from the christian tradition. It would be interesting to read Gornahoor’s take on Sherrard’s criticism of St. Augustine and St. Thomas Aquinas.

From Theology to Philosophy in the Latin West

http://www.myriobiblos.gr/texts/english/sherrard_philosophy.htm

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scardanelli on 2015-10-07 at 20:01 said:

I’m glad to hear about the eventual resurrection of the medtarot discussion list. Let me know if I can help.

Mark Citadel on 2015-10-08 at 12:47 said:

Will Gornahoor’s articles remain available online or not? I am greatly saddened that this project will be discontinued.

Alistair Fraser on 2015-10-08 at 18:15 said:

I thought this was apt and not aimed at you mark, just because your below it,

Its my tainted intuitive projection for mischievous reasons on all visitors to this site apart from the esteemed site host/hosts.

From Dirty Harry -Uh uh. I know what you're thinking. "Did he fire six shots or only five?" Well to tell you the truth in all this excitement I kinda lost track myself. But being this is a .44 Magnum, the most powerful handgun in the world and would blow your head clean off, you've gotta ask yourself one question: "Do I feel lucky?" Well, do ya, punk?

From Gornahoor Website – Sniff Sniff, pours a glass of firewater, Uh Uh uh oh oh , yeah yeah yeah, cough cough , , i know what your all thinking , you've been coming here for years grabbing free information of the highest calibre inc speeches and insights and comments on the maestros of recent human traditional thinking.

Now to tell you the truth in all this search for the truth, i kinda lost track myself, I'm talking about somethings that have got to be said that are often left unsaid, I'm talking about what this sites effort costs to run, not at a profit , you understand , but just to run in and of itself, and I'm thinking , in here I've got the most powerful level of wisdom ever gathered in the traditional sense, and i have a love of that wisdom , its taken years to amass, i even have a cordial appreciation of some of you visitors , but I'm gonna ask you all directly just one time right here right now , a thing that is usually left unsaid

Just tell me, no , show me... .how much DO U LOVE coming to this site and getting it all for nothing , at what point will it finally occur a clear thought in your minds, maybe i should DONATE a small snippet for general energy RUNNING COSTS

So now the code is broken , the unsaid has been said and now you punks have got to ask yourselves one more question = Does your Love for this free platform feel Donatey , well does it ya punks hehehe

Cologero on 2015-10-08 at 18:33 said:

Mr Citadel, the articles will remain online.

Cologero on 2015-10-08 at 18:43 said:

@Manwe, Sherrard just embarrasses himself, since he chose the path of Strife. A better guide would be Vladimir Solovyov or Nicodemus who saw in Lorenzo Scupoli a spiritual guide, not a "deviation from Christian tradition".

That said, Thomism has some weak points; see, for example, the recent discussions on karma and dharma.

The question remains, then, about the "cause" of the modern world. I doubt it is presupposed in Thomsim or the filioque as Sherrard might think. Guenon and Evola had their own opinions. Mouravieff, I believe, is more on point. The exemplars of the Medieval period were the theologian and the knight. They towered over the ordinary in their respective domains, since they achieved self-mastery in the interior life.

However, the scientist and the enlightenment philosopher, the soldier with gunpowder, the merchants, came to dominate the exterior world. The theologian and the knight became irrelevant. The way out, then, will require those with a new power of integration.

Cologero on 2015-10-08 at 23:33 said:

Thanks for the thought, Mr. Fraser. I've used a recent donation to purchase Evola's commentary on the Tao Te Ching.

However, what would be even better would be more blogs along the same lines; not necessarily some ideological purity, but more like a family dinner. Even comments made to other sites would be nice, beyond the small number of readers here.

Of course, there is the Gnosis study group which needs to expand. We are just finishing up a group for phase 1, so we will be looking to start up a new phase 1 group.

1.5 Unanticipated Recap

Nature does not make men equal; souls differ still more than bodies.

ANTOINE FABRE D'OLIVET

As I've been pondering which of two alternative endings to use for Post #1001 – if it ever appears at all – some recent inquiries have prompted this recapitulation before moving on to other topics. Perhaps a generation from now, some PhD student will write a dissertation of futile reactionary movements of the early XXIst century; he may then follow each obscure reference and come to a conclusion. Esoteric writings always leave some things unsaid.

It is pointless to explain a joke, since it then loses its purpose as a joke: it can no longer be funny. But is it pointless to explain a series of posts? After all, if someone cannot connect the dots, perhaps it could be my own fault. One of my creative writing teachers was highly critical of me. Since he preferred the vapid doodlings of the women in the class, I never

took him seriously. Maybe he was correct. Is an inscrutable metaphor still a metaphor?

Living a Worldview Some seem to believe that we are an advocacy site, comparable to movements that retain a superficial resemblance. But advocacy is the role of a sophist, not a philosopher who strives to see things objectively and dispassionately. The latter has justice as the goal while the former strives for victory of some sort.

Unfortunately, unless the situation is understood objectively, the results of actions will be mixed and victory ephemeral. At that point, another virtue is necessary: courage or fortitude. A man should live by his convictions. That is the essence of the point made by C S Peirce.

Life Aim The World offers a myriad of options for living one's life. Some will claim they "will decide for themselves", but based on what? Where do their thoughts come from? How can they understand possibilities of manifestation that have never occurred to them? Walk through a large university library; there are hundreds of thousands of volumes with conflicting facts and opinions. Can anyone master that?

Hence, a worldview can be no more than arbitrary no matter how fervently held. Nevertheless, there may be a way out: a thought from a higher source may intrude. If your mind is attuned to it, you may be able to follow it to escape the chaos and randomness of world events. Such men who are committed to that course have a life aim. Otherwise, for everyone else, life is little more than Brownian motion.

Blinded by Science Some still hold that science will open up that path. Yet science is always in the process of becoming, it is incomplete and subject to change, so how can the scientific method show us the path? So this is the first test: who can live solely by science under those circumstances? I will now provide some bullet points summarizing ideas from recent

posts. You can follow along. The path will gradually be made clear, or at least, you can see where we have gone wrong. On the other hand, you may see where certain men have lacked the courage to follow up on their world view.

- **Natural Selection.** All life arose from random variation and natural selection. But this does not explain why there are hippopotamuses and not unicorns. It does not explain the observed sequence to more complex life forms. At best, it can only be an alternative theory to design, not a refutation. Otherwise, there would be no talk of living in a simulation, etc. Natural selection is accepted to avoid facing up to the possibility of a designer.
- **Animality.** The corollary is that human beings are just a species of animal. Does anyone actually advocate living like animals, which are motivated strictly by fear, sex, and hunger, or attraction and repulsion? Few will deny the efficacy of consciousness, rationality, or morality, but on what grounds? Animals are not bothered by moral considerations.
- **Rationality.** The average IQ of physicists is much higher than that of biologist, so we consider the views of Roger Penrose. He correctly understands that, based on Gödel's theorem, rationality cannot be explained as a biochemical neurological process. Unfortunately, he then assumes that some future theory of quantum gravity will somehow explain consciousness and rationality. However, that is a technique of evasion.
- **Morality.** Scientists don't think very deeply about things, since they are only interested in quantitative results which are beyond – or actually, below – thought. However, the philosopher Thomas Nagel sees clearly that natural selection cannot explain the qualities that make us human. Hence, he postulates an environment that

will give rise to such qualities, although it cannot be known by science. Again, Nagel refuses to live by the results of his insights.

- **Scientific closure.** Hence, what matters most cannot be explained by science, that is, there is no epistemological scientific closure: something else must be added. The scholastic principle is that the real is intelligible, yet science does not account for the intelligibility of the world. There is no scientific beginning, since physics can never get to time=0 of the Big Bang.
- **Degrees of Existence.** So if the material explanation of the world is incomplete, there must be higher, non-material degrees of existence. Wolfgang Smith shows that the qualitative corporeal world is not the quantitative physical world. Moreover, there is vertical causation, so that the higher degrees of existence form the lower levels. A fortiori, it is not matter that creates the higher degrees. Smith shows that a corporeal body can be freed from its physical counterpart. Although it may look identical, it will have different powers. Specifically, a “resurrection body” can be explained in that way.

This is the rational path, the path of the intellect. It is more a question of will rather than knowledge. If the world is not epistemologically closed, then there is the possibility of revelation, or faith, intruding into the world from a higher state. If the physical world is just one state of being, then there is the possibility of super-physical events, or miracles. This is all rational, unless you want to stop at one of the bullet points. But which one?

Unobvious Conclusions So how can anyone take this as a “criticism of secularism and in favor of a religiously and ritually structured society”? Rather, it is “in favor” of the eternally valid. What is the value in criticizing

an illusion? There is only value in dispelling it. It is not a question of “choosing” one view over another, as though they are on the same level.

If someone self-identifies as an animal, what value is there in debating him? Does a man argue with his dog?

So here is a young man rather upset with an atheist’s support of Hillary Clinton: *Sam Harris VS Milo Yiannopoulos on Trump*⁵. Sam Harris is a neuroscientist who claims that “people’s thoughts and intentions emerge from background causes of which we are unaware and over which we exert no conscious control.” In other words, Harris’ support of Hillary is not a rational choice but more likely the result of abnormal brain chemistry.

The attentive reader will note that Gornahoor agrees with that claim. However, Gornahoor offers what Harris cannot (no, psychedelics like MDMA are of no value): a way out, a practice to “exert conscious control” over one’s thoughts. If he were an astute and erudite student of religion, rather than a semi-educated polemicist, he may have noticed that as fundamental to those of spiritual depth.

Another misconception is that somehow we are appreciative of the so-called alt right. This would be a good test: hold a “heavy metal” night at the Pulse nightclub in Orlando and see who shows up. There will be a large overlap with the alt right if anyone wants to do the Venn diagram. But we won’t be there.

Posted on 2016-07-06 by Cologero

* * *

Logres on 2016-07-18 at 00:24 said:

“What is the value in criticizing an illusion? There is only value in dispelling it.” I spent most of my college years in marshaling plans to work through BF Skinner, Karl Marx, etc, in order to reach rational conclusions that were educated. At some point, (and probably due greatly from

⁵<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0nOAT60NYDs>

happy influence), I grasped what my old college professor John Reist was saying about a book list of “read before you die”. It’s also tiring to drudge in a world dominated by atheist worldviews (practically) and then rush home to stay up late reading the latest attack on consciousness, soul, etc. Their debates might be more interesting if we weren’t living with the practical fruit of it all around us. Eg, the Huxley-Darwin debates were interesting, superficially, because they meant something, taking place in a world still largely dominated by Faith. I am not even really sure the new atheists believe, deeply believe, that there is no God, just that He is largely irrelevant. If there is no God, what possible good would holding a debate do anyone?

1.6 Chefs, Connoisseurs, and Consumers

I’ve had restaurants recommended to me based on the quantity of food provided or the “great” salad bar, reasonable prices, or perhaps the convenient hours, and so on. These people are consumers of food; they expect the basics and are easily satisfied. Most restaurants depend on them for survival.

Connoisseurs, on the other hand, understand food preparation, the best combinations of foods and spices, and value the presentation almost as much as the flavor. Being more selective, they surpass the consumer. However, beyond the connoisseur is the chef, who prepares the meal. Such fare is not at all the most popular even if it is the best.

A similar ranking applies to weblogs. **Consumers** like to accumulate ideas because they are satisfying. The ideas may inspire them, confirm their own opinions, or add to the ideational superstructure that guides their lives. They are satisfied with the bon mot or the conclusion. How and why the conclusion is reached is of little import. Their favorite meal is the smorgasbord, a little of this and a little of that. Most weblogs are like that. They provide a series of ideas that are only loosely connected. They present a variety of concepts as long as they reduce to similar conclusions, even if the premises and the arguments are widely different.

The **connoisseur**, however, is more sophisticated. He has a reasonably developed worldview and both a wider and deeper background. He

reads with understanding, he knows when his ideas are being confirmed and when they are challenged. For him, the argument means as much as the conclusion; in fact, he may even gain from following the discussion even when he rejects the conclusion.

Nevertheless, he is passive, since it is the **chef** who creates the argument. The reader is unaware of the outtakes, i.e., the text that didn't make the final cut. He usually misses the technique hidden within the text and may only be dimly aware of the true purposes of the chef. It is not to satisfy the connoisseur. Gornahoor is not interested in consumers or even in connoisseurs, but rather in training chefs.

The Medium is the Message **Marshall McLuhan** is famous for coining the expression that serves as the title for this section. In a work of art, for example, the unsophisticated consumer will take the ostensible object of the art as the important thing and ignore the framework. Hence they like images of kittens. A good critic, however, will focus on the technique; the kitten is of secondary interest. He will look at the technique, the use of color and shading, etc.

This past weekend, as we were listening to some music, I asked my older son, who is a musician, what exactly does he hear. At first, he didn't understand the question. I explained that most people just hear pleasant sounds and they react to the beat. Then he understood. He told me he picks out the various voices, such as the bass line, the drum rhythms, and so on. He listens for the chord changes and can even tell what type of a chord is being played.

Recently, in a trad forum the topic of Dante came up. The moderator was nonplussed and objected that nothing could be learned from a mere work of fiction. All I can tell you is to abandon hope all ye who expect to restore tradition in that forum.

Clearly, Dante has a message, a quite sophisticated message in fact. Not only that, he actually explains the medium for those who might not

figure it out for themselves. In the *Convivio*, he explains the four levels of meaning that he inserted into his poetry: the literal, the allegorical, the moral, and the anagogical. To understand it as a mere work of fiction is to be stuck on the literal. It can also be read as theology, which many do. Ultimately, it is an initiatic work, i.e., it describes the stages on the spiritual path that are to be traversed in this life.

Being and Telling So a blog about Tradition must not be only about the message, that is, mere discourse in the manner of the professors. It itself must be written in a traditional way so that the medium itself becomes the message; it may even be the real message. Everything should have a purpose in relationship to the whole.

First of all, it must be organic. Hence, it is not systematic, yet it is not a mere smorgasbord of random ideas. Nevertheless, it is interconnected, and points in one post may be developed several months later, expressed in a different or deeper way.

It cannot be reduced to discursive thought, so there can be no explicit agenda or manifesto. However, there is still a point of view that is not subject to infinite debate. Therefore, it must be decisive when things deliquesce and solidity is restored.

It is dedicated to the Logos, even when that is not obvious and not incessantly proclaimed. To repeat, it is not talk about the Logos, but an attempt to manifest Him. Therefore, it strives to be logical and rational, in a transcendent sense, and it is hierarchically ordered.

It operates on the principle of affinity in the confidence that the right people and like spirits will congregate for their own reasons. Hence, there is no attempt at evangelization or to convince anyone through argument.

Organic thinking is creative thinking. That is why we present only original material, with the intent to provide a novel insight whenever possible. We don't simply republish another man's work. We do, however, publish our own translations of works that we consider useful. Some

readers are interested only in those.

We also strive to write from our own understanding, whatever level that may be. Cynics will readily agree.

Fire and Ice Think carefully before committing to being a connoisseur or a chef. One will have to learn to be an actor to get along in the world, since everything is chosen freely. Usually, such a man will be careful about revealing his views; I am fortunate to be able to play the “crazy uncle”. Detachment, when revealed, can be mistaken as inhuman coldness or even sociopathy. People can experience the Ice but not always the Fire.

Posted on 2013-03-28 by Cologero

* * *

graham on 2013-03-28 at 22:08 said:

I'm sorry to hear about the snag. Dante's 'metaphysics of dueling' appear to be true, but one must still take in the church's view of duels, judicial and otherwise, which, from what I've read, has been unfavourable, though other ordeals have met with cautious approval. Nevertheless I will see if we cannot look more into his technique.

Cologero on 2013-03-28 at 23:27 said:

Vico provides an interesting justification for the duel. At the time, society provided for social disputes but not for disputes between individuals of the same rank. It was presumed that noble men would not lie. Now the purpose of a judge is to adjudicate disputes; but if both sides are telling the truth, on what basis can the judge make a judgment? If the disputants cannot resolve the issue between themselves, then the duel is the solution. It does have a certain logic. Clearly, it is not the Hollywood depiction of the duel that can only see hot tempers or evil wills.

Saladin on 2013-03-31 at 11:45 said:

Cologero said 'For both of them, it was always “politics first”.

I don't know Maurras (and frankly don't care) but why would you think Evola put politics first? Certainly he was not a Sannyasin and he definitely valued politics and engaged in it, but as far as I know he put Transcendence first and was well aware to which domain politics belonged.

Cologero on 2020-03-28 at 08:01 said:

Saladin, Evola falsely believed the priestly caste was subservient to royalty. There was no reference to “transcendence” which you needlessly injected into the discussion. The proper domain of the political – i.e., temporal power – is to be subservient to the Spiritual Authority. It is not obvious that Evola accepted that.

1.7 Reaching a Grand: 1000 posts

We reached 1000 posts yesterday.

That is almost 1.3 million words, enough for at least 10 books or so.

It’s been a wonderful experience. Writing makes ideas clearer than reading ever could.



My One Hope My one hope is that some of you have been motivated to live a fuller life, that is focused on God, love, adventure, intellect, poetry, tradition, and so on. Anything but the deadening effects of consumer society and the destructive and ugly positivist philosophy.

I was at a virtual social event recently, during which one fellow told me his problem: when you have so many subscription services, you have to spend a lot of time deciding what to watch next.

I can assure you that when you are in hospice care, struggling to breathe as your organs fail one by one, or during a sudden death when your life flashes before your eyes, you will not be thinking: “I wish I had watched more TV in my life.” Or, “Doc, please save me, there is a new series on Netflix that I want to watch.”

Don’t squander your human incarnation with trivialities.

Writing Style A basic readability analysis of the posts seems to show that they are written for the 3rd to 10th grade level. Those numbers, however, are based on the number and the length of words, not on the content

of the posts.

This was done deliberately, since complex ideas should be expressed in language as simply as possible, although not simpler. The inability to do so may mask misunderstanding, or it may be used to impress the “professionals”; but erudition is not intellectual knowledge.

Not surprisingly, documents written by lawyers, politicians, or bureaucrats have poor readability numbers. Obviously, that is not because the concepts are so difficult to understand. Rather, it demonstrates an inability to make ideas clear.

The translations also have poor readability numbers. That is because it was the custom of that time to write like university professors, or else a writer would not be taken seriously.

In this regard, Schopenhauer, who always wrote lucidly, is our guide for writing about metaphysics.

Idea Density The best measure for intellectual content is Idea Density. Unfortunately, computer algorithms cannot pick out the number of ideas. The expression of more ideas in the fewest words is the goal; the alternative is just rambling. In practice, this requires simplifying grammar and choosing the more expressive vocabulary word over the more general.

Printing Style The technology of printing limits style. Rock carvings are simple. Even papyrus documents have limitations and sentences were jammed together without punctuation. Much of what is considered good punctuation is due to restrictions of typesetters.

In electronic delivery, we can use ordered and unordered lists, section headers, tables, and so on, to make ideas clear. Space is not an issue and software will take care of layout changes. Many limit themselves to what typewriters could do.

Organization Some comments have point out that the site needs better topical organization. That sounds like a good task. I will try to create a topical table of contents. I am certainly open to suggestions.

Thank you Thanks to all the supporters who have been reading this, writing to me, offering corrections to grammar and facts. It requires a much higher than average intelligence to understand it. Even where you think I am wrong, it still takes intelligence to pinpoint objections.

Charles Peguy had an odd list of three philosophical influences. Junger listed three seemingly incompatible saints. I listed three influences, but they are deeply buried.

Posted on 2021-08-07 by Admin

* * *

Drakonides The Vigilant on 2021-08-08 at 00:10 said:
Congratulations. This blog is in my top 10

yourusernameistaken on 2021-08-08 at 08:44 said:
Please don't stop.

hellomcgrory on 2021-08-09 at 06:27 said:
One of my favourite websites. Thank you.

Niko The Exile on 2021-08-09 at 18:03 said:
Salutations, seeing how knowledgeable man you are i would like to ask you to write something about famous language of the gods, green language(lingue verte) or mostly known as language of the birds which adept Fulcanelli equates with his Phonetic Kabbalah.
Also would like to hear your analysis of Perceval from Chretien de Troyes.

Zebulon Goertzel on 2021-08-09 at 20:28 said:
Thanks Cologero for those of your posts that Inspired me,
It's a shame some of the content on this site is Sleazy.
Would you object if I copied the whole site and edited it into Gornahalal?

Cologero on 2021-08-09 at 21:41 said:

Thanks Zebulon, but you don't have permission to copy it to Gornahahal.

I am in the process of reorganizing and restructuring, so LMK why posts are haram. I am moving some posts to the literary site.

Perhaps I should not have revealed publicly what goes on inside an esoteric school, in which complete honesty is mandatory. Perhaps you need to read more of Ibn Arabi's poetry to understand. I accept that I don't do it as well or as elegantly as he, but I tried. There was no attempt to be "sleazy" for its own sake, but rather to expose the human condition. You may also read Schuon's writings on the Sufis; again, not that I am comparing myself, but only to show that things are not so simple as you might believe.

Rex on 2021-08-11 at 02:53 said:

1001, Guenon.

Rex on 2021-08-11 at 04:04 said:

1001: Guenon

Zebulon Goertzel on 2021-08-11 at 22:58 said:

For example, the paintings with significantly nude women and the explicit stories about Fornication, Alcohol and Gambling... It would be great if there were a Halal button somewhere on the site to filter out the content unsuitable for Muslims... Since the best of your Content is derived from Tradition it shouldn't be too hard to rewrite the same information in a more Islamic way, Inshallah.

Cologero on 2021-08-11 at 23:20 said:

Thanks for the feedback. As they show up on "On this Day", I've been moving them to the literature site. (new decameron) I'll try to be more diligent about it in the future.

Ismo Meinander on 2021-08-25 at 06:08 said:

I keep coming back to this website now and then, and I find the content very good, even if I follow a different path. I used to visit almost daily to read old posts.

I'd love to see more critic and analysis of contemporary civilization – if one can call it that anymore – and what I'd also like would be you to print the most essential content into a book or two; the Gornahoor series or something like that.

Thank you.

Cologero on 2021-08-26 at 07:44 said:

I have no influence on contemporary civilization, so there is no upside to pursue that line right now. Besides, it would most likely be a series of footnotes to this passage from Guenon's "Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power".

Throughout the Western world the bourgeoisie has succeeded in seizing power, in which the monarchy had first improperly involved it. It does not matter, moreover, whether the bourgeoisie then abolished the monarchy as in France, or whether it allowed it to subsist nominally as in England and elsewhere; the result is the same in all cases, and it is the triumph of the "economic", and its openly proclaimed supremacy.

But, as we sink deeper into materiality, instability increases, and changes occur more and more rapidly. Therefore, the reign of the bourgeoisie can only last for a short time, compared to that of the regime which it followed. Furthermore, as usurpation calls for usurpation, after the Vaishyas it is now the Shudras who, in their turn, aspire to domination: this is, quite exactly, the meaning of Bolshevism. We do not want to make any predictions in this regard, but it would probably not be very difficult to draw, from the above, certain consequences for the future: if the most inferior social elements come to power in one way or another, their reign will probably be the shortest of all, and it will mark the last phase of a certain historical cycle, since it is not possible to descend any lower. Even if such an event does not have a wider impact, one can assume that it will at least be, for the West, the end of the modern period.

S.P. on 2021-08-26 at 16:45 said:

After the period exhausts its possibilities, the tortuous stretch of the Antichrist lies ahead. The population that survives the coming conflicts will easily fall under the promises of an earthly paradise that will bring a synthesis between inverted spirituality and transhumanist science. But such is only the external consequence, deep down, each one must overcome the dark age in their own souls. My best wishes.

Ismo Meinander on 2021-09-15 at 10:36 said:

Thank you Cologero for quoting that passage. It seems that this is the way the western world is heading; even after the fall of the Soviet Union, a new line of marxism is making its way into politics and culture, a sort of Communism 2.0, under a different guise yet indistinguishable from bolshevism. Where I live cultural and economic marxism is gaining ground even if the bourgeoisie is trying to fight it.

The "tortuous stretch of the Antichrist" is already here and it is only a matter of time when war breaks out openly. Almost everyone is confused, myself included. Some military professionals have stated that WWII has already started, only its nature is so different from the last two that people generally don't recognize it; one line of the war is the "economic war" that has no less casualties than open armed conflict.

1.8 Secondo Piatto

I never said or thought that different traditions had to or even could merge or assimilate in any way whatsoever, even in their theoretical part. All that is possible and desirable, is a common understanding on a certain ground. This cannot be disputed when one admits that, the truth being one, it is possible to establish equivalences between its various modes of expression. I would further add that communication between various traditional doctrines, under conditions which do not detract from their independence, can only be effectuated from above. Perhaps you have already said that; unfortunately it is not possible for me currently to explain myself as clearly as I would like, especially as it would be very difficult, I fear, to find qualified individuals capable of taking the initiative of an effective rapprochement such as the one I am thinking of. Ultimately, this may come. Never despair.

*Letter from Rene Guenon to Noëlle Maurice-Denis, 30 March
1919*

For the second phase of Gornahoor, I have listened to comments and suggestions. So instead of reprising the same topic in different contexts, I will have a few core topics which will be updated and corrected as necessary. They will be the foundation for everything else.

The twin purposes of Gornahoor are these:

- Restate traditional metaphysics in “western” terms. I use the word in a broad sense to include all areas that were, at one time or another, part of the Roman Empire, which is not at all identical to “European”.
- Update the Path of the Knight for a contemporary context. This is different from exoteric paths or the monk’s way. It is for men of

action, engaged in the world in the search for the Holy Grail. This is the same as the Sophianic path.

Exoteric and Esoteric Spirituality

Jews ask for signs, and Greeks look for wisdom.

I COLOSSIANS 1:22

Consciousness has a history just like any other human manifestation. Esoterically the above quote does not represent two ethnic groups, but serve as types for the historical manifestation of spiritual understanding.

- **Exoteric:** At this level, religious phenomena are experienced as wondrous events, experienceable by the senses.
- **Rational:** Here, extraordinary events are rejected and the physical sciences serve as the model to understand the world. The cost of this, unfortunately, is quite high and requires the rejection not only of free will but of consciousness itself.
- **Esoteric:** At the stage, religious experience is understood by the higher intellect, which regards the senses and mere rational thinking as inadequate.

Keep in mind that the lower cannot understand the higher.

Unity of Metaphysics I don't like the phrase "Transcendent Unity of Religions" since it is unclear and even misleading. Instead, our goal is more precise: To show the compatibility of the metaphysics assumed by Traditional religions. Hence I shall rely, for the most part, on these three sources:

1. *Man and his Becoming* by **Rene Guenon**
2. *An Introduction to Philosophy* by **Jacques Maritain**
3. *Prolegomena to the Metaphysics of Islam* by **Syed Muhammad Naquid al-Attas**

I have no intention to repeat their arguments, but will instead accept their conclusions as established. This task will require some compromises from the three sources.

Forerunners At the first half of the twentieth century, there are several thinkers who have changed our understanding of religious experience. Obviously, this is a personal list, which I have categorized in this way:

- **Sophia:** Vladimir Soloviev, Sergei Bulgakov, Nikolai Berdyaev, Henry Corbin
- **Tradition:** Rene Guenon, Ananda Coomaraswamy, Frithjof Schuon, Mircea Eliade, D T Suzuki
- **Psychology:** Carl Jung (qualified), James Hillman (qualified)
- **Hermetism:** Valentin Tomberg, Boris Mouravieff

I will justify these choices along the way. There are three realms: the material, the imaginal, and the celestial. If the emphasis is solely on the celestial, it can be difficult to relate it to ordinary experience.

Degree of Difficulty This is a difficult path; after all, only 3 Knights found the Holy Grail out of the 150 who started. This is meant for those three. Failure comes from this misunderstanding:

Tradition is a way of life, not a system of thought.

Upcoming Topics

Everything must be conscious, at least potentially, or it does not exist

Anything said or any event must have meaning, otherwise it may as well never have happened.

This is a tentative list of the core topics. Other posts will be inserted from time to time, which may include translations, comments on current events, book and movie reviews, and even recipes. With some exceptions, I will use the word “philosophy” as a more general term for traditional metaphysics, not as profane philosophy in the academic sense.

Bathsheba and the Queen of Heaven The story of Bathsheba will serve as the foundation for the path of Sophia.

Eternal Sophia A review of Henry Corbin’s essay on Jung’s *Answer to Job*, as a revelation of Sophia.

First Principles First principles, common sense, and the divisions of Philosophy

Metaphysical Trinity Vladimir Soloviev, in *Lectures on Divine Humanity*, casually mentions that the idea of the trinity arises from Plotinus. Although it is metaphysically true, its religious and theological expressions are not so simple.

The World Within The world has an inside as well as an outside.

Three Gunas The three forces in the world: positive, negative, and reconciling. The last one can be the most difficult one to discern.

Intellectual Love of God The highest love of God is in the intellect, not in the senses or emotions.

Purpose of Life The purpose of life is not created.

Contemporary Philosophy These are personal interests from academic philosophy, which are not devoid of interest: Nagel's bat, the Chinese box, the Turing Test, and possible worlds.

Living in a Simulation How to determine if we are living in a simulation or a real world.

The Three Body Problem This problem has no computable solution, yet everything moves as expected.

Being and Nonbeing Some light on nonbeing.

Being and Existence Being: that which is; Existence; the act of being.

Substance and Accident What is essential to a being and what is not.

Potentiality and Act Actualization of Being

The Person What is a person?

The Possible and the Real Their metaphysical equivalence.

Degrees of Existence Different states of existence and their relationships.

Descent of Man How the human being descends through the states of being

History of Consciousness From naïve participation, to rationalism, and so on.

Great Being Auguste Comte meets Vladimir Soloviev in a strange but intriguing way.

Saving the Appearances The nature of scientific knowledge.

Unity of Being If Being is the principle of beings, how can there be individual beings?

Justice and Mercy Justice and the works of mercy.

The Common Task and Cosmism: Reflections on Nikolai Fyodorovich Fyodorov.

Posted on 2021-08-22 by Cologero

2.1 Spiritual waterboarding

For Julius Evola, philosophy was never a dry academic discipline, a mincing of words, a defense and attack of various doctrines, or trite rhetoric. For him, it was a matter of self-realisation that transcended the categories of thought, and this by necessity stands above any logic or rationality.

In his *Saggi sull' Idealismo Magico Essays on Magical Idealism*, Evola relates this Hindu story:

A disciple asked his spiritual teacher, while they were bathing in the river, when he would finally be able to realise *Brahman*. The teacher, instead of answering, pushed his head under water and held him down until, feeling himself drowning, the student freed himself and re-emerged. The teacher then explained: “When the desire in you to realise *Brahman* becomes as intense and deep as how you were just driven to reassert your physical life—only then will you achieve satisfaction.”

Evola goes on to explain:

That expresses the whole of magical development: as long as the will and the desire to realise oneself remains in mental shadows, as long as it does not equal, by penetrating into all one's being, the intensity of that obscure and irrational power that is asserted at the core of our organism, there is no point in expecting any concrete result. With some justice, Jacobi noted that man cannot improve himself by means of ideas or reasoning; what he needs is to be organised and therefore to organise himself.

This explains why Evola is often so misunderstood. He is not teaching a new doctrine or recommending a specific religion. Rather, he is trying to awaken in the reader the desire for transcendence, which can only arise in the deepest parts of himself, prior to ideas, rationality, or convention. Without making the interior efforts at such transcendence, Evola's entire scheme will remain opaque.

What follows is the opening paragraph to chapter V of the essays:

The Essence of Magical Development

I said, "You are gods"

JOHN 10:34

What distinguishes magical idealism is its essentially practical character: its fundamental requirement is not to substitute one intellectual conception of the world with another, but rather to create in the individual a new "dimension" and a new depth of life. Certainly, it does turn into an abstract opposition between theory and practice; already in the theoretical and cognitive as such—and therefore in that which only be given to be revealed to a reader—it sees a level of creative activity, therefore it holds that such a level represents only an outline, a beginning of an effort in respect to a phase of deeper realisation, which is that of magic or

practice properly called, in which the former must be continued and fulfilled. The lowering of the “being” of ontology and gnoseology to a “having to be” and the development of the activity of the judgment of value, into which the same theoretical judgment is accordingly transformed, until the judgment of existence, to a cosmically creative act of faith, such is the essence of the present doctrine. Whoever therefore does not know how to convert the principles of magical idealism into power agents in his interior being, to profound needs that impel him towards a concrete and living realisation, he kills that idealism by the tritest rhetoric. The one who can truly say to himself: “If magic didn’t exist, today I must create it by myself”, is rather welcome here.

Posted on 2007-12-20 by Cologero

2.2 Men and Ideas

The intrinsic value of an idea and a system must be judged in itself, apart from everything that is part of the world of contingencies. However, from a practical and historical point of view, what is decisive is the quality of the men who make themselves the promoters and defenders of that idea and that system.

JULIUS EVOLA

Posted on 2008-08-23 by Aeneas

2.3 Maurras and Dumézil

Early in his career Dumézil was involved with Charles Maurras and the Action française. In his biography *Maurras: Le chaos et l’ordre*, Stéphane Giocanti describes their relationship and the influence that Maurras had over Dumézil. A translation of the relevant passage follows:

... in the 20s, and up until its final decline, Action Française regularly attracted new spirits, notably among students: Jacques Isorni, Tixier-Vignancour. Around 1925, Pierre Gaxotte introduced Maurras to George Dumézil, who would have a huge career as an historian and anthropologist. Maurras took them both on as secretaries, one for the day shift, the other for the night.

Author of a doctoral thesis on “The Banquet of Immortality”, Dumézil wrote for *La Revue universelle* and *L’Action française*, since 1920, notably articles on “monarchical and dynastic principles” which were not without agreement with his later thought. His brief correspondence with Maurras attests to a deferential and friendly relationship. In May 1925, he told Maurras about his engagement. “I will go to see you in two days, after a last stop in Dijon. But I am eager to inform you right away because on Saturday or Sunday I am leaving for Prague and I would not forgive myself if I caused any neglect in the office. Maurras sent his wishes for a good trip. In September, while Dumézil was in Turkey where he wanted the chair of the history of religions, Maurras had sent him his latest books: “My dear master, your books, your two books were waiting for me at the Sarmatians. ... They are going to shake up the sweet barbaric dust and give me the taste and the strength for battle. You satisfy me with healthy favours that I will try some day to recognize. ... ”

Beyond the anecdotal aspects of this relation, we can ask about Dumézil’s debt to Maurras. We know that the historian would elaborate some comparative methods to throw light on the depths of the human spirit, by exposing their laws, structure, and hierarchies. He had a scientific spirit. Maurras, in developing the birth and the triumph of reason in classical Greece and in showing its centrality in European civilisation, was a poet-archaeologist of the human spirit. Instead of proceeding scientifically, *Anthinéa* proceeds by means of a blend of mythography, art, and philosophy. The reader only gets to a piece of philosophical anthropology

through aesthetic, historic, and political meditations. Dumezil is therefore a son of *Anthinéa*, *a fortiori* when he asserts that the results of his research have an interest “more aesthetic than scientific” that is, far from materialism. In spite of the prudence this formidable erudite would observe after dealing with accusations, Maurras (not certainly the polemicist, but the thinker of the ancient world) can be considered as one of the intercessors of his thought and a founding authority in the formation of his anti-German and anti-Nazi prejudice.

Posted on 2008-04-10 by Cologero

2.4 Montesquieu on the betrayal of truth

From Montesquieu's *Spirit of the Laws*

Dans les monarchies extrêmement absolues, les historiens trahissent la vérité, parce qu'ils n'ont pas la liberté de la dire : dans les Etats extrêmement libres, ils trahissent la vérité à cause de leur liberté même, qui, produisant toujours des divisions, chacun devient aussi esclave des préjugés de sa faction, qu'il le serait d'un despote.

In absolute monarchies, historians betray the truth because they lack the freedom to say it. In politically free countries, they betray the truth because of their very freedom which then produces factions so that each one becomes a slave of his faction, which, for him, is equivalent to a despot.

I suppose it is pointless to comment since Montesquieu says it as well as it can be said. It is as useless to implore partisans to reject their partisanship as it would be to command the waves to recede. Partisans are under the sway of *thymos*, which is the blind will to “dominate”; philosophers are dominated by *nous*, the pursuit of wisdom.

Posted on 2008-04-12 by Cologero

2.5 Siddhartha on setting goals

When you throw a stone into the water, it finds the quickest way to the bottom of the water. It is the same when Siddhartha has an aim, a goal. Siddhartha does nothing; he waits, he thinks, he fasts, but he goes through the affairs of the world like a stone through the water, without bestirring himself; he is drawn and lets himself fall. He is drawn by his goal, for he does not allow anything to enter his mind which opposes his goal... Everyone can perform magic, everyone can reach his goal, if he can think, wait and fast.

HERMAN HESSE, *Siddhartha*

Posted on 2008-04-28 by Cologero

2.6 We Hyperboreans

Let us face ourselves. We are Hyperboreans; we know very well how far off we live. “Neither by land nor by sea will you find the way to the Hyperboreans” ... Beyond the north, ice, and death — *our* life, *our* happiness. We have discovered happiness, we know the way, we have found the exit out of the labyrinth of thousands of years. Who else has found it? Modern man perhaps? “I have got lost; I am everything that has got lost,” sighs modern man.

This modernity was our sickness: lazy peace, cowardly compromise, the whole virtuous uncleanness of the modern Yes and No. This tolerance and *largueur* of the heart, which “forgives” all because it “understands” all, is sirocco for us. Rather live in the ice than among modern virtues and other south winds!

We were intrepid enough, we spared neither ourselves nor others; but for a long time we did not know where to turn with our intrepidity. We became gloomy, we were called fatalists. Our *fatum* — the abundance, the tension, the damming of strength.

We thirsted for lightning and deeds and were most remote from the happiness of the weakling, “resignation.” In our atmosphere was a thunderstorm; the nature we are became dark — *for we saw no way*. Formula for our happiness: a Yes, a No, a straight line, a goal.

FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE

Posted on 2008-05-14 by Aeneas

2.7 Morality is for Other People

Morality is for other people. I always have a perfectly good excuse for whatever I do.

Posted on 2008-05-20 by Anonymous

2.8 Know Thyself

From the essay *Know Thyself* by **Rene Guenon**:

We see that real knowledge is not based on the path of reason, but on the spirit and the whole being for it is none other than the realization of this being in all its states, which is the culmination of knowledge and the attainment of supreme wisdom. In reality, what belongs to the soul, and even to the spirit, represents only degrees on the path toward the intimate essence that is the true self; this self can be found only when the being has reached its own center, all its powers being united and concentrated as in a single point the “I” in which all things appear to it i.e., as representations, since they are contained in this point as in their first and unique principle; thus the being is able to know everything

as in itself and of itself, as the totality of existence in the oneness of its own essence.

When man knows himself in his deepest essence, that is, in the center of his being, then at the same time he knows his Lord. And knowing his Lord, he at the same time knows all things, which come from Him and return to Him. He knows all things in the supreme oneness of the Divine Principle, outside of which ... 'there is absolutely nothing which exists,' for nothing can be outside of the Infinite. that is, there is no "thing" that opposes itself to me.

Posted on 2008-07-09 by Cologero

2.9 Informers and Journalists

'Informer' ... means one who gives information. It means what 'journalist' ought to mean. The only difference is that the Common Informer may be paid if he tells the truth. The common journalist will be ruined if he does.

G.K. CHESTERTON, *Utopia of Usurers*

Posted on 2008-08-02 by Anonymous

2.10 The Cosmos as Spectacle

The ethical view of the universe involves us at last in so many cruel and absurd contradictions, where the last vestiges of faith, hope, charity, and even of reason itself seem ready to perish, that I have come to suspect that the aim of creation cannot be ethical at all. I would fondly believe that its object is purely spectacular;

a spectacle for awe, love, adoration, or hate, if you like, but in this view — and in this view alone — never for despair!

Those visions, delicious or poignant, are a moral end in themselves. The rest is our affair — the laughter, the tears, the tenderness, the indignation, the high tranquillity of a steeled heart, the detached curiosity of a subtle mind — that's our affair!

And the unwearied self-forgetful attention to every phase of the living universe, reflected in our consciousness may be our appointed task on this earth—a task in which fate had perhaps engaged nothing of us except our conscience, gifted with a voice in order to bear true testimony to the visible wonder, the haunting terror, the infinite passion, and the illimitable serenity; to the supreme law and the abiding mystery of the sublime spectacle.

JOSEPH CONRAD, *A Personal Record*

Posted on 2008-08-08 by Cologero

2.11 Man's Curious Idiosyncrasy

It is one of man's curious idiosyncrasies to create difficulties for the pleasure of resolving them. The mysteries that surround him on all sides are not sufficient for him; he still rejects clear ideas and reduces everything to a problem by some inexplicable twist of pride, which makes him regard it as below him to believe what everyone believes.

JOSEPH DE MAISTRE, *Study of Sovereignty*

Posted on 2008-08-26 by Cologero

2.12 Aquinas on Trade with Foreigners

For the country which needs considerable imports for its support must tolerate continuous intercourse with foreigners ... who, having been brought up under different laws and customs, behave in many way differently from the inhabitants of the country, so that these latter are spurred on to act similarly, and social life is disturbed. Again, if the citizens devote their lives to trade, the way will be opened to many vices. For, since the aim of traders is especially to make money, familiarity with trade leads to the awakening of greed in the hearts of the citizens. The result is that everything in the State will be put up for sale, mutual confidence will be destroyed and an atmosphere favourable to deceit and fraud created. Everyone, growing careless about the Common Good, will seek only his own advantage. The cultivation of virtue will decline, since honour, the reward of virtue, will be bestowed indiscriminately upon all comers. Hence, in such a State, social morality will inevitably suffer.

ST. THOMAS AQUINAS, *The Governance of Princes*

It is clear that Aquinas is criticizing making trade and economics the primary end of society. Even the bishops today, ignoring their Thomist heritage, see everything in economic terms and ignore the resulting social disruption. For Aquinas, on the other hand, the social disruption arising from the “continuous intercourse with foreigners” is the most important consideration. This shows how far the Vatican II Church has moved from Tradition ... apart from their peculiar animus against abortion, they reveal themselves to be *modern* men in every other regard.

It is tempting to say that the quoted passage is pure prophecy, as it has all come to pass. However, it is really the result of clear and rational thought.

Posted on 2008-08-28 by Cologero

* * *

Arturo Vasquez on 2010-05-21 at 20:19 said:

Then America must be screwed, since we are all immigrants here.

Cologero on 2010-05-22 at 11:37 said:

Mr. Vasquez, this blog takes no position on political issues, unless at some future date, they align with the proper direction of the world process. Also, as philosophers, our individual personal situations are of no concern; circumstances have brought us where we are, so that is where we must begin. In the Kali Yuga, our task is to deal with our situations and circumstances, however deviant from the idea.

Nevertheless, that does not absolve us from the task to understand our situations and circumstances dispassionately and intellectually. So a careful reading of Aquinas shows he puts not blame on "immigrants", but rather on the greed for money and the subsequent social disruptions that arise from it.

In the case of America, these disruptions affect the immigrants as much as the original populations, since the former are both economically exploited and deprived of their social networks. An unfortunate side-effect is the re-emergence of tribalism.

The economic and tribal factors mitigate against the notion of the common good, which is the moral principle for a nation.

The economic motive prefers the particular good over the common good.

The tribal motive prefers the good of the subgroup over the common good.

This is undeniable and if anything will "screw" America, that will be the cause, not immigrants per se.

Although we see the clan, tribe, nation as natural human developments, we do not regard them as absolute. Rather we are in favour of Empire, or cosmopolitanism, under the guiding spirit, with nations and tribes hierarchically arranged. This will have to be left as a topic for a future post, but it will be in the direction of the Roman Empire under the man-god Caesar, and the Holy Roman Empire under the God-man.

2.13 Schopenhauer on Christianity

The myth of the Fall of man is the only thing in the Old Testament to which I can concede a metaphysical, although only allegorical, truth: indeed it is this alone that reconciles me to the

Old Testament. Thus our existence resembles nothing but the consequence of a false step and a guilty desire. New Testament Christianity, the ethical spirit of which is that of Brahmanism and Buddhism, and which is therefore very foreign to the otherwise optimistic spirit of the Old Testament, has also, extremely wisely, started from that very myth ... The innermost kernel and spirit of Christianity is identical with that of Brahmanism and Buddhism.

The spirit and ethical tendency, however, are the essentials of a religion, not the myths in which it clothes them.

Therefore, I do not abandon the belief that the teachings of Christianity are to be derived in some way from those first and original religions i.e., Brahmanism and Buddhism But in virtue of this origin, Christianity belongs to the ancient, true, and sublime faith of mankind. This faith stands in contrast to the false, shallow, and pernicious optimism that manifests itself in Greek paganism, Judaism, and Islam.

ARTHUR SCHOPENHAUER

Schopenhauer was a student of the *Upanishads*, since he found those works — along with those of Buddhism — to be compatible with his philosophical outlook. What may be less well known, is that he put Christian mysticism, at least that based on a Neoplatonic outlook which was very influential in the early church, in the same class. Unlike the many *cultured despisers of religion*, Schopenhauer looked past the dogmas, and instead focused on the mental and spiritual attitudes engendered by a religious system.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=kLyRoKzUCaA>

Posted on 2009-08-06 by Cologero

* * *

OMAR (@OAS94) on 2019-09-10 at 23:14 said:

Completely taken out of context. It is well known that Schopenhauer despised Christianity (Abrahamic religions in general)

OMAR (@OAS94) on 2019-09-10 at 23:18 said:

"But if any one should believe for this reason that European morals have improved proportionally, and that now at any rate they surpass what obtains elsewhere, it would not be difficult to demonstrate that among the Mohammedans, Gnebres, Hindus, and Buddhists, there is at least as much honesty, fidelity, toleration, gentleness, beneficence, nobleness, and self-denial as among Christian peoples."

On the Basis of Morals, Schopenhauer

OMAR (@OAS94) on 2019-09-10 at 23:20 said:

"Indeed, the scale will be found rather to turn unfavourably for Christendom, when we put into the balance the long list of inhuman cruelties which have constantly been perpetrated within its limits and often in its name. We need only recall for a moment the numerous religious wars; the crusades that nothing can justify; the extirpation of a large part of the American aborigines, and the peopling of that continent by negroes, brought over from Africa, without the shadow of a right, torn from their families, their country, their hemisphere, and, as slaves, condemned for life to forced labour; 2 the tireless persecution of heretics; the unspeakable atrocities of the Inquisition, that cried aloud to heaven; the Massacre of St. Bartholomew; the execution of 18,000 persons in the Netherlands by the Duke of Alva; and these are but a few facts among many."

On the basis of morals

Cologero on 2019-09-10 at 23:35 said:

Gee whiz, Omar. You need to stay away from the Bronze Age Pervert. What do you bench?

Intelligent readers will recognize that the quote was entirely in context. The teachings cannot be judged by the crimes of its nominal adherents.

Tom on 2021-12-21 at 22:07 said:

Who is the "Bronze Age Pervert"?

2.14 The Art of Controversy

What is required is not the courage of one's convictions, but rather the courage for an attack upon one's convictions.

FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE

Although discussions of deep and complicated issues are difficult in person, they are especially problematic on the Internet. There is the tendency to excessive polemics, which manifests as the propensity to defend a particular opinion rather than to be challenged to reconsider one's own opinion. This often results in the magnification of rather small differences.

As Evola points out in *The Individual and the Becoming of the World*¹, growth in consciousness requires a self-emptying of all our opinions, whether from everyday life, religion, or science.

If anyone in a discussion with us is not concerned with adjusting himself to truth, if he has no wish to find the truth, he is intellectually a barbarian. That, in fact, is the position of the mass-man when he speaks, lectures or writes.

JOSÉ ORTEGA Y GASSET

Clearly the intent to find the truth must be there. Then it is possible to advance. The mass-man seems to think that is sufficient to say "I believe this" or "I think that" without any warrant. Oddly enough, this is usually the position of those who ostensibly reject "egalitarianism" as such, yet remain staunchly egalitarian in the intellectual realm.

In the following selection from *The Art of Controversy*, Schopenhauer proposes some guidelines for discussion. A small group of philosophical friends can engage in worthwhile discussions, with those ahead

¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/individual/index.htm>

leading those behind. **This would be the seed for the formation of an *elite* given the right circumstances and right motivation.** For the rest, I wish you peace, the peace to go to sleep every night secure in your beliefs.

As a sharpening of wits, controversy is often, indeed, of mutual advantage, in order to correct one's thoughts and awaken new views. But in learning and in mental power both disputants must be tolerably equal: If one of them lacks learning, he will fail to understand the other, as he is not on the same level with his antagonist. If he lacks mental power, he will be embittered, and led into dishonest tricks, and end by being rude.

The only safe rule, therefore, is that which Aristotle mentions in the last chapter of his *Topica*: not to dispute with the first person you meet, but only with those of your acquaintance of whom you know that they possess sufficient intelligence and self-respect not to advance absurdities; to appeal to reason and not to authority, and to listen to reason and yield to it; and, finally, to cherish truth, to be willing to accept reason even from an opponent, and to be just enough to bear being proved to be in the wrong, should truth lie with him. From this it follows that scarcely one man in a hundred is worth your disputing with him. You may let the remainder say what they please, for every one is at liberty to be a fool — *desipere est jus gentium*. Remember what Voltaire says: *La paix vaut encore mieux que la vérité* "Peace is worth more than the truth". Remember also an Arabian proverb which tells us that on the tree of silence there hangs its fruit, which is peace.

ARTHUR SCHOPENHAUER

Posted on 2009-08-09 by Cologero

* * *

x on 2012-04-08 at 15:16 said:

"If anyone in a discussion with us is not concerned with adjusting himself to truth, if he has no wish to find the truth, he is intellectually a barbarian. That, in fact, is the position of the mass-man when he speaks, lectures or writes."

"As a sharpening of wits, controversy is often, indeed, of mutual advantage, in order to correct one's thoughts and awaken new views. But in learning and in mental power both disputants must be tolerably equal: If one of them lacks learning, he will fail to understand the other, as he is not on the same level with his antagonist. If he lacks mental power, he will be embittered, and led into dishonest tricks, and end by being rude.

The only safe rule, therefore, is that which Aristotle mentions in the last chapter of his *Topica*: not to dispute with the first person you meet, but only with those of your acquaintance of whom you know that they possess sufficient intelligence and self-respect not to advance absurdities; to appeal to reason and not to authority, and to listen to reason and yield to it; and, finally, to cherish truth, to be willing to accept reason even from an opponent, and to be just enough to bear being proved to be in the wrong, should truth lie with him. From this it follows that scarcely one man in a hundred is worth your disputing with him."

perfect words

2.15 **Life's a Bitch, but she's my bitch so I love her**

Death is certain, the time and manner is not.

BUDDHA

In *Twilight of the Idols*, Nietzsche wrote:

The invalid is a parasite on society. In a certain state it is indecent to go on living... The highest interest of life, of ascending life, demands the most ruthless suppression and sequestration of degenerating life — for example in determining the right to reproduce, the right to be born, the right to live... To die proudly when it is no longer possible to live proudly. Death of one's own

free choice, death at the proper time, with a clear head and with joyfulness, consummated in the midst of children and witnesses.

Nietzsche himself died totally insane, staring out the window in his sister's flat.

Posted on 2009-08-13 by Cologero

* * *

S on 2011-05-11 at 11:32 said:
Only because he knew nobody with any mercy.
Leaving a man like that is torture.

santiago on 2020-01-23 at 01:49 said:

I thought the same thing, recently reading through *The Genealogy of Morals*. In the third essay, section 14, Nietzsche rails against the sick and the invalids, and all who would take pity on them. He likens the sick and the frail to abhorrent malformed and grotesque “physiological distortions and worm-riddled objects!”

The parallels between Nietzsche and the most degraded aspects of the Fascist ideal are worth considering. One can see many parallels between his thought and what would become the artistic and inspirational motifs behind the creation of the National Socialist party (especially his fetishism of unjustified temporal power and the-distanced-respect for the ‘Blonde beast of prey’). I think too often among the far right, the train stops here, and everyday compassion makes way for jaded cut-throat idealism.

Recently I had a death in the family. For a while towards the end, I was entrusted to be his caretaker. The weeks and months leading to this man's death were slow and drawn out to their utmost extreme; he really had strength, that much I can say. But—the confused looks, the constant forgetting of faces and names, the paranoia, the childlike and happy moments, the odd spurts of incredible energy, the anger, the inability to eat or maintain even the slightest trace of equilibrium, the decrepitude and absolute weakness—I will never forget it.

This is nothing new: death has always been an influence in my life. This is not special, everyone experiences death second- and first-hand at some point. How ironic it was that the death of this man was almost immediately succeeded by the considering of “retirement.”

I hope death comes quick, if I'll never see the other side sooner than later.

2.16 Life is the Absence of Sleep

The universality of sin necessitates the universality of purification, which in its turn requires pain to be universal, that the whole human race may be purified in its mysterious waters. This explains why all men born suffer from their birth to their death. Pain is the inseparable companion of life in this obscure valley, filled with our sighs, deafened with our lamentations, and moistened with our tears. Every man is a suffering being, and everything not painful is strange to him. If he fixes his eyes on the past, he grieves to see it vanished; if on the present, he bewails the past as bitter; if on the future, he feels perturbation, because the future is full of shadows and mysteries.

How little soever he considers, he discovers that the past and present and future are all, and all is nothing — the past is gone, the present is rapidly going, and the future has not come. The poor are loaded with fatigue, the rich with indigestion, the powerful with pride, the lazy with weariness, the lowly with envy, and the mighty with disdain. The conquerors who drive the nations, are themselves driven by furies, and only stumble on others because they are flying from themselves. Lust consumes the flesh of the youth with its impure flames; ambition takes the youth, made man, from the hands of lust, and burns him in other flames, and drives him into other conflagrations; avarice seizes him when lust rejects and ambition abandons him; she gives him an artificial life called sleepless; old misers only live because they do not sleep — their life is nothing but the absence of sleep.

JUAN DONOSO CORTÉS (marqués de Valdegamas), *Essays on Catholicism, Liberalism and Socialism*²

Posted on 2009-08-29 by Cologero

²<https://gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf>

2.17 The Absurdity of Socialism

To believe in the equality of all men, when we see them all unequal; to believe in liberty, when we see slavery established in all parts; to believe that all men are brothers, when history tells all are enemies; to believe that there is a common mass of misfortunes and of glories for all men born, when I see nothing but individual glories and misfortunes; to believe I am referred to humanity, when I know humanity is referred to me; to believe that humanity is my centre, when I constituted myself the centre of all; and finally, to believe that I should believe these things, when they are proposed to me by those who tell me that I should believe only my own reason, which contradicts all those things they propose to me, is an absurdity so stupendous, an aberration so inconceivable, that I stand mute and astounded in its presence.

My astonishment increases when I observe that those who affirm human solidarity, deny that of the family, which is to affirm that enemies are brothers, and that brothers should not be brothers; that those who affirm human solidarity are the same who a little before denied the political, which is to affirm I have nothing in common with my own, and all in common with strangers; that those who affirm human solidarity deny religion, though the former cannot be explained without the latter; and from all this I deduce in legitimate consequence that the Socialistic schools are at once illogical and absurd — illogical, because after demonstrating against the Liberal school that some solidarities cannot be accepted while others are rejected, they fall into the same error, accepting one amongst all, and rejecting the remainder — absurd, because precisely the one they proposed to me is not a point of reason but of faith, and because this proposal comes to me from those who deny faith and proclaim the imprescriptable right of reason to empire and sovereignty.

JUAN DONOSO CORTÉS (marqués de Valdegamas), *Essays on*

*Catholicism, Liberalism and Socialism*³

Posted on 2009-08-29 by Cologero

2.18 Manu: The kingdom will surely perish

From the **Laws of Manu** *unexpurgated translation, for what's its worth*

Chapter 4. The rules for a householder

61. He must not live in a country governed by Sudras, nor in one inhabited by impious men, nor in one conquered by heretics, nor in one abounding with men of lower castes.

79. He must not be in the company of outcasts, nor of Chandalas, the lowest of men, nor of mixed races, nor of idiots, nor of men of low class, nor of gravediggers.

Chapter 8

22. A kingdom peopled mostly by Sudras, filled with godless men and deprived of twice-born (Aryan/noble) inhabitants, will soon wholly perish, stricken by hunger and disease.

Posted on 2010-02-02 by Cologero

* * *

³<https://gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf>

Andrew on 2010-02-22 at 15:47 said:
Speaks for itself.

neontradition on 2015-03-08 at 19:34 said:
Fair enough; I shall abide by this. Although I am the lawless One.

2.19 Courage and Fearlessness

The would-be initiate must bring with him a certain measure of courage and fearlessness. He must positively go out of his way to find opportunities for developing these virtues. His training should provide for their systematic cultivation. In this respect, life itself is a good school — possibly the best school. The student must learn to look danger calmly in the face and try to overcome difficulties unswervingly. For instance, when in some peril, he must swiftly come to the conviction that fear is of no possible use: I must not feel afraid; I must only think of what is to be done. And he must improve to the extent of feeling, upon occasions which formerly inspired him with fear, that to be frightened, to be disheartened, are things that are out of the question as far as his own inmost self is concerned. By self-discipline in this direction, quite definite qualities are developed which are necessary for initiation into the higher mysteries.

RUDOLPH STEINER, *Knowledge of the Higher Worlds*

In *Sintesi di dottrina della razza* (Synthesis of Racial Doctrine), Evola included several pages of photographs illustrating various aspects of Aryan men. He included not one, but two, photos of Rudolph Steiner with this caption:

Among the race of the nordic-dinaric body type, we see the solar element differentiating itself, predominantly in the “ascetic”

sense ... The physical traits give the sense of a condition of illumination and a power of spiritual penetration.

Posted on 2010-02-27 by Cologero

* * *

Tom Blanchard on 2014-08-21 at 10:56 said:

"I must not fear. Fear is the mind-killer. Fear is the little-death that brings total obliteration. I will face my fear. I will permit it to pass over me and through me. And when it has gone past I will turn the inner eye to see its path. Where the fear has gone there will be nothing. Only I will remain."

Frank Herbert, *Dune*

_ on 2015-08-17 at 02:27 said:

Overcoming irrational fears would be a good place to start for those like me who are too careful. Think of the fear of sharks, totally irrational but very gripping on the minds of people!

Cologero on 2015-08-17 at 11:59 said:

@swimming with sharks:

You should check this out:

*Qualifications for Initiation*⁴.

Perhaps it is more than just symbolic.

2.20 Russian nihilists and monkeys

The Russian nihilists have a sort of syllogism of their own — man is descended from a monkey, consequently we shall love one another.

VLADIMIR SOLOVYOV

Posted on 2010-03-19 by Anonymous

⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1161>

* * *

Cologero on 2010-03-20 at 08:19 said:

A short paraphrase gives us the motto of White Nationalists: “man is descended from a monkey, consequently white people shall love one another.”

2.2I **Toil, Pain, Death**

Toil, pain, and death are the great auxiliaries that keep humanity from falling into the bottomless abyss of evil.

- Through toil, human beings are preserved from irresolute passivity;
- through pain, they are protected from the danger of excessive subjectivity, because through pain they are reminded of the surrounding world;
- and through death, they are rescued from a complete severance from the spiritual world.

Toil, suffering, and death preserve the human will from passivity, feeling from aloofness, and thinking from obscurity.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

Posted on 2010-03-20 by Cologero

* * *

Cologero on 2010-03-20 at 09:18 said:

According to Tomberg, Zoroaster – the “first Aryan” – in his wisdom, understood the true significance of the fall of humanity. He recognized the “curse” of the father – toil, pain, and death – “as a protective wall against evil.”

2.22 In pain there is something fortifying, manly, and profound

Pain establishes a certain equality between all those who suffer, which is to establish it between all men, for all suffer: by pleasure we are separated, by pain united in fraternal bonds. Pain removes the superfluous, and gives us what we want, and establishes a most perfect equilibrium in man: the proud man does not suffer without losing some of his pride, nor the ambitious man some of his ambition, nor the passionate man some of his anger, nor the impure man some of his impurity.

Pain is sovereign in extinguishing the fires of the passions. At the same time that it removes what injures us, it gives us what ennobles us—the hard-hearted do not suffer without feeling themselves more inclined to compassion, nor the disdainful without feeling more humble, nor the voluptuous without feeling more chaste. The violent become tamed, the weak fortified. No one comes out of that furnace of pain worse than he entered: the greater number come out with sublime virtues they knew not of.

One goes in impious, and comes out religious; another avaricious, and comes out an almsgiver; another without ever having wept, and comes out with the gift of tears; another heart-hardened, and comes out merciful. In pain there is something fortifying, manly, and profound, which is the origin of all heroism and of all greatness; no one has felt its mysterious contact without improving: the child acquires by pain the vitality of youth, youth the maturity and gravity of men, men the bravery of heroes, heroes the sanctity of saints.

DONOSO CORTÉS

Posted on 2010-03-22 by Cologero

* * *

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-29 at 09:41 said:

I want more of this. Recommendations?

Cologero on 2020-09-29 at 22:53 said:

@Tolkein:

It is a passage from *Essays on Catholicism, Liberalism, and Socialism* by Juan Donoso Cortes⁵.

Taivasvaeltaja on 2024-01-27 at 15:20 said:

“Cried the young, cried the old, cried the unmarried men,
the males and females wept, the half-aged boys wept, as well as the boys to them.”

– Kalevala, 49th poem

Let’s say it right at the beginning so that there is no doubt about it: real men cry when the burden of the world becomes too heavy to bear. Gone are the days, fortunately, when a man was not allowed to show his feelings and crying was considered a sign of weakness; real strength and power is to also recognize one’s apparent weakness, because if anything it makes us genuine and whole people. Of course, we immediately hear the Old Testament cries that only sentimental and weak mourners cry, while a real man is some kind of emotionless automaton, and that crying is the job of batteries.

But is this really in any way a new thing, as we might imagine if we were ignorant of history or myths; no, but the matter is ancient. In the mysticism of Christianity, there has been a lot of talk about the gift of tears and how this contributes to our spiritual growth, but we also notice from our very own Kalevala that all its characters sometimes cry from behind their shoulders. The European story, on the other hand, tells that a man met Christ during his travels and asked him what he should do in order to be saved. With his keen spiritual eye, Jesus saw what the man’s problem was and said to him: You must give up your anger, for those who carry anger within themselves will turn into devouring dragons. The best way to tame the raging dragon inside us can sometimes be crying, because it releases the heavy energy that has been pent up inside us, so that our whole being feels like it has been cleansed after crying; energy flows freely again and we can feel as if we have been relieved of a heavy burden – even for a moment.

“For Satan gives them heavy burdens to carry, so that they would feel the relief of bearing the liberating burden of salvation, even for a moment”.

We could only speculate about the mystical dimensions of crying and the gift of tears and, for example, its positive effect on our emotional body, but anyone who knows the subject knows,

⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf>

even without these technical considerations, how liberating and cleansing a good whistle can be.

We can even say that in the raging tears of a true warrior, the world is cleansed of its own part, and even though crying is the culmination of emotions, in the waters of purification there is not a drop of sentimentality left in the end, but pure Joy.

Let's cry.

2.23 Socialism and Christianity

Christianity urges one to give away what is one's own.

Socialism urges one to take what belongs to others.

VLADIMIR SOLOVYOV, *Lectures on Divine Humanity*

Posted on 2010-03-29 by Aeneas

2.24 The Third Testament

In order of succession, the *Gnosis* that Jesus revealed to John, James, and Peter after His resurrection reached Clement of Alexandria (about 160-215) and his direct disciples. Due to the persecutions of the third century, and the troubles that arose in the heart of Christianity after it became the State religion, it became imperative to make it 'hermetic' if it were to survive. Hidden like a treasure buried in the earth, it silently made its way and, like a subterranean stream, flowed from master to disciple and from generation to generation until the present, when it rose to the surface again. Stripped of its occult character, it reappears with its original significance as an esoteric projection into the future taking the form of a *New Covenant*, or, in other words, a *Third Testament*.

The Law of the Old Testament, dictated to Moses on Mount Sinai amid thunder and lightning, took the form of a command.

On the other hand the New Testament was not imposed on human beings, it came to them as *Good News*, and each was free to welcome or reject it. Though of great significance, this difference goes unnoticed. We will try to understand this different attitude of the divine Will in the two cases. This will enable us to penetrate more deeply the true meaning of the *Third Testament*, as well as its message.

BORIS MOURAVIEFF, *Gnosis*, Book Three, VII, IV (1)

Posted on 2010-05-01 by Cologero

2.25 The True Sons of God

- The stone exists
- The plant exists and is living
- The animal lives and is conscious of its life in its concrete states
- Man understands the meaning of life according to ideas
- The sons of God actively realise this meaning of the perfect moral order in all things

VLADIMIR SOLOVYOV, *The Justification of the Good*

Commentary This schema separates Solovyov's system (and *ipso facto* all Traditions) from humanisms. There is a spiritual Kingdom of spiritually aware men that is as different from the worlds of material men as the latter are from mammals.

Posted on 2010-05-22 by Cologero

2.26 To Love the Truth

The coming of the lawless one is by the activity of Satan with all power and false signs and wonders, and with all wicked deception for those who are perishing, because they refused to love the truth and so be saved. Therefore God sends them a strong delusion, so that they may believe a lie, in order that all may be condemned who did not believe the truth, but had pleasure in unrighteousness.

2 THESSALONIANS 2:9-12

Some of us have exhausted ourselves trying to distribute factual information and convince relatives and friends of the truth, to no avail. We ought rather to first teach them to love the truth; only then will God lift His curse from them; only then will they be receptive to the truth.

(In speaking of possessing truth, we say this with humility, vigilant against our own pride, and cognizant that we ourselves still have much to learn, and are as potentially fallible as any other human being).

MICHAEL HOFFMAN

The above passage is from the current issue of Revisionist History⁶, titled **“Judaizing Protestantism” and Neo-Platonic Catholicism in Legend and Reality**. Mr. Hoffman offers up a perspective in opposition to the Hermetic viewpoint of this project. He traces its roots to the Renaissance and the influence of the Talmud on both Catholics and Protestants.

⁶http://revisionisthistorystore.blogspot.com/2010/03/hoffmans-revisionist-store-newsletters_31.html

Although the article is valuable for its historical references, we prefer to think that the Hermetic and Platonic traditions are much more ancient than the Renaissance, are free from anti-Western influences, and represent a valuable gateway to authentic Tradition in the West.

Posted on 2010-06-05 by Cologero

* * *

GFJF on 2010-06-06 at 01:23 said:

Yes, but how? A man must reach a certain level autonomously before he can be brought to love the truth. "If any man come to me, and hate not his father, and mother, and wife, and children, and brethren, and sisters, yea, and his own life also, he cannot be my disciple. And whosoever doth not bear his cross, and come after me, cannot be my disciple . . . whosoever he be of you that forsaketh not all that he hath, he cannot be my disciple."

Cologero on 2010-06-06 at 23:12 said:

In *Stages of Man*⁷, I show the three stages of consciousness described by Evola in the **Individual and the Becoming of the World**. In the first stage, the question of epistemology does not even arise. People believe any old thing and remain unconcerned about the question of truth. If the question engages the consciousness, a man reaches the next stage and looks for truth in various religious and scientific systems. This is a good start, although such a person usually gets bogged down in some ideological system and never progresses to the next stage.

2.27 The Name of the Road

The West no longer knows Wisdom: it no longer knows the majestic silence of those who have mastered themselves, the bright calm of the Seers, the superb "solar" reality of those in whom the idea has made itself blood, life, and power. Wisdom has been supplanted by the rhetoric of "philosophy" and "culture", the realm of professors, journalists, and sportsmen—the plan, the program,

⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=214>

the proclamation. It has succumbed to sentimental, religious, humanitarian contamination, and the race of chatterers who run around madly exalting “becoming” and “practice”, because silence and contemplation frighten them.

JULIUS EVOLA, *Pagan Imperialism*

Which nation honors its philosophers and mathematicians, and which its sportsmen?

The philosopher Auguste Comte gets a major boulevard in Paris, the football coach Don Shula gets an expressway in Miami, but I get an alley in Salemi.

Posted on 2010-06-17 by Cologero

2.28 The Quality Known as Repose

The quality known as *repose* in the ancient Greek is a manifestation of that serenity which belongs to a people not yet disturbed by self-doubt, self-immolation and self-contempt. It is the extreme harmony of a mentality not yet shaken by the tortures of introspection or inner conflict, by what Goethe called ‘two souls throning within one bosom’. The beauty of the Greeks is the beauty of men who have never in their wildest dreams beheld the horrors of Dante’s *Inferno*.

Poorer than the moderns in this respect, they consequently have the bliss which is partly ignorance, and this bliss is revealed in their art. Everything that has appeared in western Europe since the fall of the Roman Empire is certainly less serene, less blissful, more foolish, perhaps, in its wisdom, than was the partial ignorance of the Greeks; but it is more fretful, more nervous, more subterranean and subcutaneous, more full of insight and second sight, and consequently, therefore, more disturbing.

ANTHONY LUDOVICI, *Personal Reminiscences of Auguste Rodin*

Posted on 2010-06-19 by Anonymous

* * *

kadambari on 2010-06-20 at 09:50 said:

“than was the partial ignorance of the Greeks”

Partial ignorance of the Greeks? This is seems a Christian prejudice. Muslims also keep saying that Islam is an improvement over the pagan civilizations—perhaps for Arabs but not for other on whom this religion was imposed. The Greeks did not know the self-loathing that arises from a conception of God as “exteror” and they did not know the “revealed truths” of the semitic faiths that results in guilt and self-loathing. One of my Iranian friends told me how after Islam everything beautiful seemed to disappear from Persia—beauty, song, dance, art (how Islam reminds her of death with its emphasis on covering women in black and distaste for art) and how the Persians kept their identity by not losing their language despite the conversion. It must be the same for Europe. Only someone who does not understand the civilization of the Greeks could think of the fires of hell of Christianity as an improvement. One thinks of what would have happened rather if the semetic faiths never came into being and disrupted civilizations in between. The East and West would have interacted harmoniously. Look at the harmony of the short lived Hellenic-Buddhist civilization in Afghanistan for a while which was then completely destroyed by barbarians. The two cultures interacted harmoniously. The contemplative civilization of the Greeks was destroyed—even the Romans were quite a different peoples—only when Greek ideals resurfaced (even by influencing Christianity) has the Western world created greatness... .Why is it a strength to have self-doubt, self-immolation and self-contempt? Someone please explain? I am a thousand times more enlightened by reading Plato and Aristotle than the Bible (everything that is good in it can already be found in the the older religions such as Hinduism and Buddhism.) I do not see why the route to spirituality has to be via the Christian one and how everything that came earlier needs to be “partial-truths”? However, I realize that Europe has been Christian and that its civilization has been Christian. But to dismiss what came earlier as “lacking” seems to be to lacking in understanding of what came before “Christianity”. However, as one of my Persian friends told me of how she thinks of Islam as something not Persian, but since they have been converted and have lost their old religion, they have no other religion to call their own so they can’t deny this religion as they are left with nothing. I sense that it must be the same way for Europe—especially as the conversion of Europe was total. There was definitely a loss there—which only those pagans still left in the East can sense as they have not lost the pagan heritage... .

Cologero on 2010-06-20 at 12:03 said:

Please be cautious in your reading. Often, a commitment to a certain ideological perspective inhibits one's ability to understand certain passages. The ignorance in question refers to the "tortures of introspection or inner conflict." Ludovici is not commending that lack of "repose" that afflicts the modern.

And just to point out that life and thought are not as simple as ideology assumes, Ludovici claims that "Christianity is merely Platonism for the mob." As a matter of fact, he blames Socrates for the disappearance of beauty in the West, because he exalted the soul and the invisible over the body. In this regard, Ludovici is following a line of thought from Nietzsche.

kadambari on 2010-06-20 at 12:24 said:

they consequently have the bliss which is partly ignorance

You did not answer my question but answer that I hold an ideology. I do not. How is their bliss "ignorance"? Is it not a prejudice on his part to call their art stemming from "ignorance"? I do not have any ideological perspectives. I have merely noticed that it is often common for Muslims and Christians to view their world view as somehow an "improvement" over the pagan one. And of course, the rigorous Christian is often on a higher level than the new age liberal without a doubt.

Cologero on 2010-06-20 at 22:40 said:

I certainly did answer your question about "ignorance". You force me to repeat myself: *The ignorance in question refers to the "tortures of introspection or inner conflict."*

The other point I made, which again you ignore, is that that ignorance which Ludovici refers to has no relationship at all to the alleged superiority of "Christianity". Since that conclusion can be found nowhere in the text itself, then it has to have come from your own presuppositions.

kadambari on 2010-06-21 at 22:55 said:

How can you be so sure that the bliss on their faces is not something superior?

'The beauty of the Greeks is the beauty of men who have never in their wildest dreams beheld the horrors of Dante's Inferno.'

Again why does introspection have to arise from external fears?

Actually the repose reminds me of the serenity you see on the faces of Hindu deities... What if it is trying to express a serenity alien to the Christian mindset?

2.29 Stay Awake during the Night

Difendere un ideale e tenere le posizioni anche se esse dovessero essere posizioni perdute — o per meglio dire: anche quando dovesse essere problematico che coloro che ancora rimarranno a vegliare durante la notte possano incontrare coloro che appariranno nel nuovo mattino.

To defend an ideal and take a stand even if the position is lost — or better said: even when it would be problematic that those who still continue to stay awake during the night will be able meet those who will appear at the new dawn.

JULIUS EVOLA, from *La Vita Italiana*

Posted on 2010-07-03 by Aeneas

2.30 The Metaphysics of Imperfection

One's circle is never closed, one's past is not the future, one's work is never finished ...

... the primitive craftsman leaves in his work something unfinished, and that the primitive mother dislikes to hear the beauty of her child unduly praised; it is “tempting Providence”, and may lead to disaster. That seems like nonsense to us. And yet there survives in our vernacular the explanation for the principle involved: the craftsman leaves something undone in his work for the same reason that the word “to be finished” may mean either to be perfected or to die. Perfection is death: when a thing has been altogether fulfilled, when all has been done that was to be done, potentiality altogether reduced to act, that is the end: those whom the gods love die young. This is not what the workman desired for his work, nor the mother for her child. It can very well be

that the workman or the peasant mother is no longer conscious of the meaning of a precaution that may have become a mere superstition; but assuredly we, who call ourselves anthropologists, should have been able to understand what was the idea which alone could have given rise to such a superstition, and ought to have asked ourselves whether or not the peasant by his actual observance of the precaution is not defending himself from a dangerous suggestion to which we, who have made of our existence a more tightly closed system, may be immune.

ANANDA COMMARASWAMY, *Primitive Mentality*<http://www.gornahoor.net/library/PrimitiveMentality.htm>

This, too, is the practice of the metaphysician. No matter how deep is his understanding or broad his knowledge, there is always something undone: something else to learn, another connection to see, another experience to integrate. The idea that someone can believe in a closed system that encompasses all knowledge, or that the repetition of old practices is totally sufficient, or that the recovery of old beliefs and rites will be the guide for the future are all temptations that too often “lead to disaster”.

Guenon points out that death comes when all one’s possibilities have been exhausted. Even if that death is not physical, it will be spiritual. For as soon as we believe we are spiritually perfect, then we become spiritually dead, no longer able to grow, thrive or pass on an inheritance. The metaphysician is convinced that the Absolute is Infinite, and thus is in no danger of running out of possibilities.

Posted on 2010-07-05 by Cologero

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Arturo Vasquez on 2010-07-05 at 23:11 said:

In Mexico, if you praise an infant for its beauty, you are supposed to to it, lest you give it the evil eye, and it falls ill as a result. This is very common in many cultures, to the point

that children were intentionally scared at times to make them less attractive. There is a certain fatalism at the heart of the cosmos which modern man tends to deny.

Cologero on 2010-07-05 at 23:49 said:

There is a certain fatalism at the heart of the cosmos which modern man tends to deny.

That is probably why modern man praises the imperfect and the unworthy ... he considers that fatalism to be an injustice.

Arturo Vasquez on 2010-07-06 at 07:59 said:

I would rather attribute the praise of the weak and the victim to Christianity, as would Rene Girard. In Christian societies, the victim is always the moral superior of the victor. However, in our own society, this has gotten to a morally grotesque point, where everyone would play the victim out of a sheer sense of social guile. The worst case of this is of course the whole idea of "white man victimhood", but that is another conversation entirely.

Cologero on 2010-07-06 at 08:36 said:

I find it curious that you would misread "the imperfect and the unworthy" as "the weak and the victim". First of all, this blog has often written about the code of chivalry and its obligation to protect the weak (widows, orphans) and the victim of injustice. Apparently I need to emphasize "protect" and not "praise"; the weak and the victim may deserve protection, but why praise? Quite the opposite: it is the knight – the protector and the bringer of justice – whom we praise.

Now to get back to the point I actually did make. The modern world praises the morally imperfect and the spiritually weak. It regards the morally praiseworthy and the spiritually strong as an affront and *ipso facto* an implicit condemnation. Rather than facing up to and correcting one's faults, the modern world, instead, would praise the faulty and condemn the faultless. It regards any inequality as an injustice – the result of a fatalism (a heathen notion) that must be rejected, rather than as the evidence of Providence. The Church (at least prior to V II) never condemned inequality nor did it ever advocate the right to do wrong.

Will on 2010-07-06 at 11:54 said:

Well said, Cologero. The line about the difference between protecting vs. praising the weak highlights one of the inversions of the modern world which you wrote of earlier. I think that, in his own way, this is part of what Nietzsche was getting at in his critique of Christianity. For all his praise of might and ferocity, he also speaks of the proper disposition of the strong and noble man as being one of courtesy and kindness towards the weak and unfortunate.

The analogy of society and the soul from Plato's Republic is also relevant here. The distinction between the strong and weak is somewhat relative. For example, Stephen Hawking is strong in terms of his mathematical ability, but weak in athletic ability. Everyone has their strengths and weaknesses, their talents and shortcomings. So the notion that the strong and noble should be kind to, and protective of, the weaker not only refers to interaction between individuals, but interactions within individuals – the strong parts of the soul showing kindness and understanding to the weak parts, and thus sharing their strength and working to remedy the imbalance.

I think this is the societal ethic that the Christian teachings point to, but in modern times it has become what Nietzsche called the 'society of nurses' – the weak caring for the weak, and banishing all strength. That doesn't work, neither in society nor in the psyche.

Also, 'kindness' here does not necessarily mean 'niceness' and tolerant acceptance. Buddhists distinguish between real compassion – the willingness to do what is necessary based on clear vision and love – and 'idiot compassion' – the mistaken belief that compassion is simply being nice to everyone all the time.

2.31 Past Performance and Wishful Thinking

Past performance is not necessarily indicative of future results. Nevertheless, it is much more reliable than wishful thinking.

Posted on 2010-07-25 by Cologero

2.32 True Diversity

In **East and West**, Rene Guenon makes this fundamental claim:

So long as western people imagine that there only exists a single type of humanity, that there is only one 'civilization', at different stages of development, no mutual understanding will be

possible. The truth is that there are many civilizations, developing along very different lines, and that, among these, that of the modern West is strangely exceptional, as some of its characteristics show.

One should never speak absolutely of superiority or inferiority, without making it quite clear from what point of view the things to be compared are being considered, even supposing that they are comparable. There is no civilization which is superior to the others from every point of view, because man cannot be equally active at the same time in every direction, and because there are some ways of development which seem actually incompatible with one another.

By “stages of development”, Guenon does not mean what Westerners call “progress”. He rejects Enlightenment notions of progress—such as Hegelianism, Marxism and similar schemes—that would force other cultures into some predefined historical pattern. Furthermore, there are groups dedicated to “saving Western civilization”, though what they would save are the more degenerate aspects of that civilization. There is no possibility of an alliance with them.

Posted on 2010-08-18 by Cologero

* * *

kadambari on 2010-08-21 at 10:42 said:

Evola sums up the true dignified, tolerant mind in the Doctrine of Awakening even though it is applied to Buddhism. He is completely on the mark here:

A particular characteristic of the Aryan-ness of the original Buddhist teaching is the absence of those proselytizing manias that exist, almost without exception, in direct proportion to the plebeian and anti-aristocratic character of a belief. An Aryan mind has too much respect for other people, and its sense of its own dignity is too pronounced to allow it to impose its own ideas upon others, even when it knows that its ideas are correct. Accordingly, in the original cycle of Aryan civilizations, both Eastern and Western, there is not the smallest trace of divine figures

being so concerned with mankind as to come near to pursuing them in order to gain their adherence and to “save” them. The so-called salvationist religions-the Erlösungsreligionen, in German-make their appearance both in Europe and Asia at a later date, together with a lessening of the preceding spiritual tension, with a fall from Olympian consciousness and, not least, with influxes of inferior ethnic and social elements. That the divinities can do little for men, that man is fundamentally the artificer of his own destiny, even of his development beyond this world-this characteristic view held by original Buddhism demonstrates its difference from some later forms...

I find the problem with “diversity” is that anyone can write books, does not take much to be a so-called “expert” on something these days, people just want to publish for a career or name, does not matter if they have anything worthwhile to say ; you have too many “cows writing books” (Count Keyserling, *Travel Diary of a Philosopher*) with the result that a great deal of confusion is generated as to what is of superior quality and what is not.

kadambari on 2010-08-21 at 15:52 said:

I meant to say: does not matter if they do “not” have anything worthwhile to say... and “truly dignified”...

Also people do not want to submit to authority these days, even if it is the authority of their betters (not to mention the problem also of the deluded types who think themselves “superior”, in the manner of Lenin’s vanguard elites and cause great harm thereby).

2.33 Ernst Junger on Apoliteia

The following passages are from Ernst Junger’s philosophical-metahistorical novel *Eumeswil*, a book which complements Julius Evola’s *Ride the Tiger* quite nicely.

I am an anarch – not because I despise authority, but because I need it. Likewise, I am not a nonbeliever, but a man who demands something worth believing in. ... Thus I take my duties seriously within an overall context that I reject for its mediocrity. The important thing is that my rejection actually refers to the totality and does not take up within it a stance that can be defined as conservative, reactionary, liberal, ironic, or in any way social.

The lack of ideas or – put more simply – of gods causes an inexplicable moroseness, almost like a fog that the sun fails to penetrate. The world turns colorless; words lose substance, especially when they are to transcend sheer communication. ... Loss of history and decay of language are mutual determinants.

Any man who swears allegiance to a political change is a fool, a *facchino* for services that are not his business. The most rudimentary step toward freedom is to free oneself from all that. Basically each person senses it, and yet he keeps voting.”

If and how far a mind penetrates matter, and whether it grasps the crown of the root from which the details branch off – these things are perceived even in practice.

Man should not be the sun’s friend, but the sun itself. And that he *is*; the mistake lies in his failure to recognize his place, his home, and thereby his right.

Posted on 2010-08-23 by Will

* * *

Simon Friedrich on 2010-09-08 at 12:38 said:

Thanks Gornahoor – always happy when someone else appreciates Jünger’s anarch!
Simon

2.34 Finding Agarttha

In **King of the World**, Guenon documents Christianity’s loss of its primordial Tradition as the gradual break of the link to its spiritual centre. This break occurred in stages following the period called the Middle

Ages. The first break came with the destruction of the Templars, since the Orders of Chivalry maintained a spiritual connection between the East and the West. The Rosicrucians made the effort to continue this liaison. The Renaissance and Reformation completed the break, and the Rosicrucians allegedly retired to Asia. Thus, according to Guenon, no western organisation has maintained full and effective initiatory knowledge. So where does Guenon suggest to look? He turns to two clairvoyants, **Emmanuel Swedenborg** and **Blessed Anne-Catherine Emmerich**.

According to Swedenborg the 'lost Word' must henceforth be sought among the **Sages of Tibet** and of **Tartary**, where the mysterious **Mount of Prophets** of Anne-Catherine Emmerich's vision is also set.

Keep in mind that Guenon is always speaking in terms of knowledge, not its outer form. Don't confuse the seed with the shell.

Posted on 2010-08-25 by Cologero

2.35 **Finis Latinorum**

From the Manifesto of the Rose + Croix, (2 IX 1881) quoted by **Joséphin Palédan** in **Comment on devient Mage** (How to become a Mage). Foretelling the end of the Latin race due to the Barbarian invasion yet to come, in the midst of its own decadence, this is a Manifesto for living among the ruins.

Nous ne croyons pas ni au progrès ni au salut. A la race latine, qui va mourir, nous préparons une dernière splendeur, afin d'éblouir et d'adoucir les Barbares qui vont venir ... Soyons le Tout-Passé en face de Tout-Paris. Soyons l'enthousiasme, en face de la blague. Soyons des patriciens en face de la canaille. *Soyons nous-mêmes*, et que nos personnalité, réfractaires au milieu où se meuvent, triomphent du péché et du public.

We believe neither in progress nor salvation. To the Latin race, which is going to die, we will prepare a final glory, in order to dazzle and soften the Barbarians who are going to come... Let us be “everything that passes” in the face of “high society”. Let us be enthusiasm the face of the joke. Let us be patricians in the face of the rabble. *Let us be ourselves*, and may our characters, resistant in the midst in which they move, triumph over sin and the public.

Posted on 2010-08-31 by Cologero

2.36 Tao and Logos

A conference on the book *Christ the Eternal Tao* by the author **Hieromonk Damascene** is available at Ancient Faith Radio⁸.

Learn how Eastern Orthodox Christian spirituality provides seekers of our day clear guidance on acquiring stillness, overcoming the passions, dealing with thoughts, and cultivating the virtues, as well as precise teachings on spiritual *deception, all of which* guides seekers more safely and surely on the path to communion with God (Tao — Chinese). In the profound mystical and contemplative tradition of the Christian East, seekers are able to go well beyond the realizations in Eastern religions. A long-awaited answer for those who, having turned away from modern Western religiosity, are drawn to the freshness, directness and simplicity of Lao Tzu and eastern philosophies, and at the same time are strangely, inexplicably drawn back to the all-compelling reality of Jesus Christ.

My teachings are very easy to understand and to practice; yet there is no one in the world who is able either to understand or to prac-

⁸http://ancientfaith.com/specials/christ_the_eternal_tao

tice them. This is because my teachings have an originating principle and arise from an integrated system. This is not understood, so I am unknown.

LAO TZU

Of the Logos, which is as I describe it, people always prove to be uncomprehending, both before and after they have heard of it. For although all things happen according to this Logos, people behave as if they have no experience, even when they experience such words and deeds as I explain, when I distinguish each thing according to its constitution and declare how it is. The rest of humanity fails to notice what they do after they wake up just as they forget what they do when asleep.

HERACLITUS

Posted on 2009-10-15 by Cologero

* * *

dagezhu on 2010-02-23 at 08:49 said:

<https://orientem.blogspot.com/2009/01/in-beginning-was-tao.html>
has a similar argument

2.37 Evolution and the Order of Being

The fact the higher forms and types are manifested or revealed following the inferior ones by no means proves that they are the product or creation of the inferior realm. The order of being is not identical to the order of phenomena. The higher, more positive and fuller types and conditions of being exist (metaphysically) before the inferior ones, though they manifest and reveal themselves

after them. This does not mean a denial of evolution; evolution is a fact. But to assert that evolution creates higher forms entirely out of inferior ones — that is, finally out of nothing — means to found a fact on a logical absurdity.

The evolution of inferior types of being cannot by itself alone create superior types, but it does create material conditions and offer the necessary milieu for the manifestation or revelation of the superior. Thus every manifestation of a new type of being is in a certain sense a *new creation*, but a creation which can least of all be designated as a creation out of nothing; for firstly, the natural basis for the birth of the new type is offered by the former one; and secondly, the superior type's own positive contents does not arise out of non-being, but exists from all times. It only enters (at a certain point of the process) into another sphere of phenomena. The conditions of the phenomenon depend on natural evolution; that which is revealed depends on God.

VLADIMIR SOLOVYOV

Posted on 2009-10-31 by Cologero

2.38 It's all one Religion

An old nun in hospital had a good deal of trouble in digesting the fact that I wasn't Christian, no I wasn't; thank God, I wasn't a Protestant, but I wasn't a Catholic either, and I wasn't a Jew, I believed in a more ancient and classical system with a place for Zeus and Apollo. To which with infinite gentleness, she said

“C'è tutta una religione.”

“Oh well, it's all one religion”

EZRA POUND

Posted on 2011-01-14 by Cologero

* * *

Attila on 2012-05-21 at 22:44 said:

Very though-provoking.

The most beautiful – and accessible tradition I know of is Turkish and Iranian Sufism. It's got everything – metaphysical speculation, exquisite music – and most of all – is a LIVING tradition.

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bYINULT0TEU&list=UUDSG8rQDZiCMhjr-TrQI3zg&index=4&feature=plcp>

Charlotte on 2012-05-22 at 09:12 said:

Attila, I recently visited Istanbul, where my first proper conversation (with someone other than drivers, hotel staff, waiters, etc), was with a Sufi called Jesus who reminded me of the simplicity of true faith and said that all my sins would be forgiven!! He managed not to attempt a conversion to Islam, which was somewhat extraordinary under the circumstances, but nevertheless I share your admiration for the way of Beauty even while I am a Christian. Brothers and sisters of one God.

2.39 The Interior Lifelessness of the Nordics

This is a section from *Il Fascismo visto dalla destra*, published by Julius Evola shortly after WWII. As is evident from this paragraph, the process of decay, or progress, depending on your perspective, in the Scandinavian countries, has been going on for quite some time. Obviously, this cannot be attributed to biological racial characteristics. I would like to translate the entire chapter which is a commentary on the Volkisch policies of the third Reich. However, that project is contingent on intelligent discussion of this topic, since biological racists have hijacked a large part of the right, even claiming to represent the values of Tradition, when they are actually examples of the mental deformation Evola criticizes.

That biological aspect had a relevant part and created many illusions because of a mental “scientistic” deformation when they thought that it sufficed to proceed to a prophylaxis and erect barriers against crossing and hybridism, along with more eugenic measures, so that by virtue of it, man, the creator of a superior civilization, vanishes, reappears, and rises again almost automatically. Today, there are populations, such as the Norwegians, Swedes, or Dutch, who are of a high level of racial and even “Nordic” purity, but who interiorally are more or less lifeless *spente*, are spiritually bastardized, deprived of the virtues that characterized them in other times.

Posted on 2011-08-06 by Cologero

* * *

I on 2011-08-09 at 15:14 said:

Nothing could be more true than this. Sentimental chickens dancing to jazz, tango & r'n b combined with arch-materialistic 'pure-blooded nordics' listening to and making rap music, treating their ladies like whores and going around cities and drive-ins with their new cars, that's what it in large parts basically amounts to nowadays. Can't really blame it upon anyone else than themselves.

Spir on 2011-08-10 at 20:18 said:

An examination of the ideas of the various rightist groups that have made active reference to the writings of Evola, and to a lesser extent Guenon, can be disturbing.

Not only a perverted biological racism, loosely defined and sentimental compared to 19th and 20th century Europe's 'scientific' attempts. In addition, there is a demented longing not for Tradition, which is truly unknown to most, but for some kind of ideal 1950s or Victorian era style of society where white men work hard and raise big families and everyone is polite and dresses well, with some folk dancing and improvised ancestor worship thrown in.

This criticism is not offered gratuitously – it should be obvious that we are witnessing the confused attempts of underqualified and sometimes suspect individuals attempting to endorse a restoration 'from the outside'; vain to say the least. These groups are ripe pickings for the real agents of the era.

Here is an example:

"Then, as "money and pleasure" cede to the imperatives of "blood and soil," only the traditions, the way of life, and the genetic principles SIC defining them as a people will matter."

"Genetic Principles"? This is idiotic. They wish to replace materialism of the commodity with commodification of the biological. As though the whole universe of Existence should be subject to the rigidity of the physical world. Great way to set up your own people for an unwinnable battle.

As though these mental deformations were not enough on their own, these groups diminish their small chances of prosperity even further by stimulating the occult war with their attacks on Islam. Their criticism of the behavior of uncouth African and Arab urban youth in Europe is lumped under a generally paranoid criticism of 'Islam' – the reproachment of a whole civilization undertaken by a rag-tag bunch of 'thinkers'. Could anyone with even a pretention to metaphysical understanding be so foolish as to aim such generalized attacks at a traditional civilization without expecting occult repercussions?

Needless to say, Cologero, that your project is an exception.

Perennial on 2011-08-11 at 05:27 said:

I presume, Spir, that your deprecation of Victorian style society stems more from a concern in baseless restorations, than in the thing itself. I personally favour the style of society you describe to a degree, but only if based on realities, and not on some exaggerated moralism.

Spir on 2011-08-11 at 09:17 said:

Perennial, suffice to say that different settings offer different possibilities, and at a certain point one can view all possibilities as neutral; any personal preference is thus acceptable, precisely because it is a preference – people prefer a setting in which they can do what they wish to do.

But in the context of Tradition, an objective standard is raised, and if activist groups agitate for a restoration of the West to resemble conditions one or two hundred years ago, are these groups not simply composed of reactive nostalgic moderns? In and of itself this desire is not illegitimate (especially if we are discussing mere style); however, trying to pass such activism off as 'traditional' betrays a lack of understanding, if nothing more.

To be fair, in the domain of action most need to work with tangible things, and so such social goals as those that I appeared to deprecate might be the only thing many people can really strive to attain. I suggest to such activists that their goals are modest enough to be decoupled from extensive association with the arcane theorists of Tradition without it adversely affecting their pursuits.

I on 2011-08-11 at 12:30 said:

Spir: A few thoughts came to my mind from both of your posts: First of all, I think you are wholly right in your basic evaluation of the rightist groups who are using and more or less distorting Evola and Guénon. They are taking this or that from their thinking and debunking what they don't like or what doesn't inspire them in their partisan actions. This is very dangerous indeed. I think this is also the very thing that the upholders of Tradition have warned about: in the end of the current cycle the counter-initiation will change its tactics from those of the anti-tradition (modernity, liberalism, enlightenment values etc.), and its agents will apparently pose themselves as upholders of Tradition, while in reality working vehemently against Tradition – the latest Borean bomber being somewhat a textbook example of this agency in its most visible form. The more hidden and vicious forces will probably try to collide different factions against each other by inspiring them to use and misuse the thoughts of traditional thinkers: for example taking from Evola his “spiritual racism” and turning it into materialistic, deterministic and biological racism and inspiring irrational hate and violence from this background.

Yet, I think that you somewhat took the “genetic principles” quote out of its context: it is true that genes (materialism, biology) cannot be the basis of this sort of awakening, but it is possible that genes (and other more occult forces traveling in blood and soil of a people) can be to some extent act as catalysts and as the activating biological / phenomenal side of a spiritual awakening. I have to add, though, that this is mere speculation, and if the spiritual principles are not latent but have been thoroughly erased as seems to be the case in most of modern men, who are largely “demos” instead of “ethnos”, then no amount of “superior genes” can help. Only “transcendence within” can, in the last analysis.

Perennial on 2011-08-11 at 13:26 said:

Excellent analysis, Spir and I. I concur whole-heartedly.

Spir on 2011-08-11 at 21:32 said:

I, your observations are sound. There are ways in which a biological base, such as a particular race of the body, can catalyze a spiritual development*. Myths play an important part in conveying the keys and animating the soul. But (with the dominance of demos, as you explain) this can never apply to whole masses of people in our time, only to rare special men, so we would see further deformations or lukewarm possibilities if activists attempted to mobilize masses around this idea; the generality of people do not even need to know that these horizons exist.

Yet, on the mundane plane, if a people want to coalesce around a shared biological heritage, and/or customs, this is not an absolute error. From the highest vantage, the Origin, one can point out omissions and shortcomings (human affairs are small from on high); but if a group has established goals particular to some limited domain, and feels that it has the means to attain them, then this special criticism can be ignored.

*Not only biological, but even social and other individual factors; since these factors pre-

dominate in the life of the person, and the person is (or more accurately, appears to be) the point of departure for spiritual development, any combination of factors can catalyze the commencement of spiritual development where it is destined. Thus, there is not such an urgent need to impose reforms modeled on the ideal society; a less lifeless reaction to turbulent times involves opening new paths.

Admin on 2018-08-06 at 12:51 said:

Looking back at these older posts, I find it curious that there are no longer any discussions in the comments.

2.40 Signs of Intelligence

Imagine, as philosophers postulate,
that the earth is another moon:
then we're all lunatic and vertiginous
within a sublunary maze. Can you doubt it?

EVAN S CONNELL, *Points on a Compass Rose*

Posted on 2012-02-01 by Cologero

* * *

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-02 at 05:01 said:
excellent, best post yet, lol! and the answer is.... a GSOH :-))

H00 on 2012-02-02 at 07:30 said:

Interestingly I find this to be one of the worst posts yet and not a sign of intelligence.

"As for life after death, the Vedic solution is fully consonant with the oldest Aryo-Hellenic spirit: images of obscure hells are almost entirely absent from the most ancient parts of the Vedas; the crisis of death is hardly noticed as such-in the Atharva Veda it is even considered as the effect of a hostile and demoniacal force that, with suitable rites, can be repulsed."

Cologero on 2012-02-02 at 08:53 said:

And who, today, is performing those suitable rites?

uberman on 2012-02-02 at 09:51 said:

Just as important a question is What are those rites?

A forth option for the last: the Individual who is still living yet has transcended death. The diamond thunder-bolt body of the immortal conqueror of the serpent hydra. Thus self-mastery complete.

H00 on 2012-02-02 at 09:53 said:

Haha, I don't know, nor would we probably know if anyone was doing so as it seems a rather secluded matter. However I do intend to, and everything else on earth seems like a joke in comparison.

Anyway, "There are, however, spiritual movements wherein people are tied by liberty. People are free to join this spiritual family. No exterior determination forces them to become brothers. Back in the day when it was expanding and converting, Christianity was a spiritual movement that people joined out of the common desire to spiritualize their lives and overcome death." –Mircea Eliade, 1937

"Nolite timere eos qui corpus occidunt, animum autem occidere non possunt" Matt 10:22
"Guénon interpreted the Latin word 'Amor' as 'a-mors' (without death)"

Gabe Ruth on 2012-02-02 at 10:42 said:

I guess we're not intelligent, H00.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-02 at 11:37 said:

For one reason or another I'm put in mind of an art history class from MANY moons ago, where we were studying ancient sculpture. Without organising an impromptu lecture I can recommend researching the meaning behind the 'Archaic Smile'. I've even got a verse about it within the epic Myth:

Now does Hermes turn. Archaic
Is his smile. Osiris sees this,
Sees within it Thoth the Ancient
Science Master, Time Atomic.

Looks he, now – the one – at Hermes,
Thinks into his mind the verdict,
Weighs the words, the vital message.
Mount Olympus quaked to hear it.

I shall not deny the Certain
 Things, these things shall be conceded –
 Such as sharing life-eternal –
 This, I think, by law, is needed.

Through the gift of sacred music,
 Orphic guides shall spring forever
 In the minds and hearts of humans,
 Everflowing love around them.

And so it goes on... ..

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/archaic-smile>

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-02 at 11:50 said:

Here's another one for you Hoo, seeing as you've migrated East (not a bad idea, I've often thought of moving to India, I love the place):

From the swelling seas, un-silent,
 Rising from the salt, through ether,
 Neptune holds aloft his trident,
 Cries: "The Spring has come; be patient!

As the centre of his offspring
 Glows – outraged to so be lectured –
 So much wisdom of the ages
 Flows from father-ocean's lectern:

"Take some good advice, Orion:
 Watch and learn the way of heaven;
 Time just moves around in circles,
 From the fish becomes a turtle."

"Onward then in time, a deluge
 Caused a boar to swim the ocean;
 Then the lion, Narasimha
 Came before the dwarf Vamana.

"Then to life a noble hero

Sprang and rid the world of tyrants.
This made way for Rama's charm,
Which came before the Bhagavad Gita.

"In this way the prince of paupers
Broke the wheel of earthly suffering;
Maybe, son, you'll hear him teaching
In the realm of endless loving..."

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-02 at 11:55 said:

Needless to say Orion refuses to listen and presses on with his plan to raise an army from the ranks of constellations, which does not succeed either...

"Will you see, great Herakles
That we are stronger, still, together,
Strong enough to reach Elysium;
Gods are great, but we are better?"

However he DOES get his revenge sooner or later, but only when he wakes up, remembers who he is and is marvellously rescued by his... wife... ..

uberman on 2012-02-02 at 19:57 said:

HOO said: "Haha, I don't know, nor would we probably know if anyone was doing so as it seems a rather secluded matter. However I do intend to, and everything else on earth seems like a joke in comparison."

Yes it is really that simple, and I share your sentiment about the joke of it all. In essence, nothing matters but that which is directed towards the transcendent. All aims of life should point vertical from state to individual and all else besides is transitory and meaningless (at least it seems this way to me). In light of that understanding, why waste time in meddling amongst the yentas?

It brings more power to the thought that Evola had penned: (to paraphrase) "Necessity is an evil".

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-03 at 02:53 said:

'meddling amongst the yentas'... ..
charming but typical :-)

HOO on 2012-02-11 at 11:18 said:

“... the Devas, in their fight against the Asuras, protect themselves (achhandayan) by the recitation of the hymns of the Veda, and that it is for this reason that the hymns received the name of chhandas, a word which denotes “rhythm.” The same idea is contained in the word dhikr which, in Islamic esoterism, is used of rhythmic formulas that correspond exactly to Hindu mantras. The repetition of these formulas aims at producing a harmonization of the different elements of the being, and at causing vibrations which, by their repercussions throughout the immense hierarchy of states, are capable of opening up a communication with the higher states, which in a general way is the essential and primordial purpose of all rites.” Guénon, “The Language of the Birds”

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-11 at 13:25 said:

Seeing as you mentioned birds I'm bound to draw attention to one of the most wonderful poems ever written, Attar's Bird Parliament. Here's a bit to remind us!

One night from out the swarming city gate
Stept holy Bajazyd, to meditate
Alone amid the breathing fields that lay
In solitary silence leagues away,
Beneath a Moon and Stars as bright as Day.
And the Saint wondering such a temple were,
And so lit up, and scarce one worshipper,
A voice from Heav'n amid the stillness said:
“The Royal Road is not for all to tread,
Nor is the Royal Palace for the rout,
Who, even if they reach it, are shut out.
The blaze that from my harim window breaks
With fright the rabble of the roadside takes;
And ev'n of those that at my Portal din,
Thousands may knock for one that enters in.

H00 on 2012-02-11 at 18:45 said:

Excellent poem.

White Rabbit on 2015-11-21 at 22:14 said:

I imagine Dante in English gets “lost in translation”

H00 on 2019-08-20 at 22:50 said:

Aside from one false dichotomy, I must say that I have changed! The opening post is a good post.

2.41 Truth and Reality

And the independent reality of the individual, when we examine it, is in truth mere illusion. Apart from the community, what are separate men? It is the common mind within him which gives reality to the human being, and taken by himself, whatever else he is, he is no human ... If this is true of the social consciousness in its various forms, it is true certainly no less of that common mind which is more than social. The finite minds that in and for religion form one spiritual whole have indeed in the end no visible embodiment, and yet, except as members in an invisible community, they are nothing real. For religion, in short, if the one indwelling spirit is removed, there are no spirits left.

FRANCIS HERBERT BRADLEY, *Truth and Reality*

Posted on 2012-07-30 by Cologero

* * *

zero is zero on 2012-07-31 at 21:54 said:

"For Julius Evola, on the other hand, ultimate reality is the Absolute Individual." I think he would only have called it that during his early philosophical period which he later rejected in favor of 'Tradition'. Evola's later position on the question of individuality is in chapter 16 of *Ride The Tiger* and seems very close to Guenon's in the letter you are referring to.

2.42 The Sane Man believes in God

L'uomo sano crede in Dio e nella libertà del suo spirito. Anche senza rendersene conto, presuppone l'uno e l'altra, in ogni suo

atto e in ogni sua parola. A cominciare dall'idea medieval, che è poi l'idea classica or greca, di Dio come *esse quo maius cogitari nequit* o essere perfettissimo o assoluto, fino al più elevato concetto Cristiano di Dio come assoluto spirit che s'incarna nell'uomo e lo riscatta dalle sue tendenze naturali, la divinità è presente in tutti i suoi apetti essenziali dentro alla intelligenze e al cuore d'ogni uomo, come incrollabile realtà, che resiste ad ogni dubbio e negazione, e perciò mai non fallisce, e regge tutte le cose e insieme il pensiero e la volontà degli uomini, quasi presupposto di ogni essere che esista e di ogni evento che accada.

GIOVANNI GENTILE, *Introduction to Philosophy*

The sane man believes in God and in the freedom of his spirit. Even without realizing it, he presupposes them both, in his every act and in his every word. Beginning with the Medieval idea, which is also the classical or Greek idea, of God as *the being of which nothing greater can be thought*, or the most perfect and absolute being, up to the most elevated Christian concept of God as the absolute spirit that is incarnated as man and redeems him from his natural tendencies, divinity is present in all his essential aspects within the intelligence and the heart of every man, as unshakable reality, that resists every doubt and negation, and therefore never fails, and supports all things and concurrently the thought and the will of men, as though the prerequisite of every being that exists and every event that occurs.

Posted on 2013-03-28 by Cologero

* * *

Logres on 2013-03-28 at 23:51 said:

That's funny: I just got through musing aloud to my wife as to why some very "noble" and "good" people resist a belief in God: I suppose I conclude that somewhere, deep down, they

know that would require a change or present a challenge or expose superstructures they would prefer not exposed. It's a very, very sore spot for them, and it continually amazes me how so many simple folk accept it, and so many intellectuals write pages and pages of narrative to show why morality and Being do not require the Christian God (or any other, presumably) for their existence. This is, in a sense true, in the sense that men can live in contradiction.

Cavalcare on 2013-03-29 at 19:14 said:

Why should I 'believe' in God? why should I not *know* Him instead? why this dogmatism, in relation to the Christian God (what is the "Christian God"?)? there is more than one path to the peak of the mountain.

Cologero on 2013-03-29 at 22:46 said:

You may be on to something, Cavalcare, or you may be missing the point. Although I have alluded to a project of translating two chapters of Evola, I didn't put this post in that context. We will see why Evola objected to Gentile's program, but first it is necessary to describe it. I also pointed out that Gentile's philosophy, in Evola's perspective, was close to being a way of realization, yet fell short. I can't cover all aspects in a comment, but I will quote asome Gentile, at the risk of being misunderstood or giving a false impression; they may even be closer to your point of view in some regards. By "philosophy", Gentile means what Guenon and Evola mean by metaphysics. However, unlike those two, Gentile relies totally on Western sources, being in the line of Plato, Aristotle, the Scholastics, etc. He falls short of them in that regard, although I think his understanding of society and political action has much to offer. Here goes:

Religion is the philosophy of the multitudes and philosophy is the religion of the spirit, or, if you prefer, that of its highest representatives.

Catholicism is truly the most perfect religion, as modern European philosophy i.e., his is the most perfect philosophy. Together they are the highest creations of the Aryan spirit.

Perhaps you don't want to hear this, but what has surpassed it in the past 1700 years? Now Gentile was concerned with national identity which requires a spiritual basis; this is opposed to all individualism. Your personal revelations may be meaningful to you, but they have no bearing or influence on the world at large. If you adhere to that sort of spiritual individualism, I don't understand why you would care what others, who are likewise individuals, believe. Moreover, the issue is not what "should" be the spiritual tradition, but rather what actually has been the spiritual tradition. There are reasons for it, and we have provided plenty of them.

I will give you this one warning, Cavalcare. Comments need to refer to the post itself. The phrase "Christian God" was not used in the post. However, Gentile did offer a definition

of God, which you can dispute if you like. Gentile mentioned that the Medieval idea of God is the same as the classical Greek understanding. So he is referring to classical theism, which apparently you need to research before offering your thoughts. Please do not confuse this with any misconceptions that you may have encountered, since we have no desire to bother to refute them.

2.43 Feast of St Augustine

Today is the feast day for **St Augustine of Hippo**. It is said that **Plotinus**, **Augustine**, and **Boethius** are the intellectual founders of the Middle Ages. If you immerse yourself in them, you will learn much about God, human nature, and the role of Fortuna in your life. Here is one of his prayers:

Breathe in me O Holy Ghost, that my thoughts may all be
holy.

Act in me O Holy Ghost, that my work, too, may be holy.

Draw my heart O Holy Ghost, that I love but what is holy.

Strengthen me O Holy Ghost, to defend all that is holy.

Guard me, then, O Holy Ghost, that I always may be holy.

Amen.

Posted on 2018-08-28 by Admin

* * *

james on 2018-08-29 at 16:37 said:

Thanks for reminding us.

Auld Wat on 2020-08-28 at 08:40 said:

It is curious that besides being the burial place of Saint Augustine, San Pietro in Ciel d'Oro contains in its crypt that of Boethius, who is accorded local sainthood.

Mike M on 2021-08-28 at 14:48 said:

To those who have passed, may we rediscover ourselves in what is Holy

3.1 My Meandering Spiritual Journey

The gnostic will is when you feel compelled to deliberate between multiple choices before deciding what to do. This is opposed to the True Will which arises spontaneously and intuitively from one's real inner being. This post started out as a prequel to the upcoming translation of Evola on Christian mysticism. One of the sections was to be on the possible alternatives. Hence, I relied on my own explorations and it morphed into what follows.

I should be reluctant to post this because it is too personal, but to give in to reluctance would be to fall victim to the gnostic will. But, you may object, I am not infallible so I have no True Will. In that case, consider what follows to be my Confessions and Retractions. I retract all the false paths I followed. I mention them to save the reader possibly years of wasted effort. Many of you are quite fortunate to have discovered Tradition at a young age. As for the confessions, if anything written here sounds enticing, I can assure you it was not so good in reality and the game was hardly worth the candle.

What are the alternatives to the dominant Western tradition? Neopaganism and new ageism are hardly serious alternatives. I have known quite a few and even participated in them. The **Course in Miracles**? Yes, I did the 365 exercises in a year.

“Nothing I see in this room (or from this window, or on this street, or in this area) means anything.” Isn’t that what Guido De Giorgio wrote? What does a blog mean?

Yet a leader of a Course study group said he canceled his health insurance, although he still wore glasses and could not grow any more hair on his head. I have known Theosophists, Anthroposophists, Freemasons, Rosicrucians, Martinists. I know people who have followed the Builders of the Adytum (BOTA) for years and painted their Tarot cards with colored pencils. I have attended classes at the **Kabbalah Center** (yes, the same one as the stars). I know **Gurdjieff** groups, and those who have danced his dances for years. I ran into a man I knew 20 years ago, still involved in fourth way work. He hadn’t changed his mind about anything.

There is one man I knew, who was most knowledgeable about such orders around the world. He was even an expert on Nordic mythology, which interested him from boyhood. He was a Russian Jew.

I have tried to follow the teachings of Don Juan and Richard Leary and Ram Das. I studied **Religious Science** and **New Thought** and still got sick and never got rich. I know the Secret and it is not worth telling.

But I did meet a woman in a religious science class. She told me she had moved past her childhood Catholicism into true spirituality. She said she would do anything for me. Since she was a dancer I asked her to do the Egyptian alma dance¹. Alma also means “soul”. She claimed sexual experience brought her close to God. Now a better pickup line cannot be imagined, but it is a longshot. So I don’t recommend it for you the reader, since no one will likely mistake you for a god. It is a tough role to live up to.

¹<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ghawazi>

I met a woman who said she “dabbled” in quantum theory, whereas I can actually follow the math; I was not impressed. I have witnessed channelers channel their mysterious beings. A friend taped the sessions and then typed them up; they were totally forgettable. I knew a woman who could see dead Indians, and they came with her to my study groups; I was never sure who she was talking to. A man told me that humans were planted here by extra-terrestrials. Who planted the ETs, I asked him? I learned Red Tantra² from a goddess priestess; I didn’t get enlightened, but it was better than spending an hour at the dentist.

I did a journaling retreat³. I still have the journals; that is why I am doing this.

I have listened to gurus from India and dined with them. I have spent time with their followers. Everyone seemed to be confused. “But there is no one to be confused,” is the usual response. Then there is no one to say it and no one to hear it.

I heard a Tibetan lama give a long speech in very bad English. Everyone was excited because he kept communicating with them by mental telepathy. I got bored. At question time, the women always ask the lama about the karmic consequences from weird situations or else what will happen to their dog when he dies. There is a pained look on the lama’s face, since the dog is on his way to the hell realms.

A man tried to hypnotize me at a party; despite the noise, I really tried. I even pretended it worked just to make him feel good, but he just got angry with me. A feng shui expert analyzed my house. So I now keep the toilet cover down so energy does not escape the house; it seems to be working. An astrologer told me my fortune, but none of it came true. I still have the cassette tapes, but no way to listen to them. Nevertheless, I did get a date with her but it wasn’t in the stars.

One time I was getting my hair cut and I mentioned to my stylist that

²<https://www.online-tantra.com/white-tantra-red-tantra/>

³<https://intensivejournal.org/>

I had two tickets to a play since my date backed out on me. On my way home, I got a phone call from her. The woman in the chair next to me overheard the conversation and wanted to go with me to the play. Lesson: maintain good relations with your hair stylist.

I have sat zazen for hours upon hours and chanted the Heart Sutra in a sort of Zen conga line. That I really miss. I have meditated on the Medicine Buddha and imagined I was an enlightened being. That is a good meditation, actually. Except place yourself in the midst of the angels and saints and the Virgin, and give up your identification with your sensations, feelings, and thoughts. Stop pretending to be what you are not.

Fortunately for me, I had done several novenas as a boy so I have been under the watchful protection of the Virgin ever since. It is a miracle enough that I am still alive, but some stories I cannot tell publicly. However, the gift of corporeal life is to provide the opportunity to overcome spiritual death. I don't have many chances left.

When you pray, be very still. You may, to your surprise, hear another prayer spontaneously arise; that is the one you need to pay attention to.

Posted on 2013-05-14 by Aeneas

* * *

Avery Morrow on 2013-05-14 at 01:11 said:

"I learned white Tantra from a goddess priestess; I didn't get enlightened, but it was better than spending an hour at the dentist."

I went to the dentist and she suddenly broke off her regular spiel and told me about Eastern Orthodox ecstasy and of her brother who became a priest at Mt. Athos. I don't remember anything that happened in December 2011 besides that one conversation. I'm not sure if the bill was more or less than what you paid the goddess, but I did get my teeth cleaned.

Jason-Adam on 2013-05-14 at 13:45 said:

I've been through similar – though as a Kshatriya my path led me through various political cults – first as a libertarian Republican then a monarchist then as a communist then a fascist

then a national bolshevik before I finally returned to the Catholic faith of my ancestors. I also was a punk rocker before returning to Tradition.

True Will – shades of Thelema anyone ?

The upcoming Evola article has my interest.....

Iñaki Luna on 2013-05-14 at 13:53 said:

To Avery Morrow : We do appreciate your Humour !

However , this article on the Gnostic Will (and its relationship to "A Course in miracles" , which is a strange book indeed ...) is very interesting too ...

Constantine on 2013-05-15 at 15:56 said:

Great article but just so you know a Jehovah Witness would call that spiritual fornication and you might have contracted spiritual aids.

Aeneas on 2013-05-16 at 00:38 said:

Not just them, Constantine, but a Guenon would say I put myself under the influences of evil or counter-initiatory influences. Yet there is always the possibility of conversion and atonement; that is why I was clear that it is a confession and a retraction.

White Rabbit on 2015-12-06 at 00:59 said:

Hagakure (The Book of the Samurai):

"In the words of the ancients, one should make his decisions within the space of seven breaths. Lord Takanobu said, 'If discrimination is long, it will spoil.' Lord Naoshige said, 'When matters are done leisurely, seven out of ten will turn out badly. A warrior is a person who does things quickly.'

When your mind is going hither and thither, discrimination will never be brought to a conclusion. With an intense, fresh and underlaying spirit, one will make his judgments within the space of seven breaths. It is a matter of being determined and having the spirit to break right through to the other side."

Alistair Fraser on 2015-12-06 at 08:00 said:

Wise words, check out the film *Le samourai* with alain delon, there is a very powerful existential message relating to certain disciplines portrayed in that film

3.2 A Story of Love and Death

In Memoriam to my mother and father **Update:** Three years ago today, my father entertained family guests and had a stroke an hour later. Two months later, both my mother and my father had died, one from disease, the other from loneliness. This is the story of their last days together.

My father had a severe stroke in a year ago today; he had been taking care of my mother with Alzheimer's. Really, neither of us (i.e., my sister and I) knew the extent of that care. He seldom complained, but we came to see how much care she needed: from showering, to getting dressed, to eating. She couldn't have been good company for him because she couldn't even follow a TV show. Every time I visited, I would go over family photographs with her. She knew she had a family, but she couldn't place the names and faces. It was extremely frustrating to her.

Yet, they didn't want to move to assisted living or even to a spare room at my sister's house — they valued their independence right up until the end. My father had retired when he was 50 and he and my mother have been inseparable for the past 37 years. Just before his stroke, he had been entertaining family that afternoon just as he loved to do. Friends, family, food, drink ... that was how he preferred to live his life.

In her state of mind, my mother never did adjust after my father's stroke, even though my sister took her in and gave her good care. Several weeks later, she had a mild problem (intestinal blockage) — in retrospect, the doctor may have overreacted and sent her to the hospital, where they took their time tending to her. One night, she tried to get out of bed, fell down, and broke her hip. That's how she ended up in the same rehab center where my father was staying. My mother's Alzheimer was getting progressively worse there.

Yet, she recognized my father. She would wheel her chair right up to him, caress his face, hold hands, proclaim her love, and tell him to get

better. It was so touching, the center staff would gather around just to witness it.

My father passed away peacefully around 7:35 on a Monday night in June — I was the only family member there.

Right afterwards my mother (who is at the same rehab center in a room directly across the hall), woke up from a deep sleep and started crying out “Chuck Chuck”. Any other time you could have asked her for her husband’s name, but the queen would have guessed Rumpelstiltskin’s name before my mother would have guessed “Chuck”. But this night, the name was spoken with confidence and authority.

I went to her to give her a hug and she embraced and kissed me, over and over, repeatedly calling “Chuck”.

Her touches and kisses were full of passion ... and sadness. She refused to lighten her grip on me. “Don’t leave me” and “I love you, baby”, she said, over and over. The intensity was both unexpected and overpowering as it gave me a glimpse into their life together, a part that they kept hidden from the children. It had to have come from a deep and primordial part of her mind that, once freed of its inhibitions, displayed itself in all its raw emotion.

I’m sure there was an intense spiritual bond between the two of them at that moment.

At some deep level she became aware that my father — her husband — had died, without anyone having told her. She was never the same and was constantly crying. The last conversation I had with her was a week later. We were sitting outside at the rehab center when she suddenly got one of her lucid moments. She looked at me and asked “Papa died, didn’t he?” I had to answer truthfully. With that she started crying. I was never able to hold another conversation with her, and within 10 days, as her ultimate act of devotion she passed away herself, dying from heartache and grief.

The final end of the story only came few months later. It was com-

mon for me to dream, but this one was particularly vivid.

I was with Nana and Papa at a large arena for a sporting event ... we were waiting in the lobby holding tickets for the lower level at cheap seats.

We decided to exchange them for \$50 seats on the upper level. I went with Nana upstairs. There I ran into my two sons who had already made the exchange. They had seats numbered 4, 5 and 6. Nana stood behind them, silent and ethereal, with her arms outstretched.

I went downstairs to fetch Papa. Though he looked pale and shuffled slowly as we walked, I thought to myself: "He doesn't seem so bad considering he just had a stroke."

Then I realized that there were only three seats ... for me and the two boys and my mother was already there. There was no place there for my father. I slowly led him up ...

Posted on 2008-04-21 by Cologero

* * *

Anna Cue on 2008-04-26 at 03:22 said:

I enjoyed reading it.

Katerina on 2010-04-18 at 17:52 said:

hauntingly beautiful...

cologero on 2010-04-18 at 19:22 said:

Thanks to http://www.freecrosses.com/celtic_cross.htm for celtic cross image.

Barb on 2010-04-21 at 09:19 said:

I once had a relationship as deep as the one you speak of... ..death and departure hurt. Fortunately, we're left with the memories – hopefully holding onto the good ones. I'm sure your parents went through trials... and as I knew them... ..they truly loved each other and help

together. Having known your parents I used to admire their love of each other... it's a rare thing "these days."

I too have had dream in which your parents have had many conversations with me... especially your father. I was thrilled to know them... they were both wonderful... and your sister, true to form was very giving.

You are in my prayers.

Barb

Cologero on 2011-10-30 at 07:30 said:

From a recent dream ...

As I was driving, I got a call from my father. He invited me to dinner, promising to make a special dish. Believing I found a shortcut, I took a right turn on an unknown road, assuming it would take me straightaway to his house. Instead, the road led to a cul de sac. I got out of the car to look. There was a steep drop off, but I was struck by the scene. I recall thinking that it was the most beautiful view I had ever seen in my life. The colors were vivid, there were flowers and a small compound of elegant cottages in the distance. I clambered down for a closer look. However, I was unable to reach what I was seeing.

Returning involved climbing back up the cliff, and I thought that I might not be able to get back. As I approached the small ledge at the top, there were two older women. I asked about the place. They told me it was a very exclusive neighborhood with strict zoning regulations, and we discussed how beautiful it was. At the same time, I noticed a younger woman also climbing up onto the ledge. She had been visiting the scene, also, and told me she had little success there ... I don't recall what she was doing, perhaps selling something.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-30 at 11:50 said:

You're definitely tuned in today C! I was just about to think on this when I turned on the computer today, having promised to more than once :-)

The first part seems to me an uncomplicated foresight into the heavenly abode you'll share with your parents, I think this is probably obvious? Also, perhaps, a reminder, to always look beyond, to leave no stone unturned in the quest for beauty, love and enlightenment.

Part two is unusual in the sense that you found yourself at the bottom of the valley without having knowingly climbed down, unless you just didn't remember that? (in lucid states like this time and space are irrelevant, so if your will directs you to a certain place you will simply arrive there in no time at all, in a spontaneous and instantaneous arrival at where you are 'supposed' to be').

I can tell you definitely that climbing up in dreams is good, even if it's a struggle, and climbs up hills and cliffs generally are in dreams as well as real life. They are straightforward

representations of the tasks and struggles most pertinent to our life mission and quest, the fact you went upwards was a sign you were making progress.

Not sure who any of the women, older or younger are, they may represent people you already know, but it's telling that you all agreed on how lovely it was – a positive place, then, do you remember at all how you felt towards both the place and them? (by the way the mention of strict zoning and exclusivity may have been a test or something to do with ego, I'm not sure).

The younger woman may also be someone you know, or (as might the others) an elemental being of the kind that frequent dreams and offer signs, tests, pointers, etc. Was she telling you that the place as a red herring of sorts (too exclusive, therefore not universal?), or was it simply the case that this was a place for you and your parents and 'not for' anyone else, but your private refuge with them?

It may have been a faerie place, which I suggest because of the emphasis on natural beauty.

The impression of very vivid colours is a spiritual sign in dreams and a measure of the lucidity – I was taught once that there is a 'plane of colour' and it's always worth noting any colours that stand out in the dream state, and also any sounds as so much that occurs there is in silence.

But you may of course disagree with all of this and already know exactly what it means...
Cx

Cologero on 2011-10-30 at 12:57 said:

I took the right turn because my father was not at the place where I would have expected him; compare this to the dream about the sporting event when he was not at the upper level seats. His time of purgation seems to have been completed.

The older women represent Moira, the Fates. The third fate is replaced by the young woman, the *Divine Sophia*⁴ who has appeared to me in many dreams in many ways.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-10-30 at 13:48 said:

nice (the earlier Divine Sophia dream I mean, that sounds amazing)! Anyways, I'm glad your father is doing well and has passed over in a good way.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-11-01 at 20:44 said:

I just heard this... .

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=65Lxd2kc8Rs&feature=related>

Cx

⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=387>

3.3 Talking Accordion Blues

As a young boy of around 6 or 7, my grandparents expected me to play the accordion. Of course, they found a teacher who showed me all the important songs: “Return to Sorrento”, “Santa Lucia”, “Malafemmina”, among others. The way it works is that you start with a small instrument — I think mine had 24 buttons — and then move on up to larger and larger accordions.

After less than a year, I was getting proficient and asked when I could get a new accordion. That’s when I got the bad news that they discovered a congenital hernia that required surgery. My father explained that I wouldn’t be able to lift a heavier instrument for a while, at least until the surgery healed, so my mother suggested I take piano lessons in the meantime. So I learned to play piano on an always out of tune upright, while waiting for my hernia to heal.

Eventually we moved to a larger house, so naturally we got a larger piano — a sweet baby grand. But, no, there was no larger accordion waiting for me. As time passed, my interests changed and I forgot about the accordion.

This is a picture I took of a wandering accordion player in a cafe in Montmartre. A nice gig if you can get it — fresh air, exercise, art, freedom ... he looks healthy enough, but I forgot to ask him if he had ever had hernia surgery. I know a few of you may be snickering, but he gets paid in euros and I rely on dollars.

It’s been said that “A gentleman is a man who can play the accordion ... and doesn’t.”

I’m no gentleman.

Connie Francis got her start on the accordion, but blocked all youtube evidence. As she claimed:

I was never encouraged to do it and I played the accordion, which I hated. I wish I had taken piano because I definitely would have

written more songs of my own, but I didn't.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0_URJbCLqXE

Posted on 2008-06-30 by Cologero

3.4 **Playing by the Book**

For my part I consider that it is better to be adventurous than cautious, because fortune is a woman, and if you wish to keep her under it is necessary to beat and ill-use her; and it is seen that she allows herself to be mastered by the adventurous rather than by those who go to work more coldly. She is, therefore, always, woman-like, a lover of young men, because they are less cautious, more violent, and with more audacity command her.

NICOLO MACHIAVELLI, *The Prince*

Many years ago this writer used to play a lot of Backgammon. While it was a fad, local discos would host backgammon tournaments, with a small entrance fee. Since I was quite competent at the game, and the competition was generally weak, it was an easy way for me to pick up the \$50 or \$100 prize money without much effort at a time when that amount of money was meaningful to a young man.

At one particular tournament, with a larger prize, the competition was stiffer. I found myself paired against an older woman, typical of South Florida, who was clearly schooled in the game. She probably had taken lessons at her condo rec room. Finding myself in an untenable position, I deliberately took a calculated risk, a move that, if made by a patzer, would have been a sign of incompetence. I could sense the rush of excitement in my opponent as she anticipated moving on to the next table. Instead, my next throw was double sixes which knocked her out of the tournament.

In a voice thick with contempt, she told me, “you know that move was incorrect” and glared at me as though I had cheated. True enough, if you go by the backgammon manuals, but on the other hand it was the only move that gave me the opportunity to take the game. Had I “played by the book”, I would have gone home early that night.

The world is full of those who would “write the book” to constrain Fortuna⁵. The book will tell you how to behave, it will make false promises to those who follow the book, but the net result is to protect those in the positions described in the book from random or unexpected results. This is an attempt to control the future by limiting possibilities.

However, the metaphysical principle that “the possible is the real” will doom any such project to ultimate failure. Instead, the adept will understand the future by understanding the possibilities inherent in the moment. Evola writes in *The Hermetic Tradition*: “*prophetic knowledge, rather than being based on fate, is based on its mastery*” and **Zosimos**: “*the race of Philosophers is beyond destiny.*” **Plotinus** writes:

The knowledge that the superior man has of the future that we attribute to him does not at all resemble the knowledge of fortune-tellers, but is like that of active participants who have a certainty of what must be; and such is the case with genuine rulers. For them nothing is undetermined, nothing is uncertain. Their decision persists as it was in the first moment. Their judgment of things to come is just as firm as their vision of present things is exact.

We **Sons of Hermes** understand possibilities, and master them by an act of will. Evola writes:

Homer said that the gods often travel through the world in the guise of strangers and pilgrims and turn the cities of men around.

⁵<https://tinyurl.com/yc2wce35>

This is not just mythology. There is reason to believe that no historical or social event of any importance, no phenomenon that has followed a determined course of terrestrial events comprising certain discoveries or the birth of new ideas, has not had a causal or spontaneous origin, but on the contrary has obeyed an *intention*, if not an actual plan conceived behind the scenes and realized via paths we can scarcely imagine today, under the sign of the Light, as well as—according to circumstances—under the sign of Darkness.

Posted on 2011-06-01 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2017-06-02 at 11:54 said:

This reminds me of a statement made by a character in the old X-Files series. To paraphrase: The best way to predict the future is to create it.

3.5 Personal Revelations

This post will address some of the more common questions that readers have asked me.

Do you Blog full time? With the massive amount of all original content, new translations, not to mention the distasteful duties of a webmaster, maintaining a full-featured web site may look like a full time job. But, no, it is a part time affair on top of the normal duties of holding a job, running a household, and so on. However, my energy level is decreasing and it needs to be a full time job, or else it will terminate. There are associated expenses to pay for web hosting and research materials from Europe. Please consider responding to the poll questions at the end for suggestions about defraying expenses.

There is a convention among Hermetists to not earn a living through the Work. Back in the day, the Hermetist would have held a job like a horse trader, or a street artist that would give him cover as he traveled from town to town on market day or other festivals. Since books were expensive and bulky, he would carry around the teachings encoded in diagrams or mandalas. These were portable and could be copied by the students. Eventually, some of them were incorporated into the Tarot deck. Along with the oral teaching, they served as a condensed digest of the work until the teacher's next visit.

What does Gornahoor mean? Gornahoor is simply a title of respect like sir, mister, or sri, although it is reserved for a three-brained being.

Are you Eastern Orthodox? Several people have assumed this. Obviously, for more than 1000 years Rome was Orthodox and Orthodoxy was Roman. So I don't recognize the schism, as it is the period prior to the Reformation and the Renaissance in the West that is of the most interest. Furthermore, I would (figuratively) agree with this quote, at a time when Constantinople, rather than Athens, was the center of the East:

Constantinople remains to this day a monument of ancient wisdom, the home of letters, and the citadel of philosophy. No Italian can pretend to be educated unless he has studied for a time at Constantinople.

AENEAS SYLVIUS (1551)

What religion do you follow? With few exceptions, a man ought to follow the exoteric religion of his nation, as it is the creation of its ethnic soul. People, even those who claim to be close to "tradition", today treat their religion as a commodity, all sitting on a shelf, with the consumer choosing one based on his personal peccadilloes. They may complain

because they don't like what the produces has provided them. That is the passive attitude. Once it is understood that it is a reflection of the spirit of a people, the choices looks much different. I don't have time to go into this now, so I am reserving it to some future discussions on the idealistic philosophy of Giovanni Gentile. It may make things comprehensible.

What is called "Traditional Catholicism", or Rad Trad, is not the same thing. Rad Trad really goes back to the Council of Trent, which is hampered by its need to address the false claims of the Reformation. Thus, too, its spirituality is primarily influenced by the post-Tridentine saints from Spain and France. Not that this is bad in itself, but it is necessary to remain further back in tradition.

Despite the prevalence of Guenon's works in our time, at least in certain circles, it is astounding how poorly understood he still is. Exoterism and esoterism are of different orders and, as such, are incomparable. This is lost on a lot of readers who attempt to find a connection or correspondence between exoteric dogmas and esoteric teachings. This shows up in two ways. The first are those orthodox believers who are concerned that some dogma may be transgressed. The worst ones are those who try to "prove" that Christianity, which for us can only mean the Roman/Orthodox synthesis, is not "traditional" or "esoteric". Of course, the exoteric is not esoteric, and the latter has never been fully revealed to the public at large, who would either misunderstand it or ignore it altogether.

As Guenon reassures us:

A truly initiatic tradition cannot be heterodox; to qualify it as such is to reverse the normal and hierarchical relationship between the interior and the exterior. Esoterism is not contrary to orthodoxy, even orthodoxy construed simply in the religious sense; it is above or beyond the religious point of view, which is obviously not at all the same thing.

That there have been conflicts between the two perspectives in the

past has been due to completely other factors. More recently, Valentin Tomberg is firm in his insistence that he has no intention to challenge any established dogmas. I concur with that.

How can a university graduate believe such things? There is more than a millennium of very sophisticated thought behind the teachings, reaching up to the stunning synthesis of Thomas Aquinas. As Thomas Aquinas himself admitted, the way he understands church teaching would be quite different from that of the typical believer.

As he points out, dogma demands the “free consent of the will”. Obviously, only a free man can grant such consent. A dogma is an internal constraint, not external, and it is a point of view. The bulk of humanity chooses their opinions and points of view with very little self-reflection; dogmas, on the other hand, required much reflection, detachment, and loyalty to one’s tradition.

Most men would object: can you prove it is true (like the Greeks), or can you give me a sign (like the Jews). But then the choice would not be free, it would be compelled. Think about this a little bit and you will see it is true. Furthermore, few things can really be proven true and signs can be interpreted in opposite ways.

Since the free man transcends all points of view, he can choose the one most appropriate for him.

Why the Fedeli D’Amore? Obviously because it provides an open example of an esoteric current. Unlike a Reghini or a Rossetti, Guenon points out that the Fedeli d’Amore were not heterodox for the reasons given. An intriguing point is the role that Medusa played in their symbolism. Now Dante was initiated by the Sicilian troubadours and Medusa to this day is on the flag of Sicily. A couple of years ago, a group tried to change it to something less pagan, but they were rebuffed.

Without further explanation, catholic means universal, the one and

only tradition. It is the new Israel, i.e., the totality of initiates, or the chosen people. In Guenon's words,

Has not the name Israel been employed to designate the totality of initiates and who possess the universal language that enables them all to understand each other, that is, the knowledge of the one tradition that is concealed beneath all its particular forms?

That is exactly what Tomberg says about the method of depth. Hence, Dante really means the Church is teaching the universal tradition and he is not opposing it as such. Those who see things differently, are most likely restricted to the horizontal, profane plane.

What's love got to do with it? Amor is Roma spelled backwards and may be related to the occult name of Rome. Some, unfortunately, see A-mor as anti-Rome rather than as its mirror reflection.

When an esoteric writing does not make much sense, that is probably because you are missing the deeper meaning. Clearly, Dante's crush on Beatrice exceeds all normal bounds. Yet it is that awakening of eros that provides the energy and impetus for the spiritual climb. That might not help you, if you have never experienced a real love for a woman, or are not even capable of imagining such a thing.

The novice to the Fedeli d'Amore had to write a love sonnet. That would be a good homework assignment, especially if you could sublimate that feeling to the Divine Sophia. Remember this is quite a different feeling from that associated with watching Internet porn. The least serious sexual sin is intercourse between an unmarried man and woman; solitary pornography does not satisfy that and can only result in unnatural acts. There are sound reasons for this.

However, don't think that accumulating sexual experiences is an acceptable substitute. When you get old, you remember none of them. Instead, you become obsessed with the ones you let get away, or the acts you never got to try. It is far better to be obsessed with the rebis to achieve

the spiritual marriage which is the primordial state.

The echoes of that tradition of Amore can be found in the tradition of Neapolitan love songs, although much secularized. However, is you need help capturing that feeling, try listening to *Core N'grato*⁶. Unfortunately, such emotions are often wasted on a woman, who only gets so passionate when shopping.

How can Gornahoor generate income

- Find a wealthy benefactor (25%, 51 Votes)
- Beg for donations (20%, 42 Votes)
- Sell monogrammed t-shirts, coffee mugs, lapel pins, busts of famous traditionalists, etc. (16%, 33 Votes)
- Charge for weekend seminars to determine your spiritual race and purpose in life. (16%, 32 Votes)
- Produce a reality TV show called the "Boys of Tradition" (15%, 30 Votes)
- Make Gornahoor a subscription only web site (5%, 11 Votes)
- Other (specify in comments) (3%, 7 Votes)

Total Voters: **118**

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NOVBrZzj0kQ>

Posted on 2013-04-08 by Cologero

* * *

⁶<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NOVBrZzj0kQ> by **Giuseppe di Stefano**

Nick on 2013-04-09 at 03:15 said:

What would the Templars do?

Mihai on 2013-04-09 at 03:39 said:

Your polls always make me burst into laughter, Cologero.

Ea Lord of the Deepes on 2013-04-09 at 07:27 said:

I would buy a Evola related tshirt,

Cavalcare on 2013-04-09 at 08:33 said:

Laptop stickers. An example would be a certain picture circulating around the tumblr-sphere: "Uber", picture of Nietzsche above, "Decline", picture of Spengler, "Tradition", picture of Evola. Can't seem to track it down.

Avery Morrow on 2013-04-09 at 09:39 said:

I would attend a Gornahoor weekend retreat, just to see if any of us could transcend our cynical detachment.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-04-09 at 09:58 said:

I think donations would be good. I'd be happy to give what little I could. Or subscribe at \$10 a month. Or "things" like t-shirts, etc.

J. Alexander Maximilian on 2013-04-09 at 10:08 said:

And I have loved a woman with much Romance, but the energies invested therein are undoubtedly "wasted" as you said.

The misery of Amoré at times. The heart JT leaps, and is quickly shot down eventually by the shopper.

Logres on 2013-04-09 at 11:06 said:

I would be happy to contribute what money I can send, although I am not sure everyone that needs to read it is able to give anything. Or, you could take donations for certain ends, like meeting website cost or getting a new manuscript from Europe.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-09 at 12:43 said:

I personally would be like Evola or Yockey and use my noble title to seduce a rich older lady with my virile masculinity who would then pay my bills to support my Traditionalist work which she could never understand as she is an inferior woman but would remain unable to resist the passion it gives her in my lovemaking...this comment is a joke. Or is it ?

Anna Kaiser-Swadling on 2013-04-09 at 14:18 said:
You could replace the Tao of shopping.

Matt on 2013-04-09 at 20:47 said:

Honestly, I wouldn't be opposed to paying a reasonable subscription price to Gornahoor. I don't think many people would be all that interested in seeing a show with people who take up camera time searching for truth and cosmic redemption, and who also don't look like carrots after days of over-tanning.

To echo Avery's comment, I also think seminar retreats is a good idea. Gives us a chance to meet each other and Cologero in person, and a chance for mutual support and guidance.

David on 2013-04-09 at 22:05 said:

If I can get the whole bunch of all articles in a .rar or .zip files, I would be glad to pay for it. That would be most useful.

George Goerlich on 2013-04-10 at 00:16 said:
Can you sell your translations?

Mihai on 2013-04-10 at 03:33 said:

One problem: many of us are literally continents apart. A plane ticket from one continent to another isn't all that accessible nowadays.

That is, unless, we arrange a non-corporeal meeting at the primordial center of the present aeon, preferably by the shade provided by the Tree in the middle. But they told me they put a Cherub at the entrance and it may take even harder work to get passed his flaming sword than the option with the plane ticket.

VerbaVolant on 2013-04-10 at 13:23 said:
thanks for quoting the great René Guénon !!

VerbaVolant on 2013-04-10 at 13:25 said:
René Guénon is surely & definitely a great reference !!

Ammonius420 on 2013-04-10 at 20:15 said:
Apparently not:

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=M0db1TAkh3k>

"He also dated a woman around 20-30 years his senior too, I was friends with him on Facebook before.? Quite an unconventional character to mildly say :o"

P.S. I would pay for this site.

Ammonius420 on 2013-04-11 at 03:32 said:

How about finding ways to increase Cologero's energy level?

Cologero on 2013-04-11 at 08:45 said:

From Wikipedia article on the Hermetist, Giacomo Casanova:

Escaping to Parma, Casanova entered into a three-month affair with a Frenchwoman he named "Henriette", perhaps the deepest love he ever experienced—a woman who combined beauty, intelligence, and culture. In his words, "They who believe that a woman is incapable of making a man equally happy all the twenty-four hours of the day have never known an Henriette. The joy which flooded my soul was far greater when I conversed with her during the day than when I held her in my arms at night. Having read a great deal and having natural taste, Henriette judged rightly of everything." She also judged Casanova astutely. As noted Casanovist J. Rives Childs wrote:

Perhaps no woman so captivated Casanova as Henriette; few women obtained so deep an understanding of him. She penetrated his outward shell early in their relationship, resisting the temptation to unite her destiny with his. She came to discern his volatile nature, his lack of social background, and the precariousness of his finances. Before leaving, she slipped into his pocket five hundred louis, mark of her evaluation of him.

I don't know that 500 louis are all that great for three months work, not to mention he also gave up his heart to her. I'm afraid my peasant background will forever bar me from such circles, despite my not unsubstantial charms.

Cologero on 2013-04-11 at 09:05 said:

After the alchemist Fulcanelli wrote *The Mystery of the Cathedrals* — which did for the understanding of the symbolism of the Medieval cathedrals what Luigi Valli did for understanding the symbolism of the Fedeli d'Amore — he disappeared without a trace. When he did arrange a clandestine meeting with a pupil several years later, the pupil reported that Fulcanelli has actually become younger. I know what I need to do.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-11 at 13:12 said:

Ammonius, who is that weirdo communist in that video you posted ? I am not sure what you intended by choosing someone with the same first name as I but he is funny though he looks a bit dazed as if he were using some illegal substance... ..

and as for Cologero, you are a peasant ? You can not be, your spirit as I read it in your writings here proves you are an aristocrat... ..

Ammonius420 on 2013-04-11 at 19:39 said:

I wish you luck.

CaseyAnn on 2013-04-21 at 18:56 said:

But aren't t-shirts a hideous product of the modern age ... ?

:-p

Cologero on 2013-04-21 at 21:05 said:

I'll take that as a "no" vote. Perhaps you can choose something from *this list*?

CaseyAnn on 2013-04-21 at 22:25 said:

Ha! But that's not a cynical dichotomy, is it?

I voted awhile ago for the now bolded, italicized text.

Question about the Catholic/Orthodox synthesis: How would that look in practice? Exoterically, I mean. I find myself drawn to this but don't understand.

I really enjoy this site, Cologero. Thank you.

Cologero on 2013-04-21 at 23:58 said:

I don't recall having mentioned any such "Catholic/Orthodox synthesis". What is there to synthesize? The West regards the separation as a "schism", i.e., a dispute over jurisdiction, not theology. I know the Easterners are always quick to identify a heresy where there really isn't one. The break up almost turned into a makeup at the Council of Florence a few hundred years ago, but extraneous issues intervened. In any event, I believe the mutual ex-communications were lifted in the 1960s, although, for some reason that makes no sense, there is still no full communion.

In practice, I suggest studying the Philokalia. You may find it simpatico. Or else go to a Greek festival where you may find an icon of St. Augustine, as I did.

⁷<https://www.google.com/search?q=medieval+clothes&hl=en&tbm=isch&tbo=u&source=univ&sa=X&ei=q4x0Ubr9PIq09QSe5oG4Dg&sqi=2&ved=0CD8QsAQ&biw=1009&bih=568>

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-22 at 12:13 said:

The problem is geopolitical – the East believes the West should be subjected to Constantinople (in the middle ages) and Russia (today – read the works of Alexander Dugin) which causes the eastern church to ally with neopagans against the Western church.

We are westerners who want the west to return to tradition of our ancestors, the east does not care about our tradition, they want to destroy us – read the debate between Olavo and Dugin and you will see that Dugin does not hate the modern world – he hates the West in toto.

The Photian “orthodox” heretics believe that the Holy Spirit does not proceed from the Son but He comes independently from the Father alone – this leads to the idea of multiple voices of God and hence the principle of chaos being the ruling Idea of the world.

Boreas on 2020-04-08 at 10:41 said:

What happened to the donate button?! I'd very much like to support your work with the little I have.

DA on 2022-02-26 at 18:08 said:

How about self-publishing the collections of articles available here, organized in certain topics? I'd definitely buy that, paying a higher margin to cover the expenses that'll keep Gornahoor running.

Also a Patreon-like monthly donations are definitely part of the equation for me. You could attach perks to certain levels of financial support. Eg. 5 USD/month – your name mentioned in the list of benefactors. 10 USD/month – previous benefit + one extra access article. 50 USD/month – all the former and a Zoom coffee meeting with the author? Treat numbers as arbitrary, I'm your reader from Poland and I don't know what's considered appropriate for such initiatives in the US.

All the best,
Heiko

Cologero on 2022-03-10 at 22:16 said:

Actually, DA, I am looking for some software that will take a wordpress database and convert it to something like a Word doc or PDF file. Then I could re-organize the articles by topic. If anyone knows of such software, please let me know.

In the USA, anything that ends with USD is appropriate.

3.6 Decentering the Western Tradition

I am among the last of a generation. Even those just a few years younger than I had a quite different experience. When a stone is thrown into a still pond, there is a wave motion that gradually attenuates, inversely to the square, the further it moves from the center, until the evidence of the original impulse is no longer recognizable. Attending public school systems in the Boston area, I was on one of those outer waves that was still under the influence of the first impulse. The mystery, then, to me is why so few of my generation have come to similar conclusions as mine.

Elementary school was in a plain brick building that could have been mistaken for a warehouse. Class sizes were around 25 to 30. A federal judge today would condemn it, as though erecting a new building in the modern style could make a difference to the education within. In elementary school, we began every day with the Pledge of Allegiance and the Our Father prayer, a tacit acknowledgment of spiritual authority and political power. One afternoon per week, we were let out of school and led to our respective nearby churches for an hour of religious education.

Yes, we did drills for a possible nuclear attack and were taught to hide under our desks and not look out the window to avoid being blinded. Obviously, if we were close enough to the bomb site to risk blindness, hiding under the desk was useless. Keep that in mind whenever the government implements a policy to keep the people safe. Beyond that, we were protected by Nike missiles and the Air Force was patrolling the skies; a sonic boom could occasionally be heard.

Our books were thick, without many pictures; unfortunately, I don't know that the book lists from that era are available. I recall we studied American and European history. We read the *Odyssey* in a text form. We read about the Germanic religion. We sang patriotic songs in music class. I don't know if the common core that is so popular now covers the same material.

There was no anti-German feeling, as the rocket engineers were well-respected. Even the rebels were respected and were frequently heroes of TV shows. Robert E Lee and Stonewall Jackson were well known names and considered to be fine Americans.

The school had a baseball field, where the boys played with no adult supervision. Even at the age of 8 or so, we were free to wander around the neighborhood, not expected home until the street lights came on. The kids had to provide their own entertainment. There was little point going home, since there was very little children's programming except for Saturday morning. In inclement weather, we played board and card games.

In junior high (middle) school, our sex education consisted in how to ask a girl for a date and what to say when meeting her parents. Since on the wave I mentioned, an educated man was expected to know ballroom dance and to speak French. So I was taught those in school. We were taught to speak proper grammar to get ahead in life, as well as habits such as diligence, punctuality, and so on. Clearly, that was another lie, since speaking and writing good English is wasted on the ignorant; as for the habits, the actual situation is slightly different, but that is a different topic.

We also had an intellectually rich home environment. My mother used to buy me books from the series Tom Corbett and the Space Cadets. From them, I learned about human types: the leader, the more intellectual navigator, and the jovial, but dimmer, engineer. In one episode, the computer went down, so the navigator had to compute the logarithms by hand. That appealed to me, because my father's table of logarithms and trig functions kept me entertained for hours. I couldn't get through his calculus book until I learned some algebra in the 7th grade. I made it through differential calculus and integral calculus.

At home, I was fortunate that my parents had a collection of classic novels. I was able to read Edgar Allen Poe, Robert Lewis Stevenson,

Herman Melville, James Fenimore Cooper, Nathaniel Hawthorne, Mark Twain, Daniel Defoe, Rudyard Kipling, and perhaps some others. Of course, there were the ones I didn't read: Louisa May Alcott, the Brontë's, Jane Austen. It was implicitly understood that they were for my sister to read.

The Expansion of Tradition So, that is what I envision when I hear about "saving the West", "restoring Tradition", etc., although I'm not sure how many others mean that. Obviously, the dominant ideology, not in a majoritarian sense but as the intellectual influence, is totally opposed to all that. Now we have twerking instead of ballroom, street lingo instead of good English, any other language but French, and a persistent, unrelenting attack on the implicit worldview⁸ of those authors I read, and whose worldview I absorbed. This is understandable coming from there, but there is a fifth column that is attacking from within, often unawares.

Several years ago, I was in correspondence with a Midwestern woman, a devout Evangelical, very conservative, who seemed educated and intelligent. She found this question game, and one of them was to name one's favorite historical figures. Mine were all literary, probably pompous as I looked back at the answers, except that I have actually read them. Hers took me by surprise, because it included Corrie Ten Boom and Harriet Tubman. It is hard to explain why, since they were both brave and admirable women, and worthy of her admiration. Nevertheless, I felt, at the time, that that selection was decentered, i.e., while important to their respective interests, it represented something outside the main thrust of the tradition that I had assumed she and I were discussing.

As I had time to think on it, I realized that the selection represented either an expansion of a wedge. For my friend, those two women were devout Christians. For her, the Holocaust and the emancipation of the slaves represented the expansion of the Western tradition beyond its eu-

⁸<http://www.thecollegefix.com/post/14698/>

rocentrism. For the anti-tradition, the religion of those women was irrelevant; rather, the two issues they brought up act as a wedge to attack the entire West at its foundation. This is why all far right movements fail, since they are forced to exist within that shadow. The equation is Pro-West = Pro-Holocaust and Pro-Slavery. Mantras and complaints will not refute it because perception is reality, and that is the perception. In some cases, it is actually the reality.

Posted on 2013-09-30 by Cologero

* * *

Michael on 2013-09-30 at 21:08 said:

It is fascinating to see how the rate of change has increased. When I grew up there was still enough of the vestiges of the old civilization to make things very pleasant.

Also fascinating to see how events can accelerate change. I am thinking of 9/11 and how it seemed to beget an evangelical atheism.

3.7 Lessons Learned

Taking a Stand When I was a young family man, I tried to be active in my community. One of those activities was to be a volunteer facilitator at a low cost group counseling centre. We underwent a Rogerian style training in being non-judgmental, reflective, and confidential. For some reason I didn't and still don't understand, two older women took a dislike to me. Furthermore, they carried it outside the training session, engaging in gossip, slander, and detraction.

When the psychologist-trainer learned of this, he was upset and reprimanded the women at a subsequent training session. In Rogerian fashion, a discussion ensued. To my surprise, the group became divided, some siding with me, and others with the hags.

I learned from that event, that there will always be those for you and those against you. From that moment on, I have never been afraid to take a stand.

Cash Value and the Gentleman Sometimes when I tell someone about my blogs, the large number of visitors, and the nearly million words of original text and translations, the response is, “Are you making any money from it?” Sheepishly, I have to admit the no, and I rue that a topic of conversation has been lost. I get emails about how to make money at blogs. I suppose by maintaining dozens of blogs and getting a few bucks from each, it can be done.

Most blog writers solicit tips like a waitress in a cocktail bar. The amounts are small, a five or a ten, perhaps a twenty. To accept such a tip is actually a cause for shame and embarrassment, the assumption being that such a paltry sum is important to me. The posts are freely offered although their actual value is much more than \$10.

The tradition is that a Hermetist does not make a living from the Work. Rather he would have been a horse trader, a street performer, or some such trade. Aristotle said the highest life is that of the philosopher who understands the nature of man, God, and the universe. However, first he must be a gentleman, “noble and good”, with a certain degree of financial independence.

Thus, this is not a “blue collar” blog with crude language, irrational views, the promotion of immoral lifestyles, and ugly presentation as a few of you persist in believing have any value for a gentleman.

Rather than money, I would like some among you to pray for my health, the good birth of a grandson, and a successful outcome for my son’s upcoming surgery.

A Prophet without Honor It may or may not surprise you that no one, literally, who knows me personally reads this blog; this includes fam-

ily and close friends. They will not even “like” the Gornahoor facebook page. I am the “crazy uncle” that the children like to be with, with outlandish yet ignorable views; my sister calls me a shaman.

There are two possible conclusions that readers can draw from this. The first is that those who know me best think I am a “kook”, so you should certainly not pay attention.

The other conclusion is that if you try to step up and out in your life, your friends and family will be the first to try to hold you back.

Runes in Salemi A half dozen years ago, I went to Salemi, Sicily, to show my son our family roots and to look for property to buy. The city is built on a hillside overlooking olive groves, vineyards, and farmland. At the top of the highest peak, there is a fort with a view for many miles around. Originally built by the Arabs, it was eventually taken over by the Normans. I was hoping to find evidence of Norse culture there, perhaps even Rune symbols, as well as the much larger fort in Palermo.

I did find a good property, three stories, with kitchens on the 2nd and 3rd floors, and enough room to sleep 8 or even a dozen. I was hoping to found a centre there for those interested in the topics discussed on Gornahoor. With a European centre, it would have been possible to work in groups where I could have taught actual spiritual exercises. Unfortunately, the economy turned, depleting my investments, and an inheritance was much less than expected.

Of course, I found no rune inscriptions, since the Normans had long since abandoned those ways. However, it was in Palermo that I was struck with a deep understanding. These Normans had moved into France, conquered England, Sicily, and from there, went on to take over leadership the Holy Roman Empire. I wondered about the inner state of these knights who had come so far and accomplished so much. In the tour of the castle in Palermo, we eventually made it to the Palatine Chapel in it and there I found the answer. It was certainly beautiful and I could

sense the knights of the past attending mass in it.

Since then I have no patience with those who deny the spirituality of those knights in favour of some remote, imaginary paganism. Particularly, since they are usually crude, vulgar, and ungentlemanly about it.

The Limits of your Imagination At a now defunct minicomputer manufacturer, we had developed a networking system; at that time, there were no turnkey solutions as there are now, so it was a unique accomplishment. At one meeting, we had to listen to a presentation of an earnest young woman who was tasked with marketing the networking product.

Unsure of what to say, she finally blurted out with unfeigned enthusiasm, “And the possibilities for this product are limited only by your own imagination.”

Of course we all mocked her. What that meant is that she could not articulate any creative or practical uses for the network, so she was counting on each audience member to think one up for her.

That is when I learned the lesson of specificity. It is difficult to provide specifics, so most people just fake it, counting on the audience to “know” what they mean. Thus we hear about a vague, unspecified “Indo-European tradition”, not unlike Chomsky’s universal grammar; of course, you cannot specify it. Curiously, we have just written about this, but some readers don’t know how to learn a lesson.

The Image of an Image When the kids were young, I had to take them to Disneyworld every now and then. There was a last time, after which I got too disgusted to return. We were on an “adventure” ride, and a mechanical deer would randomly pop up out of the ground. The passengers would ooh and ah, pointing to their children.

When you see through the contrivance, it has no effect. I thought, why not go into the woods and look for a real deer? If nature is the image of the divine, as the holy ones teach us, then what Disney provides is

merely an image of an image. Yet, on a larger scale, most of our lives today consists of images of an image, from movies, to TV, to the popularity of social media. Nothing good can come of it.

Actuarial Science In high school, I was one of the top two dozen scorers in a Massachusetts statewide math exam, so I was invited to meet with its sponsor, the Society of Actuaries. There were follow ups and I seriously considered a career in the field. By reducing everything to quantity, it manages to provide concrete and successful results. I learned some of its techniques, and still think it is applicable for many tasks of the producing class.

For example, as you all know, the insurance rates for teenage boy drivers are much higher than for anyone else. That is a simple matter of actuarial science which I cannot explain here. Some people may consider that unfair. However, when an insurance company publishes its rates, it does not have to provide copious and apologetic footnotes along the lines that “not every teenage boy is a bad driver”, or “not every bad driver is a teenage boy”, etc.

The simple mathematical fact is that without that policy, the insurance companies would simply go out of business. Contemporary western societies today are “going out of business”, but it is happening too slowly for most to notice.

A Continuous Tradition A few months ago after the Venner controversy, we lost some readership. I read his blog and he indicated his disappointment that France did not have a religion like Hinduism to preserve its racial and ethnic identity. As an historian, he had to know that France had no problem preserving its identity prior to the Revolution. However, as an ideologue, he could not admit this. Ideology is the image of an image in the intellectual realm, i.e., the image of a thought which is the image of the spirit. Nothing good can come of that, but the world

is full of ideologues.

Camel in the Desert There is a recent comment from someone who is expecting the “real” Indo-European tradition to show up, presumably just for him. To boot, it is in a post that warns against seeking any perfection in this world.

Does a man dying of thirst in the desert argue about which camel will take him to the oasis? Does he languish there waiting for the perfect camel to come along? There is a lesson there that few will heed.

Appeals to the Intellect Let us note again the three forces in the psyche: sex, anger, and intellect. Since these are fundamental, the vices of the first two are, as Augustine pointed out, insatiable. That is why nearly all media are geared to stimulating sexual desire or anger. The former is too common to provide examples. The latter is the basis for all the political blogs and talk shows in our time. They “work” only if they get you worked up about some issue, person, place, or thing. The lesson is to always be on the lookout for that.

Beyond that, there is the appeal to the emotions in general. Every show emphasizes it. News stories depend on them for the “human angle”. Along with that, there are always stories about dogs, elephants, or other animals displaying “human-like” emotions. These are very popular.

However, the truth is just the opposite. The real lesson is that, for the most part, human emotions are more animal-like and that explains the rapport. That is not merely metaphysical, but also scientific as described in **Carl Sagan’s** book, *The Dragons of Eden*. Now I am not at all opposed to building rapport with animals, but only to the idea that it somehow represents what is higher in man.

Appeals to the Intellect are much rarer, and that is necessarily so. Few can attain the equanimity of Aristotle’s philosopher. The philosopher, meant in the ancient sense as a way of life, would want to see into the

nature of things and passions can only work against this. Even writings that aspire to a higher level are still stuck on an “us-vs-them” attitude, which can never transcend the thymos.

The philosopher is the lover of wisdom, but it is still not the state of being wise. When Jesus said we must love our enemy, it means we need to transcend all points of view and see things as they are.

Posted on 2013-10-17 by Cologero

* * *

X on 2013-10-18 at 01:22 said:
Many valuable perspectives.

Scardanelli on 2013-10-18 at 06:24 said:
“The shaman” doesn’t sound half bad... At age 32, I am known as “the grandpa” by my wife and kids, who unfortunately are thoroughly under the sway of this world. Unfortunately it seems that the closer a person is to you the less they’ll listen to you.

I am grateful for your work, and I will pray for you and your family.

Michel on 2013-10-18 at 07:35 said:
“I did find a good property, three stories, with kitchens on the 2nd and 3rd floors, and enough room to sleep 8 or even a dozen. I was hoping to found a center there for those interested in the topics discussed on Gornahoor. With a European center, it would have been possible to work in groups where I could have taught actual spiritual exercises. Unfortunately, the economy turned, depleting my investments, and an inheritance was much less than expected.”

Yeah, that would have been a great idea, those darn Bavarians with their secret societies! Ruining everything for everyone, tsk!

I do hope that you get well soon, and that those with the same tinge of madness you have eventually see that you are the grand court jester, the keeper of deep truths, the heyoka who shivers when it is sunny, dresses lightly during winter, in being yourself, you are the real them. It’s interesting, the last four posts of yours have been strangely consistent with some of the things that are happening in my life, not only in terms of thoughts, but actual situations and points where I have to make ‘strange’ decisions, this very post is rather interesting, because I’ve just had a discussion with my father on certain things that are to him, ‘kooked-up’ before reading this. Even more interesting is a talk I was having with an Italian friend of mine on Wednesday

evening, he is an initiate in a Sufi Order, the Qadiriya Chistiyya, I know that this blog aims at pointing towards Western Tradition, so I mean no disrespect at all by speaking on this, but he said something similar to what you said when you said this:

...
”

Does a man dying of thirst in the desert argue about which camel will take him to the oasis? Does he languish there waiting for the perfect camel to come along? There is a lesson there that few will heed.

”

...

I was telling him of your efforts when he said that on the one hand, it is good what you are doing (not that you need anyone's approval), but he also fears that you may hinder others from turning to Traditions that are 'Alive' inspite of their being Eastern, such as Islam. I asked him about the Law of Affinity, in that it is the Truth, manifested physically as an Order that selects its members via this Law, in that those with similar 'vibrations' to it would be attracted to it naturally, and that they truly would be qualified to join it, whether it was hidden or in the open. I said hidden or in the open because I read here, and have also given thought on the possibility that certain Western Traditions did go 'underground' after the Templars were chased away, and that their 'Operation' is of a different stride or manner, in that it, more than the Eastern Orders, due to the current degenerate Western condition, works solely along inner lines, sort of like an 'inner Theophanic collective consciousness'. We also spoke about the different Orthodox writings of the Greek Church and the various monasteries that still exist today, about Freemasonry and its 'Sufi Origins' (note my use of quotation marks on that) about Hermeticism and also about Roman Catholicism. We agreed that while it would be possible that there may exist in the West an Order that maintains an unbroken initiatic chain, he said that "God has given you a river right before you, but you would rather go to the desert in search of an oasis to quench your thirst". He also says that the other Traditions are like the stars, but Islam is like the sun, in that being the final Divine Revelation, it is most suitable for the current world conditions and it also synthesizes all the others, he further said that all the avatars and prophets were all pre-figurations of The Prophet, and that he encompasses all of them, being the Initial Ray that proceeds from God, such that in Essence, he is God, the ray essentially is the sun, from whence it derives its very nature, it is the sun 'extended'. I'm not proselytizing, it's all about going beyond the form, riding the camel till it brings you to the oasis, the destination is the oasis, not the camel's back. Anyways, I pray that all your life's affairs turn out the way they were meant to.

Tosti on 2013-10-18 at 08:21 said:

Your thoughts are always appreciated and, as you know, they do have effect.

Michael on 2013-10-18 at 10:00 said:

A shaman? That would make you very popular among fans of "Eat, Pray, Love" but I think you are closer to what is described in letter IX.

You can count on my prayers for you and your family.

visionsofglory14 on 2013-10-18 at 11:28 said:

I know you personally, and I read your blog.

Thorsten on 2013-10-18 at 12:04 said:

"Since then I have no patience with those who deny the spirituality of those knights in favour of some remote, imaginary paganism. Particularly, since they are usually crude, vulgar, and ungentlemanly about it." I've made it clear that I am not denying the spirituality of those knights or of any of the other knights of that era. On the utter contrary... in order to defend their spirituality I think a Transformation would have to make it clear that this is the western Tradition, in other words the Indo-European Tradition. To that end would it not be necessary for the symbolism, that is to say the exoteric shape of Christianity, which has evidently lead so many astray to be adjusted? It has been repeated to me that Guenon and all other traditionalists authorities make it clear that a religion must undergo a spontaneous transformation (correct me if I'm wrong) by revelation. I understand this and am awaiting it just like anyone else who is convinced of this truth. I've simply indicated what I believe will be one or two of the exoteric characteristics of such a transformed faith. Why this modest assertion has been so misunderstood eludes me.

"That is when I learned the lesson of specificity. It is difficult to provide specifics, so most people just fake it, counting on the audience to "know" what they mean. Thus we hear about a vague, unspecified "Indo-European tradition", not unlike Chomsky's universal grammar; of course, you cannot specify it. Curiously, we have just written about this, but some readers don't know how to learn a lesson."

I'm not aware of any one who has done research to determine the underlying metaphysics represented in Indo-European myth and cosmologies but it should be possible in theory. I assumed most here had at least heard of Indo-European studies (http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Indo-European_studies) which is a natural companion science to studying Traditionalism in the context of European culture. Evola was evidently pretty well read in the literature in this field during his lifetime at least as far as the writings of Georges Dumézil are concerned. I don't see why suggesting the relevance of this discipline is out of place, let alone indicative of any attempts to obfuscate. In the interest of the spirit of free inquiry which I recall being written of positively here not too long ago, I would expect I.E. studies to be of interest in a place where the "hyperborean tradition" has been referenced on so many occasions.

"The philosopher is the lover of wisdom, but it is still not the state of being wise. When

Jesus said we must love our enemy, it means we need to transcend all points of view and see things as they are." I've indicated the possibility of a coming religion which may arise that transcends the viewpoint of one historical manifestation of the divine, while gathering into itself other manifestations of the divine. In sum a religion in which Christ is one avatar among many, and in which it is no longer possible to mistake his charity and sacrifice as some form of "Bolshevism of the ancient world", as it was nothing of the sort. Would this not be a solar view point transcending any illusory false dichotomies? I thought this suggestion would be received as "irenic", rather than "eristic" approach.

In any event, Cologero the best of health to you and your son, and the best of luck on the birth of your grandson. Your work is appreciated very much and has made a deep impact on me, and will continue to do so.

P.S. I look forward to discussing the symbolism of the New Testament when I'm done reading the Jung text.

Sincerely,
Thorsten

Ash on 2013-10-18 at 19:32 said:

Thank you for this post. Understandably, we want to in many ways minimize our "personal equations" when undertaking this study, but I certainly benefit from hearing about the experiences that led you and others here. My own blog has fewer readers than yours, I'm sure, in many ways due to the somewhat chaotic posting schedule. I am always impressed that you are able to write as voluminously as you do.

Speaking for myself, the reason I abandoned an economics/political science combined major for my current focus in food systems and agricultural economics is precisely the observations you yourself reported. I grew tired of the "fluff" that came with them, even in philosophy. I can work with something solid, with results. I can earn a living that, Providence willing, will be based on the Traditional principles manifesting in what I do. When I discuss philosophy or politics with friends in those disciplines, I'm doubtless the "kook" in the situation. But then, the holy fool has a very unique freedom.

I was just recently criticized by a friend for being too "aggressive" in my argumentation, picking at arguments in ways that come across as arguing for the sake of argument. Strangely enough, it came up in the conversation that the friend considered moral philosophy to be, in the end, just a matter of interest which in the real world paled in comparison to other factors such as moral intuitions. Your last words in this post are undoubtedly worth pondering.

I will keep you and your family, born and unborn, in my own prayers.

@Thorsten: The future religion you describe sounds like it has some similarities to the Baha'i heresy, which also holds that Christ, Muhammad, Krishna, and others were "equal avatars."

Could you explain what you hold Christ to be? Is he unique in being the Logos and as “Messiah”? Are other avatars incarnations of other aspects of the Divinity?

Cologero on 2013-10-24 at 00:35 said:

I was referring to “Carl Rogers”, who was an influential psychologist back in the dat.

3.8 The Ventriloquist and the Dummy

Despite appearances, this article is the prequel to a post in the Sanatana Dharma.

At a small prestigious university just outside of Boston, I was first exposed to the ideas of the New Left. The goal of Vatican II was to make the faith intelligible to modern man, but its effect was to make it irrelevant. If you think like a modern, then why not embrace it fully?

Left to my own devices, I attempted to meld a worldview out of elements from **Alan Watts**, **Timothy Leary**, **Carlos Castaneda** on the one hand and the New Left on the other. I was to explore those ideologies in some depth. The benefit of that exercise is that I understand the assumptions and forms of logic associated with those movements, so I am sensitive to their effects. That is unlike most of my cohort who have not had a new idea since the age of 19, although they are materially intelligent and nominally educated. Hence, they are dead-certain about their opinions with no real understanding of their intellectual sources.

I was a reader of *Ramparts* magazine and the *Guardian* newspaper. Although turgid, the analyses presented in the latter were detailed and logically coherent, at least as I now remember them. That is still a model to follow.

Of course, the master at that time was **Herbert Marcuse**, the “Evola of the left” (although Evola was utterly invisible at that time). It would be a mistake to underestimate his intelligence and prescience, and I still feel

his influence. His accomplishment was to reconnect Marxism with German Idealism, existentialism, and more famously, with Freudian psychology. There were three lessons in particular that have been long lasting. It is always a benefit to wrestle with serious thought, even if one ultimately disagrees with it.

In *Reason and Revolution*, Marcuse made the case that rationality cannot be restricted to mathematics and positive science. At that time positivism was a dominant philosophical movement and I simply assumed that physics was the only rational approach to the world. Idealism presumes that ideas or consciousness transcend empirical thought. That provided the intellectual cover to embrace someone like an Alan Watts. I preferred his earlier books since they were an attempt to relate Christianity to the *philosophia perennis*; it was there that I first read the name Rene Guenon, although it would be quite some time before I became acquainted with his actual works.

The next lesson was that Marcuse provided a link from the thought of the community and the individual man's consciousness. Marxism itself had no psychology, so the process from social change to the mental states of the individual was left unclear. I saw Marcuse as demonstrating a continuity from the group to the individual; that is something I still accept.

Unfortunately, Marcuse used the Freudian model for man's psychology. In a sense, it is a reworking and a distortion of traditional psychology. The id was the source of instinctual impulses, particularly the libido and willfulness. Hence, it embraces both the eros and the thymos. The ego is the empirical self, but its purpose in that system is to satisfy the urges of the id. The superego is the transcendent element in the psyche. However, it is not a true transcendence but represents the internalization of the thought of the community. Therefore, by modifying the social forms and relations, the superego is altered, thereby affecting the individual, presumably "liberating" him.

That leads to the third lesson, which is the connection between sexual liberation and the overturning of patriarchal, hierarchal social arrangements, as described in his masterwork, *Eros and Civilization*. Without going into all the details about “surplus repression”, the premise is that technology would alleviate man’s need to work. By overthrowing the patriarchal system that represses humans through the superego, man would become “polymorphously perverse”, that is, his entire body, not just the genital region, would become sexually aware and a source of pleasure. There would then be no restriction of sexual satisfaction.

The truth of this insight is all too obvious; the more the former order of things is overturned, the more demand there is for perverse sexuality. However, this is not at all a sign of liberation as was expected and is still claimed, but rather a tool of manipulation. Once the superego has lost whatever tenuous connection it may have had with the cosmic order, then almost any thoughts can be imprinted in the minds of those addicted to sexual expression. The reason is obvious. The overthrow of the cosmic order does not result in a new order of things, but rather in a lack of order, or chaos. This is nothing new, whatever you may have been told in certain circles. For a cultural history of the use of sex as a form of social control, I recommend the works of E Michael Jones.

Drinking for Free After graduation, I may have been able to continue along those lines had I entered a “soft” field like education, psychology, politics, or government service for example. Many others did and their effects have colored that past forty years.

Instead I was involved with mathematics, actuarial science, and eventually computer technology. It was a world of work unlike that described in the periodicals I used to work. The effort necessary to move people and matter is quite different from manipulating words on a page.

Beyond that, dating suddenly became much more formal, and there were no longer hippy chicks available to perpetuate the former lifestyle.

You first had to call, you had to plan a dinner, etc. I recall early on meeting someone at a club. When I called her a few days later and heard her infant crying in the background, I abruptly hung up on her. Unwed motherhood was still not socially acceptable, even for a wannabe radical.

At that time the disco era was peaking along with the popularity of backgammon. Different clubs would have a backgammon tournament before the music started, with prize money running from \$50 to \$100 or so. Unlike today, you could have a good time at a club with that much cash. Since there are few things more satisfying than getting a drink for free, and I was pretty skilled at the game, I was sure to show up for those contests. More often than not, I would get some of that cash, and it was like drinking for free.

There was one tournament that I recall being paired against an older woman from New York. Falling behind, I made the only move that would give me any chance for victory. On my next roll I hit the double-sixes and took the game. She became visibly annoyed and pointed out that I had made a really bad move. Unfortunately for her case, unlike a sport like gymnastics, you don't get any "style" points in backgammon.

She had no idea how to deal with the goddess Fortuna. She probably read a book on the game or took a lesson at her condo clubhouse. In vain did she expect that by following some rules or guidelines she could control Fortuna. Not at all, although you must never put the Lord, thy God, to the test, you should always test Fortuna.

The Last Dummy Besides backgammon, there were other ways to win money at a club. One club had a talent night with a cash prize, so I decided on a gambit. I approached an attractive young woman and convinced her to enter the contest as a faux ventriloquist act. I would play the ventriloquist and she the dummy. She would just have to sit on my lap while I stuck my hand up her back and pretended to pull a string behind her head. She would just have to open and close her mouth and

move her head around as I told jokes.

She went for the idea except she insisted that she be the ventriloquist and I the dummy. I did what I could, but she wasn't funny, so we got yanked off the stage. When I phoned her a few days later a man answered and called her to the phone. In the background I could hear voices and laughter, something about the "guy from the talent show". She was non-committal about a date and seemed reticent to talk. I sensed I was being taken for the dummy. Since there was no move that could result in victory no matter how the dice rolled, I resolved that my life would have to take a more serious turn.

Posted on 2013-10-28 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2013-10-28 at 12:06 said:

Confucius said, "Someone who spends all his time fulfilling his appetites and never once exercises his mind is a hard case indeed. There are games of luck and chance. It would be better to play those than to do nothing." (17.22)

For those unfamiliar with Herbert Marcuse, I wrote about him here:

<http://avery.morrow.name/blog/2012/07/herbert-marcuse-the-original-tumblard/>

3.9 The Evil Demiurge of the Modern World

In Gnosticism, the Demiurge was the creator of the material world. In opposition to the God, the Demiurge is evil and malevolent, creating a world that hides the true God by entrapping souls in illusion and materiality. The world picture of the modern world is the result of believing the Demiurge.

Hermetic practice must begin with a process of unknowing. That is, one's habitually conditioned modes of thought must be deconditioned. Everything assumed or taken for granted must be rethought.

Ideas, worldviews, or “memes” enter into the thinking of the world, or noosphere, in three stages:

1. The first tier of intelligence creates a new system of thought. Such thinkers may be wickedly intelligent. They latch onto a fixed idea and then develop an architectonic system based on it.
2. The second tier absorbs and propagates the ideas from the first tier. These thinkers are in a position to understand the ideas of the first tier. Since ideas are fundamental to them, they are eager to seek out new ideas. Motivated by the need for novelty, intellectual gluttony, and a revolutionary spirit, they draw out the conclusions and diffuse the ideas through publications and educational institutions.
3. The third tier then accepts the ideas uncritically. They have sufficient intelligence to learn the ideas yet lack the depth of insight to reach the roots of the worldview. For this group, certain ideas act as “status markers”, that is, they are used to separate the “educated” from the masses. Articulateness is more important than depth of understanding.

Julius Evola calls the process of unknowing the Trial by Fire⁹. When done properly, it can seem to lead to the brink of insanity although there are sufficient buffers to avoid going over the edge for a healthy person. I can describe that process at another time, but the first step is to understand the sources of one’s thinking.

Founding Fathers When I was a young man, I managed to forge a world view founded on Physics, **Charles Darwin**, **Sigmund Freud**, and **Karl Marx**. This would provide a complete explanation of the World: it accounts for matter, life, mind, and society. Around the ages of 10 and

⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1902>

11, I was sent to weekly science classes at the Boston Museum of Science. While waiting to be picked up, I spent time at the library, reading books mostly on astronomy and mathematics, with a particular attachment to the four volume *World of Mathematics* by James Newman. At home, I had a small library of books on astronomy, physics, space travel, rocketry, and dinosaurs, so I was well-disposed to make science the bedrock of my worldview.

Later, at University, I was exposed to the ideas of the New Left. I spent many hours reading turgid Marxian analyses of current events. The more interesting books combined Marx and Freud: those by **Wilhelm Reich**, *Eros and Civilization* by **Herbert Marcuse**, and *Life Against Death* by **Norman O Brown**. That completed the sequence as I read more deeply in psychoanalysis: Freud, Jung, Adler, Fromm, Horney, and so on.

Life on Earth is motivated by Fear, Sex, and Hunger, which maintain us in bondage. This constructed worldview promised liberation from all that. Unlike Buddhism which teaches the desire leads to suffering, the Modern view is the repression of desire leads to suffering. Repression comes from the superego on the individual level and from the patriarchal hierarchy on the social level. So all sexual expression is healthy. I went from high school where, in guidance classes, the issue of premarital sex was still unresolved, to university where the *Harrad Experiment* was a popular book. Oddly enough, the free sex of the Experiment has morphed into contractual sex on campuses where any breach of contract can lead to a Kafkaesque inquisition. Nevertheless, certain practices that were considered immoral, unhealthy, and illegal are now generally accepted as normal. The surprise is the persistence of just a few sexual taboos, but that may yet change. We are left now with greater incidences of incurable venereal diseases, date rape, illegitimacy, abortion, pornography, and so on. Whether all this is a sign of “liberation” or an indication of a general malaise is an exercise left to the reader.

In the social realm, Marxism was supposed to lead to abundance, thus

solving the problem of hunger (in the larger sense). Since consciousness was formed by the material conditions of life, man's mind would be freed for higher pursuits. The worker would return home for discussions in the High Culture of art, philosophy, and so on. That never happened¹⁰. Nowadays, the worker returns home, gets stoned or drunk, and then watches mindless TV shows, sports spectacles, and Internet porn.

The third motivation, Fear, has been intractable because the problem of death has not been solved. **Ernest Becker** described this in psychoanalytic terms in the *Denial of Death*. The Existentialists brought doubt into the project of liberation via sexual restraint and material abundance. The Transhumanists and Cosmists believe that this problem, too, will be solved. That post is scheduled for the near future.

The Secret Mysterian Oddly enough, I also had a Mysterian thread in my thinking life that was nourished at the same time. It can actually be traced back to childhood, but that is another discussion. The brother of a friend used to give out copies of *The Book*, by **Alan Watts**, which I read. It was unlike anything I had been familiar with, and his other books were my first introduction to the name Rene Guenon. Somehow I balanced this type of neo-Vedanta with an interest in science and psychoanalysis. I believe that my preference for spicy and picante foods prevented me from falling completely into Cogni-ism.

Nevertheless, at the third tier, the four pillars of science, evolution, psychology, and liberalism/socialism, perhaps tinged with some New Age spirituality, even Cogni-ism, supports the worldview of the “educated” person today. Thom Hartmann, whose talk show inscrutably airs nightly on Russia Today TV, is one of the more self-aware exemplars of that.

Part 2 will feature the tactics of the Demiurge.

Posted on 2015-10-28 by Cologero

¹⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1582>

* * *

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-29 at 03:32 said:

"World picture of the modern world is the result of believing in the Demiurge." This struck me as very important because I've seen a lot of neo-gnostics in alternative media lately promoting gnostic worldview, this simplified Dualism. It's a Hollywood style of good guys vs bad guys type of thing. I was puzzled by the Demiurge question for a while in the past. Starting with Plato, he obviously didn't talk about the Demiurge that Gnostics later had in mind.

Is it the personification of what Guenon called Countertradition? Personified Maya? Or Samsara? Whatever it is, I understand it's a part of the cycle, of Oneness, becoming to us the unnecessary evil but it's only a shift in balance of rising tides of antitradition during Kali yuga, not some cosmic alien overlord leading the army of Archonts and wanting to overthrow God. Dualism of two principles isn't just simplified version but a fundamentally wrong version. This may as well be the source of maya.

This Demiurge is unnecessary not just in some abstract cosmic cycle way but for our own realization. It has a practical, personal side. But I wonder what comes after those Evolian trials by fire, suffering and love?

Also, I see the Left as a manifestation of this sinister current. Luciferian, revolutionary, Promethean and eventually self-binding. It opposes every social restraint and hierarchical order set by the Right or what they call Patriarchy.

Great article, can't wait for the second part.

Thomas Blanchard on 2015-10-29 at 11:44 said:

Powerful writing.

With regard to how the Marxian future was supposed to be, it's interesting to look at science fiction. "Star Trek: The Next Generation" is probably the clearest exposition of this vision of the future, where men don't have to work, money is abolished, and all expend their energies and lives "improving themselves" and becoming more cultured. It's an attractive vision, if unrealistic. However, I think that for well-oriented person living today, it is possible to profit by taking this approach toward life. Much less effort is required today for survival and sustenance – one can either be seduced and distracted like the masses, or choose to use the unparalleled opportunity for self-development.

Another interesting dichotomy that science fiction has illustrated is that between a future in which man has developed, but dominated and subordinated his technology, his spirituality and heroism acting as primary foundation of civilization, and a future in which man is as crude and vulgar (or perhaps morose) as he is today, and is completely reliant on his machines and gadgets for his brute power. This dichotomy was depicted most starkly in 1997 videogame, "StarCraft", in

the contrast between the Protoss (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-DJ2r01o0UE>) and Terran (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4tdTdnrLVa0>) races.

klamuse on 2015-10-29 at 14:46 said:

Abstract beauty in Plato, or the Idea, is not the highest beauty but is in reality only a secondary definition of the most beautiful material object, or supermaterial objects of Godhood at the zenith of evolution. As in Plato, Godhood remains the point of reference for absolute beauty, and for goodness, but it is not the non-material “beauty” of Plato. The Great Spiritual Blockade to real beauty and real Godhood is this way unblocked in art, as well as in philosophy and religion, as we understand that we evolve to Godhood in the material and supermaterial world.

Plato says only once in his writings (according to Whitney Oates) that God creates the sacred Ideas, but in the rest of Plato he says life is the creation of the Demiurge, which is right in line with the esoteric understanding in traditional religion which rejects materialism by following the Inward Path and not the Outward Path to Godhood. To them God is not material or supermaterial but non-material—God is a sacred Idea or Word, or a so-called non-material blissful symbolic experience.

Contrary to Plato, life evolves to Godhood in the material and supermaterial world... The big difference from Plato and the traditionalists comes in my defining Godhood as material and supermaterial, as that which we evolve to become in the material world.

This is a different religious understanding from the ones you usually hear, I hope you give it fair attention.

K. L. Anderson

Traveller on 2015-10-29 at 15:11 said:

Thanks for your, as usual, excellent insights and observations. The “demiurge” element has been a problem floating around in my thoughts for a while now (i.e., is it just conceptual reification based on attitude), so it was interesting to see it come up here.

One comment: Your “fear, sex and hunger” are of course included in the first of the three poisons in Buddhism – attachment (the other two being anger and ignorance), but only to maintain the sense that Buddhism “teaches desire leads to suffering” has always seemed incomplete, and a more contextualized sense would actually turn to attachment itself as that which is already part of our existential predicament (with desire only one kind of attachment). Hence, suffering is that which must necessarily be endured (to suffer = to endure) but not be attached to the experience of it. Perhaps this is why, for instance, it is said that bodhicitta should be extended towards the self even before it is extended to the Other.

Also, it's worth pointing out the Buddhist sense in which attachment and karma are connected; that we're only here through our many transmigrations because we haven't yet exhausted

all of our karmic streams. However, it does seem that many beings actually generate karma for the sake of experience, just as some children are drawn to things under prohibition, like fire, in order to learn from getting burned. So, apropos of your comments around taboos and disease, as well as various dead ends of intellectual pursuits, the movement of many through various forms of malaise which you cited is an important part of their learning curve... thankfully, some of us no longer need the lessons.

As for the Demiurge, in this light, although it may well be a result of dualistic vision, it perhaps is necessary for some beings, in reasons suggested above, for working through their "stuff," whether as conscious projection or unconscious (karmic) manipulation... who knows? The true scope of the field of interdependence, sometimes called reality, is vast and largely inaccessible, although science likes to think it possesses a high degree of legitimate access, while taking its own limitations to be the furthest extent of intelligence... In the end, perhaps intuition can be valuable for sorting through these kinds of things.

Bryan M. M. Reynolds on 2015-10-29 at 16:01 said:

Thanks, Cologero

Exú on 2015-10-29 at 20:15 said:

Aleksandar

"But I wonder what comes after those Evolian trials by fire, suffering and love?"

What comes after is the acquire of a self, of a permanent center, that will function in union and harmonie with existence

yourusernameistaken on 2015-10-30 at 03:30 said:

This was a powerful post for me. I am undertaking a MsC, and being of a "spiritual" bent, I often feel as if higher education is a double-edged sword. One could take it to good place, being motivated in service, or one could use it to secure a good job where one could... as said, work, return home and get drunk and stoned only to watch porn.

Political Prisoner on 2015-10-30 at 10:01 said:

Why are there always fluff pieces posted here consisting mostly of petty attacks and a sprinkling of actual information? You've been playing to the crowd cologero. You should have your own talk show, you're a natural.

Mark Citadel on 2015-10-30 at 13:34 said:

It is profound in biblical terms that we are asked to choose between God and the world. Some may see this as a horrific choice imposed upon man, but I feel exactly the opposite. It

is liberating in the most extreme sense. Serving greater ends puts the world in its true place, below the feet of the Divine Realm. Serve God, and the world is unmasked as the enemy.

I have for well over a year now spoken against the Transhumanist dreams of eliminating death and thus fear. Utopian fantasia at its worst. Why would we not embrace death, unless we were not saved and redeemed? Conquer death? As foolish as thinking you can escape God.

Tulkas on 2015-10-30 at 16:54 said:

"I am the source of all spiritual and material worlds. Everything emanates from Me. The wise who know this perfectly engage in My devotional service and worship Me with all their hearts."

The notion that the material world is the creation of an evil false god is unique to gnosticism. The major world religions teach us that god created the earthly realm. The gnostic mistake is likely what led to the current revolt against nature (human nature, gender, race, heterosexuality etc) and the planned synthetic re-write of nature (genetic modification, geo-engineering, cyborgism). If nature and the human body are the work of an evil entity rather than a loving god, why not improve them?

Alistair Fraser on 2015-10-30 at 20:15 said:

Here are my words of personalised meditations on the demiurgical force for this evening, using the terminology of the i-consciousness as the signifier of the individual personas now manifested on this planetarium.

There is a perfectly understandable and simplistic model for a demiurgical force in this realm of the planetarium.

Each i-consciousness has a negated or evolved sporadic or intentionalised direct connection into the psychic realm which is located in parallel with the visible planetarium and does affect directly to indirectly (time proportionate depending on evolved certainty) what shall manifest into the realm of their physical senses.

It can be speculated that there is an overseer of control in this psychic realm but also that there is a law of development in that the personas that take the care to evolve their understanding can also evolve their conscious psychic influence on "occurrences to be" It is also possible that just being a good persona in a non-conscious intuited manner can produce similar improvements, although much more ltd in comparison to the "hero"

Now bearing in mind that one either believes that their life has or has no eternal purpose, this belief also directly affects what "occurs" based on the ambiguity or sincerity of that evolved belief in the persona.

Let us then put forth the proposition that the unspoken undefinable overseer has put in place a form of test for these inhabitants of the planetarium which not only spans all passing of time, space and culture, but also spans all levels of development of the psyche.

And this test manifests through the apparent to very real (proportionately believable by the order of ones investment into occurrences to be) by using the analogy of at every moment in ones existence, there is placed before one, a rabbit hole or rabbit holes that offer up excellent rewards both instantly perceivable or some more intricate in their perceived rewards .

Some of these holes are genuine and contain solutions to progress, others are the demiurge imposing its absolute knowledge of you to you , but you can't quite see or even believe in this possibility unless you are a "hero"

The first sign of the hole is through an apparent spontaneous occurrence which catches the attention and tempts the i-consciousness , once the i-consciousness locks on to the lure, the hole begins to be dug by they , now here is the important part, either on first sniff, first dig, or some ways down that hole, the i-consciousness will by way of its direct connection into the psychic realm receive a warning that something does not feel right , (bearing in mind that the demiurge can also confuse feelings to spoil an immense opportunity that it sees before thee) this is the moment where a lesson is learned or ignored, and so these lures continue, not just for the unaware i-consciousness but equally for the very well developed i-consciousnesses because they can be seen as larger prey for the demiurgical force.

In this manner of ongoing potential traps set in place by the demiurge under the absolute authority of the overseer , a persona is constantly tested in their sincerity of heart and clarification of purpose.

Then as both sincerity of heart and clarification of purpose are both in themselves attenuating conditions ,through both psychic and physical stimuli , the path of life is much more complex and challenging than is recorded .

Let me just project a motion of the hero that has evolved its i-consciousness to a level that demands (occurrences fall to its pleasing) when the timing is correct, the hero can do great works with incredible influence, but within this works also is agitated an excitation of the heroes ego, and if they fail to recognise and defuse this excitation , then the demiurge rubs its hands as the excitation can blind the hero to the subliminised absolute co-ordination of occurrence and the hero dares to think whilst in this excited propulsion and therein lays heightened danger for "occurrences" as the demiurge rubs its handsin excitement , in that very hero , there is the riddle of the thing in and off itself .

Silence is golden at the decisive crossings whispered the grand old lady to thine.

White Rabbit on 2015-10-31 at 00:24 said:

Tulkas: that is certainly a unique theory. However, if it's true you will have to explain why modernity is so hedonistic, materialistic, and aspiritual. Anyways, because it does not discriminate, egalitarianism actually extends its love to the whole world, so it hardly opposes the Demiurge.

As for engineering the world, the state of nature is brutal. Should we live like animals in the woods? Why not improve it?

Logres on 2015-11-11 at 19:31 said:

"The Transhumanists and Cosmists believe that this problem, too, will be solved. That post is scheduled for the near future..."

I remember the first time I browsed a copy of *The Promethean*, in which it was claimed that man would download his consciousness onto computer chips, thus living forever and conquering Death. Someone has been watching too many re-runs of *Tron*. As an acquaintance of mine remarked, if it were done, the first message we would get back, recycled 30 million times a second, would be "Turn It OFF".

Bryan M. M. Reynolds on 2015-11-12 at 07:26 said:

@Logres, professor John Gray evidently develops such a thesis about modern gnosticism in his book *The Soul of the Marionette*. I haven't read it myself but it sounds interesting.

Akira on 2015-12-09 at 22:19 said:

although there are sufficient buffers to avoid going over the edge for a healthy person

This assumes that the products of the modern west are in any way healthy.

Approach the trial by fire with great care, and assume nothing.

Those who attempt it without a strong hermetic or meditative discipline are risking a direct experience with the negative principle that they literally may not survive.

3.10 Polymaths and Self-Creation

A way stands open into heaven, but none can enter the way except those who have heaven within them.

EMANUEL SWEDENBORG

It is very difficult to become an expert in one field. To become expert in two or more fields is extraordinary. Such a person is called a polymath

and several polymaths have always intrigued me. The most obvious recent examples are Leonardo da Vinci¹¹ and Johann Wolfgang Goethe. Da Vinci's accomplishments in art, science, and technology are well known. Goethe was a dramatist and poet, while his scientific studies in fields like optics and biology have been neglected. A book recommended by **Wolfgang Smith**, *The Wholeness of Nature* by **Henri Bortoft**, provides a good explanation of Goethe's science of conscious participation in nature. Bortoft's training in visualization provided the key to understand Goethe.

Some will use a related term, the **Renaissance Man**, in place of polymath, although that is more like a well-rounded man, who does well in many disparate areas of his life, rather than as a specialist in a few. **Baldesar Castiglione**, in *The Book of the Courtier*, describes this type, as we summarized in The Duty of the Wise Man¹². Castiglione combines the duties of the courtier with the virtuous life. The goal is to consciously create a "single whole" out of one's life, which in most men is fragmented, random, and factitious. There are some polymaths whose lives I have studied in some depth at different points in my life.

Albert Schweitzer was a medical doctor who practiced as a medical missionary in Africa, much of which he documented. He made original contributions in theology, in philosophy through his ideal of Reverence for Life, and in the music of J S Bach. He was also an expert in church organs as well as a proficient instrumentalist.

Alfred North Whitehead was an expert in logic, math, science, and philosophy. After a career as a mathematics professor, he switched to philosophy. He opposed the Cartesian theory of bifurcation, and integrated qualities and creativity into a scientific worldview. At that time, I was more interested in holism and evolutionistic views. Nevertheless, just as **Arthur Lovejoy** showed how the idea of the Great Chain of Being was

¹¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Leonardo_da_Vinci

¹²<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3187>

flattened out into an evolutionary worldview in time, it may be possible to make Whitehead's metaphysics more hierarchical. You can see how this might look in our posts on how Providence works in relationship to Will and Destiny. At every moment, Providence offers us creative "possibilities of manifestation" (Guenon's term), which we can integrate into our life. This does not require Whitehead's notion of a God in evolution.

Swedenborg Since we've been discussing the role of "imagination" in our Monday Gnosis seminars, this is opportune to bring up another polymath, **Emmanuel Swedenborg**. He began as a scientist and engineer, making contributions to metallurgy, geometry, chemistry, physiology, and then became interested in philosophy. Late in life, he began to have visionary and clairvoyant experiences which he described in several books.

His writings were important among Martinist and Hermetic groups, although **Valentin Tomberg** makes just a passing reference to him. Yet his ideas resonated beyond that. Curiously, the Zen Buddhist **D T Suzuki** wrote about Swedenborg, translated his books into Japanese, and referred to him as the "Buddha of the North". I suppose this connection to Buddhism should not be surprising, as Swedenborg referred to some lost teachings among the Sages of Tibet and of Tartary. I learned this from **Rene Guenon**¹³. This idea was confirmed by the Catholic mystic **Anne Catherine Emmerich**. In the **Mountain of the Prophet**, also in Tibet, she saw the holy books of all the Traditions revealed to mankind. The point is that "Mankind was not yet capable of receiving these gifts, another must first come." That led me to explore Tibetan Buddhism, as well as the writings of **Alice Bailey** and **Nicholas Roerich** to find those secret teachings. Perhaps I did not look hard enough and stopped too soon. It is an unfinished project, which I've hinted at, to use Madhyamika philosophy to express the metaphysics of Tradition.

¹³<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=972>

Henry Corbin, the scholar of esoteric Islam, was also intensely interested in Swedenborg's ideas. He demonstrated a correspondence between Swedenborg's visions and mystical visions described in Islam. For them, there are three worlds: the sensory world, the world of the imagination, and the world of the intellect. The intermediate world of the imagination is the one described by the seers. A full review of those writings might be a good topic for the future. I know the interest will not be widespread, but it will be very intense for a few of us.

Nevertheless, the American Sufi Charles Upton, *pace* Corbin, writes this about Swedenborg:

That a great deal of profound doctrines can be found in Swedenborg's writings is undeniable. But now that the scriptures and classic of the world religions and the writings of history's greatest sages are readily available, we no longer need to take him as uniquely inspired authorities since we can judge them in the light of their orthodox originals ... there is no longer any reason to rely upon suspect sources. ... Since such doctrines were not available to a Swedish Lutheran of the 18th century, it was necessary to reintroduce them via direct inspiration.

While it is true that we don't need to take Swedenborg as "uniquely inspired", it is nevertheless still the case that his contributions to our understanding of the imaginal or astral realm has not been reintroduced into the mainstream of Western Tradition. **E F Schumacher** mentioned the visionaries **Edgar Cayce** and **Jakob Lorber** in *The Guide for the Perplexed*, as guides to his fields of knowledge.

Self-Creation When I was a young man, I realized my life as a mathematician was becoming detrimental to my social life. Time series differential equations or obscure issues in algebraic topology are conversation stoppers. So I resolved to become a latter day courtier, a Renaissance Man

of sorts. I already has some expertise in mathematics and physics, I was more literary than most, and fortunately I was reasonably athletic. Although, as a proper Bostonian, I was taught ballroom dancing, I had to learn the Hustle, and later, Salsa, on my own.

In order to take on certain qualities I thought I was missing in my life, I began an intense study of the works of **Harold Robbins** – certainly not great literature, but a good description of a world that was alien to me. But I always took literature personally. Earlier, I had read most of **Jack Kerouac**’s works and then **Henry Miller** and **Lawrence Durrell**; I adopted what I read into my own life and self-image. I saw myself in Joseph Conrad’s books. From Hesse, I decided I was a combination of **Steppenwolf** and **Siddhartha**; my life course has been close to both.

This process took several years. I developed a solid workout program, I took creative writing classes, a Dale Carnegie course, seminars at the Florida Speaker’s Association, and even acting classes. I was motivated by **Nietzsche**’s injunction:

To “give style” to one’s character– a great and rare art! It is practiced by those who survey all the strengths and weaknesses of their nature and then fit them into an artistic plan until every one of them appears as art and reason and even weaknesses delight the eye. Here a large mass of second nature has been added; there a piece of original nature has been removed — both times through long practice and daily work at it. Here the ugly that could not be removed is concealed; there it has been reinterpreted and made sublime. Much that is vague and resisted shaping has been saved and exploited for distant views; it is meant to beckon toward the far and immeasurable. In the end, when the work is finished, it becomes evident how the constraint of a single taste governed and formed everything large and small. Whether this taste was good or bad is less important than one might suppose, if only it was a single taste!

A human birth is too precious to let one's life be governed solely by chance. I learned the doctrinal basis for my task only later on. Of course, I had done an experiment recommended by Aleister Crowley as a way of freeing up one's personality; this was described in *Aghori of the Mind*¹⁴.

Tibetan Buddhism involves visualization practices. A common one is to see oneself in a mandala of the Buddha, gods, goddesses, and enlightened beings. I asked my guru what the purpose of that was. He explained that we are constantly creating a self-image subconsciously, without thought. We can create a new self-image as an enlightened being.

In high school they used to draw a curtain across the gymnasium to separate the boys from the girls in physical education classes. I used to visualize a different education during those classes. But that sort of daydreaming is passive and a waste of our sexual energies. Visualizing myself as a sort of Renaissance Man, a "man about town", successful in business and with women, did bring me a not insignificant degree of self-mastery, as I became able to overcome an inherent introversion in situations where it is not suitable.

Ultimately, then, I could visualize myself in an icon of the communion of saints like the Buddhists do. Beyond that, there is the world of pure intellect, beyond all images and thoughts.

Posted on 2016-05-30 by Cologero

* * *

Mr Man on 2016-05-30 at 04:08 said:
Lookin good, Toni!

Tom on 2016-05-30 at 11:30 said:
Fascinating insight into your personal development. I too used to read Kerouac and Miller and am guilty of styling myself as a Milleresque figure in my early twenties. I think perhaps it is hard not to take literature personally at that stage in life when one is so ready to be influenced.

¹⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3214>

I wonder, perhaps self indulgently, how I might have benefited from earlier exposure to more spiritual literature and Traditional perspectives but fate goes ever as it must.

Alistair Fraser on 2016-05-30 at 18:53 said:

"I had to learn the Hustle, and later, Salsa, on my own. '

Looking more like the "american gigolo" in that image cologero its good for the soul :-)

Thx for the rundown of some previous applications – a lot of pro-active movements there , a possible review of the said correspondence sounds of importance

francismmercuri on 2016-05-30 at 22:17 said:

Interesting piece. Something I take away from it is a description of a movement from life stage to life stage:

Beginning with "polymath", man engages in "doing something" in the world, and (attempting/striving to) become a master of it—so, the "perfection of the human state".

Further beyond worldly and skilled "prowess" comes the need to clean up the mind and imagination; mastery of the "astral", correcting sloppy and slipshod use of the apparently never ending stream of consciousness we all take for granted—akin to what Guenon describes as "psychic regeneration", or as is represented in certain Initiatic cycles as a "second degree", "fellow", or "journeyman".

Lastly, one arrives at the point where all acquired worldly skill, and visualization expertise conclude, perhaps surprisingly—at "nothing"—from "successful polymath" to an "accomplished" apophatic.

In tandem with this post's personal nature/disclosure, I think a very useful spiritual exercise involves keeping a diary. A regular diary is a surefire tool in the game of developing self-awareness.

O on 2016-12-09 at 19:51 said:

"Perhaps I did not look hard enough and stopped too soon. It is an unfinished project, which I've hinted at, to use Madhyamika philosophy to express the metaphysics of Tradition."

If this is an unfinished project, why do you discourage those of us with a firm grounding in the Western Traditional metaphysicists as well as a strong attraction to Buddhism from pursuing such a course in terms of initiation and practical traditional affiliation? For what you are mentioning won't happen if no one coming from our position delves deeply enough into those Vajrayana mysteries, which is only possible if studying and practicing under the guidance of a qualified master.

In terms of this particular goal, you certainly stopped too soon. The Tibetan tradition is ultra-complex, with diverse branches and many dimensions. While the Gelug order is good for

dry scholastic Madhyamaka, it is not the best place to look for the most profound yogic mysteries. The Zhentong Madhyamaka Tantra approach of the more obscure Jonangpas is also much closer to the viewpoint of Western Traditionalists.

O on 2016-12-09 at 20:15 said:

Suzuki's praise for Swedenborg as "the Buddha of the North" is curious to say the least. He was certainly a 'genius' (a questionable concept as Schuon demonstrated in 'To have a Centre') in his way, and a man of unusual psychic powers, but that doesn't equal true 'enlightenment'/awakening or gnosis. Doctrinally he was hardly orthodox. To Fr Seraphim Rose, he was a kind of counter-initiate. I think it's safe to say that his overall influence on the spiritual landscape of Europe has been subversive; which isn't to say that a man of good discernment cannot find valid element in his works.

Cologero on 2016-12-11 at 10:37 said:

Bear in mind that the original impulse came from Murti's "Central Philosophy of Buddhism", in which he relates Madhyamkia to Western thought. Murti was also knowledgeable about Guenon and referred explicitly to the idea of using Madhyamkia rather than the Vedanta. This is a very early post here: *Buddhism and Tradition*¹⁵

This was written five years later: *The Esoteric Path*¹⁶, and it may explain something to you.

As a matter of practicality, I cannot work on a couple of blogs, do translations, etc., and also work on this project. I doubt I would discourage anyone, also I would encourage him to at least start with Murti's book, even if it seems dry and scholastic.

From a personal point of view, I've been disappointed with the Dalai Lama who seems to have become Westernized and liberalized. Perhaps that should not hinder others.

As for actually changing "affiliation", I would discourage that simply on traditional grounds, and furthermore it is not even necessary to embark on this project. For example, the Medieval scholastics did not change their affiliation to "pagan" in order to embrace Aristotle and Neoplatonism.

I'll concede that, in this disordered age, the situation may not apply and a man has to do what is best for himself. However, in a traditional hierarchical society, men don't question their own tradition. It just makes no sense, and to say otherwise is just the result of the lingering effects of liberalism. As Evola wrote: in order to command, one must obey. So, again on a personal (and traditional) basis, I embrace the Nordic-Roman Tradition of the Middle Ages.

Cologero on 2016-12-12 at 12:49 said:

¹⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=299>

¹⁶<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7872>

Re Guenon on Swedenborg, please see *Finding Agarttha*¹⁷. What is the “lost word” that apparently eluded Swedenborg?

O on 2016-12-22 at 14:36 said:

Thank you, Cologero, that clarifies it. I had somehow got the idea that you wanted someone thoroughly schooled in the metaphysics of the Mahayana to take on Tradition as a whole in the universal esoteric manner of a Guénon or Schuon. No such representative exists today as far as I am aware, although there have been previous examples, notably Marco Pallis, who was based in the Vajrayana, but whose literary production was rather limited.

Now, to adapt and organically integrate the Madhyamaka view into the specifically Western, Christian tradition is an endeavour whose degree of difficulty vastly exceeds that other project, but the zhentong view is much more suited for this than Madhyamaka as formulated by the Gelug mainstream, which easily comes across as rather nihilistic, although it isn't if subtly understood. I honestly doubt that I would have the required genius for such a daring and pioneering endeavour. I can also foresee that it would be met with massive scepticism from traditional Christians.

For example, could this task hypothetically be performed by someone in the priesthood? The thought has occasionally struck me whether becoming an Orthodox priest¹⁸ would have suited me, as being of a contemplative nature, that is the formal traditional caste in Europe I can most readily sympathise with. (I would never consider the Catholic priesthood due to a number of problems, ranging from the Pope and Vatican II to the fact that they cannot be married.) I can't help but wonder if being in such an official position would place too many limits on what I may do in terms of visible esoteric endeavours. What do you think? Could you have been open with your own perspectives, for example, as a priest?

O on 2016-12-22 at 14:58 said:

I forgot to add that, in regards to the Dalai Lama, I share your dissatisfaction. His rather naive attitude to the West, modernity and profane science should be given an antidote through introducing him to the Western traditional metaphysicists and critics of the entire modern paradigm. I wonder if he has ever been exposed to Guénon or related authors? This might be a possible link:

<http://www.islambuddhism.com/islam-and-buddhism/>

It is perhaps worth pointing out that DL is only the head of one of the five major schools of Tibet (Gelug, Nyingma, Sakya, Kagyu, Jonang); even though he is respected by most, he is by no

¹⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=972>

¹⁸There happens to be an institution here that makes such a course very straight forward... <http://www.sanktignatios.org/home-f20r3>

means recognised as an infallible authority and even members of his own school may disagree with some of his views.

Cologero on 2016-12-28 at 20:49 said:

Several points, O.

The last place I would expect to find an Orthodox theological academy would be in Sweden. Actually, it is not quite Eastern Orthodox, but Oriental ... very ancient. I guess it reflects the changing demographics of Sweden.

Our on-line discussion for the next few months will be dealing with the spiritual impulses from Krishna, Buddha, and Christ. That will give us the opportunity to compare the underlying metaphysical assumptions.

The traditional choices for a spiritual path are the priest and the knight, corresponding to the higher castes. We here, on the other hand, have been describing a third path, more or less outside of the castes – viz., the Hermetic path. Obviously, that is a very personal choice. I've made my choice and you will make your own.

3.II The Angel of Death Spread his Wings

For the Angel of Death spread his wings on the blast,

And breathed in the face of the foe as he passed:

And the eyes of the sleepers waxed deadly and chill,

And their hearts but once heaved, and for ever grew
still!

LORD BYRON, *The Destruction of Sennacherib*

I'd like to follow up the discussion on Hope, and why it is a virtue rather than an emotion. Hope has two parts:

- There is a desire for something
- There is the expectation of its being fulfilled

The expectation distinguishes Hope from wishful thinking or blind faith. What justifies that expectation? In a natural sense, there may be knowledge of cause and effect, or knowledge of conditions, that make hope reasonable. Some things may be under the control of your will, so you can legitimately expect to achieve your goal. In the latter case, the alternatives are not at all helpful. If you lack hope, you will not even try to achieve your goal. Or else wishful thinking might convince you that effort is unnecessary.

For supernatural Hope, the expectation is based on Providence or God's Will. That is of a different order, because the very means of fulfillment are not visible. The situation seemed hopeless to the Hebrews when King Sennacherib sent the Assyrian army laid siege to Jerusalem. Hezekiah prayed to God for help. He sent the angel of death who put to death 185,000 Assyrians as they slept.

I suppose it is a test of Hope to expect that God will smite his enemies.

Alternatives to Hope Now Hope is a virtue, since it is an act of will: one chooses to live in expectation of the fulfilled desire.

Cologero asked me about a situation in which there is a desire accompanied by the fear of its being fulfilled. I don't think there is a word for it. He suggested *Sehnsucht*, the German word for "longing". I know that feeling, but I don't think his analysis is correct. It is as if the desire itself is unclear, that is, you know it but don't know it, like that word that is always on the tip of your tongue. The fear, if that is not too strong a word, arises from not knowing exactly what to expect.

Arabian Nights and Space Odyssey Cologero keeps delaying the march to 1001. He insists that he is dealing with a personal situation that suddenly arose and has diverted his attention. He even asked me today about the symbolic meaning of various flowers, as if I would know.

I suspect he believes Gornahoor is related in some way to his own

mortality. We've been looking into alternatives, one of which would be to continue Gornahoor with a different focus and design. I suggested that Phase I would be called **Arabian Nights** and the next series of posts to #2001 would be **Space Odyssey**.

His spiritual father, Losang Shenphen, has already approved.

The Meaning of a Library Cologero asked me to post a few notices. First of all, a library is not a mere heap of books. There is a coherence to a personal library. Some texts belong together, other texts reinforce each other. They reveal a history of influences over many years. Some are rare, even in our age of high-speed scanning and print-on-demand technologies. The point is that a library is a “seamless garment”, all or nothing.

Several people have asked for individual volumes. How can he assign a few thousand books to different people. You guys need to think. Moreover, some of you have appeared a little too eager. Cologero has asked me to keep you out of his hospital room, if it ever comes to that, for fear you will cut off his life support.

The goal was always to give an independent scholar or a new professor a jump start for his own library, assuming, of course, his intellectual interests were in alignment.

Writer's Workshop In an effort to encourage more writers on esoteric and Hermetic topics, Cologero plans to hold a Writer's Workshop sometime next month. Some suggested topics will include:

- Idea density and specificity
- How to write on different levels simultaneously
- How to writing esoterically
- Choosing a theme

- Choosing a title
- Promotion

Update 24 April 2021: Or probably not.

Posted on 2018-04-24 by Aeneas

* * *

TeenyTinyTarot on 2018-04-27 at 13:14 said:

“Cologero keeps delaying the march to 1001. . . . I suspect he believes Gornahoor is related in some way to his own mortality. We’ve been looking into alternatives...” One possible alternative might be to review all your posts to see if there were some that might be deleted and/or combined with others in a way that would legitimately postpone the end while at the same time “combing, curling, and braiding” the remaining artifact for posterity, eh?

“Even at the age of 80, Plato did not stop combing, curling and braiding his dialogues. Every philosopher knows about the loving care he took with them.” Dionysius of Halicarnassus p.s. Apropos of hope, think “confidence in the face of the unknown”. :-)

3.12 Health Update

Cologero has a special devotion to **St Elizabeth of the Trinity**, the patron saint of illness. She herself died of a serious illness at the age of 26. Besides her devotion to the Carmelites like **Teresa d’Avila** and **St John of the Cross**, she also was indebted to **John Ruysbroeck**.

Anyone so inclined can also ask St Elizabeth for her prayers of intercession.

Posted on 2018-12-13 by Aeneas

* * *

Tom on 2018-12-13 at 10:18 said:

Deo gratias.

Jack on 2018-12-13 at 17:36 said:

Glad to hear of his improvement, but sorry to hear of the condition. If I may offer a suggestion, acupuncture can sometimes have a positive effect on kidney function. I have personally witnessed this. Find an acupuncturist who practices either Tung style acupuncture or Tan style. (If they don't know what this means, go somewhere else – there are lots of mediocre acupuncturists.)

Patricia Kay on 2018-12-13 at 23:55 said:

What wonderful news! Thanks for letting us know and I will certainly fine-tune my prayers.

james on 2018-12-17 at 18:37 said:

Great news.

3.13 Love and Work

Love and work are the cornerstones of our humanness.

SIGMUND FREUD

Work The True Self is always subject and never an object in this world. Thus, platitudes like “contacting your higher self” make no sense; rather one must “become” one’s higher self. The corollary is that the Self is not static. It must be created in our acts. What we do simultaneously expresses the Self, reveals the Self, and creates the Self. As in everything that exceeds book knowledge, everything that requires know-how rather than knowing-about, the process of self-creation requires trial and error, a lifelong task to manifest all its potentialities.

A constrained life cannot do that. Forty years spent in a cubicle, or teaching kindergarten, or as a government functionary limits one’s expe-

riences, thereby leaving many of life's possibilities unfulfilled. Your life choices will be unique to you.

I don't believe in the anonymity espoused by some esoterists, including Guenon, Evola, and Tomberg, as though one's metaphysical views arose spontaneously, like babies in a cabbage patch. St Augustine and Rousseau are better guides with their revealing confessions. A man's mundane loves and work form his foundation; his connection to the spiritual world builds on it. Without that foundation, the symbols cannot be understood. Life is a struggle, the end of struggle is death, not peace. Analogously, life requires spiritual combat; there is no end to it. Only snake oil salesmen will promise instant enlightenment.

Third rate thinkers tend to dismiss superior thinkers with a single line or two, something that would fit on a placard. Instead, one must learn to wrestle with ideas, come to terms with them, and be willing to reject them if necessary. In my case, I had done a close reading of Benedict Spinoza in my youth. I decided then on a life course inspired by that reading: be independent, become proficient in a technical field (he was a lens maker), maintain a liberal (in the word's original sense) cast a mind, and strive to be God-intoxicated (as he was called).

Hence, I became a software consultant, fulfilling the first two conditions. I did not rely on a corporate pay check, but rather on my own abilities. That gave me a wide range of experience, so I learned how many systems work: telecommunications, medical equipment, radio, computer networks, manufacturing systems, security systems, financial systems, *inter alia*. I've had to travel, often to undesirable locations: e.g., remote locations in the South, driving 100 miles from airports in the dark, without GPS. Those places are called "fly-over country"; without discounting the people who choose to live in such places, I understand the disdain of the "elite". I've also been sent to more glamorous locales: LA, Santa Barbara, San Francisco, New York, Munich, and so on. In spite of that, I never absorbed the world view held by the pseudo-sophisticates in such

places.

The consultant is not permitted to fail; he is usually called in as the last resort. Few people like to live under such pressure, but you do find out who you are.

Love Much spiritual literature uses Romance or Love to express the desire for union with God. The obvious examples are Dante, Hafiz, Rumi, even Solovyov. The *Romance of the Rose*, an esoteric work translated into Italian by Dante himself, is an extended metaphor based on the quest for romantic love. Obviously, the symbolism of that text cannot be understood without the prior understanding of romantic love in this world. The quest is worthwhile despite the risks.

I've been playing poker monthly for several years with the same group of guys. In all that time, I barely know anything at all about their personal lives. With women, the situation is quite the opposite: it is all about personal revelation. Having had many loves is a veritable school of life. I grew up in a stable and loving family, but that is probably not the norm. From women, I've learned in great detail what goes on behind closed doors in families, things that used to shock me: abuse, neglect, fights, deceit, bad decisions. Sometimes there is malice, but often there is just poor judgment. There are too many examples: an arranged marriage by fundamentalist Christians, the CIA agent who beat his wife, the mother-in-law stomping on her daughter-in-law.

Of course, there are infidelities. I was often surprised at how willing women are willing to cheat on their boyfriends and husbands, even to my supposed benefit.

Women like to lie in relationships, even when we both know it is a lie; it is part of the charm. Yet, women also know a secret, which is more difficult to extract. I'm still trying to decode it.

A dozen years ago, I had decided to create three blogs: one for musing (this one) and one for politics. Since contemporary politics is so absurd,

I neglected the political blog. Moreover, there are many sites who do the job more or less competently.

The third blog was for the so-called Manosphere, a movement that has fizzled out in the meantime, with web sites disappearing and others having second thoughts, even religious conversions. That blog would have offered suggestions, for example, in seduction. I always had reservations about revealing so much and some guilt about leading others into sin, but it was only this year that I finally surrendered the domain name I had planned to use.

In the meantime, I've had to confess all the sins associated with my liaisons, for which I will suffer much in Purgatory. Moreover, I will have to take on the women's punishment for enticing them into their sins of fornication, adultery, and unnatural acts. So this is my one and only piece of manosphere advice: don't do it.

I often have dreams about the perfect woman; she appears to me and I experience great love and joy. The dream seems so real, so that waking up feels like entering a fake world. Then I rack my mind, reviewing my life to try to remember when and where I had seen her before. Actually, it is an encounter with my Anima, a foretaste of the Alchemical Wedding, the union of the Holy Spirit with the Virgin Soul, from which the True Self, as Christ, is born.

Posted on 2019-06-09 by Cologero

* * *

Melthorg on 2019-06-14 at 18:02 said:
Great article as always, Cologero. Thanks.

I have one question on you. Do you think it is worth to try to find that perfect woman in the real world? As you said a woman who represents your Anima, or female counterpart, and union of both of you can lead to higher mystical experience. Or it is better to experience my Anima just in my mind, as Solovyov do with Sophia?

I ask because I am a young man and dealing with a woman on a practical level(meeting sexual and sentimental needs) isn't motivating me to do it actually. It just can't change my existential state and it's no more than meeting any other physiological need.

But to find really valuable woman seem almost unreal. Most women, if they are not sluts, are perfectly average, they care only for everyday petty things, nothing really deep. I don't know if I should just seek better, or my expectations are too high.

Cologero on 2019-06-15 at 22:12 said:

Melthorg, you are asking me to make choices for you that only you can, and should, make. Moreover, I don't know anything about you or your situation. Hence, specific advice is out of the question, nevertheless, there are some general principles.

First of all, you need to learn to live without expectations, i.e., to be indifferent to results. You live and act, the best you can, come what may.

To find the perfect woman, you yourself would have to be perfect. The Cabbala explains that all pre-existing souls have a male and female part, that separate at birth. Only if the human being is pure and his deeds are pleasing to God, will the union fall to his lot which he possessed before birth. In the opposite case, he receives for a spouse a soul that does not correspond to him.

On a more pessimist note, Adam found the perfect woman for him, yet things did not work out the way he had hoped. You can look it up if you don't believe me.

But on a more practical note, don't make any woman the centre of your life. Find an interest ... a destiny ... and pursue it with all your heart and energy; that should be your central focus. Good things will follow.

3.14 Mother's Day 2020

The truth is that memory does not consist in a regression from the present to the past, but on the contrary in a progress from the past to the present. ... pure memory is a spiritual manifestation. With memory we are in very truth in the domain of the spirit, the state of the brain continues the remembrance; it gives it a hold on the present by the materiality which it (acting as a mirror) confers upon it.

HENRI BERGSON, *Matter and Memory*

Perception provides an immediate experience of the world, but memory creates a world through the power of memory to retain and recall past perceptions and images. Memory is therefore actual in the present and does not mean a return to the past. A good spiritual exercise is the attempt to remember because the one's past needs to be integrated into, and made present to, the Self.

The inability to remember is a curse. In her final years, my Mother was afflicted with Alzheimer's, which frustrated and confused her. She had the intelligence and wherewithal to be able to pretend. My father posted picture of me and my children on the wall and explained them to her just prior to my visits. She still had a vague memory of me, but her acting ability, when asking about my kids, was impressive.

The Anglophile My Mother was an anglophile. The most visible symbol of that is that she never made Sunday Gravy¹⁹, as did the rest of the family. Instead, that day was reserved for the Sunday Roast²⁰, which is a British tradition. The result is that we developed a broader, less clannish, perspective on the world.

Raising the Scientist Hence, I have often looked back to understand how she raised me. The disconnected images and memories have gradually coalesced into a coherent view. My uncle — her brother — was in the field of education and would give us (also my sister) IQ tests. Since my father was a chemist, they must have decided to prep me for one of the STEM fields²¹, years before it was a “thing”.

I recall that she would give me long strings of numbers to add up, even before I started school. I always had models to build — jets, missiles,

¹⁹<https://www.afamilyfeast.com/sunday-gravy/>

²⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sunday_roast

²¹<https://www.britannica.com/topic/STEM-education>

rocket ships, automobiles —. Toy stores had aisle of scale models until the alleged glue sniffing craze destroyed that industry.

There were no malls, so a visit to the department store was not a common event. I recall that she would always bring me a new Tom Corbett, Space Cadet²² novel. I had subscriptions to I Spy²³ and Science Digest from an early age. Of course, there were books about Dinosaurs, Outer Space, etc., which many boys still like today.

When I was a little older, around 10, I went to classes at the Boston Museum of Science²⁴ on Saturday mornings as they shopped in town. After class, I would wait in the library until they arrived. My favorite books were about Astronomy and Mathematics. The idea that those strange mathematical symbols could encapsulate so much information excited and intrigued me.

Rene Descartes fascinated me. I recall reading that, as a boy, he was allowed to remain in bed in the mornings because of his intelligence. Although I did not get that particular indulgence, I aspired to me a mathematician-philosopher.

The Poison of Liberalism My sister did not get the same training despite her high IQ. She was a pretty girl and my mother used to sew nice dresses for her. Instead of Tom Corbett, she got Honey Bunch books.

One day, I related this story to someone who knew both my mother and me. Instead of seeing a loving mother who wanted the best life for her son, this person's immediate reaction was that my mother was a "sexist". That truly upset me, and I seldom get upset, so I called her out. Unfortunately, ideologues like that simply lack the ability to see the "person" that my mother was. Instead, she chose to objectify her as one of the few

²²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tom_Corbett,_Space_Cadet

²³[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/I-Spy_\(Michelin\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/I-Spy_(Michelin))

²⁴<https://www.mos.org/>

Ready Made Ideas²⁵ that form the substance of her distorted worldview. As obstinate as she was, she refused to back down. Ultimately I was the one who was forced to apologize in order to keep the peace.

Posted on 2020-05-10 by Cologero

3.15 Audrey of the Sun

Audrey del Sol was a pisser, as we say in Boston. She was alive in her body, and in her soul, and in her spirit. Never without an opinion, her mind wandered over whatever topic intrigued her. Born in Tajikistan (née Biliana Dimitrova), her interests hardly coincided with those typical of American women. She listed her religion as the Big 5: Christianity, Islam, Judaism, Hinduism, and Buddhism.

She told me she was “hugely aligned” with Evola’s philosophy even before she heard of him. So she found a kindred voice in Gornahoor, often promoting posts and actively commenting on articles. She liked guns and was a 2nd Amendment fanatic.

She claimed a Sicilian connection. A relative lived in Italy and it was her family’s tradition to honeymoon in Sicily. She claimed to have worked with the Italian intelligence agency SISMI.

Her train of thought could be exasperating, probably because she stood beyond expected norms. This is how I described her in one post:

I know Audrey, and she does have an unusual, but not unintelligent, mind. She not only thinks ‘out of the box’, I doubt she even knows where the box is.

But, in retrospect, perhaps she did know where it is when she told me, “I also live outside of the world of library, university and home.” If those

²⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=11832>

institutions define the box, what lies beyond? For her it was the world in which Gurdjieff, Evola, Samael Aun Weor, Franz Bardon, Valentin Tomberg make sense. Some whom I know claim to live in that world, but few actually do. It may not even be possible ... except perhaps for Audrey.

Outside of library, university and home, even outside the natural state of the lion, she sees something beyond nature, a sexuality that is neither pleasurable nor procreative. She swears an “oath not to use her body as a vehicle of another’s desires.”

You can find her Gornahoor comments with a site search²⁶. When I noticed she had studied creative writing, I asked her to write an article for Gornahoor. She never did write the article; perhaps they could have explained her worldview coherently.

Her grasp of the whole boy-girl thing was neither feminist nor traditional, but derived from odd insights and her personal experiences. One day, she would send an anti-contraception article by Samael Aun Weor²⁷ and then one on Gurdjieff’s notion of the Formatory Apparatus, and then relate them to the left-hand path of vamaacharya. This sounds like a rather crazy party in DC.

This is the same apparatus that gets engaged when the male starts “barking” from his crotch and shouting “slick slogans” that are supposed to act as “banana peels” for the “sexually naive and gullible” females. But I love you... because it IS trying to wallpaper its butt crack because it DID NOT want to go on the niva fields and wipe its own butt. Not only that, but they confound this abuse of the left-hand path with the practices of vamaacharya. It is not “wide-spread”; it’s ludicrous among computer workers, and yes I mean Microsoft, etc. They disrespect that the female ac-

²⁶<https://www.google.com/search?channel=cus2&client=firefox-b-1-d&q=audrey+site%3Agornahoor.net>

²⁷<https://anael.org/es/anticonceptivos-parte-2>

tually has legs and they pretty much “rush” them into the house where a “party” begins, usually at her expense. As one of them said it: svava was all about “putting the monkey on the moon”. This is called human ROT.

Toward the end, she was getting restless. She sent me this message:

The Earth is not getting colder, it is getting warmer, and may in time become like the sun. There you go. The majority of humanity is simply being burned up like briquettes for that event. Consciousness means that you become “a” Star or “a” Sun and live immortally. “Food for the moon” or “dacha by the sea” means exactly that, as described in *Yoga of Power* by Julius Evola. THAT is what money is. THAT is why Albert Wass wrote “I am not interested in your money, but how close you are to god”. That is the actual meaning of the “veil” in Islam.

Most humans do not awaken to their “star”, Hence they are locked in a mechanism of how much and what they are getting. Hence “cops”, “wars”, “stupid food attitude”, “violence”, “poverty” and the multitude of problems we are plagued with.

This is her ultimate opinion of the human condition:

The fact is that the ‘fallen’ condition of mankind, is one of animals. We must work and struggle to become human, i.e., conscious.

She saw herself as a conscious human being forced to live among animals — lustful, money grubbing animals.

She scorned the fastest growing industries: retail, healthcare, hospitality. The only interesting work was being done by the government and military, she said, and sent me a video of the Italian Special Forces in action. She has extensive formal university education as a cognitive scientist, mathematician, linguist, philosopher and art historian.

Yet her work history is quite varied and does not always reflect that education. Her last civilian job was in hospitality, as a cocktail waitress. Nevertheless, I was surprised at her decision to enlist in the USA army, especially as a Specialist, not even an Officer; she was near the maximum age for enlistees. She seemed to like the idea of carrying a gun.

Prophetically, Audrey of the Sun made her last facebook post on 27 January 2013:

Lacking nothing, contemplative, immortal, self-originated, sufficed with a quintessence: he who knows that constant, ageless, and ever-youthful Spirit, knows himself and does not fear death.

SHANKARA

Two days later, on 29 January 2013, she was dead, struck by an SUV as she was walking along the street.

I hope she became a “Sun”.

<https://gornahoor.net/decameron/wp-content/uploads/2020/12/Audrey-De1-Sol.mp4>

Posted on 2020-12-06 by Admin

* * *

Juliano on 2023-12-15 at 11:42 said:

I hope you also became a “Sun”, Cologero, and you and Audrey are sending us help from above. Rest in peace.

3.16 Auld Lang Syne

To live without principles is to be unprincipled.

To act without a point is to be pointless.

The end of the year is customarily the time to review the past year and plan for the next. Because of the personal equation, there is no yellow brick road to follow. Instead, a man must be a wanderer, following instincts and intuitions.

During my end of year office cleanup, I found some personal journals, from 1978 through 1982. There was a collection of speeches from 1992. In particular, one was on climate change which could have been presented last weekend without revision; particular its relationship to Santa Claus. Another was based on certain ideas from Bernard Lonergan; I'll edit it a little and put it on line.

The topics were the same as today for the most part. I wrote out goals, study plans, and outlines for essays. In those days I was more nihilistic. Probably still am because ultimately there is no unassailable proof for anything. Heck, I don't even know how many, if any, parallel lines there are that go through a point not on another line.

You have to choose; the proof is in the doing. That is because Knowing is Being. You can't know unless you are. Thomas Aquinas writes:

Nothing is known except Truth, which is the same as Being.

Existence is the actualization of the possibilities of Being. The actualization of the soul's potentiality is to become what it contemplated. Contemplate God, and become God: this is *theosis*.

Influences There was a short section on five people or ideas who were influencing me.

- **William Blake:** *Those who restrain their desire do so only because it is weak enough to restrain.*

This is essential to Western thought (e.g., drive is a major element in Spinoza). Perhaps I have confused the Buddhist idea of the elimination of desire with the repression of desire, but I have reached the realization that inhibition is contrary to full self-expression.

Comment 2020: This is still true. Those who are too weak to act then call it virtue.

- **Weekend Seminar:** The notion of Expansion vs Contraction. I have counting on my Good to come to me (a contracting idea). I now work on myself to expand and encompass more of my own good.

Comment 2020: I still stand by this. A popular technique is visualization or affirmations whose practitioners beg the “universe” to satisfy their needs and desires. That is a contracting approach.

That is opposite to the way the universe “works”; since the Fall, our needs are met through toil and suffering. The outcome is uncertain because of death. Everything we create is subject to death and decay; hence, a new spark becomes necessary. You expand or disappear.

- **Weekend Seminar 2:** the idea that we choose our own experience.

Comment 2020: This may sound trite, but assume it is true as the null hypothesis. Think carefully and deeply about your life. See how you were implicated in much of what happened to you. Obviously, not everything since there are indeed accidents. Nevertheless, probably more than you suppose.

- **Mircea Eliade:** on the world as the Absolute (in Parabola)

Comment 2020: I used to have a full collection of Parabola magazines up through the 1990s. I don’t recall this particular article and the Parabola archive is not helpful. I’m assuming it came from *The Sacred and the Profane*. Here are some quotes.

This is as much as to say that every religious man places himself at the Center of the World and by the same token at the very source

of absolute reality, as close as possible to the opening that ensures him communication with the gods

Whatever the historical context in which he is placed, *homo religiosus* always believes that there is an absolute reality, the sacred, which transcends this world but manifests itself in this world, thereby sanctifying it and making it real.

Perceived by virtue of a religious experience, the specific mode of existence of the stone reveals to man the nature of an absolute existence, beyond time, invulnerable to be. coming.

- **My Father:** Taught me to develop the strength not to succumb to fear and that any decision made, for better or for worse, must be followed through, despite anxiety and public opinion.

Comment 2020. This is particularly helpful to me whenever unresolved Oedipal issues arise. I still live by it, particularly the absoluteness of decisions.

Knights Knights venture out to seek adventure and impress their ladies fair. Nothing essential has changed. The adventures are different, but so are the women.

The original knights were free. A free man has the right to bear arms and to spend his money the way he likes. The knight would entertain his friends and build alliances.

The old ways were built on Loyalty, Omertà, Respect, Honor.

Only the free man can pledge loyalty. The loyalty of the serf is compelled; he trades freedom for protection and security.

Few understand the art of gift giving today. When invited to dinner, I bring a gift. Perhaps PBR and a box of donuts, or else a bottle of wine and French pastries, depending on the host. I don't hold onto the gift until after the meal, and then give it to the hostess only if I enjoyed the meal.

It's best to give a gift that the recipient could get in no other way. A gift carries no expectations.

A knight was chivalrous. Like everything noble, when a task filters down to the bourgeoisie, it deteriorates. Woman today don't see the value in it, other than pro forma acts.

One woman never tired of repeating that if her ex-husband ever needed her, she would rush to his aid. She even repeated her pledge to a salesman and asked if he would like an ex-wife like that, and he agreed. I then asked if he wanted a gf who would return to her husband at a moment's notice. Of course not, so from that point, I treated her like a friend with benefits. There was no point to argue about it.

One woman asked me for a song to describe our relationship. I sent her this one: I will follow him²⁸. She scoffed at me, as if she had a long queue of better suitors. She was unaware of the benefits such loyalty would bestow on her. So I ghosted her.

Knights have no mercy to those who don't follow the code.

Experiencing the World

Transcending oneself: this is the great imperative of the human condition; and there is another that anticipates it and at the same time prolongs it: dominating oneself. The noble man is the one who dominates himself; the holy man is the one who transcends himself.

FRITHJOF SCHUON

A benefit of living like an anchorite is that I been able to devote 1 to 2 hours per day for Meditation time. You develop a sense of detachment of the Self. Live is not lived but is observed instead. The Self watches

²⁸<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jgPMYQTINnk>

the body squirm around a bit until it finds a comfortable position. You watch it fall asleep; sometimes you can watch it wake up.

The soul life is like a rippling pond, each ripple being a perturbation of consciousness. A feeling arises, a thought appears, a fantasy presents itself. Sometimes the ripples become waves and they need to be calmed.

All your emotions, all hidden motives are exposed; it can be difficult to act on principles and to avoid pointless behavior. But you are seldom plagued with feelings of dread, anxiety, fear of death.

The light of the Holy Spirit is best reflected on still water.

The Polemic Spirit Rational discourse is an inferior form of knowledge. Nevertheless, a certain type of fellow thinks the secret to enlightenment lies in undirected study and disputations. He lives in his head, like a brain in a vat. The Germans have a colourful word for that: *Kopfmensch*.

Avoid those with a polemic spirit. The esoteric path is one of harmonizing disparate points of view.

Rene Guenon, in a private letter, reveals more of himself than he does in his books:

Meditation is more important than reading, which can only serve as a starting point, and it is generally beneficial not to overdo it in order to avoid dissipation. Rites are effective in themselves, but of course, attention and concentration strengthen the effects significantly. I particularly recommend the regular recitation of the *wird* Sufi liturgy, because this especially strengthens the link with the *tarîqa*. Finally, I think everyone should seek to use their natural tendencies rather than fight them; but, of course, there are as many different modalities as there are individualities.

Letter from Rene Guenon to L.C. d'Amiens, 30 August 1935

Metaphysical doctrine can be taught through the intellect, but it can only be understood through concentration, meditation, and contempla-

tion. There is no one universal path to metaphysical realization. Hafiz, for example, did a vigil at a saint's tomb for 40 nights. Today, there are many who think they desire such lofty realization, yet don't have one hour per week to spare.

The point is that in order to describe a path, I need to reveal personal details. Many are not flattering, but I hope that are helpful. A wanderer will encounter many things and do many things. Perhaps, like an alchemist, he can transform dross into gold. Or die trying.

Un bel Giorno per Morire I asked my nephrologist about the process of dying from kidney disease: was it quick or slow and painful? He said the latter but reassured me that his goal is to make sure I die of something other than kidney disease. The following week I met with my cardiologist. She explained that her goal is to make sure that I die of something other than heart disease. I think the three of us need to get together and work out the details.

Sometimes I feel nostalgic and wonder what I'll miss most about the world. Young children delight in every new experience. They demand, "again, again". When is enough, enough, and repetition loses its flavour? So much of what once seemed important really counts for nothing. The World Process will continue.

Repetition has led to the forgetfulness of the awesome significance of forgiveness. It counters free will and stops human karma; otherwise, things get worse and worse. God the Merciful forgets our forgiven sins; our unforgiven sins are judged harshly.

It is a beautiful day to die²⁹ and in a leap year we have 366 such days.

There are so many good versions, quite different from each other, of Robert Burn's poem, it was difficult to choose one.

Posted on 2020-12-31 by Cologero

²⁹<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RnCmeNa5vXs>

3.17 The Pelican, the Poet, and the Puer

The union of the mathematician with the poet, fervor with measure, passion with correctness, this surely is the ideal.

WILLIAM JAMES

Puer There is great pleasure in being a boy. Everything is taken care of: food, shelter, travel, and so on. It leaves a boy with ample time to wonder about things. I used to wonder how the universe could possibly exist. The thought of such a huge and complex universe baffled me, the more I tried to imagine or conceive it. On the other hand, it was inconceivable for there to be nothing, so there had to be something.

I remember playing on the kitchen floor; there was one small window above the sink. In the morning, I would watch the rays of light streaming through it and then onto the floor. The beam of light reflecting in the dust fascinated me, since I could see it from the window to the floor.

My life seemed to be the most important. My family were archetypes: Father, Mother, Sister, Grandma, etc. On many Sundays we visited Grandma and drove back in the dark. I would stare out the car window and wonder where the other cars were going. I barely grasped that there are other people with lives.

Still young, I anticipated some great philosophical and scientific problems: existentialism, optics, solipsism. And these are just a few of the meditations of a boy.



Mater Mother was the center. It was impossible to envision her as a real human being rather than a mythical figure. Only within the past few years have I been able to understand her plans for me. She had me do complex arithmetic problems even before school age. She would buy me plastic model kits, mostly jets, missiles and some automobiles. (Yes, boys were allowed to use airplane glue.) I was subscribed to various magazines including Science Digest. After shopping trips, she would bring me back a Tom Corbett science fiction group. Clearly, I was being groomed for STEM before it was a “thing”.

The symbol of the pelican feeding her babies from her own blood is ancient, going back to pagan days. The Christians adapted it for obvious reasons and it appears in many church.

It is a symbol of charity (Dante referred to Christ as “our Pelican”). My mother’s love was an enduring presence, so much so that it was inconceivable to experience life without it.

Theoria I saw a random Twitter comment from a fellow who was concerned that studying mathematics would negatively affect his poetic skills. Of course not. Maths begin in wonder and only later does it harden into syntactic manipulations.

Every month, google sends me a report about Internet searches that point to gornahoor. I am always surprised that *Naïve Set Theory*³⁰ by **Paul Halmos** gets the most clicks. Unlike a strictly formal set theory, “naïve” in this case means something more like intuition. In *Covenant of the Heart*, **Valentin Tomberg** writes:

Intuition is the faculty of knowledge that results from instinct that is illumined by reason. It is what brings two opposite poles in humans to a unity, or unites what is most deeply implanted in them, which works hidden in darkness in the depths of their

³⁰https://www.gornahoor.net/library/Halmos_NaiveSetTheory.pdf

beings, with the reflecting faculty of intelligence, which is most bright in human beings, lying uppermost within them.

I was always good at mathematics and never had to study. People would ask me to tutor them. But I was horrible at it because I can just “see” the answer and there is no way to explain that. In a similar way, Axioms are just “seen” or “intuited”, but never proved. Here are some naïve examples:

Why is there something rather than nothing? The **Axiom of Identity** shows that something exists, namely the being that is identical to itself. But that can only refer to God whose essence is existence. We, in our human state, are subject to privations which is a lack of full being; our existence never fully encapsulates essence.

The **Axiom of Infinity** describes the Infinite, and our understanding brings us into the mind of God. There is a genuine thrill when contemplating the cardinality of the continuum!

The **Axiom of Choice** proves free will. Sets don’t operate on their own, so someone needs to be able to choose from one set in order to create another.

Finally, the **Axiom of Pairing** shows that sets can be “paired up”: if A and B both exist, then so does A+B exist. For each A, there is a special B waiting in expectation.

Lux People falsely believe that the truth is only found in the light. But daylight hides the truth. The Sun is not yellow and the Sky is not blue; they are optical illusions. Those living in perpetual daylight would never suspect that there are heavenly bodies like the Moon, Planets, and the Stars.

Truth is hidden in the darkness. Nicodemus was initiated at night. But there are two kinds of darkness³¹. First there is the darkness of chaos,

³¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=15803>

in which we cannot make out any distinct items.

The second is the night of the hidden revelation. It is God's truth that is hidden from the world. However, once God's truth is revealed, there is an inversion of all values. Then revelation is the light, and the world is embedded in darkness.

Posted on 2022-03-24 by Cologero

* * *

Tiffany Dawn Smith on 2022-03-25 at 18:22 said:
Fascinating. Thank you.

3.18 The Path with a Heart

Before you embark on any path ask the question: Does this path have a heart? If the answer is no, you will know it, and then you must choose another path. The trouble is nobody asks the question; and when a man finally realizes that he has taken a path without a heart, the path is ready to kill him. At that point very few men can stop to deliberate, and leave the path. A path without a heart is never enjoyable. You have to work hard even to take it. On the other hand, a path with heart is easy; it does not make you work at liking it.

CARLOS CASTANEDA, *The Teachings of Don Juan: A Yaqui Way of Knowledge*

There was a time in my youth when I was fascinated by the Shaman Don Juan. I did not necessarily believe the accounts about him (facts/events), yet his teachings reached into my soul. I had forgotten about him until a few days



ago when I did a search for some quotes. I was amazed at how much I had retained even if, at this point in life, I had forgotten the source. This is fundamental:

The basic difference between an ordinary man and a warrior is that a warrior takes everything as a challenge while an ordinary man takes everything as a blessing or a curse.

You see, the ordinary man is passive. Things just happen to him and his emotions fluctuate accordingly. The warrior, on the other hand, has a goal, a destiny. He expects challenges and obstacles along the way. Yet he is also blessed by those who aid and love him. He is confident because his life is ultimately guided by Providence.

Unmanifested Possibilities

The threat is stronger than the execution.

ARON NIMZOWITSCH

When I was a boy, I loved chess. My father had given me a folding chess board and some wooden pieces in a crumpled brown paper bag; he must have kept the same bag since university. He taught me the game, but stopped playing with me after I began to beat him.

Besides playing, and beating the neighborhood boys while blindfolded, I was a great student of chess. I would devour chess books and replay the most famous games. After learning the fundamentals, I discovered the rebel Aron Nimzowitsch. His commentaries excited me. Aspects of his system are valuable to the warriors: controlling the center, overprotection of important pieces, blockades, prophylaxis. I could never forget the desperado piece since I have been a desperado. His system: ‘first restrain, then blockade and finally destroy’. Good advice.

An essential aspect of chess analysis is to follow up on the moves not taken. So the reader does not blindly replay the actual game; he must, in addition, play out all the alternative moves. A joke among chess players is that the best games are the ones that were never played.

Our lives are likewise replete with unmanifested possibilities. Sometimes you need to replay them in your mind to learn of what you did well and what you did poorly. Often, memories are forced on you, either in dreams or spontaneous eruptions. Where did you apply power? What did you protect and prevent? Have you identified your friends and foes?

Rene Guenon insists that there is no fundamental difference between the Possible and the Real. Could that mean that there are alternative universes in which your Counterpart made a different choice? I don't think so. A warrior has one chance; he must make the choice when it presents itself to him. Rather, our unmanifested possibilities are just as much a part of our personalities as those that are manifested.

The Path Taken

A man of knowledge lives by acting, not by thinking about acting.

I had a fb friend several years ago named Joe. He was a supercorrect Catholic and libertarian, always eager to engage in arguments. He thought he could use an argument to compel someone to accept his point of view. He unfriended me as unequal to his intellect.

He did not understand that the greatest gift to the human being is freedom. As **Arthur Schopenhauer** pointed out in *On the Fourfold Root of the Principle of Sufficient Reason*, logic has its own compulsion. That is why it cannot be ultimate. Otherwise, your robots and even your sexbot would reason themselves to faith.

Recently, I encountered him again. He had become a depressed nihilist who had lost his faith. He did not see intellectual nihilism as liberation, for now he could choose his own path without the burden of his supercilious arguments.

When I myself had reached that point, I felt free to choose my own way, to manifest my own possibilities, my personal **Path with a Heart**. I resolved to live a Life based on High Culture, an ascetic lifestyle, and the quest for scientific knowledge.

My guideposts were the greatness that was Greece, the grandeur that was Rome, the secret gnosis of ancient Egypt, and the lofty metaphysics of the High Middle Ages.

The True, the Good, the Beautiful, are the stars that light the night sky for me. The goal is Love. That is a Path with a Heart.

Whenever I fail, I become a desperado, somehow finding victory out of apparent failure.

Posted on 2022-05-25 by Cologero

* * *

Michael M on 2022-05-26 at 09:47 said:

To realize a path chosen is not in alignment with the heart can be agonizing as the pressures work against man to keep him there (General Law) and his own illusions, false duties etc. The absolute nature of the 'I' in a path of the heart cannot be debated or argued, only lived joyously and suffered through, there lies a terrible and beautiful type of destiny.

Juan Martinez on 2022-05-29 at 23:31 said:

"My guideposts were the greatness that was Greece, the grandeur that was Rome, the secret gnosis of ancient Egypt, and the lofty metaphysics of the High Middle Ages.

The True, the Good, the Beautiful, are the stars that light the night sky for me. The goal is Love. That is a Path with a Heart."

This is well put. Thank you. I am learning much from your site and from the commenters, et al..

Juliano on 2026-04-22 at 16:31 said:

I have read this text many times. One of my favorites. Thank you Mr Charles.

3.19 Power and Random Acts of Kindness

Growing up in the Ten Hills section of Somerville, Massachusetts, up to the age of 11, was a pleasant experience. Somerville before my time was a lovely suburb, with a beach on Mystic River, and everything within walking distance. There were a large number of Italian and Irish families, the former from the North End of Boston and the latter from the South End. My grandfather told me that occasionally there were pitched battles between the North and South Ends, but those antagonisms did not pursue them into Somerville.

We were allowed freedom of movement, and our only instructions were to return home when the street lights turned on. That must have provided the mothers with some relief, unlike suburban life today when children are always underfoot. There was less traffic during the day because two car families were rare. Kids were everywhere, so there were plenty of things to do. We learned street games – passed down from the older kids to the younger – like Hide and Go Seek, Giant Steps, Red Light, Freeze, Kickball, and various versions of Tag.

Boys and girls played those games together, unless we went to the park to play baseball or just wander through the streets. We took pee breaks like feral cats, usually in one of the many alleys. The girls had to go home, except for Susan who liked to come and watch the feral boys do it. Only boys played Cops & Robbers or Cowboys & Indians; I presume the latter came is frowned upon. Of course, we all had cap guns.

Hernia Surgery I was born with a congenital hernia that was repaired when I was 5 or 6 years old. It was not outpatient at the time, but required several days at the hospital. In the children's wing, the beds were lined up against the walls, more like a barrack. The boys were on one side and the girls on the other. They used to take our temperature in the ass, probably to humiliate us. Sometimes a girl would come to our side with the pretext

of asking the nurse a question. God forgive us if a boy walked into the girls' section.

My father often told me that I almost died on the operating table, due to the anesthetic and an asthmatic condition. I did not understand why he would have mentioned it. However, over the course of my life, I have been rescued from illness, death, financial ruin, and incarceration by forces beyond my control. I am certain that it is because of all the novenas we attended as children. The church was filled with children, and after the nine days, we would receive a scapular or holy medal. I have always had a strong devotion to Mary and the *Salve Regina* is my favorite prayer.

My Best Friend My best friend, Bobby M., and I were the same age. We got to organize the games as the older kids moved on to other activities. Part of being buds was the occasional fights which always ended in a draw with no hard feelings.

On one occasion, we were seriously grappling on the ground in front of Lorraine's house. Her older sister, Elaine, came out and ordered us to stop. She screamed that we could die from fighting. Well, I was certainly getting out of breath and I figured that a teenager must know something. Nevertheless, neither of us paid her any mind. I learned a lesson that day: I would rather die than surrender. The battle ran its natural course and we both survived. There was another lesson that I did not understand until much later: a woman is perfectly willing to lie to you to make her point.

Back to the Hernia Coincidentally, Bobby had to undergo hernia surgery. That gave me a good idea, I thought, which I ran by my parents. I told them that the next time we had a fight, I would punch him in the hernia area where he would be vulnerable. They were appalled and forbade it. I suppose that it was unethical to hit below the belt; it was also risky because it would leave my upper body and head area vulnerable to a coun-

terattack.

I suppose that some of you 21st century men, and most women, would be wondering why I wasn't planning some random act of kindness to welcome my bud out of the hospital. All I can say is that you and I have traveled in different circles.

Hierarchy You more astute esoterists will recognize the battle for hierarchy. As the two oldest boys, Bobby and I often struggled to achieve dominance. Nevertheless, hierarchy is not an evil, as people today believe, rather it is, and has been throughout history, the norm. Evil results from the failure to recognize the natural hierarchy; in such cases, physical force becomes the last resort.

Friend against friend, brother against brother, have existed since the first generation of the human race. Cain murdered his brother Abel rather than acknowledge that God preferred Abel. This is Cain's punishment:

God: you shall be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth.

Cain: from thy face I shall be hidden; and I shall be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth

By refusing to acknowledge the hierarchy established by God, Cain is condemned to wander the earth aimlessly and without purpose. Does that remind you of anyone you know?

Cain immediately grasped the consequences. He would never again know God. He will try one thing and then the next, but nothing will ever bring him back to knowledge of God. No number of pretty words on social media, nor chasing butterflies will ever compensate.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SmqLKr6gF-Q>

Posted on 2022-12-11 by Cologero

3.20 Embracing Insomnia

When I was a boy around 10 years old, my parents would drop me off at the Boston Museum of Science³² on Saturday mornings while they went shopping. There would be a children's lecture program and afterwards I would wait for them in the library. My favorite topics were mathematics and astronomy, which were conveniently next to each other in the Dewey library classification system.

I loved to dream about far off stars, which used to have exotic names like Sirius, Antares, Betelgeuse, Canopus, Arcturus, or Regulus. Those names are now being replaced with dull standardized names. It's a moot point anyway because few stars can be recognized with all the light pollution today. The stars have gone the way of the armadillo, tortoises, racoons, etc., that used to wander around the neighborhoods.

My favorite books were the four volumes of the *World of Mathematics*; the four dark blue volumes contained pages of mysterious symbols that revealed secrets of the universe to that boy. One of my favorite chapters was about Rene Descartes. I read that he was allowed to remain in bed in the morning in order to give him leisure time to meditate. It became a habit which he followed throughout his life, finding it "conducive to intellectual profit and comfort."

As an adult, during the cold months, he would retire to a heated room where he meditated all day. That was the source of his philosophy. Strangely, Socrates used to meditate in the snow although there are a limited number of snow days in Athens. There have been other cold weather philosophers like Nietzsche or Evola who preferred the mountains. Nevertheless, metaphysics began in warmer climates.

Alone with the alone Unlike the young Descartes, I was never allowed to tarry in bed. Hence, time for meditation had to be planned. A few years

³²<https://www.mos.org/>

ago I developed insomnia. Not that I was a worrier who could not get to sleep, but I would wake up in the middle of the night. With nothing to do. At first, I would get up to read or watch an old movie. When sleep seemed to be returning, I would go back to bed.

Some 18 months ago, I complained to the doctor who then prescribed a strong soporific medication. After reading the side effects, I decided to keep the insomnia; after all, it isn't fatal.

That is when I learned to embrace that solitary time. The nighttime is so quiet and still. There is no sensory experience other than the flow of thoughts. I used that time to meditate on deep topics, watching the thoughts play with each other. Occasionally, fresh thoughts would be revealed from unknown sources. The benefits of such meditations exceed the reading of many books. This form of meditation is also called "mental prayer", as described by the **Venerable Louis of Granada** in *Summa of the Christian Life*:

Mental prayer is any form of meditation or contemplation of the things of God ... Meditation is of inestimable benefit to the soul, for as the study of human sciences is the principal means of acquiring human wisdom, so the consideration of divine things is a very important means for attaining to divine wisdom.

Now I look forward to the time to be alone with the Alone.

Posted on 2023-02-05 by Cologero

* * *

Kaukomieli on 2023-02-06 at 01:18 said:

We had a doctor around here who used to say to his patients that no one has ever died of insomnia but many die in their sleep.

Dimitri on 2023-02-06 at 13:45 said:

>A few years ago I developed insomnia. Not that I was a worrier who could not get to sleep, but I would wake up in the middle of the night. With nothing to do. At first, I would get up to read or watch an old movie. When sleep seemed to be returning, I would go back to bed.

Funnily enough, this is actually normal, or at least it used to be. It's called "biphasic sleep", and it was common in medieval times. People would go to bed early in the night for their "first sleep", after which they'd wake up and engage in some activity for about an hour, and return to bed for their "second sleep" in the post-midnight hours. In the preindustrial West, most people slept in two discrete blocks.

<https://www.bbc.com/future/article/20220107-the-lost-medieval-habit-of-biphasic-sleep>

As it turns out this habit of yours aligns with the traditional lifestyle. Go figure.

Dimitri on 2023-02-06 at 14:19 said:

I'm actually going through that article again and finding lots of fascinating details, I encourage others to read it too. It talks about how the practice was ubiquitous across all parts of the world for millennia (even during the Classical period) and still exists today in certain nonindustrial regions, and even talks about experiments where researchers actually restored people's biphasic sleep by reducing their exposure to artificial lighting before bed. Here are a few highlights that may be of interest to Gornahoor readers:

"The period of wakefulness that followed first sleep was known as "the watch" – and it was a surprisingly useful window in which to get things done. 'The records describe how people did just about anything and everything after they awakened from their first sleep,' says Ekirch.

...

But the watch was also a time for religion. For Christians, there were elaborate prayers to be completed, with specific ones prescribed for this exact parcel of time. One father called it the most 'profitable' hour, when – after digesting your dinner and casting off the labours of the world – 'no one will look for you except for God'.

Those of a philosophical disposition, meanwhile, might use the watch as a peaceful moment to ruminate on life and ponder new ideas. In the late 18th Century, a London tradesman even invented a special device for remembering all your most searing nightly insights – a 'nocturnal remembrancer', which consisted of an enclosed pad of parchment with a horizontal opening that could be used as a writing guide."

"Historian Roger Ekirch wonders if today people might remember fewer dreams than our ancestors did, because it's less common to wake up in the middle of the night."

Kaukomieli on 2023-02-09 at 12:41 said:

Dimitri, there is actually a strength training regimen also in today's world where you sleep in two different times a day which helps to increase testosterone and growth hormone levels naturally. It is also claimed that you'll get more done and energy levels are better if one trains oneself to follow the regimen and discipline where you sleep 6 hours from 9 pm to 3 am, then again after exercise, cleaning and eating you'll take a nap for two to three hours. The training is done in 6 am, after three hours of waking and fulfilling the bodily system with right nutrients. You'll sleep again after noon right when you wish to.

I think this could very well also be integrated into spiritual life, for the 9 to 3 sleeping is also recommended by some eastern authorities and yogis, and I believe it has been studied scientifically also that it is the best time to sleep for multiple reasons. (This is why today's 24/7 civilization produces so much illness and disease I think; the asuric modern human is moved only by constant agitation, speed etc.)

To meditate on three in the morning right after sleeping, you'll be then awake for the last watches of the night and behold the Spiritual Sun and the morning star in the morning. Then you'll do the bodily exercise (run, ski, swim, gym, martial arts, yoga etc.) and energize yourself for the next productive day.

Matt on 2023-02-11 at 13:22 said:

Reading about the longing to be "alone with the Alone" feels similar to the feeling I get from *The Isle of the Dead*; both the composition by Rachmaninoff and the painting by Arnold Böcklin that inspired it. Böcklin described the painting as, "a dream picture: it must produce such a stillness that one would be awed by a knock on the door."

Instead of being macabre, it makes me think of the kind of death that Tomberg is pointing to in *Covenant of the Heart* (aka, *Lazarus Come Forth!*) when he quotes Thomas speaking to the disciples, "Let us also go, that we may die with him". Tomberg says, "If human life is a pendulum swing between the moment and eternity, then Lazarus had—in spirit, soul, and body—chosen eternity completely and radically. His breathing became ever more "vertical"—that is, it took place increasingly in the direction above to below and became ever more shallow in the direction outer-inner, until it stood still, i.e., until he died."

Echoing what was said about meditation or mental prayer, in *Mysterium Coniunctionis* Jung says, "What I call coming to terms with the unconscious the alchemists called "meditation." Ruland says of this: 'Meditation: The name of an Internal Talk of one person with another who is invisible, as in the invocation of the Deity, or communion with one's self, or with one's good angel.'"

But it's not an ordinary kind of dialogue, like two people chewing the fat. It has the quality of showing up with, and listening with, one's entire being.

Jung also quotes Gerhard Dorn, who says, "Meditative knowledge is thus the sure and undoubted resolution by expert certitude, of all manner of opinions concerning the truth... We

cannot be resolved of any doubt save by experiment, and there is no better way to make it than on ourselves... We have said earlier that piety consists in knowledge of ourselves, and hence we begin to explain meditative knowledge from this also. But no man can truly know himself unless first he see and know by zealous meditation... what rather than who he is, on whom he depends, and whose he is, and to what end he was made and created, and by whom and through whom."

Rachmaninoff, *Isle of the Dead*: <https://youtu.be/0VR4S69bdto>

4.1 New Years Message

The ancient Tantra teachings say that the way to realization differs from age to age, so that methods appropriate to the golden age may lose their effectiveness in our crepuscular times, the “Kali Yuga”. While passive contemplation was appropriate to a more spiritual age, we are weighed down with matter, our bodies are heavy, the mundane affairs of the world distract us. We can use that against itself and follow a path of action, practical realization, and direct experience.

Let’s keep in mind that our true Self, the Atman, is more than the mere passive observer of appearances. It is their creator and their source, as they perpetually arise from that unknown nothingness, what we’ve been calling by that ugly word “noumenon”. This is not action in the sense of frenetic activity, but action in the true sense, action as *wei wu wei*, action as “letting it happen”.

We come to see that between thought and action there is no separation. Thought is possibility and action is thought made actual. Any

other thought is not “ours” and no value must be attached to it.

A stone dropped from a height falls to the ground – it cannot act against its nature. An animal may choose the means but its ends are determined by its nature. The human is otherwise. He can be in out of harmony with the Tao; he can neglect his dharma; he can reject the Logos.

As we come to realize our non-dual nature, we see that to speak of the human “being” is inadequate. For our “being” is incomplete without taking into account non-being ... the human state is always in potential. As our will actualizes itself toward its ideal, it simultaneously expresses, creates, and reveals our personality. That is how we come to know who we are.

Our personality is the heart of our being. As manifested, it is an “individual”, one physical being among others. It becomes our error to then identify with our individuality in matter rather than our personality in spirit. We see ourselves as individuals vying with other individuals. This is clearly false because the solitary individual could not even survive and would not even have language for thought or culture, nor means for self-realization without a community of selves, both synchronically and diachronically.

We then know ourselves as a spiritual community each with our own possibilities to actualize. Ultimately, we are bringing the possibilities of the One into manifestation as the drama of creation. Some want to make this totally arbitrary as though they as individuals possessed more wisdom than the Logos through which all things are created. Others wonder why our possibilities are so different; but that is simply to ask why one being is not another, a nonsensical question. Others call it an injustice and would prefer total egalitarianism. But this is to deny the Infinity and Goodness of the One.

As we make our plans and resolutions for the New Year, keep in mind that because we act in a community of persons, that means the world

is fundamentally a moral world as we create it through our collective choices. Are our choices free, arising from our deepest Self, or are they the playthings of external forces? Are we seeking to actualize our highest self or merely satisfying the inordinate desires of ourselves as individuals? During the “twilight of the gods”, as we grope in darkness, sometimes struggling with death, disease, and disappointment, we need only turn back toward the Light.

Posted on 2008-01-01 by Cologero

4.2 Not Finding Life's Purpose

A couple of day's ago I get an e-mail from an acquaintance with this message:

I know you are busy! I was wondering if you heard of this book, and if you thought it was worthwhile. It sounds interesting and I love to read when I have time. Of course if it's so inspiring I will keep reading till I'm done!

There was a link to an e-book that promises to show you how to “discover your purpose in life”. All for only \$19.95, even though you can't take it out in the garden to read at leisure, as such an important and lofty tome should be read. This is what it promises:

Just imagine what it will be like to wake up every morning and know that you hold the key to the very reason for life itself. Not just to your own purpose, but the master key to the very reason for the existence of the universe!

When you gain this profound depth of understanding, imagine the sense of purpose and destiny that will be yours each and every day!

I don't normally respond to her frequent e-mails with various money making schemes, but I fatefully did respond to this one:

Thanks, but I already know my life's purpose.

This is the very unexpected response that she sent:

I was asking if you heard of this book, but I guess you are so far above everyone else you do not read, you are all-knowing and all-seeing. Kind of like a Hindu god.

... No man is an island, but you are definitely on a trip to ego island! Have fun!

It seems, then, that, although it is good to read about discovering one's life purpose, it is rather elitist and bad form to actually discover one's life purpose. Well, this particular all-knowing Hindu God is rather puzzled by this attitude. Moreover, why is not the author of the e-book considered pompous and elitist?

Posted on 2008-03-29 by Cologero

* * *

Beornulf on 2008-04-05 at 12:45 said:

The answer is resoundingly obvious. People of modern times despise anyone with purpose, it makes them feel inadequate and fear their own morality and self.

She's obviously trying to find a way to deal with her own insignificance, you stating that you know your purpose is of course going to offend her.

4.3 The Hair of the Dog

They say that the cure for a hangover is the “hair of the dog that bit you”. This is a homeopathic remedy in the sense that a very dilute portion of the poison that caused the illness provides the method for its cure.

Nevertheless, within the past few weeks I have heard on the Internet two serious proposals from “defenders of Western civilization” (albeit in quite different ways) about how to reach “young people”. And they both proposed (independently) that what “young people” want consists of multimedia presentations with music, snappy graphics, flashing images, lively web sites ... Unfortunately, that is the very disease they suffer from! Perhaps there is a proper homeopathic dose to apply, but a full dose of the same poison is sure not to have the desired effect. In the 60s, Marshall McLuhan pointed out that the “medium is the message”. Therefore, an attempt to change the content while retaining the same medium will not have the desired effect of changing the “message”. At best, there will result isolated or shallow “conversions”, but those loyalties can easily shift to the next big media event. And scattered counter-cultural elements will not be able to compete with the barrage of large-scale public media events.

The poison is the very dependence on sensory stimulation and its kaleidoscopic variations. The only effective antidote, then, is a shift from the stimulation of the senses to the stimulation provided by the apprehension of ideas. For this, Good and True ideas must be communicated. And their dissemination can be slow and tedious. There is no expectation that the “masses” will respond to such an appeal, but an elite will gradually form around them. This elite will serve as the fulcrum of the lever that will effect permanent change.

Update 24 April 2022: The website is defunct and the creator is disgraced.

Posted on 2010-04-24 by Cologero

* * *

Comprehensor on 2010-04-25 at 09:37 said:

People young and old are surely attached to sensory phenomena.

Do you think that another part of the problem is their unwillingness to sacrifice a portion of their individuality in the pursuit of truth and unity (as opposed to individual belief and small competing factions)?

Cologero on 2010-04-26 at 22:04 said:

This is not a “put down” of anyone attached to sensory phenomena. Merely a recognition that by the very nature of things most think only in terms of opinion. A smaller number will advance to rational thinking. But true Wisdom – episteme – is reserved to the few willing and able to make the necessary efforts.

Therefore, all attempts to appeal only to the sensory will be fated to partial results, which will be fickle, moving to the next “exciting thing”. Efforts must be made to create the elite and the rest will follow.

Comprehensor on 2010-04-27 at 08:57 said:

At the end of the day, tradition will only attract a select few, who more than likely will only pick and choose what they like to believe as conforms to their own individualities.

4.4 Death to the World

In Memoriam

In the USA, today is Memorial Day, when the war dead are memorialized. By extension, it is also a time to remember the dead among our family and friends; it is the secular equivalent to All Soul’s Day for an irreligious nation. We can also use the occasion to meditate on our own deaths, something we forget to do. Forgetting, sleeping, and death are all manifestations of a similar process.

With my own struggles with illness fresh in my mind, the death yesterday of Dennis Hopper is particularly memorable. For this writer, Mr. Hopper was at one point in his life what is called a “role model”. I want to use E. F. Schumacher’s¹ “Four Fields of Knowledge” to explore what

¹<http://www.smallisbeautiful.org>

that could mean. First of all, there is the I and the not-I, or “world”, or even “you”. Those are both the subjects and objects of knowledge. Thus our knowledge derives from two sources: “Inner Experience” and “Outer Appearance”. This leads to the schematization in Table 4.4.

Source		
I	I — inner	I — outer
You/It	You/It — inner	You/It — outer

This leads us to four questions:

1. Who am I?
2. What is the inner experience of others?
3. How do I appear to others?
4. What is happening in the external world?

Question 2 relates to empathy and 4 leads to science, but for our purposes, I will explore 1 and 3.

Dennis Hopper succeeded at level 3: he was known — at least in his exteriority — to millions. In his breakout move, *Easy Rider*, he and Peter Fonda succeeded in creating an image that many in that generation aspired to copy. Leaving aside the wisdom of roaming aimlessly on the highways on a motorcycle, or the use of mind-altering chemicals, it was still an image that captured the imaginations of millions, even if very few could succeed in pulling it off. But it was all exteriority, a pose, and it seems that Mr. Hopper remained in that mode his entire life. It was a life tied to the sensuous world and only the few with the looks, charm, and money can master that world, at least for a season, until the inevitable corruption arrives.

Some few men will turn aside from the sensuous world and seek to know themselves, not as another object in the world, but as the subject and agent of their own life. Then question 3 becomes irrelevant (except for those who play the guru game), and the focus is on question 1. Even for most of them, it is a transitory, not a permanent, condition. Therefore, it is important to remember to turn aside from the sensuous world to the higher world.

Yesterday I took a walk along the beach and did the following exercise. I recalled that state of consciousness called dispassion, or *apatheia*, and then as I observed the things in the world, I would begin to detach from them. There may be a short twinge of sadness or regret at having to leave these things behind, but that passes as the sense of detachment grows. This is called dying before you die.

Posted on 2010-05-31 by Cologero

4.5 Kidz, Kulcha, Kreativity

A few years ago, I watched a contrived controversy on a cable news channel. An exclusive and expensive liberal arts college in the suburbs of Los Angeles was giving students access to time on the campus cable TV channel. Not surprisingly, one group decided to produce pornography. Appearing on the show was a young woman, who was the producer, and a young man, one of the stars of the show.

Of course, the discussion followed the old tired pattern. On one side was the progressive liberated free thinkers and on the other the puritanical reactionary conservatives. Unfortunately, the world, even the educated world, can think only in terms of dualities when they need to think in terms of triads.

The format of the show was clearly designed to excite the two soul powers. One side represented liberated *eros*, not subject to any constraint.

The other side was incensed (*thumos*) over the degeneration of youth. The missing term of the triad is, of course, *nous*, the intelligence.

The disappointment is that these privileged students could not conceive of anything higher or more creative than pornography, which doesn't take much intelligence at all. Suppose, instead, that had attempted some of these more creative projects.

- Weekly series based on stories from the Eddas
- Plato's Republic has many story ideas
 - A story based on the ideal republic (even has its prurient interest)
 - A story based on the allegory of the cave
- Contests based on medieval knights. For example, climbing up the inside of a ladder in full armor.
- Legends of Hyperborea, Agarttha, Rama, Orpheus, or the stories of other initiates

Perhaps projects like these have not been done because they can't be done. Perhaps something has been lost in the transition from an oral, to a written, to a visual society, so it is only the spectacle that captures attention, and not old myths with a metaphysical message.

Leonardo da Vinci, who knew something about the visual arts, preemptively rejected the portrayal of sexual activity.

The art of procreation and the members employed therein are so repulsive, that if it were not for the beauty of the faces and the adornments of the actors and the pent-up impulse, nature would lose the human species.

Obviously, Leonardo did not consider the visual society, where pornography has become a major industry, and the repulsive is embraced.

In the piazzas of Florence where he grew up, he would have seen the puppet shows. In the evenings, the shows would have included sexual innuendos, in particular, mocking the affairs and trysts of the rich and famous. In the visual age, however, a staged photo or a leaked video on the Internet is often the path to stardom. With visual stimulation, the primal drives of eros (sex) and thumos (aggression) can be directly appealed to, as the content of television shows and movies attests to. There is an opposition that sees this, and its attendant dangers, but they have nothing to counter it. They appeal to sentimentalism, and say that man, on the contrary, is motivated by altruism, compassion, and so on. But there is not really a contrary, so sentimentalism is often disguised thumos, manifesting as the urge to appear as high status in another's eyes.

No, the resolution lies in *nous*. However, *nous* is non-formal manifestation; that is, there is no visual or other sensory representation of it. Hence, there is no direct way to portray it in any visual medium. But pornography is its opposite as Leonardo realized:

Intellectual passion drives out sensuality. Whoso curbs not lustful desires puts himself on a level with the beasts.

Posted on 2011-01-26 by Cologero

* * *

James O'Meara on 2011-01-27 at 10:59 said:

Gore Vidal, no prude he, said years ago that pornography was only for those without their own imaginations.

A recent book, *Pornland*, though somewhat tiresomely modernist-chauvinist, does make an interestingly similar point. 'Pornography' today does not refer to say, D. H. Lawrence a Traditionalist at least in intention being banned as 'indecent' but rather to the products of a billion or so dollar industry, which PROVIDES content, obviously with a certain agenda, to fill otherwise empty heads. One is not 'free' but precisely brainwashed.

Now, these kids are likely a little more under their own power, since they are at least making their own stuff, but I would bet the actual content is the same. The projects you suggest would require an active imagination, which is precisely what is lacking today.

I notice that your suggestions seem to be based largely on oral traditions; Homer certainly, with Plato dialogues written down, perhaps to force the point a medieval epic read aloud to a courtly audience. Perhaps as Plato suggests, the move from oral to written involves a diminution of independence and creativity, and contrary to McLuhan, the move from print to visual yet more.

This would seem to be in accord with Traditional notions of esoteric ideas requiring oral transmission and, or because, requiring the student to assimilate them for himself. Evola talks of scientific knowledge being the sort that is 'public' only because it is dead ideas poured into empty minds.

Perennial on 2011-01-27 at 12:32 said:
Interesting thought, James. Makes one wonder...

threefold_crown on 2011-01-28 at 11:24 said:
"The art of procreation and the members employed therein are so repulsive, that if it were not for the beauty of the faces and the adornments of the actors and the pent-up impulse, nature would lose the human species."

Is this the L. da Vinci quote you refer to?

Cologero on 2011-01-28 at 12:06 said:
Thank you, sir, for digging up that quote!

4.6 I had too much to Dream last Night

I had a dream last night that has left me bemused. Without going into what happened before, most of which I have immediately forgotten, the dream ended with a brief conversation with a friend at a café. I was explaining to her that she had two ways to look at the world.

1. Everything that happens depends on the past. The effects of the mass of past events weighs heavy on our current options, limiting our field of action, so it is difficult to extricate ourselves from what

has gone on before. As we grow older, we sense this more and more.
As the human race grows older, as a race we have fewer options.

2. Each moment is brand new, independent of what may have happened before. Hence, at any instant a new world is possible.

I've heard stories of people receiving answers in their dreams. I just get a dilemma.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=m7KxShixE-A>

Posted on 2011-11-24 by Cologero

* * *

Jupiter on 2011-11-24 at 14:50 said:

What dilemma? Neither of those possibilities can be true without the simultaneous actuality of the other possibility.

The duality is solely in your mind.

Logres on 2011-11-24 at 19:25 said:

But doesn't it have to be "in" your mind first, before you can transcend it? Unless someone is passing it by touch, or you've "done it before somewhere else", but then, perhaps the same thing? And could someone transcend it by having a dream, and then distancing one's self from the dilemma that way?

charlotte on 2011-11-25 at 12:38 said:

it's said that mundane man is controlled by his environment, while superior man governs his environment. There is a divine plan to all creation and existence, but the free will of man is a constantly limiting factor. Regarding 'all potential' being inherent in each moment, Timothy Leary opined that the universe is moving towards a state of ever-increasing complexity with the goal of a state of complete novelty. By achieving novelties within the infinite potential we gradually attain increased connectivity with the rest of the universe – by joining up the dots so to speak. A moment will then come when connectivity is finally reached, at which point there will be harmony because of natural understanding between beings. It's a matter of time, basically...

charlotte on 2011-11-25 at 12:40 said:

i think you can transcend a former state without having prior consciousness of it

logres on 2011-11-25 at 21:12 said:

Your comments, long as they often are, always have a profitable point. You've helped connect the dots.

Perennial on 2011-12-02 at 02:41 said:

I have never fully grasped the traditional view of reincarnation, but as I understand it, if we are understanding the world through the eyes of a spirit which has existed before, could we not, by intuition, know of matters without "knowing" them, but harvest from the knowledge of our soul? Would this not help our soul be more advanced when we entered the next realm? Surely understanding the world through the spirit is easier then always trying to grasp it mentally in the physical plane only.

Perennial on 2011-12-02 at 02:41 said:

I doubt anything I just said made a bit of sense.

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-02 at 14:40 said:

yes it did make sense. In answer to your questions, reincarnation is something which (by general though not unanimous consensus) either happens or has happened. Whether it is (now) necessary is more ponderable. Whether conscious recollection of past lives is either necessary and/or beneficial for spiritual growth is highly debatable. I would say not in the vast majority of cases, although there may well be unconscious and subconscious benefits. When it comes to remembrance of (possible) former lives, I'd say it can be hazardous, depending on how the knowledge is attained, and may only happen in either emergency situations or cases where an individual has such a high degree of spiritual attainment that they have the potential to achieve a Bodhisattava type state and work great healing in the world. (It stands to reason that the enemy might also make use of such insights). Generally, though, I think it is better not to see that much and ultimately reincarnation is an unnecessary doctrine because time and space have no meaning in the spiritual dimension. We are all Adam or Eve (both, even, if the universal androgyne is considered!), what more do we need to know?

In Letter V of meditations on the Tarot (The Pope), the author speaks of reincarnation:

The Buddha recognised and at the same time denied the fact of reincarnation. He recognised it as fact and he denied it as ideal. Because facts are transitory; they come and go.

There was a time when there was no reincarnation; there will be a time when it will no longer be. Reincarnation commenced only after the Fall and it will cease with Reintegration. It is therefore not eternal, and therefore it is not an ideal.

A longer extract is here:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/two-truths>

On the other hand pertaining more to your comment, certain polarised archetypes – of the kind that appear most often in reincarnation memories (or ‘memories’) – can certainly be benefit to contemplate. Clearly if one sees one’s self as a reincarnation of Apollo, Caesar or John the Baptist there is much to be learned from that particular blueprint of the soul! Similarly, understanding what it is to be miserly, spiteful and therefore lonely – as if one once was in another, more ordinary life – might well give one the desire to be more generous, cheerful and sociable. But in either extreme reincarnation is necessary neither in fact nor in theory. Empathy will suffice and compassion will bring the wisdom to use the knowledge in a beneficial way.

Empathy in itself helps to generate that compassion, and likely also a state of heightened perception, intuition, joy and other valuable spiritual fruits. It can also be very painful. As can a knowledge of reincarnation – as in, knowing (or ‘knowing’) of one’s past lives. Some schools of thought would say that in one’s ‘last life’ this type of memory occurs, although this might also be seen as a consequence of initiation, which permits conscious identification with and connectivity to the whole, with Divinity, unfettered by time or space. In either case recollection of one’s past life dramas – be they real or clever mental constructs – may well be used to deal with the karma of the soul, but this is an exceedingly complex procedure involving participation from one’s karmic relations and friends, ideally with some degree of consciousness also, though perhaps not of the identical pool of knowledge. Each to their own after all.

Either way, in one or many lives, one must pick up and put back together the pieces of the self in the process of returning to source. Connect the dots!

Charlotte Cowell on 2011-12-03 at 06:58 said:

the other thing I was going to say about that but forgot initially, is to do with the lake of forgetfulness, as it strikes me that one may have to drink from this if one has previously been awakened to reincarnation memories, from which it may be almost impossible to move on. By which I mean, the pull of one or more former lives might be stronger than the desire to lead one’s present life, thus hindering development. And even Buddha said that to forgive is good but to forget is better... but in this case, one must then have a ‘backup plan’ with respect to the divine/ blueprint – perhaps this is one function of the hermit’s ‘book’

4.7 Let no one ignorant of Geometry Enter

Signs of intelligence No one ignorant of geometry was allowed to study at **Plato's** Academy. Topology is a contemporary and more rarefied form of geometry. Mastery of geometry demonstrates some ability to think abstractly, that is, apart from the objects of sense, as well as the talent to follow and formulate a logical argument. So if maths is the most basic of sciences, then what are the highest sciences? They are politics and theology, since they are the sciences of temporal power and spiritual authority, respectively, and hence the most sublime knowledge.

So we see that politics and theology could be properly understood only by the few. Our knowledge of man, society, being, and God are as exact and as certain as a theorem in algebraic topology. In the modern world, there is quite the contrary notion as we pointed out in an early post². We moderns seldom understand maths, yet we suppose everyone is entitled to discourse on the topics of politics and religion. Thus, they become mere matters of opinion rather than the objects of infallible knowledge.

The Middle Way Last week, John vacationed in South Beach. While there, he sent a postcard to his Mom in Boston describing the beautiful beach, the warm, calm ocean, the fine restaurants, and so on. His Mom was happy to receive the card and reading it brought her happiness. However, she had no direct experience of South Beach, unlike her son.

So, what does it mean to understand **Nagarjuna's** Middle Way? First, a man must experience his own consciousness and ways of thinking. Then, the teachings of an enlightened being can make us appreciate its significance. But without the initial efforts, the teachings can only make a man confused. By observing how thinking one thought leads to its opposite, we can become frustrated with the constant interplay of irreconcilable opinions. That may lead a man, and very few of them, to seek

²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=37>

something beyond the samsaric world. This is not the place to discuss the specifics of the Middle Way, but rather to make clear what it means to understand such a path. It is quite the opposite of glibness.

Shibboleths The **Book of Judges** describes a conflict between the Gileadites and the Ephraimites. The latter had no *sh* sound in their dialect, so they pronounced the word “Shibboleth” as *sibboleth*. Thus the Gileadites were able to recognize Ephraimites by asking them to pronounce the word, or else meet their death.

The Gileadites had no interest in the metaphysical sophistication of their enemy, just their status as enemy. The spirit of the Gileadites is quite active today. The use of words “as a test” is still in force: if you look a certain way and hold to certain opinions, then you are “one of us”. As such, it is a low level of discrimination. Yet, in a war, it may be the most important.

Posted on 2012-02-02 by Cologero

* * *

Michael M on 2021-02-02 at 10:19 said:

“The use of words “as a test” is still in force: if you look a certain way and hold to certain opinions, then you are “one of us”. As such, it is a low level of discrimination. Yet, in a war, it may be the most important.”

What does it mean to hold certain opinions? i.e. They profess a certain opinion when asked and will be held “accountable” when acting in a contrary manner? or more so actually how someone functions in behavior?

I’ll put forth the view of both are valid, as the outcome of such a test is the desired data. If one speaks a certain way and acts differently, his character is revealed. If one does not speak but his behavior is seen as in tune, his character is revealed. All is settled in both accounts. Thus it is most unclear with those who are secretive or vague and never put themselves out into the light.

4.8 Kalashnikov Dreams

They say you can't dream of your own death.

Last night I had a dream, though I now only remember the ending. My comrades and I were in an apartment; they were in the anteroom and I was sitting alone by the dining room table. A half-wall separated the two rooms, so the dining room was visible from the front.

Our enemies burst in, heavily armed, and began shooting my friends up front. One of them peered through the opening, aiming his AK-47 at my heart. I felt the panic and the adrenaline was flowing. I considered running, but there was no way out. I wanted then to plead for my life, but did not. A calm came over me, I closed my eyes lightly and started meditating while I awaited the bullet aimed at my heart. I was hoping to enter a nondual state so I could remain fully conscious at the moment of death.

Just then I realized I was awake with my eyes still shut.

Posted on 2012-03-18 by Cologero

4.9 Hell and other lovely thoughts

My plan this summer is to read **Dante's** *Inferno*, but this time as initiatory work, rather than as a work of literature or the source of *la lingua nazionale*. Dante insists that it is the beginning of a journey that he must make in his body, that is, the reader must participate in it and not regard it from the outside as a visitor at a museum views a sculpture. This is a journey everyone must make, dead or alive, although few will complete it.

It may explain the dream I had recently. I attended a funeral, where I was greeted by an old man I used to know, but never think about. He allowed me into a room, where a sick priest was lying in bed. I thought to

ask him to hear my confession, but he was rambling incoherently and asking strange questions. Meanwhile, his foot kept appearing from beneath the sheets, at right angle to his body; it tried to grab my leg, as though it were a hand, in order to pull me in. I decided to leave, neither forgiven nor condemned. Perhaps it was Minos, trying to determine my place in hell.

Feminization of Thought I was invited to dinner last night by two dear friends on the occasion of the visit from New York of an old university buddy. After dining on Japanese food, where pleasantries were exchanged and our lives caught up, we finished our sake and the conversation got more serious. Somehow, we acknowledged the feminization of American “culture” and how many young men feel alienated (although not enough). I explained the difference between the male and female thought process. Women create a fictitious thought world which they then inhabit, and attempt to draw others in through constant chit chat and attempts at consensus building. When that fails, they resort to shaming and guilt. Men, on the other hand, use thought as a tool, supervening over experiential reality. To accomplish their ends, they understand the need for concrete motivations or else coercion, both subtle or overt.

Since Nietzsche, we can no longer deny this: there are different perspectives, all masking and underlying the lust for power. As an anti-egalitarian, I do not regard all points of views as equivalent, or all opinions as worthwhile; the reasons for this have been touched on previously and will be worth revisiting at a later time.

While there is no disputing facts, thought constructions, by their very nature, automatically invite dispute, arousing an opposition between the yes and the no. Unless a thought is anchored by reference to the material world via the senses, or to the supernatural world via spiritual, intuitive vision, it creates a web of illusion. Such thoughts latch onto each other in a pattern resembling chainmail. As it tightens, it obscures any higher

vision, and a man becomes a slave to his own opinions.

The American Election As might be expected, the conversation moved onto the American elections. Of course, our view is orthogonal to all the current alternatives, and is impossible to explain to the unprepared. We see one side representing the Shudra caste, functional atheists, promoting egalitarianism, formlessness, and lack of differentiation. Opposed to them, is the remnant of the Vaishya caste, advocating a hierarchy based on financial resources, and following a degenerate religious form.

To those without a sense of transcendence, their spiritual instinct is often replaced by an emotional bond to their political position, the highest form they can acknowledge. Unconcerned with facts, they are satisfied by repeating predigested responses to any objection. This makes any dialog, in the Socratic sense, impossible; in fact, it could be driven by robots.

Those who have any serious interest in chess will know that the most common opening moves have been analyzed in depth. Thus, in a tournament, you will see the first several moves, sometimes even a dozen, take place in rapid succession. That is because the best opening moves have been memorized. It is only when that has been exhausted does the real game begins at a much slower pace. The same can be said about contemporary political discussions. There are memorized responses that are hurled with complete confidence that they are defeaters to every argument. This continues to the point where original thought must begin; since most find that impossible, the end game is usually an emotional tirade. In chess, there is an objective standard, so the delusion cannot continue forever. In dialog, with no chessboard or established rules, very few are willing to submit to the laws of logic.

Choosing Obama One man seemed completely bewildered by white blue collar men opposing Obama, since it is “in their interest” to sup-

port him. Either he, or the blue collar workers, are delusional. I have an opinion on that. Earlier in the day, I watched a discussion program on a news channel supportive of the democrats. Since the so-called left wing is souring on Obama, one commentator defended him. The commentator was writing a book and had been granted interviews with Obama. According to the commentator, Obama said all his programs, such as healthcare, were designed to help minorities. Unfortunately, he claimed, he couldn't come out and say that. But, curiously, neither will his political opponents.

Sufi Poets By then I had had enough, although it is instructive to observe the human thought process. Fortunately, our old friend was an admirer of **Hafiz** and **Rumi**, so we moved the conversation in that direction, at least the two of us did. As I was leaving, she promised to send me some recent translations of their poems. That I look forward to.

Posted on 2012-06-06 by Cologero

* * *

Kamchatka on 2012-06-06 at 01:56 said:
I just want know, "Who is Hafiz?". I know Rumi and He is one of my torches of my twilight way.

Cologero on 2012-06-06 at 07:00 said:
*Kenosis and Hafiz*³

Kamchatka on 2012-06-06 at 07:05 said:
Oh I see... Persian sufi people and their works are not main source of me...

Cologero on 2012-06-06 at 07:37 said:
Wasn't Rumi a Persian Sufi?

³http://www.gornahoor.net/?page_id=4324

Kamchatka on 2012-06-06 at 07:47 said:

He was born in Belh, Afganistan and He had written in persian and spoken in turkish. "Rumi" name means Rome or Byzantium or Easter Roman Empire, at the very end days of that empire. "Rumi" nickname is given to him by other islamic and turkish people because of his last home city, Konya. His name is Mevlana Celaleddin-i Rumi, in fact.

When I talk about my sources, I mean Anatolian people and cultures...

Michael on 2012-06-06 at 09:39 said:

I am re-reading the *Commedia* as well—mostly because of this blog. Please keep us apprised of insights you run across as you make your journey.

Avery on 2012-06-06 at 23:19 said:

Your perspective on American politics is quite enlightening. It was not long ago that America's conservative class was openly opposed to equality and direct democracy. Now, the value the conservatives want to celebrate most is "freedom" and legal equality, which seems like a very fast devolution, but actually makes sense for a country that purposefully rid itself of tradition. They are still fighting populism—only the populism has become more absurd than it was a hundred years ago.

4.10 Players and Pugilists

It is of considerable significance that the profession considered most sinful in classical, medieval, and even early modern European society was the actor, that theater was consistently denounced by both civil and religious authorities, and that actors were not considered citizens in France until the great turning point of 1789. Even following this legal inclusion, actors continued to be excluded from polite society. Before the 1940s, appearing on stage was the surest way to destroy your good graces, and returning to society required renouncing one's past as a performer; but since the 1960s, newspapers have eliminated their "society pages" entirely and replaced them with coverage solely of actors and singers, with the effect that the society of gentlemen has been totally exchanged for a society

of performers, with few even noticing the world-upending magnitude of this transformation.

The prohibition on stage performance has now vanished from society, except among the dwindling readership of the *Social Register* and surviving members of the European aristocracy. What is surprising is how long the taboo against acting held out: even episodes of *I Love Lucy*, and films through the early 1950s, exhibit this disdain for “show business”. It is equally surprising how completely the taboo is forgotten today, considering its universality up until the 20th century. It is as if actors have always been worshipped, but throughout written history the reverse is standard.

In Rome, acting was the *ars ludicra*, basically implying a pointless and irreverent burlesque, and equivalent to prostitution. The state did not grant any legal rights to the actors, who were also forbidden from entering the military. In the *Lex Julia*, masters were forbidden from forcing their slaves to become gladiators, prostitutes, or actors. Likewise, senators and emperors were forbidden from marrying into families of slaves, prostitutes, and actors. Cornelius Nepos, examining the culture of Greece, reported that “to appear on the stage and exhibit oneself to the people” appeared to be almost honorable. But in Nepos’ wording we see the key Roman criticism of acting: that it degrades one’s virtue by creating a spectacle with the self at the center, drawing in not only friends and neighbors but that unfamiliar mass, “the people”.

St. Augustine, denouncing theater as a distraction from higher callings, suggested that actors be forbidden Communion, citizenship, and the ability to hold public office. The *Decretum Gratani* shows that actors were forbidden even from filing suit. In France they could not be buried alongside Christians. In Germany, the *Mirror of the Swabians* (*Schwaben-spiegel*) and the *Mirror of the Saxons* both rendered actors outcast, since “wandering minstrels and professional fighters ... were described as taking goods for honor, indeed as giving up their personhood for money.”

The use of “personhood” here is striking, and recalls Evola’s explanation of the etymology of “person”. To reinforce how Evola is far from alone in his opinions, here is Hobbes on the same subject:

The word person is Latin: instead whereof the Greeks have προσω-
πον, which signifies the *face*, as persona in Latin signifies the *dis-*
guise or *outward appearance* of a man, counterfeited on the stage
... and from the stage hath been translated to any representer of
speech and action, as well in tribunals as theatres.

Acting in its very language is the essence of becoming. The subject of a becoming is an actor, and to become is to act. A Brahmin may be the village patriarch, or he may *act as* the patriarch; he may be a permanent institution, or *play a role* in an impermanent arrangement. In the modernist mindset there is basically no being, only becoming, which is why human beings do not exist as high and low, men and women, but are rather said to “perform” an “act” in “social roles” and “gender roles”. It is shocking to realize that many of these theatrical metaphors, now so common that the underlying metaphor is vestigial, scarcely even existed in English before the year 1900.

Personhood is the ability to represent a being, either oneself or another, and should properly be employed honorably, facing towards virtuous things and ultimately towards the divine. In a setting of initiates these representations can take on great value. The self is something that should be minimized so that greater things can be maximized. To perform on the secular stage is to face away from virtue and towards “the people”, beautifying the self, and exhibiting oneself for fame and material gain. It is thus a metaphysically degrading profession, as is prostitution and democratic politics. Having written these words, we begin reading an essay by the American Founding Father John Witherspoon on “play-actors”, and we discover that he is in complete agreement:

All powers and talents whatever, though excellent in themselves, when they are applied to the single purpose of answering the idle, vain, or vicious part of society, become contemptible... Music has always been esteemed one of the finest arts, and was originally used in the worship of God, and the praise of heroes. Yet when music is applied to the purposes of amusement only, it becomes wholly contemptible. And I believe, the **public** performers, from the men-singers and the women-singers of Solomon, to the singers in the present theatres, are considered as in a disgraceful calling. Emphasis added –AHM

The example of the gladiator or professional fighter, with whom the actor is often twinned in these sources, should provide a useful analogy. A Christian or Muslim may flagellate his own body as a demonstration of his submission and selflessness. The only audience of his action is God, and indeed modern groups which practice mortification, such as Opus Dei, do so privately. A fighter, on the other hand, aims to attract a large, paying audience to see him batter the body of another and be battered himself. The Roman gladiator lacked a monetary incentive, but the direction of the activity was the same: facing away from the sources of virtue, and towards “the people”.

The traditional attitude towards this variety of degradation is a subject which deserves more historical study, as do the changes which produced modernity. What we find consistently in the few accounts we have assembled is that actors are banned from any role in hierarchy, as above, but they are still granted basic privileges. In the Ancien Régime, actors could get married under clearly symbolic conditions: they would renounce their profession, marry, and then quickly be reinvented to their profession by the valets de chambre. This was one of the institutions eliminated by the French Revolution, and the consequent dispute over the social rank of actors can be seen as one of the first battles of the occult war, albeit one that is completely forgotten today, and part of the process

by which tradition became limited to the religious sphere in the West.

One example will suffice to show how closely this battle resembles modern battles over similar issues. In December 1870, an actor named George Holland died in New York City. An Episcopal reverend named W.T. Sabine was called upon by a comedian friend of Holland's to perform the funeral. Rev. Sabine initially agreed to it, but then the comedian remembered that not all clergymen were fond of actors, and informed Sabine of the deceased's profession. Rev. Sabine responded that he would not permit a funeral for an actor in his house of worship, but that he would officiate at a home funeral if need be, and that there was a "little church around the corner" which would be more likely to accommodate him. This simple commitment by a single reverend to his values caused a national uproar, with newspapers around the country commenting on it, and Mark Twain dubbing the reverend a "crawling, slimy, sanctimonious, self-righteous reptile". The "little church around the corner" held the funeral and became famous for doing so, and still retains that nickname today. The news media did not speak a word in Rev. Sabine's favor, while those who approved did so privately, behind the closed doors of gentlemen's clubs and parlor rooms.

We must consider, not the "right thing to do" in this situation, but what metaphysics was incarnated in Reverend Sabine. For this man of God, the Church existed for worship and submission. By making a living on the popular stage, which is quite a different activity from acting as religious service, the actor failed to concern himself with the realization of his innate capacity for worship, which we call faith. Like every populist throughout history, his executor demanded the benefits of Christendom without fulfilling any of the responsibilities incurred by being a Christian. The Reverend followed his conscience to deem the actor a sinner; the doctrine of mercy could allow him a home funeral, but holding one in the church would do an injustice to the ancient standards of the body of Christ, dating back to St. Augustine. But the Reverend had unfor-

tunately been born into modernity, where the people dictate their own laws and choose their own gods.

Metaphysics in the sense of Guénon and Evola can often be confusing, but if you understand its rhythms it is easy to recognize its human forms. When we speak of Tradition, we mean to suggest to you the instructions Reverend Sabine was following when he refused the actor a church funeral. We aim to dispel the emotional clouding of populism which caused Twain to dub the Reverend a “reptile”, and to give the reader a clear and unclouded window into the beautiful structure of the Reverend’s universe, the same beauty that is reflected when the modern church refuses marriage to homosexuals. Tradition is not a confusing relic of the past, but a permanent structure that gives access to divinity; and while it is almost vanished in the present day, it still exists for anyone with the courage to recognize its forms and appreciate them.

The New York incident was the end of official discrimination between actors and Christians. Unofficially, though, high society remained outside and above show business for many decades more. Newspapers continued to print denunciations of theater up until roughly 1900. In the private spaces of those clubs and parlors, which were quite influential in that era, marriage to an actor or singer was anathema through roughly 1940, as we have said. Following the mass production of film, however, the cult of the actor grew in America to such an extent that an unholy marriage between acting and nobility was produced, and birthed “celebrity”. The pugilist, to be sure, is still not welcome at a party, for the degrading nature of his work remains clear; but the player has become the star of the show, so to speak. The private aristocrat is no longer interesting to the common people, except when it is time to hate him. The public actor, on the other hand, shares with the common people an open desire for mindless entertainment and vanity, and is thus beloved.

The ennobling of the traditional outcaste of actors must be seen as a key step in the transition from tradition to modernity. As an outcaste,

actors formally play no role in the traditional metaphysics. This enables them to create their own, rivaling metaphysics and ridicule the values of the traditional system. When actors are exclusively male and employed by a patron or an institution, as was the case in Greece, on Shakespeare's stage, and in the Catholic passion plays, they may work as a visionary force within tradition. Left to their own devices, though, actors and actresses will display themselves to the world for money and fame, and this celebration of vanity is destructive to tradition.

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Cleveland Amory. *Who Killed Society?* Harper, 1960.

Jonas A. Barish. *The Antitheatrical Prejudice*. University of California Press, 1985.

Kathy Stuart. *Defiled Trades and Social Outcasts: Honor and Ritual Pollution in Early Modern Germany*. Cambridge University Press, 2000.

"Pharisaical Delicacy⁴." New York Times, 29 December 1870.

Recommended further reading:

<http://www.imdb.com/keyword/all-male-cast/>

Claudia Durst Johnson. *Church and Stage: The Theatre As Target of Religious Condemnation in Nineteenth Century America*. McFarland, 2007.

You may read my blog⁵ if you like.

Posted on 2012-06-09 by Avery Morrow

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⁴<http://query.nytimes.com/gst/abstract.html?res=F00715F83F551A7493CBAB1789D95F448784F9>

⁵<http://avery.morrow.name/blog/>

Izak on 2012-06-09 at 20:57 said:

This was a damn fine little essay – very interesting and thought-provoking!

Definitely adds a much-needed perspective for anyone who's ever been exposed to post-modern "performativity theory" in the American academic establishment.

Good job.

Cactus on 2012-06-10 at 20:31 said:

A fine essay indeed!

"Left to their own devices, though, actors and actresses will display themselves to the world for money and fame, and this celebration of vanity is destructive to tradition."

Ultimately, every activity left to its own devices (that is to say, performed outside of a tradition) can be degrading, 'sinful'. So, in *Cavalcade la Tigre* we read that the problem for the differentiated man is not the search for a basis, which he ought to possess by virtue of his special differentiation, but his "expression and confirmation" in this life. Hence the treatment of 'pure action' in the same text, for those who must remain in the world and choose from a variety of desecrated activities, for whatever purpose.

It is no wonder that acting and singing gained prestige at a time when traditionally respectable professions were undergoing final subjection to secular humanism, scientistic positivism, and their attendants, as all understanding of true ethics was eclipsed.

Now it is the Arabs' turn to handle the hot potato (this from today's news):

"A Saudi city known for its ultra-conservatism has created its own version of the 'Arabs Got Talent' television reality show, but with no music and women banned from taking part.

Instead, competitors will be permitted to perform religious chants, recite poems and engage in sports events."

Cologero on 2012-06-12 at 19:07 said:

It was probably Grace Kelly's marriage to the Prince of Monaco who changed all that; at least, unlike today's entertainers, she learned to act the part of a Princess. Since then, the "beautiful people" and those connected to power began their increasingly more entwined alliance. The result is that, over time, the values of the prole and the outcast have become the "in" values: the need to shock, to overturn, to revolt; the quest for the novel and the bizarre; the pursuit of pleasure rather than depth; the elevation of appearance over reality; playing the part rather than being authentic.

By definition, popular culture must appeal to the masses. As a consequence, this involves "*épater le bourgeois*"⁶. Since the bourgeois class lacks any support from above, they are made to look ridiculous. Unfortunately, we meet the same inclination from those above; for example,

⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/%C3%89pater_la_bourgeoisie

the likes of Evola and Nietzsche do the same, albeit from a higher point of view. However, that subtlety is lost on the crowd, and the overall result is a pulling downward rather than an uplifting.

Michael Rayborn on 2012-06-28 at 14:51 said:

While I understand the article being written as well as its viewpoints, I disagree with the idea that pugilism is a degenerate practice. It is valuable for many reasons which I will list below:

In a Traditional Society, the Military or "Second Function" is considered one of the higher functions because a person is willing to sacrifice themselves for their particular homeland and culture.

In order for a Military to be effective in the practical sense, it must be able to Teach a curriculum of the highest order. Part of this curriculum is Hand to Hand combat.

Sporting activities such as pugilism (MMA, boxing, ect.) provide impetus through which techniques can be explored and tested within a laboratory. Competition through the promise of fame and fortune provides motivation for the fighters to excel and develop these techniques to the highest level. These methods can the be extrapolated and then incorporated into military training.

My views on this are not unique or even my own. The modern military utilizes Mixed Martial Arts as its combat method. Ancient Greece (and Sparta) utilized an ancient form of MMA known as "Pankration" as its fighting style.

All sports, particularly combat sports (hockey, football, ect.) are useful for instilling aggressiveness, competitive attitudes, willingness to overcome and face pain, fighting spirit and many other attributes that are necessary for warrior ship. These activities also gives warrior folk something to do during times of peace so that their bodies, minds, and souls will not atrophy.

The pursuit of wealth and fame are not necessarily at odds with Tradition. A person can be Wise, Just, Courageous, and Noble and know how to utilize fame and wealth towards constructive ends. People who are wealthy and famous have more power, and people with more power are better able to cause change (for good or ill). A person who possesses fame and wealth while having a noble disposition can do very positive things. Of course, I am not saying that someone should absolutely pursue things things (I know I don't). I am simply stating that such things can be used to serve the Needs of Tradition itself.

Cologero on 2012-07-21 at 00:18 said:

This is from Louis de Bonald:

Yet when in this past century some thought that comic actors should be raised to the rank of public men because they performed for the public, *opinion*

protested against the absurdity. The profession of acting has in fact abased itself all the more in spite of the efforts that have been made to render it honorable, and we may be assured that the opinion that condemns it still exists in all of its force.

This is the precise reason:

it is noble to devote oneself to the public utility and ignoble to sell oneself to the public's pleasures.

It light of this, it is clearly a sign of the times that in the USA, young people get their *news from a clown!*⁷

Ash on 2013-07-29 at 23:21 said:

A late read, but here are a couple of comments anyways:

Are you distinguishing here between High Society (American and European) and the actor's degraded role? I want to be sure that's the case. I don't think one can overlook the public spectacle that High Society many times itself became – you yourself mention the Society pages of the papers. The extravagant pandering to the media and hotlists of the time has been well documented from the 19th century onward, from the works of Dostoyevsky and Tolstoy in Russia to the Bloomsbury group in Britain to the authors of works like the Great Gatsby in America.

Also, I think Cologero's example of Jon Stewart is rather apt. It is only when the proper authorities have failed in their duties that the forces which the "actor" here represents can take over. Stewart's role as a court jester of the modern United States is valuable indeed, even if America were a functioning society. But the "proper" news outlets are utterly vile sources of information and their journalism is barely extant. What can one do but turn to the court jester, when he at least gives us a far better substitute? In the interregnum, it's the best there is.

JA on 2013-07-30 at 13:15 said:

We still have some ways to go before our "aristocrats" become men akin to this bloke : <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Elagabalus>

Avery Morrow on 2013-08-03 at 06:06 said:

Ash, yes, I did not mean to imply that old aristocrats could not be society maniacs and love to see their name in print. But such behavior was deplored when aristocracy was by blood. Today it is significantly less so. "Celebrities" (the very term is a neologism) have only a pale

⁷http://www.cbsnews.com/2100-207_162-603270.html

imitation, almost a parody, of the restraint and decorum shown by those who they wiped from the entertainment pages of the newspapers.

JPV on 2015-03-28 at 20:24 said:

I am an actor, director and a playwright. I am also a conservative Catholic. For years I struggled to conciliate those two facets of my identity. In acting school I had to do perform in two plays and in those two plays I had to play homosexual characters (at the time I was an atheist but I was already sick of the agenda).

When I became a Catholic I had to leave the whole circuit behind, because I just couldn't conciliate my faith in Christ with the modern "values" exposed by 95% of my peers. I became an outcast. Still, I felt I was running away from my vocation.

Now I only direct and act in morality plays, or plays from Christian authors or plays I find transmit wholesome values I agree with. My last production was "Magic" by GK Chesterton and I was surprised by people's reaction. You have no idea the amount of people who came to me and said "Finally! A play who is not about a homosexual coming to terms with his homosexuality! Finally a play I want my children to see!".

This was a very enlightening post. And I do agree with the sentiment: we give actors and artists in general too much credence.

God bless.

4.II November Musings

There are those who think they can hide from the pains, frustrations, and sorrows of life simply by thinking positive thoughts. This is not the mark of high spiritual evolution, as they think, but rather the sign of a lack of depth.

There is the new age notion that our thoughts can entice the universe to satisfy all our desires, just as a baby commands the teat by crying. But even the baby needs to be weaned from milk and start eating flesh.

It is hard to believe that the end of desire will bring the end of suffering, when all our instincts convince us that suffering ends when desires are satisfied.

Most of those attracted to a spiritual life, in their initial excitement, try to adopt the dress, mannerisms, and speech of what they imagine a

“spiritual” person to be like. This is most certainly wrong. At first, change nothing, but begin to bring order to your own mind. Your life will then follow naturally.

I’m amazed at how many people show no sign of change after adopting some spiritual practice, even for a long time. Their views and ideas are indistinguishable from their quite ordinary neighbors.

Methodism was a decisive movement in the anti-tradition when John Wesley discerned God’s Will by the “warm feeling in the heart”. For Tradition, such discernment is a matter of the Intelligence or Intellect, not ephemeral and unreliable feelings. This attitude dominates American culture where nearly everyone is convinced his opinion is correct because it is accompanied by a comforting or strong feeling.

This attitude is worsened by the idea of progress. The past is considered to have been inhabited by ignorant, superstitious, stupid, intolerant, and evil men. The corollary is that men of today have “evolved”, apparently through no effort of their own. Hence, they cannot possibly be ignorant, superstitious, stupid, intolerant, or evil, no matter what they say, do, or think.

Posted on 2012-11-12 by Cologero

* * *

Michael on 2012-11-13 at 18:45 said:

This reminds me of a question I’ve had for a while but I couldn’t find the right place to ask it. Is there anything within esoteric tradition that addresses maintaining or reclaiming physical health?

Dominion on 2012-11-13 at 19:36 said:

I can’t think of any particular text, but it would seem that to maintain a healthy inner order would require its manifestation in a healthy outer form. The beauty of the outer form, in turn, inspires one to return to the source of the truths it reflects. The reflection of metaphysical principles is fairly obvious.

Anna Swadling on 2016-11-13 at 12:57 said:

Michael dear, I personally witness a stronger presence of my spirit when my physical form is what I call a diamond body—when the two are one. I think I must have also read this from Evola some years ago. More thoughts welcome . . .

4.12 Avoiding the Hands of the Sophists

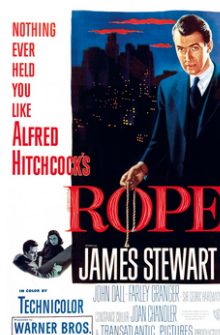
When I had an inclination to philosophy, I did not fall into the hands of any sophist.

MARCUS AURELIUS, *Meditations*

My son, who has been reading *Meditations*, asked me last night what a sophist is. I explained to him that a philosopher is a lover of wisdom while a sophist is a lover of his own words as well as the applause of other men. The sophist is paid for his opinions and will use any rhetorical device to make his case apart from considerations of facts or logic. I pointed out that we are awash with sophists today, all over television and radio; these talking heads are paid quite well to promote a certain point of view. Don't get me wrong, I am not simply saying they are necessarily cynical or hypocritical; they are still sophists even if they sincerely believe what they say. The next tier, those who provide the fodder for the more successful sophists, are apparently under the impression that every wandering influence that enters their head as a thought, is somehow worth repeating.

The first investigation of the philosopher when faced with a thought is to relate it to the transcendentals. Is it:

- True or false



- Good or bad
- Beautiful or ugly, or noble or vulgar

The opinion mongers approach the thought in a different way. They ask instead

- Does it make me feel good or bad
- Does it improve my self-image
- Does it bring me esteem or cement the “we” feeling of my group

The more alert sophists boast of knowing all the philosophers. However, they do not know them in depth, i.e., in their principles, but rather they arrange them in easy to remember categories, just as my mother used to arrange Hummel figurines on shelves. They are easily recognizable since they sound like a professor leading a survey class at university. They will synopsise a great thinker or some long historical movement in a short sentence with a few adjectives.

Conversion Since the sophist knows so many systems, his mind is flighty, converting from one to another on a whim. These horizontal conversions are meant to bring on good feelings from an artificial high. Although partisans of various groups make use of them, they are pointless here. There are simply too many and it is always formulaic. Whether a man is converted by the Doctrine of Awakening, the Book of Mormon, Mein Kampf, the Communist Manifest, or Richard Dawkins, the formula is the same: the claim to a sudden insight, the instant obliteration of all past points of view, and the urge to evangelize. H L Mencken granted a man one such conversion in his life, but more than that is too much and the man could not be trusted.

We are more interested in two related conversions, or really two aspects of the same conversion:

Intellectual Conversion The conversion from seeing the world horizontally in terms of things and events to understanding it vertically, in terms of principles.

Moral Conversion The conversion from acting from the motives of likes, dislikes, desires, pleasures, and emotions to developing the wisdom, courage, and prudence or skillful means to act in terms of principles.

It must be emphasized that these conversions are not related to “intellectuality” as currently and popularly conceived, nor even to literacy. My son, for example, has sound instincts but lacks the rhetorical skills to express them in the written word. Throughout history, initiates were often illiterate, but no less initiated for that reason. In many ways that was a boon, since literacy today makes it easier for a man to absorb the dominant propaganda.

The Abyss Because of the lack of a common mind and the ubiquity of media today, we are bombarded with opinions: those of the shopkeepers, Christians, cows, females, Englishmen, and democrats are indiscriminately mixed in with those of the warrior [Freidrich Nietzsche, *Twilight of the Idols*]. Here, Nietzsche displays his confusion or incomprehension. Which group in that list has historically eschewed pleasure to embrace difficulties, hardships, and privations, even life itself in the case of the martyrs? What about the warriors **Constantine, Charlemagne, Charles Martel**, the Templars and so on, who delight in war? Or is it only war without purpose that counts?

Some months back, I heard a neo-pagan on the radio, practically in tears about some alleged pagan holocaust of a millennium ago, claiming numbers as high as 10 million. He should have dropped the number by a few million to gain more credibility. But what was he really objecting to, if not to being among those human beings sacrificed for some other

man's cause? I'll leave it to the more enterprising readers to locate the source for these two paragraphs.

It is true about the democrats, those who are ignorant about human nature, and whose only desire is that everyone be as timid as they themselves. We see that today in the USA over the "gun control debate"; they believe a new law by a minimally competent government will forever end murders. Perhaps they are even allied with the neo-Christians of today. But we know that a murderous heart is hidden in the heart of darkness of the human being, from the time of Cain and Abel.

Your homework is to watch **Alfred Hitchcock's** film, *The Rope*, in the upcoming month. Two young men murder a classmate to prove their superiority as *uebermenschen*. They justify this from conversations with their professor who proclaimed Nietzsche's philosophy to them. The professor was appalled when he found out; presumably he was a cow or a woman, or more likely an armchair warrior. Yet their real sin was not the murder, but their choice of victim, someone too weak to strike back.

More Preparation My son was confirmed years ago at the Cathedral in West Palm Beach soon after the new Bishop was installed, whose name I have forgotten, and may memory of it be blotted out forever. Within weeks, as we were watching the nightly news, we heard that the Bishop had confessed to pedophilia. I recall to this day, the look of shock and bewilderment on my son's face. His only comment was that he was happy that the bishop hadn't touched him, since an auxiliary had confirmed him.

He is reasonably holy, but he won't step inside a church any more often than he has to. I can't argue with him, since they are seldom places where young men can feel comfortable. It is too easily forgotten that there are different spiritual practices for the different callings in life: the priest, the warrior, the creator. I know I have promised the put forth the views of the Frankish bishops on this and that is forthcoming. But

meanwhile, there is much spiritual preparation that a man in the world can still perform.

We have previously explained that the candidate for initiation must demonstrate fearlessness, freedom from lust, loyalty, and the ability to be silent (*omertà*). Don't even consider initiation until you are properly prepared. For example, my son has these qualities so I know I can trust my life in his hands; should I have told him to pray the rosary daily instead?

A man, for his preparation, can conquer his fear of the elements: fire, air, water, and earth. Overcoming such fears leads to self-knowledge and a concentrated mind. Those with a warrior cast of mind need to excel at a martial art or develop skill with weaponry. Time spent in this way is more beneficial than excessive, or obsessive, reading. If you don't regard these activities as spiritual, then make them so. Do them with the right attitude and full consciousness.

Those who practice an art or a craft can do their work skillfully and fairly. This is spiritual preparation for the third caste. They can learn techniques of concentration, control over their thoughts, and development of the will. I think I have made too much of traditional practices such as prayer and contemplation, which are the way for a select few, and not enough of these other things. Perhaps a series on the development of the will is in order.

Posted on 2013-01-17 by Cologero

* * *

william zeitler on 2013-01-19 at 11:50 said:

I agree that the range of spiritual practices is considerably larger than the standard 'meditation', etc. There are plenty of 'trees of spiritual practices'—I particularly liked this one.

<http://www.contemplativemind.org/practices/tree>

Martial arts is one I fell into almost by accident, and it has done more to smooth out the rough edges of my soul than almost anything else. Also, as a professional musician, I've realized that I can turn doing my scales into its own spiritual practice—being fully present, etc.

4.13 News on President's Day

Pope Benedict abdicated this week amidst rumours, conspiracy theories, signs, and wonders. There was a lightening strike over Rome that used to indicate that Jupiter was pleased with the Roman High Priest. The near collision with an asteroid and the strange meteor over the Urals also happened this week. The timing was strange, given the year long celebration of Vatican II and the promised encyclical on faith that will never be. We prefer to think that he had a personal revelation like that of St Thomas Aquinas and decided to spend his last days as a sannyasi⁸. If so, that would be a noble tradition to revive.

Speaking of presidents, I doubt that President Lincoln could have prosecuted the Civil War⁹ if it were happening today. CNN would call it the “American spring”, Europe would be arming the rebels, the UN would be promoting sanctions. Of course, the ultimate question is “How many of his own people is Lincoln killing?” Historian John Huddleston estimates the death toll at ten percent of all Northern males 20–45 years old, and 30 percent of all Southern white males aged 18–40. By that standard, he would make those Arab dictators look like mere patzers.

Senator Chuck Hagel's interrogation did not go well even if I am numbered among his supporters. All his groveling and retractions did not help his cause at all. A man would have stood by his statements, justified them as well as he could, and let the chips fall where they may. Based on the line of questioning, it was not always clear which country he was supposed to be defending.

The West's “great experiment” in freedom may be reaching its limits, *Deo Volente*. Iceland is calling our right to pornography into question¹⁰.

⁸<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sannyasa>

⁹[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Civil_War_\(United_States\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Civil_War_(United_States))

¹⁰<https://www.telegraph.co.uk/news/worldnews/europe/iceland/9866949/Iceland-considers-pornography-ban.html>

Which alleged right will be next?

Here is a reason that comedians should keep their serious opinions to themselves. Chris Rock said¹¹:

I am just here to support the President of the United States. The President of the United States is ... our boss. ... The president and the first lady are kind of like the mom and the dad of the country, and when your dad says something, you listen! And when you don't, it usually bites you in the ass later on.

Doesn't anyone else find this attitude totally contrary to the American system of governance by checks and balance? Isn't this apotheosis actually dangerous?

The book *Quiet*¹² points out that the USA changed from a culture of character to a culture of personality. The effect is that people now admire movie and rock stars, athletes, and those who put on the best show. The new gospel seems to be The vulgar shall inherit the earth.

The book *Quiet* shows that people in a group actually undergo brain changes that alter their perception of reality. That is why social conformity works so well, since most people will have a change of biochemistry and will then simply adopt the consensus reality of the dominant members of society. Those who oppose the consensus are by necessity exposed to alternate viewpoints (since the consensus viewpoint is unavoidable) and may thus see things more clearly.

The foundation of the college dropout Bill Gates is heavily promoting university education by means of electronic and on-line courses. You

¹¹http://entertainment.nbcnews.com/_news/2013/02/06/16872099-chris-rock-jim-carrey-bruce-willis-take-fresh-aim-in-gun-control-debate?lite

¹²https://www.amazon.com/Quiet-Power-Introverts-World-Talking/dp/0307352153/ref=sr_1_1?s=books&ie=UTF8&qid=1361053894&sr=1-1&keywords=quiet

can be sure that Microsoft technology will be heavily involved. Bill Gates said in an interview that he can raise all the average teachers to the top quartile. He must have studied the Lake Wobegon¹³ school system where all the teachers and students are above average.

Obama wants to hire 100,000 teachers for STEM subjects¹⁴. Unfortunately, anyone competent in a STEM subject will not typically choose to be a teacher. In any event, the major beneficiaries of this initiative will not be American citizens.

Wealthy people in California may not be quick to leave the state for Texas. According to The Lion¹⁵, “the vast majority of rich people would rather pay high taxes than have to live in a state full of rednecks and Jesus freaks.”

Senator Feinstein wants to outlaw several weapons she considers to be “assault” weapons. I am curious. Can she actually name one legitimate army in the world that would use any of those weapons to launch an assault?

Obama is complaining about the upcoming sequester (automatic budget cuts); he is blaming the Republican congress even though he proposed and approved the sequester himself. Secretary of State Kerry warned that the sequester would end all financial aid to Israel; presumably, he said that to scare the Republicans into overturning the sequester. It is odd that all those who believe in man-made climate change suddenly see the sequester as some sort of natural act.

Evolution is now an article of faith: you “believe” in it or you don’t. Forget the scientific method that claims to demonstrate its theories. Does natural selection explain human intelligence, language, consciousness, morality?¹⁶ Dr. Charlton claims that most liberals “are also dumb and

¹³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lake_Wobegon

¹⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/STEM_fields

¹⁵<http://lionoftheblogosphere.wordpress.com/2013/02/06/california-has-high-taxes-but-rich-not-leaving/>

¹⁶<http://charltonteaching.blogspot.com/2013/02/does-natural-selec>

uninformed and have not ever thought-about anything for more than three minutes”. If that be true, they won’t have read this far.

Posted on 2013-02-16 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2013-02-16 at 19:05 said:

Apparently Chris Rock is a monarchist... ..though he is probably not consciously aware of it. Try as they might, the champions of democracy just can’t seem to end the continuing power that a monarchy has over people (the royal wedding two years ago is further proof of this).

Avery Morrow on 2013-02-16 at 19:59 said:

“The effect is that people now admire movie and rock stars, athletes, and those who put on the best show.”

Hey, someone stole *my idea*¹⁷!

I was very concerned about the Pope at first, thinking that the necessity for an active Pope was proof that modernity was switching into high gear. But people have pointed out many possible theories behind his resignation that don’t involve a concession to the Church’s critics.

4.14 Unserious Meditations

I used to think that books like *Brave New World* and 1984¹⁸ were intended to warn us about what may happen. Now I realize their purpose was to prepare us to welcome the brave new world with open arms and closed minds. The real irony are those vocal people think they are still free when they are fully immersed in it.

tion-explain-human.html

¹⁷<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4338>

¹⁸<http://www.ritholtz.com/blog/2010/08/who-was-right-huxley-or-orwell/>

Suppose we eat government recommended food, read government approved news, receive a government education, etc. After all the answers are given, the problem of life still remains.

I watched part of a movie called *Hysteria*¹⁹ tonight. The heroine, who was a feminist, a social reformer, a free love advocate, was described as the most Christian woman in England. The doctor got rich by developing a personal massager to bring woman to orgasm. Once women are liberated, prostitutes find honorable work, and men learn how to sexually satisfy a woman, the problems of life still remain.

I really can't watch a movie anymore. It only works when the viewer is drawn in to the film and identifies with the characters. However, when you see through it, when you see actors reciting lines, when you understand how props are used and stories developed, when you read the subliminal message, then there is little more than flashing multi-colored lights.

The same applies to life. When there are only discrete and unrelated transient events, a man cannot be attracted by the glamour of life. The trick is to find the unity behind those appearances.

The Exoteric and Esoteric are not opposed but are intimately related. The exoteric perspective describes things from the outside and tries to prove things through logic and the rational mind. The esoteric, on the other hand, takes the inner view and understands things by intuition, which is closer to seeing than thinking. The philosopher is exoteric and the metaphysician is esoteric.

For example, regarding the soul, the exoteric will name its components and argue for its findings. The esoteric, instead, will observe the inner workings of the soul. The insoluble philosophical problem is the one and many. The metaphysician, through meditation, will see the one and the many directly. He will observe the ever changing contents of consciousness. He will learn to discern the different levels and will seek the

¹⁹[http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hysteria_\(2011_film\)](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hysteria_(2011_film))

unifying force behind all those appearances, that which does not change amidst all the change. That is itself not an appearance.

The exoterist will follow God's will in all things and trusts that God has chosen all for him. The esoterist will see how he chose his own life and all its circumstances. He does not mean anything different from the exoterist. Atman is Brahman, or put on the mind of Christ through whom all things were made.

Nietzsche criticized bourgeois Christians of his time, but he could not have criticized Christianity itself, which is not a "thing". A man doesn't choose a worldview because of its alleged consequences but because he believes it is true.

Nietzsche's critiques are not surprising to those who know, yet that seem novel to others. That true religion declines because of the degeneration of castes, is one such fact. That the priesthood becomes effeminate when inferior castes take dominion is another. The half-educated think they have discovered universal, rather than merely contingent, truths.

Children at school learn to "show and tell". Nietzsche tells, but he seldom shows.

That is because for Nietzsche, nothing is known until the act is performed. Specifically, thought follows action and, at best, it serves an instrumental purpose to make action effective. At worse, it is a form of false consciousness that hides the will to power.

Nietzsche predicted dire consequences because of Western Christianity. However, there have been ever worse consequences from his thought. The first is that logical discussion is no longer possible because of the hermeneutics of suspicion. All thought is presumed to be the ideological superstructure hiding the desire for money, sex and power; their respective prophets are Marx, Freud, and Nietzsche.

The second consequence is the idea that a man can become a superman simply by rejecting Christianity. Doing so does not make a man *ipso facto* a superman, no more than putting on a muscle shirt

makes a man a bodybuilder. Europe, for example, has been repaganized. Where, then, do we see a resurgence of Nietzschean supermen? But the neopagans would immediately object: they are not the real pagans, we are. So likewise the bourgeois Christians of the 19th century are not the real Christians. So who are?

Pope Leo XIII tells us in *Immortale Dei*²⁰:

There was once a time when States were governed by the philosophy of the Gospel. Then it was that the power and divine virtue of Christian wisdom had diffused itself throughout the laws, institutions, and morals of the people, permeating all ranks and relations of civil society. Then, too, the religion instituted by Jesus Christ, established firmly in befitting dignity, flourished everywhere, by the favour of princes and the legitimate protection of magistrates; and Church and State were happily united in concord and friendly interchange of good offices.

The State, constituted in this wise, bore fruits important beyond all expectation, whose remembrance is still, and always will be, in renown, witnessed to as they are by countless proofs which can never be blotted out or ever obscured by any craft of any enemies. Christian Europe has subdued barbarous nations, and changed them from a savage to a civilized condition, from superstition to true worship. It victoriously rolled back the tide of Mohammedan conquest; retained the headship of civilization; stood forth in the front rank as the leader and teacher of all, in every branch of national culture; bestowed on the world the gift of true and many-sided liberty; and most wisely founded very numerous institutions for the solace of human suffering. And if we inquire how it was able to bring about so altered a condition of things, the answer is beyond all question, in large measure, through reli-

²⁰http://www.vatican.va/holy_father/leo_xiii/encyclicals/documents/hf_l-xiii_enc_01111885_immortale-dei_en.html

gion, under whose auspices so many great undertakings were set on foot, through whose aid they were brought to completion.

The anti-Christians, then, must dispute that description or risk being irrelevant. They must refute the intellectual founders of the Middle Ages: **Plotinus**, **Augustine**, **Boethius**. They must show that **Thomas Aquinas** does not represent traditional metaphysics. They must deny that **Dante Alighieri** represents the peak of medieval Christian thought. Those who claim to be traditionalists must show how **Rene Guenon**, **Julius Evola**, and **Ananda Coomaraswamy** were wrong about the Middle Ages and tradition.

Dante regarded the Roman Empire as the supreme manifestation of temporal power and the Medieval church as the spiritual authority.

In ancient Rome, punishment was public for the edification of others; in the Middle Ages, punishment was usually hidden, since it was for the edification of the offender.

Only the isolated ascetics can restore tradition. Even if that is true, he would know how to recognize them.

Here is one such man. **St Mark the Ascetic** in the *Philokalia* mentions three great enemies:

1. Ignorance
2. Forgetfulness
3. Sloth

Ignorance, as the enemy of the Intellect, is the first thing to overcome. Obviously a man must learn proper doctrine, not just exoteric, but also esoteric.

Forgetfulness results from being absorbed in the glamour of life. Consciousness identifies with the many rather than the one. Never forget who you are, why you were born, what you need to accomplish, what your

real life is. Of course, most humans prefer to drink from Lethe, the river in Hell that causes them to forget.

Sloth is the enemy of the Will and the abandonment of the will to power. No matter how much you know, it needs to be brought into manifestation, that is, real world effects. Therefore, you will never really know what is possible, nor even who you really are, unless and until the right efforts are made.

Posted on 2013-02-25 by Cologero

* * *

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-26 at 00:25 said:

"The Exoteric and Esoteric are not opposed but are intimately related."

The teachings of Tradition would go on to say that doctrine, though indispensable, is **transcended** from *within*. This is the key principle behind the Transcendent Unity of Religions.

At OrthodoxChristianity.net, I came across an interesting debate on this subject that I would like to share. In this exchange, a defender of Christian exclusivism insisted that Eastern Orthodoxy is, of course, fundamentally esoteric with Divinization as its central teaching. However, he argued against the Perennialist view that esoterism transcends theology and doctrine.

"Our (Orthodoxy) "esoterism" is inextricably bound up with the "exoteric" dogmas and ones leads to the other. Difference in dogma results in difference of spiritual experience. Our theology and worship are inherently mystical... .. those further on the path of deification will grow deeper in their understanding of Revelation"

If the traditional Christian insists that his theology IS his esoterism, how are we to understand this with the Traditionalist framework?

Avery Morrow on 2013-02-26 at 02:03 said:

Didn't Guénon say something like this with regards to Christianity?

The influence that operates through the medium of the Christian sacraments, having originally acted in the initiatic order, subsequently, in other circumstances and for reasons dependent upon these, lowered its action to the simply religious and exoteric domain; this occurred in such a way that its effects have ever since been limited to certain possibilities of an exclusively individual order, whose scope does not extend beyond salvation...

In other words, in agreement with your Orthodox friend, Christianity lacks a limited and initiatory core; once the sacraments became exoteric, they were no longer esoteric. I do not see

anything in Guénon's claim which is much more controversial than this. But this drove Schuon batty; he replies in *René Guénon: Some Observations* that *we see absolutely no reason for this 'lowering,' in a case like that of Christianity, because the Spirit can in any event proportion its activity according to the capacity of the human receptacle; is God so poor that he would need to ration his graces after having granted them? Why should not one and the same rite be able to confer individual help to one, and supra-individual help to another? For he who can do the greater can do the lesser.*

I am not clear whether Schuon understands the need for limited initiation and the concept of caste which is so key to both Guénon and Evola; some events in his later life reflect this. The more Schuon I read, the less I understand him.

Mihai on 2013-02-26 at 04:39 said:

A link to that specific topic would be useful.

I completely agree with his view regarding the esoteric-exoteric issue. I always say that, in Christianity, the degree of esoterism is directly proportional to the degree of inner understanding.

See Vladimir Lossky- The mystical theology of the Eastern Church (by the way, around here, the word "mystical" is used, rather than "esoteric". However, it is not the sentimental mysticism of the west, but it must be taken in the original meaning of the word, which is the same as "esoteric".)

Also, Cologero, I really identify with this line: "I really can't watch a movie anymore. "

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-26 at 12:04 said:

Mihai,

Since I seem to lack the capacity to create a link, you can google the "Theology of Professor James Cutsinger" at OrthodoxChristianity.net. There is also some very interesting discussion on this subject to be found at Gnosisandnoesis.net- search James Cutsinger and/or Seyyed Hossain Nasr.

Avery,

I think Schuon had said, basically, that Christianity was an esoterism that was "exteriorized" to save the decaying Greco-Roman world- an "eso-exorterism"?

I did see a movie recently that wasn't good, but it had something, I don't know... ..well, interesting? Valhalla Rising.

Saladin on 2013-02-26 at 19:49 said:

"I really can't watch a movie anymore." Wow! I am not the only one!

Logres on 2013-02-27 at 10:40 said:

I think for me that began with the Matrix, second part, when, after the orgy in Zion, I began to root for the Machines. Although Bergman's *The Magician* was interesting to see, lately.

Cassiodorus on 2013-02-27 at 16:12 said:

I streamed an old classic last night off netflix. Definitely worth a re-watch if you haven't seen it- "A Man For All Seasons". The last scene where Sir Thomas Moore is on trial is excellent!!!

4.15 March Madness

This is an announcement from Obama that you may hear before the year is out:

Obama: I have determined that all the problems in the world stem from certain events involving Adam and Eve in the Garden of Eden. Therefore, I am proposing legislation to ensure that something like that never happens again.

Reporter: Mr. President, what measures will you take to prevent a future Adam and Eve from eating the fruit from the Tree of Good and Evil?

Obama: Adam and Eve? Who said anything about them? No, my legislation will be directed against God to prevent him from imposing those unjust punishments on humanity. I would have done this by now, except the Republicans refuse to compromise.

Sweet Whispers in your Ear Presidents should be limited to a single term. After four years, the sound of his voice starts grating on your nerves, it no longer communicates, it becomes predictable, it begins to make commercial messages sound intelligent. Apart from the occasional Mussolini, few leaders are still able to inspire after a couple of years.

Sports Talk The National Football League had their combine this week, i.e., a camp for aspiring footballers who are rated on their skill, agility, speed, and strength. Several teams have been subtly inquiring

about the sexual orientation of the aspirants. The media are shocked at that and the NFL has since banned such questions with the threat of dismissal. Now there is no uniform law in the USA banning such discrimination, although everyone simply assumes it to be true. The Federal government has taken a rather broad interpretation of the ban on discrimination on the basis of sex to include sexual orientation; this has been done through executive orders and regulations rather than any actual law.

Apparently, team managements are concerned about gays in the locker room. That is why they are reassured when players are arrested for beating up on their girlfriends. It shows they care. Female athletes are following in their footsteps. Recently a woman basketball player was charged with attacking her girlfriend²¹. She fired a gunshot and missed. Perhaps that is why her career is over.

Much has been made about the success of Danica Patrick at the recent NASCAR race in Daytona, as though it broke some sort of natural barrier. All it proves is that NASCAR is not really a sport. Now NASCAR is now trying to appeal to women and blacks to grow their audience. Apparently they haven't given much thought about why they are appealing to their current audience.

News Commentary by the Numbers What chance does the historiography of the Right have to enter into the group mind?

Bill O'Reilly and Laura Ingraham on Fox News recently discussed the Catholic Church. They spoke about the "crisis" in the Church, as though it was caused by some natural event. They rightly pointed out that the secular news media takes glee in that crisis. However, the two pundits failed to mention what everyone else is able to see: the "crisis" arose allegedly because of the large number of homosexuals in the priest-

²¹<http://www.t TMZ.com/2012/11/15/wnba-chamique-holdsclaw-arrested-gunshot-gun-fight-girlfriend/>

hood. Had they done so, the media would have been entwined in Catch 22²². Even secularists grasp that²³. Miss Ingraham's "explanation" that we are all fallen, as though your average guy will solicit sexual activity from a young teenage boy because of something Adam did 6000 years ago. But she reaches millions of people per day, and Gornahoor reaches about 600.

Miss Ingraham then pointed out all the "good" that the church does in the world. That is to confuse the spiritual mission of the church with mere humanitarianism, which is the only modern touchstone of the good. Albert Schweitzer was a great humanitarian and his writings on his experiences in Africa are much more interesting than the typical slide show of a Catholic missionary delivered in the parish hall.

Where is Al Jazeera? I had heard that Al Jazeera English would start broadcasting in March, so I turned on Current TV last night, only to find out that nothing had changed. No sports event and no litigation is conceivable without there being a referee or judge to fairly arbitrate the proceeding. Unfortunately, that policy is not followed in political debates. One American news channel claims to be "fair and balanced" because it allows competing points of view to be expressed. But that is not sufficient; a referee will also call "foul", and even issue a yellow or red card. Hence a debate referee would, for example, stop the proceeding when he hears a logic flaw or error of fact. Since I have no interest in the content of these shows, I shall, as an experiment, appoint myself the referee of the programs I saw.

I caught the final segment of a show on Islamophobia in which the

²²<http://rorate-caeli.blogspot.com/2013/02/fr-dariusz-okos-major-article-with-pope.html>

²³<http://lionoftheblogosphere.wordpress.com/2013/02/27/catholic-church-not-cool/>

anti-Islamist Pam Geller²⁴ was interviewed. When confronted with the fact that most Muslims have no desire to do her harm, she pointed out that such an attitude brings no credit, since it should be the expected norm. Besides, she said, she is not against people but only against a certain ideology.

REFEREE CALL: When certain authors write against certain Jewish ideologies, they are accused of anti-Semitism, just as she is accused of Islamophobia. The game rules need clarification.

The narrator is unconvinced and points out how Islamophobia is another example of the American experience of racism and xenophobia.

REFEREE CALL: According to the sociobiologist, E O Wilson, all life is xenophobic, i.e., the fear and hatred of interlopers. So is this a uniquely “American” experience or a more universal experience? Do predominantly Muslim countries allow Europeans to immigrate and build churches? Does Israel allow Christians to proselytize? Is there Islamophobia in Nigeria? Why is there no Christophobia?

Finally, Miss Geller mentions that Muslims were responsible for the 9/11 attack on the World Trade Center. Curses, said the narrator, people like Geller always mention the worst of the Muslims to make their point.

REFEREE QUESTION: Is that why so many progressive liberals, including our erstwhile commentator Charlotte, prefer to believe that 9/11 was an inside job initiated by George Bush? I.e., so they avoid being secretly Islamophobes?

Apparently Current TV liked that line of attack, so they decided to choose the most obscure situation to make their point about American racism and xenophobia. The next show is about Harrison, Arkansas, a nearly all-white enclave in the Deep South. Because of a purge a couple of generations ago, the city became bereft of black residents and thus it attracted white nationalist groups including the Ku Klux Klan, a Neo-Nazi group, and Kingdom Identity Ministries, a Christian Identity Group.

²⁴<http://atlasshrugs2000.typepad.com/>

The Klan leader was the most cooperative since much of the air time was focused on him. He seemed more interested in selling his merchandise. The Nazi leader seems to advocate violence, so he could be considered dangerous. Little was said about the minister but they believe that Jews and the spawn of Satan and blacks have no souls.

REFEREE CALL: Jesus said that the devil is the father of the Jews and Orthodox Jews believe that non-Jews have no soul. This needs to be cleared up.

Needless to say, blacks do not feel welcome there. Of course, there is a counter current of opposition who want to bring diversity to the city.

REFEREE CALL: By “diversity”, they mean they want Harrison to look like all the nearby cities; that sounds like sameness.

The mayor, who is a carpetbagger from Chicago, leads that opposition.

REFEREE CALL: Then why did he move to Harrison? What qualities attracted him there?

The mayor says that businesses won’t locate there, although there is a large FEDEX plant there. He says the quality of life would be better.

REFEREE CALL: To make his case, they should have pointed out measurable quality of life factors. For example, what is the crime rate compared to nearby cities? What is the high school graduation rate, and so on. These would be interesting numbers ... or not.

The mayor went to a black college to deliver a speech; he brought along a busload of high school students for support. Good thing he did, since there were virtually no black students at the speech, but his white students gave him a standing ovation. He ended his speech by quoting yet again MLK’s dictum to judge people by the content of their character, not the color of their skin.

REFEREE CALL: Then why is the mayor inviting blacks specifically to move to his city and encouraging diversity? Shouldn’t he be inviting everyone of good character to his city regardless of their race? If

everyone in Harrison had the same good character, would it be more or less diverse?

Being a Better Blogger One of our contributors has accused me of actively discouraging readers from reading. It is not deliberate, but I can point out that views have dropped nearly 50% since my posts by Guido De Giorgio. Is it too morbid? Or too difficult? Or too irrelevant to people's lives? There is a blogger who got dozens of comments about Orange Juice. But I don't have that sort of charisma or reader loyalty.

But if there are twenty people who understand, and I believe there are, I will continue on. I think for a while I will just provide some translations and book reviews of some old, obscure, little read books. That is because I have the impression that people think I just make all this up. I promise to reveal everything on Post #1001.

Note to bloggers It is impolite and really lazy to copy a text just to increase traffic to your site, not to mention it would annoy me if you got more visitors than I do. The bloggers with better manners post an excerpt and then a link to the full text. Of course, the best course is to add value. For example, some of the posts are being translated into Polish or Turkish. An intelligent option is to add commentary and incorporate selected, fair use, quotes. Please let me know.

The most vulgar thing is to solicit tips for copying someone else. One such site recently changed its policy to allow tips to go to the translator as an option. That should be the default option, nay, it should be the only option. Not that I want your money, since I'll just spend it on cigars and alcohol, or 9 mm bullets, but I will gladly accept a Maserati Quattroporte.

Kick Starter Perhaps we need a traditional Theory of Everything. It would have to be scientifically plausible, historically accurate, and true to tradition. No, it couldn't just blame the jews, or liberals, or whatever.

There is a Kick Starter web site²⁵ to get funding. I just need a title idea, or, as they say, a “hook”. Please provide suggestions.

Posted on 2013-03-02 by Cologero

4.16 April Fools Talking Blues

The pope caused a commotion when he washed the feet of heathen women on Maundy Thursday. The Traditionalists were peeved that yet another tradition was transgressed. The liberals, on the other hand, were thrilled. Not because they approved the significance of it all, but rather because they took *schadenfreude* in the overturning of the established order of things.



Am I the only one who found it kinky?

To all those who pride themselves on following the crowd into some promised Edenic future of perfect justice, peace, and equality:

It is proof of a base and low mind for one to wish to think with the masses or majority, merely because the majority is the majority. Truth does not change because it is, or is not, believed by a majority of the people.

GIORDANO BRUNO

However, after they win the cause of equality, another cause will need to arise, since they are unable to feel good about themselves without such a cause. They will be glued to their television sets to learn the next thing that progressives need to accept. As the masters of discourse tell them:

²⁵<http://www.kickstarter.com/projects/1870526265/the-god-problem-how-a-godless-cosmos-creates-book>

When we want your opinion, we will tell it to you!

They are an interesting type to observe. Like a horde of locusts that immediately change direction to cause their devastation as though with a single mind. Thus we change from “global warming” to “climate change” or from “gay marriage” to “marriage equality” in a moment. The Proverb says:

Although they have no king, the locusts fly in unison.

They may have no king, but we know who they serve. Fr. Seraphim Rose claims that the air is replete with demons. They have long experience with humans and can easily convince them to feel good while doing bad. It is really a simple choice. Either those in the past had it right, handed down their inheritance to us, which we then squandered on the next big thing. That is the esoteric meaning of “honor the father and thy mother.” Or else they had it all wrong, and only people in the present can see things truly. But then won’t people 100 years from now mock us for being so benighted?

I heard a professor on the Internet talking about an amazing Jewish gene that scientists have traced back to Abraham. I wonder if those Ethiopian Jews own all the banks, newspapers, and TV stations in Ethiopia?

Death is inevitable, the time of death is uncertain, every moment counts.

That is the lesson from the Tibetan Book of the Dead. Atisha taught his students:

For a person who is unaware of death, meditation has little power,
but a person who is mindful of death and impermanence pro-
gresses steadily and makes the most of every precious moment.

The Kadampa school teaches:

If one does not meditate on death in the morning, the whole morning is wasted, if one does not meditate on death at noon, the afternoon is wasted, and if one does not meditate on death at night, the evening is wasted.

On the other hand, American Buddhists meditate because it lowers blood pressure, calms the mind, makes them support progressive causes, and basically makes life better. Men often get restless meditating since it is difficult to focus on one thing as random thoughts intrude. Women seem to have less trouble since they don't fight random thoughts, which seem quite natural to them.

Of course, there is the sex appeal of women meditating in their yoga pants²⁶. How many seem to be meditating on sickness, old age, and death?

Would anyone like a sponge and a bucket of water?

My younger son follows the Lenten fast, maintains his traditional views, and claims to have faith, but he told me he doesn't like to go to mass. He told me about a friend, a young woman, who went to confession and the priest took a phone call in the middle of it. She won't go to confession anymore; I think she perhaps ought to have better sins in order to hold the priest's interest.

My son said his parish church got too slick with a rock band, TV monitors, and priests with great haircuts. It has a big stage with a lot of activity. A bunch of altar girls in white robes are wandering around; it looks like a Druid ceremony from a Hollywood B movie.

It seems "gay" to him. I told him there are probably a lot of gay priests these days. He has an interesting theory that I am not sure I refuted. He told me a priest can't be gay. I responded, that he shouldn't be gay, at least that is the official policy. He insisted it is not a question of "should" but

²⁶https://www.google.com/search?hl=en&site=imghp&tbm=isch&source=hp&biw=801&bih=573&q=woman+meditating&oq=woman+meditation&gs_l=img.1.0.0i10l5j0i5i10l5.2651.4901.0.7155.16.15.0.0.0.93.970.15.15.0...0.0...1ac.1.7.img.001aLHDYiss

of necessity. Go on, I said. A priest is celibate, so he is beyond straight or gay; it is irrelevant. Hmm, but they can have fantasies, I pointed out. But that would be lust in the heart and a mortal sin, he argued. I had no good answer.

My books by the Ur/Krur groups arrived today. If I post some translations, will someone volunteer to try the exercises for a week and report back? Most likely essays: “The esoteric doctrine of secret centers of the body in a Christian mystic” by **Julius Evola** and “Tradition and Realization” by **Guido De Giorgio**.

I will try to find some interesting passages from *The Magic World of the Heroes*, and also review **Fr. Seraphim Rose**’s book on the post-mortem states.

Imagine if the Pope, or your parish priest, would give sermons on the interior parts of the soul, the soul after death, angels, and demons, instead of all the talk about the “poor” and other Marxist baubles. That is not such a crazy idea, because all the old books were concerned about such topics.

You do understand this is satire, right?

Posted on 2013-04-01 by Cologero

* * *

Avery Morrow on 2013-04-02 at 00:34 said:

This pope learned from the last one. For the last few years we all saw what it was like to have a Pope speaking out against modernity. He made a perfect villain for moderns and Europeans especially, a bogeyman for atheists to scare their children (if any) with at bedtime. So, out with the old, in with the new. The old Catholics are the children of Vatican II; they should love this Pope. This is far from Petrus Romanus of the prophecy, though. Future Popes are already on the way, raised on a healthy diet of Fr. Z.

Now, a mystical Pope would sure be a sight to see.

Senkosmos on 2013-04-02 at 01:57 said:

Probably the best post I've read in Gornahoor in the last week, and all of them are fantastic, mind you. Cologero, your ideas on meditation are excellent, I've wondered about those things myself because here in Buenos Aires, Yoga and Meditation are "fashionable" and an "excellent form of exercise", which I can only see as counterinitiatatic at best.

I've been skimming through the Ur group writings so I'd love to see your translations and comments.

Oh! a friend of mine had a similar conversation with a priest from our parish a few years ago, and the priest had very similar views to your son. Maybe that's also a good point to meditate about.

Blessings in Christ

Mihai on 2013-04-02 at 03:47 said:

My parish priest, just this Sunday, gave a sermon concerning prayer and the Orthodox doctrine of the Uncreated Energies, since in the Orthodox Church, the second Sunday of the Lenten fast is dedicated to St Gregory Palama. Of course, he talked in such a way as to be intelligible to everybody, but that is the whole point of a sermon, and I appreciated it.

Taking a phone call during confession does seem incredible, but it is still nothing compared to a priest from my country, who made it on television after he took a phone call while he was chanting during a Baptism service, and he interrupted his chanting to say to the caller "call me in two hours, I'm performing a Baptism".

Fr Rose's book you speak of, is it "The soul after death"? There are a few things to say regarding the traditional Christian doctrine regarding the demonic "checkpoints" of the air, which can also be considered from the point of view of the spiritual journey during life, not only of post-mortem states. There are clear echoes of it in the Egyptian Book of the Dead, where the soul must face and get passed Seth's demons and escape from Amenti- Hell- in order to avoid the second death.

jalexandermaximilian on 2013-04-02 at 11:46 said:

Funny you mention American Buddhists. I know a few, and always have to correct their understanding of what they think it is. "It's not a religion" they say. "Buddha, Dharma, SANGHA" I reply.

This whole thing is becoming quite odd, I'm still not sure what to make of this whole Pope Francis.

4.17 April Showers 2013

April showers have chased me indoors. Last night I made enough money playing **Texas Hold'em** to cover the purchase of the UR/KRUR books and Della Riveria's *Magic World of the Heros*, so you guys are off the hook. But thanks for the offers. Don't knock playing cards which are clearly of Hermetic origin, when you consider how perfectly organized they are. Look at how many various games can be derived from them. Video games, on the other hand, fall into just a few types: shooters, role playing, and maybe another I can't think of. They are made to create fast-reacting zombies. With poker you learn to accept the delicate balance between skill and luck, while learning to discern men's wills. Plus skill at cards and similar amusements will prepare you for success at courtly life.

I have been planning another post on Darwinism, but I just found one by **Julius Evola** in the *Introduction to Magic*. So, I'll start with that and perhaps add some comments. Unlike more recent attempts to challenge Darwinism on its own terms, such as Creation Science or Intelligent Design, Evola attacks it from a metaphysical viewpoint. If a biologist simply assumes only material processes are in play, then Darwinian evolution seems to account for the appearances. Evola does not dispute any biological facts; instead, he proposes that the idea of an involution also accounts for the same facts. I'll let the essay speak for itself for now. But to be prepared, read up on Aristotle and Aquinas, since Evola says they best express his views. Specifically, look up on Gornahoor about matter and form.

There are, of course, many other essays of interest, out of about 80 or so. Perhaps I'll take the time to create a table of contents and create a poll. Of course, someone else may decide to make that table of contents; they can be found on google books. I am also considering making further translations available only in pdf format; I am willing to consider any feedback on this.

I haven't forgotten Guido De Giorgio's section on the caste of workers. This group is given short shrift in writings on tradition, which are too often focused on spiritual and political issues. Arts, crafts, farming, and other commercial activities are crucial to any society.

I will also be providing some insights into the logic of human societies with historical examples. It should be interesting to see how we got to here from there.

I have some letters from the young Julius Evola to the great Italian philosopher **Giovanni Gentile** that I will make available. These will show the basis for Evola's own philosophy of magical idealism. I know later on Evola criticized Gentile, but a family dispute something different from a war against an enemy. That will be a prelude to a fuller exploration of Gentile's system of **Actualism**. Of course, Evola's own system of Magical Idealism is interesting in its own right, not least of all because he combines philosophical reasoning with traditional teachings. I'm afraid, however, that there are only 7 people who would be interested in it, and I can't be sure I am reaching all of them.

There is just one more chapter in part 3 of Sintesi that will be sent out to the mailing list of the Society of Independents **SI**. After that, I will upgrade the software to be a two-way discussion. There are many interesting subscribers of varied backgrounds who have developed skills in certain areas. I hope, initially, to model it on the **Gruppo di UR**. Participants can provide an essay on a topic of interest to them; think about what you may want to contribute. Of course, there is the matter of the Sintesi. Evola really skates over the various spiritual types without much detail. Perhaps some of these chapters can be filled out with more detail and examples. I would hope several readers are interested in that project. If that works out, I will make more sections available.

Posted on 2013-04-13 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-15 at 11:48 said:

Is there a connection between being an aristocrat and being a gambler ? I too am a Texas Holdem player... ..

Are any of Gentile's books in English ? I've never read anything by him but a lot about him and want to start.

Cologero on 2013-04-15 at 13:04 said:

Amazon is giving away for free the kindle edition of Gentile's *The Reform of Education*. It was intended for elementary school teachers, although I doubt that many teachers could even comprehend it today.

Mercurius on 2013-04-15 at 18:10 said:

I've uploaded "Theory of Mind as Pure Act" to Scribd:

<http://www.scribd.com/doc/136095606/Gentile-Theory-of-Mind-as-Pure-Act>

graham on 2013-04-16 at 22:44 said:

I look forward to the chapter on workers. What proportion of those drawn to tradition today do you suppose are by nature workers? What does it mean if a worker is drawn to esoterism? What should be the worker's response to the mechanization of the crafts? What is his mode of realization? I hope he can shed some light on these and other questions.

Balder on 2022-04-13 at 09:13 said:

Gambling is a form of astral intoxication and world glamour and can easily turn into a serious vice. The worst dregs in rehabilitation centres are gaming addicts. Card games in themselves are a good way to enjoy pasttime with friends, although I prefer chess.

I found Evola's *Magical Idealism* far too "technical" (for lack of a better word) to arouse my serious interests.

4.18 Benevolent Centralized Power

These are three things which are rare indeed and are due to the grace of God – namely, a human birth, the longing for Liberation, and the protecting care of a perfected sage.

SHANKARA

I used to like to scan through the cable morning news shows now and then, not for the news, but to get the pulse of what we are supposed to be thinking. The shows are allegedly about the issues, but as we now know, it is never the issues, but rather affinity: whom we feel comfortable with. Fox and Friends is the more “conservative” of the shows. It is light and folksy. I do prefer it for the news because its only virtue is that it does demonstrate some *token* opposition to the established powers. Nevertheless, it is not with them that I feel any affinity.²⁷ The most liberal show is Morning Joe on MSNBC, so it is more interesting because the future can be found there.²⁸ As the progressives think, and this show is the preparation for it, so goes the nation. Ironically, these are the people I would feel most comfortable with, if not for my self-imposed isolation. Having graduated from an elite New England university, I am quite familiar with that “type”. They were the ones who dropped out the Logic class in the philosophy department, had trouble getting through Economics 101, and never even bothered with Science. Yet, as adults, they deem themselves competent to speak authoritatively on all those topics.

Jacques Ellul claimed that the purpose of education is to make it easier to indoctrinate people, so the highly educated are often the most malleable, or at least, they must be moulded first. So once the educated elite adopt a form of thought, the next layer below them follows suit and then on and on. The next great idea shows up on TV, movies, magazines, pop songs, and so on, until no one can remember any earlier time when the now accepted consensus opinion used to be taboo.

Needless to say, the cast members on Morning Joe are totally into control. They want to limit your choice of weapons, curtail your energy use, restrict what and how much you can eat, smoke, and so on, even how you think. I have felt, when listening to Mika, that they would like to treat the citizens the way Tyson raises chickens. That is, keep them

²⁷NOTE 2019: I no longer watch much of the network news.

²⁸NOTE 2021: It became unwatchable several years ago.

in a cage to limit their motion, feed them a scientific diet, ignore their opinions and desires, and exterminate them when their useful lifetime has expired.

This week that suspicion was confirmed! When discussing the possibility of new sources of cheap energy for the masses, the multi-millionaire Donny Deutsch²⁹ claimed that we need “*benevolent centralized power*” because anarchy will result from persons making their own decisions. Thus, this power can control our guns, what we eat and drink, our health care; they can tell us what to think and overturn what we previously had held to be dear. It is clear they have the power, and it is becoming more and more centralized. Benevolent, it is not.

The Element of Trust As we have already pointed out³⁰, an socio-political system can be based on social relationships, liberal institutions, or on man himself. Consider this from **Valentin Tomberg’s** doctoral dissertation.

A system, an order may be as useful and good as can be — ultimately it depends on **people**, who abandon, relinquish, reinterpret, falsify, or simply betray it. And the number of a system’s (loyal or disloyal) “guardians” need not be large. Often it takes only a few dozen people to destroy a generally recognized order. The big problem does not consist so much of which system to choose and how to organize the world, but of how and where to find **people**, who are truly of good will and who can be **trusted**. For ultimately, we are dealing with the element of trust. There is no system — neither domestic nor international — that can exist without trust as its final, practical, basic substance. For even with ten levels of control, there still must be — as the **eleventh** level — a **final** instance of control which can be trusted.

²⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Donny_Deutsch

³⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=295>

Uploading your soul There was some bad news³¹ for those who are planning to upload a virtual copy of their brain into a computer where they can achieve some sort of immortality. I was a bit surprised to learn that the idea of a soul or spirit independent of matter is “controversial”, but I don’t travel in the smart circles. Nevertheless, most of those offering comments were not dissuaded. They are certain that their entire lives are actually computable processes and that whatever remains of subjective experience within them will be shown to be illusory. It is an intriguing prospect, since the quality of immortality will be independent of any moral consideration.

Yet I doubt their lives have gone as perfectly as they assume, but it may be easier to fix a “bug” in computer software than to actually change their own lives. But that is the problem. Whereas they seemed to have arisen spontaneously into existence, their virtual copy will require a programmer. We hope he turns out to be benevolent, or at least competent. I wonder if you will be able to choose your own virtual landscape when you are uploaded. **Dante** says it is we ourselves who choose our destiny, heaven or hell. I imagine the same notion will apply.

French Comments A couple of weeks ago, I got a long two thousand word comment on the Tarot Meditations blog³², all in French, from a woman offering psychic readings. She was effusive in her praise, and asked questions about both metaphysics and blog software. Then she mentioned she hadn’t bathed in three days. Apparently that must be an aphrodisiac to Frenchmen, but she neglected to take cultural diversity into account. So I rejected the comment. Some things perfume can’t hide. So take it as a metaphor. Evil and perversity surround themselves with a sweet smell.

³¹<http://io9.com/you-ll-probably-never-upload-your-mind-into-a-computer-474941498>

³²<https://www.meditationsonthetarot.com>

Shia and Iran The April 2013 issue of *Culture Wars* has a long essay on E. Michael Jones' trip through Iran. He became a real Iranophile and noted something I myself mentioned here. He sees a certain affinity between Shia Islam and his own faith and brings up some useful points of similarity. The problem with Iran, he says, is the contraceptive mentality which had reduced the birthrate below replacement level and will open the door to feminism.

Library of Alexandria The saying goes that "either what is in the library of Alexandria contradicts the Koran, in which case it is heretical and should be burnt, or it repeats what is in the Koran, in which case it is superfluous and should be burnt as well." That is sometimes the feeling I get from reading **Rene Guenon**. He is so focused on the ultimate liberation, that he seldom engages with more profane ideas (except negatively, as in his early books on Theosophy and Spiritism).

Julius Evola, on the other hand, engages the world ("the way of action"), incorporating the ideas of diverse figures, which need not be named here. That is why he appeals to more men today, or perhaps a different sort of man.

Coincidentally, I was reading about **Mouni Sadhu's** experiences in the Indian ashram of **Sri Aurobindo**. He stumbled into the library and noticed all the books of Indian and European writers, most of which he was familiar with. He wrote:

But now all these fascinating things had lost their charm for me. I realized that I was no longer interested in anything unconnected with my Path. It seemed as if knowledge of the Direct Path as shown by my Master subconsciously excluded all else. It meant that the desires of the mind, which is always eager to investigate everything, had begun to disappear.

At that point in his life, he realized he was no longer interested in them, as he was more focused on his own spiritual realization. I suppose

there is a certain intellectual gluttony that desires to take in idea after idea. No doubt, for a certain type of man, there can be quite an intense ecstatic feeling from grasping some newly discovered thought. On the other hand, the man who had never had any such interest in learning previously in his life, is hardly on the same level.

Bhagavan Das Tomorrow I will be posting Evola's book review on the works of **Bhagavan Das**; to avoid clutter, I will put the introduction here. BD was an Indian Theosophist writing in the first half of the twentieth century. In true theosophical fashion, he claimed to have uncovered the Pranava Vada by Gargayana, which was dictated to him by a blind man who had memorized the million lines. Nevertheless, Evola has extraordinary high praise for the man and his works, claiming it was written for the Western mind. That is no doubt a side effect of his theosophical training, but he also relates Vedic ideas to Western thought, especially the German idealists.

This brings up a question, then. If the German idealists, who are actually the heirs of the Western tradition, knew so much or were so close to the same understanding, then why do we still bother to look to the East for enlightenment? Why didn't Evola himself promote his own works on Idealism as a spiritual path? Maybe Mouni Sadhu is correct, enough is enough. Or else, do you really need to hear the same thing over and over again?

Posted on 2013-04-27 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2013-04-27 at 11:06 said:

Iran is not the only Islamic country with a birthrate that is well below the replacement level. Turkey is facing this issue as well, as are other countries in that region (it will have an even greater impact on these societies than European countries as at least European ones have the social structures to soften the impact of an aging population). Bernard Goldberg had a rather

interesting take on this and what its effects are for relations between the modern west and the Islamic world.

And yes, a strong case can be made for the affinity between Shia Islam and Catholic/Orthodox Christianity. Makes one wonder if there would be less social tension in Europe if most muslim immigrants (specifically the young ones) were Shia instead of Sunni.

Avery Morrow on 2013-04-27 at 11:28 said:

David P. Goldman has also written about this demographic issue at fascinating length. He said that in 300 years, Sub-Saharan Africans will be colonizing the dying embers of Europe in the name of equality and anti-racism, riding on rafts made from empty soda pop bottles, and all our metaphysical concerns are just determining the size and plot of our final descendants' graves.

Just kidding. He said that America will continue its healthy population growth indefinitely due to its God-granted mission.

Matt on 2013-04-27 at 12:17 said:

Ah yes, it was Goldman (got him confused with Goldberg, as they both follow the classical liberal viewpoint).

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-27 at 16:13 said:

As I see it, German Idealism is passive understanding at best, and does not offer a pathway to "know" the Ideas truly.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-27 at 16:14 said:

David Goldman is an ex-Larouchite

John on 2013-04-28 at 00:47 said:

There's a sizable amount of so called trans-humanists with reactionary and counter-revolutionary political leanings on Twitter.

Such reasoning seems to me to be contradictory and absurd since they do not acknowledge a higher reality why bother with counter-revolution?

Trans-humanists are nothing more than what those who wrote the Vedas called "demons who roam samsara denying the immortality of the soul" since they seek to live forever in this unreal, reality.

Avery Morrow on 2013-04-28 at 11:52 said:

One of Augustine's greatest works is a long list of mistakes he made in life.

4.19 The Opposite of a Misconception

Destroy a man's illusions and you destroy his happiness

HUBERT VAN ZELLER

Metaphysical Errors I recently stumbled upon an article on an obscure blog titled "Common Metaphysical Errors", by a writer apparently unaware of the oxymoron involved with that expression. Rather, it is a collection of carefully selected opinions gleaned from unrevealed sources followed with a pithy counterpoint.

Of course, there can be no metaphysical errors. Metaphysics is not a collection of beliefs or opinions, but rather it derives from exacting and precise intellectual intuitions. False beliefs and opinions will prevent use from understanding metaphysical truths, but the error itself is not a "metaphysical error" as it is on a totally different, and lower, plane.

The proper term, then, would be "misconception", not "error". However, at this time, we will leave unexplored the wisdom of counteracting one misconception with another.

The Swallows at Capistrano The swallows always seem to find their way back to Capistrano every year on March 19th. That is because they are in possession of three things: a destination, a tradition, and an initiation. They know the truth, for them, is in Capistrano. There is a tradition that reliably leads them there. And the young swallows are initiated into the intricacies of that navigation by their elders.

What He Said In his critique of Christianity as a still valid tradition³³, Julius Evola brought up many good points. Just to highlight some, there is the question of a valid and continuous succession, whether there is

³³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6438>

still knowledge of the mysteries, the role of external influences on the tradition. I propose that the same standard be applied to all claimants to be the valid Tradition in the west.

We can start with the neo-pagans, the Druids, the Nietzscheans. Is there a continuous connection that goes back to an originary supernatural revelation? Do they lead a man to salvation or deliverance? Or are they a figment of someone's imagination?

Moving on, we can then ask if Evola's Buddhism meets that standard. Does it actually exist anywhere or is it one of Evola's brilliant literary creations?

Another point is the alleged egalitarianism of Christianity. Compared to what? Tantric sects are open to all, irrespective of caste or sex or nationality. But, as Emerson says, foolish consistency is the hobgoblin of little minds. Can there be a wise consistency?

Necker Cube Everyone, presumably, has seen the Necker Cube³⁴, whose ambiguity fools the mind into projecting the cube into either the left or the right direction. Some will debate the issue; others will have a conversion experience from one viewpoint to the other. Yet others will be more conciliatory and try to see "both sides of the issue". The scientist will describe the diagram by enumerating the line segments along with their lengths, origins, and slopes. It will be precise, but the feeling won't leave that they left something out.

So by Buddhist logic, the cube points left, it points right, it points both left and right, and it points in no direction. All points of view are relative. To transcend them is to see it *sub specie aeternitatis*. Either that is possible or no search for truth is possible.

The Search for Truth There can be no search for "truth". Someone once said that America needs a good five cent cigar. Now I can embark

³⁴http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Necker_Cube

on that search because I know what a cigar is and I know what a nickel is; I even know what a good cigar is. But how can a man seek the truth unless he knows the truth first? And if so, why would he bother to seek it?

Having a bad start, or not knowing the right direction, will likely not lead anywhere. Anyone who has ever been lost in the woods knows that a random walk bring him back to near the same spot. That is a mathematical truth. But we all know that guys hate to ask for directions.

False Beginnings In a recent interview³⁵, the Traditional writer **Seyyed Hossein Nasr** said that you cannot come to Tradition by starting with **Martin Heidegger**. Yet some readers were disappointed when Gornahoor pointed that out a few weeks ago. They said we do not understand Heidegger. Our retort is that they do not understand Tradition. Or else both are true and neither is true.

The Method of Depth Those men whose primary focus is the spiritual life have more in common with each other both across nationalities and even across different traditions. Valentin Tomberg called such men Hermetists, although they may not be so explicitly or formally. That is because they are not united by their knowledge of external things, but rather by their common spiritual exercises and experiences. That is the method of depth.

The Case of Thomas Merton An example of this depth that we can point to is Thomas Merton, the American Trappist monk, who famously said he had more in common with a Zen monk than an ordinary worshiper in a pew. I haven't mentioned him much, probably because I gave away my library of Merton books to a priest over a decade ago. Merton

³⁵<http://sophiaperennis.org/content/response-questions-posed-n-s-peranskaya-journal-tradition-seyyed-hossein-nasr>

was quite familiar with the perennial philosophy and either knew or corresponded with the second generation of Traditional writers who followed Rene Guenon and Frithjof Schuon. (I don't recall him ever mentioning Julius Evola.) The Sufi Seyyed Hossein Nasr respected Merton and mentioned him several times.

Toward the end of his life, Merton developed an interest in and appreciation for Sufism. Through his own contemplative practice and his study of Asian religions, Merton came to realize that the spiritual techniques still alive in Zen and Sufism had however been lost to Christian mysticism. Nasr describes Merton's insights:

Since the Renaissance, much of what survived of Christian mysticism became in fact mostly individualistic, sentimental, and passive. While Merton understood the value of this type of mysticism on its own level, his gaze was set upon the great medieval Christian contemplatives whose vision was not limited in any way by the individualism that was one of the characteristics of the Renaissance. The Sufi path, in which the adept plays the active role as wayfarer upon the way that finally leads to the Beloved, like the hero in quest of the Holy Grail, while remaining passive before the grace of Heaven, was certainly attractive to Merton who was himself moving in this direction. He also thirsted for the kind of structure mystical life which the Sufi path offered in which the active and passive modes of the mystical life could be balanced on the basis of a reality that transcended the accidentality of individual existence.

Merton's understanding of the degradation of Christian mysticism is not unlike that of Guenon or Evola. However, he did not accept that as a limitation and a reason for abandonment, as did those latter two thinkers, but rather as a motivation to learn from other traditions and incorporate what he could into his own spiritual practice. Unfortunately, Merton

died before he could meet and study with Nasr personally. The task he started is languishing.

I suggest that Guenon's thinking was guided more by Sufism than by the Vedanta, if for no other reason that he understood Arabic, not Sanskrit, and actively pursued the Sufi path. His knowledge of the Vedanta was indirect and was used more for its linguistic precision. That may throw some light on the recent discussions regarding salvation and deliverance.

Posted on 2013-06-09 by Cologero

* * *

Avery Morrow on 2013-06-09 at 23:31 said:

A master (let's call him G*rd****f) sat in the forest with three students. He took out a stick and placed it in front of him, saying, "Without calling it a stick, tell me what this is."

The first pupil said, "You couldn't call it a slop-bucket." The master hit the student with the stick and ran away.

The second and third students were actually rocks that the pupil had mistaken for students, because it was getting very dark. Suddenly, the pupil felt alone and afraid.

In the distance, a wolf howled.

August on 2013-06-10 at 05:31 said:

The wolf can smell those who make the error of imagining metaphysical errors!

Mihai on 2013-06-10 at 08:43 said:

I said that in the Introduction.... he has made some unacceptable over-simplifications and generalizations regarding the West, in which he goes so far as to deny that there was any "true intellectuality" here, minimizing the role of everything, from Christianity to Platonism.

Also, if you are referring to the predictions at the end of the book, then they have utterly failed. He explicitly said there that it is absurd to think that Easterners will succumb to the same mentality as the West. Obviously, the whole world is one big West today, and, like Saladin already told you, Guenon's view of the East had more to do with his romantic vision of it and less with the actual reality of what's been going on there.

Like I said on the forum, "true spirituality" is not reducible to non-dualism, nor is it a private monopoly of the orientals.

Jason-Adam on 2013-06-10 at 13:17 said:

A brilliant post. Indeed, we can criticise Christianity all we want but what can we replace it with ? There is no pagan today who can show that he can trace his succession back to Antiquity which is why Evola did not practice paganism nor recommend reviving it – you simply cant revive a dead religious form, man does not make forms, God reveals them.

I would like to learn more about Evola's personal practices, did he have a regular system of disciplines he performed every day ? I would say his Buddhism is valid, and existed or at least existed in the recent past, in Japan. While a western man can learn much from the Buddha, for myself the form is still too distant from my heritage.

Merton interests me because in taking the best from Zen and using it to inform Catholicism, it may be the key to restoring ourselves.

Evola destroyed Heideggerian thinking in *Ride the Tiger* – it boggles me how the minds of some crazed Russians and some deranged Germanophilic Frenchmen can imagine a synthesis of Heidegger with Evola. Whatever his errors, Evola is still so great a mind that it defames him in my view to compare him with materialistic minds like the existentialists.

While Sufism has many profound insights, I think in the exterior world it is dangerous to endorse Islamic forms because it threatens to destroy what's left of our identity as Europeans. At least because Chinese and Japanese culture is so distant from ours, there is no risk of our becoming Japanese by adopting Zen, but Islam is very close to European tradition and thus a greater danger. Remember even Evola did say that for the exterior man, Henri Massis claim of defending the West from oriental thinking was correct.

Constantine Aetos on 2013-06-10 at 21:44 said:

"At least because Chinese and Japanese culture is so distant from ours, there is no risk of our becoming Japanese by adopting Zen, "

David Carrdine did such a good job at synthesizing the European race with Asian culture. In 10 years from now, there will be more whites than Asians in Chinatown.

Jason-Adam on 2013-06-19 at 12:35 said:

The problem with Christianity, by which I mean modern day practice, not the doctrine, is that there is no warrior form of the religion. In the past there was, as the writings of St Bernard clearly show – but who today in the Church defends the crusades and advocates for establishing new chivalric orders ? Because of this many warrior minds today have abandoned the Church for neopagan dead ends.....

4.20 Talking Father's Day Blues

I had time this morning to watch some news shows. The same topics come up day after day, at least until they fade from memory. For example, does anyone even care about North Korea any more? With three cable channels broadcasting news 24×7 , you would think there would be some deep understanding of the issues. Nevertheless, I gained no such understanding today. It's not that the newsmen fail to ask the politicians the hard questions; they don't even ask them the obvious questions.

Syria Today, Syria was the hot topic since the USA has committed to arm and support the "rebels". We hear that 90,000 Syrians have been killed, but surely Assad and his men are not responsible for all of them. It seems to me that if the rebels were prevented from acquiring weapons, the rebellion would simply peter out. In the meantime, the USA is supporting a UN treaty that would disarm the American population. Why not apply it to the Syrians?

It was never made clear why Assad must go. The Christian bishops have been supporting Assad and the rebels have connections to Al Qaeda, the avowed enemy of the USA. That should count for something. The rebellion has become an international proxy war, much like the Spanish Civil War of the 1930s.

Soon after Obama's famous "Red Line", it has been proved that Syria is using chemical weapons. Very convenient, just as Iraq has weapons of mass destruction. Strangely enough, while it is against international law to use poison gas in a war, it is not so when used against a nation's own population. So nobody is criticizing Turkey for using tear gas. Is the war in Syria subject to international law or is it a civil disturbance as in Turkey or even in France last month? I am not an expert in law, but the question should have been asked.

The accusation is often made that Assad is killing his own people.

Every government will use force to maintain power and control. But that standard, how many of “his own people” did Abraham Lincoln kill? Look it up ... he is considered America’s greatest president. More recently, how many of “his own people” did Bill Clinton kill in Waco Texas?

The New Canal China wants to build a canal through Nicaragua to handle the new generation of super large tankers that cannot pass through Panama. When completed, they will be able to ship their junk to Walmart more efficiently.

The NSA The massive surveillance on American citizens by the National Security Administration was another topic, actually quite divisive. Americans always made fun of the “secret police” among the Nazis or in the Soviet Union. However, there is insufficient detachment to notice the parallels.

A defender of the practice pointed out that the phone company keeps the same metadata records. But they keep them for a limited time for billing purposes and the convenience of the customers. More importantly, they don’t mine the data to discover who is contacting prostitutes, having an affair, and so on.

Population Movement Population movement has been going on since the beginning of time. The Romans were replaced by Germanic tribes. More recently, this has occurred in the Middle East. Besides the obvious example, in the 1960s Britain deliberately changed the demographics of Bahrain in order to dilute the Iranian population. What goes around, comes around.

The immigration bill in the USA is a similar example of deliberate demographic change. A Republican senator claimed the bill had to be passed or else they would never again win a national election. He offered

no proof or explanation. The hair of the dog³⁶ is not always an effective cure.

I think Europeans are simply bored as they have perhaps actualized all their possibilities. There has been no great saint in centuries. Art, poetry, etc. have likewise reached a dead end. The best among us have become nihilists with nothing to offer except suicide or “riding the tiger”. A Dutch woman³⁷ has to pretend to be Hispanic.

Creating an Order Someone mentioned a Vedantic order that will accept “anyone”. It can’t be much of an order. The problem is not the lack of men capable of leading an order, but rather the shortage of men to enter it. Men are too presumptuous today.

Freedom and the Spiritual Vitality of Man

All of man’s freedoms serve to make the material and spiritual life worthy of his station accessible to him. It is for this reason that he is in need of freedom, and must free himself from the bonds of his lower emotions and concupiscence in order to obtain this freedom. Everyone is susceptible to and a captive of acting on their lower urges and desires, the only exceptions being those in the ranks of the righteous.

Your souls are in bondage to your deeds; so free your souls by repenting of your sins and asking forgiveness of God. Thus man’s real freedom is achieved by releasing himself from the bonds of past sins through repentance and forgiveness. It is only this spiritual law and emotional freedom that can lay the requisite groundwork for authentic and free human existence and which is the freeing of one’s neck from the burden of sin, which results in the true experience of freedom.

³⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hair_of_the_dog

³⁷<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wjk0aWTe0h4>

The life of the spirit is more important than that of the body, and inner spiritual freedom is more important than outer social freedom and is in fact its cause and origin. The soul is only truly alive when it has freed itself from bondage to its lust and anger.

Are you thinking I have quoted some Catholic saint or Doctor of the Church? No, the author is **Abdollah Javadi-e Amoli**, a Shi'a theologian. It's odd that an external enemy can be a spiritual friend, while some who claim to be close to us are in fact spiritual enemies. The latter are the worst kinds of enemy.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wjk0aWTe0h4>

Posted on 2013-06-16 by Cologero

* * *

August on 2013-06-17 at 09:32 said:

I thought as much about this Vedantic order. Here are a few interesting anecdotes about it.

I once encountered a white adherent of this "order" in Australia, in orange robes and tonsured. He approached us, seeking change, in a pub. At the time I was a somewhat ignorant but thoroughly inquisitive and skeptical youth, and I asked him what his people do with the money, without handing over a coin. He seemed to summon and concentrate what I felt to be a malefic charge in his eyes, glaring at me with no response. After a few seconds my companion, a rather ordinary soul, placed some coins in his pan and he went away.

Some time later, I was a slightly older but still skeptical and obstinate youth, when a similar projection was directed at me by another white fellow, this time conventionally clothed. He invited me to purchase a sticker with some kind of smiling sun design on it (bayimg.com/KaNMCaaEE). I declined the offer, when he became annoyed, and challenged me, sloppily but aggressively suggesting that I was very lucky and should share my happiness, or some such insight, though never telling me anything about his efforts. Later I found out that these stickers are apparently connected to the same "order", and depict the Lord Krishna, of whom this man perhaps fancied himself a representative. I am glad that he did not decide to emulate Arjuna.

Perhaps both of these chaps were ultimately vexed by the reminder that they could not effect a rudimentary psychic takeover of every Westerner they engaged, let alone a Hinduesque spiritual renaissance.

Jason-Adam on 2013-06-17 at 13:09 said:

Is the order you are discussing ISKCON ?

I am one of those tiger riders, but not by choice. To simply put it, being a traditionalist Catholic man in Gay York, what else can I do ?

Reading this post reminds me of Spengler's winter of the west. As a western man it saddens me and I wonder why I chose to be born in this time. I have hope though for the future of the West because precisely I as a strong Western man would not have chosen to be born in a time where I could be of no use to anyone, there will come a new era in my lifetime I am sure where I and others like ourselves will be needed and able to act. In the meantime Cologero is doing the world a service by being a voice of truth against the modernists, counterinitiates, and demons.

Constantine Aetos on 2013-06-18 at 00:27 said:

Two short responses: 1) since when the Dutch were ever a nation 2) it's not that men are presumptuous, they've become to feminized for God.

John Morgan on 2013-06-19 at 07:06 said:

The original reference that was made in a prior comment thread to an article about a Western Vedantic order was to the article "Vedic Veersa" by Patrick Boch, which was published in the second issue of Arktos' journal, *The Initiate*, and which was indeed about ISKCON. I myself was involved with ISKCON for three years, although I no longer am. To say that it "accepts anyone" is not accurate. As with most other religions, of course anyone is free to come to the temples, observe the services, learn the philosophy and do the basic practices. But there are two stages of initiation in Gaudiya Vaishnavism, *harinamadiksa* and *brahmana*, and one must study and practice for years under the guidance of a spiritual master before one can even become eligible to apply for the testing that is a prerequisite for first initiation (and not everyone passes the tests). The second stage is even more difficult. Whether one finds the philosophy and practices palatable for a Westerner is debatable (which is why I ultimately left), but it did satisfy me as possessing all the qualifications of a traditional, initiatic path, and its founder, A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, definitely qualifies as one of the greatest spiritual leaders of the twentieth century, if one considers his biography, traditional teachings and accomplishments.

Concerning some of the comments above, all I can say is that it is not wise to judge a religion by its lowest members. If there was indeed an ISKCON brahmachari who was in a bar and begging for change, those are two violations of ISKCON principles right there. Therefore not a good representative of the movement. Likewise that sticker that was posted is not one that I have ever come across in relation to ISKCON before. There are many White Hindu organizations today, including other branches of Gaudiya Vaishnavism, that have nothing to do with ISKCON, so one shouldn't assume that any White person who claims to be a Hindu is a Hare Krishna.

The aggressive proselytization perpetrated by ISKCON is one of the factors that led to me

leave the organization, but it is really no different in tone from that perpetrated by Christians and Muslims. Gaudiya Vaishnavism is a monotheistic philosophy and in some ways is very Abrahamic in its outlook, as in its desire to win converts. But for a Christian to condemn ISKCON for its proselytization practices (if indeed you are) would be extremely hypocritical.

Lastly, I'll say that ISKCON today is a large, international organization, and has many different branches that have evolved in different directions over the years. Some have deviated quite widely from the original philosophy. Some, such as the branch led by Bhakti Vikas Swami, are very conservative and have tried to stay as close to Prabhupada's and scriptural teachings as possible. So any statement one attempts to make about ISKCON as a whole will ultimately be incomplete.

John Morgan on 2013-06-19 at 08:46 said:

"It's odd that an external enemy can be a spiritual friend, while some who claim to be close to us are in fact spiritual enemies. The latter are the worst kinds of enemy."

I think this is a very profound and correct statement. However, I imagine that not merely the ability to appreciate a Shi'a philosopher is sufficient on its own to be considered a friend of traditionalism.

Jason-Adam on 2013-06-19 at 12:22 said:

Mr Morgan :

I have never attended an ISKCON service or had any personal experience with the group at all, aside from reading a few of Prabhupada's books (which I rather enjoyed) so I am merely an observer of things here.

May I ask, are you sure that ISKCON offers a genuine initiation and is not akin to say a Blavatsky or a Vivekananda ? I am suspicious of ISKCON because among its adherents were rock stars, punk rockers, and other such gems of society... ..also there is this http://prabhupada-krishna.co.uk/spiritual_communism.htm how can anyone be called traditional who uses words such as "Vedic socialism"... ..also it seems as if Prabhupada ignores the idea of caste as something hereditary... ..

Cologero on 2013-06-19 at 12:46 said:

The only "genuine" initiation in Hinduism, or better, Brahmanism, is the caste initiation. That is why outsiders cannot properly become Hindus. Yoga and Tantra groups do not discriminate on that basis, and probably on no basis.

Jason-Adam on 2013-06-19 at 15:02 said:

So, Cologero, by definition that means any "Hindu" group that accepts Westerners is fraudulent ?

John Morgan on 2013-06-20 at 20:05 said:

Cologero, in the Bhagavata Purana it states that anyone born in Kali-yuga is a shudra, regardless of whatever hereditary caste they belong to. (One can see this by the fact that the caste system in India today is in a complete shambles.) In the Gaudiya Vaishnava sampadaya, this is taken to mean that, during Kali-yuga, it is possible for those born in other castes, or even non-Indians, can become brahmanas, since brahmanas as exist in earlier yugas simply do not exist at this time.

John Morgan on 2013-06-20 at 20:34 said:

I hasten to add, however, that in Gaudiya Vaishnavism, varanasrama (the caste hierarchy) is still considered important, but one acquires varna (caste) through behavior and learning rather than from birth, as in earlier yugas.

John Morgan on 2013-06-20 at 21:02 said:

Jason-Adams, the only rock star I can think of who supported ISKCON in Prabhupada's time was George Harrison. Prabhupada always welcomed his support (among other things, Harrison purchased the Bhaktivedanta Manor in the UK for ISKCON, which is still one of its most important centers today), as he did from anyone who was genuinely interested, but Harrison never actually became a disciple of Prabhupada and he was never initiated. Prabhupada was an eminently practical man – he welcomed support wherever he could get it, but never compromised his principles to do so. I imagine he considered it better for Harrison to become involved with Krishna on some level, even if he was unable to bring himself to embrace the austere life of a brahmachari or grihastha in that particular lifetime.

When Prabhupada spoke about “spiritual Communism” and “Vedic socialism” and so forth, what he meant was that he considered ISKCON a non-sectarian movement that encourages the increase of God-consciousness everywhere. I always considered this to be somewhat disingenuous, since ISKCON always maintains that Krishna is God and that any other form of God (Shiva, Ahura Mazda, Jesus, whatever) is only an incomplete version of Him. Still, it is true that Gaudiya Vaishnavas do not reject other religions, and encourage their growth for bringing people closer to God in some form, even if they regard GV as the most perfect form of religion. Prabhupada was certainly opposed to Communism and socialism in the usual sense, as he made clear in many of his writings and interviews. He was always a defender of varanasrama.

The idea of a valid initiation is that there is an unbroken line of initiations between gurus and disciples leading back to an initial divine revelation. In the Gaudiya Vaishnava sampradaya, the divine revelation was that of Lord Chaitanya, and there is most definitely an unbroken disciplic chain of succession from Chaitanya (and, in turn, Kṛṣṇa) and Prabhupada. This can be found many places online. Blavatsky and Vivekananda could make no such claim.

Cologero on 2013-06-20 at 21:55 said:

John Morgan, if you are trying to make a point beyond the confirmation of what we have written here many times over, I don't see it. By definition, "shudra" means one who does not have a spiritual initiation. In the process of degeneration of castes, the shudra wrest control of administration and rule, to the point that only the shudra and Brahmin exist. Ultimately, when all that remain are shudra, there is no longer any spiritual initiation. That, allegedly, is the situation in the West and, as you claim, may be in process even in India at this time. Nevertheless, at the current time, a Westerner cannot go to India and be initiated as a Brahmin, unless you know otherwise.

So it stills leaves the question, the answer to which we have been exploring, is how initiation is re-established when it exists nowhere, i.e., there are only shudras.

So the alternative, as you say, is through behavior and learning. That is what Gornahoor is encouraging our readers to do, sort of. (We don't think anyone should become a hare krishna).

As a corollary, any attempts at premature political solutions can only be the battle between one group of shudras (which are called "common" or "vulgar" in the West) and another, is simply futile.

John Morgan on 2013-06-21 at 05:17 said:

Cologero, I'm not surprised that there are corollaries, given the reality of Tradition, although I am not giving you my personal opinions here, this is Gaudiya Vaishnava theology. So not original to me. As for brahmana initiations, thousands of people, including many Westerners, have been brahmana initiated in ISKCON, and in the Gaudiya Vaishnava sampradaya more broadly, and even more broadly in the other Vaishnava sampradayas, over the last half-century, and they are acknowledged as such by most Vedic authorities. Brahmana status, as exists in earlier yugas, is not possible at this time, even for Indians. So brahmana initiation now means something different than it does in other ages, but it is absolutely still going on and will be able to for at least another 9,500 years, as is confirmed in scripture. (Kali-yuga itself has about 430,000 years left to run, but eventually humans will degenerate to an animal level and become incapable of any spiritual impulse or activity.)

Personally I see Hare Krishna initiation as being just as valid for a Westerner as any other at this time, although it does create a wall of cultural separation between oneself and the rest of one's own people. But then again, if enlightenment and spiritual liberation is the primary goal, perhaps that shouldn't be important. Certainly Guenon would not have thought so. And many of the most seriously religious White individuals I have known were Hare Krishnas. All of the things that are being called for by this blog are certainly already being attempted, and in some cases achieved, by ISKCON.

Cologero on 2013-06-22 at 09:29 said:

Curious, John Morgan. I presume, however, that no birth rite Hindu recognizes the caste change? Specifically, will the government recognize it, with their byzantine classification schemes? And an ISKCON initiate, moreover, cannot pass his initiation onto his son (unless the son has met the ISKCON requirements)... is that true?

That entails becoming a Hindu, which is much more than the study of the six philosophical systems apart from any religious practice. Ironically, Venner on his blog rued Christianity and praised Hinduism for its ethnic closure. Obviously, he didn't know about ISKCON making Hinduism also universalistic.

John Morgan on 2013-06-22 at 10:07 said:

Cologero, there are many hereditary Indian brahmanas in ISKCON today (some of them are among my friends), and of course they must acknowledge the hierarchy, which means that sannyasis of White ancestry or Indians born into lower varnas are their superiors, so no, it's not the case that all birth brahmanas reject this system. They have seen firsthand for themselves the wretched state that hereditary varnasrama is in today. I am certain that there are birth brahmanas who do not acknowledge ISKCON initiations, however. But I never encountered any hostility myself, even though I was an uninitiated neophyte. During my time with ISKCON in Mumbai, when I used to go out in my neighborhood dressed in dhoti-kurta and wearing tilak, I used to sometimes have Indians bow to me or who addressed me as "pandit" (or who shouted out "Hare Krsna!" when they saw me). So "White Hindus" have actually managed to garner respect even in India, in large part due to Prabhupada's efforts and the strict observances of his followers and due to the poor standards of most other Hindu organizations today (ISKCON is one of the most strongly conservative Hindu movements in India today). Anyway, even in earlier yugas, someone can lose his varna due to degenerate behavior, and it is sometimes possible for someone from a lower varna to acquire higher status. So it's never been entirely hereditary. The most important ways to determine varna, according to scripture, are through one's behavior and actions.

In terms of the Indian government today, there is nothing about caste in the Constitution at all, apart from the fact that varnasrama is abolished in favor of democracy, so no system of caste has political status in India today whatsoever, hereditary or otherwise. The BJP got in hot water recently because it insisted on having caste included as part of the last census.

And no, ISKCON initiations are not hereditary. One's sons must go through the same exact process as the father, if he wants to attain the same status.

Regarding Hinduism as an ethnically-based religion, it is said in the Vedic scriptures that anyone born outside of Bharat (India) is automatically less than a shudra (basically an animal), since only those born in India can attain full spiritual knowledge and escape samsara. It is also said that the scriptures cannot be understood in any language but Sanskrit. However, during

Kali-yuga this is true of everyone, including Indians, so that is why it now becomes possible for non-Indians to become brahmanas. Until the 1930s, apart from a few rare converts, the phenomenon of White Hindus was quite unusual, which is surely where Guenon got this notion. There is a record of a Greek ambassador, Heliodorus, who converted to Vaishnavism in the fourth century BC. There was also some sannyasis, including a Gaudiya Vaishnava sannyasi, who travelled to the U.S. in the late 19th/early 20th century and made some converts there. But an earnest attempt to spread Gaudiya Vaishnavism outside India didn't begin until the 1930s, with the Gaudiya Math, and their efforts mostly met with failure until one of their students, A. C. Bhaktivedanta Prabhupada, went off to the U.S. in 1966, and then the rest of the world, and created ISKCON. Venner probably wasn't aware that the Hare Krishnas are a legitimate branch of the Vedic tree. But we shouldn't be too hard on him since, traditionally and until recently, that was indeed the case that Hinduism was an ethnically closed religion, and there are still branches of Hinduism that are closed to Westerners today.

Cologero on 2013-06-22 at 10:30 said:

I thought that India had a system of scheduled castes and tribes, so I assumed caste had some legal status. I believe I read that an Indian court was trying to undo the stranglehold of the Brahmins on temple access. BTW, I wasn't being hard on Venner, since I had the same assumption. But the larger point (which the ISKCON philosophy implies) is that ethnicity cannot, in our time, be the primary factor; the fundamental problem in the West is the lack of a spiritual tradition, and population replacement is the symptom.

It raises an interesting point, assuming the ISKCON initiation is valid (and I presume it is, if it is done properly). In the west, there is a distinction between a valid and a licit ordination. A priestly ordination is valid if the administering bishop has apostolic succession. It is licit only if approved by the proper authorities. The analogous situation in the West is "sedevacantism", i.e., the position that those who are externally responsible for the priestly functions are not living up to their vocation. This is the same as ISKCON's claim that the outward Brahmins are not really Brahmins. So there are groups in the West who could conceivably perform the similar function. Unfortunately, they all fight over who has the purest doctrine and don't bother establishing communities of the type that you say ISKCON is forming in India.

John Morgan on 2013-06-22 at 11:12 said:

Cologero, yes, there is such a thing as "scheduled castes" in India, by which is meant dalits and shudras. But this is only a form of "affirmative action" intended to undo the last vestiges of caste "prejudice" from India, not an attempt to integrate varnasrama into modern India. The modern Indian state is strongly Marxist in spirit. Even many erstwhile Hindu "nationalists" are opposed to caste. Caste may still play some role in the Hindu civil courts – the various religious communities in India each have their own courts for family and communal matters – but I

haven't studied the matter in detail.

I agree about the problem of spirituality as being greater than the ethnic one, even though I believe, along with Evola, in the importance of race as a traditional form.

And I also found ISKCON's notion of setting up farm communities as being an interesting one for members of any religious community to follow in the modern world.

I was satisfied that ISKCON's system of initiations is valid, although of course outsiders have challenged the legitimacy of ISKCON's system on various grounds over the years. And certainly there were many abuses, especially in the early years. But at least ideally it seemed like a good system to me, and especially ISKCON in India has really undergone a lot of positive changes over the last 20 years, and I imagine Indians will assume the forefront of the movement in coming years, as it seems largely dead in the water in the U.S. and Western Europe these days (not without some justification), apart from a few pockets here and there. As I wrote before, however, my problem with it was mainly that really embracing it fully essentially means giving up one's identity as a Westerner. But many see that as immaterial next to the spiritual goal.

As an aside, I'll mention that I've learned that in Goa there are Catholic brahmanas, Catholic kshatriyas, and so forth. This came about because, when the Portuguese first began converting the locals in the 16th century, the Church conducted negotiations with the Hindus, since the upper-caste Hindus didn't want to lose their status in order to become Catholic. And apparently there are still some specifically Goan rituals in the Church that can only be performed by brahmanas and kshatriyas today.

4.21 **Androids, Avatars, and Androphiles**

Most people think in sentence fragments. The more educated can think in complete sentences, or more rarely, in paragraphs.

Winding Down As we are getting close to the $\frac{3}{4}$ mark of 1001 posts, I have to think about wrapping things up. Just before #1001, I will reveal the secret meaning of one of Rene Guenon's major themes. It should be obvious given everything he has written and he did provide some oblique clues. Gornahoor has actually provided some clues. Esoteric writings usually leave something out and Guenon leaves out what anyone familiar with his path should expect to see. There can be no hopelessness in the

task of recovering tradition in the West, since hope is a virtue and the East is not bastion of tradition.

The three motive forces in the human mind are eros, thumos, and nous. The first two have a positive character when dominated by nous, but usually are allowed to run amok without the guidance of a higher intelligence. As spiritual training, readers should strive to determine which of these forces are being appealed to. Eros seems straight forward, but we are intending something more than simple appeals to prurient interest. Desire takes many forms. For example, in my fb feed, I often see links to sites on meditation that promise to lower blood pressure, to reduce anxiety, or, in general, to “improve one’s life”. Obviously, that shows absolutely no understanding of the purpose of meditation and reveals the danger of learning meditation on one’s own without a suitable guide. This is the viewpoint of the shudra, whose understanding is limited to the material and the subjective.

Perhaps the goal is rather to transcend such desires, to observe how they try to dominate consciousness, and then to reveal their emptiness.

In the areas we want to focus on here, thumos is appealed to in politically motivated writings. They are written in a way to appeal to anger and fear, to “pump up”. To do so, their technique is to attack the other side, however defined, while devoid of anything of positive content. Do we really need another exposé of the “modern world”, especially since almost everyone in the West is in love with it?

We, on the other hand, endeavor to appeal to the nous; that is why we don’t “prove” things empirically or logically (although they are useful in refutation). It is more important to “see”. Since the world of appearances in the reflection of something transcendent, we point to the transcendent. While others work themselves up over the shadow play on the wall, we want readers to see the puppets rather than their shadows. Therefore we leave you with two homework tasks:

- 1) When reading something, or better yet if you can maintain the

requisite detachment and concentration, when engaging with someone in person, notice which force is dominant in them.

2) Similarly, try to determine which caste a person probably should belong to. Schuon's schema of objective/subjective and idealist/materialist is a good way to start.

Satanism, the Vatican, and the Old Religion There was a report recently about a group of homosexual priests in Rome who maintained a ring of catamites. To juice it up, the story claimed that this group provided consecrated hosts to Satanists. The Italian police quickly hushed it up as the ravings of a bitter ex-priest. Nevertheless, there is a positive element in that someone actually believes in the real presence of Christ in the Eucharist, showing that Satan can't be fooled. Beyond that, it sounds like some new Dan Brown novel about androphiles following the left hand path; there are enough of them in the counter tradition.

Actually, Satan's religion is the first religion, pre-existing the primordial revelation given to Adam; that is why the witches call it the "Old Religion". Its creed is simple: deny God and deny God's cosmic law. These denials take several forms, from simple atheism to deliberate and conscious rejection. The Old Religion sees matter as the prison of man, rather than the symbol of transcendence. Adam's revelation understands the problem as arising from the human will, the rejection of the law, which is defined as "sin", i.e., deviating from that cosmic norm.

For example, I recently came across a discussion of some recent SCOTUS decisions; the author decided that some things can be "natural" but not "normative" and believed that the observation of forest animals is a sufficient guide to understand human behavior. This presumes, falsely, that nature is independent and can be fully understood apart from creation. The author claims that the idea of "sin" clouds the issue, and I agree that the term is overworked and not always understood, yet it is indispensable. For the Old Religionist, no appeal to any law, not even

that of forest animals, is persuasive.

Avatars and Immortality Recently, there was a conference in New York called the 2045 Initiative. Their stated goal is to create artificial humans, or androids, and then “upload” the contents of a human mind into that being. Of course, there is absolutely no reason to believe that such a project is even feasible and the participants provided none. They simply assume a Cartesian view of things.

I came across one writer who “defined” consciousness as the desires, emotions, images, thoughts, in short, all the contents in the mind. Unfortunately, as consciousness is not an object in the world, no such definition is possible. Consciousness is transcendent, even to such “mental” contents, and is always the subject. Does everyone reading this understand that notion? Ask for clarification, if not.

There is a more serious difficulty in that significant parts of the contents of the soul actually belong to the body; hence, they cannot be separated from the body. Perhaps logical forms of thought can be, but that is not the human person, but rather a simulation. Would they try to eliminate all irrational desires, urges, unsupportable opinions, prejudices, etc.? For most men, there would not be much left over.

What they are attempting is to create a copy of a copy. Nature is God’s creation and man is part of that nature. The android is an artifact, something not natural in the same way. Specifically, there is no divine idea of it, but that is a complete topic in itself.

Drunk Lamas and Pusillanimity Since a Lama is the incarnation of an aspect of the Buddha, then accidental qualities such as his dipsomania cannot affect that. There is a similar teaching in the Western tradition that is called “*ex opere operato*”; the rites of a priest are effective regardless of his personal failings. But the more interesting metaphysical question, however, is why was such an imperfect being chosen as the lama? On a

more elevated level, we can ask the related question: “why was the woman St. Joan of Arc chosen to save France?”

Well, we know that there is a revealed truth that explains it: “Many are called but few are chosen.” Specifically, many men, of better character than the Mongolian lama, were called to fulfill that role. Yet they passed the cup, assuming George would do it³⁸, until finally one spirit accepted.

So we can assume that many men were offered the chance to “save” France until there were no men left. Pusillanimity is the vice that holds a man back from actualizing all his possibilities. Often, he will justify it by the claim to be “humble” or offer some other excuse. The call often arises as a whisper out of the Silence. If your mind is so cluttered with loud, persistent, meaningless and strength-sapping thoughts then that whisper will be missed. Actually the pusillanimous man hopes it will be missed.

The Boy who Cried Wolf I watched the 1974 version of the Great Gatsby last week and was struck by the allusion to Lothrop Stoddard; apparently, that made no impact on me when I first saw it or read the book. Considering that his major opus, and those of his spiritual father Madison Grant, were written nearly a century ago, it is interesting to compare similar ideas now. Then Stoddard and Grant were respectable intellectuals, and the latter was even chummy with some presidents. Nowadays, however, neither one of them could even get a cookbook published.

If circumstances were so auspicious at that time, then what chance do similar ideas have of taking root now? There is none, since there is no common identity and this is proved by all the appeals to identity. This is actually an interesting topic when viewed from the right and deserves a post dedicated to it. It will be called: Order, Authority, and Unity.

Posted on 2013-07-07 by Cologero

³⁸<https://www.oldtimeradiodownloads.com/crime/let-george-do-it>

4.22 Midsummer Night Dream 2013

Anyone attracted to political action should read those political scientists who describe how men actually are and act, not as they should in some imaginary world. Only then can men be led effectively. Most today will think that is immoral. To the contrary, the result is Order, Authority, and Unity ... the highest morality you can and should expect in a state.

Man is faithful by nature; woman is promiscuous. Man wants to protect his own; this entails exclusion. Woman wants to nurture indiscriminately; this entails inclusion.

Those capable of thinking only in material terms and images or who understand time only in terms of number, will never grasp much of anything.

Eckhart said that the beginning of spirituality is dependent on recognizing what one is as a being outside time.

Identity is not biological. USA was 90% white in my childhood, Boston much more, but that means nothing. In *Virgin Spring*³⁹, Töre was a noble, a father and patriarch, his daughter beautiful and blonde and virginal — they lived in the light. The maidservant was dark, promiscuous, and played with frogs. In our time, many think that is “tradition” and are attracted to the bizarre, the abnormal, the ugly. The shepherds who gave into their craven lusts were also ethnic Swedes. So who then is a Swede according to the Identity movements? In Evola’s expression, who is “of race”? That is a spiritual quality and by the law of involution/evolution, not all who appear so are the bearers of the race.

Organizations eventually fail because the leaders become weak and indiscriminate; they have no standards or no longer adhere to them; they refuse to enforce discipline. Instead, they prefer to be “nice” and “inclusive”, proving the hold that the modern mind still has on them. Stronger men know who is in and who is out. There was an order in the last cen-

³⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1416>

tury that banned non-fathers and atheists. In our time the new right and the identity right embrace them. They have their reasons, none of them good, and are more in the nature of confabulations.

Even a blog should strive to be what it describes, to the limited extent that is possible. That is why certain rules on commenting are established, more as an experiment. To reject a certain type of comment is not to reject all; that is the way boys think. One fellow who was asked to take some time out from commenting did so, but came back after a suitable time elapsed. That I can respect.

Androphiles try to act like men, so they use f**k a lot in their writings to show how macho they are. That may have had a chance to be true at one time, but now that even high school girls speak like that, it no longer has any impact. Do you want a handbook on acting manly? Learn to be chivalrous. I just saved you the price of a useless book.

Men don't relish considering themselves as victims.

Men are in tenuous positions today, forced into submission to those who have no right to authority over them. But even the slave Epictetus was free.

Thanks to facebook, I found out that there are certain things men are supposed to believe only because it is the 21st century. It saves all the trouble of thinking, using logic, and research; instead, it is only necessary to check one's calendar. Who knows what will be the cause du jour next year, in 5 years, in 10? Is there someone in charge of this or do all the locusts get hungry at the same time?

I don't care very much about people's opinions; what interests me is their inner state. What is it like to be them? What caste would they be, which spiritual race? It takes a few probing questions and to discern that by listening carefully to their answers. A man's knowledge is something different.

People create sand castles out of words and then try to live in them. Words have depth or perhaps not. Do they express something real or

are they just nominal? Few can distinguish between the natural and the artificial.

I still remember my dreams as a baby and the first time I realized I was an "I". But I haven't yet been able to remember who was dreaming the baby into existence.

Gurdjieff told the story about a magician who hypnotized his sheep into believing they were men. It did not work out well for the sheep because the charade was eventually found out and they felt worse than if they had simply accepted being sheep.

Esoteric writing is always incomplete, leaving something out, even being misleading, while expecting the correct readers to discern the secret meaning.

Who built the bus?

Posted on 2013-07-18 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-07-19 at 10:17 said:

Gurdjieff's story reminds me of some problems I've had with body-spirit conflicts in my life. It was hard to figure who is the "real" me sometimes.....even know I still have problems centering around the Chief Feature.

Scardanelli on 2013-07-19 at 13:28 said:

There was an evil magician. He lived deep in the mountains and the forests, and he had thousands of sheep. But the problem was that the sheep were afraid of the magician because every day the sheep were seeing that one of them was being killed for his breakfast, another was being killed for his lunch. So they ran away from the magician's ranch and it was a difficult job to find them in the vast forest. Being a magician, he used magic.

He hypnotized all the sheep and suggested to them first of all that they were immortal and that no harm was being done to them when they were skinned, that, on the contrary, it would be very good for them and even pleasant; secondly he suggested that the magician was a good master who loved his flock so much that he was ready to do anything in the world for them; and in the third place he suggested to them that if anything at all were going to happen to them it

was not going to happen just then, at any rate not that day, and therefore they had no need to think about it.

He then told different sheep...to some, "You are a man, you need not be afraid. It is only the sheep who are going to be killed and eaten, not you. You are a man just like I am." Some other sheep were told, "You are a lion – only sheep are afraid. They escape, they are cowards. You are a lion; you would prefer to die than to run away. You don't belong to these sheep. So when they are killed it is not your problem. They are meant to be killed, but you are the most loved of my friends in this forest." In this way, he told every sheep different stories, and from the second day, the sheep stopped running away from the house.

They still saw other sheep being killed, butchered, but it was not their concern. Somebody was a lion, somebody was a tiger, somebody was a man, somebody was a magician and so forth. Nobody was a sheep except the one who was being killed. This way, without keeping servants, he managed thousands of sheep. They would go into the forest for their food, for their water, and they would come back home, believing always one thing: "It is some sheep who is going to be killed, not you. You don't belong to the sheep. You are a lion – respected, honored, a friend of the great magician." The magician's problems were solved and the sheep never ran away again.

scardanelli on 2013-07-19 at 13:46 said:

From:

<http://glossary.cassiopaea.com/glossary.php?id=2>

The site has some useful clarifications of terms and concepts from Mouravieff and Gurdjieff, mixed in with a lot of other questionable material.

Avery Morrow on 2013-07-19 at 21:35 said:

When the locusts get hungry they are trying to eat each other.

Cologero on 2013-07-22 at 13:00 said:

That is part of the common problem, J-A. The "I" is always there, it is not a "me", and there is no figuring.

Cologero on 2013-07-22 at 13:02 said:

AM, I assume that is the koan that your Zen Master gave you as you quit Japan ... so when the locusts swarm, they are trying to fly away from each other to avoid being eaten.

CaseyAnn on 2013-10-03 at 02:01 said:

The first part of this post has always stuck with me.

"Man is faithful by nature; woman is promiscuous. Man wants to protect his own; this entails exclusion. Woman wants to nurture indiscriminately; this entails inclusion."

I understand it in the sense of the second and third sentences; but I've always been troubled about it in the sense of the biological expression. Tonight Aristotle brought it up in my readings: "[F]or the female is impregnated by one copulation, while the male impregnates many females."

Does it matter?

Synodius on 2013-10-03 at 13:20 said:

I think Cologero meant man's attitude to logic (and rules) which is more binary, while a woman with her more integrative bias tends to make decisions based on emotions. For example polygamy as a biological fact does not go against 'faithfulness'. only breaking of the rules that regulate it in a society does.

4.23 Preparing for Hurricane Season 2013

The Ice Caps Are Melting Michael Hoffman has described an unusual conspiracy theory that there is a hidden cryptocracy behind seemingly contingent events. They manipulate opinion through symbols. (That is why the correct understanding of symbols is so necessary.) Curiously, they actually reveal what they are doing through popular media, particularly films.

I never took such ideas seriously, but I am now rethinking them. For example, all my life I had assumed that books like *1984* and *The Brave New World* were warnings to us to avoid such dystopian societies. However, I now think that they were actually preparing us to accept such a world, even willingly. There can be no doubt that we are embracing, in the West, more and more of the features described in that those books.

A creepier video can clinch the deal to any doubters. In 1970, Tiny Tim sang a song to a group of children⁴⁰ about the polar ice caps melting and drowning all the world. (See around 42 or 43 minutes into it). I don't know why the kids did not flip out, but consider that they are now in positions of power. If you believe in the cryptocracy, you will see that

⁴⁰<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5xfAZ6y9zzM>

the idea of melting ice caps was implanted in to the group consciousness some 40 years ago. If you believe in science, you will see anthropogenic global warming as a great scientific discovery. I'll leave the decision up to you, but take into consideration that Tiny Tim was no scientist.

Politics and Tradition Somehow, the idea of Tradition has become intertwined with nominal political movements, at least in some circles. For that to make sense, the goal of such a movement would be the restoration of a traditional society. Given that, we have analyzed to some extent the following works.

- **Ananda Coomaraswamy's** *Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power in Indian Theory of Government*. Although that deals specifically with the Hindu tradition, it serves as a background to other works. We saw, too, how this work corrected Evola's misconception about the relationship between the Brahman caste and the King.
- **Rene Guenon's** *Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power*. This is more abstract than Coomaraswamy's work since it deals with general principles rather than the specific situation in earlier civilizations.
- **Guido De Giorgio's** section on the constitution of a traditional society from *The Roman Tradition*. This is more esoteric, since it describes the inner states associated with the various caste distinctions and the role of the Leader without reference to any specific situations or sacred scriptures. His is the only work that deals effectively with the Worker caste and the role of the Leader.
- There is **Julius Evola's** essay on Monarchy with some important details. For the sake of completeness, we will next make available

his essay from the Ur/Krur group with the same title of Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power. I don't believe it has been translated into English, but let me know otherwise.

- We have mentioned **Dante's** essay *On Monarchy*. As a political realist, he realizes that if disputes cannot be resolved rationally or spiritually, then a duel may be the ultimate solution. This applies only in certain defined situations and should be contrasted with Evola's opinion that the result of a duel is a merely contingent event.
- **Fustel de Coulanges'** *The Ancient City* describes the constitution of traditional societies and ancient Greece and Rome.

Although there is room for discussion among all these perspectives, there is nevertheless a family resemblance. Primary among them is the recognition of a spiritual unity and none of them begins with racial or ethnic identity. Actually, experience proves this as evidenced by the frustrations expressed by those who start from the bottom up. It is true, by the Law of Affinity, that certain traditions are appropriate to a given peoples, but once the soul and the spirit have been lost, the body loses its coherence, devolving into atomic individuals.

Hence, any political aspirations based on tradition must start with a spiritual impulse. This cannot be defined or delimited in a discourse as its source must needs be transcendent. That is why Guenon emphasized that a transformation to reverse the flow of progressive time is a task possible only for an elite who understand and live by certain principles. De Giorgio goes a step further and points out that there can only be one leader and he represents the spiritual power in the temporal realm. That is why there can ultimately be just one movement and competing movements are part of the counter Tradition.

There is a trend in certain circles to gather disparate material together, so long as they are "on the right" in some way, in the vain hope that a

unitary movement will ensue. This is the intellectual analog of Mulligan Stew. When Hobos came together, whatever edibles they could gather would be tossed into the pot to make a stew; obviously it would never be the same from day to day. That is food suitable for bums, not for men. Likewise, that applies to “intellectual” mulligan stew.

Innocent as Doves In a recent episode of *Magic City*⁴¹, the Cuban trophy wife starts a conversation with her husband, the owner of a Miami Beach hotel.

Wife: In my world, lying and cheating your way to success is not a virtue.

Husband: In my world, I protect those I love.

Wife: Whatever it takes?

Husband: Whatever it takes!

How do they coexist in the same world? One is as innocent as a dove, the other as wise as a serpent. The Leader takes on the sins of the people in order to keep them innocent.

Two Books Two books have come to my attention this week; one a history of the movement inaugurated by Guenon, the other a history of Jesus penned by a Muslim. The former is René Guénon: *Une politique de l'esprit* by David Bisson. I have not seen it, but only partly read a review of it. Unable to conceive of transcendence, the professor reduces Guenon to a metapolitical movement and seeks to categorize him among similar figures of his time.

The premise is incorrect, since Guenon is the latest in a long line of metaphysicians. Tradition, even the Western tradition, is based on the symbolic understanding of scriptures (i.e., beyond the literal interpretation), the perennial philosophy, and a knowingness beyond discursive thought.

⁴¹<http://www.starz.com/originals/magiccity>

That has been largely lost in the West. To beat an old horse, the Protestant Sola Scripture teaching displaced the perennial philosophy. Specifically, the anthropomorphic god gleaned from the literal biblical readings has displaced metaphysics. The Traditional view is that when the literal meaning conflicts with a higher understanding, then a symbolic meaning is more likely. This is beyond the intellectual domain of a professor. Unfortunately, to understand Guenon, a man must embark on the path of spiritual realization.

The other book is *Zealot: The Life and Times of Jesus of Nazareth* by a Muslim biblical scholar, Reza Aslan. Oddly enough, for an allegedly scholarly book, it has reached #1 on Amazon. Again, he breaks no new ground, as far as I can tell, but is yet another link in the chain of scholars looking for the true “historical” Jesus. The last such book I read several years ago was by a Marcus Borg who envisioned Jesus as a liberal democrat who would have supported universal health care.

Mr. Aslan goes further, asserting that Jesus was some sort of rabble rousing revolutionary figure, willing to overthrow the established order of things. In this, he predated by centuries that spectre that Karl Marx discovered to be haunting Europe. Since everyone who is anyone today sees himself as a zealot and revolutionary, we can well understand the popularity of this book. They are happy to let Jesus onto their team since the holy name still has a certain cachet. Unfortunately, the perpetual revolutionary will eventually run out of things to rebel against, once he becomes aware that he is actually “the man”. His path can only devolve into chaos as every trace of order is destroyed. For us, on the other hand, Jesus is the incarnation of the Logos, hence the embodiment of the very order of things.

Posted on 2013-07-29 by Cologero

* * *

Thomas Blanchard on 2013-07-30 at 10:25 said:

Forgive my ignorance; what is the source on "Evola's opinion that the result of a duel is a merely contingent event"? I don't recall this from *Revolt*, *Mystery of the Grail*, or any of the articles collected in *Metaphysics of War*.

Cologero on 2013-07-30 at 12:31 said:

Thomas, that is my interpretation of what Evola wrote in *Fascism Viewed from the Right*, in which he asserted that defeat is a contingent event and could not be related to truth of the principles involved.

Compare to what Dante wrote about the Roman empire. In your research, did you find that Evola claimed that the outcome of a duel reflected divine justice?

JA on 2013-07-30 at 12:58 said:

Perhaps there is a difference between a duel between individuals in a traditional society and a war between secular modern states ? Evola did hold in *Revolt* to the justness of dueling, so the Fascism reference I think refers to a different principle in a different time.

Jacob on 2013-07-30 at 15:05 said:

I'm with you, JA.

I understand it as Evola pointing out that a martial victory on the physical plane has no bearing on objective truth. Just because the forces of revolution in France killed the king doesn't mean the king was not rightful ruler of France.

If I understand de Giorgio right (and it's highly possible I do not) the leader is supposed to be as close to pure action as possible. So that means the person most capable in martial respects should be the one in charge right? Then the priestly caste is there to make sure his enforcement of things is correct in terms of Tradition. If so it seems to resolve the question to me.

Is this a correct deduction or did I just read my own biases into de Giorgio's. ideas?

Izak on 2013-07-30 at 16:38 said:

Just wanted to say thanks so much for the translations on statecraft!

I'm a bit behind in reading them. I've got some catching up to do.

Thomas Blanchard on 2013-07-30 at 16:55 said:

Colgero and JA,

I am specifically referring to this passage from *Revolt*, in the chapter, "The Greater and the Lesser Holy War". The keys here are the last paragraph, and also when he mentions that

the action of the trial of strength needs to be given an “adequate orientation” (I believe this illustrates the difference you were speaking of, JA.)

Before continuing, I need to mention an aspect of the traditional spirit that is related to the Law and to the views expounded so far. I am talking about various ordeals of character and so-called divine judgments.

Quite often the test of truth, right, justice, and innocence was made to depend on a trial that consisted of decisive action (*experimentum crucis*). Just as the law was traditionally believed to have a divine origin, likewise injustice was considered to be a violation of the divine Law and to be detectable through the outcome of a human action that had been given an adequate orientation. A Germanic custom consisted of delving into the divine will through the test of arms as a particular form of oracle mediated by action; the idea that originally was at the basis of the custom of challenging somebody to a duel is not very different. Starting with the principle: “*de coelo est fortitudo*” (*Annales Fuldenses*), this principle was eventually extended to feuding states and nations. A battle as late as that of Fonteney (A.D. 841) was conceived as a “divine judgement” that was invoked to establish the rights of two brothers both claiming the legacy of Charlemagne. When a battle was fought in this spirit, it followed special rules: the winner was forbidden to loot and to exploit strategically and territorially the successful outcome, and both sides were expected to tend equally to the fallen and to the wounded. According to the general view that was preserved through the entire Carolingian period, however, even when the idea of a specific proof was not required, victory and defeat were felt to be signs “from above” establishing justice or injustice, truth or guilt.

...

These views were destined to be regarded as pure superstition wherever “progress” systematically deprived the human virtues of any possibility of establishing an objective contact with a superior order of things. Once man's strength was thought to be on the same level as that of animals, that is, as the faculty of mechanical action in a being who is not at all connected to what transcends him as an individual, the trial of strength obviously becomes meaningless and the outcome of every competition becomes entirely contingent and lacking a potential relation with an order of higher “values.”

Michael on 2013-07-30 at 18:38 said:

Regarding tiptoe through the tulips, I've come to a similar conclusion this year. Things are unfolding in such a way that it is hard to believe that it is not part of a brilliant plan. Who do you think “they” are? I personally feel it is just too well done to be a group of people.

Saladin on 2013-07-30 at 21:51 said:

Regarding Mr. Aslan: He was born a muslim, then turns evangelical, then becomes muslim again!!! This gentleman (a compatriot of mine to boot) claims to be a muslim, but he totally ignores the fact that his portrayal of Jesus-christ (which he states is what he believes as a "historian") goes against Islamic tradition's view of Jesus which is that of the highest of prophets. Mr. Aslan is neither a

christian nor a Muslim. Given the enormous support he has received from mass media (except Fox News), as well as his other political activities, we can safely guess where his loyalty lies (should I name the tribe?)

Very interesting choice for a title too. Remember who the "zealots" were? (look here for etymology: <http://www.etymonline.com/index.php?term=zealot>). Aslan's claim is that Jesus was a zealot whose ultimate aim was to fight the Roman Empire (and of course help the poor along the way)!! Really?

No, Mr. Aslan is no muslim. He is a clever guy who knows what his masters require of him to be amply rewarded.

JA on 2013-07-31 at 11:06 said:

@Thomas that is the quote I was thinking of.

@Jacob – I think the Capo is the same as Plato's philosopher king, he is an intellectual warrior. In modern society people's developments tend to directed into one area only so we have nerds who have brains but no body strength and we have jocks who are strong but can't add or subtract. I the the Capo as being Caesarian, wise and courageous.

@Saladin and Michael, I used to be an antisemite of the Leon de Poncins or "Maurice Pinay" variety but have moved away from that. I've met many Orthodox Jews who share the same values I do and have no wish to partake in worldly affairs. The bad Judaic-derived movements that have so messed the world up (Marxism, Zionism, Freudianism etc) all seem to derive from the Jewish heretic Benedict de Spinoza. Who Spinoza's masters and teachers were I can not say but I think ultimately there is a conspiracy at work over the past several hundred years and it is Satanic literally.

Pickman on 2013-07-31 at 18:19 said:

Cologero, not too long ago if I recall, you were very skeptical about the whole symbolism and outward expression of the cryptocracy (or conspiracies and the occult war) through media outlets. Even going so far as deriding those who pointed out these topics. They constantly leave clues everywhere and this is no joke reducible to some "spooky youtube video". It wouldn't be a stretch to assume fully that what sci-fi and popular fantasy/horror fiction of today is a prelude in preparation for fact tomorrow (both Wells and Huxleys later works prove this correctly).

I've read Hoffman's erudite analysis on these topics (especially in advertising etc). He only scratch's the surface as only one man can. Other sites have picked up on it, but have not subjected

the vast data accumulated into a scholarly treatise aka, Hoffman. This task is laid out for those interested in exposing the tactics of the media cryptocracy or whatever name one wishes to place on the beast.

Pickman on 2013-07-31 at 18:49 said:

For those interested in M.Hoffman's "Secret Societies and Psychological Warfare" it can be viewed here: downloads.umu.nu/Books/Michael.A.Hoffman.II-Secret.Societies.And.Psychological.Warfare.1992.pdf, I'd also recommend buying it on paperback to support the author.

"Who then is the modern man? He is a mind-bombed patsy who gets his marching orders from "twilight language" key words sprinkled throughout "his" news and current events. Even as he dances to the tune of the elite managers of human behavior, he scoffs with great derision at the idea of the existence and operation of a technology of mass mind control emanating from the media and government. Modern man is the ideal hypnotic subject: puffed up on the idea that he is the crown of creation, he vehemently denies the power of the hypnotist's control over him, even as his head bobs up and down on a string." – M.H.

Word's of wisdom.

Ash on 2013-08-01 at 18:57 said:

This article reminded me on your comments about an anti-Traditional elite. It appears that the new anti-porn laws in the UK will be blocking other things too, like websites depicting violence, smoking, and what I found most interesting, "esoteric materials".

Now I'm a bit doubtful as to whether whoever inserted that phrase was specifically thinking of the works of Guenon (I would imagine that they meant in the sense of "hidden"), but I find it rather disconcerting that this was specifically included, particularly with the lack of definition. I can see how the others might fall in under the nanny state's gaze, but to block access to "esoteric materials"? Perhaps something to keep an eye on. It is harder to fight a hidden enemy than an open one, and to do battle when you have forgotten there is an enemy at all is nigh impossible.

http://www.huffingtonpost.com/2013/07/29/uk-internet-filter-block-more-than-porn_n_3670771.html?utm_hp_ref=world

White Rabbit on 2015-07-12 at 07:54 said:

I think you're being unfair to the bums. We can probably assume they don't imagine themselves to be fine chefs.

4.24 The Pristine Theology

I had a dream two nights ago. A voice was giving me great wisdom. It said it was a blessing to have access to such wisdom while I was sleeping and that I should share it. I could barely wait to wake up so I could write it all down. When I awoke, I grabbed a pen, but there was nothing there to write about. So I consulted the Akashic record, but it was all pixelated, and this is all I could make out.

Take it as a warning to remain awake when receiving revelations from the Divine Mind.

Synarchy There are a great many theories about the proper socio-political organization of societies. However, only those based in reality, viz., spiritual reality, are worth pursuing, and not the various factitious or artificial constructions. Specifically, there is a spiritual authority, a political power, and economic activity, hierarchically arranged. Within this arrangement, there are still very many possible variations. The word for this arrangement is Synarchy. Of course, authority must be intelligent and power just. There is no escape from this system. The alternate is an ersatz version of each level.

Some quick examples. In the Middle Ages, there was the Peace and Truce of God. This limited the political powers from tramping on the common people, otherwise they accept no limits. In Europe, there was the ideal of the gentleman. To the extent they themselves aspired to that ideal, the money powers limited themselves to fair play. Without it, they admit no limits to the pursuit of wealth.

The Perennial Philosophy It is false that the West has no authentic tradition, and **Rene Guenon** admits it in his study of Hindu Doctrine. This has gone under the name of *prisca theologia* (pristine theology) or perennial philosophy. Following Ficino, **Valentin Tomberg** adheres to

the same tradition as we indicated three years ago in *Heart of the West*⁴². What Tomberg meant is that he is following the Hermetic tradition in the West.

Nevertheless, there are still those who believe that the most important question is whether or not Tomberg remained an Anthroposophist. Hence, they call Tomberg a "Platonist", even though Plato was but one link in that chain, since that is a fundamental anthroposophic category.

Continuity of Tradition Guenon was not the first to deny the continuity of the Western tradition, since Ficino's timeline was debunked a few centuries ago through textual criticism. However, a Tradition is not simply a continuity of texts. In Ficino's view, the Pristine Theology derived from the Divine Mind, not what someone wrote previously.

Fortunately, Tomberg has given us a complete description of how a revelation becomes gnosis and finally a book. Textual criticism is irrelevant in this case; all that matters is the revelation and how well it is expressed. Of course, you would have to learn to think with your heart rather than with your head.

Now a theologian as sophisticated as **Vladimir Solovyov** claims that Christian dogma itself can be traced back to Egyptian Hermetism. Since he never wrote his promised defense of that idea, probably because it was so obvious to him, an intelligent man today may want to take on that task now.

Arcana and Symbols Although Guenon is of utmost importance for demonstrating the universal nature of symbols, Tomberg has given us an even deeper understanding of symbolism. Saying that a symbol "is" really "that", is a start, but it is quite insufficient. Otherwise, we would be in the position of the person who gave me, in a seminar on Meditations on the Tarot, the signs in an airport as examples of symbols. They are univocal,

⁴²<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=1256>

but there is no value to meditating on a no smoking sign or the sign in front of the men's restroom.

Guenon often mentioned the symbol of the two birds in the fig tree, one silent, the other active. One could easily relate that to the transcendent self, observing the activities of the ego. But that gets you nowhere. Instead, you should meditate carefully on the entire symbol, drawing out its full import. That makes it an Arcanum, not just a symbol.

The Center is Everywhere **Miguel Serrano** mentions this quote from **Carl Jung** from one of their meetings (although Jung spoke it in Latin):

The Self is a circle whose center is everywhere and whose circumference is nowhere.

Surprisingly, Serrano did not catch the allusion. This description was applied to God by **Alain de Lille** and, I believe, **Nicholas Cusanus**. So Jung is implying that the Self is God. Of course, this is no surprise, since Serrano then quotes Jung as saying that this Self is Christ, at least for Western man, since

[Christ is] the archetype of the hero, representing man's highest aspiration. All this is very mysterious and at times frightening.

Nevertheless, that is the path to the Self and Jesus "meek and mild" will not get you there.

Theology of the Body I have a 700+ page book on the theology of the body by Pope, now Saint, **John Paul II**. I believe that a 700 page book on the theology of the soul would have been more appropriate, since there is very little knowledge of the soul today. Nevertheless, I gave the book a try. Wishing to read instead the executive summary, I discovered that there is a cottage industry offering classes on that book, for a price of course.

One of first things I found out is that it is not sinful for a man to have anal intercourse with his wife as long as he then ejaculates in her vagina. My first reaction was, why would anyone want to do that, but I realized people were paying money to learn such things. So I put the book down.

Buddhist Sex Many years ago, I was still under Guenon's influence on this issue and decided it was necessary to be initiated into a Tradition. I was then initiated into Tibetan Buddhism. So for many years I practiced Tibetan and Zen meditation, chanted the *Heart Sutra*, stared at Thangkas, and so on. I am not recommending it, because the caliber is very low, even though I heard countless times how the aspiring Buddhists had passed beyond the religion of their ancestors that they had learned in childhood. Nevertheless, the parallels are there, as might be expected if the various traditions do indeed represent some common Tradition.

First of all, there are "venial" and "mortal" sins. The former can be fixed by an act of purification, but the latter requires a retaking of one's vows publicly. As an example of a mortal sin (one of just four), there is this:

engaging in sexual misconduct, that is, engaging in sexual activities with another's husband or wife, or using the mouth or anus of one's own husband or wife.

If you read quaint old books, you will recognize these activities as adultery and sodomy. So this is a stricter standard than even JP II and may explain my prudishness. This is the one sentence version of the theology of the body, although if you look, and not even very hard, you will find a lot of words to mitigate the force of that transgression.

For the record, the other transgressions are murder, stealing something of value, and claiming to be enlightened when you are not. No commentary is necessary.

Posted on 2014-06-19 by Cologero

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Kimiwoux on 2014-06-19 at 13:16 said:

Are there examples of Synarchy in older societies? I don't believe the US is a Synarchy. I guess that's an understatement. Maybe the period of the Knights Templar?

I'm starting to learn through a gnostic tradition that these sexual codes were important. It's changed the way I view sex and life. This was a really good post. Glad I squadalahed over here.

Tomas Diaz on 2014-06-19 at 16:34 said:

I would hope that one not understand the book from the cottage industry. Men like Christopher West are, more slowly than some would like, being discredited as an interpreter of the Pope's work. John Paul's own title for the catechesis being "Man and Woman He Created Them" – it is a theology of sexuality, understood in the most spiritual sense, and the ethics that West and others seek to promote out of it are contrary to the Pope's intention.

John Paul does not discuss the merits or lack thereof of sodomy. He assumed it be obvious sin.

Cologero on 2014-06-19 at 17:29 said:

Thanks for pointing out, Mr. Diaz, that the original work cannot be judged by the commentaries. I was being a little satirical and meant no disrespect to Pope John Paul II.

Synodius on 2014-06-19 at 20:17 said:

Some historical background on JP II's ideas in his TOB

http://www.traditioninaction.org/HotTopics/f024ht_Hildebrand_Engel.htm

Primary and secondary ends of marriage and hierarchy between these is an interesting topic and I feel like the traditional focus on procreation needed to be balanced, it is wierd to give primacy to lower, physical reasons.

Dalai Lama seems to go with the flow these days...

<http://abcnews.go.com/Politics/dalai-lama-says-he-supports-gay-marriage/blogEntry?id=22834522>

Cologero on 2014-06-20 at 00:23 said:

I agree, Synodius, that some balance is necessary. Marriage itself is more than procreation.

Fr. Ripperger's sermons on Marriage⁴³ and Women and the Natural Order⁴⁴ may be of interest. There, he is claiming that the primary end of marriage is the salvation of each others' souls. That is interesting from the exoteric point of view.

The esoteric view builds on that notion through the ideal of courtly love or Mouravieff's polar beings. However, those relations do not necessarily involve physical sexual relations. Miguel Serrano's Test⁴⁵ is instructive in that regard.

CaseyAnn on 2014-06-20 at 10:50 said:

I'm glad to be informed of this. And thank you, Synodius, for linking to Tradition in Action as a counterpoint to the research I did after reading this last night. Alice von Hildebrand critiques West's work very seriously⁴⁶. But (at least I think) one should always check TIA.

"is Christ, at least for Western man" ...

Cologero, I'm sorry to say that I will be taking Gornahoor off my blogroll. At this point I'm now in an area where I can go to the Tridentine Mass and am much more conscious of the Tradition of the Church, servitude to Our Lady and so forth. While I acknowledge the noble intentions here (and have personally defended them against fellow traditionalist Catholics) and the efficacy of the pre-Christian religions, I believe one is bound to Christ explicitly when one hears the true religion proclaimed.

Que Dieu vous bénisse.

Cologero on 2014-06-23 at 10:57 said:

Thanks, Casey Ann, for your support and defense. You are free to make any choices you prefer. I have mentioned on more than one occasion that Gornahoor is optional and is not necessary. Nevertheless, some people respond better to it than more rigid exoteric approaches; it is based on valid traditions and the sources are documented.

I wish to remind careful readers that quoting an author is not tantamount to endorsing all their opinions. Certain messages are intended for some readers rather than others; everything must be read as a whole. For example, the Jung quote was intended to evoke "putting on the mind of Christ". That is the true religion.

I should also remind readers not to confuse specific devotions with the whole of Tradition. For example, "servitude to Our Lady" is neither a dogma nor a Tradition (in our sense), but rather a devotion used by certain orders. It is not binding on all.

⁴³<http://www.sensustraditionis.org/webaudio/Marriage/Marriage.mp3>

⁴⁴<http://www.sensustraditionis.org/webaudio/Sermons/KC/Disk%201/Women.mp3>

⁴⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=70>

⁴⁶<http://www.catholicnewsagency.com/document.php?n=999>

CaseyAnn on 2014-06-23 at 12:57 said:

Thank you, Cologero. I should have been more careful in using "Tradition" here; I actually meant that specifically in reference to the Church, which would include devotion to Our Lady. I do think this St. Louis de Montfort's take on this is very important, however, so I'll leave you all with it: "He who has not Mary for his Mother has not God for his Father."

4.25 Turning Back from the Gates of Hell

Your thoughts are burdened because you are influenced by the thoughts of your fellow men. Pray to the Lord that He might take this burden from you. These are the thoughts of others which differ from yours. They have their plan, and their plan is to attack you with their thoughts. Instead of letting go, you have allowed yourself to become part of their plan, so of course you suffer. Had you ignored the attack, you would have kept your peace.

Our Thoughts Determine Our Lives, ELDER THADDEUS OF
VITOVNICA

By ignoring Thaddeus' warning, I succumbed to various malignant influences. Therefore, I need this rant in order to purge myself. I was intending to review the movie *As Above, So Below*⁴⁷, but I couldn't get to it last night. As far as I can tell from the trailers, some explorers discover the gate to Hell far below the streets of Paris and they find it terrifying. My personal experience is that *the gate to Hell is quite easy to find and most people, not only are not fearful, but are attracted to it.*

Belief and Knowledge

In a given person a belief system is that conscious/unconscious set of basic beliefs, assumptions, axioms, biases/prejudices, models,

⁴⁷<http://www.asabovesobelowmovie.com/>

simulations which determine, at a given instant, decisions, actions, thoughts, feelings, motives and the sense of the real and the true.

Simulations of God, JOHN C. LILLY, M.D

Nearly all people regard knowing as something like looking. That is, they see something out there right now and claim to know it. In other words, the sense impressions create an image which we “know”, somewhat in the way that animals know.

This position is called “naïve realism” and it is nearly impossible to eradicate in people. Nevertheless, the path to esoterism requires the reverse of this mistake so that knowing is grasped as going from inside out. That is, when I know something in the world, I am actually intuiting its essence, or idea, in the Divine Mind.

That is a simple idea, but the principle applies to more complex ideas. Now, ideas are hierarchical, each level encompassing more and more of reality from a higher level. There is a philosophical theory called “holism” that postulates that more complex wholes evolve from simpler forms. The reverse is actually the case: more complex wholes create the simpler. Angelic intelligences are likewise hierarchical, with the higher orders grasping larger wholes.

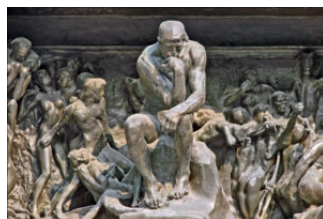


Figure 4.1: Thinker at the Gates of Hell

As explained in the recent discussion of Hermann Keyserling⁴⁸, we can relate higher understanding to meaning. I wrote,

meaning is always in reference to a Self, not in the object. The exterior world takes on quite a different feeling once it is realized the extent that the Self understands it and invests it with meaning.

⁴⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=7437>

Notice that meaning comes with understanding; through misunderstanding, the world is experienced as meaningless. But that is intolerable. That is why ordinary man (hylic man and psychic man), holds onto a belief system, as Dr. Lilly describes. The effect is that the world is misunderstood and its true meaning is obscured in a web of prejudices, etc., that are merely projections of his own thoughts.

Now, if you combine that with the naive realism of such men, you can see what happens. Believing he is experiencing a true picture of the world out there right now, he also experiences the very belief system he projected as similarly out there in the world. He is then completely so convinced that he understands the world objectively, that it is impossible to reach him with true knowledge.

The Doctor and her Dogs I recently heard from a female physician from the Midwest who read my bibliophile post and was motivated to purchase *Meditations on the Tarot*. We had a brief email exchange. Clearly she is a very intelligent woman. She majored in chemistry and became a physician, yet found time to study world religions. She even read **Meister Eckhart**. I recommended the *Philokalia*, which she had heard of. Yet there was not much depth to her spirituality; I got the impression that, for her, the idea of reading such books was more important than actually understanding them.

Immediately, she turned to politics, explaining that she was a diehard liberal democrat and wanted to know my political views. A red flag went up. I know the type; the liberal belief system is so entrenched that she had no intention of pursuing a mutually intelligible conversation. Her goal was simply to dismiss me. I've noticed that, in such types, a spiritual emptiness is replaced with political action. There is a deep Manichean attitude replete with saints and sinners; for them, no conversation with the unsaved is possible, just a desire for their annihilation. How else can they explain how the actual world bears such scant resemblance to their

entrenched beliefs?

Clearly, my own political opinions are virtually absent in the political dynamics in the USA; that is why I stopped writing on that topic. Nevertheless, hoping for the best, I gave her a detailed response. I explained that the spiritual has priority over the political, a position she associated with the Taliban. Obviously, the political is her simulation of god since every other value is secondary to it. She failed to grasp any subtleties, and accused me of being a republican, God forbid. Apparently in her understanding, beyond the liberal democrats there can only be an undifferentiated mass of republicans. She told me that democrats are for the "little guy", even though little guys of European descent oppose them. Views opposite to hers are "repugnant", even though they are the teachings of her Catholic faith; and she was glad to live in a democracy, even though decisions are often made by the judiciary and the deep state⁴⁹.

I don't want to litigate those claims here, but just to point out how predictable her comments were, certainly not indicative of any deep thought that her intelligence and education make her capable of. The real point is to demonstrate in a concrete way the psychic effects of naive realism. In a quite literal way there is an "*animal faith*" (George Santayana's words) in such a view that makes it seem simply too obvious to question.

Interim Conclusion There can be no science of particulars, so I am not generalizing from one person to a more universal critique. There are those who may arrive at views similar to the Doctor's in a more intelligent way and I have no gripe with them.

There is more material to the rant ... the world's supply of outrage is apparently inexhaustible. But that is for another day.

Posted on 2014-09-14 by Cologero

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⁴⁹<http://billmoyers.com/2014/02/21/anatomy-of-the-deep-state/>

Jacob on 2014-09-14 at 23:11 said:

"That is, when I know something in the world, I am actually intuiting its essence, or idea, in the Divine Mind."

One might say "all knowledge is self-knowledge"? Interesting, I've never actually questioned my personal epistemology before.

Cologero on 2014-09-14 at 23:48 said:

Exactly, Jacob, you need to understand how you know what you know. "All knowledge" may be going too far. There is your ordinary direct knowledge of sensory things, e.g., "the sun is shining". There is discursive knowledge you learn from education, e.g., history class. There is "how to" knowledge you use all day long. Even from the esoteric point of view, there is more. Of course, there is self-knowledge, i.e., the knowledge of the microcosm. Then there is knowledge of cosmology, i.e., knowledge of the macrocosm. Ultimately, the goal is knowledge of God.

scardanelli on 2014-09-15 at 09:39 said:

Jacob,

It is useful to keep in mind the French words *savoir* and *connaître*. Both mean "to know," yet they are different kinds of knowing. We do not have the distinction in English unfortunately. The former is purely external and acquired, such as that which we read in a book. The latter is a higher form of knowing, one might say an intuitive knowing. For our purposes, we might call it *gnosis*.

External knowledge is purely of this world, yet *gnosis* transcends this world. Thus an intellectual that reads widely and believes he "knows" something is still involving himself with external knowledge, unless and until this external knowledge provides a stimulus to look within. This, of course, has been repeated many times by Cologero. Yet we are slow wake sometimes, slow to remember...myself included.

X,

"I must say that even though I dislike some of your attitudes, but you really have something genuinely noble within"

...Perhaps that is the case with all of us...

scardanelli on 2014-09-15 at 09:42 said:

Note: I just realized that my last comment might be taken inappropriately. What I intended was that we all have something noble within, yet struggle with our "attitudes."

4.26 Prominent Attorney Marries Actor

Ethics is the science of determining which ends man should achieve and technics is science of creating the means to achieve those ends. People act to achieve some good, usually without any deep consideration about those goods. Contemporary thought, both religious and non-religious, has relegated ethics to a corner of human life.

However, if metaphysics answers the question “who am I?”, then ethics supplies the answer to, “who should I become?” The general answer is that the good is to actualize one’s own nature. Here ethics is understood as all-encompassing and the opposite of mere moralizing. In other words, man is a compound of actuality and potential, and the task is to actualize all his potentials. Most people have a basic idea of this, for example, as revealed in the phrase “be all you can be.” People will say of someone that he is not living up to his potential, and so on.

A fundamental metaphysical principle is that only something already real can actualize a potential. In man’s case, the Real I, as the intelligence of the being, can bring about that process via his true will. The goodness, then, of a man or a woman consists in how close he or she actualizes the Absolute Man or Absolute Woman.

Unfortunately, the mass of men have no means to judge that. That is why sports are so popular. There is no debate about who the best golfers or footballers are. Similarly, in entertainment, we know who the most attractive personalities are. Other easily judged categories are wealth, power, and finally popularity, even if one is popular just for being popular. So, it is easy to conclude that one should actualize athletic prowess, beauty, power, or riches.

Clearly, these cannot represent the meaning of life, since they depend on external factors, not from one’s own specific being. But the idea of an absolute man or woman is far from easy to grasp, not to mention that it cuts against the general commitment to egalitarianism in the modern

world.

For the few interested in that path, two questions arise:

1. How do I know my nature?
2. How do I actualize it?

These are intimately related since they represent knowing and being, which amount to the same thing. Esoteric psychology is the study of the soul, not empirically, but interiorly through direct observation. The more one knows about himself, the more being he will have. (The actual details will not be discussed here.)

Before proposing what the results may be, there are other competing notions for the ideal man or woman.

Better Living Through Chemistry In researching a recent post, I listened to a business consultant interviewed by a popular radio personality. The consultant's point of view was that actions should be taken that align with the "hard-wiring" of the brain. That is, the brain will respond by producing certain chemicals, specifically oxytocin, that makes us "feel good."

The interviewer agreed, and spoke about how good he felt following a demonstration, because people picked up the trash after themselves. Now, I'll agree that it is a moral good not to litter, but not because it produces certain brain chemicals. I'll remind readers about the serial killer, Ted Bundy, who told one of his victims how good it would feel to kill her.

Sexual Attraction The actor John Cusack recently complained that in Hollywood, an actress is over the hill at 29. That assumes that American film is an art form, in which acting ability is foremost. Actually, the women in most films are there to represent sexual attraction, and the age

range of about 22 to 29 is the peak of that, for obvious reasons. So this sounds like a futile path for the absolute woman.

I recall years ago as a boy, that a nun told us that in heaven (or perhaps at the resurrection?) we would have bodies around the age 25, since that is the best age, physically speaking. I have never read that anywhere else, but I doubt she just made it up.

The Dalai Lama In earlier times, I had a rather romantic attachment to Tibet. Tibet was patriarchal, hierarchical, theocratic, autocratic, ancient, and traditional. There was occult knowledge and magical practices. There was the literature of travels through Tibet, the mythical Shambhala, and telepathic gurus.

My initiation and studies were very strict. I met many people who boasted to me that they had overcome their Christian religious upbringing. However, the requirements for the sangha were just as strict: no killing, no stealing, no lying, and no unnatural sex acts, as they are called in the West.

So it seems to me that the Fourteenth Dalai Lama has turned himself into a caricature of a holy man. He rejects traditional Tibet and would convert it to a Euro-style parliament system, even communistic, which he considers morally superior. He supports all the correct causes of the Left. It is difficult to see what Buddhism has to do with it.

Has he ever told an audience that their cravings cause their problems, they will likely be reborn as an insect, and their pet dogs are heading for the hell realms? I'm sure he never read *The Doctrine of Awakening*.

George Clooney For many people, and for almost all women, George Clooney represents the ideal man. Handsome, suave, debonair, popular, wealthy, and articulate, he and the Dalai Lama support the same causes. However, Mr. Clooney is not at all religious, so his views must have come to him by some other means. If being fashionably liberal is your goal, just

follow Mr. Clooney and dispense with the years of Buddhist meditation practice.

Mr. Clooney is the cosmopolitan man of today. He owns homes in the USA, Mexico, and Italy. He recently married a British woman from a prominent Lebanese family and the wedding was held in Rome. Her father is a Druze and her mother a Sunni Muslim. Just as Mr. Clooney is sanctified by his desire to end world hunger, the new Mrs. Clooney has her own high credentials. She is not an ambulance chaser, nor a sleazy corporate lawyer, but rather a “human rights” attorney.

Now, in times past, the idea of marrying an actor would have been considered a low-brow affair, but the ideals of feminine hypergamy have apparently changed.

The Warrior Ideal In the olden days, the warrior, particularly if he was also a political leader, was glorified. This was embodied in the ideal of the nine worthies⁵⁰. There are no current figures that approach that ideal, and more recent candidates are now too outré to extend the list to include three modern worthies. Perhaps Joan of Arc can fit in somehow. The worthies represent the state of the fallen world, in which it is necessary to toil and do battle against evil.

The Spiritual Ideal The highest European ideals before the modern era are certainly the Virgin Mary and Jesus. Without intending to deny more popular notions, from an esoteric point of view, they represent the two ideals we have already discussed.

- The Virgin Mary, free from sin, is our model of the Primordial State
- Jesus, as true God and true man, represents *theosis*, i.e., the raising of the human nature to the divine.

⁵⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=331>

Now whereas those two figures were born that way, we have to actualize those states. Along with the worthies, these are the three possibilities open to us, as best suit our own natures.

Posted on 2014-10-03 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2014-10-03 at 10:18 said:

You won't be seeing any great warriors glorified in the news, because we don't have any to report on. We don't even have American pilots any more, bursting through the sky in amazing machines going six thousand miles and hour. The American myth of the renegade fighter pilot is found in many of our greatest films. But now our pilots just sit in air conditioned rooms in Kansas and direct computers on a screen.

ISIS magazines are full of warriors; in one sense they are savvy traditionalists, while in another sense trying to immanentize the Eschaton.

Clayton on 2014-10-03 at 10:19 said:

So now you are superior to the Dalai Lama. So your supposed Gnosis sure has not led to any inflation of your own self worth.

Cologero on 2014-10-03 at 12:44 said:

If you read carefully, Clayton, I was referring to his social views which are totally Western and not representative of—and actually contrary to—any Tibetan tradition. Furthermore, those views owe nothing to the Buddhist tradition, since they are perfectly acceptable to those without any spiritual orientation at all. As an example of a contrary teaching, I pointed to sodomy, which, in his lineage, causes you to “lose the vow from the root”, so you need a new initiation; he seems to have backed off from that. He also plans to dismantle the Tibetan social system if he gets the chance, he wants to abolish the dalai lama chain, and he plans to reincarnate as an attractive woman.

Then I mentioned some Tibetan teachings about which he is pretty much silent. Perhaps he has some esoteric reason for this. The point is, Clayton, that if you want to be an interesting and informed disputant, you would have addressed these **specific** points. None of those points you mentioned appears in the text. But thanks for trying.

rhondda9 on 2014-10-03 at 17:14 said:

I have a soft spot for the Dali Lama. He seemed to exude joy. However, one day when a reporter asked him what he thought of all the westerners getting into Buddhism, he said that he thought they should look to their own traditions. I was quite taken aback and then realized how little I knew about Western Traditions. It was the beginning of the way home.

Clayton on 2014-10-03 at 18:50 said:

I agree with you that he has moved away from some of these “traditional” notions which according to you automatically reduces him to a “caricature of a Holy Man” so apparently only those values which you hold in high esteem entitle one to Holiness. I see how you can disagree with a person’s political views, but one’s political views are in no way indicative of the degree of spirituality or holiness one has attained.

Cologero on 2014-10-03 at 19:11 said:

You can continue to be mean-spirited, Clayton, but it is clouding your judgment. Who says I disagree with his politics? I, too, am for world peace, the end to hunger, a clean environment, and economic justice (although the Fourteenth Dalai Lama prefers communism). But holding such views does not require any particular spiritual transformation. If you were a deeper thinker, Clayton, you would have addressed the core issue. Why has the Dalai Lama abandoned traditional notions and adopted Western values in their stead? If Western values are superior, then who needs him? Or is he just playing a role that Westerners expect of a holy man, while keeping deeper teachings hidden?

Ash on 2014-10-04 at 00:23 said:

I’ve just been re-reading *Ride the Tiger*. Evola discusses exactly this, the problem of having what are essentially multiple different personalities within the psyche. I think this multiplicity of tendencies is something I’ve always known about myself, but my introspection at this time is focusing on identifying my own “central” tendency. The actor as a symbol of the human in their most chaotic state is something completely counter to most people today. Funnily enough, I was just watching something this evening about Reagan, and they mentioned that his acting career was counted against him during his run for governor.

Avery: Strelkov, the Russian military adventurer, seems to be gaining warrior-hero status in his country. Whatever the true nature of the current Russian state, he does seem to believe that he is fighting for an imperial idea.

August on 2014-10-07 at 09:59 said:

It’s certainly hard to know what to make of those like the Dalai Lama when one learns some of their views... Perhaps they follow the old precept of not disturbing the laity, avoiding public discussion of ideas that go against the current of the times, and making do within the

narrow confines of modern discourse, maybe working invisibly somehow. Since I cannot know for sure, I'll be gracious.

In other news, one of your ebola sufferers over there is supposedly a 'tulkus', one Ashoka Mukpo (see Wikipedia).

4.27 SOS Save Our Souls

Every unhappy family is unhappy in its own way.

Anna Karenina

The international distress signal is dot dot dot dash dash dash dot dot dot, or SOS for short. It is easy to remember as “Save our ship” or “Save our souls”. In the latter case, there should be many more such signals.

At least SOS is organic, and Morse code adepts could identify the sender based on his style. 911, as the emergency number, is not so; the best I could come up with is ZAB, but it may never catch on. It is not even international. Europeans have BAD instead.

Apart from the rare cases of those predestined to righteousness, most people seek out a spiritual path following a boundary situation or an inner collapse from suffering, guilt, illness, anxiety, despair, and the like. The majority of them will gravitate to an exoteric religion or its equivalent. They want an easy way to save their souls from that collapse. Moreover, they are attracted to promises of a pretty wife or rich husband, a nice car, a better job, perfect health, etc.

Those who are naturally blessed with such things are seldom so motivated. Or else they treat their spirituality as if it were a pretty ornament, to add some “style” to their characters. Their spirituality is “bought and paid for”; they pay for a shaman, a Jungian analyst, a weekend seminar, a course on the “law of attraction”, and so on. Unfortunately, what they want cannot be bought.

Escapism Those who choose a path are often accused of “escapism”. Clearly, when the house is on fire, is not escape a sound instinct? Real escapism is pretending the danger does not exist. Such people think that the fire is still far away, or there will always be time later on.

The Buddha famously came to the realization that all life is suffering. He therefore gave up his family, his throne, his wealth, his power in order to escape from that suffering. What did he see that few in his position can see? Nothing significant has changed.

Moment of Decision An esoteric path, unlike an exoteric path, promises something different. There is an effort required to “save one’s soul”. This means that the crucifixion and descent into hell comes before resurrection. For them, salvation and liberation is achieved by developing a Real Self, Consciousness, and a True Will. That has little appeal because people assume they already have those things.

Hermetists are indistinguishable⁵¹ by sight. That is why they used to pose as horse traders or street performers, etc. Anything to give them cover, and freedom of movement, for their real task. They will appear, seemingly randomly, at various times and places. Those who truly desire an esoteric path will seize on those opportunities, since they are rare and hard to find. Yet most men are stragglers. They dream of such a path, yet refuse to actually enter on the Way. They have a consumer mentality and believe that such paths will always be available to them, since the supermarkets have an abundance of milk and iPhones are everywhere.

- Cult: easy to find, hard to leave.
- Esoteric way: hard to find, easy to leave

⁵¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=793>

Signs of the Times There is still time left until we hit bottom. As of 2014 AD we are in the seventh circle of hell. The signs can be recognized from the following stages. What was forbidden gets tolerated. Then it becomes normalized. Finally, it is considered praiseworthy. Look it up.

Suicide is gaining respectability. Those in favor of it desire access to an effective and pain free biochemical death. Yet those who oppose capital punishment claim such a death is not possible, so it is cruel and unusual punishment. Based on that alone, you might suppose that the Venn diagram for pro-suicide and anti-capital punishment activists would not intersect. However, I suspect that they very nearly coincide.

Blasphemers and atheists sell a lot of books.

Usurers make the big money. For them, money is no longer a medium of exchange of products, but the product itself. It would be like selling an “inch”, the inch of what does not matter.

The latest craze is the legalization of marijuana, particularly among the best and the brightest. I suppose that 50,000 years of evolution have blessed them with such large brains, that they now exercise the option not to use them.

Many women claim that their dog, or dogs, is her best friend. She is absolutely convinced that the dog understands her. Yet she is alone and single because her husband or boyfriend evidently did not understand her.

Anti-Christian is code word for anti-European, since it ignores and denies 1500 years of High Culture. Those who would destroy a people, do so by effacing their history.

Christianity is esoteric paganism. It does not destroy previous traditions, but incorporates them into a larger whole. Yet paganism survives, e.g., in images of God as a being rather than Being. This image is like Zeus and Hera looking over the human race and arbitrarily interfering in events from time to time, picking winners and losers. That is idolatry. You can remove statues and icons from so-called churches, but as long

as there is an image of God in your mind, that is still idolatry from the esoteric perspective.

Happy families are all alike.

Posted on 2014-11-07 by Cologero

* * *

Wayne Ferguson on 2014-11-07 at 08:43 said:

"Suicide is gaining respectability. Those in favor of it desire access to an effective and pain free biochemical death. Yet those who oppose capital punishment claim such a death is not possible, so it is cruel and unusual punishment. Based on that alone, you might suppose that the Venn diagram for pro-suicide and anti-capital punishment activists would not intersect. However, I suspect that they very nearly coincide." But are there not important distinctions to be drawn between Brittany Maynard (the young woman in the news this past week) and an inmate on death row? Is it really so strange that the same physical procedure might be judged humane in one case but not in the other?

Cologero on 2014-11-07 at 08:49 said:

Wayne, I was not opening up a debate about capital punishment and suicide. That paragraph is intended to be understood in the context of Dante's seventh circle of hell. BTW, I do think it is really strange.

Cologero on 2014-11-07 at 09:21 said:

Just to provide some context that I left out but had in the back of my mind. Several months ago a biochemical execution in Oklahoma went horribly wrong. That was hardly humane. Bracketing out the question of the man's guilt and the inhumanity of his crime, the US constitution prohibits cruel punishments. I doubt euthanasia supporters would want the same sort of self-execution.

Wayne Ferguson on 2014-11-07 at 09:23 said:

I'm not interested in debating these topics either—just pointing out that those critical of capital punishment and sympathetic to voluntary euthanasia may consistently hold both positions (the physical and psychological state of the person in question being decisive to the question of the humanness of the procedure as they see it).

With regard to the seventh circle of hell, it seems that the suicide deserves to suffer more than our contemporary “violent offenders” (assuming that the occupants of the middle circle are guilty of a more profound offense than those in the outer circle). Is that right?

[http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Inferno_\(Dante\)#Seventh_Circle_.28Violence.29](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Inferno_(Dante)#Seventh_Circle_.28Violence.29)

scardanelli on 2014-11-07 at 10:26 said:

“Christianity is esoteric paganism. It does not destroy previous traditions, but incorporates them into a larger whole.”

For those who may still doubt this or better, have yet to experience it, David Fideler's *Jesus Christ, Sun of God* is an excellent resource. I'm only halfway through it, but it has thus far quite solidly demonstrated the continuation of ancient tradition in early Christianity... in the conception of the Logos, in the parables of the feeding of the 5000 and the 153 fishes in the unbroken net, etc. Greek geometry, gematria, and the Pythagorean tradition are all present in the gospels, leading one to believe that the authors of the Gospels were well aware of it.

Wayne Ferguson on 2014-11-07 at 11:09 said:

Thanks for mentioning David Fideler's book—found a copy at Scribd:

<https://www.scribd.com/doc/230403079/Jesus-Christ-Sun-of-God-Ancient-Cosmology-and-Early-Christian-Symbolism-by-David-R-Fideler>

X on 2014-11-07 at 19:16 said:

SYOSF Save Your Own Soul First

White Rabbit on 2014-11-08 at 02:47 said:

I can see why many women believe dogs understand them. Today I met a retarded person. I was doing some public sloganeering and noticed he was responsive. I looked at him, and upon finding his speech incomprehensible and seeing a giant grin on his face realized that he was mentally handicapped. As I shook his hand and briefly lectured to him while he stood there with his beaming smile, I still felt that he was absorbing what I was saying as. Blank walls are fit for projection.

August on 2014-11-09 at 06:26 said:

That's a good point White Rabbit.

A close reading of posts here will reveal that most people are passive, subject to directed influences. If your sloganeering meets with little success, we can safely assume that those you cross paths with are already subordinated to some other more formidable impression.

Though unlike your retard they have a special blessing/curse, in that they can be convinced that they are entirely free and autonomous actors.

argusandphoenix on 2014-11-17 at 10:37 said:

This is sociology, but it's interesting and apt as an example of programming:

<http://fabiusmaximus.com/2014/11/16/castle-tv-plot-women-rights-feminism-72870/>

4.28 Scientific and Political Myths

It may some day happen that a traveler from the Greeklands will again lodge in this palace and read the book. Then he will talk of it among the Greeks, where there is great freedom of speech even about the gods themselves. Perhaps their wise men will know whether my complaint is right or whether the god could have defended himself if he had made an answer.

C S LEWIS, *Till We Have Faces*

The Flat Earth Whenever someone wants to dispute a hoary truth, he often mentions that the ancients believed that the earth was flat. Never mind that he can't identify who used to claim that or when they stopped, that accusation serves, in his mind, to discredit any other viewpoint they may have had.

An intelligent man would take another approach. He should be more concerned about all the ridiculous things he believes and work to purge them. This is the method of elenchus⁵².

The Sky God A common claim, often made on social media sites, is that Mr X can no longer believe in a "sky god" or an old man in the sky. Presumably Mr X assumes that is some brilliant insight. Of course,

⁵²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Socratic_method#Method

the true Traditional teaching is nothing of the sort and usually goes by the name “classical theism” in the West or “panentheism” in the East. Actually, if anyone believes that today, including but not limited to the Mormons, it is actually a relic from paganism, with its belief in Zeus.

Polytheism Another not uncommon claim in some circles is the alleged superiority of polytheism. On **Rene Guenon**’s principle that religious concepts can be re-expressed as metaphysical concepts, “polytheism” means “metaphysical pluralism”, a complete absurdity.

The other problem is that no pagan of intellectual merit was a polytheist in that sense. Celsus⁵³, for example, defended pagans against the accusation of polytheism by pointing to the Platonic understanding of God (i.e., a form of classical theism). Hermann Wirth’s research on the ancient Nordics⁵⁴ also confirms it.

Geocentrism Another often made claim is that the ancients used to believe that the Earth was the center of the universe. Thus, it is said, the heliocentric theory disoriented man, making him somehow anxious and insignificant. On the contrary, God, or Heaven, was regarded as the center of the universe (metaphysically understood) and the Earth was quite distant from that center. In its sublunar position, the Earth was in a bad place, subject to malevolent influences. Furthermore, Earth was closest to Hell, located deep at her center. This is quite a different picture.

The Future of Intelligence One use of intelligence, or rational thought, is to determine how best to achieve a goal. This is instrumental intelligence. True intelligence, however, is to know what goals to aim for.

Traditional anthropology says that man has a rational, animal, and vegetative soul. To be properly human is for the rational soul to domi-

⁵³<http://www.newadvent.org/cathen/03490a.htm>

⁵⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=3205>

nate the other two. In other words, the rational part of man should be determining goals. The function of intelligence is not simply to find the means to satisfy emotional and sensual needs. If science is the touchstone of rationality, can anyone truly live based solely on science? Who should you marry, what career should you follow, even which is the right side of the bed—these are all questions that no science experiment can answer.

Therefore, every behavior needs to be justified. If the only answer is “to satisfy a desire”, then intelligence is not truly involved in the decision.

Adamic Man Another Traditional principle is that science and metaphysics do not conflict. Any apparent conflict is because one or the other discipline has overstepped a line. The origin of man, as the rational animal, is one of those issues that seems to straddle that line. Biologically, man is an animal, metaphysically, man is rational, at least virtually. A viewpoint that is becoming more mainstream is that there existed hominids⁵⁵, i.e., animals that look human, but were not. Specifically, they have an animal and vegetative soul, but lack the rational soul that would make them fully human. At some point, somehow, some of them, or exactly two of them, were endowed with a rational soul.

The existence of these pre-Adamic hominids was also proposed by the Jewish physicist **Gerald Schroeder** in *The Science of God*. Even C S Lewis held a similar view, as he wrote in *The Problem of Pain*:

If by saying that man rose from brutality you mean simply that man is physically descended from animals, I have no objections. . . . For long centuries God perfected the animal form which was to become the vehicle of humanity and the image of Himself. He gave it hands whose thumbs could be applied to each of its fingers, and jaws and teeth and the throat capable of articulation, and a brain sufficiently complex to execute all material motions

⁵⁵<http://edwardfeser.blogspot.com/2014/12/knowning-ape-from-adam.html>

whereby rational thought is incarnated. The creature may have existed for ages in this state before it became man. . . . We do not know how many of these creatures God made, nor how long they continued in the Paradisal state.

Boris Mouravieff has revealed that the existence of pre-Adamic hominids is part of Orthodox esoteric teaching. Moreover, he claims that they still exist on the Earth, although they cannot be recognized by appearance alone.

Brain Use My son and I saw a commercial for the film *Lucy* in which the claim that we use only 10% of the brain was repeated. We pondered that and my son finally came up with the figure 98%, since there is not really much room for improvement in most people. Thinking about it again, I think he was much too generous.

Don't Tell Me What to Do A woman recently told me that the medieval Church was totalitarian, always telling people what to think and do. In the next breath, she told me she was confused about the current world and did not know what to think or do. Does anyone see the irony?

In point of fact, the medievals simply tried to determine rationally how best to live a human life based on its nature. As such, there can be intelligent discussion about it. The alternative is to live like an animal.

Dog on Bus There has been a story circulating in the news about a dog that allegedly gets on a bus alone in order to get to a dog park. People find it fascinating because it would seem to indicate some measure of the dog's human-like intelligence. On the contrary, the real lesson is how little intelligence it takes humans to get through their day. So if you are getting on the bus at the same stop and getting off at another, day after day, you have demonstrated the intelligence of a dog.

There is no denying that animals, and even plants, have intelligence. But that intelligence does not determine ends but merely achieves them. Matter itself is intelligent, since it follows certain laws, although science cannot say why that must be so.

Jesus as comic hero On a radio show recently, I heard someone (he may have been a priest) claim that Jesus allowed himself to be captured by the chief priest's soldiers when he could have rained down fire from Heaven to prevent it. I think he may be confusing Jesus with a Marvel comic superhero.

Speaking and Civilization I watched some of the Sunday talk shows this morning. They are continuing the sham claim that Charlie Hebdo is defending freedom of speech, following a week in which there were 54 arrests in France on hate speech charges.

Another sham, which no one cares to mention, is that a cartoon is not "speech" in any meaningful sense. In the epigram, Orual defends free speech by writing a book, based on rational thought. That way a reader can evaluate her case reasonably. There is no rationality in a cartoon: it appeals to emotion, not to intelligence.

No, the purpose of the cartoon is to silence the opposition, not to promote reasonable dialog. The new editor of Charlie Hebdo announced that their purpose was really to promote secularization or laicity, which is the absence of any religious interference in political affairs. Such views must simply be banned, not rationally, but by mockery.

Do not for a moment believe that laicity is merely a concept for bookish intellectuals or ribald cartoonists. It came at a steep price. France invented Terror as a political tactic. Vendee was brutally destroyed, much more brutally than the attack on *Charlie Hebdo*, to promote the same goals as those of the cartoonists. If history repeats itself, those who oppose the cartoonists may face a similar backlash.

Killing for Civilization It is also said that *Charlie Hebdo* represents the pinnacle of Western civilization. Of course not, Western civilization predated the Revolution for millennia; to not include all that is simply ignorant. The Revolution is anti-civilization. The talking heads are quite sure that vulgarity, secularism, sheer meanness, and irrationality represent the best of Western civilization. Can anyone seriously spend a day at the Louvre and then claim that the cartoon art is at the same level?

Now, I'm sure that many are willing to die for such values, actually anti-values. That is not the real issue. The fact that many are willing to kill for such anti-values is an evil impulse.

Race and Decadence When **Mahatma Gandhi** was asked, "What do you think of European civilization?" he famously replied: "I think it would be a good idea and they should try it."

Rene Guenon had a slightly different, but not necessarily incompatible, idea of race from Evola's. He claimed that every race at its origin had a Tradition. So what we call today the undeveloped races are, in his opinion, actually the decadent remains of once superior races. For example, the Ramayana describes a battle between the North and the darker races of the south which had a great civilization.

By this standard, the various white races of Europe, by rejecting Tradition, are in a process of slow decline and decadence. Hence, the response to Gandhi should be: "They did try it, but gave it up."

Posted on 2015-01-19 by Cologero

* * *

IA on 2015-01-19 at 08:24 said:

The European continent and culture will only survive as a distinct entity if they expell non-euros. Otherwise, France and others will become Lebanon.

Cologero on 2015-01-19 at 10:19 said:

IA, there is another way to look at it, something I learned from a Chinese colleague. China and India, which may appear monolithic to us from the outside, are really multicultural entities consisting of nations with various languages, customs, and histories. I was telling him of my trips to Europe and how different the countries are from each other. Given his Asian perspective, he looked puzzled and was unable to accept that. To him, "Europe" was a single entity, like China, and something that the various costumes, languages, cuisines, etc., could not efface. So it is instructive to see "Europe" the same way my Chinese colleague did.

So, in a sense, Europe already is, and has been, "Lebanon" for a few centuries. This is especially so once the spiritual unity of Europe was lost after the Middle Ages.

We too easily forget history. The Europeans killed some 60 million or more of their own people last century, and that was prior to the mass immigrations that began in the 60s. You may be proposing a treatment for a symptom, but I doubt that will cure the disease.

IA on 2015-01-19 at 11:31 said:

I appreciate your response but having lived in both India and China (and Europe) for many years I have a different viewpoint. The fact is, Europeans produced a very unique and valuable culture. A high-trust culture for one thing, unlike the Rest of the World. (Don't ingest anything from China.)

Islam is hell on earth. If you want to destroy civilization you can't do better than importing large numbers of blacks and Muslims. Its insane what's happening. Why you think Islam is going to cut down on violence I have no idea. There is nothing in its 1400 year history to suggest that. Just the opposite. They haven't done more damage because they lacked the weaponry. Same with blacks but they're unable to coordinate large-scale attacks. I think you need to separate wishful thinking from a dispassionate appraisal of cultural artifacts and human nature.

The Chinese and Indians especially loathe both blacks and Muslims having had intimate contact for hundreds of years. That prof. Gates character had his meltdown after returning from a trip to China. My guess is they treated him in a way he wasn't at all accustomed to and the scapegoat mechanism kicked in when he got back to the self-flagellant West.

Cheers.

David on 2015-01-19 at 18:21 said:

"The Christian ideal has not been tried and found wanting; it has been found difficult and left untried" – G. K. Chesterton

August on 2015-01-20 at 06:54 said:

"Islam is hell on earth."

Don't such judgements always depend on one's position in a given society?

It's noteworthy that many of those who have a problem with violence by Muslims will, in the same breath, fawn over the Hindus, as though they earned their place on the continent using kittens and flowers. And yet, the Hindu world is in many ways closed to them, unlike the Islamic – at least in principle, given the present situation.

Shall we ask the men of the East who recall their subjection, or today, the remaining natives of the Americas and Oceania, and the Africans, whether they think the European man violent? And if we find that they view him thus, shall IA accept the condemnation? And extend the same to, say, the Romans? What is good for the goose...

You live in the past IA, look at the modern West. Moaning about violence by Islamic militants, but no comment on the 60 million that Cologero raised, or the Vendée. Your style of criticism is poor because it opens your own to attack. You sound like a bourgeois pacifist afraid of those who would tear the comforts of egalitarian civilisation out from under his posterior. This is understandable, but should be seen for what it is.

IA on 2015-01-20 at 09:19 said:

Interesting comments, August, although you might be projecting your own feelings.

I really don't care if I'm on the "wrong side of history." I don't at all worry about what the West has done to other cultures. European men have contributed far more good than bad and have created the greatest culture in history. Black men cannot be European. Muslims don't want to, and are Arab anyway. But they do want our land and women.

I have no problem living in the past since the western past is both pagan and Christian and its this combination of blood, soil and God that define who I am.

Charlie Hebdo has always been anti-western. It is the anti-Louvre. Charlie Hebdo is the cancer while the great art in the Louvre is the cure. Modernism, the Enlightenment, is a disaster.

Your Muslims would love to get their hands on the Louvre and do a major Bamiyan. The blacks would just sell it all to the Chinese and Japanese.

Jacob on 2015-01-20 at 11:41 said:

I believe Cologero is saying the problem is much deeper than simply a "rising tide of color", IA. If you find a many dying in the middle of the road, chasing away the buzzards won't keep the man alive. He obviously is there for some other deeper problem.

I myself am a American, and have never been to Europe. However, from what I can see and what I have been told; The West is dying. Likely because it has, at least forgotten, it's inner life. Change this and I believe the rest should fall into place.

IA on 2015-01-20 at 12:25 said:

Jacob, I couldn't agree with you and Cologero more about changing inner life. If Europe or anywhere else becomes Muslim the State will kill you for a change of conscience. Or, if they

allow you to live, you will be a dhimmi. A second-class citizen. You need only look at what is happening now in Muslim lands to see this. You cannot change inner life if you are dead. Nor can you live an honorable life as a dhimmi.

Paulo on 2015-01-27 at 19:30 said:

"Vendee was brutally destroyed, much more brutally than the attack on Charlie Hebdo, to promote the same goals as those of the cartoonists. If history repeats itself, those who oppose the cartoonists may face a similar backlash."

Was the opposite Cologero, Vendee promote the opposite values of those cartoonists!

4.29 Theodicy and the Other Woman

Tis better to have loved and lost than never to have loved at all.

ALFRED LORD TENNYSON

God made us to show forth His goodness and to share with us
His everlasting happiness in heaven.

Baltimore Catechism #3

According to Scripture, the world created by God is "good". So why is there a question of evil? That is because the current world is not created by God, but by man. It is the world constituted by the knowledge of good and evil and hence death.

By the Principle of Plenitude⁵⁶, confirmed in the Catechism, existence itself is good. This may be counter-intuitive because we are accustomed to associate the good with sensual pleasure and nice emotions. Hence, pain, unsatisfied desires, and suffering must be evil. By this standard, then, life itself is suffering, since there is always desire. Keep in mind

⁵⁶<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7668>

that Buddha, as Josaphat⁵⁷, is considered a saint in the Christian church. Nevertheless, in the Medieval Tradition, the good of being surpasses the suffering of living.

The natural world is held in place by hunger, sex, and fear. The human race is motivated by the desire for things, the entanglements arising from following the sex instincts, and the reaction to fears of all types. This is borne out mightily by Hollywood films. It is an easy exercise to classify films based on their plots.

- Does the plot emphasize greed and conspicuous consumption?
- Is it about love and sex and all that derives from them?
- Does it reinforce common fears, or sometimes supernatural fears?

Of course, these motivating factors get resolved in the end, not by transcending them from a higher plane, but always on the natural plane.

The Other Woman In the Genesis story, creation is good until it is noticed that man is alone. Therefore, Eve is good for him and necessarily comes into being. Unfortunately, in the human world, the relationship between a man and a woman is as much a cause of pain and suffering as it is of joy. This duality is explored in the recent film, *The Other Woman*⁵⁸.

Kate is married to the handsome, wealthy, and successful Mark, assuming all is well with their marriage. Kate is scatter-brained, yet pops out ideas not unlike the way a flatulent person produces farts. The husband allegedly gains financial success from them, although not legitimately, but only fraudulently.

Meanwhile, his mistress Carly, a Manhattan lawyer, tries to surprise him at his house in Connecticut, but is surprised herself to find his wife

⁵⁷<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7591>

⁵⁸<http://www.imdb.com/title/tt2203939/>

at home. Passing over the irrelevant details, the two women, each feeling betrayed, form an unlikely bond. Eventually, a second mistress shows up, “acted” by the model Kate Upton as Amber (of course). Although not strictly necessary for the plot, she serves another purpose to be explained below.

Detecting Lies So this brings up the question: although Kate and Carly had such high hopes for their relationship with Mark, why were they unable to recognize his obvious lies? The glib answer is that everyone lies, which is certainly true. Nevertheless, they won’t be visible to someone who lies to herself.

Several years ago I was called to jury duty. In the *voir dire*, the defendant’s attorney asked all the potential jurors how could they tell that someone was lying. Virtually every woman responded that she could tell by looking in his eyes. Now even a modicum of real life experience should have disabused them of that opinion. I know as a fact that many women are quite happy to accept a lie.

At my turn, I responded with something stupid, along these lines: I would consider the plausibility of the testimony, its consistency both with the witness and other witnesses, and so on. For that, I was immediately dismissed and the women stayed behind. So I never learned of the outcome.

Chemistry While a man should be looking for a helpmate suitable for him, women have other plans. They may claim they want someone intelligent, funny, successful, interesting, and so on, but ultimately, in most cases today, it comes down to what is called “chemistry”. That is, rather than evaluating a potential partner intellectually, they are looking for a biochemical event to make the decision for them. Obviously, the three women had “chemistry” at some point with Mark, for all the good it did them. Nevertheless, at the end when they each move on, they still

rely on chemistry.

Now a man, too, is often overcome with his own chemistry, but the goal in that case is seldom a permanent relationship. That is why the aristocrat of the soul must learn to see circumstances rightly with his third eye rather than with his one-eyed member.

Amber's Ass Kate Hudson's ass is on display several times ... in close up ... covered with a bikini. Apparently the ass is replacing the breast as the primary object of man's lust. Ass play, as normative, puts heterosexuality and homosexuality on an equal basis. For example, the new season of *Girls* on HBO, hoping apparently to challenge any lingering Puritanism in the USA, featured a totally gratuitous scene involving anilingus. It had no relationship to the story and, since it was done over the kitchen sink, it was hardly a romantic moment.

Unfortunately, Lena Dunham must have missed *Two Girls and a Guy*⁵⁹, released 15 years ago, which featured a similar scene involving Heather Graham as the object of affection. At least in that case, the temptation was believable.

A Woman and her Dog Of course, the jilted wife had a dog, a large dog, as a symbol of unconditional love. When the dog crapped Carly's apartment, it was easily dismissed as a "mistake". However, when the husband confessed to a "mistake", he received no sympathy from any quarter. Perhaps if Kate had treated her husband like her dog, things may have been different. Specifically, she would have his meals ready on time, pick up all his crap, and scratch his belly at night. The fact that that probably sounds oppressive to most people when applied to a man, but not to a dog, reveals something ... I'm sure of it.

⁵⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Two_Girls_and_a_Guy

The Happy Ending Although this movie was panned by the critics, it was a financial success. So it is worthwhile to unravel the hidden assumptions in the script to understand its appeal.

The husband Mark is handsome, appealing to women, and a financial success. This he gained his advantages through deception and fraud, the only explanation for his position is “white male privilege”. The three women are completely innocent victims, since all they wanted was to love and please Mark. Individually, they were powerless against him. Yet, in Nietzschean fashion, when they worked together as a group, they were able to topple Mark’s position of dominance. In the end, Mark gets his comeuppance, losing his wife, his lovers, his money, and his career.

The film then appeals to two conflicting drives in contemporary women: the desire for independence versus the age-old propensity for female hypergamy. Carly gets Kate’s brother along with his beach house in the Hamptons. Amber marries Carly’s wealthy and much older father, so they can travel without financial concerns.

Kate, on the other hand, now free of Mark’s patriarchal oppression, recapitulates a theme from *The Purge*⁶⁰. She suddenly becomes a “strong and independent” woman, becoming successful in her own right from all her own ideas.

I can’t recommend this movie, but if you must, then fast forward to the scenes with Olivia Culpo⁶¹ if you just want to see an attractive woman.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uzTLRdWKah8>

Posted on 2015-01-28 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2015-01-28 at 10:03 said:

⁶⁰<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7412#purge>

⁶¹<http://top-beautiful-women.com/usa/item/31-olivia-culpo>

"At my turn, I responded with something stupid, along these lines: I would consider the plausibility of the testimony, its consistency both with the witness and other witnesses, and so on. For that, I was immediately dismissed and the women stayed behind."

A good example showing how justice is not the organizing principle of the current legal system, and has instead been replaced by cunning and manipulation to get to the goal of "winning".

At a prior period in the history of the West, people had another term for "chemistry": lust.

Justin on 2015-01-28 at 13:01 said:

"Apparently, in our homosexualized culture the ass is replacing the breast as the primary object of man's lust. Ass play, as normative, puts heterosexuality and homosexuality on an equal basis."

I would say that there is a significant distinction to be made here between the buttocks and the rectum as objects of male attraction/lust.

Paulo on 2015-01-28 at 15:36 said:

Regarding the hypergamy Cologero, it is also completely disturbed, the case that makes modern women feel attraction to a man, is demonic !!!

Paulo on 2015-01-28 at 15:39 said:

Yes it is Justin, but people nowadays cannot make this distinction any more!

August on 2015-01-29 at 09:26 said:

"At my turn, I responded with something stupid..."

Such 'stupid' responses are a great way to get out of all sorts of obligations in modern life, not just jury duty, so if anyone is looking for more free time, use them liberally in the right places.

And once a man is no longer regarding circumstances with his 'one-eyed member', directly or indirectly, he might conclude that there has never been an easier place to live in than the modern world. Of course, one's temptation to stick his tongue in dark places may diminish, and that could cost him some social cachet, but nothing is free.

Logres on 2015-01-31 at 00:54 said:

My father got out of jury duty by saying that he would use as his standard the book of Deuteronomy, which was God's Law. In his case, he was serious, although he probably knew and didn't mind the outcome.

Dan on 2015-01-31 at 14:47 said:

I would really love to read your take on the movie "Nightcrawler". Personally I've never seen evil presented in such a powerful manner and the film's protagonist embodies the culture of materialism, narcissism and greed in it most horrifying manifestations. The film is actually full of symbolism such as the occurrence of the number 6 in many scenes, suggesting that this is actually what the embodiment of an Antichrist figure would be like.

ja on 2015-02-03 at 15:40 said:

Oh how superior the Eye of Horus is to the Mouth of Isis !

4.30 The Virgin and the Machine Gun

Un gentilhomme ne se moque pas de la religion des autres.

COLOGERO

Let satirists then laugh their fill at human affairs, let theologians rail, and let misanthropes praise to their utmost the life of untutored rusticity, let them heap contempt on men and praises on beasts; when all is said, they will find that men can provide for their wants much more easily by mutual help, and that only by uniting their forces can they escape from the dangers that on every side beset them: not to say how much more excellent and worthy of our knowledge it is, to study the actions of men than the actions of beasts.

BENEDICT SPINOZA

The worst are full of passionate intensity.

W B YEATS

Evola the Dadaist There is a youtube video featuring Julius Evola explaining his early involvement with the Dada movement. The following is a translation from the French of the introduction to the video by its producers.

These are some extracts of a televised interview with Julius Evola broadcast in 1971 by TFI, the French language Swiss television network. This interview brings to the views the period when Evola was a Dadaist painter.

In March 1971, I used to attend the School of Advanced Studies in Social Science in Paris to obtain a doctorate in political philosophy. But the cinema and television was already interesting me. One evening, I discussed with Jean-José Marchand who created "The Archives of the 20th Century" for ORTF and this discussion led us to a fruitful collaboration. We were both animated with the desire to meet Julius Evola. We wanted to introduce him in a series of interviews bearing on three important points of Dadaism. I organized that interview which lasted a long time. At first, Evola was not entirely hostile but he remained skeptical. Then in impeccable French, he spoke to me for quite a while about his Dada experience and esoteric doctrines. The TV station retained just three minutes of that long dialog.

For posterity, I must point out that Evola refused to respond to two questions. The first:

"In the *Livre du Gotha* which belonged to my old comrade at the college in Geneva, Vittoria Emanuele de Savoie and his father Umberto, there is no "Baron Evola" mentioned. Are you really a baron?"

The second:

"Why did you put a picture of Rudolf Steiner in your 1941 book, *Sintesi di dottrina della razza*, without mentioning his name? Yet you called him an example for the Nordic-Dinaric race, of the ascetic type, endowed with a power of spiritual penetration."

On that day, I understood that Steiner no longer interested him, indeed Evola did not like him. Evola impressed me greatly.

It's too bad that most the interview was discarded, particularly the much more important part about esoteric doctrines. Moreover, Evola's refusal to answer two questions is curious. As we've reported in these pages, a search through a history of Sicilian nobility also failed to mention a "Baron Evola". Hence, we can dispense with the title even if it upsets those who believe such an authority is important. Besides, if he is a baron, where does that leave you in the restored world of tradition? One of the serfs, perhaps?

I've been investigating the reason for the Steiner photograph myself for several years, but have never received a satisfactory answer. Evola often quoted Steiner in his early philosophical works and he knew several Anthroposophists from the Ur/Krur groups. Yet it is curious that even as late as 1941 that he would refer to Steiner in such positive terms. It is certainly unclear how much of Steiner's occult Christianity that Evola was willing to consider.

The Virago, the M4, and the Rosary

From the female perspective, a woman identifies and rejects the coward because the coward will not protect her. The coward will abandon her and their children.

ANN BARNHARDT

A man's sexual choice is the result and the sum of his fundamental convictions. Tell me what a man finds sexually attractive and I will tell you his entire philosophy on life.

AYN RAND

The latest in the line of attractive viragos is Ann Barnhardt, in the space previously defined by Ann Coulter, or perhaps even as far back as St Joan of Arc. They seem to be taking what they conceive to be the man's role, probably for the reason stated above about cowards. Formerly the proprietor of a successful commodity brokerage, she gave it all up and converted to Traditional Catholicism. She then embraced Holy Virginity and Voluntary Poverty. I'm not sure about obedience. On the one hand she justifies usury, but most of her blog deals with the manifold injustices, not to mention financial risks, resulting from the usurious practices of certain financial institutions.

She also has high regard for the philosophy of Ayn Rand, provided it is baptized:

Rand was right — reason is our only absolute, because Reason is God Himself. If one re-reads Rand making this simple, conceptual substitution, it will literally knock you to the floor.

I wonder who else has been knocked to the floor by that substitution? She even insists that Pope John Paul II's lectures on the *Theology of the Body* were derived from Rand's views of sexuality.

She populates her blog with winsome love songs and "man food" recipes, while boasting of her housecleaning skills. It would seem that she is playing Dagny Taggart trying to lure her John Galt. If you think you are the one, you'd better man up first.

Dante as Social Barometer Dante's *Divine Comedy* can be used as a barometer to determine the spiritual state of the modern world. To do that, you check out the inhabitants of the various levels of hell. A traditional society will recognize their sins for what they are. However, in the modern world, the sins are first tolerated, then defended, and finally glamorized.

Among the sinners in the seventh circle of hell, there are the **suicides**, **sodomites**, **usurers**, and **blasphemers**. I don't think much needs to be said each of them. Obviously, this list is outrageous to the modern mind, and that includes "Fox news" type conservatives, not to mention most of the several versions of the "other" rights. We only need to look at the praise give to celebrity suicides within the past year as well as changes to the marriage laws in several nations. As for usury, the USA and most of the world runs on debt. Usury is a disorder because it is sterile. Normally, an enterprise makes money through productivity and creativity, with money as the medium of exchange. However, for the financial institutions, money itself becomes the product through various forms of derivatives and so on.

Now the circle is complete with the worldwide praise for blasphemy and blasphemers, now defended in an unintellectual and an emotive way as a fundamental human right. Now murderers also inhabit the seventh circle because blasphemy was understood as violence against God, a crime once considered to be as serious as murder against other men. This opinion is absurd to people today, although it is just as much a part of their history.

Satirists are praised as somehow "necessary" to free speech. That is true if correctly and intelligently done as, for example, we find in **Jonathan Swift** or **Boccaccio**, neither of whom is beyond employing a certain vulgarity or even scatological humor. Nevertheless, that is never an end in itself, but part of an intellectual whole.

Here we reach an abyss between Tradition and the modern world that accepts no compromise. If Dante is truly a high initiate, then it would be correct to claim that the modern West has now reached the seventh circle of hell. With this as a barometer, you can speculate about possible futures if you like by extrapolating the eight and ninth circles (in the comments).

Yet the modern West sees these inhabitants as praiseworthy, not sinners. Hence, the past needs to be annihilated and expunged, just as surely

as the Taliban destroyed the Buddhist sculptures in Afghanistan a decade ago.

Intellectual Courage Several years ago, I was tutoring the 14 year old son of a friend in maths. The topic was the number line, so there were examples from temperature scales, and so on ... anything with a plus and a minus. One particular problem was to state the number of years between 2 BC and AD 1. Now the obvious answer is “3”. However, the correct response is “2” because there is no year “0” in the scheme.

He seemed to understand and I challenged him to explain that when the question came up in class. The next time I saw him, I asked what happened; he told me he remained mute and accepted the incorrect answer from the teacher in silence. In other words, he distrusted his own knowledge and was cowed by the authority of the teacher and the textbook, as well as the conformity of his peers.

That displays a lack of intellectual courage. Similarly, those who know and understand traditional doctrines need to be certain of the correct answer and be willing to apply it when and where necessary.

Posted on 2015-01-11 by Cologero

* * *

JA on 2015-01-13 at 20:35 said:

For the record, Evola's family were barons under the Hohenstaufen kingdom of Sicily and were deprived of their rank after the French deposed the Staufens.....which is why they're not in the almanach de gotha.....

4.3I **Vanilla Tradition**

Living Dangerously There are two directions for future developments of Tradition, based on how seriously one takes Guenon's view of the modern world. Specifically, he regarded it as an “illusion”, i.e., totally false, and

it would dissipate as soon as the illusion evaporated. That means he opposed its very foundations, including the ideas of progress, evolution, democracy, equality, etc., that is, every quality that the modern world holds dear. From his perspective, these ideas are not worth debating; only an “intellectual conversion” could destroy the illusion.

Guenon began publishing his books in the 1920s. Apart from Guido De Giorgio who knew him personally, it seems that Julius Evola was the first writer to have incorporated Guenon’s views into a larger whole. That was still in the 20s, well before figures like Ananda Coomaraswamy, Fritjhof Schuon became involved. Schuon, in particular, has had a minor following who consider themselves the guardians of Tradition. They are the nice side of tradition, earned by writing favorably about world religions, even compiling a compendium of “Traditional Wisdom”. They often aim for academic respectability. This “vanilla” tradition seems far from the radical nature of Guenon himself. Moreover, this strand tends to exclude Evola from their purview, mostly by neglect, yet resorting to hostility when necessary.

Let us not forget that Guenon regarded the diremption of politics from spiritual life as another deviation of the modern world. Hence, the “separation of church and state” or the French-style secular state are simply errors promulgated in the modern world. Now it is true that apart from his involvement with Action Française, which ended with its condemnation by Pio IX, Guenon avoided active participation in politics, for obvious reasons. Evola, on the other hand, again for the obvious reason, did engage in the political situation at his time. Of course, Evola made some mistakes, since action in the world differs from the contemplation of metaphysical principles.

This hardly means that he was anti-Tradition, as the “nice” wing would have it. Quite the contrary, he was following one of Guenon’s core principles. Now who else, among the new breed of professors and professional “traditionalists”, are so intransigently opposed to the values

and mores of the modern world?

Path of Blame Charles Upton, in *The System of the Antichrist*, gives a useful summary of the ideal of the People of Blame⁶². The true esoterist becomes indistinguishable from exoteric believers. Ibn al-Arabi pointed out that the spiritual works which are obligatory for ordinary believers are even more so obligatory to the Sufi esoterist. The principle of non-duality is the metaphysical justification for this: God is beyond the duality of esoteric/exoteric, so one is not “higher” than the other.

This is the same conclusion that Valentin Tomberg reached: anthroposophy cannot be an alternative to the Traditional church. Authority comes through Tradition, not from one’s particular spiritual experiences. The latter must be subservient to the former.

This became crystal clear to me some time ago, while I was participating in a weekly discussion group on Nisargadatta’s⁶³ discourse collected in *I Am That*. Since he was regarded as an enlightened being (I am not disputing that), we strove to penetrate his mystical utterances. Of course, we were all “beyond” any exoteric religions. One day, someone brought in a documentary film about him. I noticed right away that he had a little altar set up in his apartment. So, certainly, such a man does not neglect his exoteric prayers. Once the depth of that observation sunk in, I left the group shortly thereafter.

Now Nisargadatta seemed to be a humble man, running his tobacco shop, and not running expensive weekend seminars.

Sudden Illumination That is not the case, however, for most New Age gurus. Eckhart Tolle⁶⁴, for example, followed a rather formulaic path. At the point of despair, he came to a sudden inner transformation leading

⁶²<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Malamatiyya>

⁶³<http://sri-nisargadatta-maharaj.blogspot.com>

⁶⁴<http://www.eckharttolle.com>

to the realization of his life purpose. His reading of Bo Yin Ra⁶⁵ was the trigger.

That worked pretty well for Mr Tolle. Unfortunately, it won't work for you. You will have to pay through the nose for books, videos, overpriced lectures and expensive retreats, wherein you will experience various "modalities" to dissolve the ego. As if the ego will spend all that money just to get dissolved! But it is not just about dissolving the ego, since a side effect will be the elimination of violence in the world. Any day now.

Posted on 2015-02-15 by Cologero

* * *

Jonathan Olavsson on 2015-02-16 at 00:59 said:

Responding to the poll question:

I would greatly appreciate to read 'Sintesi di Dottrina della Razza'. But not merely because it is of historical interest – even because it is my understanding that Evola's spiritual approach to the question of race came very close to the actual truth. I will learn Italian, so the book will be read eventually even if an English translation isn't made available. But such a translation would doubtless be an enlightening resource for numerous Anglophones.

Cologero on 2015-02-16 at 02:47 said:

I can't imagine what you might mean by "numerous", Mr Olavsson. A few years ago, I offered the translation to a mailing list. All I asked for in return was an intelligent discussion on the list. I couldn't get 50 people to sign up ... and that's out of 5 to 10 thousand visitors to this site per month. And there is more material even beyond Evola which I am gathering.

Jonathan Olavsson on 2015-02-16 at 03:29 said:

To those worth counting, it should be of great interest. How many those are, you are probably better qualified at estimating.

Which material are you gathering?

rhondda9 on 2015-02-16 at 10:26 said:

⁶⁵<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4611>

I am very interested in this, but I am afraid that I am very slow and have to contemplate what I have read for a period of time. I am more of a reader than an active participant in a discussion. Usually I have to put what I have read in my own words and then hope they are not foolish.

Tom Blanchard on 2015-02-16 at 10:48 said:

To be fair, Gornahoor has readers today that it did not have years ago. Judging by the quality of the comments on recent articles, I think it may be a good time.

Working on the Maserati, Cologero, as I can't seem to find a copy of "La Razza di Roma" for sale anywhere. What interior/exterior colors / options were you thinking of?

Boreas on 2015-02-16 at 16:52 said:

I certainly would like to be able to read 'Sintesi...' in English, and certainly not as a historical curiosity.

Nexist418 on 2015-02-17 at 22:20 said:

I've been wanting to read Sintesi for some time now.

Cologero on 2015-02-17 at 23:27 said:

You can find all currently available texts here: <http://www.gornahoor.net/?tag=sintesi-di-dottrina-della-razza>.

I will be encouraged by thoughtful comments.

ozzy belcim on 2015-02-18 at 13:19 said:

Cologero, first of all, the work you are doing on this blog and the material you cover are truly commendable in a cyberspace crippled with a dearth of thought. However, you should be the first to know that just like the material, the audience should be elite by definition, therefore few. I can't imagine a time past or future when multitudes can interest themselves in the issues at stake here. Therefore, don't let the numbers upset you. It is bound to be that way. As a researcher into the spread of ideas in the public space, I can tell you that your indicated 10,000 monthly visits does not really correspond to more than 200- 300 unique monthly visitors. I don't want to dwell much on the fact that a substantial portion of these are just passers-by. According to website statistics such as alexa, average visitor to your site spends 2,5 minutes here, which is hardly sufficient to read, comprehend and ponder on the ideas treated here. I am a subscriber to nielsen bookscan globally and I can tell you the same dynamic at play all around the world. You would be surprised how few serious books are sold in US and elsewhere. All Guenon titles published and sold in US over 15 years suggest these books don't reach more than a few thousand people. I can say the same thing – although 10-20 times those of Guenon – for even writers such as

Kant and Heidegger in the profane domain in spite of the number of university departments and students studying them. The advent of e-readers, electronic copies and ipads etc. has no impact on the historical sales figures of serious books. It seems your average kindle reader riding the subway is not a market for such. This is after all what Guenon has in mind when he talks about the intellectual elite although today's populace is too brainwashed and programmed against the idea of any elite based on some spurious democratic sensibility. However, intellectual elitism seems to be ingrained in human society and is indisputably demonstrable even with quantitative analysis, which the modern world is so enamored of.

Cologero on 2015-02-26 at 00:26 said:

Good points, Ozzy. Gornahoor does not subscribe to Alexa, nor to Google's enhanced demographics. They won't benefit me, just advertisers. You are correct, a lot of "visitors" are just bots and spammers trying to insert comments. Guenon has something more in mind beyond mere intellectual capability. He calls for an "intellectual conversion" which is a step beyond reading serious books. This bears repeating.

As an aside, I was at a tech event this week with several Indian Hindus in attendance. I asked each one of them if they had ever read the Bhagavad Gita. I got just one positive response out of ten. I'm not quite sure of what they thought of me as I tried to explain the BG to them as best I could! It seems that they are satisfied with a statue of Ganesh in their cars.

Cologero on 2015-02-26 at 00:28 said:

Miser, *The Turd in the Punch Bowl*⁶⁶ was for your benefit.

Cologero on 2015-02-26 at 12:35 said:

Nero Ribelle, Mr Blanchard, with a contrasting interior.

Whatever happened to "free speech" when certain groups can suppress books they deem unflattering?

4.32 Spring Fever Intoxication

That Self, which is free from sin, free from old age, from death and grief, from hunger and thirst, which desires nothing but what it ought to desire, and imagines nothing but what it ought to imagine, it is that which we should search out; that which we must

⁶⁶<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7354>

try to understand. He who reaches that Self and understands it gains all the world of desires.

CHANDOGYA UPANISHAD

For a just man shall fall seven times and shall rise again: but the wicked shall fall down into evil.

PROVERBS 24:16

Random Thoughts It is easy to sound intelligent if you make up facts as you go.

People see the tip of the iceberg and think they are brilliant for having noticed it. Even the Captain of the Titanic noticed the tip of the iceberg.

Spiritually empty people often gravitate to partisan politics as an alternative. Once ensconced inside an ideology, they can then identify the orthodox and the heretics, sinners and saints, the saved and the damned. This is an artificial manifestation of **Carl Schmitt**'s friend-enemy distinction. Meanwhile, the real enemy goes unnoticed.

Recently someone wrote to me that reality is given, and we need to passively know its "truths". That can only be the case in a depersonalized cosmos. However, the cosmos is buzzing with persons who are "willing" reality. How do we know that? By willing, of course, and the self-understanding of oneself as an "I" in the world, not as an "it".

Intellectuals and Charisma A British poll selected the top 10 public intellectuals⁶⁷. Other than Klugman and Habermas, I am not familiar with any of them. My list would be different, assuming I could even reach 10. So I watched a one man show by **Russell Brand** (#4) titled *Messiah Complex*, or rather 30 minutes of it. (I assumed it would not get better.)

⁶⁷<http://rt.com/uk/244225-brand-influential-thinker-voted>

He is just intelligent enough to be able to digest and regurgitate propaganda effectively, but not “solid food”. His theme is that we project qualities onto certain people, as “Messiahs”. Interestingly enough he referred to “Stories we are told”, as the reason for this complex. However, instead of transcending all points of view, he wants to replace those stories with a rather bland left wing story.

As **Julius Evola** said, people at the first stage simply accept a spontaneously arising world view—or “story”—as true without question. At the next stage, the first stage is called into question. Hence, the spontaneously arising worldview is replaced with an artificially constructed scientific, ideological, political, or religious worldview. Brand is at a rudimentary second stage whose success is convincing those at the first stage to uncritically adopt his “story” based on his fame and charisma.

I was conversing with three Indian colleagues last week, two exoteric and one who is searching. The latter one was quite taken by **Osho** to my chagrin. I told them the story of Osho here and also in India. I also gave them a little lesson on the Vedanta; since they appreciated it, I asked them to buy me a Maserati, since Osho’s followers bought him many cars. They politely declined.

The Osho guy kept insisting on the value in his lectures. I told him I would take an hour and teach him everything Osho knew, provided he would buy me a car. He was interested in the talk, but not in the purchase.

I asked them what the problem is and I got an answer I did not want to hear. They all agreed that, despite the value in my talk, no one would buy me a car because I lacked “charisma”.

I pondered that until a recent incident on facebook made that crystal clear to me. Someone had posted a photo with Guenon’s quote⁶⁸ about the end of the world being the end of an illusion. That got several dozen “likes”, whereas my many posts on the very same topic might get 4 or 5 “likes”. That must be due to the lack of charisma. I wonder how many

⁶⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5521>

of those likers understand that particular quote; probably no more than one.

Fairy Tales I got to watch some “children’s programming” last weekend. You can see it is TV written by teams of psychologists, to “tell stories” forming the first stage. They are artificially created stories, unlike fairy tales, which arise from the soul life of a people.

My psyche was formed by fairy tales and nursery rhymes. How may such stories and poems can you tell by heart? In elementary school, we even learned Greek and Norse myths.

I suspect that those under 35 are formed by cartoons created by psychologists. There were no 30 minute cartoons in my day.

Spiritual Delusion In my talk with those Indian colleagues, I told them to distrust any movement that attracts Westerners (like Osho). Americans, especially, believe they are entitled to start at the top. No bhakti or karma yoga for them, but straight to raja yoga. In Buddhism, too, I’ve noticed, they want to go straight to Dzogchen or Tantra without the years of preparation.

The desire to be considered “spiritual” is a tendency, particularly among a certain type of woman, but even some men. They are usually attractive, successful, financially secure, but self-knowledge is not a commodity to be bought and paid for. And a charming personality does not help. Hence they jump at every novelty, speak in elevated tones, but are totally lacking in self-knowledge. They crave a different type of attention. My advice to them is:

Only God my dear, could love you for yourself alone and not your yellow hair.

WILLIAM BUTLER YEATS

Why does Gornahoor repel women? I've met women who have read books, visited ashrams, and even have their own personal shaman or Jungian analyst. I've spoken to Buddhists (which apparently is a polite way to be an atheist these days), artists, doctors, and so on. But as soon as I point them to Gornahoor, they shut down. My sister calls me a "shaman", so perhaps I should follow that path. What should I charge?

Recently, I spoke to a woman who self identifies as a "very conservative Christian". Curiously, she ranks *Fifty Shades of Grey* as one of her favorite books, for its "honesty". Probably it reminds her of Paul's description of a Christian marriage. Always aiming to please, I asked her if she would like to try a relationship like that. She hung up on me. Just a warning to you guys: it may sound good on paper, but you probably won't want a slave underfoot all the time. Unless you can afford to give her a credit card to keep her out of the house shopping, give it a pass.

Life Changing Events I subscribe to a few "self help" mailing lists to take the pulse on things. I hear about all these "amazing" meetings with high-charged people. They are pumped up at the end. I don't know why, but that seems to be worth hundreds, or even thousands, of dollars.

The Gnosis group is not like that, no one is "amazing". It is hard work, but a beautiful work.

One cute and perky woman sends me weekly notices about "life changing" opportunities. Apparently, there is a market niche based on people who want to change their lives. (She claims to be earning a 7 figure income.)

I personally don't grok the appeal of that. If I kept changing my life that often, by this point I would have been a zoo keeper, a dance instructor on a cruise line, and would probably now be singing show tunes at a transvestite bar. No thanks, I'll keep the life I have.

Sequel This was supposed to be a post about self-mastery, but I ran out of space. As I've insisted, a man should live the philosophy he holds. Hence, you won't find, in my case, some wonderful conversion story but rather a series of attempts at self-mastery, of the subtle struggling to rule the dense. That will come soon. But first, we need the promised story of the third migration from Aeneas, but he isn't returning my phone calls.

On the path of gnosis, you will be freed of anxiety, addictions, self-doubts, and lack of confidence. What is that worth to you?

Posted on 2015-03-29 by Cologero

* * *

Ronin Yogi on 2015-03-29 at 23:45 said:
Fine thoughts today. Gnosis is of much "worth".

Wayne Ferguson on 2015-03-30 at 01:31 said:

"Hence, you won't find, in my case, some wonderful conversion story but rather a series of attempts at self-mastery, of the subtle struggling to rule the dense."

Would it be more accurate to say that the dense has been struggling to rule the dense instead of submitting to the subtle? Think also of the conflict in Romans 7 giving way to the life of the Spirit in Romans 8.

Quoting Letter XI of Tomberg's "Meditations on the Tarot":

(This thing is the strongest of all powers,
the force of all forces,
for it overcometh every subtle thing
and doth penetrate every solid substance.)
(tabula Smaragdina, 9)

"Virgin Nature therefore has her part in all the miracles. And it is virgin Nature participating actively in the miracles of divine magic which is the subject of the eleventh Arcanum of the Tarot, force, representing a woman victorious over a lion, holding its jaws open with her hands. The woman does so with the same apparent ease—without effort—with which the Magician of the first Arcanum handles his objects. Moreover, she wears a hat similar to that of the Magician—in the form of a lemniscate. One could say that the two stand equally under the sign of rhythm—the respiration of eternity—the sign ? ; and that the two manifest two aspects of a single principle, namely that effort signifies the presence of an obstacle, whilst natural integrity on

the one hand, and undivided attention on the other hand, exclude inner conflict—and therefore every obstacle, and therefore all effort. Just as perfect concentration takes place effortlessly, so does true force act without effort. Now, the Magician is the Arcanum of the wholeness of consciousness, or concentration without effort; Force is the Arcanum of the natural integrity of being, or power without effort. Because force subdues the lion not by force similar to that of the lion, but rather by force of a higher order and on a higher plane. This is the Arcanum of Force” (Letter 11, Force).

Desert Scout on 2015-03-30 at 11:00 said:

“My sister calls me a “shaman”, so perhaps I should follow that path. What should I charge?”

My rate is \$65 an hour, cash, and the girls typically tip. When the government is footing the bill charge \$240.

Before I found Gornahoor I was suicidally depressed. Thanks to you I discovered the writings of Tomberg, and through converting to and living the Sacramental life of the Catholic faith I've been freed from my anxiety, depression, and suicidal ideation. One of the problems in any field, both self help and medicine, is that if you actually cure the client you put yourself out of business. It's not uncommon that I have a patient cancel their follow up appointment because they're out of pain.

For what it's worth, you've made a difference in at least one person's life. When you go before the Almighty you can at least say you saved one of the Master's wayward sheep. I don't know if that's what you aimed for, but it's something that's hopefully worthwhile.

rhondda9 on 2015-03-30 at 12:06 said:

It is very hard for women to admit that everything they think they know is a lie and that they have to start at the beginning again. It is really a terrifying realization and better to pretend you never thought it.

Avery on 2015-03-31 at 16:50 said:

As recently as two years ago, people were still writing blogs with little to no evidence that anyone was reading at all. Now, it is impossible to avoid the quantification of the power your words place on others – what is called without irony “metrics”. Usually, the metric is the number of advertisements viewed, but it is impossible to avoid the metric of Facebook likes even for Gornahoor.

I can't remember whether I clicked like for either of your posts. Of course, the reality of Guenon's message is the same whether or not people like, or “like” it. There is really an unbelievable destruction of thought going on with this infiltration of metrics everywhere.

Paulo on 2015-03-31 at 17:57 said:

Fear your captors,fear your masters-Juan Matus

Cologero on 2015-03-31 at 19:06 said:

You need to develop a sensayuma, Avery, although that is not quantifiable.

Jacob on 2015-04-01 at 12:05 said:

Yea Avery. I guess we could say another sign of the reign of quantity?

Paulo on 2015-04-01 at 12:19 said:

"It is very hard for women to admit that everything they think they know is a lie and that they have to start at the beginning again. It is really a terrifying realization and better to pretend you never thought it."

If there is a real man there in the moment,he will cover that situation too!

rhondda9 on 2015-04-01 at 13:23 said:

Was that your attempt at humour Avery?

rhondda9 on 2015-04-01 at 15:11 said:

Oops Paulo, I mean. Back to the nunnery for me.

Paul on 2015-06-12 at 23:59 said:

"Americans, especially, believe they are entitled to start at the top. No bhakti or karma yoga for them, but straight to raja yoga. In Buddhism, too, I've noticed, they want to go straight to Dzogchen or Tantra without the years of preparation..."

Agreed in general, although some additional observations may be germane, especially with respect to Dzogchen. As a student of Tibetan scholar Namkhai Norbu, I have come to realize that given the situation in Tibet throughout the last century or so, there would be very little chance of any Tibetans practicing Dzogchen or indeed any kind of tantra openly under Chinese eyes, without persecution. Also, Dzogchen itself has not been taught to the average Tibetan Vajrayana practitioner, as such an "advanced" type of practice is well beyond the means of those who are only at the level of mantra recitations and prostrations; therefore, it has always been more or less an underground path, transmitted secretly to those who are "ready."

Norbu has also alluded that those who approach this path here in the West already have past-life connections to it since, given the above, most practitioners who were ready to approach or continue this clandestine path of development (as Tibetans in previous lives) would of necessity need to be reborn in the West to obtain the freedom to avail themselves of that opportunity. This makes perfect sense.

4.33 Artisan of the Soul

All men and women are entrusted with the task of crafting their own life: in a certain sense, they are to make of it a work of art, a masterpiece.

POPE JOHN PAUL II, *Letter to Artists*⁶⁹

Your life is your soul. Like a bodybuilder caring for his physique, give your soul exercise and watch what it consumes. Food for the soul includes the images and thoughts you entertain. Be pure, be watchful, be wise.

Grievances

From this degenerate crop comes the revolutionary proletariat, with its hatred born of grievances, and the drawing-room Bolshevism of the aesthetes and literary folk, who enjoy and advertise the attractiveness of such states of mind.

OSWALD SPENGLER, *The Hour of Decision*

The sense that one is being continually affronted is precisely a plebeian feeling.

NICOLAI BERDYAEV

A world in which everyone takes offense, or claims to be a victim, is one ruled by the plebeian spirit and the pseudo-elite who encourage it.

⁶⁹http://www.vatican.va/content/john-paul-ii/en/letters/1999/documents/hf_jp-ii_let_23041999_artists.html

The Quest for Order

The great man is filled with a very different passion, the will toward *order*.

EZRA POUND

The plebeian, on the other hand, is consumed with a passion for power.

Do It Like an Animal Several years ago I heard a faux bishop on TV claim that certain practices, which in the olden days were quaintly called “unnatural acts”, could not be unnatural since animals in the wild performed them. Of course, in the olden days, bishops encouraged us to imitate the Saints, or even Christ, but never animals.

Affinity and Attraction The Law of Affinity, which governs births, has been debased by the New Agers into the “Law of Attraction”. The former is an act of will and takes privation into account. The Law of Attraction, on the other hand, is more like magical thinking⁷⁰: just by thinking of something, the impersonal universe will somehow provide. The persistence of this notion is fascinating, since prosperity, love, health, and so on, remain elusive.

Of course, the obvious corollary, therefore, is that the lack of such goods is attributable to “stinking thinking.” Several months ago, a distraught woman approached me for advice. Not only did her boyfriend run off with a younger woman, but he managed to take a lot of her cash and even her car. Rather than lending a sympathetic ear, her new age friends insisted that something in her mind had attracted such turmoil. In other words, she was to blame.

⁷⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Magical_thinking

I asked her how she could be responsible for the free acts of another person. As for her other problems, I explained some aspects of civil law and suggested some lawyers. That gave her some peace of mind as well as a course of action. It wasn't much, but it was certainly better than having her meditate on her car coming back to her.

On the other hand, there is a certain basis to that perspective, despite its distortions. By the Law of Affinity, you have chosen, to some extent, those you come into contact with. That is worth pondering. So, if you did get involved in a bad relationship, look at it more closely. Were there little clues about that person's values or psychological problems? Was there some neediness in you that kept you in that relationship?

Ignorance and lack of consciousness are privations. The purpose of the exercise is not to place blame, but rather to lead to more personal power, or freedom.

New Sins Man is subjected to numerous laws at multiple levels. There are the abstract laws of logic and maths. There are physical laws of gravity and the other forces. It goes on: chemical, biological, sociological, and psychological laws all serve to limit one's freedom and power.

Then there are laws formulated by society. Positive law should be in conformance with natural law, or else it places unnecessary burdens. The modern world is not as liberating as it believes, since it has created a vast number of new laws, now defined as "sins". If it is not in Dante's hell or confession manuals published prior to 1789, it is not a sin.

Real Sins A real sin requires three characteristics:

- It must be a serious matter, i.e., a breach of cosmic order.
- The person must know it to be so
- The person must do it freely or willingly

The three conditions are not always met, even in acts we consider heinous. A person may not know or understand the cosmic order. More likely, he is hardly free, since he is placed under so many laws, not of his choosing.

Hence, the artisan of the soul will seek to know the cosmic order. He will work to become free from useless laws, psychological turmoil, or hastily made commitments. In that case, the experience of sin takes on a weightier, even terrifying, significance. The breach of the cosmic law involves a rupture with all creation.

Be careful about the opposites of the three imperatives.

- **Purity:** *impurity, divided will, doubt*
- **Watchfulness:** *sleep, hypnotized*
- **Wisdom:** *slyness, cleverness*

Posted on 2015-03-05 by Cologero

* * *

Paulo on 2015-03-06 at 05:32 said:

The question is
how to transcend
the laws???

Tom Blanchard on 2015-03-06 at 15:25 said:

Interesting how the pursuit of order over power results in the acquisition of true power (freedom, as you note) as a natural consequence anyhow. As I believe Evola notes, power is feminine entity and naturally weds itself to those who are worthy of it.

Do you have access / reference to any kind of pre-1789 confession manual? I am actually making my first confession (decades of sins to recount) a week from now, so it's a bit top-of-mind for me.

(I will send Aeneas a bottle of Frangelico for each Evola text translated.)

Cologero on 2015-03-06 at 17:02 said:

The section on the commandments should suffice, Mr Blanchard:

Catechism of Pope Pius X: <http://www.gornahoor.net/library/CatechismSPX.pdf>

Matthew Smallwood on 2015-03-07 at 10:26 said:

Order is a dirty word these days, so it's interesting that you can blaspheme God in any way you want, but there are other words like "order" or "sin" which (if you say) get you branded as a heretic. "Whoever is righteous has regard for the life of his beast, but the mercy of the wicked is cruel." Since men are living at the levels of beasts, things have to get much worse before we realize that the erstwhile rulers of the said modern world are not "just", although they may be "socially just". What continually makes me wonder is how the best & brightest of Europe were seduced by classical liberalism, and almost to the man fell into the thought patterns that lead toward Revolution. In some cases, it is that the person communicating their insight has had their work distorted when passed on.

Paulo on 2015-03-07 at 11:34 said:

Tom Blanchard

"power is feminine entity and naturally weds itself to those who are worthy of it."

What a astonishing statement!?!Shakti!This exactly statement,it was yours or did you get in some place else?

See how good it is to find a hard woman?

Mark Citadel on 2015-04-03 at 16:25 said:

Indeed Tom, one must be worthy of true power in order to receive it and own it. Our current elite operates on an illegitimate power that was never given to them. They stole it and abused it.

4.34 Homage to Giuseppe

News for the Week

Principles of negotiation

A deal was apparently made between the G6 and Iran over its nuclear program. Anyone who has ever negotiated in good faith understands

that a deal will involve concessions on both sides. Those opposed to the deal argue that economic sanctions should have been tightened in order to coerce a better deal. In other words, negotiations are unnecessary. A legal principle is that a deal is invalid if made under duress or coercion. Hence, the real goal is unconditional surrender. Just say it.

Climate Change

Obama is back on climate change. There is a simple solution to reduce greenhouse gases that no one is bringing up, at least not on the political talk shows. According to the World Bank, the per capita emission of CO₂ (in metric tons) in the USA is 17.5. Other sample countries: Pakistan (0.9), Mexico (3.8), India (1.7), Nicaragua (0.8). The USA could easily reduce its emissions by 5% by reducing the number of inhabitants by 5%, without excessive taxation or burdensome regulations. Instead, it insists on increasing those inhabitants.

Irrationality

A young woman claimed that being in the presence of irrationality makes her feel ill; that is something she learned from Rudolf Steiner. Unfortunately, in her case, the illness arose from her own irrationality, but she is too irrational to notice that. On the other hand, most people experience no ill effects from their irrationality.

Null Hypothesis The null hypothesis⁷¹ is the presumed truth in the absence of any evidence to the contrary. Francis Fukuyama⁷² claims that liberal democracies and free-market capitalism represent the highest point of human evolution and furnish the definitive answers to all previous political and social questions.

⁷¹<https://explorable.com/null-hypothesis>

⁷²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Francis_Fukuyama

It may be regarded as a class marker since it is the default position, with some leeway, considered obviously true by educated and sophisticated people today. Moreover, the denialists of this consensus reality are considered insane or evil. The past is the history of injustices which need to be corrected.

A Day at the Zoo A couple of weeks ago I visited the Jacksonville Zoo⁷³ with my family. My son was impressed by how “ripped” the chimps were. Of course they were, since they seldom went to the ground and never stopped moving and climbing.

The next exhibit was for the gorillas. I asked the zookeeper why they kept the chimps and gorillas separate. She explained that they were too much alike and would end up competing with each other.

A biologist has speculated that humans involved from the mating of a male pig and female chimp⁷⁴. I can’t imagine how horny that chimp had to be although I have known woman with rather poor judgments about their boyfriends.

But that would be an interesting experiment: put some pigs in the chimp exhibit and see if any humans arise. And maybe add a talking snake to see what happens.

Boris Mouravieff says that organic life is subject to three factors: hunger, sex, and fear. That does seem to describe animal life exactly.

Alternative Hypothesis The alternative to the Null Hypothesis is what sane and normal people used to believe. They were closer to their natural life in the sense that it promoted fitness. Sex was channeled into procreation and the continuation of the gene pool (“the selfish gene”). Family life was recognized as the way to safeguard this, so any behavior that was opposed to it was considered taboo. Children were considered a

⁷³<http://www.jacksonvillezoo.org>

⁷⁴<http://www.macroevolution.net/human-origins-2.html#.VSSf0vnF9Bk>

blessing. Nowadays pregnancy is often considered an undesirable, if not dangerous, side effect of natural sexuality. Strangers threatened the gene pool.

Hunger drove the acquisition of resources and the social structures to maintain and keep them. This further enhanced genetic fitness. Unfortunately, the unfit often could not survive.

The fear of the lack of food and other resources, or encroachments from other tribes or peoples, led to rule by the fathers. Their duty was to protect against invaders and organize the acquisition of resources. Since that was often dangerous, leading to premature mortality, boys were particularly valued.

Since there was an awareness into the future through one's descendants, there was also a reverence for the past. One's ancestors were revered and their cultural and spiritual inheritance passed on.

Giuseppe Salvo Giuseppe Salvo was my great grandfather. Below is the letter I recently sent to several of his descendants in the generation after mine.

I'm sending you guys a picture of your great great grandfather, taken in 1880. His name was Giuseppe

The first Salvo arrived in Sicily from Tuscany around the 15th century, where he was made a nobleman. From there the Salvo family spread throughout Sicily, especially in the province of Trapani where it is not an uncommon name. In Salemi, where our branch came from, it is a not an uncommon name.

Salemi is uniquely positioned, high on a hill where you can see for miles around. The countryside is gorgeous, dotted with farms, olive gardens, vineyards, etc. For that reason, it was also the perfect location for a military encampment, since a sneak attack would have been impossible.

The Arabs were there briefly, some 1000 years ago or so. They built a castle atop the highest hill. A couple of hundred years later,

the Vikings arrived by way of the Normans. (The Normans were descendants of the Vikings who had settle in the province of Normandy in France.)

The Normans moved on to Palermo, where there was a much larger castle. From that position, the Normans managed to re-establish the Holy Roman Empire. I'll tell that story if anyone is interested. There was a lively school of Romantic poetry, from whom Dante learned his craft. Again, let me know if you are interested.

The bottom line is that there is a lot of nobility, both from the Tuscan side as well as the Norman side, whose genetic and spiritual influence must have been quite extensive in a small village like Salemi. You can see it in the picture ... Giuseppe looks nothing like those caricatures of Italian organ grinders that Hollywood portrays.

You can treat this as an interesting, but "so what", story. Or you can use it as a model for your own lives, and the lives of your children: to achieve, to explore, to act nobly, and to avoid the vulgarity of contemporary decadent culture.

Posted on 2015-04-08 by Cologero

4.35 Too Late for Groundhog's Day

Thoughts that should never have seen the light of day.

The great majority of human beings grope about during their whole lives among these data of their own existence rather as one gropes one's way between heavy chairs and tables in a darkened room. And what is tragic about their condition is that perhaps only because their lives are passed in this shadowy gloom can they bear to live at all. It is just as if their seeing apparatus had become finally adapted to this twilight state: it is a state of non-vision

which is not, however, a state of quite complete non-awareness.
... all of us tend to secrete and exude a sort of protective covering
within which our life goes on.

GABRIEL MARCEL, *The Mystery of Being*

When we set out to speak about truth, as when we set out to speak
about God, we are in danger of speaking about something which
is not truth, but is merely its simulacrum.

GABRIEL MARCEL

Truth is the whole Universe realizing itself in one aspect.

FRANCES BRADLEY

How to Pronounce My Name See How to pronounce Calogero⁷⁵
for the correct pronunciation. The most common spelling is “Calogero”,
which in Greek means “Beautiful old man”. For some reason, our family
uses an “o” instead of the “a”; so make a minor adjustment to the first
syllable.

They Call me the Trickster Apparently the word is out that “the
Gornahoor guy is a trickster”⁷⁶. Of course, a real trickster would put
in his writing unacknowledged references to obscure works, deliberate
mistakes to hide his real intention, and half-completed thoughts that
need to be teased out.

Someone else wrote this:

⁷⁵https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Pe_1mgizPaY

⁷⁶<http://forum.socialmatter.net/discussion/70/last-book-you-read-and-rate-it>

His review of Submission is pretty good but the author seems to think that Rediger is a real person and that Guénon lecteur de Nietzsche is a real dissertation, which he claims to have accessed and read. Does he not know that Rediger and his dissertation are both fictional?

Obviously, I was the victim of an elaborate hoax. Someone claiming to be in possession of that dissertation showed it to me, but without leaving me a copy. It fooled me because the quality was quite high.

Sophistry and Philosophy Socrates distinguished between the Philosopher, the lover of wisdom, and the Sophist, a commercialized simulacrum of wisdom. The philosopher's quest is the knowledge of the Whole, the Sophist is a partisan whose goal is to promote partial knowledge as knowledge of the whole. The philosopher relies on justice, the sophist on power. The power of the sophist resides in the widespread confusion between what we would like to be the case and what is actually true; the confusion is the perversion of the understanding.

The entire news apparatus in the West is based on sophistry. That is, commentators are paid to promote specific opinions. Often, there will be two opposing opinions, so the passive viewer believes he can synthesize a knowledge of the whole out of that. Rather, what is more common, is that the viewer will cheer for one side or another, as though watching a sporting match.

But what sporting match is played without referees or umpires? Hence, a news show should have referees who will issue red and yellow cards for errors of fact and logic. Yet, that assumes there is an objective truth and that logic has power. Curiously, the ideal of pure reason is now under attack as a trick used by white males as a form of control⁷⁷.

⁷⁷http://opinionator.blogs.nytimes.com/2015/07/02/looking-white-in-the-face/?_r=0

On Being Intelligent The philosopher **Thomas Nagle** famously posed this question: What is it like to be a bat? He didn't ask the more mysterious question, What is it like to be intelligent?

The Quest for Adolph I saw episode one (of several) on the History Channel about the quest to find Adolph Hitler in Argentina. Since the obsession of that Channel on Hitler and space aliens puts Miguel Serrano in the mainstream, I decided to watch it. Its premise was based on some recently released 70 year old FBI files, full of hearsay. They even hired **Robert Baer** of *Syriana* fame as the project leader. Has anyone seen the *Syriana* outtakes that claim Baer's first wife was a secret agent?

Well, the show was so bad, I stopped watching. Meanwhile, **Wikileaks** uncovered the results of a secret quest to find a Nazi base in Antarctica.⁷⁸ They must be hiding something.

Sniffing your Neighbor's Anus Last month I stumbled upon a "bright" blog, having been mistakenly informed that it was a serious site. It was the same old, same old: atheism, science, consciousness as "nothing but" the firing of neurons. He made an interesting point that experiments have shown that there are neurons firing even before there is conscious awareness of a thought. Now from the esoteric perspective, that is not surprising, since the True Self is hidden and what we take to be our "conscious" self is secondary. Of course, the goal is to reverse that. I thought about adding a comment with that thought, but fortunately a wiser neuron dissuaded me.

The unanswered question, however, is why neurons have such different effects: what is the point of excruciating pain and sexual ecstasy? Do the neurons know? That is just a revival of ancient Gnosticism, viz., an evil Demiurge trapped consciousness in matter, while leaving it to-

⁷⁸https://wikileaks.org/gifiles/attach/49/49783_.pdf

tally ineffective. What then is the point of pain? Why do we feel fear and anxiety if the conscious self is helpless to do anything about it?

Clearly, he believes he is just a mammal. I am happy to concede that about him, but that does not imply that all beings who look human are just mammals.

He then claimed that homosexuality is “natural”, since animals in nature perform such acts. “That is the only definition of ‘natural’”, he asserted. Now it may be natural, but mimicking dog behavior is not a good argument. Our religious leaders used to tell us to imitate the saints, or even Christ, but never animals. So this is what they call progress.

Apparently he is a flop with chicks, based on some of his rants. Perhaps he should try sniffing the behinds of the women in his office to get in their good graces. After all, it works for dogs, so it must be perfectly natural.

Posted on 2016-02-03 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2016-02-04 at 00:45 said:

Taking a look at the other thinkers interviewed by that writer on the nytimes site, and what does one notice? They all share the writer's ideological viewpoint. I guess he hasn't given the Aghori of the Mind experiment a try. Maybe that experiment is too difficult for individuals like him, or maybe he'd deem it racist- like everything else.

The apparent “point” one is to take away from the conversation between those two sophists: if you're a person of European descent and you avoid speaking about race, you're a racist, but then if you speak about race, that still makes you a racist. Forget about shifting the goalpost, the goalpost has been completely removed from the field.

Jacob on 2016-02-04 at 13:13 said:

One of the best things about the right is the lack of over-seriousness. On the Left there is no room for laughter, because you either mock the enemies of revolution, or you are the enemy.

We are all tricksters. We've all deluded ourselves into some kind of grand performance, but some recognize it as a trick and some don't. I guess I'll just have to be a fool continuing in my folly.

Cologero on 2016-02-04 at 22:41 said:

@Matt, the "true north" example is absurd, since there actually is a true north. Sailors will get lost without knowing it. Post-modernists are lost because they have no true north.

Max on 2016-02-05 at 18:55 said:

The "grid north" is what maps or people tell you, it is a human convention. Magnetic north is dependent on earth's magnetic field and is in motion, a living thing, more "psychic" in character. To establish magnetic north one first needs to account for compass deviation which is dependent on local tendencies, and then to account for magnetic declination which is dependent on global tendencies.

Although there is a "True North", the same can not be said for east and west. What is truly straight may appear bent, because when sailing the shortest route, projected onto a flat map, the course will take the form of a curve.

Alistair Fraser on 2016-02-06 at 07:23 said:

On Magnetic north pole whether psychic or physical, here is an ultimate test that should define either / or existence . Go to Magnetic north pole (remembering that your not actually allowed to go there) When standing on the so called magnetic north pole, with palm of hand flat out horizontal , with a compass on it, should that compass needle now just spin or stall because it cannot locate the actual north direction ? Then according to the scientists version of the root of that magnetic force.... if you then tilt that hand and thus compass 90 degrees, then surely the compass needle should now point at your feet , into the earth ? (or is the sky ?) Then for a double proof of magnetic root , you can go to the south pole (remembering that your not allowed to go there) and repeat the same experiment which should result in the same result , i.e., tilt hand 90 degrees of horizontal and compass needle should point at your feet .

Mark Citadel on 2016-02-06 at 08:01 said:

I've been pronouncing that name wrong for so long, I thought it was a pseudonym, not an actual family name! Good to remember for the future, though through force of habit I make no promises.

As for the old 'homosexuality is natural' argument, this makes the dual failure of applying the dubious concept of 'homosexuality' itself to animals who have absolutely no sense of sexual identity, nor any kind of identity. It is also to equate natural with moral, which is a gross distortion of natural law theory. You never see early Catholic theologians proposing that cannibalism is acceptable after observing the behavior of spiders.

Anonymous on 2016-02-06 at 23:31 said:

@Scooby: what a convoluted lunatic comment! If I understand you correctly, what you're saying is that the brain is a passive condition through which the True Self consciousness manifests. This individual has laid out that point of view here: <http://www.bernardokastrup.com/2011/12/brain-as-knot-of-consciousness.html>

4.36 X Files and Bigoted Opinions

Due to the flare up of a chronic condition, I realized how difficult it is to think while in physical discomfort. Not that I missed it much ... So I put that down time to good use by studying several manifestations of popular culture. This post is the best I can do with such a poor starting point.

I read a depressingly inane magazine article by a Logical Positivist ... The burden of his teaching seems to be this:

“Since we cannot really say anything about anything, let us be content to talk about the way in which we say nothing.” That is an excellent way to organize futility.

After all, even nothingness has its dignity: but here not even the dignity of nothingness is respected. There must be the mechanical clicking of the thought machine manufacturing nothing about nothing, as if even nothing had at all costs to be organized, and presented as if it were something. As if it had to be talked about.

The atheist existentialist has my respect: he accepts his honest despair with stoic dignity. And despair gives his thought a genuine content, because it expresses an experience — his confrontation with emptiness. But those others confront only the mechanical output of their own thinking machine. They don't have the imagination or the good sense to stand in awe at real emptiness. In fact, their rationalizations seem to be a complacent evasion: as if logical formulas somehow could give something to stand on in the abyss.

And now: just wait until they start philosophizing with computers!

THOMAS MERTON, *Conjectures of a Guilty Bystander*

X Files Philosophy In the TV Show, *X-Files*, the two agents hold radically different metaphysical positions. The female character, Dana Scully, is a committed logical positivist, certain that there is no reality beyond what material science can prove. Fox Mulder, on the other hand, believes in paranormal phenomena, conspiracy theories, and so on.

Although Mulder's point of view is not a valid alternative to positivism, we could let it stand as strictly entertainment. However, a somewhat serious thinker was recently brought to our attention. He claims to be an idealist, but by that he means little more than a more systematic and sophisticated version of Mulder's philosophy. Specifically, he seems to treat philosophy as a scientific hypothesis except, in his case, he regards consciousness as independent of matter and hence a causative factor in the material world. Hence, he accepts all sorts of "psychic powers" as "proofs" of his philosophy.

Unfortunately, that is not at all what we mean by "philosophical idealism". Rather, the fundamental premise is that the world can be known by thinking about it; hence, it must be rational. This is the opposite of scientific positivism, which sees the world as the result of random forces, so that even thinking itself arises from non-rational causes.

With 7 billion people on the planet, why is there not one of them who can guess the 4 digit code to unlock that iPhone via psychic powers?

What he said In *Conjectures of a Guilty Bystander*, **Thomas Merton** tells the story of a Governor's visit to the Monastery. The Guv said, "You monks know you cannot be happy because you have material possessions." Certainly, it was poorly phrased, so Merton decided to take a

literal reading of it. A novice monk protested, “But that is not what he *meant*.” Merton drew this lesson:

How true it is that everyone instinctively pays attention not to what a politician actually says, but to what he seems to want to say.

Gornahoor draws a different lesson:

How true it is that everyone instinctively pays attention not to what a politician actually says, but to what they would like him to say.

Bigoted Opinions I’m amazed at the emotional involvement that some people have for their preferred candidate, even though there is little or no benefit for them personally. But then again, democracy is the worst form of government, except for those that will follow afterward (to paraphrase someone). That’s bad news for those hoping for a reversal of current trends somehow.

That’s because in a democracy, everyone is entitled to his own opinion. But if those opinions are simply random products of evolution⁷⁹, what value have they? Obviously, such opinions may have practical reality if they work to hold society together. Yet that is unsatisfactory to most people since they are convinced that their opinions are factually real. I’m afraid you can’t eat your Darwinism and have it, too, which what the educated class seems to want.

The real answer is nihilism. The consequence of nihilism is that there are only bigoted opinions vying with each other. I’ll leave you a longish text by **Harry Neumann**⁸⁰ for you to ponder without comment. Read it as Merton reads the atheist existentialist and develop contempt for those complacent evaders.

⁷⁹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=8474>

⁸⁰https://www.gornahoor.net/?page_id=8496

The New Religion I discovered a channel on satellite radio that euphemistically goes by the name the “Catholic Channel”. However, to a large degree, it is unlike any religion I know. For example, there was a discussion about whether burying a statue of St Joseph in your yard would help you sell your house.

I’ve noticed that there has developed a cottage industry of converts and reverts who tend to dominate blogging. Unfortunately, their enthusiasm cannot overcome their ignorance of Tradition. They lack that sense of Tradition that lingers, even in apostates like Santayana and many others. They tend to jumble things together, treating all teachings as having equal importance. I have to assume that RCIA classes are quite unhelpful.

One such woman today was talking about gluttony and Oprah Winfrey’s battle with fat. Of course, Oprah has a “food addiction” since “gluttony must be a very rare sin”. In a more sane era, the hostess would have been yanked off the air. What exactly is a food addiction, medically? It describes a behavior, not a condition. Sin is hard to talk about today, but it entails an inner bondage to a behavior. In other words, a food addiction. More on this later, but for now I would recommend *Sin Revisited* by **Solange Hertz**.

Filling the Pews On another show a Jesuit was waxing ecstatic about how great the Church would become with woman deacons who could give sermons on issues of concern to them. For good measure, he suggested that acceptance of homosexuality would also be nice. Now with estimates of up to 50% of priests of that orientation, I can’t imagine it is a problem.

I’ve been told that most parishes are already dominated by women, so what is the issue? The real problem is the lack of young men in the pew, for obvious reasons. That Jesuit talked about encounter and other

squishy words and used “privilege”⁸¹ as a verb. He can’t imagine how off-putting his language is for most men.

Ted Cruz and Tradition Ted Cruz belongs to a religious movement called the New Apostolic Reformation⁸². They are very Old Testament oriented with menorahs, stars of David, and shofars used in their services. As a sort of ape of Tradition, they seek to restore the offices of Priest and King, except they have a very democratic view of those roles. Their ultimate goal is dominion of the culture in its seven domains: religion, family, education, government, media, arts & entertainment, and business. Ultimately, they will manifest preternatural powers on the earth.

In the abstract, that sounds traditional. They seem serious, with a few million adherents, and a plan. Compare that to NRx⁸³, which consists of a few guys meeting in a bar. Logic is just one of the liberal arts and it is ineffective without rhetoric. Logic is actually easier, so much more time should be spent on rhetorical skills. The first step is to learn to recognize it.

The Sense of Wonder In esoterism, there is the distinction between knowledge and understanding. On the one hand, there is the mere accumulation of facts and information, the other is grasping the whole which links the facts together. Idealist philosophy is “knowledge of the whole”, not the development of super powers.

Ultimately, it is a matter of “seeing”. You can’t argue with the complacent evader, but you may get him to “see”. If you don’t see, then spend some quiet time and think about existence. Boris Mouravieff writes:

⁸¹[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Privilege_\(social_inequality\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Privilege_(social_inequality))

⁸²https://www.youtube.com/results?search_query=New+Apostolic+Reformation

⁸³<http://neoreaction.net/>

Exterior man feels the transcendent character of the Love arising from the Absolute I and Absolute II. The first in essence reaches his consciousness in the form of a perception of existence. But he considers the beauty of the Universe and its life as mere information, instead of as a marvelous gift capable of constantly stimulating his sense of wonder and kindling his gratitude.

update 18 Feb 2021

I guess I got the worldview of Dana Scully incorrect. I should have spent more of my life watching TV.

I forget who is that philosopher of psychic powers.

Neo-reaction is totally dead now and the links don't work. Does anyone know what happened?

Plato was the "someone" who predicted that tyranny follows democracy. So don't be surprised.

I don't know who is the fellow in the turban or what he would think of the comparison.

Posted on 2016-02-18 by Cologero

* * *

Harun on 2016-02-19 at 05:25 said:

Despite Nietzsche's disgust for Christian tradition, philosophy holds deep metaphysical truth, even Suzuki Roshi mentioned him as the European closer to a Zen understanding.

Most people who think they are nihilists are just radical relativists who still evade the question. The positivist replaces his faith in God with faith in the scientific method, when he realizes how even that method can't produce truth, he turns into a relativist. From that point nothing in the world has any meaning, the relativist is a sophist who holds only the opinion that suits him at any moment.

Many so-called nihilists refuse any moral code to live as they want; they think they are closer to the Übermensch but in fact they are what Nietzsche called "the last man".

The last man is actually the result of negative nihilism, is the product of the "age of absolute sinfulness" as described by the idealist Fichte.

Positive nihilism is something closer to a Nigredo: abandoning all ideas, beliefs, attachments and operate a painful clean to ourselves.

It's a step toward initiatic death, I feel pity for modern "nihilist" who think Nietzsche just told them to live like animals and satisfy their lower needs without any moral concern.

Unfortunately it's only normal that the profane see the opposite of truth: too many times gnostic doctrines were interpreted not to ascend but to descend into the lower realms of animal instincts.

Guénon explains too well how an initiation can be perverted and become its opposite.

Dart on 2016-02-19 at 20:12 said:

Scully is actually a Roman Catholic.

James on 2016-02-21 at 08:42 said:

https://40.media.tumblr.com/14fbaea6ff4021399e1c61539ead6207/tumblr_nj329srMKC1tx9o6mo1_1280.jpg

Hi, Cologero, I just thought that this man resembles you so much.

Cologero on 2016-02-21 at 22:33 said:

I'm flattered, James.

Dennis on 2016-02-22 at 17:07 said:

While Scully is skeptical of Mulder's more outlandish claims regarding aliens and conspiracy theories, it's not clear that she believes there is "no reality beyond what material science can prove." She's seen too much in her years with Mulder to take such a dogmatic logical positivist view. She is a lapsed Catholic in whom some residual faith seems to linger – she wears a Cross around her neck, for example – seems open to the possibility of the divine (and of aliens!), and she has never been identified as an atheist.

Logres on 2016-02-23 at 01:58 said:

That's an interesting point about Logic & Rhetoric. Rhetoric seems to carry a logic of its own, almost three or four dimensional. Some of the Southern writers like Mel Bradford were trying to say something quite similar, when they looked at the founding tradition, Lincoln's speeches, etc. Perhaps to someone with a clear enough head and clean enough heart, Rhetoric offers its own course in Wisdom and higher Logic, because "language is sermonic".

Aidan on 2021-02-18 at 07:31 said:

Neoreaction slowly petered out even though Curtis Yarvin is more active now and Urbit is picking up steam. I was in personal contact with a few that led to a surreal project.

While the likeness isn't quite uncanny it's there, he would probably be quietly amused.

Greg on 2021-02-21 at 23:27 said:

Only the Orthosphere seems active in reaction. Social matters I think drove the movement and when that site went dead so did neoreaction.

Balrog Booger on 2022-02-18 at 12:38 said:

Neoreaction went the way so many things on the internet do: as soon as the term started to pick up steam it became *cringe*, and everybody just stopped calling themselves that. The "movement" as such still exists, but has migrated from written blogs to the easier to digest mass medium of YouTube. Rather than orbiting around Curtis Yarvin, it increasingly is moving toward such video essayists as The Distributist, yet another guy on the internet calling himself Charlemagne, Auron MacIntyre, and their general sphere of social contacts. These days the term of choice for such people seems to be "dissident rightist." Calling yourself a dissident seems insane to me, but the wind of fashion blows in whatever direction it will.

4.37 **Spy vs Spy**

Un bel giorno ... un bel giorno per morire

GIACOMO PUCCINI⁸⁴

The Americans The fourth season of the FX series *The Americans* begins next week. The setting is suburban Washington, DC, in the early 1980s. The premise is that Elizabeth and Philip Jennings, outwardly the parents of a typical American family, are deeply embedded KGB agents. Raising a family and running a travel agency would be overwhelming for most people. Yet they have the time and energy to do the spy stuff, too.

They are nearly superhuman with mad martial arts skills, both armed and unarmed. That should require frequent training at the gym and practice at the shooting range, but we never see that. They are masters of disguise and social engineering, bending people to their will. Apparently,

⁸⁴<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RnCmeNa5vXs>

they have a license to kill, which they often resort to. Yet they manage to remain sympathetic, since the American public is accustomed to killing as long as it is done for a higher cause. For example, the Godfather movies are also like that: murder is not “personal”, since such motives would make it immoral. There are also real life examples that I’m sure you can find.

The Jennings’ are noble since they fight for their fatherland and the communist ideology. In comparison, the American FBI agents, always close on their tail but not quite there, are lost. For example, Stan the FBI man, seems to work out of a sense of duty, or more likely to get out of the house, but is unclear about any higher purpose. After all, the USA line is that “they hate us for our freedom” and they come here “for all our stuff”.

Yet for all his “freedom”, Stan is emotionally crippled and spiritually empty. His family is disintegrating and he and his wife fumble around with various New Age cults (like est) for life’s purpose. Elizabeth Jennings, on the other hand, has no doubts about her life purpose. She even retains a somewhat warrior ascetic attitude in the midst of the consumer society. When her husband tells her how “easy” it is to live in USA, she responds, “It is different, but not better.”

Curiously, KGB agents were active, behind the scenes, in liberal political causes. In particular, we can identify these left wing causes:

- Civil rights movements: they were active in a cell
- Iran Contra affair: they supported the Sandanistas in Nicaragua
- Nuclear disarmament: they encouraged their teenaged daughter to participate in demonstrations. (The daughter, unaware of her parents’ true identities, joined a liberal church.)
- The World Council of Churches was infiltrated by communists

So “Russian” interference in American politics was, in the 70s and 80s, more than just Internet “misinformation”.

Secret Agent Man A totally different point of view can be found in the TV series from the 60s, *Danger Man* UK) or *Secret Agent*⁸⁵ (USA). John Drake was quite sure of his mission. Moreover, he, too, relied on social engineering to solve his cases with minimal use of force. Watch some episodes if you want to see what life in a “white republic” was like. Or even better, watch *Bye, Bye, Birdie*. When my millennial aged son was a young teen, I called him to the TV to see the big dance scene in the town center. I asked him if anything seemed odd about it. He caught on right away!

White Supremacy The elections in the USA have brought attention to “white supremacy”. It is hard to see this as much of a factor, since it involves little more than a few web sites. Nevertheless, it is the “other” that the left loves to hate.

Nevertheless, I did a little research and biological racism seems entrenched in certain circles, usually associated with anti-Judaism and anti-Christianity. This is far from a reactionary position. In his critique of Fascism, Evola reminds us:

In truth, personality and liberty can be conceived only on the basis of the *liberation of the individual from naturalistic, biological, and primitively individualistic bonds* that characterize the pre-state and pre-political forms in a purely social and utilitarian-contractual sense.

⁸⁵<https://www.google.com/url?sa=t&rct=j&q=&esrc=s&source=web&cd=8&cad=rja&uact=8&ved=0ahUKEwjTsYqR2rLLAhVFbR4KHcLDCGYQtWIISTAH&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.youtube.com%2Fwatch%3Fv%3D6iaR3W071j4&usg=AFQjCNFq2P3q43pHFIlIY085y1isGKaU4g&sig2=g0cendtLTM1734o0sfRrgg&bv=116274245,d.dmo>

They seem to be attracted to neo-Darwinism, as sort of a “tough minded” worldview (in William James’ sense). Unfortunately, the so-called “neo reactionaries” are not immune from this attitude. Another Hermetist, Valentin Tomberg, in his commentary on the Arcana of the Moon, explains the danger of this attitude:

What is the state of intelligence which has abandoned all metaphysics and has decided to limit itself solely to “objective facts of the senses”? What is most characteristic of this state is that *intelligence no longer moves forwards but backwards*. It looks to

the least developed and the most primitive for the cause and explanation of what is most developed and most advanced in the process of evolution. *Thus, it looks for the efficient cause of the world not in the heights of creative consciousness but rather in the depths of the unconscious*, and instead of advancing and elevating itself towards God, it retreats into matter.

Evola regards the same movement as “categorical”, or a false feeling of self-transcendence, which

can give to the individual the illusory, momentary sensation of an exalted, intense life, moreover such sensations conditioned by a regression, by a diminution of the personality and true liberty.

Putrefaction of the Modern Soul This regression is evidenced by what such beings simply cannot see. Specifically, they fail to see what Christianity had brought to Europe. One particular web site claimed that Christianity is like a disease that takes time to manifest itself; therefore the supremacy of Christian Europe is an illusion. Then, even though a de-Christianized Europe seems to be the problem, he claims that Europe is still infected. So he has a “heads I win, tails you lose” attitude if you want to debate him.

On the other hand, Evola could see Medieval Europe as an “*heroic, differentiated, and spiritual civilization*”. Anyone who cannot recognize that is hardly likely to recognize it today. There are two errors in biological racism. The first is that genetics is not constant, not just due to mixing, but also to the accumulation of mutations over generations. A materially prosperous civilization is more likely to be declining genetically.

The second is that it ignores the race of the soul and psychical heredity, which is even more important. It is not an ideology or religion or worldview that kills the soul, but rather that a weak soul will embrace a disordered worldview. Perhaps such men are reacting to the putrefaction of the modern soul, and then confuse the cause and the effect.

Europe is just a land mass. The true destiny of its people is once again to be Holy and Roman and an Empire.

Catholic vs Orthodox This question keeps arising in certain circles. Since Gornahoor is focused on the esoteric teachings, he seldom concerns himself with the exoteric aspects. The follow up question is why didn’t Rene Guenon and Julius Evola ever comment on the Eastern churches?

The answer is that there is no difference between the two from the esoteric perspective. They are, or at least used to be, in a schismatic relationship to each other (the mutual excommunications of 1054 were lifted some 20 years ago). Now a schism is primarily an organizational dispute, unlike a heresy which involves a difference in doctrine. Too often the focus is on accidental and historically contingent differences. However, there are no essential differences.

This is shown by the examples of **St Nicodemus** and **St Theophan the Recluse**, who aggregated the *Philokalia* for the Greeks and Russians respectively. Nevertheless, they could recognize In *Spiritual Combat* by **Lorenzo Scupoli** a work of deep spirituality. They translated that book into their languages. Moreover, St Nicodemus translated the *Spiritual Exercises* of **St Ignatius Loyola** into Greek, calling it simply the work of

a “wise man”. Any other attitude does not serve a good purpose.

Sticks and Stones

Sticks and stones may break my bones, but names will never harm me.

That was the guiding philosophy of my youth, so the schoolyard bantering in the Republican debates does not concern me. However, it upsets many people and is, in any case, inappropriate in such a venue. Nevertheless, the opposition does use names with the intent to harm people. In particular, there is vitriol against **Donald Trump**, and by extension his supporters, using words like bigoted, racist, sexist, deplorable, and so on. These words are intended to put someone “beyond the pale”, yet the pundit class does not deem them inappropriate. I heard the editor of a political journal blame “racism and nativism” as the root cause for so many things she didn’t like; she may as well have tried to explain fire by phlogiston.

Speaking of “stones”, the wannabe adult on stage, **John Kasich**, was vividly threatening to go to war with Russia to defend Finland, inter alia, against an imminent invasion. While that bellicose attitude was astonishing enough, what was even more astonishing was how *normal* it sounded to everyone. I don’t believe it has ever been brought up since.

Posted on 2016-03-08 by Cologero

* * *

Harun on 2016-03-09 at 06:25 said:

Most of the points pseudo-reactionary make are based on flawed modern premises, like a purely materialistic world view.

They explain the current state of Europe to race, and thus darwinism and evolutionism. They are effectively eliminating any possibility of solving a spiritual problem.

Also they fail to realize biological race is a modern concern, not very relevant in the middle age or in the cosmopolitic roman empire.

Alistair Fraser on 2016-03-11 at 03:32 said:

the host has made a superb job on this gornahoor site of clearly distinguishing the phenomena of race distinctions/types and their mis-interpreted connotations into modern consciousness of which many people seem unable to comprehend due to the mass mediated agitating version that is recycled in modern times with a purpose mostly to hostility.

I thought this quote from evola from 1971 was a sort of parallel mirror with that race question, this time on the mis-perceptions of "magic" and the accusations that can be thrown from that

"JE: As I formerly said, there are people who want to create myths, even of the most comical sort, in order to find self-satisfaction. It was even stated in France that in my presence Black Masses were celebrated with young blondes every week. Given my condition we could recall a German saying that can be translated as "he got it wrong because it was true." Therefore I can only say in this regard that during the years nineteen-twenty-seven, twenty-eight and twenty-nine, I organised what is called the Ur Group, which did not deal with magic, but rather with initiatic operations. And after this period it is important to distinguish between the magical practices and the initiatic ones which are quite different – and I must say that from the Ur Group arose a work of three volumes called Introduction to Magic which is composed of anonymous monographies since the names that appear are not those of the authors of the diverse subjects, translations and comments. Thus, I believe that anyone who aims to explore such a subject seriously, and in a multifaceted way, should resort to this indispensable work. A third edition in Italian appeared with the same title."

4.38 Gasping for Air

A disciple asked his spiritual teacher, while they were bathing in the river, when he would finally be able to realise Brahman. The teacher, instead of answering, pushed his head under water and held him down until, feeling himself drowning, the student freed himself and re-emerged. The teacher then explained: "When the desire in you to realise Brahman becomes as intense and deep as how you were just driven to reassert your physical life—only then will you achieve satisfaction."

JULIUS EVOLA, *Essays on Magical Idealism*⁸⁶

A recent flare up of bronchitis left me gasping for air for days at a time and unable to write. It was a reminder of death (that same weekend a famous architect was admitted to a hospital in Miami with bronchitis where she died) and stoked the desire to “realise Brahman”.

Like a Herd of Cud Chewers I’ve been a fan of nature shows ever since I saw Mutual of Omaha’s Wild Kingdom⁸⁷. I especially relate to big cats and was fascinated by their coordinated attacks on herd animals. What struck me the most was how the cud chewers would quickly return to their normal activities after one of their own had been picked off. As a naïve youth, I thought that humans would never act that way.

However, in current times after an attack on a population, the government encourages everyone to get back to “normal”, even to start “shop-ping” again. Flowers are laid, candles are lit, and people reassure each other about their “resiliency”. Anything to avoid facing up to the real solution. That is because those who kill the soul are more dangerous than those who kill the body.

First Order Logic Years ago at University, I took a class on first order logic (and Zermelo-Fraenkel set theory) in the philosophy department. First order logic⁸⁸ is about statements with predicates and quantifiers, such as the universal and existential quantifiers. In other words, it is about statements such as “All X are P” or “Some X are P”, and so on, pretty much covering most everyday discourse.

I recall that about two dozen signed up for the class, but only three of us finished. I knew several of the drop outs: they were majoring in po-

⁸⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=20>

⁸⁷<http://www.wildkingdom.com/>

⁸⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/First-order_logic

litical science, pre-law, even philosophy. In short, those who most needed it. Today on the news shows, the talking heads always struggle with justifications such as “I don’t mean that all X are P” and so on, before they can get to the main point. Needless, the X’s in the audience object to being called P. Perhaps if every university graduate had to understand rudimentary logic, discourses would be more fruitful.

Heidegger ... with friends like these No one who knows me personally reads Gornahoor; I suppose you should draw your own conclusions. My sister thinks I am a shaman, who should perhaps be avoided. Others, trying to be helpful, send me links to various spiritual conferences, visiting gurus, and the like. I wonder why they never send them my link.

The end result is that I’ve accumulated a new type of 21st century relationship without a name, so I’ll use the term “Internet friend”. Usually, they are just for a season, or those with a specific common interest. One such “friend”, whom I’ve “known” off and on for years, recently wrote to me about Heidegger and Tradition, specifically Evola ... In particular, Heidegger is the cat’s meow among the “alt right”.

It brings up some questions: does the language of Tradition, with Sanskrit terms, obscure more than reveal? Can Heidegger’s language be used to express the same ideas? So, instead of “karma”, we can speak of “facticity”, instead of dharma, we talk about projects. And for human nature, we can talk about man’s mode of being in the world.

Of course, we would supplement Heidegger’s phenomenological analysis with descriptions of the inner life of the soul. I think the biggest benefit would be to abandon any talk of the “Kali Yuga”. It is too easily portrayed as some pseudo-mechanical process that operates independently of any consciousness. Man becomes, in that view, a passive spectator, rather than the active agent of change.

Instead, we can talk about nihilism à la Heidegger. This is clearer, when nihilism is understood as the complete loss of Tradition. As we’ve

pointed out on these pages, this is the age of the rule by scientists, or technocrats, and anthropoidal mammals. Those who have read carefully will begin to notice more similarities.

The Zen Master Dogen H/T to Aryayana for drawing our attention to *The Life of Zen Master Dogen*⁸⁹. No car chases or CGI monsters, if that is your preference. Rather, it provides a rather convincing portrayal of Tradition in 13th century Japan. There is the ongoing relationship between the spiritual authority and temporal power. Dogen's recovery of true Buddhism involves the discovering of the "Buddha within". He illustrates that with the reflection of the full moon in a pond. The surface of the water represents the Self; when it is disturbed, the moon is not reflected very well. However, when the water is still, the moon is reflected perfectly. Ignorance and vice disturb the Self so that the image of the Buddha cannot be found. Hence, the life of virtue is necessary, which has 8 steps, including meditation. Sitting zazen requires a good posture and the elimination of all fidgeting.

At that level, a man of one Tradition can engage a man of another tradition. They can discuss meditation practice, techniques to still the mind, and aids to overcome vices like gluttony, lust, pride and so on. That is real life. In existentialist terms, we can say it involves the recovery of being rather than being engaged in debates about theories.

That is why we object to meaningless assertions such as "X is a valid tradition", or a "sect of Old Believers has maintained tradition". That is good first order logic, but not good for spiritual practice. The nominal attachment to a Tradition leads to nothing, just as Dogen showed that inauthentic forms of Buddhism do not lead to enlightenment.

Imaginal and Conceptual Thinking The distinction between imaginal and conceptual thinking is difficult for most people to make. **Rene**

⁸⁹<https://youtu.be/8s5Uz8XSc-Y>

Guenon has claimed that those who cannot think outside of time are also incapable of proper metaphysical thinking. Nevertheless, since knowledge begins in the senses, symbols and imagery are used to convey metaphysical teachings; these involve visualizations in space and time.

In particular, postmortem states are described in terms of images rather than in concepts. Islam is famous, or infamous, for that, with its very sensuous images of “heaven”; of course, there is an esoteric interpretation of such texts. On the other hand, most Americans look forward in the afterlife, not to the beatific vision of God, but rather to being reunited with their favorite Chihuahua.

Mortal Sin Mortal sin is a term that is easily tossed around. Why, it is asked, does a finite sin have infinite consequences? Mortal sin just means a second death, the death of the soul. So it is just as permanent as the first death of the body.

If you are reading text messages while crossing the street, and get run over, isn't the penalty too severe for the offense? It doesn't matter, does it? If a man beats his son or molests his daughter, and they despise him for life, does a finite act deserve a lifelong punishment?

To be clear, a mortal sin requires three elements:

- A serious matter
- Knowledge that it is serious
- The act is deliberate

In short, only the man who knows and the man who is free can commit such sins. He would look at that prospect with total horror. That is not unlike the young chef in the Dogen movie who was horrified to discover his lust for a pretty girl.

Provocations Back to Dogen: how can we in the west overcome ignorance and vice? It turns out that the two are intimately related. **St Thomas Aquinas** explains why most men remain in ignorance:

in some the reason is perverted by passion, or evil habit, or an evil disposition of nature

So the solution to the lack of gnosis is not to read another book or study a philosopher on-line; these are pointless without restraining passions and overcoming evil habits. The Fathers described eight provocations that keep us in bondage: gluttony, lust, greed, anger, depression, boredom, vanity, and pride.

The effects of these provocations need to be observed in consciousness through watchfulness, and the kept from dominating. The phenomenology of provocations will be known both to Christians and to Zen monks.

A good contemporary resource is *Sin Revisited* by **Solange Hertz**, who describes them rather well. She includes the esoteric interpretation of some Old Testament texts, which need to be understood as describing spiritual warfare.

Posted on 2016-04-11 by Cologero

* * *

mtpollack on 2016-04-11 at 13:49 said:

"What struck me the most was how the cud chewers would quickly return to their normal activities after one of their own had been picked off. As a naïve youth, I thought that humans would never act that way.

It's an all-you-can eat Kunda-buffet.

Aryayana on 2016-04-12 at 14:54 said:

I am glad that you appreciated the Zen film just as much as I did, Cologero, and your reflections are very pertinent.

Alain de Benoist is big on Heidegger. I tried to read his 'Being and Time' back in the day, but decoding his extremely dense and abstruse personal philosophical construct didn't seem to be worth the time, when there are so many truly timeless works to read instead. One odd thing I have noticed is that certain people attempt to 'synthesize' (perhaps rather syncretize) the Traditional thought of an Evola or a Guenon with other, non-traditional philosophers like Heidegger even before having read Guenon's entire oeuvre, not to mention the works of Schuon, Coomaraswamy et al (and even less than that, having established oneself firmly in a particular stream of spiritual doctrine and praxis).

On another note, I have to disagree about dropping terminological reference to the Kali-yuga.

Completely regardless of whether or not it is mentioned, it remains the truth about what is happening; therefore, it serves to see the entire situation in light of the greater picture, to orient oneself realistically before deciding which course of action is most appropriate in one's own case. For those whose mission (rightly or wrongly) is to work to change the world through external projects, thoughts about the inevitability of further collective degeneration may be demoralizing. For those of a contemplative nature, however, this awareness only reinforces a sense of the urgency of transcending this world by means of the esoteric Path. It definitely eliminates the temptation to abandon an exclusive spiritual quest well befitting the caste of sages in favour of all sorts of worldly projects aimed at "saving" the world on a collective level, certainly doomed to fail. Heroic (in a tragic sense) as such a mission might be, it practically boils down to a struggle of individuals versus the entire world, amounting to spending for nothing a life that could have been devoted to intensive spiritual practice (the far-reaching, magnetic polar influence of which should not be underestimated) and transcendence at the one and only level where this is still possible in our time: that of the individual himself. That the world-situation depends upon consciousness is a given, but mankind (with the exception of a few) has already made its choice, and the mighty forces (born of far more than our own consciousness) that have been unleashed must be allowed to run their course, until this manifestation is exhausted in final ruin. (However central one thinks one's personal role may be, the world goes on even after the death of the most extraordinary men, many of whose efforts were unable to turn a tide that was too mighty for them: think of what became of Codreanu's mission, for example.) The fate of the world is in God's hands, and on a collective level that fate looks bleak, but for the individual, there is available a path that may defeat the enemy once and for all in our own souls, no matter what becomes of the world at large. To completely confront, without fear, the likely possibility that the world is in fact utterly lost to darkness, with no return to a true sacred order in sight, and to calmly and serenely accept it, consequently letting go of all worldly hopes and interests, may do wonders for the sense of absolute detachment that can greatly benefit the Great Work. Thus the wise man doesn't become a passive spectator, but an active agent in overcoming the Dark Age within himself, rather than running around imagining himself to be able to change

the way of the rest of the world.

The present world is comparable to a collective train that is headed for the abyss; a train whose movement cannot be stopped, nor its course be changed, since it is controlled by forces far outweighing the power of those individuals opposed to it, but that can be exited or renounced by individual passengers if they only dare to jump off. Even though the impetus of the train's movement towards the abyss is at this point much too forceful to be stopped by any human effort, we shouldn't for that reason personally submit to its determined course by thinking that the inevitable equals the Good, instead of choosing the exit, like a silent warrior in the night, so as to keep the fire of Truth alive in one more heart, even to the end. On the historical plane, this world will be destroyed sooner or later (an obvious fact which reminds us that the essential Quest of man is not tied up with the external salvation of the world, which is ultimately outside man's control) a demonstration of the illusory and vain nature of all human power and control when faced with the lightning-flash of the Absolute which destroys, reintegrates and remanifests. Then all the efforts of the Enemy who thought they had finally managed to subvert humanity entirely will once again be nothing, for their power was always nothing in view of the Ultimate, and all they really achieved was to spend their precious human existences striving so as to fall into lower states of being instead of rising to higher ones. This is the tragedy of relative power gained from darkness, so to speak. It comes at a high cost and is impermanent, as it only pertains to the most transient and limited domain. Everything that has a beginning, has an end, and to think that human self-will can change that in any other way than through its reintegration into the Divine Source is deluded. And this is where the doctrine of cycles or yugas is entirely correct. The consciousness of a being will certainly determine the 'yugic' conditions in which he manifests following the disintegration of his current form (from which his external environment—and thus the Dark Age—is indeed inseparable), but while situated in a cyclic manifestation shared with countless other beings, he cannot single-handedly change those external conditions as if he were Almighty God. The conscious, individual agents who have worked with the utmost determination to create the nihilistic chaos we have today, may certainly believe that this is the pure result of their own "power" and "will", but the truth is that they are nothing, they are mere pawns to forces out of their control, and no one is more trapped than they are. They have exploited the possibilities that the cyclic conditions already allowed for, and nothing is easier than that, if one doesn't see a problem in causing the damnation of one's soul. For those who are not determined to make sure that the death of the cycle will be accompanied by one's own spiritual death, however, one of the few remaining options is to leave the world to its fate and invest all their forces in spiritual reintegration, a path that must be the opposite pole ("... my Kingdom is not of this world") to those who have contrarily chosen to make this dark world-age their own kingdom, changing themselves in conforming thereto ... as the time before the line was crossed allowing for the possibility of temporary (and increasingly short-lived) returns to higher orders has long since passed. Maybe this is a truth that is better

kept silent, though, since not all people find themselves motivated by it as do I. It helps to remember that all Principles that truly matter, including the Spiritual Archetype of Man in the Divine Mind, outlast their contingent manifestations or emanations in this limited and particular world-cycle, a cycle whose duration cannot be prolonged indefinitely on the initiative of men.

undrownpip on 2016-04-17 at 20:02 said:

I kinda disagree about the Kali Yuga – yes it's yielding to some vast mechanical tide, but it's a self-conscious yielding, a giving over to what is inevitable. And what is inevitable is inevitable (the "ride the tiger" crowd thinks) because they are telling the world exactly what to do to save itself, and nobody is listening. At that point, what can you do but accept destruction?

Mark Citadel on 2016-04-18 at 18:39 said:

I don't think I could ever jettison Kali Yuga from my vocabulary. haha. It's just become too ingrained. But I do think you're onto something concerning Heidegger there. I have been wanting for a while to read Dugin's treatment of Heidegger which was relatively recent and no doubt tries to square him with eastern thought.

Sorry to hear you have been unwell! Please don't die on us.

Nilakantha on 2016-04-30 at 02:25 said:

I've always had a hard time thinking of any of the Protestant Buddhisms of the Kamakura as Traditional in any important sense. Even Dogen's Zen is under the cloud of subitism and is, therefore, heterodox.

Cologero on 2016-04-30 at 12:11 said:

Nilakantha, I can't comment on the merits or demerits of your point. However, that uncertainty was one of the main reasons why I decided to pass on Buddhism: I came to the conclusion that I could not readily distinguish between the authentic and the heterodox in an alien tradition.

Nilakantha on 2016-04-30 at 14:48 said:

Cologero,

Decades ago, when I left the Orthodox Church, I knew that I would need to find a spiritual home in an orthodox religion, one that had a well articulated metaphysical doctrine, intelligible morality and traditional spiritual practices. Guénon, Coomaraswamy and Plotinus helped keep me honest in my search. I also took the advice of Agehananda Bharati (of all people!).

When Bharati was teaching at Benares Hindu University in the 60s and 70s, he would ask the young western hippies who wanted to study Buddhism with him if they had done their homework, i.e. had they learned any of the languages of traditional Buddhism: Pali, Sanskrit, Classical Chinese or Tibetan. If they hadn't, he wouldn't take them as pupils, saying that these

were the only languages that had coherent terminology for explaining Buddhism. I agree with Bharati here, so I spent six years in graduate school studying Sanskrit, Pali and classical Indian thought.

I only bring this up to show that I agree with your statement that one “can not readily distinguish between the authentic and the heterodox in an alien tradition.” If for some reason you need to leave your ancestral religion, it is incumbent upon you to become as much a native of your new faith as possible.

Cologero on 2016-05-11 at 05:47 said:

Mark, it is always a *beautiful day to die*⁹⁰. But there are some loose ends:

- Who will keep the web site up?
- What will happen to my nice library? I would hate to see it carted off to the used book store.
- Who will pray for my soul?

4.39 Tempted by Calypso

If you see anyone blinded by the illusions of his empty and Calypso-like imagination, seized by the desire of scratching and delivered over to the senses, it is a brute, not man that you see.

If you come upon a philosopher winnowing out all things by right reason, he is a heavenly, not an earthly animal.

If you come upon a pure contemplator, ignorant of the body, banished to the innermost places of the mind, he is not an earthly, nor a heavenly animal: he more superbly is a divinity clothed with human flesh.

PICO DELLA MIRANDOLA, *Orations on the Dignity of Man*

Man the Brute. In popular culture, the handicapped person who excels at athletics, an elderly woman who parachutes out of an aeroplane,

⁹⁰<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r2ILyyWh3sY>

or an aging model who poses in a bikini, all elicit widespread admiration. While this a testament to the human will, it still falls short of man's higher possibilities. A man who has lost his physical prowess can still become a philosopher or a contemplator, although the public will ignore him.

Note how Pico anticipates **Rene Guenon**. In his categorization, the philosopher actualizes all his possibilities as man and the contemplator actualizes his transcendent possibilities.

Rock 'n Roll Models. If you can't become a philosopher, then how about a scientist, i.e., a "natural philosopher"? Metalheads have some role models: Brian May of Queen became an astrophysicist as did several other musician/scientists⁹¹.

Pornography for the young. Plato was distrustful of the corrosive effect of the Poets in society. Although Ariana Grande grew up just a few miles from where I live, I was not familiar with her work. Apparently her songs and show, although targeted at young girls, are somewhat pornographic⁹². Yet we fear those who kill the body, yet remained unconcerned about those who kill the soul.

Death of Cultures. Oswald Spengler's masterpiece, *The Decline of the West*, is on every new/alt right reading list.

So why is everyone surprised to witness Western culture apparently self-destruct, not necessarily with a bang, but certainly with a whimper?

Conspiracy Theory. As for the noted symbiosis between liberalism and Islam, this explanation may seem far-fetched; nevertheless, a well-crafted conspiracy theory is an art form. Manly P Hall — who knows something about secret Masonic orders — leaves some clues in *The Fraternity of the Rose Cross*. He says this about Christianity:

Whatever profundity is found in Christian philosophy is due pri-

⁹¹<http://www.thebestcolleges.org/doctors-of-rock-10-musicians-with-phds/>

⁹²<http://www.barnhardt.biz/2017/05/27/manchester-the-brutal-truth/>

marily to this infusion of pagan ideas. Conversely, the shallowness of Christianity is the direct result of the clumsy efforts made to improve upon the ancient doctrines.

On the other hand, his opinion on Islam is quite the opposite; it improved on paganism.

In his cavern on Mount Hira, Mohammed prayed not for new truths, but for old truths to be restated in their original purity and simplicity in order that men might understand again the primitive religions: God's clear revelation to the first patriarchs. ... The Prophet was but the reformer of a decadent pagandom, the smasher of idols, the purifier of defiled Mysteries.

Hall then lists several Europeans who were initiated in the mysteries by Arabians: Paracelsus, Cagliostro, Comte de St. Germain. Those Rosicrucians were, according to Hall, the precursors to the overthrow of the established order of Crown and Altar. Those are the dots ... **The Opposite of a Revolution.** Reactionaries, then, look for a restoration of the established order of things.

Christendom. So-called "White Nationalism" is a misnomer, because there is no white race, but rather white races. Instead, Europeans used to identify themselves as "Christians". For example, Queen Elizabeth granted Walter Raleigh the right

to explore, colonise and rule any "remote, heathen and barbarous lands, countries and territories, not actually possessed of any Christian Prince or inhabited by Christian People

Note that she did not refer to lands possessed by "white people" and, a fortiori, not even to "European people". Nationalism cannot be based solely on genetics, but solidarity is achieved only with a spiritual unity.

Differentiation and the Kali Yuga. One of the prophecies about the Kali Yuga is the lack of differentiation. That is, the traditional categories of caste, nation, religion, even gender become blurred. So there should be no surprise about that. The difference comes in the valuation: liberals promote undifferentiation as a sign of progress, but reactionaries see it as a symptom of spiritual decline.

However, the West is leading the way into the Kali Yuga. According to Tradition, primitive people are not evolving upwards, but are rather the residues of once great civilizations. That may be the fate of Europeans. What will kill the project is that other peoples are not at that point. Hence, they manage to retain their identities, unlike the majority of Europeans.

The way out is for a small group to live the opposite of a revolution. Judge your allies by traditional standards. Are they brahmins, warriors, or merchants? Not the latter, because the opposite of a revolution is not a business model.

Universality and identity. The dogmas about the characteristics of the Church have been transferred to Humanity as a whole. For example, traditionally only the baptized could be considered to be “children of God”, now that applies to everyone. The Church says that all its members are “one”, in the sense that everyone plays a role in the Body of the Church, which is hierarchically arranged. The Liberal says that we are all “one” in our humanity; we are all equal, so there cannot be a hierarchy.

As recently as a hundred years ago, St. Pope Pius X could categorize those outside the Church: “Infidels, Jews, heretics, apostates, schismatics, and the excommunicated.” Obviously, this is an embarrassment to any bishop today. Nevertheless, even the liberal regards some to be beyond the pale of humanity; these are called the deplorables.

Sexual Revolution. Promoters of sexual revolution are no part of any “Right” whatsoever, but are located somewhere on the Left.

Orthodox Apostates. There has been a minor movement of apostates from Rome to Orthodoxy. Now this may be legitimate in a “state of

emergency”, i.e., there is no local Roman parish that can be trusted. That does not mean that vitriol aimed back at the Roman Church is justified, especially when it includes false witness. From the esoteric perspective, there is but one Tradition; jurisdictional disputes among bishops cannot alter that.

Also, from a Traditional perspective, one follows the religion of one’s ancestors or legitimate leaders. If you are Nordic or Roman, that religion is Rome. There is too much to give up: e.g., Thomism, Chivalrous orders, mystics of a high order like Meister Eckhart, Dante, centuries of Art, etc. I suppose if Bruce Jenner can decide to become a woman, and Rachel Dolezal can become black, then a Western European can wake up and become a Ukrainian.

By the way, I sometimes attend a Uniate Byzantine Rite mass, in which the *filioque* is omitted. So it is hardly a “deal breaker”.

The Power of Hate. The Voice of the People wants to restore hate to its rightful place⁹³.

There are six things that the LORD hates, seven that are an abomination to him:

- haughty eyes
- a lying tongue
- hands that shed innocent blood
- a heart that devises wicked plans
- feet that make haste to run to evil
- a false witness who breathes out lies
- one who sows discord among brothers.

⁹³<https://voxday.blogspot.com/2017/06/darkstream-hate-is-christian-virtue.html>

PROVERBS 6:16-19

Hormone-free Humans. Supermarkets charge premium prices for hormone-free dairy, eggs, and meat. Soon, hormone-free humans will be a rarity.

Imitation and Conviction. Arthur de Gobineau theorized about culture creators and culture consumers.

The masses are invincibly ignorant of the Western world and its movements. ... There is a great difference between imitation and conviction. Imitation does not necessarily imply a serious breach with hereditary instincts; but no one has a real part in any civilization until he is able to make progress by himself, without direction from others.

Have any new/alt right groups been able to define a High Culture for our age? Hereditary instincts do not suffice.

Spiritual Combat for the Masses. Paula White in *The Power of Thoughts*⁹⁴ teaches the power of thought and dominion. Before dismissing it, consider whom it motivated. It is the opposite of resentment and victimhood for the masses.

Marquis of Queensbury rules for online debates. Online arguments and faux television news debates are pointless because they lack a referee to monitor the arguments and a judge to declare a winner. And, unlike diving or boxing, for example, there is no standard for judgment. Who would be foolhardy enough to box or play American football without a referee?

Faux Outrage. It is easy to write a post pandering to a sense of outrage. It is even easier to excite prurient interest. It is more difficult to appeal to the intellect, although it is worth the effort.

⁹⁴<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g4CBkEqPVGg>

The Feminine Universe.

Aristasia is a female-only Utopia⁹⁵ based on the writings of Rene Guenon and Ananda Coomaraswamy. Perhaps a more traditional reconciliation of the sexes may be possible if the Men's Movement rejects MGTOW, PUA, or game, and embraces innocence, elegance, cuteness (kawaii), and modesty⁹⁶ instead.

The Inevitable End. If you've reached this far, you are on the way to becoming a Philosopher, a heavenly animal.

Posted on 2017-06-05 by Cologero

* * *

James on 2017-06-06 at 11:55 said:

Thanks so much for another great post.

Andrew G Taylor on 2017-06-06 at 13:39 said:

"... if the Men's Movement rejects MGTOW... and embraces innocence..." Inner and outer. This is something I'm trying to balance in my life currently.

Auld Wat on 2017-06-10 at 10:39 said:

The last link appears to be dead. Thanks, its been fixed:

*Daughters of Shining Harmony*⁹⁷

Cologero on 2017-06-11 at 21:02 said:

"At this point it is not about destruction, but of constructing oneself at every moment, through a renewed act of love and renunciation, **on a plane higher than oneself** where there is the impassibility

of the Watcher or, better, the Lord, outside any storm or tumult whatsoever, whether interior or exterior."

⁹⁵<https://aristasia.wordpress.com/2007/09/17/the-feminine-universe/>

⁹⁶<http://www.daughtersofshiningharmony.com/>

⁹⁷<http://www.daughtersofshiningharmony.com/>

geirón on 2017-06-12 at 08:10 said:

Faith is many things. There is fideism and there is Fides, the goddess of trust and bona fides (good faith) in Roman Faith. 1 2 She was one of the original virtues to be considered an actual religious “divinity”.

Max on 2017-09-05 at 04:56 said:

There is no reason to beat down on Christianity while simultaneously promoting Mohammedanism unless the aim is precisely the destruction of the faith. If one were simply a lover of Mohammedans there is no need to waste energy on Christianity since the option lies open to move to the Middle East in order to pursue the dream, so to speak. Negative obsession with Christendom demonstrates a dependence, and the sympathy is due to both denying such a relationship.

4.40 The Temptation of Saint Anthony

The right to be free to seek out the truth [involves] the duty to devote oneself to an ever deeper and wider search for it.

POPE JOHN XXIII, *Pacem in Terris*

It is disheartening to listen to paid pundits — often earning 6 or even 7 digit salaries (in dollars) — making the most elementary errors in grammar, facts, and logic. In the USA, the rights to free speech and a free press are held to be sacrosanct. Unfortunately, this is usually understood in a nihilistic way, so that speech is an end in itself and not a means. However, as part of the US Constitution⁹⁸ these rights do have a purpose, viz., those explicitly expressed in the preamble:

We the People of the United States, in Order to form a more perfect Union, establish Justice, insure domestic Tranquility, provide for the common defence, promote the general Welfare, and secure the Blessings of Liberty to ourselves and our Posterity.

⁹⁸<http://constitutionus.com/>

Since the Truth sets you free, the Blessings of Liberty will depend on speaking the truth. Unfortunately, the Truth is often hard to discover, so the citizen is obliged to devote himself to the search. At the least, this requires a good foundation in grammar, logic, and rhetoric.

I listened to a few minutes of a political talk show this morning. The Host, who is more rational than most, was spending all his time in explaining a common logical fallacy that has been making the rounds. Obviously, wasting time on elementary logic is not conducive to a deep search for truth, so I had to tune to the opera channel instead.

This is not the place and time for a detailed discussion of logical fallacies, but a quick survey of commonly believed misleading thoughts may benefit someone.

Aging Gracefully The supermarket tabloid covers often show headlines about post-menopausal models and superstars posing in their bikinis or boasting of their sex lives. Note that men don't purchase those publications.

There is a TV commercial about some arthritic old guy who manages to complete a footrace. That accomplishment is supposed to elicit our admiration for the human spirit. As an alternative, let me point out that **Ernst Junger** published *Eumeswil*⁹⁹ when he was 82 years old. That is a real display of the human spirit.

So we propose this TV commercial. An old man, a former householder, becomes a sannyasi and achieves enlightenment.

Corporatism Left wingers misunderstand the term "corporatism" as used in Fascist Italy to mean what is called a "corporation" in the USA. Hence, they are incessantly complaining about "corporate power". However, corporations, as for-profit business entities, are usually the engines

⁹⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=9186>

of social leftism. They have even managed to overturn laws passed by elected officials in several states.

Actually, corporatism¹⁰⁰ has its roots in Ancient Greece, the Middle Ages, and was further developed in the 19th century by Pope Leo XIII. A modern economy can be divided into various business sectors. Ideally, each sector would involve the cooperation of government, business, and labour interests. Consider how trade, immigration, and social policies would differ if labour were part of the decision-making process.

In the current state of affairs, corporate power dominates life much more than the totalitarian governments of the past.

Statistical Intelligibility **Bernard Lonergan**, in *Insight*, added the notion of statistical intelligibility to the classical notion of intelligibility. In brief,

A statistical intelligibility is grasped by an inverse insight that there is no direct insight available. But while we often understand that many events cannot be functionally related to each other, we also may understand that an entire set of such events within a specific time and place will cluster about some average.

As a thought experiment, consider a naïve scientist who wants to study the tossing of a coin. He runs samples of 100 tosses, assigning 1 to heads and 0 to tails. Try as he might, he is unable to find any predictive pattern of 1's and 0's in his samples. At first, he is disappointed because a scientist's goal is "direct insight", i.e., he wants to discover a law about the outcome of the tosses and how each toss is related to its predecessor.

He then graphs his samples, and surprisingly noticed a pattern in the graphs, forming what is now called the "bell curve". He manipulates the numbers, eventually discovering the average number of heads in a sample and even derives secondary information such as standard deviations.

¹⁰⁰<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Corporatism>

This is quite remarkable. Even though each individual coin toss is independent, and has no relation to what came before or after, as a whole, there is a recognizable pattern. This statistical intelligibility of the sample set is misunderstood in common discourse to be a judgment on the individual samples. This makes conversation quite difficult with those who don't understand statistical intelligibility.

Nominalism and Realism This hoary distinction is worth mentioning again. For those who may have missed it, nominalism is the notion that words are arbitrary human constructions; realism, then, is that words describe the essential nature of what they signify. There is a communications gulf between the two notions: a nominalist can make a statement in sincerity that sounds bizarre to a realist.

Consider this. Joe says, "As an atheist, I believe in God." That is an obvious self-contradiction for the realist, since he understands the term 'atheist' to entail the denial of God's existence. Now, a nominalist cannot logically reject that statement, since Joe's self-identity is his own choice. Nevertheless, that is a bit much. However, suppose Mary claims, "I am a Mormon but I don't believe in God." A realist would say that Mary is not a "real" Mormon, but merely a nominal Mormon. But nominalists are comfortable with that. Typically they might cite a study that says 20% of Mormons are like Mary.

A farmer's product might be wheat; a builder's, a house; and so on. But for the intellectual class — e.g., journalists, lawyers, politicians — their very product is words. That is why, in the news media, concrete acts matter less than what people say, and beliefs are more important than truth. Hence, the discussion is primarily about who said what, what terms were used, how quickly did he say it, and the like. This class is entirely nominalist and has taken the place vacated by an ineffectual spiritual caste.

As **Martin Heidegger** said, language is the house of being in which

humans dwell. Hence, whoever controls the use of language, then controls humans. That would be a blessing, if that class were dedicated to the truth and the moral betterment of the human race. You would think that someone whose life work depends on words, would be dedicated to the Trivium: grammar, logic, and rhetoric. Then language would reach a lofty place. Unfortunately, that is hardly the case, which Heidegger described:

the widely and rapidly devastation of language not only undermines aesthetic and moral responsibility in every use of language; it arises from a threat to the essence of humanity.

The realist understands truth, goodness, and beauty to be realities to be discovered. The nominalist considers them to be social constructs. Hence, whoever controls discourse, thereby constructs society. In Heidegger's words:

language surrenders itself to our mere willing and trafficking as an instrument of domination over beings.

Traditionalism vs Tradition A common misunderstanding, at least in certain limited circles, is that **Rene Guenon** inaugurated a new "school" of thought called "Traditionalism". Thus, they believe it be debated and critiqued like any other philosophical or intellectual system. Guenon is trying to be descriptive, not prescriptive. Hence, it makes no sense to become a "traditionalist", but rather, one needs to follow a particular tradition. In his study of various traditions, he noticed certain common features. If you are so inclined, you don't refute him by an argument, but rather by denying those features. Ultimately, all the traditions accepted by Guenon as authentic are of two types:

- **The pagan traditions**, which derive from Hinduism. This includes Taoism, Buddhism, and the various folk religions of Europe.

- **The Abrahamic traditions**, which include Judaism, Islam, and Christianity. It is not always so neat, since the latter borrows heavily from the Greek and Roman religions.

These are the main characteristics that Guenon identifies. I won't justify them all here, since there are plenty of posts that do so.

- Each tradition claims to be salvific. Other traditions may deny that claim, or claim exclusivity, but that is besides the point.
- There is an exoteric aspect to the tradition, suitable for most people.
- There is an esoteric aspect, which is open to a limited number.
- The traditions assume a common metaphysical framework. For example, in the Medieval Period, pagan philosophers (Plato, Aristotle, Plotinus), Jewish philosophers (Maimonides), Islamic philosophers (Averroes), and Christian philosophers (Augustine, Thomas Aquinas) were able to engage in fruitful exchanges of ideas.
- Social organization is based on caste, although their manifestations differed. This is not the ideal, but rather the actual, state of things since castes are based on human nature. Some types are more suited for spiritual and intellectual tasks, others for political and military tasks, and others for trade. A disordered society has not overcome castes, but rather has placed people where they don't belong.

So a man who is familiar with Guenon's ideas and follows a Tradition such as Traditional Catholicism is ipso fact a "Traditionalist". You can perhaps dispute about his level of understanding if you are so inclined, but then you will be judged by the same standard. Obviously, not everyone will follow an esoteric path or be adept at metaphysical ideas, but

that is what we would expect. There is a statistical intelligibility even in this regard. Moreover, someone of the political or merchant caste would be unsuited for deep esoteric ideas.

Greek Popes There were a couple of centuries during the early Middle Ages when the Byzantines dominated the Roman papacy¹⁰¹. Greek, Sicilian, and Syrians accounted for a large number of popes. You would think that if the Byzantines had any objections to the idea of the papacy, that would have been the time to bring it up.

On the theory of “better late than never”, the Greeks seem obsessed with it now. There are several Orthodox denizens on the Internet, particularly converts, who have a similar mentality to the “Social Justice Warrior”. They persistently battle Rome, or often its egregore, pointing out its alleged flaws. The somehow manage to find motes that few can see. They take pride in not having a pope, although logically, they should then reject the Patriarchs as the centre of spiritual authority.

It is well known that Guenon determined that the Roman religion had lost some of her traditional elements. Of course, that is not a metaphysical certainty, rather a contingent fact that may or may not be true. Then, again, that is to be expected according to traditional teachings. Several saints have had premonitions about the failure of the popes and priests to uphold the true tradition.

Some Orthodox Warriors believe they are immune to that decline. They complain that Guenon was ignorant about the East, or he would not have had such a view about the state of the Christian religion. That is ridiculous. From Rome’s perspective, which was also Guenon’s, there was a schism between East and West. A schism is solely an administrative dispute about which priests are in charge of things. There is no difference between the religion, or tradition, of the East and West. There is at most a difference in emphasis, or in customs that may appear alien.

¹⁰¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Byzantine_Papacy

I recently encountered a blog that was critical of Catholic saints. For example, the author was critical of St. John of the Cross, whose three stages of the spiritual life can be traced back to Dionysius. He then turned to St. Ignatius of Loyola, even quoting from the *Philokalia* to condemn the Jesuit founder. This irony was lost on that poor fellow. The compiler of the *Philokalia*, St. Nicodemos, was actually quite impressed by St. Ignatius, even translating his *Spiritual Exercises* into Greek! You are taking a big risk to your spiritual life when you engage with these Orthodox warriors.

It is a shame to see self-loathing Westerners reject the Traditions of their fathers and apostatize from their faith. There is much they have to give up, and it is seldom justifiable. The only case is a state of emergency, which occurs when there is no reliable Roman priest available. But, in that case, you will not become a faux Warrior. The irony is that while Western Lutherans are converting to Orthodoxy, Russian intellectuals are converting to Lutheranism¹⁰². I suppose that is not so surprising, since Fr. Seraphim Rose often boasts about how anti-intellectual Orthodoxy is.

There must be something about the Greek view of things that values Strife. Years ago, when the Greek church was built in Boca Raton, it attracted many Russians who did not have a church of their own. On one occasion, there was a dispute about the appointment of a new priest that became so serious, so that the Police had to intervene during Mass to break up the fight. Since then, they have managed to produce the best Greek Festival from miles around.

At the end of the Latin mass, we pray for reconciliation with the East. The Orthodox warriors, on the other hand, are often addicted to strife, dissension, and the party spirit¹⁰³. The best course would be to end

¹⁰²<http://www.patheos.com/blogs/geneveith/2017/08/lutheranism-app-eals-russians/>

¹⁰³<https://biblehub.com/context/galatians/5-19.htm>

the schism. Perhaps, then, the Russian patriarch would become the next pope, which would be a blessing for all. Then we would just need the Emperor.

Conservatism vs Populism Finally getting around to spring cleaning, I found some old magazines¹⁰⁴ from around 20 years ago. One article listed the following points as fundamental to conservatism as it was understood at that time:

- Immigration control (as opposed to open borders)
- Economic nationalism (as opposed to globalism)
- Military isolationism (as opposed to adventurism)
- Social issues (not just sexual)

Curiously, those same points are dismissed as “populism” and soi-disant conservatives today typically reject those points.

The Descent into Hell There have been several movies and books describing wonderful and peaceful postmortem experiences in Heaven. There is some truth about the experiences, although it only signifies the detachment of the soul from the burden of the body. Of course, that seems peaceful, but the experience can be replicated in deep meditation, so it is not a sign of death and a return.

In **Dante’s** *Divine Comedy*, we learn that the path to Heaven passes through Hell. The fear and dread of traversing Hell prevents most people from even beginning the journey.

¹⁰⁴<https://www.chroniclesmagazine.org/>

The Problem of Masturbation Last night, I was awakened in the middle of the night by a bad dream. I had a little erection so I considered masturbating in order to relax and get back to sleep. I couldn't quite remember the last time I did that, so perhaps it might be OK to try it again. It all sounded so logical. However, further thought — for several reasons — dissuaded me from acting on that thought.

We can speak openly of such things today. This is unlike **Athanasius's** *Life of Saint Anthony* which simply described the attack of demons during the night, without describing the temptations in detail. Obviously, that act creates an opening for demonic influences to enter. Demons don't typically announce themselves as evil.

Masturbation is one of the foundations of the modern world along with sterility, death, and drugs. They all make the population stupider and weaker. Boys will pay girls to play online games with them, or send tips to sexy models on Instagram. I know a computer engineer making a high six digit salary running a network of webcam girls. The power of that temptation is nearly overpowering.

Posted on 2017-08-17 by Cologero

* * *

Fred on 2017-08-18 at 03:01 said:

An Orthodox criticising St. John of the Cross only shows prejudiced ignorance and hostility. There is an important athonite saint who read the dark night of the soul and was very surprised to discover noetic prayer in western christianity. He called St. John "a western hesychast who use a different language from the Fathers".

If people with actual experience of contemplation believe this why sould we bother with the opinions of those who had no experience of prayer and only judge according to futile mental rationalizations?

Also I would be very wary to say the pagan traditions derive from Hinduism.

Other indo-european pagan traditions lack what hinduism borrowed from the people they conquered (Rudraism and tantra were not beliefs of the aryaans).

Taoism is the native religion of China and is obviously not an indoeuropean religion.

Fred on 2017-08-18 at 03:08 said:

A paradox: sometimes I think the right Church between the Catholic and the Orthodox is the one who will be humble enough to accept the claims of the other.

(I had to make a double post because the button to send the message disappear at the bottom of the page after I write a few lines, I'll take this as a sign not to be verbose)

Cologero on 2017-08-18 at 03:40 said:

Thanks, Fred, for the anecdote about St. John of the Cross.

Yes, "derive from" is too strong a phrase, but that does not mean there is not a relationship. I had in mind the Vedas, not any later additions to Hinduism. Based on the works of Dumézil, there is a homomorphism among the ancient pagan mythologies. Check out *Interpretatio graeca*¹⁰⁵: even the ancient Greeks, Romans, and Germanics noted the similarity. They simply were not familiar with Vedic gods. So the idea of a proto-indo-european religion¹⁰⁶ is not so far-fetched.

In *Shakti and Shakt*, Arthur Avalon demonstrates that Taoism is a derivative of the Upanishads. I defer to his expertise in this opinion.

jean lave on 2017-08-21 at 14:47 said:

Hello

Taoism is esoterism.

Confucianism is exoterism.

Both together are the native religion of China.

According to R.Guenon St.John of the Cross was a mystic, and mysticism is different from initiation.

Hesychast is esoterism of orthodox christianity.

Beside mysticism is specific to christianity.(doesn't exist in orient)

Shall we admit that Guenon was one of "those who had no experience of prayer and only judge according to futile mental rationalizations?"

Sorry for my english which is not my mother tongue.

thank you for your blog.

in the Name of HE by whom everything exists.

PEACE

Cologero on 2017-08-21 at 21:40 said:

M. Lave,

¹⁰⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Interpretatio_graeca

¹⁰⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Proto-Indo-European_religion

It was a French priest, Father P. L. Wiegner, S.J, who noted that Taoism is likely a development from the Upanishads. Please look at *Shakti and Shakta*¹⁰⁷ by Arthur Avalon. China had a native folk, shamanic religion long before Lao Tzu and Confucius.

I can't judge about R. Guenon, as we know nothing about his experiences in Egypt. That is why I don't agree with his "impersonal" approach. Instead, it is possible to be "personal" in an impersonal way. For example, I believe it is helpful to describe in some detail how to deal with tempting thoughts and images, or how to achieve concentration without effort. That is the bare beginning of the hesychast path, in case you don't have your own hesychast teacher. In that case, it is better to at least discover what you are capable of. Hesychasts won't bother to read this.

I'll accept Fred's comment on John of the Cross. How can the uninitiated judge an initiate? or even a "mystic" for that matter. If John of the Cross achieved theosis, then he is a hesychast.

Fred on 2017-08-23 at 13:23 said:

I am familiar with the writings of Guenon and can safely affirm that he fell into a deep misconception by calling St. John of the cross a simple non esoteric mystic, as if St. John was just one of those pious old women who had visions (the actual mystics he had in mind when he used that word)

And yes Guenon never followed a path of Christian esotericism, so on this issue (prayer and hesychasm) his judgment on st. John of the cross is weaker compared to that of st. Silouan (the saint I mentioned in my previous comment, although it was expressed through his disciple Sophrony).

For a deeper explanation of why the typical Sufi/Sharia distinction of Guenon is applied badly to Christianity read Jean Borella.

I long struggled with this problem and concluded the ipse dixit of Guenon is not enough to solve it.

4.4I The Misuse of Intelligence

We have written this book, not for the irrational animals who, in their exterior, have the form a man, but in their image, in spirit, are evil and wild beasts, which is disclosed and exhibited by their

¹⁰⁷http://www.mysticknowledge.org/Shakti_and_Shakta-By_Arthur_Avalon.pdf

properties; but for the image of man, for those who are budding forth out of the animal image with a human image that belongs to God's kingdom, and who would fain live and grow in the human image, in the right man.

JACOB BOEHME, *Six Theosophic Points*

Pleasing One's Masters At that time, I was tutoring a middle school student at a swank private school. Tuition is more than \$30,000/year, so it is populated with the children of the wealthy and the powerful. The graduates move on to Ivy League and other top ranked universities.

The topic was the number line, with both positive and negative numbers. A typical exercise was like this: if the temperature rises from -2 degrees to +2 degrees, how much did the temperature rise? Obviously, the answer is 4. Then we came to this problem: a baby was born in 2 B.C.; how old will he be in 2 A.D.? The quick answer given by the student was 4 years old. Aha, I pointed out. There is no year 0, so the baby will be just 3 years old. He eventually grasped the point, so I dared him to speak up in class the next day. I tried to convince him it would be to his own benefit.

The next time I saw him, I asked how it went in class that day. He sheepishly admitted that he had said nothing, but went along with the consensus answer. **The real lesson he learned was this: The purpose of intelligence is not the search for the truth, but rather the repetition of what the system wants to hear.**

Progressivism as Intellectual Decline The sociologist **Christopher Lasch** described the rise of the new class that seized the role formerly held by the aristocracy of the *ancien regime*, although it lacked the sense of *noblesse oblige*. This sentence describes that class with precision:

Progressivism represented the ascendancy of secularized, deracinated élites enamored of the state, dismissive of tradition, suspi-

cious of community, hostile to the traditional family, and antipathetic to the America that had endowed them with privilege. . . . secular rationalists who took art and politics as their religion.

Lasch did not have a deep philosophical position, so his analysis ultimately falls short. That, however, does not discredit the historical trends that he documented. In opposition to these pseudo-aristocrats, Lasch advocated a form of populism. We don't know how he would have reacted to contemporary trends in populism, but we do know that the pseudo-aristocracy is vehemently in opposition to it.

There is an unfortunate misuse of intelligence. The promise of near universal education should have led to the rule of the best, a truly meritocratic state. Instead, this new elite was trained to despise the very people over whom, presumably, they were educated to rule. Although the quote above was made a few decades ago, the description is even more apt now. The points speak for themselves, so there is no need to go into more detail at the moment.

Those who are neither populists nor progressives can see both positions clearly. Unfortunately, just like the number line boy, the progressives have no interest in undermining the system that gives them legitimacy. Would that I could numb myself and become a progressive with a clear conscience. My social and family lives would become so much easier to navigate.

Types of Men

Man is as if he were three men, an **animal man**, as he is according to the senses, then a **rational man**, and finally the **highest god-like man**. . . One is the external, animal, sensual man; the other is the internal, rational man, with his rational faculties; the third man is the spirit, the highest part of the soul.

JOHANNES TAULER

Although Tauler's remark is consistent with St. Paul's teaching, it is never heard in exoteric preaching. Although in most cases this teaching is either unknown or poorly understood, there are sound reasons for suppressing it. Obviously, it is incompatible with the egalitarian attitude so prevalent today.

The main problem is that people will tend to overestimate their own progress. Anyone can claim, for example, to be the highest type of man, apart from any actual attainment. The Cathars used it to create a privileged class. Although people of the spiritual class claimed to transcend personal desires, in actuality they were libertines. This was justified by the claim that such liberties had no effect on them. The greatest danger is that the "animal man" may be associated with a particular race or ethnicity, i.e., a biological rather than spiritual state.

We had a recent comment from a reader who asserted that his spiritual director advised him not to read the mystics directly. This demonstrates the point about suppression.

There are Greek terms—hylic, psychical, pneumatic—for Tauler's classification, although "carnal" is often used for "hylic". The effect of religious teachings is different when they affect the different types. For example,

- **Hylic.** The hylic personality will be most impressed with material and physical issues. For example, he or she will be interested in miracles or other unusual phenomena, patterns of clouds in the sky, historical events (which are for reason called "literal"), and so on.
- **Rational.** This type loves to argue. He misunderstands spiritual combat to be some sort of intellectual battle of ideas. Instead of seeking wisdom like the philosophers, he enjoys "making a case", as the sophists would do. He maintains centuries old divisions,

regarding them as inspired somehow, instead of looking for reconciliation.

- **Spiritual.** The spiritual man wonders whether he should laugh or cry. I hope you find some sections of this post funny, or at least, you can tell which is which.

Psychic Reality Like **Meister Eckhart**, Tauler understands that the real birth of the Son is in the soul when he writes:

God accomplishes all His works in the soul and gives them to the soul; and the Father brings forth His only-begotten Son in the soul, as truly as He brings Him forth in eternity, neither less, nor more.

That would disturb the materially minded, the hylic personalities, who believe that the physical is more real than the psychical. Whatever his faults and limitations may be, Carl Jung seems closer to Eckhart and Tauler in his insistence that the psyche is *real*. For many, the notion that something happens in the soul means that it is less real, it is imaginary, it is all “in your head”. In opposition to that notion, Jung makes this claim:

It does not matter at all that a physically impossible fact is asserted, because all religious assertions are physical impossibilities. If they were not so, they would necessarily be treated in textbooks of natural science. But religious statements without exception have to do with the reality of the psyche and not with the reality of *physis*.

Now a **Rene Guenon** might object that religious statements are disguised metaphysical statements. Nevertheless, Jung’s observation is a good half way point, and may actually bear more fruit in practice.

Science and the Carnal Man Rudolf Steiner, in his commentary on Tauler, describes the limitations of science:

Man is entangled in the world of the senses and in the laws of nature, by which the world of the senses is dominated. He himself is a result of this world. He lives because its forces and substances are active in him, and he perceives and judges this world of the senses in accordance with the laws by which it and he are constructed.

This is the circularity of the deracinated, secularized, rational, scientific man. He is fundamentally a carnal man, a highly intelligent animal. However, all his science is self-confirming, so he is never able to break out of the circle to reach transcendent, or higher, knowledge. Steiner notes this anomaly:

Do we not stand above all mere conformity to natural laws when we survey how we ourselves are integrated into nature? We *see* with our eye in accordance with the laws of nature. But we also *understand* the laws in accordance with which we see. We can stand on a higher elevation and survey simultaneously the external world and ourselves in interplay. Is not then a nature active within us which is higher than the sensory-organic personality which acts according to natural laws and with natural laws? In such activity is there still a partition between our inner world and the external world?

A recent example is this study that finds it might not be consciousness that drives the human mind¹⁰⁸. The research notes that the carnal mind “gives us a feeling of ownership and control over the thoughts, emotions and experiences that we have every day”. On the contrary, the esoterist, the Hermetist, the yogi has known that for millennia, so the scientists

¹⁰⁸<https://www.sciencealert.com/research-finds-it-might-not-be-consciousness-that-drives-the-human-mind>

are wasting their time. The mystics understand that thoughts and feelings spontaneously arise, in a manner not unlike our experiences of the external world, so that they are not part of our “inner being”. They have developed practices to observe the arising of thought and the means to resist the internal programming that they represent.

Their conclusion is quite odd:

the contents of consciousness are generated “behind the scenes”
by fast, efficient, non-conscious systems in our brains.

We are left wondering how exactly does the brain produce thoughts. Is there some chemical formula or equation of physics that describes each thought? Since our lived world is the creation of our thoughts, it would be incredible if someone could describe a modern city as the result of some efficient system in the brain.

The denial of the immateriality of the soul is a misuse of intelligence.

A Liberal Mother Watches TV A young mother complained to me recently about the current crop of Netflix shows. It seems that they all portray the parents as bumbling idiots while the children are bright and sassy. (I have never watched these shows.) She considered them to be a bad influence on her young son, who was already prone to “talking back”. Genuinely surprised, I exclaimed, “Wow, I thought you used to be a liberal.”

She indignantly asserted that she was still a liberal, but that it is a matter of making “good choices”. Although this woman is quite intelligent in the conventional sense, she is like the number line boy who does not think very deeply about things. Unlike her, I see that Liberalism is the rejection of authority. This has been its history.

In this case, it is the rejection of the authority of the parents. For the liberal, this parental authority is not self-validating. From the child’s perspective, I suppose, he depends on his parents for survival. However, beyond that need, they might still be idiots. Ultimately, authority depends

on God, and parental authority is the first earthly commandment. The mother cannot see the long term consequences of her views, even when they are staring her in the face by way of Netflix shows.

The denial of the existence of God is a misuse of intelligence.

Menstruation In the seventh grade, a boy dared me to ask one of the pretty girls in the class to explain a Kotex to me; I was genuinely ignorant. This caused embarrassment both to her and to me, so I have since become cautious about being “set up”. Needless to say, because of that lesson, I remain quite ignorant, despite intimate relationships over the course of my life (i.e., before I decided to become “saintly”).

Now the Eastern Orthodox forbid menstruating women from entering a church. I presume, or at least hope, that is done on the honor system¹⁰⁹. Now the Romans don’t have that restriction, so it is probably one of the many heresies they accuse us of. Presumably, that custom derives from the ancient Hebrews, who had several rules relating to that topic.

I recently learned, via a youtube video, that the Brahmans of India forbid menstruating women from public worship. This is not surprising, considering that the Hebrews ultimately descend from Hindus. Now this Brahman offered a likely story¹¹⁰. He said that back in the olden days, the scent of a bleeding woman would have attracted wild animals, so keeping her at home was a matter of safety and precaution.

Around the same time I learned that at the French courts the scent of menstrual blood was considered erotic. I don’t know how the courtiers controlled the scent or flow before the days of Kotex and Tampons, but I don’t think men today have the same reaction. Moreover, it seems more likely from a Darwinian perspective that the scent of an ovulating woman

¹⁰⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Honor_system

¹¹⁰[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Timaeus_\(dialogue\)#Nature_of_the_physical_world](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Timaeus_(dialogue)#Nature_of_the_physical_world)

would be more of an aphrodisiac. But then again, the French aristocracy were approaching degeneracy.

Fapping on the Web I was invited recently to a secret facebook group that claimed to be transgressive, on the assumption apparently, that would appeal to me. Now a few members would post soft porn pictures of women every evening ... it must have taken them hours of searching through other facebook pages to find the most transgressive pictures.

In order to encourage them to desist from that practice, I commented: "You guys sure like to fap!" To my surprise, instead of an expression of remorse, shame or embarrassment, they boasted about how much pleasure they derived from fapping. After all, they pointed out, they would have no chance with such attractive women in "real life", i.e., carnally.

Since the leadership of the group was in the hands of converts to Orthodoxy, I should have pointed out the Orthodox teaching on fapping prior to my resignation. After fapping, in order to get right with God, a man needs to make 50 prostrations while making the sign of the cross. I suppose that for those callow fellows, that is a small price to pay.

The lesson: no matter their level of intelligence or learning, most men can't think of anything better to do than to masturbate.

Posted on 2017-11-27 by Cologero

* * *

Fred on 2017-11-27 at 15:05 said:

As I understand it he told me "If you are still Hylic you will misunderstand the mystics".

He didn't say hylic but that's the meaning: you can't understand what they mean by studying what their language says literally, to understand the Fathers you need a partially purified intellect.

No illumination without purification first.

Max on 2017-11-28 at 18:41 said:

The average person's limited intellect is exhausted by keeping up with what you are supposed to think. If directly commanded what is right and wrong those resources could be freed up for more worthwhile pursuits. The social consensus system ensures that it is only possible to rule through lies, whereupon the new elite assumes that the lie is a sign of superiority while it actually signifies privation. Empiric science cannot recognize authority as that is spiritual, a "nothing", and more often than not the recipients themselves are unaware of its true source and nature.

Here comes a contemporary lesson in how not to become "king", unusually perceptive for a presumed [recovering?] progressive:

"To help make my point, let's assume for a moment that Ken, instead of going for his singing career, had set out to climb Mount Everest – and failed. In that case, the public would not have set out to break him, and he wouldn't have allowed himself to be broken. The horrible thing about challenging the monarchy is that it is not 'real' in the way a mountain is real. There is no worse defeat imaginable than loosing to 'nothingness,' because not only have you lost, you've also had to grovel and beg for forgiveness from 'nobody.' Ken set out to fight windmills – and lost. It's no surprise that after such a loss, one hardly remains a man.

Thus, today's monarchy is no laughing matter, and definitely not something to be toyed with. It has overwhelming metaphysical authority. Challenge the monarchy, and your losses will be greater than you ever imagined. Winner takes all and the loser is screwed for good, left in a state of eternal disgrace from which there is no remedy." <http://www.askergren.com/monarchy.html>

Authority even this late comes down to us from a primordial sacred source no matter how erratic and wayward, – justified or unjustified, consciously seized or not – its descent may have been. The King, as Cologero pointed out via Carlyle in an earlier post, is he who can, making a necessity to resort to lies indicative of the opposite. In case someone can "tell it like it is" and remain unscathed take notice.

Gabe Ruth on 2017-12-01 at 17:13 said:

Conceiving as a result of intercourse during menstruation would be pretty miraculous, so there is no evo-psych story to justify the degeneracy of the French court.

Those crazy Orthos are something else. I wonder if Rod Dreher makes his wife stay home at that time of the month. I'm partial to the purported approach of the Alawites to this thorny issue. If you don't have a soul, why would you need to go to church?

Farewell on 2017-12-05 at 11:32 said:

"apostates to Orthodoxy"

I want to thank you for this, as lately I've been realizing just how heretical this site truly is. and with the latest post, my doubtrs have been finally confirmed. Thank you for providing

occasionally some good insights and sources. It was nice reading you all and may God have mercy on our souls.

Cologero on 2017-12-06 at 21:27 said:

Mr. Farewell, clearly you don't know what the word "apostate" means.

And it is sweet that you don't even get the irony of calling me a heretic, something predicted in the text. Of course, you have provided no example of heresies.

I suppose a "farewell" is good coming from you, since your fathers were more interested in fratricidal wars over alleged heresies. You can sink back into your safe world, thereby avoiding any future "good insights".

My apology on 2017-12-08 at 13:41 said:

I apologize for the previous comment. I was going through hard and turbulent time, and still am, so my mind wasn't clear. It's okay if you ban me from this site. Or if you can delete comments, that would be even better. Sorry once again.

Caveman on 2017-12-10 at 12:48 said:

I like your application of the term 'pseudo-aristocracy' to the new elites. Analogous to Guénon's categories of pseudo-initiation and counter-initiation, perhaps we might add the term 'counter-aristocracy' to designate bloodline descendants of the old nobility of ancient right who fell or sold out into consciously working against Tradition and the Christian project. Such counter-aristocrats ("revolting kshatriya" as Guénon would say) might have preceded the rise of the pseudo-aristocrats.

«But then again, the French aristocracy were approaching degeneracy.»

'Approaching' is a bit of an understatement. The royalty and the more urban nobility in particular were extremely degenerate. I have understood that much of the rural nobility was healthier and more traditional still.

«The promise of near universal education should have led to the rule of the best, a truly meritocratic state. Instead, this new elite was trained to despise the very people over whom, presumably, they were educated to rule.»

A universal education that is itself not universal—representing sacred and holistic knowledge (where something like mathematics for example is not allowed to develop into an isolated quantitative science)—could never achieve such an aim. It just proliferates an ignorance that sees itself as enlightened: and what could be worse than an inflated mental 'intelligence' deprived of the light of the Heart? This is the kind of 'intelligence' that leads gradually to the robotization of the world. The results of the educational system providing the formation of the present elites reveals that the development of this system even from its earliest seeds has not been driven by a force that is in service to the True and the Good.

«The Cathars used it to create a privileged class. Although people of the spiritual class claimed to transcend personal desires, in actually they were libertines. This was justified by the claim that such liberties had no effect on them.»

This is very much alike to left-hand Tantrics in the East.

4.42 Things have always been pretty bad

the suffering inside the Church “would have originated not from external enemies, but from within the same Church” ...

POPE BENEDICT XVI

The title was motivated by the idea that, as bad as things seem today, things were bad in yesteryear. So I used the story of Abraham from Boccaccio's *Decameron* to show the life of Rome in the 14th century. I followed it up with a couple of personal reflections, to which someone took objection. Her point it that it was an impious attack on the Church and harmful to the faithful. I omitted those reflections then, but have restored them at the end.

The issue is really about the nature of authority and secrecy. Criticising certain individuals for public faults is not an attack on the ideals of hierarchy and authority. After recent events, however, I can understand that point of view. Those in control of an organisation don't want their faults to be exposed, since it would undermine their credibility. This is more acute if the organisation provides an income. It certainly does not benefit the consumers of the organisation's teachings. Or “the rabble”, as this person called.

Jesus warned us about wolves in sheep's clothing. It is not a fault to point out the wolves, especially if the shepherds are unwilling to do so.

Hermetic Groups By their nature, hermetic groups form and reform as the need arises. Attempts to solidify them in an organisation with

grades, levels, etc. seldom last. When they do, the passage through the grades becomes perfunctory, and not due to any special knowledge.

Hierarchies arise naturally, those who have gone before, will help those who come after. There is no need for official grades, as a person can judge his own progress. Besides, you really can't fool the others in the group for very long. In our groups, we are interested in the "real" person, i.e., someone who is beginning to transcend his quotidian waking consciousness. Our so-called normal lives are of little interest, except when they provide the raw material for awakening to the true I.

Money, sex, and power are dangers to any organisation, so the temptation needs to be avoided in the first place. Recently a high-ranking Buddhist, close to the Dalai Lama, was accused of sexual exploitation. New Buddhist initiates are told that sex is restricted to vaginal intercourse between married couples. Does that mean one rule for the "rabble" and another for those in power? And did the Dalai Lama know?

That is why I reject the notions of anonymity and impersonality. Maybe at one time they served a purpose, but not now. Strange and contradictory claims often follow an anonymous writer after his death. The same applies to those who kept their personal lives hidden under the guise that only the teachings mattered. Not so. Ideas come alive only when they are in someone's consciousness; mere abstractions are dead ideas, not the sign of a higher calling.

I've been called vulgar, and of dragging the teachings through "rot and mud". That is the talk of LARPers, who role play as high initiates by putting on a certain appearance. The point, however, is to show that the path is difficult so that others will not be discouraged. Dante and Boccaccio, who actually were high initiates, are far more earthy than I am. Nor were they shy about criticising church officials when it was justified.

Secret Knowledge and Authority There is the idea the Hermetism is about learning some secret teachings. They are considered to be revealed

by someone held up as an authority figure. Even if you get a hold of the teaching, you are informed that you won't understand it without the "key" that the authority has. Or else, they hold out the promise of an even higher teaching.

Of course, that is only to protect the organisation. They create a cult of true believers who are high above the "rabble" and know teachings that are intended for "future" humanity.

It is just the opposite. We don't need yet another revelation, since we barely understand the ones we have. Hermetism is not about some secret teachings, but rather about self-knowledge. The teachings are only fingers pointing at the moon; the real work is in observing their effect in one's own being.

Knowledge, Being, and Understanding The distinction between knowledge of dianoia and gnosis of episteme seems hard to grasp. For example, I was just shown an article about the influence of the Golden Dawn, on the premise that it tells us something useful about Hermetism. Far from it.

Another way to put it is to make the distinction between knowledge, in the sense of book or textual knowledge, and understanding which transcends it. This is often represented as the "aha" experience when you finally "get it". I'm sure many of you can relate to that.

Zen abounds in such stories. The student hears the koans. He may "know" it, since he can repeat it verbatim, but he doesn't "get it". That is a sudden illumination, and there is no mechanical or algorithmic way to achieve it.

I like to use the analogy of a joke. You may have had the experience of telling a joke, but the hearer didn't get it. The hearer "knows" the joke; he can write it down, but he never understood it. Someone else, on the other hand, might let out a spontaneous laugh. That is analogous to understanding.

The goal is to raise one's level of being through the Hermetic exercises. Only in that way can the knowledge be understood. There are four levels of being.

- **Subconscious:** The twilight state, mental processes that are not consciously recognized.
- **Waking consciousness:** What the natural man considers his ordinary state. It is the subjective experience of the I, although most of the time he is mostly in a dream like state just below consciousness.
- **Self-consciousness:** This is the beginning of the awareness of the real I. This can come about through concentration, which gathers the disparate elements of one's psyche together. In this state, one observes oneself objectively.
- **Absolute consciousness**

What kind of Training Last week, I listened to part of an interview with **Timothy Dolan**, the archbishop of New York. In response to yet another sex abuse crisis, the Archbishop said that they now give training to those who will work with children.

Hearing that, I wanted to jump through the radio and demand to know: who the hell needs special training to know not to treat children as sex toys? A fortiori, anyone who needs such training in the first place is not suitable for the job.

Blaming the Victim Most of the cases involve teenage boys, around 15 years or so, and not children. I've sometimes wondered why these priests never got beat up. I doubt that my circle of friends at that age would have succumbed to any such proposition.

By the time my sons were 16, they knew how to handle a gun, they lifted weights with me, and fought in the PAL boxing programs. If they

had ever been involved in such situation, it would most likely have been a really bad experience for the priest.

The answer is that the priests know how to choose their victims. In the confessional, they hear who is confessing to same sex attraction. Most likely he would then offer extra counselling, but that is speculation.

Posted on 2018-09-28 by Cologero

4.43 The Hedgehog and the Fox

A fox knows many things, but a hedgehog knows one big thing.

ARCHILOCHUS

People can be like foxes or hedgehogs. The fox has a wide-ranging mind that is able to synthesize many ideas. The hedgehog is more plodding, focusing on one major idea. The world needs both types, even if most people are neither.

Tacit and explicit knowledge Michael Polanyi, in his book *Personal Knowledge*, made clear the distinction between tacit and explicit knowledge. Explicit knowledge can be communicated through the written or spoken word.

Tacit knowledge, on the other hand, cannot be communicated in that way. It is more like “knowing how” rather than in knowing. Tacit knowledge comes only by doing. Polanyi provides examples like riding a bicycle, learning to swim, becoming a wine taster, and medical diagnosis. Just reading a book or attending a lecture on those topics will not make you proficient in any of those activities. With rare exceptions, it is necessary to learn under the tutelage of someone else with more experience. Nevertheless, many people prefer to bloviate, as a simulacrum of tacit knowledge, without actually knowing how.

This distinction is even truer in esoteric matters. Reading a text has its place, but it is no substitute for the know-how of reaching higher states. The latter requires trial and error, with feedback from someone who has.

Faith Journey In this Lenten season, you may hear people discussing their effeminate sounding “faith journey”. That sounds like some sort of horizontal motion, whereas the Tradition always spoke of an Ascent to God. Most famous perhaps is **Dante’s** *Divine Comedy* which describes the soul’s ascent to Heaven.

St Bernard, who was a direct spiritual influence on both Dante and the Templars, made that the centerpiece of his *De Consideratione*. In the first book, Bernard criticizes the Curia for its worldliness and carnal spirit, even criticizing the Church as a den of thieves. Clearly, not much has changed in the past thousand years. The Church today, as an institution, seems more concerned about air conditioners and immigration than spiritual enlightenment. However, that has no effect on the Tradition itself, which is solid.

In the fifth and last book, Bernard turns his attention to God and the Angels. In contemplating them, the soul transcends the realm of becoming to find her true home. He said that the higher things can be known in three ways:

- By opinion
- By faith, which knows truths in a veiled way
- By understanding (or intuition or gnosis) which knows the same truths openly

Thus, we see that salvation comes not from “faith alone”, but from the higher intellect or gnosis. Faith sees God through a glass darkly, while gnosis sees Him face to face. **Giovanni Gentile** points out that these

three stages correspond to Virgil, Beatrice, and Bernard in Dante's own spiritual journey.

Bernard's teaching is not unusual, as I can provide many examples. But that just adds to the store of explicit knowledge. Tacit knowledge requires that one actually embark on the contemplative path described by Bernard.

The Crucifixion In the early years of TV, there was a show called *The Millionaire*. The premise was that an anonymous donor would donate one million dollars to a different person each week. The effects of that windfall on the various recipients created the drama of the show.

The Crucifixion pays off the debt mankind incurred from the Fall, restoring the human race to the status quo ante before the Fall. What have we done with the windfall?

Suppose Frank went into debt from gambling losses. Most of his pay check services that debt. Suppose that someone then pays off Frank's debt. Is Frank grateful? Check with a bankruptcy attorney and you'll learn that most people just go into debt again.

In the symbolism of the cross, the vertical bar has a twofold effect. First Christ descends into Hell, purifying all the lower elements. This initiates the process of regeneration that restores the human race to its purified state.

In the opposite direction, Christ opens up the way to ascent to God to everyone, not just a few initiates.

Chastisement Divine chastisement is the punishment of the human race. As such, it is the opposite of salvation. This may sound contradictory or even harsh from the viewpoint of explicit knowledge. Tacit knowledge, on the other hand, comes from actively contemplating the notion of chastisement.

The Hermetist **Eliphas Levi** explains it this way:

Man is himself the creator of his heaven and hell, and there are no demons except our own follies. Minds chastised by truth are corrected by that chastisement, and dream no more of disturbing the world.

In other words, truth itself is the chastisement. If one rejects the Logos or Cosmic Order, he will experience chastisement from that folly. Of course, God is also the True, the Good, and the Beautiful, so in a sense, it is God who chastises through his willing the cosmic order.

Valentin Tomberg makes this claim:

Is mankind therefore solely responsible for its history? Without a doubt — because it is not God who has willed it to be as such. God is crucified in it.

The world of everyday experience is anthropogenic, not God created. The crucifixion is the result of man's rejection of God's appearance and influence in the world. This is the result:

Man is from now on alone, hopelessly alone, left to himself, at the mercy of other men! Thus, it is vain to expect a further chastisement, as the absence of God is the true and supreme punishment of our crime of treason. God's Justice is exercised with just reason. As man in his mad arrogance has shown to God his will to do without Him, man's terrible punishment consists in being granted what he has asked for. Without God, man rapidly becomes the slave of his own pride and passions, a beast that lives only to satisfy his instincts.

CHASTISEMENT AND PUNISHMENTS^{III}

^{III}Dead link.

Post-mortem States *Pace* this bizarre rant Debunking the myth of hell, hell is not an arbitrary or cruel punishment inflicted on the unwary. A person who has no interest in God, or the things of God, in this life, will have no interest in God after death. We have all we need to be saved; take it or leave it as you choose.

Hell is the absence of God, and man is the creator of his own Hell. It is not a punishment, but a matter of justice. As Dante points out, the souls willingly take their place in Hell. They blame each other for their predicament, but not God.

The Religion of Europe We wrote previously about the Religion of Europe as envisioned by the New Right. While claiming the desire to “save” Europe, they reject the notion of Logos, cosmic order, and the true religion of Europe. Moreover, not to speak ill of the dead, the West cannot be restored by rejecting its real past and promoting a mythical unreal future.

By rejecting the religion of Europe, they necessarily reject the Tradition of saints, doctors, philosophers, poets, artists, knights, and so on, who created the West. They embody the eternal truth of “Catholicism”, not the Curia whose corruption today is no different from the Curia of a millennium ago. Whatever is of value in other Traditions can be found at home. Read the essay *Acres of Diamonds*.

Cultural Marxism You can love him or hate him. but Marx was right in many of his predictions. There can be no dispute that the technological and material changes in society have altered social behavior and mores. For example, better hygiene and cleanliness have made oral and anal sex more acceptable than what it was when bathing was infrequent. The wide availability of mind-altering drugs has had its consequences. And the mass media has made propaganda easier to promulgate to vast audiences.

The term “cultural Marxism”, although popular, is certainly redundant. The Communist Manifesto asserts:

The Communists everywhere support every revolutionary movement against the existing social and political order of things.

Hence, it is not merely a question of a new economic system, but the overthrowing of every hierarchical order. Don’t we see that today when every alleged hierarchy is under attack? If the question is why that is, Marx had anticipated the answer:

A spectre is haunting Europe—the spectre of Communism.

He could see the evil spirit of communism and its long-term effects. Even those who deny being communists nevertheless work to implement its programs. Lenin was incorrect in his belief that a violent revolution is necessary for the communists to take power. Remarkably, we see the advanced liberal countries voluntarily accepting the communist tenets. A voluntarily chosen democratic socialism is hardly superior to socialism imposed by force.

Survival of the Species Evolutionary psychology seems to have become the latest craze, even if it appears at times to be little more than a collection of just-so stories. One of the most recent goes by the name of the Jolly Heretic, although he has co-authored a book with Bruce Charlton. His hedgehog idea is that religious belief has a survival value for evolution. Obviously, then, the cultured despisers of religion are at an evolutionary dead end.

The Jolly Heretic asserts that behaviors that are evolutionary imperatives are then attributed to the Will of God, giving them a moral force. Here, in brief, are some of his main points:

- Believers have, on the whole, better health than the irreligious.

- Religion teaches that life has meaning, which has better survival value than the beliefs of secularists that life is random with no absolute meaning.
- Religious people have an in-group preference, unlike secularists. For example, marriages with someone of a different religion are discouraged.
- Reproduction and family are encouraged, unlike secularists who promote abortion, contraception, and infertile sexual activity.
- The more religious a society is, the more ethnocentric it is.
- One of his more startling claims involves the role of the Executioner. He claims that up to 2% of the population was executed for various crimes in the Middle Ages. This had the salubrious effect of eliminating psychopaths, sociopaths, and other reprehensible types from the gene pool.

The atheists and agnostics of the alt-right, with their love of genetics and evolutionary psychology, should take heed.

Posted on 2019-03-07 by Cologero

* * *

Han Fei on 2019-03-10 at 00:09 said:

The final part in particular piques my interest. To say that our ethical principles are tied quite literally, to the matter of our biological survival, is probably true, but not in the way that author intended it. God is hard working but not so hard working as to not let nature run its course once in a while. In fact I would go so far as to say the universe is designed in such a way as to not tolerate certain possibilities from coming about and persisting in a stable state. With that in mind, much of the moral compass of modern society depicts a road to ruin equally from the standpoint of judgment-detached science as that of a religious morality. I wouldn't

consider it at all anti-traditional to contend that the two aren't necessarily opposed to each other. Perhaps we did not know how this could be possible 200 years ago, but now we do.

The problem of course is that having come to accept (or argue from the standpoint) that nothing has meaning and substance beyond a hard code ingrained by nature in DNA, it would be very difficult to ensorcell ourselves to believe in any solution that directly contradicts this assumption. No matter how much he's convinced in the veracity of this causal relationship, he can't be one to partake in it.

I've made this available: *Essays on Catholicism, Liberalism, and Socialism*¹¹²

Years ago, I wrote a series on economic systems for a forum that is not longer online. I'll try to dig it up if I still have it.

Here is an article I translated: Economics and Spirituality. I have a few other translations on that web site.

There is a recent book, which I haven't read, that may be relevant to your concerns: *Why Liberalism Failed*, by Patrick Deneen.

Then there is the obvious option. If no one is doing a necessary task, they you could take it on yourself.

Many people have looked foolish by failed predictions of the end of the world. Science has predicted the end of the world in the past. E.g., Malthus, DDT, the population explosion (I can't remember the guy's name, but he was influential in the 70s), global cooling, the ozone layer, the book *On the Beach*, not to forget the heat death of the universe.

If you truly believe the world will end relatively soon, what exactly do you think I can do to prevent it? Or perhaps I am not even opposed to the end of the world. The end of one world is the beginning of another.

James on 2019-03-20 at 04:03 said:

I'm only going to assume that Arthur Konrad has a particular "message" he wanted to present via his reply rather than to authentically claim that Dante's poetry was motivated and inspired by personal rather than superpersonal considerations. Surely, his comment was simply weaponizing a single line and not an actual attempt at contradicting the obvious and intuitive fact that Dante's Hell is populated by those who willingly wish to be there. Surely this is some kind of strange and purposeful reading of his.

Still, I can't help but be nauseated by the idea. Assuming for a moment that Arthur Konrad as a person doesn't exist and merely the idea of "Dante places [the damned] in Hell according to his own personal grudges" is presented by some bystander: this is actually useful to examine.

¹¹²<http://www.gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf>

What kind of reaction is this? Is it not a purely superficial reaction? It is as if one were to read the Bible literally and only literally. It is the lowest and most primitive of readings.

Again, this has nothing to do with Arthur Konrad, but to simply examine what this comment might mean if we take it at face value.

The beauty of Dante's poetry is that it speaks of the universal in light of the personal. It is the very act of alchemically synthesizing the PERSONAL with the SUPERPERSONAL. It is an imitation of the Incarnation for it is in the Incarnation where we have the UNIVERSAL assuming a PERSONAL character. It is in the Incarnation that the infinite decided to be one gender, one man, one race, one place in time. He baptized the personal.

But look at the comment. It assumes that Dante makes arbitrary and personal choices. What this demonstrates is that the speaker of this comment "would not have recognized Christ". What I mean by that is that the LOGOS became a SUBJECTIVE person and made SUBJECTIVE decisions and teachings. His parables, His examples, His miracles, His healings were all meant to be understood not "just" 'his' own decisions but HIS decisions as well. They had universal import and relevance. The curing of the blind was not just his pity on the blind man, but His saving power on those who seek to see.

To be unable to recognize the universal and ideal in light of the imminent and personal is to fail the "test" of the Incarnation.

It is to fail the "test" of the Eucharist.

"Surely that's just bread." "Is this not the son of the carpenter?"

Dante speaks of lofty Florentines that we have never heard of nor perhaps have never been interested in. And yet to dismiss that as "personal" is to miss the very mode of God.

To be unable to understand this is akin to listening to old stories about a small race millennia ago escaping the much mightier Egyptians and wandering through the desert and saying, "I should not be interested because this is just a personal account of Jews" and "there is no value to be learned from the Exodus because it is purely the subjective grudge of the Jewish race."

The simpleton thus doesn't understand that it is also the story of the soul coming out of the slavery of sin. Again, I am not calling anyone a simpleton in any demeaning way. There are indeed people who possess the intellectual "dharma" of a simple person and that is totally fine.

For those who are not intellectual simpletons, there is a hidden and majestic universality to the intensely personal accounts of Dante's closest associates and rivals. Dante expresses fidelity to God's mode in that THE REALITY AROUND HIM WAS PLACED FOR HIS DISCERNMENT. The men and women placed in his life were not "random" but represented an EDUCATION given to him by God.

Thus, to extol and valorize—to purify and elevate the intensely subjective until it painfully reveals the universal is the intellectual participation IN THE BLESSED SACRAMENT. For the secret of the universe is that God has made this reality as a sacrament: that with the eyes of

faith, we can see the miracle of God consecrating the world and accepting upon the tongue and tasting it imminently if we are properly disposed. Dante's proximal relationships and his milieu were placed there by a guiding Hand and not a matter of chance. To be faithful to this "school of community" demonstrates whether we truly worship the God of order or if we secretly admit to being concubines of Chaos and Chance.

4.44 A Necessary Interruption

In the right order of nature, the flesh is subject to the spirit and not the reverse.

THE CLOUD OF UNKNOWING

UPDATE 12 March 2021 Cologero's surgery was a success. He is now in great health and, God willing, should be for some time ahead. He thanks Saint Elizabeth of the Trinity for her intercession.

Since Cologero is dealing with a serious health issue, he is undergoing rigorous tests. On top of that, he got dragged into a family squabble related to a small inheritance. So he asked me to fill in until he is able to get back to work. He has several posts in various states of readiness. I won't presume to complete them. However, I'll update some news items and discuss the future of our project.

Board meeting We took advantage of the Full Moon last week to channel **Losang Shenphen**, Cologero's spiritual director, to call a board meeting to discuss the last post as well as the possible future of Gornahoor. Cologero wants to offer a full confession, including a list of errors and refutations. I don't see that as beneficial at all. I proposed instead to commission a writer to summarize the entire web site.

My opinion is that it would help to re-organize the writings into a coherent system. Unfortunately, few readers know how to decode an esoteric text. Moreover, we have heard from a great many readers, who

would be interested in the material, except that they find it too difficult to read. Cologero chalks that up to the nature of things. I, on the other hand, believe it can be pre-digested to make it more practical ... i.e., to make it more in the style of a Deepak Chopra or an Oprah Winfrey.

Losang prefers not to worry about it, since a web site is by nature impermanent. He claimed he can gather the best posts into the Golden Book described by **Ann Catherine Emmerich** and hide it in the Mount of Prophets. We often have trouble determining when he is kidding or not.

Kidney Failure Cologero was informed last week that his kidney function has further deteriorated, to the point that he was placed on the Transplant List, waiting for a kidney, whether quick or dead. This has obviously changed his priorities. He still would like to translate some essential Hermetic texts, but that would require a sustained effort. Maintaining multiple web sites is a burdensome distraction. Of course, the Gnosis group is high priority, since a text alone is insufficient.

Post 1001 and Planning for Death The Board arrived at an impasse, and post 1001 may never appear, at least not soon. Perhaps in a generation from now, a professor, desperate for a project, may try to unravel Gornahoor.

One proposal was that after Post 1001, Gornahoor should continue in a different format. The obvious choice would be to integrate all the sister sites into Gornahoor, since it has established to a tiny degree, what is called a “brand”. Then we would invite other writers to contribute, as used to be the case a couple of years ago.

We thought about buying a 5-year hosting plan, in the event Cologero becomes unable to continue the maintenance functions. It would still require regular WordPress updates. Instead of that, we could convert the entire site to static HTML pages, but that would make it difficult to

update. No final decision has been reached. Apparently, we would need to appoint a Trustee for the site, assuming that is even a legal option.

Personal Library As you can imagine, Cologero has amassed quite a nice library on topics discussed on the web sites. It is certainly not full of popular texts, but a certain type of personality would be excited by it.

He is concerned that his heirs will just box them up and take them down to the used book store to cash them out. That possibility saddens him. He is not “famous” enough that a university would want the books. He is open to ideas.

Frater M Francis Mercuri, who published some posts here under the moniker Frater M¹¹³, died in police custody two weeks ago in Daytona Beach under mysterious circumstances. There has been a news blackout; I can’t find a notice in the local newspapers not in the police blotter. In other circumstances, the death of someone in custody might lead to street demonstrations. I guess Francis does not fit the profile.

A mass will be said for him at the Basilica of St. Paul on April 3¹¹⁴.

Entryism The **Society of St. Pope Pius X** has recently bought a church property in West Palm Beach. There are a mere couple of dozen participants at the moment, although the new building can accommodate 100 or more. If only there could be a concentration of people who could use it as a spiritual base. Ask Cologero for details.

City of the Sun In the Utopian society, The City of the Sun¹¹⁵, **Tommaso Campanella** suggested that older women could volunteer to sex-

¹¹³<http://www.gornahoor.net/?author=160>

¹¹⁴<http://www.legacy.com/obituaries/postgazette/obituary.aspx?n=francis-anthony-mercuri&pid=188392519#sthash.Mnbea84N.gbpl>

¹¹⁵<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=518>

ually service the young men. The USA has also adopted that system, although here they are called “high school teachers”¹¹⁶.

Electric Dreams Amazon Prime has recently adapted some Philip K Dick stories in the series *Electric Dreams*¹¹⁷. In *Episode 7 The Father Thing*, they have slyly inserted an alt-right meme:

our young hero Jack must save the human race while coming to terms with the disillusionment of childhood as he is among the first to realize that humans are being replaced by dangerous aliens

The alien who replaced Jack’s father gave quite an inspiring speech about how their superiority to the indigenous humans would be better for the Earth. I’m sure they had some valedictorians and entrepreneurs in their flying saucers. Nevertheless, Jack honored his father and rejected the proposal.

Epicenity If you believe that boys and men are becoming more effeminate, the trend originates in the 16th century, if you believe Campanella. He pointed to the prevalence of pederasty, sodomy, and whoring among the literary elite. That sound quite contemporary. Or perhaps, it has always been that way, so there is no “trend”.

Rule of Women International Women’s Day just passed a few days ago. All day, we were treated to statistics and exhortations about giving

¹¹⁶<https://www.bing.com/search?q=high+school+teacher+male+student&form=EDNTHT&mkt=en-us&httpsmsn=1&refig=bcffabfdaa9e44a7c11a858a0f253fdc&sp=-1&pq=undefined&sc=0-27&qsn=n&sk=&cvid=bcffabfdaa9e44a7c11a858a0f253fdc>

¹¹⁷https://www.amazon.com/Season-1-Official-Trailer/dp/B075NTXMN9/ref=sr_1_1?s=instant-video&ie=UTF8&qid=1520825550&sr=1-1&keyword=s=electric+dreams

women more power and money in society. That is a generally accepted good, except that the God of the Old Testament regards it as a punishment. He will remove the strong and reliable men as this threat makes clear:

For behold the sovereign the Lord of hosts shall take away from Jerusalem, and from Juda the valiant and the strong, the whole strength of bread, and the whole strength of water. *The strong man, and the man of war, the judge, and the prophet, and the cunning man, and the ancient.* The captain over fifty, and the honourable in countenance, and the counsellor, and the architect, and the skillful in eloquent speech.

ISAIAH 3:1-3

This will be their punishment:

And I will give children to be their princes, and the effeminate shall rule over them.

ISAIAH 3:4

This is the result:

As for my people, their oppressors have stripped them, and women have ruled over them.

ISAIAH 3:12

Is it any wonder that Marcionism has taken such hold?

Posted on 2018-03-12 by Aeneas

* * *

Sometimes on 2018-03-12 at 12:35 said:

Frater M had numerous run-ins with Daytona police, including reckless driving while evading a police officer; a racially motivated beating of a Jewish teenager; beating a fellow skinhead; as well as an arrest in Pittsburgh when the apartment he was staying in was raided and weapons were seized in connection with a neo-nazi group.

He was an excellent acupuncturist, and an insightful Hermeticist.

james on 2018-03-12 at 15:21 said:

My heart is really saddened by this news.

Ana Madriz on 2018-03-12 at 20:45 said:

I am very sad to hear about Cologero's illness. I pray for your fast recovery.

Bernard on 2018-03-13 at 11:35 said:

My prayers to Cologero and his family.

Bill on 2018-03-14 at 12:35 said:

My prayers are of course with Cologero, but also with everyone, living and dead, who have been involved with this website. It is a source of unending inspiration and has been invaluable in my own education and formation. My every best wish to Cologero.

geirón on 2018-03-16 at 12:21 said:

Best wishes to Cologero's health.

Malcolm Pollack on 2018-03-16 at 12:55 said:

Oh dear – I am very sorry to hear of Cologero's illness. Please give him my heartfelt wishes for a swift and lasting recovery.

geirón on 2018-03-17 at 14:49 said:

Why not allow an old man his confessions?

sindre on 2018-03-17 at 18:15 said:

I hope you recover.

Mikkel on 2018-03-28 at 11:53 said:

Feels like a flood of cold water. I hope Cologero's health improves as much as he wishes, my regards to him and his family.

To that eventual time, may we suggest a book sale through this site? A book competition entry contest? Perhaps a book lottery?

4.45 Pet Peeves

Reputations A friend's wealthy boyfriend claimed to know a "computer guy" who, he claimed is a "genius. He sent the genius to set up her vanity email account on her cell phone. After more than an hour, he failed to do so; he left her without access to email. I then had to go over to set up the email correctly. Now I understand it does not take a genius to setup an email account, but the story points out how reputations are made, usually undeservedly.

In another all too brief online discussion, I referred to the first chapter of *Revolt Against the Modern World*¹¹⁸. To my surprise, one fellow, who is internationally recognized as an Evola "expert", asked why he should consider Julius Evola as an authority on anything. In that chapter, Evola was describing the foundation of Tradition itself, not asserting his own opinion.

Speaking from the Heart Do not be awed by reputations, which are quite often undeserved. Learn to distinguish those who speak from the heart with gnosis rather than from the head with learned erudition.

The former is in the vertical direction: mystical experience leads to direct gnosis which is then, and only then, expressed in words. The word is a revelation of the mystical experience.

Erudition works in the horizontal direction, relying on intellectual studies, and knows about things, i.e., indirect knowledge. It does have its place, but not the first place. Intellectual concepts cannot lead to mystical experience.

¹¹⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=8408>

Degrees of Education Although many prefer to remain in relative ignorance — which is the natural state of man — there is the possibility of knowledge. Once the seven liberal arts have been mastered, there are three advanced degrees awarded in specialized disciplines.

These are the three degrees of education and what they should represent:

- The **bachelor** learns about all the various schools of his discipline.
- The **master** becomes an expert in one of them.
- The **doctor** creates his own school.

Doctors are rare, but many have the potential to become masters. Nevertheless, most are content to remain bachelors. Bachelors prefer to “refute” the work of a great philosopher, for example, with a pithy sentence or two. Or they will characterize epochs lasting centuries, or vast civilizations, in the same way. In short, their understanding is limited to what can fit onto a few placards.

Rhetoric Rhetoric is the art of persuasion. There are three modes to persuade an audience:

- **Logos:** by the use of logical arguments
- **Pathos:** by appealing to emotions
- **Ethos:** by appealing to “the guiding beliefs or ideals that characterize a community, nation, or ideology.”

Logos is seldom effective except among mathematicians. As an exercise, the next time you watch a “news” show or listen to a politician, take a step back to pay attention to the rhetorical techniques. Some examples

follow, without exhausting all the techniques. I will use commonly heard arguments about illegal immigration.

For Logos, they may try to point out the logical inconsistencies of their opponents. Or hardliners will appeal to the positive law, characterizing situations by their legality.

For Pathos, they will exaggerate situations to tug at emotions. Examples are the claim that Trump is “separating families”, one side calling it cruel and inhumane, with the other asserting its lawfulness. This is very common.

For Ethos, there is the appeal to allegedly moral values. Politicians will cynically bring up “Christian ethics”, even if they are hardly devout Christians, while, at other times, denying that the USA is a Christian nation. Or to be succinct, they will claim that a policy “does not represent who we are” — as though the USA has a monosemous identity.

God’s Self-Sacrifice Another commonly heard claim is that the “church” declined with the introduction of Cabbalistic methods during the Renaissance. This is another placard, which ignores complexities. As a point of fact, for example, the Orthodox Christian view on creation is virtually identical to the Cabbala.

Boris Mouravieff informs us:

Orthodox Tradition teaches that the Universe was created by a sacrifice of God. We shall understand this postulate better if we consider that it differentiates between the state of manifested Divinity and that of unmanifested Divinity — which is therefore limitless and free from all conditions. God’s sacrifice is Self-limitation by manifestation.

This is identical to the Cabbala teaching of *tsimtsum*, or God’s withdrawal and self-limitation. **Valentin Tomberg** explains why:

In order to create the world *ex nihilo*, God had first to bring the void itself into existence. He had to withdraw within in order to create a mystical space, a space without his presence — the void. And it is in thinking this thought that we assist at the birth of freedom. The void — the mystical space from which God withdrew himself through his act of *tsimtsum* — is the place of origin of freedom, i.e. the place of the origin of an “ex-istence” which is absolute potentiality, not in any way determined.

Otherwise God would be responsible for sin and evil:

The idea of *tsimtsum*, the withdrawal of God in order to create freedom, and that of divine crucifixion on account of freedom, are in complete accordance. For the withdrawal of God in order to make a space for freedom and his renunciation of the use of his power against the abuse of freedom (within determined limits) are only two aspects of the same idea.

God created Eden, not the man-made world of our experience. We know what to do to make it better, yet we choose not to.

Intelligent Children I live in a town where all children seem to be above average. Mothers are thrilled at their children’s academic success, and are justly proud of their sons’ intelligence. Women, if you can believe dating site profiles, are seeking intelligent men to be with.

The irony is that when those sons grow up, women no longer value their intelligence, or more precisely, they value intelligence only up to a certain limit. They certainly don’t much value the opinions and ideas of men whose intelligence passes that threshold.

Fool Me Once I recently witnessed a discussion about a woman who was replaced by a trophy wife. Hurt, she turned to online dating where

she met a man allegedly living far away, although never in the flesh. After some time of communicating, he began asking for money, claiming various adversities. After he extorted several hundred thousand dollars from her, he disappeared. I find it hard to sympathize with her, although the women in the discussion did. First of all, a man should not be asking a woman for money.

Ultimately the fellow contacted the woman, and gave a full confession. Some of the women thought it was wonderful that, at least, the guy confessed and apologized. They can't understand that a psychopath gets a thrill of revealing his scam to his victims.

Prevailing Prayer Jesus didn't charge a penny to teach his disciples how to pray while on the mount. Even better, he gave everyone a free lunch afterwards. In our time it might cost you \$297 to learn how to pray. I suspect that the organizers of the Dream Trip Conference¹¹⁹ are praying that a lot of people sign up.

Correlation and Causation Bachelors will often interject "correlation is not causation" into a discussion. For the empiricist, aka "science", there is nothing but correlation, as David Hume pointed out: causation is purely a mental construction to relate commonly observed phenomena.

Cause therefore is a metaphysical, and not an empirically derived, category.

The Debate over Abortion

To limit the increase of children, or put to death any of the later progeny is accounted infamous.

TACITUS, *describing the customs of the Germanic tribes*

¹¹⁹<https://sparks.clickfunnels.com/dream-trip-2019>

The debate over abortion has become quite intense in the USA recently, so it may serve as an example of rhetoric and reputation. In the now infamous interview of Ben Shapiro by the BBC¹²⁰, Andrew Neil posited that the Georgia heartbeat abortion law was barbaric and a return to the so-called “Dark Ages”. Now I don’t know if abortion was illegal under King Arthur, but his illegitimate son, Mordred, was not aborted. Nevertheless, the king was perfectly willing to kill Mordred after his birth, an idea that has even been floated by some pro-abortionists. To kill born babies should seem barbaric to everyone, although you should not count on it.

If he meant by the “Dark Ages”, however, the time when the Roman Empire was taken over by the Germanic tribes, he may be correct. Rome’s population had been decreasing due, primarily, to the desire to avoid childbirth. There was discussion about that among the Romans.

On the other hand, the Germanics, as Tacitus noted, encouraged large families. Unlike the Greeks and Romans, who could put to death unwanted or undesired children on orders of the father, those Germanics did not murder their offspring. Readers will have to determine for themselves if the Germanic tribes were more or less moral than the Romans.

Presumably, then, the Germanics did not perform abortions. The issue depends on whether or not the foetus is a human being, at a particular stage of development. This is not an abstract question about when it becomes a “person” or is informed by a soul. It is biological reality. Many deny that the foetus is human, claiming instead that it is a “part” of the woman, like an unwanted tumour. Those who are more honest recognize the foetus as human but justify abortion because it is “trespassing” on the mother against her will. Curiously, the repeated mantra that abortion should be allowed for the “health of the mother” implicitly admits that the foetus is really a child and not merely an unwelcome body part. Obviously, a mother requires a child, although no one seems to acknowledge

¹²⁰<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6Vixqv0cK8E>

that contradiction.

The other argument of some nun named Joan Chittister is that to be “pro-life” means you should be willing to be taxed to support someone else’s children. That hardly seems just and I doubt that Sister Joan pays any taxes at all.

The anger among pro-abortionists arises from the change in lifestyle that would necessarily follow. Casual sex would need to be discouraged in a society where abortion was totally outlawed. It is easy to see what other changes to sexual mores would be necessary. Thus the emotional argument for abortion rights are quite strong and persuasive.

Anti-abortion laws as a policy can only work among a virtuous people and will never be accepted in today’s USA.

Posted on 2019-05-26 by Cologero

* * *

Balrog Booger on 2022-02-04 at 12:55 said:

I’m always fascinated by the state of the discourse on the abortion question. Almost everyone fails to grasp the deepest implication of this conflict. What women are demanding by full abortion rights is nothing short of sovereignty over the future of the entire human race; de facto matriarchal society. They are demanding that men be completely disenfranchised over the most critical issue of the secular world: what kind of people are allowed to be born.

I wouldn’t expect women to be conscious of this, since so much of their behavior is implicit rather than explicit, but men’s failure to recognize the stakes is disconcerting. Even in places like the `_manosphere_` and `_red-pill_` groups that specialize in such topics,

the vocabulary and rhetoric they use on the abortion question is still not much evolved beyond the typical political discourse of the normie world. This blindness exists despite the fact that they recognize the aphroditian quality of contemporary society and denounce women’s collective quest for power that comes at everyone’s expense.

Though, maybe that shouldn’t be surprising. The overwhelming majority of people in those Internet spheres live in the simulacrum created by their discourse rather than anything resembling reality. Women have collectively declared war on men. Will men recognize this fact and react accordingly before the catastrophe on the horizon arrives? It seems impossible.

Cologero on 2022-02-05 at 20:43 said:

It's a step too far to posit the "women have collectively declared war on men". It takes two to tango, as Confucius say, so men participate in the act. Don't forget that pain in childbirth – understood in a broad sense – is a punishment, so not all women desire it. As for the other point, women have always had sovereignty over the future of the human race through sexual selection. The alternative is forced marriage and that would be a hard sell.

Arthur Konrad on 2022-02-06 at 07:01 said:

@ Cologero

'As for the other point, women have always had sovereignty over the future of the human race through sexual selection.'

That would be akin to saying that Alsace and Lorraine 'selected' Germany over France in the aftermath of the Franco-Prussian war. We all know who does the selection. Sovereign is the one who is at liberty to make a choice.

4.46 Living in Interesting Times

When man knows himself in his deepest essence, that is, in the center of his being, then at the same time he knows his Lord.

RENE GUENON, *Know Thyself*¹²¹

Buddhist meditation, but above all that of Zen, seeks not to explain but to pay attention, to become aware, to be mindful, in other words to develop a certain kind of consciousness that is above and beyond deception by verbal formulas, or by emotional excitement.

THOMAS MERTON, *Zen and the Birds of Appetite*

Know Thyself I'm not opposed to book learning, since I have read a great many books, but the mere accumulation of erudition brings one no

¹²¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=58>

closer to gnosis. That is why futile debates about paganism, Orthodoxy, etc., are of secondary interest. This is the primary issue: which path brings one closer to self-knowledge?

Death to the World To regard the world process as causally closed is to condemn oneself to be blown around by the arbitrary whims of opinion and power. There is no solution to the problems of life within the world system. The world is the play of shadows on the wall. One must be attentive to the one way of escape, which is dying to the world, but living a higher life.

Love by Government Fiat

Because your attack thoughts will be projected, you will fear attack. And if you fear attack, you must believe that you are not invulnerable. Attack thoughts therefore make you vulnerable in your own mind, which is where the attack thoughts are. Attack thoughts and invulnerability cannot be accepted together. They contradict each other.

A Course in Miracles, Lesson 36

New Ager Marianne Williamson doesn't seem to understand *A Course in Miracles* [ACIM], on which she bases her spiritual and political positions. Her use of attack thoughts is totally contrary to the teaching. Is it merely a coincidence that her political platform is identical to all the other candidates, or is it more likely that ACIM has nothing at all to do with it.

For better or worse — and I'm not recommending ACIM — I did all the ACIM exercises for one year, in the 80s. The result is that I avoid speaking the way Marianne does, with all that name calling. She uses LOVE as a weapon to claim a faux superiority, as though no one else is

capable of Love. Or worse, those who love gather together in a partisan way.

God commands us to love, but the government cannot command love. The idea that reparations, or any other government program for material gain, will lead to love is delusional.

Unfulfilling sex Bonald, Jr. wrote recently:

John Zmirak admitted that unmarried people like he then was, struggling to obey the Church's teachings on chastity, were getting annoyed by converts going on about all the hot, mind-blowing sex they had before finding Jesus, and how it was so unfulfilling. Who doesn't want to be the guy who's so unfulfilled, so jaded, with being able to get pretty girls enthusiastically into bed with him?

WHAT COULD BE BETTER¹²²

Even Roosh, who had established for years a reputation as a pick-up artist, has had a religious conversion and repudiated his earlier life of non-committal sex. His conversion to Eastern Orthodoxy seems genuine, actually more genuine than the cradle Orthodox whom I've known. On the other hand, now in his 40s with a beard turning grey, his luck as a PUA has undoubtedly run out. Without money and fast cars, the young pretty girls won't have much interest in him.

Now he is complaining that he can't find a good woman to marry, despite all his alleged seductive skills. Teresa Chicalinda made the point that only a certain type of woman gets "picked up"; the PUA has only learned how to identify them.

Back to Bonald's point:

¹²²<https://bonald.wordpress.com/2019/07/26/what-could-be-better/>

Sex is a natural desire, and is a good, unlike the murder of innocents, for example, which is intrinsically evil. It is attractive because it is fulfilling, it is fun, and you meet interesting people. The issue is not sex itself, but its appropriateness; that distinction is too abstract for most people. It is the most difficult drive to control.

Yet, the Primordial Tradition demands mastery over the sex instinct: e.g., Hinduism and Buddhism both teach sexual control in order to achieve deliverance. This is not because sex is evil in itself, but because it dislodges the Real I from its rightful place and often leads to unpleasant outcomes. Abstinence from meat is a form of intentional suffering that aids in developing attention and self-mastery. Over time, that led to the idea that vegetarianism is superior for spiritual development. In that case, however, giving up meat is no longer a sacrifice.

This is analogous to sexual restraint. One masters the sex drive, not because celibacy is superior, but because there is value in intentional suffering.

Mary Magdalene The legend is that Mary Magdalene was a repentant prostitute, who eventually ended up in France where she lived a life of penance. A New Zealand professor was interviewed about Mary for *Crux*¹²³, but I heard the interview on the radio.

It was a typical postmodern performance, short on argument, but relying mostly on psychological nonsense and alleged power relationships. She asserted without ground that “sexual sins are the worst”. That is hardly the case for the reasons cited above. Dante placed sexual sinners at the first ring of Hell proper (there is no suffering in Limbo), precisely because it is the least serious sin. The interviewer was clearly inadequate to

¹²³<https://cruxnow.com/vatican/2019/07/27/could-mary-magdalene-be-part-of-the-modern-metoo-movement/>

the task. What exactly did the professor mean? Is she implying that adultery, for example, is perfectly normal and harmless? How about pornography, pederasty, or bestiality? Ultimately, it is not a question of drawing a line, but rather of where exactly to draw the line.

The professor did end on a sound note when she claimed that the sin of pride was worse. Of course, pride is claiming to know better than 2000 years of Tradition.

Chief Feature An important aspect of spiritual growth is Finding one's predominant fault¹²⁴. Gurdjieff often referred to finding one's "Chief Feature", by which he means the same thing. This is how the essay begins:

Each of us has a particular temperament which encompasses our whole manner of feeling, judging, sympathizing, willing, and acting. This temperament is to be perfected in each one of us by the practice of the Christian virtues. What can impede this work of perfection, and even bring each of us to our eternal ruin, is what is known as "the Predominant Fault".

It is easier to see someone else's predominant fault than one's own. Nevertheless, the importance of recognizing and overcoming it cannot be over emphasized. This is the result:

Before conquering the predominant fault, our virtues are more like good inclinations than true and solid virtues that have taken root in us. When, with God's help, we have overcome it, the virtues become firm and strong in the nourishing rays of Charity. Charity, the love of God and of souls, comes to reign in our souls through our predominant virtue. It transforms our temperament, making us more truly ourselves: ourselves without our defects,

¹²⁴<https://rorate-caeli.blogspot.com/2019/07/finding-ones-predominant-fault.html>

ourselves in Charity, in God. Peace will enter the soul, and the interior joy that it brings with it, because peace is the tranquility of order which we have re-established in our souls by our mortification, that is, by our struggle against our own evil.

Communist Jesuits The Jesuits finally revealed their true motivations with the publication of two articles promoting communism in their periodical, *America*¹²⁵. To wit:

This reduces a supernatural religion to the natural level, i.e., the belief that the solution can be found within the world process. Progress can be made only by individual efforts, by overcoming ones on faults and by becoming conscious of the forces opposing that. The communist way states that individuals can be made good by altering social structures and the material conditions of life.

Although the communist solution is abhorrent, there can be no objection to a just arrangement of things and to the improvement of economic circumstances. Nevertheless, the reduction of religion to a mere humanitarianism is a waste of time. The honest thing to do is to discard religion as do the real communists. But that would take away the privileges that the Jesuits currently enjoy.

Orthodox Purgatory

The life in Christ originates in this life and arises from it. *However, it is perfected in the life to come* ... It cannot attain perfection in men's souls in this life, nor even in that which is to come, without already having begun here.

NICHOLAS CAVASILAS, *The Life in Christ*

¹²⁵<https://www.americamagazine.org/faith/2019/07/23/catholic-cas-e-communism>
<https://www.americamagazine.org/politics-society/2019/07/23/why-we-published-essay-sympathetic-communism>

A theolougemon is a theological opinion. Fruitless debates arise over opposing opinions; the only solution is to penetrate to the inner reality that the opinion tries to explain. The reality is that there are three stages of the interior life: *purgation*, *illumination*, and *union*. One must embark on the path through these three stages in this life. Any unfinished work must be completed in the next, as Cavasilas pointed out. In Man's Spiritual Evolution, Constantine Cavarnos points out that there will be continual progress in the afterlife, and points to the teachings of the Fathers to support that view.

But isn't Cavasilas illustrating a process of purgation in the afterlife? When you bypass the opinions about the exact nature of postmortem purgation, the idea of Purgatory, as a state of being, is the same in both the East and the West.

Random Thoughts about the World Process Bill Clinton, back in the 90s, signed a crime bill that greatly reduced the crime rate in the USA. Twenty five years later, Trump signed another bill that overturned many of the features of the original bill, including the early release of some felons from prison.

I watched part of a Trump rally in Ohio last week. He boasted about the crime bill on the basis that it helped the minority community. His nearly all white supporters then clapped and squealed like trained seals. You could see them looking around the arena, and even the TV cameras panned the crowd. However, there seemed to be no black felons in the audience to show their appreciation to Trump.

Trump pointed out that Baltimore is infested with rats, has a high crime rate, poor schools, and a high rate of poverty. The debate took two forms: one was that Trump is a racist for pointing it out, the other was how to "solve" the problem. I propose an alternative: Baltimore residents should seek asylum in some other country, like Canada or Germany, in order to seek a better life.

It is claimed that Sweden has become the rape capital of Europe. Now, I don't know if all that is true. But there are some social experiments that can be tried. For one, send a gang to Swedish youths to Saudi Arabia to rape the local women, and then report what happens. Or English rowdies can go to Pakistan to groom school girls for a life of prostitution. Text me the outcome.

Some commentators on Fox News often complain about how the tech companies are deplatforming those whose opinions offend them. However, we don't see them, e.g., Alex Jones, E Michael Jones, inter alia, ever appearing on Fox News. In other words, they deplatform by omission rather than explicitly.

Eccentricity

In Mill's open society, **the individual with his absolute right of expression is then instructed that eccentricity is a positive good and that there is a duty to pursue it. That is, there emerges a public orthodoxy of eccentricity and this will drive individuals to the making of exorbitant and impossible demands upon society.** This in turn will lead to confrontation and the disintegration of society, for there is no center that can hold; more importantly, there is no obligation or duty for anybody to have since all things political are conceived wholly in terms of individual rights and demands. Into the vacuum created by disintegration will move force and coercion—in a word, tyranny.

JOHN EAST, *The American Conservative Movement*

Posted on 2019-08-04 by Cologero

* * *

Clive on 2019-08-05 at 16:35 said:

"[sex] is attractive because it is fulfilling, it is fun, and you meet interesting people."

....what....

I don't think we should go easy on sexual sins as though they're not serious. Dante may have put them in only the first ring of hell....but they're still in hell.

Cologero on 2019-08-05 at 16:39 said:

Good point, Clive. I was just giving the "worldly" attitude, but I guess I did not make it clear enough.

Ernest on 2019-08-07 at 03:34 said:

One wonders whether Cologero, Teresa and Losang are all just multiple personalities playing about in the very senile, yet interesting mind of this site's author. I guess we'll have to wait for 1001 to find out!

Logres on 2019-08-08 at 20:26 said:

Magic is playing an increasing role in politics:

<https://thehill.com/homenews/campaign/455496-marianne-williamson-supporters-organize-occult-task-force-on-her-behalf>

And there were the Trump workings, which backfired spectacularly during the Supreme Court justice hearings. So misunderstanding and incompetence seem to be the order of the day. It's almost as if people are wanting to use occult Enlightenment as if it was a scientific technology, which includes as a weapon of war.

"The professor did end on a sound note when she claimed that the sin of pride was worse. Of course, pride is claiming to know better than 2000 years of Tradition."

Zounds. Great point. Being logical enough to spot irony is an essential precondition for locating your "chief feature". Failing that, to follow sound teachers who point stuff out, but few like to follow any more.

4.47 Death and Final Judgment

Arseny's soul wanted to touch Ursina's soul ... Get used to separation, said Death, it is painful, even if it is only temporary. Will we recognize each other in eternity? asked Arseny's soul. That depends in large part on you, said Death: souls often harden dur-

ing the course of life and then they barely recognize anyone after death.

EUGENE VODOLAZKIN, *from Laurus*

Potter's Field

The potter's field was a mournful place... There lay the plague dead, pilgrims, the strangled, unbaptized babies, and suicides; those drowned by waters, taken by battle, murdered, and stricken by fire. Suddenly surprised, those who had fallen from lightning, dead from frost and every sort of wound. The lives of those unfortunates were varied and it was not life that united them: their resemblance to one another consisted of death. It was death without Confession.



EUGENE VODOLAZKIN, *from Laurus*

That was the situation in Russia, some six centuries ago. Potter's field was an open pit into which the corpses were dropped. Once a year, a priest gave a blessing, the pit was filled in, and another one dug.

If sudden death without benefit of the last sacraments is a curse, then presumably a slow death, preceded by a gradual breakdown of organs, must be a blessing.

A few years ago I was sitting across the desk of a specialist. He looked at my medical history and test results, then looked up at me. He read another page and looked up again. Finally, after he had read the full report, he said to me, "Well, at least you *look* good!"

Genetics and the Gods Evolutionary psychology asserts, without proof, that the existence of some deviant behavior must have had some survival value. But that is precisely the pagan view: whatever is, must have been willed by the gods.

Obviously that is both bad science and bad theology. Whatever genetic features (assuming even that it is genetic) exists is not necessarily selected. Rather it could be mutations that have not been eradicated. Deleterious mutations in the genetic code, or “genetic load”, are always arising. Moreover, there may be group selections: a disordered society may select for various psychological disorders.

True Providence is the Realm of Being, of possibilities of manifestation, the world of perfection. That is what God wills. The Realm of Existence, or Becoming, is less certain. Therefore, it requires discernment to determine the will of God in any situation.

Detachment from the World is Attachment to God I listened to an online sermon with the title Detachment from the World is Attachment to God¹²⁶.

Thanks to youtube matching, it pulled up a lecture by a yogi with the same title. It was not in English, so I don’t know what was said. I assume the point was the same.

The Last Judgment

He sitteth on the right hand of the Father, God Almighty, from whence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead. At whose coming all men shall rise again with their bodies, and *shall give account for their own works*.

FROM THE ATHANASIAN CREED

¹²⁶<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=40o8H01ob0o>

Before this throne, in my vision, the dead must come, great and little alike; and the books were opened. Another book, too, was opened, the book of life. And the dead were judged by their deeds, as the books recorded them.

REVELATION 20:12

The just shall appear whiter, more beautiful, and more resplendent than the sun. ... on the other hand, the bodies of the reprobate shall appear black and hideous, and shall send forth an intolerable stench.

ST. ALPHONSUS LIGUORI, *Preparation for Death*

According to the saints, the general judgment is the third coming of Christ, not the second that is commonly supposed. At that time, all souls will be exposed: some will be pure, most will be hardened and barely recognizable.

The purpose is to demonstrate the justice of the judgment. The consequences of one's thoughts, words, and deeds will be fully revealed. In our current condition, we can seldom see them beyond a few people close to us or a few years in the future. However, in the general judgment, we will see how our thoughts, words, and deeds rippled through the world and down through the generations. One bad choice now may be felt for several generations.

Our innermost thoughts will be exposed. Perhaps you lusted after your neighbor's wife, or worse, his daughter, or even worse, your own step-daughter. Maybe you gossiped about or harshly criticized a friend or relative behind his back; that will all become known. You get the picture. The point is to prepare for it by keeping your soul pure right now.

You say you don't believe in such superstitions. Does that really make it OK? Do you really mean that you can lust, hate, steal, or bring pain

just because no one will ever find out? That is really sad. You would be better off believing the superstition than believing your own denials, lies, and self-deception.

How could there be light for the man who obstinately rejects the light and how would there be salvation for the man who is convinced that he must be saved from nothing and nobody has to be saved in the inexplicable drama of life? God cannot give himself to those who do not want Him, to insist with those who are deaf and blind. Religion requires men of good will who adhere to and want to adhere to the Law of God. Whoever rejects it is judged by himself before being judged by God.

GUIDO DI GIORGIO

Posted on 2020-02-28 by Cologero

4.48 Tour Guide through the Ruins

The intelligent will converge to a common worldview, but the ignorant believe all manner of things.

OLD WIVES' TALE

Justice means minding one's own business and not meddling with other men's concerns.

PLATO

The end of thinking¹²⁷ is called being empty-headed. Many are like that. Actually, the world would improve if more people stopped thinking altogether.

¹²⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=2369>

THE GYPSY LADY WITH A GOLD-CAPPED TOOTH

It seems that, especially during trying times, that “public” intellectuals feel obliged to proffer profound sounding opinions on current events. The topics include self-alienation, social isolation, and so on: usually plausible rearrangements of ready-made ideas. These get repeated on social media due primarily to the alleged reputations of the writers, rather for their actual content. Moreover, it is always an obscure “they” who are responsible. That is the opposite of the noble attitude:

Nobility, the quality which I call true aristocracy, requires of a man the recognition of his guilt. *The sense that one is being continually affronted is on the other hand, precisely a plebeian feeling.*

NICOLAI BERDYAEV

Why Consciousness The idea of alienation has a long past, so it has hardly made its appearance in the modern world. It was the showpiece of Karl Marx, but even the ancient Gnostics understood it well. You can lament about nature red in tooth and claw, natural disasters, or man as wolf to man. The Gnostics experienced that in its depth and concluded that only an evil demiurge could have created this world. What makes it so horrific is that man is fully conscious of such horrors, although his consciousness is entirely passive: an observer, yet impotent to do anything about it. What then is the point?

Of course, those influenced by “science” believe the same thing, don’t they? Their claim is likewise that consciousness is a mere epiphenomenon with no causal efficacy. Hence, did it arise just to be acutely aware of pain and suffering? Unlike the Gnostics, the new intellectuals continue on with the bourgeois existence, without taking their own theories seriously.

There is quite an abyss between cerebral knowledge and knowing it in your lifeblood.

Why Disasters A popular lament is, “why does God permit evil in the world?” Then the semi-intelligent will conclude that God is either not all good or not all powerful, usually with a smug grin on their face. Actually, we have known for quite some time how and why death entered into the world.

An interesting thought experience would be to design a world in which free beings exist. I am not considering a so-called “computer simulation”, which would be nothing other than the demiurgic world recognized by the Gnostics; I mean a world in which there are actually free beings. It might not be so different from our world if you do it right. In a totality, everything is necessarily interrelated; that is the clue.

There are two considerations: (1) natural evil caused by physical events and (2) moral evils brought about by humans. Death often comes by surprise. Even the Buddhists know it since they claim, “The fact of death is certain, the time of death is unknown.” Hence there is no reason to conclude that mass deaths in a natural disaster is qualitatively different from a fatal motorcycle accident of an individual. The world operates by natural laws, which are discoverable. The challenge is to build better technology, such as improved building standards in areas prone to earthquakes or hurricanes.

Do you really want God to prevent moral evils? For example, suppose you log into your favourite webcam girl and start fapping. Suddenly, the God squad bursts into the room and zips up your pants. Or you fudge your timesheet at the office and Jiminy Cricket steps in and re-enters the correct numbers. Or you get wired up to receive an electric shock to your brain whenever you fantasize about your neighbour’s wife.

I doubt that program would last more than a day before widespread protests erupted. Men are quite content to continue in their sinful ways while simultaneously blaming God for allowing evil.

Gift Giving Gift giving is a traditional practice. Not so long ago, it was common to bring a dessert or wine when invited to someone's house. Men today seem to be less conscious of that tradition. Nevertheless, it is good practice to offer a gift when requesting time or service from someone, although it is not mandatory, nor even a condition for that service. Yet, if you ask your buddies to help you move, don't you spring for lunch and have cold beers ready for them afterwards?

Obviously, thanks be to God, I don't need a web presence to pay my bills and hope it remains that way. In any event, it would be impossible given the low volume of readers. And I don't need to appeal for "tips" like some waitress in a cocktail bar. I can afford to keep the web site online for the foreseeable future, but that is not the point.

To prove me wrong, more than a few people have asked me to restore the gift button. Many of them have been overly generous, for which I am very thankful.

Someone recently told me that most of Gornahoor's pageviews are from bots. In that case, I plan to program my own bots in Python; perhaps I'll get better comments that way. (You don't see the rejects.)

The Almost Life In the second volume of *My Brilliant Friend*, Lila is stuck in a Neapolitan ghetto with a husband she does not love, a job she hates, and no friends. Elena has been able to escape by following all the rules, making the right connections, and not making waves. Her life is safe and predictable.

The contrast with her best friend Lila is jarring. Elena suddenly realizes has been living a "quasi", an "almost" life, falling short of full commitment. She is on a path to conventional success. Lila, on the other hands, knows no bounds, acts out her emotions with abandon, and pushes things past socially acceptable limits, even to the point of hurting others and especially herself. Nevertheless, for me the idea of an "almost" life is the more terrifying alternative.

Male Pronouns An apparently well regarded female theologian¹²⁸ was plagued by this profound observation:

What is the significance of saying that Christ came down from heaven “for us men and for our salvation”?

She seems to believe that it is anti-woman, when it is actually anti-man. Women get their very own pronouns, but men have to share theirs. The change to “for us women” deliberately excludes men, but as it stands, it includes females as well as men. That is why the grammatically challenged practice of using an explicitly female pronoun where the male pronoun is grammatically correct. (e.g., “to each his own”) This professor doesn’t understand that grammatical gender is different from biological sex. Speakers of Romance languages should probably grasp that idea better.

The consequences are immense. That is why we can speak of “women’s rights” but not of “men’s rights”. The former conception definitively indicates females, but the latter is ambiguous: does it mean rights for males alone or for all humans, of whatever sex? This is so obvious that even professors can’t grasp it.

Love at First Sight I watched *Stagecoach* (1939) a few nights ago, starring **John Wayne**. The banker sounded like a guest on Fox News: His opening statement was, “What’s good for banks is good for America”, he then complained about the National debt then at \$1 billion, and concluded, “we should have a businessman as president.”

In the movie, the banker got arrested at the end, unlike real life, in which they get bailed out.

John Wayne proposed marriage to a woman he had just met on the stagecoach ride. (i.e. What romance was like before Tinder.) Love at first

¹²⁸<https://womenintheology.org/2016/02/16/theologienne-theologien-theologian-from-angelique-arnauld-to-mary-daly/>

sight was common in old movies. That actually is rather easy, but love six months later is a much different movie.

Loving your Tradition Although we believe in the superiority of our Tradition, that is not intended in a triumphalist ways nor do we necessarily need to promote or try to demonstrate it. We have readers from around the world with different beliefs. Rather, we mean it in this sense:

If I love my wife, I will not covet your wife. That is your business. Furthermore, if I love my wife, I will not say to her, "Honey, I love you but there are probably 5 or 10 other women who could have made me equally happy." Not at all, I will tell her, "Honey, you are the only one for me," and mean it.

Far too many people presume that the Church simply refers to the practices, deeds, and misdeeds of a particular terrestrial organisation. That is far, quite far, from the truth. The Church in her fullness has three branches: the Church Militant (earth), the Church Suffering (purgatory), and the Church Triumphant (Heaven)¹²⁹.

On earth the Church Militant includes the apostles, martyrs, theologians, saints, artists, poets, doctors, philosophers, and so on. Those represent the sources for our worldview. That is why we are little disturbed by the antics of any particular pope, bishop, or priest.

The dogma that the gates of hell shall not prevail against the Church must be understood in her threefold fullness, even though buildings may fall and men might fail.

Choosing the Team When I was a young boy, we would organise baseball games on our own, without adult supervision. The two best players, would choose the teams, each one in turn selecting one of the boys. The better players would be chosen first, and the least competent would be

¹²⁹<https://diocesan.com/church-suffering-militant-triumphant/>

last. Competence was the sole criterion; there was no favouritism, no one could bribe his way onto a team, and diversity was unheard of. This was no feeling of injustice in that process, since we all knew our ranks. Looking at this a day later, perhaps there was resentment; they turned into the Boomer socialists.

During the worldwide lockdowns, we've learned that we can live just fine without professional sports, but not the workers at power plants. As captain of a team, as if your life depended on it, which of these would you choose first: a "news" channels or a meat packing plant?

Given the collapse of many economies around the world, we can see who is necessary and who is not. It is clear we can do without professional athletes, talking heads newscasters, and so on. So, were I a team captain, I would choose the power plant workers, farmers and ranchers, truck drivers, meat packing plant workers, and so on. Athletes, actors, Broadway musicals, and so on would be left on the sidelines.

Family Values Talk today about family values is completely misguided, as it has degenerated to nothing more than a so-called nuclear family with bourgeois values. It is all exterior, in appearance only. The character and achievements of the family members are barely taken into consideration, so one wonders exactly what values are meant.

Traditionally, family values were understood as multi-generational. What has the family contributed to the wider society? At the top are the rare families who produced statesmen, bishops, artists, scientists, musicians, and so on. Nevertheless, it is not too late to work on your own family values, however modest. First, know what is really of value.

The ancients used to keep a hearth going for their ancestors. Each family in the city had its own rites and rituals. This is called "honour thy father and thy mother". I'm amazed at the number of people, even self-described "traditionalists", who reject the life that their ancestors led for the past thousand or more years. Why do they believe their ancestors

were deluded, unintelligent, etc.? Like that woman who called the mother who loved her a “sexist”.

Mystery of the Crucifixion It is impossible not to take notice of the ignorance, lack of intelligence, cupidity, laziness, and even maliciousness in public figures. The party system in the USA is unsustainable, since power and winning are the only goals, with no bounds set on means. A disagreement on policy is understandable, but not the wickedness that should be obvious, but is not to partisans. Satan is the father of lies, but too many people prefer the lies.

I suppose I am describing the ruins no better than anyone else. However, you would never hear that on the nightly news.

I know partisans who believe that all the good people in the country become democrats, and the bad ones, are republicans. Certainly that cannot occur by chance, and I don't see any evidence of Maxwell's demon making the choice.

If you could detach enough and take a high-level view, you might also see souls falling into hell like snowflakes in a winter storm. You don't believe that to be possible, even though every traditional religion teaches it? You could take the secular view, but that leaves you with no skin in the game. And that is true for a few professions like journalism, law or politics, in which no one pays a price for being wrong. Everyone else will suffer for being so wrong so often.

But here is the mystery that bothers me. There are a few precious people whom I would die for, but absolutely not for those people just described. So when I hear the Jesus died even for their sins, I am awestruck.

Posted on 2020-05-17 by Cologero

* * *

Sviatoslav on 2020-05-21 at 06:28 said:

Very nice article, thank you Cologero. Indeed, we are men among the ruins, though, the light did not completely disappear. Hopefully, this won't be off-topic, I just want to share something positive. I have recently discovered this youtube channel <https://www.youtube.com/user/tfpstudentaction/videos> and have been searching a little bit more about that organization and in the end, I have been positively surprised. They are not some neoconservative evangelists as I thought firstly, but truly traditional Catholics.

At least on videos, I see healthy young men with potential (unlike neopagan nationalists, they don't have tattoos and barbaric look). For example:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gPf6eKmfZs>

<https://tfpstudentaction.org/get-involved/call-to-chivalry-camps/catholic-manhood>

Sylvan Savant on 2020-05-23 at 19:03 said:

"Nobility, the quality which I call true aristocracy, requires of a man the recognition of his guilt. The sense that one is being continually affronted is on the other hand, precisely a plebeian feeling."

This statement encapsulates everything of worth and value that has been relayed through this website. Even if it was discussed previously, I still believe it is worth revisiting the profound meaning of these words every now and again. The importance of this message can't be stressed enough.

The world is indeed a hell not because it was created this way, but because WE are responsible for making it thus. The Bible illustrates this fundamental truth on its every page.

Despite being thoroughly of a "fringe" persuasion, I am becoming increasingly skeptical of the prevailing narrative of the evil elites being responsible for all the world's ills. Don't like how Uncle Gill wants to inject you with his gecko DNA? Stop using Microsoft products. Maybe in a few months or so he will be serving you at a nearby burger joint. Slap his ass for me and don't forget to tip generously.

4.49 A Solitary Man

'Informer' ... means one who gives information. It means what 'journalist' ought to mean. The only difference is that the Common Informer may be paid if he tells the truth. The common journalist will be ruined if he does.

G.K. CHESTERTON, *Utopia of Usurers*

Back in the day, I aspired to be a public speaker, so I attended a conference of the Florida Speaker's Association. They told me that I had to be funny if I wanted to be paid. I figure the information is funny enough on its own, so I don't need to add a joke.

Isaias It has taken TV newscasters three days to learn how to pronounce the name of Hurricane Isaias correctly. Years ago, Hurricanes all had female names. Then the feminists objected, so traditionally male and female names alternated. People were still unhappy, since the names were mostly Anglo. So the pool of names was enlarged, and where it ends I don't know.

As for Isaias, I'm sure the forecasters think they did pretty well, predicting the storm with 75 km or so. But for us who live here, 70 km offshore (as it was) is quite different from a direct hit (as was predicted). Hence, we didn't get much bad weather. The mathematics of weather forecasting involves what are called "chaotic systems". It goes well for a while, but at some point, the equations break down and there is no solution possible. Most people are ignorant by disposition, design or their own choice. But even for those who know, there are inherent obstacles to complete knowledge built into the cosmos.

The New Decameron **Giovanni Boccaccio** wrote the *Decameron* about 10 (upper class) people who evaded the Black Death by moving out of the city into the countryside. But they each had to come up with a story to entertain each other. I've had some friends who suggested the same thing, but none of them was clever enough to create a story. Boccaccio's are pretty good, but since this lockdown has gone on longer than anticipated, I think I'll post some of my own. One them will begin like this:

Brianna had a lust for life, ok let's be honest, she just had lust.
When I walked into the kitchen for coffee and breakfast, she was

with her 15 year old daughter Jessa. Just to be clear, if I had a pretty teenage daughter, I would lock her up in the bell tower. To my surprise, the two of them were dancing around singing together, “me so horny, me so horny” over and over, all smiles. Just then, I realized that there is a secret wisdom passed down through the generations from mother to daughter, of which men have no inkling.

Speaking Truth to Power

We are dealing with real attack of globalists on all kind of independent media. That is the sign of their weakness they cannot stand the truth.

ALEXANDR DUGIN, after being deplatformed.

On the contrary, that is a sign of their strength and the truth does not matter. They have adapted the traditional Chinese model of statecraft:

In classical Chinese statecraft there are two tools for gaining and maintaining control over “the mountains and the rivers”: The first is *wu* (**weapons, violence** – 武) and the second is *wen* (language, **culture** – 文). *Chinese leaders have always believed that power derives from controlling both the physical battlefield and the cultural domain.* You can’t sustain physical power without discursive power. *Wu* and *wen* go hand-in-hand.

What matters is who holds power and controls discourse. This has always been the case. This may disappoint idealists who try to win an argument rather than win. Mao followed the antique tradition which is still applicable.

Mao’s discursive advantage was Marxist-Leninist ideology. *Language was not just a tool of moral judgment. It was an instrument for shaping acceptable behaviour and a weapon for distinguishing enemies and friends.*

You still don’t get it?

Poets and philosophy Poets have a different perspective on things. So when **Charles Peguy** asserts that *Plato*, *Henri Bergson*, and *Rene Descartes* are the three greatest philosophers, that is not a ray of light. Rather it is an irritant like a grain of sand in an oyster. It is not obvious that a pearl will result unless you believe that Peguy offers a special insight to life.

Ditto for **Ernst Junger** placing *Saint Francis*, *Saint Anthony*, and *Max Stirner* among the great saints.

They teach detachment from worldly concerns and relief from the gnomonic will.

I'm looking into becoming an anchorite, just to make my lifestyle official. Demons attacked the solitary Saint Anthony. They can feast on my carcass.

New Morality Memes

What thus impressed me was the chapter in which Bentham passed judgment on the common modes of reasoning in morals and legislation, deduced from phrases like 'law of nature', 'right reason', 'the moral sense', 'natural rectitude', and the like and characterized them as dogmatism in disguise, imposing its sentiments on others under cover of sounding expressions which convey no reason for the sentiment, but set up the sentiment as its own reason... *The feeling rushed upon me that all previous moralists were superseded and that here indeed was the commencement of a new era in thought.*

JOHN STUART MILL

Mill discovered the "meme" and it was life altering. We are undergoing another new era in thought, in the same way. There has arisen a new set of dogmatic moral views, of which no past moral philosopher had

ever taken notice. Argue against them if you must; let me know how it turns out.

Overcoming temptation Is there temptation if there is no desire in the first place? There is no masturbation or homosexuality among the Aka and Ngandu people of central Africa. Instead a man and his wife have sex several times a night to create children. How many American men long for a wife like that (or perhaps vice versa)?

The Bronze Age Pervert claims that animals fap only in captivity. Do you want to hunt gazelles all day or work in a cubicle for 40 years?

Life as Allegory

Every man's life is a perpetual allegory.

JOHN KEATS

Life is like a symphony in which the same theme recurs with slight variations. Actually, your life has been lived before by someone else, probably in a different key. I find the keys to my life in great literature. If your life is rather stunted, you may find the keys in mediocre literature or B movies.

The things which happen to a person, and the order in which they happen, may be as much a part of him as his physical organism.

OWEN BARFIELD

Actually there is no "maybe". Before you retire for the night, review your day. What happened? What was your role in it ... and for that you must be honest. How about the past year, the past 10 years, etc. The first time that your will was totally aligned with God's was the choice of the circumstances of your birth. I was probably the only time, if you continually rebel against the idea.

The Horror of Reincarnation Someone who claims to know, told me that the people you know before the age 35 were known in a past life, but the people you meet after that age will be part of your future life. My past life must have been pretty good, but I have reason to dread my next life. I sure hope she is wrong.

High school experience I was not one of the popular kids in high school for obvious reasons. I was eager to graduate and hoped things would be better. But life is still like high school. The “popular kids” still get all the attention no matter how bland and ordinary their opinions are. They get all the “likes”.

Clear Ideas for Young Men

For an individual, however, there can be no question that a few clear ideas are worth more than many confused ones. A young man would hardly be persuaded to sacrifice the greater part of his thoughts to save the rest; and *the muddled head is the least apt to see the necessity of such a sacrifice*. Him we can usually only commiserate, as a person with a congenital defect. Time will help him, but intellectual maturity with regard to clearness is apt to come rather late. This seems an unfortunate arrangement of Nature, inasmuch as clearness is of less use to a man settled in life, whose errors have in great measure had their effect, than it would be to one whose path lay before him. **It is terrible to see how a single unclear idea, a single formula without meaning, lurking in a young man's head, will sometimes act like an obstruction of inert matter in an artery, hindering the nutrition of the brain, and condemning its victim to pine away in the fullness of his intellectual vigor and in the midst of intellectual plenty.**

CHARLES SANDERS PEARCE

Truth and Reality

And the independent reality of the individual, when we examine it, is in truth mere illusion. Apart from the community, what are separate men? It is the common mind within him which gives reality to the human being, and taken by himself, whatever else he is, he is no human ... If this is true of the social consciousness in its various forms, it is true certainly no less of that common mind which is more than social. The finite minds that in and for religion form one spiritual whole have indeed in the end no visible embodiment, and yet, except as members in an invisible community, they are nothing real. For religion, in short, if the one indwelling spirit is removed, there are no spirits left.

FRANCIS HERBERT BRADLEY, *Truth and Reality*

The Anarch, on the other hand, is real.

Sources

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- **Johnny Cash**¹³⁴, *Solitary Man*

Posted on 2020-08-02 by Cologero

4.50 **Waiting for a Miracle to Come**

You can hope for a catastrophe or wait for a miracle¹³⁵, but you cannot expect normalcy.

I am becoming more like Don Quixote. I live in a world that does not really exist and I fight imaginary battles. I hope I win one someday.

Wittgenstein confessed, "It's damned hard to write things that make blank sheets better!" ... he got that right, but I don't see it discouraging anyone.

Adam named the animals, which implies he understood the essences of things. Lesser men today engage in magical thinking. They change the names of things, believing, thereby, that they are changing essences.

Everyone sees what you appear to be, few really know what you are, and those few dare not oppose themselves to the opinion of the many, who have the majesty of the state to defend them ... the vulgar always judge by appearances and by results, and in the world there are only the vulgar

MACHIAVELLI

I've been watching physics videos to see if the world makes sense. It doesn't. In *Is faster-than-light travel possible?*¹³⁶, Sabine tells of a fellow

¹³⁴https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e_0ZrUo-7m4

¹³⁵<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1L2DzqrUNQc>

¹³⁶<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-2c0P2CEU9A>

who went back in time, accidentally killed his grandfather, and immediately ceased to exist. Also, a particle can't tell if it is moving backwards or forwards in time. I think I could tell.

We've learned that we can live just fine without professional sports, but not without the workers at power plants. Which of these would you choose: shut down all the "news" channels or the meat packing plants?

We poker players have an adage: "If you can't recognize who the chump is at the table, it is probably you." Likewise, you don't want to be the one with a knife at a gun fight.

The Argyraspides¹³⁷ were a feared and revered division of Alexander's army, consisting of veterans past the age of 60 years. They won many a battle. They could save the US army beaucoup bucks since they pay themselves out of their plunder, and they may actually win a war or two.

The Inverse of Truth The effects of Adam's fall are from a higher state to a state of ignorance, malice, and concupiscence. Tradition teaches that knowledge of the good ameliorates malice and concupiscence. The collected wisdom of the group provided that knowledge to the ignorant.

The current belief is that man "evolved" upwards to ignorance, malice, and concupiscence. This is the solution of the modern world:

- Universal education as the solution to ignorance. It has made things worse, because the ignorant believe they are knowledgeable.
- Social reforms as the antidote to malice. Result is permanent revolution, since no reform is ever enough.
- Promiscuity as solution to concupiscence. The expression of each and every sexual desire has not made anyone happier.

¹³⁷<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Argyraspides>

Animal Intelligence Joe Rogan¹³⁸ was impressed by the intelligence of an octopus who climbed out of his tank, crossed the floor, ate some fish in another tank, and returned to his own. Conclusion: If you can go to the fridge, make a sandwich, take it back to the couch and turn on the TV, then you have reached the intelligence level of an octopus.

Scientists have been trying to decode animal talk. It's bad enough listening to people, but do you really want to listen to your dog complaining all day long? Unfortunately, animal can't make vowel sounds¹³⁹, so they can't speak. Danish has too many vowels, and it has not helped their speech.

The Allure of Women Axel Heyst in **Joseph Conrad's** novel *Victory* was a Christ-like figure. Axel lived a solitary idyllic life on an Indonesian island. On a trip for supplies, he meets the most beautiful woman in a touring orchestra. He reluctantly brings Alma (his soul, get it?) back to his Island, where they fall in love. Heyst's worldly detachment is challenged by his desire for Alma and he succumbs to the world of action. Then she is tragically murdered by a gang of thieves with "mud souls".

I do not understand why they keep talking of love when they are around me, when they look into my eyes and kiss my hand. ... But when the red light is on, at the midnight's hour, and everyone hears my song, the reason becomes clear to me: My lips they give so fiery a kiss, my limbs are supple and white. It is as if it were written in the stars: You shall kiss! You shall love! My feet glide and float, my eyes lure and glow, and I dance as if in a trance because I know: My lips give so fiery a kiss.

¹³⁸https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TLzY_KvGSZ4

¹³⁹<http://theconversation.com/examining-how-primates-make-vowel-sounds-pushes-timeline-for-speech-evolution-back-by-27-million-years-128514>

My son ties me down to my chair before I watch Patricia Janečková sing My Lips¹⁴⁰.

The Media Now and Then Rachel Maddow, a popular TV “news” analyst, won a defamation lawsuit on the grounds that her statements were so hyperbolic that any rational listener should not take her statements as literal facts ... yet so many do. You would think that such a decision would discredit her, but apparently that is considered normal. Rachel was just kidding, get over it¹⁴¹.

In the classic movie *Stagecoach* (1939), starring John Wayne, the banker sounded like an episode from Fox News: “What’s good for banks is good for America”, he said, and then complained about the National debt reaching \$1 billion, and finally “we should have a businessman as president.” 75 years later his every desire has been fulfilled. Watch it before it gets canceled.

The John Wayne character proposed marriage to a woman he just met on the stagecoach the day before. (i.e. life before Tinder) Love at first sight was common in old movies. That actually is rather easy, but love 6 months later is a much different movie.

Education Advice Teach your children — or yourself to play music¹⁴² — it is one of the seven liberal arts. Playing Music helps your Brain. It will help your brain as much as grammar, logic, math and cosmology.

When I started Junior High School (NKA middle school), they divided the students into tiers: e.g., 7A1 to 7A4, 7B1 to 7B4, then the C levels. It wasn’t meant to hurt anyone, just to help them find their best

¹⁴⁰<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pzF3ubtimGE>

¹⁴¹<https://www.nbcsandiego.com/news/judge-dismisses-sd-based-one-americas-defamation-suit-against-rachel-maddow-msnbc/2331027/>

¹⁴²<https://getpocket.com/explore/item/the-benefits-of-playing-music-help-your-brain-more-than-any-other-activity>

job. Presumably, there was a college track, a business track, and a trades track. At that time, you could make a living from any one them. They must have had that system for decades. Then egalitarianism crept in, so they renamed the groups 8L6, 8O3, etc., until someone figured out that LOQUACIOUS represented the correct order. Now, I suppose, they don't even do that anymore, so few students know what their best skills are.

Plausible if not True The US government was supposed to release their UFO files this month. A source says it is more like invasion of the body snatchers.

In the movie version of *Marat/Sade*¹⁴³, the Marquis de Sade directs a play starring the inmates of an insane asylum in which he

subtly manipulates both the players and the audience to create an atmosphere of chaos and nihilism that ultimately brings on an orgy of destruction.

Now it repeats as farce. Nevertheless, it would be great to be one of the inmates; then you could take solace in being on the winning side of history.

The Divine Comedy Rene Guenon can sometimes be so tedious as, for example, in his treatise on Dante. He sees symbols and correspondences everywhere, while ignoring completely Dante's own explanation. Guenon writes nothing about contemplation, self-knowledge, etc. Purgatory is, for him, the "trials" of achieving the Masonic grades. From what I see, there are no trials, just expenses. Richard of Saint Victor repeats that purity of heart and self-knowledge are the conditions for mystical elevation. The soul is a mirror that reflects the invisible things of God,

¹⁴³[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Marat/Sade_\(film\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Marat/Sade_(film))

and a purified soul reflects best. Theosis is the overcoming of the human state of being. It does no harm to keep repeating this.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HBdq4mTk6Tk>

Posted on 2020-08-16 by Cologero

* * *

Mike on 2020-08-17 at 06:13 said:

This whole country is about to burn to ash, past November. NYC's "expiration date" is a foreshadow of the country's own "expiration date". If Trump wins, the whole country will be set ablaze by useful idiots such as antifa, extremist-liberals and blm. As a response to this the national guard will be deployed, martial law will be enforced and a civil war, maybe as a precursor to WWII will break out. If Biden wins, together with his crackpot sister, Harris, then say hello to communism, insane taxes, death of privacy, increased degeneracy, no more guns or other weapons to protect oneself, unbridled immigration and just generally bowing down to whatever whims the globalists have. Not to mention the violent responses from right-wing extremists that would also erupt on account of an ultra-leftist, ultra-progressive government.

Things might turn out differently, but this is not too far afield from the realm of possibility. I can only wonder how the plans at gornahoor and its affiliates will be affected by this. 2021 will be a very interesting year...

Cologero on 2020-08-17 at 07:20 said:

Don't the Chinese consider this a curse: "May you live in interesting times."

2021? You're more optimistic about Gornahoor than my doctors are.

My plan is like Dante's plan for the Divine Comedy:

The purpose of the whole and the part could be multiple, that is both remote and proximate. But leaving off subtle investigation, we can say briefly that *the purpose of the whole as well as the part is to remove those living in this life from the state of misery and to lead them to the state of bliss.*

burningfireeye on 2020-08-18 at 19:28 said:

UFOS are spiritual realities, I know a friend who was with another friend of his, they both saw a great lightning at the same time while inside of the car, both of them were perfectly

sober. He told me he felt a great energy inside of him. It is the Astral Light spoken of so much by Eliphas Levi.

jalexandermaximilian on 2020-08-18 at 22:36 said:

Burningeyes.

UFOs are most certainly a Reality. I see them almost everyday, generally in the dawn and twilight. I had a similar experience in which I was meditating, with my wife (we are both pupils of Serrano and that is what brought us together) in the cemetery by my house, it was nighttime. I was visualizing a stream of energy coursing from a sphere above my head, when the energy actually manifested and I felt a great electrical current, a strange vapor, which tasted of ozone was rising out of my stomach and out of my mouth. My wife mentioned me reeking of ozone as well. We felt we should begin back home... I was still on fire with same energy your friend mentioned, and it was 30 degrees outside, my wufe was getting cold and I was able to put the warmth into her as she got cold. Suddenly about 100-150 feet in the air a White Disk, quite large, and alarming flashed at us 3 times, it was very close, and illuminated the entire area, and flew away. When we got back home we were elated, and just mind blown! It was now late so we went to bed, it was hard to sleep as I was charged and when I'd close my eyes I'd see a field of typical "grey alien" faces. That was a bit disconcerting to be honest. But we now see the white Disk, and orbs as well quite regularly, not as intense as that one, but I do have photos and footage. Quite a bit. I'd swear on Christ this true, but He said not to swear such oaths so I will just say... I tell you no fib.

Mike on 2020-08-20 at 09:31 said:

@Cologero

I suppose an esoterist's manner of prepping is all-inclusive and the items on his list are ordered differently. (I doubt toilet paper would be your number one priority and I doubt communing with God through effortless contemplation would be on the ordinary person's list, even in ordinary times).

@burningfireeye

I recall watching a surprisingly interesting documentary done by Vanity Fair, that documented domestic terrorism fueled by left-wing groups in the 70s and 80s, mainly in liberal areas like NYC. These were children of the wealthy and the bourgeoisie that went about making things like nail-bombs and also blowing up buildings. Eventually, their group fizzled out, but some of them made it into academia and just continued funneling whatever poison had destroyed their minds into the new generation of kids we see today. So maybe this is some sort of cyclic-resonance, since it's been 50 years or so since the 70s and it's the same cushioned children of the wealthy and bourgeoisie that are causing mayhem. Perhaps they too will fizzle out and some other biggie distraction will stave off the animal-like impulses of the masses, for

a little while longer...

Arthur Konrad on 2020-08-20 at 19:20 said:

I was of impression that your health was improving Cologero. I derived much value from your writing once, and your translations of Evola and his correspondences helped us all learn more about him.

Music, as opposed to what Schopenhauer said of pity, makes life worthy of praise. Romanticists devalued it somewhat with their infantile love of decibels. The world owes Italy a great deal for its conception of taste in music. The country was nearly immune to all sorts of folly and excess in this domain, and many Italian musicians remain so to this day.

4.5I Message to Prodigal Sons

O God, thou art my God: early will I seek thee: my soul thirsts for thee. My flesh longs for thee in a dry and thirsty land, where no water is. To see thy power and thy glory, so as I have seen thee in the sanctuary.

KING DAVID

We are not writing for the elder son, who stays home playing it safe. As Augustine reminds us, the predestined have what is needed to be saved. The elder son has what he needs; he can ignore us. We write for the **prodigal son** who gets lost in the world, yet needs a path back. The easy answers no longer have any appeal. The world is offering him less and less, even to the point of transferring his rightful legacy to someone else. In short, is Jack Kerouac or William Buckley your role model?

Jack travelled, wrote about his life, loved, drank, fought in bars, married three times and lived with his mother. Bill had a good dictionary and was born with money and privilege. There is a place for both. Unfortunately, Jack took it too far and was unable to roll it back.

In the story, the elder brother stayed home, prayed the rosary in Latin, had 7 children, and knew Denziger by heart. The younger son left in innocence but came back experienced. The father, excited to see his son return, organized a feast and purchased the son's favourite beer. The elder son felt some jealousy, quite unnecessarily. He ensured that the prodigal son had some place to return to, so any resentment is unnecessary.



King David David's outer life was ambiguous, full of trials, hardships, triumphs, and blunders. While he was active in the world, he also had a deep spiritual life. The two are not incompatible. Nevertheless, there are those who persist in the notion that a spiritual life needs to follow a pre-ordained pattern and embrace limited modes of thinking. The life of experience is not like that; it is not all sunshine and lollipops.

Actually, in most cases such a life is better, since one learns much more about myself: how to overcome obstacles, face fears, deal with adversity. Yet his relationship to the spiritual world was pure, without illusions, and free from his personal prejudices. His mistakes among the world of men became offerings to God, as revealed in this prayer:

I acknowledge my transgressions and my sin is ever before me.
Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew a right spirit within me. The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit: a broken and a contrite heart, O God, thou will not despise.

The Human State Every Tradition agrees that the Human State is unique in the cosmos. A being in this state, unlike those in other states:

- Experiences both the physical and spiritual world

- Knows both good and evil

That is why only such a being can make moral progress.

Rather than focus solely on higher, or even lower, states of being, I've made the decision to describe the Human State in some detail, particularly of this particular being. The predominant impulse in the literature of Tradition has been to leave out everything that reeks of the personal. But is that at all helpful? The journey to higher states cannot be done on a tourist bus.

In the past, children were told that they were brought by a stork. Now, under the influence of a misapplied materiality, we show them anatomically correct renderings of the reproductive system. But isn't the former more correct? Even if the stork version still does not answer the questions surrounding the mystery of birth: "Who am I? Why am I here?", at least it recognizes a mystery.

The anatomical version doesn't even take the mystery into account or even bother with the question.

Esoteric School The Candidate for Initiation must demonstrate fearlessness, freedom from lust and finally loyalty and the ability to be silent.

There are some who read a little in Tradition, and then go speculating about esoteric schools. Yet they have probably never considered how they would even recognize one; there are no neon signs advertising their presence. Moreover, at least in the West, they may disappear and reappear as conditions change. They are hard to find, but easy to leave.

Many are disappointed with a school because of unrealistic expectations. They may not be willing to face up to their inner nature, once it is revealed to them. A certain type expects to learn metaphysical speculation and leaves when such mere intellectuality is discouraged.

The goal is the primordial state, from which higher states may be reached. Someone recently asked me what the primordial state "feels" like,

as if it could be described in a book. Everyone delights in stories about visiting heaven and in descriptions of higher states of consciousness. But you first need to start where you are, which means, in effect, to “know thyself.”

An esoteric school will start by teaching techniques for self-knowledge and self-observation. There will be training in the three stages of concentration, meditation, and contemplation. The meaning of sacred symbols will be unlocked. It may sometimes be tedious, but over time a true centre is developed. Then other teachings are introduced.

Complicity It is necessary to accept responsibility for one’s life. In order to understand one’s life and integrate the discrete and seemingly random events in life into an awareness of your life as a unified whole, it is necessary to consider the following:

- Act as though you chose to be born
- Act as though you created your life

For an exoteric thinker, those would be points for debate. He would read another book, pore over ancient texts, argue online.

In an esoteric school, the approach is different. First, you would consider these ideas in your Imagination. For one example, imagine this scenario:

Perhaps you are in a bad relationship. How did you contribute to it? What clues about your partner did you ignore or lie about to yourself?

Or imagine that you are choosing your life circumstances before birth. What country, what parents, what religion? Give the imagination free reign to consider what results.

Perhaps over time such exercises will lead to Inspiration or even Intuition.

Overcoming Fear Shallow thinkers will tell you to “follow your bliss”, as the key to happiness. So why does not everyone do that? First of all, your bliss cannot be imposed on you from the outside and it fails to acknowledge any obstacles. The path to self-knowledge does not begin with recognizing one’s bliss, but, on the contrary, it requires recognizing one’s fears. These fears are the hidden parts of oneself and must be exposed to the light, then overcome. See *Qualifications for Initiation*¹⁴⁴ for descriptions of traditional tests to deal with fears.

The Spiritual Battle Don Quixote chose to be a Knight Errant (wandering knight). He ventured out into the world to right wrongs, defend widows and orphans, and earn the love of a beautiful woman.

He found out that the path is hardly easy. If you don’t accept consensus reality, they will mock you or call you a “conspiracy theorist”. They will call you “mad”. They will ignore you, deplatform you; your family will ignore you.

Narcissus and Goldmund Narcissus creates an intellectual edifice. Everything has its place. All sins and all virtues are accounted for. He then tries to inhabit it. If you try to inhabit it, you are like a hermit crab trying to live in the dead shell of some other animal.

Goldmund goes out into the world and gains experiences. He finds out that It is messy. Goldmund is an artist. That is, while Narcissus is a cataloguer of life, Goldmund is the creator of his life. Ultimately, he gets reconciled with Narcissus.

Better than Tolkien People love fantasy stories in worlds populated by unusual beings and wondrous stories. However, our world, the real world if you can experience it in its fullness, is much greater.

¹⁴⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1161>

You are engaged in spiritual warfare. There are angels and demons using your own mind as the battlefield. You need to overcome obstacles, resist forces from below and respond to influences from above.

The world is hierarchically layered with the planets and stars above, infernal states below. You will encounter Saints, Warriors, Knights, Sages, Mystics, Poets, Artists, Musicians, Philosophers. They will offer clues and advice along the way. Heck, you may even become one yourself.

Lighting up the Chakras You can relate to a woman in three ways: sensually, in the heart, or in the head. Those correspond to three different sensations of the I: the I of the body, the I of the heart, the I of the head. If you can relate to her on all three levels, then the three main chakras all light up enabling the free flow of psychic energy. This can be understood on three different levels:

1. In consciousness: this is the alchemical marriage that leads to the true Self, transcendent to the other thee I's.
2. With a partner: if your souls can unite, you become a single polar being. This is the most effective, although rare.
3. Spiritually: you achieve union with God.

Spiritual Infatuation You have seen a beautiful woman. You gaze at her, you think about her, you fantasize about her, you desire her; she dominates your consciousness. If you are fortunate enough to meet her, you do anything for her. You notice her clothes, her scent, the smell of her hair after a shower, the way she moves, her smile. When she fully reveals herself, you experience desire in a way you never had previously, you nearly faint from her touch. When she moans or cries out, her pleasure becomes your pleasure. Afterwards, you promise to please her and look for ways to do so. Her joy is a joy to you. Yet, there is more – life is not a

series of stepping stones from one pleasure to the next. Her pain becomes your pain, and you vow to alleviate hers.

Do you feel the same way about God? Do you think about Him all day long, do you long to be with Him? Do you try to please him? Like David, do you acknowledge your faults and pray for forgiveness?

The Biography of Jesus He received no Nobel prizes. He did not propose an economic program. He did not reveal the laws of physics. He did not teach better living through chemistry. Although he effected cures, he did not eliminate disease itself. He did not write great literature, but relied instead on those who followed. He did not bring peace but rather a sword.

Unlike the rich and famous, his biography as a man, as described the Apostle's Creed, is simple and straight-forward:

He was conceived, he was born, he lived, suffered, died, and was buried. Can't you at least achieve that?

His one superpower was the ability to forgive sins. It is too easy to gloss over that and not understand the magnitude.

Posted on 2020-12-02 by Cologero

* * *

Ilo Stabet on 2022-04-04 at 09:13 said:

I wonder if the last section was inspired by Fernando Pessoa, who has a famous poem (famous, at least, for the Portuguese) that ends with: «More than this is Christ/who knew nothing of finances/and didn't seem to have a library».

4.52 The Boulangerie: A Parable

I had planned to return to metaphysics for a while, but this post was virtually dictated to me in the middle of the night. In high school, the French Club performed various skits for parents' night I doubt many parents could understand, and, given our lousy accents, probably no Frenchman could either. Maybe a Quebecois could. That is how I became a French standup comedian. Before I reveal the joke about the French bakery, some context is necessary.



Bird song Every morning, except during hurricanes, I sit out on the patio for breakfast. And every such morning, a bird alights on a tree, singing her song. Perhaps she is communicating something, or even singing for pure delight. But she is not singing for me, although I, too, take delight in listening.

Do I therefore owe her some morsels of my pastry for providing me with that pleasure?

Gravitational Waves When bodies accelerate, they distort the space time continuum. Imagine standing on a trampoline, and you will see that you create a distortion of the surface. If you roll a ball across the trampoline, its path will be affected by that indentation, so that it may roll to your feet rather than the intended destination. The ball believes there is a force attracting you to it and the ball calls the experience “falling”.

Instead, the mass creates a gravitational wave, moving at the speed of light. Since everything is vibration, everything in its path will be affected to the degree of its proximity.

Psychical Waves The subtle body of the earth is called the noosphere. Thoughts and emotions circulate throughout the noosphere, forming diverse knots something like Sheldrake's morphic fields. But like gravita-

tional waves, they feel like an attractive force, and are also experienced as “falling”.

When the Girl from Ipanema walks by, all the beach boys sigh. Just like the gravitational fields, she creates a distortion in the noosphere. As the psychic waves emanate, they affect the voyeurs in various ways. Some daydream of a day with her, some of a night, a few dream of a lifetime.

Do they owe her a Brazilian Real for the sweet 15 minute daydream she gives them?

The Boulangerie Every morning the baker was up early to prepare the loaves for the day. And every morning the pauper, who could not afford fresh bread, stood outside the doorway, just to experience the scent of freshly baked bread. This annoyed the baker, who thought he should get paid for the smell of the bread. So he took the pauper to court.

The judge, having heard the baker make his case, asked him to come up to his bench. There the judge asked the baker to give him a few coins. The judge dropped the coins on the bench and rendered his verdict.

“Just as the pauper enjoys the smell of your bread, you can enjoy the sound of the money.”

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c5QfXjs0Ne4>

Posted on 2021-02-20 by Cologero

* * *

Paulo Adolpho on 2021-02-21 at 00:01 said:
I love you Cologero

Paulo Adolpho on 2021-02-21 at 00:24 said:
Thank you

4.53 Not Even Wrong

The principle of excluded middle states that for every proposition, either the proposition or its negation is true. That means that the opposite of a false statement is a true statement.

Oftentimes, we encounter a proposition that is so far off the mark that even its opposite is not true. Hence we say that it is “not even wrong”.



Not Good Enough for You Fellows write to me, explaining that there is no organization good enough for them. Usually it is the Catholic Church which has lost her way ... not that he has lost his way. Such types are incapable of understanding the distinction between a Collective and a Singular entity. Instead, they judge the collective by its visible members.

Physicist on Eternity of the World A physicist, Stephen Barr, asserted that Bonaventure was incorrect to claim that the eternity of the world could be disproved by logic and metaphysics. He gave as the counter-example the set of positive and negative integers. Of course, in the time-line sequence he had in mind, that set is not well-ordered. But time, by its nature, is ordered. This is how:

- **Present.** What is happening now.
- **Future.** Possibilities not yet actualized.
- **Past.** Possibilities which have been actualized.

Since there cannot be an actual infinity, Bonaventure was correct in denying that the past could extend back to negative infinity.

Black Holes If you are on the spectrum you may miss the irony:
Team takes colour picture of a black hole.¹⁴⁵

¹⁴⁵<https://www.bbc.com/news/science-environment-49571917>

Fall of Rome Neopagans tend to claim that Christianity destroyed the Roman Empire. Of course, the Germanic tribes that invaded the Empire – in several directions and times – were also Christians. Alaric, when he entered Rome, protected the churches from destruction. Although the Arian and Catholic faiths nominally differed, they used the same prayers and rituals. Eventually, they merged into each other.

Moreover, Christianity took over voluntarily: Clovis in France, King Ethellbert in England, even Iceland adopted it voluntarily. The current decline of Europe – if you choose to see it that way – is due to the return of paganism.

Three Political Worldviews There are three basic worldviews that determine one's political perspective. For a proper understanding, it is necessary to evaluate things in terms of principles not specific policies. Specifically, it is not informative to say that such and such a policy is socialism, etc. Here are the three worldviews:

Traditional: Social problems result from defects in human persons. Hence, improvement requires that people learn to moderate their own behaviour.

Liberalism: Social problems are solved by political organization. But we can see that high sounding ideas like free speech, voting rights, etc. are failing to mediate competing interests in society.

Socialism: Social problems are responsible for personal problems. Implementing certain social programs will improve the human race. But removing personal responsibility seems to make things worse.

The Idiot in the Room Suppose a mad scientist proposed this challenge to you. You will enter a room with me in it and you have 10 minutes to determine who is the idiot in the room. To make it interesting, you will win \$1000 if you get it right, just enough to pay for your mother's life saving surgery. Assuming your desire to save your mother's life exceeds

your pride, who would you choose?

This is a typical conversation I get, either in the comments or by email. A fellow poses a question A. I assume it is a sincere question. Unfortunately, question A is so ill-posed that it is not even wrong. So I respond with B. If you ever followed a Platonic dialog, he should take B into account and respond with C. Unfortunately, such simple minds assume that I am the idiot in the room; thus, they repeat question A and tell me that I must not have understood it. Here is another law of metaphysics:

An incoherent statement cannot be understood.

Content of One's Character We hear this claim over and over lately: We should be judged by the content of our character, not by the colour of our skin.

Are you serious? Do you really want to be judged by the content of your character? Maybe we should channel Anubis to grade everyone's character.

Algebra and Elementary Education As a Teaching Assistant, I had the misfortune to teach algebra to Elementary School Majors. Many were taking the class for the second or third time. No matter how I tried, I was barely effective in many cases. An attractive co-ed came to my office and told me that she would do anything to pass the class. She repeated it, this time emphasizing **ANYTHING**. My innocent mind was shocked, so I decided to decline her offer. Nevertheless, I cut her some slack at the end; after all, is is the thought that counts.

The Obnoxious Convert Several years ago there was an argumentative, obnoxious convert on facebook. He unfriended me for not being Catholic enough. Recently, I bumped into him again. He is now a nihilist, but still argumentative and obnoxious. That makes me the excluded middle.

Not even wrong news Things heard in the news this week.

80%: I was watching the second game of a best 2 out of 3 women's softball tournament. The announcer asserted that in the history of the tournament, the winner of the first game won the series 80% of the time. Of course, by the laws of probability, assuming the teams are equally matched, the loser of the first game has just a 25% chance of winning the series. No surprising insight here.

Pissing: A female analyst was embarrassed to use the phrase "pissing in the wind", so she spelled out the p word. I did not object to the vulgarity of the phrase, but rather to the fact that she was not speaking from personal experience.

Jane Austen: Critical Race Theory classes are banning American authors including Jane Austen.

Stereotype: A stereotype is a false generalization of a group.

So a Texas newspaper declined to identify the race of the perpetrator of a recent mass shooting, on the grounds that it would perpetuate a stereotype. So a true statement can somehow prove a false stereotype.

Becoming Popular I've noticed that blogs that post a simple post on a single topic get more traction than this one. So perhaps, I should post one of these topics daily for a week, instead of a weekly post with several topics.

Posted on 2021-06-18 by Cologero

4.54 Dialectics

Wer sagt A, muss B sagen.

This is the dictionary definition of dialectic:

The art or practice of arriving at the truth by the exchange of logical arguments.

In a Socratic-style dialog, a

series of questions clarifies a more precise statement of a vague belief, logical consequences of that statement are explored, and a contradiction is discovered (Wikipedia)

As a general principle, therefore, in regards to to comment, call it “A”, there can be two responses “B”.

1. Expose the unexpressed presuppositions behind the comment
2. Follow up on the logical consequences of the comment

So if someone says A, he is intellectually obliged to accept B. Then you can answer B with C so that a legitimate dialogue may ensue. If you simply repeat A, usually on the assumption that I am incapable of grasping your original comment, then you have ended the dialog. Your future comments will be blocked.

Don't presume you understand my inner psychological states. If you are incapable of understanding dialectic, then I might respond with rhetoric. It's just part of the game; learn to play Calcio fiorentino, not Tiddly-winks.

The number of readers who take this blog seriously are few; they don't want to be bothered with nonsense. Some of them do take the trouble to post relevant and useful comments, but most of them just reach out to me privately.

A comment should reference the text and not bring in writers or concepts not referenced. E.g., if I never mentioned “intersubjectivity”, then you shouldn't either.

No one has a right to waste my time reading poorly thought-out comments. There is a web site that charges \$120/year so that your comments will make it to the top of the list, tout suite. I wouldn't think that there would be enough suckers to fall for that, but I've been mistaken before. Perhaps I'll try it. Just name a fair price to let your comments flow through unmoderated.

Ultimately, this is for your own good:

The principal aim of Socratic activity may be to improve the soul of the interlocutors, by freeing them from unrecognized errors; or indeed, by teaching them the spirit of inquiry. (Wikipedia)

Posted on 2021-07-10 by Cologero

4.55 The Heart of a Lion

Sometimes I feel like a lion wandering aimlessly across the savanna — peeing on the bushes to stake out my territory, eating to satiation, gazing intently at the lionesses. The sun sets, the sun rises ... I have cheated death.



The Wisdom of a Knight Errant “You should know, Sancho,” said Don Quixote, “that love shows no restraint, and does not keep within the bounds of reason as it proceeds, and has the same character as death: it attacks the noble palaces of kings as well as the poor huts of shepherds, and when it takes full possession of a heart, the first thing it does is to take away fear and shame.”

Sancho: “My master is valiant, intelligent, and in love.”

Facebook, forgetting and forgiving At the final Judgement, there is hope that the Most Merciful God will forgive our sins and blot them out of memory forever. Facebook neither forgives nor forgets.

Everyone Hurts Recently, two athletes, who abandoned their commitments, have been praised for their courage. Each of them asserted that their “mental health” required it. I’d like to point out that everyone is hurting. How many people experience anxiety or depression, yet show up to work day after day. Athletes today are lionized for quitting and get more endorsements. Ordinary folk will lose their jobs.

Walking to First My Mother was very loving, but is only after some time has passed can I see how she guided me. She was tender when necessary but tough on me whenever I showed weakness. One morning I was tardy, so I had to walk to kindergarten alone. Terrified, I felt I was walking through a jungle. The streets, normally filled with the sound of children, were eerily silent. Every barking dog seemed like a threat. At that time, dogs roamed freely and there was one dog in particular that always chased me. I was in dread walking past his house. The final obstacle was the main drive whose traffic I needed to dodge. I made it to school and checked myself in. Suburban mothers will not do that today.

Perfect Grammar The Lone Ranger spoke grammatically correct English and there are few of us left. It sounds trivial, but it isn’t. Michel de Montaigne :

The greater part of the world’s troubles are due to questions of grammar.

Thoughts on the Olympics Archery: The Huns could hit a moving target while riding on horseback with homemade bows and arrows. I

would watch that for sure. But these archers with high tech bows and machine tooled arrows are boring. And they're probably all on beta blockers.

Fencing: I've watched enough movies, so I know that a good sword fight should take 10 minutes or so, and requires a lot of space. That would make compelling TV. These 10 second jousts don't seem real to me.

Rowing: A galley slave used to be the worst job in the world; now rowing is an Olympic sport.

Equestrianism: The equestrian horses are impressive with their dances. I wonder if, for his reward, the horse gets to party with geisha horses.

Clothing: For "beach sports", it is entirely appropriate to wear beach costumes, common to our age: bikinis for women and shorts for men. To counter an absurd objection, men do not wear Speedos to the beach. Nevertheless, they do wear Speedos for swimming events and women wear costumes they help them glide. If women still want to sexualize men's sports, they should watch wrestling and weight lifting in which their entire sac is outlined.

Ibn Arabi's Dream Someone sent me this poem, right after I had had a similar dream. Now I understand it.

I saw a girl in my sleep who did not, so far as I could see, and so far as my sight can judge, Have a sister equal to her in the beauty of her form — a girl of Turkish race, whose light covered my gaze.

I entered her in the vision, and she came towards me for me to gain my desire in embracing her.

Pleasure spread over my limbs, and on waking, I did not find any trace.

So I said, 'Well-being and relief must surely come; God's determination will bring it, walking with the divine decree.'

I interpreted seeing her genitals (*farj*) as meaning that I would see relief (*faraj*), taking away from me the clothing of misery and

harm.

For I have never seen a more perfect vision bringing joy to me like her before in my life.

I called it a sighting (ru'ya) and did not call it a dream (ru'yā), because of the danger that dreams bring.

The Possible and the Real Tradition teaches about the possible and the real. With larger population, more possibilities can manifest. That is why we are experiencing change at such a vertiginous pace.

Give them what they want To be popular, it is advisable to give people what they want, not what they need. Usually, that involves sentimentalism. Frithjof Schuon tells this story about Abd al-Qadir al-Jilani:

The saint relates a story about cats and the whole audience begins to weep from spiritual emotion.

They listened with boredom to the brilliant sermon of the great theologian.

The Myth of Er JE claimed: “I have always subscribed to the traditional doctrine that we have wished all relevant events in our life before birth.” That is just a restatement of the Myth of Er from Plato’s *Republic*.

Even Adam was give the choice. At first he was reluctant to be born into a body made of clay, but relented when he heard the celestial music.

Ace in the Hole “It’s been a nice day, Chuck, I feel like smiling.”

But it wasn’t nice for others.

*Ace in the Hole*¹⁴⁶ is a 1951 classic film that illustrates the unholy alliance of amoral journalists and corrupt politicians. The media and corrupt politicians conspire to create a “story” out of a random event. They

¹⁴⁶https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0043338/mediaindex/?ref_=tt_mv_sm

extend the event beyond what is necessary to resolve it, just to milk it. With a well-crafted narrative, the public is emotionally manipulated and drawn in. A “victim” is identified and nearly eulogized. Other characters are also media creations, barely resembling their real-life counterparts.

Leo gets trapped in a cave while collecting Indian artifacts. Chuck is the journalist who sees the story as an opportunity for a “big story”. Instead of going straight in to rescue Leo, Chuck convinces the local sheriff to drill from above, which will take several days. By promising to make the sheriff a national hero, Chuck bends events for his benefit. In the next few days, the mountain becomes a tourist attraction filled with people.

Lorraine despises her husband Leo, but Chuck describes them as a loving couple. We see Lorraine biting into an apple, with the obvious symbolism. She tries to seduce Chuck with the line above, with a seductive look worthy of the best of the undines. Ultimately, Leo dies due to Chuck’s ambition.

Keep all this in mind if you ever waste your time with TV news or “journalists”. The only difference is that in the movie, the bad guy gets his comeuppance.

Only from you my sweet Love

Only from you, my sweet love,
Shall this heart find peace and solace
Your beautiful hazy eyes are the stars
By which love guides me to port.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dg0cvWe60xI>

Posted on 2021-08-06 by Cologero

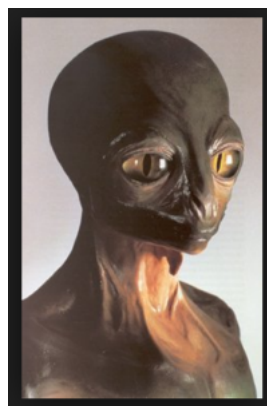
4.56 Humans may be Everywhere

Here are some topics that I've been exploring, when the *Masked Singer* was not available. Some will become full essays, some not.

Vanity All is vanity. Everyone on social media is promoting the next book, the next translation, youtube video, or seeking new followers and new "likes". But for what purpose? All is vanity.

Metaphysics and Physics Reality has an inside and an outside. Metaphysics, as the study of being, is concerned with the inside, and physics that of becoming and the outside. Hence, metaphysics is constant while physics changes. As such, metaphysics is certain and absolute, so it cannot be regarded as a "philosophical system" in the contemporary understanding of the term.

The phrase, the transcendental unity of religion, is somewhat misguided, since it fails to recognize the unmistakable differences in religions. What is correct is that the higher traditions share and understand the same metaphysics. The metaphysic is the genus and the species is the exoteric religion.



Evolution and Wings Darwinian evolution cannot explain, if mutations are random, why and how evolution progresses from simple to complex life forms. Pumpkin Person ponders why Evolution is progressive¹⁴⁷.

¹⁴⁷<https://pumpkinperson.com/2021/02/14/evolution-is-progressive-debunking-goulds-drunkard-walk-metaphor/>

Scientists Say There May Be “Humans” All Over the Universe: Humans are Everywhere¹⁴⁸

The new theory is that evolution is not quite random, but rather that it converges to predictable forms. For example, the wing evolved independently in birds, bats, insects and pterosaurs. That makes no sense unless we presume there is a prototype of a wing that manifests itself in different creatures. Valentin Tomberg explains this based on traditional sources that predate “science” by millennia:

Tentacles, paws, arms, wings —are they not simply diverse forms manifesting a common prototype or principle? They are in so far as they express the desire to bear the sense of touch further, to be able to touch things more removed than those in the immediate neighbourhood of the surface of the body.

The organs of action are simply crystallised will. The “what” of the will engenders the “how” of the action (the organ), and not inversely. It is similar with wings. They are also an exteriorised will — a will become organ. This is the will to go out from the usual orbit not only in the horizontal but also in the vertical, not only to bear touch forward, but also to bear it above. Wings express the will for movement according to a cross, i.e. not only that of expansion on a plane but also that of elevation to another plane.

End time prophecy **Hildegard of Bingen** was a Saint and Doctor of the Church from nearly 1000 years ago. In her masterwork *Scivias* she uses the symbolism of five beasts to explain the stages of the end times: the red dog, the yellow lion, the pale horse, the black pig, and the grey wolf. If you are an animal lover, or just would like to know what to expect next, the blog *The Five Beasts*¹⁴⁹ attempts to relate Hildegard’s vision to

¹⁴⁸<https://futurism.com/scientists-humans-universe>

¹⁴⁹<https://thefivebeasts.wordpress.com/the-five-beasts-in-a-nutshell/>

our own times. Regarding the final stage of the Grey Wolf, she writes:

It is interesting that Hildegard goes into far more detail regarding the Grey Wolf than the other eras. Essentially, three main things will define the era:

- Civil unrest and revolutions with their cause being economic inequality.
- Physical persecution of the Church by a specific group of people.
- A powerful spiritual revival in the Church.

She also adds that it is when the Church will be "...replete with the full number of her children." The Church's mission to evangelize will have been completed.

Satan's revelation I don't think it is wise to believe anything that Satan says. But if you do, you might be interested in this discussion: Exorcist says Satan's Time is running short¹⁵⁰.



Signs of the End of Time Here is a Muslim perspective on the end of times¹⁵¹, which tracks Rene Guenon more or less closely.

Figure 4.2: Grey Wolf

- Prophecy of Phones
- Prophecy of the Talking Shoe
- Inanimate Objects would speak

¹⁵⁰<https://www.lifesitenews.com/news/exorcist-says-satans-time-is-running-short/>

¹⁵¹<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hyHv6Mx0oJ0>

- Rulers are the lowest people
- No people are left except the dregs
- Entertainers, prostitutes — the lowest of people — will be the happiest
- The far will become near

Four horsemen of meaning Jordan Peterson created a fictitious group calling itself the “Dark Enlightenment”. It fractured as one of them was deplatformed and probably no one really got enlightened. Undeterred, Peterson has created a new group calling itself the Four Horsemen of Meaning, including himself and three others he recruited.

It seems to me that the symbol of the Four Horsemen is the worst possible one to use, as it calls to mind the Four Horsemen of the Apocalypse. I suppose this is fine for men and women who are unable to find meaning in their lives, so they need it regurgitated like a mama bird feeding her brood.

Unfortunately, this is an impossible task. Meaning is never found independently in the object, but only in relation to a Self. Hence, Meaning cannot be inserted into the mind; rather it the Self expresses its meaning through its acts. See this essay on Hermann Keyserling¹⁵² for how to think about meaning.

IQ and ignorance The topic of intelligence, IQ, and their relationship will be explored soon. So I did a field study of some really high IQ people. Since it is impossible to sustain a serious discussion on social media because not everyone is equal, I thought I would try one devoted to those with IQs in the 99.9 percentile (one in a thousand).

¹⁵²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=7437>

I posted a short video about Schopenhauer, who certainly had a high IQ, whatever your opinion might be of his philosophy. See *Why Smart People Don't Care About Being Social*¹⁵³.

I thought it would be appropriate to that group. One fellow ranted about it, proclaiming that Tolstoy's ethical views were superior to Schopenhauer's. I gently pointed out that Tolstoy was deeply influenced by Schopenhauer, as documented in *Leo Tolstoy: Religious and political beliefs*¹⁵⁴.

The ability to solve puzzles and find patterns does is not the same as understanding the deep meanings of things.

Inanities Social media is replete with inanities that are regarded as highly motivational and deeply spiritual. But there is nothing in them about bearing wrongs patiently, submission to the will of God, self-knowledge, purification of the mind and will, or the pursuit of a virtuous life.

Neuroscience and free will A neuroscientist debunks "free will" because he sees some electrical activity in the brain as the subject is making a decision. That means that these weird neurons know in advance whether I will choose pistachio or chocolate gelato while I am on the way to the gelateria. The moderator chooses not to pursue this line of questioning in *Patrick Haggard — Is Free Will an Illusion?*¹⁵⁵

I just found this¹⁵⁶ today that debunks that very experiment.

Posted on 2021-11-24 by Cologero

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¹⁵³https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_oR78_QVF8s

¹⁵⁴https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Leo_Tolstoy#Religious_and_political_beliefs

¹⁵⁵<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lKKZdzVbIOs>

¹⁵⁶<https://mindmatters.ai/2021/11/does-science-disprove-free-will-a-physicist-says-no/>

Cologero on 2021-12-15 at 06:31 said:

The idea of humanoid creatures descended from dinosaurs has been part of the human collective unconscious, and has been part of folklore. Consider, for example:

Edgar Rice Burroughs' Pellucidar series featured primitive dinosaur-descended humanoids living in the Hollow Earth called the Horibs or snake-men in his 1929–1930 crossover Tarzan at the Earth's Core.

Source Reptilian Humanoid

This fits into today's UFO speculation about their source being the hollow earth. The point is that the possibility of reptilian humanoids may actually be a plausible idea. This post is intended to be a thought experiment for people with an imagination. It is off the mark to interpret it as a debate about Darwinism or as an assertion that such beings actually exist.

Balder on 2021-12-19 at 13:32 said:

Wolfgang Smith believes that the answer to the problem of free will is in what he calls Vertical Causation (in Physics and Vertical Causation), namely that humans who possess a rational soul have access to the equivalent of a Cosmogenic Act. Sounds plausible to me even if free will exists only as a potential.

4.57 **How to Break an Egg**

The person who writes for fools is always assured of a large audience.

ARTHUR SCHOPENHAUER

Lilliput is a small island nation in the Indian Ocean. They have been wracked for centuries by an unresolvable dilemma: should you break a soft-boiled egg on the big end or the little end? The traditional practice was to break them on the larger end until a radical emperor decreed that they should be broken on the small end. This led to a series of internal conflicts that continue to this day. At first, scientists tried to answer that question. Then theologians scanned their scriptures looking for answers.

Personal preference was not allowed by law. One side had tradition in its favor, the other did not.

Now that social media has reached the island, the battle is played out in public. That led to such bitterness that two competing social media platforms have arisen: one for big-enders and the other for little-enders. Now they don't even need to talk to each other.

Vaccine destroys the image of God A renegade Orthodox priest in a podcast recently concluded that Covid vaccines alter one's DNA, thereby destroying the image of God in the vaccinated. The notion that God favors certain DNA is hardly new, but not so blatantly stated in recent years.

High Culture Human beings are meant to live in a civilization. So-called primitive people are not earlier versions of the human race, but rather the degenerate remnants of a higher civilization. Otherwise, the human race could not have survived in the wild.

The Chinese Imperial Examination The Traditional view is that the social system should be guided — but not ruled — by the spiritual class. That served to maintain ancient civilizations like China, India, and old Egypt for centuries. India has had a hereditary caste of Brahmins to fill that role. China, on the other hand, relied on an examination system from about the seventh to the early twentieth century. Thus, people from all classes were able to compete.

The exam was so strict that only one in a thousand could pass. In principle, the notion that the best and the brightest should rule sounds fine. There are several high IQ societies that accept only the top 99.9 percentiles. However, intelligence alone is not enough, so that these societies have accomplished nothing of merit. Currently in the West, the spiritual guides are selected from certain elite universities. Unfortunately, they are

not being trained to sustain the nation's culture but rather to overturn it.

The Chinese imperial examination¹⁵⁷, on the other hand, included questions on Confucian philosophy, ethics, and culture. That served to protect the spiritual foundations of the Chinese people.

Natural Law Western ethics used to be based on the concept of Natural Law, viz., one should act in conformance with one's true nature. For example, if man is a "rational animal", then he must act intelligently in all situations, not emotionally nor motivated by sensual desire. Moreover, anything that diminishes one's intellectual capacity, such as alcohol or drugs, is inherently immoral.

Thomas Aquinas developed a hierarchy of loyalties that is remarkably in conformance with biology and group selection, as understood today. Revolutionaries, including leading clerics in the Church, teach the opposite which is the foundation of revolutionary ideology.

Great Divergence The Great Divergence¹⁵⁸ is the term used to describe the sudden dominance of Europe over the rest of the world, beginning in the Renaissance and continuing until recently. The elite view today is that the dominance was achieved through racism which hardly makes sense. On the contrary, it does not illustrate the superiority of the European races, since Asian nations have been achieving the same results.

The West seems to be undergoing the lassitude of Mouse Utopia.

Capital expenditures It used to be that a nation's power depended on capital formation (CapEx), such as factories, farms, mines, in short, anything that could produce wealth. Now, the West is converting to a system of Operational Expenditure (OpEx), in which capital is neither

¹⁵⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Imperial_examination

¹⁵⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Great_Divergence

created nor preserved. Because of tax laws, it is often beneficial to rent rather than buy. This is happening quickly today in cloud technology, in which a few companies — Amazon, Microsoft, and Google, primarily — are investing capital in computer technology, while other companies are disbanding their computer infrastructure and renting computer power from the cloud companies.

Trump's tax cut a few years ago did the opposite of what was intended. After hearing an economist on TV praised the plan, I commented on his Twitter feed that companies would use the windfall to buy back stocks (a practice that used to be illegal) rather than create capital. He ignored me.

Now we see the results today with the worldwide chip shortage. Intel, which used to make its own chips in the USA, spent \$100 billion gained from the tax cut to buy back stock. That raised the price for investors. They should have used that money to build a new chip manufacturing facility.

Capital accumulation is an advantage to a country, but Marxists claim it leads to inequality. Just so you know how the tell the players apart.

Common Task The oddball 19th century Russian philosopher, Nikolai Fedorov, developed the idea of the Common Task. This is how he defined it:

There is not a single invention which the military are not bent on applying to warfare, not a single discovery which they fail to turn to military purposes. So if it were made the duty of the armies to adapt everything now used in warfare for controlling natural forces, this duty would automatically become the common task of humanity as a whole.

His point is just as valid today. Theological problems may be better served by technology and administration. For example, once you get past

your food snobbery, McDonalds has done more to “feed the poor” than the church or government. The same goes for “healing the sick”; for the government to promise “healthcare for all”, there has to be healthcare in the first place.

Fedorov is in the unique position as being a strong influence both on the Russian Sophiologists as well as on transhumanists.

Hunter gatherers The Platonic ideal of justice is “to each his own”. The hunter-gatherer ideal is “see and take”.

Sex and iguanas The iguanas have been skittish lately, seldom coming out in public. However, it must be rutting season, because, in their excitement, they are mating in broad daylight, making themselves vulnerable. My son was able to get a kill on the male but the female scampered away. I asked him if she asked for a cigarette before she left.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=n0DFXvTuyKM>

Posted on 2022-01-04 by Cologero

4.58 Ides of March

The father loves his children, the mother loves her children, the children love their father and mother; but this is not like that, brothers. The wild beast also loves its young. But a man can be related only by similarity of mind and not of blood...

GOGOL, *Taras Bulba*

The Steiner version of the three Vedic gunas — Ahrimanic, Luciferic, and Christic forces — may be more expressive for us. How do events appear using those categories? Appealing to the superstition of facts misses the forest for the trees. This is a recent comment I wrote:

The temperature and pressure of a gas can be measured without knowing the positions and motions of each individual atom. That is because the gas is a totality, so the differences in individual atoms turn out to be irrelevant as they average out. Moreover, the individual atoms are not even aware that they are participants in a larger process.

The theologian **Michael Heiser** wrote the book, *The Unseen Realm*, a few years ago. His thesis is that the stories about angels, Nephilim, demons, divine councils, etc., in the Bible need to be taken seriously. In practice, this means that there are influences in the world that transcend the combined actions of individuals. Whatever their individual intentions, higher intelligences, both benign and malign, are manipulating them for their own purposes. They have no power over physical events, but work through the hearts and minds of individuals.

I heard one pastor claim that the seraphim are dragons with wings and the cherubim are bulls with wings. That makes for beautiful symbolism, but that is not how we recognize their activity in the world. Rather they reveal themselves — both angels and demons — through constellations of thoughts. It is necessary to become aware of those worldviews. Here, Nietzsche can offer us some insights. The worldviews are expressions of the Will to Power, not topics suitable for intellectual debate.

On the individual level, the first temptation of sinister forces is doubt — double-mindedness. Like every negative thought, detach yourself from the thought, find an anchor point, and observe it. THERE IS NO INTELLECTUAL ARGUMENT TO MITIGATE YOUR DOUBT. It is an existential problem, not an intellectual problem. Recall Tomberg's discussion of the fall, for reference.

Esoteric teaching — as least true esoteric teaching and not pop spirituality — is not anti-theology. Actually, just the opposite, because it teaches a worldview in which theology makes sense. The alternatives are inscrutable theological conundrums, like this discussion between intelligent and educated theologians. If your dog goes to heaven, then do his

fleas also go to heaven? If you want to be a Zen Buddhist, then treat it as a koan and let me know.

Today, on the Ides of March, we celebrate the assassination of the Roman worthy Julius Caesar. Instead of killing Julius Caesar today, purge your mind of useless and vain thoughts.

What happiness: it is night and we are alone!
The river is like a mirror, all ablaze with stars,
And there – lean your head back and look up –
What profundity and purity there is above us!
Call me mad! Call me what you will:
At this moment
Reason fails me,
And in my heart I feel such an outpouring of love,
That I cannot be silent, I won't, I can't!
I'm sick, I'm in love, but anguished and in love –
Just listen! Hear me well! – I cannot hide my passion.
And I want to say that I love you,
It is you, you alone that I love and desire!

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qr7BJ67xv3o>"

Posted on 2022-03-15 by Cologero

* * *

Balder on 2022-03-16 at 10:54 said:

I'm constantly surprised you refer so often to Steiner; wasn't he the very epitome of anti-tradition and a prophet of neo-spirituality? It's not along time I read Evola's 'Mask and Face of Contemporary Neo-Spiritualism' in which the Steinerian current is given a very harsh treatment.

I don't think the Steinerian forces of Ahriman, Lucifer and Christ refer to the three gunas, at least not in Steiner's own thought in which they depicted the personalized fallen forces /

entities of past humanities (manvantaras). They are more like the qliphoth of Qabalah (The “kings of Edom that fell” to quote Guénon), the unusable residues of past manvantaras that still haunt men.

To not engage in discussion whether Steiner’s theories of these fallen entities is correct or not, I still think they depict quite well the impulses that a human may undergo in one’s trials. In Lord of the Rings they are the “shadows of ancient kings”, the Nazgul (dupes of Sauron). In a dream a few years ago I fought them (successfully); in that dream they were first “Nazi black magicians” who turned precisely into “shadows of ancient kings” and then vanished into dust when I stroke them with my sword.

Balder on 2022-03-16 at 12:18 said:

Correcting myself: Christ was of course not one of the fallen hierarchies, the inverted trinity is satans, ahrimans and lucifers. They all depict a spiritual impulse wrongly conceives and used for selfish ends, that is why they are written in the sources with small initials.

This is how I see those forces acting in man: 1) satans: power and violence; power for powers sake (“Might is Right” philosophy and Nietzschean will-to-power). 2) ahrimans: technocratic materialism. 3) lucifers: self-aggrandizement, narcissistic self-worship, ego-inflation, megalomania. To refer to LOTR again, fallen Saruman represents all of these in one person while Gandalf is of course the risen Christ Victorious.

temptation of the ahrimans: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9PHxTEoVbjk>

temptation of the lucifers: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KQK1h7UxaRQ>

Drew on 2022-03-20 at 20:25 said:

So my problem is not that I cannot reason my way to faith but that I have fixated on reason. I’ve built a tower when I should have cultivated a garden.

4.59 UFO Research: Aliens

UFO research¹⁵⁹ is usually met with derision on one side, and passionate belief on the other. But in keeping with revolutionary science, it is necessary to be neutral, or zetetic. For the purposes of this article, only data that is consistent with the extraterrestrial hypothesis¹⁶⁰ — i.e., UFOs are spacecraft operated by intelligent beings — will be considered. There are

¹⁵⁹<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ufology>

¹⁶⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Extraterrestrial_hypothesis

many stories of not just visual sightings, but also physical contact with such aliens.

There must be thousands of contact stories but a cursory search did not reveal any organized body of evidence. We are only interested in physical entities, not any claims about demons or psychic entities. The assumption that such contacts are real, raises many questions. Somehow the aliens have solved these problems.

Navigation How does a craft navigate in outer space? Everything is moving in relation to each other, so there is no fixed point like the Polestar on earth. Even supposing we could send a craft to Alpha Centauri, how would the crew find their way back to earth? ETs must have solved the problem in some way.

Relativity As far as we know, it is not possible to surpass the speed of light, and even reaching a fraction of that speed would require large expenditures of energy, more than we can generate. The craft would need to be huge, which brings new problems, e.g., getting bombarded with space dust. There is no reason to doubt the Theory of Relativity, since it has never been empirically refuted. Hence, there are technologically insoluble problems with accelerating a craft to make space travel feasible.

But suppose Relativity is not true, so aliens are not actually limited by the speed of light and the energy required to reach it. That would be good to know.

Human beings Despite the diverse odd-looking depictions of aliens, they all seem to resemble human beings. They are upright and have sense organisms analogous to ours. It may be that that people, who have claimed contact with aliens, are unable to conceive of any being other than humans. Or it may be that human like qualities are pervasive in the universe, and are necessary to any intelligent beings. These proper-

ties may be metaphysical, as we believe, or they may simply be emergent properties of certain material arrangements, as physicalists believe. These are:

- They are material beings, presumably also based on DNA.
- They are alive in a basic sense, as are plants.
- They experience emotions as do animals.
- They have intelligence. Thus, the aliens are rational animals like us; that is what permits fruitful contact between humans and aliens.

If we avoid biological definitions of humans, this all makes sense.

Moral Universe Whether you believe that the universe is fundamentally moral, as does this site, or that it is a human construct, reported alien contacts involve moral issues. This is necessary for rational animals. There is no point to intelligence, if the intelligent being is unable to choose between the alternatives presented by the intellect.

The motives of the aliens have often been in question, most famously in the **Twilight Zone**¹⁶¹ episode *To Serve Man*. Even the atheist Stephen Hawking was concerned about letting aliens know about our existence because they may have evil intents toward us.

Limits to Intelligence Aliens may reveal inherent and intractable limits to our intelligence. As a graduate assistant, I had to teach basic algebra to elementary school majors. It was a frustrating experience, because many of the students seemed to be constitutionally unable to learn the topic. I tried explaining in several different ways, but it was futile. Premed

¹⁶¹<https://www.dailymotion.com/video/x80j7it>

students have had to drop out because they could not understand organic chemistry, and business majors often can't pass an economics class. I am fortunate, because there is no academic subject that I have not been able to learn.

But what if aliens have knowledge the simply exceeds the capacity of our brains. There have been stories of alleged visits of aliens to earth, such as the one described in *The Sirius Mystery* by **Robert Temple**. But in none of these stories, has anything been taught of much significance. To wit, they haven't taught unknown physics or cures for all diseases. Nor have they taught the best way to organize societies. You would think that they would have mastered those subjects. Perhaps, we simply cannot grasp what they know, so that we are forever limited in our knowledge.

Theological Issues Sometimes, people raise theological problems, viz., about the "fall of man", and how it relates to aliens. There are no difficulties to the esoteric understanding of events. The entire universe is fallen, not just on earth. We would be surprised to discover a civilization of immortal, totally good inhabitants.

Fleshly human beings, understood in the sense described above, are corruptible. The Adam of Eden was in a degree of existence above ours, which is why there was a "fall".

Sources Theories of Everything with Curt Jaimungal¹⁶² has provided the following list of UFO research projects. I could not listen to much of them, because they ramble too much and struggle to get to the point. But maybe others will find good material.

- Need To Know (with Ross and Zabel): <https://www.youtube.com/c/BryceZabel>

¹⁶²<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eouxDJMlPuM>

- Alien Girl: <https://www.youtube.com/c/Aliengirl111>
- That UFO Podcast: <https://www.youtube.com/c/ThatUFOPodcast>
- Cristina Gomez: <https://www.youtube.com/c/ParadigmShifts>
- Red Panda Koala: <https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCvSbzThCfsiETLp3e0dVkNw>
- GUFON: <https://www.youtube.com/c/GUFONRadioStream>
- Thomas Fessler: <https://www.youtube.com/c/thomasfessler>
- Truthseekers: <https://www.youtube.com/c/Truthseekershow>

Posted on 2022-07-24 by Cologero

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Balder on 2022-07-25 at 06:26 said:

The UFO phenomenon never stops amazing me. In this issue otherwise intelligent and serious people seem to fall for the post-modern mythology / demonology more easily than an illiterate peasant; perhaps they are desperate inside.

The UFO cult has penetrated even into religion and esotericism. New agers are especially drawn to aliens, as proven by the likes of Benjamin Creme and his ilk. Even the esoteric Hitlerist, Miguel Serrano, claimed that the superior blonde Aryans literally came from space, namely from Aldebaran, and the supreme cosmic tragedy was that they intermingled with the dark races created by Yahweh. All this goes on to show how deeply 'materialized' the concept on of a heavenly descent has become in modern minds.

Now I have seen some strange things in the sky like mysteriously moving lights that then suddenly disappear from sight but I'd rather opt for secret military intelligence as a cause than actual UFOs.

Nevertheless, Ancient Aliens must be the best program that has ever been broadcasted on TV for its deeply humoristic aspects (although there are actually people who take it seriously, and I'm guessing most of them are Americans). "Now I'm not saying it was aliens but it was aliens." ?

Michael DeJoy on 2022-07-25 at 10:04 said:

My take on the ufo story is that our physical universe is a closed system existing for the benefit of humans to carry out its destiny. All the discoveries of planets, solar systems, etc simply occur for the development/entertainment of man. It appears that the universe is infinite so that humanity will have hope of "progress" and that their beliefs in progress are good and correct. The universe that we see is like a painting existing in a museum along with many others. They are all different from each other existing in their own frame of reference. Probably the best of the sci-fi movies is Tarkovsky's "Solaris", where humanity finds an intelligent planet capable of interacting with people only on a scale which defies our understanding as to why it does what it does.

Balder on 2022-07-28 at 19:29 said:

@Michaeldejoy: we are absolutely not living in a "closed system". Our world is interpenetrated by forces from below or above every SECOND. IDEA OF a closed world can only appear on a closed mind. Every one who walks upon his own path in some point has to realize the different forces and powers, the national spirit around, above and below him.

WHEN THE KSHTRITA HAS OENETRATWD HIS OEN HAART.

It is said that the modern requirement of openness is only veiled forum of hatred upon secret. There are good reasons for gentlemen not to indulge in a basically profane ponderings upon inclinations of one's own character. There is the point from where free Men act.

Zagreus on 2022-07-31 at 19:44 said:

Any thoughts on Revelation 16:12-16

Balder on 2022-08-02 at 17:57 said:

I must have been very drunk when writing the previous post and I apologize for it. Cologero, you are a very patient man.

Cologero on 2022-08-02 at 19:10 said:

The spam detector blocked it, and I don't know why. Should I delete it or not?

Balder on 2022-08-02 at 20:00 said:

There was a right idea but it was dispersed between a drunken thought and bad expression.

Balder on 2022-08-02 at 20:05 said:

Did the spam detector also block my post on love post? Maybe it detects when a man is drunk which is exceptional! Does the AI know when I'm posting something when binge drinking? It must be the aliens!

Dimitri on 2022-08-03 at 10:17 said:

I don't think mankind has encountered any physical, tangible aliens (yet), but many people have had strange interactions with "psychic" beings from different spheres of reality that they believed were aliens (this would probably include "Lovecraftian" beings). Charles Upton has written books on the subject as I'm sure you're aware. I do find it interesting that prominent theologians used to discuss these sorts of things openly, like Nicholas of Cusa, who wrote the following:

"Life, as it exists on Earth in the form of men, animals and plants, is to be found, let us suppose in a high form in the solar and stellar regions. Rather than think that so many stars and parts of the heavens are uninhabited and that this earth of ours alone is peopled – and that with beings perhaps of an inferior type – we will suppose that in every region there are inhabitants, differing in nature by rank and all owing their origin to God, who is the center and circumference of all stellar regions."

4.60 The Great Fez Hat Sanction

Sanctions are nothing new. During the years before World War I, the Austria-Hungary Empire was a great power and manufacturing powerhouse. The Czech Republic, the part of the Empire, made most of the Fez hats in the world. The Fez was important to the Ottoman Empire:

The fez became a symbol of the Ottoman Empire in the early 19th century. In 1827, Mahmud II mandated the fez as a modern head-dress for his new army, the Asakir-i Mansure-i Muhammediye. The decision was inspired by the Ottoman naval command, who had previously returned from the Maghreb having embraced the style. In 1829, Mahmud issued new regulations mandating use of the fez by all civil and religious officials. The intention was to

replace the turban, which acted as a marker of identity and so divided rather than unified the population.

Wikipedia

During the first decade of the 20th century, there were several wars between various Balkan nations and the Ottoman Empire. Meanwhile, Austria-Hungary had its own designs on the South Slavs. It had been gradually getting closer to Bosnia and Herzegovina. But when the Empire formally annexed Bosnia in 1908, Türkiye put sanctions on Austrian Fez hats. As we know, sanctions hurt the sanctioner, so Türkiye lost their hat supply. Turks were then forced to turn to other hats.

In any event, Atatürk banned them a decade later as part of the effort to modernize Türkiye.

Posted on 2022-10-16 by Cologero

4.6I Statistics Ruin the Game

At that time, my father, mother, sister, and I were playing a family game together. I don't recall the game, but I was scorekeeper. Of course, I started to calculate various statistics and announced them at the end of each round.

I could see my father squirming and looking upset. Finally, after one round, he snapped at me, "You're ruining the game!" That ended the computations, both then, and for the future.

Perhaps he was expecting some type of Victorian era family chit chat. But we knew each other too well to engage in small talk and I was probably the only one capable of a more stimulating discussion. Even at that age, I knew elementary science, history, and geography. I used to read the encyclopedia and almanac; every day, I would read the all the sports stats in the newspaper.

I did learn when to be quiet, but boys are going to count. I still count even if I don't let people know.

Fast Forward If you fast forward to today, you will see the domination of statistics even if few understand them. The biggest adoption is in the sports world. I have always been a sports fan, so I've seen how Sports Analytics¹⁶³ have come to dominate in the past decade or so.

In the past, for example, a basketball coach would want the ball passed to the player with “hot hand”. Now the pass goes to the player with the opportunity for the highest percentage shot. It's funny to hear sportscasters talk about “sample sizes” even if they had never heard the term until 20 minutes ago.

The downside is that, with computers, they repeat all sorts of statistics that have no bearing on the game. The old story about the ignorant using technology.

As Galileo noted, “the language of science is mathematics.” But this is true for all manifestation. When writing a sonnet, the poet counts lines and syllables in each line. In a good sonnet, the counting will not intrude.

Boys will count.

Posted on 2023-02-25 by Cologero

4.62 Artificial Intelligence is better than none

A reader recently pointed out that the AI tool ChatGPT¹⁶⁴ knows about Gornahoor and provides a not unreasonable evaluation of it. Actually, it is better than my family and most of my friends, who ignore me altogether. At this point, Chat AI technology is, at best, only capable of paraphrasing text that already exists. This is ChatGPT's summary.

¹⁶³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Sports_analytics

¹⁶⁴<https://openai.com/blog/chatgpt>

Gornahoor is a blog that explores traditional metaphysics and the perennial philosophy, particularly in the context of the Western esoteric and spiritual traditions. The blog features articles and essays written by various authors, covering topics such as traditionalism, spirituality, philosophy, history, and culture.

The blog emphasizes the importance of the traditional worldview, which holds that there are timeless principles and truths that are accessible to human beings through spiritual and intellectual development. This perspective contrasts with the modernist and postmodernist worldviews, which often reject traditional knowledge and emphasize individualism, relativism, and materialism.

The authors on Gornahoor draw on a variety of sources, including the works of traditionalist writers like Rene Guenon and Frithjof Schuon, as well as the esoteric and occult traditions of the West, such as Hermeticism, Kabbalah, and alchemy. The blog also engages with contemporary cultural and political issues, applying traditional insights to current events and trends.

Overall, Gornahoor provides a platform for exploring the perennial philosophy and traditional metaphysics, and offers a perspective that challenges the dominant materialist and relativist assumptions of modern Western culture.

In contrast, the description from Bing AI Chat¹⁶⁵ is more terse, yet not incorrect.

Gornahoor is a blog that explores metaphysics, physics, religion and high culture, connecting Ancient Wisdom to the modern world. The blog covers topics such as the religion of medieval Europe, metaphysics, spiritual knighthood, sophiology and the common task, romantic Christianity, high culture.

Posted on 2023-03-27 by Cologero

¹⁶⁵<https://www.bing.com/search?q=Bing+AI&showconv=1&FORM=hpcox>

4.63 Simulation and Yellow Cards

At that time we had just moved to the suburbs. There I learned of an abandoned crabapple orchard which exist nowhere in the city. At harvest time boys would often go there and engage in a war of all against all, using crabapples as weaponized projectiles. They could really sting, but the potential joy of inflicting pain overcame the aversion to experiencing pain oneself.

Jacques got hit hard by one such globose pome. To my surprise, he started bawling like a baby. Since he was past the age when it was appropriate for boys to cry, I was confused; perhaps it was a defect of country folk. Nevertheless, since he was in my sixth grade class, I felt an obligation to comfort him. But then, I was even more surprised when he suddenly stopped. He said to himself aloud, “Where is Mrs. F.? Doesn’t she hear me crying?”

So he was just trying to get attention from some mother on the street, whom he apparently knew. Perhaps she knew his ruses or was reluctant to go outside during the war, but she never appeared.

That was when I learned about “simulation” for which he should have received a yellow card. Now I never assume that outward emotional manifestations necessarily correspond to inner states. Jacques was never a playmate after that incident.

Posted on 2023-04-11 by Cologero

* * *

taivasvaeltaja on 2023-04-19 at 02:38 said:

Perhaps he didn’t get hugs at home from his mother? From experience I can say that children usually want their mother to comfort them; it’s written in our biological make up. Men and fathers just don’t suffice, we’re not built for it and the children know it.

Logres on 2023-05-20 at 12:17 said:

In case the news has missed anyone here not on lists.

I am grieved to have the duty of letting the bees know that their beekeeper has passed away, peacefully, after a month long battle with Covid and attendant complications. Joel Salvo his son was kind to reach out. He passed on Ascension Eve. The website will be maintained by Mr Joel Salvo. If I receive a funeral date and time I will add it here. The beautiful old man is dead to this world but is with the Resurrection and the Life. Long long indeed, shall he live. Had thought of canceling meetings in his honor. But some may wish to commemorate him with attendance and reminiscing. Either way, but he would wish us carrying on, as the Spirit leads.

Arthur Konrad on 2023-05-20 at 13:28 said:

I'm very saddened by the news. Cologero was inimitable and he will be greatly missed.

Candido Catão on 2023-05-20 at 23:15 said:

This was the last article I read by C.S while he was still physically present in our world. It was a great honour and privilege for Humanity to have had the opportunity for such a valuable soul as like his to have shared great teachings with us.

Ismo Meinander on 2023-05-21 at 01:08 said:

R.I.P. Cologero. You were a treasure island of knowledge and wisdom, and you'll be greatly missed.

Juliano on 2023-05-21 at 06:18 said:

Rest in peace Cologero, you will be greatly missed.

Fergus on 2023-05-21 at 12:59 said:

Rest in peace Cologero.

Noct on 2023-05-21 at 13:03 said:

His writings have been a great contribution in the formation of men called by the Spirit. We could have differences, but you have been a great contribution in my own way and in that of many others. May the grace of the Lord be with you.

Santiago on 2023-05-21 at 17:51 said:

Thank you for everything.

PS on 2023-05-21 at 21:26 said:

Thank you for everything, Cologero.

Sunrise on 2023-05-22 at 03:04 said:
Thank you for sharing your wisdom with us, Cologero.
You will be greatly missed. RIP.

De Bosit on 2023-05-22 at 10:32 said:
I hope he is in Islamic paradise now.
I will miss his posts.

Avery on 2023-05-23 at 13:55 said:
"By giving birth to true virtue and nourishing it, he would be able to become a friend of divinity; and if ever a human being could become immortal, he could."

Sullen Eyes on 2023-05-23 at 17:50 said:
Forgive me for never compensating you in any way for the hundreds of articles you gave away for free. Farewell, Cologero

T. Freitas on 2023-05-23 at 22:05 said:
Rest in Peace, C.
I learned a lot from your writings. Thank you very much.

Dimitri on 2023-05-25 at 11:05 said:
Rest in Peace, Cologero. The work you've done here has been indispensable and invaluable to so many. Thank you for carrying on the torch of Tradition, rest assured your memory and mission will carry on. God bless all here at Gornahoor.

Aria Veritas on 2023-06-03 at 16:57 said:
This post was for me I believe. He was acknowledging that he'd stepped over the line and knew I was taking his request seriously- I wasn't coming back out of the house until he knocked politely.
I first heard of Charles' death yesterday through the O.I. newsletter.

For the last fortnight I've been expecting an email from him every day because he's been so strongly about, but decided to completely obey him for once and 'leave him be,' which was the last thing he wrote to me on April 4th. I wrote back, 'Consider it done my friend,' on the 5th. One month is by far the longest break we'd had since correspondence began.

I needed time to write and he didn't altogether approve of my themes; he thought it almost betrayed the church and his beliefs. But I must write what I see as true of course, intending to finish a few posts before contacting him again to explain my position in detail (through said posts).

Several times I thought something had happened but just as often overrode the feeling, figured he was messing with me (been hit by a globose pome, haha..) as he'd done a few times in the past.

He had told me of a dream about his father around mid-March. His father had asked him to sign a document or pay a fine to stay. He decided to pay the fine. We both suspected he was about to either jump or die but didn't voice these possibilities. That was what Gornahoor was about anyway- and he knew I had low tolerance for fears of death.

I'd also dreamt about a similar situation a few months prior, beautifully situated and surrounded by friends. But it was still rather a bell tolling in the distance and we both heard it, wishing we hadn't.

We were writing to each other for over a year. He found me wandering about in the worlds he described on this site back in 2021, and his (usually) charming and unexpected attachment enabled me to see God face to face during the 2022 Burning of the Ram, making universal sense of literally everything to my profound surprise and utmost gratitude.

MasterRaider on 2023-06-05 at 05:56 said:

May god embrace him as a friend, what a brilliant and great man he was. Rest in glory my brother, thank you for what you so generously taught us all these years.

tom on 2023-06-05 at 11:01 said:

<https://www.godsongs.net/2021/09/celtic-song-of-farewell-may-choirs-of-angels.html>

Max on 2023-06-05 at 15:13 said:

Thank you, Cologero.

Verity on 2023-06-06 at 02:54 said:

Thank you for everything. Eternal respect.

quantum lament on 2023-06-10 at 09:12 said:

Thank you for everything, Cologero.

<https://youtu.be/CxCReGRH61M>

Juliano on 2023-06-13 at 11:01 said:

Anyone knows about Cologero's translation of Man and His Becoming? I hope this important work is not lost.

DA on 2023-06-16 at 16:12 said:

The work is finished, God called for his servant. Rest in peace.

J on 2023-06-17 at 23:56 said:

I'm very saddened to hear this. I'm thankful to have been able to read Cologero's posts for many years now. It truly was a gift.

Rest In Peace Cologero.

InIlloTempore on 2023-08-10 at 08:44 said:

First of all, Cologero, thank you for opening for us the fountain of Tradition. That light which some wanderers have been seeking for so long. Before arriving this site, I believed that there was no hope of quenching that odd thirst of depth... Rest in peace, beautiful old man.

I pose a couple of questions to those who are still around.

First, I am making slowly my way along the posts of this site. That arises the feeling of compiling and ordering them in a manageable format for study and meditation. The purpose is that compiling becomes itself a way of meditation and inner work. The task is vast, since the amount of content may fill at least ten books. The point is that some of the readers of this site may be interested in sharing such task.

In particular, the project would be collecting posts in pdf's according to main issues: philosophy, metaphysics, translations, reviews, the Ancient City and family values, practical work, etc; and trying to track a path within the collection to make its inner thought a bit more apparent. Edition can be rendered via LaTeX or similar. It is worth the try, to give proper design to such a excellent content.

Needless to say, such project is to be done between friends. I mean, the final output is just to be shared between those interested. Only spiritual profit intended.

InIlloTempore on 2023-08-10 at 08:46 said:

Second, I read that there were forums, mail lists, even a study group to put into practice inner work. Have they been discontinued? If not, how can anyone join them?

PS: I beg your pardon for any misunderstanding above, English is not my native tongue.

Cae on 2023-09-29 at 19:35 said:

I'm so very saddened to hear of Cologero's passing... He was truly a source of light, and I have deeply appreciated the wisdom of his writings here.

May it be that he has been welcomed into Heaven – Amen.

Woody on 2023-09-30 at 09:40 said:

Blessed repose and eternal memory. Christ is risen.

Presbyter Iohannes on 2023-11-25 at 11:59 said:

AVM

Only now I came back here and read the news. I'm heavy hearted now. I will be sure to include him in my prayers and urge everyone who was a regular here to do the same. The work conducted by this man played a significant part in transforming me for ever. Thank you, Cologero. Condolences to his family and may he find the way of union with his heavenly archetype, for Eternal rest and Glory in the Absolute.

And for those who still dwell in here. Memento Mori. Let us die before we die, so that when we die, we don't die; and may we have the grace of meeting him and all of those who might be worthy in the Last Day.

Requiem aeternam dona ei, Domine, et lux perpetua luceat ei.

Requiescat in pace.

Amen.

William on 2023-12-10 at 11:20 said:

Hello,

As I understand it, from now on Mr. Joel Salvo will be taking care of the site. Does anyone know how can I get in contact with him?

Thank you in advance

Jean M.M. Bernard on 2025-11-21 at 08:05 said:

I had, regrettably, been out of touch with this site and its mastermind for a while, and did not learn about Cologero's passing away before today. I was compelled to check in here after Cologero seemed to appear to me in a dream this morning, communicating certain things which included giving me some kind of old clock in purple. He said that he loves all of you: emphasis on all.

May God bless him.

Musings about Tradition

5.1 The End of All our Exploring

Musings on excellence, the purpose of life, and the dissident right.

We shall not cease from exploration
And the end of all our exploring
Will be to arrive where we started
And know the place for the first time.

T.S. ELIOT, *Four Quartets*

Laid up with a little *agita* caused by too much Harp Lager¹ and corned beef², I got a chance to catch up on some Internet links my “friends” have recommended. They turn out to be of a little interest, though probably not in the way they were intended. They are categorized as Excellence, God is Love, and something new under the sun.

¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Harp_Beer

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/New_England_boiled_dinner

The underlying theme is that we already have everything we need. We don't need to explore elsewhere nor seek any modernist or post-modernist novelties.

Seeking Excellence A Swami Nirandjananda, speaking in Bulgaria³, assures us that the true purpose of life is to seek excellence, for which information, he was accorded rousing applause.

Of course, we upholders of the Western tradition recognize this as a call to *arête*⁴. Yes, we Westerners are expected to seek excellence, we have known this for quite some time, and we don't, or shouldn't, need an outsider to remind us. Guenon expresses it as the power to actualize the possibilities of the human state, a task naturally suited to the warrior caste. So now Gornahoor urges you all to seek excellence and to actualize your talents. Isn't that enough or are you secretly expecting something more spectacular?

God is Love

An American master of Krishna consciousness also explains the purpose of life in this online lecture⁵. He talks about cosmic order, or Logos. He asserts that man is a rational animal. To be human a man must be interested in purposes, or final causes as it is called in the West; otherwise he is no different from an animal. He condemns abortion and homosexuality. Finally, he assures us that God is Love. He claims he was raised as a Roman Catholic, and his talk could have been taken from the Catechism of the Catholic Church.

Of course, he no longer believes in "that" God, the sky God who

³<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=McPFZmngym4&feature=share>

⁴<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Arête>

⁵<https://www.bvks.com/2011/07/his-holiness-lectures-at-stanford-university-california>

punishes masturbators unjustly. He fails to mention that in the Hindu scheme you may come back as a rutabaga, or worse, as a dalit. What he neglects to mention is that Catholic or Western teaching does not actually teach such a God. The theism of the Western tradition is the God of Being, both transcendent and immanent, and nothing like what was described. Western theism is based on Aquinas, Aristotle, and Plato, with roots deep into paganism. Guenon notes this, and asserts that the Western conception of God is the same as Ishwara in Hinduism⁶. Now we can fault, perhaps, the priests for not effectively teaching the reality of God, but a public intellectual has an obligation to know better.

This applies *a fortiori* to the theorists of the Nouvelle Droite, who are obsessed with monotheism and its alleged evils. Western theism is nothing like what Mr. Benoist describes, and is certainly not a Semitic notion, as it is based on Roman, Greek, and Indian notions. Apparently, his intuitions of his feelings is not interested in such facts. You can take that critique seriously at your own risk.

Something New under the Sun The third link is an interview with the alt right. Whenever I hear this, I am reminded of the Three Stooges⁷ skit on the “other right”, but I will try to overcome this. Like the New Right, the alt right is based on Nietzsche somehow. About a third of the way into the interview, the question of Nietzsche’s influence was posed. To my surprise, the speaker became tongue-tied and was unable to answer the question; I assume because it is impossible to extract a political program from Nietzsche’s writings.

Nietzsche taught the will-to-power, not the will-to-knowledge. Hence, there can only be various perspectives, so the search for truth is futile. All the expressions of these perspectives are manifestations of the will to power. It is therefore pointless to dispute their truthfulness. Rather,

⁶<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ishwara>

⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Three_Stooges

the approach must be psychological. That is reason that Nietzscheans always attack the motives or psychological health of holders of alternative perspectives. Or else, like New Agers⁸, they point out the logical consequences of holding a certain perspective. For example, the writers on the new right never ask the question of the truth of the monotheism of the Western tradition, since it is absolutely irrelevant. Rather they point out the alleged consequences of holding that opinion. For example, they claim that a belief in monotheism somehow leads to intolerance or totalitarianism, which are a priori assumed to be (dare I say?) evil.

We hold that the Right can be objectively defined. The Traditional Right is based on the Ancien Regime, of which **Edmund Burke** and **Joseph de Maistre** are the exemplars from different perspectives.

Some of them claim that there are some Christian writers, presumably intellectual residues of the Old Right, aligned with the alt right. That seems incredible to me, as the movements are intellectually incompatible. True to his tradition, they are unconcerned with the truth claims of his allies, and attributes psychological motives to them. Namely, they embrace those traditions only because they are dissatisfied with American Protestantism. Gornahoor, on the other hand, recalls Constantine, Charlemagne, Aquinas and Dante; hence we are quite dubious about that assertion.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cx1klDB02bs>

Posted on 2012-03-19 by Cologero

* * *

logres on 2012-03-20 at 00:08 said:

The title of the interviewing radio show "Voice of Reason" reminds me of that propaganda writer in Gironella's trilogy on the Spanish Civil War who was called "Warning Voice" – definitely not portrayed very sympathetically, although plenty of the Requettes and Carlists come out looking just fine.

⁸<https://www.theseecret.tv/>

<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Requet%C3%A9s>

He looks like an Anglofied Romney.

Visionsofglory14 on 2012-03-20 at 09:16 said:

Why does the 'Old Right' tend towards greater intolerance for attempts at implementing a New Right than for the formless blob of Mass represented by the modern Left. Why reject an ally to that?

Christian theology teaches: "God blesses those who love Him, Others have meaningless lives"

Christians want the lives of non-Christian to be meaningless. Where they are not meaningless, they go out of their way to make them meaningless. A non-Christian who has found meaning is a Christian's worst memory.

Cologero on 2012-03-20 at 13:04 said:

Here is yet another example of the modern mind at work, much to my disappointment. Once again, rather than addressing the intellectual content, the commentator has to ascribe evil motives to others. Apparently, Visions of glory can read minds and is thus able to ascribe unexpressed desires and intentions to men across the Internet.

An intelligent reader would note these issues:

1) We mentioned Maurras and Evola as examples of the Old Right, neither of whom is a Christian.

2) No one is rejecting allies. We are discussing the roots of ideas. If we have misrepresented Mr. Benoist in any way, then please offer a correction. It seems to use that the New Right is rejecting allies, and for some very unconvincing reasons. *Are we making stuff up? No, we actually quoted Mr. Benoist himself when he specifically and unambiguously rejected Charles Maurras and Julius Evola as guides to the new right.*

3) The post was not written from a Christian of view and nothing was said about the meaningless lives of others. The final two paragraphs of the comment are incomprehensible gibberish.

4) Unfortunately, Visions of glory, despite his education, is apparently unable to grasp a literary allusion. The quote from Elliott was meant to reinforce the idea that meaning can be found at home, after much searching. A careful reading of the post will show that there is no dispute with the swamis per se. Rather, we pointed out that there is no need to turn East since the exact same teaching is found in the West. Was that not totally obvious to anyone else?

Visionsofglory14 on 2012-03-20 at 16:40 said:

http://findarticles.com/p/articles/mi_m1141/is_40_36/ai_6564378

March 1997: Ratzinger describes Buddhism as “an auto-erotic spirituality” in an interview with a French newspaper. Ratzinger said, “In the 1950s someone said that the undoing of the Catholic church in the 20th century wouldn’t come from Marxism but from Buddhism. They were right.”

Quote from China Matters: “Reportedly, at the time Cardinal Ratzinger was incensed that there were allegedly more Frenchmen studying to be Buddhist monks than Benedictine monks.”

One obvious problem with certain Protestants that makes their view anti-Traditional is their bunker mentality. They see things from a rigidly dualistic, ‘us versus them’ or ‘Christians versus ‘the world’ point view that stems straight from the Bible. It cannot form a common front with Tradition because it interprets any creed that is not their own as “evil,” “the world,” etc. They actually prefer to ally with the forces of global subversion because those forces are easy stereotypes of the “evil” familiar to them in the Bible. Hedonists, gross materialists etc.

Evola referred to those who practice the Catholic Faith in its old form as mere “half-way Traditionalists.” (I posit he would dismiss its modern form as anti-Traditional altogether). This means that Catholics who want to form a common front against global subversion must consciously go against the grain with the rest of their global community and even against their Pope. This makes it difficult to find dependable allies within the Church.

It’s exceedingly uncommon but not impossible to find good allies within Protestantism now; it’s probably about the same for Catholicism.

Enda Miller on 2012-03-20 at 17:50 said:

As far as the “New Right” is concerned, I have found some of its political insights intriguing and insightful, especially its analysis of classical “liberalism” and the dangers of “communism”. Yet, I have to agree that its criticism’s of Western Monotheism are puerile and unconvincing. For example, Benoist claims, along with many New Right thinkers, that Judeo-Christianity is the father of totalitarianism. However, if one is to be candid, one must admit that totalitarianism is a modern political phenomenon and that the modern era can hardly be defined as Christian. Of course, and perhaps paradoxically, the New Rightists agree with this latter claim, and have shown extensively that all of the modern “isms” are the result of the secularization of Christian dogma. Intellectual honesty would suggest that “New Right” thinkers are in fact great Inquisitor’s, exposing the dangers of leaving Christianity to the Masses, and upholding the necessity of an all-encompassing Orthodoxy... :.)

Cologero on 2012-03-20 at 18:00 said:

Compare this quote from Evola’s *Men Among the Ruins*

Action through “myths,” namely through formulas lacking any objective truth and that appeal to the sub-intellectual dimension and passions of individuals

and the masses, is the inseparable counterpart of the aforementioned political climate. In the most characteristic modern trends, the notions of “country” and “nation” display to an eminent degree the quality of myths, susceptible to receiving the most varied contents depending on which way the wind blows and on the political parties, with the only common denominator being the denial of the political principle of pure sovereignty.

To what Alain de Benoist has claimed:

1) Unlike Evola, Benoist has clearly articulated his preference for mythos over logos, that is, myth over objective truth

2) Unlike Evola, Benoist has clearly articulated his reliance on the “intuitions of his passions,” which Evola calls “sub-intellectual.”

This aligns Benoist with modernity, as someone who denies the principle of pure sovereignty. And Benoist does indeed deny that, and can only see in it a totalitarianism.

So in what conceivable sense can he be considered an ally?

Cologero on 2012-03-20 at 19:46 said:

Once again, Visions of Glory, you have posted a random comment with no point and no relation to the post in question.

We are not interested in choosing up sides like some children’s game ... check out our post on the Shibboleth to understand why. You have merely given the equivalent of a weather report, describing which way the wind is blowing.

Our main concern is developing the intellectual understanding of Tradition. You seem to be overly concerned with looking over your shoulder to check for “allies”, usually in the wrong places. That is not the kind of man we are looking for. Create your own allies.

Cologero on 2012-03-23 at 17:29 said:

Apparently the Buddhists see things differently: *Just for the Hell of it*⁹.

Cologero on 2012-03-23 at 17:48 said:

I agree, Mr. Miller, but my intent was not to criticize the New Right per se, but rather to explore the roots of their thought as described by Alain de Benoist himself. Men may agree in certain conclusions, but if their presuppositions differ, then a superficial agreement does not count for much. From the Traditional point of view, what is necessary is the *Common Mind*¹⁰.

⁹<http://bhikkhublog.blogspot.com/2007/04/just-for-hell-of-it.html>

¹⁰<http://www.righthandpath.org/the-church-and-the-common-mind/>

(Readers may substitute the metaphysical notion of “Spiritual Authority” for the theological term “church”. The point is the same.)

Now, by *polytheism*, the New Rightists do not really mean belief in multiple gods, but rather the assertion that the world consists of multiple powers, independent of each other and irreducible to a common principle. This is metaphysically unacceptable and is really no different from liberalism; instead of individuals themselves being independent monads (as in liberalism), for the new right, different cultures are monads. There is no basis for inter-communication as there is no common mind.

The New Right’s claim is based on a historical error. As we pointed out in our several posts on the *Ancient City*¹¹. The pagans of the Ancient City were not at all tolerant of each other. That is because the cults of different cities were mutually incompatible, so there was all out war between them. Only when they could be arranged hierarchically, could they be at peace with each other. But a hierarchy require a peak ... which leads to monotheism.

5.2 Evil, Disorder, and Redemption

There was an early morning fire in Boca Raton at a sushi restaurant ... it seems someone had left the stove on. Why does a sushi restaurant need a stove?

It is more than a little amusing that men who are clueless about what they want in their own lives are nevertheless able to discern the will of God in current events.

The many shooters may be angry young men, but they are angry for the wrong reasons and against the wrong people. Nonetheless, this disguises the many young men I meet who are righteously angry for good cause. **Peter Chojnowski** writes:

Liberalism is giving man a world in which he cannot live. ... anger is kept from its normal release in the rectification of that which is disordered. When normal release in acts of ordering are forbidden due to a legal and juridical preoccupation with rights and

¹¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?tag=ancient-city>

tolerance, you have personal and social explosion waiting to happen.

St Thomas Aquinas: “wrath is the spiritual strength to attack the repugnant.”

Fox News had a weird interview with a female rabbi and a Catholic priest, ostensibly to get God off the hook for the tragic events in Newtown. They blamed the boy’s free will, allowing God to wash his hands of it. The rabbi, with a touch of *schadenfreude*, explained that nothing could surpass the Jews, who were no strangers to even worse sufferings. The boyish priest thought the parents of the slain children just needed a hug, proving he has no clue the depth of pain that they are feeling. To match the rabbi’s claim to ultimate suffering, he said Jesus, too, was unjustly killed ... sensing an awkward moment he immediately added “at the hands of the Romans”. Pontius Pilate, too, washed his hands.

St Thomas Aquinas claimed that effeminate mannerisms disqualified a man from the priesthood. Hence, the lunar priesthood we witness may be *de facto* but it is not *de jure*.

It’s more than a little sad that boys don’t know how to become men today and then turn to the Bravo network version of the counter-tradition for advice on counterfeit manliness.

Every spiritual awakening begins with the problem of suffering.

Hail Holy Queen, Mother of Mercy, our Life, our Sweetness, and our Hope. To thee do we cry poor banished children of Eve, to Thee do we send up our sighs, mourning and weeping in this valley of tears.

Boethius had wealth, power, fame, prestige, family and lost it all, imprisoned and condemned to death. He sought consolation from Wisdom-Sophia, whom he called Philosophia. Sophia did not offer pious pabulum, but challenged him about his false conceptions of happiness; it is those which caused his suffering. She reminds him to remember who he is:

You have ceased to know your own nature. So, then, I have made full discovery both of the causes of your sickness and the means of restoring your health. It is because forgetfulness of yourself has bewildered your mind

The intellectual equivalent of the awareness of suffering is the consciousness of illusion. Consensus reality protects us from unveiling us from illusion. Do not be so quick to assume that is what you want; usually men choose another illusion when they get bored with one.

Evil comes from ignorance, weakness, and malice. They prevent us from knowing the nature of order or how to overcome disorder. Message to those who deny God for allowing evil in the world: first overcome your own ignorance, weakness, and malice. The antidotes: intelligence, courage, the will to justice.

In the awakened man, there is a gap between the impulse and the act. This gap is what the neopagan objects to, since it interrupts the natural flow of life. To shag a wench, to drink an ale, to unite with his kin, to smite an enemy: those are natural impulses, so why the gap?

Moses and Jesus, with their different revelations of the moral law, brought awareness of that gap to Europeans. Hence, the neopagans blame it on the Jews. They are suspicious of that gap, and rightfully so in many cases, since it gets filled up with a lot of pious nonsense. Grace does not destroy the natural impulses, rather grace builds on nature. Instead, however, the natural law is consciously chosen and not left to unconscious impulse. The gap is to be filled with wisdom and virtue.

Some regard it as a sign of great depth to fill that gap with doubt and angst. However, faith and gnosis bring absolute certainty. A wise man or sage, therefore, acts with complete certainty.

A woman came to me for advice about a moral dilemma she was in. She had two choices so I advised her to choose the moral one. She balked, claiming both choices were immoral. What she meant was that the moral choice was difficult and she lacked the courage to act on it.

The proletarian and the warrior both have violent and aggressive natures. Yet there is an unbridgeable abyss between them.

Schuon reminds us, we are to love our neighbor as ourselves, but not more than ourselves.

When reading the parable of the Good Samaritan, modern man, full of pride and vanity, puts himself in the place of the Samaritan. The Fathers, on the other hand, saw man as the stranger beset upon by thieves. Young men today are beaten down, robbed of their heritage, and left to spiritual death. Where is their Samaritan?

Plato said that the written text can serve those whose memories have been weakened by old age. Hence I write. But young men today have nothing to remember, hence must recreate Tradition from its remaining traces. I envy them.

Posted on 2012-12-18 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-18 at 23:54 said:

This is one of your most fiery articles yet and every word is true, Cologero. Your post reminds me of some great sermons I've heard from a priest of the SSPX. I am one person who though young and ignorant, am ready to take up the cross and follow Him with sword in hand to conquer Jerusalem.

Cassiodorus on 2012-12-19 at 20:42 said:

Vincit Omnia Veritas.

George on 2013-02-02 at 10:28 said:

Thank you for this. I have actually be wondering about that Good Samaritan passage for a time, as it doesn't seem to actually state what liberals claim.

"Which now of these three, thinkest thou, was neighbour unto him that fell among the thieves?"

So the innocent man who was violently attacked by evil men has now a neighbor, one he should love as himself who took care of him, who proved himself a true friend. We also have

the act of kindness itself, of Knightly courage and compassion, to right a wrong that evil men created.

Someone liberals read the parable as “give all your money to the evil thieves in all circumstances, and especially if they ask nicely.”

5.3 Year in Review: 2012

Past WordPress has released a statistical summary for Gornahoor in 2012¹², for those interested in taking a look. 170,000 page views are not very many in the grand scheme of things, yet for a blog that has no real identity, it is probably significant. The trend has been gradually increasing, but quality, not quantity, is the real goal. Note that three of the most frequent commenters are now missing, which is fine since they were the most disruptive and showed the least understanding. Recent comments, i.e., over the past several months, have been much more useful.

What is less interesting, and actually disappointing, is the quality of the search terms, which overwhelmingly come via Google. Despite having such extensive original material and new translations, Gornahoor shows up almost nowhere for the search on “Evola”. However, we come up high for “hermit crabs” and periodically we get several hits for that; I always assume it is from a science assignment at some school somewhere. “African ass” comes up every now and then; I assume they are really disappointed. Keep this in mind next time you rely on Google to do your research for you.

Present The experience has been personally fruitful. Over the past year, I have heard from several readers via email or telephone about their own spiritual paths. Obviously, I cannot and do not tell them what to do, since Gornahoor is not evangelizing for any particular exoteric path.

¹²<http://jetpack.me/annual-report/4840255/2012/>

However, if our interaction has helped anyone achieve clarity, I am happy. Interestingly enough, everyone seems to choose a valid Western path with relatively recent ties to the Middle Ages; specifically, no Druids or Wiccans trust my judgment. I have had one disappointing failure, a revert back to neo-paganism. He pesters me with nonsense missives that prove nothing; he should use the comments or the forums to get better feedback.

Future I have written 638 posts and I am committed to 1001 before shutting Gornahoor down. That comes to several hundred thousand words, since I try to keep posts around 1000 words. At 3 or 4 posts per week, if I can maintain that, we will be done in around two years. One of the posts is usually a translation, although I am finding fewer interesting pieces to translate. Those by Charles Maurras and Guido di Giorgio are not very popular. Evola is getting stale. There is some old material, plus the large volumes of his philosophical system; these would not be worth the trouble to translate and it is difficult to pull passages out of context. Then, of course, there are the books on race. A year or so ago, I translated his book *Synthesis of Racial Doctrine* for private subscription. I could not get 50 people worldwide to sign up for a free translation, so I stopped. Perhaps I will start again, but charge for it this time; let me know.

There is a toll for this on my life and on my health, since each post takes effort; they are never mindless commentaries on the daily news. In addition, I am taking on commitments to write blogs for commercial enterprises, anonymously of course. These tasks are preventing me from some projects I have in mind which would require a sustained book length theme. Even worse, it is affecting my spiritual life and the time I have for my own contemplative reading. I have been using up capital accumulated earlier and that may be running dry.

Another contributor or two to share the load would be helpful. I can suggest topics. For example, someone may want to do a meditation on

the labors of Hercules or the Romance of the Rose. We can be so limited to theory.

Initiation It is impossible to find a discussion of Tradition that is not obsessed with the notion of initiation. Is the issue of sacerdotal initiation vis-à-vis royal initiation truly a burning existential issue for anyone? If so, I would like to hear from the readers who are priests and kings to get their take on it.

I believe I have mentioned that I myself have been initiated into Mahayana Buddhism, since that option was available to me, plus the reasons I have mentioned several times already. I have recited the Heart Sutra, repeated the mantra endlessly, engaged in yantra meditation, and sat zazen. I know the sound of one hand clapping. Does that make me more reputable to anyone beyond the actual texts? Does anyone think to himself, ‘wow, that was written by a real initiate’? Yet it was, for what it’s worth. If I bore you, then you could listen to the Beastie Boys instead; they are also initiates. Does anyone get the point or do I need to spell it all out?

Preparation That brings me to the real point, to wit, what is important is not initiation, but rather preparation for initiation. Otherwise, you will most likely end up with the spiritual equivalent of drinking wine out of a box. Obviously, being familiar with sound doctrine is necessary. Is your preparation including the following points, at a minimum?

- The World is Intelligible
- The World is ordered
- There are multiple states of being beyond the physical world
- Man is a unity, yet composed of multiple sheaths or souls
- And so on

Of course, this must be “carnal knowledge”, that is, ideas you live out in the flesh. Your whole life centers around sound doctrine and you are not deluded by the snares of ordinary life. You remember you have chosen all that happens in your life or else it is the Will of God; better if you cannot tell them apart.

When you read religious and spiritual texts, you understand the symbolic meaning behind them (which does not necessarily deny their factual meaning.) You understand that esoteric teachings are not opposed to the exoteric and, most especially, they do not represent a competing set of beliefs. Rather, they indicate different states of consciousness (not necessarily states of being). Efforts must be made to recognize these states.

In other words, you cannot wait for an elusive initiation. It is a struggle, a search, and adventure; even if and when you find a good initiator, he will not show you everything. No, he will still make you struggle and search. There is no one right way for everyone; that is why the hero has 1000 faces.

Winding Down Although some few men (I hear from no women) have benefited, I am at this point not sure what else needs to be done. The original task was to serve as the catalyst for an elite who would go into the world. I have heard from students, and I pray they will someday be in an academic position where they can spread the ideals of Tradition. Others hope to influence youth education; still others plan to form a healthy family in today’s unsound environment.

On the other hand, there is no shortage of ideas, if we know how to think, how to have patience, how to mind fast. The idea creates the thought which creates the word that leads to action. That is a law and it reveals the importance of good ideas.

Hence, in the time left, I want to make sure that Gornahoor actually exhibits, and not just documents, the principles. Probably no one has noticed that. For example, it should demonstrate organic rather than me-

chanical thinking. It should be about principles, not limited to opinions or facts. When the thought becomes the external word, it should adhere to the rules of grammar, the laws of logic, with the art of rhetoric.

Hence, the topics need to arise from intuitive awareness, not from technical planning. That is the way it will be, for those who continue to visit.

Year in Review Continued

The direction in which we may find awakening and liberation, the direction of liberation, is vertical and has nothing to do with the course of history.

JULIUS EVOLA, *The Doctrine of Awakening*

Rather than respond to comments, I'll address several issues here. As I've indicated several times, our goal at Gornahoor has been to prepare an intellectual elite. Over time, the audience has changed quite a bit to the point where there is now more of a common mind or at least a general agreement of principles. In post 1001, I will reveal everything.

The end of my involvement in Gornahoor is not necessarily the end of Gornahoor. As more writers become involved, it will develop a different identity. It could take some time, perhaps generations, for the elite to become effective; after all, the time of preparation began some 90 years ago. Some readers think I have the alchemical skill to translate spiritual ideas to the written text and they have benefited from it. That was the intent: to clear away false ideas to get to the core of Tradition. Once certain principles are understood, the ensuing choice and commitment becomes clear and necessary.

Ideally, there should be 100 new blogs bringing Tradition to the various walks of life, professions, arts, and crafts. So, I am not predicting an end, but rather a beginning.

Buddhism Readers must take care in what they read and not jump to conclusions that do not follow. I try to be precise. Furthermore, texts must be understood in the light of other texts. Reading in this manner is difficult; however, writing in such a way is even more difficult. I hope I have not failed completely. For example, I wrote:

I myself have been initiated into Mahayana Buddhism, since that option was available to me.

Given what we have written about initiation and conversion, particularly in the case of Guenon, who can conclude from this that I am a Buddhist? It is obvious that Guenon and Evola have put great stock into the idea of “initiation”; as the correspondence show, Evola pestered Guenon with that question even 25 years after their first exchange of letters. So I, too, took it quite seriously. I also took seriously Guenon’s claim in the *King of the World* that the ‘lost word’ would be found among the sages of Tibet.

Hence, I studied everything Tibetan, including occultists like Blavatsky, Nicholas Roerich, even Alice Bailey who claimed a Tibetan connection. I took the sangha vows and a few initiations from various Tibetan Lamas. Now that settled the problem of initiation for me so I could continue my studies of Tradition knowing I was an initiate. Was that necessary? Readers can decide for themselves. As for myself, I have been thinking lately “no”. On the other hand, maybe personal instruction in forms of meditation and hearing doctrine from initiates really has made an effective difference in understanding; that can’t be ruled out. In retrospect, it did lead to a change of direction in my life. However, I don’t recommend this for all, especially those who have returned to the Western Tradition since they would have to confess that apostasy.

In any case, that did not make me a Buddhist; just an initiate in a valid Tradition. I left when I realized that my purposes had been served. In any case, Buddhism in America is in a sorry state. For example, I received

a booklet about my dharma vows, in which there is a general prohibition against oral, anal, and masturbatory sex. Since a large number of American Buddhists are ex-Catholics who have told me they have moved beyond that, these prohibitions are mostly ignored. Even more curiously, a minor transgression against the vows can be repaired with a personal prayer, but a more serious one requires the retaking of the vows with a lama. This is identical to the Catholic distinction between venial and mortal sins.

What I liked about Tibet was that it was the last of the patriarchal theocratic societies, so it is still a good model. Unfortunately, no one else was interested in that sort of Tradition. Apparently, the Dalai Lama himself is thoroughly Westernized, despite his reactionary past if anything on the Internet about him can be believed. A blessing did come my way, from a Jewish convert to Buddhism who had a PhD in medieval history. She convinced me that the Medieval era was much more than the “Dark Ages”, which gradually altered my view of that time. More detailed study led me to my current understanding.

As for the question about the Doctrine of Awakening, Buddhism has become a “devotional faith” by Aryan westerners. I oppose “large” judgments about movements that evolve over the centuries involving hundreds of millions of people. They give the impression of erudition while lacking all content. You can judge the Doctrine of Awakening by how well Evola extracts the various inner states of Buddhist practices. He does that well through his quotes and organization of key ideas. Nevertheless, that is merely academic exercise without making the efforts of actually achieving those states. They do not arise, I can assure you, from reading about them.

Priests and Kings Redux To return to this tedious theme once again, despite the many times it has come up, no one ever addresses anything specific in those posts. In the first edition of *Revolt against the Modern*

World, Evola quoted a text from the Aitareya Brahmana and claimed that the King was the Sun and the Priest the Moon. Coomaraswamy, a Sanskrit scholar, pointed out Evola's error in a review. The text really said the exact opposite; the Priest recited the bridal vow that an Indian groom makes to his bride. That is the proper relationship between the Priest, as the Sun, and the King as the Moon. Evola pulled that reference from future editions of *Revolt*, but never changed his thesis. Draw your own conclusions about hiding contrary evidence. From now on, any comments on this issue will have to address that specific text from the Brahmana.

From a metaphysical point of view, it makes sense. The Priest is the link between the physical and the transcendent, i.e., the vertical. The King acts horizontally, although accepting the advice and the counsel of his priests. The vertical is Purusha, the unchanging, the masculine. Action is Prakriti; even in Tantra, Shakti is the feminine principle of action. To twist this to mean something else is a waste of intellectual capital. Together, the vertical and the horizontal form the sign of the cross, the sign of Triumph.

The Western Tradition So this brings us to the self-loathing that marks certain segments of the counter-Tradition in the West. They look everywhere for Tradition except for where it is. For us, that is the pre-schism Church, uniting the East and the West horizontally as well as the connection to the best of pagan Greece and Rome. We also need to mention the contribution of the Celts and the Franks to this synthesis.

This includes an esoteric Tradition that has been poorly preserved and also the Hermetic tradition that is also preserved and developed. Note that this is not the same as so-called "Traditional" elements in churches today, since they are usually suspicious of anything called esoteric, perennial, or Hermetic. Nevertheless, the esoteric teachings are not intended to replace the exoteric teachings; rather they are reserved for the few who

interest themselves in such things.

In modern times, we have mentioned a particular trend that shows the initiation still exists in the West, as Guenon suspected. The Russian esoterist **G. O. Mebes** initiated both **Valentin Tomberg** and **Mouni Sadhu**¹³. We have mentioned less about the latter. Sadhu was actually a Polish Catholic who lived in **Ramana Maharshi**'s ashram for a time before settling in Australia. Based on his own experiences and studies, he claims that the highest teachings of the West were not less than those of the East. He published several useful books of exercises on concentration, meditation, theurgy, and control of the mind. Some may find them helpful.

Otherwise, you are all on your own, some doing better than others.

Posted on 2013-01-13 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-14 at 02:56 said:

The reason for the endless debate on priestly vs kingly initiation is the Evolian substitution of political activity for spiritual enlightenment. Too many people, especially from the Dugin camp today, think being a traditionalist means marching down the streets screaming death to the West and support for third world atheist socialist regimes rather than trying to spiritually leave the world and know oneself.

Your reference to a certain American rap musical group whose deceased lead singer was a Tibetan Buddhist initiate was made to illustrate I believe the need for study to make said initiation real, otherwise it remains virtual and of no benefit. Too many people today think initiation is like a magic formula that suddenly makes a person into an angel, they forget it requires hard work... ..

I apologise if I go off course, but may I ask you, as a Buddhist, what your opinion is of Evola's Doctrine of Awakening ? I dont believe I've seen you comment much on it before and would like to know your thought on his hypothesis of Buddhism being an Aryan warrior anti-religious path that was later made into a devotional faith by the non-Aryan Asiatics... ..I find Evola's interpretation problematic but would like to know your thoughts.

¹³15 Jan 2021: Correction. Tomberg was not initiated by Mebes, but was in direct contact with some of his students.

Audrey on 2013-01-14 at 10:58 said:

Shocking to hear no register for Evola, especially considering the quality and background width of material presented. But again, we live in a paradise of roses, or do we?

Audrey on 2013-01-14 at 11:00 said:

As for shutting own, does that include deletion as well?

Audrey on 2013-01-14 at 11:19 said:

Not sure if I count as a man, though.

Cassiodorus on 2013-01-14 at 14:17 said:

My skepticism and scientism was effectively smashed to pieces by the writings of the Perennialist school. Taking their lead, Tradition brought me “back” to Catholic Christianity. Since then, I have invested myself in the works of the Church Father, but recently I have focused on the Angelic Doctor, Thomas Aquinas.

The more that I have learned about the Great Tradition, the more that I have come to doubt the transcendent unity of religions. Is it not possible that the Christian revelation is something of a “ground zero” of the Divine descent and that the Trinity does, in fact, tell us something about the Divine on the level of the pure Absolute?

scardanelli on 2013-01-14 at 18:27 said:

As I have mentioned, your writings have been extremely helpful to me as well. I was raised in Catholicism and have made the journey from progressivism, to radical environmentalism, to Heidegger and Nietzsche, to tradition. When I first stumbled upon this site I was but a “traditionalist without a tradition,” as most become after reading Evola. But little by little, I have come to see my native Catholicism in a newer (and older) light.

“And the end of all our exploring. Will be to arrive where we started. And know the place for the first time.”

This site has been a light in a darkening world, opening a way beyond the darkness. It would be selfish to ask you to continue your efforts further than you are able. As I seem to have come upon this site near the end, I hope that I can contribute in any small way that I am able.

Mihai on 2013-01-15 at 03:38 said:

I don't know, Cassiodorus.

You really have to put yourself in the position of someone at the other end of the world. For them, Christianity is just some abstract religion practiced in a far away land. Just like for the

common Christian man of the West, Taoism is some abstract asiatic philosophy and Hinduism is some weird practice of sitting cross-legged with a minimum of clothes on.

Of course, this is all after the advent of globalism, when contacts between different parts of the world became open to large masses of people, not only to some merchants and wanderers as was the case before. In those days, knowledge of far-away religions was non-existent.

CS Lewis wrote somewhere that “the pole you’re sitting next to seems a lot bigger than the other ones further down the road”. Of course, it wasn’t in any context concerning the unity of religions, but it is a good metaphor for this case as well. The further geographically and mentally we are from a pole – which in this case is a certain religion – the smaller and more insignificant it seems to us. A reversal of perspectives also applies.

Though I do agree that for western man, Christianity is the most suitable.

Cassiodorus on 2013-01-15 at 11:33 said:

Mihai,

I appreciate your thoughts on this matter. I totally resonate with your pole metaphor and it represents the view that I have always upheld. However, the problem that I have been wrestling with, of late, is the difficulty in reconciling Trinitarian theology with the central claim of the Perennial Philosophy. According to Frithjof Schuon, the Christian Trinity must be on the level of the “relative Absolute” – the first determination of the Supreme Principle. But, to my lights, this runs contrary to the fundamental Christian claim that the Trinity tells us something of the Absolute at the highest degree of *beyond* being. If you are interested, an excellent debate/exchange on this subject between the Christian platonist Robert Bolton and the Traditionalist Jose Segura can be found at sacredweb.com.

Avery on 2013-01-15 at 11:53 said:

I have found that those who become influential within a particular tradition, like Seraphim Rose, credit traditionalism with awakening them to the reality of metaphysics, but only as a conduit to eventually finding higher truth as a member of an order.

Pickman on 2013-01-15 at 17:31 said:

“The reason for the endless debate on priestly vs kingly initiation is the Evolian substitution of political activity for spiritual enlightenment.”

Excellent analysis. An angry nationalist will achieve more (against modernism) by physically pushing basic conservative principles while upholding the faith within a dogmatic manner. The internet has killed genuine action in many ways.

If one has learned over many years of struggle to develop a coherent character then action is inevitable and must be taken as course of fighting dark forces in the name of Tradition.

Since the noose narrows around the few who care it is of urgency that there are those to stand against the external crisis we find ourselves in.

“Too many people, especially from the Dugin camp today, think being a traditionalist means marching down the streets screaming death to the West and support for third world atheist socialist regimes rather than trying to spiritually leave the world and know oneself.”

Dugin is not a traditionalist and certainly given too much attention by European nationalists for his own worth. He is a Slavic national bolshevik at the root and never holds back his distaste for the “West”. If his political theory (or scheming) was simply a cause of modern reaction then we could take a more favorable view but there are deeper layers of his native soul at work here. Basically his political theory is not for export.

“Your reference to a certain American rap musical group whose deceased lead singer was a Tibetan Buddhist initiate was made to illustrate I believe the need for study to make said initiation real, otherwise it remains virtual and of no benefit. Too many people today think initiation is like a magic formula that suddenly makes a person into an angel, they forget it requires hard work... ..”

This is the new age spiritualist fallacy, there is a magic pill for anybody to become whatever they want from Brooklyn Jew to Buddhist (in the BB's sense)

at least nominally. Interior they are the at the will of the counter-initiation.

“I apologise if I go off course, but may I ask you, as a Buddhist, what your opinion is of Evola's Doctrine of Awakening ? I dont believe I've seen you comment much on it before and would like to know your thought on his hypothesis of Buddhism being an Aryan warrior anti-religious path that was later made into a devotional faith by the non-Aryan Asiatics... ..I find Evola's interpretation problematic but would like to know your thoughts.”

Evola's interpretation is more than reasonable as it goes to the original source. Some scholars have backed this analysis. Buddhism is suddenly appealing when stripped down from all the layers of sentimental muck endowed by profane explication. The eight-fold path is harsh and therefore will rarely be answered but by a few.

Pickman on 2013-01-15 at 17:47 said:

You count as a conduit for male chromosomes and that is significant enough. You are the “matter”, mother, the feminine lunar archetype that is the reflection of the mans genius and light. Men shape you, mold you, decide your fate and will, you do not and never owned yourself. This is the cosmic law weather you believe this rule or not and any deviance from it leads to chaos and hell. Just what women want unless they are tamed appropriately in their place.

Now listen up woman, you have no choice but to make way for the solar masculine light that is the cosmic law of the universe by divine right and holy imperial justice. It is what exists eternally within the metaphysical heavens as absolute and will by divine right return to manifest again on earth by divine rule of order. If the world crumbles, if priestesses rise from the bowl

of modern puss to rule over the emasculated west, it will be a fleeting moment of extreme corruption against natural law, to which it in the end of time and beginning of a golden cycle it will be hammered down with divine justice. Gold outshines silver.

Saladin on 2013-01-15 at 23:01 said:

Dear Cassiodorus,

I looked at the list of the contributors to sacredweb.com. Guenon was not listed and there was no mention Evola. This is enough (for me) to prove that this journal is run by "Counter Initiation" or at least has been co-opted by it. Bunch of safe academics, pseudo-sufis, and "scholarly oxen" (with a few notable exceptions).

This may be heretical to some here but I think Frithjof Schuon and his followers have deviated from Guenon's teachings. This is a proof that "Counter Tradition" is very much attentive and extremely aggressive in first identifying and then co-opting any resistance to Modernism!

Mihai on 2013-01-16 at 06:23 said:

"but I think Frithjof Schuon and his followers have deviated from Guenon's teachings."

This is quite a strong statement. What makes you say that? Do you say that he deviated completely, in the essentials, or in some particular respects? And if Schuon "deviated" why hasn't Evola done that too, for example?

Also, I find it a bit disturbing to say that Schuon deviated from Guenon, as if Guenon founded some new religion or cult, or something.

The only concern for me is who deviated and who conformed to the truth, not to another individual.

I am asking this (and I am waiting for your answer on this) because I am tired to see that even in this field, things have deviated to partisanship, skirmishes between followers of this or that writer and so on.

Scardanelli on 2013-01-16 at 10:52 said:

Agreed. The search for purity of thought in others seems to be a stumbling block on the spiritual path. In the modern world, everything is mixed and confused and it must be enough to know and recognize counter traditional ideas as they arise without throwing the baby out with the bath water so to speak. We must learn to be discerning when it comes to ideas and not fall into the trap of the "true believers" of Guenon, Evola, Schuon, etc... Wasn't the division of those who seek to uphold tradition delineated as a tactic of the counter initiation in a recent post?

Cassiodorus on 2013-01-16 at 11:19 said:

Schuon, a Guenonian deviation? I wouldn't sign my name to that. You can go to online articles at Sacred Web.

I'm struggling to create a link. Mihai, if you are so inclined, take a look at the essay, "The Problematic of the Unity of Religions" by the Perennialist Catholic, Jean Borella. I'd be curious to hear your reaction.

Best,
Cassiodorus

Logres on 2013-01-16 at 16:19 said:

Cassiodorus, I haven't found the article yet, but here are some editorial remarks upon it:

http://religioperennis.org/documents/Editorial/Issue5/editorial_III1.pdf

Borella is certainly right to think that Christianity may be a "revealer of revelation", yet I don't know enough about Guenon to say whether or not he would have rejected this – certainly Tomberg talks about the new religion as a hallower and purifier of what had already come.

Cassiodorus on 2013-01-16 at 20:27 said:

Hi Logres,

You can just google that essay by Jean Borella- it can be found at sacredweb.com. Another essay of note that I think would be of great interest was posted recently by Charles Upton entitled, "Were Rene Guenon and Frithjof Schuon Biased Against Love?" in response to a charge made referring to Guenon as an "eye without a body".

Logres on 2013-01-16 at 21:44 said:

This debate is immensely interesting, but we should be careful that we "find what we seek" : that is, if we approach the subject expecting to find deviations, then we shall find them. Jesus addresses this, when he tells the Pharisees that they have an evil eye. So, I think we should humbly approach Schuon and Guenon and even Borella's differences (they may simply be ill put) with an eye to discovering the unity. By their fruit, you will know them, and Guenon and Schuon need no defending on this score. I just started an article on the Marian roots of Schuon's spiritual lineage, which looks good:

http://www.cutsinger.net/pdf/colorless_light_and_pure_air.pdf

Cutsinger says right out that the article is "not for anyone", not for the skeptic.

Logres on 2013-01-16 at 21:48 said:

Borella is a latecomer : that is, the Church has belatedly "woke up" to the perennial tradition, so there are problems with this situation that need to be kept in mind. As far as I know, even F. Rose was cautious in his critique of Guenon. He limited himself to saying that they were a waysign on the path of Truth, but not its fullness. But no one here, as far as I know, would want

to commit to the same ecclesiastical views held (in their particular entirety) that F. Rose had, although I certainly wouldn't mind him praying for me. Cassiodorus, thanks, I did find it.

Mihai on 2013-01-17 at 04:47 said:

This is something interesting. It seems that many people who started from Guenon and ended up embracing a Christian path have become skeptical of the unity of traditions. Borella and Fr. Seraphim Rose are perhaps the best known examples, but I see here other people too.

I don't know the cause of this. Is it indeed a matter of an inner superiority of the Christian revelation? Or maybe the exclusivist spirit of the Church Fathers that is overwhelming in the long run?

It would be interesting to hear Cutsinger's point on this, since he did not come to embrace this view.

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-17 at 08:28 said:

Boris Mouravieff explained the matter quite clearly – the other forms of the tradition were revealed to one group of humanity in particular whereas Christianity is universal and given to all men as a completion of the Tradition. Thus it is not contradictory for me to say all religions are derived from the one God but only the Catholic Church contains the fullness of truth.

Cologero on 2013-01-17 at 08:35 said:

In a response to F. G. Galvao's claim that "Schuon had realized Guenon's dreams", Rene Guenon wrote back (2 December 1948):

I don't recall having used that expression but I have to recognize in it that it corresponds nicely to something true, for it is certain that without him, many things would have remained in the state of some sort of "theoretical" possibility and would not have been able to come to be realized *se realiser*. (My translation)

That is a rather strong endorsement, but perhaps something changed subsequently.

Mihai on 2013-01-18 at 06:43 said:

"Thus it is not contradictory for me to say all religions are derived from the one God but only the Catholic Church contains the fullness of truth."

For you it may not be contradictory, but for God it surely is.

What you just said implies that God, who is Truth, has been delivering to humanity something less than the truth. And anything less than the truth contains a degree of falsehood. Which is to say God is the author of falsehood around the globe.

Such explanations are not going to do.

Logres on 2013-01-18 at 06:55 said:

The fullness of Truth can/could be ready for certain stages of humanity, if the makeup of the receiver determines (partially) the form and content of what is revealed; isn't this the whole point of the Old Testament? However, it is also true that "not one jot or tittle shall pass away till all is fulfilled" – so that there is a paradox. A revelation can be (if the OT is any guide) fully complete, and totally the truth, containing within it the splendor of truth and fullness of beauty, and yet the fulfillment be such as to make it seem (if possible) lacking. I realize this analogy may not hold for other revelations, but the paradox exists. I think it has something to do with the "double oath", once by earth, once by heaven.

Cassiodorus on 2013-01-18 at 20:45 said:

It seems to me that the question of Christianity and its "compatibility" with the Perennial Philosophy revolves around how we interpret the Incarnation, the Word Made *Flesh*. *As I understand it, the Perennialist would draw a very important distinction between the statements "Jesus is God" and "God is Jesus." Speaking for the Traditionalist School, the Perennialist Orthodox theologian, James Cutsinger, states the following:*

"Christian Perennialists conclude that it is a mistake to confuse the uniqueness of the only-begotten and eternal Son of God with the alleged singularity of his historical manifestation in first-century Palestine. Without denying that there is only one Son of God, or that he alone is the author of salvation, or that Jesus Christ is that Son, they contend that there are no Biblical or dogmatic grounds for supposing that this one Son has limited his saving work to his incarnate presence as Jesus. On the contrary, as St Athanasius and other fathers insisted, though the Word "became flesh and dwelt among us" (John 1:14), he was not confined by his body even during his earthly ministry."

Inclusivist Christians hold to the view that the the Third Person of the Trinity, the Holy Spirit, can be and is present in other world religions, rendering them salvific, but indirectly. The Perennialist position seems to be saying that it is Christ, the Logos, that is manifesting in different ways in other Traditions, in addition to Jesus of Nazareth. Can this view truly be reconciled with Christian orthodoxy?

Cologero on 2013-01-19 at 08:25 said:

Cassiodorus, all things visible and invisible, were created through the Logos, obviously including different Traditions in some way. Guenon repeatedly claimed that all theological dogmas can be reframed in metaphysical terms; hence, discussions along these lines are well worth the effort. Now, Solovyov attempted to explain dogmas such as the Incarnation and the Trinity in terms of his metaphysical system, as well as those influenced by him. That should be

worth a few studies at some time. Meanwhile, you could refer to Rama Coomaraswamy who tried to deal with this issue of exclusivity vis-a-vis perennialism. For example, what he writes about the *Baptism of Desire*¹⁴ is of interest.

Graham on 2013-01-19 at 10:09 said:

There is a difference between being “derived from God” and being “delivered by God”.

I'm just pointing this out. I don't necessarily agree with JasonAdam's formulation.

But the idea that God would ‘hand-deliver’ polytheistic religions is surely less tenable. See the first Commandment.

Cassiodorus on 2013-01-19 at 20:14 said:

Your last comment in the forum was well said.

Vincit Omnia Veritas

Janus on 2013-01-16 at 01:39 said:

Where in the west would you say one can find the pre-schism Church? In my journey, I have investigated both Catholicism and Orthodoxy. In Catholic churches today, one seems to be faced with a grim choice of a modernizing Church more concerned with condoms in Africa than transforming sacraments on the one hand, and a traditional Catholicism on the other which so often is filled with reactionary elements (in the sense of being hostile to anything perennial or esoteric, as you said). Orthodoxy seems to me to have far more promise, but as Fr. Rose found, hostility can come from this direction as well.

Personally, I stumbled upon Tradition as one not believing in God (a conclusion reached after the journey mentioned above). Investigating the Traditionalist writings, the idea of God as the “face” of the Divine provides some reconciliation here to me. As I once read it described, “God is a mask. Who wears Him?” The questions of Traditional metaphysics and personal practice are great ones indeed, even without considering the question of God in the theistic conception of Him. As such, Buddhism has increasingly seemed interesting to me, as it is not a theistic path. Would you say that I should look back to Catholicism or Orthodoxy despite this (as thoughtful advice, not guidance from a guru, of course)? One might have either “a shaykh or Shaitan” as ones’ guide, but when shaykhs seem impossible to find in the remains of the the western Tradition, one really seems left to ones’ own devices.

That said, I was reading earlier today Prince Charles’ opening address to Sacred Web’s 2006 conference. If the Prince of Wales himself is struggling with these questions, perhaps that provides some comfort that we are not so alone as it may appear, and hope that we may indeed see the “end to all our exploring”. Thank you very much, Cologero, for the work you did here. I

¹⁴<http://www.the-pope.com/bapodesc.html>

particularly enjoyed the Maurras translations, and would definitely like to see more if you are able. For Maurras and de Maistre alone, French is a language to learn. Best wishes, and I hope to see this blog and your work continue after you finish.

Avery on 2013-01-16 at 02:09 said:

Janus,

Inherent in the juxtaposition of tradition and modernity is the recognition that things are at a very decayed state today. But I see the existence of this blog as a sign of hope. Guenon diagnosed the disease before the victim was entirely dead. After him there have not been many doctors with the intellectual ability to start treatment. This is the beginning of that era. It is natural, following the intellectual rigor of Guenon, to see decay all around you. Embrace it and correct it with compassion.

Brett Stevens on 2013-01-16 at 07:35 said:

Tradition seems to me to be a truth derived from life itself that can be spoken in many languages or philosophical types. However, that doesn't mean it bends like a young tree in the wind. It is roughly the same thing because the world and cosmos are the same everywhere.

I hope you continue writing in whatever form suits you. From having written online for over 20 years, I recommend taking regular breaks anyway. You can simply deplete yourself of what you wish to communicate, and in doing so, neglect internal communication that helps you develop clarity of your own ideas.

Cologero on 2013-01-16 at 08:24 said:

I'm afraid, Janus, that the only thing I can tell you is to not confuse a particular institution with the spiritual tradition itself, which is much larger. Also, practices which are suitable for monks are not always suitable for men in the world.

Visionsofglory14 on 2013-01-17 at 00:48 said:

You are correct that actual initiation in the modern west might be helpful but is unnecessary and often detrimental if you get involved with the wrong institution or subgroup of an institution. In this Kali Yuga, all of the once carefully guarded sacred texts are easily available for everyone, so once a seeker has the general idea, initiation is perhaps even frivolous. That isn't to say guidance from a master won't be helpful. There's a ton to be misled by out there.

However, we can expect rot from top to bottom in these organizations, so self-education/direction is necessary. Former traditional bulwarks have completely lost their orientation even to the point of inversion of principle. Only in rare glimpses can the former spirit be witnessed. It only remains in disparate individuals. And you can often find that you have a better chance of communicating principle to any half-way decent person you meet than a member of an apparently traditional

institution, so restoration is a red herring. Better to simply aim at self-development while communicating to those who cross your path than hoping for a restoration.

Visionsofglory14 on 2013-01-17 at 01:07 said:

Doctrine of Awakening is an exemplary work. I don't know where I'd be without it. Evola and Nietzsche are two poles of the same spirit. Nietzsche alone forms a closed circuit as modern hands have neutered him, but Evola is like an outlet that makes spiritual combat possible again. Guenon is the opposite extreme from Nietzsche. Nietzsche=pure activity, Guenon=pure spirit. Evola is an attempt to mediate the two.

Cologero on 2013-01-17 at 07:39 said:

How exactly do you "mediate" between "pure spirit" and "pure activity"? You say Evola "attempted" to perform that mediation ... did he succeed or fail? If the former, how did he do it?

Guenon alone of the three understood the relationship between Purusha (spirit, masculine) and Prakriti (activity, feminine). Nietzsche seemed to intuit this when he wrote, "when you go to a woman, bring a whip," but he probably never understood its true significance. To wit, activity must be guided by spirit, or, a fortiori, activity must be dominated by spirit.

For Nietzsche, there is no spirit and no pole, rather only power and appearance. That may explain why, judging from my facebook feed, Nietzsche appeals primarily to women and homosexuals.

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-17 at 08:24 said:

1. I am still surprised that anyone still can admire a man like Nietzsche on the same level as a true man of wisdom such as Guenon or even Evola.

2. Cologero has done an amazing service in pointing us to Mebes, Tomberg and the others as they may be well the long sought after Christian path to transcendence that was occluded after the Middle Ages.

doctoroctagon on 2013-01-17 at 08:48 said:

"our goal at Gornahoor has been to prepare an intellectual elite."

I was put in mind of this: "Never doubt that a small group of thoughtful, committed, citizens can change the world. Indeed, it is the only thing that ever has."

Margaret Mead. Also my blog over at <http://www.golgonooza.blogspot.com> is going to have some more

Tradition and the arts oriented posts soon – it might become one of those 100 blogs that you mention!

Visionsofglory14 on 2013-01-17 at 10:32 said:

Evola, Guenon, and Nietzsche are united in that they recognize the decadence of modernity and that it must be destroyed so that life can regenerate. The greatest difference between Guenon and Evola is that Guenon sees the Kali Yuga as a blight, even though he recognizes as a necessary step in the return to the Golden Age. Nietzsche, on the other hand, teaches to enter the nihilistic phase with glee.

Nietzsche gave his bible *Thus Spoke Zarathustra* the subtitle “A Book for All and None.” A book that is meant for everyone will be vastly read, read at many different levels, yet clearly, as Nietzsche expected, to be greatly misunderstood. So Cologero’s attempt to defame Nietzsche as a tool for homosexuals and women is sidestepped by Nietzsche’s quite obvious knowledge and intention that he would be used for destructive purposes by devious people.

Both Nietzsche and Guenon, however, do see envision a return to greater times. Unknowingly or not, they share this. Guenon’s focus is on the preservation of tools that will bring back the golden age and be used by the future elite. Nietzsche, though, recognized that the negative polarity is necessary to divide mankind and make us hopelessly unequal, to the socialist’s chagrin. Thus, with his books, he offers both high and low a new found freedom in power. For the high, Evola and Guenon may offer something: Ride the Tiger. For the low, this cannot mean anything more than the tools for their own destruction.

Cologero on 2013-01-17 at 12:44 said:

Dear Delusions of Glory: First of all, I did not attempt to “defame” anything. I simply stated a fact. A fact is true or false; if you think it is false, then simply refute it. Others will make up their minds about who is “deviously” misusing Nietzsche.

Let me remind you, as well as everyone else, we are interested in discussing principles here, not in idle displays of pseudo-erudition of the type found in Spark Notes. So what exactly are the principles embraced by Guenon and Nietzsche? Obviously, Nietzsche claimed that the Will to Power is the fundamental principle of the world. That is, there is no transcendence, nothing hidden, just multiple manifestations of the will to power. There is nothing of Guenon in that, nothing of Tradition in that. Now to mediate – something I asked you to explain, although you are not quite up to the task – between Guenon and Nietzsche can mean nothing other than finding a higher principle that would incorporate and encompass both of them. So what is that mediating higher principle? Take your time answering ... You say Evola tried to do that. What he did was distinguish between the best and the worst of Nietzsche, as he called it, much like a boy how tries to pick the peas and carrots out from his beef stew. The question then becomes, what exactly is left of Nietzsche? Is Evola being devious and destructive by “correcting” Nietzsche? The same could be said of Coomaraswamy, which we documented here. Yes, we can rely on Nietzsche for his powerful poetry and heroic attitude, but is AKC also devious? Again, take your time, because we expect specific quotes and examples, not empty hand waving.

As for Nietzsche and glee ... does he truly demonstrate that in his life?

Mihai on 2013-01-18 at 06:47 said:

If Nietzsche's end goals are taken seriously (instead of merely adopting some good points and means he presented) than he can only be a catalyst for one thing: the counter-tradition.

Visionsofglory14 on 2013-01-18 at 08:46 said:

Explain Nietzsche's, Evola's, and Guenon's end goals, since you speak on such high authority.

Mihai on 2013-01-18 at 09:49 said:

Explain the difference between Nietzsche's "superman" and Marx's "end of history"- if there are any

(Hints: They are both relativistic, utopic, and they begin and end in the immanent, meaning that both are completely horizontal, lacking in any transcendence.)

Cologero on 2013-01-19 at 09:31 said:

I have no obligation to explain anything to you, visions of glory. Rather, you have the obligation to properly prepare yourself before entering comments. Specifically, you need to refer to the actual content of posted texts and especially you need to respond to direct questions. The only authority comes from truth. If there is no truth, there is no authority. That is the fundamental issue and always the starting point. If you deny the existence of truth, or the ability to know it, then there is no independent objective authority. There is only the personal will to power to impose opinions through force.

andrewlmt on 2013-01-20 at 02:21 said:

Reading the Church Fathers is good medicine. They are a way "in"; I believe worthy guides for the Christian.

5.4 A Beautiful Day to Die

Even without being killed a man can experience death, he can conquer, he can realize the culmination characteristic of a "super-life". From a higher point of view, Paradise, the Kingdom of Heaven, Valhalla, the Island of the Heroes, etc., are only symbolic figurations forged for the masses, figurations that in reality designate transcendent states of consciousness, beyond life and death. The

ancient Aryan tradition used the term *jivan-mukti* to indicate such a realization while still in the mortal body.

JULIUS EVOLA, *The Aryan Conception of Combat*

A couple of weeks ago I had a dream in one scene of which I placed a book under my seat. When I reached down to pick it up, I noticed it had disappeared. Still in that dream state, I thought, “This must be a dream, since in real life books don’t disappear just like that.” That is when I awoke. Similarly, the waking state of consciousness is itself revealed to be a dream from the higher state of Samadhi. Does anyone pay attention to the clues like the missing book to realize that?

If you believe your life to be a random accident, of no significance, there is nothing to notice. However, most men look for their purpose horizontally, as some goal to achieve within that dream. Have you noticed how your dreams are mostly incoherent, that there seems to be relationships from scene to scene, but turn out to be tenuous, that one’s intention fails and morphs into another? Is that the description of a dream or life as you know it? If the latter, how do you know when it is time to wake up? When do you choose to wake up?

So, if you don’t believe your life is random, and you see that your purpose is not found within life itself, and that your real life is your super-life, then how much effort are you putting into living your real life? Shouldn’t you be obsessed with it?

Don’t think you hide from it or evade this task, for you will reach that state at the moment of death. However, at that point, it will not happen consciously and freely, but rather will be determined and automatic. This man dies in the first or second state of consciousness. That is, in the first, he lives his life in a passive sense, thoughts flow through him. In the second, his mind is full of theories, opinions, philosophies that maintain him in the illusions of ordinary life. The *jivan-mukti* dies to eternal life,

beyond life and death, in a transcendent state. The other man just dies in the state he found himself in.

The Last Thought That is why a man's final thoughts have been considered so important. Tibetan Buddhism has an elaborate ritual to guide a man toward his approaching death. The Greek and Roman Churches offer the sacrament of extreme unction to improve the quality of a man's final thought.

Observe your breath. Notice that every exhalation may be your last; you cannot be certain that you will inhale another. What are you thinking at that moment? Is it a thought you want to be remembered by? Or, better said, is it a thought you want to die remembering?

Some may think they are superior because they don't believe the sensual understanding of the post-mortem state in folk religion. However, Evola changes nothing in his esoteric interpretation. Even the popes have called Heaven a state of being, not a place, so the goal of a happy death remains.

The Samurai's Servant In Japanese legends, the last thoughts of a dying man were believed to have irresistible powers. Lafcadio Hearn tells the story of a samurai who condemned one of his slaves to death by beheading. The slave, convinced of the injustice of the sentence, bitterly told his master, at his execution, that he would take revenge. The samurai's family were terrified, because they understood the power of a dying man's final thoughts.

The clever samurai told the slave he didn't believe his threats unless the slave could prove it to him. The slave offered to prove it. So the samurai told him to bite the step as his head was rolling down; he would take that as proof of the slave's threat. The slave exulted, "I will do so!" The samurai then chops off the slave's head, which then latches onto the step with its teeth as it is rolling down.

The samurai's family and retinue were horrified to witness that proof of the slave's threat of vengeance. The samurai himself was unperturbed and gloated: "The slave's final thought was to bite the step, which he did, so his earlier threat is ineffective!"

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RnCmeNa5vXs>

Posted on 2013-01-30 by Cologero

* * *

A on 2013-01-31 at 00:38 said:

Have you ever considered how would that samurai's final thought be after he has committed injustice and cunningness himself in his life.

Cologero on 2013-01-31 at 00:43 said:

The samurai was a warrior, violent by nature, beyond good and evil. Does that count for anything?

Mihai on 2013-01-31 at 09:06 said:

You know, this is a good exercise for when dealing with Thanthos' little brother- Hypnos. Before falling asleep – to meditate on the possibility of never waking up again and focus all your attention on the name of God, with all the power of your being.

Janus on 2013-02-01 at 13:03 said:

Well, the samurai as kshatriya would surely be required to conform that nature to the higher Self according to the rites of the warrior? He doesn't seem to be the quite so honourable samurai, although if we look at the Eddas then we have many similar stories of trickery. The tale nowhere says that the samurai is honourable or perfect, I suppose.

Cologero on 2013-02-01 at 13:15 said:

I am glad this topic has come up. On Evolian grounds, how can you judge the Samurai? He is following the way of action that Evola claims is as valid a path to the "higher self" as the way of contemplation. In other words, action is its own judge. The Samurai is to act honorably to his peers and to be loyal to his superiors. However, he has no obligation to be honorable to the slave. Perhaps he should have followed "noblesse oblige" and acted magnanimously. So perhaps you could say the Samurai did not act nobly.

Janus on 2013-02-02 at 16:19 said:

How would you say the Samurai has no duty to be honourable to the slave? Surely he must be honourable to everyone, whatever that may mean according to their relationship. In the case of the slave, that would mean dispensing true justice. If he did so and the slave was wrong, then magnanimity does come into it, I suppose. I'm not too sure how far the concept of noblesse oblige influenced the Samurai. As for Evola, this might be an example against his concept of contemplation and action being on equal planes. If the samurai's actions are not guided by the precepts of Bushido, founded on higher rites, principles and realities, then he is acting mindlessly (or perhaps better said, without Intellect), something which does not exactly communicate honour or discipline.

Cologero on 2013-02-02 at 18:02 said:

Exactly, Janus, that is the point I didn't make so well. Does Evola's Nietzscheanism, action beyond good and evil, not subject to a higher law, and even embracing "cruelty", justify the Samurai? Evola is correct that there is a karma yoga of action, alongside jnana yoga, but is his understanding of it distorted? Next week I'll post something on Coomaraswamy's critique of Evola and perhaps we can revisit this topic with some additional conceptual tools.

5.5 Return to Normalcy

Over the weekend, someone uploaded child pornography to the Gornahoor forum. Bluehost disabled the entire site, without warning or explanation, until the situation could be evaluated by their legal department. They deleted the images and reactivated Gornahoor. When informed, I disabled attachments to forum posts. I also restricted posting, even in the public forum, to registered users. Even before I could complete that action, the offender managed to get in one last post, and in a taunting way wrote that he was glad the site was back up. He did leave a couple of links which I deleted.

On the plus side, it shows that there is one human activity that is almost universally considered reprehensible at a time when so much else is up for grabs. As for the forum, I'm inclined to abandon it. Its manage-

ment is more trouble for very little benefit or use. From the logs, I can see dozens of attempts every day from China and Russia to hack into it; I have no conceivable notion of how that would benefit anyone.

In any event, I see that something needs to be done about web hosting. Gornahoor is getting too large for a mass market hosting service like Bluehost. On the other hand, there is not enough traffic for a virtual server. I have two months to find an alternative that is more reliable and faster.

In what follows, I want to make some quick points and mention future translations and reviews.

Salvation It did give me an opportunity to read the recent posts on Christianity, to which I'll provide some comments, "dialectically" of course. First of all, and most important, I have no intention of challenging anyone's faith. If anything you read here disturbs you or brings you doubt, I suggest you stop reading forthwith. This is decidedly an optional exercise and is not intended for everyone.

Nevertheless, if you need to persist and still feel agitated, I can make some calming points. Esoteric doctrine is not superadded to the exoteric, nor is it meant to be in conflict or opposition to it. It is our contention that theological (i.e., exoteric) dogmas can be restated in esoteric, or metaphysical, terms. The results speak for themselves: either you see it and agree with it or you don't.

I strongly recommend that everyone focus on his own salvation and not be so concerned about everyone else. Don't take your own for granted, actually don't even assume you even know what that means. We are not nominalists, so for us salvation requires a real change, an "intellectual" conversion, and not a nominal, or "imputed" one. There is no mechanical process involved and each man must follow the narrow way the best he can. If you are really so concerned about whether some fellow in Nepal is "saved" or not, then become a missionary.

Certainty What, then, is esoteric? When Augustine claims that truth is found in man's interiority, is he being esoteric? When St Gregory of Nyssa adopts Plato's and Aristotle's understanding of the soul, is he being esoteric? Where today will you even hear such teachings, outside of a survey course at university? The teaching is exoteric when taken in an external sense, as just one theory of the soul among many. The same teaching is esoteric when a man in his interiority actually "sees" the gradations and faculties of his own soul. In other words, esoterism is hidden in broad daylight.

That is why esoterism is not solely about "thinking more carefully" as Prof Cutsinger seems to believe. Actually, it is not about thinking at all, but rather about developing the powers of intellectual intuition. I don't know how this can be missed, since it is a fundamental teaching of every writer on Tradition. Nevertheless, it usually is.

The One Thing Needful Dialectic is weakness, we today need men of decision, men of conviction who are infallible in their understanding of metaphysics, intransigent and unsentimental in the face of truth, detached from personal concerns, and for whom tradition is not a career, nor raw material for journal articles, nor the road to money, sex, and power.

This is not for the faint or heart in our time, since deviation exists everywhere. What outwardly appear to be natural alliances are in reality false friends. The inner life is not matching the outer life. In a recent article on Takimag¹⁵, cases of corporeal and spiritual mismatching are becoming common today. However, this was foreseen by Julius Evola 70 years ago, in this passage, the entirety of which will be sent to the subscribers to the S I mailing list:

The castes, in which the "race of the soul" and the "inner vocation"

¹⁵http://takimag.com/article/my_otherkin_headmate_is_a_two_spirit_ed_starseed_kathy_shaidle#axzz2MjMZsZ0X

do not correspond to the race of the body, so as those of every romantic laceration, in the last analysis, from the metaphysical point of view, are to be explained in such a way. Even modern psychology knows, at this point, so called “second personalities”. And the more the minor forces diverge from the central direction, the more we will have, as the effect, men in whom the physical is not in accord with the soul, in which the spirit contrasts with the body and the soul, in which the vocation does not correspond to race or caste, the “personality” is in dissension with tradition, and so on.

Fortunately, Gornahoor has matured to reach a higher quality of reader, at least in my estimation of quality. This is obvious in the comments and posts, but especially in the private communications I have received. I hope that Goranhooor will continue to prove itself worthy of such readers.

Translations I will continue with Guido De Giorgio’s description of the constitution of a traditional society. After the warriors, there will be the workers, and then the leader “Capo” . By way of background, De Giorgio uses the terms Silence, Rhythms “ritmi” , and Forms in a specific sense. They correspond to spirit, soul, and body, or to the concerns of the priests, warriors, and workers. Without going into a long digression, they can be thought of, without too much distortion, as the Tao, Duality, and the 10,000 things. The Silence is the ineffable at the center of the cross (in Guenon’s sense), Rhythms are the opposing points (life and death, ascension and resurrection), and Forms are the manifested things.

I will also provide an article from the UR group called “Plotinus, the greatest of pagan wisdom”. Please let me know if this is already available. Also some more Maurras, including his “Latinity” to complement De Giorgio’s Romanity. S I subscribers will continue to receive the translation of Sintesi. Note that this is a direct translation from the Italian, and

not a retranslation of the German translation.

Book Reviews I will also try some more book reviews, although the previous one simply faded away. They will be selected to elucidate certain points. These are the current candidates:

- *St Gregory of Nyssa on the Human Soul*, by Constantine Cavarnos
- *Dante & Aquinas*, by Philip Henry Wicksteed
- *Humanity, its Destiny and the Means to Attain It*, by Heinrich Denifle
- Works of Mouni Sadhu

Posted on 2013-03-06 by Cologero

* * *

Sandra Eggers on 2013-03-06 at 00:39 said:
Mouni Sadhu would be interesting.

Super Tutor on 2013-03-06 at 00:41 said:
I wonder what will happen to the pervert?

Avery Morrow on 2013-03-06 at 03:26 said:
Dialectic is weakness. Agreed.

I've noticed that a great majority of Evola readers, excluding the Nouvelle Droite ethno-nationalists (who are not my concern), are people who are of mixed ethnic heritage, or second or third-generation immigrants from non-Christian countries, or otherwise racially/sexually confused; in other words, people who can intuit some metaphysics, but cannot simply join the traditionalist Christian communities around them because they have within them some "minor forces diverging from the central direction" as Evola says.

The concerns of these people are worthy of an entire book, which I intend to write. Traditionalism is not something suitable for blogs, and people who read these blogs are to some

extent lost in a thicket, although I credit this one with doing a good job of pointing towards the way out.

Omar Chowdhury on 2013-03-06 at 10:20 said:

Intellectual intuition is missed because those who who overlook it are drenched in thought, all they know of is thought, conceiving of anything higher would be an admission of their own ignorant myopia.

Scardanelli on 2013-03-06 at 12:29 said:

As far as translations are concerned, would anything by Cesare Della Riviera be possible? There isn't much available in English, and I'm curious as to what he might offer. I've only read of him through Evola, as well as Godwin's novel *The Forbidden Book*.

Logres on 2013-03-06 at 14:32 said:

The implication of this teaching on esoteric/exoteric is that those who attack exoteric religions, by implication, are mounting an assault on secret doctrine and Tradition, as well.

Jason-Adam on 2013-03-06 at 15:11 said:

Avery,

I have never thought about your point before that way but upon meditation I think you are correct – aside from the Nouvelle Droite most Evolians today do seem to be very confused and lost individuals – I notice a trend of repressed homosexuals, not to mention open homosexuals, also alot of people who confuse being a warrior with being a bully.

A problem that I think we all need to confront is this : most traditional Catholics of the present day are of the priest-type mind whereas warriors seem to be more drawn to neopaganism and the ND. We need to have more masculine, combative Catholics of the old crusader type and revive the warrior spirituality. I think it'd be an interesting personal challenge for a few men to try live according to the rules of the Templars.

David on 2013-03-06 at 18:20 said:

@Logres : Rules of the Templars applied to a divine mission that was granted in the microcosm, macrocosm and inner world. It would be very difficult to find something like this in the modern that can unite those three. I agree with the idea, but to implement it is something else. It was a unique conjunction in christian history.

David on 2013-03-06 at 18:21 said:

I'm sorry I meant @Jason-Adam,

Cologero on 2013-03-06 at 19:21 said:

RE: confusing being a warrior with being a bully

The shudra are equally violent, but there is difference, a holy difference, between the shudra bully and the warrior. That will come out in the next segment which, I think, will be a little shocking, especially for those with contemporary sentimental ideas about spirituality. He may even topping Evola in this regard. Also, be sure to catch the allusion to Dante when he discusses dueling.

Alexander Maximilian on 2013-03-13 at 10:36 said:

I highly concur. This is the one blog that maintains high integrity when it comes to the dispensation of Traditionalist content. Real Spiritual/ Metaphysical concerns beyond the mere political theories promulgated on other "traditionalist" sites that miss the entire point if initiation and dutiful service. I highly applaud the work done.

5.6 The Turd in the Punch Bowl

It will be useful to provide more concrete examples illustrating the difference between the consciousness formed by persuasion and that formed by rhetoric, as described by **Carlo Michelstaedter**.

The End of Rhetoric There is an intellectual lust just as surely as there is sexual lust. Men get excited about hearing a new idea, becoming part of a new movement, and engage in discussions, debates, and so on. Then the movement splinters into several factions. There is more rhetoric about how to name the factions. Then the debates devolve into contests between the factions and the aim of the original movement is pushed aside. Then it becomes personal: who is in and who is out. This is the path of infinite conversation and the way to resolve it.

Rhetoric $\Rightarrow$ endless conversation $\Rightarrow$ authority

Donoso Cortes¹⁶ pointed out that rhetoric leads to infinite, and ultimately pointless, conversation. To end it, there has to be an ultimate au-

¹⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5016>

thority. This is even more so for movements that oppose the amorphous, undifferentiated mass, since its opposite is organization and hierarchy. A movement cannot be in thought only, but must be alive and organized in the way that complements its thought.

Now ideally the man of authority is the one who knows. Of course, for spiritual movements, what he knows is the cosmic law. This law is supreme but adherents of movements make rhetoric itself supreme. Hence, they will accept members, even if they deny or oppose the cosmic law, provided the say and believe the right things.

Satan may throw great parties, but he always leaves his mark as a turd in the punch bowl. Those addicted to rhetoric will tell you to stop spoiling the fun. After all, the rest of it is all good and you can scoop around the turd if you are careful. I'm afraid no one is that careful.

Make your Paths Straight

Make your paths straight.

MATTHEW 3:3

The difference in understanding this, and similar, passages has changed considerably over the centuries. St Anthony of the Desert¹⁷ explains:

As far as the soul is concerned, being straight consists in its intellectual part's being according to nature, as it was created. ... Virtue exists when the soul maintains its intellectual part according to nature. It holds fast according to nature when it remains as it was made—and it was made beautiful and perfectly straight.

Hardly anyone today is concerned with the intellectual soul; almost no one can even recognize it in his own consciousness. Considering that

¹⁷<http://www.newadvent.org/cathen/01553d.htm>

it is the soul that is to be saved, this is quite strange, not to say, risky. The intellectual soul is straight when it is aligned with the cosmic law. Other words for straight are righteous or just. This indicates a persuaded man, in self-possession, indicating an inner, or esoteric, understanding.

Modern commentaries will interpret the passage as God making your path straight, or something similar. This is exoteric as it sees things coming from the outside, thus giving up one's own freedom and power.

Amor Fati

I have, in fact, brought this thing upon myself.

RUDOLF STEINER

There must be something in a human being that causes him to be born in a definite environment.

RUDOLF STEINER

According to Steiner, when something happens to a person that arouses a feeling of distress, he can take it in two different ways. The first way is to give into the negative feeling, and the second is to accept full responsibility. Now Steiner attributes the event to a past life, but that itself is a form of non-persuasion, pushing responsibility onto something we are not conscious of.

Nevertheless, the principle is sound. We should first look on our choices, or the string of choices, that led to the distress. We can often find the answer there. When we can't, that indicates a privation, a block, that we are not yet conscious of. Accept as much responsibility for your life as you can bear.

Consciousness of the Real I Someone mentioned today that his Buddhist teachers instructed him to be wary of the “sense of I”. Apparently, he sees a conflict with the consciousness of the real I. This points out the danger of mixing traditions since vocabulary and frames of reference will be different.

The first principle is that everything must be verified. This is the opposite of rhetoric, since debates about various theories are not permitted. One of the things that we will verify that there is indeed a “sense of I”, that is, I as an object. *A fortiori*, there are many such I’s.

Consciousness of the Real I is different as we can verify. It is not an object of sense, it is not even part of natural life. It is not subjective as are the I’s of sense, but rather just and objective. Or “straight” if we prefer St Anthony the Great.

Pagan Unconscious

Our natural evolution in Western Europe was broken by the introduction of a psychology and of spirituality which had developed from a civilization higher than our own. We were interrupted at the very beginning when our beliefs were still barbarously polytheistic, and these beliefs were forced underground and have remained there for the last two thousand years. That explains the divisiveness found in the Western mind. Still in a primitive state, we were forced to adopt the comparatively sophisticated doctrines of Christian grace and love.

CARL JUNG

No longer able to contain such sophisticated doctrines, many Westerners today are returning to barbarously polytheistic beliefs. They are bitter against what they see as an alien imposition, both through physical force and effective propaganda. However, the return to the unconscious

is the opposite of persuasion. It is made worse since the main adherents of the Christian religion no longer have any understanding of it.

They way forward is twofold. First, to understand the doctrines esoterically, which is really to give them life, beyond mere rhetoric. The second is to love our pagan past, using **Valentin Tomberg**, **Dante**, or **Boethius** as our models. This is an act of self-possession.

Gods within There is a pastime, especially popular among women, to take some test on the Internet that will reveal our true inner nature. Obviously, this involves giving up our power to some anonymous source. Our true inner nature can be revealed only through serious efforts at self-observation.

Jungian psychology to a large extent has devolved to a similar point. In this case, people want to know what “inner god” they are, and they take great pride in the answer. It is great party conversation in some circles. Unfortunately, that can only mean that one is possessed by unconscious forces represented by the god. This is the opposite of the self-possession that we want, or are.

As above, so below. Below, we integrate all these forces under the dominion of the True Self. Hence, above there is only one God.

Talking to Angels Another popular idea in some spiritual circles is the idea of communicating with angels. Once again, they are seen as “outside”, and hence that involves surrendering our self-possession. This is safe, because there is the pleasure of the thought of angels, but no effort is involved on our part.

The persuaded man will understand the angels to be higher states of being, as Rene Guenon pointed out. So the angels must impart their own nature in order to be heard or understood.

Effects of Crystals

The divine sleeps in the rock, breathes in the plant, dreams in the animal, and wakes in man.

NORDIC ADAGE

Since a crystal is a rock, it is part of the unconscious and hence represents a privation to us. Although Rene Guenon has taught us how to understand the conscious symbolism of highly developed traditions, Carl Jung has shown how the subconscious has its own symbols. Understanding such symbols can have a therapeutic effect. Hence, it is not surprising that crystals, through the symbolism associated with them, can also have healing effects.

As above, so below: any effects the crystals have come from the manifestation of more subtle powers. We can learn to possess them, too, and not project them onto the crystals.

Posted on 2014-06-11 by Cologero

* * *

Tom Blanchard on 2014-06-15 at 20:49 said:

As usual, Cologero, you seem to have your finger right on the pulse of certain reactionary currents: <http://www.radixjournal.com/blog/2014/6/15/wolves-among-the-ruins>

Vis a vis the "return to the unconscious" of paganism, I can't agree more. The bitterness felt by some is easy to sympathize with, because their problem is one that we also face. Nevertheless, the solution seems clear:

The problem was insoluble for pagan Icelanders because they had no conception of goods transcending ordinary natural purposes that could allow man's ultimate end – the proper object of moral commitment – to be distinguished from what particular men happen to want. Manly honor rooted in pure assertiveness was in the end self-contradictory, because in idealizing the assertive self it made what was asserted something ideal and therefore not merely the self. A man who asserted the self seemed to lack loftiness, while a more disinterested man seemed to lack energy; both qualities were necessary for true honor, but it seemed impossible to have them together. The problem was eventually resolved by adding Christian love to the native

heroic conception to form a knightly ideal personified by Kari, Njal's son-in-law and avenger, who combined strength and courage with humility, forbearance, and in the end forgiveness.

(Taken from an article by Jim Kalb, written here: <http://antitechnocrat.net:8000/node/22>)

5.7 The Lupercalia of Mad Men

A time is coming when men will go mad, and when they see someone who is not mad, they will attack him, saying, "You are mad, you are not like us."

ST ANTHONY THE GREAT

Guenon the Master **Rene Guenon** is the master who made religion and spirituality comprehensible to modern men. This was accomplished by pointing out the esoteric element, elucidating the true meaning of symbols, and by describing the metaphysical principles underlying Tradition. In the West, this metaphysic is most clearly expressed in the Platonic tradition, although, as we pointed out¹⁸, Plato was but one link in a much larger chain of Hermetic philosophy.

Now this manner of thinking used to be taught to educated men, but in our time, may seem quite incomprehensible. All the more so, it is worth the effort and the result is an intellectual conversion that will see the material as the effect of the spiritual, rather than the opposite.

Since **Julius Evola** is often the "gateway drug" to tradition, and since he made a conscious effort, in his philosophy of magical idealism, to become part of that chain of Hermetic philosophy, we take the trouble to make known the general outline of magical idealism. The ideal is to build on Evola, and even Guenon, and not fall into a form of sterile scholasticism.

¹⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1256>

What is Rationality *Soi-disant* bright men today claim to be adherents of a scientific rationality, without really defining it. Rationality, if it means anything, is equivalent to knowing sufficient reason of things, i.e., why it is one thing rather than another. In that case science does not know the sufficient reason for the existence of the universe itself, life, or conscious thought. It never will, so we need to look elsewhere. As esoterists, we look within, since the truth resides in man's interiority (**St Augustine**).

As Evola points out, behind rationality, there is the alogon, which transcends all rational thought. Although he would not likely approve this formulation, it is still worth the effort. That is, the Father-God transcends the world. He then generates the Son, or Logos, through whom the world is created. This doctrine is critical. *Pace* Arianism, if the Son is a creature, then the Father could have created Chaos in opposition to Logos. However, that is not possible since the Logos is one with the Father.

This is very important in practical terms. In Essence, the Logos is perfect. However, we don't experience that in Existence. But the reason for that cannot be a contrary transcendent principle that opposes us. Rather, as Evola points out, it indicates a privation, i.e., something we should have, but fail to bring about. The first alternative would mean that we are the playthings of other forces; the second indicates that we are lacking in this or that power, something that can be rectified.

Evolution from Apes I recently saw one of those famous Internet quizzes that pretend to show how well you have imbibed the consensus reality of the men who have gone mad. In in, you are expected to agree with the statement, "Man evolved from the Ape."

Of course, neo-Darwinism claims no such thing. The most they can claim is that at one point there was a population of some defunct ape species, following by a population of hominids. But they cannot show

any sufficient reason for that population change. That is, there is no chain of events leading from one species to another. By its own principles, in place of any rational explanation, it postulates a series of random mutations that resulted in the hominid.

In other words, there is no “inner man” just waiting to arise from the ape. Rather there is a rupture, even by its own principles. That is why Evola can say that the ape represents a privation of the man struggling to manifest in Existence. This position is different from alternatives such as creationism or intelligent design; it need not even dispute the fossil record.

Three I's There are two dimensions of nature. The physical or hylic, represented qualitatively by the four elements and the psychic represented by the fifth element of life, irreducible to matter. The pneumatic, supernatural or spiritual element, is the third dimension that transcends the two natural dimensions. This is verified esoterically in the idea of the three I's. The physical body has an I, i.e., its own center of intelligence. The psychic body has the I of the personality. These are given naturally to every man, although few become aware of the two different I's, falsely believing instead there is an inner unity.

Awareness of the Real I, on the other hand, depends on making certain efforts. A man who believe he is one and free, will not make those efforts. Nevertheless, Traditional metaphysics becomes more comprehensible to those who make such efforts. It also constitutes the truth of such doctrines, beyond any rational argument, logical proof, or scientific experiment.

The Purge and Patricide I had the occasion to view the movie, *The Purge*¹⁹, recently. The premise is that the USA has been reconstituted on different grounds with new founding fathers. They implemented a

¹⁹<https://www.imdb.com/title/tt2184339/>

festival called the “purge”, one night a year, during which any crime is permitted. This is sort of a latter day Lupercalia²⁰. The state clearly claims the power to declare that what was considered evil, can now be called “good”.

The protagonist, a caring father, became prosperous from selling high end security systems, required for protection during the purges. The mother is the perfect wife, even cooking dinner while wearing a dress and high heels. On the night of the purge, the father arms the alarm system. In direct disobedience to the Father, the adolescent son lets a stranger, clearly not a resident of the neighborhood, into the house for sanctuary. Then marauders, who were stalking him as part of the purge, demand that the Father return the stranger to them, or risk having his home invaded and his family killed.

The Father then captures the stranger, ties him up, and prepares to hand him over to the marauders. The morality of the Father is to enforce the boundaries of his property and to protect the lives of his family members. Then the mother, along with the children, has a crisis of conscience, feels compassion for the man, and convinces the father not to release him outside. So the Father betrays his own principles and adopts the moral principles of women and children. Hence a hellish night ensues, born of their own choices.

Nevertheless, the destruction of his home and accepting the risk to his family, are insufficient to redeem him. He is killed as an act of symbolic patricide. This seems to empower the mother who suddenly becomes a strong character. When her neighbors arrive, not to help her, but rather to kill her out of covetousness, the stranger suddenly appears and rescues her and her family. Thus the mother, in alliance with the stranger, without her husband and contra her neighbors, is ready to create a new world.

Posted on 2014-07-10 by Cologero

²⁰<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lupercalia>

* * *

Tom Blanchard on 2014-07-11 at 11:53 said:

I have not seen "The Purge", although this is a powerful summary of its moral message. It is amazing how deeply the "morality of the mother and children" has penetrated modern western consciousness, to the point where it is always assumed that it is the logical conclusion of Christian teaching (even by the representatives of the Roman Church). One has difficulties even attempting to make a case for the Father's morality in our setting; even the most high-minded opponent would counter that the Father's "noble sacrifice" to die for this stranger's sake represents the pinnacle of Christian virtue and that to turn away the stranger would be an expression of imperfection and a short-sighted selfishness.

Max on 2014-07-12 at 10:25 said:

When talking to people or looking around the internet, a general but vague awareness of something major changing is evident. People expect our "civilization" to burn, -we all know we deserve it. In fact it is what keeps some motivated to continue to live the lie. People want to experience the great collapse, to be in the middle of it. Secretly men wish for a Lupericalia, a scorched earth to renew the land. They say they will repopulate the earth and make a new order. Why would we believe them if they cannot produce something of that order in their own life right now? Guns and canned food will not make a new order.

Man seems destined to consume things increasingly more similar to his own nature. We made an alliance with animals to take care of and protect them and they gave us milk and wool. They trusted us but we betrayed them and put them in concentration camps. We made a prison for ourselves.

A problem arises if the scorchers only go half the way. Will the reality of the dissolution have them grasping for a false saviour and cling to every illusion just to stop their self induced suffering? Christ endured and he was resurrected, the true way of life.

The world is sacrificed to be resurrected. We cannot fight the collapse and we cannot further the collapse, only endure it and remember our beginnings with the knowledge that when beginning and end meet the world is united to eternity. It is only at the exact moment when the serpent bites its own tail that we can strike it with a single blow. Until that we will be here suffering. The fruit of knowledge of good and evil is transformed into the golden apple containing the liquid of immortality, blood of Christ. The cross leads us back to the tree of life, becoming visible again.

5.8 Spirit in the World

Within a traditional civilization, categorized as “civilizations of space” by **Julius Evola**, time seems to stand still. A citizen then would have had a much different experience of time than we do today. There was no notion of “progress”, as Evola explains:

The civilizations of space, according to the formulation current today, would therefore be the “stable”, “static” or ultraconservative civilizations. In reality, they are the civilizations whose material vestiges even seem destined to live longer than all the monuments or all the ideal creations of the modern world that appear powerless to endure more than a half century and within which the words “progressive” or “dynamism” mean only a compliance to contingency, to the movement of an incessant change, of a rapid ascent and a likewise rapid, vertiginous decline.

Thus, today a man must make a choice, a choice that was inconceivable to the original traditional man. That is because we today are aware of both worlds. Nevertheless, that decision opens up more possibilities and, since time is “quicker” today, more rapid results can be gained. First it is necessary to become detached from the verbal representation of the modern world in order to see it as just one worldview among many others. Then, through meditation and exercises, one can begin to re-experience the world in a traditional way.

Pansychism and Animism Recently I heard a biologist on the radio claim that biology did not have a good definition for “life”. By that, he meant that the transition from “inanimate matter” to life was not clear cut. Curiously, **Rene Guenon** makes the identical point, although with a totally different meaning. In the chapter on Shamanism in the *Reign of Quantity*, he writes:

there can in fact be no ‘inanimate’ objects in existence, and also that ‘life’ is one of the conditions to which all corporeal existence without exception is subject; and that is why nobody has ever arrived at a satisfactory definition of the difference between the ‘living’ and the ‘non-living’, for that question, like so many others in modern philosophy and science, is only insoluble because there is no good reason for posing it, since the ‘nonliving’ has no place in the domain to which the question is related, and the only differences involved are really no more than mere differences of degree.

By that, Guenon opposes the “animism” of the shamans to the “mechanism” of profane biologists. Thus, there is a “psychic” or “animic” aspect to corporeal manifestation. Another way to phrase it is to say that the world has an “inside” as well as an “outside”. Or again, the psychic realm is related to “quality” as the physical realm is related to quantity.

For those philosophically inclined, **Timothy Sprigge** defends “panpsychism” in *The Vindication of Absolute Idealism*, although from a different perspective.

Spirit in the World In **Karl Rahner**’s phrase, man is a “spirit in the world”. Man’s mode of being in the world, then, is non-dual: not a soul trapped in matter, or a mind interacting with inanimate matter. Rather, man participates in the world directly. Matter is what individuates one person from another quantitatively, but the experience of quality (“qualia”) is direct, since the material world is itself ensouled.

Hence, our experience of gravity is not just quantitative as in physics, but we also experience the pull of gravity directly. A thermometer will show the temperature quantitatively, but we have a direct inner experience of hot and cold.

An Indian colleague recently asked me if I could experience what a plant experiences or a cat. Not exactly, I answered, since I cannot expe-

rience the subjectivity of a *particular* plant or cat. Nevertheless, I can experience what it is like to be a plant or an animal. Man incorporates and integrates the three souls of the material world. Hence, we can experience growth, respiration, the attraction to light, and so on, like a plant. Continuing, we also experience hunger, desire, fear, satiation, in short, anything an animal might experience.

This is all part of corporeal life: not merely subjective, but an authentic way of being in the world.

God's Knowledge of the World Since God is not corporeal, he does not have the experience of the world that man does. Qualia like color, warmth, hunger, and so on are all corporeal as mentioned above, that is, in the broad sense of the corporeal comprising both the physical and psychical elements. A fortiori, as the Eye of Providence, he is not looking out over the world in an exterior sense. Rather, he is at the absolute center of the world.

In a sense, this is what **Carl Jung** was getting at in the *Answer to Job* that God becomes conscious through man.

Specifically, through man, he is experiencing the qualia of creation. This may give some insight into the meaning and purpose of the incarnation.

So God knows the essences of things and through this knowing, they are brought into existence. This is the identity of knowing and being. Another way to put it is that he knows things because he wills them, analogous to the way that you know what you're having for lunch at the deli: you will your choice, and don't need a scientific theory to predict what you'll get for lunch.

God's knowledge is "all at once" and does not need time. By knowing the possibilities of manifestation in his mind, he thereby brings them into manifestation. The world is a great unfolding, or "evolution" in the literal sense, of these possibilities.

Posted on 2015-07-29 by Cologero

5.9 Heard Around Town

Arseny's soul wanted to touch Ursina's soul ... Get used to separation, said Death, it is painful, even if it is only temporary. Will we recognize each other in eternity? asked Arseny's soul. That depends in large part on you, said Death: souls often harden during the course of life and then they barely recognize anyone after death."

EUGENE VODOLAZKIN, *from Laurus*

Potter's Field

The potter's field was a mournful place... There lay the plague dead, pilgrims, the strangled, unbaptized babies, and suicides; those drowned by waters, taken by battle, murdered, and stricken by fire. Suddenly surprised, those who had fallen from lightning, dead from frost and every sort of wound. The lives of those unfortunates were varied and it was not life that united them: their resemblance to one another consisted of death. It was death without Confession.

EUGENE VODOLAZKIN, *from Laurus*

That was the situation in Russia, some six centuries ago. Potter's field was an open pit into which the corpses were dropped. Once a year, a priest gave a blessing, the pit was filled in, and another one dug.

If sudden death without benefit of the last sacraments is a curse, then presumably a slow death, preceded by a gradual breakdown of organs, must be a blessing.

A few years ago I was sitting across the desk of a specialist. He looked at my medical history and test results, then looked up at me. He read another page and looked up again. Finally, after he had read the full report, he said to me, “Well, at least you *look* good!”

Mohammed and Charlemagne I made **Julius Evola**’s review of *Mohammed and Charlemagne*²¹ available for its possible relevance today. **Henri Pirenne**’s thesis has been influential, even today I believe. As Evola points out, it has the defect of explaining everything in terms of material causes: economic activity, trade routes, etc. There are several things to notice in the review.

Pace materialists: Attention must be paid to the difference between necessary and sufficient causes²². Even if certain material circumstances apply pressure to social structures, that alone cannot explain everything. Specifically, material forces are the passive elements, leaving out the active elements. Agency must be accounted for and cannot be explained in material terms.

Pace neo-pagans: The Holy Roman Empire was Germanic, true Indo-European civilization. Evola used the word “Aryan”, but that word has changed its meaning since 1939. Rather, we can understand Indo-European in the way used by **Georges Dumézil**²³. Today, we often hear of saving “white” or “European” civilization, which is an imprecise way of expressing it. This is what is meant by that:

The Middle Ages took on its own appearance and which, in its great political-social structures, reproduced essentially the distinctive traits of all the Indo-European civilizations of Antiquity

So to be precise: there must first be a tradition to save. “Europe” as a geographical designation or “white” as a biological category, are simply

²¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=15799>

²²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Necessity_and_sufficiency

²³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5198>

forms of materialism and would suffer from the same explanatory defects mentioned by Evola about Pirenne.

That Tradition, as Evola asserts, was the Catholic religion (whatever you may think of its current manifestation). That religion was the bearer of an older tradition. Evola explains:

We find these traditions i.e., the Germanic in a state of involution and degeneration in the course of the period that we have called the interregnum, but not at the point of preventing, under certain conditions, a resumption, an awakening, a galvanization. That is exactly what happened, thanks to the tradition already mentioned and to a certain heroic morality, when an historic conjuncture led to the formation of the Holy Roman Empire. Here, the Roman symbol was the common reference of a *supernatural order proposed by Christianity, which acted, so to say, as a catalyst on the manifestation and the survival of latent spiritual and racial forces.*

There was no mistake, no deception as neo-pagans claimed. To the contrary, they don't even seem to know what that latent tradition was, in terms of its understanding of the supernatural order, social order, and even a heroic morality.

Pace capitalists: Capitalists and leftists regard Medieval society as regressive and decadent. In the communist historical scheme, capitalism replaced feudalism and communism will replace capitalism. Hence, capitalism is just one stage of the revolutionary mindset.

Evola asserts, on the contrary, that the disdain for mercantilism represents a higher value. Hence, the agrarian and feudal system, centered on the transcendent, represents a higher value.

Pace Evola (perhaps): It is unclear how Evola regarded the influence of the transcendent, or perhaps he regarded it all as the expression of transcendent values. In other words, a genuine Tradition not only has

a theory of the supernatural order, it also provides access to that order. The third dimension of history, then, implies divine interference.

Therefore, a Traditional society should be the beneficiary of divine blessings. Hence, the emergence of Europe, from the time of Charlemagne as long as it was Christian prospered. The French revolution, which inaugurated a new worldview was the overthrowing of Christianity. That process was completed with the end of last remnants of the Holy Roman Empire last century. Since then, Europe has been in turmoil, with periods of death and destruction, with what seems to be a lack of the will to live.

This is the result of the re-paganization of Europe, which has failed to catalyze “a resumption, an awakening, a galvanization” of traditional values. That is simply a fact. Pagans will consider this condition to be the will of the gods.

Information, Understanding, and Esoterism

I have guarded in my memory two precious treasures of knowledge which I received from the Messenger of God. One of them I have made public, but if I were to divulge the other, you would cut my throat.

ABU HURAYRAH

Information is the accumulation of facts, scholarly documentation, and so on. Without understanding, that is, without the ability to grasp the accumulation as a “whole”, there is only effete erudition. It is necessary to learn to think like the angels, who understand a myriad of specific facts because of the understanding of a paucity of higher principles.

Here are some steps to reach understanding:

- Follow logical consequences of a thesis, even if not explicitly affirmed

- Put ideas into a larger whole,
- Bring out the inner meaning of ideas

Frithjof Schuon explains the last step, which may require some thought:

Esoterism refers to the nature of things, hence to intrinsic, and not legal or conventional, values.

These days, one hears a lot about “tradition”, whether such and such idea or some so and so is “traditional”. The first question to ask is: “Can you build a civilization on it?” For example, can you build a society on the basis of a man-made myth of Cthulhu²⁴? Some seem to think so.

Putting on a Show Someone asked me recently about whether Guenon was “putting on a show” with his conversion to Islam. A rather strange question, since who would you be when the show ends? To put on a really big show²⁵, you have to go all in and not pretend.

Gangs of Feral Men Another distortion of Tradition comes from a new movement calling itself neo-reaction. Rather than being formed by years of immersion in the likes of **Edmund Burke** and **Joseph de Maistre**, and their many followers and expositors, they read a web site last month.

A recent result is the claim that bands of feral men²⁶ were the source of civilization, rather than the threat they really are. In the face of all of history, common sense, and higher thinking, he asserts that the family is not the foundation of society. There is no understanding of “organic”,

²⁴<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cthulhu>

²⁵<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xnNM-vZoaHw>

²⁶<http://www.socialmatter.net/2016/02/23/mannerbund-101/>

since it is asserted that it is the result of some “male competitive instinct”. Rather, organic is intrinsic and essential; that is, it cannot be the result of something more fundamental, since it is fundamental. A group of random men getting together for a contingent purpose is just the opposite of “organic”.

A foundation of a real civilization is not some pseudo-Nietzschean will to power, but is rather its transcendent source. Thus, according to Evola, the Goths called their kings “divine heroes” and they believed their origin was divine, not instinctual.

The essay assumes some strange update of Rousseau’s Social Contract and asserts that women are the “property of men”. If you decide to read that essay and want to restore your sanity, then you can start with Family values²⁷

And for an alternative view of the origins of civilization, try Where Have All the Heroes Gone?²⁸

Of course, the thesis that men will naturally arrange themselves in a hierarchy can be easily proved, when the intellectually inferior begin to defer to their intellectual superiors.

Genetics and the Gods I read one comment about the existence of some deviant behavior. It *must* have some survival value, the comment asserted. But that is precisely the pagan view: whatever is, must have been willed by the gods.

Obviously that is both bad science and bad theology. Whatever genetic features (assuming even that it is genetic) exists is not necessarily selected for. Rather it could be mutations that have not been eradicated. Deleterious mutations in the genetic code, or “genetic load”, are always arising. Moreover, there may be group selections: a disordered society may select for various psychological disorders.

²⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4534>

²⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6067>

True Providence is the Realm of Being, of possibilities of manifestation, the world of perfection. That is what God wills. The Realm of Existence, or Becoming, is less certain. Therefore, it requires discernment to determine the will of God in any situation.

Detachment from the World is Attachment to God I listened to an online sermon with that title.²⁹

Thanks to youtube matching, it pulled up a lecture by a yogi with the same title. It was not in English, so I don't know what was said. I assume the point was the same.

The Last Judgment

He sitteth on the right hand of the Father, God Almighty, from whence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead. At whose coming all men shall rise again with their bodies, and *shall give account for their own works.*

from the Athanasian Creed

Before this throne, in my vision, the dead must come, great and little alike; and the books were opened. Another book, too, was opened, the book of life. And the dead were judged by their deeds, as the books recorded them.

REVELATION 20:12

The just shall appear whiter, more beautiful, and more resplendent than the sun. ... on the other hand, the bodies of the reprobate shall appear black and hideous, and shall send forth an intolerable stench.

²⁹*Detachment from the World is Attachment to God*: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=40o8H01ob0o&list=PLtdt1LQlokf-evtBjgotlYnNBXLJo-lhC&index=2>

ST. ALPHONSUS LIGUORI, *Preparation for Death*

According to the saints, the general judgment is the third coming of Christ, not the second that is commonly supposed. At that time, all souls will be exposed: some will be pure, most will be hardened and barely recognizable.

The purpose is to demonstrate the justice of the judgment. The consequences of one's thoughts, words, and deeds will be fully revealed. In our current condition, we can seldom see them beyond a few people close to us or a few years in the future. However, in the general judgment, we will see how our thoughts, words, and deeds rippled through the world and down through the generations. One bad choice now may be felt for several generations.

Our innermost thoughts will be exposed. Perhaps you lusted after your neighbor's wife, or worse, his daughter, or even worse, your own step-daughter. Maybe you gossiped about or harshly criticized a friend or relative behind his back; that will all become known. You get the picture. The point is to prepare for it by keeping your soul pure right now.

You say you don't believe in such superstitions. Does that really make it OK? Do you really mean that you can lust, hate, steal, or bring pain just because no one will ever find out? That is really sad. You would be better off believing the superstition than believing your own denials, lies, and self-deception.

Posted on 2016-02-28 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2016-02-29 at 06:39 said:

It's interesting to see people who would balk at John Calvin's thought all of a sudden became unacknowledged Calvinists with respect to the divine will. "If God permits it, then God must have intended it," so they say.

I need to read Laurus soon.

5.10 Idea Density

Idea Density = Number of propositions/number of words.

A proposition contains information and can be true or false.

Idea density can be used as a measure of intelligence and a low density may indicate some mental impairment. However, to be truly useful, that quality of the ideas must also be taken into account. First and foremost is specificity. A specific idea is of more value than a vague one. We recently suggested that in *Spirituality for the XXIst Century*³⁰ an idea that can be manifested can be of special value.

As an example, the post *Salvation and Evolution*³¹, particularly Tomberg's list, shows high density. It defies summary, which must necessarily be more dense, yet invites expansion. There are specific names and movements that can be discussed.

Intellectual Pride There is often a misunderstanding by religious people concerning esoterism. **Frithjof Schuon** writes:

There are people who are quite ready to attribute to intelligence a Luciferian aspect and who speak without hesitation of "**intellectual pride**" as if this were not a contradiction in terms; hence also the exaltation of "childlike" or "simple" faith, which indeed we are the first to respect when it is spontaneous and natural, but not when it is theoretical and affected.

Schuon responds to that charge:

It is not the man who chooses the way. It is the way that chooses the man. In other words, the question of a choice does not arise, since the finite cannot choose the Infinite: rather the question is

³⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=8630>

³¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=8642>

one of vocation, and those who are “called” to use the Gospel expression, cannot ignore the call without committing a “sin against the Holy Ghost” any more than a man can legitimately ignore the obligations of his religion.

Gnosis is one of the gifts of the Holy Spirit, which therefore is not to be spurned. So, on the contrary, intellectual pride can be ascribed to those who claim a knowledge that they are not entitled to, which can only be a simulacrum of true gnosis.

The Scent of a Woman Frithjof Schuon points out that, according to an Hadith, **women, perfumes, and prayer** are worthy of love. Schuon explains why:

- **Woman**, synthesizing in her substance virgin nature, the sanctuary and spiritual company, is for man what is most lovable; in her highest aspect, she is the formal projection of merciful and infinite Inwardness in the outward; and in this regard she assumes a quasi-sacramental and liberating function.
- **Perfumes** represent qualities or beauties that are formless, exactly in the same way as music; that is to say that side by side with the formal projection of Inwardness, there exists also a complementary formless projection, symbolized, not by visual or tangible qualities, but by auditory and olfactory ones; perfumes are silent music.
- **Prayer** leads from Outward to Inward, and both consecrates and transmutes the qualitative elements of the outward realm.

We are accustomed to associate Love with the Goodness of God, but Mystical Love relates to the Beauty of God. Schuon even claims that the Beauty of God corresponds to a deeper reality than His Goodness. No doubt, Prayer may take some effort and training in order to learn to love

it, but we instinctively have fond memories of scents and aromas from the past – a fresh baked pie, newly mown grass, or the passing whiff of a good perfume.

Those men who have no experience of the attraction to a woman are really missing out – and not a marginal or arbitrary experience, but an essential one. Poetry and literature abound with stories of that attraction, which is beyond rational explanation. Hence, we can suffice with a more homely example.

Some time ago, “Sophia” was a model who took a job as a project manager at a tech company. Although there were other attractive woman in the group, Stella stood out in an inexplicable way. Perhaps it was her stylish clothes, her smile, or just the way she moved. Well, at 3 PM every afternoon, Stella would go outside for a walk. Soon, large groups of men would start taking their “breaks” outside at the same hour.

Two Heavens

There are two heavens: one sensible, and the other, ideal. In the one, both the animal spirits and the rational souls enjoy bliss; in the other, the rational souls alone. The latter paradise is the heaven of knowledge and intuition.

IBN ARABI

He goes on to explain:

God has depicted paradise in accordance with the different degrees of man’s understanding. The Messiah [Christ] defined the delights of paradise as purely spiritual ... if the Messiah was so explicit on this point and had recourse to none of the allegories found in our Book, it was simply because his words were spoken to a people ... whose mind was thus prepared for his words.

Not so with our Prophet Mohammed whose Divine mission fell among a rude people ... Accordingly, most of the descriptions of paradise in his book are based on the body, in order that they might be understood by the people and serve as an incentive to their minds.

Interesting idea, but one can hardly count on “rational” souls (i.e., pneumatics) being prevalent today. I suspect there are many who get more excited about the prospect of uniting with their pet dogs in the afterlife, rather than experiencing the Beatific Vision.

Die Before you Die A common criticism is that the prospect of a future postmortem life devalues human life in the here and now. Yet, to be honest, how many of your human projects have come to fruition? Sure, there are precious few who have excelled in wealth, fame, beauty or intelligence, only to find they are ephemeral. If you have not sought those things, perhaps you have just set your sights too low.

However, if we understand the human condition correctly, we will better understand our project and our destiny. If we have fallen from a higher state, then, like trapped miners, we need to find a way to restore that higher state.

For exoteric religion, that is “salvation” which comes when we are freed from the body by death. The esoteric task, on the other hand, is liberation while in the body. That is “dying before you die.”

Image and Dignity There has been a subtle change in the teaching of the Roman Church since Vatican II, which accounts for much of what churchmen today believe and teach. There are three related concepts:

1. Man is born in the image and likeness of God
2. We are all children of God

3. The human person has ipso facto “dignity”

The more Traditional view is that (1) applies to Adam, but the rest of mankind has lost the “likeness”. The “image” of God means to have an intellectual soul as well as a body. The “likeness” means to be deified (or, in the West, to receive “sanctifying grace”). That comes from the second birth.

Hence, only those who have the likeness can become adopted children of God, that is, to be of the same nature, a “chip off the old block”. Finally, dignity is “the state or quality of being worthy of honor or respect”, so the true dignity of man consists in participating in the divine nature. (see *Is the New Catechism Catholic?*³² for the Roman teaching and *The Image And Likeness Of God*³³ for the Greek).

Toleration in the Empire Neo-pagans like to praise the alleged “toleration” of the pagans (as though that were truly a virtue). However, life in the Ancient City was hardly pluralistic. When religions clashed, one had to become subservient to the other in hierarchical fashion.

Likewise, in the Roman Empire, colonial religions were tolerated as long as they put allegiance to the Emperor in the highest place. The only exception was the Hebrews, since the Romans venerated great antiquity. Nevertheless, that exception was not passed onto the Christians, since they were not considered a Hebrew cult.

In today’s world, Liberalism holds the same place as the Emperor. A man is free to practice any religion he pleases, as long as, in the event of any clash, he is subservient to the Liberal State. Hillary Clinton, for example, has the hubris to assert that religions need to change their teaching on abortion and homosexuality.

³²<http://sspx.org/en/new-catechism-catholic>

³³<http://www.stgeorgeserbian.us/darren/darren03.htm>

Liberalism is incompatible with true religion. Actually, a marker of spiritual progress is the extent to which a person purges himself of liberal assumptions.

Social Reign of Christ The incursion of Islam into the West should bring to light how much of Tradition has been lost. On the contrary, unfortunately, the temptation is to double down on a bad debt.

The talking heads, even those who self-identify as “conservative” condemn in Islam characteristics that used to be considered “sane and normal” in Europe. It would be one thing to oppose one Tradition to another, but quite another to adopt Liberalism instead.

For example, it used to be normative for Catholicism to be the state religion wherever it was dominant. Hence, the state would fall under religious law in its various aspects as natural law, social teachings, and so on. Modest dress was encouraged (and still is at Latin masses), the man was head of the family, prayer was the center of life.

Other religions would be allowed as long as worship was private. Moreover, the priest would serve Mass “ad orientem”, i.e., facing East. Anyone proposing such a program today would be shunned.

Star of Creation This is from a facebook “discussion”:

Nick: Why does your standard bear the Jewish star of Moloch/Satan?

Gornahoor: You have quite the imagination, Nick. That is my family coat of arms that goes back to the 14th century ... perhaps you should ask them.

Nick: Sure, stars are a part of medieval heraldry, and the six-pointed ones especially in countries, where Jews were given rights and a path to infiltration. In the case of your standard, the star is what is commonly called the star of David, but actually of those two demons I mentioned. Can you find out what it's supposed to represent in your family's coat of arms? I doubt it's well-meant, if it's

put on top of the cross, considering the followers of that star are the biggest anti-Christians that walk the earth.

Obviously, it is not a “Star of David” which consists of two interlaced equilateral triangles.

A similar image is the symbol of the Anahata, or Heart, Chakra. This chakra is connected to the Sun, and also to Christ, since that is where one points when saying the Sign of the Cross.

Also, in Hinduism, the six-pointed star refers to Shakti (pointing down) and Shiva (pointing up), so their union signifies “creation” through the union of male and female. Likewise, in Christianity, the six-pointed star (found in some Orthodox churches) is called the **Star of Creation**. Hence, the true symbolism should be obvious.

I used to catalog the various kinds of idiots I encountered in life until I ran out of fingers and toes. However, I’ll give “Nick” a special award: **The 21st Idiot Award** (and an honorable mention to the person who “liked” Nick’s comment).

Posted on 2016-08-02 by Cologero

* * *

Mark Citadel on 2016-08-10 at 06:56 said:

Excellent stuff. I was fascinated by the two heavens concept, as it relates to my own thinking on racial differences present between the Arabs who embraced Islam, and the Occidentals who embraced Christianity. Interestingly, though we were far more capable of understanding a heaven of spiritual reward, we also had this aversion to an element of mitigated dualism, that being the gulf between God and man. It’s as if our needs in the here and now were more physical, we needed a God that was in some senses human, but in the future, we were more amenable to the abandonment of the merely physical, so long as the spiritual destiny was close to God.

What you say about Islam’s incursion is entirely accurate. Since I was once active in the Counter-Jihad sphere, I still get people who misunderstand my present opposition to Islam in the Occident for a simple xeno-aversion, when actually I have a lot of respect for Islam.

The main thing I took away from this article however, is that I definitely need to read more Schuon.

5.II The Succubus and the Houri

Princeton Gnosis The French philosopher **Raymond Ruyer** wrote a strange book, the *Gnosis of Princeton*, that intrigued thinkers such as **Henry Corbin** and even Jean Borella³⁴. It is a work of philosophical fiction disguised as fact, that left more than a few convinced that he was describing an actual movement. In any case, it establishes fiction as a legitimate philosophical genre.

The theme is that an elite cadre of scientists from Princeton, having rejected any positivist and materialist interpretations of science, set out to create a neo-gnostic religion based on Ruyer's peculiar philosophical positions, e.g., pansychism, pantheism, holons, and so on.

This raises an intriguing question. Suppose you encountered a movement dedicated to esoteric gnosis, how would you — in your current state of development — be able to distinguish the “real thing” from a hoax?

Spirituality for the Last Man In a book dictated by **Orin**, an alleged “source of wisdom”, we learn that

loving yourself means accepting yourself as you are right now ...
It is an agreement with yourself to appreciate, validate, accept and
support who you are at this moment.

There is no exhortation to self-knowledge, to striving, to overcoming and transcending one's spontaneous instinctual and emotional arisings, to developing a true will. As you are “right now” is little more than the vector sum of unknown forces encountered throughout the course of life. A real source of wisdom would show how to develop a Real I that can be the master of such forces.

³⁴<http://jeanborella.blogspot.com/2008/11/la-gnose-ruyrienne-religion-de-lge.html>

Facing the Facts An old Latin saying is, “Inter faeces et urinam nascimur”. This applies also to our spiritual life. If we accept living spiritually in our own mess, we will never be motivated to clean up. That is not negative thinking but leads to an authentic Joy. This was channeled to me by a source much higher than Orin.

Attack of the Succubus A frustrating aspect of spiritual development is backsliding, i.e., reverting to the same unhelpful states of consciousness repeatedly. I can go for days with a mind as still as the ocean on a calm summer’s day, interspersed with periods of bliss. Yet, unexpectedly, a demonic attack occurs, usually in that twilight state between waking and sleeping.

In a way, I am fortunate to be so weak, because I could not withstand the demonic attacks borne, for example, by a Saint Anthony³⁵ or an Anne Catherine Emmerich³⁶.

The Succubus attacks by bringing sexual imagery into consciousness. Now it doesn’t help to avoid pornography, which in any case does not interest me. Rather, she uses events from my own memory. It’s odd how random encounters from decades ago can be so vivid, while the memories of more important life events have dimmed. Now it is the case that sex creates one flesh, which is the problem with promiscuity. Even if you haven’t seen a former sexual partner in several years, it is often very easy to slip back into that relation as though just a month passed by.

In the *Life of Saint Anthony*, we never do find out exactly how the demonic attack was resisted. Perhaps, in this case, it may be useful to reveal the method. First of all, it is necessary to become aware that the pleasure of the imagery is false. Bring to mind the decay of the flesh, bodily excretions, and so on, in as much detail as you need.

Guenon claims that the personal element is irrelevant. That would

³⁵<http://www.newadvent.org/fathers/2811.htm>

³⁶<http://www.spiritdaily.net/amazingemmerich.htm>

make sense except that we necessarily begin in the human state. So some concrete suggestions may help others, or probably most will just be offended. So I hesitated to post such personal information, until I came to the realization that others have encountered the same Succubus. A Houri is the opposite, a female figure who leads upwards to Paradise. A Hadith claims that the Houri does not menstruate, urinate, or defecate. It is almost as though a Houri were interceding for me.

Life in Hell To the modern mind, the idea of being condemned to Hell seems unjust, something only a cruel God could do. Yet, what seems to be a conundrum for exoteric thought is understood differently esoterically. Hell is a postmortem state that is entirely just. Is a hydrometer unfair for indicating the alcohol content of your beer?

Actually, the time element is irrelevant since it confuses eternity with unending time. If a punishment is itself cruel, then why would ending it after a million years be an act of mercy? A thousand years? A day? Just once is already cruel.

Note that descriptions of the Hell realms described, for example, by Dante, are repeated exactly the same over and over. Since repetition is impossible for the Infinite, we should interpret that as a static state of being. A dead body can no longer act, improve or evolve. Likewise, a spiritually dead soul cannot act, improve, or evolve. It is stuck at the same state, at least until the passing away of this world.

The soul experiencing the Beatific Vision, on the other hand, is alive. The experience is never duplicated, since God is Infinite.

Liberalism and Strange Attractors In a dynamical system, an attractor³⁷ is a point toward which the system tends to evolve for a wide variety of starting conditions. In a fallen world, Liberalism, or the Consensus Reality of the Modern World, is such an attractor. On the one hand, atheists,

³⁷<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Attractor>

secularists, and materialists tend to end up as Liberals. Curiously, New Agers and liberal Christians, despite starting from a widely different set of assumptions from the secularists, are likewise attracted to Liberalism.

In this case, the attractor is like a steep bank that leads into the sea.

True Man and Social Justice Warrior When I was at St Patrick's church in my youth, a young priest named Fr Shanley arrived. The name will be familiar to you if you've seen the recent movie *Spotlight* about clerical abuse in the Boston area. They always speak of "children" but the truth is that most cases involved pederasty, i.e., sexual activity with an adolescent under the age of consent. I just looked it up on Wikipedia and was surprised to learn that pederasty is

not likely to give rise to psychological discomfort or neuroses for all or most males.

Just so you know what's coming. If that be true, then the large damage awards make no sense.

Well, back to the point. First of all, I had no interactions with him other than at mass or at CCD classes. Nor was he involved in with any of the youths in my circle, probably because we were too old. He hung out with the 10th graders. I suspect he was able to identify SSA boys, whom he chose as his targets, through their confessions. Otherwise, I don't understand why they capitulated so easily or why he was never severely beaten up. That was the customary way of dealing with unwanted sexual advances in those days.

He was the new breed of priest, youthful, long hair, jeans wearing, with "social concerns". He would be called today a Social Justice Warrior. That designation has a certain élan today, since it costs nothing personally, just a willingness to attack others. That gave him the cover for his misdeeds; he was too cool to be bad, or at least he was "good bad".

In the Tao Te Ching³⁸, the **True Man** is not humane, benevolent or compassionate. From the Taoist perspective, I suppose, Fr. Shanley was “benevolent” and “humane”, or at least gave the appearance of it. Those are the types to be wary of.

That is the opposite of the True Man, who has overcome such sentimentality.

Clash of Religion Traditions From reading Michael McClain, it is unclear if he is promoting Persian Sufism, Russian Orthodoxy or old-fashioned Spanish-style Catholicism. When I asked him which Tradition he followed, he refused to answer, although it is easy to guess. I found this in an old letter from him to a British Islamic publication³⁹.

It is Islam which is best equipped to save what can be saved from this possible wreck, and for this reason every traditional Christian should do everything in his power to favour the strong presence of Islam in Europe and America. (April 1983)

Obviously, the situation is quite different now from what it was 33 years ago. Now at the level of depth, two esoterists of two different traditions can understand each other, and even get along. However, at the exoteric level, whenever two Traditions clash, one would have to be the master of the other.

Perhaps he was being true to the ideal that the important thing is the preservation of Tradition rather than any particular form.

God knows best.

Posted on 2016-08-15 by Cologero

* * *

³⁸<https://www.gornahoor.net/?s=tao%20te%20ching>

³⁹<http://aail.org/text/articles/thelight/1983/light19830408.pdf>

Wayne Ferguson on 2016-08-15 at 07:21 said:

"Inter faeces et urinam nascimur". St Augustine of Hippo

Trying to verify the source—does anyone happen to have a citation?

https://en.wikiquote.org/wiki/Talk:Bernard_of_Clairvaux

https://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Inter_faeces_et_urinam_nascimur

Cologero on 2016-08-15 at 14:21 said:

Wayne, probably nobody ever said it. But is it true?

Matt on 2016-08-21 at 03:12 said:

Ruyer's work seems quite intriguing. If there are any english translations of his works I'll have to check them out at some point. He seems to be a rarity among the modern French intelligentsia in that he argued in favour of a teleological worldview, which is not in line with the fashionable existentialism and post-modernism that his peers flocked towards.

Max on 2016-09-04 at 11:21 said:

There seems to be a collective element to the attack of that sort of imagery. That would imply more far reaching consequences than if the phenomena were just isolated to us, and gives a deepened sense of responsibility to conduct the spiritual battle.

Ulysses on 2016-09-24 at 20:22 said:

A French hadith says that the houris supplicate: « O Seigneur, aide le dans la voie de ta religion, fais que son cœur t'obéisse et qu'il parvienne jusqu'à nous. Ô Toi le plus Miséricordieux des Miséricordieux » still looking for a precise reference ...

5.12 Reactionary Chic

There was a time — not so distant in terms of world history — when converts came from world-class authors, novelists, or philosophers. I am thinking in particular of Jaris-Karl Huysmans, Charles Peguy, Leon Bloy, Jacques Maritain, G K Chesterton, or Graham Greene, not to mention Charles Maurras and Ernst Junger, all exemplars of the Catholic intellectual.

In our time, that is not the case. It seems that in the Internet age, there is an abundance of converts (or just as many so-called “reverts”) who feel compelled to write and speak publicly via blogs, youtube, and even satellite radio. Although I am sure that the angels in heaven are rejoicing over their conversions, on the human plane we might hope that they take a vow of silence instead.

When they are not being progressive — demonstrating that their conversion is still incomplete — they too often become too negative, not about the worldview they had rejected, but rather about their newly adopted Tradition. It is as though the solidity and certainty they were expecting were ephemeral.

The memorization of the catechism is an insufficient compared to a solid study of Tradition. These new converts can bowl you over with knowledge of dogma, but what is really needful is a solid grounding in Tradition. Hence, there is little added in terms of art, literature, and so on. That is the point of **Ananda Coomaraswamy**’s observation:

A knowledge of modern Christianity will be of little use because the fundamental sentimentality of our times has diminished what was once an intellectual doctrine to a mere morality that can hardly be distinguished from a pragmatic humanism.

When the intellectual tradition was better known, artists and philosophers could often count on support from wealthy patrons. But as for “mere morality”, there are better alternatives today. A lukewarm leftism is the null hypothesis in our time, which therefore is difficult to displace. A convert has little to add to contemporary morality, other than perhaps some quaint objections to abortion, divorce, or homosexuality, but the force of those counter-cultural positions is diminishing.

Making Reaction Chic Again Wealthy young patrons like the chic Larry and Toby⁴⁰ support secular hospitals and art. So how to make reaction chic? Instead of séances to mediocre historical figures, how about invocations to the saints and the Holy Guardian Angel? Then there can be meditation classes, like those described in these pages. Kabbalah is somewhat chic. But we could offer Hermetic and Tarot centres. Fundamentally, the Western Tradition is so alien to the modern mind, it could become chic again just out of sheer novelty. The goal would be to reach the TOOS and Category X status categories. That would require an elite view, something more elite than the genteel leftism that passes for elitism. So that leads to the next topic.

The Futility of Intelligence This study, *The Inappropriately Excluded*⁴¹, shows that those with an ultra-high IQ (UHIQ) are nearly systematically excluded from many of the professions which are normally associated with high intelligence. The sweet spot of IQ seems to be in the 120-135 range (very high IQ – VHIQ). Other than theoretical physics and advanced mathematics, all college majors can be mastered by those in that range. Mastery for the VHIQ is the ability to remember and repeat the material that has been taught. All their lives, they have been assured about their intelligence, and therefore see little need to doubt it. They don't suffer from the adjustment problems that often plague the UHIQ.

The UHIQ not only masters the material, but goes beyond it. In some cases, they may then pester the teachers about their mistakes. In other cases, they find the behaviour of the less intelligent so inexplicable, that they have trouble adjusting to classmates. Without getting bogged down in this topic, the point is that the UHIQ for the most part absorb

⁴⁰<https://www.nytimes.com/2017/06/24/fashion/larry-toby-milstein-leonard-bernstein-ghost.html>

⁴¹<http://polymatharchives.blogspot.co.uk/2015/01/the-inappropriately-excluded.html>

leftism in the belief that is what intelligent people accept. An alternative viewpoint might be coherently proposed that could perhaps gain some traction. I'm afraid that conventional conservatism is too prole and even incoherent. The alt-right is too vulgar and lacks moral imagination. Perhaps neo-reaction aspires to higher intellectual standards, but it has not gained traction.

Symbolism and Realism In our age, the ideal of “realism” in art is considered edgy. The problem is that the notion of what is “real” is so constricted. For example, I recently caught a fragment of a TV show (I forget which one), in which a chic lesbian high school student was discussing her class text in which “masturbation” was mentioned in a positive way. I assume it was not one of the Great Books, even though Thomas Aquinas did address the question from a different perspective.

The opposite is Symbolism, which uses symbols and imagination to reach deeper dimensions of reality. There are soft echoes of that today, although the themes are attenuated. A recent example is the return of *Twin Peaks*, which is inspiring a lot of speculation about its “deeper” meaning. Unfortunately, there simply is no deeper meaning, as though the dream sequences were sufficient in themselves.

The point is that Art is the path to Chic, and the new converts are without Art.

Free Will and Animals In *The Romance of the Rose*, there is speculation about what would happen if animals had free will. Perhaps the hens would refuse to lay eggs, the cattle would conspire against the cowboys, and your dog would stop sniffing your ass. Of course, that is exactly what human life is like, thus proving free will.

Forced Conversions Nevertheless, freedom is nauseating, so it is often denied. Men are happiest when they can attribute their behaviour to

external causes, e.g., genetics, a disease, environment or circumstances.

A logical argument is likewise a form of compulsion. Recently, I've heard two different "explanations" from otherwise intelligent men about why they apostatised from the religion of their ancestors. One mentioned that he recognized the pagan roots of Christianity and the other, after he read some historian's claim that Christianity was reducible to the ancient Egyptian religion.

Quite strange, since these pages have often documented those same points. Hence, the arguments are without force, and indicate bad faith since they deny free will. A conversion is a matter of will, you will it, or you will something else.

Birth and Irrationality The Hermetic teaching, as revealed by Valentin Tomberg is this:

The individuality descends consciously and of his own free will to birth, into an environment where he is wanted and awaited.

What is remarkable is that some Russian theologians like **Vladimir Solovyov** and **Sergius Bulgakov** integrated some of these teachings into their systems. In *The Burning Bush*, Bulgakov discusses the problem of births. He begins with this:

God sends souls into bodies individually fitted with qualities ... all the circumstances of birth and earthly destiny.

However, the soul cannot be free if it is created against its own will. Hence, there is an element of self-determination in the soul when it is created. The soul is joined to its body *willingly*. The obvious question is why does not the soul remember having made this choice. The answer is that it is not a temporal event in the life of the soul, but is pre-temporal.

The point is that the human spirit assumes a personality with individual qualities; men are born different and have different destinies.

These qualities are partially determined by the individual heredity which includes family, clan, and even its generation.

If you observe yourself carefully, you may notice little clues that help you recall your primordial choice. Perhaps some bon mot that means little to the world, yet something special to your own life.

Skin in the Game Nassim Taleb explains the necessity of eating one's own turtles⁴². More prosaically, this may be termed "practice what you preach". Yes, it is true that I drink wine, cook pasta, and read medieval philosophy while listening to Gregorian chant, or to Erik Satie when I am feeling "edgy".

Mr. Taleb has convinced me that the personal element is relevant to the intellectual element. This is unlike previous generations of writers on Tradition who avoided any hint of the personal. However, in the course of life, I've encountered False Seeming much too often; the initiate must learn to distinguish what is from what seems to be.

I don't believe that so-called white nationalists have been forthcoming with their ancestry reports. I'm considering posting mine publicly, if I determine that it is a wise or worthwhile idea. Basically, it is 97% European, with 2.5% Middle Eastern. Of course, that is, or was, part of the Roman Empire which is my real identity, although there is no big market for Romanity at the moment. Nevertheless, it probably accounts for my fondness for falafel and belly dancers.

Secret Rebel You don't need extravagant outward displays to be convincing as a societal rebel. In the spirit of openness, here is a fragment from my personality profile:

He has a good deal less than optimal concern for the standards

⁴²<https://medium.com/incerto/why-each-one-should-eat-his-own-turtles-revised-8a4be2f11e61>

of society and tends to be low on conventionality and group conformity.

The psychologist offered to cure me of that, but I graciously declined.

Calumny and Detraction The initiate should be very careful not to repeat things about other people which should not be told. Nevertheless, Evil Tongue is unable to be quiet. Now calumny, which is the making of false and defamatory statements, is commonly acknowledged to be a moral flaw. At least it used to be before political positions became warlike.

What is not as well-known is that detraction is also immoral. In other words, truth is no defence. Detraction is the making of true and defamatory statements about someone's flaws, if they are not publicly known and the only reason for their revelation is to hurt someone. Evil Tongue simply cannot help himself.

A Child's Prayer When I was a young boy, I prayed this prayer daily.

- Thank you, God, for making me Catholic.
- Thank you, God, for making me an American.
- Thank you, God, for making me Italian

Point 1 is obvious, since everyone else is risking his salvation.

The reason for Point 2 may not be. At that time, the USA was locked in a cold war with the Russians, who were promoting communism and atheism. Those went against point 1. At this point in history, there is some ambiguity since the roles of the two parties seem to be reversing.

Point 3 is because we had more fun than the other kids and ate much better. Once time I was invited to a friend's house for dinner. The mother must have thought she was pleasing me when she served ravioli from a can. I ran out of the house and back home when no one was looking. They must have had a panic attack, but they eventually called my mom.

Posted on 2017-07-10 by Cologero

* * *

James on 2017-07-11 at 04:17 said:
Thanks for another great post.

Fred on 2017-07-11 at 06:40 said:

The problem is can we offer and make chic a western tradition we lost?

There is hardly any 19th or 20th century hermeticist who didn't use karma and other eastern concepts to explain his theories. The presence of reincarnation is probably the easiest way to spot the frauds.

The only time I felt part of a living tradition is when I studied for confirmation with Catholic traditionalists: thomism, Aristotle, the Pseudo-Dionysius, Plato. Solid foundations. The only time.

Buddhism is chic today in the west, too bad in the west is mostly leftist new age self-centered garbage.

Hinduism is chic today in the west, too bad is just misconceptions and "do as you please". Why Hermeticism would be different than another parody?

Thomas Blanchard on 2017-07-12 at 12:14 said:
Cologero:

Speaking of Twin Peaks, I was researching a bit about David Lynch the other day and discovered that he's a long-time advocate and devotee of Maharishi Mahesh Yogi's "Transcendental Meditation" technique. You've mentioned familiarity with this work multiple times in the past, but not discussed it in detail. I'm curious to know your thoughts on his work.

Lynch can be found discussing the technique and some of his related insights here: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BH4qD5Fzyjk>. He seems sound insofar as he posits God as uncreated consciousness, also reciting some perennialist boilerplate about all traditions having access to the same metaphysical truths, etc. The most glaring flaw that I can see is his attitude toward suffering, which seems incomplete, at best (he seems to view the whole phenomenon of human suffering as totally unnecessary and easily overcome by meditation).

Going by their own descriptions (<https://www.davidlynchfoundation.org/about-tm.html>), TM is different from "focused meditation" (lectio divina, Jesus prayer, etc.) and "open monitoring" (the kind of awareness exercises we practice), and is described vaguely as "automatic self-transcending". The marketing on the various TM-affiliated websites is very heavy handed and big on promising huge results for little effort. Is this kind of technique totally a scam and/or counter-initiatory, or is there something of value here worth studying?

Numen on 2017-07-12 at 14:01 said:

I thought similarly when I was a wee lad. Born in the States, I went on vacation to the fatherland in Bangladesh with my family, and those were some of my earliest memories. I remember my aunt telling me not to play or talk to the “asura boys” since they were filthy and lower than us. This aunt is the sweetest person I know, so it may sound strange to the uninitiated that she would say such a thing. Part of Tradition is nostalgic, in the sense that Schuon and Tomberg framed it as a tend toward primordiality and the sacred. Proper focus on personal aspects, I also think, can help.

Fred on 2017-07-13 at 05:35 said:

@Thomas Blanchard

I never had any actual personal experience with TM but there is a lot to be suspicious around it.

First of all the fact that its founder got very rich, always the easiest way to spot false teachers.

Then it spread mostly in the anti-traditional environment of 60s and 70s hippies, californian celebrities, and other “do what you wish”, hedonistic, self-centered kind of people.

There is actually an article of Rama Coomaraswamy against TM, Mahesh Yogi is called a rakshasa.

It doesn't mean, however, there is nothing true in the technique. He probably stole something from various yoga traditions in India.

Arthur Konrad on 2017-07-13 at 07:15 said:

It had a rough start few years ago, plagued then by egoistic outbursts, but NRx seems to have solidified recently into a discourse which at the very least won't compromise eloquence and good manners. It's a sorely lacking thing

The question isn't whether promoting reactionary views is possible within modern circumstances, especially when it comes to inner life, which is crucial in reaching the proper comprehension, but whether history needs another “uncompromising” and “stubborn” Traditionalist to repeat the same motions once again – initial enthusiasm, followed by resignation, and concluded by pessimism and abstention.

Perhaps we should be content in acknowledging that this latter phase is inherent to this day and age, and go with this preposition. I'm wondering myself.

Schoolboy on 2017-07-13 at 17:11 said:

Off topic but would like some input from those higher than me. Recently I read “Lost Horizon” by James Hilton and will be viewing the film version on Turner Classic Movies tonight. On some level Shangri La appears to be a heaven world, being reached thru arduous effort or

grace from those who can offer a great opportunity if we can make use of it. All are offered the option to stay and improve themselves in ways not always available to most people. Message: be prepared to step into that new life and move into it gracefully, after all that may be the whole point of all this endless meditation, seeking, saving the whales, etc.

yourusernameistakeng on 2017-07-14 at 19:14 said:

This is great. I am a musician planning to tour and I have often thought... how could I represent Tradition in my band branding etc.... ..I think there is a young generation interested in this idea, but they're definitely in the minority. If they're like me they're looking and hoping for more connections to the past in culture.

Fred on 2017-07-16 at 16:44 said:

A chinese saying goes like this "It's useless to stop an avalanche with your hands, better take shelter and wait for it to end"

Maybe this is what it needs to be done. Creating safe places of faith, tradition and knowledge like the Benedictine monks during the dark centuries between the fall of Rome and Charlemagne.

Max on 2017-07-25 at 09:20 said:

From where do intelligent people get the mistaken assumption that intelligent people ascribe to leftism? Because intelligent people knows not to upset the masses in vain, they proceed to tell them what they want to hear, and missapply the imperial strategy of worshiping at the shrine of the conquered as a display of good will. Most things can be assimilated except the outright denial of truth.

Note in which way Christianity fits this ancient pattern since Christ never was nor will be conquered. Christ magnanimously adopted the worthy elements of paganism as a sign of good will towards the conquered, also being an act of free will since he was not compelled to do it. When neo-pagans misinterpret an act of free will as a display of weakness it reveals that they personally know of nothing but compulsion.

A sign of reasonably high intelligence is to begin to understand the workings of ones mind. A sign of ultra high intelligence is to also understand other minds, making intelligence universal in scope rather than individually restricted.

5.13 The Order of Things

There are four nutriments for the maintenance of beings who have come into being or for the support of those in search of a place to be born: Physical food, gross or refined; touch as the second; thinking the third; and consciousness the fourth.

BUDDHA, *Samyatta Nikaya*

Namaste In certain circles, “Namaste” has replaced a hale “Hello” as a form of greeting. Sometimes the English translation follows: “The divine in me honors the divine in you.” That may have some merit if taken literally, but the subtext is usually something like this: “The vulgar part of me accepts the vulgar part of you.”

What is less well known is that the major spiritual Tradition of the West has its own understanding of Namaste, i.e., the true understanding without the subtext:

One loves one’s neighbor for what there is of God in him and not for what he puts of himself in himself, that is, his sins, his whims, his personal ideas. We love him in the measure that he is with God.

POPE ST. PIUS X

Reality of Ideas Curiously, the writer **Charles Upton** grasped the reality of Ideas from the channeled Seth material. He quotes this passage:

The term, a supreme being, is in itself distortive, for you naturally project the qualities of human nature upon it. If I told you that God was an idea, you would not understand what I meant, for you do not understand the dimensions in which an idea has its reality, or the energy it can originate and propel. You do not believe in

ideas in the same way that you believe in physical objects, so if I tell you that God is an idea, you will misinterpret this to mean that God is less than real — nebulous, without reality, without purpose, and without motive action.

From this, Upton realized that objective Ideas are not abstractions but rather densely-packed, conscious realities. He mentions that the Islamic theosophist Suhrawardi represents the Platonic Ideas as angels. Of course, this is also more or less the esoteric teaching of the West. The order of the angels corresponds to different levels of thought. Hence, our thinking is a participation in the transcendent order, good, bad, or neutral. The alternative is to believe that bio-electrochemical processes somehow create thoughts.

Psychic Reality in Jung Carl Jung likewise accepts ideas as entities to be studied by psychology, just as natural scientists study plants and animals. Although *qua* scientist he remains agnostic about the metaphysical reality of the ideas, that need not deter us. He explains:

For modern psychology, ideas are entities, like animals and plants. The scientific method consists in the description of nature. All mythological ideas are essentially real, and far older than any philosophy. Like our knowledge of physical nature, they were originally perceptions and experiences. Insofar as such ideas are universal, they are symptoms or characteristics or normal exponents of psychic life, which are naturally present and need no proof of their “truth”.

Universal ideas are part of the natural constitution of the psyche. Such ideas that are not consciously experienced are buried in the unconscious and may appear as neurotic symptoms. If you don’t think that possible, recall that the Buddha distinguished thinking from consciousness.

For example, the idea of God is a psychic fact. The idea of immortality is a psychic fact, too. Hence, it is normal to think about it and abnormal not to.

Jung also researched “so-called occult phenomena”, although we prefer the more traditional expression, “preternatural phenomena”, including amnesia, dual consciousness, automatic writing, channeling, and so on. He pointed out that in practice it can be exceedingly difficult to distinguish such states from normal psychology and “even with the psychology of the supranormal, that of genius.” I mention this to explain how the Seth material can display signs of genius, as Upton noted, while being so wrong in other aspects.

Psychic Reality in Freud Freud is much maligned today but, like Jung (or Seth), he may have had some good ideas, provided we don’t draw any metaphysical conclusions from his psychological observations. An oddity of the official English translation is that it replaces the concrete German pronouns with abstract Latin ones. Hence, instead of the ego and the id, we should rather understand “the I” and “the it”. In that case, the I is never an object, but always a subject, and the It is an impersonal mass of impulses and desires. In terms of German idealism, the It is the not-I.

However, the contemporary mind understands things in quite the opposite way. The It has become the “true self”, since all such desires define who we really are. Then the I (or ego) becomes the object that acts on those desires.

In Freudian terms, the Pleasure Principle has achieved dominance over the Reality Principle. There is little point to appeal to reality and logic, when desire has become the ultimate arbiter of behavior. We see this in Freud’s description of sexual perversion. By that term, Freud did not intend to imply a moral pejorative, but rather a neutral scientific term. “Perversion” is simply the turning away from the biological function of

sex. He wrote:

The common characteristic of all perversions is that they have abandoned reproduction as their aim. We term sexual activity perverse when it has renounced the aim of reproduction and follows the pursuit of pleasure as an independent goal.

Of course, that was the most common understanding up until a century or so ago. It was the teaching not only of the Catholic Church, but basically all the denominations. Freud conceded that touching, kissing, or licking were not perverted if they were part of foreplay prior to intercourse with the aim of reproduction. In our time, however, what was foreplay is now the end game, and reproduction is merely a risky side effect of sexual activity.

Old Age

Ordinarily we cling to our past and remain stuck in the illusion of youthfulness. Being old is highly unpopular. Nobody seems to consider that not being able to grow old is just as absurd as not being able to outgrow child-size shoes. A still infantile man of thirty is surely to be deplored, but a youthful septuagenarian— isn't that delightful? And yet both are perverse, lacking in style, psychological monstrosities. A young man who does not fight and conquer has missed the best part of his youth, and an old man who does not know how to listen to the secrets of the brooks, as they tumble down from the peaks to the valleys, makes no sense; he is spiritual mummy who is nothing but a rigid relic of the past. He stands apart from life, mechanically repeating himself to the last triviality.

CARL JUNG

Yet we promote the spiritual mummies. We praise retirees who run a marathon, 60 year old supermodels who wear a bikini, or a grandmother foolishly playing virtual reality Star Wars games. There are many baby boomers who have not had an original thought since they were 19 years old.

Barnyard Animals

We must not forget that to speak of blood in the case of a man is not the same thing as to speak of it in the case of an animal. If, by blood, one means the biological heredity of a race, then in the animal, race is everything, while, in man, it is only a part. The error of certain race fanatics, who think that the reintegration of a race in its ethnic unity signifies *ipso facto* the rebirth of a people, lies exactly here: they regard man as if he could be regarded as horses, cats, or dogs of a “pure breed”. The preservation or the restoration of the purity of race, in the narrowest sense, can be everything in an animal, but not in man—in the man of superior type: even for man, it can constitute a condition which may be necessary under certain aspects, yet is not sufficient in any case, since the racial factor is not the only one which defines man.

That is Julius Evola’s description of man and his relationship to biology. Somehow that is considered evil today. Nevertheless, the “educated” scientific view is that man is indeed just a biological creature, not fundamentally different from horses, cats, and dogs. Go figure.

The Opposite of a Revolution There is a persistent misunderstanding of what the terms left and right might mean in their socio-political context. A careful reading of *The Communist Manifesto* by **Karl Marx**, however, will bring much clarity. These are its two fundamental points; everything else follows upon them:

1. A spectre is haunting Europe — the spectre of communism.
2. In short, the Communists everywhere support every revolutionary movement against the existing social and political order of things.

Those statements are from the beginning and the end of the Manifesto. The fundamental impulse of Marxism comes from a “spectre”, that is, an evil spirit. You may prefer the euphemism that it arises from an “idea”, or a meme. In that case, it is easy to forget that ideas are “conscious realities”; a fortiori, it neglects to take Marx’s own claim seriously.

The goal of Marxism, as Marx pointed out, is to support “the forcible overthrow of all existing social conditions”, i.e., the socio-political order (not just the economic order), wherever and whenever possible. This is always couched in terms of increased freedom or liberation, so that even many who claim to oppose Marxism, are actually supporting its aims.

Once this is grasped, contemporary events reveal themselves. There is no rationality to the revolution, since it is guided by evil spirits. The revolution always denies the Logos, and attacks Him constantly.

Joseph de Maistre famously claimed that what is required is the “opposite of a revolution”, that is, the establishment of the proper socio-political order of things. That can be understood as the recovery of the values that “every well-bred man considered healthy and normal” prior to the revolution. This is not nostalgia for a return to the social and material conditions of a bygone era. The natural, or better, supernatural, order is transcendent to the vagaries of history. Thus, Tradition has manifested in many different concrete forms, while retaining its transcendent values. Marxism, on the other hand, is a materialist understanding of history.

In sum, every counter-revolutionary movement must have a deep understanding of the proper order of things; otherwise, it will be part of the problem, not part of the solution.

The Regression of Castes Rene Guenon has documented the regression of the castes: the spiritual authority gives way to political power, and so on. Curiously, Marxism and Tradition both agree on the transfer of power from caste to caste, or from class to class in Marxist terms. They only disagree on its significance.

There is a cartoonish diagram of Evola's explanation of the regression that has been making the rounds. Presumably, it is for those who cannot follow a written text, as it gets a lot of attention on social media. What would be more helpful is a little quiz that would identify which caste you belong to, based on your personality, character, abilities, and level of understanding. There will be a lot of surprises.

Planet of the Apes I found my copy of *Fads and Fallacies in the Name of Science*, by **Martin Gardner**, which I had first read as a boy. The cranks he refutes are, unfortunately, more interesting than Gardner. A lot of chapters are on alternative medicine, the age of the earth, and anti-Darwinism.

One of the more interesting is Francis Crookshank⁴³, who related human races to the apes. He claimed that the White race is like the chimpanzee, the Oriental like the orangutan, and the Black race like the gorilla. Now I've only seen the original *Planet of the Apes*, and that was some time ago. Does Crookshank's theory offer a key to understanding the hidden meaning of the movie? When the apes someday film the movie, *Planet of the Humans*, then we will know for sure.

Posted on 2017-12-29 by Cologero

* * *

patriciakay3 on 2017-12-29 at 13:28 said:

⁴³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Francis_Graham_Crookshank

How helpful your writing has been over the years. You have brought about an order in my thinking that has centered my life in greater clarity. An inner "lightedness" has emerged from a chaotic darkness, and you have contributed to this happening. Thank you.

james on 2017-12-30 at 04:30 said:

Thanks for all the great posts over the years. Looking forward to whatever new format you adapt.

kalpatraveller on 2017-12-30 at 15:54 said:

I am well aware you have a more important set of topics for the remainder of Gornahoor's incarnation (looking forward to all of them), than the one I am about to suggest, but it would be appreciated (at least by someone at my relatively unintegrated level) to know what kinds of things you might have found of value in the Seth material (the "signs of genius"), as well as what was "so wrong" in his case otherwise, perhaps channeling in general.

Rudolf Steiner once said, near the end of his life, that the time would come when many more would connect with higher realms, and while channeling might seem a likely example of that, I've had unresolved doubts. Richard Leviton, who was (and still seems to be) an indebted follower of Steiner, generally denounced the channeling phenomenon in his earlier book surveying anthroposophy, *The Imagination of Pentecost*. However, it seems more than ironic that he now practices a kind of "clairvoyance" in which he communes with entities such as Merlin, and has regular contact with the Ofanim, his angelic "mentors" at the level of the thrones...

Auld Wat on 2017-12-31 at 06:10 said:

Thank you for another great post, Cologero!

Cologero on 2017-12-31 at 11:32 said:

The Seth material has already been analyzed by Charles Upton in "The System of the Antichrist", so I don't need to repeat it all here.

As for Steiner, start with this: *Rudolf Steiner Gave Two Paths: The Science Path And The Occult Path*: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ApMCQn0HXuM>

I am more interested in the philosophical (scientific) Steiner rather than the later clairvoyant (occult) Steiner.

For a analysis of clairvoyance vs creative imagination, check this out: *The Theosophical Imagination*: http://correspondencesjournal.com/wp-content/uploads/2017/12/16401_20537158_hanegraaff.pdf

Malopello on 2018-01-03 at 05:30 said:

Thanks for your blog, I discovered it recently, it's a pleasure to read.

I don't know if you already wrote about modern notions as Progress, or the mechanization of human life to a subhuman life, transhumanism, the drying of human imaginary, scientism, mass communication and information, etc.. And relating it to philosophers, saints, or whatever you want.

Some interesting readings that you may know :

The Reign of Quantity & the Signs of the Times – by René Guénon

You seem to speak fluently french so this book too can be good too (didn't find in english) :
la France contre les robots – by Georges Bernanos

I think it would be interesting to read your thoughts about it.

I don't know if this type of subjects can have its place in your blog, whatever thanks for your writings.

5.14 What, Me Worry?

The sweet and loving knowledge she says He taught her is mystical theology, that secret knowledge of God which spiritual persons call contemplation. This knowledge is very delightful because it is a knowledge through love. Love is the master of this knowledge and that which makes it wholly agreeable. Since God communicates this knowledge and understanding in the love with which he communicates Himself to the soul, it is very delightful to the intellect, since it is a knowledge belonging to the intellect.

ST JOHN OF THE CROSS, *The Spiritual Cantic*

What tradition can remain to us of those generations that have not left us a single written line? ... Fortunately, the past never completely dies for man. Man may forget it, but he always preserves it within him. For, take him at any epoch, and he is the product, the epitome, of all the earlier epochs. Let him look into his own soul, and he can find and distinguish these different epochs by what each of them has left behind.

NUMA DENIS FUSTEL DE COULANGES, *The Ancient City*

Remember the past ... what if you do? Then what?

Living in the Dark

Because history—as, moreover, the life of the individual—is “worked” by day and by night. It has a diurnal aspect and a nocturnal aspect. The former is exoteric, whilst the latter is esoteric. The silence and obscurity of the night is always full of events in preparation — and all that which is unconscious or superconscious in the human being belongs to the domain of “night”. This is the magical side of history, the side of magical deeds and works acting behind the facade of history “by day”.

VALENTIN TOMBERG, *Letter V, The Pope*

Negative Capability, that is, when a man is capable of being in uncertainties, mysteries, doubts, without any irritable reaching after fact and reason.

JOHN KEATS

There are two kinds of teaching: the speech of day and the knowledge of night, i.e., verbal teaching and direct inspiration. Those who rely only on knowledge based on evidence and reason are afraid of the dark. That is equivalent to looking only at the tip of the iceberg, when there are hidden or occult forces at work.

In John 3, Nicodemus visits Jesus at night. In the night time, the cares of the day should be left behind so the mind can turn to spiritual teachings. Jesus tries to explain the necessity of the second birth to him, but Nicodemus is confused. He can only understand the idea as a daylight teaching rather than as knowledge of the night.

Tomberg explains that there are two truths that must be harmonized:

- The logic of facts, which deals with the actual, the temporal, the phenomenal
- Moral logic which is ideal, eternal, and noumenal

The discrepancy between the ideal and the actual worlds is a gaping wound, represented by the Sacred Heart. We know what to do to align them, yet we refuse to act.

Calvinists claim the God created sin. However, in Hell, no one blames God for their situation because they understand God's justice. Instead, they spend eternity blaming each other. That is why life on Earth is a foretaste of things to come. We cannot seem to avoid incessant mutual blame. As even Sartre recognized, "Hell is other people."

Death is a continuation of life. Hell is more of what you are now.

A woman lost her faith when she learned that her cat would not go to Heaven. Her real concern should be her own postmortem destiny.

The Godforsaken World Science displaced the earth from the centre of the universe, but did not remove its godforsakenness. The centre of a circle is the point farthest from the circumference. In that sense the earth is still the centre, and at the centre of the earth, is Hell. Hence, being at the centre is not a privilege, but rather a hazard. It is a long and difficult journey to ascend to God who is even beyond the circumference.

St Theresa d'Avila had a vision of souls falling into Hell like snowflakes falling in a blizzard. It would be hard to argue with her.

The stratification of men has been forgotten. The trend is to classify people by race, whereas the most valid classification is that of caste.

Sin has been forgotten. Yet there are 10 commandments, of quite different characteristics. Atheism and irreligion, for example, are not defensible intellectual positions, but rather moral failings.

The Judge

Jesus did not trust himself to them because he knew all men and needed no one to bear witness of man; for he himself knew what was in man.

JOHN 2:24-25

The Real I appears as an impartial Referee or an inner Judge. The referee is just and impartial, as opposed to the personality which is motivated by subjective concerns.

The second coming of Christ takes place in the heart. The third coming appears as the Judge. You can wait until death to be judged, or else you can awaken the judge in this life.

A Serious Life At a recent dinner party, time was spent discussing trivia like the best TV shows to watch. On your death bed, I doubt your last words will be, "I wish I had watched more TV." Take your life seriously, do something relevant.

Death Wish Sigmund Freud postulated the existence of a Death Instinct, i.e., the desire for unconsciousness. That is unnecessary since the natural state of man is to be unconscious. The real mystery is waking up, or better said, becoming conscious. **Erich Neumann** makes this observation:

The unconscious state is the primary and natural one, and the conscious state the product of an effort that uses up libido. There is in the psyche a force of inertia, a kind of psychic gravitation which tends to fall back into the original unconscious condition. In spite of its unconsciousness, however, this state is a state of life and not a state of death. It is just as ridiculous to speak of the

death instinct of an apple that falls to the ground as to speak of the death instinct of the ego that falls into unconsciousness.

The pull exerted by the great “mass” of the unconscious, i.e., by the collective unconscious with its powerful energy-charge, can only be overcome temporarily by a special performance on the part of the conscious system, though it can be modified and transformed by the building of certain mechanisms.

Even in its waking state our ego consciousness, which in any case forms only a segment of the total psyche, exhibits varying degrees of animation, ranging from reverie, partial attention, and a diffuse wakefulness to partial concentration upon something, intense concentration, and finally moments of general and extreme alertness.

ERICH NEUMANN, *The Origins and History of Consciousness*

Modern men falsely believe themselves to be conscious when they are really dominated by subjective elements, fantasies, negative emotions, and so on. In politics, there are two sides: one claiming to be “woke”, the other to be “red-pilled”. Both are deluded.

Nevertheless, there is a dim collective consciousness of our ancient ancestors being more conscious. That is the appeal of movies like the *Invasion of the Body Snatchers* and *They Live*.

The first stage of the Hermetic path is to resist the pull into unconsciousness. Hence, there are deliberate exercises to develop attention, concentration, and awareness.

Plebeian Values The novel *My Brilliant Friend* is about the friendship of two girls, Elena and Lila, in the slums of Naples after the war. Lila was a child prodigy while Elena was more conventionally intelligent. Nevertheless, there was a telling comment from the school teacher who warned Elena about Lila because Lila was a plebeian.

Each Ancient City had a spiritual foundation, some ancestor or spiritual being who created the constitution for the City. Thus this foundation was essentially spiritual, not genetic. Catholic teaching is that there is an Archangel associated with each city, nation, etc. So the claims of the Ancient City are not implausible; people then had a deeper awareness of transcendent reality.

Each family in the City had its own religious rites; religious observances were an important part of the City's daily life. In addition, each family had clients or dependents. The clients did not have rites of their own but participated in the rites of their family. Eventually, the City would attract other people, alien to the founders.

For example, Athens was on a hill but the plebeians live on the outskirts. The plebeians did not come to Athens to study philosophy, mathematics, or gymnastics for that matter. Rather they were attracted to the security and prosperity of the City. They were the mass without their own religion, unlike the citizens. Ultimately, this led to conflicts as described by Fustel de Coulanges:

At Rome, the plebeians undertook to form *gentes*, in imitation of the patricians; at Athens they attempted to overthrow the *gentes*, to blend them together, and to replace them by the *demes*, which were established in imitation of them. ... Every *gens* had a special worship; in Greece the members of the same *gens* were recognized by the fact that they had performed sacrifices in common from a very early period ... It was a duty to perpetuate this worship from generation to generation, and every man was required to leave sons after him to continue it.

The history of Rome is full of the struggles between the Patricians and Plebeians, struggles that we find in all the Sabine, Latin, and Etruscan cities. We can even remark that the higher we ascend in the history of Greece and Italy, the more profound and the more strongly marked the distinction appears — a positive proof that the inequality did not grow up with time, but that it

existed from the beginning, and that it was contemporary with the birth of cities. What constituted the peculiar character of the plebs was, that they were foreign to the religious organization of the city, and even to that of the family. The plebeian, at first, had no worship, and knew nothing of the sacred family.

NUMA DENIS FUSTEL DE COULANGES, *The Ancient City*

This fact was also noted by Valentin Tomberg. I'm sure he had the French and Russian Revolutions in mind—both hostile to the established religion—when he wrote this:

A pyramid is not complete without its summit; hierarchy does not exist when it is incomplete. Without an Emperor, there will be, sooner or later, no more kings. When there are no kings, there will be, sooner or later, no more nobility. When there is no more nobility, there will be, sooner or later, no more bourgeoisie or peasants. This is how one arrives at the dictatorship of the proletariat, the class hostile to the hierarchical principle, which, however, is the reflection of divine order. This is why the proletariat professes atheism.

VALENTIN TOMBERG, *Letter IV, The Emperor*

Posted on 2019-04-28 by Cologero

* * *

Mike M on 2021-04-28 at 15:51 said:

"A pyramid is not complete without its summit; hierarchy does not exist when it is incomplete. ... This is why the proletariat professes atheism"

Recently I reflected on my experience with certain existentialist creations, I noted that my experience was entirely different than others in that they were focused on the bleakness and absurdity of it all which would affirm a human striving in the meaninglessness. On the other

hand, I took messages of joy, grace, and boundless hope, albeit with some grim realities of the failures of ideologies, pragmatism, and even “religion”.

I asked a friend why the label existentialist even existed at all, wouldn’t any philosophy or work of art have something to do with the fundamentals of human existence? He answered that it begins with atheism. Once atheistic, nihilistic, thought is started, the whole chain of interpretation can only lead to the collapse of hierarchy, reason, structure etc. I saw that the perception of messages and the consequences of those ideas were only too real. Once the Emperor is finished, the whole State collapses as Tomberg notes, my life has not been much different.

In the internal, there is a 1:1 reflection of this process, first goes God and the Emperor, Kings, nobility, working class and guilds, and then all distinction entirely. Then the outcasts and outsiders of oneself have the greatest opportunity to come into one’s Personality.

“The first stage of the Hermetic path is to resist the pull into unconsciousness”

I then work to stay awake and attentive and discerning what comes out of an unconscious state. Further, accepting responsibility for the actions of the unconscious state instead of attempting to pass the blame onwards. That seems to be a restoration of what is good in the whole system. Perhaps instead of resisting per se (which is necessary at times), its easier when one develops the attraction to consciousness, so to speak.

Auld Wat on 2022-04-28 at 10:50 said:

The stratification of man is not hierarchical in the modern sense of the word but rather each caste emanates from the centre to the circumference with the caste closest to the centre representing a singularity or unity. Looking from above we see this more clearly than if we look from the horizontal as moderns do.

Now this may appear to be the reverse of what you say vis a vis Hell but one has to pass through Hell to get to the other side. Dante’s journey downward through the circles of Hell is necessary as then, and only then, is he able to begin his ascent up Mount Purgatory to the Celestial City (which itself contains spheres to pass through in turn).

5.15 Perpetual Motion

The present age is a critical one and interesting to live in. The civilisation characteristic of Christendom has not disappeared, yet another civilisation has begun to take its place. The shell of Christendom is broken. The unconquerable mind of the East, the pagan past, the industrial socialistic future confront it with their

equal authority. Our whole life and mind is saturated with the slow upward filtration of a new spirit—that of an emancipated, atheistic, international democracy.

GEORGE SANTAYANA, *The Winds of Doctrine* (1913)

Motion Detector While discussing the discoveries of the cognitive psychologist James Gibson, Wolfgang Smith pointed that we don't perceive motion as a series of independent frames, but rather we grasp it "all at once". Music, too, is experienced "all at once"; that is, songs, concertos, symphonies, etc., are recognized as a "whole", not as a series of unrelated notes.

This experience is so common, it is barely noticed, if at all. It is the cause of the "gambler's fallacy". A gambler, having seen Red come up 10 consecutive times on the roulette wheel, believes that a Black is "due" to come up. The gambler is deluded into thinking there must be a relationship between the rolls of the roulette wheel.

Civilisational Decline When it comes to the larger question of the course of human events, the opposite is the case. Then only individual events are noticed, but few are able to see these events in their Wholeness as part of a larger pattern lasting, perhaps, generations. Early last century some astute minds were able to see the "motion" and "direction" of events. I am thinking of Oswald Spengler, for example, but also Rene Guenon and Julius Evola. Writing in 1913, George Santayana, who famously declared that "Those ignorant of history are doomed to repeat it," had his own astute observations of events. Unfortunately, in our day, it seems that we are doomed to repeat Santayana's phrase *ad infinitum*, while still remaining ignorant of history. The civilization in decline, more complete now than then, is called **Christendom**. Santayana identifies the forces that have been, and still are, replacing it:

- The mind of the East
- Paganism
- Atheism
- Socialism
- Globalism

This list includes those movements whose goal is to “save the West”, as well as those explicitly committed to its continued destruction. Here is the first distinction.

- Those committed to destruction understand they are destroying Christendom.
- Those allegedly committed to preservation don’t understand that they need to preserve Christendom.

Turn to the East Not much needs to be said about the turn to Eastern religions. Thanks to the researches of Rene Guenon, we realize how pointless and unnecessary that is. There is nothing in an Eastern religions that cannot be found in the West; if you don’t recognize it in the West, then you won’t recognize it in the East. I include Eastern Orthodoxy in the group. I have great respect for Orthodoxy as it is appropriate to those born into it. But once again, the same principle applies: esoterically, there is no difference between Latin and Greek Christians. Perhaps your complaint is that the Roman church has “changed”. Well, if someone has taken something that belongs to you, then a man fights to get it back.

Paganism Regarding the neopagans, I am tempted to say, “forgive them, for they don’t know what they do,” but the thought quickly recedes. The province of yobs and the semi-intelligent, they yearn for a past the preceded Christendom. Santayana identifies them as destroyers, so they are doing the enemy’s work for them.

Atheism, Socialism, Globalism This group, which we can’t dwell on at this point, explicitly intends to overturn civilization. They have the upper hand.

Common Ground C S Lewis, in an essay titled⁴⁴ *Modern Man and His Categories of Thought* (1946), identified the modes of thought that separates the modern and traditional minds.

Speaking of Jews, Gentiles, and Pagans, he wrote: “all three classes believed in the supernatural... All were conscious of sin and feared divine judgement... All three believed that the world had once been better than it now was.” The Pagans, in particular, had “reverence for heroes, ancestors, and ancient lawgivers.”

That is why, in the Middle Ages, the Christian Scholastics, the Jew Maimonides, or the Muslim Avicenna, could all draw on the thought of the Pagans Plato and Aristotle; thus, they could have mutually intelligible conversations with each other, despite their exoteric differences. If you listen in on their discussions and then compare them to the one between Bishop Barron and Ben Shapiro, you cannot help but be struck by the decline in the quality of thought.

The Devil Will Find You In a podcast on *In Search of Chartres*⁴⁵, Peter Chojnowski went into a rant against **Wolfgang Smith**. He assumed

⁴⁴<https://theimaginativeconservative.org/2015/12/c-s-lewis-on-modern-man-and-his-categories-of-thought.html>

⁴⁵<https://isoc.ws>

that Dr. Smith is messing with Ouija boards, Tarot spreads, and the “intermediary realm”. Dr. Chojnowski claims that the realm is inhabited by devils. I am sure there are some aspects of Dr. Smith to be critical about, but Peter is really not capable of doing it well. I will leave him with one warning, and this applies to whoever is reading this: *The Devil will find you in whatever “realm” you think you are hiding in.* Keep your guard up.

Do What you Will

*Der Mensch kann zwar tun, was er will, aber er kann nicht wollen,
was er will.*

A man can certainly do what he wills, but he can’t will what he wills.

ARTHUR SCHOPENHAUER

If you are wondering how you can save civilization, the Saturnine philosophers are not too sanguine about your prospects. Santayana is the worst of all, believing that humans are just the playthings of material forces. Schopenhauer concedes that you can choose between a lager or an IPA, but you can’t choose not to enjoy a beer. Other than that, a blind cruel will is behind everything. Contra him, we do see pockets of order here and there.

Spinoza claims that we simply are unaware of the forces that guide out will; salvation is becoming aware of those forces. This is much more than simplistic notions of self-knowledge. For example, a man may “like” a politician and get excited about his policies. So the man thinks he knows himself. But what he does not understand is why he likes that politician. That is real self-knowledge.

Poker Training In my ideal curriculum, everyone would take a semester of poker — using your own money, of course; ideally, your tuition money to make it spicy. Then you will gain self-knowledge as well as knowledge of others. The worst players think they will hit the flush or inside straight. Although they seldom do, the thrill from doing it once is too much to resist. But, as the song says, you need to know when to hold them and when to hold them.

The same principle applies to an online argument. You need to know when you've lost an argument and give it up. The jobs always try to have the last word. There needs to be a fee to post a comment; skin in the game changes everything.

Infinity Every once in a while, I awaken in the middle of the night and contemplate infinity. Unlike a Nietzsche who believes in the infinite return of the same, I understand that the infinite has too much variety to be restricted to like that. Besides, I have a large task ahead of me that may require infinity.

You may be pleased to know that every infinite set has a subset equivalent to ω . That is, the natural numbers will belong to every possible world.

Moreover, every set can be well ordered. So just when you suppose that the chaos cannot get any worse, you are not seeing the world the way that God does.

Posted on 2021-05-02 by Cologero

* * *

N.W. Flitcraft on 2021-05-02 at 22:57 said:

I posted this on Chojnowski's blog, though I don't think it's been approved yet:

From the fact that the intermediary domain—what the Orthodox call the “aerial world”—is where the exorcist communicates with demonic entities, it does not follow that all one can say about this domain is that demons operate there. That would be like saying that because ICE

spends most of their time in Texas and Arizona, all that one will find in Texas and Arizona are illegal immigrants.

Auld Wat on 2021-05-03 at 16:36 said:

Nietzsche's concept of Eternal Return is useful as a stepping stone to greater things. Likewise Herman Hesse's *Steppenwolf* sees the infinite possibility of his personalities in the fragmented mirror. It is a recognition of a higher state of being above the monotony of eternity and the disorder of unconsciousness.

Jorgen B on 2021-05-23 at 23:29 said:

"There is nothing in an Eastern religions that cannot be found in the West"

Anything Buddhism can do NeoPlatonism can do, and since it accepts God, it can be merged with Christianity. That may be called "heresy" but its no worse than any other commonly accepted heresy; since NeoPlatonic Christianity will of necessity lead to amillenialism its much better than the dispensationalist heresy.

Dimitri on 2022-05-08 at 00:44 said:

Genuine question for any at Gornahoor that wish to respond: since we acknowledge that the so-called pagans of the past are just as integral to Western Tradition as Christianity is, and pagan religion and Christianity had become synthesized, does it follow that it is acceptable for a Christian to pray to Jove as he would to Michael, or have devotions to Ceres as they would to Mary? If these are all divinities and are all part of Western Tradition, and we are to love the pagan past, this should not be problematic, except perhaps on the exoteric level, no? What would the "Hermetic" response to this be?

Cologero on 2022-05-08 at 09:43 said:

That is not a genuine question, Dimitri, as I doubt he really gives you *agita*. Perhaps you could look up the word "past" in the dictionary, as that might help.

Dimitri on 2022-05-08 at 12:45 said:

I confess I did have to look up the meaning of "*agita*" to understand what you meant. I wouldn't know whether Olympians can provide that, as I don't pray to them myself (maybe the Romans would have disagreed?), but I do want to figure out what role they would have for us now. I'd like to think they have a place somewhere rather than just being a thing of the past. Perhaps they go by different names these days. Do forgive any perceived ignorance on my part, by the way.

5.16 White Boi Summer

“There’s no use trying,” she said: “one can’t believe impossible things.” “I daresay you haven’t had much practice,” said the Queen. “When I was your age, I always did it for half-an-hour a day. Why, sometimes I’ve believed as many as six impossible things before breakfast.”

LEWIS CARROL, *Alice in Wonderland*

For today only, believe that humanity has signed a peace accord with alien intelligences from outer space.

From Predestination to Providence Our Saturnine philosophers represent a decline: from Spinoza’s God of Reason, to Schopenhauer’s blind Will, to Santayana’s meaningless movement of matter. From the planet Saturn, looking down at the Earth, humanity seems to be driven by forces beyond their awareness or even common understanding. The philosopher can do nothing but observe detachedly from afar. But Dante reveals what lies far beyond the Sphere of Saturn: A long ladder leads to the Heavens, but his deep love for Beatrice, makes his ascent instantaneous.

Virginity . For a boy, unless he is a born saint, his plan to lose his virginity is “first available.” It is my impression, however, that a girl gives more thought to it, as to person and circumstances. Surprisingly, the decision does not necessarily depend on meeting some great love. In effect, then, the woman is the selector in the game of pseudo-Darwinian selection.

Three Initiates Rene Guenon mentions, in various essays, the works of Shankara, Ibn Arabi, and Dante as prime exemplars of initiatory texts. You would think that anyone “influenced” by Guenon or members of

the so-called “Traditionalist School” would rush out to understand those texts. I haven’t found that to be the case, however.

Understanding a Text Reading an esoteric texts requires understanding its meaning, not just the grammatical arrangement of the words. In a letter to L C d’Amiens of 26 June 1937, Guenon explains:

Reading the Quran can certainly “open” a lot of things, but, of course, on condition of being made in the Arabic text and not in translations. For this and also for some esoteric writings, this is something that has no relation to the external and grammatical knowledge of the language; I was also told the other day of the case of a Turk who admirably understood Mohyid-din Ibn Arabi, while in his life he had never been able to properly learn fluent Arabic. On the other hand, I know teachers from El Azhar (Cairo) who cannot understand a single sentence.

Statistical distribution Although metaphysical understanding never changes, that is not true of our knowledge of mathematics and physics. For example, many assume that qualities, or ideas in the Divine Mind, are unalterable in their descent into manifestation. The truth, however, is that these qualities are distributed statistically, usual as a Normal Distribution, but not always. Hence, in a given population, a quality varies both in terms of count and of intensity. Otherwise, it is difficult to understand how psychological qualities like Intelligence, the Big Five, and disorders are distributed in a population.

The Top Dog Some women are attracted to the Alpha dog and others to the rescue dog. You want the former type, since the energy between them is strong. The latter type makes her man into a “project”, but if that does not work, she becomes an SJW.

Deliverance It is important to insist that G is not proposing a new “philosophy”, or worse, a new “school of thought”. Rather, he is describing a path to Deliverance, which is unachievable just by “thinking” about it. That teaching is basically invisible to most readers. Guenon explains that the true Self transcends all states:

The being who manifests himself as a human individual in a certain state also contains the possibilities of all the other states.

Explorers of the Mind I was tempted, at one point in life, by the likes of Alan Watts, Timothy Leary, William Burroughs, and Ram Dass, by the idea that the next stage of exploration was of consciousness, since the Earth has already been explored. This led to a period of risky behaviour and involvement with some oddball people. Ultimately, I concluded that natural means are the only effective tools. Moreover, the use of any compound that darkens the Intellect is sinful, since it inhibits the single characteristic that defines the Human State.

Gnosis The Quran says, “And he who has been given hikmah (gnosis), has been given much good.” For the Christian, Gnosis is a gift of the Holy Spirit. Do not be dissuaded by those super-correct people who will call you a heretic. On the contrary, those who have been given this gift, and spurn it, are mistaken.

Christian polytheism The Trinity is a difficult doctrine, and many Christians are material polytheists without realizing it. One fellow explained that the Holy spirit is a “Being”, which is explicitly denied by the Nicene Creed. It smacks of polytheism.

The Absent Minded Professoressa Years ago, I met a college professor who, one might suppose, has a certain measure of intelligence. We

seemed to hit it off and she offered me her phone number. After a suitable interval, I called and left a message. A maelstrom erupted. She changed her phone number and reported me to the police for “harassing” her. Although I’ve known a lot of creepy guys, who actually do harass women, but in my experience, they can’t always be believed.

A Gentleman’s Knowledge The prole mind is interested in knowledge only if it has “cash value”, as William James described it. So he watches “how-to” videos on youtube. A gentleman, on the other hand, is full of general knowledge of literature, art, poetry, science, mathematics, history, metaphysics, etc. An evolutionary psychologist might say that it demonstrates that he has the intelligence and the resources to pursue such knowledge. Yet he is not a specialist in any of them, for that would make him a hedgehog and he is a fox.

Unexpected death In the olden days, an Eastern Orthodox town had a mass burial ground for foreigners, visitors, suicides, heretics, etc., who could not be buried in hallowed ground. Even those believers who died suddenly, perhaps by accident, were buried there because they did not have the benefit of a final confession and the last rites.

Living in the Fast Lane It is said that a drowning man experiences his whole past life. Rudolf Steiner provides a more interesting perspective. A man who dies a sudden or accidental death, experiences his *future* life as it may have progressed had he lived. This all happens in an instant. Perhaps he even sees his final confession and last rites.

Til Death do we part Marriage ends at death, but how many believe it? If that be true, then why do people feel bad when their spouse dies? Maybe they have been with their polar being. But there is but one Polar

Being, all others are just biding time. That is a hard teaching. But the feeling of meeting one's polar being is unforgettable.

The Prince Naida Muslić contrasts the goals of completion and perfection⁴⁶, applicable to the feminine and masculine elements respectively. The devouring mother, however, shames the daughter into perfection, which is opposed to her normal psychological development leading to completion. The perfect male (the “Prince”), on the other hand, is incomplete. In the fairy tale *Rapunzel*, the Prince finds his dream lover, but then becomes blind (i.e., unconscious), thereby losing her. When he does ultimately find her, she restores his sight, thus making him a complete being.

Leftover Scotch Do you know the feeling when you fall asleep, leaving half a glass of fine Scotch on your desk, and you awaken in the morning and think it would go good with your bowl of Cheerios, but then discover that it does not taste good because all the alcohol has evaporated?

The Human State I often enjoy the Human State and tend to spend much time there. I have learned not to take it so seriously. Yet, there is something much better, so I am now exploring the planetary and celestial spheres, with a sweet little star as a guide.

Posted on 2021-06-01 by Cologero

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Arthur Konrad on 2021-06-01 at 04:58 said:

“In effect, then, the woman is the selector in the game of pseudo-Darwinian selection.”

That would only be true if the female in the Darwinian paradigm enjoyed freedom to choose a weaker male as well. Since females never bind themselves to a loser in a duel, then the correct term for her bondage to a stronger male is “submission”, not “choice”.

⁴⁶<https://www.orphicinscendence.com/post/momma-how-could-you-do-that-to-me>

5.17 Don't be that Iguana

In metaphysical knowledge, reasoning can play no other role than that of occasional cause of intellection; the latter intervenes in a sudden, not continuous or progressive, way as soon as the mental operation, conditioned in turn by an intellectual intuition, possesses the quality or perfection that makes of it an effective symbol.

FRITHJOF SCHUON

In the two days of winter that we had this weekend, the headlines were about cold-blooded iguanas going comatose and falling out of trees. The news stations were telling people how to care for the shivering iguanas.

I say that they are pests and should be killed on sight, humanely, of course, with an air rifle. They are not a native species and they alter the ecosystem in unnatural ways. The state condones and encourages that policy. Intelligence sometimes requires a Machiavellian attitude.



Talk talk There are three ways to look at the political systems of the world. It is important to grasp the essences of things rather than manifestations.

The traditional view is that evil resides in men's souls; nothing will improve unless people make efforts to live virtuous lives.

The essence of Liberalism is that talk and rational discussion will lead to social improvement.

The essence of socialism is that people are born good but society makes them bad. The "means of production" standard just misses the point. Many people materially hold this view without realizing it. For

example, they may blame social media, or Hollywood, etc., and assume society would improve by eliminating them.

I say: In a traditional society everyone has a place and the social group has cohesion. People are not constantly blaming the “system” for personal problems.

There is no evidence that discussion has converged to a common world view and likewise no expectation that such a situation will ever come to pass. There are many obstacles to rational discussion. At that point, a spiritual authority, who knows the truth, must step in to settle the dispute.

If that fails, then the political power must step in with force, if necessary, only as a last resort.

Choosing and Willing Thomas Aquinas makes a distinction between choosing and willing⁴⁷. Willing comes from a deep part of ourselves: we will the good, happiness, knowledge, being close to God, protecting one’s family, etc. Those are all legitimate aims and represents our True Will.

Choosing means to select the means to achieve what one wills. The choice may or may not be “free”. This is the gnostic will which deliberates courses of action. Clearly, the best choice is the one that fulfills one’s true Will. A choice is not free when it arises from ignorance, unexamined impulses, social pressures, and so on.

The Moral Burden The IYIs (Intelligent yet idiot) assert, without any proof or evidence, that religions were invented by the people to give them assurance and peace of mind. Only a peer of a Tolkien can create such a complex world as are the major religions, and they are quite rare. The religions themselves claim to be founded by great spiritual leaders: the rishis of the Vedas, Zoroaster, Moses, Jesus, or Mohammed. That makes

⁴⁷<https://iteadthomam.blogspot.com/2020/06/are-will-and-free-will-synonymous-in-st.html>

more sense and cannot be so easily dismissed. The greatest religions create lasting civilizations.

The metaphysical teachings, therefore, are very important because they demonstrate that there is a world view contrary to physicalism, consistent with itself, and common to the major religious traditions. That is the essence; the outer differences can be handled in a different way.

Moreover, the threat of Hell is the opposite of the “pie in the sky when you die” attitude. Atheists concede that their conversion to atheism lifts a huge moral burden off them. So that is the essence of atheism; it is an immoral position, not an intelligent system of thought.

Solidified Intelligence With technology, the intelligence of a very few can be shared by the masses. Obvious examples include cell phones, computers, automobiles, and on and on. Very few know how any of those things work. When Rome fell to the goths, the knowledge of building aqueducts, hot baths, roads, etc., as well as administering a vast empire was lost. We know the results.

Even everyday tasks, that used to require actual intelligence, Sailing, which used to require difficult navigation skills, now relies on GPS and google maps. Tuning a violin used to rely on a tuning fork and a feel for fifths, now can be done with a device that measures the actual frequency of the string.

Artificial Intelligence As an alternative to authority and coercion, some believe that Artificial Intelligence can be used to rule society. There are many obstacles. AI does not know essences, only facts. So a human still has to program the AI to achieve a certain goal. Then the algorithm can analyze data to best achieve that goal.

Unfortunately, there are several limiting theorems, including:

- Gödel's theorem. There may be desirable outcomes that the AI cannot prove.

- No free lunch theorem:⁴⁸ There is no single algorithm that will work best in all scenarios
- Kraitichik's paradox:⁴⁹ A situation may arise in which both options appear equally good. Then the algorithm will go into an infinite loop because it cannot decide.

Thinking and Being No matter how many times, and in how many ways, the distinction between thinking and being seems difficult for some people to make. They get stuck in a thought loop, quoting disparate authors, trying to resolve apparent contradictions in a verbal way. It cannot be done. Understanding arises only when thinking and one's state of being coincide.

Recently I bought an iguana trap. I put some enticing food in it, better than what they eat in the wild. An iguana approached the trap. He could see and smell the food, so he tried to get at it, from the side. He kept bumping into the cage over and over again. Finally, in frustration, he walked away, leaving the food behind.

He did not realize that his entire approach was wrong. All he had to do was find the front of the cage, walk right in and be fed.

Don't be that iguana.

The Cloud of Unknowing I often recommend the *Cloud of Unknowing* for those getting starting in spiritual life. Its technique is to meditate on a simple word or phrase, like "love" or "God". Unspiritual men believe that the darkness can be cleared away by thinking, but the author of the *Cloud of Unknowing* claims otherwise:

⁴⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/No_free_lunch_in_search_and_optimization

⁴⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Two_envelopes_problem

For the first time you lift your heart to God with stirrings of love, you will find only a darkness, and as it were, a cloud of unknowing. Whatever you do, this darkness and the cloud are between you and your God, and hold you back from seeing him clearly by the light of understanding in your reason and from experiencing him in the sweetness of love in your feelings. And so prepare to remain in this darkness as long as you can, always begging for him you love; for if you are ever to feel or see him, it must always be in this cloud and this darkness.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RFfVd_pj fMg

Posted on 2022-02-03 by Cologero

5.18 The Secret Garden

To know is to remember: let us therefore remember together, immortal Souls, who on earth sigh for Man's celestial kingdom, and desire the divinity of life.

SAINT-YVES D'ALVEYDRE

Poem by Soloviev

Dear Friend, don't you see
That all we see is only
A reflection and shadow
Of what cannot be seen?

Dear friend, don't you hear
That this discordant roar is
Only a distorted echo
Of joyous harmonies?

Living by one's choices A man lives or dies by his decisions. He accepts the rewards or consequences, and neither rejoices nor cries about the outcome.

Secret Thoughts He is out every day, as is she, doing her chores. She looks longingly thinking he would never accept her. He stares wondering how to approach her. Her secret thoughts, the walls are high to protect them.

She: I hear the birds sing of love, too, I look at the cloudless sky and watch the shepherd guide his herd into the neighbor's garden, I feel the sun, the passion and I can't stop thinking of you. You are everywhere.

World Without Love Too often, one fantasizes about the circumstances — time, place, etc. — where love can be found. The one fails to seize the opportunity when it presents itself, since it does not resemble the fantasy.

In the novel *Zanoni*, Mejnour and Zanoni were initiates who knew the secret to eternal life. Mejnour was living forever, although he was nobody in particular, moving around to no place special. But his student, Zanoni, fell in love with a mortal woman. He then had to make the choice to live at a particular time and place with one special woman. For that one love, he gave up his immortality.

The lesson is that one moment of love is preferable to eternity without love. How many people live a life without love? More than you know.

Living with Mystery

All that He wrought among men, all that He said and suffered,
He disposed in such wise that not a single moment was passed
without mystery, not a single letter was devoid of some mystery.

ST. BERNARD, *Sermon III on Palm Sunday*

Sacred History

Historical facts conform to the law of correspondence, and thereby translate higher realities, of which they are a human expression. It is this that gives to these facts their significance. This symbolical character is bound to be particularly clearcut in the case of events connected with sacred history; thus it is recognizable in a most striking way, in all the circumstances of the life of Christ.

If the foregoing has been properly grasped, it will at once be apparent not only that there is no reason for denying the reality of these events and treating them as mere myths, but on the contrary that these events had to be such as they were, and could not have been otherwise; it is clearly impossible to attribute a sacred character to something devoid of all transcendent significance.

RENE GUENON, *Symbolism of the Cross*

Changing the Past The demon appeared to three monks and He told them: if I gave them power to change something from the past, what would they change?

The first of them, with great apostolic fervor, replied: “I would prevent you from making Adam and Eve fall into sin so that humanity could not turn away from God.”

The second, a man full of mercy, said to him: “I would prevent you from God and you will condemn yourself eternally”.

The third of them was the simplest and, instead of responding to the tempter, he got on his knees, made the sign of the cross and prayed saying: “Lord, free me from the temptation of what could be and was not”.

The devil, giving a raucous cry and shuddering with pain, vanished.

The other two, surprised, said to him: “Brother, why have you reacted like this?”

He replied: “First: we must NEVER dialogue with the enemy. Second: NOBODY in the world has the power to change the past. Third: Satan’s INTEREST was not to prove our virtue, but to trap us in the past, so that we neglect the present, the only time in that God gives us His grace and we can cooperate with it to fulfill His will “.

Of all the demons, the one that catches the most men and prevents them from being happy is that of “What could have been and was not”.

The past is left to the mercy of God and the future to his Providence. Just the present it’s in our hands. “Live today”

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jR1gerSNTYk>

Posted on 2022-06-12 by Cologero

Contributions from other authors

6.1 Christmas Message (2007)

What message should I give for Him Who is the Eternal One?

He as God alone exists. There is only One Who exists eternally; not many, but One. No one else exists. Whatever appears as existing exists in non-existence. Manyness comes because of the dream, that is, ignorance. It is the shadow of Truth.

So what is this Creation?

Creation is that which was created in order for God to know the answer to the question, “Who am I?”

When God was in the Beyond-Beyond state, He had neither consciousness nor unconsciousness. Suddenly, the Whim came: “Who am I?”

And what happened because of that?

As soon as that Whim, “Who am I?” came in the Infinite Ocean, innumerable drops emerged from it to find out who they were. First, they entered into the mental sphere, then the subtle sphere and finally the gross sphere. So we have come down with the gross, subtle and mental

worlds within us. But the drops had no consciousness. The Whim was in every drop, but actually, the drops were not there. It was the Ocean.

But for the Ocean to know itself as the Ocean, the drop has to experience the dream. In this dream, whatever you see yourself as being, you believe that you are that.

Mind was created, and energy was created, to play their roles in Creation in order to give the reply to the question, "Who am I?"

And because of that, mind (which is illusory and within the drop) starts working.

In the gross sphere, there are seven kingdoms: gas-stone-metal, vegetable, worm and insect, fish; bird, animal and human being.

Mind and energy do not develop in the stone kingdom. But in the vegetable kingdom, we find energy starting to develop, because a vegetable needs water, manure, light and air. Then comes the kingdom of worms and insects. Worms have movement. If you try to catch one, it runs away.

Why?

Because mind is developing. In this way, energy and mind go on developing and developing in the fish, bird, animal and human kingdom.

Actually, the Ocean is every form in each kingdom, but to the drop, all forms look like drops. The Ocean asks, "Who am I?"

And each drop says, "I am a stone, I am a vegetable, I am a worm, I am a fish, I am a bird, I am an animal. I am a human being."

If you try to count the species and varieties in every kingdom, you will find that they are innumerable. But this is all a dream.

So you may say, "God has a dream in order to find out the Real Answer to the Real Question, "Who am I?"

After ages and ages and ages of passing through all the kingdoms of the gross sphere, you come into human form. The impressions of the last gorilla form come with you, and in human form, reincarnation as a human being starts. Mind and energy are fully developed. You have passed through all the lower kingdoms, and now you experience gross

consciousness in the gross sphere. You take the form of a man, the form of a woman. Sometimes you are born poor, sometimes rich. Sometimes you are a king, sometimes beggar. Sometimes you are in this country, sometimes in another. It goes on and on.

You say, “I am this, or I am that.” But you realize that these are not the Real Answer to the Whim, the question, “Who am I?”

Earth is very close to the Creation Point. Though the gross sphere is the seventh shadow of the Truth, God, this seventh shadow is infinite. In it, there are different planets. On some, there is only stone; on others, there are stones and vegetables and on others, stones, vegetables and insects.

And on 18,000 of these planets, human beings live. However, on these planets, there is only mental development, no development of the heart. The earth is the only planet upon which human beings can get the Real Answer to the Whim, “Who am I?”

After you achieve human form, it takes ages to enter in the subtle sphere. You pass through eight billion four hundred thousand births and deaths before your progress enough to enter into the subtle sphere. When you enter into the subtle sphere, you forget the gross sphere and experience energy.

Every night when we sleep, we dream. Sometimes we dream that we are kings and have big kingdoms. When we dream this, we enjoy! Sometimes we dream that we are beggars. And then we suffer.

But happiness and suffering and misery are all just a dream. They are not real.

The dream world that we experience when we sleep is the first part of the first plane of the subtle sphere. We pass through it whenever we sleep. At the time, we don’t know that we are dreaming. But when we wake up, then we know that it was a dream.

And what are we passing through for ages and ages?

Nothing but the dream, Illusion. God alone exists. Nothing exists

besides God. But we have to experience Illusion in order to find out the Real Answer to the Whim, “Who am I?”

In the second plane of the subtle sphere are the hell and heaven states. They are but dreams into a dream. When we collect good impressions, we feel happy. When we drop our body, we go into either heaven or hell. If we have more good impressions than bad, then we enjoy the heaven state, in which the body is not there, but the soul, mind and energy are.

Say, for example, you enjoy liquor. When the gross medium of the body is no longer there, the impressions of liquor are still with you. When you are in heaven and a thought of liquor comes, you have thousands of times more enjoyment than when you are in a gross form.

In this way, in the heaven state, you spend good impressions quickly. But what happens?

Suppose you have one billion good impressions and have spent all but sixty million of them. You also have forty million bad impressions. You are nearing equality, or a balance of good and bad impressions. If good impressions and bad impressions equalize, you get liberation. But this never happens. Before you come to the point of equality, you become free and come into the body again. You take birth, and now you bring fifty million good and forty million bad impressions with you.

So in this life, we are spending our past impressions, and while we are, we create new ones. But we don’t spend the impressions that we create in this birth. They are for the next life. This goes on and on. We spend the grossness of these good and bad impressions until equality comes.

Then we enter into the subtle sphere. Because of gross consciousness, you see the world and time and space. But as soon as you enter into the subtle world, there is no time and no space. We enter into subtle sphere when we don’t create new impressions and are only spending past ones. Still, we see the dream. The dream continues, but it becomes subtle, and in the subtle world, we experience energy.

Anyone in the subtle world is not attached to the gross sphere. In the

subtle world you have only subtle impressions. In this world, there are only subtle thoughts and subtle desires. Any action you perform is not gross, but subtle.

From the subtle sphere, we enter into the mental sphere, where there are only mental thoughts, not subtle or gross ones. If you are in the mental planes, you remain mentally conscious. You have no attachment to the gross or subtle. You are completely detached.

Those in the subtle and mental spheres may eat, but they cannot create gross thoughts. They remain detached from the physical body. Someone in the mental world knows the thoughts of everyone, even in different countries. When they sit here in India, they see the thoughts of everyone in the world. They do not have to remember them; they just know.

There was a mast here at Meherabad, Mohammed. Baba had taken him to France, and when he returned, Mohammed would say, "I want to go to France! Take me to France!"

He went on saying this until the Second World War took place. Nobody can understand what work Baba had given to him during this war.

After his return from France with Baba, Mohammed would often say about a servant who took care of him, "I want to marry that one. I want to marry her."

Every day, he would catch hold of her hand, saying, "I will marry you." Sometimes he would not let go of her hand for hours together.

People would call Mohammed "Deva," and at the time, Sidhu was looking after him. Sidhu would say, "Deva, leave her, because her children are hungry. She has to cook food for them."

With great difficulty, Mohammed would release her hand and say, "Go and cook food for your children."

This would go on every day. When Baba would go to see him, Mohammed would still hold on to her hand, saying, "I want to marry her."

Baba would smile and laugh. "Allow her to go," Baba would tell Mo-

hammered. "Her children are very small, and they must be waiting for food."

Then Mohammed would release her.

Mohammed was a mast of the fifth plane, the mental plane, so he did not have gross thoughts or gross desires. Those on the mental planes do not have such thoughts or desires, and they cannot do any physical action. Their actions are non-action.

The sixth plane of the mental sphere is the plane where you see only the effulgence, the Light, of God. When you see this, you want to become One with the Light. Your longing increases infinitely.

As soon as you cross the mental plane into the seventh plane, mind is annihilated. Then you know Who you are. The "I am God" state is experienced. You experience All-Knowledge, All-Power and All-Bliss. That is the goal of life.

So Creation is there in order to for each drop of the Infinite Ocean to experience God.

There are always five Perfect Masters who have-God consciousness as well as consciousness of Creation. This is under the Divine Plan and follows Divine Law. But they cannot give a Universal Push to the world or anyone in it. So when consciousness in the gross sphere remains suspended, the Ancient One has to come down upon earth. Age after age, He comes down, and He gives a Universal Push, a push to all the seven kingdoms from stone to human being.

You must have read the story about Adam and Eve. Both were in Paradise, and there was a particular tree, the fruit of which was prohibited. No one should eat it. But one day, what happened?

The serpent persuaded Eve to pluck the fruit from the prohibited tree, and she gave that fruit to Adam. Adam ate it, and when he did, God got very angry, and threw them out of Paradise.

What a beautiful story it is. It is about the beginning of Creation and how it was created. Who was Adam?

Adam was the first one you read about in GOD SPEAKS: God was neither conscious nor unconscious. Then He got the Whim, “Who am I?”

That is why God in that state started searching, why Creation took place and why evolution and involution began.

Adam and Eve were God. Eve was the shadow of God, and Adam was God Himself. People say, “He was a very bad man. He ate the fruit from a prohibited tree!”

But no one knows the essence of this story. Adam is the Ancient One who comes down on earth, age after age, to help the universe. In every religion His Name is different, His face is different, and the place where He comes is different, but He is One and the same Adam Who comes down on earth age after age. He is the Saviour of Creation.

Another story given by Baba was entitled, “The Mischievous Chicken.”

He also told different stories about the Creation. You can read them in THE NOTHING AND THE EVERYTHING.

God is not different. God is infinitely One, indivisible. God cannot be divided – it is mind that divides the Ocean into every drop, that is, everyone and everything in the Creation.

Because the Whim, “Who am I?,” is always there, each drop is searching for God unconsciously. One day, after crossing the seven kingdoms of the evolution of consciousness and six kingdoms of the involution of consciousness, you reach the seventh plane. Mind is annihilated, and you know Who you are.

The Divine Plan and Divine Law are under Him, and He always remains in Paradise, having Infinite Knowledge, Infinite Power and Infinite Bliss. He lives on the seventh plane, and though He does not have Creation consciousness except when He comes down upon the earth, He remains eternally connected with each individual eternally. He is duty bound to take everyone and everything towards God.

When Jesus said, “My father and I are One,” nobody understood

Him because the situation then was quite different. During His crucifixion, He said, "O Father, forgive them all, who know not what they are doing."

He would always tell people, "I am the Son of My Father." At the time people, were so engrossed in rituals and ceremonies that even the Ancient One would not utter before their ignorance, "I am God."

The same thing happened in the time of Prophet Mohammed. He said, "I am the Messenger of God."

But God is infinite and indivisible. He is All-Eternal. It is God Who alone exists, and nothing exists besides God. Whatever appears as existing exists in non-existence.

And now again, I say about Lord Jesus:

He took birth, and He was crucified for the world. He is birthless and He is deathless, but when He comes down on earth, His birth is for the universe. When His work is completed in the gross sphere, He drops the body. He is the only Sustainer, and He lives in everyone and everything. But when ignorance goes on increasing and increasing, He has to come down on earth in order to lead human beings this from ignorance and push the progress of consciousness toward Reality.

What message should I give to you about Lord Jesus?

We need His help all the time, and we always must seek His help to find Him in His true form. He is always the same: Zoroaster, Ram, Krishna, Buddha, Jesus, Prophet Mohammed and now Meher Baba. This is the end of the cycle of cycles, and Meher Baba is the last One of this cycle. Now a new cycle will begin after His Universal Manifestation. The world will be awakened, and a new cycle will begin.

For Lord Jesus, whose birthday and New Year we are celebrating, I say:

May Beloved Lord Jesus help us all, so that we forget the beginning and end of Creation and know our Real state.

May He guide us at every step of our life towards Him.

May He keep our path clear so that we proceed towards Him without any hindrance by the unwanted impressions that we create every day.

May the Lord give us inner strength so that we become blind to Creation and see only Him and Him alone as infinite.

May He awaken us so that we depend upon Him fully at our every step and take any step only according to His Divine Wish.

May the Lord give us that longing to awaken us towards Him. May we come to know that we never took birth, and we never died, and the births and deaths which we have passed through were all mere illusion, the dream.

May Lord Jesus make us His slave so that we become free from anger, lust, temptation, greed, selfishness and all desires and wants in order to lead our life for Him and remain awakened towards Him.

O Lord, listen to our prayers. We are ignorant and you are the only One who can give us awakening. Only You can make us free from ignorance. You are the only One who can make us free from all rituals, ceremonies, customs and religious limits. Only You can give us the awakening that we are all One and that some day, we become One and realize that from the beginning until the end, we were One, but because of the play of Illusion, we found divisions and were surrounded by hatred and all low desires.

May the Lord give us that awakening in order that we do not become the prey of ignorance so that He may not suffer for us. May the Lord be with us in such a way that we know that the Lord is with us and that we follow His pleasure.

I pray to the Lord for you all — my mothers, fathers, sisters and brothers. Our Lord is One, and we should not make divisions because of ignorance. Everything happens according to the Divine Plan, but everything does not happen according to His Divine Wish. And therefore, we must follow His Divine Wish with all love, not in a ritualistic way.

O Lord, I bow down to you in such a way that I should not lift my

head from Your feet, but remain there until this mind goes away and I forget all the differences and remain One with Beloved God.

In my 2006 Christmas message to all you dear ones, I wrote about Ravana and Rama. Below is a “Letter of Ravana to Rama” which was given to me by dear Falu Mistry from Meherazad. The source is unknown (perhaps not from the Ramayana itself). But the letter from the dead Demon King to the Avatar who killed him, Rama, also beautifully illustrates that God alone exists.

THE LETTER OF RAVANA TO RAMA

Rama stood alone over the corpse of the Demon King, Ravana. There was no one else about, nothing stirred.

Sukha, the Raksha Minister walked straight to Rama and handed Him a sealed letter. “For you from the dead King..

Rama cracked open the stone envelope with his strong hands. He looked at the letter awhile, then turned to Suka. “Ah my friend,” said Rama fondly. “Listen:

“Lord Naryana, you are the witness, you make the moon walk in brightness and the stars vanish in the daylight.

“Dear Rama, Lord of the Worlds, think and remember, how you promised Indra to kill me forever. Nothing is forever except for Yourself. Except by dying at Your hand, how else could I make You take me into Your Own Self?

“I was only a Rakshasa, and You were very hard to approach. Yet seeking wisdom, I learned many things. You do not know Who You are again. I knew it all along, but even still You do not know. Nothing You do ever fails. One glance of Yours, and people sing again the good old songs.

“I took no protection against men. You go everywhere and know everything that ever has or ever will be done. How was I careless? I was nowhere careless! O Narayana, lo, I looked, I marveled. Men are mines.

Men are precious mines. O Rama, did you think that dark was bad?

“You see whatever happens, and You support all creatures. I saw that Heaven was impermanent, and Hell itself did not endure. I discovered that the time of every life is one day full, and I found how all creatures that are separate from You are ever and again reborn, over and over, always changing. I do not love things that come and go and slip away with Time, and Time himself I hate. I warned him when we first met, that I took him for my enemy. I told him so.

“Best of men, there are many kinds of Love. I never hurt her. I kept Lakshmi to lure you here. I offered you my life and you accepted it.

“You are Narayana who moves on the waters. You flow through us all. You are Rama and Sita born out of Earth and Ravana the Demon King. You are Hanuman like the wind. You are Lakshmana like a mirror; you are Indrajit and Indra. You are the Poet and the Players and the Play. Born as a man, You forget this. You lose the memory, and take on man’s ignorance again, as You will, every time.

“Therefore welcome back your Sita. The war is done, and so we close our letter.”

Dear ones of Beloved Avatar Meher Baba, every day is Christmas. During this season we call Christmas, we eat, drink and make merry, but we forget Him. There is nothing wrong in enjoying the food, drink and merry-making, but never forget Him. Remember Him. Remember Beloved Meher Baba, Who was once born as Jesus Christ and Who comes again and again as the same Ancient One.

AVATAR MEHER BABA KI JAI!

With all love and Jai Baba to you,

In His love and service

Bhau Kalchuri

Posted on 2008-01-02 by Isabeau

* * *

SoldaTheero on 2010-10-22 at 23:27 said:

What an excellent synopsis of Meher's teachings and what an awesome Christmas message I will be sure to read this again come Christmas. Jai Baba

BTW I stumbled upon this site a year or so ago while researching something besides Meher, I believe anyhow. & Now I see you also are aware of Meher Baba. :)

Cologero on 2010-10-23 at 12:57 said:

"Isabeau" has her own blog now.

Please visit *Contessa Isabella Vacani*¹ for more of her writings.

6.2 How the Angel Gal-el became Gloria, the Christmas Angel

The tiny angel Gal-el embraced the fetus. It could feel its heart thumping with fear. The voices of the nurses in the room increased their intensity inside its mother's watery womb.

"Honey, don't you worry. The thing in there, won't feel a thing it will go to sleep and never wakeup," one of the younger nurses reassured the woman with child.

"The Doctor and the rest of us just want to make sure that you intend to go through with this abortion. Our psychiatrist has prepared some papers for you to sign," declared the Head Nurse.

The fetus flung its arms wide. The angel Gal-el enfolded the fetus unto itself.

"She is going to kill me for no reason. You know that. She changed her mind about me."

¹<http://isabellavacani.blogspot.com>

“What are you telling me?” asked the 25-year-old mother with a quivering voice.

“Just that you waited a long time before deciding on an abortion. You must know that it’s a boy and about five and a half months old. It’s perfectly formed. It’s an illegal procedure. You must be aware of that too. Without the signed statement from our eminent Psychiatrist and countersigned by you, you’ll leave this clinic still pregnant,” the Head Nurse made no attempt to hide her irritation.

I hate these bitches. She probably decided to take up surfboarding or dressage. She wants an abortion now Next week it might be botox or cosmetic surgery. They are all operations right? So why am I here? Because I am way over my head in debt and I have three children to support.

“O Gal-el, I don’t want to die? Why did God bring me all the way here only to stand by and watch me die before I even go down the birth canal into the light?”

‘I don’t know baby dear. Remember that your body might die but your soul and spirit will live and I am sure that you will come back to earth through another baby.”

“Will it be soon?”

“I don’t know my Beloved,” replied the angel sadly.

Suddenly the fetus began to kick and flail as hard as he could. The amniotic fluid created strong waves within the placenta, which then reverberated into the abdominal walls and muscles.

“I am a human being. A person. An individual full of promise. I don’t want to be thrown into the trashcan like a dead rat. You are going to kill me. You are a murderer and you don’t even know it,”

The mother felt the kicks and stifled a gasp. The nurses saw it at once because there were continuous ripples going through her abdomen.

“That a very active baby you have there. We don’t want to rush you but our waiting list is awesome,” declared the Obstetrician entering the room.

He was holding an injection. "I am going to inject this through your abdominal walls. It is painless for the fetus and for you. Well, you might feel a little discomfort but nothing more."

It was a poison designed expressly to kill the fetus swiftly yet painfully.

He stepped aside to allow the Head Nurse to hand over the authorization papers for the illegal abortion to the patient. She had attached the document to a clipboard. She signed it in silence.

The kicking went on unabated. The mother gasped again. "Is there something wrong with the baby?"

"It's just doing what comes naturally, kicking and flexing its muscles," replied the Doctor soothingly as the toxic fluid slowly entered the uterus and found its target, the fetus.

"My angel, where are you. I can't see and I can't hear. My legs and arms are numb. I can't move. I can't cry out. But you can read my thoughts," said the nameless creature of God.

"I am next to you and I am holding both of your beautifully formed hands. You can feel my presence. God has given me the power to do that. I will not leave you. I am going to walk you through the death pangs. Then I will make sure that your spirit and soul follow the bright path towards the great and immeasurable cosmos."

Then the tiny angel Gal-el prayed: "O Powers of the Universe, I bring you yet another innocent being slaughtered. Dull his pain as the nurses dismember his arms and legs to pull and wrench him out of the canal of Death. Archangel Metatron, Protector of children, even those yet to be born and those destined not to be, welcome him with open arms for he has fought valiantly to live and fulfill his destiny but it was not to be."

The nurses tugged and pulled and threw the pieces of the lovely boy who would never be into a tall metal can lined in thick plastic. They closed their eyes as they did so. There were too many well-formed bodies piled up one on top of another.

"Don't look down sweet baby, your place is among the galaxies," ad-

monished Gal-el.

“There must be countless millions of us. Helpless before these never-ending massacres. Does this not cry out for vengeance?” exclaimed the soul of the fetus.

“The Laws of the Universe are harsh but they are not vindictive. They are Karmic not vengeful. For many of those mothers they will remember to their dying moment the exact day you were untimely ripped from their wombs. Children who would have been around your same age in the parks or playgrounds or in the streets will stab them with pangs of regret over. Too late, you are all gone forever. They will weep and agonize all of their lives alone and by themselves. For who can they confide this terrible anguish?”

The spirit of the murdered fetus understood and he uttered a silent prayer of forgiveness for his poor mother who would know what true desolation was in her heart of hearts for this wicked deed.

The Archangel Metatron was waiting for baby 370 million and three hundred thousand.

“Welcome to your very own Kingdom of the Innocents. Jesus visits this place often. He loves you all more than he loved his Apostles, if that is possible. Your name is Adventalius, for you came to us during the period of Advent. Everyone here has his or her own original name. We are angels after all and therefore, powerful and original beings.”

Gal-el wept tears of joy for Adventalius. But then the angel remembered that its duties consisted of serving as guardian angel to those who would never be born. This boy had been singularly brave. He never despaired. He was full of joy and gladness. His spirit flew away with a lightness he had rarely seen.

Christmas Eve would soon come to planet Earth, and the thought of acting as guide to a bright and unblemished tiny piece of God who would soon be eliminated with less kindness than poisoning a rat filled Gal-el with more sadness than he could bear. So out of sight of everyone,

Gal-el wept long and bitter tears.

“Why must I and my companions always be the same ones to bring the unwanted and murdered fetuses towards the Light? I am afraid that it has become too much for me to bear. I realize that the cross Jesus carried for humans must have been excruciating. That’s why he fell three times and in the end, the Romans commanded several strong men to help him uphill with his cross. I am only a tiny guardian angel of fetuses. I fear that I have been drained of all force.”

All the angels listened to the deep laments of Gal-el. They understood the emotions piercing it. Among the guardian angels of the unborn, Gal-el was the most ancient. Since Assyrian-Babylonian times Gal-el had been their Accompanist and Guide.

Time in the Universe is but a flash of light or a blink of God’s eye. Five thousand years of looking after dead unborn babies was a different matter. That was enough.

“Perhaps on Christmas Eve, we could send Gal-el to a newly conceived being? It’s parents prayed and longed for a child of their own for years. They have six adopted children of all colors and creeds,” declared Metatron gazing into the deepest sky blue eyes of the Archangel Rafael.

“I concur. This little being’s mother sings in Saint Paul’s Choir in London. She has a fine contralto voice. On Christmas Eve during the Midnight Mass she will sing the Gloria in Excelsis Deo. Glory to God in the highest. Yes! By all means. Let’s send Gal-el to look after the fetus until she or he is born and stay till death separates them,” replied the Archangel Rafael.

“It is a wonderful idea. To reward Gal-el for the difficult assignments throughout the millennia, the angel shall henceforth be known as Gloria,” decreed the One Cosmic Force of the Universe.

The Archangels Metatron, Michael, and Rafael hastened to give the beautiful news to Gal-el.

“From this day forward, you will be known as Gloria. You will be the

guardian angel of a child that will see the light of day. You will remain with the newly conceived being until it is called back into the fold of the Universe when its time on earth is ended.”

The angel now known as Gloria knelt and exclaimed “O Glory to God in the Highest.”

Posted on 2008-01-02 by Isabeau

* * *

Barnabas on 2026-04-25 at 23:07 said:
Beautiful

6.3 The Fog Travelers

There is an episode in the *Neverending Story*² about people who sail an ocean of fog. They steer their ship by a collective chant and their collective will. They don’t have names nor do they ever do anything as individuals. Bastian feels attracted to this life at first, because he had become the strongest and best in everything — thus he felt very lonely.

But then he witnesses the sudden disappearance of certain crew members on the ship — they are taken by a giant crow. Nobody is interested in the missing people, the remaining crew members don’t even notice that people are missing! He starts feeling uneasy and realizes that what he is looking for is not losing himself in anonymity, but rather the desire of being recognized and loved for who he is. He then leaves the people of fog travelers to look for that love.

I’m mentioning this, because sometimes I get the feeling that no matter how brilliant and intelligent people are, there is a tremendous fear

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_Neverending_Story

of saying something “wrong”, not as a simple mistake, but to reveal a thought that comes from somewhere other than the source of the chants of the fog travelers. Something beyond the fog, where you don’t just wander around in other people’s thoughts and deal with, or ignore, what “happens”, but rather create a thought that breathes away the fog.

This clinging to the fog may be the only way for the fog travelers, because their survival depends on their collective will to navigate the fog. But you know I was in love with “Bastian” as a girl and I did understand his desire to move beyond what everybody else was “singing”.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LHytjEj7B9g>

Posted on 2022-07-17 by Sibylle

* * *

Balder on 2022-07-19 at 08:27 said:

Only an awakened person can breathe the fog away. The thing is, first you have to pass through the inner fog before you can sing another song apart from the collective.

Balder on 2022-07-19 at 08:30 said:

This came to mind also:

“It is certainly a good idea to plead to reason and common sense, but what if you’re audience is in the midst of a collective psychosis?”

– C.G. Jung

Arthur Konrad on 2022-07-24 at 18:18 said:

Things that I’ve clamored for were often ushered in on a white horse right in front of my face, but it made no difference because I was hopelessly self-absorbed. Perhaps everything that is ‘wasted’ in life too has some sort of redeeming power. I honestly admire attentive people, the kind of people who are not content to sit by when important things are taking place.

I loved, and will always love Mary.

The New Decameron

7.1 The Hyperborean Saga

Love is but a Dream The monk confesses his sin and reveals the secret of love to the Kid.

“Hey, kid, I’m back.”

“Tell me how I can get rid of you.”

“You can’t ... I need you to help me get back to earth.”

“But, that’s not something I’m looking forward to. Why is your torment suddenly my torment?”

“Maybe you can avoid what happened to me.”

“What harm can a butterfly do ... sounds like there is more to this story.”

“Yes, there is more that arose from my monastery experience.”

“Sounded like a good position to me. Why would you blow it like that?”

“How naïve you are. There is much more to Tantra than your little mind imagines.”

“Trust me, my imagination is pretty good.”

"The Dalai Lama kept instilling in us the need to be totally indifferent to our Tantra practice. As an example, he said that a meal of crap with a glass of pus should be as appetizing to us as the finest meal."

"I know which I would choose."

"Alas, I know what I chose. I did the unthinkable and fell in love with a beautiful nun named Leonora"

"No wonder they never made a movie of your life."

"This is no joke. I took a vow of indifference and it was a bad example to the novices. That is why I hoped that math and physics would clear up my mind. Alas, it didn't work so I was forced into this series of incarnations."

"So have they served to subdue your ardor?"

"Quite the contrary, it has only increased. As a toad, I kept dreaming she would be the princess that came to rescue me. And then I thought she was the geisha girl ... so close yet so unapproachable. And now, where they incarnated me, there is no hope of seeing her again. Yet, strangely, I have not yet lost the power of being happy from my thoughts of her."

"Interesting. Then which is sweeter, to see your beloved or to think of her?"

"That's hard to say. When I was physically with her, she seemed a woman; from a distance, she appears to me to be a goddess."

"How does that work." He was finally sounding a little interesting to me.

"These goddesses are so considerate, that whenever one of them approaches a mortal man, she doffs her divinity, hiding her halo in her pocket, in order not to dazzle the mortal who stands before her."

"I hear you. Don't you see that as a fault of women, that they are so different from what we imagine them to be?"

"Son, is it their fault that they are made of flesh and blood and not of nectar and ambrosia? Which amongst the ten thousand things possesses even a shadow of the perfection you imagine women to have? You have

no such illusions about men—do you?— who are so often of little worth. Why would you expect women to be angels?”

“I’m beginning to understand. There is someone I, too, am dying to see and speak to again.”

“Ah, tonight I will bring her to you in your dream. She shall be so beautiful and courteous that you will take courage and speak to her much more freely and readily than you have ever spoken to her before. You will be satisfied with the sweetness that will fill your soul. And tomorrow, whenever you think of this dream, you will feel your heart overflowing with tenderness.”

“Is that a consolation? A dream in exchange for truth!”

“Between knowing the truth and the dream there is only this difference, that the dream is always many times sweeter and more beautiful than the truth can ever be.”

“So is the dreamed pleasure then as good as a real pleasure?”

“It is. I know of a monk who, after his lover appeared to him in a dream, the whole next day he avoided meeting her and seeing her, because he knew that the real lady couldn’t compare with the dream image. Reality would deprive him of the extraordinary delight the dream gave.”

“I don’t know whether to thank you for this advice or throw you into the microwave!”

With apologies to Giacomo Leopardi¹

Posted on 2011-11-08 by Cologero

* * *

Alistair Fraser on 2015-10-22 at 18:16 said:

Quite beautifully elaborated cologero , and it is true about the dream for all , i fear, but always fighting against that fearwith constant and more demanding demands from the spontaneous activities ! (;

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=25>

Rodolfo Arévalo Pedrín on 2018-11-08 at 19:19 said:

Can't say I would second any of the monks notions. Im a Perfmperfectologist, im not making any sense I just wanted to say reading this was a pleasure, very good.

Loving an Earth Girl Three heads are better than one, if you get my drift.

I didn't hear from my strange conversation partner for several weeks, though I became obsessed with the ideas he had left me. "A dream in exchange for truth!" he had told me. Yet, how I treasured my dreams. Everything is perfect, I always say the right thing, I always get what I want. And I never tire of my dreams ... I can rehearse it, tweak it, fine tune it, improve it, vary it, and the end result is all the same.

True, as I had told him, there is someone I was dying to see and speak to again. However, the dream was so perfect, and flesh and blood so ordinary, I always hesitated. Whenever we were together, it was like the infinite hotel ... endless shuffling and reshuffling, but everything the same in the end. Simply never-ending variations of the same conflicts, gripes, misunderstandings, and pain. Was there no escape? Yet the Tibetan monk had dared to love even though he, of all people, knew better. Look what it got him ... he spurned Nirvana and the calm life of the Bodhisattva for an illusory goddess. How bad off could he be to come to me for advice?

"Whoa, kid, back off," the voice suddenly intruded out of the void, "forget everything I told you."

"How can you give me back my dreams instead of the truth? Just who or what are you anyhow."

"I told you, already. Call me the Hyperborean, since I know the secret entrance to Hyperborea."

"Ok, Hyper, is that where you are now?"

"No, I'm on the planet Thule, prohibited from another human incarnation while I pay my penance for loving an earth girl."

“Isn’t falling in love its own penance?”

“You’re wise beyond your years, kid, but a life of nectar and ambrosia has its own shortcomings.”

“Well, I have a lot of free time at night lately, so tell me a bit about Thule and how you are working out your salvation.”

“It’s really been an adjustment for me. The males have two penises.”

“Cool. That must make it very convenient for threesomes.”

“You would think, but nothing is ever as good as it sounds. Few males have the emotional stamina to deal with one woman, never mind two at a time. But there is more to it. Only one of the penises is biologically active for reproduction, the other is made solely for pleasure.”

“Wow! How did that come about?”

“A few centuries ago, a scientist was trying to develop the perfect woman, though his experiments were inconclusive. On the way home one night, he got hit by a bus as he was distracted by a Scandinavian-looking blonde crossing the street.”

“A good scientist is ever observant.”

“Unfortunately, he left behind two quite different formulations with no further instructions.”

“Are you serious? You mean there are two types of perfect women?”

“He thought so. One formulation created a type of woman suitable as a wife and mother, while the other created the ultimate mistress. At the age of puberty, every female on Thule has to choose one or the other formulation.”

“Sounds complicated. How do you fit into all this?”

“It’s actually less complicated on earth, where women are a mix of the two, and it takes a lifetime of trial and error trying to get the correct balance. Alas, for me, this is all impossible, since I am committed to celibacy. I’m actually living the life of a chodpa². ”

“That’s one heck of a penance ... two penises both going to waste.”

²<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ch%C3%B6d>

"I can't look at it that way. There's something more I gotta tell you. There's a third penis, a psychic one located at the top of the forehead. That's the one I have to awaken, so I can get back to earth."

"Hmm ... so every guy on Thule is a dick-head! But seriously, are you insinuating there is a *third* type of woman?"

"Yes, there is, and that is why I am here. She is my soul-sister, my âme-soeur with whom I would share a deep spiritual connection, exchange poetry, discuss philosophy, and experience the profoundest depths of unconditional love. That love would awaken the third penis and initiate the circulation of the Shakti energy leading to final enlightenment."

"So it sounds like you are on your way to peace?"

"Ha, ha. You can't be serious. I haven't found her ... I'm much more likely to find a snark!"

"Tell me more ... I'm totally confused, yet enchanted."

"Can't do it now, son. Have to get back to the cemetery where I spend my nights ... the ghouls need someone to spook. Besides some kids planted some weed last spring behind the gravestone of the scientist ... I've got some that should be dried perfectly by now."

Posted on 2011-11-13 by Cologero

The Little Yellow Pill "Hey, kid, do you have a Twinkie?"

"I've told you before, I won't give you my last Twinkie. You're a Tulku, why don't you just conjure one up?"

"It wouldn't be ethical to use my powers for such a mundane task."

"Since when have you been concerned with being ethical?"

"I'm always ethical when I think someone is watching me. You know I can read minds. I think there's more going on with you than just the Twinkie®. Something phallic?"

"What a guess. There's always something *phallic* going on in my mind. You want to guess my weight now?"

"I told you about Thule. Didn't you learn anything?"

"You mean about the penis in my head? I know about it and it won't leave me in peace."

"Normally in nature, there is just enough sex energy for reproductive purposes. The excess needs to be used for something else. The pleasure penis is a destructive use of that energy."

"My higher penis seems content to create fascinating scenarios for my pleasure penis."

"That's not what I meant. You need to use the higher penis to transcend the pleasure penis, not encourage it."

"Why? So I can become like you?"

"You are like me. If that thought bothers you, then mend your ways."

"I'll think about it, maybe I'll make it my New Year's resolution. By the way, why this sudden desire for Twinkies?"

"I told you about my project. I'm doing a pharmacological study of various plants and fungi, from the inside, as it were, not as a medical researcher would do it. Some of them give me the munchies."

"Yes, I know about some of those vegetables, the ones my mother never told me to eat. So if you eat all your vegetables, you're allowed to have some dessert?"

"You're missing the point. All plant life has an etheric element. I'm investigating their effects on the corresponding soul element in man. By the way, I'm trying to track down some Cinchona bark from Peru and I can't find it here. I bumped into Quetzalcoatl recently and he suggested it."

"Get a bottle of Lillet. It has a side effect as an aperitif. Perhaps it will encourage you to eat more nutritious meals."

"I'll try to observe that. It's the last plant on my list."

"You mean a glass of Lillet will bring you to a state of enlightenment?"

"Of course not, kid. I'm doing all this for the sake of science. I've had

to study Tantric sex practices, quantum mechanics and now pharmacological plants. It's all documented. But none of those can free me from the situation I've gotten myself into."

"Yet they are all popular practices on Earth."

"We can see that, that is why I need you to get the word out. Self-transcendence is a little more difficult than that."

"I understand. No one wants to make an effort for anything. They would rather take a little yellow pill."

"How do you know what color it is?"

Posted on 2011-12-31 by Cologero

7.2 Cosmic Telepathy

A common man marvels at uncommon things; a wise man marvels at the commonplace.

CONFUCIUS

About 20 years ago, a man, who was very active in occult and Theosophical circles, approached me with a very remarkable story.

He had met a woman with extraordinary powers. She had recently been released from the schizophrenia ward where she was being held unjustly. She claimed to be from a planet a great distance away. She revealed to him remarkable facts about the universe in general and her own planet in particular. Furthermore, in the middle of every night, she reported on her experiences of Earth life back to her own planet, on their equivalent of television via mental telepathy.

His desire was to introduce this woman to a wider audience ("for the benefit of humanity"), but he was having a difficult time convincing people to believe her and accept her with any seriousness. He then asked for my support and advice. As diplomatically as possible, I told him:

I bet they don't believe her on her own planet either.

Posted on 2012-02-25 by Cologero

* * *

Joe harpo on 2019-07-09 at 22:45 said:
Dreams are their cognitive frequency

roballengvalecourt on 2022-02-25 at 14:48 said:
I once said to my Ba-gua teacher—"If I tell others I am your student they will not believe me." He answered, "No matter – the same do not believe I know Ba-gua either."

7.3 Money, Sex, and Power

Twenty something years ago, a fellow, let's call him Paul, belonged to my circle of friends. Like Travis McGee³, he lived on his yacht in Bahia Mar. I recall that he was once on the Sally Jesse Raphael late night talk show in a segment about handsome and eligible millionaires. Although he was handsome, he was no millionaire, and he lived on his yacht because he couldn't afford a house. So, *caveat emptor* when it comes to believing anything you watch on television.



We were at a pool party and I was sitting with a couple of women. As he walked by us, their heads perked up to watch, intrigued by his good looks and blonde mane. But then they noticed his formless legs, which stuck down from his bathing suit like two uncut ziti. I may not have been as pretty as he was, but at that time, I was quite athletic with tight glutes, sinewy thighs, and well shaped calf muscles. In disgust, the

³https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Travis_McGee

two women expressed their disappointment in those legs that paled in comparison to mine. I never would have thought they noticed, still less that it was important to them. Let's say they lost interest in him and spent the afternoon with me. That is my "game" lesson for the week.

Well, Paul was a sensitive 90s type with that treachery spirituality. He kept encouraging me to attend one of those weekend seminars, Life-spring⁴ I believe it was called, or one of its spinoffs. "It would be life changing." Now, I get that a lot, even daily, how some book, or video, or teacher, etc. will be *life changing*. The way I see it is that a man has expended a lot of effort in creating his life, developing his mind and body, living by a set of morals that suits him, establishing relationships, even down to the little things like his dietary preferences. I really can't imagine such a man to be so anxious to radically change his life, especially based on the say so of some stranger.

Nevertheless, I agreed; he was my friend, I was curious, and we expected a lot of women to be there. The meeting was held at night with a couple of hundred people attending the free introduction at a hotel in Fort Lauderdale. We mingled and listened to some motivational talks. He had taken the weekend seminar previously and was involved in more advanced classes, so he was the "big brother" in this situation.

So he started probing me with some questions. Part of the program was some version of the Law of Manifestation, which, as you readers know, is a major teaching of the New Age. Finally, Paul bluntly asked me, "What do you want to manifest more of in your life?" Although it was a rather personal question, I quickly answered:

Money, Sex, and Power.

I don't know what answer he was expecting, or hoping for, but that certainly wasn't it. He made some strange face at me, with a sardonic grin. He walked away and I never saw him again.

⁴<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lifespring>

Posted on 2012-07-20 by Cologero

* * *

Aghorable on 2012-07-21 at 02:17 said:

There you have it. 'Speak your mind, and a base man will avoid you'.

Speaking of New Age, some of you might be interested in a recent show on 'Coast to Coast AM', with Charles Upton discussing 'inverted spirituality'. The first segment is a rejig of the familiar 'modern science approaches ancient truths' trope of neospiritualism, on the wave of the recent 'discovery' of the 'Higgs Boson'. You'll find it on their website. I haven't listened to it yet, but will do so after my imminent bubble bath.

Speaking of the 'Higgs Boson', particle physics just smacks too much of early 20th century to sustain the same interest in the present day, and even its popular blasphemous monicker has not managed to change that. The one youthful conversation in which I overheard it being discussed, on a train ride, was wedged betwixt discourse on sports in the upcoming Olympic Games, and exposition of an interlocutor's travels through Eastern Europe. The take-home message was that the boson doesn't explain everything yet, but "it's a start to the explanation of everything". I'm yet to run into another Higgs Bozo, but then I really don't get out much.

gamemaster on 2012-07-23 at 21:25 said:

"I don't know what answer he was expecting, or hoping for, but that certainly wasn't it. He made some strange face at me, with a sardonic grin. He walked away and I never saw him again."

Strange that he would. I wanna hear more about your tight ass, and how you've manifested more Money, Slags and Power since discovering Evola. Shouldn't this be under an orientation title? You see, my asperger virgin fellows, Tradition does get you laid.

Cologero on 2020-01-18 at 20:57 said:

All these climactic moments of life mutually stimulate one another; the world of images and ideas of the one suffices as a suggestion for the others: in this way, states finally merge into one another though they might perhaps have good reason to remain apart. For example: the feeling of religious intoxication and sexual excitation (two profound feelings, coordinated to an almost amazing degree. What pleases all pious women old or young? Answer: a saint with beautiful legs, still young, still an idiot). *The Will to Power* #800

Cologero on 2020-11-28 at 08:12 said:

As I was going through some old DMs, I noticed that Audrey del Sol tried to explain the fascination with legs, although I still don't get it. These are her words:

THAT made me laugh. If you want to know a bit of the why behind the leg story, you must understand that for whatever reason, females crave to be play bunnies with their hands tied around the belt of a male with strong legs who likes to play futbol with their head. Don't ask me, why.

7.4 Naida, the Sea Nymph

While the nightingale sings,
both night and day,
I am with my beautiful
beneath the flowers,
until our sentry from the tower
cries: "Lovers, get up!
for I clearly see the sunrise and the day."

Occitan Alba

As Naida was blossoming into womanhood, tales of her beauty began to circulate in the nearby villages. Many claimed that she had the gift of Second Sight. Her mother had died in childbirth, so Naida was raised in the forest with her father, the local healer. From him, she learned the secrets of the herbs of the countryside, which she would gather for her father's potions. He also taught her the mystic arts which had been passed down from father to son for generations. Without a male heir, he called her Niko, as it was the custom in that land to give the only child a boy's name.

The summers were spent by the sea. There Naida would go pearl diving, her hair yellowed by the Sun. When she suddenly appeared out



of the sea, like some Nereid, the boys would rush to the shore just to gaze at her. They would retain that image all day until they tucked themselves under the sheets at night.

Axel One day, she heard the bad news. Her father had to leave to do battle with the Turanians invading from the East. He had a premonition that he would never return, so he arranged a marriage with an older man named Axel who lived in a northern country. Sadly, Naida left the only home she had ever known.

Axel was a prominent apothecary and spiritual counsellor, well respected in town. Since his business had been in decline, he relied on Naida to mix new herb combinations and on her scrying for spiritual counselling. Unfortunately, their marriage was more akin to a business arrangement than a work of love. Axel was as cold as the ocean wind that cut through her in winter and his soul as disharmonious as the sound of the language spoken in that land.

Naida could not even stand his touch and actually pushed him away on one fateful night. In fury, he exclaimed, "If I can't have you, then no one can." He locked her in the upstairs room where she continued to mix herbs and scry for him. There was a small balcony overlooking the town square, from which she stared out all day. The men stopped, dazzled by her beauty, but the women could see the sadness in her eyes. Naida developed a network of women who would pass notes for her. In that way she communicated with the finest minds in Europe.

Arnaut One spring, the town was abuzz with rumours that the famous Troubadour Arnaut would be passing through. Some even said that he learned the secret teachings of the Templars from his grandfather who had fought alongside the Knights in the Second Crusade. Arnaut would meet with his followers in different towns and villages as he travelled.

Even Naida could not conceal her glee when she heard the news. Ar-

naut was handsome, refined, wise, and romantic; all the qualities that the young Naida had dreamed of in a man, yet evaded her in her maturity.

Arnaut did not disappoint. Every afternoon, he would set up in the town centre. Sometimes with a lute, other times with a hurdy-gurdy, he would sing songs of love, betrayal, infidelity, and the exploits of famous Knights. There would occasionally be satires about the foibles of the ruling classes.

Even Arnaut, despite his sophistication, was smitten by Naida who watched him sing from above. During the performance of one particular Alba⁵, he felt a tear fall from the balcony, which burned into his skin like a drop of caustic acid. He resolved that Naida should never again shed such a tear. Gossipers claimed that Arnaut was composing new songs just for Naida.

Courtly Love At first, they communicated by her system of notes. Later, his students would set up a ladder so he could speak to her through the bars of the balcony after the lamplights were extinguished. They would talk through the night, about their lives, their dreams, and more often of their deepening love. More importantly, they would discuss the Hermetic sciences. Naida passed her father's extensive notes onto Arnaut, so they would never be lost. These were the same teachings that Dante learned during his travels on the that side of the Adriatic Sea.

Arnaut's students would return to warn him of the approaching dawn, which signalled another painful separation. Arnaut's days continued: Singing in the afternoon, clandestine meetings with his students at dusk, then stolen moments of furtive joy at night with Naida.

The Test During one fateful meeting, which was destined to be their last, Naida told Arnaut that she needed some herbs grown only in Latvia.

⁵[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alba_\(poetry\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alba_(poetry))

Her husband was getting suspicious and made the odd request. Not wishing to be punished again, she pleaded with Arnaut to fulfil that request.

On his return from the difficult journey to Latvia, several students rushed outside the city gates to warn Arnaut not to enter. Axel had convinced the authorities that Arnaut was teaching heresy. Not only was his life in danger, but so were those of the students if he entered. And Naida might be tried as a witch.

Greatly distressed, Arnaut turned back and resumed his meanderings, singing in town squares, and meeting secretly with his students across Europe. Occasionally, he would receive a perfumed note from Naida, pledging her undying love. The last missive was a tear soaked sheet of paper with no note. Arnaut understood at once that he had failed his pledge that Naida would never shed another tear.

Naida was let out of her room and she accepted her position as a prominent woman in the town.

Although Arnaut visited many more towns, and met many more women, he was never able to love again. Some say that, in recompense, his most beautiful, yet poignant, songs were composed during this period.

During the lockdown, I set myself the challenge to write stories like the ones in the Decameron by **Giovanni Boccaccio**, with a hidden message. His book of stories was also written during an epidemic. This is one of the stories for the *New Decameron*.

Posted on 2020-09-01 by Anonymous

7.5 Onslaught at Bellosguardo

It was three o'clock in the morning of November first. One hundred and fifty delighted guests had left my masked ball. It was a ritual I hosted every 31st of October in the Great Hall of my Villa of the Saracen, an architectural jewel on the Piazza di Bellosguardo, Florence.

"My dear, I thought your idea of playing Saint Saens' "Danse Macabre" on your piano at the stroke of midnight was great theater," declared Sir Harold Acton, Lord and Master of the 16th century Florentine estate Villa La Pietra.

Father Andreas Resch, the psychiatrist, exorcist and demonologist, bent down to give me a hug. Andreas was my mentor, confessor and friend.

"You are spiritually vulnerable, you are aware of that yes? Ring me at the convent if anything strange occurs," he murmured.

"Really Andreas, the creatures and I have established a tolerant *modus vivendi*."

"Don't be flippant about this Isabella. Promise me you'll be careful."

The granite fireplace in my bedroom reached up to the vaulted ceiling. It cast suggestive shadows on the walls, which fascinated me. My bedroom, music room and library stood at the far end of the Great Hall.

I shall undress by the fire. The air has suddenly turned gelid.

In 1519, the Bardi banking family, deadly rivals of the Medici, commissioned Baccio D'Agnolo, master and mentor of young Michelangelo to design a villa in the Florentine hills.

"It must surpass all the Medici dwellings in Florence," commanded the Bardi. The Villa of the Saracen not only had Florence at her feet, but all her splendors proudly stood facing her.

More than four centuries have passed. I can't believe she's mine.

"Contessa, you are willful and capricious. The villa has naughty and nasty spirits who drive everyone away." I was sternly warned.

"I don't care. I'll charm and seduce them with music and dance. I'll surround it with my beauty and laughter. Nothing is going to stop me from living in that enchanted villa," I replied resolutely.

The "beings" and I established an affectionate entente. They opened and shut massive wood drawers in the Great Hall only between the hours of 9:00 and 10:00 in the evening. The velvet curtains in the Dining Hall

swished to and fro at dusk and stopped abruptly the moment I said, “guys and dolls, enough. You have broken my chops.” The howling wind came calling when I was cozily inside my quilted silk embroidered coverlet. Faces without bodies and vice versa swirled in the vaulted ceilings. One of them resembled Franz Liszt, my favorite composer. He had spent a summer in Bellosguardo. It was natural for him to fly around, particularly when I played his sublime but taxing Transcendental Studies.

I stepped out of my opulent scarlet gown and inched closer to the fire. I stood there, naked. Its warmth filled me with a sensual torpor. The mewling sounds coming from the Great Hall startled me.

I forgot to close the door. What are my cats doing out there? Oh! They’re here, sleeping on my bed. Someone is still crying, one of the children? Criminy! Here I am illuminating my nakedness.

“Marko, Cynthia, what’s wrong? I’ll be right there.” I called out, hastily grabbing my nightgown where it lay across the bed and slipping it over my head. I stood on the threshold between my bedroom and the Great Hall. A viscid fog reeking of sweat and sexual fluids assaulted me. Invisible hands lifted my long nightgown soaked with coital frenzy. A force was pushing me slowly out of my bedroom.

Mistake. I had addressed entities indulging in the most wanton sex. I heard the moans of a woman, accompanied by the loud rhythmic creaking of a high backed carved chair. A man gasped raucously. Every sound reverberated throughout the vaulted ceilings of the Great Hall.

“No! No!” I yelled in horror and ran towards the telephone by my bed. Oh dear Jesus. I can’t remember Andreas’s telephone number. Isabella, be calm. Recite the Our Father. Don’t listen to the sounds of lust. Ah, I got the number right at last. It’s ringing.

“Cara, I was hoping it wasn’t you.”

“Andreas, I’m under attack. I have never felt such terror. I fear for my soul. Help me please.”

“Isabella, listen to me. Do not venture into the Great Hall under any

circumstances. Surround yourself with light. You can overcome them with love and prayer.

“How long will this onslaught last Andreas?”

“I don’t know. My prayers and rituals will help you. Don’t be afraid, whatever happens. Trust in Jesus.”

I turned on all three chandeliers and lit every candle. I placed seven blue candles on my night table beside the crucifix — for the Seven Last Words of Jesus on the cross. I knelt on the Florentine tiles and repeated them over and over as loudly as I could without damaging my vocal chords.

In the Great Hall the lovers continued their crazed sex. They screamed and yelled in lust.

I remained close to the light and the crucifix. I dared not close the door and expose myself to the forces of darkness.

The sobs and sighs abated and finally vanished.

Deliverance!

“There are three possible explanations for what you experienced in the darkest hours of dawn. You entered another dimension that occurred centuries ago and received their signals much like a radio. Because of your long sexual abstinence, your powerful psyche might have created the frenetic coupling. Demonic entities tried to possess you by using a weapon that almost always works — sex.”

“I thought I knew most spirits at the Villa.”

“After 450 years, I doubt you’ll ever encounter all of them but never let your guard down. Is the chapel ready to receive the Blessed Sacrament?”

“Yes. My children and I will assist you during the Mass on this special All Saints Day.”

“Sia Lodato Jesu Cristo.”

“Amen,” I humbly replied.

THE END

N. B. This is a true story in all its details. Real names and places have

been used throughout the narrative. Contessa Isabella von Vacani.

7.6 The Nihilist and the Traditionalist

Over the weekend, I met up with my essence friend Tony, who drove up from Miami Beach to pick up some of his girlfriend's stuff. I met her briefly in the driveway; she dropped him off and set off to do her errands. She was quite attractive and well spoken, with a lithe trim figure. We found a shady spot in the backyard near the pool and settled in. I had whipped up a pitcher of mojitos with mint I had grown in the garden, and poured two glasses. He pulled out two Cuban cigars and we were ready to relax for a couple of hours.

Curiosity got the better of me so I asked how he had met Lorraine.

"Actually, I met her two months ago, the last time I was in this area. I stopped by Trader Joe's downtown to pick up some lunch items. She was checking out, just ahead of me. I couldn't keep my eyes off of her, as her shorts were too short, just enough to show her cheeks dancing every time she shifted her weight. From her body type, I figured she did Pilates or yoga. Her order was not too large so it looked like she lived alone. There was no pet food, which was an added bonus.

"So I casually asked her, 'Are you going to make me lunch?' She turned around, looked me over, and responded, 'Only if you pay for it!' With no hesitation, I added my stuff to hers on the conveyer belt, paid for everything, and followed her home."

"I guess the rest is history, as they say."

"Ha. I say you make your history. The moment was there and I seized it. There was no guarantee. But, more importantly, there was no regret. There won't be a time in the future when I look back and think to myself, 'What if?'"

"OK, I was just speaking metaphorically."

"Were you really? You hide behind your books and poetry. Has a

woman ever really loved you? For no reason, I mean. Not because she sees you as a meal ticket or a prize to display to her friends. You have a theory for everything, but do you have the reality?"

"I think so, I can see it."

"That you are good at: you can experience things vicariously through others."

"I know the most intelligent and creative minds in history, you know that. I believe they are good teachers."

"Sure you do. You know I am a nihilist; I don't believe in anything. Only what I can experience directly."

"I am likewise a nihilist. That means I can choose to believe anything I want. And that means a world populated by Knights, Ladies, Poets, Prophets, Philosophers, Sages, Mystics, Artists, Heroes, even angels, gnomes, jinns, and gnomes. It is a difficult worldview, requiring an understanding of maths, physics, metaphysics, history, and so on. Not everyone is capable of it."

"I see the same world as you, except that it is populated by criminals, psychopaths, usurers, gluttons, adulterers, idiots, and worse."

I wasn't pleased with his sudden mood change, but he wouldn't let up.

"I know your circle of faux traditionalists who don't actually follow a real tradition. They think they are bad boys for being banned by fb for a week. For all the talk of Heidegger, they are Cartesians at heart, men without qualities, with a detached "I" that sits in judgment on the 'modern world'.

"They are not a Dasein, with mysteriously given attributes, who is thrown into a particular world at a time and place with unchosen relations. That is the battle to be fought, not the imagined one in their heads."

As he had never spoken so harshly to me before. Perhaps it was the sun and the alcohol. I have known him a long time, sometimes closely,

but often with gaps in our relationship. Usually, we are so close that it seems that we share the same brain, but use it for different thoughts.

Since our smokes had gone cold, we had to pause momentarily to re-light them. That gave us a chance to change topics.

I still have unpublished notes from the summer he spent as a dance host so he could get free Mediterranean cruises. Or the three times, he was selected as a poster boy for matchmaking services catering to women; he got an invitation to the Marine Ball at the Jamaican embassy out of it. I'll clean them up and post them someday, but I was interested in a simpler topic that afternoon. As our moods changed from Saturn back to Jupiter, I brought it up.

"I got involved in Twitter thread posed by some young women discussing what is the best first date. I tried to interject some thoughts but got nowhere."

"You don't seem like the Twitter type, my friend," he responded.

"Apparently, most people agree with you. I am totally ignored on Twitter. That is why I decided to write a post about it and would like your input."

"I do have a lot of experience in that area. It will make for a nice conversation."

We continued talking until dusk, when we had to go inside to avoid the mosquitoes. Soon after, Lorraine arrived to pick him up.⁶

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QBU0KnLdJpc>

Posted on 2021-07-13 by Cologero

⁶DISCLAIMER: This is a work of fiction and any resemblance to persons, living or dead, is probably coincidental.

7.7 Stolen Dreams

Have you ever dreamed of being a poppy? It is a life to envy. The rising sun warms your petals just as the breeze is keeping them cool. Occasionally, gentle rains wash everything clean. Then the bees arrive and tickle your stamen; there is no sweeter or pleasurable feeling. The anticipation is nearly unbearable.

But the poppy is unusual. Not content to be a plant, the poppy desires her own dreams. So the poppy spirit makes a deal. She will take away your pains, assuage your anxieties, eliminate your fears. In exchange, she uses your consciousness to dream her dreams as you passively watch them unfold.

The poppy becomes addicted to these dreams and will not let you go. She demands that you take her sweet nectar, no matter how difficult or how costly. And you? You would prefer to die while high rather than to wake up.

Recital <https://www.gornahoor.net/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/Poppy2.mp3>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qFLw26BjDZs>

Posted on 2023-03-01 by Cologero

* * *

Santiago on 2023-07-20 at 00:09 said:

"The sacred soldiery, those who were once mortal and who were redeemed by Christ... are seated upon the thrones of the Mystic Rose... The second soldiery is of the angels who never left heaven. They soar above the Rose like heavenly bees, in constant motion between the Rose and the radiance of God. Unlike earthly bees, however, it is from God, the mystical hive of grace, that they bring the sweetness to the flower, bearing back to God... the bliss of the souls of heaven.

The first host is more emphatically centered on the aspect of God as the Son; the second, on the aspect of God as the Father."

from translator John Ciardi's notes to Canto 31, *Paradiso*

Aria on 2026-03-01 at 13:54 said:

Charles... so pleased you recorded your voice. Three years ago today.

Juliano on 2026-03-24 at 13:08 said:

Aria, thanks for commenting here. It brought my attention to this audio. I have wrote to Charles a few times, but never heard his voice before.

8.1 Dialogo di Torquato Tasso e del suo Genio familiare

By **Giacomo Leopardi**

Genio. Come stai, Torquato?

Tasso. Ben sai come si può stare in una prigione, e dentro ai guai fino al collo.

Genio. Via, ma dopo cenato non è tempo da dolersene. Fa buon animo, e ridiamone insieme.

Tasso. Ci son poco atto. Ma la tua presenza e le tue parole sempre mi consolano. Siedimi qui accanto.

Genio. Che io segga? La non è già cosa facile a uno spirito. Ma ecco: fa conto ch'io sto seduto.

Tasso. Oh potess'io rivedere la mia Leonora. Ogni volta che ella mi torna alla mente, mi nasce un brivido di gioia, che dalla cima del capo mi si stende fino all'ultima punta de' piedi; e non resta in me nervo né vena che non sia scossa. Talora, pensando a lei, mi si ravvivano nell'animo certe

immagini e certi affetti, tali, che per quel poco tempo, mi pare di essere ancora quello stesso Torquato che fui prima di aver fatto esperienza delle sciagure e degli uomini, e che ora io piango tante volte per morto. In vero, io direi che l'uso del mondo, e l'esercizio de' patimenti, sogliono come profundare e sopire dentro a ciascuno di noi quel primo uomo che egli era: il quale di tratto in tratto si desta per poco spazio, ma tanto più di rado quanto è il progresso degli anni; sempre più poi si ritira verso il nostro intimo, e ricade in maggior sonno di prima; finché durando ancora la nostra vita, esso muore. In fine, io mi maraviglio come il pensiero di una donna abbia tanta forza, da rinnovarmi, per così dire, l'anima, e farmi dimenticare tante calamità. E se non fosse che io non ho più speranza di rivederla, crederei non avere ancora perduta la facoltà di essere felice.

Genio. Quale delle due cose stimi che sia più dolce: vedere la donna amata, o pensarne?

Tasso. Non so. Certo che quando mi era presente, ella mi pareva una donna; lontana, mi pareva e mi pare una dea.

Genio. Coteste dee sono così benigne, che quando alcuno vi si accosta, in un tratto ripiegano la loro divinità, si spiccano i raggi d'attorno, e se li pongono in tasca, per non abbagliare il mortale che si fa innanzi.

Tasso. Tu dici il vero pur troppo. Ma non ti pare egli cotesto un gran peccato delle donne; che alla prova, elle ci riescano così diverse da quelle che noi le immaginavamo?

Genio. Io non so vedere che colpa s'abbiano in questo, d'esser fatte di carne e sangue, piuttosto che di ambrosia e nettare. Qual cosa del mondo ha pure un'ombra o una millesima parte della perfezione che voi pensate che abbia a essere nelle donne? E anche mi pare strano, che non facendovi maraviglia che gli uomini sieno uomini, cioè creature poco lodevoli e poco amabili; non sappiate poi comprendere come accada, che le donne in fatti non sieno angeli.

Tasso. Con tutto questo, io mi muoio dal desiderio di rivederla, e di riparlarle.

Genio. Via, questa notte in sogno io te la condurrò davanti; bella come la gioventù; e cortese in modo, che tu prenderai cuore di favellarle molto più franco e spedito che non ti venne fatto mai per l'addietro: anzi all'ultimo le stringerai la mano; ed ella guardandoti fiso, ti metterà nell'animo una dolcezza tale, che tu ne sarai sopraffatto; e per tutto domani, qualunque volta ti sovrerà di questo sogno, ti sentirai balzare il cuore dalla tenerezza.

Tasso. Gran conforto: un sogno in cambio del vero.

Genio. Che cosa è il vero?

Tasso. Pilato non lo seppe meno di quello che lo so io.

Genio. Bene, io risponderò per te. Sappi che dal vero al sognato, non corre altra differenza, se non che questo può qualche volta essere molto più bello e più dolce, che quello non può mai.

Tasso. Dunque tanto vale un diletto sognato, quanto un diletto vero?

Genio. Io credo. Anzi ho notizia di uno che quando la donna che egli ama, se gli rappresenta dinanzi in alcun sogno gentile, esso per tutto il giorno seguente, fugge di ritrovarsi con quella e di rivederla; sapendo che ella non potrebbe reggere al paragone dell'immagine che il sonno gliene ha lasciata impressa, e che il vero, cancellandogli dalla mente il falso, priverebbe lui del diletto straordinario che ne ritrae. Però non sono da condannare gli antichi, molto più solleciti, accorti e industriosi di voi, circa a ogni sorta di godimento possibile alla natura umana, se ebbero per costume di procurare in vari modi la dolcezza e la giocondità dei sogni; né Pitagora è da riprendere per avere interdetto il mangiare delle fave, creduto contrario alla tranquillità dei medesimi sogni, ed atto a intorbidarli; e sono da scusare i superstiziosi che avanti di coricarsi solevano orare e far libazioni a Mercurio conduttore dei sogni, acciò ne menasse loro di quei lieti; l'immagine del quale tenevano a quest'effetto intagliata in su' piedi delle lettiere. Così, non trovando mai la felicità nel tempo della vigilia, si studiavano di essere felici dormendo: e credo che in parte, e in qualche modo, l'ottenessero; e che da Mercurio fossero esauditi meglio che dagli

altri Dei.

Tasso. Per tanto, poiché gli uomini nascono e vivono al solo piacere, o del corpo o dell'animo; se da altra parte il piacere è solamente o massimamente nei sogni, converrà ci determiniamo a vivere per sognare: alla qual cosa, in verità, io non mi posso ridurre.

Genio. Già vi sei ridotto e determinato, poiché tu vivi e che tu consenti di vivere. Che cosa è il piacere?

Tasso. Non ne ho tanta pratica da poterlo conoscere che cosa sia.

Genio. Nessuno lo conosce per pratica, ma solo per speculazione: perché il piacere è un subbietto speculativo, e non reale; un desiderio, non un fatto; un sentimento che l'uomo concepisce col pensiero, e non prova; o per dir meglio, un concetto, e non un sentimento. Non vi accorgete voi che nel tempo stesso di qualunque vostro diletto, ancorché desiderato infinitamente, e procacciato con fatiche e molestie indicibili; non potendovi contentare il goder che fate in ciascuno di quei momenti, state sempre aspettando un goder maggiore e più vero, nel quale consista in somma quel tal piacere; e andate quasi riportandovi di continuo agl'istanti futuri di quel medesimo diletto? Il quale finisce sempre innanzi al giunger dell'istante che vi soddisfaccia; e non vi lascia altro bene che la speranza cieca di goder meglio e più veramente in altra occasione, e il conforto di fingere e narrare a voi medesimi di aver goduto, con raccontarlo anche agli altri, non per sola ambizione, ma per aiutarvi al persuaderlo che vorreste pur fare a voi stessi. Però chiunque consente di vivere, nol fa in sostanza ad altro effetto né con altra utilità che di sognare; cioè credere di avere a godere, o di aver goduto; cose ambedue false e fantastiche.

Tasso. Non possono gli uomini credere mai di godere presentemente?

Genio. Sempre che credessero cotesto, godrebbero in fatti. Ma narrai tu se in alcun istante della tua vita, ti ricordi aver detto con piena sincerità ed opinione: io godo. Ben tutto giorno dicesti e dici sinceramente: io godrò; e parecchie volte, ma con sincerità minore: ho goduto. Di modo che il piacere è sempre o passato o futuro, e non mai presente.

Tasso. Che e quanto dire e sempre nulla.

Genio. Così pare.

Tasso. Anche nei sogni.

Genio. Propriamente parlando.

Tasso. E tuttavia l'obbietto e l'intento della vita nostra, non pure essenziale ma unico, è il piacere stesso; intendendo per piacere la felicità; che debbe in effetto esser piacere; da qualunque cosa ella abbia a procedere.

Genio. Certissimo.

Tasso. Laonde la nostra vita, mancando sempre del suo fine, è continuamente imperfetta: e quindi il vivere è di sua propria natura uno stato violento.

Genio. Forse.

Tasso. Io non ci veggo forse. Ma dunque perché viviamo noi? voglio dire, perché consentiamo di vivere?

Genio. Che so io di cotesto? Meglio lo saprete voi, che siete uomini.

Tasso. Io per me ti giuro che non lo so.

Genio. Domandane altri de' più savi, e forse troverai qualcuno che ti risolva cotesto dubbio.

Tasso. Così farò. Ma certo questa vita che io meno, è tutta uno stato violento: perché lasciando anche da parte i dolori, la noia sola mi uccide.

Genio. Che cosa è la noia?

Tasso. Qui l'esperienza non mi manca, da soddisfare alla tua domanda. A me pare che la noia sia della natura dell'aria: la quale riempie tutti gli spazi interposti alle altre cose materiali, e tutti i vani contenuti in ciascuna di loro; e donde un corpo si parte, e altro non gli sottentra, quivi ella succede immediatamente. Così tutti gl'intervalli della vita umana frapposti ai piaceri e ai dispiaceri, sono occupati dalla noia. E però, come nel mondo materiale, secondo i Peripatetici, non si dà vòto alcuno; così nella vita nostra non si dà vòto; se non quando la mente per qualsivoglia causa interrompe l'uso del pensiero. Per tutto il resto del tempo, l'animo considerato anche in se proprio e come disgiunto dal corpo, si trova con-

tenere qualche passione; come quello a cui l'essere vacuo da ogni piacere e dispiacere, importa essere pieno di noia; la quale anco è passione, non altrimenti che il dolore e il diletto.

Genio. E da poi che tutti i vostri diletti sono di materia simile ai rag-nateli; tenuissima, radissima e trasparente; perciò come l'aria in questi, così la noia penetra in quelli da ogni parte, e li riempie. Veramente per la noia non credo si debba intendere altro che il desiderio puro della felicità; non soddisfatto dal piacere, e non offeso apertamente dal dispiacere. Il qual desiderio, come dicevamo poco innanzi, non è mai soddisfatto; e il piacere propriamente non si trova. Sicché la vita umana, per modo di dire, e composta e intessuta, parte di dolore, parte di noia; dall'una delle quali passioni non ha riposo se non cadendo nell'altra. E questo non è tuo destino particolare, ma comune di tutti gli uomini.

Tasso. Che rimedio potrebbe giovare contro la noia?

Genio. Il sonno, l'oppio, e il dolore. E questo è il più potente di tutti: perché l'uomo mentre patisce, non si annoia per niuna maniera.

Tasso. In cambio di cotesta medicina, io mi contento di annoiarmi tutta la vita. Ma pure la varietà delle azioni, delle occupazioni e dei sentimenti, se bene non ci libera dalla noia, perché non ci reca diletto vero, contuttociò la solleva ed alleggerisce. Laddove in questa prigione, separato dal commercio umano, toltomi eziandio lo scrivere, ridotto a notare per passatempo i tocchi dell'orologio, annoverare i correnti, le fessure e i tarli del palco, considerare il mattonato del pavimento, trastullarmi colle farfalle e coi moscherini che vanno attorno alla stanza, condurre quasi tutte le ore a un modo; io non ho cosa che mi scemi in alcun parte il carico della noia.

Genio. Dimmi: quanto tempo ha che tu sei ridotto a cotesta forma di vita?

Tasso. Più settimane, come tu sai.

Genio. Non conosci tu dal primo giorno al presente, alcuna diversità nel fastidio che ella ti reca?

Tasso. Certo che io lo provava maggiore a principio: perché di mano in mano la mente, non occupata da altro e non isvagata, mi si viene accostumando a conversare seco medesima assai più e con maggior sollazzo di prima, e acquistando un abito e una virtù di favellare in se stessa, anzi di cicalare, tale, che parecchie volte mi pare quasi avere una compagnia di persone in capo che stieno ragionando, e ogni menomo soggetto che mi si appresenti al pensiero, mi basta a farne tra me e me una gran diceria.

Genio. Cotesto abito te lo vedrai confermare e accrescere di giorno in giorno per modo, che quando poi ti si renda la facoltà di usare cogli altri uomini, ti parrà essere più disoccupato stando in compagnia loro, che in solitudine. E quest'assuefazione in sì fatto tenore di vita, non credere che intervenga solo a' tuoi simili, già consueti a meditare; ma ella interviene in più o men tempo a chicchessia. Di più, l'essere diviso dagli uomini e, per dir così, dalla vita stessa, porta seco questa utilità; che l'uomo, eziandio sazio, chiarito e disamorato delle cose umane per l'esperienza; a poco a poco assuefacendosi di nuovo a mirarle da lungi, donde elle paiono molto più belle e più degne che da vicino, si dimentica della loro vanità e miseria; torna a formarsi e quasi crearsi il mondo a suo modo; apprezzare, amare e desiderare la vita; delle cui speranze, se non gli è tolto o il potere o il confidare di restituirsi alla società degli uomini, si va nutrendo e diletando, come egli solea a' suoi primi anni. Di modo che la solitudine fa quasi l'ufficio della gioventù; o certo ringiovanisce l'animo, ravvalora e rimette in opera l'immaginazione, e rinnuova nell'uomo sperimentato i beneficii di quella prima inesperienza che tu sospiri. Io ti lascio; che veggo che il sonno ti viene entrando; e me ne vo ad apparecchiare il bel sogno che ti ho promesso. Così, tra sognare e fantasticare, andrai consumando la vita; non con altra utilità che di consumarla; che questo è l'unico frutto che al mondo se ne può avere, e l'unico intento che voi vi dovete proporre ogni mattina in sullo svegliarvi. Spessissimo ve la conviene strascinare co' tarla in sul dosso. Ma, in fine, il tuo tempo non è più lento a correre in questa carcere, che sia nelle sale e negli orti quello di chi

ti opprime. Addio.

Tasso. Addio. Ma senti. La tua conversazione mi riconforta pure assai. Non che ella interrompa la mia tristezza: ma questa per la più parte del tempo è come una notte oscurissima, senza luna né stelle; mentre son teco, somiglia al bruno dei crepuscoli, piuttosto grato che molesto. Acciò da ora innanzi io ti possa chiamare o trovare quando mi bisogni, dimmi dove sei solito di abitare.

Genio. Ancora non l'hai conosciuto? In qualche liquore generoso.

Posted on 2007-12-26 by Aeneas

8.2 Hollywood Action Flicks

In his inimitable way, **Gilbert Chesterton**, in a discussion about adventure or romance novels¹, anticipates the plots and defects of Hollywood action movies. The title of the essay is “The Position of Sir Walter Scott”; in this segment he compares Scott to later adventure novel authors.

It is in this quality of what may be called spiritual adventurousness that Scott stands at so different an elevation to the whole of the contemporary crop of romancers who have followed the leadership of Dumas.

In contrast this is how he describes Scott's inferiors:

There has, indeed, been a great and inspiring revival of romance in our time, but it is partly frustrated in almost every case by this rooted conception that romance consists in the vast multiplication of incidents and the violent acceleration of narrative. The heroes of Mr. Stanley Weyman scarcely ever have their swords out of their hands; the deeper presence of romance is far better

¹Not meant in the contemporary sense.

felt when the sword is at the hip ready for innumerable adventures too terrible to be pictured. The Stanley Weyman 1855-1928, adventure novel writer hero has scarcely time to eat his supper except in the act of leaping from a window or whilst his other hand is employed in lunging with a rapier. ... In short, Mr. Stanley Weyman is filled with the conviction that the sole essence of romance is to move with insatiable rapidity from incident to incident.

You see the parallels with contemporary action films? Nothing but chase scenes and fight scenes for two hours, with barely a plot intertwined: the later *Die Hard* movies, the incessant and repetitive battles of *The Matrix*, the faux fights of *Kill Bill*. And these are the better ones, of a list that can go on and on.

In contrast, this is what he says about Sir Walter Scott:

In the truer romance of Scott there is more of the sentiment of "Ho! Still delay, thou art so fair"; more of a certain patriarchal enjoyment of things as they are – of the sword by the side and the wine cup in the hand. Romance, indeed, does not consist by any means so much in experiencing adventures as in being ready for them.

A criticism of Scott is that his descriptions of details is too monotonous; in one case about the details of armour and costume, GKC responds:

The only thing to be said about the critic is that he had never been a little boy. ... Not being himself romantic, he could not understand that Scott valued the plume because it was a plume, and the dagger because it was a dagger. Like a child, he loved weapons with a manual materialistic love, as one loves the softness of fur or the coolness of marble. One of the profound philosophical truths which are almost confined to infants is this love of things, not for their use or origin, but for their own inherent characteristics, the

child's love of the toughness of wood, the wetness of water, the magnificent soapiness of soap. So it was with Scott, who had so much of the child in him.

Yes, the half-educated man can only deal with his abstractions. But the boy prefers direct sensual experience. And, yes, we boys love pageantry, dressing up in costume, and especially our weapons.

Posted on 2010-04-21 by Cologero

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rkirk on 2010-04-26 at 11:11 said:

"The Stanley Weyman hero has scarcely time to eat his supper except in the act of leaping from a window or whilst his other hand is employed in lunging with a rapier."

Chesterton anticipated not only the action genre, but also the question of when Jack Bauer sleeps, eats, or goes to the bathroom.

Cologero on 2010-04-26 at 22:15 said:

Or perhaps Jack Bauer is a follower of Plotinus and has contempt for such lowly human bodily functions.

8.3 The Legacy of the Byronic Hero

The Romantic Era was one that idealized an unspecified past as more natural and where people's lives were less fragmented, slower paced, and fuller. Some assert that the movement was something of a revolt against the emphasis on the rationalism of the Enlightenment, but more troubling was its attack on traditional morality. Indeed, it seems odd that a movement that idealized the past due to its simplicity and contentment would attack the standard that made such things possible.

A longing for this fuller life is a recurring characteristic of Lord Byron's protagonists. Characters with these traits have evolved into an archetype

of their known: Byronic heroes. For the young and dissatisfied, these anti-heroes have much appeal. Highly contradictory beings, these figures have imposed themselves to self-exile, as their restlessness and shame condemns them to always look to a new horizon where they believe that a better life will await them.

The Byronic Hero is amoral. While genuinely searching for a pure life, the heroes instability causes him to take action that violates the most basic codes of conduct. As a strong, charismatic, and attractive man, he is able to accomplish great deeds, gain fame, and seduce the innocent, rural women he idealizes, but his achievements ultimately prove fleeting.

These figures challenge the establishment and have a contempt for hierarchy. When their destruction is taken to its limit, they break the social bonds that tie society together, but some realize their error before this happens.

The traits of these figures were embodied in 60s 'Beat' or 'Hipster' counterculture. Jack Kerouac, Allen Ginsberg, and other writers of the time were real people who brought the sense of dissatisfaction and revolt against the 'normal' life to its logical extent. Like Romantic contempt for the artificiality of Enlightenment thought and society, the Beats saw in American bourgeois life nothing except paralysis. To them, the way of life offered represented nothing more than a death before dying, and they put themselves to the task of rediscovering 'life.'

The Beats took the restlessness represented by the Byronic Hero and brought it to its most extreme extent. Destroying every bond and limit became a total, uncompromising mission. Freedom came to be understood as a temporary, overload of the senses; it was to them something that could only be grasped for a short time and had to be continuously re-discovered through ruthless destruction of the self and others. Normalcy came to interpreted as oppression. Purity, here, becomes inverted in its totality. One does not find happiness through innocence, chastity, and contentment, instead, restlessness is cured by an attitude of complete ap-

athy towards the future and the development of an ability to impulsively erupt at any given moment.

The utter success of this social revolution lay in the lack of comprehension that those who claim to be its opponents have regards to its success. A new, contra-civilizational standard was set. Restlessness and apathy have become the new norm, and the social institutions have been reformed not to push people back toward social ways of life, but rather to normalize the abnormal and to create dissatisfaction and confusion where there had not been before. Rene Guenon explains this process perfectly in the *Reign of Quantity* and the *Sign of the Times*, describing the transformation of the institutions as the “Counter-initiation.”

For the individual to overcome these processes, delusion about their nature cannot be permitted. Buddha derived a formula to remind oneself of when such conditions arise: “No, I do not want this. This does not belong to me. This, I am not. This is not myself.” This renunciation of the world is meant to be no arbitrary thing. Rather, it is a refusal to mix oneself with the ignoble and corrupt oneself in the process. Of course, the Christian teaching is similar: To be in the world but not of the world. Also, “Don’t copy the behavior and customs of this world, but let God transform you into a new person by changing the way you think. Then you will learn to know God’s will for you, which is good and pleasing and perfect.”

These renunciations are not meant to mean withdraw from the world or denial of the will, although in plenty of mistaken interpretations of these religions that is exactly what is practiced. Rather, one should will, but not in a self-deluded matter. Seeking to “obtain positions of power” in order to “reform the system from within” is not a working proposition without first a more general spiritual realization. It was our own restlessness and misplaced desire that brought us to the crisis we are in now. Until the next horizon is understood to be the reconquering of the self, and not more chasing delusions, we will get nowhere, and our fate

is already sealed.

Posted on 2011-02-02 by VisionsOfGlory14

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Count Cagliostro on 2011-02-05 at 07:34 said:
Excellent text!
PS Do you happen to know the name of the creator of the painting?

VisionsOfGlory14 on 2011-02-05 at 09:57 said:
It's a painting of Faust and Mephistopheles. Can't tell you who the painter is.

Helmholtz on 2011-02-12 at 04:36 said:
Apparently that's an Arnold Böcklin work, also a self-portrait: http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Arnold_Böcklin

8.4 The Finger of Father Sergius

Leo Tolstoy's story about *Father Sergius* begins with the ambitious, intelligent and handsome Prince Stepan Kasatsky. In everything he tried, including speaking French and playing Chess, he strove to excel. He began a military career and tried to enter into the stratified court life around the Czar. Unable to break into the highest circles on his own, he determined to accomplish that through marriage. He fell in love with a beautiful countess.

The Prince idolized femininity and regarded unmarried women as possessing great purity. Women, in return, flattered by such an evaluation, strove to be goddesses. Men, on the other hand, were permitted to satisfy their sexual urges. However, since men were so overpowered by sexual urges, it was left to the virgins to draw the line. This is the opposite from today when women are now free to pursue their sexual lusts and it is the responsibility of men to respect the line under their own power.

Before their wedding, she confessed that she was not a virgin. This so disturbed the prince that he gave up the world and entered a monastery to live a life of purity and devotion to God. Of course, as Father Sergius, he followed the monk's life with single-minded attention. At this point, the story is open to misinterpretation unless Father Sergius is understood from the inside.

Obviously, the simple act of becoming a monk does not lead to immediate sanctity. Rejecting the lures, enchantments, and glamour of the world, just exposes more deeply rooted lures. Two sorts of cynicism arise from this.

The secularist will expose the false consciousness of the monk and declare that the life of the prince is the real one. Sexual satisfaction, social life, and nihilism are his values. One's inner life is irrelevant. The problem for the secularist is that the game of life is stratified, as exemplified by the court life of the Czar. Sexual life is also problematic, since some are desirable and others not, some are considered natural, others disordered. Hence, the inner battle becomes externalized as the fight for economic equality and sexual normalization.

A Lutheran would say that the justified is still a sinner. While true, in one sense, it does not distinguish between the prince and the monk. The prince is a sinner spontaneously, while the monk has reached a higher stage. This spiritual egalitarianism, that is, all being equal in their depravity, is more insidious than the secularist. Until he can become master of his own soul, the monk relies on exoteric teachings, the regulated life of the monastery, and the authority of the Abbott as legitimate aids.

Nevertheless, Father Sergius struggles with feelings of pride and superiority. This is a paradox of the spiritual life. From the objective point of view, the life of the monk is indeed superior to the life of the soldier. Probably unintentionally, Tolstoy has written a parable of the superiority of the Brahman over the Kshatriya. At a higher stage of spirituality, not found until the end of the story, such feelings are themselves transcended.

The celibate path embraced by the monk frees him the strongest attachment to the world. As Nicolas Berdyaev puts it²:

Man is greatly dependent, sexually, on woman: he has a weakness for the other sex, a radical weakness which may be the source of all his weaknesses.

By overcoming this ur-weakness, a man is free to sublimate his eros in service to spiritual evolution. On the other hand, this becomes a challenge to a particular sort of woman. In this case, an attractive divorcee, knowing of the monk's sanctity, vows to seduce him. She tricks him into allowing her into his cell where she begins to disrobe. Overcome by lust, Father Sergius takes an axe and chops off one of his fingers. Strongly moved by that act, the woman fled the cell and shortly thereafter entered a convent.

At this point, the life of Father Sergius aligns with that of St Anthony of the Desert. He is sent off to a more worldly monastery. As this reputation for sanctity grows, a throng of people begin pestering him, the opposite of the life of a hermit. They ask for healings, blessings, spiritual direction, advice, and so on. Now he is considered a saint and a staretz. Since miracles seem to be happening, more people come and he begins to believe them himself.

This demonstrates a peculiar problem in spirituality. Instead of following the example of the monk, most people prefer to live their spiritual life at second hand by attaching themselves to who they believe to be a holy figure. In the case of a Saint Anthony, this may be somewhat beneficial, but it opens up a path to darker forces, as recently occurred with Rampal in India. On a smaller scale, this is happening in the case of Valentin Tomberg. Instead of executing the difficult tasks of meditating on the Tarot, the focus shifts to the person of Tomberg. Speculation then arises about his role, is he a bodhisattva or some sort of savior. Some

²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=234>

will claim to be receiving special inspirations from the deceased Tomberg. This is a peculiarly feminine phenomenon for the most part.

After years of this, Father Sergius begins to tire under the demands placed on him. Despite decades of prayer life, his faith wanes and he considers leaving the monastery to live as a vagabond. Finally, left alone with a simple woman whom he was really supposed to help in some way, he allows himself to be seduced. This is not uncommon psychologically, since apostasy is very often associated with a fall into sexuality. Examples, are too numerous to mention.

He sneaks away, and looks for his cousin whom he has not seen in decades. She is a simple woman, once wealthy but now a commoner; yet, she is devoted to her family and to fulfilling her duties. This makes a final impression on him. Some months later, he is arrested on a minor charge and exiled to Siberia. Symbolically, Siberia is on the edge of the world. There,

he settled down as the hired man of a well-to-do peasant, in which capacity he works in the kitchen-garden, teaches children, and attends to the sick.

Postscript Tolstoy was opposed to the Russian Orthodox Church, so in the final stage Kasatsky rejects “churchiness”, ritual, healings, and other siddhis. Perhaps this choice is not ultimately opposed to the esoteric path outlined by Rene Guenon. Nevertheless, there is no shortcut in this. Kasatsky lives the life of a Warrior, then a Priest, before he is able to transcend all possibilities open to man.

There is an echo of this in *Siddhartha* by **Herman Hesse**. After successive disillusionments with financial success, the love of a beautiful woman, and family life, Siddhartha ends up as a ferryman, ferrying people from one side of the river to the other, and back again, world without end.

Posted on 2014-11-21 by Cologero

* * *

Gert on 2014-11-21 at 07:40 said:

If avoiding sin requires such drastic measures for men, it should make leftists think about what's the real rape. Millions of deeply religious males have had their innocence SLAUGHTERED on the Feminist altar of sexual liberation. If a woman drunk on alcohol cannot consent, how can a man drunk with sex hormones do the same? Sex captivation BULLDOZES intelligence and rational thinking in males, prosecute SEDUCTIVE females for complicity in rape

August on 2014-11-21 at 18:56 said:

It's not so much seductive females – these days, there is an abstract, collective sexual atmosphere, heavy, hostile and not really oriented toward fulfilment, hence the provocative exhibitionist neurotic, much worse than true seductive women.

If only people were more suited, the 'bulldozing of intelligence and rational thinking' could lead upward, and sex could be restorative. How would Kasatsky's life have looked if sex had instead been a positive point of departure for him? There is a potential shortcut – through the mountain, rather than over it. No wonder women dread the highest type of man.

Pickman on 2014-11-22 at 17:23 said:

Gert,

"prosecute SEDUCTIVE females for complicity in rape." True in some of the cases. However, why not just wrap women up in dark blankets so men can safely keep their penis in check without the lure of sin. This is the method of the Levant and removed from the Aryan spirit. Beyond seclusion to concentrate on the inner work

or any personal work of a professional creative disposition.

I would be more inclined to August's commentary on the matter.

August on 2014-11-22 at 23:27 said:

The style of the Levant can be criticised, but emphasis on female modesty was also a feature of the Aryan world, where it was considered to be a distinguishing custom of the well-bred.

"When someone inquired why they took their girls into public places unveiled, but their married women veiled, he said, "Because the girls have to find husbands, and the married women have to keep to those who have them!"

– Plutarch – Sayings of Spartans

David on 2014-11-23 at 01:35 said:

In the end, so-called "hormones" and deviation are not product of external features. They are internal response to specific perception of "external" realities. Therefore, any (re)action to those are coming from the interior of the subject and therefore bound to be an act of passivity (in the case of reaction to stimulus) or will (in the case of self-control). This is of course the higher state – which I do not say that I possess -, it is the goal. Even if you remove all women from earth, you do not adress the direct problem of self-control and higher aspiration.

Scardanelli on 2014-11-23 at 22:00 said:

Very true David. The solution must be sought within rather than without. Yet rather than simple self control, wherein one restrains an impulse, perhaps what is needed is a transmutation of that impulse, raising its vibrations as the hermeticists say. Once can transmute desire for the flesh and physical union into desire for the spirit and spiritual union. This, I think, is what is truly meant by the transmutation of sex, rather than any potentially dangerous "sexual gymnastics."

Lu Dongbin on 2014-11-29 at 17:55 said:

Good post. Though I wonder, if we know that what Berdyaev says is true, which seems to meld quite well with Indian traditions with its emphasis on brahmacharya as a necessity for spiritual growth or Daoism's emphasis on celibacy to conserve vital essence needed for alchemic work and transcending the need for woman for the same purpose, what are the best ways to go about achieving this aim?

We live in an era where pornographic and semi-pornographic material surrounds us and in a generally hyper-sexualized society, and as your post pointed out with woman who are free to pursue their lusts and thus temptation everywhere for man. So what are the best methods or lifestyle changes from the world's wisdom traditions for obtaining perfect self-restraint in this area? I see a lot of emphasis on dietary changes and the practice of constant prayer in Christianity or japa mantra in the Indian traditions. Perhaps Augustine would have some insights into this matter since it was one he apparently struggled with but overcame.

August on 2014-11-30 at 04:27 said:

If that is the aim, start by avoiding women and situations where desire can be aroused and consummated. Do you find that difficult to do? Or are the consequences hard to bear? If there is difficulty, the next step depends on understanding it somewhat.

Pickman on 2014-11-30 at 09:05 said:

The real answer is transmutation. Restraint through the power of will, and "sexual gymnastics" as Scardanelli has pointed out is not the ideal (even though the tests of "love" and some tantric sexual rites of coitus). Neither would physical dismemberment. Even after consulting

Metaphysics of Sex and trying to point to a populist spiritual figures in history is troublesome. Anyone have any other suggestions on the transmutation process?

August on 2014-11-30 at 18:04 said:

I think most here are aware that transmutation is the answer. But that is the goal. Abstinence is a means to that end, and initially* requires a greater or lesser application of the will.

Some traditions have specific methods aimed at sexual transmutation, others simply require abstinence with the knowledge that sex will follow the general development of asceticism from gross to subtle, outer to inner; this change of direction is transmutation.

If you really need more drastic means to cut yourself off from sexually, there are plenty of things one could do before taking the knife. For example, if any girl has an eye for you, sit her down and start talking about the degeneration of the castes, your medium-term aim of restoring the Primordial State, the spiritual death indicated by modern music and culture, and a hundred other topics that we are familiar with. If she still wants you after that, you perhaps ought to keep her.

* "Initially" could mean decades, and the enthusiasm those with an appropriate vocation feel at the outset should be used as a boost, but without courting illusions about the extent of the task ahead.

Cologero on 2018-11-21 at 09:50 said:

his review arose from a correspondence with a Russian woman living in Kazakhstan. She was a student of Agni Yoga and claimed that Fr. Sergius was running away from life. My response:

The only way to run away from life is to let it live you rather than you living your own life. Whatever prevents that needs to be cut off. The finger is not a dead end, just one of the many temptations he had to overcome. Tolstoy's views on sexual abstinence are those of Fr. Sergius. In the end, the aristocrat Kasatsky works for the peasant. So the simplicity of the peasant is superior to the court life and church life of the aristocrat.

For me, Natasha, a man has to be a whole. His personal, political, and spiritual life has to be a consistent whole. By experience, I often see that women don't care so much, as long as the man looks good or says nice things.

Cologero on 2018-11-21 at 09:51 said:

Fr. Sergius aka Prince Kasatsky insisted on virginity and was immune to seduction. That makes him, in a sense, not easily controllable.

8.5 The Condor and the Anarch

We fail not because of our dreams but because we do not dream forcefully enough.

ERNST JUNGER

The Rose does not ask why. It blooms because it blooms.

ANGELUS SILESIUS

I live after a calling as little as the flower grows and gives fragrance after a calling.

MAX STIRNER

Of course, the anarchist is hemmed in from the first day by father and mother, by state and society. Those are prunings, tappings of the primordial strength, and nobody escapes them. One has to resign oneself. But the anarchic remains, at the very bottom, as a mystery, usually unknown even to its bearer. It can erupt from him as lava, can destroy him, liberate him. Distinctions must be made here: love is anarchic, marriage is not. The warrior is anarchic, the soldier is not. Manslaughter is anarchic, murder is not. Christ is anarchic, Saint Paul is not. Since, of course, the anarchic is normal, it is also present in Saint Paul, and sometimes it erupts mightily from him. Those are not antitheses but degrees. The history of the world is moved by anarchy. In sum: the free human being is anarchic, the anarchist is not.

ERNST JUNGER, *Eumeswil*

While I was preparing a book review of *Eumeswil* by **Ernst Junger**, Keith Preston published this excellent review of a new translation of Max Stirner's

*Der Einzige und sien Eigentum*³. I use the older translation titled in English *The Ego and his Own*, but the new one is titled *The Unique and its Property*. Apparently there is no concept in English that captures the meaning of the German.

Since Eumeswil is more or less an extended meditation on Stirner's book, I had to go back and make some revisions. Stirner is of interest to us, not least because of his influence on Carl Schmitt, Julius Evola, and even Rudolf Steiner who penned the *Philosophy of Freedom* as the metaphysical justification for Stirner's views. Steiner once described himself as an Individualist Anarchist⁴. Evola wrote a book on Junger's idea of the Worker and his notion of the Autarch seems close to the latter's Anarch. The Anarch also rides the tiger in a world he can neither consent to nor oppose.

Eumeswil is a small post-cataclysm city-state located in the Maghreb, at an unspecified future date. The Condor is the nickname for its tyrant (as opposed to a despot). The narrator, Martin Venator, is a courtier in the Condor's Casbah by night, but an historian and scholar by day. This is not a conventional novel, but more like a series of meditations akin to Rousseau's *Reveries of a Solitary Walker*. Presumably Venator's voice is also Junger's.

The name Martin comes from Mars, the god of war, and Venator means "hunter" in Latin. Hunting is a recurring theme in the novel. "Martin" is the name given by Venator's father, a point emphasized, and apparently not harmonious with his last name. Mars Hunter is rather aggressive, and Venator does not accept his natural father's view of life. However, the Condor renamed him "Manuel", which is Hebrew for "God with us". So henceforth, the Hunter is associated with a different

³<https://attackthesystem.com/2017/07/24/a-little-less-piousness-please/>

⁴<http://philosophyoffreedom.com/profiles/blog/list/tag/max+stirner>

God.

Venator had two primary mentors, one an historian, the other a philosopher. Vigo is modelled after **Giambattista Vico** whose guiding principle was “The truth is the fact itself”. Venator is interested solely in facts, not opinions or metaphysical speculations. On the other hand, Vico’s views are balanced by Bruno, modeled after **Giordano Bruno**. A third factor is the grammarian who lectures on the importance of the use of words to legal issues. At a time like ours, grammar is being deliberately mangled in order to alter legal reasoning.

The Anarch Although Max Stirner is often associated with Left-wing anarchism, Venator rejects anarchism in favour of the Anarch. Hence, the book is an extended meditation in the difference between the two outlooks. The anarchist rejects authority and attacks the system, and the Anarch works within and around it, while being detached from it. The former tries to be outwardly free, the latter is inwardly free. Venator writes:

It is not that I as an anarch reject authority à tout prix. On the contrary, I seek it, and that is precisely why I reserve the rights to examine it.

There is a reason for this:

The anarchist, as the born foe of authority, will be destroyed by it after damaging it more or less. The anarch, on the other hand, has appropriated authority; he is sovereign. He therefore behaves as a neutral power vis-à-vis state and society. He may like, dislike, or be indifferent to whatever occurs in them. That is what determines his conduct; he invests no emotional values.

The anarchist scorns the rules, “like people who deliberately drive on the wrong side of the road.”

The anarchist, in contrast, knows the rules. He has studied them as a historian and goes along with them as a contemporary. Whenever possible, he plays his own game within their framework; this makes the fewest waves.

The Anarchist The anarchist generally holds to these principles:

- **Atheism:** There is no necessary being, therefore everything is contingent. In practice, this means that there is no sufficient reason for any given state of affairs. Hence, any other possible state of affairs has its own legitimacy.
- **Antilogos:** A corollary is that there is no overarching order to the world. An imposed order, even by a god, is an affront to the freedom of the anarchist.
- **Positivism:** Reality can only be known through the senses. There is no transcendent source of knowledge. Any such claim is merely a human construct, or, in Stirner's terms, and airy "spook".
- **Nominalism:** There is no abstract realm of pure ideas. Words are arbitrary human constructions. This goes by the name today as "anti-essentialism". For example, there is no essence to being a man or a woman. Such characteristics are for the Ego or Unique One to determine.
- **Egoism:** The purpose of mind is to pursue the alleged self-interest of the being. Not surprisingly, this almost always reduces to sex, as in *Kidz, Kulture, and Kreativty*⁵. Stirner and his subsequent acolytes felt, and still feel, obliged to flout bourgeois sexual morality, like people who deliberately drive on the wrong side of the

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1582>

road. When combined with anti-essentialism, then even “biological facts” are considered an affront to freedom.

Traditional ideas like “tradition, nation, race, family, religion, morality, duty, order, obedience” refer to nothing in reality. Rather, they are “spooks”, i.e., human creations, a superstructure added to the natural world. The scientific view is that they are mere bigoted opinions⁶.

The anti-philosophy of nominalism, in practice, means that the most powerful and most wealthy are able to control the discourse, or “spooks” if you prefer. There is no concern for objective truth, just for the satisfaction of desires and will. Hence, if science is objective, nominalism is not scientific. Only realism is scientific and thus able to effectively combat the powerful. The man who understands reality does not believe in spooks, i.e., he knows what is real and what is an artifact.

The Luminar Venator had access to the Luminar, a strange brew of Wikipedia, the Akashic Record, and spirit channeling. Through it, he could see the unfolding of the whole scope of human history. Hence, he couldn’t consent to any particular movement, since each one would pass. Only facts counted. What is considered right or legal can change.

Apparently, the luminar could reconstruct historical personalities so that Venator could engage in discussions with Bachofen on matriarchy and with Moses on morals and religion. Although Venator is free from “moral and religious bonds”, there are some problems that he “can scarcely resolve, but that have an effect precisely by surfacing” — for example, the Resurrection.

Three Great Saints

⁶https://gornahoor.net/?page_id=8496

One consequence of the worldwide entanglement is that solitary men appear, talents not rooted in one specific landscape or tradition.

Bruno taught Venator detachment. He points out that the view that external things like “rank, money, and honors” bring happiness, is not necessarily correct. Thomas Aquinas would describe them as “accidental” qualities. If so, then what exactly is essential to the Unique One? What is his Own or his Property? The Ego has a calling higher than the pursuit of money, sex, and power. Venator explains:

If one manages to separate essence from flesh, if one manages, that is, to get distance from oneself, then one climbs the first step toward spiritual power. Many exercises are geared to this—from the soldier’s drill to the hermit’s meditation.

Why does this elude the great majority of human beings? It is because they have no depth:

Why do they not know that the world remains inalterable in change?
Because they never find their way down to its real depth, their own.
That is the sole place of essence, safety.

So who shows us that depth?

The characteristic feature of the great saints is that they get at the very heart of the matter. The most obvious things are invisible because they are concealed in human beings; nothing is harder to evince than what is self-evident. Once it is uncovered or rediscovered, it develops explosive strength. **Saint Anthony** recognized the power of the solitary man. **Saint Francis** that of the poor man. **Stirner** that of the “only” man. At bottom, everyone is solitary, poor, and “only” in the world.

It is certainly curious to include Stirner among the great saints, “of whom there are very few”. What exactly is the matter whose heart Stirner reached? Venator mentions two of Stirner’s axioms:

1. That is not My business.
2. Nothing is more important than I

Stirner made the self-evident, evident, namely, in Venator’s words:

Each person is the center of the world, and his unconditional freedom creates the gap in which respect and self-respect balance out.

For Stirner, there is nothing to achieve. He writes:

As this rose is a true rose to begin with, this nightingale always a true nightingale, so I am not for the first time a true man when I fulfill my calling, live up to my destiny, but I am a “true man” from the start. My first babble is the token of the life of a “true man”, the struggles of my life are the outpourings of his force, my last breath is the last exhalation of the force of the “man”. The true man does not lie in the future, an object of longing, but lies, existent and real, in the present.

A dog does not aspire to be a “good” dog, it has no essence as a task. Stirner applies this to man, also. For a man to aspire to be good, or rational, etc., is to aspire to be other than what he is. For Stirner, the fact of man is the exercise of force or strength. So who has the most force? Obviously, the man who is most conscious, who has self-mastery. Can I propose that as a goal? Not in Stirner’s eyes, but some men will choose it, just as the rose chooses to bloom. It is an error to presume that all men are alike.

Venator seems, however, to have seen even more deeply, viz., the distinction between the anarch and the anarchist. He takes the first term,

rejecting anarchy, while Stirner's followers mostly embrace it. Venator, the historian, needed to determine where anarchy's self-understanding in acting, thinking, or poetic creation occurred. Specifically, he sought the point where it coincided with the attainment of self-comprehension, the basis of freedom. Venator looked to the pre-Socratics (as did Heidegger), the Gnostics (as did Jung), and the mysticism of **Angelus Silesius**. Silesius was a German Catholic priest who continued the Nordic tradition that began with Meister Eckhart through Jacob Boehme, including John of Ruysbroek among others. Like the rose that blooms, the Anarch prays, the anarchist does not. There is no purpose to the prayer, it is simply his nature.

So we see that the basis of freedom begins in self-knowledge (or self-comprehension). After all, if nothing is more important than "I", then that "I" must be known. Even God commands you to love yourself, as if you needed that nudge. The traditional order of charity is: God, Self, and then spouse, children, parents, siblings, friends, and so on. Even the atheist can agree to most of that.

Venator seeks to transcend the material, perhaps because matter limits his freedom. One day he came to this realization:

I thus managed to achieve something I had always dreamed of:
a complete detachment from my physical existence. I saw myself
in the mirror as a transcendent suitor—and myself, confronting
him, as his fleeting mirror image.

Angelus Silesius also found the transcendent suitor:

I am like God and God like me.
I am as Large as God, He is as small as I.
He cannot be above me, nor I beneath him.

Venator says that the anarch is to the anarchist as the monarch is to the monarchist. That is, the monarchist wishes there were a king, the

monarch really is the king. Analogously, the anarchist wishes he were free, the anarch actually is free.

Postscript on the Condor Venator posed as a bird-watcher in order to have an excuse to wander in the outskirts of the city. He tells this tale of the Condor. A South American tribe would capture a condor and starve it for a week. Then they would tie the condor to the back of a bull that had been severely bloodied through deliberate cuts. The hungry condor would then rip out the flesh of the still breathing bull.

For more on spooks from 2010, see *The Demon of Dialectics*⁷.

Posted on 2017-07-31 by Cologero

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Max on 2017-08-05 at 16:18 said:

Please allow me to re-germanize the English in order to produce an accurate translation of the title that also manages to preserve the artful wordplay intact: "The Only and His Alonedom" [The One-Like and His All-One-Dom].

Dom is an archaic English word that has fallen out of use except in relic composite words such as kingdom, wisdom and freedom, and is the exact translation of the German suffix -tum, meaning judgement. No latin neologism to be seen here. As it happens, neologism is not possible within purely germanic tongue because of its fluid poetical nature, but is rather a phenomenon resulting from the interplay of the latin and the germanic spirit. (English is germanic spoken in latin mode, French is latin spoken in germanic mode. Thus, learning Latin, French, English and German should provide the whole spectral loom to understand the particular and recurrent modifications of the Roman current up until modern times.) Wisdom as an example means wise decree, so it is not something you "have" in an abstract way, but an exercised activity. Likewise, property in the sense of eigentum or alonedom is actively exercised and enforced by an only "alone" as implicated in the word.

In germanic languages the word for "property" (in the sense of belongings) has the same linguistic form as kingdom. Perhaps that linguistic privation of modern English says something of the Anglo's and a presumptive jacobinism. I do not usually work myself up emotionally over

⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=813>

trivial discussions, but recently got into quite a heated argument with an anarchist precisely over the nature of "eigentum" when the inner anarch was unexpectedly provoked by the repulsive apparition of anarchism.

It is curious that in popular English usage a positive word for exerting judgement has acquired associations such as "doom and gloom". I guess that people are generally averse of judgements, distinctions, discriminations and decisions, which by the linguistic evidence is an already hundreds of years old development.

Now in my deeming, doom, in all of its wondrous forms – some of which listed above – cannot really come too quickly. To that end it could be wise to start out only with ones lonely operation to then dare moving on to wider applications. The changing connotations of such words belonging to the dom of the second estate speaks of a bourgeoisie revolt against the knights occurring towards the end of the middle ages but nevertheless not finally sealed until the catastrophe of the world wars, thereby destroying the remnants of legitimate authority in any capacity of earnest ealdormen doomhood, the consigned consigliere henceforth residing but abiding in the blazing bowels of mount doom. Meseems the neat manyfold seemliness of ere lands, fielded with unseamed gilden fleece, beflees the areless naysaying weasely fleas.

Your last point about the monarch reminds me of an amusing anecdote about a former king of Sweden writing an admonishing letter to his youngest son signed off with "Head of Family, Father, Friend and King" There is no arguing with that, it is just a fact.

Cologero on 2017-08-06 at 19:41 said:

Well, this explains why the grammarian was so important to the Anarch!

Sparrow on 2017-08-31 at 21:55 said:

It was rather hard to read Stirner, and the obnoxious behavior of some of his followers (as well as their criminal tendencies) further made it difficult to want to read such a figure. But it seems that Junger and Evola managed to find something profound in him.

I know it is probably impudent to ask, but would you consider writing on the Japanese Kokugaku movement, due to figures such as Motoori Norinaga and Hirata Atsutane attempting to seek a pure Japanese Tradition through the Kojiki and mystical experiences.

Fax Fay Faz on 2017-09-19 at 18:14 said:

I believe you're a bit off on Venator's name. Juenger was a close friend of Heidegger and modeled his narrator more on Heidegger than on himself. The character of Attila (a Hun aka ww1 German soldier) seems rather to be the author's self-portrait, or self-caricature.

Venator is born as Martin (Heidegger) but is renamed Manuel (Kant) by his employer. To paraphrase Nietzsche, Kantianism is the philosophy of the civil servant. The Condor (probably Pinochet) wants to ensure Venator's reliability by making him heir to a "safer" school if thought.

Much worthwhile in this blog, it appears. Please continue with it, and of course leave the archives up.

8.6 Kerouac and the Faustian West

The sinner is at the very heart of Christianity. Nobody is so competent as the sinner in matters of Christianity. Nobody, except the saint.

CHARLES PÉGUY

Love, Work, and Suffer

Motto of the Kerouac family (*Rivista Araldica*)

Am actually not “beat” but strange solitary crazy Catholic mystic

JACK KEROUAC, *Lonesome Traveler*

Since I was under the impression that Jack Kerouac was lost in the memory hole, I was recently surprised by the publication of *Jack Kerouac and the Decline of the West*⁸, an essay by **Semmelweis**, published by Rhodes Scholar Press.

Since “Semmelweis” claims to be a GenX latchkey kid, the lifestyle described by Kerouac is hardly a living option for him. For my generation (I have GenX sons), Kerouac, when was even acknowledged, was either a passing “stage” one passed through, a proto-hippy, or lumped in, rather inaccurately, with the “beats”. Semmelweis, unburdened by such preconceptions, is able to separate the “real” Kerouac from the stereotypes of the beatnik ... not that that task is so easy to do, since Kerouac was rather complex and his behavior did not always match his innermost thoughts. What Semmelweis is able to see is much deeper than what those of Kerouac’s generation were able to see.

⁸<https://shop.aer.io/roquescholar>

One Man and Three Respectable People

Favorite complaint about contemporary world: the facetiousness of “respectable” people

Lonesome Traveler

Semmelweis comments on Kerouac’s appearance on *Firing Line*⁹ in 1968, which is worth watching.

Of the four men on stage, Kerouac was the only one who was able to connect with the audience. Allegedly intoxicated, he brought the audience to laughter several times, while the three “respectable men” droned on. They are what the French call a “type”; that is, they are devoid of individual personality. These are the other three on the show:

- **William F. Buckley:** At that time, he was the Maxwell’s Demon of conservatism, deciding who was in and who was out. After 50 years, his brand of conservatism has conserved nothing.
- **Lewis Yablonsky:** Professor Yablonsky, I should add. He was the “expert” on hippies, although he contributed nothing. There was no creed for hippies nor membership cards, so he contributed nothing.
- **Ed Sanders:** He was the “hippie” type, and the contrast with Kerouac could not have been clearer. He recited the platitudes of love and peace, etc., like a cardboard cutout. You can see them in the baseball games this week. Put the cutout on a new show in 2020 and you would not even know the difference. The same speech repeated ad nauseum, and everyone thinks it is new.

In high school, I had the Fugs album. When my mother heard it, she took it off the record player and returned it to the record store for an exchange. I guess she could see further than I could.

⁹<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BYgv7ur8ipg>

Personal Encounter A generation ahead of me, Kerouac grew up in Lowell, Massachusetts, not very far from my home town. As a rather bookish youth, I tended to act out roles from the books I read. Not quite willing and able to take things as far as Kerouac did, I did find opportunities. So in some ways, I understand his mindset from the inside, not just descriptively. Fortunately for me, I don't have an addictive type personality and was left unscarred. Unfortunately, that encounter has left me with an attraction to troubled women, like the sad but beautiful Tristessa.

My boomer friends, feeling the cold breath of impending death on their necks, have grown nostalgic, as though memories of old times will be as restorative as blood plasma transfusions from youths. So they send me links to albums by an 80 year old Dion, or old tracks from the wrinkled Rolling Stones. I'd be much more impressed if Dion became an anchorite or Jagger went full sannyasi.

Few of them have had a new idea since they were 19, despite professional successes. In their best moments, they sound like a second rate Ed Sanders. They can't figure me out, but I have just followed the logic.

There is a story, perhaps apocryphal, that some hippies tracked him down in St. Petersburg and went to visit to pay homage. He threw them out while claiming to be Catholic and conservative. The hippies didn't get the point, although some of us did.

Man as adventurer

Kerouac never lost his longing for a loving family, for a wife and children, and for the simpler, wholesome life of small town America. But he was always thwarted by his longing for adventure, passion, excitement, and lust.

SEMMELWEIS

If you watch some youtube videos today, you may come to the conclusion that to be religious, it is only necessary to wear a scapula, pray so

many rosaries, etc. This is not a criticism of those men or their practices, especially since in this day and age those are acts of defiance. Yet through Christian history, there has always been the desire for more. There have been explorers, knights, traders, warriors, pilgrims, missionaries, all with the urge for travel and adventure. They kept the faith, no matter how imperfectly.

Most of those options are not available today, so Kerouac made America his exploration (and more followed later). A GenXer cannot imagine what the USA was like in 1956, either physically or psychologically. That description will have to wait for my autobiography.

It seems that converts and reverts have been dominating the public discussion of religion. They are sincere and enthusiastic, and know their dogmas, canon law, and rituals perfectly. However, they often lack a certain “feel”, a Catholic mind that has embraced centuries, the globe, and been encultured with tales of saints, sinners, mystics, philosophers, and so on. There are classical pianists who are technically proficient and know how to play each note at the right time. Nevertheless, they lack an aesthetic “feel” that gives life to the music, so they never make it to the top ranks.

Kerouac, on the other hand, has that “feel”, even if he is not a good role model for your children. For example, while getting high with William Burroughs in Morocco, he could be inspired by a Muslim poem, or image some old man on beach as the coming Bodhisattva. Yet in his best moments, he could have a genuine spiritual experience.

And on Good Friday afternoon a heavenly performance of the St Matthew’s Passion ... I cried most of the time and had a vision of an angel in my mother’s kitchen ... and I realized it didn’t matter that we sin, that all my own petty gripes didn’t matter either.

Lonesome Traveler

Final Plans

hermitage in the woods, quiet writing of old age, mellow hopes
of Paradise

Lonesome Traveler

Kerouac never got to be old, since alcohol killed him. That should be the goal of every old man, and Kerouac knew it. When Siddhartha tired of the pursuit of money, women, family, he, too, isolated himself. But he could think, fast, and wait. Jack was addicted and impatient, so his road of excess cannot be recommended, even if it leads to the palace of wisdom. Did he attain Paradise? Perhaps, since Paradise is for saints and sinners, not the lukewarm.

The peasant farmers Semmelweis picks out an interesting theme in Kerouac that I never would have noticed. He references the Fellaheen or “peasant farmer”: those who persist after a civilization has collapsed. Oswald Spengler defines them this way.

only the primitive blood remains, alive, but robbed of its strongest and most promising elements. This residue is the Fellaah type ... Life as experienced by primitive and by fellaheen peoples is just the zoological up and down, a planless happening without goal or cadenced march in time, wherein occurrences are many, but, in the last analysis, devoid of significance."

OSWALD SPENGLER, *The Decline of the West*

Valentin Tomberg attributes them to the forgetting of the past. In our time, we can see that the forgetting is deliberate.

the “primitive” tribes and nomadic peoples, disinherited from their past and obliged to begin everything again, began to live in caves or camp under trees. There were once powerful kingdoms and magnificent towns but their descendants had lost all memory of them and gave themselves up entirely to the daily life of “primitive” tribes —the life of hunting, fishing, agriculture and war.

VALENTIN TOMBERG, *Meditations on the Tarot*

Semmelweis points out that Kerouac identified with the Fellaheen of his time: hustlers, drug addicts, winos, even though they could not sustain even a primitive civilization. Nevertheless, Semmelweis points out the logic: Beat = beatific, therefore the Fellaheen, the lumpen, the outcasts, are holy. Perhaps this might also be due to the way the respectable men of the publishing industry marginalized him, so he was never able to penetrate into the respectable literary circles.

Faustian and Magian Civilizations Besides the Fellaheen, Semmelweis pulls out another point from Spengler. Kerouac was prophetic about the 21st century. Semmelweis explains:

He saw the distinction in Spenglerian terms, which classifies Western European civilization as “Faustian,” and Near-Eastern civilization as “Magian.”

It’s remarkable that he saw that 21st century culture and spirituality would not be “American,”

which in this context means Western European and Faustian, but would be “Magian,” of the East, and of a type which rather than promoting the heroism and individualism of Faustian man, promotes the dissolution of the individual ego into the greater collective Spirit.

That is why the spirituality of the East involves the dissolution of the Person in the unconditioned state, while Western spirituality, like in Catholicism, there is always the two in one. That so many Westerners are preferring Eastern spirituality is just a regrettable sign of the times.

Dionysus vs Dionysius

I believe in order, tenderness, and piety.

Kerouac confessed this to Buckley:

[the counterculture is] apparently some kind of Dionysian movement in late civilization, and which I did not intend, any more than I suppose Dionysus did ... although I'm not Dionysius the Areopagite. I should have been.

Semmelweis expands on that distinction:

The point [is] that Kerouac's sensibilities and values are religious like Dionysius the Areopagite, not chaotic and destructive like the god Dionysus.

Since the two names differ by only one iota, it shows how close the two temptations are. At birth, we are assigned a good angel and a bad angel. Hence, life is a perpetual spiritual warfare; that is not an option and you cannot be a draft dodger.

Errata The beatnik on the TV Show, *The Many Loves of Dobie Gillis*, was named Maynard G. Krebs.

Posted on 2020-07-27 by Cologero

* * *

Max on 2020-07-27 at 15:04 said:

In Jünger's novel *Eumeswil*, the only non-fellaheen part of the population left seems to be the tyrant and his entourage. It describes a post-democratic polity, in the Platonic sense. Now old and tired, having already cycled through civilization, those who still possesses some measure of vitality reluctantly governs the rest. You do not have to agree in everything, but their company is still proves more interesting and valuable than the small-minded people down in the city. Of course, towards the end, those more energetic elements, however flawed they might be, will leave on a mysterious expedition, never to be seen again. Religious sensibility without a religion. Apollonian without an Apollo, but still better off than the converse. The fellaheen probably hardly notices one way or the other, and could not care less. There is no point in identifying with those left behind, or when the time comes, to look back.

Michael M on 2020-07-28 at 17:27 said:

"Fortunately for me, I don't have an addictive type personality and was left unscarred. Unfortunately, that encounter has left me with an attraction to troubled women, like the sad but beautiful Tristessa."

Hey I thought you said you didn't have an addictive type personality! Addictive types of personalities seem to be called to the Spirit, what a powerful drive and a great weakness and impurity and what we don't realize in them: "For this reason, as we shall afterwards say, God leads into the dark night those whom He desires to purify from all these imperfections so that He may bring them farther onward." Perhaps there's something to the "addictive" element that no longer has a compass in our times, barring those with biological issues.

"We have a huge barrel of wine, but no cups.

That's fine with us. Every morning

we glow and in the evening we glow again.

They say there's no future for us. They're right.

Which is fine with us."

Beatnik or Sufi? Let the inner element of the reader decide, moreover let the inner element be more than passively witnessing.

Thank you for the article, the Saint and the Sinner, there's no room for error, an example of the trauma of the world and the light that penetrates through all, only then to transcend, though the closed circle continues, not to be celebrated but overcome.

"Cold, hunger, hate, mockery, scorn, injustice, prison, illness and even death?"

– 'I know it.'

– 'Do you expect to be shunned by everyone? Do you expect to be totally alone?'

– 'I am ready. I know it. I shall bear all the suffering and all the blows.'

– 'Even if they do not come from enemies, but from parents, from friends?'

– 'Yes... even from those...'

- ‘Good. Do you accept the sacrifice?’
 - ‘Yes.’
 - ‘An anonymous sacrifice? You will perish and nobody... but nobody will even know whose memory to honour?’
 - ‘I have no use for recognition and pity. I have no use for a name.’
 - ‘Are you ready for crime?’ The young girl bowed her head.
 - ‘Even for crime.’
 - ‘Do you know that one day you will believe no more in what you believe in now, and come to think that you have been a dupe and that it was for nothing that you have lost your young life?’
 - ‘That too I know. Well though I know it, I wish to enter.’ The young girl crossed the threshold. A heavy curtain fell. Gritting his teeth, someone uttered behind her:
 - ‘A foolish girl!’
- At which, from another place, a voice replied:”
I’ll keep the cliffhanger this time.

AghorNath on 2020-07-28 at 19:26 said:

Quite curious the timing of this post Cologero.

Thank you for this, brings back memories of my days as a NYC youth in the early to mid-nineties; though I’m not looking for any restorative blood plasma transfusions on my stroll down memory lane. A GenXer myself, I developed a spiritual friendship in my late teens with someone of your generation who happened to be quite close to Kerouac at one time. Just last week I was informed of his death, though it’s been several years now since his passing. He mentioned Kerouac and Ginsberg on a few occasions, just in passing. When we first became acquainted I thought he might be blowing smoke up my arse, all the people he would mention so casually, it was quite dizzying. That was until he introduced me to Peter Lamborn Wilson (who was one of Seyyed Hossein Nasr’s disciples) when I had a pressing question about one of the Shi’ite Imams. I was inquiring about Islam at the time. Hassan (said friend), was himself Muslim, and apparently many years ago (long before I ever met him) a shaykh in a sufi order. Even though by the time we met, he had been battling addiction, there was always an air of saintliness permeating, irregardless of his vice. The expression “give you the shirt off his back” doesn’t do the man justice, at all. A sinner and a saint if there ever was one. Some would see just a washed up hipster, others an eccentric downtown grandfatherly figure. But I knew better, because while most knew only the exterior... drugs and Downtown NY life... I was probably one of the few who knew his True Man. And the regret he felt for living a life on the margins. He was wholly conscious of his sins. But he never forgot his Lord.

He told me once, Kerouac and him had spent literally days locked in a tiny room discussing the nature of Christ (no drugs involved). And that the coffee shop crowd in alphabet city back

in the day could “never figure us out...we left them always scratching their heads...were we left-wing, right-wing(?)...labels are for the birds”. Though he did always say him and his mates (Kerouac etc) where “bohemian...NOT beats or hippies!”

After an old acquaintance told me of Hassan’s passing, I googled his Christian name to see if there were any pictures floating about so I could say a prayer for him while in the presence of his image. A touching, if impersonal and lacking (on his spiritual life) article popped up that was written about him by The Daily Beast...

<https://www.thedailybeast.com/from-the-beat-generation-to-c-s-quatfriends-bid-farewell-to-a-counterculture-forrest-gump>

It turns out that Kerouac put him in a book. Under the name “Joey Rosenberg” in *Big Sur*. I heard tons of stories but this was news to me! Never read Kerouac, now is as good a time as any.

It seems that Mr. Kerouac and Mr. Heiserman (Hassan) may have suffered as the Holy Fool and Malamati respectively. Of the variety that there nature is kept hidden (to most)...even unto themselves. I always wondered (during our conversations, and even years later when i’d recall our talks) if he was a Bodhisattva, or my own personal avatara secretly guiding me out of troubled times. Probably not, but his deeply altruistic heart and his often sagacious advice in my youth gives me pause for thought.

Did he attain Paradise? The sinner is closer to God.

Inna lillahi wa inna ilayhi raji’un

Ps. – Praying your health is better Cologero... Godspeed

AghorNath on 2020-07-28 at 19:56 said:

Also interestingly, I forgot to mention in my previous comment. Last night I had been watching a nice conversation of thinkers on spirituality and community. Speakers included Seyyed Hossein Nasr and William F. Buckley. Buckley in his usual dry manner was something of an odd duck within the group not quite understanding why he was there and holding fast and firm to his exclusivist outlook. When other panel members would seemingly like to scoff at Buckley for his exclusivity, Nasr came to his defense asserting “...No religion can accept the idea that it is not True. I agree 100% with Mr. Buckley, if he rejects me as being a heretic, I nevertheless except his position, because he claims the Truth of Christianity is THE Truth, that’s why he follows it. If we just have truth as relativity, then why do we have to attach ourselves to it. There is a sense of absoluteness in all religions...”

Anyway worth a watch <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aq7BJLPfiYw>

Cologero on 2020-07-30 at 17:22 said:

That brings to mind the “double truth” theory¹⁰, that philosophy and religion could be contradictory, yet both be true.

8.7 Bridge of Life

There is a certain risk in misunderstanding a text by commenting on it half way through. Nevertheless, like sending a postcard on a trip, a good time could be had even before reaching the final destination. In the most recent comment to *The Scent of a Woman*¹¹, some readers may have noticed the strong similarity to the First Trial¹² of initiation.

It is clear that **Gustav Meyrink** has some sort of training in an esoteric school. In esoteric writing, the main point is often expressed midway through the work. Almost precisely at the 50% mark of *The Green Face*, we get a monologue by the character Dr. Sephardi, a Sephardic Jew, describing a path he calls the “Bridge of Life”. He claims an ancestor was murdered in the eleventh century for publicly revealing it. He calls it a “dangerous” path, but no one can understand it without certain keys.

Dr. Sephardi claims it has reached the West from the East, although it is mostly swindlers or charlatans, who don’t understand it, yet are promoting it. The Doctor claims that Westerners are flocking to India and Tibet, although the secret has been lost there for some time. Instead, the path they find in the East is a path of weakness. He suggests that the secret has been preserved by the Rosicrucians who left Europe centuries ago, for points unknown in the East.



¹⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Double_truth

¹¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4704>

¹²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1902>

The first part of the path is mastery of thought. The Doctor says:

Mastery over thought is an ancient heathen path to truly transcending humanity. Not to become the Uebermensch the German philosopher Nietzsche spoke of ...

The important point made is that few men understand the source of their thoughts, since most men falsely believe they are the authors of their own thoughts. This has been part of Gornahoor's message from the beginning. Dr. Sephardi points out that certain ideas take hold almost simultaneously among a group of people. This is empirically verifiable. In reality, thoughts are more like perceptions, although their sources are not from physical objects, but from the subtle realms.

Some men think in words, others in images. When there is yet no word to express an idea, images may impinge on a man's mind, sometimes haunting images, that are just beyond the word. Regarding the Green Face, which three characters have experienced in different ways, the Doctor speculates:

The agreement which I am supposed to explain seems to me to prove that it is the same new idea which tried to force itself on all three of you, to explain itself to you or, perhaps, is still trying. The fact that the phantom appeared in the mask of an ancient wanderer through the years means, I think, nothing less than that some knowledge, some insight, perhaps even some exceptional spiritual gift, which existed in a long-departed age of the human race, was known and then forgotten, wishes to renew itself and is revealing its arrival in the world in a vision granted to a few chosen ones. Do not misunderstand me, I am not saying that the phantom could not be some independently-existing being; on the contrary, I maintain that every idea is such a being.

Yet the mastery of thought is insufficient to cross the Bridge of Life. Dr. Sephardi continues:

Only there is one thing that is essential: he cannot reach the goal alone, he needs a ... female companion. It is only possible, if at all, by a combination of male and female forces. Therein lies the secret meaning of marriage which has been lost to mankind for thousands of years.

Clearly, he is referring to the alchemical marriage, although he is suggesting that it is more than merely symbolic. Meyrink is bringing into play the old teachings about "soul mates" or "polar beings", that crossing the Bridge of Life requires the fulfillment of the longing to become whole again. A man who can master his thoughts may seem cold and impersonal to those people he reveals that characteristic, since he no longer reacts like the mass of men. In a sense, he is no longer a "person", it by that, we mean the psychological or empirical ego. By mastering thoughts, a man creates a space in consciousness which used to be filled with a flood of thoughts. Apparently, the Doctor is saying that such a space needs to be filled by another, not anyone, but a specific partner. We'll see how the protagonists in the novel attempt that task.

From a practical point of view, such a path is exceedingly difficult. It is difficult enough alone, but trickier in tandem, as differences in development are usually inevitable. Some few women will find themselves attracted to such a man, even if they are not quite sure why. They will balk, however, and stop short of the bridge. Rather than being passive to the idea, they invoke active tactics. Such tactics may involve attempts to "change" him into something they are more comfortable with. Often, they are satisfied with a sentimental New Age type of teaching, which has the appearance of a "path", but without the inner exertion required for genuine progress. Even when they do get a glimpse of what is really happening, often there will be an emotional outburst, a counter-reaction and a devaluing of the man.

Art by Sussana Katherine: <https://paintingsofsusannakatherine.blogspot.com/2013/04/painting-of-bridge-of-life.html>

ml

Posted on 2012-08-28 by Cologero

* * *

Matthew on 2012-08-29 at 07:49 said:

It's interesting that Mouravieff doesn't make the "polar being" claim in a non-nuanced way, final way – actually, there are quite a few women who are configured in such a way that they are compatible with the configuration of a particular man, and he details how a couple of them work (one of them is that of a man who is allured by sight, and a woman allured by sound, although there is more to it than that). Ideally, one finds a mate who is as close to the "polar being" as possible, and this is the "sanctioned" marriage from the point of view of the Church – a blessed marriage that furthers the individual's path towards eventually finding that polar being.

Zoe on 2012-08-29 at 07:55 said:

Really enjoyed this commentary on Meyrink's novel and am eager to find out – either from a later post from you or by the self-exertion of actually acquiring a copy of the novel and reading it myself – how the need for Other plays out in the protagonists' experiences.

Cologero on 2012-08-29 at 12:59 said:

Didn't Mouravieff say somewhere that a young man get himself involved in too may karmic entanglements, and spends the rest of his life getting out of them?

Eva, in the story, is aware of the possibility of entanglement, so she is approaching the affair cautiously. Of course, she is idealized: of noble blood, beautiful, wealthy, intelligent, aloof from the masses, and naturally on a spiritual path.

Kimiwoux on 2014-06-15 at 21:12 said:

This is an inspiring post. I'm wondering how on earth, especially in a world like the one I see today, one could ever find their polar being. It would be great if there were a formula. T

8.8 A True Couple from among Mankind

Rabbi John said: to bring together a true couple from among mankind is more difficult than Moses' miracle in parting the Red Sea.

So says the rather odd Mr. Egyolk, a Russian Hasidic Jew, in **Gustav Meyrink's** *The Green Face*. One of the subplots in the book involves a group of Christian mystics, in which Mr. Egyolk nevertheless plays a role. In some ways they are similar to Pentecostals with their ecstatic trances; one character even goes down and barks like a dog!¹³

Curiously, each member of the group takes on the name of some Biblical character: Abraham, Gabriel, King Balthasar, Mary Magdalene, and so on. Such figures are not simply individual, historical, or mythic characters. Rather, they represent prototypes, exemplars of certain characteristics. In particular, Mr. Egyolk's prototype is "Simon, the cross bearer", i.e., the Simon who carried Christ's cross for a spell along the Via Dolorosa. Hence, we anticipate that Mr. Egyolk will take onto himself the burdens of someone else.

A fascinating, and discomfiting, contrast is the one between Mr. Egyolk and Dr. Sephardi. Both Jews, there is nevertheless no possibility of full understanding between them. Dr. Sephardi is a scholar, very erudite, rational, with his theories of religion and spiritual evolution. Mr. Egyolk, on the other hand, actually has had a real conversion of some sort, and experienced directly a spiritual intuition. He describes his conversion as the reversal of the positions of his head and his heart. Because of this, he does not think, but rather "sees"; and when he does think, it is very detached, without any feeling.

Dr. Sephardi understands that Mr. Egyolk has experienced what he had only theorized or read about; nevertheless, he does not envy Mr. Egyolk and is glad not to be like that. Mr. Egyolk claims to be instructed by Elijah, whose presence is always with him. Curious, Dr. Sephardi presses him to describe exactly what he means by that: does he see Elijah? does Elijah speak to him? and so on. Denying that he sees or hears Elijah, Mr. Egyolk provides a totally unexpected explanation.

¹³<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rqwwvpwhf9U>

You cannot understand it by reason, Dr. Sephardi. When you're happy, is happiness there with you? Yes, of course it is. But you can't see or hear your happiness. *That* is what it's like.

Dr. Sephardi began to question his whole life, which was devoted to the study of religion. "Now it seemed to him that there was much that he had overlooked, and that he had missed the most important part."

To return to the opening quote, Dr. Sephardi was stung on hearing it, because it reminded him of Eva, whom he apparently had designs on, although she decided to be with another. Obviously, the name is significant. Meyrink understands the Biblical narrative, from Adam to Christ, as the story of the primordial state, its loss, and its fulfillment. The original true couple was Adam and Eve. Eve was Adam's perfect help meet, without which creation was incomplete. Symbolically, they are one, since Eve is a genetic duplicate of Adam, other than taking two of his X chromosomes. In them, all the possibilities of the race descending from Adam are embodied. Deliverance, or the **Supreme Identity**, means actualizing all the possibilities of the Being. Hence, we can understand the **Spiritual Marriage** as the means to actualizing those latent possibilities. The sole remaining question is whether we understand it like Dr. Sephardi, i.e., by reading about it, or rather like Mr. Eglyolk, by experiencing it directly.

Posted on 2012-08-30 by Cologero

8.9 Art and Illusion in Meyrink

All that once was directly lived has become mere representation.

GUY DEBORD, *Society of the Spectacle*

It is no secret that Plato harbored a distrust of the artist. There are two reasons for this. The first has to do state of mind of the artist, who creates

an image of an image, an illusion purporting to be the form itself. **George Steiner**, in *Grammars of Creation*, poses these questions:

How can the aesthetic represent, call to persuasive life that of which it possesses no direct, existential knowledge? A painter, wholly ignorant of seamanship, can depict a vessel performing some expert manoeuvre in raging seas. An arrant coward can sing famously of battle. A playwright who has never held public office will put in the mouths of his characters searching perceptions of statecraft.

Beyond the illusion, there is the more serious ethical element. Steiner continues:

Enactment in the arts, in fiction, are not only factitious and, in a fundamental sense, illusory. They are irresponsible. Devoid of authentic knowledge of that which it re-creates, the aesthetic plays with reality. The botched painting, the failed drama, are, in the strict sense of the word, inconsequential. The pilot who runs his craft onto the rocks, the loser in battle, are answerable even to the point of death.

It is certainly banal to mention at this point the extent of this illusion of representation on contemporary Western life. Given Evola's fascination with **Gustav Meyrink**, I am more specifically interested in the mystical or spiritual literature, or in the many false currents claiming to represent Tradition today.

To start, we will look at a genuine work of spiritual value, such as Dante's *Divine Comedy*. As Dante himself points out, it is intended to be read on four levels: the *literal*, *allegorical*, *moral*, and *anagogical* meaning. The first three levels are clear enough and can be easily found; they are products of the work itself. Although the first three levels may

evoke intense aesthetic feelings in the reader, whether of beauty or horror, that is an essentially passive process.

The anagogical, on the other hand, is of a different nature, as it must fully engage the reader. It is gnosis, pure and simple, which cannot simply be conveyed in words. The reader himself must reach the same levels of consciousness as Dante himself in order to grasp the meanings at this level. So far from being a work of illusion, an irresponsible re-creation, it really calls for a commitment of the reader, an appeal to make the same journey engaging the whole man. To follow that path is far from inconsequential.

Can we say the same of Meyrink? As Evola points out, Meyrink's works can be read simply as literature, although Meyrink himself claims they are a record of his own personal experiences. However, they don't have the gnostic, or anagogical, level as does the *Divine Comedy*. Rather, they are replete with visions, dreams, and trance states. Now Guenon made the rather mysterious claim¹⁴ that he had to "remediate certain evil consequences of *The Green Face*," without providing specifics. More than likely, the consequences may be related to the confusion of the psychic and the spiritual as he describes in *Reign of Quantity*. This confusion is based on the search for "imagined powers" and "extraordinary phenomena" instead of "spiritual realization"; that is, there is the confusion between the "forms of subtle manifestation" and the "formless world".

It may not be so simple in fact. One of the characters in *The Green Face* acknowledges the danger of hysteria associated with trances that leads downwards. He says, "*our* hysteria, on the other hand, is a matter of mental balance, the achieving of clarity, and is the way upwards, from insight through rational thought to knowledge through direct contemplation." This state is "beyond error or even uncertainty".

There are other interesting notions such as "to be master of one's own thoughts must also mean to be the all-powerful controller of one's own destiny" and how people "take philosophy for a theory and not the prac-

¹⁴<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4559>

tice." Meyrink writes about taming the body and taming one's thoughts. As for the former, it is insufficient, since he only makes a man a "fakir". Regarding the latter, he writes:

The next warriors your body will send out against you will be thoughts, whirring round you like a swarm of flies. Against them, the word of will-power is of no use. The more you strike out at them, the more furiously will they buzz around your head . . . It is impossible to command them to be still; there is but one way of escaping from them: by fleeing to a higher wakefulness. What you must do to achieve that, you must find out for yourself. . . The important thing is not to rid yourself of these thoughts for good, the purpose of your battle with them is to enter the state of higher wakefulness.

Now we get to a crucial paragraph, which presumably provides the clue to understand all the visions and apparitions in Meyrink's works. These visions are merely appearances of something else. He continues:

Once you have achieved that, the realm of ghosts, of which I have already spoken to you, will be near. You will see apparitions, both terrible and radiant, that will try to make you believe they are beings from another world. They are merely thoughts in visible form, over which you do not yet have power. The more sublime they appear, the more lethal they are, remember that!

Many a mistaken belief is founded on such apparitions, and has dragged mankind down into darkness. In spite of that, each one of these spectres conceals a deeper meaning. They are not mere pictures; irrespective of whether you can understand their symbolic language or not, they are signs of each stage of your spiritual development.

So the psychic appearances that play such a prominent part in his books are not real in themselves, but illusions whose reality comes from the

formless realm. Whether Meyrink has a “direct, existential knowledge” of these teachings is hard to say. Regardless, there is not an anagogical level to the books nor an initiatic path that can be followed.

Posted on 2012-10-22 by Cologero

* * *

Mihai on 2012-10-26 at 03:35 said:

“Regardless, there is not an anagogical level to the books nor an initiatic path that can be followed.”

I don’t think that Meyrink ever intended these sort of things. As far as I can tell, he wrote about esoteric topics in an artistic way- just like a historian can present real historical events in a historical novel.

In any case, I have just begun reading *The angel from the west window*. The beginning is interesting. I will see what follows and then pass a judgement.

Cologero on 2012-10-26 at 12:31 said:

I agree with you, Mihai, Meyrink did not consider his work to be an initiatic path. Rather it is a record of his own experiences. So it is a matter of how you judge those experiences.

8.10 The Muzzle of a Pistol

A review of *Against Nature* by *Joris-Karl Huysmans*, in which the decadence of the pursuit of phenomena is exposed.

After such a book, the only choice left open to the author is the muzzle of a pistol or the foot of the cross.

From Barbey d’Aurevilly’s review of *Against Nature* by
Joris-Karl Huysmans

Seeing that nowadays there is nothing wholesome left in this world of ours; seeing that the wine we drink and the freedom

we enjoy are equally adulterate and derisory; and finally, seeing that it takes a considerable degree of goodwill to believe that the governing classes are worthy of respect and that the lower classes are worthy of help or pity, it seems to me no more absurd or insane to ask of my fellow men a sum total of illusion barely equivalent to that which they expend every day on idiotic objects.

from *Against Nature*

Verily it is a pitiable thing to live on earth

from the *Imitation of Christ*

Joris-Karl Huysmans was present at the end of Naturalism in art. By attempting to place so-called “real characters” in “precise settings”, the Naturalists ended up just repeating themselves. In a preface published 20 years after the initial publication of *Against Nature* (*A Rebours*) in 1884, Huysmans explained that since Virtue was such an exception on earth, it was excluded from the Naturalist framework. He wrote:

It must be admitted that Virtue is an exception here on earth, and so it was excluded from the Naturalist framework. Not having the Catholic conception of the fall from grace and of temptation, we were unaware of the struggles and sufferings from which Virtue springs; the heroism of the soul, triumphing over life’s pitfalls, escaped us. It would not have occurred to us to describe this struggle, with its highs and lows, its wily attacks and feints, or the able allies standing at the ready deep in their cloisters and often far from those the Devil is assailing. Virtue seemed to us the attribute of individuals without curiosity or bereft of sense, and in any case of too little emotional interest to treat from an artistic point of view.

Without the spiritual combat of virtue against vice, the Naturalists could only write about the latter. Of course, the only interesting vice turns out to be Lust. Eventually, even that topic gets played out, at least for the intelligent artistic mind. Nevertheless, in popular culture it remains a popular theme, since the mass mind cannot even conceive of an alternative.

Addiction to Phenomena If naturalism is true, then only what can be experienced by the senses exists: sight, sound, touch, taste, scent. Hence, the goal of life is to accumulate the best experiences possible. For most, this is mostly a passive way of life: attending concerts, choosing a tattoo, finding a great restaurant, watching sports, and the like. A more sophisticated person will have refined tastes. For example, a woman recently wrote to me with her goals for the new year:

Freedom, authenticity, creativity, love, connection... laughter, fat books, Eddie Higgins, eating with the locals... oysters, avocados, ripasso, chocolate with sea salt, rose-scented soap.

A cute list, but still rather passive. The novel *Against Nature* is a story about nothing, except the pursuit of sensual experiences. The sole character, Des Esseintes, is a recluse with the resources in money and time to indulge his tastes. The difference is that he is the creator of his experiences. In this review, we can only highlight some of these.

First, he is obsessed with the way the changing light in his room reflects the multicolored threads of his rug. Whatever he does involves intricate attention to detail. To better reflect the sunlight in his room, he goldplates a tortoise and covers the shell with carefully selected gemstones. Needless to say, the tortoise died, probably due to a disease of the shell. He built a “mouth organ”, which controlled a variety of various liqueurs of various colors and shapes. That invention was reprised as the pianocktail in the French film comedy *Mood Indigo*¹⁵.

¹⁵<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5bdX5i0nAWw>

He had an extensive library, with many titles privately and extravagantly printed. They were arranged like the Louvre, from the ancients to the medievals, and ending with contemporary French literature. Curiously, it included an extensive collection of religious texts although Des Esseintes was an unbeliever. Some of it was of good quality and some merely sentimental. Apparently, he had been quite experimental with sex in the Parisian whorehouses. This left him impotent, probably because conventional sex could no longer arouse him.

Despite his further experiences with exotic flowers, literature, and fine art, he remained dissatisfied. Eventually, his health began to deteriorate. His physician recommended that Des Esseintes return to live in the city and “try to enjoy the same pleasures as other people.”

The thought of that was repulsive. He prided himself on his ability to appreciate “the delicacy of a phrase, the subtlety of a painting, the quintessence of an idea, or whose soul was sensitive enough to understand Mallarme and love Varlaine.” Where could he find a “twin soul”:

a mind free of commonplace ideas, welcoming silence as a boon,
ingratitude as a relief, suspicion as a haven and a harbour.

There it is: the pursuit of experiences for their own sake leads to death, not only of the body, but especially of the soul. The only possible solution is to transcend all experience, yet he couldn’t bring himself to the Faith. Hence, he expects to be engulfed by “waves of human mediocrity”. With no hope of a future life, his earthly life is all there is. Nevertheless, the atheist ends with a prayer:

Lord, take pity on the Christian who doubts, on the unbeliever
who would fain believe, on the galley-slave of life who puts out to
sea alone, in the night, beneath a firmament no longer lit by the
consoling beacon-fires of the ancient hope.

The Foot of the Cross Here we review Huysmans' preface for the edition of *A Rebours* published 20 years later. In particular, it deals with the influence of **Arthur Schopenhauer** and **John of Ruysbroeck** which led Huysmans to take the vows of a Cistercian oblate.

Joris-Karl Huysmans describes his journey from Des Esseints to the Cistercians.

I must rejoice beyond the bounds of time ... though the world
may shudder at my joy, and in its coarseness know not what I
mean

JOHN OF RUYSBROECK

John of Ruysbroeck was a thirteenth century mystic whose prose presented an incomprehensible but attractive amalgam of gloomy ecstasies, tender raptures and violent rages.

Des Esseintes, in *Against Nature*

Extraordinary things can only be stammered out, and stammer [John of Ruysbroeck] did, declaring that the sacred obscurity in which Ruysbroeck spreads his eagle's wings is his ocean, his prey, his glory, and for him the four horizons would be too close-fitting a garment.

ERNEST HELLO

There is more knowledge and understanding of the human heart in one page of Ruysbroeck than in all the Stendhals, Bourgetts, and Barreses in the world.

JORIS-KARL HUYSMANS

In a new Preface to the 20th anniversary edition of *Against Nature*, **Joris-Karl Huysmans** tried to explain how, eight years after its original publication, he ended up taking vows in a Cistercian monastery. However, the full story of his conversion was related in three subsequent books, we will focus at this time solely on what he wrote in the Preface. In particular, what is of interest is the influence of two writers, one a philosopher, the other a mystic, who achieved a certain prominence at that time. The philosopher was **Arthur Schopenhauer**, who was achieving a posthumous reputation that had eluded him in his lifetime. The mystic was **John of Ruysbroek** whose *Adornment of the Spiritual Marriage* had recently been translated into French by the theologian Ernest Hello.

After posting some extracts from Huysmans' Preface, we will conclude later this week with some fascinating ideas from Ruysbroeck. These will show how differently doctrine is understood today compared to the Medieval era. The important point to notice is to observe how a great artist approaches things. Like the poet, Huysmans seemed to have had negative capability and was willing to consider many ideas, while avoiding simple answers. Nowadays, in the age of social media, thoughts that require more than a dozen words are ignored. Entire worldviews are expressed in seven declarative sentences, often with a florid background. Negative views are viewed negatively.

The idea of living with uncertainty and mystery is terrifying; all must be known and under control. Huysmans wrote:

I did not grasp that all is mystery, that we live only in mystery, that if such a thing as chance existed it would be even more mysterious than Providence.

The lack of negative capability makes an artistic conversion like Huysmans' rare today. For example, what unbeliever could make this observation:

The strange thing was that, without my realizing it at first, I was drawn by the nature of my work itself to study the Church from a number of angles. It was in fact impossible to trace one's way back to the only unblemished times humanity has ever known, the Middle Ages, without realizing that the Church was at the centre of everything, that art existed through her and by her. Not being a believer, I looked at her, a little defiant, taken aback by her greatness and her glory, wondering why a religion which seemed to me to have been created for children could have inspired such marvelous works of art.

At that time, Huysmans was under Schopenhauer's spell, who was the philosopher of the tragic side of life. Like Huysmans, Schopenhauer was aware of religious literature like the Upanishads, Buddha, and even Christian mysticism. They all acknowledged what Schopenhauer observed, except that they offered a solution, an escape.

Yet I thought myself so far from religion. I did not imagine that it was only a short step from Schopenhauer, whom I admired beyond reason, to *Ecclesiastes* and the *Book of Job*. The premises about Pessimism are the same, only when the time comes to reach a conclusion, the philosopher disappears. I like his ideas about the horror of life, the stupidity of the world, the mercilessness of destiny; I like them also in the Holy Scriptures; but Schopenhauer's observations lead nowhere; he leaves you, so to speak, in the lurch; in the end, his aphorisms are only a herbarium of dry complaints; whereas the Church explains the origins and the causes, indicates the conclusions, offers remedies. She does not limit herself to giving you a spiritual consultation, but treats and cures you, whereas the German quack, once he has proved the incurability of your condition, simply sneers and turns his back on you. ... Never has Pessimism been of any comfort to those sick in body or in soul!

There was no single event that led Huysmans to his conversion. He tries to explain the inexplicable:

There was undoubtedly, as I was writing *Against Nature*, a land-shift, the earth was being mined to lay foundations of which I was unaware. God was digging to set his fuses and he worked only in the darkness of the soul, in the night. Nothing could be seen; it was only years later that the sparks began to run along the wires. I felt my soul moving to these shocks; it was at the time neither especially painful nor especially clear. ... During the liturgies, I felt nothing more than an inner trepidation, a trembling that one feels when one sees or hears or reads a beautiful work of art, but there was no precise warning to get me ready to make up my mind.

He continues:

I was simply emerging, little by little, from the shell of my moral impurity; I was beginning to be disgusted with myself, but still I balked at the articles of faith. The objections I placed in my path seemed irresistible to me; and one morning, when I awoke, they were resolved, how, I have never known. I prayed for the first time and the explosion happened.

In these events, Huysmans was following the course described by **John of Ruysbroeck**:

And from this love there come forth perfect contrition and purification of conscience. And these arise from the consideration of misdeeds and all that may defile the soul: for when a man loves God he despises himself and all his works.

Selected texts from John of Ruysbroeck: <https://gornahoor.net/?p=8452>

Posted on 2016-01-06 by Cologero

* * *

winchelljames1 on 2020-01-08 at 23:40 said:

Your opening lines seem to imply so much by saying so little, yet the little information they DO manage to convey ignores so much substance and nuance as to qualify as a kind of vacuous “negative space” of both literary criticism and history, to wit: “Joris-Karl Huysmans was present at the end of Naturalism in art.” Well, yes, this is correct as far as it goes—but as a young disciple of Emile Zola, who attended the regular salons of the Naturalist Master at his home in Médan, Huysmans was even more remarkably present—and active—at the coming-of-age of Naturalism as a literary-artistic movement, when those disciples’ early prose works, written under Zola’s tutelage and edited collectively as “*Les Soirées de Médan*,” were published in 1880—the same year Zola published his Naturalist manifesto, “*Le Roman expérimental*.” Such demurrers may be dismissed as “the tall grass” by those not in the field, but the truly off-handed overstatement and dismissive attitude conveyed in your second sentence may raise bristling hackles on the necks of even the most determined generalist: “By attempting to place so-called ‘real characters’ in ‘precise settings,’ the Naturalists ended up just repeating themselves.” This second clause does a gross disservice-by-reductionism to Zola’s theory and practice of Naturalism as he developed it over a span of some 20 novels (and they were big, ambitious, bulky, door-stop volumes, mind you) gathered under the names of the two families whose genealogies he attempted to trace (“*Les Rougon-Macquart*”), AND as he theorized the movement in the above-mentioned essay (“*Le Roman expérimental*”), published in 1880. The latter proves to be, upon inspection by anyone who might actually bother to read it, an extremely rational, detailed, pioneering (if only quasi-scientific, if not merely—and enjoyably—“Quack-xotic”) synthesis of then-current theories of evolution as had come down to him from Hippolyte Taine and Auguste Comte. Your gloss on the authors’ commitment to Realism at the heart of Naturalism sounds both musty and snobby (“so-called ‘real characters’...”), but I take most offense at your final clause: “...the Naturalists ended up just repeating themselves.” This complacent, dismissive, cocktail-party apothegm may sound informed and succinct, but alas reveals a most basic failure to grasp even the most basic premise of the movement: by recreating in the petri-dishes of fiction the evolutionary life-forces of aberrant breeding (“*race*” en français), specific history (“*moment*”) and recognizable locale (“*milieu*,” *topos*), Zola (naively, of course) believed that he might trace—or even predict—one, or some, of the evolutionary traits in the biology of human beings. You may be mistaking the “repetitions” you so blithely dismiss for the background of non-aberrations occurring “naturally” within any specimen-sample, or, of course, in “Nature” herself. Of course—Modern Art, or the advent of Impressionism and all subsequent Abstractions, begins with nothing less than the statement: Seen one landscape, seen ‘em all! Is it merely

an accident-coincidence?—that Impressionism is flowering at pretty much the same time as Naturalism is running—and completing—its course?

Cologero on 2020-01-09 at 08:18 said:

By the way, what you attributed to me was actually a quote from Huysmans' preface to the novel. So you are hardly the expert you seem to believe you are. From Huysmans: "In those days Naturalism was at its height; but this school of writers, which was to fulfil the invaluable service of placing real characters in precise settings, was condemned to repeat itself over and over, and endlessly to go over the same ground."

Which Zola himself did in his 20 prolix volumes, endlessly repeating himself.

winchelljames1 on 2020-01-10 at 02:48 said:

Au contraire, mon frère.

Cf. my complete response on FB page "Christian Pessimist Thinkers."

santiago on 2020-01-10 at 21:17 said:

I know next to nothing about the late history of Naturalism in art, so I hope this post won't be entirely irrelevant, but; in my experience, the 'life is a theme park' mentality is especially dangerous for those who have a 'transcendent', 'adventurous' or 'pioneering' inner constitution. Among these types, when infected with this disease of 'experience collecting' or 'thrill-seeking', one can find drug addicts, gamblers, sexual degenerates, brawlers, adrenaline junkies, etc. Re-reading Nietzsche recently, I think he, better than most, exemplified this tendency of a drive towards experience and self-actualization, and the consequences thereof, when divorced from any higher principles. It really is a shame. The darkest moments of my life have usually been preceded by having adopted this same mentality beforehand. I learned my lesson.

This reduction of life to a collection of separate 'experiences' only significant in themselves, and only measurable in their 'authenticity' as decided by the personal subjective observer, has consequences far greater than just addiction, depression and ambivalence. "By absurd and destructive actions, they sought to attain the only possible meaning of existence, after rejecting suicide as the radical solution for the metaphysically abandoned individual."

"Needless to say, the tortoise died, probably due to a disease of the shell."

8.II Evola: The Second Rumi?

Some souls learn nothing except from human masters; others have learned everything from invisible guides known only to them-

selves.

SHIHABODDIN YAHYA SOHRAVARDI

Fr. Frank Gelli, a Roman by birth, now an Anglican priest living in a predominantly Muslim section of London, recently made available on Amazon an e-book, *Julius Evola: The Sufi of Rome*. This book tries to work on two levels. Ostensibly, it is a record of the author's many encounters with **Julius Evola**. In the 1960s, the young Fr. Gelli was a member of a rightwing movement loosely affiliated with Julius Evola. The members, including Gelli, had occasional audiences with Evola. From there, Gelli was apparently singled out for special attention and became a regular visitor to Evola's flat.

He was strangely asked to keep their relationship private, presumably not to make the others envious. Not very convincing. But why after 40 years, has Fr. Gelli broken his silence to reveal what had been sealed? We'll take a guess at that in the end.

For the second level, Gelli seems convinced that Evola is a closeted Sufi, but of a special type. A *malamatiya* appears outwardly to bring blame on himself, but inwardly he is quite blameless and pious. Here Gelli is less convincing. Gelli assumes Guenon initiated Evola, but the two never met in person. He points out that Evola is rejected because of his associations with racism, anti-Semitism, and fascism. However, at the time Evola was writing on those topics, he didn't do it to bring blame on himself, rather he was trying to curry favour. Only after his side lost the war, did his positions on those issues put him on the wrong side of polite society.

It is true, nevertheless, that Evola attracts enemies and even worse friends for whatever reasons. I myself was publicly upbraided by a Sicilian professoressa from a local university when she found out I did translations of Evola. I found out later her specialty is Michel Foucault, who is a much more loathsome man. Albert Schweitzer was more explicitly

racist, but is regarded as a great humanitarian; T S Eliot was a cruder anti-Semite, but that never affected his career; Martin Heidegger was publicly part of the Nazi regime, but is still considered the best philosopher of last century. The reason why Evola is such a polarizing figure is not so easy to discern.

The Way of Blame Although he claims to be praising Evola, his portrayal is so pedestrian, it has the totally opposite effect. And it cannot be due to that Sufi path. There is a story of a Zen monk who was accused by a single woman of being the father of her bastard child. He said, “I see.” Then he took the young boy into his home and raised him. A few years later, the real father returned and the woman at last revealed the truth. When the real father came to claim his son, the monk handed him over.

Compare that to Evola’s behavior in a similar situation. Evola showed Gelli a letter from an Argentine woman who claimed she gave birth to his son. Evola protested to Gelli, doubting the proof of his paternity (that’s what happens with promiscuity), and wishing she had “done away with him”. Compare this story to the monk; unlike the monk, Evola actually was not blameless, and his character barely rises above ghetto life in the USA; certainly not what we would expect from a well-bred man.

Right Wing We learn little of the “right wing” group Gelli belonged to, other than they would meet in a specific café to chat, occasionally formulating a plan (usually instigated by a police informant). They were mostly thuggish types, and Gelli tells us nothing of their goals and platforms. He does reveal that it was riddled with homosexuals. Since all the loose women were on the left, Gelli often attended their rallies. He even became a Maoist in 1969, so it seems several years of conversation with Evola did not leave a lasting impression on him. Evola himself never seemed to what the right wing should be like. He did suggest that perhaps the remnants of European aristocracy may work something out.

Tradition It is likewise difficult to discern what was particularly “Traditional” in their chats. Evola participated in neither rites nor prayers. He never mentioned “God”, preferring, instead, allusions to a rather vague “transcendence”. But there was no discussion of initiation, how to reach higher states of consciousness, and so on.

Curiously, Evola told Gelli that the Roman Senate could not proceed in any course of action, until the Augurs approved it, based on their readings. But this illustrates the superiority of the spiritual authority, or sacerdotal caste, *pace* his own point of view. I suppose readers can take this as Sufi wisdom; I take it as an intellectual contradiction.

Omar Amin von Leers Evola asked Gelli, on his trip to Egypt, to visit Omar Amin von Leers¹⁶, a Nazi refugee and convert to Islam. Omar mysteriously claimed Evola was “one of us”. Gelli assumes that means Evola was a Muslim, but he could just as well mean he was a Nazi.

Lepanto Evola discussed the Turkish threat to Europe on one occasion, incorporating both historical details and the philosophy of Nicholas Cusanus. Despite lack of support from the kings of Northern Europe, the Pope was able to rally enough military support to stop the Turks at Lepanto. Interestingly enough, Evola did not praise this. He, along with Cusanus, preferred an ecumenical, or worldwide, unity. Left unsaid, we are left to assume that Evola expects that to happen under a Caliphate.

That will shock the European new right, who for the most part oppose Muslims in Europe. They will never give Pope Pius II credit for his efforts, nor will they consider their present plight the result of divine retribution.

Gelli makes much of an alleged prediction by Evola that Islam would someday dominate Europe. If so, he is merely parroting Guenon, which

¹⁶<http://www.andrewbostom.org/blog/2011/05/30/egyptian-islamo-nazism-and-%E2%80%99Omar-amin%E2%80%9D-von-leers/>

we pointed out already¹⁷. A spiritual vacuum in the West will make that likely, if not inevitable. Paganism has no chance of filling that vacuum, and the traditional spiritual authority of Europe is rejected by Evola; we can see Gelli's point.

Pope Julius Evola revealed a dream he had of becoming pope. He replaced the statues of the saints in the Vatican with those of the Roman deities. However, the saints rebelled and restored their statues. In frustration, Pope Julius conquered Moscow, where his troops slaughtered the populace indiscriminately. The Pope approved since he does not love his enemies. Perhaps out of boredom, he asked them to stop. When they refused he returned to Rome, he found it full of Turks who worshipped him as the Mahdi. The new pope balked when they asked him to be circumcised. Evola then woke up.

Readers may take that as a hidden message that paganism is a dead end path. Gelli never took Evola's paganism seriously, regarding it as a means to shock the complacent. Nevertheless, many today take Evola's paganism, racism, and anti-semitism quite seriously, so if that was not his intent, he should have been more clear.

Pagans don't shock anyone anymore. Perhaps had he converted to Traditional Catholicism (as did many of his followers in the 1980s), he would have shocked more people. At least, he would have kept his precious foreskin.

Love and Sex Evola curiously asserted that initiates cannot marry and have families. This is contrary to the entire Roman Tradition, which was dominated by fathers, who were the priests of their own household hearths. Instead, he proposes the life of a single man, but not without sexual relations. However, this is possible only in the modern and decadent

¹⁷<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=35>

world, not in the world of Tradition where women were more protected; certainly not in the world of Islam.

In talking of Eros, he points out that lovers are not thinking of children in the heat of passion. Too bad Fr. Gelli did not point out Dante's part of Hell for lovers. Keep reminding me, as I will do that soon.

It is a sign of intelligence to see the connection between sex and reproduction. Obviously, we now have superior technology, in contraception and safe abortions, to block that link. Evola fully supports that. He did not live to see the effects of population depletion now afflicting Europe, the effects of which won't be clear for another generation. However, the Montini pope did see that, but Evola never forgave him for a negative comment made 40 years before.

Loyalty Despite the talk of loyalty and keeping one's word, Evola seems loyal to no one or anything. He blames the Italian people for losing the War, calling them shit, and unworthy of their great Fascist state. However, a popular army is not composed of the warrior caste, and modern war is not won by valour alone, but rather by amassing superior and overwhelming resources. The Fascist conception is that the leader creates the people. So, it was the state that was shit, sending Italy into a war it was not materially prepared for.

He was not at all loyal to the spiritual authority of Italy. An anti-nationalist, he at one point praised the spiritual unity of Europe in the Middle Ages. Yet, simultaneously, he rejected that very spirit. That is not the kind of spiritual contradiction the Nicholas Cusanus was describing, but comes closer to incoherence.

Conclusion Shortly before Evola's death, Gelli emigrated to the UK, a nation and people that Evola had little respect for. That is where the story ends.

Gelli's recollections are of this nature. There are many interesting

tidbits, but nothing in much depth. Gelli assumes Evola took a special liking to him as a “son”; that makes little sense for reasons I’ll explain another time. What seems more likely is that Gelli stood out from the rest of the rightwing pack, so Evola enjoyed him as a conversation partner. Gelli has the intelligence to keep up with Evola’s many interests and he writes in an engaging fashion and is a good teller of tales. For those interested in the man behind the ideas, *The Sufi of Rome* is a satisfactory way to spend a summer afternoon in the mountains with your Kindle.

But, it seems Fr. Gelli has a further purpose in mind based on his rejection of Evola’s alleged racism and paganism. These, from his perspective, are merely Evola’s way of blame, hiding his true spiritual perspective from the world. Evola would then be the second Rumi (which means “Roman” in Arabic), working, perhaps on the supernatural plane, to bring Islam to the world. Or else he may just be a “beautiful loser”, destined to be misunderstood and ignored. I don’t think Fr. Gelli has cleared up any misunderstandings.

Readers will have to decide about Evola, but perhaps that is really Fr. Gelli’s projection. He told me he owes much to the spiritual perspective of **Henri Corbin**. Corbin was exoterically a Protestant, with a degree in Catholic Thomist philosophy. However, Corbin rejects the Incarnation. Corbin devoted much of his life to the study of Shi’ite and Sufi spirituality, of the sort explicitly preferred by Evola.

Corbin created a complex system relating the traditions of pre-Islamic Iran, Shi’ism, Hermetism, and Christianity. He also described a spiritual geography, where the East is not where you think, and the North, what we call Hyperborea, where the Midnight Sun (the Black Sun?) is the true light. Corbin also relates the Iranian cosmology to that of Nordic paganism. The Walkyries are equivalent to the Fravartis. This is just the surface of much deeper correspondences, which are too complex to discuss here.

Is this something known by the Sufi of Rome? Fr. Gelli would have us think so.

Posted on 2012-06-10 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-06-10 at 20:42 said:

I think Evola's dream about becoming Pope just eliminated whatever remaining romance Classical neopaganism had for me.

Jason-Adam on 2012-06-11 at 03:49 said:

I dont think Gelli is right in writing that Evola was against the defence of Europe from the Turks.

In Revolt against the Modern World, he wrote that it was a sign of decline that Christendom was unable to mount a crusade to recover Constantinople after it fell in 1453, also in the same book he castigated Francois I, the king of France, for making an alliance with the Turks and betraying the unity of Europe-Christendom.

In other writings, Evola made it clear he opposed conversion to Islam because he saw Islam as being un-European. It is important to note that while Evola did believe in the unity of Traditions, he did see the outward exoteric form (the culture) as not being transferable. It was not enough for him to be Traditional, he also had to be European.

If anyone is interested, I can post some links to articles by Evola that back up my points.

apeiron on 2012-06-11 at 22:50 said:

Since I haven't purchased a kindle and the author appears to have side-stepped a printed version(un-peered?), we'll just have to rely on second or third hand even information from the available reviews and comments. "The way of blame" is a fitting eulogy for an apprentice trying to rationalize his masters life and actions? In this case just live as you wish and someone will fill in the gaps of the misunderstood hero when you're dead.

Anyways to what extent can these claims be verified, if at all true:

1)"Evola showed Gelli a letter from an Argentine woman who claimed she gave birth to his son." Has Evola a son/s (if the promiscuity is to be believed) somewhere down in Argentina we never knew about?

2)" ... Gelli often attended their rallies. He even became a Maoist in 1969, so it seems several years of conversation with Evola did not leave a lasting impression on him."

This is most surprising but not too far-fetched, given Freda's position and Yockey's post-war "solidarity with the third world" anti-Anglo/American forces jibe. Evola had referred to those who had "regressed in character" later (not because of) despite reading his works. Perhaps Gelli and others fit this profile.

3)Omar Amin von Leers : Could easily be “on our side”, the semantics are of little importance either way.

4)Lepanto: Jules knew the crescent and the scimitar as lunar symbols of the reflected silver Semite. The solar cross was and is “our symbol”.

5)Pope Julius: What truth is there to this alleged dream or musing?

6)Love and Sex: “Evola curiously asserted that initiates cannot marry and have families.” Why did Guénon do Both (marry, have kids and being initiated)?

7)Loyalty: Evola kept a loyalty all his life to Rome(Amor). He also praised those who were willing to fight on in post-war Italy despite all and secondly that it was not Facism that failed but the Italian people who failed Facism regardless of the trappings of modern combat. Perhaps a fair statement.

8)At this point it's too close to call on the veracity of Gelli's “tales” and a thorough reading of the book , if ever it be published is in order. However, all else said, Henri Corbin is beginning to sound very interesting.

Cologero on 2012-06-12 at 18:01 said:

Apeiron, I think it can be read on any computer, not just a Kindle, although it may be a little pricey for an ebook. I TOFFT.

To be honest, if it concerned Frank Gelli and anyone else, no one would read it. Where he could have offered some good insights he declined. Specifically, he mentioned discussions about the “left hand path” and tantric experiences; these, unfortunately, are omitted from the book.

Claudio Mutti, an Italian convert to Islam, who knew Evola and Omar Amin von Leers wrote an thorough analysis of all of Evola's writings on Islam in *Islam in the eyes of Julius Evola*¹⁸. Clearly Evola had a high regard for Islam, although it appears doubtful he “converted” in any normal sense of the world.

AghorNath on 2012-06-13 at 02:19 said:

“he saw Islam as being un-European. It is important to note that while Evola did believe in the unity of Traditions, he did see the outward exoteric form (the culture) as not being transferable. It was not enough for him to be Traditional, he also had to be European.”

On the topic of transference it should be noted that Islamic civilization, wherever it's seeds were sown (by the very fact of its inherent universality and primordiality) always allowed the soil of the native lands which adopted an Islamic identity to retain its traditional weltanschauung, ethnic identity, customs(as long as it did not contradict ‘tawhid’ i.e. Divine Unity) and other localized flavors. The cultural manifestation of Islamic culture adapts where it's winds blow. The

¹⁸http://www.claudiomutti.com/index.php?url=6&imag=1&id_news=130

various cultural 'zoning' of Islamic migration which include, Arabic, Persian, Turkic, African(both in its black and arab/berber manifestations), Malay, Indian, Chinese, Slavic and a few others, only shows that its cultures and arts took on distinct localized character of it's Islamic inheritance. I find it hard to believe that Baron Evola found the idea that European identity would be usurped by any primordial traditional social changes. If perhaps Evola did utter that Islam was "un-European"(keeping in mind that if he did, he could have said it in his earlier days, and changed his mind as he matured), he probably had in mind Sunni Islam, and not Shi'ite Islam, which in fact is esoteric by its very nature, thus granting, or rather, allowing, an organic transferable acceptance of Islam to Europe as a whole.

Egemen on 2012-06-13 at 04:21 said:

Your last link; "Islam in the eyes of Julius Evola" is fantastic. Thanks for your sharin'.

Mihai on 2012-06-14 at 06:01 said:

I think that this whole thing is just a fantastic story, entirely made-up.

Jason-Adam on 2012-06-18 at 19:08 said:

In response to AgorNath – Evola did not have a complete understanding of Islam, there is another article by Claudio Mutti entitled "Evola and Nasser" (see <http://www.centrostudilaruna.it/evolaenasser.html>) that shows some errors he made such as assuming that the Wahabi sect (an anti-Traditional cult from the XVIIIth century) was somehow orthodox Muslim. Evola also saw Roman Tradition (and the Roman spiritual race it created) as being superior to others and thus he would not accept receiving tradition, as a Roman writing for Romans, from a non-Roman source. Obviously there are many ways the holes in his logic can be attacked. *Evola and Nasser*¹⁹ is also available in English – admin

Cologero on 2012-06-22 at 22:59 said:

Yes, Jason-Adam, there are always two points of view on such a matter; e.g., in the Middle Ages, Muslim scholars regarded European races as unfit for civilization. For example, Said of Toledo wrote:

The other peoples (apart from the Chinese and Turks) that do not cultivate the sciences, resemble rather beasts than men; as regards those that live in the lands of the far North, bordering on the uninhabited part of the globe, the prolonged absence of the sun renders the air cold and the atmosphere in which they live less clear; accordingly they are men of a cold temperament and never reach maturity; they are of great stature and of a white colour, with long

¹⁹http://www.claudiomutti.com/index.php?url=6&imag=1&id_news=206

and lank hair. But they lack all sharpness or wit and penetration of intellect, and among them predominate ignorance and stupidity, mental blindness, and barbarism.

Cologero on 2012-06-29 at 14:18 said:

When I wrote this review, the book was about 280,000 on Amazon. It rose to 110,000 in the course of a week. Now it is falling like a rock.

Aghorable on 2012-06-30 at 03:06 said:

What cause for surprise? Islam in Europe was absorbed most thoroughly by peoples across the Mare Adriaticum from Italia, starting from around 700 A.H. and surviving there until today. Even the Egypt where Guenon and others found solace from the West was fathered by an Albanian, Mehmet Ali Pasha. Perhaps the winds carried some secret songs to Evola from the Dinaric Heights as he stalked the Italian Alps?

We are in agreement with AghorNath's comment above, and add for clarification that the Bosniaks, for instance, are mostly Sunni Muslims, yet this has not prevented a thoroughly organic adaptation of Islam from taking root there. To conceive of Islam in emulation of the Arabic fashion is indeed not mandatory, and has only become prominent with the rise of Wahhabism, and this is to be regretted. The traveler to Bosnia is saddened by the sight of austere white-washed Saudi-sponsored mosques replacing elaborate old Ottoman mosques that were razed in recent conflict.

Jason-Adam on 2012-07-02 at 21:30 said:

@Aghorable

Is not ancestor worship though part of Tradition ? One dilemma that will have to be overcome if you are correct is that if Islam is the true religion, then the ancestors of the European aristocracy who fought and died for Catholicism were in error. If shown to be in error, the aristocracy can lose its entire basis for legitimacy.

Aghorable on 2012-07-03 at 01:51 said:

Jason-Adam, Islam, understood in the conventional sense as a particular religion, is not 'the true religion' any more than Catholicism or any other. The covenant between God and man remains valid in both religions, and their respective faithful do not maintain their belief in vain. So the Catholic aristocracy of the past maintains its right in God.

The very perspective that involves a comparison of these faiths to discern the truth is, in the last analysis, an exoteric one; the highest Truth effaces them both, together with apparent contradictions, and this is the goal of esoterism. Because of the times that we live in, even

those students not in a position to aspire to the actual realization of this as a goal are privy to the didactic statement of its truth and consequences. This constitutes a good theoretical preparation for them, but the privilege also entails a certain responsibility; namely, permitting one's consciousness to acknowledge the existence of a superior universalism (not to be confused with its modern parody, 'globalism'). Naturally, if one is not up to the task of such a responsibility, he may always retreat to pure and simple worship according to the laws of his faith; no man should be compelled to wrangle with esoterism, nor do we need them doing so.

Ancestor worship is noble, but it does not simply entail unvarying ancestral emulation, because the descendant does not live under the same stars. Nor can it be asked whether a rule is a part of 'Tradition' as such, because there are multiple traditional forms*; but we take it that you refer to that continuity of sympathy by blood that lives on in those men who are not deracinated moderns. So if the question is not about discerning a 'true' religion and thus determining obligations, but whether a Catholic becoming Muslim by preference thereby dishonors his ancestors, then the answer must be determined according to perspectives and details. In our case, men of European heritage and students of metaphysic, a parallel question asks whether we accept the charge that it was dishonorable for pagans to become Catholic? Are we to unreservedly regret and lament our Catholic heritage on that account? Some do, but we share no such sentiment. In the plenitude of God, there is, so to speak, room for brothers to face off on the battlefield by day, and to drink and dance alongside the fire by night.

The proud race must be able to assimilate anything extrinsic that it chooses to assimilate, thus making it its own in synthesis. And the function of the highest caste, the men of aether, in such a race must be to guide this assimilation with the luminous knowledge that nothing good is really extrinsic, for what can come to us from outside of the Supreme Being?

*If we could recall the title, we would refer readers to Cologero's article on this matter.

Aghorable on 2012-07-03 at 02:06 said:

The article mentioned in the above *note is "*The Absurdity of Traditionalism*"²⁰

See also "*Guenon and Islam*"²¹

Saladin on 2012-10-30 at 20:08 said:

With all due respect Cologero, this article does not convey the irony adequately! And I have a high opinion of your writing in general.

That aside, HOO's mention of crypto-gynaecocratic had me thinking... Could there be some truth to that?!

²⁰<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=728>

²¹<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=4412>

Saladin on 2012-10-30 at 20:15 said:

Jason, anyone familiar with Evola's work clearly knows that he was not against defending Europe from the Turks. Frankly imagining the Maestro as a Sufi makes me laugh! By the way I am a moslem by birth.

Cologero on 2012-10-30 at 20:58 said:

With all due respect, Saladin, if I did not convey the irony adequately, it is most likely because I did not see it.

If you believe there is something "crypto-gynaecocratic" about Gornahoor, it is up to you to point it out specifically. As Chicalinda recently said, women do not think logically, so they believe it suffices to just put a label on something and call people names, as Hoo did. It is something else to actually build up a case.

Hoo also accused us of fabricating the non-existent meeting between Evola and Guenon. We painstakingly produced correspondence between them over the course of decades. As is obvious, their relationship was cordial, yet strained. We also see from the letters that in the late 40s, Evola was asking for Guenon's picture because *Evola had no idea what Guenon looked like!* Not did he know Guenon's age. So how could anyone believe they had ever met in person?

I'm still waiting for an apology from HOO and I am very patient.

But that is how a man thinks and acts, he builds his case logically and thoroughly, no matter what you may have been told elsewhere.

Cologero on 2012-10-30 at 21:02 said:

Saladin, Evola was not the Maestro, Guenon was the Maestro. Evola himself referred to Guenon in those terms.

Graham on 2012-10-30 at 23:30 said:

The last paragraph is astute. A penchant for irony often indicates a deeprooted insincerity.

Saladin on 2012-10-31 at 21:12 said:

Regarding the "crypto-Gynaecocratic" comment: I am new to this site but one of the very first posts I read was about Bulldog (or maybe it was Pitbull). The writer of that post had put this "artist" on the pedestal as a "real" man worthy of emulation. This and other posts by the same writer was the cause of my raising the G question.

I am with you on the issue of a Guenon-Evola meeting. Although one can never be certain, the logic of your argument against the possibility of such a meeting is convincing enough. By the way, let me thank you for reproducing/translating such valuable information on this Blog as correspondence between Guenon and Evola.

That a man “builds his case logically and thoroughly” I agree! A man also is not afraid to apologize, so maybe HOO will do just that.

Cologero on 2012-11-01 at 10:50 said:

“Gynaecocracy”, if it means anything, means rule by women; justification for that cannot be found on Gornahoor.

What “critics” imply by that, however, is the false distinction between allegedly lunar and solar traditions. Tradition, to be called such, leads to knowledge of the Absolute, or Tao, since we are in a Taoist frame of mind lately. Any system whose ultimate reality is either the yin or the yang (as the terms lunar and solar would indicate), rather than the Tao, is incomplete, hence cannot be a Tradition in any true sense.

Would anyone seriously consider Dante, Hafiz, Rumi, Ibn Al'Arabi to be crypto-gynaecocratic because of their acknowledgment of the feminine?

I think Chicalinda mentioned pitbull as a man with charisma able to influence women; that is simply a fact. What I would take from it is that a “real man” will also have that charisma, even if there are few real men around today. A “real man” with such charisma will inspire entire nations to follow God’s ways. I believe, Saladin, you may be able to think of some examples.

Frank Gelli on 2016-12-12 at 11:37 said:

Haha! Zarathustra laughs out loud!

Cologero on 2016-12-12 at 12:49 said:

We are all having a good time here, Fr. Gelli!

8.12 **Attack Thoughts and Cold Hearts**

O you, sweet warm soul, how inspired I was in your arms.

RICHARD WAGNER in a letter to Judith Gauthier

And when man falls silent in his torment.
A god allowed me to say what I’m suffering.

GOETHE, *Marienbad Elegy*

Und wenn der Mensch in seiner Qual verstummt.
Gab mir ein Gott zu sagen, was ich leide.

GOETHE, *Marienbader Elegie*

I carry peace in me,
I carry in myself the forces that strengthen me
I want to fulfil myself with these forces of warmth,
I want to permeate myself with my will power.
And I want to feel how peace pours through all my
being,
When I am strong, peace as power.
To find within me through the power of my striving.

RUDOLF STEINER

Attack Thoughts The recent guest post about correct thinking²² coincides synchronistically with our group exercise on observing negative thoughts. On the same day, the quote from the Orthodox priest, the **Elder Thaddeus of Vitovnica**, about the effect of attack thoughts also showed up.

Although I don't like to promote New Age ideas, the Elder's teaching that our thoughts determine our lives is not so incompatible with the *Course in Miracles*. It is no secret that I diligently performed the exercises daily for one year, more than a couple of decades ago. I did learn the role that our thoughts play in our lives. I certainly don't recommend the main text, but some of the exercises are worthwhile. What is relevant are the exercises on Attack Thoughts²³.

Conversations and discussions often devolve into mock legal battles. Instead of a dialectic leading toward a higher aim, there is nothing but

²²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=10120>

²³https://gornahoor.net/?page_id=10130

attack and defence, in an endless loop. If the initial attack is fueled by intense passion, even a guilty plea will often not suffice. Ideally, at least between friends, the attack should not even start. When there is a misunderstanding on one side, or a poorly phrased statement on the other, a request for clarification should be the first step. That most often will rectify the issue before hard divisions are formed.

After all these years, those daily exercises I performed are still fresh in my mind. In a way, this demonstrates the wisdom of Rudolf Steiner's assertion that a mere 5 minutes per day of careful thinking can change your life. Those exercises took little more time than that. I'll leave you with this idea:

Today's idea accurately describes the way anyone who holds attack thoughts in his mind must see the world. Having projected his anger onto the world, he sees vengeance about to strike at him. His own attack is thus perceived as self defence. This becomes an increasingly vicious circle until he is willing to change how he sees. Otherwise, thoughts of attack and counter-attack will preoccupy him and people his entire world. What peace of mind is possible to him then?

The Decameron Ever since I was a boy, I've been an avid reader. Also, an active reader, like the boy in the *Neverending Story*, who inserts himself into the story. From Tom Corbett to Robert Heinlein novels, then to Ian Fleming and assorted detective and pulp fiction novels. I also read the best authors. But it is in novels like *Siddhartha*, *Steppenwolf*, *Là-bas*, and *Zanoni* that I still find my life story played out.

So the great authors have been my invisible friends who have shaped my life and my thoughts. **Giovanni Boccaccio** was among them. I regard him as a high initiate of the Fedeli d'Amore, while others only see a wise observer of the human condition, or merely a clever story teller.

His stories are alchemical transformations, that convert the vices and foibles of men and women into a deep insight into humanity, most often by some clever or unexpected catalyst. The stories were intended as a diversion to women since at that time they weren't granted the pastimes of men. He writes regarding women:

Women are restricted by the wishes, whims, or commands of fathers, mothers, brothers, and husbands. They remain most of the time restricted to the narrow confines of their bedrooms, where they sit in apparent idleness, now wishing one thing and now wishing another, turning over in their minds a number of thoughts.

But men have more choices:

If men are afflicted by melancholy or ponderous thoughts, they have many ways of alleviating or forgetting them. If they wish, they can take a walk or listen to or look at many different things. They can go hawking, hunting, or fishing. They can ride, gamble, or attend to business.

However, in our day, women are free to pursue distractions just as men do. Nonetheless, they still seem to occupy their minds with a number of thoughts. Sometimes, these thoughts take offense at the stories.

Boccaccio anticipated this, and justified his style as an Afterward. Here follow some snippets. Just as Jesus said we are not made impure by what we eat, Boccaccio makes a similar argument:

A corrupt mind never understands a word in a healthy way! And just as fitting words are of no use to a corrupt mind, so a healthy mind cannot be contaminated by words which are not so proper, any more than mud can dirty the rays of the sun.

To the women who objected to his words, Boccaccio replied:

Nothing is so indecent that it cannot be said to another person if the proper words are used to convey it; and this, I believe, I have done very well.

As for right speech, it all depends on the situation. Boccaccio explains:

These tales were not told in a church, where things must be spoken of with the proper frame of mind and suitable words. Nor were they held in schools of the philosophers, where a sense of propriety is required. But they were told in a garden, in a place suited for pleasure, in the presence of young people, who were nevertheless mature and not easily misled by stories.

This blog is my home and my garden and I have invited you all as guests. Sometimes my tales are serious, sometime more humorous or even ribald. Please indulge me as your host. I don't want to offend, but if so, I stand on Boccaccio's defences. If you prefer to convict me instead, things are just how they are.

The Conversion of Abraham The reason I include this story is as an antidote to all the hysteria going on about Rome. We can see that the moral level of 14th century Rome was probably worse than what there is today. To not feel dispirited by current events, we need to take the long view of human history. We've seen it all happen before, we've seen empires appear and disappear, battles won and lost, hopes dashed, loves lost, faiths shaken. Yet we persist, knowing the final victory will be ours.

One of the tales was about a Parisian merchant, Giannotto, and his close friend Abraham, who was a Jew. This story is certainly not an attack on Rome. Rather, it shows how the Holy Spirit can transform the worst in man into something Holy. There is no other way to understand it.

Giannotto and Abraham were both respected and trustworthy gentleman. Of course, the topic of religion often came up between these

friends of different faiths. Giannotto always failed to convince Abraham to convert.

Eventually Abraham made a proposal. He would travel to Rome to see the Pope and the cardinals. If they were truly holy men, then Abraham would convert. Giannotto was shocked at that since he was aware of the wicked and filthy lives of the clergy in Rome. Believing that Abraham would never convert if he saw that, he tried to dissuade Abraham from his trip, but Abraham persisted.

Once in Rome, Abraham observed carefully the behaviour of the Pope, cardinals, and other prelates. Boccaccio describes what was seen:

They all shamelessly participated in the sin of lust, not only the natural kind of lust but also the sodomitic variety, without the least bit of remorse or shame. And this they did to the extent that the influence of whores and young boys was of no little importance in obtaining great favours. Besides this, he observed that all of them were open gluttons, drinkers, and sots, and that after their lechery, just like animals, they were more servants of their bellies than of anything else; the more closely he observed them, the more he saw that they were all avaricious and greedy for money and that they were just as likely to buy and sell human (even Christian) blood as they were to sell religious objects pertaining to the sacraments or connected to benefices ... they called their blatant simony “mediation” and their gluttony “maintenance” as if God did not know the intention of these wicked minds.

After he returned to Paris, Abraham told Giannotto about his experience:

I don't like them a bit and may God condemn them all; and I tell you this because as far as I was able to determine, I saw there no holiness, no devotion, no good work or exemplary life, or anything else among the clergy. Instead, lust, avarice, gluttony, fraud,

envy, pride, and the like and even worse, were so completely in charge there that I believe the city is more a forge for the Devil's work than for God's: in my opinion, the Shepard of yours and all the others as well are trying as quickly as possible and with all the talent and skill they have to reduce the Christian religion to nothing and to drive it from the face of the earth when they really should act as its support and foundation.

To Giannotto's surprise and delight, Abraham concluded that, under those circumstance, only the Holy Spirit could be the real foundation. Hence they went off to Notre Dame for Abraham's baptism.

Posted on 2018-09-14 by Cologero

* * *

Lavender on 2018-09-15 at 10:01 said:

I don't understand the ending at all, why is "only the Holy Spirit could be the real foundation" the conclusion?

Should we not judge the tree by it's fruit?

James on 2018-09-15 at 11:30 said:

I wouldn't confuse the fruits for the fertilizer , Lavender . God's light makes the faithful heart grow . His forgiveness waters its roots . His Spirit breathes life invisibly into each organic heart . I suppose , to learn by analogy , there is a great mystery on as to why such fruitful and sweet things come out of the , literally , crappiest soils .

The clergy are not the fruits of the tree . Can some clergy be fruits ? Yes .

Still , the question is a bit deeper .

What it sounds like to me is that Abraham has had an "encounter" with Catholicism already . Perhaps it was through his friend . In essence , Abraham has some idea of something supernatural . He goes to Rome to test if this strange and "new life" that he witnesses with his friend or Catholicism as a whole is man-made or God-made .

Seeing how incredibly human the clergy are , he soundly realizes that this unmentioned encounter – or this intuition that he has that something extraordinary is present (perhaps seeing it through his friend) , he realizes that only a supernatural being could produce such fruits against all "natural" odds .

It is an interesting story and idea – the idea that we can “eliminate” the human factor “through” the human factor . The miracle of the Church , ironically , is that it literally “is” the body of Christ .

After all , the body of Christ is indeed a human one . His physical body contains all of the imperfections of humanity’s physicality . In other words , he was also physically dirty at times . Dirt would cling to Him ; bacteria would help His intestines digest food . It could be pierced . It could bleed . It did get pierced . It did bleed .

The Church is an interesting elevation to a higher consideration of Christ’s physicality . The Church becomes a metaphysical meditation on Christ .

And here is where I , at least in my limited knowledge , understand Christianity :

Many Jews could not recognize Christ because they assumed the messiah would be clean and grand .

There is a certain smugness to assume that we are no longer vulnerable to the pitfalls of some of these Jews and yet why do so many of us cling to the idea that for the Church to be true , she must be totally washed clean ?

If the Body of Christ in physicality endured the dirtiness of the Levant’s sands , then why do we assume that the spiritual manifestation of this Body in the Church would not suffer the dirt of the world as well ? Yet the very core of the Church never changes even while dirt clings to her . No dogma , teaching , or miracle has been altered or changed even while the lowliest inhabit her halls . After all , despite how dirty the world was in Christ’s time , Christ never suffered illness nor was He ever corrupted . Yes , we use the word “corrupt” to apply to many clergymen , but the very core – the interior world of the Church – her teachings and her spirituality were never infiltrated . It is here that we find “the tree” that you are looking for . It is there that you can judge if the fruits exist or not .

I will also say that reading Dante as a young man made it very easy for me to understand the supernatural basis of the Church . The Divine Comedy itself is one such fruit that convinced me of the existence of this Eternal Truth . After all , how could something so ... “beautiful” exist ? And yet Dante spends nearly half the lines talking about how ridiculously bad the clergy are . I know Catholics who refuse to read the Sublime poet “because he puts Popes in Hell” .

Still , Dante , as Pope Benedict XV would say in an encyclical , is “the most eloquent singer of the Christian idea” . Grappling with the paradox and scandal of perfection wrapped in limitation and imperfection (and thus understanding the existential position of the Church in modernity) is the very encounter of the Incarnation . Anyone who is able to eat that flesh and drink that blood (especially as they watched His body being crucified) will truly have life eternal . It is not easy nor is it an intellectual exercise (hence why the flesh must be eaten rather than simply looked upon – it must be COMMUNED with rather than studied) . Even if one is faithful , only one of the apostles was able to remain at the foot of the cross (and as a reward received Wisdom herself into his home as his mother) .

Anyone who debates this fact rather than peacefully meditates upon it unto acceptance is, in some ways, “doomed”. He who lives by the sword dies by it. He who lives by debate (i.e. the sword since the sword is a tool of ‘bifurcation’ or ‘justice’ or ‘judgement’) dies by debate even if he is ultimately right. After all, the apostles who fled and could not synthesize or could not “reconcile” GOD DYING ON THE CROSS ended up martyred. This is not some kind of threat for martyrdom is not at all to be looked down upon, but there is a privilege to attaining peaceful acceptance and faith that does not become hindered by internal “discourse”. John was able to stay and, thus, John was able to see even to the end of the world. It does not make John “superior” in the earthly sense. He still observed the hierarchy even while taking a “better” path. After all, even though the Archangel Michael is the Prince of the Heavenly Host, it is the Seraphim who are ranked higher than even he. (How hierarchy exists in the different emanations is .. not something I know much about anyway so I’m only guessing by intuition here).

I cannot rightfully express all of these thoughts in just short lines, but there are certainly many threads to this that come to mind.

argusandphoenix on 2018-09-15 at 12:12 said:

The Abraham story was helpful: I anticipated the ending. There is something in that.

Max on 2018-09-16 at 20:16 said:

There are some relevant thoughts for the discussion in “The Philosophy of Freedom”. Despite having a difficult time following Steiner’s style, I finally managed to finish the book this weekend (along with three other titles that had piled up). His initial remarks together with the concluding ones were the best, while much of the inbetween felt like filling.

“No system of Ethics can ever invent other tasks than the realization of those satisfactions which human desires demand, and the fulfillment of man’s moral ideas. No Ethical theory can deprive him of the pleasure which he experiences in the realization of what he desires.”

This is a critique meant for those who would wish for a false start in seemingly safe but bloodless “oughts”, rather than coming to terms with what is actually found in the soul. Desires are very valuable, and ought not to be squandered. It is not helpful to raise ethical systems that dismisses all pursuit of pleasure as immoral. Without it, humans would ultimately not do much of anything, and even less achieve learning or wisdom. The pleasure associated with fulfilling ones moral ideal, which is the desire of the spirit, makes it worthwhile to endure every pain. Morality means the fullest development of human nature. This teaching will however -says Steiner- be easily misunderstood by half-fledged youths and developmentally stunted beings. The mature man makes use of the generic features and peculiarities that he was dealt as a material, and imparts on it a form.

“Anyone who wants to eradicate the pleasure which the fulfillment of human desires brings,

will have first to degrade man to the position of a slave who does not act because he wills, but because he must.”

The Philosophy of Freedom sets three distinct options before us; find our motive in our moral imagination, imitate others; do nothing.

Moving on, Steiner cautions us to see too much of the generic woman in women. It risks sounding too much like the cliché that “everybody is unique”, but the difference for Steiner and other esotericists is that individuality is not just a question of quantification, but essentially belongs to an order of a larger whole. Individuality is not easy to understand as evidenced by its modern distortions.

“Those who always mix their own ideas into their judgement on another person can never attain to the understanding of an individuality.

Women are today still as much victims (to a greater degree than men) to the trap of the generic as at the time of Steiner’s reflections, and that despite their supposed emancipation. Instead of “the general idea of womanhood”, which he laments, we have now progressed to a general idea of whoredom. A definite danger is how desires implanted from the outside comes to be admitted as ones own, obfuscating our true desire, and serving as its parody.

Our contemporaries are also severely mentally challenged in distinguishing between considerations and deeds. It may very well be risky to consider a thought, but neither can we reject it forcefully unless we do. Half-thought thoughts are more dangerous, and hence, do not go there at all, or go all the way.

Mikkel on 2018-09-17 at 16:58 said:

I had been researching the Elders as well when Elder Thaddeus specifically came up, perhaps good algorithms at play? Nevertheless I did choose to watch and listen... While many flock to articles that state “5 quick tips to boost self confidence”, practical techniques and their ideas such as these are largely ignored except in those derivative ways, the gulf feels vast when attempting to discuss the merits of these ideas or even in normal conversation when noticing another’s presumptions that their world is built on. Maybe we just need better search results, though an elite will never be formed in that concept... I will journal how they work for me, I hope to make use of it.

On the state of the Church, thank you for sharing that story, interesting to see the variety of responses from the ‘public’: “close your wallets to the Church until it is reformed”, “this is what made me stop being Catholic”, it makes me think about the actual type of person who ends at that decision (as well as their allowed influences), as if salvation and the Way can ever be mitigated by external influences. As we seek to understand the Age of the Spirit, it seems relevant that the foundation of the Church is of the Spirit. Joachim of Fiore was mentioned jokingly about being the foundation of a Church that only has one member which he himself created the Church he was in (a recently popular individual was talking about this in an interview), how can ones

interior truly reflect the Church of the Spirit though? This is an exercise I've been thinking about recently.

If the type of person like Abraham is out there, perhaps more so there needs to be more Giannotto's to be friends to those Abrahams.

Mikkel on 2018-09-17 at 17:20 said:

@Max

It does risk sounding that "everybody is unique" (sentimental) and there is reasoning to that. When we look at what Guenon wrote in *Man and His Becoming*, he specifically denotes the difficulties in the Western perspective interchanging the words Self & Ego and Personality & Individuality respectively, specifically critiquing Theosophists' use of the terms interchangeably in the incorrect way, ie. Self/Individuality, Ego/Personality, the reverse is true. Reminds me of why "Every Man and Every Woman is a star" is completely misused, when thought of in combination with the next statement "Every number is infinite; there is no difference." this seems to have more significance on the Self and Individuality and the commonality from which it descends from, one of many possibilities but still from the infinite. Quoting Guenon, "it (center of individuality) effectually possess this reality only through participation in the nature of the 'Self', that is, insofar as it is identified therewith by universalization", this is from Chapter 2 if curious.

I wonder if seeing "too much" of the generic woman in women (or any X in x1 issue) is a issue in projection from that individuality onto the whole in the first place rather than truly understanding the transcendent principle from which it derives from in the first place. Does anyone else remember the Gornahoor posts on mathematical sets and what they mean about the person as analogy? This is what comes to mind reading this. At the same time, that transcendent principle of the Self cannot be individualized as it cannot be fragmented from itself, so perhaps this is the idea that Steiner is speaking to and I think you are saying as well that a one sided approach does very little into really grasping these concepts. To then apply those concepts onto people thinking it is true leads to more ignorance, Matthew 7:1-3?

Of course the emancipation that women have received is nothing of the sort given it has come from a place of revolution, resentment, and the like, to begin with on manufactured 'principles'. When you say the dangers of how desires are implanted from the outside, I am reminded of how women and in general people in our society are portrayed in order to be "valuable" though they know nothing of what value is, this becomes entrenched in people's brains to the point where nothing else is known any longer and has fully taken over their thought processes, how do we help remove those from ourselves and others?

8.13 The End of Patriarchy

Giovanni Boccaccio, in *On Famous Women*, relates the story of the Queen of Lemnos. During the reign of her father, King Thoas, the women rebelled against the patriarchy. Boccaccio describes it:

The women were seized by madness and withdrew their untamed necks from the yoke of men. Scorning the old king's rule, they unanimously decided that on the following night they would turn their knives against all the men. They did not fail to carry out their plan.



The women all carried out their plan, except for Hypsipyle. She secretly allowed her father to flee on a ship bound for Chios and pretended to cremate his corpse. She was then made queen. Boccaccio draws a moral from this story:

The devotion of children toward their fathers is certainly very holy. What is more proper, more just, and more praiseworthy than to reward with humanness and honour those from whose labour we received nourishment when we were weak and who watched over us with solicitude, brought us to maturity with continuous love, taught us manners and gave us knowledge, enriched us with honours and abilities, and made us strong in morals and in intellect? Since Hypsipyle solicitously repaid this debt to her father, it is not without reason that she is placed among noble women.

Boccaccio is describing the fourth commandment to honour one's father and mother. As with all such commandments, a resistance develops. We don't know the reasons that motivated the women of Lemnos

to murder their fathers, husbands, brothers, and sons. Yet we can be sure they felt justified, just as similar sentiments arise in our own time. Perhaps the fathers in Lemnos were not as ideal as those described by Boccaccio. That can't be the whole story, because a man who appears today to be such a father is still not protected against those knives.

I listened briefly tonight to an Internet figure who claims to be right wing, devoted to evidence and reason, before turning it off in contempt. He asserted that such devotion toward the fathers is an abnormality, based on genetic programming. Without any evidence or facts to back him up, he claimed that in early societies, the young had to respect and agree with their elders or risk losing the source of their sustenance. Those with the "genes" for conformity survived. This is a denial of a moral universe; as we see from the story, there is a moral choice involved. Piety is the virtue of loving one's parents and, by extension, one's ancestors and way of life; it is not a genetic defect.

To continue the story, **Jason** and his Argonauts arrived on the island. We can assume that Hypsipyle was filled with desire, so she invited Jason to her bed. The result was twin sons. She had to send them away under the laws of Lemnos, so she sent them to Chios to be raised by her father. This act revealed her earlier deception. The women revolted against her and she, too, had to escape on a ship. Things did not go well for Hypsipyle at this point. Pirates seized and enslaved her. She was then given to Lycurgus and served as a governess to his son. He was killed by a snake while in her care, bringing her great grief.

By chance, her sons found her and took her away to safety. Although she was cared for by her father and her sons, the other men she encountered were not so solicitous toward her. They used her for their own purposes.

Jason, in particular, who reneged on his promise of eternal fidelity to Hypsipyle, ended up in the eighth circle of hell for his deceit, seduction, and abandonment. (**Dante**, *Inferno*)

Posted on 2018-10-02 by Aeneas

* * *

argusandphoenix on 2018-10-04 at 07:36 said:

Even assuming something comes “after” patriarchy, something improved, the era of the polar beings perhaps, it would necessarily follow that matriarchy is movement in the other direction. If we’re stuck with patriarchy until we appreciate it, we will be in it a long, long time. The virulent section of the current Red Pill-manosphere crowd reminds me of Evola’s warnings that an “Assyrian” or “titanic” period follows up the Demetrian Silver Age of Matriarchy (Revolt Against the Modern World).

8.14 Angels, Templars, and Joseph de Maistre

We must be ready for a profound event in the divine order, toward which we are marching with an accelerated speed that must strike all observers. Terrible oracles already announce that *the time has come*.

JOSEPH DE MAISTRE, *Soirées de Saint-Petersbourg*

Herein, we review the following books:

- Seven Archangels: Rhythms of Inspiration in the History of Culture and Nature²⁴ by **Emil Pales**
184 pages in full colour, linen hardcover with dust jacket, format 190 x 135 mm, 115 colour illustrations, 105 diagrams
- Contra Mundum: Joseph de Maistre & The Birth of Tradition²⁵ by **Thomas Garrett Isham**

²⁴<http://www.sophia.sk/en/kniha/sedem-archanjelov>

²⁵<https://angelicopress.org/product/contra-mundum/>

- The Templars: Knights of Christ²⁶ by Regine Pernoud
- *Studies in Freemasonry & the Compagnonnage* by **Rene Guenon**

Angelology First of all, we should mention that the book itself is a work of art. A finely crafted hardcover printed on glossy paper with dozens of illustrations and diagrams. It even comes with a purple ribbon for bookmarking. The appendix is also of interest. It is comprised of a series of seven images of the angels by the artist David Newbatt, along with a detailed interpretation.

Emil Pales is a philologist and mathematician living in Slovakia. His aim is to continue the theology of Sophia which was developed by Vladimir Solovyov. This involves, as we have pointed out, the synthesis of science, art, philosophy, and religion. He claims Goethe, the biologist Adolph Portmann, and Rudolf Steiner, as other influences.

The main idea is that the seven named Archangels are really the spirits of the seven traditional planets, viz., the Greek gods associated with them; he even traces them back to the Babylonians. Each of the Archangels rules or influences a specific time period in human history. Using statistical techniques, Dr. Pales has documented periodic cross-cultural changes in human history. This book is an abridgment of the 1500 page Slovak version, which has more extensive supporting documentation. We miss the days when the educated would communicate and publish in Latin; there are only so many languages one can learn.

Dr. Pales offers this explanation:

Angelology is a spiritual astronomy. It is a science about introspective observation of phenomena in the spiritual sky.

Star and angel are used interchangeably in the bible, since angels are the spiritual intelligence of the stars. Just as the planets and stars have

²⁶<https://angeluspress.org/products/templars-knights-christ>

their laws and cycles, so too does the activity of the angels. Their activity can be noticed on three distinct levels:

- 1. The evolution of the universe
- 2. Changes in human culture
- 3. The developmental stages in the life of the human being

The correspondence between the planets and the angelic intelligences was pointed out in *Tantra Vidya*²⁷ by **Oscar Hinze**. Using a totally different approach, he demonstrated that the correspondences between the chakras and the planets could not have arisen by chance. This would account for the third level. Dr. Pales goes further, showing that levels one and two are not random processes, but are rather the manifestation of deeper metaphysical laws. For reference, Table 8.1 has the correspondences noted in the book.

Table 8.1: Planet correspondences

Planet	Babylon	Angel	Description
Moon	Sin	Gabriel	The archangel of the Moon - Enlivener of nature - Inspirer of childhood and the Baroque - The most picturesque of the angels - Unrecognized by scientists and philosophers - The queen of the heavens is alive

²⁷<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=8618>

Table 8.1: Planet correspondences

Planet	Babylon	Angel	Description
Mercury	Nabu	Raphael	The archangel of Mercury - The patron of physicians, botanists and linguists - The geological age of Mercury. The birth of Gothic - The inspirer of rationalism and the Enlightenment - The joker and protector of youth
Venus	Innana	Anael	The archetype of love and beauty - The spirit of puberty - The muse of fine arts. Soul copper - Compassionate saints - Romantics, mystics and revolutionaries - Patron of alchemists
Sun	Shamash	Michael	The sun of truth - The spirit of the Paleozoic era - Michaelic art - Sun cults - The inspirer of philosophy - The history of democracy - The task of the present day
Mars	Nergal	Samael	Gods of war - The geological age of dragons - The universal conflagration - The rhythm of the goddess Eris - The twentieth century - New knighthood

Table 8.1: Planet correspondences

Planet	Babylon	Angel	Description
Jupiter	Marduk	Zachariel	The god of the celestial dome - The geological age of Sagittarius - The patron of Indo-Europeans - The great kings - Renaissance aesthetics and thinking - The inspirer of geometry and geography - The soul blue of those in their fifties
Saturn	Ningirsu	Oriphiel	Soul lead - The geological age of Capricorn - The patron of hermits and emperors - Oriphielic geometry: the circle - Saturnian sciences - Every man is the architect of his own fortunes

For the modern mind, this is all absurdity. Dr. Pales points out the three stages of decline that leads to our incredulity:

- First, direct experience of angels
- Then, mere verbal assent to their existence
- Finally, disbelief

Like Rene Guenon, Dr. Pales, traces the devolution of our understanding of angels to the waning of the Middle Ages. Apart from a few, people believed in angels, but without any gnosis. Angels then become the subjects of schlock art, but without any relevance to natural processes and world affairs. For example, I recently listened to a youtube talk by

a Catholic doctor of theology. He scoffed at the notion that there are cosmic forces at play in the world.

To recover an interest in angels, it is imperative to understand who and what they are. *Viz.*, they are discarnate intelligences. That means, we experience them in our thoughts, moods, inner images, etc. These inner experiences are so close to our identities that we seldom take care to observe their real source. This book will serve as a guide to become aware of angelic influences in cosmic evolution, human history,

For the still skeptical, there are the many graphs and histograms demonstrating the thesis of the book by using contemporary research tools. Nevertheless, the events described are not due to impersonal, mechanical causes. Since angels have intelligence and will, there is *ipso facto* a moral cause behind the world process. This leads us into a discussion of Joseph de Maistre.

Joseph de Maistre **Thomas Garrett Isham** wrote the book *Contra Mundum* about **Joseph de Maistre** and his ties to esoteric teaching. In particular, he compares Maistre to Guenon in a fruitful way. He has previously written a few books on the Enneagram.

Thus, in this book we get an esoteric perspective on Maistre. The most influential essays on Maistre have been by the atheist Isaiah Berlin and by the nihilist Emil Cioran. As Mr. Isham points out, they both see in Maistre only a proto-fascist; yet Berlin condemns him and Cioran praises him. Obviously, such an anachronism does a disservice to Maistre. Berlin and Cioran are unaware of the Maistre's deeper spiritual project.

First of all, he was intransigently opposed to the philosophes of the Enlightenment. Although a conventionally religious Catholic, he recognized the importance of the esoteric dimension, which was not opposed to exoteric practice. Thus for years, he was a member of a Masonic lodge. But that was at a time when it was more focused on esoteric ideas, before the Masons became a secretive political power. In particular, Maistre was

influenced by the illuminist writings of Louis Claude de Saint-Martin. As Mr. Isham pointed out:

members were drawn for weightier reasons and they found the churches spiritually mediocre and ill-suited to the mentality of the age.

Maistre proposed three degrees on Masonry:

- The promotion of benevolent acts and the study of morals and politics.
- The promotion of the reunion of the Christian churches and sects.
- Seeking the revelation of revelation, the sublime knowledge that constitutes knowledge of man at the highest level, a transcendent Christianity based on factual research and metaphysical knowledge.

Maistre further adds:

This Science does not differ essentially from ancient Greek or Egyptian initiation.

Mr. Isham writes about Maistre's interest in ancient pagan and Christian antiquity, particularly his high regard for Origen. He writes:

Maistre shared Origen's belief that the planets were "alive," part of a cosmos "created by and for intelligence." Imbued with such notions Maistre went so far as to urge the Platonic idea that the stars themselves were divinities and to hold that at least some early Christians found this belief conformable to dogma and of use in their initiations.

Throughout his book, Mr. Isham points out some “amazing” parallels between Maistre and Rene Guenon. Obviously, they had common interests: the Primordial Tradition, initiatic organizations, esoterism, Masonry, spiritual hierarchy, reaction against Modernity and the Enlightenment. He then adds an extensive review of Guenon’s Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power. What Guenon makes explicit in a systematic way, Maistre held implicitly, scattered throughout his writings.

In our time, constitutions, whose origins are public and allegedly clear, are believed to be the foundations of the political system. Yet that is delusional, since there is debate about what precisely the constitution means. Hence, there is something deeper, and not fully understood, that is the real foundation. Mr. Isham explains Maistre’s opposed view:

In Maistre’s view, the origins of both spiritual and temporal authority are necessarily shrouded in mystery. For obscure origins are the hallmark of legitimacy. Miracle, ritual, the favor of heaven; all are part and parcel of the traditional order. Hence legendary or mythical beginnings, he insists, more adequately ensure the wisdom of the governors and the consent of the governed than the shaky parliamentary systems and man-made constitutions of modern dreamers.

In *Contra Mundum*, we have a work that deals with Maistre’s ideas as he may have experienced them, rather than as an academic exercise.

The Templars The story of the Knights of the Temple of Solomon has had many variations over the years. Some consider them as a holy Order of Knights that protected pilgrims to the Holy Land. Others see in them the founders of usury and deviant spiritual practices. More outlandish are the conspiracy theories described in various fictional accounts.

Curiously, the ultra-traditional SSPX organization has promoted the recovery of the Templars by making available a CD and a book on them.

The book *The Templars: Knights of Christ* by Regine Pernoud provides an historical record of the Templars, based on primary documentation. As such, it is quite matter-of-fact in its approach. Although such an approach is informative, and even necessary, Pernoud does not address the deeper spiritual nature of the Templars. Presumably that is because the Templars did not commit such topics to the written word. Moreover, in an initiatic organization, the leaders would have been of a higher grade. The neophyte knights, on the other hand, would not have been privy to their deeper knowledge.

There is extensive documentation about the initiation rites, the daily life, the architecture of the Templar buildings, their many battles, their banking activities, and finally their arrest and trials. There is too much detail, e.g., their daily food productions, to mention here. What is amazing is the sheer number of Templar monasteries scattered across Europe. Their unique life as both monks and warriors must have appealed to a large number of men. In addition to the knights, a large supporting staff of sergeants, squires, and sundry other workers were necessary to sustain them. Although they were the recipients of largesse from the wealthy, each monastery was self-sustaining.

The story of their decline is disheartening. After years of success in the Holy Land, they started losing battles. Rivalry with the Hospitallers led to unnecessary battles. King Philip the Fair coveted their financial wealth. He had the Templars in France arrested on trumped up charges, with confessions made under torture. In that way, he aimed to confiscate their wealth. He pressured Pope Clement V to disband the order, thereby inverting the proper order between the spiritual and temporal authorities. Thomas Isham makes this clear:

By these actions, temporal power began to use spiritual authority for its own ends. Guenon says it is instructive that Dante attributed Philip's action to cupidity, the vice of greed, the vice not of a Kshatriya but of a Vaishya. "We could say that when they en-

ter a state of revolt, the Kshatriyas, as it were, degrade themselves, losing their own character and taking on that of a lower caste.

Templars and the Esoteric Tradition In *Studies in Freemasonry & the Compagnonnage*, Rene Guenon includes a chapter on Joseph de Maistre. For our purposes, we are more interested in what Guenon has to say about the Templars and their relationship to Masonry. He quotes Maistre: “What does the destruction of the Order of the Templars matter to the Universe?” Guenon then responds:

But it matters very much, since this marks the point at which the West broke with its own initiatic tradition reaches back, a rupture that is truly the primary cause of the intellectual deviation of the modern world. This deviation in fact goes back further than the Renaissance, which marks only one of the principal stages, the fourteenth century being the actual starting point.

This corresponds to the time frame mention by Emil Pales. Although Maistre maintained their existence, he knew nothing of the actual means of the transmission of initiatic doctrines nor of the representatives of the true spiritual hierarchy. In the case of the Masons, Maistre noted that the beginning of Masonry coincided with the destruction of the Templars, but did not really connect those events.

The irony is that the last Grandmaster of the Templars, Jacques de Molay, who was executed by the Church, then became the spiritual father of the Freemasons, the sworn enemy of the Church. Moreover, both Masonry and the Church seem to have lost their initiatic character. Nevertheless, Guenon rather optimistically believed that the Great Work could be resumed in some other form. He explained:

Is this to say that such a Plan will never again be undertaken in one or another form by some organization with a truly initiatic

character and possessing an Ariadne's Thread to guide it through the labyrinth of innumerable forms under which the sole Tradition is hidden, in order finally to recover the Lost Word and leave the Light of the Shadows, the Order of Chaos?

Posted on 2019-08-11 by Cologero

* * *

admin@warofart.xyz on 2019-08-12 at 00:11 said:

This is honestly making me consider giving Masonry a shot. Anyone have any real experience with it? Is it worth the trouble? (Also reading Mouravieff, but I'm still trying to get the sages pose consistent, and it's slow going.)

Cologero on 2019-08-12 at 10:39 said:

I doubt you'll find what you're looking for in contemporary Masonry.

As we pointed out: Guenon rather optimistically believed that the Great Work could be resumed in some other form

That new form should be attached to a genuine Tradition. On this blog, we've been trying to outline what that Great Work might look like.

Masonguy on 2019-08-14 at 03:24 said:

If you find what they call a "traditional" lodge. There was an attempt made recently at my lodge to make it more traditional which I supported, but it was squelched by the majority who view esotericism with suspicion. Go figure. There are all kinds of lodges just like all kinds of people, and frankly you have to take it on a lodge by lodge basis. Some are very into the esoteric, while others are little more than old boy cigar smoking clubs or just dining clubs where the guys get to get away from the wives at least once a month.

Fallen adam on 2019-08-15 at 09:08 said:

I've also been having problems with achieving the posture of the sage. I use a hard wood stool og about 35 cm, but the problem is that if I can't find a comfortable and relaxed position while having my legs crossed. Should I keep trying, or just do with my legs having a 90 degrees angle at the knee, which I've found to be easier to do?

Sviatoslav on 2019-08-16 at 09:28 said:

Great to hear that my favorite website Gornahoor is familiar with Emil Pales. Here in Slovakia, he even has a school of Angelology and his books and podcasts deeply influenced me. He's a profound person.

Although some healthy masonry lodges probably exist and that can be an option for inner growth of a few individuals, freemasonry as a whole cannot become a vehicle for a Traditional message. It's too corrupt and essentially nonesoteric.

Purely esoteric order in modern circumstances is very hard to establish and maintain, but I think that restoration of warrior-initiatic order as Templars were, isn't so unrealistic even nowadays. Such an organization could be founded with few idealistic men who are as well capable in practical areas – making money, engineering, management, military, marketing. So the organization would be self-funded and would operate in a small, but effective team. And then is possible to create more exoteric organizations, e.g. metapolitical, political and through them to influence society.

I think this would be a task for men of warrior nature with ideological help of priests. Unexpectedly, globalization could help us with international recruitment of members (foremost Europeans countries). Unlike all modern mass organizations, which are dependent on society conditions a small elitist group can operate even among ruins.

Has someone opinion on this?

Sviatoslav on 2019-08-17 at 17:55 said:

I just want to add to my previous comment, that this website <https://www.bernardoption.com> is trying to do the same thing.

After Gornahoor another excellent work. Hopefully, I will find more valuable information to study. I have found a few interesting ideas here <https://www.knightstemplarorder.org/> but also a lot of dubiously egalitarian views (membership for women, muslims and so).

Sviatoslav on 2019-08-21 at 08:16 said:

That could be done. I will try to upload on youtube an English version of his best podcast.

Cologero on 2019-08-21 at 09:17 said:

Keep in mind that you can hear Emil Pales live on Monday, August 26... and even ask questions.

Much better than a podcast.

Cologero on 2019-08-21 at 22:01 said:

Make yourself familiar with the Angels, and behold them frequently in spirit. without being seen, they are present with you. St. Francis de Sales

Boreas on 2019-09-27 at 03:44 said:

I would love to hear your take on de Maistre's Ultramontanism.

John Fitzgerald on 2021-03-08 at 15:27 said:

The idea of the stars as divinities (De Maistre/Origen) feels congruent and right to me. CS Lewis articulated something very close to this in *The Last Battle* when Aslan calls time on the Narnian world and beckons the stars home –

'Stars began falling all around them. But stars in that world are not the great flaming globes they are in ours. They are people (Edmund and Lucy had once met one). So now they found showers of glittering people, all with long hair like burning silver and spears like white-hot metal, rushing down to them out of the black air, swifter than falling stones. They made a hissing noise as they landed and burnt the grass. And all these stars glided past them and stood somewhere behind, a little to the right.'

So not quite divinities, perhaps, but not far off. A bit like the Sidhe of Gaelic mythology, maybe.

And in Lewis's *Space Trilogy* the planets are most certainly alive, especially in the last volume, *That Hideous Strength*, where they each play a decisive role in the affairs of the Earth.

9.1 How Keats May Have Died – in memory

Came he among the whispering wood, or in the golden
meads,

Still he holds the cypress crown, which gold Apollo gave.
Walked he in stormy wind about or in the laze of noon,
Yet still he sings the song around, eternal end too soon.

He rose above the blue sky wild and stopped beneath the
sun,

The eagle grew his pinions strong yet earth does not outrun.

Others voyaged the ether out or wandered into space,
The psychonauts, dead stars about, are lost unto our race.

False gods may fly like crimson sparks thrown out of Eden's
heat,

Though one took wing, in faithful gyre, halfway the sun to

meet.

He melted not, nor smitten blind, but sorrowed in his mind,

His weakened corse you cannot find, in England, green and
kind.

In water writ, in Rome bestowed, a man between two worlds,

Forever twixt the sun and sky, his ruddy heart unfurled.
For us, he loved and lost his mind, for us did name our vale,
For us the mansions traced in fate, and young, faced Death's
black gale.

I prayed his soul last Good to find, to early love yet keep,
The answer came the Moon around "long yet so shall I sleep".

"Until the fickle Fortune bows and Fame is quite forgot,
Until my unconsummate Love unto the Phoenix, wrought."

"Each upward shines in golden Love who holds what they
were gift,
And dances in God's hearth, a Dove of flame to sing, to sift."

"The change will come upon a day, the change I won in pain,

To come again a second Self, like sunshine in the rain."

"But still the special color min that welled from in my heart,

Remains forever changeless dyed, as in that vase of art."

"Unbroken yet and still and bright I yet remain as them,
Alone for ages in the rest, and dreaming on the wind."

Posted on 2012-03-10 by Logres

9.2 Dies Irae

A Transliteration & Addition to the Latin *Dies Irae*¹

The *Dies Irae* was authored by Friar Thomas Celano, biographer of Saint Francis, and its view of God is conditioned by the emergent Holy Roman Empire, whose peripatetic king would visit his manors all across the West in a movable judgement that brought even the mightiest count or duke to the bar, before the sacral emperor. It has been praised as a hymn of “singular awe and piety”, though to modern ears its vision of a vengeful God is alienating and crude. Its triple-rhymed Latin is about as far from a modern sound as one can achieve, yet there is something modern about it, perhaps its lack of classical elegance and folk (we would say pop or popular) origin. It was chanted at All Soul’s Day, and Catholic scholars seem fairly unanimous in regarding it as the greatest specimen of sacred poetry in the Middle Ages (excluding, of course, Dante’s *Inferno*, whose worldview is remarkably consistent with the *Dies Irae*).

Note: I have given, here, a more modern, non-rhyming version of the poetic thoughts in the poem, although I also have done a more literal translation. Knowing even a little Latin, nothing can really compare with the Latin chant. So this is merely a loose paraphrasing from the text of the Graduale Seraphico-Romano and Roman Breviary. I should also note that any who want to read an in depth treatment of how the Holy Roman Empire founded Europe ought to consult Rosenstock-Huessy’s

¹http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dies_Irae

*Out of Revolution*² or Kantorowicz's *The King's Two Bodies*³. The only disclaimer is that these are secular, but relatively accurate and scholarly collections of data about the overwhelming pre-eminence of the early German emperors in Europe's foundations. On a personal note, I will say that this was done when I was "less traditional", & therefore, the traditional note is all the more obvious against the Semitic influence; the *Dies Irae* naturally breaths the air of transcendence, even with its heavy Christian piety.

A Thoroughly Modern Day of Wrath

Melting skies in the wolf-day, world-dissolving!
The Sky-breaker clenches our globe,
And coals tumble from a note-singing trumpet,
Horrible comets that heat stone to ashes,
Just as David sang a black psalm on the lyre,
Or the blind Sybil read from demon lips.
The Strong-Sustainer hurls fire down,
And that thick book enscripited at dawn,
The pregnant dawn containing all things.
Our whole earth gapes like a rotten fruit,
And every thing crawls to the king of gods.
The trumpet astonishes the brute dead,
And lashes dead souls with quick fear,
Fear that shrieks at the roots of the mountains,
Shaking the silver tears of Mother Nature,
Stupefying that tyrant, shockless Death.
All ooze and flesh and dust awake to flame,
All hidden things quake at the brassy throne,

²http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Out_of_Revolution

³<http://www.amazon.com/Kings-Two-Bodies-Ernst-Kantorowicz/dp/0691017042>

Shame is the garment of the unjust,
When invisible vengeance appears at the last.
Down sits the Mighty Judge and Lord,
His judgment accomplishing itself and done
Before He draws the sword and strikes,
Written already in the book of doom.
What shall the miserable wretch plead,
What great patron shall intervene?
The just and good are scarcely snatched
From bright red, hungry hell.
Emperor of awful heaven's abyss,
Who freely saves any who escape this day,
Kiss me, O fountain of white,
Do not deny me this day.
Surely You fell from the sky,
Not to lose your work on the cross,
Not in vain so far, dying for filth.
Lose me not, or lost I will burn.
Adam's broken skull cracks wide,
And the Pegasus of mercy springs wild,
And Mary the whore was absolved,
And the thief at the end of days.
Give to me their same strong hope,
And pass over my unworthy prayers,
Deal most kindly, Good God,
For long has my black heart cursed.
Your red, right hand of fire
Silences the wicked goats.
Under the cold stars I lament,
For inside me there is nothing.
Let Paradise come in an instant,

Or never at all, for I fail,
And the cosmos ends and is rent,
So hide me at your riven side.
O Accuser and Defender,
Make our tomb like broken Golgotha,
I pray this in the ash, Our Maker,
And hear what is not spoken in the heart.
O, Thou God of All-Majesty,
Sustaining, Shining Trinity,
Be to us, now and in eternity.

Posted on 2012-02-04 by Logres

* * *

Caleb Cooper on 2012-02-07 at 13:32 said:

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZDFFHaz9GsY&w=640&h=480%5D>

9.3 The Poet and the Sacred

The most ancient Traditions are expressed in the form of poetry as, for example, in the Hindu Mahabharata, which includes the Bhagavad Gita, or the poems of **Homer**. These poems were originally sung, rather than read, by the priests or wandering cantors. As we have pointed out⁴, poetry reaches a primordial part of consciousness, beyond, and prior to, the reasoning mind.

Following **Vladimir Solovyov**, art reveals the universal in the particular. The modern

⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1374>



mind, which expects uniformity in space and time, has trouble dealing with revelations which occur in a particular place at a particular time. Space and time are qualitative rather than quantitative, so only the intuitive mind can grasp it. The grasping of the whole in poetry is one step removed in grasping the totality of the Absolute.

The recovery of Tradition in the West will necessitate the recovery of the great initiates of Magna Graecia. We start with Pythagoras. **Virgil** begins with Troy, to describe the founding of Rome, which was the *ecumene*⁵, the known world. **Dante** continues the story with his great synthesis.

We bring three selections, all objectively unrelated to each other, but subjectively expressing the same understanding. **Virgil's** *Eclogues* was believed by the Medievals to be a prophecy of the new age to come, which we celebrate at Christmas. If modern minds can no longer grasp it, so much the worse for them. The second selection is from **Guido De Gior-**
gio's *Aforismi e Poesie*. The third is taken from *Iota Unum* by **Romano Amerio**, again showing the inner connection between the ancient civilization of the pagans and that of the Middle Ages.

Eclogues

The final age of Cumae
And the virgin damsel has now arrived,
And the reign of Saturn and Rhea returns.
The centuries of the Golden Age return.
Again the heavens send us long years
And new people born of them.
Thou, chaste Moon, full of joy,

⁵<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ecumene>

Favour, since thy Apollo now reigns,
The Child who was born this day.
He alone will cast iron out of the world
And populate both Poles with
A most precious lineage of gold.

The Poets The Poets, after the Saints, seem to me to be closer to God because, in a certain sense, they spiritualize matter, they lighten it, rendering it ethereal, impalpable.

Poetry is the crown of life, Holiness is the crown of heaven. The poet is more than man, but the Saint is more than the poet. But at one time the Poet was also a Saint when he was not singing of the world, but of God, when he contemplated the world according to God, when he thought while singing, and sang while thinking.

Plato says that the Poet is a “winged and light being” who wanders like a bee in the groves of the Muses, gathering the nectar and transforming it into honey ... and he sings like one possessed, aroused by God, who, as Dante would say, dictates to their inner being, and this God is Love ... It is life renewed by the Spirit, no longer a place of wandering, but of conquests and redemption. Consider Virgil: how many poets did he not remove from error, on the road of the Truth of God, he who went, Dante says, like a man, who has a lamp in hand and will bring light for those who lead him but not himself:

You did what he does who travels by night,
and carries a lamp behind him, that does not help
him,
but makes those who follow him, wise

Purgatory XXII: 67-69

Here is the awesome drama of the poets who sometimes save but do not save themselves, who illumine others but not themselves, who return

to prison after unchaining the others ... Who will ever sing the drama of Virgil who at the apparition of Beatrice, leaves Dante and takes up again the way of Limbo? ... He, Lucifer, returns to the shadows and lives there "without hope and in desire..."

And Brunetto Latini? The Masters of eternity who are excluded from joyful eternity ... These are among the most terrible secrets of the Justice of God which could lead the most steadfast to doubt ... it is necessary to believe awfully in God in order not to waver, not to doubt, to accept what is repugnant to our human reason, to exalt the Lord in everything, in the good, in the evil that He permits, in the implacability of His justice and the apparent injustice of his Mercy. He who is hidden to us to lead us into temptation, to test our resoluteness, to strengthen our faith, to inflame our love, and give wings to our hope.

The Breadth of the Christian ideal When we remember the breadth of the Christian idea, it becomes clear that the Renaissance was a revival of that breadth, leading the Christian religion to realize the kinship uniting it to past civilizations within which, buried in sleep, there lay the values of natural religion, ideal beauty, the civic life and such treasures as the *Phaedo*, the *Metaphysics*, the Venus of Knidos, the Parthenon, Homer, and Virgil.

Religion has an expressive capacity much greater than can appear in any one period: it comes out in successive developments which are not always complete in themselves but which, taken as a whole, tend towards a progressive perfection. This growth is hinted at in the Gospel parables of the seed, and in St. Paul's references to the Church in an organism that grows up to the full measure of perfection.

Nor should it be thought that this assimilation of classical culture began with the Renaissance and the flight of Greek refugees from Islam, since it was in fact begun long before, in the midst of the Dark Ages but the monastic preservation of Greek and Latin authors. They were

preserved not because the monks found incentives or nourishment for their devotion in Virgil and Horace, but because, quite distinct from the all-pervasive ascetical inspiration of that period, the monks appreciated another ideal which although not ascetic, was nonetheless religious if Christianity does acknowledge the value of earthly things while directing themselves towards heaven.

Furthermore, the blending of ancient civilization with the Christian idea had already happened before the Renaissance in the primordial form of intellectual development, namely poetry; especially in Dante's *Divine Comedy*, in which the myths, thought and aspirations of the classical world are powerfully combined with the Christian outlook in a daring synthesis. The limbo of the pagans, in which the light of natural wisdom, while not bringing salvation, nonetheless preserves man from the fullness of damnation, is an outstanding intuition of the medieval genius, which was well aware of the spiritual spaciousness of the Christian ideal that both includes, and extends beyond, the ascetic world of the cloister.

Posted on 2012-12-20 by Cologero

* * *

william zeitler on 2012-12-22 at 07:44 said:

Another noteworthy sacred poem in the West would be *The Book of Job* in the Hebrew Bible (6th-4th century BCE?). Except for a brief prose prologue and epilogue, the entire book is in poetic form.

Cologero on 2012-12-22 at 09:07 said:

Thanks for bringing that up Mr. Zeitler. *The Book of Job* had a large role in the formation of the Medieval mind because of the commentary on it by Gregory the Great, "*Magna Moralia*".

9.4 The Maid of Destiny

*To the Queen of Heaven & inspired by Eliot's Sunday Morning*⁶

“Young Mary of the sky-blue cloak,
 The lily hands, the dusty feet-
 Indefectible awoke,
 From her soul's noetic heat.
 She held an angel in her eye,
 She spoke the flame with Seraphim-
 Interchanging earth and sky,
 Shock the changeless Cherubim.
 Sublunar Eve in Lim cried out
 To see her motherhood respire.
 Mary's prayer upon her brow
 Burns with a kenotic fire.
 The remonstrance ungilded stood
 Before the angel of the Host-
 Across the shadowed twisty-wood
 Moved a many-colored Ghost.

Paley rose in petals torn
 Sprang up within a heart unbound-
 Beyond old suns, a rose-gold morn
 Moves with us, our God around.
 I fell asleep last night and feared
 Destroying winds in sphered wheels.
 The Lady pure in prayer appeared
 Before the angel's eyes of steel.
 God's herald unblinds his gaze,
 And dolefully unbinds his sword.

⁶<http://www.bartleby.com/199/23.html>

He snaps it and before her stays,
Contemplating ancient words.
Across deep heaven's blue-dark sea
Still sparkling with great Gabriel's wake,
In golden hours, by silver tree,
A slender youth the fruit shall take,
And eating some, will cast the rest
About our world as he falls dead,
Sinking swiftly with the West,
Rocked in seeming changeless red.
But Mary has a faith that's swift-
It outruns all the angry dead,
So from the angel's upward lift,
Her wide eye feeds her heart instead.
The Word is done, the song is winged,
The deeds are named, the Glory burns,
A little maid of clay will bring
The star on which all turns.
Turn, Lady, that your cloak is winged.
Sigh, Lady, that your prayer is thus.
Sing, Mary, with only your eyes,
Breathe out the rainbow out of dust.

Posted on 2012-05-12 by Logres

* * *

Charlotte on 2012-05-12 at 09:40 said:
beautiful!

littleM on 2018-05-12 at 05:27 said:
fantastic.

9.5 When Time Flows Back

One night I fled, beyond the dread,
And looked for place to lay my head,
So thought upon the sainted dead,
Yea, how it was if they were gone.
Oh, wished it well, for such a spell,
As would surely one truth tell,
How when at tripping heart's last knell,
Sun chimed the ice at dawn.
If by hap some ghost was true,
Or Aiken Drum feared hallowed dew,
Yes, if the haunted folk grew few,
Still chanting sunrise would last long.
Are dead men holy, even they,
Who perished in a loathsome way?
This life again to worse than fey,
If saints could sing their song.
They rise again, no doubt gone by,
The fated ones with only sighs,
Who perished e'er they ever die,
But rise again, in a dun saint's eye,
For the bells of old ring long.
Stumble, curse, or doubt this rune,
Until your angel finds your tune,
And plucks the strings un-slung at doom,
When Good makes one with Strong.

Posted on 2012-05-18 by Logres

9.6 Quest for Camelon

Quick, quiet is the snow on a low hill,
So is winter wind under the low stars.
My well draws under whispered charm until
The circle, cold & grave, it can unmar.

Swift & sweet is the gray dawn's careful rose,
As sudden sun upon the giant cloud.
My wood is waiting, and its druid knows
Some antique secret underneath the shroud.

Grave and good is the dying, drying oak,
As is the path to the top of the mont.
Though shaded altar there was ever broke,

The water is still pure beneath the font.
Trace, lady bright, the shining symbol true
For you are clear and clean, as is the blue.

Posted on 2012-02-25 by Logres

9.7 Sonnet to the Knight

Born in ignorance, and tempted by sin
Aroused by beauty and to passions bound
Love and adventure, the knight has found,
Not in the world for the struggle's within.

The greater battle is by far the best;
In Napoli he lay dying in bed
Ere his journey to the home of the dead



Ridwan assures that he has passed the test.

A glowing torch in the moonlight sky
Guides the knight on the path to the river
Howling hounds tell him the goddess is nigh

Hecate assuages his hidden fear.
At the crossroads she will him deliver,
There she will whisper his poem in God's ear.

<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/0deToTheKnight.mp3>

Posted on 2021-02-19 by Cologero

* * *

Rusalka on 2021-02-20 at 10:02 said:
Thank you ?. May Beauty always follow you.

Rusalka on 2023-05-21 at 16:25 said:

My dearest Knight, I whispered & spoke your poem. I unlocked the door, and not for a moment were you alone.

Be well and stay well, I shall remember & pray until my last breath.

May the heavenly choirs sing & perform for you.

Rusalka on 2023-05-21 at 16:32 said:

She spoke his poem into God's ear

And even God's unmoved eye let out a tear.

Not for a moment were you alone, my Knight. Shine like a blazing Sun and keep me ablaze here.

9.8 Laura and the Fedeli d'Amore

Petrarch wrote 300 sonnets about his love, **Laura**.

Rene Guenon claims that Laura was not a real woman, and that Petrarch was passing on esoteric teaching, as this quotation shows:

The various “ladies” celebrated by poets relating to the mysterious organization of the Fedeli d'Amore, since

Dante, Guido Cavalcanti, Boccaccio and Petrarch, are not women who really lived on this earth. They are all, under different names, the one and the same symbolic “lady”, which represents the transcendent intelligence (Madonna Intelligenza de Dino Compagni) or Divine Wisdom. The most unintelligible poems in the literal sense become perfectly clear with the hypothesis of a “jargon”. In Persian Sufi writing, a similar meaning has also been concealed under the appearances of a simple poetry of love.



Sonnet #156 This is my translation of sonnet #156, so you can decide if Laura is real, or perhaps it does not matter:

I saw her on earth disguised as an angel
Her celestial beauty was the sun in the world
And to remember her brings both joy and melancholy
As I gaze upon dreams, shadows, and smoke.

And I saw those two lovely eyes cry,
Which caused the sun envy again and again;
And I heard words said with longing
That would make the mountains move and rivers stand still.

Love, Wisdom, Virtue, Compassion, and Suffering
Make weeping a sweeter harmony
Than any other accustomed to be heard in the world.

Heaven was so intent on the harmony
That no leaf was seen to move on the bough,
So much sweetness had filled the air and the wind.

Franz Liszt put Sonnet #156 to music.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gVX5YUp9EiA>

Posted on 2021-06-23 by Cologero

9.9 Eternal Life is Seeing God

Petrarch was an initiate into the Fedeli d'Amore. He wrote a few hundred sonnets mostly to Laura, his secret love. The initiatic theme of Sonnet 191 is revealed by the comparison of “seeing God” to seeing his “lady”. She satiates his longing, his Sehnsucht, for God. The very sight of her



is reflected in his Heart; knowing her is Knowledge of the Heart. She makes his thoughts taste sweet, satisfying all his other hopes and wishes. She is his secret love.

Just as eternal life is seeing God,
longing for nothing greater, no longer longing,
so I'm made happy, my lady, by seeing you
in this brief and fragile life of mine.
I never saw you as lovely as today,
if my eyes truly reflect my heart:
sweet in my thought the hour, and blessed,
overcoming every other hope and wish.
And if its flight were not so fast,
I'd ask no more: if there are creatures
that live only on air, and such things believed,
others on water or fire, their taste and touch
sated by things deprived of sweetness,
then why not I on the dear sight of you?

Posted on 2021-11-18 by Cologero

* * *

veritycacciatrice on 2021-11-23 at 03:07 said:
Is there an equivalent Laura/Beatrice for a woman?
'God' is fine by me, but is there a story (other than 'The Captain and Mrs. Muir') that describes the balance and the joy from a feminine perspective, historically-speaking?

Cologero on 2021-11-24 at 21:00 said:
Here are two posts from a woman's perspective. Obviously, I can't be the judge, nor predict your reaction.

*Nigredo, Albedo and Rubedo*⁷

⁷<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=13757>

*Leaving the Cave*⁸

9.10 Laudi alla Vergine Maria

Giuseppe Verdi composed four choral pieces, three of which are based on prayers. *Laudi alla Vergine Maria* (*Praise to the Virgin Mary*) sets Canto XXXIII of **Dante**'s *Paradiso* to a choral arrangement. This Canto begins with praise to Mary.



Thou Virgin Mother, daughter of thy Son,
Humble and high beyond all other creature,
The limit fixed of the eternal counsel,

Thou art the one who such nobility
To human nature gave, that its Creator
Did not disdain to make himself its creature.

Within thy womb rekindled was the love,
By heat of which in the eternal peace

⁸<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=13668>

After such wise this flower has germinated.

Here unto us thou art a noonday torch
Of charity, and below there among mortals
Thou art the living fountain-head of hope.

Thou Virgin Mother, daughter of thy Son,
Humble and high beyond all other creature,
The limit fixed of the eternal counsel,

Thou art the one who such nobility
To human nature gave, that its Creator
Did not disdain to make himself its creature.

Within thy womb rekindled was the love,
By heat of which in the eternal peace
After such wise this flower has germinated.

Here unto us thou art a noonday torch
Of charity, and below there among mortals
Thou art the living fountain-head of hope.

Lady, thou art so great, and so prevailing,
That he who wishes grace, nor runs to thee,
His aspirations without wings would fly.

Not only thy benignity gives succour
To him who asketh it, but oftentimes
Forerunneth of its own accord the asking.

In thee compassion is, in thee is pity,
In thee magnificence; in thee unites
Whate'er of goodness is in any creature.

(from Canto XXXIII of Dante's *Paradiso*)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ufc0WRz4sPU>

Posted on 2021-12-26 by Cologero

9.II Donna, nel mio ritorno

Torquato Tasso⁹ was a Renaissance Italian poet well known for his love poems, the epic poem *Jerusalem Delivered*¹⁰ about the Crusades, and a blank verse retelling of the seven days of creation in Genesis. His work brought him fame in his day and, until recently, he was one of the most read poets in Europe. Many subsequent poets were inspired by him and several madrigals were composed for his poems. This, composed by **Claudio Monteverdi**, is one of them.

Unfortunately, Tasso drifted into insanity. Giacomo Leopardi wrote *Dialogo di Torquato Tasso e del suo Genio familiare*¹¹ about his stay at the St. Anna insane asylum. This is a dialogue between Tasso and his family spirit.

⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jerusalem_Delivered

¹⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jerusalem_Delivered

¹¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=25>

Donna, nel mio
ritorno

il mio pensiero,
a cui nulla
pon freno,

precorre dove il

Milady, as I return to you
my thoughts, which nothing
can restrain,

rush across the cloudless sky
and come to abide with you;
never do they leave you,
neither by day nor night,
because any other thought would

ciel è più
sereno,
e se ne vien a far
con voi
soggiorno;

né da voi si di-
parte
giamai la notte
e'l giorno,

perché l'annoia
ciascun'altra
parte.
Onde sol per virtù
del pen-
sier mio,

mentre ne vengo
a voi, con
voi son
io.

bore me.
Thus, thanks only to my thoughts
As I approach you, I am al-
ready with you.

TORQUATO TASSO, 1590

This is my own translation, based on personal experience.
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oxJ2Zv8PGbo>

Posted on 2021-12-27 by Cologero

* * *

Arthur Konrad on 2021-12-28 at 04:25 said:

Venetian music (and especially opera) is second to none. Baroque has experienced quite a bit of revival, in every sense, from performances to instrument construction. Venetian libretti are always splendid – how different an air from the latter day defilement of poetry with intellectualism (which was to be the swan song of opera in any case). This particular ensemble (and this soprano) specialize in ‘authentic’ baroque performances and is most excellent:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=H2Ks_TurCUo

This song I first heard on one of the finest evenings of my life:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Bofbxcz4bqw>

9.12 The Moon was a ghostly Galleon

The Highwayman, a romantic ballad poem written by Alfred Noyes, is considered one of the best British poems of all time. The imagery is tangible, the story dramatic, and even if you anticipate the ending, the poem is thrilling.

In a sense, the highwayman is a criminal, but not petty. After all, he could afford a horse, he dressed impeccably, and had a certain nobility in his bearing, certainly more than all the king’s men. That made him a romantic figure, perhaps more like a Robin Hood than a petty thief. He was not beholden to the system, so he made his own way.

Does that answer why would the landlord’s daughter love a criminal? Is it because conventional minds can’t reach her soul, but only the outsider, the adventurer? Someone who doesn’t play on the safe side of the sidewalk?

The Lady of Shalott¹² also loved a knight, the man who makes his own way in life. Elaine and Bess each loved her knight totally, unconditionally,



¹²<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=15391>

and irrationally.

How do lovers meet today? On a dating app, matched by a computer? They go for long walks on the beach, watch the same TV shows, and bring their dogs to the doggie park. And they love until they get bored of each other.

But the dating app does not ask if you prefer death to a life without love. Elaine died from lack of being loved by Lancelot and Bess, the land-lord's daughter, died from being loved too much by the highwayman. A life without love was inconceivable to them. And true love comes just once in a lifetime, so it must be seized.

As you read the poem, read along with Loreena McKennitt's recital, which is a work of art in itself (see below). She leaves out the last stanza which reveals that Bess and the highwayman continue to meet whenever the moon is a ghostly galleon tossed upon cloudy seas. Their souls are entangled, so not even death can separate them.

The Highwayman PART ONE

The wind was a torrent of darkness among the gusty trees.

The moon was a ghostly galleon tossed upon cloudy seas.

The road was a ribbon of moonlight over the purple moor,

And the highwayman came riding—

Riding—riding—

The highwayman came riding, up to the old inn-door.

He'd a French cocked-hat on his forehead, a bunch of lace
at his chin,

A coat of the claret velvet, and breeches of brown doe-skin.

They fitted with never a wrinkle. His boots were up to the
thigh.

And he rode with a jewelled twinkle,

His pistol butts a-twinkle,

His rapier hilt a-twinkle, under the jewelled sky.

Over the cobbles he clattered and clashed in the dark inn-
yard.

He tapped with his whip on the shutters, but all was locked
and barred.

He whistled a tune to the window, and who should be wait-
ing there

But the landlord's black-eyed daughter,

Bess, the landlord's daughter,

Plaiting a dark red love-knot into her long black hair.

And dark in the dark old inn-yard a stable-wicket creaked

Where Tim the ostler listened. His face was white and peaked.

His eyes were hollows of madness, his hair like mouldy hay,

But he loved the landlord's daughter,

The landlord's red-lipped daughter.

Dumb as a dog he listened, and he heard the robber say—

“One kiss, my bonny sweetheart, I'm after a prize to-night,

But I shall be back with the yellow gold before the morning
light;

Yet, if they press me sharply, and harry me through the day,

Then look for me by moonlight,

Watch for me by moonlight,

I'll come to thee by moonlight, though hell should bar the
way.”

He rose upright in the stirrups. He scarce could reach her
hand,

But she loosened her hair in the casement. His face burnt
like a brand

As the black cascade of perfume came tumbling over his
breast;

And he kissed its waves in the moonlight,

(O, sweet black waves in the moonlight!)
Then he tugged at his rein in the moonlight, and galloped
away to the west.

PART TWO

He did not come in the dawning. He did not come at noon;

And out of the tawny sunset, before the rise of the moon,
When the road was a gypsy's ribbon, looping the purple
moor,

A red-coat troop came marching—

Marching—marching—

King George's men came marching, up to the old inn-door.

They said no word to the landlord. They drank his ale in-
stead.

But they gagged his daughter, and bound her, to the foot of
her narrow bed.

Two of them knelt at her casement, with muskets at their
side!

There was death at every window;

And hell at one dark window;

For Bess could see, through her casement, the road that he
would ride.

They had tied her up to attention, with many a sniggering
jest.

They had bound a musket beside her, with the muzzle be-
neath her breast!

“Now, keep good watch!” and they kissed her. She heard the
doomed man say—

Look for me by moonlight;

Watch for me by moonlight;
I'll come to thee by moonlight, though hell should bar the
way!
She twisted her hands behind her; but all the knots held
good!
She writhed her hands till her fingers were wet with sweat
or blood!
They stretched and strained in the darkness, and the hours
crawled by like years
Till, now, on the stroke of midnight,
Cold, on the stroke of midnight,
The tip of one finger touched it! The trigger at least was
hers!
The tip of one finger touched it. She strove no more for the
rest.
Up, she stood up to attention, with the muzzle beneath her
breast.
She would not risk their hearing; she would not strive again;

For the road lay bare in the moonlight;
Blank and bare in the moonlight;
And the blood of her veins, in the moonlight, throbbed to
her love's refrain.
Tlot-tlot; tlot-tlot! Had they heard it? The horsehoofs ring-
ing clear;
Tlot-tlot; tlot-tlot, in the distance? Were they deaf that they
did not hear?
Down the ribbon of moonlight, over the brow of the hill,
The highwayman came riding—
Riding—riding—
The red coats looked to their priming! She stood up, straight

and still.
Tlot-tlot, in the frosty silence! Tlot-tlot, in the echoing night!

Nearer he came and nearer. Her face was like a light.
Her eyes grew wide for a moment; she drew one last deep
breath,
Then her finger moved in the moonlight,
Her musket shattered the moonlight,
Shattered her breast in the moonlight and warned him—
with her death.

He turned. He spurred to the west; he did not know who
stood
Bowed, with her head o'er the musket, drenched with her
own blood!

Not till the dawn he heard it, and his face grew grey to hear
How Bess, the landlord's daughter,
The landlord's black-eyed daughter,
Had watched for her love in the moonlight, and died in the
darkness there.

Back, he spurred like a madman, shrieking a curse to the sky,

With the white road smoking behind him and his rapier
brandished high.
Blood red were his spurs in the golden noon; wine-red was
his velvet coat;
When they shot him down on the highway,
Down like a dog on the highway,
And he lay in his blood on the highway, with a bunch of
lace at his throat.

And still of a winter's night, they say, when the wind is in
the trees,

When the moon is a ghostly galleon tossed upon cloudy
 seas,
 When the road is a ribbon of moonlight over the purple
 moor,
 A highwayman comes riding—
 Riding—riding—
 A highwayman comes riding, up to the old inn-door.
 Over the cobbles he clatters and clangs in the dark inn-yard.

He taps with his whip on the shutters, but all is locked and
 barred.
 He whistles a tune to the window, and who should be wait-
 ing there
 But the landlord's black-eyed daughter,
 Bess, the landlord's daughter,
 Plaiting a dark red love-knot into her long black hair.

ALFRED NOYES, 1906

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IIInoIB1V1LU>

Posted on 2022-01-08 by Cologero

9.13 The Two Nights

Earth creates the illusion
 Of the yellow sun, and the blue sky above.
 Moon dispels that delusion
 The Sky is a raven, the Sun is a dove.

The atmosphere is a womb
 That protects life in its earthen jar.
 But it is a whited tomb

To those who choose to venture afar.

Children do not get along
They are unable to achieve consensus.
No one admits being wrong
So they are forever contentious.

Will and desire are persistent
Appearances confused with reality.
Things appear self-subsistent
Malice unveils its brutality.

Chaos is the lower night
The unmanifest lies hidden in the deep.
Selene brings him the light
As her kisses sweeten the dreams in his sleep.

Cf. *The Two Nights*, by Rene Guenon.

Posted on 2022-03-01 by Cologero

9.14 Cast your soul to the sea

Loreena McKennitt composed the song Dante's Prayer while riding the Trans-Siberian Railway after the fall of the Soviet Union. The barren landscape inspired the poem. The **St. Petersburg Chamber Choir** performed a piece entitled *Alleluia, Behold the Bridegroom* in the first recording of the song.

The poem begins in the woods, rises through the mountains, and flies to touch the face of the stars.



Dante's Prayer by **Loreena McKennitt**

When the dark wood fell before me
And all the paths were overgrown
When the priests of pride say there is no other way
tilled the sorrows of stone.

I did not believe because I could not see
Though you came to me in the night
When the dawn seemed forever lost
You showed me your love in the light of the stars.

Cast your eyes on the ocean
Cast your soul to the sea
When the dark night seems endless
Please remember me.

Then the mountain rose before me
By the deep well of desire
From the fountain of forgiveness
Beyond the ice and the fire.

Cast your eyes on the ocean
Cast your soul to the sea
When the dark night seems endless
Please remember me.

Though we share this humble path, alone
How fragile is the heart
Oh give these clay feet wings to fly
To touch the face of the stars.

Breathe life into this feeble heart
Lift this mortal veil of fear

Take these crumbled hopes, etched with tears.
We'll rise above these earthly cares.

Cast your eyes on the ocean
Cast your soul to the sea
When the dark night seems endless
Please remember me,
Please remember me.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KC2cCNspS1M>

Posted on 2022-05-17 by Cologero

9.15 Fernweh: I belong not in this place

I belong not in this place

I think that I belong not in this place,
Separated by an abyss of time,
I hear a sweet song from another space
Floating on the breeze that changes the clime.

With the Cherubim's song, it is admixed.
The ethereal voice makes my soul soar
Beyond the world that has had me transfixed
To fly with the angels who her adore.

Joined not in space, but by affinity
What I see and hear abides in my heart
Love lasts not in time, but infinity.

What would I really gain to taste and touch
What no cosmical force can tear apart?
Unlike the world I used to love so much.

<https://www.gornahoor.net/wp-content/uploads/2022/11/Fernweh.mp3>

Posted on 2022-11-29 by Cologero

* * *

Mike M on 2022-11-30 at 11:20 said:

Once you jump you realize it was a comedy all along.

De Bosit on 2022-12-01 at 15:21 said:

"Paradise is still on this earth", this was one of the earliest sentences I read in Evolas Hermetic Tradition, just gotta find my spot...

Nice to hear your voice.

Balder on 2022-12-02 at 06:35 said:

The Harmony of the Spheres is throughly a sight once you get a touch of the Ogdoad's transcendent impulse that moves them from the super-worldly Kingdoms of Light.

Sibylle on 2023-05-22 at 02:39 said:

I have some blurred memories of an imagined ride on a carpet somewhere in my childhood home. I used a lot of pillows to secure the edges of the carpet, so I wouldn't accidentally fall off, since I remember I was flying very high, too high for a little girl on her own... You know when you get homesick for something that is so far away and so deeply hidden that you don't recall it properly. But you know that is your real home. You can call it Fernweh – and that's what I thought it was when I was little, and I imagined I was flying to the stars... Now I am no longer afraid to fall, because I realized what no cosmical force can tear apart. And I know you are there, flying with the angels. You abide in my heart.

My thoughts and prayers are with the Salvo family.

9.16 The Sonnet Challenge

As a condition for initiation into the Fedeli d'Amore, the candidate submitted a sonnet. Writing a sonnet has several benefits for the poet:

- He cannot rely on discursive thinking to express ideas. Instead, he has to create images and thoughts in the reader's mind through succinct sentences.
- He is forced to write with a high idea density. Since the number of words is limited, there can be no unnecessary words.
- The restriction to a rhyme scheme and meter disciplines the mind.

Fundamentally, some thoughts can only be expressed in a poem.

In that spirit, several participants in our esoteric group have accepted the sonnet challenge. We shall be posting them each week for the next month or so.

Posted on 2023-01-18 by Cologero

* * *

Ignatius on 2023-01-19 at 09:21 said:

Die Zeit hat nur ihn selbst zurückgelassen;
 nie wird er den Sphären lauschen wie an jenen Tagen;
 wenn er doch nie die höheren Mysterien aufgeschlagen;
 wär ihm das bescheidne Glück belassen.

Welch Grausamkeit, sein Leben so zu schließen;
 er verpaßte Anfang, Mitte und End in einem;
 weder konnte er in Gottes Gnade sich vereinen;
 noch die frischen Wonnen des Tages genießen.

Das Schicksal ist die kalte Zwischenwelt;
 Denen es bei den Menschen nicht gefällt;
 Nicht tot, nicht lebend in die Höhe starren.

Kann sich nicht winden und nicht beugen;
 Nur noch aus sich selbst heraus erzeugen;
 Um auf ewig pflanzlich auszuharren.

9.17 Sonnet: Nocturne



by **Mike M.**

Nocturne

Crust covered, creaky feet, marching on twigs.
I gaze at the moon. Owls cry, none are seen.
Some stay 'round the fire. Logs snap and scream.
I recall home, only the snout of pigs.

Seated, silent. All falls off in one glance.
Orion ambulates above. What can
I do with this life? Not one thing. What plan
Does man carry through infinite expanse?

Children joyfully toss 'round the divine.
I join them knowing all the rules. Before
One mote of dust is the rose scent divine.

Rest now, your work boots have fallen apart.
You are never without. There is no lack.
Make it a comedy, make it your art.

Posted on 2023-01-19 by Cologero

* * *

Naida on 2023-01-20 at 12:38 said:
Beautiful!

Kaukomieli on 2023-01-21 at 06:56 said:
This was enjoyable! Thank you.
I got so inspired that I wrote this just now.

I have carried the weight of Atlas
Upon my burderned shoulders
I discard the heavy baggage
Into the pit of wilderness

I am a dismal cry in the wilderness
Searching for the sacred centre
I am the cry of the white wolf
Holding up the banner of strength and wisdom

Alas, the Gods have now Fallen
And the Titans gain power
As caesarian rule destroys humanity

Where to look for salvation
now when everything
has crumbled to dust?

9.18 Sonnet: Springtime

by Tannheuser

Springtime *For my noblest joy, named Eve.*

Like rain in the desert, the shower of high romance,
Soft breath of May, brings heart's undying flow'r
They gaze into each others eyes and dance
He plucks her not, and she becomes his power

Fates split his thread from hers, so bittersweet
She burns his hell and floods his heav'n with light
Clandestine, spurs him to his greatest feats
To scour the world, to strive and test his might

Blood mixed with fire, his ardor does not wane
Clock's hands arrested, she keeps him ever young
A sage's pearl of price, he seeks to gain
That rose for her, from that first garden sprung

Each night, they steal to secret rendezvous;
Her kiss conducts him to a life renewed.

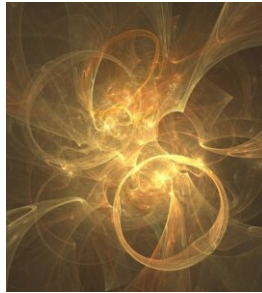
Posted on 2023-01-26 by Cologero

9.19 **Sonnet: Miserere**

by **One Fugue**

Miserere

Floating aimless clinging to whatever,
Unaware of what is going on.
Drifting down to hell upon this river,
Toward the swirling vortex of death's maw.



Give up hope all ye who this way row.
See your fate and feel it's fearful tenor.
But fear the Lord and you'll reverse the flow.
Oh Lord my God have mercy on this sinner.

A light is widening before my vision.
My heart is stretching wide as it can go,
Expanding from your beauty and your wisdom.

It is not burning wrath that you will know,
When fear is given to the place above.
But burning of the heart that's pierced with love.

<https://www.gornahoor.net/wp-content/uploads/2023/02/Miserere.mp3>

* * *

Ruadri Laeth on 2023-02-10 at 09:35 said:
Beautiful. Well done.

Matt on 2023-02-09 at 23:21 said:
This poem was inspired in large part from an experience listening to Miserere by Arvo Pärt.
<https://youtu.be/7HjaGF5TLNI>

9.20 Sonnet: Dying Ember

by Max Ley^{f3}

A dying ember swallowed up by grey
A swansong born on golden pinions bright
Is sung the solemn psalm of fateful night
Of the hero who had held our plight at bay,

Who with single hand had mastered Winter's sway
Now fallen with the fading of the light
A shadow only of his onetime might
An echo only of the glorious day

A fading echo, yet I will take it in
And like a secret, I will guard and tend
This kernel whence the age to come begins.

Forth its leaves and golden boughs to send —
I know the secret: the god shall rise again
Whose reign shall last until the world's end.

Posted on 2023-02-23 by Cologero

9.21 Clementia Dei

The soul & heart, all mine & all of me,
Floats over small body and huge abyss
Easily dissolved into a hot mist
Or not so, to rise quickly and swiftly,

Like the glimmering, vapor breath of dawn,
Into heaven's bourne and the breast of God,

^{f3}<https://theoriapress.substack.com/>

As speedy and as hidden as a nod,
Upon the whirling wind and garden song.

The I lives on as the body unwinds.
What shall keep grave me sinking down to hell?
(So heavy and so long dead the soul that fell.)

Long time before mere Worthies' hope, I find,
An older good, an ancient Love, perhaps
The Light Who spoke to me before the Hap.

Posted on 2023-02-23 by Logres

* * *

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-11 at 05:26 said:

That's beautiful Logres – I hear you! not easy coming to terms with the Fall is it.....thankfully the Lord is indeed merciful Cxx

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-11 at 05:54 said:

relevant to this – and also tangentially to some of the posts about music and geometry – is an extract from MoTT Letter VI, The Lover, which I transcribed here:

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/ecstasy-and-enstasy>

In particular Logres: The descent into the depths of your own soul in meditating upon the account of paradise in Genesis will render you incapable of doubt. Such is the nature of the certainty that one can have here....

....It expresses in symbolic language the first layer (first in the sense of the root of all that is human in human nature) of human psychic life, or its 'beginning'. Now, knowledge of the beginning, initium in Latin, is the essence of initiation.

The above pertains to the Hermetic initiation (by which a state of enstasy is reached), achieved via spiritual touch, and this is 'mirrored' by what is termed the Pythagorean initiation which has rapturous ecstasy as it's result and is attained primarily via spiritual hearing and is 'essentially musical'

H00 on 2012-02-11 at 11:11 said:

Impressive comment Charlotte.

logres on 2012-02-11 at 12:05 said:

Agree with HOO. In fact, there might be something here as relates to Christianity's problems with traditionalism, something about beginning at the beginning. Tomberg thought that Greek and Jewish thought were both logically prior to Christianity (the Kabbalah, and the mysteries). I think he referred to them as "Father" and "Mother". Steiner seems to want to start with John? This helps, Charlotte, thanks.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-11 at 13:09 said:

the kind words are appreciated both, but I think we can all thank our unknown friend for the evergreen words of wisdom – it helps me too.

Steiner does indeed seem to hold John in very high (highest?) esteem. He was very open in his adherence to the Rosicrucian stream, which I understand he sees as starting with John? I have also heard Steiner 'accused' – I think this is the right word! – of following John rather than Jesus, but I would not like to say that this is entirely true. What I can say I've noticed in some branches of the faith is that John is held in extreme reverence as the 'originator' and this of course hearkens back to Elijah, who from a 'new age gnostic' perspective is very much relevant at this point in time.

My personal research has confirmed (to me at least) the connection between Elijah and John, but I'm not sure if this is generally accepted? All of this brings us back to Lazarus. Here is one of the many things Steiner had to say on the matter:

"We have shown how in the course of time the being who was present in Elijah appeared again at the most important moments of human evolution on Earth—appeared again so that Christ Jesus Himself could give him the initiation he was to receive for the evolution of humankind. For the being of Elijah reappeared in Lazarus-John—who are in truth one and the same figure."

This was his first and only indication of the connection between John the Baptist and John the Evangelist.

What else can I say except that I tend to get them 'mixed up' too?!

This is what Steiner told his doctor on his deathbed:

"At the awakening of Lazarus, the spiritual Being, John the Baptist, who since his death had been the overshadowing Spirit of the disciples, penetrated from above into Lazarus as far as the Consciousness Soul; the Being of Lazarus himself, from below, intermingled with the spiritual Being of John the Baptist from above. After the awakening of Lazarus, this Being is Lazarus-John, the disciple whom Jesus loved."

I have not read the pertinent lectures but apparently Steiner believed that after his beheading John became a kind of 'group soul' for the 12 disciples, and Lazarus/John in particular. Granted

the idea of Lazarus and John being one starts with Steiner, unless anyone knows otherwise?

This 'sharing of spiritual essence' seems to me characteristic of Steiner's teaching, which also incorporates 2 separate Jesus children...

H00 on 2012-02-11 at 19:02 said:

Speaking of poems...

"That is why an Islamic tradition says that Adam, in the earthly Paradise, spoke in verse, that is, in rhythmic speech; this is related to that "Syrian language" (lughah suryāniyyah) of which we spoke in our previous study on the "science of letters," and which must be regarded as translating directly the "solar and angelic illumination" as this manifests itself in the center of the human state. This is also why the Sacred Books are written in rhythmic language which, clearly, makes of them something quite other than the mere "poems," in the purely profane sense, which the anti-traditional bias of the modern critics would have them to be. Moreover, in its origins poetry was by no means the vain "literature" that it has become by a degeneration resulting from the downward march of the human cycle, and it had a truly sacred character. Traces of this can be found up to classical antiquity in the West, when poetry was still called the "language of the Gods," an expression equivalent to those we have indicated, in as much as the Gods, that is, the Devas, are, like the angels, the representation of the higher states. In Latin, verses were called carmina, a designation relating to their use in the accomplishment of rites; for the word carmen is identical to the Sanskrit karma which must be taken here in its special sense of "ritual action"; and the poet himself, interpreter of the "sacred language" through which the divine Word appears, was vates [...] [Guénon, The "The Language of the Birds"]

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-12 at 05:55 said:

yes, I read this last night, it is a very interesting text. Actually I've been enjoying everything of Guenon since I (finally!) started reading a few weeks ago – a man after my own heart in many ways, it seems. I agree with everything said about 'poetry'. it's a theme that goes way back into the ancient world, from the stories of Enki to the utterances of the Pythia, Orphic hymns, epics of Homer and Virgil and so on. More recently, looking at the three interlocking circles of tradition, I always thought that the Islamic essence was very much about bringing the fire of beauty and joy to the overall equation, in no small part via the arts. It always struck me as significant that the Koran was sung and it is very relaxing to hear the call to prayer in Muslim countries. It drives some people mad when they go out there but I think it's wonderful. More specific to the Devas, there are some wonderful recitals of prayers and mantras to be heard around Diwali.

"This is she! the peerless princess, Rama's consort loved and lost,? This is she! the saintly Sita, by a cruel fortune cross,"

Hanuman thus thought and pondered: "On her graceful form I spy,? Gems and gold by sorrowing Rama oft depicted with it sigh,

On her ears the golden pendants and the tiger's sharpened tooth,? On her arms the jewelled bracelets, tokens of unchanging truth,

On her pallid brow and bosom still the radiant jewels shine,? Rama with a sweet affection did in early days entwine!"

Santiago on 2023-02-26 at 00:47 said:

This is an incredible poem and a superb delivery.

9.22 Sonnet: All at Sea



by **James Lawrence**

Night is at its nadir and the moon-scythe's light
Gets mocked to dizziness in the drunken sea;
The tomb of fish-shoals spittles up its spite,
And glimmering squid-hordes dream and breed in me.

Hail has hammered me in my open cot,
And freezing ice-floes fettered me to standstill;
And the sink of rivers, swelling as it rots,
Spreads out more wave-halls long before my land-sill.

Still I'll not despire to no mermaid's rock;
I plot one hundred paths to my beloved;
But her liquid heart sits hard behind its lock;
I pitch, and toss, one hundred tries rebuffed.

The sun-brand swelters, and the salt-sick main

Mists up, distills this whispering refrain.

https://www.gornahoor.net/wp-content/uploads/2023/03/AllAtSea_Audio.m4a

Posted on 2023-03-16 by Cologero

* * *

Mike M on 2023-03-24 at 12:04 said:

Beautiful imagery and metaphor as well as the reading itself.

10.1 The Prisoner: Free for All

When I first watched the television series, *The Prisoner*, I assumed it was a warning against the dehumanizing and massification methods of the Western liberal “democracies”. When I recently saw it again, it dawned on me that it is actually a blueprint for the world to come. Do you remember those ominous, ubiquitous cameras that kept an eye on the village? They are actually a “good thing” as the UK has installed tens of thousands of those ominous, ubiquitous cameras.

In the episode “Free for All”, the Prisoner — #6 — is encouraged to run against the village manager #2 in a staged election. The similarities to the recent Democratic National Convention are hard to miss, right down to the staged and emotion-driven speeches and demonstrations.

In anticipation for the POTUS election of 2008, we note that:

1. #6 runs as the agent for “change”
2. #2 runs as the “experienced” candidate

3. There is only the illusion of choice, since the most fundamental issues are not at stake.

Beyond the specifics, we can note that #1 is never shown, since the “true” ruler of the village is forever unknown and unexposed. All opinions are manufactured, usually willingly by the villagers, but by force and violence, if necessary, as in the case of the Prisoner. There is always the need to prove loyalty, not to any higher standard, but purely to the power holders of the village, whoever they may be.

Although the UK today actually does imprison those who dare to transgress their various and sundry speech laws, the BBC web site find it yourself assures us that the “Prisoner” is clearly fiction and utterly unlike the government today. But wouldn’t you expect them to say that? What if the Prisoner is the documentary and BBC documentaries are works of fiction? How adolescent!

Posted on 2008-09-01 by Cologero

10.2 Prisoner of the System

I used to believe that novels such as *Brave New World* or *1984* were to serve as warnings to us, as representing something to be avoided. Unfortunately, it seems their intention is to prepare us for the shape of things to come. We can see the TV series *The Prisoner in the same way*.

In the series, #6 is a prisoner in a mock village, and #2 — whose identity usually changed from week to week is the visible leader. The goal of every #2 is to extract a confession from #6 and integrate him into the village. #6 on the other hand, resists all such attempts. #2 only implements policy; the identity of #1 who actually creates policy is left unknown.

#6 holds to the principle: “I am a man, not a number.” We can regard this as a metaphor for a transcendent principle, since his self-identity as a

man transcends his identity as an anonymous individual in the village. In other words, he asserts his identity as a Person rather than an Individual, a concept with origins in Thomas Aquinas. For Evola,

A person is an individual who is differentiated through his qualities, endowed with his own face, his *proper nature*, and a series of attributes that make him who he is ... that make him fundamentally *unequal*.

#2 is a modernist, since he holds no transcendent principles.

Therefore, he can employ all means of social coercion — drugs, seduction, opprobrium, threats, bribes — designed to break down #6. Because #2 holds no principles, there is no possibility of dialogue between #6 and #2. Instead, their conversations are nothing but mutual posturing, so every episode devolves into a battle of wills.

Concerning the purpose of social institutions, Evola writes:

The perfection of the human being is the end to which every healthy social institution must be subordinated. ... This perfection must be conceived on the basis of a process of individuation and progressive differentiation.

To the contrary, for the village, the end of the human being is to fit into the social structure without disruption. The villagers are under constant surveillance, a trend seen today from the control of finance and medicine sectors which will make those records available to authorities, to public CCTV and the street, and even GPS tracking of citizens. Ideas that would in the past have been restricted to a small circle of initiates are now publicly available on the Internet.

The illusion of dissent is also part of the village. When coercion and deception fail, #2 participates in a “democratic” election, which, of course, will not result in any real change. Any and all attempts by #6 to influence

the villagers fail. Without any transcendent principles themselves, the villagers are motivated by fear and sentiment. Speeches in the public square, editorials, and personal conversations are all ineffectual. Ultimately, #6 does find some allies and the behind-the-scenes superstructure of the village is destroyed. Revolution is the only solution.

Of course, that cannot happen today. First of all, because, while the #2's are legion, there is no #1 in total control, hence no single point of vulnerability. That is because there is no real unity of the unprincipled, only a false unity opposed to Tradition. Thus, incompatible and incoherent viewpoints can ally with each other on the basis of anti-principle alone. An explicit #1 is not required because

the locusts have no king, yet but they attack in formation.

PROVERBS 30:27

Unprincipled themselves, the villagers can only view #6 as an agent of destruction, hence as something to be opposed. There is no possibility of change within the system.

Posted on 2010-08-30 by Cologero

10.3 Virgin Spring

Virgin Spring¹ is a 1960 film directed by Ingmar Bergman². Loosely based on a medieval Swedish legend, Bergman develops it into an examination of the relationship between the new Christian religion and the old Norse religion which it was

¹<https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0053976>

²https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ingmar_Bergman



supplanting. We are not interested in the many moralistic interpretations of this story, but rather in what it reveals about the struggle in the consciousness of the Western mind between two opposing world views or spiritual impulses. This struggle continues unresolved to this day and repeats itself in various formulations, often expressed polemically with a strong emotional element. Its partial resolution in the Western world unfortunately embodies the worst aspects of each impulse.

Tore was a prosperous landowner with an estate that supported his wife Mareta and beautiful daughter Karin, as well as Ingeri, a young woman under his care. Tore was a Catholic, of noble birth, strong character, with a commanding, yet paternal, presence. Karin was blonde, pretty, outgoing, devout and virginal. In short, they were the perfect family.

In contrast, Ingeri was private, dark, and bitter. She was pregnant with a bastard child and was resentful of Karin. Ingeri was a witch, using a frog to cast a spell on Karin. On the occasion of a feast day to the Virgin, Karin and Ingeri set out on a trip to the village church. Along the way, Ingeri met a practitioner of the pagan religion and joined him in a ritual. Karin continued alone. Passing by some goat herders, she offered them some of her food. They broke bread with her, then raped and murdered her. When the crime was discovered, Tore killed them all, in revenge.

Tore and his family exemplified what we would call “solarity”, that is, solar characteristics; nobility, strength, beauty, virtue. They represented the Christian consciousness.

On the other hand, the pagans were seen as unsophisticated country bumpkins, driven by resentment, lust and greed. In this story, the pagans represent the lunar element.

The obvious objection is that the legend was slanted by its Christian originators. But this makes no sense for three reasons:

- It implies that the Christians understood solarly and consciously sought it.
- The story would make absolutely no sense if the roles were reversed.
- But the most damning is that the neopagans of today actually embrace the values of the pagans in the legend.
- To be fair, the neo-christians of today would not see Tore in such a positive light. They would embrace the goat herders as the underclass needing assistance programs, and would reject the justice exacted by Tore.

Herein lies the criticisms of Evola against the neopagans: rather than embrace an authentic solar paganism, they adopt the Christian caricature of pagans. Their lustiness simply results in the unwed motherhood of Ingeri. Their intellectual isolation keeps them away from the centers of power, as was the case of the Odinist in the country hovel. The goat herders embodied an amoral “might makes right” policy that seems to be popular among neopagans. And the final irony is that the pagans — Ingeri and the goat herders — were drive by a resentment that a Nietzsche ascribes to Christians.

This perspective is obviously far from the best of the pagan past. Instead, we need to understand this as a battle for the soul of Western man, although its true nature has been obscured by many masks over the course of history.

In the Middle Ages, a balance was established, more or less, between the two tendencies. The pagan and Christian elements were kept in balance. In practice, this shows up in the Traditional conception of the doctrine of Two Powers: Spiritual authority and temporal power. Spiritual authority can be experienced in one of two ways:

1. As a call to transcendence, to life on a higher and creative level
2. As an obstacle to the complete fulfillment of animal appetite – sex, greed, lust and so on

Temporal power, therefore, must either adhere to or reject spiritual authority. Man is driven by three forces: the drive to the transcendent (nous), spiritedness (thumos³), and appetite. Thus *thumos* can be the motive power to a transcendent life by sublimating the appetites. Or else, it can focus on the Sisyphean task of satisfying the appetites while forgetting the transcendent.

The Reformation was the rejection of the Medieval synthesis. Thinking it could purge the pagan element, it overemphasized the transcendent, making it effectively an unreal factor in the world. It brought back the uneasy tension of the ancient Gnostics: Either an unrestrained libertinism, since all sins are forgiven for the saved. Or else a rigid asceticism, that served to demonstrate one's salvation rather than to serve as a means to it.

To the neo-christians (which includes Vatican II Catholics), we quote Tomberg: "Love your pagan past." To the neopagans, we say "Honor your father and mother." This is a task that requires integration, not a pitched battle. For example, despite his many references to and appreciation of the pagans, Carl Jung still claimed that a man's task was the creation of a Self, an archetype that is represented by the Christ figure.

Posted on 2011-01-17 by Cologero

³<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Thumos>

10.4 The American

The American⁴ is a 2010 film based on the novel *A Very Private Gentleman*⁵ by Martin Booth⁶. Although the film deviates from the book, it contains many eloquent and elegant passages about the lifestyle and beauty of Italy. The setting of the film is a small town in the mountainous regions of Abruzzo, a province east of Rome overlooking the Adriatic sea (and one of my ancestral homes). The town is an integral part of the landscape, following its contours in a very natural way. The book points out that international agribusiness has not yet ruined the environment, so it is particularly rich in flora and fauna, particularly the butterflies that so interest the protagonist.

A striking feature of the film is that the cast is entirely European, lacking the obligatory multicultural elements of contemporary American films. This is a way of life that the post-modernists and neo-marxists detest, seeing in it either as a brake on universal progress or as representative of the idiocy of village life. If such a place still exists, it represents a traditional culture, built up over the course of a dozen centuries. Nevertheless, on the other side the neo-pagans see in its yearly rhythm of holy days and processions to the saints only a superstitious, weak, and alien society. Its defenders are AWOL.

To emphasize the point, all the male characters in the film are aged; when that generation goes, the European traditional way of life will go. The young will either “progress” or ineffectively chase after ancient gods.

Jack, the American, is a maker of custom high-performance weapons used in assassinations. When an assignment goes awry in Sweden, he runs off to Italy and secludes himself in the town. His chief gives him

⁴<https://www.imdb.com/title/tt1440728>

⁵<https://hagelrat.blogspot.com/2011/01/americana-very-private-gentleman-martin.html>

⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Martin_Booth

one last job, after which Jack plans to retire. The activities of the groups are played out in secret above the regularities of ordinary life, much like the chivalrous orders of the Middle Ages. The male characters sport a similar haircut, reminiscent of Julius Caesar, thus making a connection to the ancient warrior caste.

Jack works with a sense of inner detachment, although his conversations with the village priest are meant to introduce a doubt into his mind. Nevertheless, it is interesting that Jack retains some characteristics of the Primordial State. First of all, there is his intense concentration. He is intensely focused on his task, which often involves modifications of spare parts.

The other factor is his acute sensory awareness. He is conscious of everything in his environment that could affect him and has almost a sixth sense in his anticipation of danger. This is not due to a better sense apparatus, but rather to his detachment and lack of a personal element. He has no close friends or love relationships.

With women, he enjoys before possessing. After a visit to the prostitute Carla when she reaches orgasm, he complains that he came to get pleasure not give it. But she desires to possess in order to enjoy, so she pursues a personal relationship with Jack.

His personal relationships with Carla and the priest lead him to his final act. In the Bhagavad Gita, the warrior is justified to kill his oppressor if there is no thought of reward. His career, however, was not directed against oppressors, and he was well rewarded. In the end he identifies and does kill his oppressor and, in a chivalrous act, gives up his reward to another.

Posted on 2011-01-18 by Cologero

10.5 The Girls and the City

Man is reasonable, and by that very fact, like unto God; he was created free, to be master of his acts.

ST IRENEUS

My son gave me **Marcus Aurelius'** Meditations on CD nicely read by David Steen. Reading is an unnatural act which transforms the sight of the text into an inner hearing, so listening brings out the text in a different way. Aurelius exhorts us to live a life of Reason, by which he means to follow the natural order, or Logos. Yet, we stray from that once in a while.

I am usually embarrassed in social situations from not recognizing certain icons of pop culture or TV shows. So I watched a show called *Girls*⁷ Sunday night, although I am nearly a year behind its debut. It is a creation of a woman who both wrote the script and stars in it, so I suppose I have to praise her creativity and energy. Its premise seems to have been taken from *Sex in the City*⁸, but updated for Generation X, so it lacks the glitz and glamour of the latter. First of all, I don't recommend that any man refer to adult women with the "G" word, but it seems OK if they do it. I guess it is meant to be a metaphor for the emotional immaturity of the show's characters.

Having watched two episodes, it reminded me of *Seinfeld* in that it is a show about nothing, except that it is not funny ... unless you think watching a cripple fall down the stairs is funny. The players are hardly masters of their acts, but are blown about in the wind of their own disorder. For the women in *Sex and the City*, sexual activity was the path to ecstasy. For the *Girls*, it only leads to angst. One is afraid of contracting an STD. Another is pregnant and both wants and avoids an abortion.

⁷<http://www.hbo.com/girls/index.html%20target=>

⁸<http://www.hbo.com/sex-and-the-city/index.html>

A third is concerned that she is barren because she never got pregnant. They are all concerned that someone else's experience is more exciting.

Emperor Aurelius would scoff at all this. For him, sex is merely the rubbing together of membranes and the secretion of mucous. Put that way, it is hardly comprehensible how sex dominates social structures and individual energies. From a physical point of view, he is correct. But sex is not merely physical: it depends on extended periods of thought, fantasies, and preparation. I will propose an experiment, and I mean this literally to anyone who is sexually active. During foreplay try to remain fully conscious at all times, in the sense that you are the detached observer of what is transpiring. Observing the thoughts and imagery that way will tend to dissipate them before they are fully formed. Observe the body, i.e., focus attention on the physical sensations. If done properly, you may reach the same conclusion as the Emperor.

Although the women of *Sex and the City* were promiscuous, they always held out hope for the perfect man. In that show, there are still remnants of persons with backgrounds and allegiances. One character was infatuated with a man she called Big. However, he was a Presbyterian of an upper middle class background, for whom a Jewish prole would not be appropriate, so he married a WASP. This was counterbalanced by the upper class Episcopalian woman who fell in love with a rather homely Jewish man. Yet this relationship was so important, it superseded her allegiance to that other Jew, Jesus Christ.

In contrast, the Girls seem to be deracinated generic human beings. Although objectively white, that seems to play no part in their identity. *A fortiori*, New York is where Lethe flows, so the Girls can forget their pasts. Families are significant only insofar as they continue to provide financial support. There is no expectation of a relationship from sex. One has a boyfriend who uses her for sex and then disappears for weeks at a time. Another finds herself pregnant and alone, yet is still addicted to anonymous sex. A third is dissatisfied—emotionally and sexually—

with her doting beta boyfriend. Another can only dream of a boyfriend, expecting the secret of romance to be found in self-help books.

Women today, technologically unleashed from the natural binds of the human body, have apparently become obsessed with sex, which should not surprise anyone familiar with the story of Tiresias⁹. For example, I received this notice from my alumni association. At first, I thought it was a satire piece from the Onion¹⁰, but that is not the case. It was meant as a showcase to convince us alumni to donate money to support such efforts.

When Bryn C. was scanning a map of the world, imagining the places she could study abroad, the possibilities seemed endless. Eventually, she chose Amsterdam, where she's excited to spend a semester studying sexuality and gender issues as they relate to social justice.

Justice is when each thing is in its proper order, so social justice is when a society is properly ordered, which Bryn can read about here. A just sexuality will follow the natural order as Aurelius described. Gender issues are resolved in the proper order between men and women. I hope this helps Bryn and it will save her a trip.

Posted on 2012-12-12 by Cologero

* * *

Dominion on 2012-12-13 at 15:45 said:

I must say, as a member of what is probably Gen Y (born in the 90's), the quality of media has significantly improved since the days of MTV trash that Gen X had to endure. HBO has far better shows than *Sex and the City*; try the *Rome* series, which I thoroughly enjoyed (although the character of Octavia is not quite the virtuous woman painted by the histories. The new

⁹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4852>

¹⁰<https://www.theonion.com/>

Spartacus series (currently stalled after season 2's end, it seems) and the Borgias (also awaiting season 3) are very good. The latter has excellent character development... one sympathizes with Pope Alexander VI and his lovers as much as with Cardinal della Rovere's attempts to purify the corruption of the Vatican. The aesthetics are beautiful as well, with Lucrezia's first wedding being a scene I watched repeatedly.

They all are far more concerned with the proper order of the individual spirit and the State, Church, and/or social system than a group of aging and obsessed city 'girls' can be expected to be.

Cologero on 2012-12-14 at 06:54 said:

I'm not sure we are on the same page, Dominion. I don't deny the technical quality of HBO shows, although that is not the same as artistic merit. The topic was the show "Girls" (which I watched because Boardwalk Empire was not on), which is ostensibly about your generation Y. Why is sexual activity portrayed in such a perfunctory and unerotic way, compared to the previous "generation" of a decade ago? After all, art imitates life.

Dominion on 2012-12-14 at 13:44 said:

I mention them as examples of modern media where ideas like family, faith and even caste (to a degree) figure more prominently than in the show you mention. They are obviously somewhat distorted, but also differ from the bland, plastic way some "conservative" media tries to portray them.

As for your question, as anyone in high school or university can tell you, it's because sex is now unerotic. Sex for the act's sake, or for the prestige of the act, dominates in the public sphere. Hookup culture dominates on campus, in cities, even in small towns. The late, great Ferdinand Bardamu's Age of Onanism is manifest. It seems a man of Tradition should be striving to re-eroticize the most erotic of physical acts in his private life.

Audrey on 2012-12-16 at 23:20 said:

Cologero, you really think reading is unnatural? Your posts are very intelligent and sharp. What about Evola's writing? Self-dialogue? Jealous of the gift, a nice son.

Audrey on 2012-12-16 at 23:22 said:

Hookup culture dominates everywhere.

Cologero on 2012-12-17 at 00:25 said:

Audrey, I provided an explanation that reading is a substitute for hearing ... is your experience different? Actually, I've had such a piece in mind, but it would range from Julian Jaynes to Plato's Seventh Letter to Augustine's Confessions to Coomaraswamy's Bugbear of Literacy.

Reading a text is only the simulacra of intuition. That is why the posts are “sharp” rather than extended monologues and “proofs”. Evola writes like a German professor; yes, it makes me jealous.

Audrey on 2012-12-17 at 18:15 said:

Apropos of reading being a substitute for hearing?! Definitely.. calligraphic arts of Japan?

Alistair Fraser on 2015-08-30 at 21:47 said:

Cologero , the experiment works , good point, and i think this is sometimes also occurring unintentionally in couples which can then get mis-diagnosed onto a man as being impotent , but the true problem might be that there is no sexual tension present in which as its allowed to flow, no such experiment could possibly enter the thoughts because the needs are overpoweringly imminent

Alistair Fraser on 2015-08-30 at 21:52 said:

And there are definitely huge variants in the phenomena of “sexual tension” , but it seems definite to me that the intellectual man is going to be more prone to falling back into a mind body separation (unintentional experiment) pre-sexual act because they stuck in a habitual situation , but also they are capable of a higher level of erotic intensity once they realise this

10.6 Lucy in the Sky

Last night I saw the movie *Lucy*¹¹, starring **Scarlett Johansson**, with a good friend. Unlike typical reviews, we always review from the perspective of the third dimension. From this dimension come various influences, both baleful and benevolent. Understanding those influences will reveal the “meaning” of what occurs on the empirical plane. It is this meaning that then determines events. In the case of an artistic endeavor, this may or not coincide with the meaning imputed to the artist, since there are both conscious and unconscious agents of these higher influences.

¹¹http://www.imdb.com/title/tt2872732/?ref_=nv_sr_1

First of all, there are the unexamined assumptions made by the director. What is immediately noticeable is the total irrelevance and almost complete absence of males of European descent. There is Lucy's grifter love interest who inadvertently kicks off Lucy's adventure. Later on, the French gendarme plays the French poodle to Lucy's initiatives. Morgan Freeman plays the brilliant brain researcher, Professor Norman, who provides a pseudo-intellectual theory to make the rest of the story plausible, given the requisite suspension of belief.

The Johansson Lucy is the type of Leaky's Lucy, the *australopithecus* hominid. In other words, her psychic roots go back far beyond the appearance of the first humans as Adam and Eve, to a pre-Adamic humanoid being, presumably devoid of truly human qualities. As in so many recent movies, Lucy begins her transformation as an aimless party girl, fearful and meek in the face of danger. As she gains in knowledge, or awareness—losing her boyfriend along the way—she miraculously turns into a confident, strong, and independent woman.

A Chinese gang created a synthetic version of an imaginary hormone CPH₄, which initiates the formation of a skeletal system in the fetus. In small doses, it creates a nice high so the gang is preparing to introduce it to the traditionally white nations of the West. They enlist Lucy against her will and surgically implant a bag of CPH₄ in her abdomen. When she is kicked in the belly by an overzealous guard, the drug leaks into her system. This leads to a doubling of her brain capacity from 10% to 20%, giving her self-confidence, great physical strength, and a perfect aim with handguns.



Figure 10.1: Scarlett Johansson

What is interesting is the predominance of psychopathy in Hollywood films. Perhaps filmmakers are fascinated with characters lacking any sense of higher human emotions. Or more likely, that is the “type” that

they typically encounter, assuming they themselves are not psychopaths. Although he may have superior intelligence, the psychopath is basically reptilian in terms of emotional development. He is driven by the needs and desires of the body, interested in little other than money, sex, and power. There is no sense of self restraint in their pursuit.

We can therefore accept that the Chinese gang members have no respect for human life, killing in cold blood. What is strange, though, is that Lucy herself is revealed as a psychopath. She shoots a taxi driver for no reason, and even a cancer patient on the operating table. This shows there is a need among the masses for the uninhibited expression of an *élan vital*; isn't that the point of having knowledge and power?

The *frein vital*, which should be the self-restraint developed in a higher level of human being, is experienced by them as a restraint from the outside, as a limitation on their freedom, and a nagging inner voice that prevents a carefree life in the state of nature. Unfortunately for them, it is that inner friction, or spiritual warfare, that leads to higher consciousness, so they remain perpetually in a poorly developed emotional state. This view then leads to a mistaken understanding of compassion. If it is good to discard or ignore the *frein vital* in oneself, then others should be encouraged to do the same.

Hence, no one is judged, although the true self always judges justly.

As Lucy begins to use more and more of her brain capacity, she develops powers not just over herself, but over others as well, and ultimately over the physical world itself. She discovers she acquired an addiction to CPH₄, so she needs to track down the other mules in Europe. The authorities bring them to Paris, where coincidentally Prof. Norman is visiting. In Paris, Lucy races a car through the city in order to get her fix of all the remaining CPH₄, oblivious to the collateral damage she is causing. That psychopathic solipsism is somehow justified in her pursuit of the ultimate goal.

That goal is not an evolution, but revolution, as the Professor said.

Since revolution is the overthrow of the established order of things, Lucy's revolution reaches into the very nature of being. In her first encounter with the primal Lucy, the second Lucy wonders about what has been done to the world. We then see a montage of human created cities, which are in contrast to primal Lucy's natural lifestyle. It was unsaid, but it is obvious that the montage represents the world created by men, with the authorization of the Father God.

As Lucy receives intravenously all the remaining CPH₄, she gradually transforms into a human-machine hybrid. She then is able to download all her knowledge into a computer, implausibly, due to the limited capacity of any such machine. When her brain capacity reaches 100%, her physical body evaporates and she adds omnipresence to her omniscience. The revolution is complete as the goddess finally displaces the antique Father God. This is confirmed when she astral travels to meet Lucy. She gives her a "finger bump" reminiscent of the scene in the Sistine Chapel where God does the same to Adam.

As her final gesture, she leaves the Professor a flash drive, apparently containing all human knowledge. Since it is an elongated flash driver, it is a phallic symbol.

What does this mean? Since the representation creates reality, the worldviews we are fed have a real consequence. The goddess is psychopathic, solipsistic and will stop at nothing to further her aims. Since the world is malleable, "not subject to mathematical laws", as the goddess demonstrates, then we are not bound by our natures. Hence, everything is up for grabs, most recently in what defines a human life, marriage, and even gender.

So the real issue, then, is who gets to provide the world representation. In the mass media, it is always an external trigger, a drug or a burst of radiation, etc., that leads to higher brain capacity or superhuman powers. This is the passive approach. As we recently read in the commentary on **Hermann Keyserling**, "what is important is not to procure new

knowledge or experiences, but rather to change the *level* of one's own personality".

This is the complete opposite to Lucy, who achieved new knowledge, without, however, changing her level of being. Although Lucy achieves something like the Absolute Self, she is still "other". Although she provides the world with all knowledge as bits on a flash drive, she does not solve the problem of meaning. What do they do with that knowledge? What does it all mean? Ultimately, nothing.

Posted on 2014-08-01 by Cologero

* * *

Valvar on 2014-08-01 at 05:29 said:

As an aside, regarding the lack of European males, does that not cut both ways? From what I could gather in the trailer, the villains were also Asian?

Anyway, I apologize if you have already brought this up (I am slowly working my way through your works), but could it not be said that the core of leftist (and other branches of the same tree) thought is *transgression*? It seems to me, that that is the center of gravity that our entire contemporary society and this film revolve around.

Cologero on 2014-08-01 at 08:12 said:

Valvar, admittedly using the tools provided by magical idealism to review and interpret mass culture is something new and will undoubtedly undergo some development. ... hopefully not by me alone. These tools have been described in recent posts. Fundamental is the principle that representations create reality, not vice versa. Hence, we first of all try to describe the representation. Since very few people are conscious of their own interiority, the elements of the representation are not explicitly stated. The task is to unveil the undisclosed assumptions behind it.

There is no moralizing involved in this, simply statement of facts, beyond good and evil. You are attempting to moralize the representation. The irrelevance of European males in the plot is simply a statement of fact. That reveals conscious or more likely unconscious assumptions about the world process.

If by "transgression", you mean a state of permanent revolution against the cosmic law, then we have brought this up over and over.

Paulo on 2014-08-02 at 16:35 said:

Will this subversive propaganda make some reaction in people soon enough? Make an outburst of disgust in them? Here in Brazil they make a movie where a famous actor interpret a gay character, and people became very irritated with this and I even left the movie when it was in the cinema. I hope this kind of thing, helps even more the process of separating the wheat from the chaff!

Cologero on 2014-08-02 at 19:03 said:

Paulo, you are missing the point. I am not criticizing the movie or trying to evoke disgust or anger, merely cataloging worldviews just like a botanist describing various herbs in the Amazon jungle. Think Arjuna and remain indifferent. Like him, we have friends, relatives, and colleagues who adhere to a similar worldview.

Paulo on 2014-08-03 at 17:28 said:

Cologero, I get it what you have said perfectly, I was just wondering about this possibility. But please understand what I have said, is this kind of situation that makes some people awake to what is really going on!

Valvar on 2014-08-07 at 16:36 said:

Cologero, you mention "both baleful and benevolent" in the first paragraph. Is this not a moralization, or am I missing something? I realize that the rest of the article and the method do not follow that track, so is it perhaps correct to assume that your intention is to let the reader make their own assumptions and conclusions (granted that they understand the elements at play), or am I passing you entirely by here?

Yes, by transgression I meant precisely that. Any pointers as to where to start on that subject?

scardanelli on 2014-08-08 at 09:55 said:

If I may... when one moralizes, he is making a judgment based upon a preconceived dogma or set of ideals. That is not the task here. Rather than judging or intellectualizing, simply observe the various influences that are ultimately manifested in the movie. The point is to learn to see.

Like most posts here, it is much easier to understand if one is practicing this inwardly. To understand the "meaning" of your life, observe inwardly the ideas, thoughts, and emotions that are being manifested in your life, either actively or passively. The macrocosm corresponds to the microcosm.

10.7 Man in the High Castle

Ostensibly a review of some artifacts of popular culture including the *Man in the High Castle*, the *Vikings* and *Valkyrie*, but a few may notice something else ...

Amazon recently released a dramatic television series, *The Man in the High Castle*, loosely based on **Philip K Dick**'s novel of the same name first published in 1962. The premise is based on the counter-factual history that the Axis powers won World War II. The Pacific states are occupied by Japan and the Eastern states by Germany, with a buffer zone around the Rockies.

It's difficult to understand Amazon's purpose, since the occupied USA seems more attractive. Was that by accident or design? Or most likely, the writers saw it as less attractive. The Nippon states were less attractive, since the white citizens were pretty much in dhimmitude to the Japanese. Nevertheless, one is struck by the Japanese code of honor and politeness, at least among each other. Moreover, a government official who failed in his duties felt shame to the extent that suicide was preferable. Now in the USA, many politicians are willing to "accept responsibility" for their failures, but that is something quite different from accepting the consequences.

The Eastern sector was populated by normal families, who were well groomed, polite, dined together, interacted with each other rather than electronic devices, valued patriotism and education. Apparently the intact family, in the mind of the Amazon Studio writers, sounds fascist to the modern mind. On the negative side, the right to bear arms was rejected and Bibles forbidden, available only on the black market. In 1962, a well-bred man in the USA would have been shocked that a government would have that power, since he still "clung to his gun and his Bible". Nowadays the possession of guns and Bibles is considered fascist and the utopian left is working to ban both of them; what was fascist in 1962 is

progressive today.

If the elimination of guns and bibles sounds normal to you, perhaps assisted suicide still makes you queasy, at least it was unthinkable in 1962. When the son of the American Nazi officer John Smith starts exhibiting symptoms of a genetic degenerative disease, the father is given a suicide kit to use on the son. Nowadays, it is called “end of life” counseling, and the “right to die” is increasingly accepted. Moreover, the idea of euphemistic post-natal abortions¹² is gaining acceptance. So the idea of a hospital cremating the handicapped and terminally ill, as in the series, is really a foretelling of our own future rather than an imaginary fascist past.

There is even an annoying SJW, Juliana, who is headstrong in taking on a mission she does not understand, oblivious to the collateral damage she is causing. She illustrates the danger of the sex instinct, since her boyfriend, a young nazi secret agent, and even her I Ching casting Japanese boss, all had major crushes on her. Let’s just say some people get hurt, especially the boyfriend’s sister, niece and nephew. The men all compromise their own life missions for her.

So back to the important part of the story, which we will have to fill in, since it was unclear in the series. The man in the high castle is collecting films that depict alternate versions of reality. For example, in one of them, the Allies won the war, in another the secret agent assassinated the boyfriend.

Now we are getting into Philip K Dick territory, even if he himself did not actually use that motif. In *Gnosis*, **Boris Mouravieff** compares each person’s life to a film in which he has a leading part. Such as we are, we are passive participants in the film, interacting with persons for unknown reasons. However, the goal is to become the conscious agent — writer and director — of the script of one’s own life.

Perhaps that is the real point of the series, rather than as an homage

¹²<http://aleteia.org/2014/11/05/post-birth-abortions-an-idea-thats-gaining-ground-on-campus>

to our “superior” way of life. As Guenon pointed out, “The end of one world is the beginning of another.” Awakening from the common dream leads to the real world, but it must start with a few.

Valkyrie The series includes a failed assassination attempt on Hitler, perhaps mirroring a real attempt in 1944, that **Julius Evola**, writing in 1952¹³, claimed was little known. *Valkyrie* is the title of a 2008 film, about the 1944 assassination attempt on Hitler, starring Tom Cruise, so it is perhaps more well-known now. One can easily get the impression from these shows that liberals and progressives were interested in eliminating Hitler. However, in fact, the attempt was engineered by the conservative elements in Germany who did not regard Hitler as conservative or right-wing.

The Vikings The History Channel has been airing a series about the Vikings at the time they were becoming interested in England and France. The broad outline is historically correct, although certainly not in every detail. There is a lesson in it about a real “clash of civilizations”. A couple of generations after Charlemagne, Europe had become Christianized while the Vikings remained pagans. Although both sides practiced Realpolitik, the Vikings had no regard for just way theory. Whenever they wanted something, they went on a “raid”. Saxon England and Paris, as more advanced, and possibly more effete, civilizations, provided attractive targets for raids.

There may be lessons here for contemporary attempts at multi-culturalism: it does not happen by wishful thinking. Even when a Saxon king allowed a Viking settlement on his land, the problems did not go away. Differences in race, religion, language, and culture are not easily bridged.

The conflict between pagans and Christians is one of the more interesting aspects. Despite their general amorality, there is still something

¹³<https://gornahoor.wordpress.com/2015/12/06/a-failed-revolution/>

noble about the Vikings. They regard patriarchy as normative, support their community, love and value their children, are indifferent to pain, accept the tragic side of life, and look forward to an afterlife. Ragnar, the Viking leader, tells his son that “happiness does not matter”, i.e., it is neither the purpose of life nor a goal to pursue. So the “pursuit of happiness” in the *Declaration of Independence* must be an illusory right.

The Nordic gods and stories are a real presence and even temptation. Nevertheless, from an esoteric perspective all that must be left behind. One Viking explains to a Christian monk that his gods are real, they eat, fight, and so on. To him such humanized gods are regarded as a strength. Yet, **Boris Mouravieff** tells us something different:

Reason attributes to the divine an attitude, a weakness, and even more often, purely human motives... which tended to humanize the divinities. The Good News announced by Jesus reversed this ancient conception, calling for the divinization of the human in man by a second Birth; the gateway to the Kingdom of God.

Some try to idealize the pagan life in its immediacy and closeness to nature. They can't see past the first birth into the state of nature. The task of the esoterist is quite different: it is not to humanize the gods, but rather to divinize the human.

A final thought: in our time, it is rare to see a movie or TV show with an all white cast and no gay characters. If you are flirting with white nationalism, you can look and then decide if you like that. I suspect not, since there is no gay character to explain to the Vikings how to act more manly.

When We Were Young Avoid this if you can; I couldn't. It concerns a culture clash between a boomer and an ambitious millennial. There was a minor point that was of interest, viz., acting either from innocence or experience. The boomer was all high tech, but the millennial went retro.

For example, he played board games rather than electronic games, used an old mechanical typewriter for his scripts, sported a fedora, and owned an extensive music collection on vinyl LPs.

I don't see that millennials are going retro in droves, although Barnes & Noble is phasing out CDs in favor of LPs. Now in fact I play board and card games rather than electronic games, often wear a fedora, and still have a nice collection of vinyl. But I do it naively, since that was the world in which I was raised. It is not necessarily a conscious choice, but more a matter of habit.

However, the millennial is acting ironically. He makes a conscious decision to reject the contemporary option; it is not a habit, but rather an acquired taste.

We are in an analogous position. The world of our fathers no longer exists, so we can't absorb that worldview automatically without thinking about it much. Quite the contrary, we are faced with a choice since the worldview of the modern world totally surrounds us. Hence, we can no longer be naïve, but rather we need to know exactly why we adopt one worldview while rejecting its alternatives.

For the innocent man, the will follows the intellect which was formed by family, society, and church. The man of experience needs to consciously create. He is in the situation described by Mouravieff:

By progressively taking his fate into his own hands, man at the same time takes responsibility for all the partners in his film. It has already been said that he must restore the original meaning of his film, then push the development of the latter in such a way that the 'play' be properly played out to its intended denouement. The hero, while working on himself, must apply himself to create new circumstances around him, which will enhance the unfolding of the action towards its originally intended conclusion.

Posted on 2015-12-17 by Cologero

* * *

AghorNath on 2015-12-18 at 18:17 said:

Thank you for the post. Brilliant and thought provoking as always. I was wondering if “Man in the High Castle” was actually worth watching as far as production value, character structure, presentation etc? I remember trying to watch it sometime ago, but didn’t give it much of a chance. Once they started showing scenes of NYC decked out in regalia I turned it off. It all looked so plastic and silly, so not what one with any sense of the aesthetics that these powers conveyed would expect. Too overtly ‘Hollywood’, and sensationalized. Any thoughts? Should I give it a go, or have your sentiments surmised and articulated it enough beyond it’s scope? Cheers

Avery on 2015-12-18 at 22:05 said:

I met a Chinese guy who has adopted an ironic faith in Buddhism. When he sees a Buddha image, he puts his hands together, bows, gets down on both knees and prostrates himself in prayer. Except that he obviously didn’t learn this behavior from his parents; he’s urban elite and extremely overeducated. The piety comes off as false and pretentious. It makes one want to doubt Guénon’s principle that there is no such thing as empty ritual.

Cologero on 2015-12-18 at 23:32 said:

@AghorNath, the reviews are not usually intended to promote such popular works. Rather, we are trying to illustrate the third dimension of history by rooting out and exposing the unexamined prejudices of such works. In an intelligent work of art, on the other hand, the artist works consciously, understanding full well what he is doing. He will help the reader (or observer) bring to light his own unexamined prejudices. That is the difference between, for example, the recently reviewed *Submission* and the Amazon production.

Cologero on 2015-12-18 at 23:36 said:

@Avery, perhaps he is just doing it badly. Has he performed the tea ceremony for you? How do you explain *Guenon’s Conversion*¹⁴? When he answered the calls to prayer, was that an empty ritual?

Proud Indo Hindu on 2015-12-19 at 20:14 said:

“Reason attributes to the divine an attitude, a weakness, and even more often, purely human motives... which tended to humanize the divinities. The Good News announced by Jesus

¹⁴<http://www.gornahoor.net/?p=262>

reversed this ancient conception, calling for the divinization of the human in man by a second Birth; the gateway to the Kingdom of God. ”

The beauty of Hinduism is that it does both. We humanize our gods and divinize ourselves.

infowarrior1 on 2015-12-23 at 22:11 said:

The vikings suffered from grll power syndrome thought at at least the TV series anyway

White Rabbit on 2015-12-24 at 01:22 said:

Viking society was still patriarchal. Actually, women tend to be the weakest when they are “free”: <https://www.psychologytoday.com/blog/sexual-personalities/201504/are-women-more-emotional-men>

The fairer sex is strongest on its knees (a “pretty picture”, in Trump’s word).

Alistair Fraser on 2015-12-24 at 08:48 said:

“Reason attributes to the divine an attitude, a weakness, and even more often, purely human motives... which tended to humanize the divinities. The Good News announced by Jesus reversed this ancient conception, calling for the divinization of the human in man by a second Birth; the gateway to the Kingdom of God.’

My interpretation of the second birth with regard to “modern western life” because that is what i am recently experiencing in a simplified manner, is that so-called civilised citizenship existence in general “pretends” to be dictated by reason , and there are rules of law that also proclaim to adhere to an “agreed reason”

Now , it seems there are many people that can get through their individual lives , in these western societies conforming with and to these laid down reasons for existence which in a simplified manner are in their optimum , get schooled , get further universalised schooled, get a career, get a wife or husband, get a nice house, even a car, have holidays, friends , and you may then even live a very happy existence or at least qualify for the conditions of a very happy existence laid down by this reasonings.

Anyone who follows the above protocol as dictated to by their society will then be judged by others and their very selfs on just how happy they are based on their acquirement of the above acquisitions . If they don’t have the collection , they can reason that they are not quite happy enough or at all because of that lack .

Some others , may even, on that journey of societal reasoned development , start to feel that something else is not quite being satisfied , and to satisfy that, they might start going or go to the weekly church, which provides a sanctuary that does at least address this little x-factor in their consciousness that was not fully happy or even in a little distress , and in that church they will mix with other like minded people whom will either be attending for reasons of social

status, or reasons of intangible needs, or they might be one of the few higher developed beings that are there to guide and nourish others .

The second birth – As each person is sort of launched into earthly existence through the trauma of birth (modern western birth is industrialised -RdLaing) they sort of come to consciousness with a certain amount of propulsion dictated by their keepers and the society structure of schooling, and as they get older and more involved and investing in this societal/keeper propulsion , it follows that their consciousness has a central stream of more powerful influences that have been induced into themfor their own goodis the reasoning , to help them survive and prosper in the society.

Now in some people , there already is , or begins to manifest in time, another deeper mode of consciousness , which is potentially in all people, but in some, this inner voice becomes louder and its nature is firstly of protest , and that protest is that , the propulsion that one has been induced by into society , is now becoming a drain on the vitality and this then leads to various reactions, some will still have their ambitious eye completely focussed on the ladder of acquisitions that they are on and these people will ignore or apply a plaster to that inner protest , like alcohol or drugs or pharma.

The first stage of repression or denial which can also develop into more severe stages.

But others will take this inner protest seriously and this is the second birth as what they do, is they realise that up until this moment, they have been a strange kind of passenger in their own existence with may or may not have gone the way they wanted or thought they wanted , but from this moment on, they come to realise that this inner protest or (conscience) might just be an interface to higher intelligence or a god aspect and this is the awakening of the divine possibility in they. From that moment in time, they come to recognise the possibility that there may be a divine guide that speaks through inner conscience but that also this may arrive through others inner consciences and so now the world of communications and existence takes on a whole new meaning and purpose . They now start to take control over their own existence , not to satisfy societies reasoned ambition although that may very well co-ordinate for some, their main focus is to arrange their lifestyle into a nourishing environment that they then can exist in with a portion of self-control that is propelled by this very inner voice . and in this world of propulsion , nothing is absolutely certain, destiny may change route at any moment , but that inner voice is no longer a cry of protest, it starts to develop into a voice of wisdom developed in its depth and effect by the selfs aptitude

But there is also great danger possible because when it is ascertained that there is a higher intelligence or divinity then also there must be a lower order iof influences and these lower orders of influences can also seem to penetrate and occupy the “false conscience” like a trojan horse .

So to cut a long story short, happiness , whether by societal reasoning or divine recognition and attempted development , is a path of obstacles for all

Proud Indo Hindu on 2015-12-26 at 23:13 said:

@White Rabbit "The fairer sex is strongest on its knees"

I'll assume you mean in prayer. Oral sex is a perversion that the West has mainstreamed and tried to export only after it adopted it from gay porn. You can ask both of your grandmothers if this was expected of them. That this has become a staple of the western erotic repertoire only shows how pornified you've become. And if a presidential candidate openly promotes it, only shows the level of your political discourse.

Proud Indo Hindu on 2015-12-26 at 23:15 said:

@Avery, "I met a Chinese guy who has adopted an ironic faith in Buddhism. When he sees a Buddha image, he puts his hands together, bows, gets down on both knees and prostrates himself in prayer. Except that he obviously didn't learn this behavior from his parents; he's urban elite and extremely overeducated."

What makes you think his parents didn't teach him this? As an elite and overeducated Hindu myself, I can assure you that we do pass on our spiritual traditions and rituals, with much cultural pride as well.

White Rabbit on 2015-12-27 at 01:21 said:

Hindu: thank you for giving me the opportunity to clarify, apparently that was an unfortunate choice of words (I didn't mean to imply anything pornographic). The point is, in a natural and healthy order wives will venerate their husbands.

Proud Indo Hindu on 2015-12-27 at 21:01 said:

"The point is, in a natural and healthy order wives will venerate their husbands."

In traditional Hindu culture the wife is seen as an embodiment of the Divine Feminine/Goddess and the husband as the Divine Masculine/God. The two are to venerate each other. We have rituals that invoke this sense of sacredness in the human.

Alistair Fraser on 2015-12-28 at 04:08 said:

Below the horizon = of the flesh = profane = falling = dominated and ruled by past time

Above the horizon = Transumanar = of the imaginary = ascending = dominated and ruled by the future time

On the Horizon = the perfect conjunction of the imaginary and the flesh = creates a separation from time = "The two are to venerate each other"

"We have rituals that invoke this sense of sacredness in the human"

What are these ? Who has achieved such ? maybe not possible in today's moments, so new possibilities to be achieved .

Proud Indo Hindu on 2015-12-28 at 23:14 said:

Alistair, in Hindu culture we have tons of holy days, festivals, and we celebrate them in pomp. Our weddings are several days long and involve rituals for both bride and groom. We also have festivals for honoring the spouse. Anyway, we've got tons of festivals in which we honor goddesses, gods, family members, saints and of course cows

Come to India, you'll see. Or hang out at a Hindu temple in your own country to get a glimpse.

Alistair Fraser on 2015-12-29 at 10:07 said:

@PiH "we have tons of" i suppose im trying to extract information about the extent of this so called "sacredness" and "veneration" in those relationships , and im a little sceptical about many festivals etc as they often are hijacked by the socialising prerogative which in my view tends to dip the dynamics of relating below the horizon , although i am always ready to be pleasantly surprised by existence and others in it.

But this "veneration" and "rituals to amplify its bandwidth and depth" sounds like a decent protocol for at least developing a more profound and respectful form of relating that should not stagnate and shrink as a victim of time more expand and enrichen as a master of time .

But i have seen no evidence of such relationships in a western capitalist society.

Usually any longevity of intimate or other lived-in relating is a result of mutual benefits in the material and psychological security (or insecurity) sense and the initial intimacy has evolved through variable stages from lust to respect to moments of contempt and worse . And these 3 varying stages in their temporal manifestations then serve as a cyclic mirror of the internal harmony or disharmony of the relationship

And somewhere in there , there may be a phenomena called "love" applied and used in the rhetoric

This western mythical version of "love" which by the way is probably never actually elicited in elaborative words, then serves as the bottom line glue that welds this relating in an intuitive sense rather than a sensibilised elaborated sense which then when re-affirmed , acts as a fuel to overcome the down cycles of the 3 stages.

So the mythical love uses a mythical faith as a real power to control lesser moments of human relationship expressions

I use the term mythical for love and faith because their historical and present power of actualisation far outweighs any form of universal elaborated meaning given for them , a good example of the power of mythological idea right there used through an apparent shared intuition either from wisdom or even fear in some , the fear of loss.

What exactly does "i love you" mean for many ? and how has that term been abused by those using it that have no comparison to others use of it , and thats how , in the end it comes

down to an intuition from one to another, if that term is used authentically or not so. And even then, their shared moment of intuited “love” agreement is but a small splash in the bigger picture of possible developments and then it can be arrived at, the great piece of wisdom, that ignorance is indeed bliss

Olavsson on 2016-01-02 at 13:12 said:

@Indo Hindu:

Regarding your claims about how apparently spiritual your modern Hindus are, even the absurdly Westernized and profanely over-educated “elite”, what is your comment to Rama Coomaraswamy’s statement that almost nobody have the time to practice a true Hindu dharma seriously any longer? Was his insight into the matter insufficient? I’m afraid you have a superficial understanding of what this really means. Having a cultural-religious identity and carrying on certain customs is hardly breathtakingly impressive. Such options are available to westerners as well. It doesn’t make the civilization truly Dharmic in any complete sense, however.

Mark Citadel on 2016-01-04 at 08:08 said:

I couldn’t help but find a link between this production and the Trump campaign. The advertising for it apparently almost looked like a Trump ad until the ‘sieg heil!’. Might be coincidence, but the premise would seem to bolster America’s weariness of far right ideas with the specter of Nazism. I agree that it looked a little plastic from the trailer.

1234kid on 2016-01-23 at 17:06 said:

“I suspect not, since there is no gay character to explain to the Vikings how to act more manly.” haha, zing to donovan, right?!

i guess the vikings could be doing some mannerbund thing off screen but still procreating and doing family stuff with the womenfolk.

Akira Kalashnikov on 2016-01-24 at 18:23 said:

Those trying to understand the more sinister aspects of Donald Trump would be well advised to read “The Three stigmata of Palmer Eldritch” by PKD.

10.8 Black White and Grey

Being a review of some recent, and not so recent, films: *For Greater Glory*, *Swept Away*, *I Am Love*, and *50 Shades of Grey*.

Swept Away This 1974 film was directed by **Lina Wertmüller**, a committed leftist. A small group of Milanese industrialists take a cruise on a private yacht on the Mediterranean, crewed by some Sicilian sailors including the communist Gennarino. Milan is the Nordic part of Italy and the main female passenger, Raffaella, is blonde, lean, and dolichocephalic.

The theme is how a love relationship might work in the state of nature compared one in an the artificial society. The bourgeois passengers are fashionably left, except for Raffaella, who defends her social privilege, often by maltreating or insulting the crew. For example, she chastised Gennarino for overcooking the pasta (that would have irritated me, also).

It becomes clear that the “progressives” on the cruise have no intention of reversing the social order maintained by financial privilege. Rather, for them, progress consists in overthrowing the established spiritual order of the Church, which was still quite strong in Italy at that time. Hence, they praised the recent plebiscite allowing divorce. Moreover, they looked forward to further erosion of the spiritual authority such as legalized abortion.

One of the passengers gave it away as he gazed upon the beautiful open sea, with no other boats in sight. He said, “I hope this doesn’t get ruined with hordes of poor people.” Obviously, he had no inkling of what would someday happen at Lampedusa, the camp of the saints.

While on a side trip away from the yacht, Gennarino and Raffaella get stranded on an uninhabited island. There, in the State of Nature, bourgeois social structures count for nothing. Gennarino is able to survive by capturing lobsters and finding shelter. Raffaella continues to nag him as though nothing had changed, but the elements and hunger finally get to her, so she submits to Gennarino. Through all the time on the island, Raffaella is perfectly coiffed with makeup; that is how she appears to Gennarino, who desires her, but on his terms.

When he captures and skins a rabbit, she initially turns away, calling him “cruel”. Yet, at that same moment she begins to fall in love with him,

acquiescing to his demands. He frequently slaps her, but she seems to enjoy it. Now, women have asked me to slap them in the middle of coitus, but it always seemed odd to me, so I don't know if it is a common fantasy.

When she sees a ship come by, she hides in order to remain with Gennarino in that Edenic bower. She confesses to him that her one regret that she could not give up her virginity to him, as if it were the most important gift a woman can give a man. Unexpectedly, she asks to be sodomized instead; apparently her anus was still pure and virginal, not having known man. Although that was the best gift she had to offer him, Gennarino seemed uninterested. Rather, he wanted her undying love, freely given, in all possible worlds.

To test her, Gennarino flagged down the next boat. On leaving the state of nature, Rafaella decides to resume her previous life with her husband and their financial advantages. Gennarino reluctantly goes home with his dowdy and nagging wife.

Degeneration of the Generations *I Am Love (Io Sono L'Amore)* was a minor hit in 2009. It describes three generations of the Recchi family, who owned a textile manufacture in Milan. The spiritual and moral decline of the family mirrors the degeneration of society:

1. **Entrepreneurial:** The founder of the factory and patriarch of the family, Edoardo Sr, was assertive, creative, and self-confident. He describes how he had to manoeuver the business through the Fascist period and thereafter.
2. **Managerial.** His son, Tancredi, represents the next phase. He used his resources to collect art. When in Russia, he met Emma, whom he took back to Italy as his wife. He is intelligent and competent to run an established company successfully. However, you never get the sense that he could have founded a company on his own.

3. **Decadent.** The grandchildren are spoiled and decadent, incapable of either founding or managing an enterprise.

Edoardo Sr passes the business on to both Tancredi and Edoardo Jr, one of the grandchildren. Junior has no interest in the enterprise and Tancredi is the real manager. Instead, Junior plans to finance a natural, but seemingly impractical, restaurant with a friend, the chef Antonio.

The sister Elisabetta, a wannabe artist, announces that she has become a lesbian. At the airport on a trip home, she ignores her humiliated boyfriend, left standing with a bouquet of flowers in his hand. When an international conglomerate offers to buy out the family business, she excitedly wonders about how rich she will become after they cash out.

Meanwhile, Antonio, who has a rocky relationship with his own father, starts a weird Oedipal relationship with Emma, the mother of his friend and business partner, Junior. When Junior becomes aware of it, he angrily confronts his mother. During the spat, he slips, hitting his head on the edge of the swimming pool and dies.

After the funeral, Emma confesses her affair to Tancredi, who immediately disowns her. Emma rushes back to the house to pack up some things to leave. Before she goes, her daughter Elisabetta gives her a knowing look of approval.

On the surface, this may seem like a story of liberation. Both Emma and Elisabetta follow their passions, their bliss, into their true happiness. That is what women today call “chemistry”, a passive response to biochemical hormonal surges, that trump any sense of responsibility or prior commitments. Without the question of morality, the third dimension of the story cannot be understood. If everything is “natural”, i.e., two dimensional, then adulterous and lesbian desires are simply natural forces, neither good nor evil, whose compulsion need not be resisted.

Rather, these forces are not natural, but are instead telluric, Demetrian, or Aphroditic forces: sexual expression is undifferentiated so the object of one’s affections does not matter, whether a man or a woman.

Promiscuity is normal. Although Emma's and Elisabetta's privileges are the result of patriarchy, the cuckolded husband and the spurned boyfriend received their just rewards.

Shades of Grey J J Bachofen described the reaction of the Hellenic mind when it first learned of earlier matriarchal cultures:

The older system represented an utter puzzle to the patriarchal mind, which consequently could not have conceived any part of it.

I find myself in the same state of puzzlement in trying to understand the phenomenon of *50 Shades of Grey*. With over 50 million copies sold followed by a wildly popular film version, the hetaeric influence reveals itself as stronger than expected. You begin to wonder how many women you may pass by are secret admirers of the book. There was an older woman, who described herself as "Christian" and "very conservative", but loved *Shades* for its "honesty". I asked her if she would like to engage in that sort of relationship, but she immediately "unfriended" me without explanation.

Since I was unable to read more than a few pages of the book, I watched the movie version instead. Anastasia, a college student studying English literature, goes to interview Christian Grey, a 20 something handsome billionaire, who wants to help the poor people in Africa through various business ventures. The demure Anastasia is overwhelmed by the phallic symbol of Grey's skyscraper. She is flustered during the interview, yet Christian seems intrigued. He explains that he owes his success to his ability to understand people. When he wrongly guesses that Anastasia loved Bronte, rather than Hardy, he must have felt a sense of mystery in Anastasia.

Grey loves motion, owns several cars, even a helicopter and a glider. The bookish Anastasia can't get enough of that motion. Dakota Johnson,

as Anastasia, displays her acting talents when in the glider, she captures the same expression of your dog when he rides in the back of your pickup truck.

Grey shows Anastasia his “playroom”, full of various bondage and domination items. Instead of running out the door, she shows some interest. Of course, all acts are to be fully consensual, explicitly mentioned in a binding contract. That seems to be the direction of sexual encounters on college campuses today.

While Grey wants to tie her up, beat her, and lick her body parts, Anastasia wants the full boyfriend experience. Therein lies the whole dramatic tension, if you actually give a damn.

Spiritual Warriors *For Greater Glory* is the story of the Cristero War in Mexico in the 1920s. The Masonic government cracks down on the Catholic Church giving rise to an armed rebellion, a revival of the ideal of the spiritual warrior. It is not just Islam that is willing to engage in the lesser Holy War.

The film is better than the reviews would have it. If you don’t see it as the story of the creation of saints, amid the horrors of religious persecution, it will mean nothing to you. Stories of saints and martyrs are always edifying.

This is just one particular moment of history, which must include persecutions by communists and the terror of the Vendee. So don’t believe it can’t happen again in the West. I mean the persecution, because a new generation of spiritual warriors seems unlikely.

One thing, however, is certain. If large bands of Cristeros began to migrate from Mexico to the USA, then liberals would be clamoring to build a wall.

Viva Cristo Rey !

Los Cristeros, orate pro nobis

Posted on 2015-07-16 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2015-07-16 at 15:58 said:

"Dakota Johnson, as Anastasia, displays her acting talents when in the glider, she captures the same expression of your dog when he rides in the back of your pickup truck."

"While Grey wants to tie her up, beat her, and lick her body parts, Anastasia wants the full boyfriend experience. Therein lies the whole dramatic tension, if you actually give a damn."

Over the years you've provided some great zingers on products and trends of the modern world, and these two rank at the top of the list.

Sparrow on 2015-07-16 at 21:50 said:

"Rather, these forces are not natural, but are instead telluric, Demetrian, or Aphroditic forces:"

I'm likely wrong, but wouldn't it be more correct to state that these forces and acts are completely natural (given that they can be observed in the animal world, and the aforementioned races of the spirit) while the Traditional man strives to go beyond such base, naturalistic impulses?

Matt on 2015-07-16 at 22:36 said:

Sparrow,

I think Cologero was using the term 'natural' in the sense of what a thing is (its essence), with the specific context of what a human being is (the human essence) and its essential attributes. I don't think he was using the term in the sense of referring to the wild/natural world, though many that defend the impulses and passions in question will point to the natural world (the wild) as a justification in arguing for them. They would be committing the naturalistic fallacy in that regard.

So in light of Tradition, those passions and inclinations, rather than being natural and arising from the human essence, are in fact unnatural; they are ethical privations (lack of moral goods a human should have given their proper essence) and represent a gap between the human essence and its full/complete manifestation.

Sparrow on 2015-07-16 at 23:06 said:

Matt,

Thank you for clarification. I realized that I was likely misinterpreting the use of the word "natural." but at that time, my message had already been sent.

obscure on 2015-07-17 at 15:33 said:

Matt and Sparrow,

In the physiological triad of the soul (vegetative/nutritive, sentient/animal and rational) the passions are indeed natural if only the two lower animating principles are considered. Thomas Aquinas refers to the lower appetites as concupiscence and irascibility. Concupiscence is of course the desire to feed and multiply which man essentially shares with plant-life, but this is enhanced by sentient irascibility which is essentially a substrate of sense-experience which consists of pre-intentional fear and anger; the instinctual desire for safety and preservation of the body; the general arousal relative to sense-objects. The free will is the rational appetite of course and for a rational animal to only operate according to the lower appetites is indeed a degradation of its nature. Before even considering what is above nature (grace) the relative perfection of nature is required on the part of the human subject. The subject must 'do what it can' and prepare itself.

Matt on 2015-07-17 at 19:06 said:

Obscure,

Thank you for mentioning the concupiscible and irascible appetites and that they should be kept in mind when considering these topics.

I should have been clearer when using the term passions, and so I'll try to provide some needed clarification. By passions, I mean more in the eastern sense of the term, which is 'sins' instead of the scholastic sense referring to our sense-appetites which make up our essence as embodied beings.

obscure on 2015-07-19 at 01:29 said:

Passion is simply the opposite of action. Categorically, it is bad. Of course, a finite subject must always be passive in some way and ultimately it is passivity to God alone which is the aim; not through being freed of social obligations, devotion, necessary bodily appetites, etc., but through the 'integration' of these things into the one final aim. In other words, one is to play his role perfectly solely for the sake of the Infinite which has granted all things.

10.9 Pulp Fiction

There are few people who know the full force of the different movements of the heart. The vast majority of men are only sensitive to five or six passions, in the circle of which their lives are passed and which define the boundaries of their imaginations. Take away love and hate, pleasure and pain, hope and fear, and they will feel nothing.

But persons of a nobler character can be moved in thousands of different ways. It seems that they can receive ideas and sensations which surpass the ordinary norms of nature.

ABBE PREVOST, *Manon Lescaut*

Prevost was not far off. Psychologists have identified six or so universal emotions¹⁵ with their corresponding facial expressions: disgust, sadness, happiness, fear, anger, surprise. Therefore, the development of the emotional centre in order to experience more subtle states is an important part of esoteric training.

The intellectual centre, on the other hand, is completely undeveloped and therefore must be trained. The result is that the child learns programmed responses so his deeper self gets submerged. Boris Mouraviev compares this programming to recordings. Dialog becomes rote and automatic. He writes:

This procedure is mechanical. We can easily observe this in any conversation between a number of persons who know each other slightly. Such an interchange necessarily falls to an elementary level of the most banal interests: weather, political news, or the city. We hear these records being played, turning continually and passing from one person to another, each with their faces congealed in a grimace which—we commonly agree — gives evidence of an amiable attitude.

He continues:

The recording continues practically forever, as the disc library is vast and the recording apparatus very sensitive. When a person

¹⁵<https://people.ece.cornell.edu/land/OldStudentProjects/cs490-95to96/HJKIM/emotions.html>

speaks, it is generally easy to distinguish whether his records are playing or whether he speaks from some deeper part of himself. ... One moment it is 'I' who speaks then, unnoticed, it is no longer I; a recording from the past begins to play in me. A curious thing: once a record has been started, it is almost impossible to stop it before it has run through its content.

Therefore popular fiction needs to be limited to Prevost's passions and the universal emotions, otherwise it will be misunderstood. Those of a nobler character are simply bored by popular culture due to its self-imposed limitations.

Creators of popular culture are certainly aware of such limitations, so they create for that level. Of course, in most cases they may simply be incapable of creating art and literature of High Culture. If you have ever taken acting or screenwriting classes, as I have, you will start looking at shows and movies in a much different way. Instead of being captivated by the spectacle, you will perceive "behind the scenes", to see how the director or writer arrange things to create a purposeful effect. That effect is intended to appeal to certain inner states of the audience or invoke pre-determined reactions. That makes the viewer a purely passive receptacle of the ideas of others. In High Culture, effort is required to participate in the creation of the author.

Psychological Manipulation Generally speaking, the writers are more intelligent and better educated than the popular audience. If you listen to common everyday speech about personal events, you will notice the meanderings, lack of focus, and inability to get to the point. On the other hand, experienced writers follow a plan. For example, Aristotle wrote about the structure and plots of plays. Others followed, such as the Romans Horace and Aelius Donatus.

Writers will also employ insights from psychology, particularly the excitation of the eros and thumos drives. That is popularly called "sex

and violence". Only High Culture will try to engage the nous. So creators of popular culture will stick to the themes mentioned by Abbe Provost and the more primitive, universally recognized, emotions as described above.

More recently, writers are learning to appeal directly to the subconscious. Specifically, the structure of myths described by **Joseph Campbell** in *Hero With A Thousand Faces* is employed by screenwriters. More recently, *The Origins and History of Consciousness* by Jung's disciple **Erich Neumann** is serving that purpose. Of course, both works have similarities due to their common source in **Carl Jung**. In this way, the writer is able to reach into the subconscious archetypes of the audience. For more information, check out *Consciousness, Personality & Hero Sequence The Origin and History of Consciousness: A New Structure for Stories?*¹⁶ by a professional writer.

Jack Ryan As an example, I will use the Jack Ryan show that was streamed on Amazon. I did not know at the time that this character has appeared in several books and movies. However, in postmodern fashion, in which "there is nothing but the text", I'll treat the series as self-contained, just as I watched it. I'll try to relate the show to Joseph Campbell's hero sequence as described in the link above. The sequence is incomplete and some stages may be out of order, probably because the story has to appeal to the imagination of typical viewers.

The Ordinary World. Jack Ryan seems to be an ordinary cubicle rat, albeit with some extraordinary credentials. He has an advanced degree from Boston College and was a financial analyst before his CIA job. Of course, for popular TV it is essential to appeal to the Walter Mitty fantasies¹⁷ of the audience. Thus, Ryan is in demand by rich and power-

¹⁶<https://greathousestories.files.wordpress.com/2015/12/origin-history-of-consciousness1.pdf>

¹⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Walter_Mitty

ful men, yet he prefers life in his cubicle. He also has six pack abs, which is unlikely from sitting in front of a computer all day.

Love Interest. This is not in the screenwriter's or Campbell's list, although it is needed in most any story, from Homer to Virgil and beyond. In medieval romances, the Lady would set the task for the Knight. Not in this case, since Cathy is opposed to Ryan's secret life. Cathy is an attractive physician, not a waitress from Denny's – nothing but the best for Ryan. She turns out to be a cheap date. He doesn't even have to worry about the #Metoo movement, since Cathy initiates their first sexual encounter. Even better for him, she insists on keeping their relationship casual, as though that would disappoint him. *Au contraire*, every guy would love to hear that, since he interprets it as a "friend with benefits".

Call to Adventure. He notices some abnormal transactions which he believes can be traced to a terrorist named Suleiman. He tries to bring his theory up the command chain but experiences resistance.

Meeting with the Mentor. Greer is Jack's cynical and disillusioned mentor who initially doesn't accept Ryan's conclusion, but then guides him through the process. He is also the "good Muslim", unlike Suleiman.

Crossing the Threshold. The honchos eventually figure it out. In spectacular fashion they send a black helicopter to pick up Ryan while he is at an elegant party. That impresses his new girlfriend Cathy, again, another plebeian fantasy. Ryan is whisked away to the Near East with "unfamiliar rules and values".

Test, Allies and Enemies. The hero Ryan is tested in unique ways and is forced to distinguish between allies and enemies. Even his big bosses have doubts and prefer to "play it safe". That is a test so that Ryan is forced to stand his ground. Suleiman's wife betrays her husband and turns into an ally. Her motivation is to "protect the children", as if you had never heard that before. That creates another test: Ryan has agreed to keep the children out of harm's way.

The Approach. The hero Ryan and his allies have to prepare for an

unknown attack by Suleiman.

The Ordeal and the Road Back. Ultimately Ryan is alone with Suleiman in a running gun battle through the subway system. Suddenly the desk jockey is a crack shot, even though breathless and anxious. In the face of death, he becomes more than a nerd. He is now the hero, and saved the King (or President) no less.

The Resurrection. The final test is to bring Suleiman's wife and children to safety. Ryan is a man of his word and the conflict is over.

Return with the Elixir. Ryan returns home as a hero and is offered a promotion. By his facial expressions, Ryan is not happy with another desk job. Meanwhile, his mentor is transferred to the Moscow office. By leaving him a ticket, the presumption is that Ryan will join him there for another adventure. He's better off leaving his whiny blonde girlfriend. In Moscow, the Slavic women are more exciting, even if somewhat treacherous.

Conclusion A government study has shown¹⁸ that screen time has deleterious effects on brain development in young children. A similar study needs to be done on adults, many of whom watch propaganda all day. This revelation should convince you about deliberate psychological manipulation in the media. Maybe it is done just to make a buck, but in many shows, it goes well beyond that.

Posted on 2018-12-11 by Cologero

* * *

swagmoto on 2018-12-12 at 20:45 said:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tM8nR9sJbMQ>

¹⁸<https://www.bloomberg.com/amp/news/articles/2018-12-10/screen-time-changes-structure-of-kids-brains-60-minutes-says>

Tom on 2018-12-13 at 12:11 said:

A very revealing example of this, in which the “magician reveals his tricks”, is Christopher Nolan’s “Inception”. The protagonists of the film are experts at creating and manipulating dream worlds. Their mission is to put to sleep & surreptitiously invade the dream of an heir to a large company and plant the idea in him that he should disinherit himself (make your own connections to the political history of the late 20th century). They have to go deep into his subconscious within the dream to be able to do this, and then fabricate a narrative for him that takes account of his personal factors and strained relationship with his father in order to bring all of these internal tensions to a particular resolution that ends in him adopting the idea they want to implant in him.

This is a pattern of “black magic” (the goal being to make the target less free; subjected to the will of the magician) and is exactly how modern television and film today are set up – to put the target into a state of reduced consciousness with images and appeals to eros, etc., and then to start working through the stages of human psychology in order to ultimately implant the idea of the filmmaker, all while leaving the viewer totally unaware that he has been psychologically “raped”.

What’s new about this isn’t so much the reliance on traditional mythological structures (the ancients obviously used similar knowledge to create stories), but the power of modern cinema to suppress the reasoning faculty through imagery & sound and more effectively put the audience into a “dream” state. This way, ideas can be implanted that the audience would otherwise reject out of hand. The lack of a religious foundation or any true development of intellectuality makes modern man particularly defenseless against these kinds of suggestion.

There are nevertheless grey areas – opera, for example. Opera employs spectacle and sound in order to bring the audience into a desired psychological state, and uses traditional mythological structures in order to communicate ideas, but most would agree that going to see a traditionally staged & performed opera is a far more uplifting experience than watching the latest superhero film. It requires some intellectual and emotional participation from the audience, but generally not as much as, say, Shakespeare. Even a relatively uncultured person can be touched by Richard Wagner.

This subject of the proper employment of art, music, and storytelling is discussed at length in Book III of the Republic, which I will quote here:

“And therefore, I said, Glaucon, musical training is a more potent instrument than any other, because rhythm and harmony find their way into the inward places of the soul, on which they mightily fasten, imparting grace, and making the soul of him who is rightly educated graceful, or of him who is ill-educated ungraceful; and also because he who has received this true education of the inner being will most shrewdly perceive omissions or faults in art and nature, and with a true taste, while he praises and rejoices over and receives into his soul the good, and becomes noble and good, he will justly blame and hate the bad, now in the days of his youth, even before

he is able to know the reason why; and when reason comes he will recognise and salute the friend with whom his education has made him long familiar. “

Cologero on 2018-12-14 at 16:23 said:

@Tom, Good points

As you point out, the goal of “black magic” is to make the subject less free, rather than to increase his freedom.

Given what you wrote, I think we can make a distinction between a mythos that arises organically and one that is deliberately constructed.

For example, a good opera might use a myth that arose from the spiritual formation of a folk. In that case, I would think the effect is salutary.

On the other hand, if the structure of myth is deliberately employed for commercial ends, the effect is most likely destructive.

10.10 The Empty Man

An empty man uses the completeness of a woman all the time. A complete woman is dangerous in her completeness, more so than a man. She is unreliable, moody, nervous, but also capable of great changes. Women like that can pick themselves up and go anywhere. They’ll do nothing there, but that’s because they had nothing going to begin with. Empty people, on the other hand, can’t jump like that anymore, but they’re more reliable. The Nagual said that empty people are like worms that look around before moving a bit and then they back up and then they move a little bit more again. Complete people always jump, somersault and almost always land on their heads, but it doesn’t matter to them.

CARLOS CASTANEDA, *Second Ring of Power*

Nothing real can be threatened.

Nothing unreal exists.

Herein lies the peace of God.

A Course in Miracles

I wasn't expecting much from this film about the Empty Man¹⁹, assuming unjustly that it is yet another teenage slasher film. That is, until I noticed the students were attending "Jacques Derrida High School"; that caught my attention.

The story begins in Bhutan, where the experience of Buddhist emptiness is quite unlike California happy talk Buddhism. Paul, one of four hikers, discovers the Empty Man and is never the same again. His three companions meet their demise in a murder-suicide, presumably suggested by the Empty Man.

Emptiness Several years later, in the US, James, a private detective, is alone at a Mexican restaurant, celebrating his birth day ... literally. Then begins Day One. James becomes self-aware, his I is born²⁰; he remembers growing up in San Francisco, he recalls the deaths of his wife and young son. They cry to him, "Where were you?" Of course, how could he be "there", since "they" are just a memory? And bringing the past into the present just causes pain.

Sitting on a park bench, his girlfriend's daughter, Amanda, approaches him. She explains that she found a wonderful teaching that helped her realize that nothing can hurt you, because nothing is real. Or maybe she meant, "nothing" is real. Reality does not create thoughts, just the reverse:

What's real starts here she points to her head and ends up out there. What we think about with focus, attention, and repetition, we manifest. But what if there is a secret truth? What if our thoughts begin somewhere else and they travel through us like a

¹⁹https://www.imdb.com/title/tt5867314/?ref_=fn_al_tt_1

²⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=57>

signal traveling down a wire? Thoughts that are old and hidden and singular.

When she suddenly goes missing under suspicious circumstances, he tries to find her. Among her effects, he finds a flyer for the “Pontifex Institute”; pontifex refers to a bridge that may cross an abyss.

Abyss He attends a lecture at the Institute and hears:

You are complete in yourself. There is no struggle; struggling has failed; struggling is what wakes you up every day. There are no distinctions. Therefore, we deny that there is such a thing as right or wrong. They are evolutionary constructs that foster the illusion of separateness. The Empty Man beckons you to discover the true face of the world.

Privately, the speaker tells James:

Our thoughts feed and are fed by the noosphere, which is the sum of all conscious thought transmission from which can be stimulated through the application of certain vectors very much like a virus.

There are three intakes required for proper development:

- Atmosphere: Air
- Biosphere: Food
- Noosphere: Thought and images

This is especially important for children who need pure air and nutritious food. What may be forgotten is that they need to fill their minds with positive thoughts and healthy images. Sitting them in front of the TV all day is not at all helpful.

The Noosphere is real. People do indeed tune into it, ingesting thoughts at random. They then mistakenly take the thoughts as representations of reality. Quite the contrary, the truth is that what they take to be “reality” is nothing but the projection of their fears onto the experienced world. Through repetition, they become collective stories and worldviews that are superimposed on the actual world. The fear and anger they fell toward the world is misdirected.

Constant repetition turns ideas into gibberish, even more so of entire bodies of thought. The leader mentions, in particular, Nietzsche’s quote about the abyss looking back at you. It has been repeated so often by yobs on the Internet, that it has lost its impact.

I have frequent dreams about the abyss, but not just dreams. In the twilight states between sleep and awakening, disturbing images of an abyss enter my consciousness. It may be a building or a natural structure. I look down, straight down, and experience the same vertigo as if it were there physically in front of me.

It is not the fear of falling that is the cause. Rather, it is the fear of jumping that raises alarm. The return to the unreal status quo is a bad option, since it is just more repetition of the same old. On the other hand, there is no bridge to cross it. At such moments, it is necessary to make a decision and accept what life has offered you. So you jump.

Tulpa The Empty Man is the abyss. On Day 2, you see him and on Day 3 he stares back at you. Then you know fear! If James is born on Day 1, then he comes to full life on the third day, when he learns his true identity.

From the Pontifex Institute, James is led to a secret camp in the countryside. There he discovers a dossier containing a complete and factitious

biography of his life. He is ultimately led to a hospital where the aforementioned Paul lies comatose, on the verge of death. James learns he is a Tulpa, that is, an artificial thoughtform created by the cultists, as Amanda described. James kills Paul and becomes the new transmitter of the Empty Man. The cult members then bow to him, as they seek the Primordial Thought that created the world.

Unbeknownst to them, apparently is that the purpose of Tulpa creation is to learn to face one's fears. That accomplished, the Tulpa is destroyed the instant the illusion is destroyed.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0D4V5awe-PA>

Posted on 2021-07-22 by Cologero

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Paulo Adolpho on 2021-07-24 at 01:35 said:

There is the so-called luminous emptiness, and its opposite, Buddha called himself empty, but the so-called emptiness of today people, are not empty, they are full of shit, or rather, they have a big wound in them, a hole that sucks their energies. Can you understand the difference, and how words can confuse us!?

10.11 **Laura: Men Desire Her and Women Envy Her**

Arthur Schopenhauer's criterion for a good novel is not the amount of action in it, but rather how well it reveals the inner life of the characters. The same criterion should also apply to films. Yet, in our time, the most popular movies are almost all action, as if the producers had neglected to hire a scriptwriter until the very end. Many



scenes are extended battles between CGI characters which, by definition, have no inner life.

Hearing is the most subtle sense so it leads us closer to ultimate reality. In Schopenhauer's understanding, the noumenon, or hidden reality, cannot be known through the senses. Yet most people believe "seeing is believing", but sight is secondary. It merely creates a representation of reality, rather than reality itself. In the olden days, filmmakers took advantage of voice overs to reveal the thoughts of the characters. The motivations drove the plot and the resolution came when conflicting motivations were resolved. There were no mock battles nor extended martial arts fights between the protagonist and antagonist.

The film *Laura*²¹ is like that. Voice overs expose the thoughts of the detective. Artifices like letters and diaries are used to give us a glimpse into Laura. The columnist won't stop talking about himself and the aunt discusses her amoral life choices.

As a young piano student, I learned to play the theme song from the movie; I loved to play it over and over. I have also watched the movie several times, and again last week. It is considered one of the 10 best mystery films of all time.

Carl Jung praised the novel *She* for its insights, and *Laura* is of the same genre. Laura, like She, had that rare combination of intelligence, beauty, and brashness that made "men desire her and women envy her." As such, she draws attention that will lift her out of her office job into the world of the rich and powerful. Shelby, as the Senex, is a columnist — the equivalent of a blogger today — who used the power of his words to make and destroy reputations. He introduced Laura into a world of glamour and money.

A rival for her affection was the gigolo Shelby, the Puer Aeternus. The Crone, her wealthy aunt Ann, confessed to Laura that she was amoral.

²¹https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0037008/?ref_=fn_al_tt_1

Into the mix was Diane, a model, who just complicates the various relationships which arouse jealousy. A woman was murdered in Laura's flat by a shotgun blast to her face. Initially, it was assumed that Laura was the murdered woman.

Mark, the police detective, becomes obsessed with finding Laura's murderer. He becomes infatuated with Laura's portrait on the wall at her flat. He reads through all her letters and secret diary. He even spends a night at her flat where he was interrupted by her sudden unexpected return. When he realizes that Laura was not murdered, the focus of the investigation changes. Was Laura the target, in which case who wanted her dead? Or was Diane the intended victim?

Laura's relationships with the Senex and Puer disintegrate, as she falls in love with Mark, her Animus, the strong man in her life who knows her secret thoughts intimately. Of course, the killer is revealed and we wonder about Laura's future.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b-QtnIaG0xE>

Posted on 2021-09-02 by Cologero

10.12 Naima

*Ida*²² is a 2013 Polish film about a young woman orphaned during World War II and raised in a convent. In 1962, she has to decide whether to leave the convent or remain. Before taking her vows, the wise Mother Superior sends her out into the world to learn of her past. Her only living relative is a hard-living, chain-smoking, heavy-drinking, promiscuous, cynical aunt named Wanda. Ida learns that she is Jewish.

So Ida and Aunt Wanda go on a road trip to discover the fate of Ida's parents. On the way, they pick up a hitchhiking jazz-rock saxophonist, Lis, on his way to a gig. They listen to him play, although there were

²²<https://www.musicboxfilms.com/film/ida/>

no sparks with Ida. He was playing *Naima*, which was a nostalgic moment for me. I recalled hearing John Coltrane as a teenager which was a shock to this suburbanite. I had never heard sounds like that before, so I spent hours listening to him and Pharoah Sanders. Of course, I had the advantage of playing them on vinyl through a high-end audio system with expensive speakers. Listening to mp3 files through a computer audio system is almost criminal.

Together they visit the family's home to find it occupied by a Polish family. Ultimately, the owner, Felix, admits murdering Ida's parents to take over their property. In return for a promise not to try to claim the house, the wonder takes them to where the bodies were buried. Along with Ida's parents, Wanda's young son was also buried. Felix explained that the boy was too swarthy—Poles are rather pale—and circumcised. Since he could not pass as a Pole, he had to go. Ida, on the other hand, looked Polish so she was spared.

Ida and Wanda took the family's remains to be buried in a Jewish cemetery. After the war under the communist regime, the tables turned and the aunt became a bloodthirsty state prosecutor who was able to extract revenge for crimes committed during the war. But that was not enough.

Ida returned to the convent. On the other hand, Aunt Wanda, still unhappy with her life, defenestrated herself. Now a life of tobacco, alcohol, and promiscuous sex can reveal a lot about a person. For many people, that sounds like just another Saturday night. They have high time preference. Aunt Wanda is more intelligent and sophisticated and has low time preference. However, as an atheist, she had no higher values to live by. The future would be the same as the past. She had no prospect of salvation to atone for such a life.

Ida realizes she is still not ready to take vows. Having confronted her past, she leaves again to confront her future. She hooks up again with the saxophonist Lis and spends the night with him, sacrificing her virginity.

Naked in bed together the next morning, she asks, “Now what?” He suggests, “we get a dog, get married, have children, buy a house.” And “then what?” she asks again. “Life as usual,” he responds. And then what? Then we bicker over money and sex, fight about the children, have our friends over for dinner, And then what? And then we die.

That possible future has no appeal to Ida. She has a much lower rime preference, which only eternity can satisfy. We see her walking on the road with her bag. She is returning to the convent to devote her life to her God.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ikZ_0BEk_rA

Posted on 2021-11-04 by Cologero

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veritycacciatrice on 2021-11-05 at 04:12 said:

Sounds great on paper.

I lived each of those lives (above more or less) and made the choice in my very late twenties to settle only for my other half, who I eventually found. It seemed hopeless for years and that was fine too.

Yes we do all that sniping stuff at each other but it's harmless banter, but also yes I dedicate my life to God simultaneously and he and the children know it. The balance is usually glorious.

So. In a nutshell this film reeks of (...) propaganda.

Because- and this is what changed my mind about being a cat-lady Hermit (which I still consider myself to be in part), I doubt I'm perfect, therefore I will need to return.

Therefore I would like to return to my own family...

Therefore I ought (and do) educate my own blood with every wisdom and foolishness learned this life, so they're enabled to recognise the illusions and adjust their choices accordingly.

Fingers crossed they breed well. I hear a third cousin is ideal.

Arthur Konrad on 2021-11-05 at 11:52 said:

'Ultimately, the owner, Felix, admits murdering Ida's parents to take over their property, apparently not an uncommon practice'

It is a Jewish film, and Jews never waste an opportunity to address their present political agenda

10.13 Happy Wife, Unhappy Life

I watched the movie, *Let Him Go*²³, so you don't have to.

George is a retired sheriff living with his wife Margaret, their son James, his wife Lorna, and little Jimmy. James dies in a ranching accident, so Lorna eventually marries Donnie who belongs to some evil family. Donnie, Lorna, and Jimmy move away. Margaret is upset about that and has concern for Jimmy. She packs her bags with the intention of finding the new family and "rescuing" Jimmy. That is called "kidnapping" because grandparents have no custodial rights over the grandchildren.

Nevertheless, she stubbornly cannot be dissuaded. So George agrees to go with her, against his better judgment. Then stuff happens.

The lesson is that if you follow every crazy idea of a woman, you will do things you don't want to do, go to places you don't want to visit, and deal with people you don't like. Then some bad guys will chop off your hand and you will die a horrible violent death trying to get her what she wanted in the first place.

Then she lives happily ever after with Jimmy, keeping the bloodline intact.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GfMkjDIc24I>

Posted on 2021-11-12 by Cologero

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Allogenes on 2021-11-12 at 20:30 said:

Brilliant

Presbyter Johannes on 2021-11-13 at 13:55 said:

Seems pretty much in line with my relationship experience.

Balder on 2021-11-14 at 15:58 said:

²³https://www.imdb.com/title/tt9340860/?ref_=nm_filmg_act_3

Love's cruel fate that tears the worlds asunder.

Joe on 2021-12-03 at 13:12 said:

So he had to make the ultimate sacrifice by giving up his dearest possession, his retirement. Beautiful story, glad everything worked out in the end. I read yesterday that "men manipulate the world, women manipulate men." What does that say about patriarchy?

10.14 Brief Encounter

The two lovers, conscious of their presumably integral polarity, are called upon to straightway renounce carnal love. They must do this consciously and of a common accord, at the same time cultivating the Sacred fire of their Love, which then takes the form of *courtly love*.

BORIS MOURAVIEFF, *Gnosis Book II*

Schopenhauer's criterion for a good novel is not the amount of action in it, but rather how well it reveals the inner life of the characters. This can be more difficult to achieve in film. The highest revelation is always in words, not pictures, because hearing is the most subtle sense, associated with the element ether (akasha).

For the functionally illiterate of today, who prefer action to thought, that is hardly an issue. CGI characters don't have an inner life; one suspects that a large part of the population has a rather limited inner life. Or else, much of it is tedious and unpleasant. That is why there is such a large usage of mind-numbing agents in the West like alcohol, as well as legal and illegal drugs.

A common technique in film is to use a voiceover as, for example, in the first film version of *Dune*. In most action-packed movies, it is difficult to understand the motivations for the actions of the characters. Usually, the motivations are so trite that the viewer simply assumes one. Film as art,

rather than mere entertainment, must rely on dialog or facial expressions for that purpose.

The film *Brief Encounter*²⁴ is a 1945 British film which takes place just before WWII. It is considered one of the best British films ever made, so it is worth the trouble. I don't expect it to be superseded given the current cultural decline of the UK.

Laura is a dissatisfied housewife who realizes that an essential element is missing. Laura, it must be noted, is the name of the mysterious woman who was the subject of so many of Petrarch's sonnets. Hence, she must not be understood as a contemporary woman eager for sexual experiences, although she is never quite sure of what is missing in her life. The return to the Primordial State requires the union of the man and the woman who are uniquely suited to each other, just as were Adam and Eve. Her real desire is to be known, but she can be known only by the one who knows himself. There is no distinction at that point.

Plot What is it like to be a middle class housewife, who realizes that she is married essentially to a stranger, and is bored with her uneventful life of grocery shopping, watching movies alone, etc.; in short, she is trapped in the illusions of ordinary life? Then she meets the charismatic general practitioner Alec Harvey at the train station, who seduces her. She hears Rachmaninov's Concerto #2 whenever her imagination wanders into an alternative future. Concerto #2 is arguably the most beautiful concerto ever composed.

Half of the film is her inner monologue and she is frustrated because she cannot share her innermost thoughts with anyone else: they would either misunderstand or else judge her harshly. Her delightful thoughts of love arouse her kundalini which then fills her imagination with visions of vacations in the tropics while dancing by the ocean at midnight.

²⁴https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0037558/?ref=fn_al_tt_1

Boris Mouravieff reveals the source of such dreams which must never be ignored.

With the aid of impulses proceeding from the sexual centre via the motor centre, the emotional centre has erotic dreams which can seem entirely true. On the other hand, if it dreams with the pure and direct aid of the sexual centre it creates ideal images of its polar being, founded on the experience of its present life at previous experiences. With the sexual centre's direct intervention the emotional centre can also create idealized images of living beings that the man has met, or who resemble his polar being.

Then her lover forces a decision. She realizes that, in order to love him, she will have to be a liar to her husband. But isn't a return to her current life also a lie? She implores her lover to release her since she lacks the strength herself. Had they undergone some esoteric training, the result might be different. Mouravieff describes the case similar to that of Laura and the Doctor;

Two polar beings who meet at a mature age, when life has already burdened each of them with a karmic load. In such cases, the first sacrifice demanded is the renunciation of a physical relationship, and the first exploit consists in the methodical liquidation of the respective karmic burdens. If they ardently and effectively undertake some esoteric work in the same direction, the moment will come when they will be purified. Having become courtly, their Love will assume all its objective force, and in the purity rediscovered in this way, they will finally be convinced of the reality of a polarity that they had felt intuitively. There is no possibility of error at this stage. At this moment, the Second Birth will unite them forever in the midst of the vivifying Love; and death, finally conquered by this, will lose all semblance of catastrophe for them.

Their final meeting is at the cafeteria at the railway station. He had made plans to leave England, boarding his train, as she boards the train home, expecting never to see him again. Suddenly she disembarks, but it is too late; he is gone forever. She is forced to return home to her husband.

Tis better to have loved and lost,
No matter how high was the cost,
The pain of loss at the cafeteria hall
Is less than never to have loved at all.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rEG0ihjq09w>

Posted on 2021-11-14 by Cologero

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Presbyter Johannes on 2021-11-14 at 22:45 said:

In the subject of films, this might be of interest to you... <https://youtu.be/vqnjzVX8EKA>

I'd have a lot to talk about this particular subject as well, but don't quite have the time. I hope you like it though.

Auld Wat on 2021-11-23 at 07:48 said:

I have definitely experienced dreams in which the 'ideal' woman for me has appeared. The sense of loss on waking is intense, and the desire is to find that woman immediately. Mouravieff suggests, as you point out, that it is possible to use the sexual centre to directly intervene in the emotional centre to create 'idealisations' of those who we have met. So we don't necessarily need to physically find that ideal woman, although if we did that would be a great blessing if the opportunity to purify themselves is taken. As was said to Heloise regarding Peter by the Abbot of Cluny, you will meet again where beyond these voices there is peace.

Tom C on 2021-12-02 at 08:58 said:

Great post (and great movie), but surely you mean Petrarch, and not Plutarch? (Plutarch was the Greek historian). Thanks for the plug to Geist magazine!

10.15 Charade or the Primordial State

The important thing about the chivalric ideal is the double-demand it makes on human nature. The knight is a man of blood and iron, a man familiar with the sight of smashed faces and the ragged stumps of lopped-off limbs; he is also a demure, almost a maiden like guest in hall, a gentle, modest, unobtrusive man. He is not a compromise or happy mean between ferocity and meekness; he is fierce to the nth and meek to the nth.

C S LEWIS

When a traditional form is on the point of becoming extinct, its last representatives may deliberately entrust to the collective memory what would otherwise be lost beyond recall; that is, in fact, the only means of saving what can, in some measure, be saved. At the same time, the natural incomprehension of the masses is a sufficient guarantee that what has an esoteric character will not be laid bare and profaned, but will remain only as a sort of witness of the past for those who, in later times, will be capable of understanding it.

RENE GUENON, *Fundamental Symbols*

*Charade*²⁵, starring the seductive Audrey Hepburn and the perennial leading man, Cary Grant, was a romantic comedy released in 1963. Historically, marriages were often based on convenience or were even necessary for survival. However, as a means of keeping alive the idea of the Primordial State, ideas of Romance was made part of popular culture.

The reunion of the male and the female represents the return to the Primordial State of Eden; the Edenic stage is the integration of the human being brought to his original centre. Thus Adam-Eve is the “Universal

²⁵https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0056923/?ref_=nv_sr_srsq_0

Man". This teaching was consciously preserved in the Middle Ages by Dante and the Romance of the Rose. The authors of the grail romances were probably less conscious of any hidden meaning to their poems, but preserved the teaching intact.

My One and Only Reggie, diminutive for Regina (the Queen), was on holiday when she announced to her friend that she no longer loved her legal husband, Charles. There she met the mysterious and handsome stranger, Peter Joshua. Lovestruck, she tried to seduce him, unaware that he was seducing her.

Back in Paris, she sees that her flat was totally emptied and that her husband had been murdered and thrown off a plane. Summoned to a CIA office, she learns that her husband was involved in a caper with four other men; they stole \$250K from the US Government, which was trying to recoup it.

They all believe that Reggie knows where her husband Charles had kept the money. They each threatened her, but they don't trust one another. Meanwhile, Peter kept showing up to protect her. Through a series of complexities, which are better watched than explained, Peter undergoes several identity changes. Although they rattle her, Reggie remains in love with the bearer of those name changes. She is able to discern the one soul that she loves despite the multitude outer identities.

Hidden in Plain Sight While everyone is looking everywhere for the money, it turns out that Charles was hiding it in plain sight all along. So many times, what you are seeking is right there in front of you, but you don't see it.

The Knightly Ideal Peter demonstrates the knightly ideal. Among the men, he displays cunning, strength, and power, while with his one

and only love, Regina, he is “a gentle, modest, unobtrusive man”, always kind to her and very protective.

Let’s say that all’s well that ends well. Peter’s “true” identity is revealed, they marry, expecting the sort of bliss than can only be fully realized in the Edenic state.

Knights, Knaves, and Mansplaining As an interesting diversion from the movie plot, Peter describes a version of the logic puzzle named “Knights and Knaves” by the logician **Raymond Smullyan**²⁶, several years later. In frustration with Peter’s lies, she asks how can she tell when someone is lying. He engages in mansplaining with this puzzle.

Suppose there are two Indian tribes: the white-footed tribe always tells the truth and the black-footed tribe always lies. How can you tell which is which?

Reggie, not illogically, suggests, “why not look at their feet?”

Sometimes you have to break free of the system to finally see the truth. Love cannot be explained by the logic of the world. The Queen found her knight.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C6T2Q4X07uA>

Posted on 2022-01-06 by Cologero

* * *

Anon 7777777 on 2022-01-10 at 19:50 said:

I’d like to humbly recommend Diary of a Country Priest if you haven’t reviewed that yet

10.16 **Gone, Baby, Gone: Man’s Justice**

This is an ancient conundrum:

²⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Knights_and_Knaves

- Is a command just because God commanded it?
- Or did God command it because it was just?

On the human level, governments establish a set of laws and policies in order to achieve just decisions. This involves a complex bureaucracy with established procedures. The conundrum can be rephrased:

- Is a result just because the procedures have been faithfully followed?
- Or does following the procedures define justice?

In the first case, God is justice, there is no distinction between the alternatives. However, in the human case, there can be a privation between the ideal of justice and its implementation in specific cases. For the purposes of this discussion, let us assume that the law is not inherently unjust.

Outline of the Story Amanda is the four year old daughter of the tamasic Helene, who is addicted to alcohol, cocaine, and sex. While she is out carousing for several hours, she returns home to discover that Amanda went missing. Since the police investigation is making no progress, Amanda's aunt Bea and uncle Lionel come to Patrick and Angie for help. The latter two specialize in finding deadbeat debtors, but not kidnap victims. Nevertheless, they take the case.

Since Patrick has buddies in the Bostonian underclass, who never talk with the police, he is able to extract information unknown to the detectives. He is even introduced to the malevolent underworld of pedophiles, now known as "minor attracted persons". Leaving aside all the plot twists, misdirections, and machinations, we can cut to the chase.

Amanda's death was faked. However, eventually Patrick figures out what really happened. Those who loved Amanda conspired to protect her

from her mother: Uncle Lionel often saved Amanda from her mother's neglect; Detective Remy was disgusted by his experience with abused children; the police captain always wanted a daughter.

Patrick visits the captain at his country home and spies Amanda; she seems healthy, happy, and loved. He has to make a choice:

- Leave Amanda with the Captain for her own good.
- Do the "right" thing and report the kidnapping to the proper authorities. That would return Amanda to a sad life with her mother, and bring bad ends to the Uncle, the Detective, and the Captain.

Mother The justice system has a process in place that almost always keeps the child with her biological mother. But what is a mother? Is she the birthing person or the one who desires what is best for the child?

Jochebed was willing to give up her son, Moses, in order to save him from death by the Pharaoh.

To resolve the dispute between two women who each claimed to be the mother of the son, the wise Samuel decided that the one who wanted to protect the baby was the true mother.

The justice system has no room for wisdom, since everything must follow the law. And Helene was not willing to provide Amanda with a safe, stable, and loving home life.

The Decision Patrick has to decide what to do.

Jochebed disobeyed the Pharaoh's law to protect Moses. But if everyone disobeys the law, then anarchy ensues.

Wisdom may have selected the new family as best for Amanda. But the justice system follows a process for which the question of Amanda's future is not considered.

The Captain warns the young Patrick that he will have to live with his decision for the rest of his life. In a display of bravado, Patrick denies concern. But the Captain was right.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wzh4Q88sthY>

Posted on 2022-01-20 by Cologero

* * *

Matt on 2022-01-20 at 23:41 said:

Is it even possible to make a just system? To be just, in many cases, would require a discernment from a moral being that no set of laws, no matter how complex, could possibly capture fully. But the more room for human discernment you place into a system, the more room for corruption. Too bad we can't just place God in charge of such things.

Arthur Konrad on 2022-01-21 at 05:44 said:

There is a distinction between justice as an institution, and justice as a concept in philosophy, and once this distinction is examined, a question appears as to whether their subjects are related at all. In reduced language – the former is concerned chiefly with outcomes (or more precisely, ought to be). In theory, it is possible to practice law as a moral exercise – that's how law works today for the most part – but in that case a legal science is inconceivable.

Mike M on 2022-01-21 at 22:42 said:

@Matt This came up in group, which I enjoyed your answer the best, and my question is, if in fact, humans cannot make a "perfect" system in which the idea of justice is enacted in every circumstance (that is typically the definition I see of people calling something "perfect"), is it true impossible? Because if it is not possible to manifest, is it truly the ideal at all? An analogy is how Christ did not cure suffering in the world because suffering is part of the human condition for a purpose of perfection in eternity.

Perhaps what humanity does make out of a system of justice over time is the representation of a truly just system depending on their achievements to align with the idea of justice. If so, then mustn't we subject ourselves to the system to some degree? Hence I liked the answer given that one should do one's best to satisfy the system while at the same time pushing for the goal that is most "just" intuitively, without breaking the rules. This would take personal responsibility for the man in the film to involve himself and not just pass the decision onwards either way. This would satisfy Gospel as well: "Do not think that I am come to destroy the law,

or the prophets. I am not come to destroy, but to fulfill." I believe a good example of this in film is *Ikiru*, in which a man with determination utilizes the system without breaking it to achieve a common good.

Logres on 2022-01-22 at 12:07 said:

This conundrum reminds me of Tomberg's passages on "gilded silver" or "silvered gold": if one is aware of the "trap" (or varieties of possible outcomes for choices, and giving justice to all sides), there is a chance of seeing a way through (with courage and intuition) to a satisfactory conclusion, even if, the result itself is still slightly imperfect as Tomberg describes, or rather, has an emphasis on one element of either Justice or Mercy, slightly. It does occur to me, that the choice is not presented to "everyone", but to an exception or a unique person. And it is not possible to "refuse" it, except by abdicating morally. If the person rises to this exceptional element, there is a hope that their choice will neither ignore Mercy nor break Justice, but bring them closer together. However, most people will not even understand their dilemma.

10.17 The Unforgiven and unforgivable

The *Unforgiven* was a movie released in 1960. Directed by John Huston, and starring Burt Lancaster and Audrey Hepburn, one should expect a superior film. That depends. On the one hand, it could be a history of how the West was won, in its raw brutality, or it could be an allegory about racism and why the West should not have been won.

The film begins in the middle of things, since the patriarch of the Zachary family, Ben, had been killed in a battle with the Kiowa Indian tribe. He left behind his wife, Matilda, his eldest son Ben (Burt Lancaster) as the acting pater familias, the hot-headed middle son Cash (Audie Murphy) and the lovable dim-witted Andy.

Finally, there is the mystery meat Rachel²⁷, played by the unduly attractive Audrey Hepburn. The family legend is that Ben found the baby Rachel alive, after a raid by the Kiowa. He brought her home to the delight of Matilda who desired a daughter and raised her. Rachel, approach-

²⁷<https://www.urbandictionary.com/define.php?term=Mystery%20Meat>

ing her prime, was pretty and spunky. She also had an affection to Ben which bordered on the incestuous.

But then the mysterious Kelsey appears on the scene and, like the even more mysterious Khidr²⁸, reveals the true origin of Rachel to whoever is willing to listen. He even reaches the ear of Lost Bird, of the Kiowa tribe, who learns that Rachel is actually his sister.

What's fair is fair, so Lost Bird offers to buy back Rachel from the Zacharys for a few horses. Ben will have none of it. As the rumor spreads, Ben's business partner Zeb turns against the Zacharys, whom he blames for his son's murder.

At that time there was no DNA testing, so no one suspected that the very Belgian looking Rachel could possibly be a Kiowa. Cash became furious to learn that he had been living with an Indian all those years. He used a slur that can never be spoken aloud; like the secret name of Rome, it must be protected lest enemies use it to gain power.

In a huff, he leaves home to spend a night in the hay with the very blonde, very pretty, and very horny, Georgia. Before Tinder, it was risky to swipe left because there were few eligible men within a reasonable radius. So Georgia was desperate to snag the manly Cash, offering to him man's supreme pleasure, right on the spot. That left him with the moral dilemma: stay with Georgia or return home to protect his family.

Meanwhile, Lost Bird returns to the Zachary homestead, with a bunch of his bros. Ban hunkers down and prepares for battle. He even convinces Rachel to shoot at her own tribe. After an extended battle, the situation looks gloomy for the Zacharys. Meanwhile, still in the hay with Georgia, Clay hears gunshots from 10 miles (16 km) away. To her disappointment, he gathers up ammo and weapons and heads home, now contrite from his earlier outbursts.

Unlike the John Wayne move, Stagecoach, in which the calvary shows up at the last moment to save the white people, Cash rides in firing his

²⁸<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Khidr>

six-shooter all alone, thus dispersing the hated Kiowa. Lest that sound implausible, Audie Murphy was a legitimate real-life hero in World War II. He was awarded several medals from three different countries. This was his best:

Murphy received the Medal of Honor for valor that he demonstrated at the age of 19 for single-handedly holding off a company of German soldiers for an hour at the Colmar Pocket in France in January 1945, then leading a successful counterattack while wounded and out of ammunition.

Wikipedia

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Audie_Murphy

In a touching scene, Rachel is confronted by her blood brother Lost Bird. After a few moments of thought, she shoots him in the belly in cold blood. As Ben had convinced her, although she was a Kiowa by blood, she was Anglo in every other way, thus settling the nature vs nurture debate.

Finally at peace, Ben makes plans to marry his sister Rachel. After all, they aren't blood relatives and she was never legally adopted.

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=UHUa_svkuU0

Posted on 2022-01-26 by Cologero

10.18 The Last Duel: God's Justice

For the Lord is righteous, he loves righteous deeds.

PSALM 11:7

In the review of *Gone, Baby, Gone*²⁹, this question was raised: If the legitimate processes and procedures of the State do not result in justice in a particular case, is it appropriate for a citizen to bypass the State's system of justice?

In the recent film, *The Last Duel*³⁰, a different question is raised: if the State's system of justice results in unresolvable aporia, how can justice be achieved?



Story The story tells of the 29 December 1386, trial by combat (duel) in which the Norman knight Jean de Carrouges dueled squire Jacques Le Gris. Carrouges had accused Le Gris of raping his wife, Marguerite, while he was away. It is based, rather closely, on actual events as they were documented in the subsequent trial of Jacques. The circumstances of the story can be found on Wikipedia, so we can focus on the trial itself.

Female Orgasm A common theory of the time was that pregnancy could result from intercourse only if the female experienced an orgasm. This notion has sources going back to Hebrew, Greek, and Roman times. Since rape was considered to be a great sorrow, a woman could derive no pleasure from it; hence rape could never result in pregnancy. I did an Internet search on the topic and discovered that many people hold the same belief today.

If you want my opinion, you should not rely on it as a method of birth control. It's like thinking you won't get fat if you don't enjoy the food.

²⁹See Section 10.16 in this book.

³⁰https://www.imdb.com/title/tt4244994/?ref_=fn_al_tt_1

The Trial Although there were a few minor witnesses, the main part of the trial consisted on the testimonies of Jean, Jacques, and Marguerite. Those of Jean and Jacques were documented, but Marguerite's was a fictional reconstruction because a woman's testimony was not considered reliable in court.

Keep in mind that the accusation was high risk for Marguerite. If Jacques were to be found innocent, then she would be burned alive for perjury in a rape case. That law might discourage frivolous sexual assault accusations.

Jean de Carrouges

Jean had to speak for his wife. He described his relationship with Jacques, their disputes, and subsequent reconciliation. Of course, the reconciliation is over since Jean believes his wife. While he was away on an errand, he asked his mother to never leave Marguerite alone. Nevertheless, the mother did leave her alone when she took all the servants for an errand of her home.

At the time, Jacques visited Marguerite, forced his way inside the house, and then allegedly raped her.

Jacques Le Gris

Jacques worked his way up to his position through his skills in accounting and business. He had a reputation as a womanizer and engaged in orgies. When he met the beautiful Marguerite at a public event, he assumed she was making goo-goo eyes at him. He admitted to visiting Marguerite where he expressed his undying love for her. He then chased her up to her chambers and took her on her bed.

He even admitted that she resisted his advanced, but, in his mind, women often feigned protests even though they secretly desired to be taken. After the deed, he warned her not to tell her husband.

Marguerite

Marguerite's testimony (fictionalized) did not add anything new. She denied misleading Jacques and insisted that the rape was real. Since she was pregnant, the question of paternity arose. The believed in the science of the time that the rapist could not be the father. However, paternity could not be determined one way or the other. Since she never conceived a child with Jean, the suspicion was that Jacques was the father. In that case, there was no rape since she derived pleasure from the act.

Ultimately, the case could not be resolved one way or another by the court.

The Duel Jean insisted on a legally sanctioned duel to finally salvage his wife's honor. This was granted to him. For the legal justification for the decision, see *The Metaphysics of Dueling*³¹.

The duel itself was brutal. Although Jean was the older man, he had more battle experience. When he eventually got Jacques in a "tap out" position³², he demanded the latter's confession. Jacques, however, repeated his innocence. At that point, Jean killed him, which everyone accepted as a sign of Marguerite's purity.

If God is indeed righteous, how else do you resolve a "he said, she said" scenario. We often witness evil defeating the righteous, but battle, under those circumstances, do not meet Dante's criteria for a just duel. In any case, that was the last time that a duel was used in France to determine the outcome of a legal proceeding.

References From the Smithsonian magazine: The True History Behind "The Last Duel"³³.

³¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=3636>

³²<https://dictionary.cambridge.org/us/dictionary/english/tap-out>

³³<https://www.smithsonianmag.com/history/the-true-history-behind-the-last-duel-180978860/>

For the history of the science of the female orgasm: Bitenosh's Orgasm, Galen's Two Seeds and Conception Theory in the Hebrew Bible³⁴.
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mgygUwPJvYk>

Posted on 2022-01-30 by Cologero

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James on 2022-01-30 at 23:33 said:

I also watched this movie and was mildly intrigued by it . I wonder if there was a possibility of satisfying the Dantean qualifications for a righteous duel by instead choosing champions of Emperor-esque quality , i.e. if it were possible to create a warrior-religious caste that would fight on behalf of all severe cases . "public defenders" so to speak . In other words , analogous to how lawyers are employed nowadays as officers of the court and abide by court ethics (in theory) and are experts on the law since the defendant and accuser are unable to attain that level of "knowledge" , what if it were possible to create an ORDER which fulfills this role on a spiritual level . Warrior-monks who take on cases as a means of coming together in fraternal mortal combat against each other for the sake of finding the Divine truth . This would sidestep the personal gains , hatred, or common lack of spirituality of the contestants and instead , for matters of grave purpose , the Lady may find her true champion and the gentleman may find his champion . If the warrior-monk in his judicial wisdom refuses to take up the cause of one of the parties , that in itself could be seen as indication enough that the cause is not just . It may be an interesting science fiction conceit I may have to explore for the future .

10.19 **Fallen Angel**

We were born to tread the earth as angels,
To seek out heaven this side of the sky.
But they who race above shall stumble in the dark,
And fall from grace.
Then love alone can make the fallen angel rise.
For only two together can enter Paradise.

³⁴https://brill.com/view/journals/dsd/28/1/article-p38_3.xml?language=en

MARTY HOLLAND

*Fallen Angel*³⁵ was a 1945 film noir based on the novel by Marty Holland (nom de plume for Mary Holland). Like every film noir, there is some drama, a murder, a mystery, and ultimately a confession. You can watch the film if you like, or read the plot on Wikipedia. For now, I prefer to focus on the character archetypes, since they fit in so well with the so-called manosphere. Yet, as the film shows, there is nothing new under the sun.

The Chad Eric Stanton is a man down on his luck. He had sold his business in New York but lost it all gambling on his way to San Francisco. Unable to afford the last leg of his bus trick, he was forced to stop in the small town of Walton. Down to his last buck, he stops at a greasy spoon³⁶ for a late meal.

Eric is what is called today the Chad, that is, the man desired by the most woman. He is tall, handsome, romantic, assertive, and a smooth talker. Nowadays, he would be in the top 10% to 20% of men who get all the attention on dating apps. For such guys, women often become disposable commodities, while the bottom 80% of men get hardly any attention.

In a small town, however, the options are fewer. Nevertheless, Eric manages to seduce two women in a week, even proposing marriage to both. Since juggling two women won't end well, Eric finds himself involved in a situation beyond his control.

The Town Flirt While awaiting his meal at the greasy spoon, Stella suddenly waltzes in. He is immediately smitten. It turns out that he is not

³⁵https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0037691/?ref=fn_al_tt_1

³⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Greasy_spoon

alone. She is the Town Flirt³⁷, a seductive dark-haired beauty with Siren-like qualities, turning heads, stopping men in their tracks, and insinuating her image into their private fantasy lives. Even Pops, the old guy owner of the dive, is not immune to her charms. Same for the rest of men in the town, since Stella has a different date every night.

Eric manages to get some quality time alone with Stella. The tension between the Chad and the Beauty is palpable. For once, Stella meets a man that she would like to be with. Eric pushes himself on her, but she parries his advances. Here is an example of the Hermetic teaching:

Man wants to enjoy before possessing; woman wants to possess before enjoying.

Drunk with love like a rutting iguana, Eric even proposes marriage in order to enjoy her; he even promises to gather a nest egg to make her life comfortable.

The archetype of the Town Flirt is not uncommon. Stella tells Eric that she has had enough of riding the carousel³⁸, and expresses her need to finally settle down. Men should beware of getting involved with a woman with a high body count.

Some attractive women date around in their late teens to late twenties. Eventually, they stop getting the same type of attention; perhaps they see their friends settle down or they get baby fever. Then they have to settle for what's available. Stella is juggling three marriage proposals; the jealousy that such a situation arouses will not turn out well for her.

The Alpha Widow Often a woman will meet a Chad and fall madly in love. Of course, he leaves her in a state called the Alpha Widow³⁹. She

³⁷<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AS4bqgSFWAw>

³⁸<https://notesfromaredpillgirl.com/2016/03/18/dont-ride-the-carousel/>

³⁹<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6ClzNJglxVU>

becomes totally heartbroken by her boyfriend and the resulting sorrow can last a lifetime. Clara Mills is part of the upper crust of the town. Now an aging spinster, she reveals that she had once been madly in love with a Chad. So she recognizes the type and tries to protect her younger sister from his charms.

The Girl Next Door Eric plans to embezzle some money from June Mills by seducing her. June, a blonde of course, represents purity. She plays the organ at the local church, and immerses herself in the high culture of books and music.

Eric challenges her to live a real life, with real people, and real events, not second hand through books and music. She falls in love with him at a night picnic at the beach, eating hot dogs, as the waves break the silence in the background. She even agrees to elope with him.

Pure and innocent, June can only see the best in Eric, even when he is accused of murder. Unable to deal with her naivety at first, he eventually returns her love. That is when she recites the poem that is the epigraph to this review.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LIHcAkeSlP0>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6ClzNJglxVU>

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_y6WMHZv7pw

* * *

Auld Wat on 2022-02-21 at 18:46 said:

True love's the gift which God has given

To man alone beneath the heaven;

It is not fantasy's hot fire,

Whose wishes, soon as granted, fly;

It liveth not in fierce desire,

With dead desire it doth not die;

It is the secret sympathy, The silver link, the silken tie,

Which heart to heart, and mind to mind,

In body and in soul can bind.

10.20 Have Gun, Will Travel

Fortune favors the audacious.

ERASMUS

He doesn't care about proof, he doesn't care about the law, he only cares about what's right.

RE JACK REACHER

Three Soul Forces The three soul forces are:

- **Epithumos or Appetite:** The force that satisfies desires.
- **Thumos or Passion:** The emotional elements that drives the will.
- **Nous or Intellect:** The drive to knowledge.

In the healthy soul, the Nous will be the master over the passions and appetites. The disordered soul will be dominated by passions or desires.

Knowledge of the Good The nous does not mean the person who can write a scholarly paper with references, footnotes, etc. Rather, it is knowledge of the Good which is accessible even to those without a formal education. On the other hand, those who are capable of it, and have the opportunity, should undertake the appropriate studies; that is indicative of the desire to know the Good.

Knowledge of the Good and desire for the Good are insufficient. One must will the Good, which is a much more difficult project. Knowledge of the Good is dispassionate, disinterested, and objective. This may come in conflict with one's personal desires. There are two ways to mitigate that problem:

- Reduce one's property and personal needs.
- Have an excess of property or wealth, enough to satisfy one's needs.

The Solitary Man What applies to the individual man, applies also to the City. The best City promotes the good and teaches the good. Its goal is justice. The corrupt City is unjust and is dominated by those with excessive desires, such as lust or greed. They then use the mechanism of the City for personal gain.

In such cases, often justice can be achieved by the Solitary Man, who acts from outside the system. That archetype is common in the West, going back to the Paladins of the Round Table. Although that figure was satirized in *Don Quixote*, it still lives on. The colonization of the West in the USA during the 19th century gave new life to that figure, even in Germany of all places. With the growth of the film industry, this figure has reappeared in different guises. These are the main characteristics:

- He is incorruptible.
- He is solitary, having no permanent personal attachments.
- He is experienced in the world, having previously taken part in the life of the City.
- He is highly intelligent and knows several languages.
- He is a great judge of human character and notices details missed by most.
- He is the consummate fighter, skilled in martial arts and fisticuffs.
- He is an expert in weapons, both hot and cold.

- He is protective of women and children. The female relationship is usually chaste, although some studios, like Amazon, simply cannot restrain themselves.
- He works outside the system. The rules and laws of society are flouted in the interests of Justice.

Jack Reacher A contemporary exemplar of the first type is Jack Reacher, based on a novel and then made into two feature films and more recently an Amazon series. Jack Reacher has no permanent address, no credit rating, and is basically invisible to the Internet. He wanders like a hobo. Of course, since corruption is ubiquitous, he will often encounter an unjust situation.

As a former member of the military police, he is knowledgeable about the laws and procedures. Through insight and force, he manages to uncover the secret movers and shakers in the City. Unburdened by the laws and rules of evidence of the City, he employs any extreme measure, even torture and extortion, to gather information. Although the authorities are exasperated by his style, he is vindicated in the end.

There is an interesting comment by the teenage female character in *Jack Reacher: Never Go Back*. After Jack warned her to stay away from the street people, this was her response. “I always go to the alpha male, because he won’t hurt me. He has a younger sister, or wishes he did. The strong man won’t hurt me, only the weak man will.”

Paladin Paladin refers to the character in the 1950s television series, *Have Gun – Will Travel*. Paladin is primarily a “fixer”, who resolves problems for the wealthy. Nevertheless, he will still help out those who cannot afford him *pro bono*.

Unlike Reacher, Paladin lives the life of a prosperous gentleman. He lives well, follow high



culture, is interested in music. He is educated in the classics and Western philosophy, speaks several languages, and has a good knowledge of the Law. He knows Chinese martial arts, fisticuffs, guns, and even swords.

His business card bears the image of the Knight chess piece. In my fantasy life as a consultant, I modeled myself on this character; I would fix problems few other could. Travel took me to some desirable places, but often remote areas in the rural South. Eventually the lone wolf went out of style in favor of large consulting firms with various certifications.

Posted on 2022-03-13 by Cologero

10.21 Sleeping Through the Junta

Take heed, watch and pray, for you do not know when the time will come.

JAMES 13:33

The Movie Z The 1969 film “Z”, about the military junta that took over Greece in the 60s, made quite an impact when it was released. A junta of colonels established a “dictatorship” in 1967, a month before a scheduled election, because they opposed the leftist policies of the likely election winner. The director of the film Z, Costas-Gavras, was adamantly opposed to the junta.

The anti-communist junta promoted conservative social policies. Anyone who opposed them were canceled, including journalists, artists, musicians, writers, philosophers, and even modern mathematics. When that failed, they resorted to the imprisonment, torture, and exile of political opponents. Crimes against such figures were covered up by government agencies.

More astoundingly, they even banned the letter “Z”!

The Greek junta could not be missed as they were publicly visible. That tactic is not used much in our day. Instead, it can only be recognized by its effects. Neither the visible leaders, nor the purported political stance, matter. When journalists, writers, intellectuals, philosophers, and so on, are “canceled” then that is an indication of the junta in charge, not matter how or by whom. When political opponents are imprisoned and allies are not prosecuted, then the junta is in charge.

If could happen someday, so take heed, watch, and pray. When the junta takes control, let it not find you asleep.

Good and Evil at Play Religious people, of a certain sort, often claim that the world is “good”. They claim the story of Genesis as the source, but that valuation applies only to the Edenic world. The expulsion of Adam and Eve from the Garden was supposed to be a punishment, not a vacation in the good world. Neither is the world wholly evil; rather it is a mixture. Hence, debates about conflicts in terms of good and evil are always fruitless.

The Law of Correspondence provides a better tool for analysis. The levels of being correspond to teach other in a way appropriate to that level. For example, here is a schema for the fundamental levels:

- **Spirit Level:** The Good
- **Soul Level:** Good and Evil
- **Material Level:** Friend and Enemy

Since the physical earth is in darkness, there is no battle between good and evil. Matter is neither good nor bad. The lion is not evil and the gazelle is not good. The distinction makes no sense. The one that does is the distinction between friend and enemy. The lion is the enemy to the gazelle, but there is no battle between good and evil.

Each combatant in a conflict has the right to self-defence, but that is not a battle between good and evil, except, perhaps, in a relative sense. But for spectators, is it really clear who is the friend and who is the enemy? Or is it better to stand aside?

It is different at the soul level, but how do you identify good and evil? There is talk in the air, in certain circles, about *The Decline of the West*, *The Crisis of the Modern World*, and *The Revolt Against the Modern World*. Herman Hesse, in *A Glimpse into Chaos*, also argued that Europe is in a state of terminal decline.

Those works were written a century ago, so, if true, what is worth defending. Yet the times they are a -changing. Now the West is the leader of the free world, the protector of democracy, and on the right side of history. Anyone opposed to the agenda of the West is considered evil, and even canceled if necessary. On the other hand:

The fulfilment of the “American Dream” is for many societies, especially traditional ones, an eschatological nightmare.

*Catholic Herald*⁴⁰, 6 February 2022

A decision must be made: Are the values of the West a sign of progress or an eschatological nightmare?

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=rHB28qfsV2w>

Posted on 2022-04-02 by Cologero

* * *

Santiago on 2022-04-04 at 19:27 said:

So I recently went and saw Z.

Perhaps most conspicuous was the absence of any genuine political ideology throughout—towards the beginning of the film, the military junta describes their opposition as “mildew” which

⁴⁰<https://catholicherald.co.uk/putins-take-on-the-russian-idea/>

must be thoroughly eradicated through an impersonal process of “heat”, “cleansing”, etc. Such a materialistic, ‘scientistic’ approach is hardly what you would expect from ‘far right’ monarchists with self-professed Christian ideals.

The foremost general, Papadopoulos, would almost immediately—after the events of the film—opt for a reformed parliamentary system, perhaps to take the heat off of himself and his friends, which again is something you would not expect from a radical right-wing ideologue. His later move to formally abolish the monarchy all but confirms this.

The movie features some AntiF (radical left wing group) types of characters, who are in bed with the media, various workers institutions, even the higher ups of law enforcement, and funded by the political establishment. I thought it was revealing that 2 of this groups primary agents are both secretly Communists, and one is even a convicted child abuser, of the worst kind. Again, where is the motivating ideology behind the military junta if they are so readily willing to employ such people for their purposes?

The only distinction which is clearly apparent throughout, is that between “friend” and “enemy.” All ideology becomes nothing more than a vocabulary with which to dog-whistle to your “friends” that you are benevolent to the Regime.

American director William Friedkin said about the film: “it was filmed like a documentary... Like the camera didn’t know what was gonna happen next. And that is an induced technique.” It’s ironic now, because everything in that movie is, while tragic, utterly predictable. It’s almost as if we’re still banning letters of the alphabet today.

Greg on 2022-04-05 at 13:19 said:

To answer your concluding question. The values of the west are indeed an eschatological nightmare. We are ruled by a high tech junta which will cancel you if you question their depraved values.

Tiffany on 2022-04-05 at 23:37 said:

As an American, I would truly not be surprised if an alphabet letter were canceled this week. I can hear it now: Perhaps the letter ‘P’ is “triggering” to some for its phallic nature, which promotes binary gender “concepts” and, I mean, its existence allows the word Patriarchy to exist(!).

I echo Greg’s comment.

10.22 The Zone of Innermost Desires

You are sitting at the bus stop, or shopping at the outdoor market. A man who calls himself the Stalker hands you his calling card with his phone number and a mysterious, yet compelling, tagline. You complain about your malaise to a friend, who hands you the same card. Ultimately you don't know where or when you will meet the Stalker. Everyone will meet the Stalker sometime in his life. When that happens, he will be forced to make a decision.



The Stalker tells you of a place, a mysterious place called the Zone, that has a Room in which your most innermost desire is satisfied. The Stalker himself has no desire other than to lead others to it. He is poor and cannot provide adequately for his wife and disabled daughter. Like the final days of Siddhartha, he is just the ferryman.

The Zone is protected by armed guards who themselves fear the Zone. Once in the Zone, the Room is protected by traps, an eerie landscape, and tunnels. The Stalker demands absolute obedience in order to reach the Room safely. He warns of the fellow called the Porcupine who had reached the Room and then committed suicide.

Yet nothing deters you and the others in the small party you are with. The thought of fulfilling your innermost desire is too compelling. The trip to the center is the opposite of Lethe; instead of forgetting, one begins to remember. Are you mistaken about your innermost desire? Perhaps it is something else, because your desires conflict with each other.

Moreover, once your innermost desire is satisfied, it is no longer private. It is there for the world to see. Do you want your neighbors to know about your lusts for their wives or daughters? Or what you privately think about your family members? Your hatred for your boss, your envies, your greed? Wouldn't it be better to keep those to yourself? Perhaps you are not really the nice fellow you imagine yourself to be.

You reach the Room after many hardships. Instead of feeling the

excitement of the imminent satisfaction of your desires, dread sets in. Maybe you don't really know your innermost desire as well as you had presumed. You don't want to be surprised. A Scientist in the party wants to blow up the Room so that no one can have his innermost desires satisfied; he rightly fears that.

Everyone leaves, unsatisfied.

Epilogue Most return to their ordinary lives in which nothing significant changes.

A very few encounter an esoteric school. There he learns "the profound silence of desires, of preoccupations, of the imagination, of the memory and of discursive thought." (Valentin Tomberg)

He is no longer interested in satisfying desires since that is a passive exercise, something imposed on him from without. Instead, he develops a True Will.

He who sees the beauty of that which he recognizes as true cannot fail to love it — and in loving it the element of constraint in the duty prescribed by the true will disappear: duty becomes a delight. It is thus that "work" is transformed into "play" and concentration without effort becomes possible.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

Such a one is then free to fulfill the destiny given to him by Providence.

Stalker Directed by **Andrei Tarkovsky**.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q3hBLv-HLEc>

Posted on 2022-05-15 by Cologero

* * *

Michael M on 2022-05-20 at 21:09 said:

This is a film that contains a great deal of similarity to the work in Gnosis.

The Stalker in the film has to be followed even if the rational part of the characters tells them it doesn't make sense. Following conscious steps on the Way to a center that reveals an inner most desire, they realize the terrifying nature of the fallen personality. Something M. says all must do and accept within themselves to understand Reality as it is.

The Stalker laments at the end of the film as no one seems to understand, though many are called few answer and are willing to cross the next threshold.

AghorNath on 2022-05-23 at 23:36 said:

Stalker, indeed every opus composed by Tarkovsky (at the behest of True Will), is/are mandatory viewing for those on the Straight Path... seeking the Narrow Gate. They are pensive, visionary recitals of initiation. Each film acts as a map through the veils of life, and plays out within the Alam al-Mithal, and it's varying degrees. They are prayers in motion.

The camera should always be viewed with the eye of the heart, mirroring His watchful eye.

Light a mental candle prior to every viewing, say a short pray. You might just get what you wish for!

10.23 Behold your mother!

Allegory is a rational operation, implying no transition either to a new plane of being or to a new depth of consciousness; it is a figuration, at an identical level of consciousness, of what might very well be known in a different way. The symbol announces a plane of consciousness distinct from that of rational evidence; it is the “cipher” of a mystery, the only means of saying something that cannot be apprehended in any other way; a symbol is never “explained” once and for all, but must be deciphered over and over again.

HENRY CORBIN, *Alone with the Alone*

Allegory is the lowest form of symbolic writing. There is a key – an isomorphism, as it is called in Category Theory – that is, a mapping from

one concept to another. The purpose of allegory is to simplify the thing symbolized by stripping it of its inessential elements. The allegory is also easier to remember than the thing allegorized.

People may use the word metaphor when they mean allegory. A metaphor is used once to express an idea of vision in more colorful language, for example, “The moon was a ghostly galleon”. An allegory, on the other hand, is extended.

It is easy to visualize the full moon as a galleon crossing the sky. Allegories like *Pilgrim’s Progress* or *Animal Farm* are likewise easy to understand. They can be explained.

However, a true symbol defies such analysis and explanation. A mistake is to try to “explain” the symbol. Doing so is a way to become popular but not a way to achieve gnosis. A symbol leads into great depths at each level of understanding.

In this sense, Hollywood movies cannot be symbolic. They cannot serve as the means to preserve and transmit traditional symbols, unless accidentally and incidentally. Perhaps some day that will change.

Hence interpreters of symbolism do no more than explain metaphors and allegories. Alleged symbols are just eruptions of the unconscious and in that sense may even elude the director, writer, and actors.

To the Point The film *mother!* is a film that attempts to be deliberately symbolic in the lower sense of the word. Including obvious allusions to biblical stories hardly gives a film any depth, unless perhaps the stories are actually believed. Unfortunately, in our day and age, biblical allusions are not so obvious to everyone. Reviews of the film believe it is a “metaphor” or “allegory” for something or other. Perhaps to save the environment as the attractive starlet believes.

I shall neither recommend nor dismiss the film. It is a way to pass some time while being confined to the sofa with a sprained ankle, the pain of which exceeds the pain of watching the film to its completion.

The characters have no names since their roles illustrate the allegory. Jennifer Lawrence is the Virgin Mother who is married to a much older man, a popular poet by trade, known by his pronoun “Him”. We see that his life had become ruined; his idyllic house in the garden had burned down and his creativity had atrophied. As the opposite of Eve, mother restores the lost Paradise, restoring the large old mansion to a pristine condition.

Then stuff happens. Visitors arrive much to Him’s joy. The first arrivals are Adam and Eve along with their two sons. Eve feels entitled to live in the mansion, even while initiating its destruction. Cain kills Abel, bring death back into the Paradise recreated by mother. We empathize with her sorrow and sense of helplessness as Him allows event to get out of control.

We learn that the marriage had never been consummated, leaving mother as a Virgin. Desirous of having a child, mother taunts Him. Angered, he takes her by force, although she eventually yields to his will. The next morning she finds herself pregnant and Him becomes prolific. His new book of poetry is an immediate success, attracting ever more visitors.

They are emotionally moved by his beautiful words. That is spot on. How many posts on social media are full of such beautiful quips? We all “like” them, as if the act of liking is the same as incarnating the thought. But we see how the lovers of the Poet reveal their true inner selves. They become angry, lustful, crass, violent.

During the commotion mother gives birth to a son. Unable to recognize them for what they are, Him takes the baby to his many admirers. They then kill the baby and eat its corpse as if consuming a holy sacrament.

Understandably distraught, mother sets the mansion ablaze send the interlopers to the hell that they deserve. Mother dies in the conflagration while Him is unscathed. She is idolized and the cycle repeats.

Posted on 2022-07-02 by Cologero

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Michael DeJoy on 2022-07-03 at 12:42 said:

There are two kinds of people: the people of the "Bright" and the people of the "Shade". The Bright people are the rational, logic, study philosophy and explain allegories to make sense of them. The Shade people understand symbols, give up reading philosophy texts and trying to explain things to Bright people no matter how concerned they appear. Another example of Bright people are those who insist on riding their bicycles as fast as possible thru all intersections thinking how wonderful it all is.

Juliano on 2022-07-04 at 11:51 said:

Have you watched Tarkovsky movies? I think there is great symbolism there. Nostalgia and The Sacrifice are my favorites.

Cologero on 2022-07-04 at 13:44 said:

Maybe this one about *Stalker* by **Andrei Tarkovsky**.

The Zone of Innermost Desires: <https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=16139>

Juliano on 2022-07-13 at 11:48 said:

Great article about *Stalker*, thank you. I still have to watch this one, will do it soon.

Blade on 2022-08-22 at 19:43 said:

Have you written a post that scales symbolic terms? Dictionaries are not a great help. I skip over allegory because it's use often appears idiosyncratic to the author. Now I have a clue. Thanks

Cologero on 2022-08-22 at 22:58 said:

More or less in this post. That is what most people mean by symbol.

Also *The Elite and the Gospels*⁴¹.

I can't recall the posts where this is explained: The real symbols are deliberately put into texts by those who know and understand. One of the reasons is so that esoteric teachings are not lost. The people will continue to preserve and publish the texts, even when they don't understand the esoteric meaning of the symbols.

Blade on 2022-08-22 at 23:17 said:

Thank you

⁴¹<https://www.gornahoor.net/?p=16286>

10.24 The Garden of Allah

A man who fears to acknowledge his god, is unwise to set foot in the desert. The Arabs have a saying, Madame, the desert is the Garden of Allah.

from *The Garden of Allah*

The desert has often had a peculiar fascination for the West. This is reflected in the movies about the Maghreb during the colonial era. (Obviously it is different now.) It's a little side hobby of mine to watch such films. Here are two of them.

Legend of the Lost

Joe: I can't recite any Psalms for ya'. but I know about people who believe in God. Our friend didn't! He put his faith in his father. A man! A human being! That's an easy faith to lose. I know about that, too.

Dita: But he was a good man. He tried to do good. He dreamed of goodness all his life.

Joe: I'm gettin' a little sick of this "Poor Paul," "Kind man," "Full of grace." What does it take to wake you up? He didn't believe in anything but being a big-shot with God as a front. I've seen these do-gooders before; usually doin' the most good for themselves! Believing in God is different than drooling over rubies and emeralds.

Legend of the Lost starred **John Wayne** as Joe January, the tough guy desert guide with a soft heart that was usually kept hidden. **Sophia Loren** was Dita, the street-wise woman always seeking ways to achieve respectability. **Rossano Brazzi** played Paul, an idealist who was searching for a lost treasure discovered by his father; Paul intended to use it to help humanity. Although filmed near Tripoli, the setting Timbuktu, administered by the French at that time.



Paul had letters from his dead father that revealed the location of a treasure trove in a lost city. Paul hires Joe to guide him to it. Dita invited herself along. After a challenging journey, they found the ruins. There were three dead bodies and a diary indicating adultery and murder. Paul was devastated even after finding the gold and jewels. In the middle of the night, Paul takes the donkeys and supplies, leaving Joe and Dita without resources.

Joe, the realist, could see right through Paul's idealism. Joe is a believer and survived the desert. Paul lost his faith and was consumed by it. In many of Wayne's movies, he is saved in the end by the calvary. In this one, he and Dita are saved in a similar way, by a fortuitously passing caravan of Tuaregs.

We are not sure if Joe and Dita were meant for each other, but it seems that way.

Moral of the Story: Do not place your faith in men nor in their schemes.

The Garden of Allah Marlene Dietrich called John Wayne the most boring man she'd met. So it is only fair to watch Marlene in her own Maghreb film, *The Garden of Allah*. Although set in the Maghreb, it was actually filmed mostly in Arizona; but is that not also Allah's Garden?

Domini, played by Dietrich, raised in a convent, is spiritually and emotionally lost. She said to herself, "No one but God and I know what is in my heart." Alone in the world, even when among people, she returns to the convent and got advice from the Mother Superior who told Marlene to go to the desert because,



"There in the solitude, you may find yourself. In the face of the infinite, your grief will vanish and you will realize that life is larger, fuller than you think."

Meanwhile, Charles Boyer played the Trappist monk Boris, who mysteriously fled from the monastery after having taken his final vows. It was doubly upsetting because only he knew the secret of making the famous liqueur that was the monastery's source of income.

When Domini went to the desert, Destiny took over when she crossed paths with Boris, now disguised as a layman. Of course, they fell madly in love with each other. Finally, she could tell him,

"Now you also know what is in my heart."

Yet, Boris was conflicted, and his faith was endangered in the desert. Eventually, he was exposed by a French officer who had seen him at the monastery.

In those days, it was still shocking when a man rejected his final vows, unlike nowadays, when it is a matter of indifference. Domini was more understanding, although she knew that he would have to return to the monastery. She accompanies him there and when they painfully parted, she promised him,

"We are believers, Boris, we know this isn't all, it can't be. Surely in that other world, the real and lasting world, we'll be together forever."

In the depths of her heart, Domini understood the multiple states of being. The pain of separation in this impermanent world paled in the knowledge that they would be reborn to be together forever.

Posted on 2022-09-05 by Cologero

10.25 Zabriskie Point

*Zabriskie Point*⁴² is a 1970 film by the famed director **Michelangelo Antonioni**. Hence, the film is about Antonioni, which makes a complex plot and great acting unnecessary. Unfortunately, the only version that I had available was a poor quality video I found on youtube. That did not do justice to the cinematography of the film, so I was compelled to rely on imagination and memory.

The place Zabriskie Point is near Death Valley in California. It was once a lake, which dried up leaving the badlands. It is not something that humans would normally see, which explains its alien yet compelling look. At one time, it was home to camels, mastodons, and other fauna, all of which left their marks. Of course, there must have been humans whose psychic residues probably still haunt the area.

A film should be an experience, not a story. There must be scenery to look at. The plot of the story must be secondary to the inner lives of the characters as per Schopenhauer. Mark and Daria were a young couple whose paths crossed momentarily in an unexpected, and impossible, way.

The film begins with a meeting of revolutionaries debating whether blacks or whites are more oppressed. Some 70 years later, the argument continues even though the revolutionaries are now in total control. Mark is not impressed; he claims he is willing to die, but not of boredom. He then embarks on an adventure that few would describe as boring.

⁴²https://www.imdb.com/title/tt0066601/?ref_=nv_sr_srsrg_0

In a single day, he gets arrested, steals a Cessna 210 airplane, flies over the desert, spots Daria on the highway and “picks her up” by impressing her with airplane tricks. They make love in the dunes of Zabriskie Point, paint the aircraft with brightly colored slogans and designs; he then flies back to the Los Angeles airport where the police shoot him to death as he landed the craft.

Most men would need a week to accomplish all that. Actually, on second thought, most men might fantasize about that for years, expect for the part about dying in a hail of bullets.

Obviously, it is not at all an action flick, so we do learn about their inner lives. Daria is clearly infatuated by Mark’s rebel without a cause persona. He tells her about revolutionary philosophy that divides people into heroes and villains. When she questions such a sharp distinction, he explains that it is the only way to tell them apart. He was wise beyond his years and understood instinctively the friend-enemy distinction described by Carl Schmitt. Even today there are the Darias seeking peaceful resolutions and the Marks advocating for unpeaceful revolutions.

Mark tells her that they are all alone on the lake floor. She soon yields to his seduction as he slowly unbuttons her dress. Suddenly, dozens of other amorous couples appear. They are the primordial couple but centuries of human visitation are revealed to them. As a side note, the authorities investigated the film. It was a federal crime to bring women across state lines for the purpose of sex; it was, and might still be, a state crime to have an orgy at a state park. So, guys, if you ever find yourself in such a situation, just get a room. Antonioni was cleared because the scenes were simulated.

Daria hears of Mark’s execution on the radio, but she continues her trip to Phoenix to meet up with her boss Lee, at his awesome desert home. Lee is a real estate developer whose current project is to create a desert paradise with a lake; but has trouble attracting investors. Little did they know what Phoenix would turn into.

Daria finds her life emptied of meaning, her new love lost forever, and unable to return to the past. She drives off, turns around, and fantasizes Lee's home exploding and bursting into flames.

Who is living in an illusion, Daria or Lee? Whose world will end? As Rene Guenon concludes:

It can be said in all truth that the end of a world never is and never can be anything but the end of an illusion.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Lb1h4RsmIM0>

Posted on 2022-10-09 by Cologero

11.1 Pumpkin Spice Muffins

I woke up so happy on Venus day this morning, so I decided not to go back to sleep. I was thinking about Pumpkin Spice Muffins. I made some earlier in the week and they attracted family, friends, and foes, before I could even photograph one for this recipe. They look like Double Chocolate Chip Muffins¹, except that they are brown, and they don't taste at all the same.

Like so many other things, pumpkins originated in the New World, yet another legacy of forces set in motion by Christopher Columbus. No, a random “discoverer” counts for nil. That is why Lief Erickson has no enemies. A man in the world who accomplishes something quickly finds out that he will have friends and foes; he must learn how to deal with both.

So I leave you with a recipe for Pumpkin Spice Muffins. Once you learn the basic Mother Muffin, then you can easily adapt that knowledge

¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=14871>

to make specific muffins of your choice.

Pumpkin Spice If you can't find pumpkin spice, then you can make your own using 1 teaspoon cinnamon, 1/2 teaspoon ginger, 1/4 teaspoon ground nutmeg & 1/4 teaspoon ground cloves. Variations of pumpkin spice have been found in North American cookbooks since the 18th century.

It is so popular in the Autumn that a variety of products flavored or scented with pumpkin spice can be found. These include muffins, pies, candles, coffee, lattes, beer, vodka, cookies, aerosol spray, toothpaste, and even Spam.

Ingredients Metric equivalents are within parentheses.

- 1 1/2 cups (240g) all-purpose flour
- 3/4 to 1 cup (150g to 200g) sugar
- 1 Tablespoon (15ml) baking powder
- 2 teaspoons (10ml) of pumpkin spice
- A little salt
- 6 tbsp (84g) melted butter
- 2 large eggs, beaten (a US large egg is 57 g. A European large egg is 63 g, so close enough)
- 1/4 cup (60 ml) sour cream
- A little Vanilla (optional)
- 1 15 oz. can of pumpkin puree. About 1 cup (250 to 500ml)

Mixing Combine all the dry ingredients in a bowl and mix thoroughly.

In the meantime, melt the butter, either stovetop or microwave (easier), and beat the eggs.

Add the wet ingredients (sour cream, butter, eggs, pumpkin puree) and mix thoroughly. It should turn into a shade of orange (also called brown) loose paste. It will be less viscous than chocolate muffins, so cooking time may be extended.

Baking Spray oil into a muffin pan and put some of the muffin mixture into each of the holes.

Bake at 375°F (190°C) about 20 to 22 (20 to 22) minutes

I use a Ninja toaster oven which heats up quite quickly and holds heat well. You may need to cook longer. A trick that looks really cool if you are trying to impress friends is to insert a wooden toothpick into the muffin. If it comes out clean, the muffin is ready; otherwise, it needs longer. In practice, the technique is not very helpful, so I just look see if the top is encrusted.

This makes a dozen (12) American muffins or 10 metric muffins.

This is a Halloween favorite. It was banned by the BBC when it first came ou on the grounds that it is to morbid.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l2PoSljk8cE>

Posted on 2021-10-29 by Cologero

11.2 Eating on La Vigilia

It has been a tradition in our family, both the Sicilian and Abruzzesi sides, to have a seafood dinner on Christmas Eve. It starts with an antipasto that includes tuna and anchovy, and ends with an assortment of smelts, shrimp, and baccalà. But as the family dispersed and the number of guests decreased, so did the assortment of seafood.

Primo Piatto In any case, my favorite has always been the first plate and is actually all that I need to consider the dinner complete. This is calamari sauce. It is simple to make, so I am providing the recipe here in case you have not yet made your Christmas Eve plans.

Prepare the Sauce

1. Heat olive oil in a sauce pan, and sauté some finely chopped onions.
2. Optional: include some diced yellow onion if you prefer it.
3. Add salt and pepper to taste; I don't like too much salt.
4. When onions and garlic is ready add tomato puree. I use Pomi strained tomatoes which comes in 750 g boxes. Two boxes minimum or three or even more for more people or hearty eaters.
5. I like to add a bottle of clam juice and/or dry Marsala; perhaps white wine if you have it around.
6. Let it all simmer slowly for a while.

Get the seafood ready Slice up some squid in rings and don't be shy about including the tentacles, which are the tastiest part. A giant squid would have no compunction about eating you.

Add the squid to the sauce and let them cook. Not too long so they don't get tough. That suffices if that is all you want to do.

I like to include some mussels and/or clams. Brush the shells clean and add them several minutes before serving. You need to wait for the shells to open.

You can even add some peeled and deveined shrimp. If I have enough sauce I add a lobster tail for special occasions.

Serving the meal Cook some pasta, following package directions if you don't already know how. I prefer pasta with more body like linguini, although my absolute favorite is bucatini. It is easy to cook al dente and the sauce penetrates the entire strand. When the pasta is ready, transfer it to a serving bowl and cover it with the sauce. Always include extra sauce at the table.



Purists insist that you should never serve cheese with a seafood sauce. However, my family has always used grated pecorino romano cheese quite liberally on the pasta.

I know that because my job was always to grate the cheese.

Dining in Castellammare This is a postscript, demonstrating how to be creative with your cooking. About 10 years ago, my son and I were touring around Sicily. On one trip to Castellammare, we saw a restaurant displaying all the fresh seafood at the entrance. So we found a table. Just as we were deciding what to order, a small truck stopped and unloaded fresh seafood that was placed immediately in the display case.



We got up to check it out and saw a beautiful lobster, which we ordered. The waiter then enquired about how we would like it prepared. We looked a little puzzled. Noticing that, the waiter said, "Don't worry! I'll make something nice for you." A short time later, he returned with this beautiful and delicious dish. And, yes, he offered us some grated cheese to cover it.

Posted on 2021-12-18 by Cologero

* * *

Oswald Spengler on 2021-12-19 at 02:46 said:

What a great recipe. This website is worth reading if only for Cologero's Italian cuisine instructions. I can't cook to save my life but wow, Cologero really makes me want an Italian wife who'd cook me these kinds of dishes

Balder on 2021-12-19 at 11:45 said:

Being a Finn, I prefer overcooked ham with rye bread and mustard, salmon with potatoes and liver & carrot casserole on the Yule table. Being thinking also turning full vegetarian, but I will never touch that horrible seitan.

Auld Wat on 2021-12-20 at 13:38 said:

I will be fasting on the Vigil. So sadly while I can see the food, I can't eat it.

Cassiodorus on 2022-12-20 at 12:29 said:

As a fellow Italian American , I totally appreciated this post . When I was a kid , the big fish dinner wasn't a winner . Later on , when I came to enjoy seafood , the Christmas Eve feast is something I look forward to all year.

Grazie Mille !

II.3 Nana's Sauce

Sono poeta. Que faccio? Scrivo.

All the recipe web sites promote complex recipes where simplicity should suffice. They also tend to ramble on. I can ramble, but the recipe will be simple. Peasant food does not depend on a well-stocked kitchen, but rather makes do with what is on hand. You've probably heard stories about the women slaving over "Sunday gravy" with all its ingredients. My mother, however, was an Anglophile, so we always had a roast on Sundays. Pasta with tomato sauce and meatballs was a midweek specialty.

As a master of negotiating the vagaries of the modern world, I have simplified the recipe. After a little practice, this can be put together about 20 minutes; cleanup is easy. You will love the result and wonder why you ever bothered with those heavy sauces. It is even halal.

Lonely Girls

Venus is the source of the power of taste. She governs the stomach whence emerges the ability and taste for eating and drinking.

PICATRIX

If you happen to be in the supermarket between 5 PM and 6 PM, you are likely to see a lonely girl or two. She is still in her daytime uniform as she shops for dinner, her face vacant. In many cases, she has, in her cart, a box of pasta, a bottled imitation Italian tomato sauce, cheap shelf-stable grated cheese, and a bottle of wine. The giveaway is the pie or cake from the bakery — there is just one slice.

This is the nigredo stage. If she only knew how simple this is; maybe should could entice a man and being the albedo stage.

The Sauce Crops, such as the potato, maize, pumpkin, chocolate, vanilla, and tobacco, originated in the New World yet radically transformed the Old world. Imagine Ireland without potatoes, England without chips, Russia without good vodka, Belgium without chocolates, or dolce without vanilla. What did Europeans do with their hands before tobacco?

New World Tomatoes came to define Italian cuisine, at least in the South. So let's prepare the sauce first. I can reveal a personal secret: I cook it in a wok these days for obvious reasons.

- Chop up a small onion and sauté it in some olive oil.
- When the onions are translucent, add two boxes of Pomi strained tomatoes, or 1.5 kg of something else.
- You can add a little water to the emptied boxes, shake them a bit, and add to the sauce.

- Add some ground black pepper and some fresh or dried basil.
- Finally add some wine, such as Marsala. This serves two purposes. It is better than adding sugar to remove some bitterness from the tomato. Moreover, just as vodka is added to penne alla vodka, the alcohol brings out more of the tomato essence. The alcohol will boil off, if that is a concern.
- Bring it to a light simmer.

Dual Use The sauce can be used as a marinara sauce, say for use with ravioli or gnocchi. Add some oregano if you want to make pizza. Slicing a baguette in half makes a quick pizza like snack. Toast it a little, then cover with some sauce, mozzarella and grated cheese. Bake until cheese melts. Kids will eat it up.

Meatballs Simmering some meatballs in the sauce will continue the alchemical process.

Ingredients

- 1 pound or 500 grams of quality ground beef such as sirloin. To make them more tender, you can use 25% of ground lamb and/or ground veal. However, if Bambi made you cry, the skip this step. Don't use ground pork; try to maintain some dignity.
- 2 large eggs, beaten. Euro eggs are slightly larger than American eggs so don't mix American and metric measures. No one has explained the reason to me.
- Add some ground black pepper and salt if you like it. For me, the cheese is salty enough

- Locatelli Pecorino Romano Cheese: $\frac{1}{2}$ cup or 125 ml. Don't go cheap on the cheese.
- $\frac{1}{4}$ cup or 60 ml of plain bread crumbs. A nice alternative is a slice of white sandwich bread, without the crust, cubed into small pieces and then soaked in a little water for a few minute.

The Process

It should have taken you perhaps 5 minutes to gather the ingredients. Now you need to mix them all together by hand. Clean your hands thoroughly or use food gloves; don't get nail polish on the meat.

Stop when the mixture is homogeneous; do not overmix the ingredients.

Now roll the meat mixture into balls and drop into the simmering sauce. This will make 12 American or 10 metric meatballs.

Cover the pot or wok and let everything simmer for about 90 minutes or two hours. Stir occasionally with some flair and sing along as you do so. If people are around, pretend to taste it and add a little more spice with great fanfare. Be sure to skim excess oil and fat off the top.

If you concentrated as you cooked, you may get a taste of the rubedo stage, red like the tomato!

Service You've made enough sauce for 1 pound or 500 grams of your favorite pasta. Cook it al dente; don't embarrass yourself. Drain the pasta and mix it with some sauce.

Serve the pasta with some extra sauce on the side, which I like to do. Sprinkle liberally with some Pecorino cheese until the plate looks like the peaks of Mount Zalmon.

Posted on 2023-03-30 by Cologero

* * *

taivasvaeltaja on 2023-03-31 at 09:36 said:

Sounds very tasty and elegant. Just ate some mama's meatballs with an oatmeal-rice mix. I could add or suggest a small change into the meatball recipe to make it more nutritious, filling and tasty: instead of bread crumbs or flour, use oatmeal instead. And if the recipe says two eggs, use at least three.

Cologero on 2023-03-31 at 14:58 said:

There is no one perfect sauce, taivasvaeltaja. You can use your own creativity to enhance it in a way that seems suitable to you.

taivasvaeltaja on 2023-04-03 at 15:42 said:

May I then perhaps present my classic tomato sauce?

Cook 500 grams of minced beef

Add some salt, black pepper, white pepper, oregano and basil according to your taste

Add 2 sliced onions and 6 nails of minced garlic and let it cook

Add 1 can of kidney beans

Add 5 sliced tomatoes and one can of tomato sauce

You can also add ketchup according to your taste

Cook middle heat for 15-20 minutes and roll it up now and then. Don't forget to cook the pasta with it. I also like cooked potatoes, carrots and broccoli.

Cologero on 2023-04-03 at 16:08 said:

I had a girlfriend who added ketchup to her tomato sauce, unknownst to me. After I tasted a bite, I put down my fork and walked out of her house.

taivasvaeltaja on 2023-04-04 at 08:26 said:

Haha! I knew the ketchup part was controversial. I forgot to add that it is only allowed little and when the label is Heinz.

Some Evola's Translations

12.1 Evola's Advice to the Pope

On the occasion of the visit of Pope Benedict XVI to the USA, it may be appropriate to quote Evola on the situation of the Church just after Vatican II and on its prospects to become an authentic force of Tradition.

This is from the conclusion of the chapter “Esoteric Catholicism” in his work *Mask and Face of Contemporary Spirituality*.

Nominally, the pontificate, an institution that was already existent in ancient Rome, is part of Catholicism, and stands at the center of the Church and at the top of her hierarchy. But we must ask what subsists in it of its primal function and of Tradition on the whole. The prophetic hope of a Joachim of Fiore¹ in the coming of a “angelic pope” having almost the marks of an initiate and inaugurating a new “Reign”, that of the acting, vivifying, and living Holy Spirit, has remained a utopian illusion. And if we want to adapt ourselves to the contingencies of recent times,

¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joachim_of_Fiore

in particular the figures of the two most recent pontiffs, John XXIII and Paul VI — with the climate of “aggiornamento” and modernization, with the increasing aversion toward Catholic Integralism² and toward so-called “residual medievalism” — seem to definitively seal a disastrous balance sheet.

So the conditions for which we can give a somewhat positive response to the issue we formulated, viz., the possibility of Catholicism to furnish what many sought elsewhere, appears to be nonexistent, at least if we consider the large picture. Yet so often this search has pushed them into the confusions and errors of neo-spiritualism. Given what we have said, it is problematic that, in spite of everything, the Church, the “mystical body of Christ”, is the carrier and administrator of a true supernatural power objectively acting through rites and sacraments, of which it can benefit those who become its members, hoping thereby to experience beyond the confessional religion and not seeing the paramount goal in so-called “holiness”.

One can nevertheless recognize that Catholicism contains, in spite of everything, traces of a wisdom that can serve as the basis for an “esoteric” dimension of various elements. One exponent of “integral traditionalism” had this to say:

The fact that the representatives of the Catholic Church understand so little of their own doctrines here he is referring to their inner dimension must not make it such that we ourselves demonstrate the same incomprehension.

Otherwise, all the impediments and all the limitations appear difficult to remove. Leaving priestly Catholicism out of consideration, we could refer to the ascetic Catholic in regard, above all, to the ancient monastic traditions, to that which concerns, if not an initiation, at least an inte-

²<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Integralism>

rior discipline that looks toward an opening to transcendence and an approach to the supernatural. But even in this case, the difficult work of purification and essentialization would be imposed, given the co-presence of devotional elements and specifically Christian complexes through which it is perhaps difficult to gather up valid tools for interior action without including the knowledge of what other traditions offer.

A Catholicism that is raised up to the level of a truly universal, unanimous, and perennial tradition where faith can be integrated into a metaphysical realization, the symbol integrated into the path to awakening, the rites and sacraments into acts of power, dogmas into expressions of an absolute and infallible consciousness because it is beyond human and, as such, alive in beings unbound from terrestrial chains through an ascesis, and where the pontificate recovers its primal mediating function — such a Catholicism could supplant every “spiritualism”, both present and future.

But observing the reality is this anything more than a dream?

Posted on 2008-04-18 by Cologero

12.2 Julius Evola on Esoteric Catholicism

Today with difficulty, if not exceptionally in some close to dangerous existential crises, the potentiality of Christianity at its beginnings as that “tragic doctrine of salvation” can be re-actualized. The problem is not set and we even say without reticence that if anyone who has known, for some time, nothing other than the vainest constructions of philosophy and the secular plebeian university culture of today or the contaminations of the various contemporary individualisms, aestheticisms, and romanticisms, would “convert” to Catholicism and would experience truly the faith at least, with a total commitment and possibly in a “sacri-

ficial” sense, that would signify not an abdication but rather, in spite of everything, a progress.

From *Maschera e Volto dello Spiritualismo Contemporaneo*

Posted on 2011-03-31 by Aeneas

* * *

Cologero on 2012-12-21 at 09:20 said:

Alex, we here at Gornahoor have gone through a lot of trouble to make Evola's work available, including much of his correspondence. At this point, there are several hundred thousand words of text, but there is a search feature available plus google indexes everything here.

Since you seem to be a recent visitor, I'll make you aware of this text by Julius Evola: *Esoteric Catholicism and Integral Traditionalism*³. So obviously your grasp of his work has limitations. This is not a criticism, since we all have limitations; keep that in mind whenever and wherever you read anything.

We have elucidated several hermeneutic principles. First is that, regarding Guenon and Evola, Guenon is the Master and Evola the pupil. This is not just our position, Evola himself admits it. In their correspondence over decades, Evola went to Guenon for advice, but never the reverse. A careful reading of our texts will reveal inconsistencies in Evola over the years. Evola seemed to have, as Guenon points out, certain prejudices that colored his opinions, as well as ambitions to be academically acceptable, something Guenon did not care about. Also, Evola was never initiated into anything, so we must take his ipse dixit pronouncements with a grain of salt.

So let's start with Guenon. He addresses the Christian tradition in several of his works and understands its esoteric origins. Moreover, he points out that such works as Dante's *Divine Comedy* and the *Romance of the Rose* are esoteric texts. So anyone with the proper understanding can certainly see that there definitely is an "esoteric dimension" in Catholicism, at least as it was understood in the Middle Ages, which is really all we are interested in here.

Another hermeneutic principle is to look at whether a teaching is consistent with the metaphysics of Tradition. We see that in the Middle Ages, there was an understanding of the different levels of the soul, that there is an intellect that is superior to the rational mind, that there is a cosmic order, that the persons in society fall generally into a caste-like division of

³<http://www.gornahoor.net/library/EsotericCatholicism.pdf>

functions, and so on. We see this all in the spiritual tradition of the Middle Ages. Not even Evola denies that the European Middle Ages was a Traditional society. Obviously, this was not the result of an accident, but indicates the existence of an esoteric tradition that manifested in what we see as its outward forms.

Ultimately, how does it help you if someone tells you there was an esoteric society in Prague in 1647 or some such thing? This is all mechanical thinking and can only result in the simulacra of authentic esoteric understanding. Your starting point must always be self-knowledge and self-understanding, to see how your mind works, where your thoughts come from, how desires arise, and so on. As your own consciousness becomes more ordered, it will be easier to understand esoteric texts.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-22 at 01:47 said:

I apologise if I intrude but several of Alex's points are in error :

1. The Holy Grail is not of pagan origin but is an esoteric representation of the eucharist. I recommend strongly reading AE Waite's work of the Grail to understand its role as a symbol of inner Christianity.

2. Guenon did admit the existence of initiation in Christianity but that it was no longer open to all as the organisations in question were withdrawn from the world. With time that could change.

3. Evola was indeed quite inconsistent because at the end of his life, in *Orientations*, he admitted that the Church held to the positions of the Syllabus of Errors, then he would support the Church. In other words Evola was of the same opinion as the late Archbishop Lefebvre.

4. Alex, I believe your development would be aided by reading the works of Jean Borella...

Mihai on 2012-12-22 at 09:56 said:

The Grail has its antecedents in ancient Celtic legends and traditions and it was considered a pre-figuration of the Eucharist, thus transposed in Christian terminology.

Also, Waite is an author that can hardly be taken seriously, given his connections with "organisations" such as The Golden Dawn.

Guenon actually reviewed that very book in an article which is part of *Symbols of the sacred science*.

Cologero on 2012-12-22 at 17:47 said:

Alex: Guenon has written extensively about initiatic organizations in the West, which he claimed existed up until a few centuries ago. He also made a rather surprising revelation in one of his letters to Evola. Guenon also explained his conversion to Islam, which is probably not what you think. All that is documented here, and in his books, so perhaps you can comment on specifics.

You have a misunderstanding of initiation or tradition, by confusing the Tradition with the various outward forms it may take. What is your purpose in that if not polemical? If you want to strut your stuff, then explain why the Divine Comedy is not indicative of initiatory knowledge? Guenon certainly thought it was, and if he was wrong about that, how can we trust him on anything else?

Evola, unfortunately, mixes up non-traditional ideas with his own philosophical “system”. That is what makes him appealing, and we add, comprehensible, to certain kinds of minds. He is good on the criticism of the modern world, but unreliable on anything of a positive nature.

Logres on 2012-12-22 at 23:07 said:

Alex said “That doesn’t mean they were contained inside the main Christian religion...”

I don’t understand this point of view – it sounds as if you are saying “unless so-and-so exoteric religion has organized within itself, as an institution (albeit a secret one, or a “hidden one”), which is sort of an acknowledged ‘state secret’, then that religion cannot be said to ‘contain’ an esoteric tradition”.

Those seem like very loaded terms – granted, no one is arguing that the exoteric Christian religion did everything it could to foster esotericism in the West – if it had done this, it would either

a) be esoteric itself

b) the exclusive product of said esoteric society

I am not sure if any religion would fit category b, and choice a seems to undercut the idea of “religion” to begin with.

Instead, Christianity seems to have been a hybrid or amalgamation of sorts, a “Platonism for the masses” or (as Borella put it) a sort of esotericism made into exoteric religion. Perhaps one can disagree with the “gambit” of doing this, but I am not sure what the point would be – every possibility will have to manifest, and this possibility was certainly latent in any attempt to inter-relate esoteric mystery with exoteric dogma.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-22 at 23:27 said:

As a way of relation, it must be said that the esoteric-exoteric conflict which exists in Christianity also exists in other traditional belief systems – in Islam many exoteric Sunnis and Shia believe Sufism to be heretical and Sufis have been persecuted from time to time. In China and Korea exoteric Confucians at time persecuted esoteric Taoists and Buddhists. Evolians are holding Christianity to an imaginary high standard no religion in the world is up to par on. Ultimately we are dealing with the prejudice of a Dadaist and his heavy metal fan followers who despise their ancestries and cover up their nihilism in pseudo-academic effete jargon.

Now to return to the nature of Christianity, it is indeed Platonism for the masses as a philosophy professor of mine also put it, Schuon also agreed on the notion of esoteric made

exoteric. More to the point, Boris Mouravieff shows that Christianity is not simply another form of the tradition but it is the completion and fulfillment of all traditions. Christianity is the universal religion to unite all men under God's kingdom.

One word of advice to students I should add – instead of focusing solely on politics as Evolians tend to do, one should study the art of a particular time and place to know the inner feeling and dynamic of said society. The Christian Mediaeval West had art based on the theme of transcendence, whereas the Classical art preceeding and the Renaissance art following it were human-based art styles. Art history matches perfectly with Guenon's interpretation of Christianity as restorer of Western tradition from Greco-Roman degeneracy and the decline of the Church is the decline of the west... .

Mihai on 2012-12-23 at 06:09 said:

@Alex:

Try to look a little into what the Christian East contains.

Try Dionysius the Areopagite, Maxim the Confessor, Gregory Palamas, John of the Ladder as well as many other saints whose teachings have been collected in the Philokalia. The Hesychastic Way, the way of the Heart, is the very core of Christianity and represents an integral Christian esoterism, without it being mixed with non/pre-Christian elements, as was the case with Christian Hermeticism and the Grail.

I agree that Catholicism has tended, with each passing century, to cultivate a more and more rationalist approach to religion, which lead to the numerous problems that have sprung in the West, beginning with the very idea behind modernity itself.

Also, you have to understand that Evola is no authority when discussing the Christian tradition. Some of the arguments he brings in that chapter posted by Cologero are of the kind that only a rationalist academic critic would make.

Evola's approach to spirituality, also has some flaws, some only in particulars, but a few in essential matters, which cannot be passed over.

One such example is his view of spiritual as something "impersonal".

Logres on 2012-12-23 at 15:01 said:

Alec, those are good recommendations by Mihai – everyone's been argued with on this Forum – it's part of who we are – iron sharpening iron. You might be interested in the Hesychasm controversy that erupted around Barlaam, who denied "navel-gazing": the Eastern Church strongly defended not only the ideal, but the specific practices. http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Barlaam_of_Seminara

Cologero has done a lot of work digging up obscure Christian teachings and examining them in light of Tradition – the consensus on this Forum is against you, so it's a rough, uphill

row to how, because it's not a religious, but an intellectual consensus, between those of widely varied practice and background.

Cologero is right to emphasize a certain purity of will and intuition here – you find what you seek. What needs to happen, as soon as possible, is that Traditionalists begin reweaving the garment of God, which has been ripped asunder. It exposes (to the casual eye) the project to the accusation that we are cherry-picking for a special thesis, but this is something deeper than a will-based and relativistic reshaping of history “as we would like it to be” – it is the Hermetic method of seeing below the surface, and discerning the Logos at work. The Church has a lot to answer for, and judgement starts at the household of God; but we have the critical evidence and the criticism, which only sets the task before us: to see deeper into the mysteries. As you do so, you will no doubt come upon “things” others are not aware of – test the spirits, and keep going. But don't take a starting point as an ending point, and shut the Book. Keep going.

Logres on 2012-12-23 at 15:03 said:

Also, as regards Evola, one learns (or should learn) more from the errors of genius, than the “correct thinking” of the mediocre. That is the approach one should have with Evola.

Senko on 2012-12-23 at 21:38 said:

Alex, Charbonneau-Lassay, who was a really orthodox Catholic was the depositary of the Order of the Paraclite, that was a “mainstream” Catholic initiatic order. By the way, in this issue I have to agree with Reyor and Borella, the very Sacraments are meant to be initiatic, so, for those qualified and aware of their nature they are initiatic, for the rest, they appear as exoteric, though the initiatic influences are still there, even if wasted or not “used”.

Senko on 2012-12-23 at 21:41 said:

Mihai,

You are right pointing to the Orthodox East, but if you let me, I'll add that all this can be used in the West too. My parish priest (I'm Catholic) taught me Prayer of the Heart, and I used to discuss with him so Orthodox and Hermetic authors (even Guenón a few times)

Logres on 2012-12-23 at 22:16 said:

Alex: I am not so sure you just asked a question, you also actually made the assertion:

“I certainly agree the European Middle Ages was a traditional society, but Christianity in itself never had an initiatic system...”

Mihai on 2012-12-24 at 02:12 said:

You are certainly lucky to have found a parish priest who is open towards things like Hermetism and esoteric matters in general.

Nowadays, Christian priests (both in the East and in the West) who have an integral knowledge of the very heart of Christian teachings are hard to find, but not impossible.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 00:33 said:

1. When dealing with matters of truth or falsehood emotions play no role in the decision, Julius Evola was a seeker after truth and a lover of order, as such we are all united in the same endeavour, thus I respect Baron Evola as a man who offered sometime profound insights. However he sadly was infected with the spirit of rebellion which created the modern world he despised and he never quite shook off his Dadaist past, his hatred of Christianity being part of said rebellion. However, at various times in his life, he seems quite close to the truth. I've learned over the years to sense a writer's inner feelings that he tries to disguise in his words and I can tell that for all his Stoic front he put on, Evola was hollow and looking for what he could not find. If only he had lost a little pride, as God Himself suggested with the wound in 195, he could have found liberation in Catholicism.

The respect I have for a tragic hero such as Evola does not extend to those degenerate pariahs who use his name to justify their antisocial and destructive behaviour. It must be pointed out, as I am surprised Cologero hasn't yet, that Guenon clearly said in *La crise du monde moderne* that a dead tradition can not be revived once an organisation has no successors to its spiritual power – we can all agree that paganism has no valid chain of initiation that go back to pre-Christian times – and as such Evola did not advocate restoring something he knew could not be done but instead he believed in abstract principles with the hope that revelation would come at a future date.

And one more note – in the piece Cologero translated above Evola actually said that on the vulgar level it is correct to defend Catholicism from other spiritualities in the West for foreign beliefs divorced from their places of origin are prey to becoming agents of the countertradition, as we can see today in various perversions of Brahmanism, Buddhism etc etc... .

Cologero on 2012-12-27 at 06:38 said:

Very well put, Jason-Adam. It is not up to me to say everything, but anyone with an objective mind can put things together as you have. On the positive side, Evola has been instrumental in leading many to see the shortcomings of the modern world. That, of course, includes the existing spiritual traditions which seem far from what they used to be. I believe that I have documented sufficiently how the spiritual worldview of 1000 years ago differs significantly from what is commonly held today. Perhaps you can understand why Evola was so reluctant to associate himself with its contemporary forms.

Unfortunately, that left him in a precarious position, a “traditionalist” with no Tradition. He knew paganism could not be restored; that is why he was so harsh in his criticism of neo-paganism. From his correspondence with Guenon, we can see that even into his 50s, he was

still searching for an initiation or tradition, even through marginal figures. That is sad.

His attitude toward Dadaism is quite strange. Clearly, it was a revolutionary movement; we can understand why a young man would have been attracted to it, but would have dropped it after finding Tradition. He seems to have done so, since he associated Dada, and its Romanian founder, with "cultural Marxism", as we showed in an essay written in the 1930s that we translated. Yet in his spiritual autobiography, he retracts himself and goes on to praise Tristan Tzara. Then there is that rather sad interview with him floating around on youtube where he shows great joy in his association with Dada. To shock the bourgeoisie is a left wing sport.

Evola often wrote about the inner spiritual combat. It should not be necessary to point out that there is an abyss between writing about it and actually engaging in it. At this point, it is no longer sufficient to simply quote Evola as an "inspiration"; our inspiration needs to come from a higher source.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-27 at 17:49 said:

One blessing in disguise I think Vatican II has brought is that in the fight against it, traditionalist Catholics have been inspired to rebirth the Mediaeval spirit in themselves and not remain passive as too many Catholics had become by the 1930s-1940s. While the circle of traditional Catholicism is quite tiny, we do not know yet if they may amount to something more in the future... ..

Evola I think had 3 phases in his life – the initial revolutionary period in the 20s, his shift to conservatism in the 30s and 40s, and then his "anarchist/active nihilist" post-war return to his youth in the 50s and 60s. Even yet though, as late as 1974 he was writing that he hoped the Church could hold Spain together after Franco's death... ..

12.3 Giuliano Imperatore

In the November 1940 issue of *La Vita Italiana*, Julius Evola, writing under the pseudonym "Arthos", addressed the ancient concept of race in the article "Sulle origini e sul doppio volto del razzismo". We here are interested in the Emperor Julian, known as the Apostate. In this article, Evola aligns himself with Julian and states his opposition to the scientific, genetic view of the origins of races, nations, and castes.

Flavio Claudio Giuliano⁴ was the last of the pagan Roman emperors, the nephew of Constantine, who had established Christianity as the religion of the Empire. After several successful military campaigns against the Germans and Gauls, Julian became Emperor following the death of his cousin Constantius and resided in Constantinople, the seat of the Eastern part of the Empire. In the tradition of Marcus Aurelius, Julian was a philosopher-king. Although raised as a Christian, he abdicated under the influence of neo-platonic philosophy⁵, which he studied in Athens (and was the classmate of two future saints: St. Basil the Great and St. Gregory). Apparently, he was initiated into the Eleusinian Mysteries and Mithras. As Emperor, he tried to govern on these three planks:

- Roman Tradition
- Hellenic Culture
- Neoplatonic philosophy

In short, we have a unique man: warrior, philosopher, emperor, initiate who supported the fundamental supporting principles of Western civilization. So what went wrong? Julian was not content to be non-Christian; he became anti-Christian. This led him to rule by force and violence, something Evola has warned against. He forced Christians out of state administrative duties and created martyrs, so any positive contributions he made were forever forgotten under the rubric of Julian the Apostate. A more cautious man may have noticed that his program was already in effect.

- **Roman Tradition.** He was concerned about the parallel hierarchy in the Church that mirrored the leadership hierarchy. Well,

⁴http://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Flavio_Claudio_Giuliano

⁵http://www.traditioninaction.org/Cultural/A014cpManualCivility_Bearing.htm

because of the hierarchy, the Catholic church was able to sustain Roman tradition and law well into the Middle Ages.

- **Hellenic Culture.** He forbade the Christian schools from teaching Greek literature. This just isolated the Christians from Hellenic culture. Prior to that, Homer's epic poems were considered divinely inspired, Alexander was considered a saint, and Plato a revealer of divine Truth.
- **Neoplatonic philosophy.** Christian theology was founded on Neoplatonism and should have been encouraged.

Although he himself did not believe in the existence of the Roman gods (he was a monotheist), he nevertheless tried to re-establish their cult. The problem is that once the noble lie is no longer believed, you cannot just will it back into existence. All that is now moot, in any case, since the so-called Reformation of the Northern peoples did much to destroy the triple foundation of Western civilization. So let's move on to Evola's points. Evola summarizes Julian's position:

Against the Christian conception of the generation of men from a single couple, this emperor held to the doctrine of multiple creations, that is, of the diverse origins of men, unequal in race and disposition in the primordial times of the immortal gods. This idea reflects traditions very familiar to the ancient aryan peoples, which accounts for the differences not only of race, but also of castes and lineages or nations, *stirpe*, by fundamentally distinct divine or demonic symbolic figures.

Thus, in his monotheism and polygenism, Julian is aligned with the theories of Herman Wirth⁶. It is important to note here that Julian claims

⁶<https://gornahoor.net/library/UltimaThule.pdf>

that races, nations, and even castes have their origin in spiritual differences, *not* because of genetic factors. This is why Evola quotes him approvingly as one of the advocates of the Traditional doctrine of spiritual races. The modern mind can see origins only in term of time, in the past. So to them, the origins of man appear to be singular from the genetic perspective; even more absurdly, the genetic view would trace man's origin to the orangutan⁷.

Evola next addresses Thomas Campanella's City of the Sun⁸. Although the City is based on traditional principles, such as rule by the philosopher-king and solarity, Evola notices the beginning of a more modern idea of race. For the Solarians, breeding is planned in the same way that horses or dogs are bred. This Evola criticizes as a rationalistic and mechanical approach. Evola then relates Campanella's "solar race" to the the Aryan-Hyperborean "super-race", and to the conception in the Middle Ages:

the idea of race, united from the beginning to the idea of a public service, constituted one of the fundamental conditions of the nobility of the Middle Ages; a condition considered so natural, that no one thought of having to express it in words, much less in an "myth" or a theory. Let's keep in mind that, in later periods, "science", in the modern sense, appears always as the enemy of this true aristocracy, faithful to the idea of race up until the period of the Enlightenment, the precise point where the scientific myth, in strict connexion Masonic agitations, helped it to dig its grave.

Posted on 2011-03-15 by Cologero

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⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=1604>

⁸<https://gornahoor.net/?p=518>

EXIT on 2011-03-16 at 09:50 said:

Actually, Julian emphasized the differences in races and nations due to the national gods who were subordinate to the supreme god (thus, contrary to what you have stated, he did believe in the gods), but the actual existence of these differences are what really matters, and because of these differences he rejected Christian universalism which he considered racial treason and supported the ancestral traditions. Christianity, he said, was a wicked fiction. It mixes Jewish mentalities with misunderstood Aryan teachings, steals quotes from the mouths of gentiles, rewords them, then places it all into the mouth of a fictional messiah which is presented as historical fact. If you ask me Julian was not forceful enough in dealing with this false religion. This modern anti-power mentality is wholly foreign to true European character. It was Heraclitus who said that "Strife is the father and king of all... it is necessary to understand that war is universal, and order is fighting, and everything comes about through fighting and necessity" for "the lightning bold steers all things."

Cologero on 2011-03-16 at 12:49 said:

"Belief" is the word in question. He didn't accept a literal belief in the stories. To repeat Evola, which would be unnecessary to careful readers, races are the accounted for by "fundamentally distinct divine or demonic symbolic figures"

So we see conjoined "divine" with "symbolic figures" ... the gods are "symbolic figures" which is all we implied. That, plus monotheism, makes Julian's "religion" something other than the traditional cult. Again, exactly what we claimed.

So all you show that Julian had his opinions, but was ineffective in his project ... again what we said. There are alternate ways to win the battle and Julian allowed his passion to get in the way of his intellect.

Albion on 2011-03-16 at 14:43 said:

Evola's objection to materialistic origins repeats almost verbatim Oswald Spengler's objection to Darwin, which he characterized as essentially "English" (by which I believe he meant materialistic). Likewise, Aristotle compares unfavorably in his book to Plato. The fundamental point seems to be that the origin of freedom lies in the invisible realm, and not the other way around. The material world can never superimpose itself in a one-to-one relationship, or else it would destroy that more real kingdom. This is a very helpful post, Cologero; it sheds a lot of light on why Rome collapsed.

Albion on 2011-03-16 at 16:09 said:

Evola was working backwards, and so (in a sense) was Julian. Certainly, the gods do not look to us as they did to our ancestors. Nevertheless, they can remain real, more real perhaps, and differently real than before. Whatever Julian thought, Evola was most likely right to eschew

some kind of fundamentalist re-paganizing worldview. St. Ambrose of Milan wrote, concerning Rome, “it is no shame to pass on to better things”. Yet this could also be applied to “Christianity”. It is always from the higher perspective that such superimposition is possible. I think this is what Evola was driving at.

Graham on 2011-03-16 at 16:27 said:

The criticism of Julian is only over the policy of setting pagans and Christians against each other, when under Constantine they had been synthesizing. Perhaps history affords a symbolic judgement of his efforts, in the division of the two ‘halves’ (geographical and spiritual) of the Empire, and their subsequent fates.

Graham on 2011-03-16 at 16:50 said:

Albion,

The unconditioned influence of ‘genius’ or ‘daimon’ would seem to be somewhat beyond Spengler’s purview. For Evola, the origin is always potentially present; not so for Spengler, which explains his fatalism. This is a key difference between him and Tradition, which should be emphasized for the sake of understanding the latter.

John Bardis on 2011-03-18 at 05:52 said:

As to “believing” in the gods, an interesting book might be Jean Richer’s *Sacred Geography of the Ancient Greeks* (1967, ET 1994). From the back cover:

“Richer found Plato’s ideal city repeated around the most important oracular centers on ancient Greece. He shows how Plato’s description was a later codification of a much earlier practice of dividing geography into twelve regions under the patronage of the gods of the zodiac. Several such twelve-part divisions of the Greek Territories are presented here.”

The center, of course, was the place of philosophy and monotheism.

As to the idea that each nation has its own angel—that comes from the Old Testament. Also note the matter of twelve tribes.

Another book that might be relevant is Anthony Damiani’s *Astronoesis* (2000). This brings astrology into Plotinus’ system. In other words, the twelve signs, but especially the “odd” movements of the planets, explain the transition from the One to the many.

John Bardis on 2011-03-18 at 12:26 said:

That reminds me of Hegel’s view of the Monarch, here described by Zizek:

“Let us recall how the King—this exemplar of point de capiton, this individual who ‘quilts’ the social edifice—was conceptualized by Hegel: the King is undoubtedly the point of the ‘suture’ of social totality, the point whose intervention transforms a contingent collection of individuals into a rational totality—yet precisely as such, as the point which ‘sutures’ Nature and Culture, as

the point at which a cultural-symbolic function (that of being a king) immediately coincides with a natural determination (who will be king is determined by nature, by biological lineage), the King radically 'desutures' all other subjects; makes them lose their roots in some preordained organic social body that would fix their place in society in advance and forces them to acquire their social status by means of hard labour. It is therefore not sufficient to define the King as the only immediate junction of Nature and Culture—the point is rather that this very gesture by means of which the King is posited as their 'suture' de-sutures all other subjects, makes them lose their footing; throws them into a void where they must, so to speak, create themselves."

Cologero on 2011-03-19 at 00:50 said:

Interesting, since Evola was quite familiar with Hegel, though he never accepted Hegel's conception of a determinate unfolding of consciousness in history. However, I think I'm missing Zizek's point: this first part makes sense, but who are "all other subjects"? Are they outsiders who don't fit into the rational totality? Is the point that with Julian, suddenly the Christians were "desutured" from the Empire?

John Bardis on 2011-03-19 at 09:21 said:

Actually a King and an Emperor are two different things.

In Hegel's political philosophy he describes a very modern conception of the state. The one odd thing about it, though, for an American at least, is that he reserves a place in the modern state for a king. So the position of king would be the only hereditary office that he knew about. So the king is what he is by nature. Everyone else in the state has to become whatever it is he or she will become.

Like most Germans of that time, for Hegel ancient Greece was the ideal. It was an _immediate_ concrete universal. The Roman empire was an abstract universal. The modern state is a _mediated_ concrete universal.

So a king gives the people of a given state its identity. But an emperor destroys the identity of all the various people in the empire.

So, then, Hegel's view is _very_ different from that of the Traditionalists. He was very much opposed to the Romantic thinkers of his time who glorified India and the Catholic Church.

So, really, it isn't particularly appropriate to bring Hegel into things here. But on this one point, he seems to have been the last of the modern Western thinkers who had any appreciation at all, even if only very slightly, for a hereditary office.

12.4 Universality and the Heroic Life

Between 1931 and 1943 Julius Evola published 135 articles in the journal *La Vita Italiana*. What follows is the conclusion to “*Universalità imperiale e particolarismo nazionalistico*” from the April 1931 issue, in which Evola contrasts the Universality of the Empire to the particularity of the nation. In a few short paragraphs, he brings in the expected themes of caste, spirit, the ascetic life, the heroic life, fate, and so on.

Universality as knowledge and universality as action: the two bases of every imperial age. Knowledge is universal when it reaches the point of giving us the meaning of things, in the face of that greatness and eternity, everything that is *pathos* and the fads of men vanishes: when it leads us into the primordial, the cosmic, into that which in the field of the spirit has the same characteristics of the purity and power of the oceans, the deserts, the ice fields. Every true universal tradition carried in itself this breath of vastness, animating disinterested forms of activity by it, arousing the sensibility for values that do not let themselves be measured by any criterion of utility and passion, whether individual or collective; introducing to the “living” a “more than living”. This is the type of an invisible empire that history shows us in the examples of Brahmanic India, the Catholic Middle Ages, even of Hellenism: a homogeneous culture that rules every politically and economically conditioned reality, from the inside in a range independent of the people or city.

But we can think of a concept of empire, visible as well as invisible, having a both a material and a spiritual unity. We understand a similar empire when along with universality as knowledge, we also have *universality as action*. Here as historical references, we can mention ancient China, Rome (in part), and once again the Middle Ages in the movements of the Crusades on the one hand and Islam on the other.

Universalizing action is pure action: it is **heroism**. So in the two con-

ditions of imperialism we again find exactly the qualities that defined the two higher castes of antiquity, the sapiential caste (which is not necessarily the sacerdotal) and the warrior caste. We immediately point out that the concept of "heroism" here described is not that of the moderns. In the traditional concept, heroism is an asceticism in the strictest meaning of the word, and the hero is a nature so purified from the "human" elements, as far as he is the ascetic: he participates in the same character of purity as the great forces of circumstances, and has little to do with the passionality, sentimentality, and various movements of men, whether ideal or material, individual or collective.

The specific functions of each one of the ancient castes expressed its proper nature, the way of being of those who belonged to it: so war to the warrior was valued as his purpose, as the life for his own spiritual realization. He fought therefore in a "pure" way, war in itself was a good, and heroism was a "pure", hence universal, form, of activity. The rhetoric of the "battle for rights", "territorial claims", sentimental or humanitarian pretexts, and so on, are modern things in everything and for everyone, totally alien to the traditional concept of heroism. In the *Bhagavad Gita*, in the *Koran*, in the Latin concept of the *mors triumphalis*, in the Hellenic assimilation of the hero at the beginning of the city, in the Nordic symbol of Valhalla, opened up only for the heroes, in certain aspects of the "holy war" known even by Catholic feudalism: we find, formulated in various ways, the transcendent idea, both supernatural and super-human, of heroism. Heroism here is a method of virile asceticism, of the conquering of one's lower nature, a life of immortality and in relationship with the eternal. Transfigured in a similar atmosphere, action gains a universal nature: it becomes almost a force from above, also capable of transposing the universality of a tradition of the spirit into a earthly body: it is the condition of the empire, in its highest meaning.

Are these exhumations of ancient ideals anachronistic and vain? They can also be so. But then this means only that current conditions are such

to reduce the evocation of ideals and symbols, that today have lost their original meaning, to an empty rhetoric in which many indulge.

This does not block anything in the doctrinal sense. One can and must always trace a line of demarcation between concept and concept and to take care not to allow in a contradiction. When the points of reference are “national pride”, the “irredentistic demand”, the “necessity for expansion”, etc., one is in the legitimate principles of a strongly modern nation, but one is certainly not in that of the empire. One wonders if a Roman had ever fought for any similar reason, and if he had ever needed to get motivated by such passional rhetoric to accomplish the miracle of that worldwide conquest, through which the universality of the luminous Greco-Roman civilization was spread to distant parts of the earth.

It is necessary to go back to the state of pure force, of force that comes with the same fatality and the same purity and the same inhumanity of the great forces of circumstances. The great conquerors always felt almost like **sons of fate**, carriers of a force that had to be realized and to which, starting from their own person, their own pleasure, their own tranquility, all of which had to be subdued and sacrificed. In its integral meaning, the empire is something higher, transcendent: the *Sacrum Imperium* Holy Empire . How can we then associate the myth of the empire to this or that idealism or traditionalism (in a narrow sense) or sentimentalism or utilitarianism? How to connect it to the needs of a faction or nation, not to also mention a district, village, or country? Nevertheless, among the moderns it is all too frequently the case that it ends up in similar absurdities.

Whoever recalls the imperial symbols, which is the land that gave life to his body, must be capable of seeing all that. It is necessary that he knows what the “nation” is and what the “empire” is: which is the limit of one thing and that of the other. It is necessary that the mind be opened up to that which in man neither begins nor ends in man: that he understands, as the culmination of the most intense individuality, universality, both

as knowledge and as action. And above all it is necessary that having the sense of the measure to which today everything is unnaturally reduced, he knows that there is all one world to which to say “no” before the auroral brightness of a possible European imperial era beyond the world of slaves and merchants.

Posted on 2011-08-10 by Aeneas

* * *

logres on 2011-08-12 at 21:45 said:

“... which does not begin nor end with man...”

Christianity has forgotten that the Father is archetypal and hence beyond our current form, and that our destiny is not to be merely man, but to pass to another state. How shameful it is to have to be reminded of this from a “pagan” – but how instructive!

12.5 We Antimoderns

In 1930, **Julius Evola** launched the periodical *La Torre* which was subsequently shut down by the Fascist government of Italy. This was just after the publication of the Italian edition of *Pagan Imperialism*, but before Revolt against the modern World. This essay, *Noi Antimoderni*⁹ is from the inaugural issue. While there is nothing unexpected here, it sets the scene for his subsequent works. The translation will appear in two parts.

Commentaries are featured with small letter.

In many ways today, a dark threat, understood in an always more precise sense, looms over the entire civilization of the West. In the crisis, without insisting on this or that special form, but rather on the structure

⁹<http://www.juliusevola.it/documenti/template.asp?cod=527>

of the entire modern world, it seems to foretell the symptoms of the end of a world, the decline of a culture.

While **Rene Guenon**, analyzes the imbalance and discomfort characteristic of this era, he, in fact, shows how its characteristics are precisely those of the Dark or Iron Age, foretold by ancient traditions.

There are two important points to keep in mind:

1. The so-called crisis is entwined in the very structure of the modern world. It is not a question of fixing a limited problem, winning an election, or purging the West of some group or form of thought.
2. Its characteristics can be known in advance by those who understand cosmic cycles. Everything that happens does so for a reason, by following certain principles, or rather, by the denial and neglect of real principles.

Spengler indicates how today there is in existence a fatally inflexible law, for which, like any organism, each civilization, after its rise and prospering, its fall and its petrification into a lifeless barbaric grandeur follow.

After **Netzsche**, **Keyserling**, **Kalergi** indict the immoralism and the irrationalism of the European soul, while **Benda** notes the treason of the intellectuals, the enslavement of the classes that were the legacy of a spiritual tradition, due to passion and political hatred.

In fact, ancient certitudes totter everywhere, principles are uncertain everywhere, traditions are lost, spirits are divided, and dark, uncontrollable, and irrational forces impel and overwhelm men and society, playing with them through ideas, interests and passions that they delude themselves into pursuing.

Haven't we had enough kvetching and jeremiads? We know things are awry, so what is the point of indulging in criticisms of this injustice or that stupid policy? There is a time for righteous anger

and a time for sober reflection. Pace this critique, there must be men who stand above them.

- They know the ancient certitudes.
- They are certain about their principles.
- They seek to recover their traditions.
- Their spirits are unified in solidarity each other and continuity with their ancestors.
- They are aware of the dark and chaotic forces within themselves and learn to master them.

Those who insist on simple or one-dimensional answers will get lost here.

That civilization, of which the Modern man was so proud, and in the name of which he believed the *myth of progress* and had marched to the conquest of the world, that civilization is now faced with a *reductio ad absurdum*, and with a reversal of the values which it had claimed for itself.

Having thrown itself into the conquest of matter, it served its purpose only at the cost of materializing the spirit, of excluding any higher form of life, of amalgamating individuals in the tyranny of collective bodies, we would almost say *subhumans* in their lack of face, rationality, and light, in their subjection to energies that from time to time, as though galvanizing with a temporary life fearful of dead or automated bodies. It hurls them against each other.

The Christian attempt to give the West a religious tradition can only be considered a failure. Nostalgia, as shown in spirits like **Maritain**, **Guenon**, or **Berdyayev**, turn to the feudal and Catholic Middle Ages, putting aside perhaps the insurmountable distance between then and now, when Europe really had begun to organize itself under the two great symbols of Action and Contemplation. What does it matter that Christianity (without realizing it) served as a vehicle for the transmission of a Transcendent

Wisdom, *prior to every age*, and that the Church in its Rites, Symbols and Dogma conserved its deposit, if for some time now, there has been no consciousness corresponding to it?

Evola's criticism is misguided here. There is no question of returning to the material conditions of a bygone age, but rather of recovering its essence. Maritain became infected with modernist ideas. Berdyaev, although not a Traditionalist per se, was nevertheless a man of Tradition. He called for a new Middle Ages. Guenon had a deeper understanding of Tradition and was beyond certain prejudices, as he adhered to a strict intellectuality.

It matters quite a bit if Christendom was the bearer of a Transcendent Wisdom. At the very least, it provides us with an understanding of Tradition that is "close to home" in space and time. The exercise of extracting the Traditional elements from the thought, rites, symbols, and dogmas is very valuable and less prone to misunderstanding than the abstract study of Asian traditions. Conversely, we are dubious about the claim of any man to be a Traditionalist if he cannot recognize Tradition in those elements.

We agree that for quite some time, there has been no consciousness of such a Tradition in the visible representatives of Christianity today. *A fortiori*, the Middle Ages are an embarrassment to them, and the pagan and Traditional elements in it were explicitly rejected by the Reformation. Hence, those of a nostalgic bent are disappointed and are forced to hold many mental reservations.

However, Evola's assertion that the Middle Ages were *never* conscious of the Traditional element is simply absurd. A Tradition, by its very nature, requires a conscious elite to maintain it, and when that is lost, the Tradition is lost. It cannot run mechanically or automatically. Thus, Guenon's explanation that Christianity was originally an esoteric movement makes more sense. He

points to *The Divine Comedy* as an initiatory poem, as well as other writings from the period. This is not to defend Christianity, but rather the notion of Tradition itself, as well as the intelligence and integrity of our European ancestors.

Christianity today is no longer of value to people than as a small faith and morality that everyone professes and everyone betrays; it is mediocre and bourgeois in Catholicism, weakened and stimulating practical achievements in the social rigour in Protestantism? It is only this regard that those who speak of *Tradition* and of the *Return to Tradition*, in fact, know even less of those who deny what Tradition is.

Here Evola goes for the low lying fruit, repeating what has been said by others ad nauseum. At least he only takes a paragraph to do so. What is the value of criticizing the worst elements rather than the appreciating the best? In Ancient Greece and Rome, the bulk of the population consisted of serfs, slaves, and outcasts. Does he judge paganism by their superstitions or by the few priest-kings and warriors? Always remember there are different castes and types of men, who embody a Tradition to a greater or lesser degree. We should always look to the greatest exponents.

Henri Massis, who brought up the symbol of the Defence of the West and raised the alarm against the asianization of the Latin world, in reality, does not know what the East is nor what could be of value in the West as a principle of reintegration. He does not know how much of what he denies is in what he affirms, nor how much of what he affirms is in what he denies. We then are silent about everything that for some time we proclaimed concerning traditions and traditionalism, whether on this or that basis, those who exalting a Vatican Rome, others a Masonic Rome, or a Mazzinian and Giobertian Rome, who, raising strange taboos to the right and the left, launching attacks in the void, preparing with wordiness and the most implausible mess. Here, as elsewhere, the confusion of

tongues is complete; the power of diagrams, formulas, and words, that, as entities created by Magic, no longer depending on those who created them, is almost without limit.

Neither is sufficient. An amorphous need to escape to the Ahrimanic embrace of materialism, no longer meeting those supports that were given by the surviving traditions only on the assumption of interior and living relationships, has created an even more dangerous perversion in the unbalanced Western soul: *neo-spiritualism*.

From the various revivals of a suspect mysticism to the introduction of always more counterfeit exotic doctrines; from the newest spiritualistic superstition to the morbid interest in the problems and complications of the unconscious and psychoanalysis; from Intuitionism and Surrealism to the various messianic forms and to pseudo-religious and pseudo-occultists of the 1700s that swarmed at the margins of Protestantism; from humanitarian and universalistic ideologies to those of a **Religion of Life** and a **Superman** who, strange to say, almost always ends in associations of women and sub-men: from all of these forms a common meaning is revealed.

It is the unraveling of the European soul, it is its self-release, its escape.

Diverted by an insane drive for liberation, it evades the real, not for a super-real, but rather for a sub-real and a pre-real in which the sense of individuality is dissolved, and a cloudy, ecstatic coalescence with sub-human forces abolishes the law of pure action and clear vision.

With the void left by the loss of the Tradition in the Middle Ages, many false and counterfeit traditions rush in. No point to belabour them ... you see them as counterfeits or not. The reference to Ahriman is interesting, the result of his time with the Anthroposophists in the Ur and Krur groups.

As we would expect he opposes the path of ecstasy in favour of **pure action** and **clear vision**. The former follows the latter, lest we forget.

As little as that against which it reacts, such a spiritualism therefore constitutes a principle: it is not a sign of rebirth, but is instead — like that which already Asianized the Greco-Roman world in the Alexandrian period, and to which it so strangely resembles — a symptom of decline, an expression of rejection and resistance in the universal turmoil.

Evola later dedicated a book to this topic, *Mask and Face of Contemporary Spiritualism*, which included critiques of Theosophy, Anthroposophy, Psychoanalysis, and several other neo-spiritual movements. Here, he compares them to the various spiritual imports from Persia and India, following Alexander's conquests. Nevertheless, Evola seems to have later excluded other Asian influences such as Mithraism, early Buddhism, Taoism, Tantra, *et al.* However, while he never advocated incorporating their cultural artifacts along with their metaphysical teachings. Contrast that with some contemporary neo-Traditionalists.

Hence, sad omens loom over the Western world: since it is not a question of a circumstance of recent times, but rather the logical conclusion of the very principles on which this civilization has developed. In America — which is the most formidable of the newest barbarisms — is there perhaps not found the endpoint of the industrial course initiated by European Civilization?

And in Bolshevism, which in a certain way constitutes a different form of the identical danger — does it not reveal perhaps the law in the materialistic social mask of that mysticism of community that, through the Christian subversion, swept away the individual, hierarchical, and imperial values of the Greco-Roman world?

This is old news by now, especially as Bolshevism as such is no longer a threat to Europe. Perhaps in his day, there seemed a viable Third Way, but is of little significance now. Even the opposition between capitalism and liberalism is a mirage, since they not just

co-exist, but are actually in a symbiotic relationship, despite some rumblings from the left fringe and even less consequential clamoring on the various claimants to the real Right. The reference to the Christian subversion is unfortunate here, for several reasons.

1. First of all, he claims to be relying on principles rather than contingent events, a promise he breaks here.
2. Secondly, it is misleading. Many assume that casting off Christianity will suffice to solve the problem. Yet, as Europe becomes more and more de-Christianized, the problem worsens. Rather than unveiling the “inner pagan” in the European soul, it has brought about a spiritual vacuum filled by materialism, hedonism, or neo-spiritualism.
3. It is historically untrue. The Greco part of the world continued its hierarchical and imperial values for another millennium. The Roman part managed to recover it and maintained it in one form or another for a thousand years. Rome was already in decline; a spiritually strong people don’t go looking for novelty. The degeneration of castes had already occurred in the city-states. Rome was forced to make concessions to the mass of Plebes around the city. This suffices for now.

All this tells us how little there is to hope about the efficacy of a reaction.

Still one generation — two at most — and every surviving possibility can be choked off, and nothing will stop this great dark mass that already runs down the slope: unless a sudden upheaval, a crisis that radically jolts the foundations of modern civilization comes to reestablish the equilibrium, whether through something, that through the eyes of most men for most of them will be the same as a catastrophe.

Possessing this conviction, what task remains to the few that still resist?

Not a direct action, but that more disconcerting action which can wield the mute and impassive presence of a stone guest. We must break the bridges, and with absolute adherence to primordial meanings and visions, those who will still act before the causes of the current civilization are established, constitute a pole, which, if it will not prevent this world of deviants from being what it is, will impede them, however, from asserting the nonexistence of every other horizon, to glorify itself, to establish by law itself to religion, to think that which is, should be what it is and that is good that it is.

Hence, a fixed point, and from such a point, new relationships, new distances, new consciousnesses; from such consciousnesses, perhaps — in someone — the beginnings of liberating crises.

Well, we are two generations from the publication of Evola's essay. Are all possibilities choked off? Yet, don't we see more interest in Tradition, especially among young men? More translations are available, more commentaries on Eastern metaphysics, and so on. The World Cycle has its own program and is not as impatient as we are.

A catastrophe may occur but is not the only possibility as Guenon pointed out. The task is simple: *absolute adherence to primordial meanings and visions*. Then act as a **stone guest**, a sojourner in the land of the lost, act as the unmoved mover, without attachment to results.

It is natural that many points in this regard be made precise and clarified: we will return to that task in our subsequent articles. Up till now we say that it is not a question of returning, because the reference is primarily to certain principles and certain interests, which, being above time, they have (in the words of Guenon) a permanent relevance.

To be a man **above time**, adhere to principles whose relevancy and applicability are never in doubt.

Having lost the sense of this relevance, having been dissolved in the myth of a pure flowing, of a pure stretching that pushes further and further its very goal of a process increasingly powerless to reach mastery, this is one of the characteristics of the world against which we anti-moderns set ourselves.

Hence, a clean boundary that separates two epochs, not in an historical sense, but rather in an ideal sense: and we might call one the **Traditional**, the other **anti-traditional**.

The first point is that relating to the spirit of the beginning, cancels every difference of the common opposition to the other. Then, we would like especially to mention the symbol closest to us Westerners: the symbol of **action**, restored to its full and traditional significance, of which the equivocal defense of the West of today could have a shapeless premonition.

To be a man **against time**, act on Traditional principles.

But not before the fixed point is established; that the sense of the distance is precise, so that the modality and nature of the processes appears, which sustain and foment the perversion of the European soul.

Posted on 2012-01-30 by Aeneas

* * *

Avery on 2012-01-31 at 01:58 said:

"The so-called crisis is entwined in the very structure of the modern world. It is not a question of fixing a limited problem, winning an election, or purging the West of some group or form of thought... We know things are awry, so what is the point of indulging in criticisms of this injustice or that stupid policy?"

A spot-on point that people know intuitively, and are being taught to forget by the media. Politics is one of the blasts that a culture unleashes into the world, like the corona of the Sun. It is an epiphenomenon and attacking who sits on the throne at the moment, on the basis of

your cultural reaction to him, is the farthest thing from orienting yourself as an actor within your culture at large.

Avery on 2012-01-31 at 02:04 said:

As for Evola's approach to Christendom, he strikes me as the epitome of European alienation. With alienation comes spiritual destruction, so Evola looks for a more ancient and mysterious spirit. His firm resolution to embrace both tradition and Europe without also embracing Christianity is the struggle behind much of his work.

Boreas on 2012-01-31 at 04:43 said:

Well said, Avery. Evola was right and had superior knowledge on many things, but he forgot or did not fully understand – maybe because of his “personal equation” which led to his errors also (manipura again) – the three things Christ brought to the world with the fulfillment of his own Great Work: Unity, Love (ultimate compassion and loving-wisdom) and the embodiment of the Spirit from the highest realms into the deepest recesses of matter.

Recommended reading: Matt. 12, the whole chapter

Cologero on 2012-02-01 at 22:42 said:

“And why should it be that among the greatest mystics only the women, Saint Ignatius Loyola excepted, have been visionaries? Think about Catherine of Siena, Marie of the Incarnation, Mechtilde of Hackborn, Elizabeth of Schoenau, Julian of Norwich and others. For the most part, like oceans or tidal pools, women keep their vital secrets.

Evan S Connell, Points for a Compass Rose

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-02 at 16:26 said:

yes, it is tricky, especially when you don't know someone, hence my checking in about possible upsets (I can be quite blunt, mainly I make myself laugh and not necessarily anyone else!). But regarding that comment I was not actually ‘worried’ but it would be very complicated to convey why I was feeling beyond confirming I was very amused! However I can be a nervous type of person at times – highly strung you might say – so it is not surprising if you wondered if I really WAS worried!!

@Boreas, I went through a heavy metal phase when I was about 13 and shall never, ever return. However, I do think Led Zeppelin are an amazing band, one of the best ever, even though they're a bunch of lefthanders, well Jimmy Page at least. There's an extremely readable biography by Peter Levanda called *Stairway to Heaven*, covering the whole band, which I really enjoyed. Levanda has also written equally gripping books on Hitler's Occult War – *Unholy Alliance*. Other

than Led Zep a bit of Deep Purple is fine, same for ACDC, I'm not entirely writing off the genre, but I really prefer.....D I S C O (the Studio 54 and Paradise Garage kind [D83D?][DE42?]), world music, reggae, house, chillout stuff and things of that ilk. Some people call it 'girly music', although the best DJs are usually men

Point 2 you make I agree is valid in terms of catharsis, but there is also a danger of dark music or whatever invoking dark forces, as is the intention of the artist in many cases. In the same way you hear atonal rap music now, which is truly repulsive in most cases – I can't see this having any kind of good effect on listeners and the same goes for the worst kind of death metal, which can really be very sinister.

Charlotte Cowell on 2012-02-02 at 17:57 said:

Boreas, with respect to something we were talking about on another thread, I read someone post this on facebook that is relevant to the points you were making:

The gospel teaches that Yohanan the Baptist lived in the wilderness and that he ate "locusts and wild honey." According to the Kabbalah, the "locusts" represent admixed and dark forces, and the ability of the prophet to devour and transmute them, and the "wild honey" represents divine forces, and the ability of the prophet to receive and integrate them, and embody them. In the Yeshua Messiah we are also called to this "diet," empowered in the very same spiritual work so long as we live in this wilderness. Peace be with you!

uberman on 2012-02-01 at 19:01 said:

This series is a very welcome, perhaps belated diction and commentary on our historical predicament, penned from the heights. Like a breath of cool air in the encroaching desert, bringing with it a message of steadfastness and hope to an otherwise panic stricken cause.

"If you can force your heart and nerve and sinew

To serve your turn long after they are gone,

And so hold on when there is nothing in you

Except the Will which says to them: 'Hold on!'" – R.K

12.6 Orientations: The Religious Question

The *nature* of man is to be a cognitive, religious and sociable animal. All experience teaches us this; and, to my knowledge, nothing has contradicted this experience.

JOSEPH DE MAISTRE, *Study of Sovereignty*

Evola regarded Joseph de Maistre as standing on the same side of the barricade as himself. And, like Maistre, he does not deny the obvious — man is a cognitive, religious and sociable animal. It is only the characteristics of knowledge, religion, and society that is in question.

In 1950, Evola wrote a short pamphlet, *Orientations*, consisting of eleven fundamental points to guide his young followers who were out to form a new right movement after the collapse of World War II. The eleventh and final point deals with the religious question.

A religious factor is necessary as the background for a true heroic conception of life which must be essential for our battle deployment. It is necessary to feel in oneself the evidence that there is a higher life beyond this terrestrial life because only those who feel that way possess an intangible and inner directed strength, only they will be capable of an absolute impulse — while, when this is lacking, defying death and taking no account of one's own life is possible only in sporadic moments of exaltation or in an outburst of irrational forces: nor is there discipline that can be justified, in the individual, with a higher and self-sufficient significance.

Posted on 2008-08-25 by Cologero

* * *

GF on 2010-05-25 at 19:48 said:

In the Hindu Doctrines, chapter four, Guenon's definition of religion pointedly includes sociability and cognitivity. It is also worth noting that etymologically the word religion has two meanings: that which binds men to men and that which binds men to a higher principle. Clearly the social bond, in its deepest sense, is only possible by means of a shared principle. What's more Guenon says that metaphysical incapacity "brings a strange confusion of thought as its fatal and unquestionable consequence." (58) So it seems that man's cognitive and sociable natures are wrapped up in his religion (in the principled sense).

While on ch. 4, I have to ask: who's evaluation of Rome is more correct, Evola's or Guenon's?

Cologero on 2010-05-26 at 23:27 said:

Do you have something specific about Rome?

Evola would regard Rome from the perspective of Action. Also, the Emperor being both spiritual as well as political leader. He considered the Roman mystery cults to be authentic sources of initiation.

Guenon's perspective is contemplation, and the Roman religion was not as advanced as the Vedanta. Guenon thought the political authority should be under the spiritual authority.

GFJF on 2010-05-29 at 02:20 said:

That answers my question, actually. Should have seen it for myself.

12.7 Orientations

Point 1

Tonight, we are posting the first point of **Julius Evola's** Orientations and will continue for the next ten Sundays.

It is useless to create illusions with the pipe dream of any optimism whatsoever: we find ourselves today at the end of a cycle. Already for centuries, at first unfelt, then with the surge of a mass that caves in, numerous processes in the West have destroyed every normal and legitimate ordering of men, and distorted every higher conception of living, acting, knowing, and struggling. And the impulse of this downfall, its speed and its dizziness, is called "progress." And hymns were sung to "progress" and we were deluded that this civilization is — a civilization of matter and machines — civilization par excellence. The entire history of the world was preordained to it: until the ultimate consequences of this whole process was such as to bring a few to an awakening.

Where, and under what symbols, of those who sought to organize the forces for a possible resistance, is well-known. On the one hand, there

is a nation [Italy] which, from when it became unified, had known only the mediocre climate of liberalism, democracy, and constitutional monarchy — dared take up again the symbol of Rome [the eagle] as the basis for a new political conception and for a new ideal of virility and dignity. Analogous forces were awakened in the nation [Germany] that had made in the Middle Ages the Roman symbol of the Imperium as its own, to reassert the principle of authority and the supremacy of those values that have their root in blood, in race, and in the deepest strength of a people. And while in other European nations some groups were already oriented in the same direction, a third force in the Asian continent [Japan] added itself to the alliance, the nation of samurai, in which the adoption of exterior forms of modern civilization did not compromise the fidelity to a warrior tradition centered on the symbol of the solar Empire of divine right.

We do not pretend that in these currents the distinction between the essential and the incidental is clear cut, that in them it made to the ideas of the opposing party an adequate persuasion and qualification of persons, that there were various outdated influences affected by the same forces that had to be combated. The process of ideological purification would have been able to take place a second time, so that some immediate and non-deferrable political problems were solved. But it was also clear that an alliance of forces was taking form, representing an open challenge to “modern” civilization: both to that of the democracies inherited from the French Revolution and to the other, representing the extreme limit of the degradation of Western man: the collectivistic civilization of the Fourth Estate, the communist civilization of the mass-man without a face.

The rhythms accelerated and the tensions increased ending up in an armed conflict of these forces. What prevailed was the massive power of a coalition that did not back down in the face of the most hybrid of their agreements, and of the most hypocritical of this ideological mobilization

in order to crush the world that was rising up and that intended to assert its right. Whether or not our men were equal to the task, if errors were committed in regard to timeliness, complete preparation, or measure of risk, that is beside the point, that is not something that compromised the inner meaning of the battle that was fought. Likewise, it does not interest us that today history is avenged on the victors, that the democratic powers which, having formed a coalition with the forces of red subversion just to conduct the war up to the senseless extremism of an unconditional surrender and total destruction, today sees come back to roost against the allies of yesterday, a danger more terrible than the one they wished to avoid.

The only thing that counts is this: we find ourselves today in the middle of a world of ruins. And the problem to be posed is: do men still exist on their feet within the middle of these ruins? And what should they do, what else can they still do?

Point 2

The way out of the current situation, according to Evola, will not come from a new political party or platform. Rather, it will require men of a certain character, vision of life, and principles. These are not yet made. Probably, they are still not clear, because after 60 years, there is still no single vision of life among those who oppose the modern world.

Political systems alone are not determinate: the best systems will fail if the population cannot maintain it, while a superior people will succeed despite the system. After 60 years, there should be evidence for this claim. In making this moral argument, Evola goes against the entire modern world which sees the Axis powers he supported as the very embodiment of evil.

Such a problem indeed goes beyond yesterday's alliances, since it is clear that the winners and losers [*vincitori e vinti*] now find each other on

the same level and that the only result of the second world war was the reduction of Europe to the object of extra-European powers and interests. It must be recognized then that the devastation that we have around us is of an especially moral character. We are in a climate of general moral anesthesia, of profound disorientation, in spite of all the words of order in use in a society of consumption and democracy: the breakdown of character and every true dignity, the ideological confusion, the prevalence of the lowest interests, living hand to mouth, are what characterizes, in general, the post-war man. To recognize this, also means to recognize that the first problem, the base of every other, is of an inner nature: To pick oneself up, to rise up interiorly, to give oneself a form, to create in oneself order and rectitude.

No one has learned from the lessons of the recent past if he still fools himself about the possibilities of a purely political battle and about the power of one or the other formula or system, whose new human quality is not made by a specific opposing party. Here is a principle that today more than ever should have absolute evidence: if a State possesses a political or social system that, in theory, is of value as the most perfect, but the human element was deficient, that state would descend sooner or later to the level of the basest societies. However, a people, a race capable of producing true men, men of right feeling and reliable instinct, would reach a high level of civilization and would stand on their feet in the face of the most calamitous tests even if its political system was defective and imperfect. One takes therefore a precise position against that false "political realism" that thinks only in terms of programs, party organizational problems, or social and economic prescriptions. All this belongs to the contingent, not to the essential. The measure of what can still be saved depends upon the existence — or not — of men who are in front not to preach formulas, but to be examples, not going towards demagoguery and the materialism of the masses, but to awaken different forms of sensibility and interests. Starting from what can still remain among the ruins, to reconstruct slowly a new

man to animate through a determinate spirit and a suitable vision of life, to fortify through the tenacious adherence to given principles — this is the true problem.

Point 3

First of all, what is that “legionary spirit” and where is the evidence for it today? That spirit has nothing to do with hot-headedness, emotional outbursts, or partisanship. Rather, it is characterized by an iron will, a sense of order, rationality, mental sobriety, the ability to plan or strategize, loyalty, the adherence to principles.

How does that fit in today, among those who can see in such a spirit only a disease, a mistake, the “authoritarian personality”. Today hedonism is preferred to sobriety, living for the moment instead of strategizing, the lack of discrimination instead of the quest for order, the irrational, the unusual, the absurd instead of rationality. But what idea or principle is there to be loyal to? Even among certain groups that claim to be “radical traditionalists” there is no underlying unity. Rather, they are motivated by the party spirit, i.e., alliances are made based on similarity of immediate goals, but not on the possession of a common mind.

Evola’s vision is far from being realized, even further than when *Orientations* was published. Where do we see the *legionary spirit* “in the factories, in the laboratories, in the universities, in the street”? The “agitators” today wonder why no one will follow them. Isn’t it time to look elsewhere?

Something already exists as spirit that can serve as evidence of the forces of resistance and resurgence: it is the *legionary spirit*. It is the attitude of those who were able to choose the hardest way, who were able to fight even knowing that the battle was materially lost, who were able to confirm the words from the ancient saga: “Loyalty is stronger than fire” and through which the traditional idea was affirmed; that is the meaning of

honor and shame, — not small measures drawn from petty morality — that creates a substantial, existential difference between beings, almost like that between one race and another.

On the other hand, there is the realization typical of those in whom what was the end now appeared as the means, in them the recognition of the illusory character of multiple myths while leaving untouched those who were able to achieve *for themselves*, on the borderline between life and death, beyond the world of contingency.

These forms of the spirit can be the base of a new unity. The essential thing is to adopt them, to apply them, and to extend them from the time of war to the time of peace, of this peace especially, that is only a setback and a poorly kept down disorder—to those who bring about distinctions and a new alignment. That must happen in rather more essential terms than what is a “party”, which can only be a contingent instrument in sight of given political battles; in terms more essential than even as a simple “movement”, if by “movement” is meant only a phenomenon of the masses and aggregation, a quantitative phenomenon more than qualitative, based more on emotive factors than on strict, clear adherence to an idea.

It is instead a silent revolution proceeding in the depths, that must be propitiated, to those who are, it first creates on the inside and in the individual the premises of that order that then will have to also be asserted on the outside, supplanting as quick as lightning at the right moment the forms and forces of a world of subversion. The “style” that must gain emphasis is that of whoever holds onto positions in faithfulness to himself and to an idea, in a collected intensity, in a repulsion for every compromise, in a total engagement that must be manifested not only in the political battle, but also in every expression of existence: in the factories, in the laboratories, in the universities, in the street, in the very personal life of the affected. One must reach the point that the type of which we speak, and who must be the cellular substance of our alliance,

is well recognizable, unmistakable, differentiated, and one can say: "He is one who acts like a man of the movement."

This must today be recovered, which was already the guarantee of the forces that yearned for a new order for Europe but which in its realization often was impeded and diverted by multiple factors. And today, fundamentally, the conditions are better, because misunderstandings do not exist and it suffices to look around, from the streets to the Parliament, because the callings are put to the test and one has, clearly, the measure of what we must *not* be. Facing a world of mush whose principle is: "Who makes you do it", or: "First comes the stomach, the skin (the *Malapartian Skin*!¹⁰), and then morality", or again: "These are not times in which we can be permitted the luxury of having a character", or finally: "I have a family". One is able to oppose clarity and service to them: "We cannot do otherwise, this is our life, this is our being". Whatever is positive will be able to be reached today or tomorrow. It will not be through the abilities of agitators and politicians, but rather through the natural prestige and the recognition of men whether of yesterday, or, and even more, of the new generation, that so many are capable and in that give the guarantee for their idea.

Point 4

Here a new vision is put before our eyes. The regression of castes must be walked back up, but in today's undifferentiated world, one's caste is unclear. New spirits will awaken, but not from the expected places. This has nothing to do with economic classes. It is a revolt against the conformity of the bourgeois world, but from superior values, not the lower values of the mass man.

This awakening spirit comes from the inside and cannot be identified with an external movements. Thus all attempts to identify

¹⁰<http://www.britannica.com/EBchecked/topic/359524/Curzio-Malaparte>

such spirits based on adherence to some political ideology or religious form will be far off the mark. Yet, these spirits will recognize each other and form natural hierarchic structures. It is not a "big tent" or equals, or debaters in endless conversation. Hence, counter-traditional movements that try to include anarchists or the abnormal cannot be part of this.

Sentimentality has no part of this, despite those who tell me I should "like" this person or web site, etc. But "liking" is not the issue. This sentimentality is opposed to "impersonality", the idea that it is "strictly business, nothing personal"; this attitude comes apparently from a deep part of Evola and its source is not the Nordic soul.

The text follows.

Therefore, a new substance must clear the way in slow advance beyond the squares, the classes, and social positions of the past. It is necessary to keep a new pattern right in front of your eyes, in order to measure your own strength and calling. It is important and fundamental to recognize exactly that this pattern has nothing to do with classes as economic categories, and the antagonisms related to them. It could manifest itself in the clothing of the rich as well as the poor, of the worker as well as the aristocrat, of the businessman as well as the explorer, of the technician, theologian, farmer, or the politician in the strict sense. But this new substance will know an internal differentiation, which will be perfect when, again, there will be no doubt about the vocations and functions of followers and commanders, when a restored symbol of unshaken authority will tower over the center of new hierarchic structures.

That defines a direction that is as anti-bourgeois as anti-proletarian, a direction totally devoid of democratic contaminations and "social" foibles, because leading toward a clear, virile, articulated world, made by men and leaders of men. Disdain for the bourgeois myth of "security", for the petty standardized, conformist, domesticated, and "moralized" life.

Disdain for the anodyne bond characteristic of every collectivistic and mechanistic system and of all ideologies that grant to confused “social” values primacy over those heroic and spiritual values by which we have to define, in every domain, the type of true man, of the absolute person.

And something essential will be attained when the love for a style of active impersonality is revived, for which that which counts is the work and not the individual, for which a man is not capable of considering himself as something of importance, importance being instead his function, his responsibility, the task he adopts, the goal he pursues. Where this spirit asserts itself, many problems of the economic and social order will be simplified, which would otherwise remain insoluble if confronted from the outside, without the counter party of a change of spiritual factors and without the elimination of infectious ideologies that already in part prejudice every return to normality, as well as the perception itself of what normality means.

Point 5

Although the Cold War between the USSR and USA is over, this makes Evola’s insights in this point all the more prescient. As long as communism and the Soviet Union were perceived as external enemies, the USA could sustain internally a certain amount of reaction and conservatism to define itself as the opposite of the USSR. However, once the wall came down, the right in the USA became irrelevant, so that progressive forces could continue unchecked, no longer subject to the charge of being pro-marxist and treasonous.

Evola was not deceived and recognized that the various movements, ostensibly in opposition, were in fact different degrees of the same frame of mind. The imagery he uses of the dusk and poison are beautifully written. Little else has changed in 60 years, since the trends he abhors are still considered to be “progress”, and

the West is in a constant state of "waiting" ... waiting for the culmination of this "progress" in the indefinite future in who knows what form. Since the "real" world only exists in the future, the past, and Tradition, are thereby disvalued. Evola may be placing too much blame on the USA, for Europe herself has been equally complicit, if not even leading the way. He is correct, though, in a significant point: the battle has been lost without even a shot being fired.

Not only as a doctrinal orientation, but also in regard to the world of action, it is then important for men of the new arrangement to recognize correctly the concatenation of causes and effects and the essential continuity of the trend that has given life to the various political forms in play today in the chaos of parties. Liberalism, then democracy, then socialism, then radicalism, finally communism and Bolshevism have historically appeared only as degrees of the same evil, as stages that prepare each one that follows in the complex of a process of decline. And the beginning of this process stands at the point at which Western man broke his ties to tradition, denying every higher symbol of authority and sovereignty; he claimed for himself as an individual a vain and illusory freedom; he becomes an atom rather than a conscious part of the organic unity and hierarchy of a whole. And the atom, in the end, had to find, opposed to himself, the mass of other atoms, other individuals, and to be involved in the emergence of the reign of quantity, of the pure number, of the materialized masses and not having another God outside of the sovereign economy.

This process does not stop here halfway. Without the French Revolution and liberalism, there would not have been constitutionalism and democracy, without democracy, there would not have been socialism and demagogic nationalism, without the preparation of socialism there would not have been radicalism and finally communism. The fact that these various forms today often represent, one alongside the other or in

opposition, must not prevent the recognition, to an eye that truly sees, that they hold themselves together, they link to each other, mutually condition each other and express only the different degrees of the same trend, the same subversion of every normal and legitimate social order.

So the great illusion of our time is that democracy and liberalism are the antitheses of communism and have the power to stem the tide of the forces from below, of what in the jargon of the syndicates are called the "progressive" movement. Illusions: like those who say that the dusk is the opposite of the night, that the incipient degree of an evil is the antithesis of the acute and endemic form of it, that a diluted poison is the antidote of the same poison in its pure and concentrated state. The men in the government of this "liberated" Italy have learned nothing from recent history whose lessons were repeated everywhere to the point of monotony, and continue their pitiful game with out-of-date political conceptions and hands in the parliamentary carnival, almost a dance macabre on a simmering volcano.

But for *us* there must instead be the courage of radicalism, the "no" said to political decadence in all its forms, both of the left and of a presumed right. And, above all, we must be aware of that which he does not share with subversion, and that making concessions today means condemning oneself to be totally overwhelmed tomorrow. The rigour of the idea, therefore, and readiness to push ahead by pure force when the right moment is reached.

That naturally also implies the disengagement from ideological distortions, unfortunately popular even in a part of the youth, because of which they indulge in excuses for the destruction that has already happened, deluding themselves by thinking that they, after all, were necessary and served "progress"; they think that it must be combated for anything "new", put off into a determined future, rather than for the truth that we already possess because they, although in various forms of application, always and everywhere made from the base of every right type of social

and political organization.

These foibles must be rejected. And we come back to those who are accused of being "anti-historical" and "reactionary". History does not exist, a mysterious entity spelled with a capital H. They are the men, if even they are *really* men, who make and unmake history; so called "historicism" is more or less the same thing as what is called "progressivism" in leftist circles and it wants a single thing today: to foment passivity in respect to the trend that swells and always leads lower. And, as to "reactionism", you ask: You would therefore prefer that while you act, destroying and profaning, we do not "react", but stay to look so that they say to you: bravo!, continue? We are not "reactionary" only because the word is not strong enough especially because we start from the positive, we represent the positive, real and original values, the light of some "sun of the future" is not necessary.

In the face of our radicalism, in particular, the antithesis between the red "East" and the democratic "West" appears irrelevant, yet a possible armed conflict between these two blocks appears to us also tragically irrelevant. To look only at the immediate, the choice of the lesser evil certainly remains because the military victory of the "East" would imply the immediate physical destruction of the last exponents of resistance. But at the base of the idea, Russia and North America are to be considered as two prongs of the same pincer because they squeeze themselves permanently around Europe. In two different but converging forms, the same foreign and hostile force acts in them. The forms of standardization, conformism, democratic leveling, frenetic productivity, a more or less domineering and explicit "brain trust", and piecemeal materialism in Americanism can only serve to pave the road for the last phase that is represented, along the same direction, by the communist ideal of the mass-man.

The distinctive character of Americanism is that the attack against quality and personality is not put into effect by the brute force of a Marx-

ist dictator and the mind of the State, but it happens almost spontaneously, by the ways of a civilization ignorant of ideals higher than wealth, consumption, productivity, production without brakes. Therefore, through a worsening and a reduction to the absurd of what Europe herself chose, the same patterns have taken, or are taking, form there. But primitivism, mechanism, and brutality remain so much more on one side than the other. In a certain sense, Americanism is more dangerous for us than communism, because it is a type of Trojan horse. When the attack against the residual values of European tradition is effectuated in the direct and naked forms characteristic of Bolshevik ideology or Stalinism, some reactions still reawaken, certain lines of resistance, even if ephemeral, can be maintained. Things are different when the same evil acts in a more subtle way and the transformations take place on the plane of the general customs and visions of life, as is the case for Americanism. Enduring this influence with a light heart in the name of democracy, Europe is already predisposed for the final abdication, so that it could even happen without even the need for a military disaster, but it will arrive, through “progressive” path, after a final social crisis, at more or less at the same point. Again, it doesn’t stop here halfway. Americanism, willing it or not, works for its apparent enemy, for collectivism.

Point 6

There are several important issues brought in Point 6. That these are in dispute today is incredible, if, in fact, they are even noticed. Perhaps the professional politicians do know it, but are coy enough not to mention them publicly.

- The first is the reduction of the political to the economical. This is even more pronounced in the USA elections, where the economy is supposed to outweigh every other issue. The net effect of this is that, because they are left out

of the political discussion, lower political and social forces can continue unchecked.

- The second is that there is no such thing as a “spontaneous” grassroots movement from below. We are led to believe that there are certain important issues and movements then arise to deal with them. The opposite is actually the case; movements fabricate issues to gain power and achieve their own ends.
- The false ideal of “social justice” is still used to this day for political gain. It is quite effective, except for those who expect “justice”.
- On a positive note, Evola proposes, as always, a hierarchical arrangement based on high and heroic ideals. To replace the parliamentary system of professional politicians, he proposes a form of corporativism. This is not, as often believe, the rule by corporations as understood in the West, particularly the USA. Rather, it refers to the representation of the various business sectors, e.g., health, energy, etc., by workers as well as owners. They would bring expertise in their fields to the political and spiritual hierarchy, unlike democratic politicians who typically have no expertise. Contra this, one could complain that these are “special interests” who already have too much influence. However, now it is done in secret, behind closed doors. That would not be the case in a corporative system which actually has a more balanced and diverse representation than current Western deliberative bodies. Furthermore, in such a system, economic factors alone would not have dominance.

Not without relation to that, our radicalism of the reconstruction requires that we do not compromise not only with every variety of Marxist or socialist ideology, but also with what in general can be called the *hallucination* or the *demon of the economy*. Here it is a question of the idea

that in both individual and collective life, the economic factor is the important, real, and decisive one; that the concentration of every value and interest on the economic and productive plane is not the unprecedented aberration of modern Western man, but rather something normal, not a possible brute necessity, but something that must be desired and exalted. Both capitalism and marxism remain enclosed in this dark circle. We must break through this circle. As long as we know how to speak only of economic classes, work, salary, production, as long as we delude ourselves that true human progress and the true elevation of the individual are conditioned by a particular system of distribution of wealth and goods and have therefore something to do with indigence or affluence, with the state of USA *prosperity*, or with that of utopian socialism, we always remain on the same level of what must be combated. This we must affirm: everything that is economy and economic interest as mere satisfaction of physical needs had, has, and always will have a subordinated function in normal humanity; that beyond this sphere an order of higher, political, spiritual and heroic values must be differentiated, an order that—as we already said—does not know and not even admits, proletarian or capitalists, and only depends on what things must be defined as worth living and dying for. A true hierarchy must be established, new dignities must be differentiated and, at the top, a higher function of command, of the *imperium* must dominate.

Thus, in such regards, many evil herbs that have taken root here and there are eradicated, sometimes even in our camp. What is, in fact, this talk of “State of work”, of “national socialism”, of “humanism of work” and similar ideas? What are these more or less stated requests for a regression of politics into the economy, almost as a resumption of those problematic tendencies toward an integral and, fundamentally, headless, corporatism that fortunately already found the way blocked in fascism? What is this consideration of the formula of “socialization” as a type of universal drug and this elevation of the “social idea” to the symbol of a new civilization

that, who knows how, should be beyond both "East" and "West"?

These—it is necessary to recognize this—are the sides of a shadow present in not a few spirits, who only, for other reasons, find themselves on the same side as us. With that they think they are faithful to a revolutionary order, while they obey only stronger suggestions of them with which a degraded political environment is saturated. And among such suggestions the same "social question" returns. When will they finally take into account the truth, i.e., that Marxism did not arise because a real social question existed, but the social question rises—in endless cases—only because Marxism exists, that is to say, artificially, and yet in almost always insoluble terms, to the work of agitators, to the famous "awakeners of class consciousness", on which Lenin expressed himself very clearly, when he refuted the spontaneous character of proletarian revolutionary movements?

It is starting from this premise that it would be necessary to act, in the first and foremost meaning of ideological anti-proletarianization, as the disinfection of the still healthy parts of the people from the socialist virus. Only then will the one or the other reform be able to be studied and actuated without danger, in compliance with true justice.

So, as the particular case, we will see, according to that spirit, the corporative idea can be again one of the bases of the reconstruction: corporativism not so much as a general system of state and almost bureaucratic composition that maintain the deleterious idea of opposed political arrangements of class systems, but rather as the need that in the very interior of the business that unity, that solidarity of differentiated forces be reconstructed, that the capitalist lie (with the subversive parasitic type of the speculator and the finance-capitalist) on one side, the Marxist agitation on the other, have jeopardized and shattered. It is necessary to bring the business to the form of an almost military unity, in which they compare the solidarity and the fidelity of associated working forces around it in the common enterprise to the spirit of responsibility, to the energy and

the competence of the directors. The only true task is, however, the *organic reconstruction of the business*, and to realize it is not necessary to use formulas intended to adulate, for base propagandistic and electoral ends, the spirit of sedition of the strata inferior to the masses disguised as “social justice”. In general, the same style of active impersonality, dignity, solidarity in the production that is typical to the ancient professional and artisan corporations should be recovered. Syndicalism, with its “battle” and those genuine threats which it now offers us too many examples, is to be banished. But, let us repeat, much one must reach that point starting from the interior. The important thing is that against every form of resentment and social antagonism everyone knows how to recognize and love his own place, that conforms to his own nature, recognizing thus even the limits between which he can develop his possibilities and follow his own perfection: because an artisan who perfectly discharges his function is undoubtedly superior to a king who is unfit and not at the height of his dignity.

In particular, we can permit a system of expertise and corporative representation, to supplant the parliamentarianism of the parties; but we should keep in mind that the technical hierarchy, in their entirety, can signify nothing more than a level in the integral hierarchy: they concern the order of means, to be subordinated to the order of ends, to which only the properly political and spiritual part of the State corresponds. To speak instead of a “State of workers” or of production is to make the part equivalent to the whole, the same as reducing the human organism to its simply physical and vital functions. Nor can a similar obtuse and dark thing be our emblem, nor the “social” idea itself. The true antithesis facing both the “East” and the “West” is not the “social ideal”. It is instead the *integral hierarchal idea*. In respect to that, nothing uncertain is acceptable.

Point 7

Highlights of point 7:

- The ideal is a virile and organic political unity
- This unity is fundamentally a spiritual unity
- The dignity and freedom of the human person is found in an organic society, not in individualized liberalism
- Evola rejected the Salo Republic because it excluded the Italian monarchy
- The spiritual environment must be created prior to the political and a suitable symbol created

The Carlyle quote is from *Heroes and Hero Worship* and is misquoted in *Men Among the Ruins*. This is the full quote:

The Valet-World has to be governed by the Sham-Hero, by the King merely *dressed* in King-gear.

If the ideal of a virile and organic political unity was an essential part in the world that had to be swept away—and through it, we also brought back the Roman symbol—we must then recognize the cases in which such a need deviated and was almost miscarried in the mistaken direction of *totalitarianism*. This, again, is a point that must be seen with clarity, so that the differentiation of the political fronts is precise and, also, arms are not furnished to those who want to confuse things after due consideration. Hierarchy is not hierarchism (an evil that, unfortunately, today at times tries to come back in minor tones), and the organic conception has nothing to do with a statolatrous sclerosis and a leveling centralization. As for the individual, a true surpassing both of individualism and collectivism happens only when men are face to face with men, in the natural diversity of their being and their dignities. And as for the unity that must prevent, in general, every form of dissociation and absolutization of the particular, it must be essentially spiritual, it must be a central, orienting

influence, an impulse that, depending on the leaders, assumes very differentiated forms of expression. This is the true essence of the "organic" conception, opposed to the rigid and extrinsic relations typical of "totalitarianism". In these fields the requirement of dignity and liberty of the human person that liberalism can conceive only in individualistic, egalitarian, and privatistic terms can be realized integrally. It is in this spirit that the structure of a new political-social ordering must be studied, in solid and clear articulation.

But such structures need a center, a supreme point of reference. A new symbol of sovereignty and authority is necessary. The delivery, in this regard, must be precise and ideological prevarication cannot be admitted. It is good to say clearly that here we are only talking about the subject of the so-called institutional problem; it is first of all about what is necessary for a specific *climate*, for the fluid that must animate every relationship of fidelity, dedication, service, disindividualized action, so that the gray, the mechanistic, and the oblique of the current political-social world is truly surpassed. Here today it will therefore end up with no way out when at the top it is not capable of a type of ascesis of the pure idea.

Both the less felicitous antecedents of our national traditions, and even more, the tragic contingencies of yesterday's prejudice are, for many, the clear perception of the right direction. We can still recognize the inconclusiveness of the monarchical solution, when those who today can only defend a residue of the idea are kept in view, a symbol emptied and devitalized, which is that of the parliamentary constitutional monarchy. But in an altogether decisive way the incompatibility in relation to the republican idea must be pointed out. To be anti-democratic on the one hand, and on the other to defend "ferociously" (this is unfortunately the terminology of some exponents of a false intransigence) the republican idea is an absurdity that is the proof of it: the republic (we mean modern republics: the ancient republics were of the aristocracy, as in Rome, the latter of the oligarchy, often with the character of tyranny) belong

essentially to the world that rose to life through Jacobinism and the anti-traditional and anti-hierarchical subversion of the XIX century. And to such a world, which is not ours, let it go. In terms of principle, a currently monarchical nation that becomes a republic can only be considered as a "degraded" nation. For Italy one does not play in the ambiguity in the name of a fidelity to Fascism of Salò, because if, for this reason, one should follow the false republican way, at the same time it would be unfaithful to something more and better, it would throw into the sea the central nucleus of the ideology of the 20s, i.e., its doctrine of the State in regards to authority, power, *imperium*.

It is necessary to conserve this doctrine, only without agreeing to level down and without making it the game of any group. The concretization of the symbol can be left indeterminate for now; the essential task is to prepare silently the spiritual environment adapted to what the symbol of an intangible elevated authority has felt and reacquired the fullness of its meaning: it cannot correspond to the stature of any revocable "president" of the republic, and not even that of a tribune or populist leader, the possessor of mere individual formless power, lacking every higher blessing, supporting himself instead on the precarious prestige he exercised on the irrational forces of the masses. It is that to which some have given the name of "Bonapartism" and that was justly recognized in its meaning not as the antithesis to demagogic or "popular" democracy, but also as its logical conclusion: one of the dark apparitions in the Spenglerian "decline of the West". There is a new touchstone for us: the *sensibility* in respect to all that. Carlyle had already written: "the Valet-World has to be governed by the Sham-Hero" and not by a real Ruler.

Point 8

In this point, **Julius Evola** brings up the topic of nationalism, which he rejects. In particular, there is no support for anything calling itself "White Nationalism", despite those movements that

claim to be “radical traditionalist” or “influenced” by Evola. That would be to be based on “naturalistic” principles, a notion totally opposed to any Traditional state.

Rather, it must be based on the “Idea”, and of course, this Idea is the Traditional idea. This is not at all comparable to the American claim to be a “proposition nation”, that is, it is based on an “idea”, not on an ethnicity, religion, or culture. The American proposition is that “all men are created equal”, the polar opposite of the hierarchical state. In theory, that means that each man decides what is true and good, and determines his own meaning of life. However, what that means in practice is the idolization of the least common denominator. In theory, each man would be free to actualize his highest possibilities; in practice, the harsh reality is that the possibilities of the mass of men are quite limited. In the Traditional State, dominated by the highest spiritual ideal, common men are raised beyond their natural capacities and find their true meaning in higher values.

We see Evola proposing an Order, presumably along the lines of the Templars, that is, an order that is both spiritual and chivalric. That would only be possible when there are a sufficient number of men who both know and are faithful to higher principles, and can testify as witnesses to a higher authority.

Another point must be made in an analogous order of ideas. It concerns the position to take in regards to nationalism and the general idea of homeland. That is so much more timely, inasmuch as today, in order to try to save whatever possible, many people would like to adopt a sentimental and, at the same time, naturalistic conception of the nation, notions foreign to the highest European political traditions and irreconcilable with the same idea of the State which we spoke about. Even prescinding from the fact that we see the idea of homeland being invoked rhetorically and hypocritically by the most opposed parties, even by exponents of red

subversion, that conception is not now factually at the height of the times because from one side it assists the self-formation of great supranational blocks, and from the other it always appears more necessary to find a European point of reference, unifying beyond the inevitable particularism that inheres in the naturalistic idea of the nation and still more in "nationalism".

Nevertheless, the question of principle is more essential. The political plane in such regards is that of an elevated unity in respect to the unities defined in naturalistic terms as are also those to which the generic notions of nation, homeland, and people correspond. In this higher plane, the idea unifies and divides, an idea carried by a resolute elite and tending to be concretized in the State. For this reason the Fascist doctrine—that part of it which remains faithful to the best European political tradition—gave primacy to the Idea and State in respect to nation and people and it understood that nations and people acquire a meaning and form and participate in the higher degree of existence only within the State. Even in periods of crisis, as there is currently, it is necessary to hold firm to this doctrine. Our true homeland must be recognized in the Idea. Not being from the same land or the same language, but being of the same idea is what counts today. This is the base, the point of departure. As for the collectivistic unity of nation, of the children of the homeland¹¹—which has predominated more and more from the Jacobin revolution until now, we in any case oppose it with something like an *Order*, men faithful to principles, witnesses to a higher authority, and legitimacy proceeding precisely from the Idea.

In the matter of practical ends today it is desirable to arrive at a new national solidarity, only we do not descend to compromises in order to reach it; the presupposition, without which every result would be illusory, is separation from that and taking the form of a definite political arrangement from the Idea—such as political ideas and visions of life.

¹¹In French, *des enfants de la patrie* from *La Marseillaise*.

Even today there is not another way: it is necessary that among the ruins the process of the origins be renewed, that which, depending on elites and a symbol of sovereignty or authority, unites the people in the great traditional States, as forms arising out of the unformed. This realism of the idea is not to be understood as meaning to remain on a fundamentally sub-political plane: that of naturalism and sentimentalism, if not completely of the patriotic rhetoric.

And in case we want to support our idea also on national traditions, one remains very careful: because there is an entire “homeland history” of Masonic and anti-traditional inspiration specializing in attributing national Italian character to the most problematic aspects of our history: starting from the revolt of the Communes supported by Guelphism. With it, a tendentious “Italianity” takes prominence in which we cannot and do not want to recognize ourselves. We leave it voluntarily to those Italians who celebrated the “second Risorgimento” with “liberation” and partisanship.

Idea, order, elite, State, men of Order—in such terms the lines are maintained, as long as it be possible.

Point 9

In Point 9, **Julius Evola** rejects the “solutions” offered by the modern world. First of all, it is not simply a matter of preserving a certain “culture”, which is the superficial, but rather of developing an entire “worldview”, in the heart of man’s being, from which culture will arise as an effect.

This worldview does not come from reading books and, we should add in our age of mass media, it definitely cannot arise from passively absorbing the ideals, values, and opinions of main sources of public discourse today. The “right” worldview cannot only arise within, from living a noble life, perhaps following, as Evola said in different circumstances, the *Path of the Gods*. Personally, I

find that the Noble Eightfold Path of the Buddha expresses this idea: right view, right aspiration, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, right concentration.

Evola then singles out three modern worldviews for a withering critique: darwinism, pschoanalysis, and existentialism. All three—and even today they form the foundation for the modern and postmodern wordlview albeit in somewhat mutated forms—reduce man to the lowest level. He is an “evolved” animal, he is the plaything of unconscious forces, he is dominated by feelings of angst and meaninglessness. Anyone who opposes these worldviews is then branded as ignorant or even evil. As he points out, the worst invective is directed to those who refuse to accept darwinism as a valid understanding of the origin of man; the darwinian dogma is enforced more strictly than any previous Inquisition.

Something needs to be said about the problem of culture. Not beyond measure. We in fact do not overvalue culture. What we call a “worldview” is not based on books; it is an inner form that can be more precise in one person without a particular culture than in an “intellectual” or a writer. We must ascribe the fact that the individual is left open to influences of every type to the weight of everything among the bad omens of “free culture”, even when he is not able to be active in relation to them, to know how to discriminate, and to judge according the right judgment.

Thus discourse cannot just point out that, as things currently stand, there are specific currents from which the youth of today must defend themselves interiorly. We spoke initially of a style of rectitude, of inner resistance. This style implies a right knowing and young men especially must take account of the intoxication working on the totality of a generation from concordant varieties of a distorted and false vision of life, that have affected men’s internal strength. In one form or another, these toxic elements continue to act in the culture, in science, in sociology, in literature, as so many points of infection that must be identified and

beaten. Aside from historical materialism, which we already mentioned, Darwinism, psychoanalysis, and existentialism are among the major ones.

The fundamental dignity of the human person must be asserted against Darwinism, recognizing his true place, which is not that of a particular, more or less evolved, type of animal among so many others, differentiated through “natural selection” and always tied to bestial and primitivistic origins, but he is to elevate himself virtually beyond the biological plane. If today no one speaks much anymore about Darwinism, its substance nevertheless remains. The biological Darwinian myth, in one or another of its variants, has the precise value of a dogma, defended by the anathemas of “science”, in materialism, whether of the Marxist or American civilization. Modern man is addicted to this debased idea, he recognizes himself in it comfortably and finds it natural.

Against psychoanalysis the ideal of a Self (or “I”) must be validated, a Self who does not abdicate, who intends to remain conscious, autonomous, and sovereign in the confrontation with the dark and subterranean part of his soul and the demon of sensuality; that does not mean either “repression” or a psychotic scission, but he brings about an equilibrium of all his faculties ordered to a higher meaning of living and acting. An obvious convergence can be pointed out: the disempowerment of the conscious principle of the person, the prominence given to the subconscious, the irrational, the “collective unconscious” and similar ideas from psychoanalysis and analogous schools, corresponds in the individual precisely to what the urgency, the impulse from below, the subversion, the revolutionary substitution of the inferior to the superior, and the disdain for every principle of authority, represent in the modern social and historical world. The same tendency acts on two different planes, and the two effects cannot avoid being mutually integrated.

As for existentialism, even to distinguish in it what is properly a philosophy—a confused philosophy—it remained, until our time, of pertinence to restricted circles of specialists. It is necessary to recognize the

state of soul in crisis that became a system and was adulated, the truth of a broken and contradictory human type who experiences, with anxiety, tragedy, and the absurd, a freedom from which he does not feel elevated, and to which he instead feels without escape and responsibility, condemned in the midst of a world deprived of value and meaning. All this, when the best Nietzsche had already indicated a way to recover a meaning for existence and to give to oneself a law and an intangible value even in the face of a radical nihilism, in the sign of a positive existentialism, according to his expression: from a "noble nature".

Such are the lines of surpassing that must not be merely intellectualized but lived, realized in their direct meaning for the interior life and one's own conduct. To lift oneself up is not possible as long as one remains as though he is under the influence of similar forms of false and deviant thinking. Detoxified, a man can pursue clarity, rectitude, strength.

Point 10

Julius Evola points out the three possible reactions to the modern world, which he regards as fundamentally "bourgeois". We may dispute that today in that proletarian values seem to predominate in our time.

1. Oppose the bourgeoisie with a "collectivized and materialized humanity," to which we may add an "undifferentiated" humanity.
2. Maintain the bourgeois status quo through focusing on the economic life, solely.
3. Oppose the bourgeoisie with a "higher heroic and aristocratic conception of existence", which is both "anterior and superior" to the current state of affairs.

The position that lies in the zone between culture and custom will finally be made clear. From communism came the rallying cry of the anti-

bourgeois that was also picked up in the cultural groups of certain “committed” intellectual circles. As bourgeois society is something intermediate, so there exists a double possibility of surpassing the bourgeois, of saying “no” to the bourgeois type, to bourgeois civilization, to the bourgeois spirit and bourgeois values. One corresponds to the direction that leads even lower than all that, toward a collectivized and materialized humanity with its Marxist “realism”: social and proletarian values against bourgeois and capitalist decadence. But the other is the direction of those who oppose the bourgeoisie in order to actually rise up beyond it. The men of the new arrangement will still be anti-bourgeois, but by way of the afore-said higher heroic and aristocratic conception of existence; they will be anti-bourgeois because they disdain the comfortable life; anti-bourgeois because they will follow not those who promise material advantages, but those who demand everything from themselves; anti-bourgeois, finally, because they are not preoccupied with security but love the essential union between life and risk, on all planes, making the inexorability of the bare idea and precise action his own. Yet another aspect, through which the new man, cellular substance for the motion of awakening, will be anti-bourgeois and will differentiate himself from the preceding generation, is through his intolerance of every form of rhetoric and false idealism, of all those great words that are written in capital letters, of everyone who is merely a gesture, words intended for effect, scenography. Essentiality, instead, a new realism in pitting itself exactly against the problems that will be imposed, in doing so the value is not appearing, but rather being, not prattling, but rather realizing, in a silent and exact way, in sync with similar forces and in adherence to the command that comes from above.

Those who are able to react against the forces of the left only in the name of idols, of lifestyle and the mediocre conformist morality of the bourgeois world, have already lost the battle beforehand. This is not the case for the man who stands on his feet, having already passed through the purifying fire of internal and external destruction. This man, in the

same way that politically he is not the instrument of a false bourgeois reaction, so, in general, he regains forces and ideals anterior and superior to the bourgeois world and the economic era, and it is with them that he creates the lines of defense and consolidates positions when, at the opportune moment, he will strike out with the action of reconstruction.

Even in such regard, we intend to reclaim a delivery not followed: because we know how in the Fascist era there was an anti-bourgeois tendency that had tried to explicate itself in a not dissimilar sense. Unfortunately even there the human element was not up to the task. And they knew how to make rhetoric even out of anti-rhetoric.

Point II

In the final point, **Julius Evola** addresses the question of spirituality. He first considers Catholicism, the last Tradition in the West, but rejects it as inadequate in our time because the Church no longer represents that Tradition. If, instead, had it maintained that Tradition, had it still represented the only force against the modern world, and had it held firm to the principles of *The Syllabus Of Errors*¹² (which everyone should read), Evola would support it.

Evola does not propose some other tradition, alien to Europe, but rather counts on new men, aware of the transcendent, aware of life beyond death, to forge a new spirituality, in expectation of a blessing from above. Given his anti-clerical attitude, this is a somewhat inconsistent position. What is there to prevent such men from recovering that tradition on their own? Why must they wait passively for the "church" to give it to them? The Kingdom is taken by force.

Let us briefly consider a final point, that of the relationship with the dominant religion. For us, the secular State, in whatever form, belongs to the

¹²<https://www.papalencyclicals.net/Pius09/p9syll.htm>

past. And, in particular, we oppose its parody that asserted itself, in certain circles, as the “ethical State”, the product of a weak, spurious, empty “idealistic” philosophy associated with Fascism [that of Giovanni Gentile], but through its nature such to give equal approval, like a dialectical game of dice, to the anti-Fascism of a [Benedetto] Croce.

Yet though we oppose similar ideologies and the secular State, a clerical or clericalistic State is likewise unacceptable for us. A religious factor is necessary as the background for a true heroic conception of life that must be essential for our political alignment. It is necessary to feel in oneself the evidence that there is a higher life beyond this terrestrial life, because only those who feel this way possess an unbreakable and unconquerable strength, only they will be capable of an absolute enthusiasm. But where this is lacking, to defy death and to take no account of one’s own life is possible only in sporadic moments of elation or in the unleashing of irrational forces: nor is there a discipline that can be justified, in the individual, with a higher and independent meaning.

But this spirituality, which must be alive among us, does not require obligatory dogmatic formulations of a given religious confession; however, the style of life that must be drawn from it is not that of Catholic moralism, which aims for little more than a virtuistic domestication of a human animal; politically, this spirituality cannot but foster mistrust in respect to everything that as humanitarianism, equality, principle of love and of the forgiveness instead of honor and justice; it is an integral part of the Christian conception. Certainly, if Catholicism were capable of making a program of high ascesis its own and exactly on this base, almost like a recovery of the spirit of the best Medieval crusader, makes of faith the soul of an armed bloc of forces, almost a new close-knit Templar Order, relentless against the currents of chaos, breakdowns, subversion, and the practical materialism of the modern world—certainly, in such a case, and also in the case that, at the minimum, it held firm to the positions of the Syllabus, there could not be a single instance of doubt about our

choice.

However, as things currently stand, given the mediocre and, fundamentally, bourgeois and parochial level, to which today practically everything that is confessional religion has descended and given the modernist destruction and the rising opening to the left of the post-conciliar Church of the "aggiornamento", for our men, pure reference to the spirit will suffice, precisely as the evidence of a transcendent reality, to appeal to another force in order to graft onto our force, to have a foreboding that our battle is not only a political battle, to attract an invisible consecration on a new world of men and leaders of men.

Conclusion

With this paragraph, **Julius Evola** concludes his *Orientations*. Note that he asks the next generation to take up the torch, but not necessarily to repeat exactly the past. Lessons must be learned and Tradition expressed perhaps in new terms. Fighting old battles may not be helpful in the present battles.

Note that Evola, the "man of action", insists on intellectual rigour and intransigence with respect to the ideas of Tradition. Those who hold firm to those ideas will be united. This unity cannot be achieved on the basis of some contingent political position; certainly not with those who deviate from such ideals while claiming to be "traditionalists". Those who keep their minds focused on the ideals of Tradition will never be overcome by the enemy. They remain firm in the conviction that "what can be done, will be done."

As a side note, please note the reference to "illusory order". This distinction will be important in the discussion of the Logos.

These are some essential orientations for the battle to be fought, especially in respect to the youth, who take up the torch and the baton from those

who have not fallen, learning from the errors of the past, knowing how to discriminate and review everything that was affected, and still today is affected, by contingent situations. It is essential not to descend to the level of the adversaries, not to be reduced to repeating the same mantras, not to insist unduly on those of yesterday which, even if worthy of being remembered, do not have the impersonal and current value of an idea-force, not to yield to the suggestions of false politicizing realism, the mark of every "party". It is necessary for our forces to act also in political hand-to-hand combat in order to create all the possible space in the current situation, and to contain the assault, otherwise almost uncontested, of the forces of the left. But beyond that it is important, it is essential that an elite constitute itself which, in a gathering intensity, identified by an intellectual rigour and an absolute intransigence, depending on the idea that must be united and affirmed above all in the form of the new man, of the man of the resistance, of the man standing up among the ruins. If the task will be to go beyond this period of crisis and vacillating and illusory order, the future will be up to this man. But when also the destiny — that the modern world created for itself and is now sweeping away — should not be restrained, beside such remarks the interior positions will be preserved: in whatever eventuality, what can be done will be done and we will belong to that country which will never be occupied or destroyed by any enemy.

Posted on 2012-07-01 by Aeneas

* * *

apeiron on 2012-07-10 at 19:06 said:

"Starting from what can still remain among the ruins, to reconstruct slowly a new man to animate through a determinate spirit and a suitable vision of life, to fortify through the tenacious adherence to given principles – this is the true problem."

This problem is a very true one that still begs for a solution and surely it will be ongoing for the foreseeable future. For it appears that each rectitude since the end of WW2 has been one of a personal nature rather than one holistically aligned. I praise Gornahoor for trying at least to bridge this divide in an original way by continuing Dantes' task, the hermeticism and templar Rosicrucianism of transcendent European sovereignty that links a Tradition from our deepest hyperborean antiquity to our break with the present circumstances. Guenons example to abandon his own Tradition and seek that of an Islamic one, is not ours and neither can Evolas' personal equation amount to a solid example for emulation despite the greatness of the man's works. Yes I'm generalizing in this post without getting into academic specifics, but its holds true all the same.

To quote Mouravieff, from Gnosis (book III):

"Since then, the revolutions that have successively brought us steam, electricity, mechan-
imtion and atomic energy have transformed the face of the world, and habit as a substitute for
buppiness has disappeared during these upheavals. This means that, although we hear people
claim happiness with growing fewour in the feverish atmosphere of our times, we find ourselves
in a void. If a few 'last of the Mohicans,kith their outdated mentality, raise their voices to call
for a return to the 'normal' state of things, in their ndive sincerity they appear like mediaeva1
knights leading a cavalry charge against armoured cars"

It is slightly puzzling to understand why such an important work as "Orientamenti" had not been translated into English before so for that reason I extend my thanks to Gornahoor for taking the initiative. If all systems have fallen and all ideologies have failed then surely a guide of this sort that works on interior strengthening of the spirit is needed more than ever. At the same time I'm not suggesting anything conclusive will be drawn from this, but I look forward to the subsequent points in this series. We know what the problem is but the answers are lacking as usual, and even the best minds spend years in the wilderness piecing together the pieces of a fragmented interior.

Dominion on 2012-07-15 at 12:29 said:

Seeing at last one of the few Traditionalist writings in which we get a view of how the revolt takes place is definitely inspiring. Evola's idea that the Traditional man must simply live as a Traditional man, and make himself known by virtue of his existence is simple and yet highly practical. Assuming that a personal inner order has been achieved, or is being achieved, it lets this fact be transmitted into the real world. It can be done in daily life, at any level of society. In a sense, the man of Tradition then displaces the current order by refusing to be a part of it through his personal actions. It reminds one of Michael Collins' dictum that the Irish would "defeat the British Empire by ignoring it." Thanks for publishing.

Logres on 2012-08-05 at 20:59 said:

Baron Ledhin proposed something along the lines of corporativism:

<http://www.phillysoc.org/Portland.htm>

Cologero on 2012-08-06 at 07:18 said:

Logres, that is one ugly hard-to-read web site.

To consider the question about "why" to deal with such political/economic topics, particularly since it can only be done in a Platonic way with no chance of implementation. First is as an antidote to the many web sites that claim to be "radical traditionalists", "influenced" by Evola, when they clearly have no such program as that envisioned by Evola, often run by people who "no longer know what normal is".

The hierarchy of spiritual values, then military/political, and lastly economic is the traditional social arrangement, described even by Hermetic authors. Can such an arrangement even be considered "in thought" at this time? Clearly, this arrangement has been the target of overthrow by all revolutionary movements. To this day, the ideal of religious authority, martial spirit, and cooperative economic activity is falsely considered "fascist", and every vestige of it is attacked. For example, an attack on the remnants of spiritual authority is disguised as a women's health issue. The warrior spirit is mitigated by egalitarian pressures in the armed services. And so on ... why would there not be any value in considering such events from the standpoint of Tradition?

Logres on 2012-08-06 at 09:51 said:

"The important thing is that against every form of resentment and social antagonism everyone knows how to recognize and love his own place, that conforms to his own nature, recognizing thus even the limits between which he can develop his possibilities and follow his own perfection: because an artisan who perfectly discharges his function is undoubtedly superior to a king who is unfit and not at the height of his dignity."

Great quote. Ledhin used to say "loving command, and proud obedience" were the watchwords of the organic Catholic order.

logres on 2012-08-12 at 14:57 said:

I must say that Evola always surprises me with what a precise mind he possessed – once he says it, very often, it clears away a century of thought, and years of personal confusion:

"In these fields the requirement of dignity and liberty of the human person that liberalism can conceive only in individualistic, egalitarian, and privatistic terms can be realized integrally."

This was exactly the same goal aimed at by Baron Ledhin, who (unfortunately) did not understand the abiding ideal of imperium – once the monarchs were all equal, the World Wars commenced, and they seemed powerless to stop it (though they personally wished to, at some level). I wonder if Ledhin knew of Evola? I'll have to check...

logres on 2012-08-12 at 15:08 said:

"Indeed, Kuehnelt-Leddihn observed that one of the weaknesses of the Right was its failure to failure to offer a utopia of its own as a counter to the utopias of the Left.^{9[2033?]} (Leftism Revisited)

Indeed, "Erik von Kuehnelt-Leddihn was fond of pointing to the traditional Chinese civil service examination system as one reflecting the ideals of meritocracy. The scholars who comprised the Mandarin class were drawn from the ranks of those demonstrating superior skill and ability. This was not a hereditary class but one where even the lowliest peasants with remarkable talents could achieve self-advancement."

Interesting that Ledhin (like CS Lewis) seems to have appreciated the possible directions "things might have gone", but appeared powerless to actually articulate it. One wonders what might have happened had a more coordinated, concerted, and spirited effort been made to re-constitute the opposite of a Revolution, without falling into the Benoist (or similar) side-tracks.

Cologero on 2012-08-12 at 20:08 said:

Good points, Logres. I was speaking to someone a couple of weeks ago, who claims to follow the New Right. I asked about his (or their) vision. He envisions communities of pagans, practicing their own way, apparently like the city states of Ancient Greece. I asked him the a question, equivalent to what you mentioned about kings. How do you guarantee the "kings" won't begin to battle each other and consolidate; especially since they want to be a "virile" (at least some do) and warrior society. I also pointed out that they would have no way to protect themselves against the dreaded "monotheists", who would probably have the imperium in mind. Curiously, he tried to shame the monotheists for being intolerant; sounded just like a liberal.

As Evola points out, the spiritual vision comes first, the symbol to gather around. It will be a hard sell, since liberal individualism is so ingrained and anything else seems a threat to that willfulness that is called "freedom". One of the dominant spiritual visions involves being raised up into the clouds; doesn't make sense and is untraditional, yet it holds a lot of hearts and minds.

A meritocracy like the Mandarins is hardly possible now, as we know who will administer the tests, what answers will be deemed acceptable, and who will get "bonus" points. I suppose we are already, in a way, ruled by Mandarins, just not what Kuehnelt-Leddihn would have hoped for.

apeiron on 2012-08-12 at 20:35 said:

I always resonated with the simplicity inherent in the spiritual unity of the true golden Imperium, everything else just falls into place almost with a non-rational(supra-rational) gnosical understanding.

"One of the dominant spiritual visions involves being raised up into the clouds; doesn't make sense and is untraditional, yet it holds a lot of hearts and minds."

Which dominant spiritual vision do you speak of here? Christianity, Judaism or Islam? Are these untraditional visions in your eyes?

Cologero on 2012-08-12 at 21:57 said:

Apeiron, apparently you are not familiar with religious trends in the USA. I was referring to the neo-Christians in North America who believe they will be lifted up into the clouds before the end of the world as described here, for example¹³. There are many such believers in the USA. Not every Christian sect is "traditional" in its outlook.

The point is that there is no spiritual vision that can unify the West at the present time. Part of task pointed out in Point 7 is to see clearly the various movements competing for that vision.

Dominion on 2012-08-12 at 21:59 said:

A similar system still exists in China with the CPC's cadre apparatus. Prussia's Junker aristocracy is another good example of a sort of "aristocracy of merit".

This statement by Evola is, I think, very handy both as a repudiation of totalitarianism and aspects of historical fascism, and a guide to what exactly was wrong with it. When we look at fascist movements, there is a very big pattern of trying to preserve traditional forms without adhering to the truths that the forms are meant to embody. For example, Italian fascism's focus on the Roman Empire in its expansionist policy and "Caesarism", rather than in its spiritual Tradition. Spanish fascism's focus on the Catholic Church and the archetypal peasant, which resulted in the stagnation of many aspects of Catholic life in that country as the State used the Church as a justification for its totalitarian rule (writer Richard Wright reports that fornication among the Spanish agricultural classes was higher than in most other "liberal" European countries, a pattern that continues today in the American South with things like teenage pregnancy and use of pornography). National Socialism's focus on the racial Aryan, and not the spiritual one.

It is of utmost importance to realize the steps in which a transition and reformation in ideas must go. The ideas by some groups to implement an "Imperium" in Europe or the West at this stage is nonsensical. The first great task is to enable individuals to grasp the truths of Tradition themselves and begin their 'personal' transformation. As these numbers grow, it may become possible to create bigger and bigger networks. Then, and only then, can one even begin to think about restoring Tradition at the level of society and State. It may be well for us to purge the idea of ever seeing these later stages in our lifetimes, for it would be better to die knowing

¹³<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dispensationalism>

that a rebirth is being carried out step by small step than to see a false Imperium created by those who cannot see that it is a form containing nothing.

Ferdinand Gombault on 2012-08-13 at 09:59 said:

logres, Erik von Kuehnelt-Leddihn knew of Evola; in one of his works he mentions his name in a somewhat condescending manner pointing to his "paganism". If you wish, I could try to find the exact quotation. However, I doubt that Kuehnelt-Leddihn was really familiar with Evolas writings.

The two had a decisive dissent: Kuehnelt-Leddihn was a fervent catholic and I do not have to explain Evolas conviction in this regard. On top of that, Kuehnelt-Leddihn regarded himself as a "liberal" (though in a Central-European sense, which does not have the meaning "left", for Kuehnelt-Leddihn rather to the contrary), which I strongly doubt Evola would have done. Kuehnelt-Leddihn also was decidedly anti-racist and anti-fascist, although anti-egalitarian and "right-wing". I personally would recommend reading his books as a stimulating contrast to Evola.

Logres on 2012-08-19 at 16:31 said:

Wouldn't there be a difference between arguing for a "white" Imperium & prudentially believing that certain ethno-states be maintained in relative genetic stability, provided that the entity was not allowed to exalt itself to a transcendental level, or expand at the expense of other, similar entities? Or is that an inevitable betrayal of principle, as well? Is the distinction moot at this point?

apeiron on 2012-08-19 at 19:15 said:

It is fair to say that Evola rejected the Jacobinic manifestation of the nationalist idea as lesser to that of a spiritual Imperium of Aryan races, hierarchically aligned. Why National Socialism and Fascism were not explicitly called "white" or "Aryan" nationalism is simply because there was no demographic crisis of white peoples in their indigenous homelands or of their genetic stock worldwide: the first tier of race. At least back in the thirties one had, more or less, only the spiritual problem to worry about.

In Evolas words, from "Doctrine of Awakening":

"We have to remember that behind the various caprices of modern historical theories, and as a more profound and primordial reality,

there stands the unity of blood and spirit of the white races who created the greatest civilizations both of the East and West, the Iranian and Hindu as well as the ancient Greek and Roman and the Germanic."

To say that there was no support for "anything calling itself "White Nationalism"" may be true but slightly misleading. Equally one could make the same argument for National socialism and Fascism, both modern themes influenced by masonic ideas yet stood as the last bridge-stone

since the middle ages to surpass modernism with the right direction. Both of these regimes Evola worked with, had they not been crushed by two daemonic hyper-material superpowers, it is only our speculation what may have come of them.

Cologero on 2012-08-19 at 20:39 said:

Logres, Evola's context was post-WWII Europe; he was pointing a way out of the ruins. Hence, a "white" imperium was implicit, given the ethnic constitution of Europe in 1951; he was not speaking of any other situation or other civilizations. The point, nevertheless, is that race, or even ethnicity, is insufficient as a unifying principle, and the facts bear that out. By definition, an Empire consists of ethno-states. So what Idea would unite them? Certainly, ethno-nationalism in itself would not.

As for Apeiron's thoughtful point, we wonder if the race that created the "Iranian and Hindu as well as the ancient Greek and Roman" civilizations even still exists; certainly that spirit no longer exists. Ironically, this is implied in his comment about the "two daemonic hyper-material superpowers", the modern equivalent of the "civilizations both of the East and West".

Sparrow on 2015-03-02 at 03:01 said:

I once made the point that White Nationalists with their petty agendas, orgiastic violence, and inability to contemplate the transcendent, had more in common both psychologically and in spirit with a drunken Red Army officer than the calm, disciplined SS foot soldier they desire to emulate. The remark was not well received, but I feel it had a certain truth to it.

Michael on 2012-09-02 at 20:46 said:

Will the action of reconstruction happen spontaneously, or will it be the result of an organization? In other words, is it just a matter of living in a certain way (riding the tiger) or the result of a movement?

Cologero on 2012-09-04 at 12:09 said:

Michael, nothing happens "spontaneously".

First, the conscious and unconscious agents of revolution need to be identified

Then, of the former, the covert and open agents of revolution

Then there must be an understanding of what revolution is

Then there will be the understanding of the opposite of the revolution

The possible is the real, hence the conditions to make the foregoing possible must be identified.

Cologero on 2012-09-04 at 20:23 said:

There is a rather odd debate¹⁴ between Olavo de Carvalho and Alexander Dugin. In Section 9 Carvalho describes the possible historical agents. Although both men are Traditional men of the Right, influenced by Guenon, they are far apart from each other. I don't believe either one identified fully the revolution; whether their solutions are fully convincing is a matter for debate.

Logres on 2012-09-05 at 05:53 said:

That was an odd debate – I found myself in sympathy with the Westerner, but nodding at points Dugin was making, such as the necessity to love both a country/culture's flaws as well as excellencies (in a sense). Any comments you care to make further on this debate would be much appreciated, Cologero. Dugin has a Gnostic streak, at least in rhetoric, that is difficult to contextualize, for me.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-05 at 06:17 said:

Not to go tangential, but I think that in order to fully understand what Olavo and Dugin were debating, we first need to consider the ideas of Franco Freda, the follower of Baron Evola, and his book *THE DISINTEGRATION OF THE SYSTEM*. I am sure Cologero has read the book, but to summarise it, Freda's argument was that men of Tradition are loyal to timeless principles irrespective of race or culture and thus if the West has become anti-Traditional beyond all hope of recovery, as Evola argued in *Ride the Tiger*, to restore a Traditional world it is first necessary to destroy the West; hence Freda's call for the "Right" to ally with the extreme and violent left. This is a huge influence on Dugin's worldview.

Michael on 2012-09-05 at 20:10 said:

When you said agents of revolution, I thought of the individuals and organizations that initiated and spread Enlightenment ideas, but Carvalho appears to have a broader understanding of what an agent is.

If Carvalho is correct, then the only hope of a return to Tradition in the West is the Catholic Church since it is doubtful that the other entities named (royalty & nobility, initiatory & esoteric organizations) are willing or able to do anything. This is especially true if Guenon was right in saying that initiatory organizations no longer exist in the West.

Cologero on 2012-09-05 at 23:52 said:

On one point, the two men agree: there is a globalist financial elite. Carvalho supports a conspiracy theory, identifying that group as the "Syndicate", transnationalist, not confined to any

¹⁴<http://theinteramerican.org/blogs/olavo-de-carvalho/257-olavo-de-carvalho-debates-alexandr-dugin-ii.html>

particular country. Dugin, OTOH, conflates that group with American power *in toto*. Whence, their widely divergent views. Carvalho¹⁵ identifies three movements that can oppose the Syndicate: (Section 5)

1. An international union of Catholic and Protestants
2. Zionism
3. American neo-conservatism

There is no evidence of them acting in concert, nor even verbally opposing the plans of the "Syndicate", not even in muted tones. Nevertheless, Carvalho wishes to defend the existence of Catholic-Protestant Christianity, Israel, and the USA as a nation; he sees Dugin as calling for their extinction.

Cologero on 2012-09-06 at 00:02 said:

No, Jason-Adam, I hadn't read it, despite its interesting premise. At the time of its publication, I would have been supporting the Left and would have seen no purpose in such an alliance. As far as its being "first necessary to destroy the West", every death is a birth; what interregnum of the left born from that destruction would then cede power voluntarily to Tradition?

As Evola makes clear in Point 10, the bourgeoisie can be opposed in two directions: from below and from above. What purpose would be served by adopting the goals of the proletariat? Would "aristocrats of the soul" take to the streets? We agree with Joseph de Maistre that what is necessary is not a revolution in the opposite direction, but rather the opposite of a revolution.

I'll reconsider it in the forthcoming review of Dugin's Fourth Political Theory.

Cologero on 2012-09-06 at 00:10 said:

Michael, Carvalho himself anticipates a "worldwide united front of Christians [Carvalho does not include Orthodox], Jews, and American nationalists", whose existence, he believes, is threatened internally by the globalist elite (Syndicate) and externally by the powers Dugin supports: BRIC and international Islam. It is certainly not obvious what would unite those three groups, other than the desire for mere survival. The Catholic Church, such as it is, seems unable, and even unwilling, to do anything to oppose the modern project. However, this is not to say that the Traditional spiritual forces of the West cannot arise again in some other way.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-08 at 22:33 said:

¹⁵<http://theinteramerican.org/blogs/olavo-de-carvalho/257-olavo-de-carvalho-debates-alexandr-dugin-i.html>

The end goal is to restore Tradition. The perspective Evola took later on in his life was that it was no longer possible to go BACK to the Tradition of our ancestors but that we need to move forward to the start of the new cycle, hence we support the proletariat to speed up the process of destruction.

Over a period of several generations, it is possible that a new aristocracy would emerge from communism, and the system would transform itself from a material system to a meta-physical based one....the example of north Korea must be mentioned. north Korea has become a quite traditional monarchy based on Confucianism and (according to even its own officials) metaphysics.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-08 at 22:39 said:

The other point to mention is that, in his recent essay THE MISSION of JULIUS EVOLA, Dugin said that Guenon and Evola were wrong to declare capitalism the thought of the third estate, and communism that of the fourth. He makes an intriguing thought that since the Kali Yuga concludes with the rise of the Counter Tradition, atheistic communism cannot be the Antichrist. The fact the USSR fell while the USA remains shows that in the world of decline the Soviet Union was not as fallen as America is.

I forget to add that these are not my views but I am arguing Dugin's case, as part of a Socratic exercise to stimulate Cologero and Logres.

Logres on 2012-09-08 at 22:56 said:

Dugin wants to argue that the West is "water" and hence Chaos (the Thalassocracy of the Sea). But isn't Water just one of the Four Elements? Why would (inherently) Water be worse than Earth (Asia)? And does Water have something to do with the spiritual flood God is pouring out over the Earth? And does this make the North "Fire" and the South "Air"? Dugin has some fascinating insights and criticisms of the Anglo imperium, most of which I agree with in point, but I'm waiting for C to review the book before saying more. The destructive Gnostic side of Dugin is evident here:

<http://arctogaia.com/public/eng/gnostic.htm>

Russia will always be "Red" (Mouravieff emphasizes this) but I see no reason why Dugin would want to characterize the spiritual heritage of Orthodoxy as inherently "Gnostic" in the sense he describes. Part of the problem is with terms, but another part of the problem is that different sections of the globe are going to be "different" while remaining Traditional. Dugin may be deceived by some of his own rhetoric, it's possible – it wouldn't be the first time someone extremely bright (eg., Zizek) has gotten carried away by the sound of his own voice and ended up spinning webs of illusion for himself.

Cologero on 2012-09-09 at 18:45 said:

I am going to ask you, Jason-Adam, to hold that thought until we begin a review of Dugin's book *The Fourth Political Theory*. Despite his vast and deep knowledge of Guenon and Evola, he makes some serious errors. The first and most obvious is confusing the empirical and contingent with principles. Guenon and Evola point to the degeneration of castes, not necessarily to specific ideologies. For example, the problem is not capitalism in itself; rather it is making the values of the bourgeois the dominant values, and so on.

Keep in mind, too, that the USSR was leninist; according to Marx, communism would arise only after capitalism, so the USSR was premature and does not reflect perfectly what Dugin tries to pull from it. Also, there is little doubt that proletarian values are predominating in the USA; this is what we need to ponder, not how we label its economic system. Beyond that, there is the "fifth caste", the former outcastes, whose values (or lack thereof) predominate. How this manifests is up for discussion.

The worse fault is the metaphysics of Chaos over Logos, a very unfortunate mental error. The reasons should be obvious, but this will be a topic of discussion perhaps later this week.

Mihai on 2012-09-10 at 09:59 said:

"it is an integral part of the Christian conception"

The problem with Evola, in respect to his view of Christianity, is that when he speaks unconditionally about "Christianity" he actually has in mind Catholicism, which is certainly not the whole of Christianity. He is usually right when he criticizes certain failings of Catholicism, but- it is clear from his writings- that he completely ignores and has no knowledge of Orthodox (Eastern) Christianity.

It is true that here he only speaks for western Europe, but in general, he writes about Christianity as if there is nothing there except Catholicism.

Also, I agree that when talking about a positive solution to bring Europe back to Tradition, he only gives equivocal solutions.

"[...]for our men, pure reference to the spirit will suffice, precisely as the evidence of a transcendent reality, to appeal to another force in order to graft onto our force, to have a foreboding that our battle is not only a political battle, to attract an invisible consecration on a new world of men and leaders of men."

At best, this may only work for a few, very gifted, persons; but even they need a certain form in which to practice their spiritual aspirations. All in all, this really doesn't answer to the question of a "practical" spiritual life.

Michael on 2012-09-10 at 10:49 said:

Evola indicts Christianity as a whole: "These forces worked spiritually, through primitive Christianity, to destroy the European spirit. At first, they concealed themselves within the lunar spirituality which took shape in the Catholic church, that is to say, a spirituality whose type

is no longer the sacred king, the solar initiate, or the "hero", but the saint or the priest who bows before God, whose ideal is no longer the warlike, sacral hierarchy and "glory" but fraternal community and *caritas*."

I doubt that Orthodoxy is that different on these points given that the teachings of Catholicism and Orthodoxy both spring from the same Founder, the same scriptures. That is not to say that there are not differences, only that these differences are insubstantial in comparison to what is held in common.

I disagree with Evola on his rejection of Catholicism as the religious form for the West. The old imperial paganism and the cult of Mithra may be more ideal (from Evola's perspective), but they are both long dead because there is no succession in these religions.

I also don't follow on what has changed in the Catholic Church that has rendered it completely illegitimate. It was arguably valid in the Middle Ages. True, Western Civilization has changed, but the change has been in spite of the Church, not because of it.

Cologero on 2012-09-10 at 12:44 said:

Evola has been remarkably inconsistent over the years on this question. This is probably one of the reasons for Guenon's accusation that Evola was full of prejudices. Orientations was updated toward the end of his life, as the references to Vatican II make clear. Nevertheless, if the church still supported the Syllabus (which I don't see how Evola could agree with in toto) and there were warrior orders, he would support Catholicism. Keep in mind that the purpose of those orders was to (1) destroy paganism and (2) recapture Jerusalem. Which of those programs does Evola support? Or who else should they fight? Perhaps liberals? Is open warfare really the best option today? These and other obvious questions are never addressed.

Guenon and Evola disagree fundamentally on this issue. Guenon asserts that Christianity was esoteric at its source, hence Western Medievalism was also. For him, there would be no problem with Orthodoxy, particularly since it preserved much of the neo-platonic tradition. For Evola, on the other hand, early christianity was an aberration that was corrected in the West only by its fortuitous encounter with Nordic influence. The East did not have that encounter, but I doubt Evola even gave it a moment's thought.

As for the church today, which is embarrassed by the Middle Ages and treats the Syllabus with neglect, how can it be the same? Vatican II opened the door to the modern world, ignoring completely both the crisis and the revolt. All that is necessary is to read, for example, *De Monarchia* or *Consolations of Philosophy* to realize there was quite a different thought process. Since the Middle Ages was the last Tradition in the West, it is the place to start. To mindlessly repeat Evola's prejudices, which we run into quite often, is to really miss the point.

Michael on 2012-09-10 at 14:34 said:

Thanks for the clarification Cologero, but now my reading list has expanded yet again to include Boethius and the documents of the Council (read in light of the Syllabus).

What are your thoughts on the chivalric orders that have survived into the present? As you point out, they are no longer warrior organizations in our current age.

Mihai on 2012-09-10 at 15:48 said:

The Eastern Roman Empire (known today as the Byzantine Empire), preserved the old Greco-Roman traditions and laws and incorporated them in a Christian synthesis.

Not to mention the fact that Orthodoxy preserved throughout the centuries an initiatic path- Hesychia. Of course, this is a jnamic, contemplative path, which I doubt would attract much of Evola's interest. Still, I am pretty sure that he had no idea of it, because in one of his articles he said something like "The notion of a Christian initiation is, today, a pure fantasy", while it is clear that Hesychia is not a fantasy, even though it is quite difficult to obtain such an initiation.

I think Evola's view of Christianity was much too influenced by his early Nietzsche period, and this carried on, even if only residually, throughout the rest of his life.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-11 at 01:47 said:

Evola is very contradictory. Here it seems that if the beliefs of the Vatican hierarchy were the same as those of the SSPX, Evola would be pro-Catholic. Yet when the Church was under B. Pius XII (who is denigrated by the enemy as a nazi) and fighting communism with success in Spain and Portugal, not to forget Croatia, and working with fascism from above through the Society of Jesus to make it into a positive state-building force while eliminating the negative destructive elements much as Evola was trying to do himself, Evola was totally anti-Catholic that whole time !

For myself, I am trying to decide on whether to adopt a western Orthodox or traditional Catholic practice. I lean towards orthodoxy because it preserves the doctrine of imperium as well as initiation through hesychasm and deification/theosis; but the one flaw I find in orthodoxy is that it does not have a theology of holy war the way catholicism does. I actually think traditional Catholicism as being somewhat more masculine and warlike than orthodoxy

Now, I think Evola's dismissal of orthodoxy comes from his reading DeMaistre's book on the Pope where he considers orthodoxy to be another form of protestantism.

Dominion on 2012-09-11 at 02:04 said:

In place of the western Crusade doctrine, Orthodoxy appears to have its battle theology encapsulated in the histories of the Orthodox nations. Tsar Lazar of Serbia, who chose the Kingdom of Heaven over that of Earth and died in a holy battle, is an example.

Mihai on 2012-09-11 at 02:15 said:

Catholicism seems to have created a confusion between temporal power and spiritual authority. The Pope's pretence to temporal power and the attempt at usurpation and annexation of the duties that rightfully belong to the Emperor have created many problems in the West.

In the East, there was no such confusion. Orthodoxy certainly is a path that is dedicated towards contemplation and purely metaphysical knowledge. However, this does not exclude the participation of more active types in the tradition.

The advantage that Orthodoxy has over Catholicism is that the latter has as its supreme point of reference the Supreme Being. The former goes beyond this point and considers the Supreme Identity and synthesis between Being and Non-Being.

DeMaistre, while I greatly respect him, does have some limitations because of his exclusivist Catholic upbringing. Even his easy dismissal of Luther and early Protestantism doesn't stand, as the problem is more complex than he seemed to consider. I have seen this sectarian type of exclusivism in many Catholics, which is a really assumptive attitude on their part. After all, it was in Catholic Europe that the modern deviation began, and it was from there that it spread all over the world. Catholicism has not only been unable to do anything to stop it, but, with Vatican II, it even gave in to it and began accepting whatever terms modernism imposed on it.

As always, realization is indirectly proportional to the level of boasting.

Graham on 2012-09-11 at 11:58 said:

Regarding Hesychastic initiation:

As we indicated above, genuine Hesychasm is so exclusive that any attempt at popularization and vulgarization is impossible. What is scattered in the modern world is a pseudo-Hesychasm which gives many the illusion that they obtain an initiation by repeating the Prayer of the Heart or practicing other techniques made public.

<http://www.scribd.com/doc/81326126/Hesychasm-II>

Graham on 2012-09-11 at 12:30 said:

"Now, I think Evola's dismissal of orthodoxy comes from his reading DeMaistre's book on the Pope where he considers orthodoxy to be another form of protestantism."

Christ himself established the Petrine Primacy: 'Thou art Peter and upon this rock I build my church...'. This was accepted with docility by the Eastern Fathers for hundreds of years, until the wanton rebellion that led to the Great Schism. Under such conditions I'm not sure how one can believe that the East "preserves the doctrine of Imperium."

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-11 at 19:30 said:

I am willing to accept that, Graham, but do Christ's words extend to the temporal sphere of things ? Is Peter Caesar ?

Audrey on 2012-09-16 at 21:29 said:

You know, I would agree 99%. The missing percent being a caveat on the female gender. Every female in the beginning of her sexual life is at the mercy of a good partner who will assist her to grow up. It rarely happens and predatorial female cougars abound.. not to mention gurus. Society would be less to the left if sexual perversity did not abound.. Yet males need to be held accountable and they never are. More often than not they like to play Lambs of God as if it is all the women's fault. I believe that Evola addressed that as well.

Andrew on 2012-09-17 at 23:01 said:

Audrey is correct and that point deserves more discussion.

I have always thought a return to Sol Invictus is the only real option in a world that depends so much on the empirical. Manifestation is the living symbol of the principles from which phenomena precipitate. Emulation of the natural world's relation to the sun would produce a religion and society perfect on every level of realization.

Andrew on 2012-09-17 at 23:03 said:

Yes, Evola did address that point to the tune of, "the problem with women is that men have let them deviate in line with their natural tendencies".

Andrew on 2012-09-17 at 23:07 said:

There is an entire class of mythology, of which the trials of Heracles are a part, that tell the story of the "herculean" efforts it took to subjugate feminine nature to the order of Heaven. It was a sustained effort. What we have today is several generations that have given up on that civilizing project.

12.8 Spiritual Knighthood

This is from a brief article by **Mircea Eliade** on the importance of **Ananda Coomaraswamy** and **Henry Corbin**. I don't know if this article is available elsewhere¹⁶, but in case not, I have translated the French portions of it.

Ananda Coomaraswamy did not try to prove any doctrine, but rather

¹⁶https://www.amiscorbin.com/images/documents/pdfs/Eliade_1979.pdf

to show its consistency and intelligibility. Those properties provide the ground for faith, in the sense of "confidence" rather than belief. AKC writes:

[Philosophia Perennis] is neither a system nor a philosophy, it cannot be argued for or against.

However, the story does not end there. Tradition cannot be proved because it is a fact, and there is no disputing facts. But to become a "fact", it must be realized, i.e., made real. When this happens, it is no longer faith, but rather gnosis.

What Ananda Coomaraswamy did for the comparative study of the religions of India with those of the West, including ancient paganism and the spiritual system of the Medieval period, Henry Corbin did for what are referred to as the three "Abrahamic faiths". He probes them in their depths, thereby rescuing them from the superficial critiques of both contemporary neo-atheism and neopaganism. Besides his lifelong devotion to the study of Persian and Sufi esoterism, Corbin was also interested in Heidegger's philosophy and, curiously, the immense works of Emmanuel Swedenborg.

Recognizing that the crisis of the West is in its foundations a spiritual crisis, Corbin founded the **International Center of Comparative Spiritual Research** in 1974. His goal was to encourage a new kind of university, where Traditional sciences could be studied free from the rationalistic prejudices of academia. He describes it:

The specific character of this Association is marked in its very name: it makes the concept of "spiritual knighthood" the norm of its researches and activities, and it makes Jerusalem the mystical "symbol" of the encounters and gatherings whose place it hopes to be. The self-criticism of the West, as well as the accusations brought against it, never, in general, take into account

the spiritual traditions of our western world, because they don't know them. The first cause of it is that unlike the great theological systems maintained by the religious Orders, or unlike the philosophical systems professed in the Universities, the treasure of the spiritual sciences, that can be grouped under the more or less suitable and adequate term of "esoterism" is found abandoned in a state of neglect. One could just as well speak of suffocation by the canonical and legal spirit. The result is that this treasure remained buried in libraries, an object sometimes of the curiosity of well-intentioned scholars, but most often the prey of improvisers lacking discernment. Whence the proliferation of pseudo-esoterisms. It is therefore important to finally form a home for these high sciences whose neglect and oblivion are at once the cause and the symptom of the crisis of our civilization. To this purpose we cannot separate the history of philosophy, the history of the sciences, the history of spirituality. But it is possible to not separate them only by a "rebirth" presupposing a plan of transhistoric permanency. Such is the meaning that we give to a restoration of traditional sciences and studies in the West. This restoration presupposed the necessary conjunction of the needs of the spiritual life and the rigors of scientific investigation, such that academics are accustomed to conduct.

There are three stipulations: first, it is limited to the three "religions of the book". Second, the spiritual meaning, i.e., the esoteric meaning of the Sacred Word is common to those religions. In his own words, this is the third:

The Man, Adam, the *Anthropos*, was created in some other parts, let us say in the Pleroma, and "descended" down to this world. With him, the Word [Logos] descended to this world. With that descent, History begins. Man and the Word were made captive in or under a terrestrial envelope. Otherwise, they would not have

been manifested in this world and History would never have begun. They would have remained in the state of flashing of non-perceptible light. However, under the terrestrial envelope, thanks to which we can see and hear, thanks to which we can give form to something like History, lives that flash of light which belongs to another world. At that point history is truly understood only if man perceives the trace of that flash and recognizes it . . . When he recognizes it, when that flash is remembered (*anamnesis*), man experiences the state of "those who know", the *gnosis* of the gnostic, in the strict meaning of the word "*gnosis*" . . . we therefore say that the flash of light, *exiled* under the terrestrial envelope, is at this point, *saved*. And such is the deep meaning of the word *gnosis*: a salvific knowledge because it is not a theoretical knowledge, but because it effects a transmutation of the inner man. It is the birth of the true man, the *verus homo*.

Corbin identified three sources of knowledge for "traditional science":

1. **Philosophy.** Intellectual activity, in the metaphysical sense of *nous* or *intelectus*.
2. **Theology.** The body of traditional teachings.
3. **Theosophy.** Inner revelation, or active imagination.

For Ananda Coomaraswamy, the *philosophia perennis* consists of the first principles behind the appearances of the several traditions. For Corbin, it is the visionary perception of the intermediary world that "is designated in Arabic as "*alam al-mithal*", that I need to translate by *mundus imaginalis*, the *imaginal* world, to differentiate it from the *imagination*.

Corbin concluded his presentation:

Henceforth, the relationship between man and his God is that of knightly service. At its limit, this relationship produces the metamorphosis of the warrior knight to the spiritual knight.

I just tried to find the type of scholar who, in the measure where he corresponds to the idea of the legitimate heritage [the esoteric Abrahamic tradition], can assume the vocation of spiritual knight. Because he is at the same time the man of knowledge and the man of desire [yearning for the Absolute; see e.g., *Man of Desire* by Louis Claude de St-Martin], because for him the intellectual life and research could never be isolated from the spiritual life and research, he provides a powerful contrast with the type of man in whom intellectuality is developed in ignorance of all spirituality.

Posted on 2012-10-18 by Cologero

* * *

Audrey on 2012-10-19 at 21:22 said:

Indeed.. I had a brief moment of wondering 'why' I do what I do.. and then it occurred to me that it largely is about boundaries. Without constant work, mechanicalness will win. Hence, I understood the notion of working with others.

Audrey on 2012-10-19 at 21:24 said:

The mechanicalness of the Earth cannot be combatted with self-actualization only. Others must be brought along as well.

12.9 The Secret Meaning of Marriage

Recently several of Gustav Meyrink's books were republished: *The White Dominican*, *Walpurgis Night*, *The Angel of the West Window*, after the publisher Bompiani had already published a new translation of the *Golem*, a book that had in its time a great success in Germany and from which a film was also made.

Gustav Meyrink (1868-1932) is a truly unique author in his genre. The designation "novel" is only approximately applied to his books. If the supernatural has a prominent part in them, the whole is not reduced,

however, to the fantastic, as, for example, in Poe or Hofmann or even Lovecraft.

In them, the supernatural has, in its way, a realistic character through the frequent references to initiatic teachings, which sometimes are directly given, other times they come from symbolic contexts. For Meyrink this element is actually his primary purpose. So in an interview he declared that his novels were only "coverings", that they had a symbolic content which reflected his experiences. He asserted, moreover, that he more than invented his characters and their events, he "lived" them.

It is possible that Meyrink had an initiation in the proper sense. First of all, in his youth an impulse toward the supernatural had brought him to be interested in some spurious forms of "occultism" and to the same spiritism from which, however, he turned away from them decisively, pronouncing severe judgments on them. Especially thanks to successive contacts with some Hindus and Cabalistic circles, he found the "way" and was able to formulate a complex conception of life with a magical and initiatic orientation that, although expounded in novels—novels of a high artistic value — through his clarity and authenticity, it is difficult to find in works specifically dedicated to this material.

We can note here some of the principle aspects of this conception. As the center, we can value the doctrine of Awakening with the contrast between the habitual state of human existence and that of those who have passed onto a higher form of existence and who are also called the "Living", in its eminent sense. If Buddhism at its origins itself had the doctrine of "anatman", or the denial of a true I in common man, this is also Meyrink's view.

A character in *Walpurgis Nights* says:

You truly believe that all those who often mill around in the streets possess an I. They do not even possess anything. They are rather possessed at every moment by a phantasm that plays the part of an I in them.

Elsewhere Meyrink speaks of “extinguished suns”, of existence fundamentally spectral.

Man is so firmly convinced of how much he is awake. In truth, however, he is imprisoned by a network of sleep and dreams that he himself has created. Those who are entangled pass through life like a herd led to the slaughterhouse.

The man who breaks away from the herd, has found again that

key of power over his lower nature, rusted since the flood, who is called to be awake. To be awake is everything.

Only the awakened man is, in reality, immortal. Stars and gods fade, he only remains and can accomplish everything that he wants. But there is a god above him.

Concerning the way that leads to awakening, Meyrink speaks of the “magical kingdom of thought”, something different from the usual peculiar exercises of mental concentration pointed out by theosophy and “spiritualists”. In a text inserted in the *Green Face*, some techniques to lead to awakening are pointed out, techniques that in part recall those of Yoga and that start from the immobilization of the body in order thereby to detach from it and transcend a world of appearances and illusions. Elsewhere, he also mentions the test of remaining conscious in a change of state provoked by toxic fumes.

It seems, therefore, that Meyrink also considers a type of predestination or vocation (in the sense of being called) necessary to reach toward Awakening. For example, he recalled the legends about the apparitions of beings who “never died” — Elijah, John the Evangelist of the gnostics, the cabbalistic Chidher Green, to whom we could add the mysterious Islamic El Khidr — who would manifest themselves to those who “were bitten by snakes”. Or to lead to such is a “destined” configuration of his

own existence, a sudden interior reversal (that in a certain world brings to mind the "satori" of Zen) or the sudden acceleration of existential rhythms: "like a horse who up until now had gone by walking and in one stroke launches into a gallop".

The event, then, can also have tragic aspects, it can be that of a type of Walpurgis Night: forces that are liberated, that take possession of the being and transport him. The awakening happens after something like a nightmare, and on that very subtle line that separates the "Way of Life" from the "Way of Death".

In Meyrink's world, woman and the symbol of the androgyne have an important role. The words put into the mouth, in the Green Face, of the cabbalist Sephardi in speaking of the bridge that leads to Life are:

No man can reach that goal alone; he needs a female companion.
It is only possible, if at all, by a combination of male and female
forces. Therein lies the secret meaning of marriage which had
been lost to mankind for thousands of years.

The reference is, however, especially to a particular "magical" type of conjunction, and it is only to this that the symbol of the realization of the androgyne (of the complete being, more or less in the Platonic sense) is tied. The basic idea here is that the sexual instinct "is the root of death", but that the task is not to eradicate it and to flee from woman as Christian asceticism proposes, but rather to absorb in man the feminine principle, separated on earth from the masculine principle, and a secret union that is not deprived of dangers.

The masculine and the feminine would not constitute just a polarity (which in common existence can also lead to a simple, banal complementarity). Between the two principles a tension and a latent but real antagonism exists. A character in the *Angel of the West Window* contrasts the "eros procreating like an animal" and common love, called "plebeian", sexual relations in which the latent sexual polarity becomes manifest and extreme, as much to confer on experience a destructive character.

If in China woman was called “the enemy” because she tends to capture the yang principle of man, Meyrink speaks of the “draining death that comes from woman” in relation to the action that she would exert — insensibly and invisibly — already in a general way; with clear reference to tantric practices, he however considers — always in the clothing of fictional events — some procedures intended to make the “magical element” carried by the masculine sexual energy not spill out and be lost in the feminine substance.

Among the various themes taken up by Meyrink from the initiatic Traditions, there is that of an “Order”, that may also correspond to the “chain of the Living”, i.e., of the “Awakened Ones”, and the theme of a supreme occult center of the world, the seat of beings who invisibly control the destinies of men. For the second theme, recurrent in one form or another in secret teachings and in the traditions of various cultures, we can return to the vast material collected and interpreted by **Rene Guenon** in his book *The King of the World*.

The reader can also limit himself to the simple literary aspect of the “novel” in Meyrink’s works which, as we said, are unique in their genre.

Some readers will be able, however, to also value adequately the actual teachings, like those which we have brought attention to, woven into the narrative events and symbolized by them.

This essay by **Julius Evola** was originally published in the journal “Roma” on 7 July 1972 under the title *Senso occulto del matrimonio*.

Posted on 2012-10-20 by Aeneas

* * *

Audrey on 2012-10-20 at 20:07 said:

Similar to Franz Bardon. Seems to be a beer putsh trend around the 19c. Meant not derogatorily, by the way.

Audrey on 2012-10-20 at 21:08 said:

And he seem to touch on the same things as Franz Bardon, esp. in his the Key to the True Qabbalah. The Hindu influence remains a mystery to me at its roots, despite my acquaintance with it both in terms of teaching as well as persons.

Audrey on 2012-10-21 at 01:18 said:

Indeed! Hence for example, whereas I find rape absolutely unacceptable, as it robs the female of chances of growing conscious, it is true that in fact sexual instinct is te root of death. Evola wrote that even in death the man acts as a gateway for the female. Humorously, the power rape in the Army becomes subjugation to men's fear, cowardice, etc. Hence a perversity of survival and the entire food nonsense. Humorously, I carry an M16 which I shoot left-arm, even though I am right-handed. Nothing, and I mean nothing makes military males angrier, feeling weaker, etc. The whole notion that they cannot dominate a female's ass and fertilize it like it's mother earth drives them crazy. Sorry about the graphic quality of what is written. It is also why so many regard sex as initiatory and so forth. A female who has powers of life and death over men, and is not your mother/wife is extremely, how shall we say, unpalatable.

Tiffany Dawn Smith on 2021-10-20 at 17:14 said:

What a great blog to have found today! I just ordered Guenon's King of the World on your recommendation. Thank you.

12.10 Nietzsche for Today

This essay by **Julius Evola** was originally published in the journal *Roma* on 28 July 1971 under the title *Nietzsche ancora oggi*. This is Evola's mature statement on Nietzsche, although it is not always clear if he is describing Nietzsche or himself. Tomorrow we will post our own opinions on "Nietzsche, 40 years later".

In Italy it seems that an interest in **Friedrich Nietzsche** has been revived. One obvious sign of it is that Adelphi of Milan is publishing critical translations of all his works; secondly, there is the almost simultaneous appearance of two books, *Nietzsche* by Adriano Romualdi, which contains a full essay on this thinker followed by a selection of passages from

his writings, and then the translation from the German of an excellent systematic work, *Nietzsche and the Meaning of Life* by Robert Reininger. The specific approach of the second of these books leads us to pose this question: apart from the importance that Nietzsche has as a philosopher in general, what can his ideas mean today and, more precisely, which of his ideas maintain any validity?

The relevance of this problem was brought to light by Reininger, by noting that the figure of Nietzsche also has the quality of a symbol, and that his persona embodies at the same time a cause: "it is the cause of modern man for which one fights, of this man no longer with roots in the sacred soil of tradition, oscillating between the peaks of civilization and the abysses of barbarity, seeking himself, i.e., led to create for himself a satisfying meaning for an existence of everything pushed back to himself."

One can further specify this view concerning the problem of the man of the period of nihilism, from the "point zero of all values", of the period in which "God is dead", on the basis of what Nietzsche had his Zarathustra announce, and that today is notoriously translated in a common and almost banal form; of the man in the period in which all external supports fail and in which — as our philosopher already said — "the desert grows".

In the same way, one can say that however much Nietzsche can possibly provide concerns the pure individual problem. All the formulations having a possible relation with collective and political problems are put aside, those for which many wished to see a collusion between Nietzschean doctrines and some past political movements, especially Hitlerian National Socialism and which were also accused of having fueled the pride of a presumed "Herrenvolk" (i.e., a master race) and the fixation with a poorly understood biological racism.

If a "superman" undoubtedly constitutes a central idea of the whole of Nietzschean thought, it is in terms of a "positive superman", it is not that grotesqueness in the style of d'Annunzio, nor the "blond beast of

prey" (this is one of Nietzsche's poorest expressions) and not even the exceptional individual who incarnates a maximum of the "will to power", "beyond good and evil", however without any light and without a higher sanction.

The positive superman, which suits the "better Nietzsche", is instead to be identified with the human type who even in a nihilistic, devastated, absurd, godless world knows how to stand on his feet, because he is capable of giving himself a law from himself, in accordance with a new higher freedom.

Here we must note the clean line of demarcation that exists between Nietzsche as "destroyer", the smasher of idols, and "immoralist" (this latter designation which he often claimed, but only to cause a sensation: because his disdain only concerned "petty morality" and "herd morality"), and that "revolution of nothing" [i.e., 1968], that anarchism from below which the profound crisis of the modern world is bringing about. It is as significant, as it is natural, that Nietzsche is absolutely unknown by the so-called "protest" movements of today, while he was the first and the greatest of rebels. There is no correspondence in the human subject, the true elective affinities — i.e., the plebeian — of such current movements is revealed in their frequent collusion with Marxism and its offshoots, and with every social and racial slum near to the violent and destructive surface of the purely subpersonal and naturalistic strata of being.

The words of Nietzsche's Zarathustra are current and pertinent, in this regard, when he asks who strives to loosen himself from every chain: "You call yourself free, but that does not matter to me — I ask you: free for what?", remembering that there are cases in which the only value that he possessed was thrown away together with the chain. This is a clear warning for those who today only know how to speak of "repressions" and who feed a hysterical intolerance for every type of authority — and they feed such an intolerance — just for this reason: because they do not have in themselves a higher principle that commands.

Now the Nietzschean type, who has put “nihilism behind him”, who, in fact, “knows how to obtain a healthy remedy from such poison”, is the one who instead possesses that principle, and who therefore also knows how to give himself a law. Reininger, in this regard, is correct in seeing in Nietzsche the affirmer of an “absolute” morality like Kant’s, and certain connections could even be established with ancient Stoic ethics, which likewise advocated an interior sovereignty.

Certainly, the multiplicity of dramatically changing positions, sometimes even contradictory, among which Nietzsche sought to find his own way, can lead toward a quite different direction: for example, when Nietzsche promotes the exaltation of “life” or when he invokes the “fidelity to the Earth”. Fidelity also to oneself: to be and to will to be what one is, sometimes this is proposed as the only possible and valid standard in the “desert that grows”. The adequate, but dangerous, standard, known even in classical antiquity before any “existentialism”.

The fundamental problem, of the greatest importance for what the best of Nietzsche can offer today, entails this danger. After what has been said at this point, one must be one’s own law to oneself, it is a question of seeing what the individual finds in himself and accepting the limit reached by the multiple processes of spiritual dissolution that have acted in recent times: to see whether one finds in oneself that natural disgust for vulgarity and for every base interest, that will for a voluntary, clear discipline, that ability to freely establish “values” and to achieve them without giving up whatever the cost, those values that in Nietzsche define the “Overcomer” (Überwinder), the man not broken among so many things that are broken today.

Posted on 2012-12-30 by Cologero

* * *

Mihai on 2012-12-30 at 11:13 said:

I agree with your introduction, that Evola seems to combine a description of Nietzsche with a description of his own ideas.

In Nietzsche, there is nothing of the "positive superman" to be found- that is the person who can give himself a higher law according to a higher function, because for Nietzsche, there is no higher law or function to begin with. For him everything begins and ends in the individual- just like in every modern philosophical movement one might add.

If Nietzsche's writings are to be exploited, then one must keep his best ideas as regarding the means (such as his view of freedom), but totally discard the ends, because they are truly dead (ends).

It is also to be remarked that Evola only gives ambiguous explanations and descriptions whenever speaking of "higher values" or of "Transcendence".

X on 2012-12-30 at 12:12 said:

When Evola could address such person as Nietzsche having "an 'absolute' morality" in the last years of his life, it just can represent the actual level of his own morality. It was from such level of morality he could write those words about Christianity.

Avery on 2012-12-30 at 18:04 said:

Evola does have a few descriptions of higher values. He makes a few vague lists in *Ruins* which I will not go hunting for, and elaborates on some of them, like this one: "Against all forms of resentment and social competition, every person should acknowledge and love his station in life, thus acknowledging the limits within which he can develop his potential; and should give an organic sense to his life and achieve its perfection, since an artisan who perfectly fulfills his function is certainly superior to a king who does not live up to his dignity." (*Ruins*, IT edition, 171)

However, citing the *Tao Te Ching*, he insists that the laws of the traditional era "could not be reduced in any way to the domain of morality in the current sense of the word." (*Revolt*, 56) This reflects some statements in Guenon as well.

The main difference between Evola and Guenon, as articulated here before, is that Evola sees the articulation of Tradition as a will to solar power, while Guenon sees it as the discovery and maintenance of alchemical marriage. Of course the historical eras they most preferred were different as well.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-30 at 18:40 said:

It will be interesting to read Cologero's thoughts on this article – he is correct to see that in discussing Nietzsche, Evola is really discussing himself, and in this way we can see the total and absolute affinity Evola felt with Nietzsche, something that began at a very young age for him, Nietzsche filled for the void for him left after he abandoned Catholicism following his reading

of Merejkowski's books. Nietzsche was arguable Evola's greatest influence considering how he modified the thought he took from others, even Guenon, to fit the Nietzschean pattern. As one website puts it, Evola's philosophy is an attempt to give Nietzsche a universal and metaphysical basis.

Cologero on 2012-12-30 at 20:18 said:

Regarding the artisan, Aquinas makes a similar point. That passage from *Ruins*, moreover, seems to contain a lot of "moralizing". Even the *Tao Te Ching* can be translated as the Way of Virtue. I guess the key is to know what the current meaning of morality is.

There cannot be incompatible ways to "see" tradition. Those approaches must be harmonized or else one must be rejected.

Which historical eras did each prefer, assuming that makes sense? Evola was on record in saying that the way he thinks was the same as that of the well bred man before the French Revolution. Guenon is on record in saying that the restoration of Tradition in the West should use the Middle Ages as the model and that form it would take should be based on the spiritual tradition at that time. We seem to be isolated in taking that project seriously.

Cologero on 2012-12-30 at 20:38 said:

Dealing with the Nietzsche piece, Jason-Adam, will not bring any pleasure. I don't think it correct to say that there is a total and absolute affinity between Evola and Nietzsche. Evola often used the phrases "the best Nietzsche" or "the worst Nietzsche", so he clearly became aware at some point of the incompatibility of Nietzsche with Tradition. There is really no explicit doctrine of N. that E. adopts. E.g. in *Revolt*, we read "the superman notion which is Nietzsche at his worst." In this piece, E. rejects "the blonde beast of prey". E. never mentions, AFAIK, the eternal return, E. rejects N's naturalism, and so on. It was more a question of style. E. adopts a pattern, as you put it, a way of looking at things, and the bombastic style with its ideals of pagan greatness and anti-Christianism. This leads to some absurdities such as his wanting to praise the Middle Ages while rejecting its underlying spirituality.

Also in *Revolt*, E. claims N had an absolute morality without knowing it. I'm sure N would deny it, had he heard that. The problem, as you accidentally point out, is that Evola had a personal philosophy instead of an impersonal metaphysics as explained by Guenon. By letting the camel's nose of Nietzscheanism under the tent of Tradition, Evola has led many astray. Yet on balance, I still think Guenon was Evola's greatest influence; E. referred to him as the "Master of the 20th century". On balance, then, I think the best practice is to read Evola through Guenon to get the most out of his writings.

Jason-Adam on 2012-12-31 at 00:04 said:

I agree with your observations, Cologero, and stand corrected.

Another point regarding Evola should be meditated on – his statement to Abd-el-Wahid Pallavicini that he was interested in temporal power moreso than spiritual. So it is fair to say that Evola places a greater emphasis on politics whereas Guenon sticks more with principles. I wonder what Evola (or Guenon) would think of Dugin's statement that one can not be a Traditionalist without personally being involved political anti-liberal activism.

I agree with the principle of Gornahoor on taking the Moyer Age as our base to which we should return to, as opposed

to following a foreign form or waiting for a new form to arise. The road is narrow and the way is rough however....

Not to sound tangential, but how would you respond to Dugin's words in an interview early this year where he said that he believes Orthodoxy is a fully valid form for the east, but as for the west it is up for westerners to decide which form is best suited for them; he personally preferring neopaganism because he fears a revitalised Catholicism would attempt to impose union with the eastern churches. We went over a lot of this before in discussing Romanides who is an important if uncredited source for alot of Dugin's beliefs – but I do see myself that the east-west schism is something that can not be undone so easily as there are cultural and geopolitical impasses in addition to the doctrinal.....I hope you can suggest something I am not aware of....

Mihai on 2012-12-31 at 03:29 said:

Dugin is hardly a worthy source for anything...

Avery on 2012-12-31 at 11:52 said:

Yes, both were trying to work with all pre-modern ages, but where Guenon saw Tradition as something that flowered with the intellectual glory of the Middle Ages, Evola was big on Roman pre-intellectual intuition, and disapproved of Catholic Christian developments as a step downhill that opened the path to failure. He was a well-bred and orthodox pagan, and he would have made a fine Japanese, but he never made any pretense at embracing developed, medieval traditions as Guenon clearly did.

I agree that at least one of these views is wrong, or at least needs repair. Evola's use of Nietzsche and Otto Weininger can clearly be improved on. But both writers presented internally complete systems and there are good arguments to be made for both "Tradition as the primeval pagan imperialism" and "Tradition as fulfilled by the medieval nations". I made a study of both views in my recent book but failed to reach a conclusion; we'll see how the editor likes it.

Janus on 2012-12-31 at 17:08 said:

It's important to not fall into a "will the real Tradition please stand up" trap. Both ancient Rome and medieval Europe incarnated the Tradition in it various aspects. The difference, as

Lings pointed out, what that the Christian embodiment of Tradition pointed to Love as a path to salvation, whereas this was not emphasized as much in Rome. Given that we are working in the western context, It's useful to look at both Christendom and Rome as predecessors in Tradition. But its re-manifestation won't look exactly like Christendom, nor Rome. Once an age of Tradition is lost, it can only be reborn, not resurrected into a zombie.

Cologero on 2012-12-31 at 18:55 said:

Excellent points, Janus. I think we are just interested in what features are Traditional so they can be recognized. The next cycle will begin first in consciousness, so there will first appear a vanguard with that clear inner vision.

Fourth Magi on 2021-12-30 at 10:23 said:

Nietzsche is great, but logic is not his forte. Otherwise, he would have noticed that humanity rejected God when it realized that the concept of God contradicts the concepts of human good and evil. There is no need to overthrow God, since God has become superhuman and needs protection from everything that is too human.

12.II Initiatic Centers and History (I)

This essay is chapter 17 of *L'Arco and la Clava* by **Julius Evola**. It will be published in two parts; the first part deals with general considerations and the second with Tibet.

There are several things to ponder. For example, what is the “symbolic dimension” to consider, and how is it related to the historical? Is there really any historical evidence, in the current academic sense, for these centers? How can such centers be recognized? What are the higher states of consciousness? Why were the centers unable to prevent the current decline, a topic Evola brings up, blaming the fall on man's freedom? Are the current pan-Islamic movements really an attempt to restore Tradition to those lands? If so, have the Sufi centers played any role in those movements?

Given the confusions that abound in this area, it is opportune to clarify

first what we mean, in general, by “initiatic centers” and “initiatic organizations”.

We treated initiation in an earlier chapter¹⁷, so here we will limit ourselves to recall that, in its authentic and integral meaning, initiation consists in an opening of consciousness beyond human and individual conditionalities, entailing a modification of the subject (of his “ontological status”), who then participates in a higher freedom and a higher consciousness. That is tied in the grafting in the individual of an influence in a certain transcendental, or not simply human, way. In general such an influence is transmitted, and the transmission is an essential function of an initiatic center. What arises from it is the idea of an uninterrupted “chain” (the term used in Islam is exactly *silsila*) whose origins are remote and mysterious, in parallel with a “tradition”. According to the Guenonian school, the various initiatic centers, if they are authentic and regular, would be connected to a unique center and would even draw its origins from it. A similar assumption confronts us however with difficult problems, if it must be validated in some way.

For the topic that we intend to discuss here, the question arises about that aspect of spiritual influences that do not solely concern “knowledge”, a spiritual illumination, the attainment of gnosis, but also a power. This power could even be considered by some—and not incorrectly—as a positive sign because, as long as it is only about a knowledge regarding higher spheres, but if it remains in a purely interior domain, it could also create illusions. The coexistence of a power, that as such is verifiable, is an indirect, but sufficiently positive, proof, for the solidity and the reality of the same knowledge which is considered to having been attained by means of an initiation.

Titus Burckhardt, moreover, was able to speak, in terms of initiation centers, of spiritual influences “whose action, if not always apparent, passes incommensurably beyond everything that is in the power of men”.

¹⁷http://thompkins_cariou.tripod.com/id49.html

Let's move now into the area of reality and history. We had a friendly debate with Burckhardt about the existence and the state of initiatic organization in the world of today. It is not that we assert that they no longer exist, but rather that they have become ever more rare and difficult to access (the assumption is always that it is about authentic initiatic organizations, and not of spurious groups that claim to have such a character). It seems that a progressive withdrawal of such organizations, and therefore of the forces that are manifested in them and of which they were the bearers, has been verified. Moreover, to refer to some traditions worthy of note, this phenomenon would not even be recent. We will limit ourselves to mention those texts in which it is said that the search for the Graal was brought to an end, but through a divine order, the Templars of the Graal abandoned the West and moved, together with the mystical and magical object that no longer remained "among the sinful peoples", to a mysterious region, sometimes identified as where "Prester John" reigned. And there, magically, the castle of the Graal, Montsalvat would also have been relocated. Naturally, the symbolic dimension must be considered in all this.

A second, more recent tradition concerns the Rosicrucians. After causing a commotion, especially with their Manifestos in which they made known their "invisible and visible presence" and with their project of the restoration of a general higher order, the Rosicrucians also withdrew, going back to the beginning of the 18th century; for this reason, we consider that certain groups who subsequently self-qualified themselves as "Rosicrucian" were without authorization and lacking every regular traditional filiation or continuity.

We could add an Islamic testimony of the Ismailist initiatic stream and in particular by that of the so-called Twelvers. The corresponding view is that the Imam, the supreme head of the Order, the manifestation of a power from above the also the beginning of initiations, has likewise withdrawn. They instead await those who will manifest again, but the

current epoch would be that of an "absence".

Nevertheless, that, in our opinion, does not imply that initiatic centers in the strict sense do not currently exist. Without doubt, they still exist, even if in that respect the West barely comes in question and needs to advert to other areas, both in the Islamic world and in the Orient. That established, the problem is the following: if, as Burckhardt asserts, such centers were deposits of the spiritual influences by definition, were deposited, apart from the initiatory use, we have to attribute the beginning of a possible action to something external that "if not always apparent, passes incommensurably beyond everything that is in the power of men", how must we conceive the relationship between such still existent centers (if existing not as mere survivals) and the course of recent history?

From the traditional point of view, this course has, in general, an absolutely involutive and dissolutive character. Now, in the face of forces that are at work in these developments, what is the position of initiatic centers? If they always have had those influences as is claimed, must one think of a type of order received from them, but not using them, and not preventing the process of involution, or must one hold that the general process of "solidification" and impermeability of the environment to the supersensible, provoking a type of rift now renders relative every action that goes beyond the initiatic field in the purely spiritual and interior direction?

It is good to clarify and to put aside the cases in which historically are only the harvested fruits which had been sown earlier. Men have a fundamental freedom. If they have used it for their ruin, the responsibility falls on them and there is no reason to intervene. Now, we can say that for the West, which has been taking the path of the anti-tradition for some time and that through a chain of cause and effect, sometimes quite visible, sometimes hidden to a superficial glance, fatally proceeded to find itself in its current state, that resembles the kali yuga, the "dark age" prophesied by ancient traditions.

But in other cases, things do not remain in the same way. There are civilizations that by not having followed the same path, by not having chosen mistaken vocations, but finding themselves subjected to external influences, would have to be defended. But that seems to not be observed. For example, in the case of Islam there are certainly existing initiatic Sufi centers, but their presence has not actually prevented the evolution of Arabic countries in an anti-traditional, progressive, and modernist direction, with all the inevitable consequences.

This is the conclusion of the essay, dealing with initiatic centers in Tibet. In it, **Julius Evola** proposed a sort of occult drone warfare, assuming initiatic centers truly possess superhuman powers. He offers reasons why the Tibetans allowed the communist invasion had they been able to prevent it by paranormal means. I am curious about reactions to this piece as well as how it relates to the current obsession with various “superheros”.

But a decisive case is that of Tibet. Tibet did not consider at all taking the same path as Western countries. It had maintained its traditional structures intact and was also considered as a country in which, more than any other, individuals and groups existed who were in contact with super-extensible and divine powers. That did not prevent it from being invaded, profaned and devastated by the Chinese communist hordes, which also put an end to the “myth” of Tibet whose fascination had such a hold on the Western spiritual milieu. Yet, in principle, there should have been manifested and presumed for possible use, some concrete opportunities of what was attributed to influences of a not simply human and material order.

To be precise, we are not thinking of invisible and magical barriers of protection that would have blocked the invaders of Tibet. It is sufficient to advert to something somewhat less spectacular. For example, with reference to so-called modern parapsychological research, performed under

strict controls, the reality of "paranormal phenomena" has been verified, that is, the possibility that objects can be displaced, moved or levitated at a distance without a normal explanation. Only that, given the matter with which almost exclusively has to do paranormal research, it is a question of spontaneous sporadic processes, often extrasensory, but not producible at will. Nevertheless the fact has been verified that a psychic agent can cause phenomena like the levitation of a heavy object, that implies an undoubtedly superior force to the force necessity to cause, for example, brain damage with a deadly outcome. Even the phenomena of bilocation, or of the projection of one's own image in a distant place, has been verified (moreover, it seems that it has happened even with Padre Pio of Pietralcina).

So, from everything that has been reported by travelers and observers worthy of credence, beginning with Alexandra David-Neel, similar phenomena was verified in Tibet, however not as phenomena of an extrasensory and unconscious character, but rather as consciously controlled and willed phenomena, made possible by discipline and initiations.

Now, it would have sufficed to use powers of that type to cause, for example, a cerebral lesion and thereby to strike down Mao Tse-Tung at the moment the first communist division crossed through the Tibetan border. Or rather to use that power of projection of one's own image to cause a warning apparition in the face of the Chinese communist leader.

All this should not appear as a merely digressive fantasy to those who have a conception of initiatic centers like that indicated by Burckhardt's words cited above and who believe that similar initiation centers still exist. And haven't the Tibetan traditions even spoken of the famous Milarepa who in the first period of his life, before reaching the Great Liberation, was an outlaw who dedicated himself to black magic, and, in fact, caused a massacre of his adversaries by magical means? Instead we are present at the end of Tibet, without being able to bring in the idea of a type of

Nemesis (as for the West). A recently translated book in Italian¹⁸ speaks of the Odyssey of those lamas who were able to do nothing but escape in order to save their lives, while in the country others were massacred, by those who sought to eradicate everything that had a holy character, and began the communist atheist indoctrination of the people. The only resistance was the guerrillas of Tibetan partisans who pulled back in an inaccessible area. It is useless to say what, an occult defense like that mentioned would have signified instead. Its significance would have made all the marvels of voyages and amazing explorations boasted about by the modern Western world appear very banal and insipid.

So the problem we just posed holds good, without, it would seem, an adequate clarification of it being possible. The only idea that perhaps I could put forward is that of a type of fracture of what exists and the autonomization of a certain part of reality, therefore also of history, with a consequent impermeability in regard to extrasensory influences. It could also relate to the doctrine of cycles, to that which is characteristic of the closing of a cycle. Only that in the case in question, little space would remain for values of a moral character. We should think of a general process in which even those who have not fomented it find themselves implicated. And it should also relate to a type of password transmitted to initiatic centers, with the goal of letting destinies be fulfilled.

This is an order of ideas that would lead rather far, to the same conception of an inscrutable direction of the world and, in another direction, to the existing relation between freedom and necessity. When another perspective should not be of value, necessity could be related only to the factual domain of existence and freedom for various attitudes that could be assumed in the face of facts (or to the reaction to them), which, in terms of principle, is not determined. In this context one could give, among others, a particular weight even to negative and dramatic experiences, that they can give if one assumes a given attitude, even to take on

¹⁸*Born in Tibet*, by **Chogyam Trungpa**.

the character of a test. As we see, this is a field of rather vast and complex problems, with which is also grappled with in the theology of history. We have mentioned this only as a general background to which the deepening of the specific subject of this essay refers.

Note Evola added the following note regarding the theology of history.

At the traditional Catholic base, things are not so easy in cases like Spain's so-called "Invincible Armada"; organized against the heretics and set sail after having every very solemn consecration, it was destroyed, even prior to actual combat, by a storm, the "forces of nature".

Posted on 2013-01-20 by Aeneas

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-21 at 08:24 said:

Some modern writers that that Evola was maybe a bit pessimistic regarding the influence of initiatory centres in the Islamic world and that the modern Islamic movements such as the apocalyptic Khomeini movement in Iran, based around the coming return of the 12th Imam, is such a result of a traditional force acting.

Cologero on 2013-01-27 at 20:45 said:

It seems Evola is moving the problem of theodicy from God to the initiatic centers. If the latter centers had been able to prevent a great evil, should they not have done so? he asks. He makes some conjectures about why that may not have been possible.

You can imagine how absurd history would be if every "bad guy" was occultly punished by initiatic centers prior to their nefarious deeds. Given such powers on the material plane, it is difficult to conceive how they could have disappeared. Isn't it more likely that the superhuman powers spoken of involve states that transcend human, all-to-human, concerns?

His theology of history is also skewed. If God always "intervened" to punish the bad and reward the good in this life, then men would become religious merely to be on the right side of things, in order for personal gain. There would certainly be no need for faith, since God's will would be visible to everyone, clearly and not as a reflection in a dirty mirror.

Logres on 2013-01-27 at 23:22 said:

If the natural state of affairs is the "Golden Age", then to induce a degeneration, the falling asleep of higher centers (collectively and personally) would be required: it would grow colder and colder, and conscious centers would drop off to sleep. Those that were still awake would perhaps withdraw in order to maintain their own equilibrium? Basically, a period of dormancy? This is in Nature. Maybe, as you say, the whole point is to reassert the absoluteness of God at the end of the cycle, in such a way that no one who remains awake can be in any doubt that God's sovereignty is supreme. He seems to be referring at the end of the essay to "transvaluation of morals"; and I have no idea what he means by a "password". But the Spanish Armada reference is intriguing, especially when one thinks that Lepanto had an entirely different outcome in the opposite direction (and not that far removed in time).

Cologero on 2013-01-27 at 23:59 said:

Password or watchword ... the translation of "parola d'ordine".

Yet Constantinople fell not long before the Armada and a millennium after Constantine's victory. Notre Dame lost to Alabama.

The rain falls on the just and the unjust ... I don't think we can draw any conclusions from who gets wet.

But he was writing specifically about Tibet which in recent times (Evola's recent) was presumed to still have secret initiatic centers, or perhaps not so secret. They had the powers of telekinesis and bilocation. If true, why did they not use them against the communists? Of course, these superhuman powers existed in a vertical direction, not on the horizontal plane. In line with the principle "don't feed the animals in the wild", and "let wildfires run their course", these higher powers don't interfere directly on lower planes.

Mihai on 2013-01-28 at 05:15 said:

This article surprises me. As an author of so many good esoteric books (and a person who studied such things all his life) Evola seems to speak with no reservations about reckless usage of magical powers, with an ease that only the lesser of occultists would be capable of.

It surprises me even more greatly since, even as early as 1931, in his "Hermetic tradition", he wrote about magical powers for material ends that "a true adept would only make use of such a thing when it is justified by a higher, spiritual goal". (the quote is approximate, from my memory- see the closing chapters of the above mentioned book).

If we are to approach historical things from such an angle, we could ask indefinitely all sorts of non-sense questions such as : why did the early Christian martyrs, who produced such great miracles, not use their powers to (at least) avoid detection from the Roman authorities when they came looking for them. Or why did Christ, as the Second Person of the Trinity and

Principle of the whole of manifestation, did not use His powers to come down from the Cross (as His adversaries "suggested"), or, better yet, to tear them to shreds, or to destroy the whole universe at that moment, as unworthy to receive His blessings.

It is very unclear to me why would Evola, who his whole life emphasized the overcoming of a merely human understanding of history, would make such inquiries in this essay.

As for the theodicy that Cologero brought forth in the above comment, I think that Boethius did a fine work.

Cologero on 2013-01-28 at 07:58 said:

Not to forget the first half of the essay where Evola is addressing Burckhardt's claim about initiatic centers "whose action, if not always apparent, passes incommensurably beyond everything that is in the power of men". Evola seems to be saying that if that is true, then their action in history is not visible. Recall this passage:

From the traditional point of view, this course has, in general, an absolutely involutive and dissolutive character. Now, in the face of forces that are at work in these developments, what is the position of initiatic centers? If they always have had those influences as is claimed, must one think of a type of order received from them, but not using them, and not preventing the process of involution, or must one hold that the general process of "solidification" and impermeability of the environment to the supersensible, provoking a type of rift now renders relative every action that goes beyond the initiatic field in the purely spiritual and interior direction?

Mihai on 2013-01-28 at 08:54 said:

Yes, it seems I have taken this text out of context.

However, it remains true that Evola does treat this question rather simplistically, although he does seem, in the end, to at least lean towards a right conclusion. The problem is to understand, first of all: what do we mean by an invisible "action". Surely, no such center would ever act against the course of Divine order.

It is just a question of HOW do these 'centers' manifest beneficent effects, according to the natural flow of each age. For example, in the current state of the Iron Age, to act upon the world may mean to lead a few of the individuals who still are capable of upholding superior principles back to tradition.

I believe that Evola's perspective does tend, at times, to be limited because of his somewhat "magical" understanding of certain esoteric phenomena (if I can call them such), a perspective he never really quite shook of.

Scardanelli on 2013-01-28 at 09:22 said:

So the modern superhero phenomena could be seen as a sort of counter-initiate... He who uses his superhuman powers strictly on the horizontal plane for material gains and ends, and always to the benefit of the masses. For a traditional initiate to use his powers in this way would be a debasement of himself.

Scardanelli on 2013-01-28 at 12:16 said:

Further, would this not also imply that physical superhuman powers are but the lower analogue of a higher understanding? For instance, telekenesis is simply the physical manifestation of a power which is manifested differently at a higher level? I'm not sure what the higher analogues might be that correspond to their lower physical powers, but perhaps this is why I can't fly through the air or read the thoughts of others.

Scardanelli on 2013-01-28 at 13:10 said:

Thus, it would seem that it isn't a question of why these initiatic centers failed to act, as it would seem that in the "solid" nature of the Kali Yuga especially, these purely physical powers might be easier or encouraged in some way. Perhaps any attempt to physically act against the forces of degeneracy would only encourage the process...you hint at this somewhat in your comment Cologero, and forgive me if I'm repeating the obvious here. I'm just following a line of thought...

Jason-Adam on 2013-01-28 at 23:59 said:

Very well written and thoughtful piece by Evola here.

The only thing I can add to his writing is by asking if there is any merit at all to the hypothesis of a few so-called traditionalists that there were somehow connections between initiatory centres and communist parties and that the triumph of communism in the east was not in spite of but because of said centres ?

Avery on 2013-01-29 at 02:02 said:

Evola had a bit of blurring between fantasy and reality in his most abstruse studies of distant places and ancient lands, even while his practical understanding of the world around him was solid. If you read *The King of the World* carefully, you will notice that even when Guénon felt personally convinced of a fact about magic, initiation, deep history, etc., he found its symbolism to be more important and make the pursuit of "authenticity" less relevant. Evola,

on the other hand, really was interested in Atlanteans and superpowered Tibetan monks, even though he saw through the myths of contemporary Italy. It's sort of a modern version of the traditional Eastern story of getting distracted by promises of unlimited power while following the initiatory path.

Pickman on 2013-01-29 at 14:05 said:

[Cologero :Of course, these superhuman powers existed in a vertical direction, not on the horizontal plane. In line with the principle "don't feed the animals in the wild", and "let wildfires run their course", these higher powers don't interfere directly on lower planes.]

What are you suggesting that these so called superhuman powers were metaphors of in a vertical direction?

Cologero on 2013-01-29 at 16:51 said:

Yes, Pickman, primarily metaphors or better, symbols. This is not to suggest that they are not "real" powers at their own level.

Otherwise, we are stuck with the problem Evola brings up: why did the centers not use their powers over material manifestation to prevent the communist takeover? Instead, the lamas took off when they could, leaving the population to their own devices.

We see this, too, in our time with the "Law of Attraction" fad. For its adherents, the purpose of higher spiritual powers is to manifest better things in life such as automobiles, money, love, etc. This would eliminate the whole notion of a "quest", or seeking, since who were of superior spiritual development would be visibly obvious. But mythically, the quest is into the unknown, not the known.

12.12 The Fire of Creation

This review by **Julius Evola** of J J van de Leeuw's book **The Fire of Creation**, in its Italian translation, originally appeared in *Bibliotheca*, volume XXXII, August-September, 1928.

J J van de Leeuw was a Theosophist and a priest in the Liberal Catholic Church¹⁹. In van de Leeuw's understanding of the Trinity, the Father is the Will, the Son the Logos, and the Holy Spirit

¹⁹<http://www.thelccusa.org/>

is Thought. Evola sees in this book an echo of Joachim of Fiore²⁰, a saintly Abbott and highly regarded by **Dante**. In this review, Evola picks out one of the more interesting themes of the book, summarizing it rather well. Since the Liberal Catholic Church, just like the Roman, claims apostolic succession, we could read this as what Evola wished the Catholic Church would teach. Consider it his contribution to Vatican II, had he been allowed.

Though belonging to the stream of Blavatsky's anglo-indian theosophy, about which we have written not very favorably in the past, this work, whose Italian translation we draw attention to, represents something deep, clear, and well sketched out. The usual mythological cosmologies are not found in it, nor does he stray into clairvoyance, reincarnation, or similar topics. Van de Leeuw instead proposes a *practical* point of view, of direct spiritual experience.

The mystical prophecies of **Joachim of Fiore** had earlier announced: "The Kingdom of the Father has passed, that of the Son is passing, the Kingdom of the Holy Spirit is on the point of arising." And Van de Leeuw declares precisely that today we are truly at the dawn of the coming of the third person in the dialectic of the divine; the direction of creative activity in motion, of the universe in which *dynamis* or power is the fundamental note, and the immanent presence of the "cosmic Fire" is characteristic of this. The evolutionist and becomingistic direction, the meaning of liberty, of independence from every creed, of individual initiative; the more and more prevalent tendency to move from action to knowledge rather than from knowledge to action until now, are, in modern times, so many signs of it. Those who have been touched by the "Fire of Creation" throw themselves into action, confident of drawing their certainty and their religion from it: they no longer say "we pray", but they say instead "we work". The author insists greatly on this aspect of *experience*, and not

²⁰https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joachim_of_Fiore

of philosophy or belief. One is put in relationship as with a conductor charged with a current of spiritual life, from which proceeds a discharge that dynamizes all our being. In the experience of the “Fire of Creation” one has the sense of a superior energy of something previously felt, and we are electrified through action. In such a moment we feel not only that we desire to do some things, but that we *can* do them: it seems to us that no obstacle can ever resist this enormous energy that we now feel inside of us.

The author seeks moreover to justify in terms of inner experience the same concept of the “Divine Mother”: it would be an aspect complementary to the Fire or to the Holy Spirit, to which it stands in the same relationship of the feminine to the masculine. The sense of hot activity producing its happening in something, the perception of being the same nature and of transforming within ourselves the radiant powers, the creative activity of the creative Fire in the fruitfulness of advancement and in abundance of beauty and form. Close to the impulse to act, the direction that we can make of the exultant joy that is awakened when we know the “Holy Spirit” principle, the complementary aspect “Mother” is instead a process of intimate transformation that renders productive what used to be dead.

The author also gives examples of techniques to produce these experiences. The presupposition is that the ordinary world is only a projected image of our consciousness through the mind and senses. We confuse this image with reality. It is then a question of controlling such an idiosyncrasy of our human manufacture, that makes us project the consciousness of what is inside us around ourselves into the world, and to reconverge at the center, instead of losing ourselves in the contemplation of our image of the world, just as the prisoners of Plato’s cave stare at the shadows on the walls. It is possible to concentrate our Self into a very small point of consciousness and to pass through that point into the world of the Real, of the “things that are”, and no longer our exteriorized images of it. We

have to push ourselves ahead, and having withdrawn our consciousness from its image of the world and stopped its transcendental imaginative faculty, reintegrating ourselves in that absolute immanence, from which they originate, at the same time, the sense of the Fire of Creation and the vision of the Real in the world.

Posted on 2013-04-10 by Cologero

* * *

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-11 at 13:27 said:

I have not read this book but desire to after reading Evola's positive review.

Let me add though that the Liberal Catholic Church is a heretical breakaway sect based on Free-Masonry and rebellion against Vatican I and is not an apostolic Church.

Cologero on 2013-04-11 at 16:08 said:

I suspect, Jason-Adam, that Evola's review is better and more inspiring than the book itself, which may disappoint. Unfortunately, I can't locate my copy of the book which I had read quite some time ago.

Jason-Adam on 2013-04-11 at 17:35 said:

This is tangential but I feel it necessary to include this on a page devoted to Evola and the Church – I hope Avery will see this and comment as well :

Avery made an interesting remark that all the political Traditionalists are anti-Christian whereas the Christian Traditionalists are not involved in political movements. I believe this is because we are seeing the difference between brahmans (the Christians) and kshatriyas (the pagans). I offer as an opinion the reason why modern day kshatriyas in the west are driven to despise the Church is because the Church has failed to maintain the path of action, the old time warrior Christianity of the Crusades. What Catholic of today would praise Godfrey de Bouillon the saviour of Jerusalem ? One of my favourite works of epic poetry is Gerusalemme Liberata of Tasso's, would modern Catholics see themselves in that work ? Would any respectable theologian say with St Bernard that it is good and right to kill the enemies of the Catholic religion ? The general effeminacy and passivity of the modernist Church is turning away men of fighting spirit.

It is ironic that the main reason I am so drawn to catholicism, true catholicism, is that compared to the contemplative spirit of the eastern church, western catholicism is a religion of action as Soloviev eloquently explained in Russian and the Universal Church.

Michael on 2013-04-11 at 20:48 said:

Van de Leeuw's teaching sounds attractive. Who would not want to be filled with the power to overcome all obstacles? But chasing after this kind of experience is probably a waste of time. Better to just be men of action in fact rather than waiting for some move of the Spirit, and we will find that it has been the Spirit moving us all along after all.

Cologero on 2013-04-12 at 08:34 said:

Yes, Jason-Adam, you have identified the cause of the break up. I've noticed, however, that even the neo-pagans display images of Christian knights on their web sites, so they may not be as far from you as you may think. This split is bad for both sides. The "brahmans", as you call them even though they have not preserved the entire spiritual heritage, are attracting spirits of a certain type. Occasionally I check their writings and what is remarkable is the vitriol and antipathy they display toward their fellow religionists who doesn't accept that the church began – or recreated itself anew – in 1965. They are really modernists, perhaps with little quirks such as opposition to abortion; otherwise, spiritually they are quite similar.

The "kshatriyas", in their position, give up 1500 years of their history along with the deep metaphysical, spiritual, and moral teachings, etc. It seems to me that the battle needs to move to a different front and the spirituality appropriate for the kshatriya given its proper place.

Avery Morrow on 2013-04-12 at 12:57 said:

I agree that the split is bad for both sides. I will give Jason-Adam's question a shot. For me, Hannah Arendt's *The Human Condition* has been a key to this pagan-Christian puzzle. To summarize just some of her work: the ancients considered labor an animal necessity, and only who had absolutely no need for work could be considered freemen and citizens, who were suitably free of private hindrances to devote their lives to public work. So far, so Evola. Christianity cultivated this disgust for lowly animal needs into a complete rejection of the earthly city, which perhaps was becoming a burden for the late Romans. Thereafter you had Guenon's division of spiritual authority and temporal power, with only the spiritual being truly public. But even in the temporal world the proper distinction between public and private persisted and was widely understood.

Arendt identifies some modern inversals that even Evola did not seem to catch. She says that the modern devolution of power actually destroyed the idea of "public good" entirely in the West and replaced it with a confluence of private interests which slowly corrupts and devalues our sense of the public sphere. Furthermore, she identifies this counter-tradition with "society"! As opposed to the classical Senators and medieval peers, whose speech was truly free, modernity more and more requires people to agree with each other to achieve social graces. "The victory of equality in the modern world is only the political and legal recognition of the fact that society

has conquered the public realm, and that distinction and difference have become private matters of the individual.” (41)

The neopagan-Christian distinction is therefore obvious. Modernity basically tells religion and all other former public interests to step aside and let the private interests rule. Christians earnestly believe that they can accomplish their goals while following the rules of society. The Nouvelle Droite, from a utilitarian perspective at least, sees the Christian ideal as a waste of time, and wants nothing to do with “society”, because a true nation needs a national spirit. Yet I still do not believe that the neopagans are right from the deeper, spiritual perspective.

By the way, I recently read a Japanese spiritualist's idea of Christianity where he focused on the concept of “not peace, but a sword” and claimed that Christians should also be enemies to this world. It's certainly all there in the Bible, but it would be a very Protestant and un-traditional rereading.

Jason-adam on 2013-04-12 at 14:40 said:

I am glad to see my question brought out good points by both Cologero and Avery... ... I dont recall Evola discussing ever the concept of society but Avery's comments reminded me of Carl Schmitt discussing the differences, tension of, and basic opposition to state and society. The modern world is clearly the same thing as the liberal world and liberalism believes that the central place once occupied by spirituality should be replaced by private inquiry and skepticism. It is plain to see how this means the revolt against tradition. The catholic Church fought against this idea and tried to subjugate society to itself but after Vatican II it has accepted a role as punching bad of society and a refuge for old women nd closeted faggots... ... of course Schmitt was modern himself in believing that the state could be a substitute for spiritual authority which was the main flaw in fascism. i'm curious to see how Gentile describes the situation.

I am not a neopagan because, besides my feeling that catholicism explains the world in a better way than paganism can, my parents are catholics, my grandparents are catholics and my family has a heritage of being catholic knights. this may sound stupid but i dont feel a need to rebel against my family's history, even if the entire Church visible has become apostate, i dont see a need to abandon my beliefs. if need be i can live my life by myself separate from the world in the truest christian sense of the word.

This actually raises another question ; before my abandoning national bolshevism, I was constantly attacked by my former 'comrades' as being sentimental and reactionary for my views – so would you say that attachment to family and ancestors is emotional and should be overcome ? or is devotion to family the essence of Tradition ?

Cologero on 2013-04-12 at 17:41 said:

I'm not grokking this Avery. For example, just from the first paragraph. Evola criticized Christianity for sacralizing labour; he himself avoided it on the principles you noted. Did Christian

really invent “disgust for lowly animal needs”? Are you making defecation a pagan virtue? Are you saying that Guenon somehow invented or fabricated the concepts of spiritual authority and temporal power? There is no “thereafter”, it always was. Where does Guenon imply that only the spiritual authority is truly public?

Arendt adds nothing to this discussion and actually seems to be harming your intellectuality. A “confluence of private interests” is a professorial expression for unbridled individualism, or a “heap” rather than an organic society. Evola has definitely “caught” that, in ways that Arendt and her admirers cannot understand.

Christians “earnestly believe” they should be following the will of God, not the rules of society.

You are partly right about the new right. There is no “nation” without a national spirit; in that case, it is just a country. They reject Christianity as the expression of that spirit. It is an ideological position, not a utilitarian one.

Michael on 2013-04-12 at 19:58 said:

Just curious, where does identifying Christians with brahmins and neo-pagans with kshatriyas come from?

Avery Morrow on 2013-04-12 at 21:31 said:

Did Christian really invent “disgust for lowly animal needs”?

No, you’ve got it backwards. The pagans saw politics as part of the intellectual life. The Christians didn’t. That’s all I meant to say.

Arendt doesn’t stick to Evola’s line but I’m pretty sure she has got more figured out than you give her credit for: “The modern reversal followed and left unchallenged the most important reversal with which Christianity had broken into the ancient world ... The victory of the Christian faith in the ancient world was largely due to this reversal of the individual life for the body politic, which brought hope to those who knew that their world was doomed ... This reversal could not but be disastrous for the esteem and the dignity of politics.” (314)

Cologero on 2013-04-13 at 16:45 said:

It was just being used metaphorically, Michael, to show how one-dimensional the Christians had become.

12.13 The Idea of the World in the East

This very early review by **Julius Evola** of “The Science of Peace” and “The Science of the Sacred Word” originally appeared in *Bilychnis*, volume XXVI, September, 1925. This is part one of two parts. The third part will deal with the idea of the world in the West.²¹

As readers here know, Evola’s first book, *The Individual and the Becoming of the World*, was presented to the Free Theosophical Society in Rome; hence, he was aware of theosophical literature. **Bhagavan Das** was one of the figures who stood out to Evola, although apparently ignored by the Theosophical Society today. Evola expresses the reasons below, but it should be clear that Bhagavan Das’ knowledge of German idealism, particularly the thought of Fichte made an impression on Evola.

Bhagavan Das was an Indian Theosophist writing in the first half of the twentieth century. In true theosophical fashion, he claimed to have uncovered the *Pranava Vada* by **Gargayana**, which was dictated to him by a blind man who had memorized the million lines. Nevertheless, Evola has extraordinary high praise for the man and his works, claiming it was written for the Western mind. That is no doubt a side effect of his theosophical training, but he also relates Vedic ideas to Western thought, especially the German idealists.

In my research into Bhagavan Das, I found out that his works were also highly recommended by the Theosophist **Alice Bailey**. Curiously, there are some pagan circles in Russia²² that hold both Evola and Bailey both in high esteem, for reasons that escape me.

For those interested in the texts:

²¹This is not the American musician who goes by that name.

²²<https://web.archive.org/web/20170711193147/http://sicsa.huji.ac.il:80/13shnir.html>

The Science of Peace: <https://gornahoor.net/library/ScienceOfPeace.pdf>

The Science of the Sacred Word: http://www.makara.us/05ref/01books/pranavavada/pv_toc.htm

Background information on the Pranava Vada: <http://thecelestialnavigator.blogspot.com/2010/12/pranava-time.html>

First part

There is a point that whoever approaches oriental wisdom should keep constantly in mind and that instead, as far as I know, is neglected also by our major philologists is this: the quality and role by which its expressions in the East and in the West is experienced are in fact different. While among us, to experience a content means, approximately, to think it and to know how to speak it, so that the expression in its rational form is something that expresses it adequately and with which it is interchangeable, in the Oriental, the content instead draws its evidence from an interior and individual experience and, in respect to which, its expression is always an allusive sign, a symbol, a contingent image. Hence, simply translated oriental texts imported into Europe can only yield little or nothing: to translate an oriental text should not mean to put our words in the place, e.g., of Sanskrit words, but rather to seek for an inner reconstruction to take into account the profound explanation of that content, which in the Orient is supported not on the expression, but rather on an internal apperception, and therefore to make oneself give this same content back to rational mediation according to its own form. Such is the true translation, in respect to which the linguistic translation is something in fact secondary and subordinate, and only in this conditions can oriental metaphysics fit into the western mentality and can be not a simple object of erudite curiosity, but can operate in a vital way.

Now the work of Bhagavan Das, which we highly recommend to the

reader, represents the most serious and successful effort along such lines. Bhagavan Das is an Indian who has sketched out an austere discipline of western speculative culture, and joining it with singular gifts of penetration and critical awareness, he has proposed to give the essence of one of the greatest Indian metaphysical systems—the Vedanta—in an explanation proper to our European mentality, and thus (and in that is the superiority of his work in respect to various purely intellectual presentations previously attempted) to the dialectical and critical awareness elaborated by German idealism, in which that mentality has culminated. The Science of Peace represents a general placement, a taking of a purely speculative, synthetic and fully detailed position; the redaction of Gargayana's Pranava Vada is its later development that is deployed and shares in the opulent material of the Vedas, thereby leading the reader into the heart of the Indian tradition. It treats a work so complex and rich that the attempt to give it here in few words not just a summary, but even only the meaning and the more general lines is certainly rather risky. This is therefore a warning to the reader.

In the introductory section, Bhagavan makes us present at the rising of the moral crisis in man: doubt, anguish, the problem of certainty, that of the I and the not-I, and finally the anxious searching for a firm point, of a concept that can take account of the chaotic and contradictory material of experience. Various solutions proposed by the East and the West are little by little undertaken and then criticized and made to pass into other until it reaches an understanding of an opposition as the final foundation: on the one hand, the experience of multiplicity, the changeable, and the illusory refers, as in its condition, to something simple, firm, self-evident: to the I; on the other hand, the I does not have at all a pure experience of itself as such, but is inseparably connected to this dispersed, changeable, and uncertain matter of sensible reality, to which it is opposed. Having reached such a result, it remains to understand its meaning. Here the author moves onto a deductive procedure, discussing the Pranava Vada,

i.e., the “Science of the Sacred Word”.

The central point is that the truly absolute is not that which is simply itself in an emptiness of abstract identity, but rather that which is itself as negation of all that it is not, and that therefore it is at the same time the creative function of its “other”—of the particular, the contingent, and the changeable—if only as the simple antithesis, against which it strikes the awareness of the universal, if only as the simple matter generated only by giving life to the flame that, devouring it, reaffirms the point of infinity. One therefore has a dialectic concept of the Absolute, enclosed in the sacred word Aum, whose meaning is: aham etat na = “I-this-not” = “I am not this”; i.e., the idea of the Absolute as that supreme simplicity that draws itself from the synthesis of three movements: of an I, of a not-I or “this” opposed to it, and of a power that connects the three terms together according to a double function of creation (the I that poses the not-I) and of negation (the not-I dissolved and taken back into the I).

Brahman is exactly this syntheses in its aspect of actual, eternal, simultaneous unity of the three moments; a unity that is neither the one opposed nor the other, neither affirmation nor negation, neither universal nor particular, neither rest nor motion, etc. but something that transcends and contains them all, all contradictions and higher reconciliations. It is the *dvandvatitam*, opposed to the *dvandam*, i.e., to the relative, the process of which one can say, like Aristotle, that it is the *act* and the eternal substrate.

As to the *dvandvam*, it therefore includes everything that is determined through relationships, and is expressed in the three moments just mentioned.

Second part

Pratyagatma Pratyagatma, would be the I or Brahman understood in his immanent aspect so that it is determined by its opposite or not-I. It is

that which stays fixed and one within every variation, the universal, the point without extension, and the eternal required through the possibility of the experience of everything that is spatially multiple and temporal. From its relation to the not-I, which is essential to it, it nevertheless takes in three determinations:

1. Jnana = knowledge, as the moment according to which it places for itself and against itself or represents the not-I, the “this”
2. Kriya = action, as the moment according to which it is affirmed in the not-I
3. Iccha = will or desire according to which the possibility required by the preceding moments, of self-identification or disidentification from the not-I

Mulaprakriti Mulaprakriti, matter or not-I. As opposed to the I, which is the universal, it would be pure, dispersed particularity. Nevertheless, in as much as it is also tied to the I, it reflects in itself its characters, i.e., infinity, immobility, and eternity, however as that false infinity, immobility, and eternity that is characteristic to the infinite number of particulars, to the eternal of the “always finite” and the “always changeable”. The way that Bhagavan Das deduces the becoming of nature is interesting. If one could take the not-I in its totality, it would be possible to conceive its negation in a single simultaneous act; but the character of the not-I is instead particularity. Now the particular does not have a *contradictory* that negates it suddenly, but rather a *contrary* that negates it successively. More clearly: being can be negated suddenly by non-being; but heat has instead is negation in the cold that follows it. So the “I am not this” of the supreme synthesis, the reflection in mulaprakriti, has the meaning of “I am not this, but this other; not this other, but still this other” and so on, in a succession and an indefinite recurrence of opposites that negate

each other, the one after the other, in a current through eternal revolution and eternal craving. Such is the truth of nature, the eternal wheel of beings and rebirths. The unlimitedness of the world as becoming is therefore only a self-reflection, onto the many things, of the unlimitedness of Brahman—the transcendent One without limitation.

Mayashakti Mayashakti, which is the demiurgic power from which creation and destruction proceeds and from which the various relationships between I and not-I are determined and governed. Under a first aspect is pravritti, i.e., the direction by which knowledge pushes itself in a certain way beyond itself and, identifying itself, associating itself with a particular material, becomes conscious of a such and such determined finite being. Under a second aspect is nivritti, that through which the I reconverges, detaches itself from particularity, negates it, and little by little elevates itself in every higher degrees of synthetic consciousness and of universality, reflected by the hierarchy of the beings of nature approaching man, to whom in his turn the way of the yogis and rishis is destined up to the limit of the brahmanjanis, or “those who know” Brahman.

Conclusion Here we cannot even sketch the ample and complex developments given by Bhagavan Das to this conception; on the basis of the ternary rhythm contained in AUM transposed on various “octaves”, he has the means of giving deductively not only the general lines of a logic, of a music, of an anthropology, of a theory of knowledge, but also of the rituals, symbols, of traditional mythology, thus reaching a true system of Indian knowledge. We pause only on one point. The I in itself, contains and negates in a single act the totality contradicted by the infinite particulars of infinite oppositions. This synthesis therefore is obscured at the level of finite existence, which instead experiences a particular or group of particulars at the same time: these are for them the real and the actual, the rest are pushed back into the past and into the future, as

virtual, whose unity (i.e., that total synthesis described above) is nevertheless ideally presupposed by him, in the sense that it makes those universal concepts possible, which is needed in order to be orientated and organize his own finite experience. Now this problem arises: how can one conceive the coexistence of the finite I (jiva) in whom only a part of possible experience is actual, with that "I" in which all is actual (Brahman)?

Bhagavan Das' answer is that whatever is virtual for a single particular consciousness, is on the other hand actual for other consciousnesses, and is explained with a rather nice image. Let us suppose a gallery of paintings immersed in the darkness, and a person with a lamp capable of illuminating only one of them at a time; this person will pass from painting to painting, excluding thereby the rest of them, relegating them into a past or a future. Let us now assume as many persons as paintings: for each one of them the same could be said, however the opposition of an actual and a virtual; but in their wholeness they will succeed in entirely illuminating the gallery that they walk through freely substituting themselves each one with the other. Such is the relationship of pratyagatma or universal consciousness with the consciousness of the individuals; a pure brainwave pulling itself from the infinite process with which infinite individualities, by identifying and disidentifying themselves, experience, and transcend step by step, they pose and negate the infinite multiplicity characteristic of the non-I.

Even by this fleeting review, the interest that the works here mentioned should generate is obvious. These works should therefore not be missing from the library of all those who turn to the East not out of extrinsic curiosity or a craving for exoticism, but through a true interest; and that therefore they desire to have the spirit and the concept of traditional wisdom, not erudite and philological representations, discourses, and disquisitions about them, as unfortunately is the case of the great number of the publications of our orientalists which, to tell the truth, too often resemble eyeglasses without eyes.

The Idea of the World in the West

This the the concluding part of review by **Julius Evola** that originally appeared in *Bilychnis*, volume XXVI, September, 1925. In this section, he discusses the book *L'idea e il mondo* by R. Pavese, while comparing it to the ideas previously discussed about Bhagavan Das. I know nothing of Pavese and he does not seem to have made any impact on subsequent philosophy. Nevertheless, the review brings up good points. In particular, there is the insistence that speculative thought is vague and useless without a spiritual practice to bring such thought into realization.

Regarding what we just said about the Pranavavada²³, the reader will have observed by himself—as Bhagavan Das did not fail to observe—the many analogous points that oriental views share with what has been developed in recent European speculative thought. One would almost be tempted to think of a sort of great cycle of culture, at whose end some themes proposed at the beginning would be reintroduced, although on another octave. It is, for example, surprising how close to the Pranavavada is the conception constructed by R. Pavese. In his own way, starting fromgnoseological idealism, as opposed to which he reaffirms the legitimate requirement that it is not sufficient to return to the so-called “transcendental I” and to a priori logic, but rather it is necessary to determine a conception of these, which takes into account our concrete experience, reality, and physical discoveries in which it has developed. Otherwise, one might just as well exile philosophy into a world of vague and useless abstractions.

The meaning of the conception he proposed is, approximately, the following. God cannot be conceived as absolute transcendence unless in reference to a contrasting, absolute immanence, as eternity is in contrast to temporal becoming. Therefore by showing effectively the process

²³https://www.makara.us/05ref/01books/pranavavada/pv_toc.htm

that generates this opposition in order to then reconcile it in a higher inspiration, we have approximately the same idea condensed in the sacred word AUM. Although for Pavese, one pole is the idea as “logical comprehensiveness”, the other is matter as physical extension and energetic field. The two poles correspond to each other (that which ideally is concept logically comprehending the various known things, objectively is the “nucleus” that dominates a “certain energetic field”, and vice versa) and they convert into each other. It is like a cyclic flux of “precipitation” and “sublimation”. On the one hand there is the idea that realizes itself and, in that way, engenders physical extension, existence in space and time, from that logical comprehensiveness: such is the “practical” or natural phase that implies a beginning of relative unconsciousness, since the idea is immersed in it, it loses itself in its act, making itself brute power.

On the other hand, there is the nature that reconverges, the idea that reclaims itself from that multiplicity and that existence into which it had degraded itself, and it reincludes it in a new spiritual unity, that is proper to the concept and knowledge in general. Such is the conscious, “theoretical” phase opposed to the natural unconscious process. But the two moments, as was said, are simultaneous and recurrent: it is a flux that rises from one place and descends from the other without interruption, according to an unending vortex that makes spirit from matter and matter from spirit. The two directions, intersecting each other, give rise to nodes or “inflection points”, in which the eternal cycle is reflected in miniature and which would correspond to individual beings. The identity, the absolute adequation of idea and reality, of comprehension and extension, nucleus and field, simple form and plural matter, is found only in God, the eternal “concept” of cosmic becoming, to become what is His “conception” or content, in which He circulates with alternating rhythms. In finite individuals, identity is instead a “having to be”, something to which they tend, since the order of nature is precisely defined by an eternal imbalance of the two moments from which its becoming arises.

Pavese's originality lies in his bold placing in reciprocal conversions the logical comprehension of a concept with the extension of an energetic field understood as its objective correlative. That gives him a way to graft onto a dialectic scheme, that reminds us of Proclus and Spinoza, the views of recent physics and mechanics, and thereby extends the speculative penetration right into the very heart of the concreteness established in science. In the second place, in the effort of dynamizing, of making "fluid", of gathering in simultaneity the moments of the process, it results in a type of classificatory system of other conceptions. Opposed to that, there is the lack of an organic and systematic exposition and a certain obscurity and convolutedness of expression.

In similar oriental and occidental conceptions, one must nevertheless ask up to what point is it critically justifiable to place oneself at the Absolute, in order to deduce all the rest from that. A Cartesian argument attempted by Pavese is, to tell the truth, inadequate. Similarly for Bhagavan Das, it is true that he first proceeds inductively starting from the analysis of the nature of human experience; but when he then tries to explain the result of that analysis with a deduction, even he makes, and cannot help but make, a leap: the two methods cannot be joined together. Deduction can offer only probable explicative principles in order to interpret the data of fact and, as such, they are deprived of necessity and convertibility. It is therefore necessary to note that the criterion of certainty for the Oriental is not criticism and logic, but rather that of a "transcendental experience". It is, for example, said that the Vedas are the expositions of what the *rishis* have *seen*. For the *rishi*, meaning those who have realized themselves up to the level of Brahman, the deductive procedure of their knowledge could have in itself the character of intrinsic evidence and a justification, that cannot appear to those who look at it from the level of finite existence.

Posted on 2013-04-28 by Cologero

12.14 Outline/Summary for Evola's Revolt

Housekeeping note: *Logres* is the pen name of M. Smallwood, and I appreciate the fellowship and camaraderie of all those here, and at Gnosis group; I thank you all, and also our host. What follows is an outline of the foreword to *Revolt against the Modern World*, an executive summary, Evola's own review, and a few footnotes. There will be a discussion Thursday, starting with a few high points and remarks from the Foreword. Evola claims to establish a metaphysics of history, a possibility denied or inverted by all modern thought. His purpose is to aid those who either can, or will be able, to awake from modern history. We will look closely at the text in the foreword, focus on his insights, and discuss. Food for thought: Contrast Evola's work with the Durant's *History of the World*, O. Spengler's *The Decline of the West*, or A. Toynbee's *History of Civilizations*, or even Marxist anti-metaphysic purporting to give the meaning of history.

Between the desire
And the spasm,
Between the potency
And the existence,
Between the essence
And the descent,
Falls the Shadow.

T. S. ELIOT

I. An Outline for the Foreword in Revolt Against the Modern World

A. Justification and Need for the volume Amateurish "intellectuals" have wrung their hands over the "West" while lacking true principles, retain (due to passions) false principles they ostensibly reject, and

get caught up generally in “contingent and terminal” forms which are the spasms of false principles to begin with. None of these “reactions” have positive value, only possessing value as a symptom merely, like the sleepwalker whose deep sleep prevents him from noticing he is ambling about on a dreadful height or precipice, subject to the ever-increasing likeliness of tumbling lifelessly down into ruin. This is a protective mechanism which creates an illusory “limit”, allowing the disease to run a terminal course before detection, thereby creating a better climate for the inevitable death of the patient. This process has only lately been detected, and ineffectually, although ancient man was well aware of its possibility and outcome. This demonstrates that the process robbed man of even an awareness of “true normalcy and health”. On the contrary, we must dig ever deeper to uncover the true root of the disease (as opposed to symptoms, since treating symptoms will not lead to a good outcome). A foundation, a center, a principle gives rise to true action, rather than reaction, and men today are incapable of anything but reflexive protest. Even experience teaches that nothing salutary happens in this way: we cannot toss and turn on a bed of agony – the point is awaken and arise. The real starting point is not to protest “technocracy” or “consumerism”, but to find the root. The real still exists, invisible and mute – we have to acquire eyes and ears to see it. This would be an absolute reference point. This would be a point of understanding modern deviation and simultaneously, mounting an effective defense²⁴. “The only thing that matters is the silent endurance of a few”. This will induce liberating crisis in those around them.

²⁴The energies that have been liberated, or are in the course of liberation, are not such as can be reconfined within the structure's of yesterday's world. The very fact that attempts at reaction have referred to those structures alone, which are void of any superior legitimacy, has made the subversive forces all the more vigorous and aggressive. *Evola*.

B. Purpose This is my task, within my limitations, to contribute to this work of establishing the total decadence of the modern world. It is upon the ruins of real civilization that the "Modern" has been constructed, and this realization will provide the true foundation for revolt, clarifying what is reacted against and in what name (legitimacy). The cadaverous wisdom of "Progress" glorifies defeated, decrepit man as the ultimate standard, outside of which is supposedly darkness and nothing. This intransigence and Lie proves the blindness of the Modern.²⁵ It is not merely that we gain a certain perspective from realizing the relativity of "the Modern" in studying what is past, but we also see that from the perspective of what is Past, the Modern simply "is not": the disappearance of the Modern will itself mean nothing, from the vantage point of Tradition. I call this the "dualism of civilizations" (as opposed to merely the "relativity of civilizations"). There is a moral dimension, not merely a historical one, at work here. One possesses Being, the other is built upon illusions. They are different types.²⁶

C. Thesis In the 8th-6th centuries BC, the process of involution and degradation began, when "History" actually began. There have been several phases following, including the fall of Rome/advent of Christianity, the decay of the feudal order and Empire, and the advent of humanism and Reformation. All of these are Iron Age phenomenon, the "Wolf Age". Underground forces have become more and more manifest, and the process of decay swifter and swifter, more decisive, more universal. It will seal the collective fate of millions. This is the historical and relative side. The fact that we cannot trace it further shows how deep the process

²⁵"Those whom the gods wish to destroy, they first make mad". Livy.

²⁶They are "unequals". Any argument about which is "better" is pointless, or incomplete. One is an actual civilization, the other is the opposite of that.

had already gone, & how a reaction must step outside of history.²⁷ Any civilization that bases itself in the "temporal" will eventually fall prey to these same forces. It is "accidental" that true Tradition lies outside of Time, however, that accident demonstrates where we should begin.²⁸

"These things did not just happen once, but they have always been" – a fog cannot obliterate the heavens. The best of "modern" scholarship is a display of ignorance at best. Although a relative value can be placed on the results of their research if they are used from another perspective, there is always a tendency of other influences to creep in, the presence of which are subtle. Myth, legend, and epic have a high validity in this line of inquiry²⁹. Our perspective is super-individual and non-human.³⁰ These truths either Are or Are Not: they cannot be debated or even discussed (in the modern way). It is only possible to remember. They are constant and central and equivalent, regardless of how difficult to discern or how fragmentary in application. "Certainty and transcendence and universal objectivity is innerly established" by them. Nothing can destroy them, nor can they be reached by alternate means.

D. Method For the first part of the volume, I intend to identify by correspondences the traces of what is spiritual, true, certain, and objective (which must be made to speak and to appear) which are homologous across all times and places – this will result in one Truth which is invariant, transcendent, and the origin. Having achieved this, in part two,

²⁷Thucydides, for instance, had a modern conception of history, and is the father of "history". Ancient man had no concept of "Time" as we do.

²⁸I take his meaning here to be that, from a modern point of view, the descent into history represents a happy evolutionary accident, or at best, a kind of historical twist, which lead to the randomly meaningless but ultimately beneficial situation we find ourselves in today.

²⁹Wagner's *Parzifal* is interesting from this point of view: a look at ancient myths and "new" ones (the Grail).

³⁰He doesn't speak of a "superman" like Nietzsche, but of what is "non-human"

we will proceed (with this knowledge) using induction, “a discursive approximation of a spiritual intuition”, which will clarify the pathways and etiology of decline, as well as inform us as to the greater and lesser degrees the truth was manifested. (So part one is “seeing” what is of value in the wreck, part two is understanding the trajectory of the wreck through its relation to what is real). This induction of part two is neither eclectic (as in the sense of picking a certain language best suited to subject or person) nor comparative (just as using parallaxes to find the location of star³¹ is not mere comparison). The result will be “the same one meaning and same one principle”. This will lay the foundations for an eventual positive and effective revolt, against what is passively and semi-consciously accepted today. Those who defend the “concrete” of the modern world ought to be told, not “Stop!” but “Go Ahead!”: “the pit must be filled: there is a need for fertilizer for the new tree that will grow out of your collapse”³².

E. Result This work will provide guiding principles and essential elements – certainly entire volumes more could be written. These forms and ideas are not “realities”, but that which makes “realities” possible: their value is independent of that which they establish, which will never be “perfect”. Of course there are imperfections – but this argument would eventually invalidate any reality³³. Indeed, from this point of view, establishing what is normal and healthy may be no less possible today than yesterday, as even in the past Tradition was not lived up to. We are providing here a “metaphysics of history”, allowing us to trace the genesis

³¹Using parallaxes allows someone in a seemingly relative position without hope of measurement to actually triangulate a relative position vis a vis other distant and also relative points. Erasthenes used the variant positions of shadows on obelisks at Alexandria and in Nubia to calculate the exact circumference of the earth.

³²Guido de Giorgio quoted here.

³³It is certainly true that even traditional civilizations did not utterly do away with sin, injustice, or imperfection (view it how you will).

of the modern world, and at the same time, embrace what is symbolical, super-historical, and normative. The result will be sufficiently enough (but not exhaustive) for those who are either already awake, or possess the possibility of awakening.

II. Executive Summary of Evola's Volume Evola delineates his purpose in the Foreword to *Revolt Against the Modern World*, in a manner to obviate, absolutely, any potential misunderstanding. He clearly explains that the work is a beginning, and a foundational contribution to the preservation of Tradition (rather than a complete edifice, which would require "volumes"). He is laying a foundation in the sense that he uncovers and defends in an absolute and definitive way that which is, strictly speaking, absolutely necessary to the recovery and manifestation of those principles. Astoundingly, it will be a "metaphysics" of history, a possibility denied or inverted by all modern thought forms (eg., Spengler, Marx, liberalism, degenerate Christian schools of thought, etc.) Because most Western thought involves and invokes a modicum of history & theory, it is helpful to explain Tradition both as a counterpoint to modern historicism (Part One: the unreducible remainder of the "Myths"), and also as a non-historical object that has maintained a decisive presence even in a period which has abandoned it in favor of the temporal continuum, as well as denying it clear and full expression (Part 2).

Therefore, Tradition manifests, in a positive sense in the myths and legends and even some historical periods of the Past (Part 1), & also as deprivation and endurance (a negative sense) during the period of its so-called eclipse (Part 2), the period in which modernity and anti-Tradition enjoy a titulary and technical dominance that saturates Being today and heavily hampers even the possibility of conceiving Life differently from its current distortions. Because of this, his book includes the "death" of tradition (in the 6th-8th centuries), & traces the presence in the periods following this immersion in the heightened historical sense (an immer-

sion which springs to life, for instance, in the histories of Thucydides). However, he also seeks knowledge "beyond" the historical period (Part One). In this way, he not only traces the rise of Tradition's opposite (Revolution in a pure sense), but forcefully proves the reality of Tradition in a period which did not perfectly or even greatly manifest it (in Evola's mind, there is a distinction between the essence of Tradition which manifests, and the vehicles it uses, as well as the degree or particular form to which it perfects itself: this is why he divides his work into two parts, Part 1 being concerned with the Essence, Part 2 with the particular "story" of how Tradition manifested).

That this is not a virtuoso parlor trick of the intellect is further shown by the perfect interchangeability and equivalent nature of Tradition throughout the historical continuum in various highly contrasting periods (eg., Greek and Aztec), as also by the fact that this very Tradition radiates an energy which something else has twisted and distorted, making possible the very decay which presumes to deny the primordial source of its remaining power and twisted legitimacy. Evola demonstrates all of this with crystal accuracy, sourcing primary texts, and restates the unwritten thesis in language and arguments suitable particularly for the Western seeker, even the one who is interested in comparing the Western tradition with other traditions. Not only does Evola's thesis possess far more explanatory power than its logical competition (it should be remembered that explanatory power alone is practically the sole criteria of certain higher forms of scientific argument)³⁴, it is internally coherent in a way which demonstrates its freedom from truncated and merely ideological solutions to the "problems" of Life. Another way to put this would be that it is not merely analogically compatible with what we find in history and pre-history, but homologous.

You may find it useful to compare the above with what follows below,

³⁴It is certainly true that even traditional civilizations did not utterly do away with sin, injustice, or imperfection (view it how you will).

which is the

III. Editorial Presentation to the First Edition (Evola's Own Anonymous Review) "The seemingly polemical title of this work conceals a powerful historical and metaphysical reconstruction, as the basis for the in-depth understanding the greatest problems of the current age.

The author's fundamental idea is the opposition between two types of civilizations, called "traditional" and "modern" respectively: the former, based on the values of pure spirituality, aristocracy, and hierarchy; the latter, rooted in the purely human, secular, and contingent element. With a series of summaries, the fundamental meanings are given that used to dominate in the living, believing, knowing, acting, ruling, and self-transcending of "traditional man": meanings that an in-depth examination of the most varied texts and evidence are shown to be remarkably identical in all the greatest civilizations of the past. In a second part, the processes are made precise that, in a type of fall, led from the traditional world to the modern world. From the exploration of prehistory, in order to which it throws unsuspected light, the investigation proceeds in an historic outline that extends to the birth of the new Russian-American barbarism. The Aryan civilizations, then the Roman and Ghibelline, in the author's presentation appears as great luminous culminations in this sequence of events over millennia and as symbols of perennial current events.

In a conclusion, the author poses the problem of future times. That last world of the book is not so much a "decline of the West", but instead a profession of heroic faith, precisely a call for the spiritual revolt after having had the courage of looking into the depths and its most remote roots that world of decadence, against which today those who believe in the highest possibilities of our Revolution, fight.

The book, of which a German translation is in preparation, has a totally particular character, in order to join a series of truly revolutionary

historical views to a very serious, scientific documentation presented in an incisive, suggestive, and fully accessible style.

Revolt against the modern world is not a book of sterile polemics, but of serious culture, particularly illuminating for those who want to understand, through a series of quick summaries, the meaning of history and the spirit of the greatest civilizations and institutions of the past as the positive basis to achieve to a truly reconstructive action.

It therefore interests anyone who is not indifferent in the face of the great problems that in the present hour assail the people and from which solutions will depend the destinies of the future world and of Western man in particular."

Posted on 2015-08-22 by Logres

* * *

Alistair Fraser on 2015-08-24 at 18:27 said:

Logres , i am pleased to be reading yours and the hosts and others illuminating works , and good tidings from scotland , i am adding my own inputs in various areas

Mark Citadel on 2015-08-25 at 15:17 said:

I feel I am definitely going to have to read this one again. My highest recommendation to anyone is to read Guenon's Crisis first, its a gentler introduction to the concepts Evola dives into.

12.15 The Metaphysics of Sex and the One

Interim Note on Being One with Everything

Pantheism does not admit the existence of individual beings.

Pantheism offers only the perspective of letting oneself be lulled by the undulation of the ocean of deified nature.

VALENTIN TOMBERG

There is a photo of **Giulio Cogni** in **Julius Evola's** *Sintesi di dottrina della razza* with the following caption:

An Italian Nordic-Aryan type of the body with an Amazonian race of the spirit. Actually, it is a matter of a person, in whose theories an external energetic and almost Promethean aspect is mixed with a Demetrian-Lunar pantheistic vision of the world with a special recognition given to the feminine element.

Giulio Cogni was a philosopher, music critic (a specialist on Wagner), and an author of books on Eastern spirituality. After the German-Italian alliance in the 1930s, there was a scramble among Italian intellectuals to outline a Fascist understanding of race, in opposition to the German's. The consensus was a more spiritual understanding of race. Thus Julius Evola published several works on the topic. His young friend, Massimo Scaligero, published a book on race based on some ideas from Anthroposophy. Giulio Cogni, who was a follower of the philosopher Giovanni Gentile, tried to reconcile Alfred Rosenberg with the situation in Italy. From the snippets I've found, Cogni denied the notion of racial superiority and, not unlike Evola, claimed that "Aryan" referred to a spiritual quality rather than a biological quality.

After the defeat of WWII, Evola more or less abandoned the topic. Scaligero and Cogni, on the other hand, managed to rebrand themselves: Scaligero as an Anthroposophist and Cogni as a Vedantist. As an indication of their success, some of their articles have been republished in the American *Yoga Journal*, with no mention of their Fascist past.

After the war, Evola's and Cogni's life paths diverged. I did find a rather long review by Evola of Cogni's book *Io sono te: sesso e oblazione* ("I am you: sex and offering"), which highlights the differences between the two thinkers and would explain Evola's evaluation of Cogni.

In that book Cogni proposes a pantheistic worldview based, as he claims, on the Vedanta: "we are all one". That logically leads to an undifferentiated view of the human situation, which includes promiscuous

sex, self-sacrifice, and androgyny. Since Cogni articulates in an intelligent and sophisticated way many of the commonly held views in the modern world, the review is an apt essay for discussion.

Being Cogni bases his ideas on the notion of the Vedantic One, as he understands it to indicate the overcoming of all distinctions. Quoting Hegel, Evola describes this view as “the night in which all the cows are black”. I noticed this years ago when I participated in a **Nisargadatta** discussion group. The consensus view in that group was that, as an enlightened being, he more or less disappeared into the “One”. Nevertheless, as I pointed out, he spoke, responded to his name, etc., but that had little impact on the discussion.

In that view, there is only undifferentiated Being, so the beings we experience are illusions. “Whose” illusions they are, or why those “illusions” take such a specific form, or why do different people experience a similar world, was never made clear if only the One exists.

Jacques Maritain, in *The Degrees of Knowledge* provides a more satisfying answer. When I know Peter, I judge him to be a man, but even more fundamentally, I have an intuition of Peter as a being. This intuition is found everywhere, it “saturates all things”. Maritain explains our experience of Being.

Being is a primordial and general conceptual object which is at once and from the beginning essentially diverse in the diverse subjects in which the mind discovers it. What is primarily known, and in which every object of thought is resolved for the intellect, is being. But nothing can be added to it extrinsically to differentiate it, for all its differentiations issue from its own depths.

In other words, Being is known through beings. *Pace* Cogni, Being is already highly differentiated. In the Western tradition, this is expressed as the doctrine of the consubstantiality of the Logos with Being. Evola expresses the same notion in a slightly different way:

The One dominates a well-articulated order of differences (a cosmos, in the Hellenic sense).

So, "Illusion" has a much different connotation. For Cogni, the illusion is the separateness and distinction of beings, which are ultimately part of Brahman. However, illusion is actually much more subtle, and hence, more difficult to eradicate. The illusion arises from our failure to grasp the meaning of the Whole and how the parts are interconnected. This is due to the weakness of the intellect and erratic emotional reactions.

Descending and Ascending Movements Evola claims that Cogni fails to distinguish between the subconscious and the superconscious, with the following consequence:

Cogni has no sense of the fact that just as an "integrative ascending self-transcendence" exists, so a divisive descending self-transcendence also exists for the true personality. That is, there are possible openings of the I both toward the higher as well as toward the lower, which also means toward "nature", toward the unconscious, toward the vital formless bottom.

In an early essay, *The Holy Spirit & the Sophia*, Tomberg describes that downward movement in these steps.

First the Logos descends to the conscious I. If the I is oriented to the Logos above, it is ascendant. This supersensory "Temple of Wisdom" or "House of Sophia" is the knowledge of the Whole (but not of every individual fact).

However, that movement can continue downward in these stages, each with its own type of intelligence:

- **Hunger.** The stream of the Logos is brought down to the level of digestive activity. This leads to a logic in which the stomach and its interests determine logic and conclusions. This is the level of Marx.

- **Sex.** The stream is brought down to the instinctive life. This is the level of Freud and psychoanalysis.
- **Nature.** The stream descends to the subterranean spheres. This logic may seem quite convincing. At its lowest point, the individual no longer thinks independently, but thoughts arise through him.

Pantheism Tomberg distinguished between theism, pantheism, and naturalism, which are valid on different planes:

- **Naturalism:** only what is experienced through the senses is real
- **Pantheism:** thought alone can grasp the world. Existence is illusory, only the Absolute, One, Brahman, or God is real
- **Theism:** Transcends rational thought. Existence not strictly logical, i.e., cannot be derived from thought.

Evola offers something similar in this comment:

So Cogni denies that that polarity is an essential requirement of eros, which he believes concerns only the naturalistic plane, like electrical and similar phenomena. That means that for him all the documentation that we have gathered, in an entire chapter, from the most varied cultural areas, regarding the “metaphysical dyad”, might as well not exist because it contradicts his promiscuous pantheism.

Thus, on the naturalistic plane, any sexual experience is worthwhile in its own right if it is observed in natures. Neither electricity nor eros depends on anything higher. For pantheism, the male-female polarity is just a form of thought with no ultimate reality. It is no more than one particular expression of sexuality.

Not to forget that the young Evola's first book was a translation and commentary of the *Tao Te Ching*, he understands that, on the metaphysical level, the Yin-Yang, male-female, dyad is fundamental. Hence, sexual expression on the physical plane needs to mirror that.

Postscript on Sexual Intelligence The flip side of Evola's critique is that Cogni has empirical experience and contemporary mores on his side. As we saw above, the sex instinct has its own logic and intelligence. Those who have "transcended" the self in the descending direction will be baffled by appeals to sexual restraint based on higher principles.

The occultist **Alice Bailey** seemed to have had an intuition of this, making predictions that have largely come to pass. In *Esoteric Healing*, she wrote:

Inter-marriage between nations and races, the fusion of bloods for hundreds of years—due to migration, travel, education and mental unity—has led to there being no really pure racial types to-day. This is far more certainly the case than the most enlightened think, if the long, long history of mankind is considered.

The European wars of last century, not to mention more recent turmoil, have certainly exacerbated those four factors. Eros, or the sexual drive, is potent, even to the point of overcoming barriers:

Sexual intercourse knows no impenetrable barriers . . . The urge to mate becomes peculiarly strong when men are removed from their familiar settings and experience the novelty of complete loneliness, when the normal inhibitions and customs imposed by family relationships and national standards are removed, when danger of death is constantly faced and the larger value submerges the lesser values and the usual conventional attitudes

Appendix on the 120 Days of Sodom Curiously, Evola accuses Cogni of tending towards the sexual excesses of the **Marquis de Sade**. This may not be so far-fetched, given the tendency of some on social media to associate the “right” with bondage, domination, and so on. They are not to be taken seriously.

Nevertheless, the Italian communist film director **Pier Paolo Pasolini** created a work based on de Sade’s book, but situated it in the Salo Republic. Perhaps he derived that association from Cogni, but certainly not from Evola who rejected such practices. Paradoxically, it was Pasolini himself who advocated sexual experimentation. He was murdered by an underage hitchhiker who objected to Pasolini’s proposition to sodomize him with a broomstick.

Translation

Evola’s review of Giulio Cogni’s book *Io sono te: sesso e oblazione* (You and I: sex and offering).

In general, we do not believe that discussions have a meaning and a seriousness unless it essentially aspires to a clarification in the premises of a common base. If a writer is able to recognize the fundamental premises of his own thought (whether or not tied to a “personal equation”) and sees his fundamental difference in respect to those of another writer, the only serious thing is that he follows his own way without trying to insert himself in an intellectual world foreign to him. Unfortunately that happens rarely, due to the lack of such a preliminary self-analysis. That does not limit us to an inescapable criticism of other people’s views (which is of course approvable and fruitful), but is put on a confused argument: precisely because of the heterogeneity of basic conceptions. That demonstrates fundamentally the activity of subrational explanations.

For this reason, we would not have considered that a book titled *Io*

*sono te: sesso e oblazione*³⁵ was by Giulio Cogni. The author has certainly believed he included in it an essay on our work, the *Metaphysics of Sex*. That would not be as important as the fact that in the circumstances grave confusions and distortions weighed on a domain that goes beyond the ideas that we've espoused in various places. Hence, the opportunity of a development that, apart every polemic need, intends to highlight some ensemble of ideas which may be of interest for the reader.

The views of *I am you* reproduce, in its essentials, that which Cogni had already expressed in another book, *Saggio sull'amore* [Essay on Love], published in 1922. At that time, someone wisely said that Cogni, at that time a Gentilian through the skin, had translated the Gentilian theory of the "spirit as pure act" into a more sapid "theory of the spirit as impure act", since he recognized in the sexual union a principle concrete form of the identification of the subject with the object postulated by Gentile's actualism. Moreover, Cogni formulated a phagic or anthropophagic theory: love, would mean eating oneself, devouring oneself. A similar thesis in his new book: where "the famous hunger — sex, hunger-love, equation" is established. Previously, Cogni presented the situation in rather masochistic terms: man eaten by the woman in whom he was absorbed and lost himself as individuality. In the more recent exposition erotic anthropophagy seems to be conceived as reciprocal, turning out however to be little imaginable because, ironically, he would want to think that at the end of the lovers, there remained only two mouths, each being ingested and consumed wholly by the other.

If it all ended here, with phagia, it would be said the Cogni was inspired only by the crudest aspect of sexuality: the "hunger" of bodies, simple lustful longing. But suddenly he proceeds to appositions that are in complete contrast with what, as analogy, might suggest "eating" and hunger. In fact, Cogni always returns again to self-denial, to sacrificial offering, the abandonment of oneself that there would be in eroticism

³⁵ *You and I: Sex and Offering*.

and in sexual union. Carnal pleasure would be “complete renunciation of oneself in order to make oneself the other.”

He moves directly to a type of mysticism: “the sexual act is humility of annihilation and sacrifice of oneself to the universal life that is seen in the body of the beloved”. “Love is phagic because only with the gift of the body and with devouring and making oneself devoured one realizes the more powerful symbol of Unity: every alleged individual separation is removed.” The ultimate goal is “the immersion of the cosmic One without a second.” All this seems to us pure digression, even with a slight paranoid tint.

First of all, about the incongruence between the points of view, it must be pointed out that in hunger and in phagia presented as the keys of sex, there is nothing of this sacrificial orientation, of the abandonment of oneself, and of “sweet” identification (sweet is a word that often recurs in Cogni even in connection to sadomasochistic situations; that would point, to malign him, at the strong preference, usually female, for products of the confectionary industry instead of the prevalent manly taste for spicy and peppered food). indeed, in hunger the need operates by suffering from a deprivation, while eating leads only its own conservation and satiety: exactly the opposite of the abandonment of the sacrificial gift of oneself. Nothing sweet, then, if hunger is absolute, devouring. And since Cogni even makes almost a dogma out of anthropophagy in its proper sense, he does not know that in it, at most, the situation is not different: it is multiply attested that if the savage feeds himself with the flesh of others, he does not do it for a “sweet” identification, but only and darkly because he believed he absorbs the other’s strengths to this own advantage. As for eating the flesh of sacrificial victims, it is a fantasy to say that in it the tendency acts to submerge oneself in the cosmic One. In general, here everything comes down to totemic participation (the victim incarnates the totem), then a rather restricted order, shadowed by sorcery and demonism typical of totemism in general. Therefore, these are very

fragile and inconsistent bases for the advocated theses referring to sex. And the Eucharistic symbol, if one does not want to totally contaminate it by discovering in it rather suspect roots, is reduced to a mere allegory.

As far as we are concerned, the fundamental intention of the book *Metaphysics of Sex* was to highlight the existence of a possible transcendent dimension of sex. We tried to lead the transcendental meaning of eros (in the almost Kantian sense) back to a dark, unconscious impulse to restore an original wholeness, which we referred as the most noted mythical formulation in the West, to the Platonic theory of the androgyne. Besides, we found that phenomena of transcendence could intervene in the erotic-sexual experience of a momentary traumatic removal of the common conditionality of the individual consciousness, we showed that this was the presupposition of practices of some environments, especially the Oriental, in which it was done in a magical, initiatic, or evocatory use of sex. But all that is quite far from Cogni's mystical-phagic digressions, and every confusion in this regard is deplorable.

First of all, we should not generalize by attributing the strong value of transcendence to that which is typical of almost all sexual unions of human beings. What appears in the metaphysical or transcendental cannot be made of value in the phenomenological. In a phenomenological examination fall all the idealizing and mystical fixations, with the very sweet sacrifice and the sacrificial surpassing of oneself in the flesh of the other which Cogni always comes back to. Factually, in most sexual intercourse, one partner seeks only his *own* pleasure, making the other the means, so that the situation is not very dissimilar, *sit venia verbis*, from a "masturbation duet". Therefore nothing overcomes the individual bond. In the second place, existentially, often, and today more than ever, sex is of value to the individual only as a self-confirmation, only to assert a "need" (*Geltungstrieb* as Adler would say), or to look for an illusory, turbid substitute for a true sense of existence, of which he is deprived: then, again, no exit from the closed circle of the individual. Finally, as we said

and also highlighted in our book, if sporadic phenomena of “transcendence” in the profane experience of sex can sometimes be verified, they often are not *experienced* as such. They are realized in apical forms to the trauma of the organism which represent, for the most part, a solution of continuity of the consciousness from which one returns emptied, instead of having had the “shining experience of the One”. That, in general, is rarely the case in profane, carnal, or romantic love. It is especially pertinent to the magical and initiatic use of sex, the use that, *inter alia*, involves a special conduct of sexual intercourse and about which one thing is certain: intensive states of a special destructive intoxication intervene (in an almost ontological, not a moral, meaning), which excludes phagia, the abandonment of the other, the sacrifice of oneself, and all the sweet and pantheistic affectations so dear to Cogni; and they never failed to emphasize the dangerous character of that practice, for anything idyllic, romantic, and idealizing.

Cogni has also noticed the relation, noticeable in multiple forms, between eros and death, between the divinity of sex and the destructive divinity and death, that we did, but without understanding it in its true sense. It is significant that, among other things, the secret Hindu orgiastic rites that aimed at the aforementioned experience of transcendence, was celebrated in the sign of goddesses like Durga and Kali, not in their maternal aspect but in the destructive aspect. Sekhmet, the Egyptian goddess of love, is also the goddess of destruction and war (her leonine head refers to a beast whose manners are not at all the sweetest). Something analogous applies to the ancient goddesses of the Mediterranean area, starting with Ishtar, also the goddess of the orgy.

The following point is related to that. We indicated the magnetic base of every eros and every intense sexual experience. It is the development of such a base that serves as the basis for those experiences. But it is due precisely to the polarity of the male and the female as ontological principles, something always acknowledged. So Cogni denies that that polarity is an

essential requirement of eros, which he believes concerns only the naturalistic plane, like electrical and similar phenomena. That means that for him all the documentation that we have gathered, in an entire chapter, from the most varied cultural areas, regarding the “metaphysical dyad”, might as well not exist because it contradicts his promiscuous pantheism.

Without dwelling on such a, perhaps a little too specialized, topic, let's indicate in general the horizons between which the erotology proposed by Cogni moves. The theory of eros as pantheistic identification has found nourishment, in Cogni, in his references to India and to Hindu philosophy of the Vedanta. It appears in a clear way that Cogni has seen of India only what, given his temperament, he was capable of, the India that would be immersed in the “dream of the One”, the “hot all comprehensive all justifying sweetness, royally tolerating, loving and accepting of the people and the land of India”. *Mother India*, discovered by certain useless humanitarian American authoresses like women, with Gandhiism, non-violence, the alleged climate of “loving equality” for the meaning of the One above every illusory difference, would be the true India. But that is an image in part one-sided, in part absurd.

First of all, Cogni seems to overlook the small defect of the beauty present in the “sweet tolerance”, exhibited by the recent massacres between the Hindu and Islamic inhabitants of India, which Gandhi made out as another pleasant event. He then ignores the fact that, if there was a social regime which ruled in the most rigid way the principle of difference for entire millennia, this was the Hindu caste system. To the alleged India all love, abandonment and pardon we contrast the India of the great epochs and of the Bhagavad Gita, a traditional text having the same popularity which the Bible enjoys among the Westerners. It attributed the characteristic of a passion, destructive in its transcendence, to the highest form of the appearance of the divine, while also drawing from it a spiritual and metaphysical justification of the duty of the warrior to fight and kill, sparing neither friends nor relatives who were found on the

enemy front. And everyone knows that the Hindu Trimurti, much closer to the Hindu population than the abstractions of Vedantic speculation, considers a divine function in Shiva to whom destruction is proper.

But now it is necessary to repeat myself that Cogni is visibly affected by spiritual scotomas which prevent him from seeing whatever does not support his inclinations. So Buddhism interests him only in its late and popular exoteric forms of a religion, with "love for all creatures", Amitabha the god of love, etc., in contrast to the serious individual ascetic techniques of the Buddhist doctrine of "awakening" of the authentic texts of the original Buddhist canon, that we showed with strict reference to the texts in a book that Cogni says he was familiar with. From that canon it becomes obvious that, among other things, if love and compassion figure (however with an instrumental function) as preliminary stages in the sequence of the four phases of the highest Buddhist contemplation, of *dhyana*, they are left behind, since the summit is constituted by a state of sovereign, disincarnated impassibility and imperturbability that, pleasing or not to Cogni, has something of the Olympic quality and nothing of a weak humanitarianism.

In fact, our author does not stand at the peaks but in the trash heaps of India. The current devotion has had a part in India, but in the lower popular strata, not unrelated to a pre-Indo-European substrate of the country. Only relatively recently has it corresponded with a philosophic system, that of Ramanuja. Earlier, it was considered a "path of devotion" and love, *bhakti-marga*, but it certainly did not stand at the first level, the dignity of a spiritual "regal path", *raja-marga*, which was instead attributed to the path of knowledge", *jnana-marga* and *jnana yoga*.

That character was mainly attributed to the Vedanta, which Cogni is enthusiastic about, seeing in it however only the theory of absolute Identity, of non-duality, of the One-All, of "thou art that", the theory that serves him as the basis for his ideas of eros that embraces and reunites everything.

Well, here we can first of all say that the Vedanta in the primitivistically pantheistic key does not at all exhaust the Hindu spiritual world. We can point out, especially, that a radical monism was not attested in its origins, in the Vedas, which present us with a clearly articulated *pantheon*. In the second place, India has known great speculative systems, like the Samkhya, which has instead emphasized a primordial duality, that of Purusha and Prakriti, and like metaphysical tantrism, which argued against the "illusionistic" Vedanta (the world is *maya*) and along with the school of Kashmir formulated a well differentiated cosmological doctrine.

We will not dwell on these factual data about India. The essential point is that Cogni exchanges the metaphysical One with the pantheistic One, with that One which, according to the expression Hegel used in regard to the philosophy of identity of the later Schelling, is "the night in which all the cows are black". It is not about the One that dominates a well-articulated order of differences (a cosmos, in the Hellenic sense) but rather of a promiscuous "naturalistic" unity to be related, rather, to "Life". This is Cogni's spiritual horizon.

From that confusion, much more serious confusions arise in the practical realm. Cogni has no sense of the fact that just as an "integrative ascending self-transcendence" exists, so a divisive descending self-transcendence also exists for the true personality. That is, there are possible openings of the I both toward the higher as well as toward the lower, which also means toward "nature", toward the unconscious, toward the vital formless bottom. Only the former correspond to the high ascesis, to initiation, to authentic yoga. The ancient wisdom already distinguished and counterpoised the higher waters from the lower waters, the first illuminating, the latter intoxicating and divisive, and this basic doctrine, taken up again by thinkers around the period of the Renaissance, was opportunely recalled by one of the few people today truly qualified in this field, by Rene Guenon, to alert us about the danger and deviations of a certain contemporary spirituality.

To return to the field of eros, Cogni recalled in passing the ambivalence that is present, from the spiritual point of view, in sexual experience. If the woman was seen as a danger, if one could say *foemina mors animae* in Latin so as to recommend continence, that is not attributable to a moralistic attitude, to the “theological hatred for sex” that Vilfredo Pareto spoke about or to the “sexophobia” on which L De Marchi insists. They also had in view the possibility that the experience of sex, when it was not about curbing mere mortals and moralizing, but for those who had supernatural aspirations, that it could even lead to the negative direction of a “descending self-transcendence”. And if we examine the use of sex predominant in the most recent generations, we find a reflection of that even on a quite profane plane: other than a “sweet” sacrifice of oneself, a “carnal offering”, that redeems and leads to the One, but couplings used on the same life of drugs (to be precise: of the current profane pandemic use of drugs) to draw from the extreme sensations of the orgasm the illusory confirmation of the sense of oneself (the exact opposite of the direction toward the higher).

When the One is “the night in which all the cows are black”, every difference is challenged and discouraged, and promiscuity in the name of that One becomes a norm even in the forms more repugnant for every well born person. In that regard, Cogni is explicit and demonstrates, if nothing else, the courage of coherence. He asserts, for example that “every doctrine that starts from the absolute and not relative point of view, from inferiority or hierarchal superiority, is erroneous at its base, if it is true that the One is all and identical to Brahman”. Note that these words are said in regard to the difference between the species, between men and animal species, for example. We are not talking about how it relates to the human environment. Cogni will certainly not object, to the greater glory of the Vedantic One, if a young Nordic girl beds a Zulu or an Australian aborigine whose morphological and mental level corresponds to the stone age. He is certainly an egalitarian to the bitter end, a fanatic

integrationist (he rushed to make an act of contrition, keeping to date in relation to a past error because in the fascist period he was a racist, albeit of a dubious racial theory), an admirer of “unisex” and the “third sex” and so on. But the last straw is in the area of carnality. As a more audacious form of identification, phagist or not, in the name of the One, he actually admits not only homosexuality and pederasty, but even sex with animals, sodomy with women, and so on. His theory explains how “many people have so much attraction for such relationships commonly judged against nature”. “Only by accepting in principle the ordinarily most repugnant areas of the other (for sexual use), is one certain of having reached absolute identity.” At this rate, we believe that Cogni would, in the same way, value even coprophagia (the eating of feces as a form of eroticism) and would sanctify the disgusting events where even coprophagia figures abundantly as the decisive erotica along with the other horrors, described in the *120 Days of Sodom* by the **Marquis de Sade**.

Naturally, in denouncing similar aberrations of Cogni, we do not appeal to any conformist moralism but to what is called normal in a higher, not social, sense. For example, pederasty at the most can be tolerated when it arises from special constitutional situations of imperfect sexualization but must be stigmatized as a vice, deviation, and perversion in all other cases, denying also that in this, as in all other case of sexual psychopathy, the necessary objective requirements from a metaphysics of sex are present for the actual experiences of a deconditionalizing intensity. But there is no hope that Cogni has such an understanding for similar things.

Finally, we need to point out another deviation in Cogni, unifying promiscuous sexuality with pantheism. Since, as we have seen, his reference point is not metaphysical reality but rather the promiscuous bottom of “Life”, skirting the unconscious and the subconscious; in his more recent writings, Cogni sympathizes openly with psychoanalysis and metapsychics. He goes so far as to say that parapsychology “remains still the great hope of the future”. He poses himself in a duet of mutual ad-

miration with Emilio Servadio who had “opened the way”, “knowing India in depth and every type of initiatic thought and psychic depth”. That makes us smile. If Servadio had ever really had some idea of initiatic matters and authentic wisdom that was when, before the war, he was vividly interested in the publications edited by the “Ur Group” which I directed. After the war, at a snail’s pace, he more or less set all that aside and he immersed himself in psychoanalysis. Moreover, that brought on a lucrative professional program and seeking to put himself everywhere before the public, he associated psychoanalysis with parapsychology, in place of initiatic knowledge and wisdom traditions, giving himself however to probe not the psychical depths but rather the slums of the psyche. The connection with psychanalysis and metapsychics took place in Cogni without difficulty through the fact that his One is easily relatable to the “deep unconscious that is one in the entire universe”, by which telepathic phenomena and metapsychics in general can be explained, while it is the field proper to psychoanalysis.

In fact, in these new disciplines the unconscious becomes a sack in which things of every type are placed. One does not think at all about such an elementary and basic distinction, like that between the subconscious (or unconscious) and the superconscious, in part for the simple reason that psychoanalysis and metapsychics have no idea of the latter, and then because in their experimental field, for obvious reasons, it is rather difficult to even imagine. From this also come aberrant assimilations, like those of C G Jung, in which the homologous figures perceived by psychopaths or oneiric visions of symbols and mythical structures of the initiatic and religious field, reducing everything to the emergence of the archetypes of the collective unconscious. Now, it still holds that, apart from psychoanalysis with its murky world, all modern parapsychology embraces only the offal of the extranormal and is outside all that might have an authentically spiritual value. It is only a question of the slums that can impress only the naïve. But the reason for Cogni’s interest in

such things appears evident given what is said: it is a question of true elective affinity. At this level is where he locates which he called the "great hope". Signs of the times.

In conclusion, from the present considerations it turns out that the mentality, the personal equation, the elective affinities, the theoretic referents of Cogni have no point of contact with a spiritual world that we presume is not personal. In cases of this type, as was said at the beginning, discussions have little meaning. However, these notes are less about "arguing" than taking the occasion to make clear certain questions of undoubtable relevance for those readers who might have an interest in the themes treated.

Posted on 2015-10-08 by Aeneas

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Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-15 at 01:40 said:

Alice Bailey certainly knew all about the united world and homogeneous raceless population agenda due to the connection between Theosophy and various groups of shady origin, including Fabian society, who, in the spirit of Bavarian Illuminati, continued the work of subtle social engineering towards the Age of Aquarius i.e. Lucifer. We are all witnessing a progress of this plan and it's acceleration. I wouldn't be surprised if they had connection with the Frankfurt school as well.

Speaking of ascending and descending in regard of transcendence of human experience I am reminded of Terrence McKenna's "Archaic Revival", a concept of complete cultural and individual dissolution of boundaries and return to, what he called, protohistoric paradisaical existence of pastoral, orgiastic and classless mushroom worshipping potheads. McKenna was a feminist, profound one some may say, but still a feminist who never missed a chance to blame evil patriarchy and it's fascist spirit for all the wrongs in modern world. Well, his idea of the return into a sacred womb of matriarchy included different kinds of human descendance into the subconscious and nano existence within the cyber world. On the other hand, he considered ascending spiral "techocratic and fascist". When we research his origins we will find the same shady connections. Since I don't intend to turn this comment into a conspiracy rant I will stop here. But there is definitely a global agenda regarding descending transcendence and it's popularization.

Italian racialists had every right to criticize National Socialists race theory which ignored spiritual dimensions and focused strictly on blood alchemy. How many Aryan looking nordics

are out there, with the completely atrophied spirit and essence? Could we call them Aryans? Certainly not, for Arya is a spiritual nobility as well. Arya is a title not a race, although it's reserved only for certain races (indo-european stock).

Cologero on 2015-10-16 at 07:42 said:

Cogni's views are more in tune with the signs of the times. His views on sexuality, psychology as a spiritual path, pantheism, paranormal experience (e.g., the widespread interest in "channeling", astral travel, shamanism, the "law of attraction") have become mainstream since Cogni's book was published. On the other hand, Evola's insistence on the transcendent "meta-physical dyad" is losing steam (and is not aided by Evola's past association with race and fascism). Even one of the last holdouts for the dyad, the Roman Church, is wavering, if the discussions emanating from the Synod on the Family are any indication.

The Italians started destroying everything associated with Mussolini as the Allies advanced toward Rome. Thus, it is impossible for an independent scholar to find most of the books from that era. However, I did find this article, *The Italian Roots of Racism*³⁶, which has a discussion on Cogni. The writers discussed may have well as been space aliens, since their viewpoints are so far from anything being expressed today.

Sparrow on 2015-10-18 at 06:39 said:

Since he was a Vedantist, one would think that Cogni read the Bhagavad Gita and realized that the "Oneness," is not a call to promiscuous dissolution rather than a virile call to action and obeying one's dharma.

Cologero on 2015-10-18 at 15:37 said:

Yes, Sparrow, that is precisely the point Evola made against him. Since I haven't been able to find Cogni's text anywhere, it is impossible to make a complete judgment. Nevertheless, he seems to be among the "neo-vedantists" who are prominent today in the West. (A google search will provide many examples.)

Since Cogni was heavily influenced by psychoanalysis, I suspect he had in mind Freud's notion of the "oceanic feeling" in which there is a return to the infantile consciousness of being "one with the world".

SB on 2015-10-18 at 15:55 said:

Is Cogni very well known among spiritual and philosophically inclined people today in Italy? And if so, is his reputation more "mainstream" than Evola's?

³⁶<http://escholarship.org/uc/item/85r1607t#page-1>

SB on 2015-10-18 at 15:59 said:

Re. Pasolini, if I may offer a comment re. his association of Sadism with Fascism, I believe it may simply be a result of New Left association of authoritarianism with sexual dominance, as part of their general worldview basing everything on sexuality (derived ultimately from Freud but more to the point from Wilhelm Reich, Herbert Marcuse etc)

Cologero on 2015-10-18 at 16:46 said:

@SB, as I mentioned, Cogni's books are unavailable in print or electronic editions. Hence, I can't imagine that he has much of a reputation at all anymore. What I did say is that his worldview appears to be more congenial to people today. For example, he is much more open to, let's say, the "varieties of sexual experience" than Evola was. Evola was more attached to the boy-girl thing, not for any moral or religious reasons, but rather because he believe it reflects the polarity of the male-female, or yin-yang, principles, the overcoming of which results in the "androgyny".

As for your other point, Pasonlini, Marcuse, etc., seem passe now. Such an association was shattered by Michel Foucault's life and work. He combined gay S&M with libertarian economics, sort of the precursor of the "socially liberal but economically conservative" type, not uncommon today. But he went further, challenging power structures that would marginalize certain groups, perhaps those who could be considered the "fifth caste" that the Tantras refer to.

SB on 2015-10-18 at 18:23 said:

If I'm not taking the discussion off topic, what's the fifth caste as I'm ignorant of the subject? The pariah/untouchable?

In response to your mentioning the New Left as being passé, my observations would be that society has hit a key turning point with the transition to postmodernism; the rationalist mentality that has been dominant since the XVII-XVIIIth centuries, the search for a theory which explains everything, has been judged a failure and now rather than proposing new systems or axioms for all to follow as they did in the past, philosophers are questioning every existing remaining "given" rule of society with the aim of abolishing it, to the extent where language even no longer has a definite meaning (Derrida and Deconstructionism). It's an interesting thought process to see where it's leading to; one could well say the world is heading to the submersion into the undifferentiated all . The rise of the environmentalism with their quite pantheistic beliefs (Gaia hypothesis) is another trend in this direction.

Aleksandar Gueric on 2015-10-18 at 19:22 said:

"If I'm not taking the discussion off topic, what's the fifth caste as I'm ignorant of the subject? The pariah/untouchable?"

You probably think of dalits. European gypsies descend from them, which is proven in genetic studies.

12.16 Scaligero Meets Evola

First part

In this essay, **Massimo Scaligero** describes his first impressions on meeting **Julius Evola**. Although they went in different directions (Scaligero became an Anthroposophist), they remained good friends and collaborated for several years. Like Evola, Scaligero was interested in the Roman spirit in the context of spiritual races. Scaligero incisively notes the essential differences in their world-views. Scaligero uses thinking and imagination to penetrate into reality, and ultimately to the Logos. Evola, on the contrary, insists on the primacy of will.

I knew Evola at a time when almost everyone prudently distanced himself from him: he revealed himself, by means of the journal *La Torre*, to be the boldest protester of the culture of the Regime. Even though those around him created a type of vacuum, for that reason he carried on the attack unperturbed. That attracted my attention, even if I did not yet understand what he was really driving at. In those days, around the spring of 1930, I went to him despite being advised against it by well-meaning friends: I did not want others to decide for me. At that time telephones in the home were rare, so the appearance at someone's home would not have been considered an indiscretion: in case of the absence of the person you wanted to visit, we used to leave a calling card with the concierge.

I was curious to know the person who showed so much courage and about whom Adriano Tilgher had spoken to me with admiration,

albeit with reservations about the content of his doctrines. I remember he called him “the most powerful dialectician of Europe”. But that was not what impressed me. I had yet to understand that Tilgher was referring mainly to the dialectical battles at the *Associazione per il Progresso Morale e Religioso* (Association for Moral and Religious Progress), then directed by professor Giuseppe Puglisi, and headquartered in Piazza Nicosia (later, it was transferred to Piazza Campicelli under the direction the poet Raniero Nicolai) where, at the end of the conference, a debate took place in which the usual participants included Professor John Imperato, Professor Ernesto Quadrelli, Professor Giuseppe Palanga, sometimes Tilgher, and, finally, Evola, who regularly beat them all with compelling arguments and humorous barbs.

I knocked on the door of the next to top floor of Corso Vittorio 197 and a youthful, tall, rangy character, undoubtedly older than I, opened the door: his expression was between Buddhist and Olympic, his bearing quite calm. Having at once intuited the meaning of my visit, or rather, lack of one, Evola promptly met me with genuine affection and this affection was the strength of the connection, beyond dialectics and doctrine, that linked me to him for years.

As I wrote in my book *From Yoga to the Rosicrucians*, I didn't know that Evola had followed an esoteric path for a time and directed a group of aspirants to initiation, although his name was familiar to me from the journal *Ignis*.

I was already following my own very personal path since adolescence, which was between Yoga and the most unrestrained thought of the West — Nietzsche, Stirner, Bauer — but I did not like to talk about it with anyone.

I recall that at first Evola was surprised by the meaning of my visit, neither political, nor esoteric: as I said, at that time he was subject to continuous attacks and intimidations. I remember that the theme of mountains and the inner impressions of the climb, the silence and soli-

tude of the peaks, united us right away. In a chapter devoted to Evola, in the book I mentioned, I outline the meaning of my relationship with him: the encounter with a world that gave me the perception of thought as a primordial force.

I loved Goethe and Nietzsche for that reason: not the Nietzsche of the exaltation phase, but rather that of *The Birth of Tragedy* and *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*.

At that time, I dramatically felt the state of death of the thinking of the whole culture, every expression of culture, whatever its subject, or its political complexion: I had the impression of moving in a vast cemetery: I came out of it every time thanks to energetic meditation, but it was important for me to encounter, through Evola, a kind of thinking that I secretly cultivated in myself: a thinking still capable of life and freedom. After several years, moreover, I had to believe that it was not so much the content of Evola's writings which delighted my inner self, but also feeling that content as a very personal construction: a work of art: a work of brilliant, organic art, even when I felt the affects — to be clear — of Tantrism of the "left Hand".

The harmony with Evola was essentially this: the contact with a world of forces. But this was possible because I myself carried in me this world of forces: the recognition of their origin, however, gradually brought about the orientation that was to carry me out of the path. But what is not in dispute: reality is one, truths are many.

The dialogue with Evola reinforced in me the need for a distinction of values and traditions: that was decisive for me with regard to issues such as karma and reincarnation, the essentially Christian character of Western alchemy, the mysteriously Christian character of the Grail, the fundamentality of the Logos as Christ-Principle. I understood Evola's paganism, but I considered it only as a positive impulse of the quest for what really was the Logos beyond all worldly expressions and beyond what He had become in theological and ethical-political formalism.

Actually Evola is a strong medicine, a shock treatment, the application of force without mediation: as such, he acts in those who already have the power of mediation and just has the task of making it operative. But if he truly realized that, he already has the principle of the Force. Thanks to Evola, I encountered a decisive moment of my inner experience: the feeling of liberation, which gives the image rather than knowledge of liberation: the heroic, mythic image, not cognitive. I then had to discover that the cognitive way was necessary for me: Evola's way had the cognitive appearance, but in essence it relied on the feeling of strength, not on its reality, penetrable and comprehensible by the power of the idea. To renounce this power of the idea, means to accept super-nature mystically, or by faith.

In other words, we do not enter into the magical by the feeling of magic or by the dialectic of magic, but only by virtue of its initial power in the soul, which is ideational or imaginative power. Evola, indeed, cannot hide a certain contempt for thinking, or for a "way of thinking", believing thinking as the expression of a specific sentient nature and not of super-nature.

The ideal of the absolute individual was for him an expression of the will sufficient in oneself: thinking indeed has nothing to do with it, and he is right, but you cannot move away from it: nor can you willfully experiment with thinking, which ceases to be dialectical, but volitional. He pointed out that in yoga, essentially the strength of the will was awakened and recovered in its magical movement, and it becomes the flow of Kundalini.

The whole power of evolian "persuasion" is this immediacy of the possessed will. He refuses, as premise, thinking, the cognitive act, the mediation of the idea: Evola always speaks about an absolute act, a movement from which they come about, as it should be in itself magical.

It is in effect the raw material of the Work, which it is necessary to already have: Evola attributes it to a particular inner constitution, to be-

longing to a particular race of the Spirit. For me it was always clear that it is about the meeting of the free I with its own karma: This is the condition of the element with which a psychophysiological I covers itself.

Nevertheless, that persuasion, so decisively expressed by Evola, was a confirmation of my personal experience of the centrality and the invincibility of the I: which, brought to the depths, can encounter the Logos, His origin: Evola was not able to recognize that. I knew that the formulation of the centrality and asceticism of the I was correct: I appreciated Evola, because at that time I was convinced that he had never come to talk about it so explicitly and methodologically. Stirner's and Nietzsche's attempts were ultimately Hegelian-romantic: bold offshoots of the Hegelian left, but prisoners of dialectics.

Second part

This is the conclusion of **Massimo Scaligero's** essay describing his first impressions on meeting **Julius Evola**. In this part, Scaligero gets to the heart of Evola's thinking, describing what unites them and what separates them.

Unlike other reviews that describe Evola as a political figure, a philosopher, etc., Scaligero understands Evola in the way that one esoterist can understand another.

The way which I personally followed at that time was my own synthesis, which, I believed, could not correspond to a doctrine. The term "Science of the I" resonated pleasantly familiar with me: in fact it corresponded to the ideal of asceticism to which I tended and to the correlative method. This was the true help that I got from Evola: to perceive the doctrinally justifiable asceticism of the I, independently of Tradition. The reality of this proved to be traditional, even as it did not correspond to any conceivable form in Tradition. In a similar way, however, it was possible to come to see the source of this asceticism. For a while I had the

feeling of having found in Evola the master that I was looking for, and he had indeed more than a claim.

I think I was affected more than Evola, by the disappointment of the fact that, at a certain time, even as I was following the “way of the I”, I was no longer able to follow his path. I could recognize in him only a characteristically strong indicator, an individuality from autonomy so sufficient in himself, since it does not require *metanoia*, or conversion, of his own dialectic to arouse in others the feeling of his strength through dialectic: naturally, without possibility of the resolution of individual limits: in the end a resolute titan, whose strength however had its foundation in himself, but he could not become the weakness of the less autonomous disciple who is unable to find the foundation in himself, that is, his inner path.

Along the way, I could understand my relationship with Evola even better. Generally it happened — and it is happening — that one reads his works and then decides to follow him. In substance it had happened to me in a something different way: I had gone to him without reading a single line of his: for a long time our conversations had as its theme the mountains, nonconformity, the courage to oppose the pseudo-culture. I kept company with a group of aggressive transtiberine friends, that I mobilized when he was in danger of being attacked again on the occasion of the different causes that he had in court for lawsuits and the aftermath of lawsuits. I remember that, at our second meeting, he lent me Meyrink's *Golem*, probably to give me the opportunity for an esoteric connection with him; but, just flipping through the pages, I was not too convinced of their content. In truth I did not read the book at all and after a fortnight gave it back to Evola, avoiding telling him that I was not interested. I noticed, however, in Evola a minimal expression of disappointment. Later, however, I carefully read Evola and Meyrink.

The true meaning of what had driven me inwardly toward him, became clear to me with the passing of time: it was the meeting with expert

disciples of Steiner, collaborators of Ur (although I was already connected with Giulio Parise and Arturo Reghini through the journal *Ignis*), among whom the significant and decisive one for me had to be Colazza, and the inner encounter with the one whom I came to recognize as the Master of the new age, Rudolf Steiner; in fact, the original edition of Ur contained impartial appreciations of Steiner. Actually, it was not so much the knowledge of Evola's works that united me to him for several years, but rather his lively, exceptionally individual, personality. Of course, I then would examine these works line by line, before making the decision for another path.

The meetings I had with Evola were filled with a Hermetic climate, from which the feeling of magical forces regularly arose, something like what I actually had from the habit from personal meditation. Or else there were Bacchic-gastronomic meetings, based on spirited philosophy and bucatini all'Amatriciana³⁷, but with the unusual addition of peperoncino. I was struck by the fact that Evola, who was a compelling alcohol supporter, cared to drink very sweet wines such as vino passito³⁸, or Gaglioppo³⁹. He explained it to me, saying, I don't know how jokingly, that, having learned from Colazza that alcohol deadened the I, while sugar was the physical food of the I, he, not to take risks, tried to reconcile them. Moreover, he connected me to him by an inclination that has always guided my action, to support the one against whom everyone, the *koinonia ton kakon* communion of evil, manages to feel themselves sympathetic: so-called "public opinion", or Phariseism, whose hypocrisy I have always felt. At that time Evola had only adversaries, even if, truth be told, he did everything to provoke them.

The idea that the truth was from the party against whom everyone

³⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Amatriciana_sauce

³⁸<http://italian-flavor.com/notes/passito.php>

³⁹<http://drinks.seriousseats.com/2011/01/calabrias-gaglioppo-grape-wine-southern-italy.html>

lined up in solidarity, in a certain sense corresponded for me to a specific supersensible law. On the other hand, Evola today is translated into the major languages of the world, and he has a following even in Asia. However Evola never assumed the role of the “master”: guidance counselor, instigator, yes, but not the master. Sometimes when I had problems with respect to the method, and I turned to him, he demurred, recommending Colazza or Bonabitacola to me, that is, Steiner’s disciple or Kremmerz’ disciple. Evola found Bonabitacola interesting especially because he received all insults like a Zen master; while Colazza was the character for whom he professed the utmost deference, because he recognized him as an outstanding investigator of the “occult”.

Colazza also had respect for Evola as a strong personality: he reproached him only for his yoga and the fact that he wrote books. “One of us”, he said to me one day, “must not write books. Books occultly bind the author, they bind him to his present thought, preventing him from opening himself up to the new, to the unknown, to what he still is not capable of thinking. Besides, whoever plays the role of teacher, loses the opportunity to be a disciple.”

Something substantially true can be recognized with this thought of Colazza. Nevertheless, you cannot help but consider in Evola’s case the mission of sacrifice by the word: namely the compromise of one’s own way, on the dialectical level, for the way of others. The snare that he throws would not be necessary if the initiatory path were not in relation to a free choice, to self-determination, that is a determination that is not fated to occur, otherwise it would not be free. This can sufficiently explain his dominant and bold reconciliation of Buddha with Nietzsche; for us it is valid, even if only introductory to the true sadhana. When esoterism is realized, it ceases to be mental position.

The enigma of Evola’s inner personality and his relationship with Tradition remains. In truth, the traditional form cannot conceal the powerful thrust of his anti-traditional system of thought. If you observe, Evola

makes use of the traditional element for building his own absolutely personal spiritual cosmos. He uses the value of Tradition as the aristocratic touchstone, that is, as the opposite to the modern world. He seems to propose a return to Tradition, but in fact, he wants something that is not Tradition, indeed positively against it. And this is what we can recognize as important in Evola.

Guenon is in Tradition, Evola leaves it all the time, while appealing to it: it is a juxtaposition, a dialectical theme, a *habitus cogitandi* habit of thinking. From Novalisian “magical idealism” to Tantrism, from the Nietzschean formulation of Mahayana to the “pagan” interpretation of Alchemy and the Grail, to the sympathy for Michelstaedter and Meyrink, Nietzsche, Kummerow and Crowley, the imperious authority of thinking is clear, that makes everything subject to an intimate personal vision, to an individual, determined “will to power”, ultimately, to an impulse of freedom that subordinates everything to self-affirmation.

Evola succeeds in making his own world real through the power of thought. This is the aspect that could give real help to those who want to follow his path, not as a follower dazzled by his light, but as a conqueror of the Light. It does not matter whether the thinking is correct or not, it becomes correct when it is powerful. It is undeniably true: error, immorality, is weak thinking, or merely dialectical, or reflexive. The power of thought is the truth: the truth that coincides with reality. But only a free man can realize it and make it his own. Those who believe in that thought as a content that comforts him, excites him or hypnotizes him, is not free, he is not in the current of reality. He believes he is in Tradition, but he is against it in the worst form, that of dogmatism and mystical subjection. So we said, at the beginning of this essay, that Evola is a strong medicine, a shock treatment: a discipline that it is necessary to possess. If you do not possess yourself, you actually betray yourself, because you act with respect to it as one who is subjugated.

The living element of Evola’s work is the idea of liberation, which

requires, however, pure recognition, the decision of self-knowledge, by the person who encounters it. This is the demand and the virtue of his system, but also the real thrust of his personality, which can be seen as a synthesis of what he is individually with that which the real Guides of humanity implant in him, despite himself. Certain inspirations in the ascetic become operatively individual, even as they draw on the Super-individual. Julius Evola points out a direction that, to become creative in the esoteric sense, requires its separation from its phenomenology, that is, from *maya*, from the *ethos* resulting from it in a social, political sense: especially from this. Certain mixtures betray the spiritual proposition: the worst disasters always come from the collusion of the Sacred with the profane. A similar separation, just like the assumption of the discrimination of *subtile a spisso* the subtle from the dense, is about Evola's own karmic direction. You can metaphysically become aware of his cosmic-spiritual future. It will be determined by how much independence he has achieved from the written works. The possibility will be decisive that he not be identified with his own doctrinaire expression, i.e., with the mythical and mystical world of his followers.

Posted on 2015-03-10 by Aeneas

* * *

White Rabbit on 2015-03-11 at 23:56 said:

It is interesting how Evola's path of negation and tearing down ideas can also be described as one of faith. For a thinker I'm sure it would require a strong intellectual propulsion from the start, at least.

Scaligero says that that way wasn't for him. A puzzle: is someone who tends to "question everything" fitted for the cognitive way, or Evola's way of demolishing all intellectual supports?

David R on 2015-03-12 at 22:21 said:

Thank you for this translation. There is a lot to ponder about. Might I ask, if you know, if Scaligero is of any worth in himself? Does this text render him justice? Thank you.

Tom Blanchard on 2015-03-13 at 11:20 said:

Scaligero has a truly unique perspective on Evola. His idea of Evola as a kind of “titan” seems accurate – Evola frequently mentioned that Olympian heroes often came from titanic stocks/backgrounds, almost as titanism was a sort of prior phase or necessary pre-requisite state that nevertheless had to be wholly overcome and transformed.

Scaligero’s description of Evola as a man whose style and approach was a “necessary discipline” but whom he nevertheless had to leave behind (without repudiation) is slightly reminiscent of Dante’s relationship with Virgil in the Divine Comedy. This is even reinforced by his reflection that he for some time thought of Evola as an appropriate “master”.

Cologero on 2015-03-13 at 23:41 said:

David R: As Scaligero wrote, for a time he followed Evola, but then left him to develop his own idiosyncratic brand of Anthroposophy. We’ll be making use of some of those earlier writings over time. As for his second phase, that is up to your own interests; I know that the Anthroposophists think highly of him.

Aeneas on 2015-03-13 at 23:47 said:

Mr Blanshard, not only was Evola a “master” but according to Scaligero he also had spirit Guides. The Comedy is a good analogy; Evola just couldn’t “get” the Logos.

Am I the only one who was more interested in the pasta and wine? BTW, the pasta recipe should be made with bucatini rather than spaghetti. If anyone makes it to South Beach, look me up and perhaps I’ll cook it up.

12.17 The Esoteric Origin of the Species

This essay originally appeared in the *Introduction to Magic*, volume 3. It was published under the name “Avro”, which I believe to be **Julius Evola**.

Part I The reader will not fail to notice that in one particular point among others, the esoteric teachings have a distinctly counter-current character: this is in regards to “evolution”.

Evolution is a type of obsession of the modern mind. It is a true psychological complex that, in the middle of the “logic of the subsoil”

about which Iagla Evola wrote (Vol 2, ch 2), directs the minds of many of those who presume that they were using the “scientific method” and objective research. Here it would be necessary to be convinced of what is also of value for many other things: or else that certain possibilities of understanding, seeing, and controlling are the effect of a certain change of attitude: and not vice versa, as rationalism would like.

Regarding evolution, it could, for example, have caused surprise about what we said about the Hyperborean tradition. In effect, the idea that previously in the interglacial and paleolithic period, a great unitary civilization existed, to which the fundamental symbols, the roots of language, and the graphism⁴⁰ are related to the oldest cultures — a similar idea must arise as revolutionary in respect to modern opinions, which are believed to have been proved once and for all on a positive basis. And it is not only a question of simple evolutionism in the history of civilization: even parts of science begin to be touched where, in one form or another, the Darwinian hypothesis on the origins of the species and on the descent of man from animals is current even now.

So the problem must be confronted as a whole. We will therefore mention what the esoteric teaching say about it, without going into details that could take me rather far: beyond the extent it can be usefully discussed in this journal.

Although not stopping myself here, I have to emphasize first of all that in the same field of profane science today it is no longer about the evolutionism that Darwin announced in his time. The Darwinian hypotheses, ever since, has undergone numerous criticisms, and real difficulties, previously not seen, have compelled it to be modified.

Where it is especially shown to be weak, is in its attempt to deduce the variety of the species from an almost automatic play of material conditions of the environment, of natural selection, and of inherited transmission of acquired characteristics. The vitalistic point of view, which

⁴⁰<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Graphism>

asserts precedence and an excess of vital energy over all the conditions, must instead acquire a greater significance.

Bergson is among those who have come into play in strictly scientific terrains against Darwinian evolutionism, showing through its insufficiencies that have left the field free for the hypothesis of an evolutionism of a no longer bio-materialistic, but of a creative, character.

The same biologists after all recognized how much the variety of species resists the attempt of that simple and linear deduction, the one from the other, that Darwin conjectured; they were led to admit “quasi-jumps” from some species to others, so that the hypothesis most in vogue today is that of De Vries, who appeals to unpredictable and essential internal mutations precisely to explain those jumps within the scheme of evolutionism.

This, nevertheless, is one hypothesis like any other, which is of interest only for the difficulty that it calls attention to, and that in a great part exists even after the introduction of enigmatic concept of mutation. I note in passing that the difficulty finds an exact comparison in what physics has recently chanced upon, when, with the theory of quanta (Planck) and the principle of indeterminism (Heisenberg), it has had to stop in the face of finite quantities of “action”, without being able to explain, and without being able to point out a continuous process that leads from one to the other.

Moreover, since the evolutionistic hypothesis continues to be in force in biology as far as it has been modified and revised, it is necessary to examine its general foundations. We know the impressive bounty of facts Darwin and his school have gathered in the field of morphology, embryology, paleontology, and even geology. No one would consider denying these facts. What there is to discuss, and to indicate as arbitrary or, at least, as one-sided, is in the interpretation, through which in Darwinism these facts become proofs to support the materialist evolutionistic concept. Without postponing any longer, I will go directly to the fundamental

argument.

When they had just succeeded in establishing a continuity of forms and rings, permitting the passage from one species to another, up to man, with that, one line remains simply established, and no one tells us in what direction it has traversed. Hence, a priori, every fact adopted to uphold evolutionism could be simultaneously adopted to sustain the opposite thesis: the *involutionistic* thesis: neither more nor less. As true that the lower species are the levels preceding the higher—it is as true that they are instead *degenerative involutions* of the latter. *The presence of intermediate stages* (when they are also transitional stages)—and not from *crossbreeding* or from *selection*: other possibilities that the evolutionists don't consider) *cannot tell me, by themselves, in what direction the march happened.*

That is the fundamental point. Let's now see what can be added to it.

Let us begin with the peoples called backward from the point of view of their mentality and their civilization. Who tells us that they represent the primitive states of present humanity rather than involutive forms and residues of an even older humanity? The fact that the backward peoples are more likely to disappear than to “evolve”, should make us reflect. Besides, one must consider that an even more ancient humanity could have been *different*, as much from not leaving traces where forms of civilization closer to us were successful and superimposed: from leaving instead traces of them precisely in their degenerating origins, but only of the same trunk. Modern ethnological studies on presumed “primitives” have ascertained in them not a lower level of the same mentality, but rather of another mentality, another civilization. From them, through integration, one can reach back to an even older humanity. Modern explorers of prehistory, like Frobenius and Wirth, for example, have followed this method.

Part II Moving from primitive man to the anthropoid and the ape, and presuming the jumps are surmountable, which therefore must be made in order to reach the other animal forms according to transformist models, we can say the same thing: as far as being able to consider many animal species as degenerations or degradations of still older non-animal forms. Our point of view is exactly this: *Man does not derive from the animal but, if ever, it is the various animal species that derive from man, in a sense that we now try to explain.*

The principle difficulty that this point of view encounters lies in the fact that the traces of man end at a given geological period: while the traces of prehistoric animals continue up to a much older period. But this same fact is susceptible to different interpretations, for those who can consider the idea of transformations with sufficient breadth: *that the mineral traces of man are more recent, could mean only that man was the last to come into that process, under a certain involutinal aspect, through which it is precisely possible that they exist as fossils and therefore those traces are retrievable.*

The misunderstanding about “cavemen” comes from not thinking that it is natural that certain very old traces are still found in the caves, because, for multiple factors, they have not been preserved elsewhere. The idea of the recent appearance of man on the earth is based on a lack of vision of the same type; I certainly am not asking anyone to admit the fall of man from the sky: it is enough to surpass the *mineral*, but not the material, concept of corporality; it suffices to think of the possibility of a body whose most physical element (which today is the skeletal system) was composed by a substance unsusceptible to self-conservation through the process of fossilization—to remain indifferent in the face of the fact of the lack of traces in the most remote geologic periods, and to be able to admit the existence of primordial human stocks (of which the anthropoids would be the first degenerating materializations) coexisting among more driven forms of the involutive process, which would be represented

by the oldest animals of prehistory. This concept has nothing absurd in itself. Analogically, every manifestation has of necessity an inversive character: whatever stands more to the origin, more to the internal, more to the center, can only be the last to appear in the movement toward the external. And at the center and at the origin, according to esoteric teaching, would exactly be Man.

NOTE: What happens to the rest in every finalistic process: the goal, the end precedes as idea all those conditions that are necessary to actualize it, and as reality it appears as the last, after them.

This Man naturally does not correspond to the man of today: but he corresponds to them in the sense that man of today can be considered as the most approximate manifestation and the most direct lineage of primordial Man. As such, he represents the origin, the axis, while the other species represent lateral or divergent directions, if not to say, byproducts.

With an image previously used by “Ea”, I can perhaps indicate better what otherwise would require a long detour of concepts in order to be understood.

Let us imagine something like an assault, like an undertaking of conquest. A group of tightly unified forces confront the danger, they approach the goal. A battle is undertaken. On the defenseless front some begin to fall back, others advance. The resistance is met, the clash begins. The empire bends. Few succeed in maintaining the original direction – like the wake of a boat, they leave behind them, dispersed, stopped, sacrificed or beaten, the greater part of those, with whom they were together at the beginning of the undertaking. The group of survivors hold firm, advance again: always fighting, they succeeds in opening a way, they finally reach the position that it was the goal of the undertaking, they conquers it, they maintain it, they planted their own banner in it. In all the other directions, the aborted, frustrated, arrested attempts of the same will lag behind on the way without exit.

We mean now by “conquest”, the achievement of the physical state

of existence in the conditions well-known to us today; we mean that those who have reached the end are men and others who were defeated or have deviated, are the various animal species. Man, as known today, expresses the form in which the stock of a primordial humanity is conserved and still standing in the conditions of materiality, in which various animal species were included in the beginning, certainly not in the forms that appear to us today, but rather in the principles of them, which have taken their origin biologically from a degenerative specialization, from a ramification of the original direction into divergent directions, each one expressing the exhaustion of an attempt, the arrest of a surge of assault from which those who have “broken down” are separated and that they left behind themselves.

It is interesting to notice that ideas of this type were also put forward at the fringes of modern culture, without a connection with traditional teaching. In the works of **Edgar Dacqué** *Leben als Symbol, Urwelt, Sage und Menschheit* I find, for example, a rather similar conception, and an illustration that makes very clear the concept discussed above.

Conclusion

The Diagram discussed is by **Edgar Dacqué**. He was a German paleontologist who was a devout Lutheran, a Theosophist, and was involved with the OTO.

In this conclusion, Avro explains how man arises from the collective. He makes use of the Aristotelean-Thomist teaching in an interesting way. The weakness of the A-T system is that it does not take the individual into account. Here Avro expands on that teaching, with the person as the form or idea and the genotype as the material or matter.

In U, where it runs in the central direction, there is man as we know him. A, B, etc., can be considered as the nearest attempts, e.g., the diluvial

man, the anthropoid, the ape-man. Further down and backward in time, there are the other, more elementary and divergent, attempts, the first to appear in the completely “densified” form of existence that we know, accessible to paleontology and whose region extends to the outside of the circular line marked in the figure. The individual points of exit on this line from which then a group of vectors and secondary deviations starts in turn, represent the “types” of each species; and these secondary deviations (which are, in the figure, the vectors $U'U$, $A'A$, $B'B$, $F'F$, etc., in respect to the directions U , A , B , F , which also continue to the outside the vector that comes from the axis) are the transformation that each species has undergone in a partial battle, in the middle of adaptation, selection, etc.: that is to say, in the middle of the factors to which Darwin wanted to reduce the whole. Instead, the passage from one species to another does not happen at the periphery: at the periphery only hybrids (as in Z and Y) can be verified, erroneously interpreted by evolutionists as “transitional forms”. The “passage” is instead determined by the issuing and from the emerging of a new branch that departs from the central direction (which goes toward man) to the head of a new impulse, at the failure of what preceded.

Here we can also take into account the true meaning of another of the facts that would seem to prove evolutionism, summarized in the idea that ontogeny repeats phylogeny. That man, in his development from the embryo, through a series of phases which have a certain resemblance with the animal forms of life, from our point of view, means only this: that each human realization includes in brief and retraces the attempts, whose possibility was included in the original stock: *but to retrace them exactly on the base of the original impulse, that goes beyond them all*; something evident in itself, insofar as an embryo stopped in any phase you want, always remains just a human embryo, not that of a fish or another animal species.

It is in a very special sense, not material and not valid for biological

consideration, that one can say that to the extent the central line UU passes through the origin of the various types of animality, man, before appearing as such in this world, lived in the hierarchy of animal forms. It is not a question, moreover, of any of the animal forms that are terrestrial and historical manifestations anterior to man: instead it is about that which corresponded to the “sacred animals” in the ancient mystery traditions. In the cult of such “animals”, that in an involutive and restricted form often are found again in certain primitive peoples, that conceal the record of this knowledge, of this co-essentiality, being related to other planes or states of existence. The sacred animals are powers of life that made up part of primordial man, and from which he separated to go beyond; they are not individual animals, but the “group soul” *anima di gruppo*, daemons, whose body is the total life of a given animal species—and, each one, a transcendent experience, used up and abandoned in the wake of the past through a type of catharsis or purification. But, as I said, they were in origin parts of universal man, and terrestrial man was the most direct expression of the origin the relationships, the hidden correspondence, will remain: those that esoterism considers as marking the limbs, the functions, and the energies of the human body with the zodiac symbols or other equivalents.

Our figure corresponds, more or less, to the model of a branched tree which should be conceived in its external part as a continuous movement of expansion and return, similar to that produced by a heart: that, in order to indicate the appearance of the individuals of each species and their reabsorption into the original stocks to which they belong, and in which the dark will is conserved that continues to be blindly asserted in the dead-end efforts that constitutes it.

And as each one of these efforts constitutes, less a factor of fall and deviation, an approximation of the central will that reaches its realization only in man; equally humanity itself is an endless reiteration of attempts and approximations that achieves a perfect realization of the type only

in very rare men. In a certain way, the battle expressed in the preceding image is still open: if man represents, at least on earth, the last conquered position, as the most advanced position, is the most difficult to maintain. The drifters, the fallen, the deserters, those who are overwhelmed by animal passions are again aspirated and redissolved in forces that bring them back, through contacts with the hidden forces of animality, are without number.

The doctrine of metempsychosis comes into play here in its correct light. It is true in the sense that the possibility of an involutive process is real, for which there is not—as in the vulgar interpretation—the passing of the soul of a man into the body of an *individual* animal: but there is instead its reabsorption into the being or archetype that constitutes the form of the animals born of a given species, whose hidden direction is similar to what informed the whole life of such a man.

Recalling what was said many times in these pages, we can moreover think that, also apart from such “sacrifices” of men to “sacred animals”, other possibilities exist and places of reabsorption. In general, the measure in which the human life receives collective influences, likewise indicates that of the reabsorption and the refoundation in the matrix of humanity, the individual serving as the material for other attempts, other blows, that more or less can happen at the center of the target.

In this regard, many things could be said to clarify the esoteric view about conditioned immortality and reincarnation, if only to interpret phenomena correctly, like those of certain “inheritances”: which—I give it a quick look—do not have for their basis the transmission from individual to individual, but instead a type of “habit” picked up from the “*genius*” or “*manes*” of a given stock: from where every individual who is enucleated in it brings, at the most, a determined characteristic attribute that refers back to a collective influence.

Perhaps I will give myself the opportunity to add something about this. Here, I will conclude by mentioning that the Aristotelian-scholastic

terminology, through which the “genus” is the *matter* and the individual is the *form*—the more there is individuation, the more there is form and perfection—it is that which best reflects our ideas.

Everything in life that is still collective, shows how much there is in man that is still unaccomplished. Separating himself from all that is not himself, individuating himself absolutely from being only himself, and only himself, man goes beyond the destiny of rebirth, because he accomplishes the goal of that very rebirth. Without further variations and deviations, he then incarnates the pure central vector by “not having more daemons” and by doing a single thing on earth with his “idea” and his “Name”.

Posted on 2013-04-14 by Aeneas

* * *

Mercurius on 2013-04-16 at 08:14 said:

Recently, Evola’s review of Berdyaev’s “Meaning of History” was published on Gornahoor; there are likewise some similarities between Evola and Berdyaev’s ideas regarding evolution. Berdyaev neither dismisses nor argues against biological data or “fact”—for him as well, all of the biological and chronological data could very well be accurate, it is the interpretation that differs. Unlike Evola, Berdyaev does not however discuss a “devolution”, or difference in “direction”; rather, he stresses that despite bio/morphological changes, teleology is the best argument contra evolution, “This does not imply the acceptance of man’s destiny as the theme of the metaphysics of history. For to admit the manifestation of man’s destiny in world history, it is also necessary to admit his preworld existence; that his destiny originated and was determined prior to the establishment of that world of reality where occur all those processes of evolution and development by which evolutionary theory tries to explain both man’s origins and his further development”. Somewhere on Gornahoor seemed to be a very similar excerpt from Solovyov, although it is being allusive right now.

Ammonius420 on 2013-04-17 at 02:04 said:

How do the Yugas described by Guénon and Hindu tradition relate to geological time? I recall that Fulcanelli wrote a book that in part touched on fossilized lifeforms and their relation to cosmic cycles, has this been found?

Boreas on 2014-11-19 at 00:47 said:

Ammonius, regarding the geological record and the Yuga cycles, there is an excellent article at Cakravartin about the more recent past; the second part of the article especially deals with the geological facts in relation to the cycles. Here's the link:

<http://www.cakravartin.com/archives/the-end-of-the-kali-yuga-in-2025-unraveling-the-mysteries-of-the-yuga-cycle-by-bibhu-dev-misra>

taivasvaeltaja on 2023-09-23 at 11:08 said:

<https://taivaanmalja.com/2023/09/23/kaannos-esoteerinen-lajien-alkupera/>

Mihai on 2013-04-18 at 04:58 said:

Evola introduces here some complications which are certainly not sustainable by traditional doctrine. From a Christian point of view, at least, Each species manifest a given aspect of the Logos, being, thus, fixed, each having its own reason for existence, separated to the others. Man is the only one who manifests the Image in its entirety.

Transformism is as much a problem when conceived both evolutionary and involutory, since it introduces a confusion between the various 'logoi', making only a difference of degree between one species and another. Nature, however, is a hierarchical order, with essential differences between the four levels of mineral, vegetal, animal and human.

Now if the Image of God in man, no matter the degradation, can never be annulled, and if animals derive from man in an involutory process, than we are either forced to admit that the animals also have the Image of God within them, or that, somehow, that Image has been along the way annulled.

So this is going to far. It is enough to say that man can degenerate to such a degree that he comes to resemble the animal, but it is only caused by the fact that he reaches the outer limit of the human domain and the features of the inferior one (that of the animals) begin to be reflected on him, especially since he has strayed so far away from the primordial origin. However, between the two domains there remains an impassable limit.

As to the various geological records:

1. They are extremely controversial
2. They are actually quite smaller than the mainstream authorities try to make us think
3. Their 'history' is built through a very procroustean method
4. They, themselves, can account for multiple theories.

Cologero on 2013-04-18 at 12:48 said:

You bring up interesting points, Mihai, but as the text says, Evola perhaps means by “derive” something different from what you express. In the process of involution, the idea of Man comes first. So these “derivations” are actually successive attempts to lead up to the appearance of man in his corporeality. Several of the attempts branched off into different directions, or went extinct. One path led to man. Thus, they are not physical human beings who were degraded. There are two questions, then.

(1) Does this theory accord with the facts as we know them?

(2) Does this theory explain how it leads to Man?

Darwinism answers (1) but not (2), since there is no necessary reason for Man to arise within that theory.

The essential differences between the four kingdoms of mineral, vegetable, animal and human are not absolute. The higher stage is related to the lower stage as genus and differentia. So, while man is an “animal with reason”, it would not be correct to understand an animal as a “man without reason”; I think that is the point you are getting at? But I don’t see Evola denying that.

You may want to go back and read the essay on Plotinus from the UR group that was published on Gornnahoor a few weeks ago, since a similar theme arises. Plotinus claimed that evil was “derived” through “degradation” and “dissolution”. So there is a convergence of ideas, as one would expect.

Pickman on 2013-04-20 at 21:55 said:

So what came first, the chicken or the egg? Certainly in respect to Darwinism “there is no necessary reason for Man to arise within that theory” as the lower does not give birth to the higher and we are left to ponder the “why” behind the theory – since basic bio-determinism, within the limits of a materialist theory or survival of the fittest is ill-equipped to answer what is essentially spiritual.

The goal of the universe was to lead the material to its superior form of spiritual transgression. Yet we are left with questions as to how the original manifestation began (a fall?). This I find the most difficult part to grasp of the involution theory.

So how did man first appear?

I will leave that question open to others before I venture to offer my own theories on this subject.

Cologero on 2013-04-21 at 11:18 said:

Yes, Pickman, that would be a good discussion. Perhaps it should wait until the rest of the essay is made available. Perhaps this idea can be pondered in the meantime. When you consider any of your own projects, the idea of it is formulated and a plan adopted. Then there is the effort to materialize it. Here is where the difficulties arise. Certain aspects of the plan

may hit roadblocks or veer into dead ends. A “feedback loop” is necessary to continuously alter the plan to take extenuating circumstances into account. The “material” world, dominated as it is by the principle of Destiny, or determinism, is resistant to anything new. It is a measure of one’s will to power to be able to overcome such obstacles in order to realize one’s ideas in the material world; in this case, essence and existence become a unity. Guenon refers to that as the self-manifestation of one’s possibilities. So the “goal” of the universe is not really so much to lead the material (which really does not exist at all independently) to the spiritual, but rather to materialize all the possibilities of manifestation.

Sigurd on 2017-07-07 at 11:32 said:

“essence and existence become a unity. Guenon refers to that as the self-manifestation of one’s possibilities. So the “goal” of the universe is not really so much to lead the material (which really does not exist at all independently) to the spiritual, but rather to materialize all the possibilities of manifestation.”

Cologero, could you elaborate on this? It appears very nebulous to me. I presume you aren’t referring to some “horizontal” application of possibilities; lest you fall into some justification to “realize” all sorts of abominations, their very possibility demanding it. You’re aware of this, I’m sure: can you edify me on what it means to “realize” the spiritual? Is this related to the so-called “resurrection resolution of the flesh”?

If I’m on the right track, I can employ certain terms to ask for clarification as well, at the risk of misusing them due to my nascent understanding of tradition and philosophy: the essence (eidos), that is virtual, becomes actual or “substantial” (ousia) through participation in being (on), its “material” side (materia secunda) then giving rise to specific accidents in time.

Cologero on 2017-07-07 at 22:22 said:

It’s interesting to me, Sigurd, that you even noticed that. It is hard to accept, although I’m not offering it as a *justification* for abominations, but simply as an observable fact. I can outline a little syllogism, and then you can decide if it makes any sense, or might require some refinements (if not outright rejection).

- 1) We can stipulate that in God, essence and existence are identical.
- 2) We can stipulate that, although man is both a spiritual and material being, his essence and existence are not identical.
- 3) Rather, man is a privation, i.e., he has possibilities of being that are not actualized.
- 4) That is clearly, if trivially, true in the growth and development from infancy to adulthood.
- 5) I tried to get at this in the *Meditation on the washing of the feet*⁴¹. This should be more than a philosophical exercise, but needs to be contemplated. (I.e., raised to the level of

⁴¹<http://www.meditationsonthetarot.com/death-and-resurrection>

“intellectus” from the “ratio”.)

6) I think this is in accord with your third paragraph, isn't it? This is unlike some eastern or gnostic systems which attempt to flee the world, rather than to tend and transform it.

7) As for the “horizontal” possibilities that may lead to abominations: are they truly my possibilities? They may be infernal possibilities, i.e., ideas that don't arise from my own Being, but rather are imposed from the outside. As such their “actualization” represents a privation of my being, not its actualization. This may be true of seemingly “good” accidents, such as one's family, culture, race, etc., insofar as they represent a blind collectivity.

On the cosmic scale, it does indeed seem that all possibilities are being manifested, either in a positive sense or most often as a privation. If Guenon is correct that no possibilities, like snowflakes, are ever exactly the same, then things repeat over and over, just with very subtle variations. For example, how many ways can people die or be tortured? How many ways can humans engage in sex? How many variations in food, clothing, etc. are there? Everything just nauseatingly repeats itself with small changes. And people go wild for it, believing in the novelty of their little variation. The world will end when there has been enough.

So, yes, there is participation in being when the essence becomes actual, but privation is non-being, merely appearance. But the appearances are horrifying.

Caveman on 2017-12-07 at 19:22 said:

How should the Neanderthal be understood in this anthrogonic framework? This question is perhaps all the more relevant as it is scientifically alleged today that there occurred some interbreeding between Neanderthals and Cro Magnon man, leaving DNA traces in the modern genome which peaks in Caucasians (and is absent in sub-Saharan Africans). Would they be considered the fallen and deteriorated remnants of some pre-Adamic man? Their apparent practice of cultic rites indicates that some intuition of spiritual reality survived in them, which means that they must probably be considered human, albeit a less central manifestation thereof than their Cro Magnon contemporaries.

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-17 at 08:23 said:

As much as I enjoy Evola's writings, I think he is wrong here.

In the first place, he didn't know that the Neanderthal man was not an “anthropoid ape like figure”, but was fully human, there were many frauds that were only uncovered recently.

Also the many huge skulls and bones that were found, making the “evolutionist” hypothesis even more incredible, bones of giants for example.

To finish it off, Michael Behe proved in solid biological grounds, that mutations cannot construct irreducibly complex forms, because they need all parts at once to work. Not only that, he proved that species tend to devolve, that mutations are actually changes in existing genes, not the creation of new ones.

Lucy, the astrolapithecus, and many other fossils, have been shown to be fully apes. There were many other frauds, that are innumerable. Transitory forms have actually been shown to be very problematic, species appear in the geological record suddenly, as he himself noticed.

Now, to say that there has been a material that made the substance of humans and it doesn't fossilize or show in the geological record is to invent something based on imagination, because there is no proof of that, even though we can clearly see in many ways how the modern life is a degeneration in many ways from the profound ancient wisdom. But there have been improvements too, as in medicine, so there is no progress, nor regression depending on the point of view.

Obviously, spirituality is that which is the highest, so in general one could say that there has been a regression.

But that there were simpler forms to appear I don't think can be denied, again, this only shows that the things more steeped in materiality appeared first, while man appeared last being crowned, there are other elements that will never be known to us regarding the giants, the gigantic skulls, the humans that appear to have degenerated from the primordial stock early on, all we can do is to make up hypothesis that will never lead really anywhere, since the events cannot be brought back, maybe there was an age of gods and men, but how will we know? What about the huge animals that appear in the fossil record, why are there trees that live over thousands of years? Humans have no natural defence against the natural world, no instincts, could it be that humans struggled like beasts in order to "conquer" mother Earth? The order of things indicates that humans were given from the beginning the means to achieve his final destination, which is a high spirituality that leads to ecstasy and self-mastery. As soon as they appeared, they were given all of these gifts, but they already existed ideally celestially, in the eternal idea, according to the myths of all traditional peoples they were immortals from the beginning.

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-17 at 08:36 said:

Buried Alive: The Startling Untold Story About Neanderthal Man Jack Cuozzo

The author is an orthodontist who measured the dental arch of the Neanderthals in a Paris museum and found that they had all been assembled wrong, so they looked chinless, he was persecuted fiercely after showing the fraud, this myth of the anthropoid neanderthal is still being told this very day.

Ciência Aristocrata on 2020-09-18 at 06:17 said:

The great myths recall divine origins, not animalistic origins. But the Bible speaks of lower races that mingled with the human race, which is curious, the Bible mentions a race of giants, and today we find the fossils of these giants. It is not possible to understand a perfect history of the past with horizontal science, because the history of origins is a metahistory, only a vertical

science could say anything about this type of history.

We find human fossils huge and inexplicable skulls, of which ufologists say they are aliens.

But this idea of highly technological aliens is part of the modern myth of progress, which has already been demonstrated by Guénon to be fallacious, the modern myth is ingrained in the modern mind.

If there is purpose in the causes, first humans were given the means to reach their purpose, the purpose of humans is to reach the contemplation of truth.

Materialists who deny the finality of the causes claim that they were like beasts that suffered by dying and attempting to dominate mother nature, in a blind, brute way, this is because the highest thing for materialists is the dominion of matter, they don't see that this actually doesn't satisfy the human will.

Indeed, human beings have no natural defenses, unlike birds that when released into nature know how to distinguish good fruits from poisonous fruits, there is nothing in humans that allow them to distinguish the bad from the good things for their survival, they have no protections against the various dangers of nature, no fur, no shells, nothing, if no science was given to them from the start, not only would they not be able to reach their finality, nor would they be able to survive, it is absolutely necessary that the first humans were aware of the means of protection and to reach the end that is proper only to man, which is contemplation.

Cologero on 2013-04-22 at 08:44 said:

On page 180 of the American edition of *Revolt*, the reference to Dacque was dropped and only the reference to *The Transformist Illusion* by Douglas Dewar was retained. That whole paragraph has some errors, which are even misleading. E.g., the original text does not contain the phrase "man is not alone". One would wonder then who else is far from being the product of evolution. I will be providing a revised translation in this space soon.

Max on 2015-07-24 at 06:22 said:

Evola says this: "... humanity itself is an endless reiteration of attempts and approximations that achieves a perfect realization of the type only in very rare men."

I interpret it as that the race is not necessarily what determines a person, but on the contrary a person possibly determines the race. The other individuals who belong to the same race are "approximations" to its fullest expression. From this it follows that there are guiding ideas of races. He writes that races and species are different "directions". I think we could characterize the horizontal direction in a race, species or type as a sort of general will, a kind of inertia in movement that steams along quite unconsciously in many cases. The vertical descent of will in a particular person is able influence this direction. Some may not keep up or agree to the change of direction, perhaps they drop off and become another race with another destiny. These ideas are connected to the idea of kingship and hierarchy. If the king legitimately decides "this

is the direction", those who oppose that can not be part of the community. Something to note here is that if we have a goal in mind, the direction has to be changed during the course of travel depending on what is encountered, so it is important to interpret the signs. Nowadays however, we have a situation where there is not much hierarchy, and people become subjected to unhealthy influences instead.

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-17 at 08:58 said:

What else is far from being the product of the evolution of animal species? Tigers? Why do you think they removed the reference to Dacque?

J. R. R. Tolkien on 2020-09-17 at 09:22 said:

As we see modern man becoming more and more like an animal, proves that in the beginning man was more and more like a god.

13.1 An Introduction to Guido de Giorgio

Guido Lupo Maria De Giorgio, pseudonym “Havismat” (San Lupo, October 3 1890 – Mondovi, December 27, 1957) was an esoterist and Italian writer.

After graduating with a degree in philosophy, he went to Tunisia where he worked as a teacher of Italian. There, he came into contact with Islamic esoterism through a local brotherhood. He then moved to Paris after WW I, where he got to know Rene Guenon. He backed his friend, collaborated with him by writing articles for the two major French esoteric journals of the time: *Le Voile d’Isis* and *L’initiation*.

He returned to Italy in the 1920’s and participated in the *Gruppo di Ur*, writing under the name **Havismat**. In 1930, he joined with **Julius Evola** in promoting the journal *La Torre*, in which he came up with a theory of a type of Sacred Fascism with the effort to universalize the Fascist movement in an esoteric way.

In *La Tradizione romana (The Roman Tradition)*, de Giorgio accused Europe in the aftermath of WW II of have become scientific and

of stifling the spiritual research of man. The solution, according to de Giorgio, lay in returning to an ancient conception of spiritual and temporal authority. A typescript version of this work, whose original title was “The dead badge of power. Introduction to the doctrine of Roman Sacred Fascism”, was given to **Benito Mussolini** for Christmas in 1939.

In *Dio e il Poeta* (*God and the Poet*), de Giorgio poured out his mystical experience arising from his ascetical practices.

None of his works was published during his lifetime, some posthumously and others still unpublished.

Julius Evola In *Cammino del Cinabro*, Julius Evola describes Guido de Giorgio.

He was a type of initiate in the wild and chaotic state, he had lived among the Arabs and personally knew Guenon, who held him in high esteem. He was a man of exceptional culture, he knew several languages, but he had a rather unstable temperament and strong passionate positions, emotive and lyrical almost like Nietzsche.

Evola goes on to describe de Giorgio’s erratic personal and love life, his strong personality, then describes their collaborations and even trips together to the Alps. (They both loved the mountains.) Evola conceded that towards the end, they grew apart somewhat due to de Giorgio’s “indulgence in a sort of Vedanta-ized Christianity”.¹

From *La Tradizione romana*

The restoration that we propose, taking up again the thought, aspiration and ideal of **Dante**, is a return to the spirit of Rome,

¹Apparently, Evola was unaware of *La Tradizione romana*, which was never published during his lifetime.

not the pure and simple repetition of the past that would unrealizable, because nothing of the contingencies of the world ever repeats itself, but the adhesion to those eternal principles of truth that are contained in the Sacred Books and expressed by ancient symbols. To save Europe and the West from catastrophe, it would depend not as much on the external material things that are of scant value in themselves, but on those deep, internal, spiritual values ... the catastrophe of the life of the spirit, the collapse of the truth.

References:

- Wikipedia article²
- “Il Cammino del Cinabro”, by Juius Evola
- La Tradizione romana³, by Guido de Giorgio

Posted on 2010-12-18 by Cologero

13.2 The Instant and Eternity

This is an article by **Guido de Giorgio**, titled *The Instant and Eternity*, first published in Diorama Filosofico in 1939.

The Myth of the Future We can say that the sacred is distinguished from the profane in what is essentially oriented toward the past to fix the stages of a procession which necessarily finds its culmination in a “present”. This “present” is the metaphysical point where eternity throws itself, where the worlds dissolve in a fullness without limits, a duration

²https://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guido_De_Giorgio

³https://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guido_De_Giorgio

without rhythm, a bliss without end. The present is eternity, the past is only the vestibule that leads toward, which inserts into eternity. To repeat, to retrace the whole cycle which is realized in the point means to carry with oneself the experience of the centuries, all cosmic evolution to unravel the framework in the pupil of God.

Faust could not stop the instant because he knew only the caducity of the instance, the immediate iridescence of illusion, the vertigo which submerges instead of transfiguring, the “shadow of the flesh”, the labile and evanescent phantasm, not that which in God resides an infinite momentariness which is the mystery of the eternal now. Such are the two aspects of the “instant”, according to which one places himself on the human or divine plane; it is about two apparently opposed and divergent points which mark two worlds, two rhythms, two realities, of which one is absolute, true, the other fallacious and illusory. Faust’s words “stop, you are so beautiful!” is only a not very original lyrical substitute in the face of the unfathomed plenitude of the Ineffable where the mystery of the divine gestation takes place. The myth of purification through aesthetics is only the very fragile bridge thrown by modern imbecility onto the momentariness of the human-cosmic illusion in order to evade the positive certitude of the mystery, an impassable wall or else by the dizzying passing of the wing, i.e., of the Spirit of God.

That is why the modern world oscillates between a dead past and a nebulous future, between what is no longer and what will never be, except in the hope that anticipates and builds. Traditional wisdom, on the contrary, turns toward the past, lives it, enriches it, *updates* it, inserting itself in it to lead it fully into the present and renew it in the *ver aeternum* eternal spring which the Ancients attributed to the Golden Age, pointing to the perennial germination of the Truth, the multitude of transfiguring states, life which knows neither birth nor death, for it uncoils itself in the bliss of the realizing consciousness. But for moderns the past is past, dead, finished, concluded, closed, irremediable: “le déjà vu, le déjà vécu” already

seen, already lived, says Bergson, according to a psychological orientation that clearly manifests all the nostalgic sentimentality of the small man horribly enslaved by his small world. So that between a dead past and a future not yet born, the twilight present swings, at once a cloudy waning and a too pale dawn, in sum a veritable pause in agony. And from this erroneous vision the *myth of the future* is derived, the tension toward what is not, toward what will never be because in reality only the present, in absorbing the past, is the dynamic point, *the whole bow of the ship* which faces the horizon *but never reaches it*.

The Past as Death and Life

This is the second section of **Guido de Giorgio**'s essay *The Instant and Eternity*. Here de Giorgio compares modern and traditional man. He brings in many themes previously covered here: the continuity of the past; the notion of depth in the flow of history, i.e., "subterranean history"; the past understood in the interiority, not as something external. Moderns can never rest, they can never "be", because they are always becoming, looking to the future to pass judgment on them. But the moderns of the future will despise them as much as the moderns of today despise their own roots, heritage and past.

Burying beetles bury the carcasses of small vertebrates such as birds and rodents as a food source for their larvae. This is the perfect description of modern man as a beetle. Although the essay was written in 1939, it is even more applicable today.

Modern man can be compared to a burying beetle *nécrophore* that longs for the day that never comes: the cadaver that he carries is the past, his inert, sterile heritage, and the day that he awaits is the future, the imaginary descent, the glorious completion of a chimeric unfinished childbirth. We will remark that all modern men, the "great men of history", wait for a definitive judgment of the future on their oeuvre, for perhaps they feel,

consciously or not, that nothing of what they made relates traditionally to the royal stream of the past, not is it capable of resisting the movements of the magnetic needle of the present, the brief and momentary instant having an impact on many abysses other than the insignificant trace of the passing cloud. That is why ancient man is a bearer of worlds: he did not leave the past behind him, but harvests it and carries it along, in such a way to construct in reality a single incidental point, the sole present, the current time, while modern man, discarding a heavy burden for his not very virile shoulders, is light, inconsistent, and through fear of being thrown to the earth by the blows of the crosswinds, clings to the machine, which is both his cradle and his tomb. For the myth of the future is associated with the myth of speed which—if we consider its function, its interior plan—is the abolition of the past in the already traversed, the imperceptibility of the present minimized in the permanent expectation of the future. The readers who would like to deepen these insights in a penetrating manner will find more than one way leading easily to the comprehension of some major truths. We desire to establish here, with a certain insistence, only some critical reflections whose development perspective will turn out to be clearer and surer.

We therefore understand that modern man and ancient man are absolutely opposed and like the antipodes, in the literal sense of the term, the one by relationship to the other: tied to a same line of descent but turned toward different heavens with different constellations, although the same impassible sun throws light on that line of descent in what for one is day for the other, night. For the Ancients, in effect, the past is everything, for the moderns, nothing, even when they have the illusion of absent mindedness looking in the past for solutions to the questions of the present—what are called the “warnings”, the “teachings” of the past—, around sentimental fantasies exploited with a cynical opportunism according to the circumstances and proposed to the credulity of the naïve for the most pitiable perpetrations. Rhetoric, which triumphs today as

never before in today's cloudy and swampy Europe, has recourse to the most bestial ruses to obtain the consent of the plebes as the audience and makes use of the past as a remedy against all illnesses, the universal balm, the supports of the present, but of a momentary usage as if to ward off the *Vae soli*! Woe to him who is alone, Eccl. 4:10 Modern man, in reality, is already frozen in the past, no longer lives it, and takes from it only dust and ruin: he studies it, classifies it, ignores it. The more detailed the inquiry is made, the more it becomes sketchy, each one seeking subsequently to make life blow over these bones asleep in the slumber of death. Thus, when they turn toward the past to study it, the moderns then succumb to the same illusion as when they believe, for example, that the photograph is closer than the truth, although it is denatured totally in being fixing in the momentariness of something already passed. But independently of study, let us see if the moderns use the past according to life. Who says past, says tradition, i.e., interior, dynamic unification, not exterior adhesion, not opportunistic sympathy, not simple position or situation; in other words, there should be between the past and the present, *continuity, immutability*, or, better said, a rhythmic development so regular, permanent, internal, that it would appear to be indifferent. Antiquity, in fact, is characterized by a constant tonality which endures, immobile, from one epoch to the other; there is and must be a change, but it takes place in depth, in the interior strata, invisibly, we are tempted to say, in a way to not disrupt the regularity of the rhythm.

The Meaning of the Past

This is third section of an article by **Guido de Giorgio**, titled *The Instant and Eternity*, first published in *Diorama Filosofico* in 1939.

I am constantly struck by so many people today who only perceive darkness, ignorance, or intolerance in the past. They tell me about

dictators oppressively their people, who must be saved; some unfortunates who cannot afford this or that without a new government program; some marginal group that must be accepted; and so on. They long for some mythical future when all will be well with the world. Yet they do nothing for their own family, their own children and grandchildren; they assume their current life will continue, just as it is now. They cannot conceive that someday they will be oppressed, impoverished, or marginalized, with nothing to hope for. Those who cut their ties to the past don't have a future, because they don't even know what it is.

We said many times that ancient cultures are immobile or seem to be such; but that is precisely their greatness, that fundamental stability that removes all contrasts, integrates all rhythms into the central vein, to the *traditional type*, who alone remains in the wholeness of its formative efficacy. That is why whoever intends to remain in the pure domain of traditional truth, always turns, logically, toward the past, to retrace the stages of certitude and add them to his experience. This, under that angle, is then recapitulative and conclusive: it is not an exterior repetition, but grants its rhythm to that which is none other than its own face, today still ignored, from now on found again and vivified. It is very difficult to explain certain things to those who hold onto dualist positions and who think that there is something besides the Truth, which is God eternally present. Truth: there only can *one become what he is*, i.e., one transcends the sphere of human limitations to live the same beat of the infinite.

When we say *ancient* we mean everything that is valuable, perennial, traditionally authentic in the past of the East and the West, whether it is about a distant or near, doctrinal or poetic, past: it matters little, provided that it reflects, in the truth of its expression, the great light of the Superworld. Beyond the Sacred Books, there is Poetry and sacred Art. There is finally all the forms of activity which, in the past, always relate to a truth of a higher order, be it in a modest utensil, and in the fabrication and the

destination of objects of current usage. That past, as we mean it, and all those who are searching only for the truth of God should mean it, is life, creative rhythm, an inexhaustible deposit of wisdom which renews itself each time it is actualized by a new experience. But it is especially the reality of a vibrant life because vivified by the perennial breath of traditional energy. Moderns consider the past as a relic whose ruins they borrow and around which they prowl with the curiosity of photographers and archeologists: who, among them, accepts the past totally, assumes it in all its fullness, not in order to seize from it some fragments and exalt them, but in order to integrate it in one's experience of life while recapitulating it in a creative manner?

The Tangible Immediacy of the Present

This is final section of an article by **Guido de Giorgio**, titled *The Instant and Eternity*, first published in *Diorama Filosofico* in 1939.

How many of Dante's admirers are there who are not content in glorifying his verses or expression—something absolutely exterior and superficial—but who in applying the doctrine, the knowledge on all the planes of being to which they relate and in the totality of the Heavenly Voyage.

The past is nothing if it is not integrated, lived, validated by personal experience, by life, if it is not totalized and exalted in the great shaking of the eternal now. The moderns, when they are not fornicating in the past like the thieves in a necropolis, turn their backs on it, contemplating then the hypothetical "sun of the future" which will never shine, because the future exists only as the last evanescent border of an arduous vision, a mirage and nothing more, a fallacious projection stained by the spasms of their own insufficiency. The "non-achievement" in the face of the Truth, the incurable sentiment of one who does not know nor wants to know,

does not know how to nor wants to carry with himself all the weight of the world, to assume it in the divine instant, created the myth of the future. Turning obstinately their backs to that which is, they wait with curiosity for what is not, for what will be, and they long for the confirmation of a dream by an illusory reflection of the dream itself, in a nocturnal march of phantoms that alone engender the present, by the spontaneity of its flux and its mirage. Strange speculation on the future, which makes them forget the treasures of the past and the tangible immediacy of the present. For they are really only in the present, with all worlds, in the essential unity of the point, jewel of all jewels, the eternal eye of God!

We would like to still say some other things, but we prefer to conclude with the words of **Zarathustra**:

To these men of today will I not be light, nor be called light. Them,
will I blind with the lightning of my wisdom! Put out their eyes!

FRIEDRICH NIETZSCHE, *Zarathustra*

Posted on 2012-06-12 by Cologero

* * *

Egemen on 2012-06-12 at 04:51 said:

A nice dealing about the sacred past of civilization. I want to share a song and poem of one of the esoteric orders of the that is bektaşilik (http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bektashi_Order), (<http://it.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bektashi>)

And this is the youtube link of song; <http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=m-awL-CGLCNo>

And these are the lyrics which will translate and explain by me later...

Ondort bin yıl gezdim pervanelikte
Sıdk-i ismin buldum divanelikte
?ctim sarabini mestanelikte
Kırların ceminde dara düs oldum
Guruh-u naci'ye özümü kattım

?nsan s?fatından çok geldim gittim
Bülbül oldum firdevs bağında öttüm
Bir zaman gül için zara düs oldum

I had travelled in space for fourteen thousand years (pervanelik means space or outer space and also pervanelik means planets; if a object turning around another thing, you can say for object; it is the pervane of other thing)

I had found the true meaning of your name (sidk-i ism) in madness (divanelik means madness or extacy)

I had drunk your wine at mestanelik (mestanelik means a place which people is getting transcendence state of mind)

I had forced to be brought to book at forty's court (in ancient asian tribes or little orders there was a court that call sometimes "gathering", which judges some problems of society. Forty's are prophets from Adam to Muhammed)

I had put in the forty's to my essence (güruh-u naci is the persian idiom of Forty's)

I had come and gone from the presence of human (or Adam Kadmon), (that means i had many experience of transfiguration, transformation or metamorphism...)

I had had form of nightingale and sing at the vineyard of Firdevs... (Firdevs is the highest level of the heaven; maybe as mentioned in Dante's Comedia)

i had fall to a garden for rose, for a moment... After all this explanations, there is a little story about origins of that song:

Before Islam and other monotheistic religions, ancient central asian nations had their pantheons, their celestial beings as elohim in torah. One of them called as "Gabriel, Cebrail or Cibril, most probably after influence of Islam, and this Gabriel is humanlike creature of the god.

This human's breed was in danger, because of their green sun which Gabriel's home planet rounds around it (pervanelik), had come to hers ver end of life.

If Gabriel could not hade found a way to rescue his breed, they will have been destroyed with their planet. Hereby, Gabriel or Cibril had get a quest for a new planet to live on. And Cibril had prepared his spacecraft and hit on the roads of outer space, after that he had met with the god. And god asked to the Cibril:

"Who are you and who am I?"

Cibril answered was a little bit defiant;

"You are You and I am me"

God had not liked that answer and He punished Cibril by rampant traveling in outer space about fourteen thousand years.

In this punishment era, Cibril was getting into the madness and suddenly God appears and ask his same question again:

"Who are you and who am I?"

After all these hard years, Cibril had come to his senses and answers:

“You are the Creator, I am the creation”

After being excused, Cibril encounters a blue planet, they land to that planet and search of the lands and waters. They recognize, a creature that has similar genetically similar to them is living that blue planet. They decide to make a mержence between their breed and that creature. They had get some of these creatures with them and return their home planet.

At the Forty's Court; they had made some genetical experiments about mержence of breeds and they found a new species that are similar to them. After that, the creators of human generation had get that new species and return to the blue planet and so on as you know.

P.S. I listened that story in 1987 from a Bektasi person. After several years, I met with Zecharia Sitchin and his Works

<http://www.sitchin.com/>

After some research about that story, I found it is not only belongs to Bektashi order, and you can find similar stories in Dharma and Ancient Chinese Traditions...

13.3 Tradition & the General Law

Before beginning this post, several definitions of terms peculiar to Boris Mouravieff's work:

A Influences: sensate pressures and resulting spiritual tendencies, along with the cosmic hierarchies which keep them in “tutelage” (see St. Paul in *Galatians 4*)

General Law: the karma which keeps the men in bondage to the above from ever escaping the spiritual entropy of their own lusts. The General Law aims for the common good – it “uses” mankind to accomplish aims which it itself, by itself, cannot accomplish. General Law is itself subject to Higher Laws, which are “B Influences”.

What this essay will postulate is that submission to Authority (A Influences at first, then B influences, if man succeeds spiritually) is the only way according to Tradition that the “masses” can be helped (primarily, by avoiding a cataclysm of fiery judgement, but also by making “quiet lives of godliness and peace” possible through the organization of man. The

Revolution, on the contrary, postulates that Authority does not exist, or (if it does or is “felt”) ought to be “broken”. Thus, a third definition:

Revolution: the idea/ideal that A Influences (and by extension, B Influences as well) can be “broken” rather than transcended or undone. Mouravieff takes pains to explain that “The Great Game” means that A Influences are legitimate, & that they can only be overcome through purity of heart (forgive your enemies, turn the other cheek, etc., all of which has esoteric meaning as well). It is not possible to defeat Satan by reifying Evil as Authority, and attacking Authority. Saint Paul concurs: “the weapons of our warfare are spiritual, not physical”. “Love the brotherhood, Fear God, Honor the King”.

So a reading of Mouravieff’s Gnosis⁴ makes clear that Christian Esotericism is not an *ersatz* for those wishing to avoid other traditions or authority, nor an escape for those who want to remain purely exoterically Christian, without ever advancing (or preparing to advance in the post-mortem state). One cannot substitute political “Revolutionary” progress in external matters for inner development. To explain this, he notes after a long discussion of man’s “three centers” (head, heart, motor) and how they inter-relate with the higher centers which remain (for him) unactualized, that “practically speaking” for most men, the only break upon their unbridled self-domination of the false I of their mini-personality is actually the “links” or “shocks” which this personality induces upon the other parts of him which are (at the moment) not acting, or not directly involved in the instantiation of the false I. Mouravieff then links this with the General Law – in the absence of self-government, men come under the “General Law” (which he later specifies is the Adversary, cosmologically). So, since the “fear of God” is missing in these people, their governments reflect the “brakes” or links within their own *chakras*, which are all that is holding them back from *publicly* proclaiming themselves to

⁴<http://www.scribd.com/doc/4549935/Gnosis-Book-I-Boris-Mouravieff-Exoteric-Cycle1>

be as God. Therefore, strong

government is required to hold them in check. Penalties and checks are required to restrain them, because (and he is clear on this) “morality alone” cannot restrain the extreme and anarchistic tendencies of the unbridled false I/personality. Mouravieff is saying that Revolution by itself (and that is the definition of Revolution) is “Hell on earth”. The Revolution destroys little Satans, & sets up even bigger Ones. How is this Progress?

This is precisely the ancient, traditional doctrine of government, endorsed by none other than the apostle Paul in Romans 13, when he proclaims the secular arm or Caesar to be the “sword of God”, whose purpose is to bring terror to evildoers. Christ taught this also – “render unto Caesar”.

Bondarev’s interpretations of Steiner are accurate here, in that the Counter-Initiation will seek to proclaim an Anti-Christ, which will counterfeit the Kingdom of God and the integrity of Tradition, falsely liberate man, and suck all of Creation (or at least the earth) into a black hole (since the Lie can only live until the “fullness of evil” is reached, after which, it will implode). Mouravieff teaches that Peter warns against this in his own epistles – either redemption (the rise of a Christian elite, or “salt and light”), or another cataclysm.

It is not difficult to connect this with either the French Revolution or with the modern ideal of Progress: in fact, Mouravieff explicitly states in the early pages of *Gnosis 1* that “progress” (as such) can have no absolute meaning at all, in the slightest. In fact, there is no “progress” in material affairs, when measured by the yardstick of true Enlightenment. Material man is subject to Death, and this is all. *The Earth returns to the earth*, says Scripture. The “straight line” of Progress goes against the Logos, because only the spiral (in accordance with the Rays of Creation) can resist entropy, which is Christ’s mission. Tomberg would call these “vertical energies” which transcend the Serpent’s eternal horizontal circle

of purely physical reality. Satan offers man the chance to “die” by refusing self-government and embracing Revolution (Lust). Thus, he promises life without Life, life through illusion: “sorcery-States”. Man can, therefore, stay as he is, as he wishes to be and remain. This is an illusion, the General Law will still win – thus man is eternally frustrated in “Revolution”.

It should be unnecessary (here) to connect these teachings with the Anti-Christ. That is not our concern for now, instead to defend the idea of a Christian knighthood. In fact, “Superman” is a term which Mouravieff says applies properly only to a “new elite” (pages 185ff in *Gnosis 1*). If the false elite succeed in spreading this corruption (and find fertile ground for it), the Scriptures promise a baptism of avenging fire for the earth, rather than a redemption. Christ (says Mouravieff) warns of many wolves and false shepherds.

It is not hard to draw the conclusion that almost every trend in the modern world (I say almost, because Mouravieff also makes clear that the “transmissions” of B influences from God-ward towards man never cease, nor does Providence’s spirals of upwardness) is towards the sensate or “New Man” of the Revolution. In Mouravieff’s terms (as we shall see) this is an evolutionary “dead-end” (Tomberg) or a “one-sidedness”.

Mouravieff’s work, when read alongside of Evola’s treatises, or without them, should point us towards the idea that our stand on behalf of mankind has to be made, and can be made, only upon the path that has been revealed – that of individuals who attain higher levels of Being which render them immune to the general process of A influences and the Counter Initiation. The other option is a “Progress” that substitutes for legitimate victory over A influences (the Serpent) *through collective slavery to the endless cycle of A influences in their totality, a totality which still amounts to a Zero*. The General Law, in fact, rewards those whose “go along”. Brilliant careers, much money, fame, fortune, good reputation, etc. Their esoteric energies (teaches Mouravieff) are preyed upon

by higher powers in order to “feed the Moon” (evolve a new world for the common good, which will one day be inherited by the “meek of the earth” who resist A influence and opt for personal revolution over exoteric activity).

This is the reason that Donoso Cortes and Oliviera, as well as Taparelli⁵, van Prinsterer⁶, & also even someone like Althusius⁷ should be studied as models for practical men of action seeking to understand against what they are struggling. Evola is useful for the very same reason.

And what do these good gentlemen have to say?

We are living in a condition of permanent revolution ... revolutions are here to stay and will grow much worse in scope and intensity unless men can be persuaded to return to Christianity, to practise its precepts and to obey the Gospel in its full implications for human life and civilized society. Barring such a revival, the future would belong to socialism and communism, which on this view were but the most consistent sects of the new secular religion. To Groen, therefore, the political spectrum that presented itself to his generation offered no meaningful choice.

In terms of his analysis, the ‘radical left’ was composed of fanatical believers in the godless ideology; the ‘liberal centre,’ by comparison, by warm believers who warned against excesses and preached moderation; **while the ‘conservative right’ embraced all those who lacked either the insight, the prudence, or the will to break with the modern tenets yet who recoiled from the consequences whenever the ideology was practised and implemented in any consistent way.** None of the shades or ‘nuances of secular liberalism represented a valid option for Christian citizens.” Groen called for a rejection of the entire available

⁵<http://bonald.wordpress.com/2010/07/19/taparelli-dazeglio-forgo-tten-founding-father-of-the-right/>

⁶http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Guillaume_Groen_van_Prinsterer

⁷http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johannes_Althusius

spectrum of political positions, calling for a “radical alternative in politics, along anti-revolutionary, Christian-historical lines

HARRY VAN DYKE, GROEN VAN PRINSTERER, *Lectures on Unbelief and Revolution* (1989, pp. 3-4)

Here is the same thought, from Clement Maria Hofbauer⁸:

“Almost as a postscript to the heavenly warning issued at Fatima in 1917, Saint Maximilian Kolbe, two years later, reviewed the three Great Evils of the latter times, noting: “In 1517, the Protestants rebelled against the Church; in 1717, the Freemasons rebelled against Christ; and, in 1917, the Communists rebelled against God.”

In a single sentence the Polish martyr had exposed common origin and natural succession of each of these Apocalyptic nightmares.

What Christian esotericism (Tomberg & Mouravieff) does is offer a way that explains this in terms that most modern people are capable of understanding and accepting, at least in their saner moments and if they are trying to understand (granted, which assumes a lot), thus re-linking exoteric Christians to the Tradition. *The peculiarly Christian hope that exists here is to make the process less dangerous*, both in terms of premature or unnecessary rejection or going astray down a side alley. Whatever else it does, it reaffirms Tradition’s *verdictum* upon the French Revolution – this was not (at least) a permanent way to help the “masses”. The “masses” are to be trained and educated into being a “folk” and a “people”; the creation of the “masses” was itself a diabolical act, and no good will come of it, either for the false elite who did it, or those who wish to accept it as a *fait d’accompli*.

Many other points throughout *Gnosis I* make this clear:

⁸<http://www.catholicism.org/clement-maria-hofbauer.html>

As for the ordinary man of the new era, he will continue to live outside the Truth, as he does today, as long as he can dissimulate his thoughts. The latter will however be easily read by any person who has attained a degree of culture which can be compared, all proportions maintained, to those who give University teaching today.

This reading of thought will no doubt be intrusive & uncomfortable – it might even allow an “upper hand” (in many maneuvers) by the “elite”. And what is the implication of knowing the ordinary man’s thought? A countervailing action will be taken, at the least, to make provision for his duplicity, and perhaps it will simply be made known what he is. Is this in accord with “human rights”, as understood today? It is not.

Mouravieff concludes, & does not hesitate to speak of an elite:

Esoteric Tradition teaches that any civilization is none other than a projection of the consciousness of the ‘I’s of elite man onto the exterior world. The ‘I’ of the intellectual already differs from that of a knight. In the coming civilization, characterized by Art inspired by the sacred, the elite man will possess an ‘I’ consciousness altogether different from the three preceding epochs. He will have, as has already been said, the consciousness of the real ‘I’, of a permanent and unshakable ‘I’, not that of the personal, unstable and composite ‘I’ which our times accept and glorify. Thus the edifice of the future civilization will not be built by the elite on sand, but on the rock of the consciousness of the real ‘I’, the spark.

Mouravieff even puts his finger on the problem of the ruling class of our time:

For man 3 in a ‘world 3’, this is much more difficult. For his mental constitution, reinforced by education, instruction, and the intellectual environment, ends by making a perfectly one-sided

being of him. This is the underlying cause of the weakness of the governing class, which today is not able to stabilize and equilibrate the life of human society even though technical progress offers all the necessary material means to reach this end.

Man 3 (intellectual man) lives in an excessively intellectual age. Thus, we have the global age of the manipulator and technocrat, the best of whom are undoubtedly aware of what is happening. It is their one-sided (my noted added: one might say, in Tomberg's words, "evolutionary dead-ended" development) which propels them to power & renders them an obstacle to world peace at the same time.

Man 2 (emotional or heart-driven man) is at a disadvantage, and cannot attain power, but the Ray of Creation is turning the wheel back to the heart, in order to "recalibrate" human nature. In the coming Age, those who rule will be those who are obviously superior (a spiritual elite). Even the masses will turn to them, just as they turned to the intellectual to end the age of rule by overt physical force. The Revolution is not eternal, Progress (as Mouravieff also states) is not a straight line. Nothing in Creation is a straight line, because straight lines attain their goal, and thus come to a natural end.

Here is a warning for those who want to "go Modern":

It is the same with the woman who, in this modern world, is endowed with refined emotions, and finds herself in conditions which permit her to realize rapid progress on the esoteric plane. In fact the tendency to develop the intellectual qualities in our civilization favours the equilibrium of her centres, on condition, however, that even if dazzled by science she does not lose her feminine emotionality and does not become too calculating. For her, this preservation of her femininity is an obstacle, a competitive test by which selection is automatically made. She must beware

of acquiring a masculine mentality and identifying with this. A male mind in a woman's body excludes the possibility of esoteric development. This type of woman is unfortunately widespread in our days, as is that of the effeminate man, representing what the Tradition calls the neutral sex. Union between these people who have thus deviated from the normal represents the opposite pole to the Androgyne, the summit of deified human power. The Kingdom of God is closed for them.

The Kingdom of God is closed to them. Tomberg makes precisely the same point, more gently, when he warns of becoming over-developed in one aspect, in *Meditations*. The only way, according to Tradition, to overcome Authority and General Law, is to gain victory over the Self. Any other path sets the stage for impurity of heart and delusion, and an actual triumph of A Influences & General Law.

To be continued, with more on "General Law" and overcoming it...

Posted on 2012-06-16 by Logres

* * *

apeiron on 2012-06-16 at 11:14 said:

A good article on the reactions we often encounter from Men who were witnesses in their day to the early onslaught of Satanic decline. While they offered hints and examples of how they lived and brilliant analizations of our circumstances, they have also left us as lone soldiers without an army. No impermeable institutions/orders have lasted their passing on.

"The only way, according to Tradition, to overcome Authority and General Law, is to gain victory over the Self."

Now what of the disciplines, actions and practices to prepare for the postmortem states, to overcome the self and to attain the kingdom of god? No one here has a word to say about these. If you do, then please state them, because it appears that Tradition today is studied, contemplated and over-rationalized from every angle other than lived by the most important and foundational issue at hand: What actions to take.

Logres on 2012-06-16 at 13:33 said:

I understand the frustration, yet unfortunately, it is a lot easier to “do” what is wrong than what is right – therein is the rub. Mouravieff, if you interested, has many instructions in Gnosis for spiritual exercises, including postures, breathing, etc, as well as directions for discerning A influence in your life. This is the first, most vital element – “detoxifying”. Only then can one act with comparative safety of attaining the goal. He also offers guidelines for marriage, as well as explaining the reason behind differing castes and characters of men. This is in addition to a cosmology interpreted by Tradition (Tomberg also has small hints and practices buried in Meditations, including how to use the sign of the cross). However, all of these practices are geared towards preparation – they are preparatory, and thus, not on a grand “world saving” scheme or in the nature of direct action. Their intent is merely to “clear ground”. If you interested in more “direct” rituals, you should read Magic:

<http://www.amazon.com/Introduction-Magic-Rituals-Practical-Techniques/dp/0892816244>

But read it in conjunction with Meditations or Gnosis, because it has spiritual dangers. Personally, I would say that almost all “action” in today’s world is necessarily “hidden” or “occult” – otherwise, it invites the retribution of General Law on a grand scale. Are you prepared for that?

Logres on 2012-06-16 at 20:25 said:

Apeiron, your question is a fair one. Mouravieff actually teaches that faster means are necessary, & in Volume III (which I haven’t read lately, I finished the first two) talks about “polar beings”. The situation is unsatisfactory; I’d be interested in what Cologero or others have to say.

H00 on 2012-06-17 at 14:50 said:

The masses shall return to the tortured bowels of the earth from which they came, they malformed subhumans. Begone, and good riddance. Now Godspeed the First Men.

logres on 2012-06-17 at 22:39 said:

Actually, the “masses” will never do anything good on their own, or even with leadership, until they are made into a “folk” or a people or a commoner. But if there is an elite that is ready when Rome begins to burn, then individuals from lower castes will be drawn to them.

Cologero on 2012-06-18 at 12:25 said:

The masses shall return to the tortured bowels of the earth from which they came, they malformed subhumans. Begone, and good riddance.

This is the sort of ersatz machismo that passes for “virility” really has no place in Tradition. The Traditional organization of society must be understood as organic, with the different segments interrelated in a hierarchical manner. The Kshatriya rules and fights not for their own

end, but rather for the whole. Disdain for those who butcher our meat, bake our bread, mow our lawns, or care for our children needs to be replaced by the ideal of magnanimity.

The “masses” are driven by the passions of eros and thymos, unchecked by reason. Without the spiritual authority to provide that check, their fate is the first rings of hell. The deeper levels are for those who act out of deliberate malice, i.e., the higher castes who know better.

scardanelli on 2013-04-16 at 10:30 said:

After getting a bit further into Mouravieff while also learning a bit about Orthodoxy, i'm curious as to how those in the Orthodox church react to Mouravieff. Is his work seen as basically in line with the church or as heretical new age speculation? I suppose i'm wondering how those in the church view his claim that his work represents a synthesis of esoteric knowledge and practices found scattered throughout the writings of the Church Fathers. It seems that many Orthodox writers strongly recommend the help and advice of a spiritual father from within the church. Would the work of Mouravieff be something to discuss with this spiritual father, or would it be frowned upon and better kept to oneself? Is this perhaps an instance where one would remain silent lest he provoke the General Law?

scardanelli on 2013-04-16 at 10:46 said:

I know that one must take into account the differences that exist between the esoteric and the exoteric, but it seems that the exoteric Orthodox church has a well developed esoteric and ascetic tradition, and i'm curious as to how this tradition regards Mouravieff.

13.4 Death

This is the chapter “La Morte” from *Dio e il Poeta* by **Guido De Giorgio**; this is the first of two parts. The influence of neoplatonism is obvious. De Giorgio has several excellent turns of phrase; I hope I have done them justice.

There is an interruption, a withdrawal, a fracture: Death. Universal, necessary, conclusive, that everyone knows, everyone is present at it, it is continuous, hammering, unforeseen. It gleams madly, one could say disorderly, most times against justice, with a cruelty that often offends the petty human calculation that does not know and overlooks the mysteries

of divine justice and rails and springs against the hard law of necessity, as if God were imperfection, casualism⁹, vindictiveness, and not intelligence, perfection of justice and above all of mercy, of love! They do not think that everything is measured, ordered, foreseen in creation but in a sphere and an abundance that passes beyond common human discernment, beyond every egoistic partialism, every eudemonistic calculation. They do not think that one dies because one must die, that human existence without death would be folly, desperation, pure and simple impossibility. If death did not exist men would pray to God for it, as a liberating escape, as a flight that finally interrupts the existential desperation derived from the *taedium Vitae*, from the disgust of life.

What is death in reality? It is the abandonment of form, of the visible, of sensory concreteness and the passage to something that is unknown, i.e., that which cannot be made precise, fixed, defined. In the human, no one can assert or deny what we will be when we no longer will be and men could conjecture nothing without the Sacred Scripture that—in every religion—speaks above all of death and of that which begins when terrestrial existence terminates. One should say instead that all the religious dynamic puts death in the first place as the limit-point for the intelligence of the divine and the attainment of true wisdom, that which leads to God. The various philosophies, instead—with the vacuity that characterizes them—disregards death, as if it did not exist, as if it fell into the ambit of an experience too common to be considered important, as if its necessity were the indicator of fatalism of becoming, universal recurrence, that it does not depend on the human will, that it is not explained, and is only accepted, coasts along, ignoring it. Yet it a culminating point in the evolution of man that he is viciously split from it with a hurling into the void, the terrible abyss of what is not known and is feared to be known.

Why does Religion make death almost the center of the true vision that man must have of life? The answer is simple: because only religion

⁹<http://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/casualism>

sees after death, sees what follows earthly existence and puts men on guard and admonishes and orients them to this existence in accordance with the necessity of death. To live thinking of death, to always comport oneself in life in view of the end and only in respect to this abrupt void that suddenly spreads wide in front of our soul, our only soul since the corporeal shell is separated and motionless forever and is returned to the earth.

The “force” no longer exists, the pneumatic-psychic-somatic unity is ruptured and what remains can, furthermore, constitute a shadow that begins the voyage of eternity. The detachment will not be rescinded: in the first days the soul of the dead will desire to return to the immobile skin and will roam ravenous around the cadaver then, after every attempt to take back possession of the corpse is rendered useless, he will bring his judgment, his examination and—according to a traditions of the Orient—he is placed facing a great light, in front of which most will close their eyes. His destiny depends on the degree of light that the soul is able to support. The symbolism is obvious: the light is the divine truth and the degree of splendor is the level at which the soul stopped on earth, hence the judgment by which the soul will be fixed for eternity.

The value of prayers and funereal rites that sustain and help to passing over is immense, they serve to facilitate the escape to give the soul in pain the strength necessary in order not to be extinguished, to not lose consciousness of himself, to not let himself go to the vertigo of the void. It seems that the whole cohort of the Saints and archangels is invoked to salvation and it makes the crown of the soul that abandoned the body and that remains fearful, without a home. Only the Saints and the Just who are already *dead* in life do not fear the detachment but instead wait for it with joy because the flight toward God is more certain.

Sanctity is above all the experience of the voluntary death through the realization of the divine and the certain flight of the soul in the formless void. In order to do that the Saint already has prepared himself, by this earth, the wings in order to not be afraid of the void and to be freed in the

immensity of the “world without people”. Whoever, while still in life, has habituated himself to the detachment of the soul from the body, who has glimpsed his naked transience from the contemplative height, who lives of the soul, does not fear death and once this happened, he is “placed” in the order of the spirits who are assigned to him by the Divine Will and that he himself had chosen on earth renouncing every vain desire of choice to conform to the will of Heaven.

For the greater part of men instead, death is a leap, a fearful leap into a bottomless abyss, a laceration, a shout, a falling without knowing how or where one falls, the tragic epilog of a sterile life, and a life without a reason. Even if these men adhered tepidly, superfluously to a Religion in which they did not truly believe, who accepted it as a norm transmitted secularly, as an inert formula, a dead weight, a useless heredity, and difficult to access.

To a life not sanctified by prayer, by thought of God, by the gaze of the heart gathered in Him who alone is true, to a human, only human, life, there follows a poor death, the death of those taken by the throat by the cruel bite of necessity. They have no excuse: on the one hand human reason alone is sufficient to make them glimpse the necessity of a higher, divine Order that justifies the cruelty, the insanity, the enormity of our earthly existence, always hoping but never reaching, a rejoicing, a thinking about the *void*, a construction that is abandoned forever, a love to be what we will never again see, a hooking on walls that fall on us with us but beyond common reason, they have the Religion that extends a hand, supports, explains the precariousness of this world in view of *another* which invites us with songs of hope, expectation, joy.

Religion aims at *everyone*, it has hope wisdom, strength for everyone, it has its rites, its prayers, it extends a very valid hand to all, from birth to death, it has an exercise of ministry that dispense the word of God in order to understand what does not need instruction, study, quality of criticism, only the will to participate, the will to believe, the will to

hear, the will to recognize, suffice. To understand does not count, is not important, is not worthwhile: it is enough to *feel*, to love, to give oneself: in the night darker than ignorance, the most alive stars shine, the holiest wisdom is offered, the most resolute certainty, because the things of God are so different from the human, just as sacred wisdom is different from the profane. For the things of God only love, only faith, only the gift of oneself to the Truth is demanded, the Good, Love that everyone believes, that everybody supports, that is lowered to everybody, who gives himself to all, who runs, gallops, flies, rises up, gives himself in.

To refuse the help of Religion means to blaspheme against intelligence, reason, light, it means to dehumanize, to descend to the level of the brute, the filthy beast, the stone, to have a heart of stone, *cor lapideum*, insensible both to what is in life and to what is beyond life. They are the men who don't even know they are men, who believe, by rejecting and disdaining Religion, they are elevating themselves to a rigorously higher vision of life, they who collect only the more infantile detritus, refuse, and illusion, admitting the real existence of matter which is less real, denying being to spirit which is more real, without which there is nothing that is.

The illusory materiality of matter is sufficiently proved by the miracle that breaks its laws, that is a fracture, a suspension in the realm of necessity that it annuls the most rigorous laws temporarily and subverts any certainty of causal link, definition, norm. This and nothing else is the reason for the miracle, to show men like lightening, through twinklings, that matter is an illusions if its laws can be violated, even if only for a few instants. They are warnings, rebukes, that the Lord throws to men of good will because they see, they understand, they put judgment, they become aware that outside appearances there is a reality that they don't know, but it is not to be denied outside of their ignorance, if the best men, those equipped with sacred science, affirm its existence.

Miracles are for those who do not believe, do not see, do not want to hear the word of the wisdom of God. The miracle in an instant beats

down the illusory structure, falls through material matrix, makes redeeming action pass through it that it gives back to God what is of God, showing that from God who is Spirit, nothing can come that is not spirit and that materiality is not other than the illusory condensation of spirit that is denied and is hidden because the world is the mask of God and it is opposite to Him just as, in some way, the mirror is opposite to the image because it is reflected in it. If matter truly exists, the miracle would not be possible, but especially the liberation of the material yoke of those men would not be possible, who not only deny, but actively supplant the cohesive laws of terrestrial nature, living supernaturally in the same nature, penetrating the impenetrable, dissolving the ordinary, solidifying the subtle, crossing the uncrossable mountain, and annulling temporarily the iron web of necessity. Whoever does not want to be convinced of this remains in his error where Death, the tardy revealer, surprised him.

Death and Deliverance

This is second and concluding installment of the chapter “La Morte” from *Dio e il Poeta* by **Guido De Giorgio**. Here we see De Giorgio moving past salvation to liberation (or deliverance as Guenon translates it). Evola draws upon similar traditional teachings in his distinction between the path of the ancestors and the path of the gods. For liberation, even Heaven is a prison. De Giorgio is forced to use apophatic language¹⁰ to describe this process of deliverance. He leads us to the God beyond God, non-Being beyond Being, or in Vedantic terms, Brahman behind Ishwara.

Divine knowledge is like a voice that passes by and does not return: whoever does not subscribe to it in freedom, will have his own negation as fate, i.e., the darkness, the void, death. And we arrive in this way at the crucial point: what is Death? Is it truly a cessation *in toto*, an irremediable

¹⁰http://orthodoxwiki.org/Apophatic_theology

end, a no longer existing, or a simple, even if complex, break in the natural process of transformation? For common belief, it is the end, the stop, which follows what is not known nor does it want to be fixated on it, but that is, in sum, a not-life, a no longer being what one was. This opinion is common as much to the deniers of God as well as to the lukewarm adherents of Religion. But for Religion, instead, Death is only a crucial point from which another life begins, one more certain, more secure, and truer than that false life that is experienced in the world, the world being a bridge, a necessary passage that conditions the future destiny of man who, we affirm it, is its judge to the extent he *wants* to be it.

How, in fact, could there be light for the man who obstinately rejects the light and how would there be salvation for the man who is convinced that he must be saved from nothing and nobody has to be saved in the inexplicable drama of life? Certainly, when a man passes from the essence of God, from His being all that is, to men's *post mortem* destiny, to the diversity of that destiny and above all to the rather vast exclusion of most from the life in God, he is seized by doubts, he is chased by protests, he is here ontologically out of place, as in the face of the partial negation of a total Affirmation, to an exclusive part of the All, to a tragic void in an absolute fullness, to an inexplicable residue of the divine Universality, to a clashing collision, to a radical injustice. But that depends on the limitations of our vision that is only human, and therefore is in a certain sense *passionate*, and of our reason that is confined to fixed fields of logic.

One thinks only that God offers Himself to those who want Him and denies Himself to those who deny him and that, at least and only in this, that "reciprocity" is manifestly just, in asking and giving, as a man can claim nothing, if, when he returned home in the evening, he did not find what he didn't want to find, rejecting the unpopular guest to whom he always denied access to his own home, slamming the door in his face.

God cannot give himself to those who do not want Him, to insist with those who are deaf and blind. Religion requires men of good will

who adhere to and want to adhere to the Law of God. Whoever rejects it is judged by himself before being judged by God. This personal way of seeing things can be very useful only to those who adopt it, even if necessarily limited and partial. Because, examining the thing from a higher and truer point of view, the problem of his own salvation vanishes in the face of that more universal idea of *liberation* which is the dissolution *in toto* of the human-cosmic illusion in God. It corresponds to what St Paul says; when he speaks of the crucifixion of the world, he alludes precisely to the entire and universal process of liberation that is a definitive escape from every limitation, even the supernatural, for the realization of God in the negation of everything, even of Paradise.

But this integrating God in oneself and for oneself, this centering Him in His purest Essence, which is the exclusion of every perfection, for the perfection of all the perfections, this ontological rarefaction that is the negation of every affirmation, this surpassing of every praise, of every eulogy, of every superlative, is truly the intuition of the True God, of the Deity about Whom nothing can be said, not even that He is, if being is only being, and if beyond being, there is the unthinkable absolute, the unintelligible absolute, the absolute ineffability of the Ineffable. In this total super-eminence, God is more than God, since even God is surpassed in the vertiginous exclusion of every perfection. The realization of so much muchness that coincides with the mininumness of every minimum, it is the highest degree of divine realization and it is the silence of silence in silence: here God says of Himself: *Ego sum quod non est*, the neuter absorbing in his indeterminative infinity every personal veil, every aseity, every formulation is only tautological.

There is no more mirror—*Ego sum qui sum*—not even of God in God, not a name, not a voice, not a song: nothing. The Being that is, is the non-being that is. It suppresses the last, the universal determination, which is that of being, of aseity, nothing remains if not the Nothing, the non-Being, the Ineffable of the Ineffabile. This is liberation and those

who attain to it will find “that even Paradise is a prison” and that there is no longer anything to attain for those who ask for nothing because they can have nothing more. This is not an absurdity of words, but rather a radical absurdity, a divine absurdity that climbs over every limit, every peak, that fills up every chasm, that sinks in the intimate, hidden beauty of the Infinite. For so high a liberation, so total, Death is nothing, barely a transit, not even a passage, but the door through which the Wise, the Saint, abandons the cosmic prison, climbs through all the heavens, and penetrates into the ultimate, *Coelum Coeli*, where God is more than God, He is the infinite totality of negation. Here all the songs are silent and the Abyss alone is silent.

Death is a great master of wisdom and virtue if it is known like that, to what sublimities and what terrible ruins it leads, if one familiarizes oneself with its advent, if it is obtained from God who prepares us to receive it as the necessary means for the exodus from this “false world” and the access point to the highest degrees of Being, to the boundless possibilities of new worlds where the soul can sing its loftiest victories. God’s true wisdom prepares us to accommodate it as the liberation from the corporeal burden, as the abandonment of the cadaver that we drag on earth, since the life of the multitude, deprived of God’s light, is foolish, dull, a worthless necrobias, a dragging of artificial superstructures that hide vermin, the putrefaction of a dead man who dreams.

Dying before dying prepares us for death, feeling oneself a cadaver before becoming one, separating before detachment, sanctifying the corpse, purifying it, making it the marble temple of the Living God. The sanctification of the body is the sanctification of life and the sanctification of the soul that only the Holy calls Holy, i.e., God in us. The divine integration, the knowledge that God alone thinks, feels, and works in us, is the most certain means to attain freedom and serenity at the transition.

Whatever pain, whatever sacrifice, St Paul says, is nothing in the face of the infinite richness of the prize that is now pure of God in comparison

to the meager and false earthly riches. Freeing oneself from the tyranny of the I, one can gradually and laboriously attain to peace, to the triumph of the eternal in us, when all the interior springs flow with fresh water. It is a type of progressive denudation, of spiritual desquamation, of the gradual frustration of transience, of no longer feeling the demon that roars in us, the tormenting hammering of the I that arrogantly grabs the openings of the soul and twists them to pain, to crash, to laugh, to tears. To empty life of every content, to give it back to God, through contemplation, prayer, invocation, pneumatic elevation, radiant of Love, the inward conversation with Saints and Masters who become our Guides, our helpers, our mirrors of virtue. This reducing oneself, this abolishing the inner thunder, this listening to the perennial sources of peace flowing, this flowing of silence, this caressing the void in its fullness, this perceiving the darkness of oneself until the Light bubbles, this darkening, this crumbling and incorporeal re-emerging, this confident abandonment in God, this acceptance of all only for the love of the Lord, this No to the world and this Yes to God, this reflecting oneself in other-than-onese, no longer recognizing one's own face, and ignoring everything except for Him, here is how rebirth is realized after the end, when Death, death killed, is the triumphal song of the soul that rests in God.

Posted on 2013-02-26 by Aeneas

* * *

Izak on 2013-02-27 at 16:21 said:

This really is very beautiful. I realize that your 'musings' posts get more comments, but I think the reason is because these translations are harder to digest and demand a higher degree of contemplation, so everyone risks looking like a fool so much more before saying anything.

But I think everyone appreciates these very invaluable translations, perhaps more than anything else on the site. The fifth paragraph is especially nice. I'm assuming that its poetry is even more strong in the original Italian than it is here.

Cologero on 2013-02-27 at 22:12 said:

I appreciate your interest, Izak. As you may imagine, it is not necessarily easy to translate, to find the right word, to be sure that the meaning is correct. It is actually a transformative process to do so, and I hope the readers of the translation will experience the same process. It is important to avoid being presumptuous, i.e., by assuming the meaning is obvious and clear cut. Some facebook comments claim the text is “life denying”; if so, their lives must be quite spectacular.

george on 2013-02-28 at 00:22 said:

The perspective is so thoroughly antimodern that it is hard to contemplate without letting go of modern perspectives.

Izak on 2013-02-28 at 14:49 said:

Yeah, I'd say you did about the best translation that the English language can permit, at least for that paragraph. I can get a sense of what Guido was doing with language.

It's really nice to see Guido de Giorgio in English either way. I can see why people would call this passage “life denying,” but real metaphysics always kind of does walk the tightrope, doesn't it! It's very hard to say the truth without appearing Manichaeian or pessimistic or whatever. Not to totally switch topics, but I always did appreciate when John Woodroffe took pains to explain that “maya” does not mean “illusion” in the way Westerners think about it, with negative or moralistic connotations. If only more people could be alleviate of such confusions!

Cologero on 2013-03-03 at 08:00 said:

Someone called me last week and in the course of the conversation, he claimed that “God would not send him to hell.” At the time, I thought it was an odd comment from someone who frequents Gornahoor, not least of all because of the rather blasphemous view of God as some sort of remote “sky god”, occasionally poking around in the world rather arbitrarily and even unjustly.

Coincidentally, since this particular post was scheduled, rather than attempt to answer him directly, I asked him to read this post when it appeared to see if it addressed his particular concern. I assume it has or else he lost interest. De Giorgio claims that in the post mortem state, the soul will itself seek its own level based on how much “light” it can bear. He claims to be repeating traditional teachings.

It is true that Plotinus said that different souls would exist on different levels, reflecting their large diversity, Dante mapped out these levels in the Divine Comedy. It seems obvious that a soul attached to a certain vice will have an affinity to a certain level of hell. It is pointless to put him on a higher level since he will just fall back to his own lever; there is no need to “send”

him there as though it were against his own will. This is not a theory, it can be verified in your own consciousness, at least for those who have achieved the proper level of self-awareness.

To avoid such a fate, the important issue is to understand the “light”. It is well worth the effort. According to traditional teachings, the Self is self-effulgent.

Michael on 2020-03-24 at 10:14 said:

Just the way GdG forms this writing is amazing, even more so is his light which the writing attempts to convey.

And yet he gives us the parts of a process, specifically the last two paragraphs. All of the statements made there convey exercises to be done by us the reader. Perhaps more can be elaborated on them, will sit with them to digest.

13.5 Ascesis and Anti-Europe

This is authored by **Havismat (Guido De Giorgio)**, from Volume 2 of *Introduction to Magic*. We see more of the paradoxical style of his writing. He reveals some personal details about his time in Tunisia and his experience with Sufis. See *Short Note on Woman in East and West*¹¹ for an interesting note that was in the early editions, but not the final edition of *Introduction to Magic*.

Regarding expression. There is the traditional one, the doctrinal one, the personal one. The first is integral, complete because of a pure intuitive order (Upanishad): the second is rigorous and complete, but presupposes the first: the third is poetic, strong, *poignant* — in the Sufi, for example — these three forms are totally complete and definitive in spite of the enormous differences: in one word, orthodox, in the etymologically rigorous and therefore true meaning of the term. These three forms of expression are superior in adhering to the inexpressible, eliminating everything that, as individual, alters and makes this same adherence opaque. These

¹¹<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6420>

three forms of expression are absolutely innocuous: for those who neither know nor intuit, they are like water between the fingers; for those who intuit, they are cast, fleeting and revealing; for those who know, they are bends of teaching, they are support, discoveries and, in ascesis, stellar vertices.

Beyond all the hesitations, efforts, breakthroughs, perpendicular invasions, or serpentine vortices of personal labors of resolution and culmination, the metaphysical domain of the great Tradition shows an absolute, very clear transparency. In everything, one can deceive and be deceived—and the more one knows, the more one realizes that — except on that level that can be intuited, through convergences, or “integrated”, but does not cease being what it is: a point, a knot of points of continuous connection that remains an unfathomable and intangible heaven, but only heaven, for those who intuit, that-cannot-be-said for those who know.

If poetry is the marginal game that opens the cracks of the Illusion, so the Poet, who opens and closes his eyes, is to be preferred to a minor expert and to a false mage; he is true — flashing, cultured, and lost depths — but always on the true axis, on the axis of the truth. This is why a tradition (in the integral sense) admits and justifies, without disdain, the one who knows and who does not know as long as the *axis is unique*, as long as there is no prevarication, as long as the one who does not know or who only intuit says: “It is here, it is absolutely here, also and *especially* (and this is the enormity of the Orient) if I will not have it and blessed are those that have it and who proceed.”

India has achieved that integrally, extraordinarily: I refer in a special way to the Dharmanga and Acrama, that is, to the integral tradition in the totality of its accomplishments and the resolution of the accomplishments. The West does not know that: there can be no true resolution, “asceticism”, accomplishment, if Illusion is not placed in its own domain, i.e., if its members are not recomposed in a way that everything converges in that which is the Root of Illusion.

Elite, that is good: they are provisional means. The martyrs of the West have not moved the overturning of the West by a millimeter: the tradition, through a thin thread, of the West, has not subverted this cadaver that plays at resurrection. An elite is not the tradition: an elite is a vein, a precious vein, but a vein: it wants the boulder, they want other veins, and it is necessary that all the veins converge, although the central one alone, the most hidden, it goes regally and, hiding itself, submerging itself, dominates.

If there is no space, there is no echo, if there is no silence, there is no Voice, if there is no unanimity, there is no song. To create adaptations, and what is begin done in the West if not this, and for centuries? It is necessary that things sing, the boulders, the metals, the woods, the thoughts, the stars. Everything must sing, from the blade of grass to Brahman.

But in the West one plays masquerades: a mask appears and disappears: a thrill of passion — “he is a genie” — seen, known, buried: and he draws away: and by degrees the West submerges itself. Do you think of the price of the thing, of the object: what is one thing worth now? Nothing. A bucket, a book, a statue, a house, a city, the world: what is it worth? Nothing. What is it to give birth? Nothing. What is it to die? Nothing. What is it to think? Nothing.

Man now steals life: if the hunt is in his pocket, he touches it fearfully: he escapes from it. Here you are. He lives for nothing, dies for nothing. There is no sense. He plays with ghosts: the Lemurian age: individual, humanity, society, family, science. Those do not exist. That is outside Tradition: Tradition does not know ghosts: that is why it is not only about showing and suggesting a unique higher type, but of establishing the conditions for which a tradition, which includes all the variously ordered activities but along a single axis, can exist. To hurl thrills of absolute liberation to men who do not even know how basic human existence should be established in the field of action, but always related to a center that is not its essence, is dangerous and absurd. *Either life is a rite* or it

is nothing: either everything reacquires a symbolic character, under the general type of the offering, or else nothing remains.

The *tragic sense of life*, for which modern men have so much sympathy, is also the element of dissolution and above all irresolution. Life is not tragic: tragedy has created the desperate man. Life is that which is and is that which must be. Pessimism harms more than optimism. The modern idea of “value” is already a construction like that of *will* and *power* in another field. Neither optimism nor pessimism, but *to give meaning to action*, to direct it on the basis of a boundary of resolution, to bend it to give everything down to the foundation; in everyone, not in the few. The few will be here: but there will always be those-who-go, not the grim despisers, but those who watch very calmly the turmoil of the waters from above.

Today one “builds” on the whole line: such tragic sense sweeps things away, it is the Rembrandtian sense of the shadow that sweeps away the truth: the white, the neutral, it is a key, the psychological key that slaughters the very placid grass of the meadow.

Ascesis is not asceticism. Asceticism is a deviation of ascesis. To transcend means to surpass that which is called reality and to see this reality under a different aspect: one cannot achieve the one without automatically getting the other. Therefore, whoever transcends, changes his eyes and by changing his eyes, everything is changed. The relationship Ascesis-Reality is the true one: supposing that one realizes Fulfillment, i.e., that individuality is re-solved, reality is play, i.e., tentacles that now open up, now disappear according to whether the eye opens or closes. The concept of Ascesis is precisely this: the elimination of everything that makes of the I that which it is: one denies, one burns, one dissolves up to that, at the boundary of the end, the resolution is completed. Then this is absolutely exact: “*Quicumque Deum intelligit Deus fit*” “whoever knows God becomes God”, from the *Mundaka Upanishad*, but that *quicumque* is no longer *quicumque* when the transition from *intelligere* to *fieri* is com-

plete. but that “who” is no longer the same “who” when the transition from “knowing” to “becoming” is complete. And I would like to say: *Secretum tegendum, secretum tegendum* literally “secret to be kept”, the Latin translation of *Upanishad*, now more than ever. I know of someone who went to a Sufi and demanded from him like a European: in French, in the original “Initiate me into Sufism.” The Sufi looked at me, I smiled, and he responded: “But my dear sir, if you are not yourself a Sufi, how do you count on becoming one?” The European said: “But, in the end, through initiation?” “Initiation!” said the Sufi watching the sea with eyes grinning. And I answered for him roughly: “There is no initiation: either beyond you, or nothing.”

This man, who is still looking, never finds, in spite of the lyricism of his conversation. And, curiously, having found himself with a Master, he did not believe he had to do what, with that method, is imposed on those initiated: to close his eyes and let them fall. Do you know the game of the cadaver? But they want closed hands and a rigid body: and then, perhaps, *it is foolishness*. “Parietes non faciunt Christianum” walls do not make a Christian said Victorinus as a pagan. Then he realized his error and became a Christian.

Another point: I don’t like the term “will”. If by “will” one means that which it is meant in the West, let us no longer speak of it: the Orientals do not know it. Will is for Westerners a hard weapon, a stumbling block, a “construction”: and if one does not mean that, then it is useless to call it “will”: useless and dangerous, because who wills, in reality, does not will anything: willing is a establishing ties (an example close at hand is in the races of the North of today: the will-obsessed). As to the will-consciousness, it is no longer “will”.

“Resolution” is the true term that expresses the super-rational and ascetic reality.

Years ago, down in Africa on an unbearable, infernal, hot, afternoon. I had fallen, naked and immobile, onto the bed. All of a sudden, in the

hurricane blast of the sirocco, I felt a dull dark visceral rhythm in the sun. I jumped up from the bed, put on some clothes, and was on the terrace: dazzling sun, sea, clouds of sand, the wind burned the eyes; three black men in front of me, their eyes rolling, the slow powerful rhythm, the bowels twisted inside out, the evasion of the base and the sea, oh! The dark gloomy disheveled sea.

Again, one evening. Jasmine. An Arab courtyard, Arabs lying down, reptilian eyes and a dancing girl, a belly dance and a dance song. The rhythm dug the abyss and the voice filled it up; the rhythm cut through the darkness and the voice called the abyss. And the eyes, oh! The eyes of that woman, the smile of the Virgin, the cosmic dance, the creation-game, the game-rhythm, salient in the voice, the voice bending itself on the rhythm like an abyss on fire.

It is dangerous to approach the **true** Sufis, those, empty or full, *who have a hidden origin*. The activity will come, if something can still be saved, simply, like passing the self-resolution of chaos in a very clear sky. Like resolving the ties of the seasons. But that will entail anything but certain unclean pseudo-actions of “willing”, with poor human and also “super-human” finalism. The structure asks for, requires absolute disinterest, *the absence of that which makes that which changes, change*.

Atheism consists in *not having a human god* who is concerned with the colds and ailments, a pharmacist god.

To surpass (there are the Chinese), not to bring closer: to act such that heaven overlooks the solid speck: high, very high. Alone then one will see what true immensity is. With the little god close at hand, i.e., close to the soul, because the soul no longer goes far from the hand. Not to open oneself to everyone and so to give a single thing to everyone, but to put oneself very high, in the absolute place, on the lines of a peak like those secure panoramic seats where one glimpses the end of the world, that stays in order to come, of this world and of the other.

Otherwise, let it be said *to men*: “It is necessary to adore God face

down on the ground.”

Posted on 2013-05-12 by Cologero

* * *

Logres on 2013-05-13 at 09:59 said:

“He plays with ghosts: the Lemurian age: individual, humanity, society, family, science. That does not exist. That is outside Tradition: Tradition does not know ghosts: that is why it is not only about showing and suggesting a unique higher type, but of establishing the conditions for which a tradition, which includes all the variously ordered activities but along a single axis, can exist. To hurl thrills of absolute liberation to men who do not even know how basic human existence should be established in the field of action, but always related to a center that is not its essence, is dangerous and absurd. Either life is a rite or it is nothing: either everything reacquires a symbolic character, under the general type of the offering, or else nothing remains.”

He sees straight through “life” today. Was it on this site, or somewhere else, that I read that modern individualism will one day be regarded as a species of black magic? Also useful, the endorsement of a species of “atheism” & the definition of “will” as resolution. Is it fair to say that the line between Tradition and anti-Tradition is the line between Being and Non-Being? He seems to be saying that taking “Illusion” (which I have until understood as “non-being”) in a certain way can be done along an axis of Being as “intimation”. On a mere common-sense or basic and vulgar level, could one rephrase this by saying that one’s direction is more important than one’s current state, unless one is “awake”?

Saydan_Shah on 2015-12-07 at 15:23 said:

Introduction to Magic

This is the book authored/edited by Evola? And any idea of where I can get more of Guido de Giorgio?

13.6 The Second Precept of Love

This passage is taken from *Dio e il Poeta* by **Guido de Giorgio**. **Julius Evola** asserted that De Giorgio followed a Vedantized Christianity; this is immediately apparent in his description of the world as the “play of God”, which has its exact analogue in

the idea of *lila*¹² in *Hinduism*. Readers will also recognize the influence of **Rene Guenon**'s *Multiple States of Being*, as shown in the topics of the Infinite, Possibility, or multiple worlds. Then again, Guenon claimed only to be explicating the metaphysics of the **Vedanta**. Yet, De Giorgio does not approach that text as a logical exercise, but rather as "one who knows".

Finally, there is the profound influence of **Saint Thomas Aquinas** and, of course, **Dante**. Much of the vocabulary, which cannot come across in a translation, is archaic, originating from Dante's time. There are several references to *The Divine Comedy*, which I have provided whenever I could recognize them. The Comedy is more than a poem, it is a detailed text for initiates. It seems to us that De Giorgio followed the path outlined, climbing the seven story mountain of Purgatory, and saw the world from that height.

It is tied to the first, and subordinated to the first, *ancillarily*, but in the purely religious meaning in which this term must be used, as profound comprehension of the divine drama, of creation, that, divine and nonhuman, refers to that which, coming from God, returns to God, as a "restitution" which becomes a "gift", a gift of love. The world is the fruit and the work of divine love which multiplies itself, remaining one, gives itself because given to Him, offers itself because offered to Him, breaks itself, shatters itself, apparently because every part, every fraction, purely apparent, comes back in the All, from which it separated itself as pure "play". The world is God's "play", removing from this word any frivolous, human limitation whatsoever, in the special, precise sense that, e.g., Saint Thomas gives it, when he speaks of contemplation, in the Latin word "ludus". The world is the "mirror" of God, the crystal in which the Unity contemplates Himself and, contemplating Himself, pluralizes Himself, multiplies Himself, still remaining One, because He cannot not be One

¹²[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lila_\(Hinduism\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lila_(Hinduism))

while being One, like a fire of a thousand sparks each one of which is fire but not *the fire*, since every relation with God is *unilateral*, not double, not reciprocal, God alone being God and what has life from God, has being, not being able to be God, if God is God, “for the contradiction does not allow it”¹³. The world is “imprinted” by God in the sense that God, while passing, creates, and the created reflects Him, it is His footprint, nor can it be considered otherwise than in relation to Him, without which nothing would be, it is obvious, because the trace is a sign, a sign that indicates the Giver, the Donor, the One who imprinted it, stamped it, engraved it. One could not speak of God without the world, although God is without the world, beyond all possible worlds, for the simple reason that He cannot exhaust Himself in creation which is His work, nor limit Himself to it, why His power is always “in infinite excess”¹⁴ in the ambit of created things and since this “excess” is infinite, it is understood without difficulty, that which we call “everything” created, is, ontologically, nothing in the face of He who created it.

If we call the “world” the visible, it is clear that it cannot reflect God who, by definition, by necessity, by absoluteness, is invisible, that not removing, however, what is visible, insofar as it is visible, it is also the sign, imprint, mirror, reflection of the invisible, and that the visible breaks itself, shatters itself indefinitely (a multitude of beings) *because it cannot contain the invisible*. The creaturely multiplicity is the indication of this impotency, as numerical indefiniteness is the indication of the infinity of unity, without which it could not offer itself, although no number of the series entirely reflects the unity that is in everything and in none of them.

God as God must create the world, without which He would not be God, or, at least, He would not be known and therefore loved as God, but if God is the Invisible, it is also necessary that he is God outside and

¹³*Inferno*, XXVII

¹⁴*Paradise*, XIX

beyond the world, outside and beyond creation, which is one of his possibilities but not all of his Possibility that must be infinite as He himself is infinite. His “infinite excess” ... Manifestly, therefore, everything originating from Him, each thing should return to Him, and in fact, does return to him, must return to Him, but each thing, as every creature, through its way and manner, or *diversimode* diverse modes, Latin as Saint Thomas would say, by levels of integration. Among all creatures, there is man, who has his mystery which corresponds to the Mystery of the Incarnation, the descent for the ascent, and this mystery can be determined in a certain manner saying that man can “take up again” all the work of God, in a *syn-thesis*, i.e., in a *com-position*, in the universality of understanding, of prehension as the eye which embraces an entire horizon in a unitary vision, uniting the multiplicity, joining the separated, but it is necessary, however, that he has a *third eye* in the middle of the forehead in which the two eyes are “centered”, to resolve the duality in unity, since the two is limitation, it is a throwback, and must result in the three.

The privilege of man, therefore, is this, to be able to return to God, *freely and totally* because he alone, among all creatures, has the option, the choice, to remain in creation, or return to the Creator, taking up all creation, *capitulatim* summarily, Latin in the unity. This is the true, the great dignity of man that he owes to the faculty that, only in him, embraces not only what appears (the visible, the world), but that which is, God. This faculty is the intellect, not reason which, visibly, cannot pass beyond the visible domain of quantity, the world, creation.

Posted on 2023-03-21 by Cologero

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William Zeitler on 2023-03-22 at 09:32 said:

What's the first precept of love? I haven't been able to find a blog by that title or a link thereto. Thanks!

13.7 German Influence on Indology

This is the final chapter of **Rene Guenon**'s *Introduction to the Study of Hindu Doctrines*, which was first published in 1921, right after the end of World War I. It was removed, at the author's request, from subsequent editions, including the version translated into English. It is quite harsh on German scholarship and even on Germans themselves. Moreover, his criticism extends to Europeans in general whose "imagined superiority leads to misbehavior in the world."

I don't believe this chapter is available in English. Even if it is, it is worth repeating.

German Influence It is rather curious to notice that the first Indologists, who were mostly English, without showing any very deep understanding, often said more correct things than those who came after them; no doubt they made many mistakes as well, but which at least were not of a systematic character, and which did not result from a bias, not even unconscious. The English mentality, of course, has no aptitude for metaphysical conceptions, but it does not make any pretension in this respect either, while the German mentality, which is not really better endowed, has the greatest illusions. To realize this, we need only compare what the two peoples have produced in terms of philosophy.

The English mind hardly left the practical order, represented by morality, sociology, and experimental science, represented by the science of psychology which it invented. When the English mind is concerned with logic, it is above all induction that he has in view and to which he gives preponderance over deduction. On the other hand, if we consider German philosophy, we only find in it hypotheses and systems with metaphysical pretensions, deductions from a fanciful starting point, ideas which might seem to be profound when they are simply nebulous; and this pseudo-metaphysics, which is everything that is farthest from true meta-

physics, the Germans claim to find in others, whose conceptions they always interpret according to their own.

Nowhere is this latter fault more invincible than with them, because no other people has such a narrowly systematic mindset. Moreover, the Germans, in this regard, just push defects which are common to the whole European race to the extreme. Their national pride leads them to behave in Europe as Europeans in general, infatuated with their imaginary superiority, behave throughout the world. The extravagance is the same in both cases, with a simple difference in degree. It is therefore natural that the Germans imagine that their philosophers have thought all that it is possible for men to conceive, and no doubt they believe they are doing a great honor to other peoples by assimilating the conceptions of these to this philosophy of which they are so proud.

This does not prevent Schopenhauer from making a ridiculous disguise of Buddhism by making it a kind of "pessimistic" moralism, and from giving the precise measure of his intellectual level by seeking "consolations" in the "Vedanta"; and we see, on the other hand, contemporary orientalists like Deussen claiming to teach the Hindus the true doctrine of Shankaracharya, to whom they quite simply lend the ideas of Schopenhauer! It is because the German mentality, by the very fact that it is an excessive form of the Western mentality, is the opposite of the East and cannot understand anything about it. As it nevertheless claims to understand, it necessarily distorts it. Hence these false assimilations against which we protest on all occasions, and in particular this application of the labels of modern Western philosophy to Eastern doctrines.

When one is incapable of doing metaphysics, it is certainly better not to be concerned with it, and positivism, in spite of its narrowness and incompleteness, seems to us still much preferable to the rantings of pseudo-metaphysics. The greatest mistake of the German orientalists is therefore to be unaware of their incomprehension, and to carry out works of interpretation which have no value, but which are imposed on all of

Europe and very easily succeed in doing making themselves authoritative, because other peoples have nothing to oppose or to compare to it, and also because these works surround themselves with an apparatus of erudition which strongly impresses people who have a strong superstitious respect to for certain methods.

These methods, moreover, are also of Germanic origin, and it would be quite unfair not to recognize in the Germans the very real qualities which they possess in the matter of erudition: the truth is that they excel in the composition of dictionaries, grammars, and those voluminous works of compilation and bibliography which require nothing more than memory and patience. It is extremely unfortunate that they did not fully specialize in this kind of work which is very useful to consult on occasion, and which, appreciably, saves time for those who are capable of doing other things. What is hardly less regrettable is that these same methods, instead of remaining the prerogative of the Germans, to whose temperament they were particularly suited, have spread to all European universities, and especially in France, where they are considered to be only "scientific", as if science and erudition were one and the same thing. In fact, as a consequence of this deplorable state of mind, scholarship comes to usurp the place of true science.

The abuse of cultivated scholarship for itself, the false belief that it can suffice to impart understanding of ideas, all of this, among Germans, can still be understood and excused to some extent; but, among peoples who do not have the same special aptitudes, we can only see in them the effect of a servile tendency to imitation, a sign of an intellectual decadence which it is high time to remedy, if we do not want to let it turn into a definitive decline.

The Germans very skillfully prepared the intellectual supremacy they dreamed of, by imposing both their philosophy and their methods of scholarship. Their Orientalism is, as we have just said, a product of the combination of these two elements. What is remarkable is how these

things have become instruments in the service of national ambition; it would be quite instructive, in this regard, to study how the Germans were able to take advantage of the fanciful hypothesis of "Aryanism", which they had moreover not even invented.

We do not believe, for our part, in the existence of an "Indo-European" race, even if we do not wish to persist in calling it "Aryan", which makes no sense. But what is significant is that German scholars have given this supposed race the denomination of "Indo-Germanic", and that they have taken all their care to make this hypothesis plausible by supporting it with multiple ethnological and above all philological arguments. We do not wish to enter into this discussion at this point. We will only point out that the real resemblance which exists between the languages of India and Persia and those of Europe is by no means the proof of a community of race.

To explain it, it suffices that the ancient civilizations that we know of were originally brought to Europe by some elements relating to the source from which the Hindu and Persian civilizations directly proceeded. We know, in fact, how easy it is for a tiny minority, under certain conditions, to impose its language, with its institutions, on the mass of a foreign people, even though it is ethnically absorbed in it in a short time. A striking example is that of the establishment of the Latin language in Gaul, where the Roman presence, except in a few southern regions, was never more than negligible. The French language is undoubtedly of more or less pure Latin origin, and yet the Latin elements entered only a very small part in the ethnic formation of the French nation; the same is also true for Spain. On the other hand, the "Indo-Germanic" hypothesis is all the less valid since the Germanic languages have no more affinity with Sanskrit than other European languages. It can only serve to justify the assimilation of Hindu doctrines to German philosophy; but, unfortunately, this supposition of an imaginary kinship does not stand the test of the facts, and nothing is in reality more dissimilar than a German and

a Hindu, intellectually as well as physically, if not even in more ways.

The conclusion that emerges from all of this is that, in order to obtain interesting results, it is necessary to first get rid of this influence which for too long has weighed so heavily on Orientalism; and, although it is hardly possible for some individuals to break free from methods which constitute for them inveterate mental habits, we hope that, in general, recent events will be a favorable occasion for this liberation. However, let us understand our thought: if we want the disappearance of German influence in the intellectual field, it is because we consider it harmful in itself, and independent of certain historical contingencies which do not exist and change nothing. So it is not these contingencies that make us wish that the influence in question disappear, but we must take advantage of the state of mind that they have determined.

In the intellectual order, the only one we are dealing with here, sentimental concerns do not have to be taken into consideration. German conceptions today are worth exactly what they were worth a few years ago, and it is ridiculous to see men who had always professed a boundless admiration for German philosophy to suddenly start to denigrate it under the pretext of a patriotism which has nothing to do with these things. Fundamentally, this is little better than more or less consciously altering scientific or historical truth for reasons of national interest, precisely as the Germans are accused of doing.

For us, who owe nothing to Germanic intellectuality, who have never had the slightest esteem for pseudo-metaphysics in which it delights, and who have never accorded to erudition and its special procedures more than the most relative value and importance, we are very much at our ease to say what we think about it. And we would have said absolutely the same thing even if the circumstances had been quite different, but perhaps with less chance of agreeing in this with a generally prevalent trend. We will only add that, especially as regards France, what is at present most to be feared is that one escapes German influence only to fall under other

influences which would be hardly less fatal. Reacting against the spirit of imitation therefore appears to us to be one of the first conditions for a true intellectual recovery: it is not a sufficient condition, no doubt, but it is at least a necessary, and even indispensable, condition.

Posted on 2021-07-04 by Cologero

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Arthur Konrad on 2021-07-05 at 05:44 said:

First things first:

Whosoever aspires to be dabbling in the black arts must at the very least be able to read a language in which it is possible to communicate the music of things. Which is to say, Germans, as well as the Slavic peoples (with whom they share many mental attributes) are at a disadvantage from the onset. Among the latter, only the Russian language is an exception, and how perceptive of otherworldly things have the Russians always been! The rest of them have been derived from the speech of the folk, apparently, to satisfy the needs of both practicality and national-romantic fervour.

But alas, the 'language of the people' is for issuing curt agricultural commands and managing domestic affairs, not for communicating the highest mystical teaching. That is why among the Eastern Slavs, the clergy thought it prudent to preserve the Church Slavonic, a true liturgical language. People like to say 'Oh, but the German poetry!'. But German poetry is valued for its intellectual content, which is only one part of poetry. That being said, German is the most bastardized of all Germanic tongues, which really goes against all common wisdom, and conversely, the Russian is the most pristine of the Slavic ones.

As for me, if I haven't learned English my mental development would have been altogether stunted, what with my ears condemned to hearing only that which can be communicated in this clumsy, unwieldy linguistic apparatus which is called my mother tongue. For that I can thank globalism and capitalism.

Max on 2021-07-05 at 18:05 said:

Perhaps it could be profitable to narrowly systematize Guénon's pure Latin thoughts, if not even fitting them into some form of compilation. Takeaways:

The German mentality has the greatest illusions.

The Germans always interpret other's conceptions according to their own.

No other people has such a narrowly systematic mindset.

The Germans imagine that they have thought everything that it is possible for men to conceive.

The Germans believe that they are doing a great honour by assimilating other people's conceptions.

The other more superstitious peoples of Europe are easily fooled by German methods of erudition.

It is unfortunate that the Germans did not specialize in being Guénon's personal secretary – they could have been useful on occasion.

Germans excel in things that require nothing more than memory and patience.

Scholarship has come to usurp true science.

The Germans very skillfully prepared the intellectual supremacy of their dreams.

Guénon knows how easy it is for a tiny minority to impose its language and institutions on a mass of a foreign people.

Germanic has no more affinity with Sanskrit than other European languages.

The kinship is an imaginary supposition anyway.

Intellectually, nothing is more dissimilar than a German and a Hindu.

Physically, nothing is more dissimilar than a German and a Hindu.

If not even in more ways, nothing is more dissimilar than a German and a Hindu.

It is hardly possible for some individuals to break free from Germanic methods, which for them constitute inveterate mental habits.

Guénon hopes that certain events will nevertheless present a favorable occasion for the liberation from the German mentality.

German influence is harmful independently of certain historical contingencies, which do not exist, and would change nothing even if they did.

Guénon owes nothing to Germanic intellectuality.

In the intellectual order, sentimental concerns do not have to be taken into consideration.

14.1 The Correspondence Project

Beginning tonight, on successive Mondays, we plan to make available selected correspondence between the various men of tradition. Our initial efforts will include letters from **Rene Guenon** to **Guido de Giorgio** (the letters in the opposite direction are missing) as well as the exchanges between **Mircea Eliade** and **Julius Evola**. We will learn, for example, that Guenon was in touch with the three advocates of Romanity, albeit with quite different approaches: De Giorgio, Evola, and Reghini. The letters to De Giorgio are instructive since they often offer critiques of the other two.

I know from the statistics that our texts by De Giorgio are among the least read. That is unfortunate for, as we shall see, Guenon, unlike the other two, treats him as an equal, a peer. Tradition is much more than discussing what some king may have said to a priest three millennia ago; it is nothing if it is not accompanied by a change of consciousness, the recovery and re-creation of Traditional modes of thinking and expe-

riencing the world in one's very being. De Giorgio accomplished that, he internalized Tradition. He did not always explicitly "spell it out", but it is obvious to the discerning reader. Besides absorbing the two Traditions of Rome, he brings in elements of the Vedanta and Sufism into his meditations.

The exchanges between Guenon and De Giorgio take place between 1925 and 1930, just prior to Guenon's relocation to Cairo, Egypt. We can therefore account for Guenon's whereabouts during this period. We will see his true opinion of Evola. We will learn of a Sufi center for initiation in Paris, but not in Rome. This should silence our critics who claim we just fabricate facts. Gornahoor is a center for cooperation, and those who only understand *strife* place themselves outside. They are simply fighting the wrong battle, but we pray they will eventually engage in the greater and lesser Holy Wars.

Posted on 2012-06-18 by Admin

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Justin on 2012-06-18 at 08:27 said:

A tantalising prospect!

golgonooza on 2012-06-18 at 12:29 said:

On the subject of things to read, and knowing that you intend this summer to read The Divine Comedy as an initiatic text – I was thinking of reading it (only in translation unfortunately) for the first time but wanted to be have some kind of esoteric guide (aside from Virgil!) – is there any commentary on it you recommend? (Sorry this is a bit off-topic)

Cologero on 2012-06-18 at 18:34 said:

The first goal is to understand the literal meaning of the text which is hardly possible today because of all the allusions to ancient mythology, poetry, and historical events. I use the Charles Singleton prose translation and commentary. The penguin translation by Musa also has excellent notes.

As for an "esoteric" guide, try Guenon's book on Dante. Dante starts by indicating he is taking the journey of "our" life, so he is inviting us to participate, not to be mere observers or

curiosity seekers. He makes the journey as a “living man”, so we shouldn’t read it as a “hell and brimstone” sermon about our future fate. Rather, we need to look at the spiritual tendencies he describes in our own consciousness. “Fear” holds us back, since we don’t want to face such things; after all, we tend to think more highly of ourselves than is warranted. Least of all, should we read it as a theological treatise, describing God’s justice, etc., as is commonly done. Nor is it a travelogue or a vision of the fate of specific persons, who really represent “types” or symbols, of certain states of consciousness.

It must also be read in the light of the goals of the “Fedeli d’Amore”, those men faithful to love (of which “sex magick” is a corruption). This tradition is mostly lost in the West, so some familiarity with the Sufi version (e.g., Rumi, Hafiz, Ibn Arabi) may be helpful.

14.2 From Guénon to Evola

14.2.1 First Letter

We have 11 letters from **Rene Guenon** to **Julius Evola** in the span from 1930 to 1951. In earlier letters to **Guido de Giorgio**, we saw Guenon’s frustration with some of Evola’s views. Here, Guenon confronts Evola directly, although more politely than in his letters to de Giorgio. Evola claims to have read all of Guenon’s books; nevertheless, it seems he either misunderstood or rejected some significant aspects of Guenon’s view. I believe there is some of both.

For example, Evola does not seem to understand Guenon’s notion of the Intellect and thus shows little interest in ideas like the Supreme Identity. On the other hand, Evola is committed to his own philosophical system which differs from Guenon’s metaphysical writings in important ways. In a letter to Mircea Elide, as we will soon see, Evola points out indeed that his doctrine is contained in his philosophy of the Absolute Individual.

The first of the letters follows:

24 August 1930

Cairo, Egypt

You must have thought that I would not respond to your letter, which reached me in Paris a little more than a year ago.

The truth is that at that time I was quite ill and, subsequently, different unforeseen difficulties and commitments of every type made me always delay every correspondence that was not absolutely urgent. Time flew by quickly and I never succeeded in doing everything I wanted to. I'm taking advantage of the fact that I am close to a little office in this residence to finally write you, asking you to excuse this excessive delay.

I have to tell you how little I was able to understand at all the interest that you showed in the reading of my books.

Obviously, the point of view you are assuming is quite distinctive and certainly cannot be mine, but I am pleased to see that that has not prevented you from getting rid of the anti-Oriental prejudice that, by your own admission, you used to hold. I wish that many others in the West would have the same attitude and come to understand the ancient doctrines of the Orient.

You ask me about [Jacques] Maritain; notwithstanding everything, I have always had friendly relations with him; as to ideas, we are in agreement especially on a negative point of view, that is, on "anti-modernity". Apart from that, even he, disgracefully, is full of prejudices against the Orient; at least he was, because it seems that those prejudices since a short time ago have been attenuated; but, something strange, it is fed by a type of fear in the face of what one does not know, and it is a disagreeable thing, because it prevents him from broadening his own point of view.

But permit me to point out to you, from the moment that you read all my books that, after *The Crisis of the Modern World*, there is another, *Spiritual Authority and Temporal Power*, what was published last year.

Currently, I am working on *The Symbolism of the Cross* that will definitely be published toward the end of this year.

Excuse the briefness of my letter; I would like to be able to more or

less get up to date with our correspondence.

Posted on 2012-07-16 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-07-17 at 00:38 said:

It is surprising that Evola would have once held a prejudice against the East, since his work ends up being much more relevant to East Asian traditions than Guenon's.

Cologero on 2012-07-17 at 07:12 said:

It's true that Evola adopted aspects of Tantrism, Buddhism, and Taoism into his own system but, unlike Guenon, Evola's integration of those Eastern doctrines was idiosyncratic. I suspect Guenon was referring to Evola's Euro-centrism and white supremacism; after all, Evola continued to support European colonialism.

Umisumi on 2015-12-20 at 09:47 said:

Good work of translation. May i ask you where you obtained these letters? Do you have copies or scans of the originals?

Cologero on 2015-12-20 at 10:09 said:

<http://www.libreriaeuropa.it/scheda.asp?id=5216&ricpag=1>

Evola saved all his correspondence, unlike Guenon, so we just have one half of the correspondence. That was the era before photocopy machines. The letters were handwritten, apparently, so Evola didn't keep carbon copies of his side (if anyone still remembers those). Evola wrote in Italian; Guenon responded in French.

An interesting point that people today tend to overlook is that even photos were had to come by. After years of correspondence and even Evola's translations of Guenon into Italian, Evola had no idea what Guenon looked like.

14.2.2 Second Letter

The Truth is too high to receive the least insult.

It is unfortunate that we don't have Evola's letter to Guenon, although we can surmise what it contained. We see in this dialog, that Guenon is always the master. We have to agree with

Guenon that Evola misunderstands certain principles that dis-color his work in unfortunate ways. As for the inability to clearly distinguish the esoteric, or metaphysical/initiatic aspects from the religious/exoteric, Evola has created confusion in those whose understanding of Tradition is limited to Evola. It is not a matter of choosing or preferring one exoteric form over another. Hence, there are the mindless debates of paganism vs Christianity that are pervasive in counter-Traditional circles; the very fact of debating is itself an indication of the counter-Tradition.

It also makes Evola's understanding of the Middle Ages quite confused, since he admires that period as Traditional, yet fails to adequately grasp its spiritual foundation. Yet Evola makes it very clear that what is required is an inner transformation, so this corrective would not radically alter his overall project.

Evola apparently wasn't clear about the distinction between mysticism and the ascetic or initiatic path, although he referred often to it. For Guenon, they belong to different spheres, so there is no point in criticizing mysticism, if that path is proper for a given person. This is also related to the distinction between salvation, which is meant for the many, and liberation which is restricted to the few. Again, there is no value in disputing this question.

In practice, Evola's choice seems to lead to a dead end, viz. to "ride the tiger". Yet that is not at all the goal of an ascetic, heroic, or initiatic path. Rather, it seems to me, a man should devote his efforts toward Liberation, the Supreme Identity, that is, an overcoming of the modern world, rather than an uneasy accommodation to it. The rest of the letter speaks for itself, although I do not know who "P. A." is.

Added 22 July MMXX

(1) Re Guenon's aphorism: in the *Act of Contrition*, the fear of hell or the desire for Heaven are considered imperfect motives. Make of that what you will.

(2) Re RTT: The comments were harsh on this point. The question is does it proceed beyond individual possibilities or not.

23 February 1934

Cairo, Egypt

Forgive me once again for being so late in responding to your letter that I received with pleasure after such a long silence. But I have suffered from an acute eyesight weakness, and your letter reached me exactly at the moment when I was able to read it only after a very long time. The quantity of things of every type that had accumulated while I found myself in that impossible situation of working is such that, ever since, I have not yet succeeded in freeing myself from it and to regain that lost time.

I thank you for all your appreciations in regard to my works; and I think that in effect we can find ourselves in agreement, at least, on what concerns the conditions of the current world and the necessity of a return to the tradition and spirituality, if indeed it is still possible for the West, at the point in which things have currently reached.

As far as living far from Europe, I cannot perhaps precisely take into account certain tendencies; I must confess that I do not excessively trust in a "renewal" that, as much as I know of it, remains up to this point very superficial and somewhat confused: above all, except for rare exceptions, it is about vague and poorly defined aspirations, and it is very difficult to say what will result from it. But what is certain, is that we notice in very general lines how the people are no longer so satisfied with their own modern "civilization", and that some begin to doubt the "progressive" pretense: as far as that goes, it is insufficient, nevertheless it is already at least something...

Regarding the problems brought up in your letter, permit me to tell you with great frankness that these difficulties appear to me especially to derive from the fact that you do not make a very clear distinction between the religious point of view of the one hand, and the metaphysical or initiatic, on the other. Whatever their relationships might be in certain

respects, it is never necessary to confuse or mix them, since they refer to totally different domains, and they cannot consequently interfere with each other. The domain that defines religious truth belongs to what Hindu doctrine calls “non-supreme” knowledge; it is sufficient to put everything in its place and in its order because there is no conflict possible. Above all, it is necessary not to forget that mysticism belongs totally to the religious ambit; any comparison is therefore not possible between mysticism and metaphysics.

The two ways, without considering the very relevant differences of their modalities, are not, in reality, absolutely marked out to reach the same goal; and the “mystical union” is not the *jivan mukta*, no more than “salvation” is “Liberation”.

Everything that is religious, including mysticism, concerns individual possibilities, in the indefinite extension of which they are susceptible and does not go beyond them; on the other hand that is its reason for being. On the contrary, the reason for metaphysical realization is to proceed beyond [individual possibilities]; and this is why the one can serve as the base of the other. Nor was it the case for Christian esoterism of the Middle Ages, as it was always for Islamic esoterism; and, in this regard, I cited this aphorism that seems to me to be perfectly adapted to the argument: “As long as a man desires Paradise or has fear of Hell, he will not be able to aspire to the least grade of initiation”.

I must moreover bring to your attention the fact that the religious point of view is necessarily tied to certain historical contingencies, while the metaphysical point of view refers exclusively to the order of principles. To speak of “multiple *avatars*”, is to stick to the domain of appearances; nevertheless, in absolute reality, they are “the same thing”; the Christ principle is not multiple, whatever it can be made of its terrestrial manifestations or other types. The “Mediator”, according to all traditions, is the “Universal Man”, which is also the Christ; whatever the name by which he is called changes nothing, and I do not see what difficulty there

can be in regard to this.

The “ascetic” way would be, in its type, more comparable to the initiatic way of what is not mysticism, if only in that it implies a method and a positive effort. Mysticism, for its part, is instead totally the opposite because of its passive character. The ascetic way can therefore be a preparation for a realization of another order, much more than the mystical way, which would even seem even incompatible with that goal.

But I do not think on the other hand that we can assert that some of what passes beyond elementary religion is open to all; asceticism belongs only to some, and mysticism to some other. As to what is beyond the religious domain, it is obvious that it concerns a much more restricted number of persons. Whoever finds his fulfillment at a certain level would make a very great error to try to pass beyond it. That concerns the question of a necessary hierarchy, against which all sophisms of democratic egalitarianism are impotent, though many of Catholics themselves today unfortunately are affected by it: and there are perhaps still a few of them who even suspect it.

In regard to your objection inherent to the domain of pure intellectuality, is it quite certain that it is even what it has as a goal? In that case it is still necessary to make an essential distinction: the texts that you cite are revolts against profane knowledge, not against sacred knowledge; and we absolutely do not confuse what is simply rational with what is purely intellectual. When I speak of profane knowledge, I understand by it, naturally, everything that is philosophy; the less the spirit is blocked from all those things, the better, certainly, and from the initiatic point of view even more than the religious. It would be necessary perhaps to include also a good part of theology, insofar as it contains many useless subtleties and is of a still quasi-philosophical nature. In any case, everything that is discussion and controversy is of a purely profane spirit. That said, it is necessary to add that pure intellectuality eludes on the other hand the religious domain; this is another thing and it stands to reason that sen-

timent and action have their part in it. Yet again, it is necessary to put all things in the place that belongs to them, without allowing them any influence over a domain that is not their own.

Finally, pure intellectuality is in the same way indifferent in regards both to pride and humility, two opposed notions that are of a sentimental order in the same manner; those who pretend the contrary show clearly in that case that they do not have the least idea of what is truly intellectuality.

I see that you consider as valuable the incomprehension of P. A.; it would be somewhat difficult to find a more limited spirit than his. Moreover, what a fine way of defending Christianity by continuing to deny that its doctrine reaffirms a higher meaning, instead of the nonsense of moral and social character that one admits to often see in it! I don't see in what a similar vulgarity would presuppose the intervention of a superhuman principle; fortunately, I have for my part a better idea of Christianity than his.

It is sad to see how persons of this type look to diminish all that is higher than them ... The Truth is too high to receive the least insult.

Posted on 2012-07-22 by Cologero

* * *

Aghorable on 2012-07-23 at 04:38 said:

"So long as a man desire Paradise or fear Hell, he cannot aspire to the least grade of initiation"

Cf. Evola's statement that the aspirant must be able to sustain "severe blows upon one's self, without being hurt thereby."

P.S. Thanks for the articles and translations.

Mihai on 2012-07-24 at 01:30 said:

"In practice, Evola's choice seems to lead to a dead end, viz. to "ride the tiger" "

To ride the tiger doesn't have to be an "uneasy accomodation to the modern world". It is a necessary step to take in the disordered, anti-spiritual world of today, for the person who cannot yet escape it, until the conditions for an effective initiation can be reached. There are not really

many options for the western man, so riding the tiger can also be seen as a challenge of worth, of patience, and of serious orientation.

Mihai on 2012-07-24 at 06:08 said:

PS: Who is the P.A. that Guenon refers to in the last part of the letter ?

Avery on 2012-07-24 at 07:52 said:

Cologero doesn't know. Obviously it would have had to have been someone in the circles of both Guenon and Evola in 1934.

Cologero on 2012-07-24 at 08:25 said:

That is the point, Mihai. If it is a necessary "step", what, then, is the next step after it?

It has been 50 years since "ride the tiger" was published, so it is time to move beyond. Certainly, there should be agreement by now about what is the opposite of the "disordered, anti-spiritual world", but, due to the great influence of pseudo-Traditionalists, that is not the case. Unfortunately, there is a rather vocal segment who know nothing of Tradition except what they find in Evola.

That is why this letter is important. It is the only time when Guenon provides a clear critique of what is lacking in Evola's perspective. And Guenon's points are necessary and fundamental. Properly understood, they make most of Evola's points stronger, not weaker.

The task now is no longer just to criticize the modern world, but rather to describe what comes next in terms of order and spirit.

Mihai on 2012-07-24 at 10:27 said:

"It has been 50 years since "ride the tiger" was published, so it is time to move beyond."

For us, who live in the modern world, Ride.. is an important principle to understand and apply. It is about living in the modern world, participating in some of its activities because of necessity without letting this brake your will and right orientation.

This is most important from the spiritual point of view. Nowadays, all that is left to western man is a formalized and bureaucratic Christinity, almost entirely devoid of its deeper, intellectual elements. It is not easy to find one's path under such conditions. So until the path reveals itself, one will have to keep one's cool amidst the chaos and survive it without despairing. This is why I consider this to be Evola's most important work.

Also, it is important to realize that Evola refined and deepened his views with the passage of time. However, he lacked a participation to a spiritual path, as far as I know he had no initiation, so it is obvious that he couldn't penetrate into the deepest meanings of symbolism and Tradition as Guenon did.

Cologero on 2012-07-24 at 12:44 said:

I have been revealing a path, Mihai. Do you think I do this for fun and profit?

Mihai on 2012-07-24 at 15:25 said:

I would never have thought of accusing you of anything like this, nor did I ever say anything that would hint such a thing, so I don't know why you made this assumption.

As for the path, I think it is necessary to clear up what I mean by this. I am referring to an active participation to a traditional spiritual path. This is a personal quest and the answer to it certainly cannot be found on the internet.

I think the website provides a starting point in seeking and an orientation.

Cologero on 2012-07-24 at 21:02 said:

Transcendence, by definition, means to be above the forces of the world, whether destructive or positive. If you cannot abandon the world, you lack power. If you do not wish to abandon the world, then you are still attached to it.

But as a preparatory stage, the neutralizing of negative forces, otherwise called drinking poison, handling snakes, or transmuting lead into gold, is certainly necessary. But it is likewise necessary to understand it is still far from the ultimate goal.

14.2.3 Guenon/Evola Letter 7 Introduction

The correspondence between Rene Guenon and Julius Evola was broken after 1934 and resumed in 1948, where there was a regular and frequent correspondence between them. Letters 3 through 6 and the first several paragraphs of Letter 7 were concerned primarily with topics only of interest to authors: books in progress, reprints, translations, etc. The second part of Letter 7, however, addresses several important topics. Unfortunately, we don't have Evola's letter which I am sure would be of great interest. We can only infer its contents, based on Guenon's responses. Here we see some significant differences between the two, and Guenon is taking the teaching role. My opinion is that Evola's works would be even stronger had he been able to absorb some of Guenon's corrections.

Guenon can be curt and often shows impatience with Evola's views. The points addressed are important and need to be taken seriously. There

should be ample material for those interested in a discussion. but for those concerned about our comments policy, bear in mind we are not interested in infinite discussion, but in coming to a decision. Please try to understand what Guenon is saying, either by reading our material on the topics, or better, his directly if you have the time. By coming to terms with their fundamental principles, one's understanding of both Guenon and Evola can only be deepened.

Since the letter is rather long, it won't be published until tomorrow evening. But, in anticipation, the following topics will be addressed:

- whether the metaphysical identity of the possible and the real is an error
- the esoteric character of early Christianity
- whether Masonry has a true initiation
- the current existence of Christian Hermetic orders that go back to the Middle Ages
- discussion of Eliphas Levi, Meyrink, Bo Yin Ra, and Kremmerz
- the difference between the true man and the transcendent man (jivan-mukti), a topic recently addressed here
- Guenon took several initiations at a young age
- Evola was still looking for a valid initiation (so much for the "Sufi of Rome")

Posted on 2012-07-29 by Cologero

14.2.4 Seventh Letter

Here we find Rene Guenon admitting the existence of initiatic organizations in the West, whether derived from Masonry or the Christian Hermetism of the Middle Ages. He himself was “initiated” in a Western form. These organizations may not be known, but it is not out of the question for them to reveal certain things from time to time.

Obviously, Julius Evola was interested in the four men discussed (Eliphas Levi, Meyrink, Bo Yin Ra, and Kremmerz), all of whom Guenon dismisses. (Eckhart Tolle was inspired by Bo Yin Ra.) Even at the age of 50, after some 25 years of correspondence with Guenon, Evola does not understand some metaphysical teachings and seems to still be searching for some “initiation”.

Guenon is not taking into account that Hermetists are often tricksters, with a cultivated public persona that may be quite different from their real understanding. Esoteric writings are couched in symbols and often contain deliberate contradictions and hyperboles. This was often necessary, in fact, when there was danger of crossing political and religious authorities, to hide the true meaning from outsiders, while being understood by initiates.

Unfortunately, Guenon’s obsession with initiation has in practice been deleterious since every Tom, Dick, and Harry believes he knows which “organization” is valid. Instead, they should follow Guenon’s advice: learn the “theoretical knowledge” either from his writings or, even better, from the sources from which he himself got his theoretical knowledge. Once you have that knowledge, only then can you determine where to find its practical application. As he hinted, there are still initiatic organizations in the West based on Christian Hermetism; they just don’t advertise on Craigslist for obvious reasons.

“Schuon’s book” is *The Transcendent Unity of Religion*, which

was published in French in 1948..

See Guenon/Evola Letter 7 Introduction for a more complete introduction.

18 April 1949

Cairo, Egypt

About what you say in regards to Schuon's book, I don't see exactly how the affirmation of the metaphysical identity of the possible and the real could be an "error", actually just the opposite. Nevertheless, if there is anyone to whom this should be attributed, it was I and not he, since, long before him, I devoted a whole chapter (the second) of the *Multiple States of Being* to this problem.

As to the esoteric character of early Christianity, of which later Christianity was only an exteriorization (i.e., no longer having anything initiatic about it); we have no doubt about that, all the more since the Islamic tradition asserts it explicitly, claiming that Christianity, in its origins, was *tariqa* [way] and not *sharia* [law]. The absence of sharia is in fact evident from the moment that it had to supply it through an adaption of Roman law (whence "canon law" was derived), therefore with the contribution of something that was completely unrelated to Christianity (and it is necessary to note in this regard that the word in Arabic *aqnun* is still used today, in contrast to sharia, to define every law that is not integrated in the tradition).

After my latest books (especially the Perspectives on Initiation and the Reign of Quantity, since in the Great Triad I only used two or three articles), there currently remain very few of my articles, as you noted, that have not yet been republished, at least among those that were intended to be copied in Ur. As for the articles on the **Fedeli d'Amore**, I must say that I had the intention for a long time to include them in a new edition of the Esoterism of Dante; I was not able to find the time to systematize it, but I did not abandon them and moreover it is likely that the edition is about to go out of print very quickly.

On the problem of Masonry, I believe that it will truly be very difficult for us to agree; but there are a few things that astonish me about what you say in this question. First of all, you make me say (without any qualification, for I had made quite clear that it concerned only the West) that “the only initiatic traditional organizations existing are the Compagnonnage¹ and Masonry, and then you assert that I should not logically write that some Masons would seem to not take into account Oriental initiatic organizations, that otherwise exist and among which some have more or less numerous members in Europe itself. It stands to reason that it can at least write also for them. I add, to finish with this subject once and for all, that my writings can furnish to some people, unless they are associated with an initiatic organization, a theoretical knowledge of traditional doctrine that in itself is not unimportant. As to the Masons, they have had in this circle, in recent times, many more results than I myself had hoped.

Another thing: I said that in the Western world itself there still survive certain organization tied to Christian Hermetism and dating from the Middle Ages. If I have not stressed this more strongly, it is because they are so closed (one of those that I knew more in depth restricted its membership to just twelve) that the possibility of being admitted is in practice not even to be considered.

I come to another problem; if you take Masonry to be considered, or rather its origin, as an idea similar to what you express, I ask myself how you could have once had, as you had told me some time ago, the intention of developing a work on the rituals aimed at eliminating its anti-traditional elements that were introduced into it. Under these conditions it would be a totally useless task, and there is in that, I confess, something that is absolutely incomprehensible to me. [Before he was injured in Austria, Evola had been doing research on a book on Masonic rituals.]

¹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Compagnons_du_Devoir

However, what I would like you to take notice is this: the date of 1717 does not mark the origin of Masonry, but the beginning of its degeneration, something that is quite different. Furthermore, because we can speak of a utilization of “psychic residues” in this time, it would be necessary to suppose that operative Masonry had then ceased to exist, something not true, from the moment that it subsists still today in different countries, and that in England, between 1717 and 1813, it participated effectively to complete certain things and to straighten up others, at least in the measure in which that was still possible in a Masonry reduced to being only speculative. In reality, the schism of 1717 involved just four Lodges, while there still existed a number of much higher Lodges that did not take part in it. On the other hand, where a regular and continuous filiation exists, the degeneration did not interrupt the initiatic transmission; it only reduced its efficacy, at least in general lines, because in spite of everything there could always be exceptions. As to the anti-traditional action of which you speak, it would be necessary in this regard to make some precise distinctions, e.g., between the Anglo-Saxon and Latin Masons; but, in any case, that only proves the incomprehension of the great part of the members of one or another Masonic organization, simply a question of fact and not of principle. Fundamentally, what could be said is that Masonry was the victim of infiltrations of the modern spirit, as in the exoteric order even the Catholic Church is in its current state even to a greater degree.

Of course, it is that I do not want at all to attempt to persuade you or anybody, only to make you see that the problem is much more complex than what you seem to believe.

Regarding the “initiatic strains” you mention, without denying at all their existence (and what I just said of certain existent Hermetic groups could otherwise be connected to them), I have to say that, for many reasons, I am very skeptical in the great number of cases, and that even the examples you cited are among those that seem to me to be more than

dubious. **Eliphas Levi** was a Mason, and certain English circles with which he was in relationship were, to summarize, study groups, without a proper initiatic character, and were reserved exclusively to Masons. Apart from that, I never found the least proof that he had received any other regular initiation, and all the stories that some have told about this can only be placed in the category of occultist fables.

Meyrink was certainly in the current of very numerous traditional ideas, especially of a Jewish source; but, not to mention that this presupposes precisely an initiation (I do not think that he was able to receive a truly Cabalistic initiation, the only thing without doubt to be taken in consideration in a case of the type), the burlesque manner and caricature with which he often presented these ideas leaves a truly sinister impression (a shame that I cannot tell you by letter all the efforts that I made to remediate certain detrimental consequences of *The Green Face*). Besides, his relations with the school of **Bo Yin Ra** (whose true origin I am probably the only one who knows, because I noticed that his own disciples did not know it) are not certainly a very favorable indication.

As for **Kremmerz**, there would be much to say, and it would require too much time. But what I saw of his writings and even certain rituals that were too clearly “fabricated”, gave me the impression of something of rather scant consistency, and that recalls the worst parts of Eliphas Levi’s work; in any case, the different groups into which his disciples split give the impression of not knowing absolutely how to direct themselves, and some admit to finding themselves at a true impasse.

I will add that, every time that it concerned self-styled Egyptian organizations, there were more serious reasons to be suspicious of them, because nothing authentic is found there and not even, quite often, of any consistency. As for an initiation received outside of the ordinary way of joining a known organization, there are certainly some examples of them, but in these cases it was a question of extremely rare exceptions, and no one can be confident of finding himself in a similar condition to

avoid a normal tie; to think of it differently would be self-delusion in a very serious way. As for me, since the age of 22 or 23, I have been attached with some initiatic organization both Oriental and Western, from which you can take account that the supposition you advanced could not in any way be applied to my situation.

The doctrinal question that you speak about at the end of your letter is, fundamentally, less difficult than what it seems at first view: every “true man” has instead realized all the possibilities of the human state, but each one following a way that is congenial to him and thanks to which he differentiates himself from the others. Moreover, if it were not so, how could there be a place here, in our world, also for other beings that have not reached this level? The same thing can also be applied, at another level, for the “transcendent man” or the *jivan mukta*; but then it is a matter of the totality of the possibilities of all the states.

Only, what is real, as weird as it can seem, is in fact that beings who have reached the same level can then be, in a certain sense, “indistinguishable” from the outside, as far as it concerns corporeal appearance. It happens in effect that they encompass a “type” that no longer has any individuality, and that occurs above all for those who carry out certain special functions: the “type” is then that of the same function, something can make one believe that it is always the same being to exercise it over the course of a period of several centuries, while the reality is something completely different.

Posted on 2012-07-30 by Cologero

* * *

Mihai on 2012-07-31 at 03:19 said:

I intend to read a book by Meyrink- *Der Engel vom westlichen Fenster*. I am curious to draw some conclusions on the character, or at least his ideas. Evola certainly held him in high regard, but he is not the only one. Vasile Lovinescu, a Romanian follower of Guenon, who was also initiated on a Sufi path, mentions *Der Engel vom...* several times in his writings, calling it one time as “one of the few worthy esoteric novels of the 20th century”.

I am wandering about what was the western initiation that Guenon received. I am only aware of the Sufi one.

Also, I am wandering if there are any such Hermetic organizations, that he mentioned, still existing in Europe today.

logres on 2012-07-31 at 06:27 said:

The Simple Life of R. (P Charconac) claims Bo Yin Ra was the only European member of the Teshu-Marú, a Mongolian order.

Cologero on 2012-07-31 at 08:17 said:

Mihai, have you read the Green Face? Guenon makes this strange statement: "a shame that I cannot tell you by letter all the efforts that I made to remediate certain evil consequences of The Green Face." How bad can a novel be?

And it is not as though Guenon was casually dismissing Meyrink et al off the cuff; apparently he was deeply involved in investigating some of those figures.

Guenon was involved at that time of his life (22 or 23) with the French Hermetic school (e.g., Papus, Josephin Peladan, Fabre d'Olivet etc.). I assume that is the Western initiation he is referring to.

I believe that the major books of Valentin Tomberg and Boris Mouravieff are evidences of a Hermetic school; I have already pointed out some coincidences in their publication that cannot be coincidences. Tomberg traces back to an obscure Russian Hermetist (his name escapes me at the moment); Mouni Sadhu worked with the same teacher. Since the Rosicrucians escaped to the "East", it should not be surprising that Russia maintained that tradition. The life and work of Joseph de Maistre in Russia attests to that.

Michael on 2012-07-31 at 11:08 said:

I believe the Russian esotericist was G.O. Mebes.

Mihai on 2012-07-31 at 16:57 said:

Cologero, I have not read any work by Meyrink until now. However, in the volume "Introduction to magic", which contains some of the articles published by the Ur group there is an article called "The path of awakening according to Gustave Meyrink" - a collection of excerpts claimed to be taken from *Der Golem* and *Das grüne Gesicht*. In those excerpts there are clearly some equivocal expressions and attitudes mixed with, what I perceive to be, authentic esoteric thought. Of course, it is hard to pronounce a judgement basing oneself solely on a few excerpts.

In Lovinescu's works (I did have not read all his works) I only came across praises and references on *Der Engel vom westlichen Fenster*. Perhaps this particular book is above the

others, maybe Meyrink deepened his understanding over time (although I do not know the order in which his books appeared). I can only see when I will read some myself.

Avery Morrow on 2012-07-31 at 23:13 said:

Bo Yin Ra is really an odd duck. His writing suggests a Theosophical connection; it's unclear what Guénon could have meant by his "true origin".

<http://www.kober.com/name.php>

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Joseph_Anton_Schneiderfranken

Mihai on 2012-08-01 at 04:45 said:

I think he meant his country of origin or something.

logres on 2012-08-07 at 08:08 said:

http://www.alexandrededanann.net/boyinra_fr.htm

If anyone reads French, English still under construction – Bo Yin Ra and the "White Lodge" (which I think Guénon had a low view of).

Cologero on 2012-08-07 at 08:52 said:

So the Dalai Lama was Bo Yin Ra's master whose portrait Guénon recognized? If so, what was Guénon's objection?

Cologero on 2012-08-08 at 13:09 said:

Bo Yin Ra's master was Swami Narad Mani aka Hiran Singh. More later ...

logres on 2012-08-09 at 17:54 said:

Just got a Bo Yin Ra book today in the mail, so am anticipating your comments rather keenly. I must say that the excerpts of his on the official website don't strike me as typical Theosophical jargon.

Mr Zero on 2013-12-15 at 19:32 said:

The society with only 12 members was called *L'estoile internelle* and was brought to Guénon's attention after he had left to Cairo in his correspondence with Reyor who was the editor of *Etudes Traditionnelles* at the time. It is described in pages 80-82 of Sedgwick's book, they are previewable for free on google books. His sources are in the endnotes.

Cologero on 2020-08-01 at 18:04 said:

My copy is in storage, so I assume the book referred to is "The Transcendent Unity of Religion", which was published in French in 1949. Evola's confusion may be due to the word

“possible” instead of “potential”. The Arabian commentators on Aristotle made that change, so that “potential existence” became the “possibility of being”, which Guenon and Schuon adapted. The latter way of expressing it seems to imply something contingent, i.e., it may or may not be; so how could that be equivalent to the real? On the other hand, Potential existence and actual existence are intimately related, when the potential is actualized. That makes it easier to see that potential is just as much being as is the actual.

14.2.5 Eighth letter

Letter VIII repeats the same topics discussed in Letter VII. I’m sure that Evola’s letters would be more interesting, but they are unavailable, presumably because Guenon’s family was not forthcoming about releasing his personal papers. We still see Guenon’s often curt and condescending tone in addressing Evola.

Evola still does not grasp the notions of the possible and the real; this will need to be explored. We see that Evola was still interested in certain marginal figures (from Guenon’s point of view). Curiously, Evola was interested in Eliphas Levi. Equally curious is Guenon’s admission about the existence of Hermetic organizations and his own “Western” initiation (Letter VII)²; in East and West, Guenon denied any existence of initiation in the West. My guess is that Evola was fishing for such organizations, but Guenon was not forthcoming on the grounds that (1) he does not give personal advice and (2) his own experience is of no interest to anyone else. Yet, it strains credulity to believe there were only 12 Hermetists in Europe.

Once again, I have omitted discussions about publishing, etc.

13 June 1949

Cairo, Egypt Discussions about publishing, etc. omitted As you imagine, it’s been quite some time since I had a chance to read your *Revolt*

²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=4559>

against the Modern Word. I will therefore make an effort to reread it when I can find some free time, in order to see if there are some points to make as you requested.³

According to what you explained to me this time, it seems that you consider the words “possible” and “real” in the sense of “non-manifested” and “manifested”; if that were so, one could say that it is merely a question of terminology and that, in spite of this expressive difference, we are basically in agreement on the point in question. However, such a use of the words “possible” and “real”, in a sense much different from how we use it, does not seem to be acceptable, because the non-manifested is not only just as real, but even more real than the manifested.

What I said last time regarding my ties with initiatic organizations (even though I don’t really like to speak of these things that ultimately can be of interest to no one outside of myself) was in response to what you wrote: “most often out of that secret society those capable of greater comprehension with respect to initiatic things were found, something that perhaps was verified in your own situation.”

That made me think you gave yourself the idea that, in my case, it could be a question of one of those pretended initiations without any regular ties, which, in my opinion, I could consider only purely imaginary. By the way, I will point out to you that, in *Perspectives*, I dedicated an entire chapter to explain the reasons why the word “secret society” is absolutely unacceptable in cases of the type of those which you referred to.

You think that, in *Perspectives*, we do not speak of Christian Hermetic organizations; but to the contrary, I expressly mentioned them even in the note to which you referenced and, if I didn’t talk about it more, it is because those whose existence I was able to come to know admits such a restricted number of members that they can be considered

³Evola, at that time, was revising *Revolt* to be republished in a new edition. More discussions about publishing, etc. omitted.

as inaccessible for all practical purposes. I also see that you have not well understood in what sense I spoke of “complex problems”. I only wanted to say with what in reality they have many more elements than what can be known through a study made “from the outside”; it is therefore totally contrary to something that could be defined as you thought.

As for the source itself of the question concerning Masonry, I clearly mean that I do not at all claim to convince you, and that otherwise you would have no interest in it. You say that in that case, it is a question for you only of the truth, but it is also the same even for me. You know moreover that I have never been concerned to entice anyone to join one or another organization, no more than to distance him from them. I only said in a very clear way that that could not be my role. I never had the time nor the interest to be concerned with individual cases and I always refused to give particular advise to anyone, for this thing as for any other. That said, I must however make two or three observations on what you tell me this time, and first of all on what concerns the side degrees, since the true nature of the relationship between those and Masonry seems to elude you. When I speak of Masonry without further clarifications, it is always about Masonry properly called, including only the three degrees of Apprentice, Fellow Craft, and Master Mason, to which can only be added the English degrees of Mark and Royal Arch, totally unknown in “continental” Masonry.

Regarding the many other degrees like those you refer to, it is obvious that internally there are some things of a quite different character, and that the connection which you wanted to establish between the different “systems” is completely artificial. I am furthermore less inclined to question what I myself wrote formally in a recent article; but, as that is the way with which all these things ended up by agglomerating themselves around Masonry, they do not form an integral part of it to any qualification and consequently it is not what is in question. Another point on which I would like to bring your attention is that when you say that

the Lodges that had not adhered to the “speculative” schisms were not able to do anything to stop or rectify its consequences, it seems that you do not take into account things that nevertheless cover a certain importance, like the reestablishment of the degree of Master, totally unknown by those of 1717, or the action of the “Ancients’ Great Lodge”, whose independent existence continued up until 1813. To say so frankly, I have the impression that you always think only of what Masonry became at a certain period in Italy and France, and that you have no idea at all what concerns Anglo-Saxon Masonry.

To move on to other issues, I confess that I do not understand at all what realizations you mean concerning Eliphas Levi; in fact, like his filiation (or rather like drawing inspirations in his writings, since he himself died before that), there was nothing other than the occultist French movement of the end of the XIX century and the beginning of the XX, on whose insignificance I think we find ourselves in agreement.

For Kremmerz, I know well that a very unclear story is concealed underneath, but that it gives rise to many doubts, at least because I was never able to find any proof about the real existence of the organization to which he would have belonged. In any case, even if he had personally received an authentic initiation, that would still demonstrate nothing for the organization he founded, insofar as there were other cases of the same type (e.g., that of Inayat Khan, who belonged to a regular tariqa in India, but whose self-styled “Order of Sufis” corresponded absolutely to nothing); everything that I can say, is that his rituals are more or less “Egyptian” like those of Cagliostro⁴!

There could nevertheless be certain realizations totally within that circle, as you say, but they do not go beyond the psychic domain, something that entails nothing of the truly initiated. I add that, after Kremmerz’ death, the different groups into which his organization divided appear absolutely not to know where to turn. I notice that, concerning

⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=764>

Eliphas Levi, I forgot to cite the use of his works by Albert Pike; but in that case it is a matter of an influence exercised (otherwise indirectly) on the interpretation of the side degrees of the Scottish Rite, something that does not proceed even in the direction you have seen.

There are certainly cases in which an influence of the counter-initiation is quite visible, and among them, it is necessary to include those in which traditional information is present in a manner of a willful parody. This is above all Meyrink's case, something that, well intended, does not mean that he was perforce conscious of the influence that was exercised over him. Here is why I am amazed that you seem to have a certain esteem in regard to Meyrink, and all the more so, since he had belonged to Bo Yin Ra's movement, for which you clearly had no regard.⁵

In this regard, it is necessary on the other hand for me to make a rectification: certainly there was in Bo Yin Ra a little bit of charlatanism and mystification, but there was at least still more to him, because he was connected with a very strange organization that had its own headquarters in parts of Turkestan and represented a more or less deviant type of Tantrism. About that, I can certainly be certain (and perhaps I am the only one), at the time when the future Bo Yin Ra was still called Joseph Schneider and studied painting in Paris, some members of the organization in discussion made it known to me one day that he was the only European to be a part of it. Later, I also saw the portrait that Bo Yin Ra had made of his "Master" and that it was perfectly recognizable for me; in such occasions, I was able on the other hand to question whether even his most intimate disciples knew absolutely anything at all about that, and I was very aware of letting them in on what I myself knew of it.

Posted on 2012-08-06 by Cologero

⁵As long ago as 1924, Evola reviewed some of Bo Yin Ra's works. Although Evola did not render a fully positive judgment, he conceded that his doctrine had some interesting points.

* * *

Mihai on 2012-08-07 at 04:51 said:

“Yet, it strains credulity to believe there were only 12 Hermetists in Europe.”

He didn't say that there were only 12 in Europe, but that a particular organization only admitted a maximum of 12 members. Which means (and it is implied) that there were others, but who had a similarly exclusive membership.

14.2.6 Ninth Letter

Main points:

- Guenon gets a little snarky about the possible and the real
- Guenon considers Inayat Khan to be absurd, demonstrating that a “legitimate” initiation offers no guarantee
- Guenon teaches Evola about Islam, including role of Melchizedek, the coming Imam, El-Khidr, and the meaning of infallibility and impeccability
- Guenon had high regard for **Mircea Eliade**.
- He tells a strange story about a spell cast on **Leon de Poncins**. We will have more to say about the latter at some other point.
- Guenon tells an even stranger story about a Jewish lawyer, but we are left hanging.
- Guenon explains why he never allows photos to be taken of him.
- Since Evola neither knew Guenon's age nor had ever seen a photograph of him, it proves that they had never met each other in person, no matter what others might claim.

2 August 1949

Cairo, Egypt

[Discussions about publishing, translations, and the proofs of *Revolt* omitted]

Regarding *Revolt*, you are doubtlessly correct: it will be simpler if you send me the proofs and I send back my observations after reading them, because otherwise you may have already modified something that I had noted.

Inayat Khan, whom I also knew, was regularly associated with the tariqah Chishtiya, one of the most widespread in India and totally orthodox; something that did not prevent the organization he founded to be completely the fruit of his fantasy and lacking any value; the name, "order of Sufis" that he gave it is also truly absurd.

As for the Masonic question, I think like you that it is useless to revisit it again. I only point out that as you say yourself this time, it is good to understand how it is not possible to speak of "Masonry" meaning a type of global entity, that in reality does not exist, or rather, if you prefer, exists only in the line of principle and which one cannot attribute it to any more or less exterior action: the refusal by some of its branches to recognize others whose deviations they criticize sufficiently proves on the other hand that there is no unity in this regard.

The problem of the possible and the real seems very simple and obvious to me, but, of course, under the condition of examining it from the metaphysical point of view. It is obvious that, from the philosophical point of view, one can always think anything whatsoever and discuss a problem endlessly without ever reaching a conclusion; it is even what characterizes profane speculation, and I have never been able to entertain any interest for those so-called "problems" that fundamentally have only a verbal existence.

Melchizedek corresponds, in Islamic esoterism, to the function of the Qutb, as I have otherwise explained in *King of the World*. On the other

hand, El-Khider is the Master of the Afrad, which are found outside the jurisdiction of the Qutb and is said that they are not even known by it; in this regard, the Koranic story of the meeting between El-Khidr and Moses (Surat El-Kalif) is otherwise very significant. The way of the Afrad is something absolutely exceptional, and no one can choose it on his own initiative. It is about an initiation received beyond the ordinary means and belongs in reality to another chain (perhaps you can find an article of Abdul-Hadi in which he deals with these two chains, even if his definitions are not perhaps very clear).

In the Jewish Kabbalah, the same distinction is found expressed through the duality of Metatron and Sandalphon.

The hidden Imam is something completely different: those who admit his existence generally think that it is he who has to appear as the Mahdi. He is on the other hand defined as “el-Muntazer”, that could mean, the “expected one”, but that is interpreted almost always as “he who waits”.

Doctrinal infallibility belongs to whoever exercises legitimately a traditional function, naturally within the limits of that same function.

The issue of “impeccability” is quite different, and it is usually considered, at least in orthodox tradition, as reserved to the Prophet: if it happens that he sometimes performs some acts that could seem reprehensible from an exterior point of view, it is only a question of an appearance, and such actions should in reality justify for the reason that elude the understanding of ordinary men.

I can provide you some news about **Mircea Eliade**: he published, as you might know, three articles from his journal *Zalmoxis*, the last of which in 1942. After that, he spent the rest of the war in Portugal, and subsequently he returned to Paris where he still is today. He has had many items published recently: *Yoga: Immortality and Freedom*, the *Myth of the Eternal Return*, and the *History of Religious Ideas* (which I have not yet had time to read), without mentioning the many important articles

in the *Revue de l'Histoire des Religions*. I don't have his address, but I think I can easily find it out and will then let you know.

As for **Leon de Poncins**, it is a matter of a rather unpleasant story. Shortly before the war, a certain Eve Louguet was his secretary who took part in a group of dangerous sorcerers. He himself was a victim of these people and concerning the people who by chance saw him again around 1940, they reported to me that he seemed to have undergone a true collapse. I never knew what became of him since, but, in such conditions, I have many doubts that he can still be alive. [He actually outlived both Guenon and Evola.

ED.]

What is strange is that in the same period, one of the individuals in question tried to start a correspondence with me for some reason. At that time I did not know what it was about, but very soon the affair appeared suspicious to me, so that I immediately gave him a clean break.

I recently had the chance to speak about you with Mr. M., who has for more than a year been representing Argentina in Cairo and he informed me that he had known you at one time.

He intends to translate *Man and his Becoming* into Spanish; up until now, only the *General Introduction* has been translated into that language, in a version published in Buenos Aires during the war.

Since you asked me my age, I am 62 years old; I knew that you had to be younger than I, but I didn't think that the difference was so great. [Evola was 51 at the time.] As for my photograph, I am sorry that I cannot satisfy your request, but the truth is that I don't have any, and for many reasons. In fact, first of all what could be called a matter of principle that commits me, as you say, to give no importance to anything that is of a simply individual character. But, beyond that, I am also cautious that it could present some danger. About 15 years ago, I was informed that a certain Jewish lawyer was poking all around here to procure one of my

photographs, claiming to be willing to pay any price. I never knew what he truly wanted to do with it, but what is certain in any case is that his intentions were not at all benevolent. Since one never knows where a photograph can end up, I concluded from the episode that it was much more prudent to not take one.

Posted on 2012-08-13 by Cologero

* * *

Ali Alavi on 2012-08-13 at 14:32 said:

Would I be wrong to suppose that the Abdul Hadi Guénon mentions and refers to, is none other than Ivan Aguéli?

Cologero on 2012-08-13 at 17:53 said:

Ali Alavi, thank you for pointing that out as I neglected to include that in a note. Here is the note from the collection of letters:

Abdul-Hadi, i.e., John Gustav Agelii (1869-1917), also called Ivan Aguéli, a painter, was the one who connected Rene Guenon to Islamic esoterism through the tariqa of sheik Ilaysh el-Kebir.

Dominion on 2012-08-13 at 22:53 said:

Not having read about Leon de Poncins before, does this account fit with what is known about his life before and after said period? And if this is his response to a single picture, I can only imagine how Guenon would have viewed Facebook and the internet...

Cologero on 2012-08-13 at 23:03 said:

I did a google search, Dominion, on Leon de Poncins and Eva Louguet; Gornahoor showed up first, so it wasn't very helpful.

Leon de Poncins was a counter-revolutionary Catholic who saw Masonry and Judaism as hidden forces in Europe; actually not unlike Evola.

The notes point out that Leon lived another 25 years or so; hence, Guenon overestimated the negative effects. I have no idea why Leon's secretary would try psychic attacks against him.

As for the Internet, there may be safety in numbers. There are so many images, and not enough Jewish lawyers to use them for their own purposes.

Aghorable on 2012-08-14 at 10:07 said:

Regarding how G. might view pervasive "social networking", recall his describing a world where everything was made public as a "monstrosity" (ROQ). Even then he had surmised enough to acknowledge this trend in the possibility of its full extension, and look around you now; yet another instance of a terminal approach to the limit in a particular domain (spearheaded by a nontraditional Jew).

For me, it necessitates a serious redefinition of where one invests oneself; the greater the encroachment, the more one is forced to redirect his essence, away from the glare of whatever fumbling hunchback's shoulders our world is currently resting on.

Concerning the psychic attacks from the secretary, it could have been a case of her mainly serving as a conduit for lower forces by her involvement in some peculiar group, without her necessarily knowing entirely what is going on. Damn, I bet she friend-zoned him too.

Generally, anyone with a practical interest in initiation does well to consider just what it would mean to a person living in, say, a typical metropolis of the modern West to suddenly gain a direct perception of their inner being, without the supports that existed in regularly organized dominions. Such an operation would imply, at some point, an unguarded opening to the psychic plane, and the lower forces that inevitably converge upon one are exceedingly difficult to detect as something extrinsic at first, perhaps because they are not entirely so. This is why G. mentions, more than once, the importance of theoretical preparation; should one face a collapse, he would need tools and strength to dig himself out and rebuild. And then he might find himself in a new state where he directly perceives the very forces that are behind the events, both petty and great, that are taking place every day in the corporeal realm, especially wherever he is situated. This is the 'world as power'. and as you might imagine, living a life with such awareness is not for the faint hearted.

For the majority who have no idea of what is really at work when they are hit by forces of a similar kind, many end up in the hands of their local psychiatric team, which profession has apparently undergone a curious retreat from its previous position at the avant-garde of the psychic incursion, to the reassuring illusions of security in materialism and its favourite panacea, the chemical dose. Still others end up dead, often in grotesque circumstances (search your local Coroner's reports for particulars), hence G.'s doubts about the Vicomte de Poncins's survival.

Cologero on 2012-08-14 at 22:08 said:

I haven't found anything about Poncin's personal life other than he was from an old aristocratic family and was a Catholic counter-revolutionary along the lines of Joseph de Maistre and Donoso Cortes. I have some old books that reference his works and confirm that point of view. Furthermore, in the Italian edition of Evola's *Revolt*, Poncin's work, the Hidden (or Occult) War, is referred to twice. The references are not included in the English translation, nor are the

references to Donoso. Evola himself described Poncin as a Traditionalist.

Lucio on 2016-06-28 at 21:28 said:

"I recently had the chance to speak about you with Mr. M., who has for a time more than a year been representing Argentina in Cairo and he informed me that he had known you at one time".

Who is this Mr. M.?

Cologero on 2016-06-28 at 22:55 said:

Lucio: I assume it was a Maxim Montoto who translated "Man and his Becoming" into Spanish (as Guenon indicated). However, I can't find out anything about him.

Lucio on 2016-06-29 at 02:33 said:

Thanks, I consider important to know who the translators are, and I assume that the edition I have of "General Introduction" is from him, though I cannot tell for sure.

14.2.7 Tenth Letter

- Guenon explains more about impeccability
- Guenon expands on the powers of sorcerers and that no one is safe from their spells
- Guenon offers opinions on Thomas Palamidessi, Carl Jung, Meher Baba, the Golden Dawn, and Aleister Crowley
- Kerenyi sided with the liberals in Hungary during WW II. That may explain his change of attitude towards Guenon
- Evola translated Leon de Poncins' book on the occult war into Italian. Both Guenon and Evola believed in conspiracies, aka "counter initiation", which may explain their mutual interest in Poncins.

29 October 1949

Cairo, Egypt

I received your letter of 4 September about eight days ago; I wonder if you were able to reach **Eliade**, since I rushed to send you his address in

Capri. A short time after I wrote you, I knew that he had already returned to Paris; it seems that he did not take a very long vacation.

[Discussions and complaints about publishing and editors omitted]

Abdul-Hadi's article, which I spoke about, entitled *Pages dedicated to Mercury*, was republished in "Etudes Traditionnelles", but I realized that occurred only after the war, which explains the reason why you aren't familiar with him.

As for "impeccability", it goes without saying that it must belong equally to all who have reached a certain spiritual level. But, excluding the case of the prophetic mission, the possession of such a state concerns only the person who received it, and no one else can speak of its merit or care about it, hence the absence of every explicit affirmation in this regard in orthodox doctrine.

If I learn something about **Leon de Poncins**⁶, I will let you know, but I still don't know what happened to him. I believed, I no longer know exactly why, that he had to retreat to Switzerland during the war, but I was not able to confirm that.

Regarding evil spells, there is a great difference between true sorcerers like those with whom he had to deal and simple occultists. The latter, notwithstanding all their pretenses, never reach any effective result. There have often been some of them who attempted to do something against me and, also like you, I never heard anything about it at all.

On the other hand, when you think that things of that type should not be able to strike those who have a true spiritual vocation (however I don't think that can be said to have been the case of Leon de Poncins), it is also necessary to make a distinction: if you want to speak of the psychic and mental side, you are absolutely correct, but things are quite different from the corporeal point of view and anyone can always be struck in this regard. Furthermore, since it has been passed down that some sorcerers succeeded in sickening the Prophet himself, I don't even

⁶https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/L%C3%A9on_de_Poncins

see who could boast of being secure from their attacks.

Thomas Palamidessi, whose writings you inserted into your letter, is again obviously another charlatan of the type of those who currently abound everywhere. But what is astonishing is that he again appropriated ideas found in your and other's books, to use them in a way that can only discredit them; in such conditions, the works that he publishes should not require much effort to write.

I heard about **Meher Baba** in the past and his vow of silence, which does not seem to prevent him from responding in other ways to the questions that are asked of him, but I did not know that he has reappeared in recent times. I do not know if he ever was associated with any regular initiatic organization, but it seems dubious to me because he is a Parsi. Nothing of the type seems to exist among the Parsis of India, who moreover have conserved only rather incomplete fragments of their tradition (I speak of the Parsis of India, because those of central Asia have quite other knowledge, even if they keep it hidden).

I am quite astonished about how much you tell me in regards to **Karoly Kerényi**⁷, because I remember that in the past he had spoken very favorably about me; it had to be in 1939 or 1940, and at that occasion he had sent me his book *Religion in Antiquity*. On the other hand I reviewed it, but because of the suspension of "Études Traditionnelle", I was able to publish it only after its resumption.

As for **Carl Jung**, his influence unfortunately is gaining ground everywhere, in France as in Italy and Switzerland, and he seems to me still more dangerous than Freud because of his pseudo-spiritual pretense. Recently I had to write an article about the deformations of the very idea of Tradition provoked by his theory of the "collective unconscious".

The Golden Dawn⁸ was a self-styled Hermetic organization that fundamentally did not seem to have a very serious character, because it was

⁷https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/K%C3%A1roly_Ker%C3%A9nyi

⁸https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hermetic_Order_of_the_Golden_Dawn

from its beginnings an authentic mystification. It is true that this could serve to conceal some rather suspect things. Internally, the principle role was developed by MacGregor and his wife (Bergson's sister). Only much later was Crowley introduced to it, as he also did in many other things. Even when it was not about rather insignificant pseudo-initiations (perhaps that was not at all the case for the Golden Dawn), his involvement introduced truly sinister influences into it, if only making of it something much more dangerous. The Golden Dawn has ceased to exist, following a misunderstanding among its members, but a part of them followed it up under the name of *Stella Matutina*⁹.

To come back to **Aleister Crowley**¹⁰, what you told me reminds me of the story that turned up in 1931 (I believe at least that was the exact date): while he was in Portugal, he suddenly disappeared. They found his clothes on the border of the sea, something that made them believe he had drowned. But it was only a simulated death, since they were no longer concerned about him and did not try to find out where he had gone. Actually, he went to Berlin to play the role of secret adviser to Hitler who was then at his beginning. It is probably this that had given rise to certain tales about the Golden Dawn, but in reality it was only about Crowley, because it does not seem that a certain English colonel named Etherton, who was then his "colleague", had ever had the least relationship with that organisation.

A little later, Crowley founded the Saturn Lodge in Germany; have you ever heard of it? There he called himself Master Therion, and his signature was *to mega Therion* (the Great Beast), something that in Greek gives exactly the numeric value 666.

Posted on 2012-08-20 by Cologero

* * *

⁹https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Stella_Matutina

¹⁰<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6789>

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 14:16 said:

I'm somewhat loathe to comment again as I'm genuinely perturbed and often exasperated – to the point of intense sighing and face-palming – by some of what I've seen and heard on this website, albeit some very interesting subjects are covered. However, I feel this is an important matter for the esoteric community and want to say that I'm glad reservations about AC have been raised. Throughout my life, even since before I became consciously Christian, I have been intensely wary of him. I and was once told by a (male) witch to not even physically touch one of AC's books because his works are so intensely charged with 'black magic'. (We were in a bookshop together and saw a upside-down pentacle-adorned tome looming in sinister fashion from the bottom shelf). I do realise that he is a very complex character – and pioneering in his own right – but his identification with the number of the beast says it all really. I also agree about the damage that can be inflicted by a sorcerer given the right conditions to work in – it would be possible to see the precarious state of the world and human spirituality as having been partially brought about by the nefarious actions of determined black magicians(I could name names in this regard but don't want to draw the wrong sort of attention to anyone here). AC's involvement in the war is a curious subject. Paradoxically in this context, I actually heard that he taught Churchill the famous 'V' sign in order to counterbalance the dark magic of Hitler's gestures, but I'm not sure if that's just a legend. Chances are he was an Agent ZigZag character who worked for both sides. Either way he appears not to have won much respect for his contribution. Other magus-type characters, such as Gurdjieff, couldn't stand him, but magus types are notorious for not getting along – not enough space for more than one mammoth ego in one room I should imagine.

zero is zero on 2012-08-20 at 16:56 said:

All this stuff is cool but where is the article on game Cologero? I can't wait. Is it going to be called "Game and Sex Magic as Authentic Initiatory Tradition"?

Cologero on 2012-08-20 at 17:30 said:

Mr. Zero, you need to check the poll results, which were overwhelmingly opposed to posts on Game.

Nevertheless, since I am not much of a fan of the democratic method, I wrote a sample article anyway, which was rejected by our Board. They felt it would be unwise to reveal publicly such intimate details of female psychology. I may try to rework it to get it approved.

In the meantime, while you're waiting, I suggest taking matters into your own hands.

Cologero on 2012-08-20 at 17:35 said:

Thank you for your continued interest and valuable insights, Charlotte. Yet, I have no idea why you would be perturbed or exasperated by someone else's opinions. Enjoy what you find

interesting and ignore the rest.

Perhaps Crowley is as evil as you say, but real evil seldom announces itself so clearly. It typically hides behind bright smiles and chatter about "love", much like a wolf in sheep's clothing.

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 18:28 said:

Well I haven't tended to think Gornahoor is about opinions, I think it is a group of people presenting their views as the wholly representative of the 'primordial tradition'. which I do not necessarily see in the same way. Certainly many things are presented far more forcefully than as 'opinions'. but there are nonetheless things we can agree on, if not all things.

I know what you mean about wolves in sheep's clothing, opposites and mirrors, etc, there are even those who say that entities appearing 'white' (in terms of colour) in the spiritual dimensions, including dreams, are in fact luciferic and manifesting evil. Personally I do not agree with this (not that I've been given many instances where the issue cropped up at all), although I WILL admit that the most evil entity I have ever encountered was indeed white, although this may be because it was translucent (ie, of no colour at all).

Recently, in the interests of objectivity, I have tried to listen to some fans of Crowley and I can see that he did impart some truth within his body of work so I am not meaning to be overly judgmental, simply conveying what my own impression has been. I also really enjoyed his biography by Lawrence Sutin I think it was, as at the very least the man had a fascinating life and certainly did a lot for gay rights! The 'evil sorcerer' I was referring to however, is not him, it is someone who was leader of the Temple of Set in the US. I don't really want to talk much further about that, especially here where there is the potential for the dark energy to be attracted, I just thought it was worth clarifying in case people thought I meant AC. In my opinion this (the activities of the temple leader) goes right to the dark heart of dark occultism in the modern world, but getting one's head around it, apart from being subjectively horrific, is so unbelievably complicated it's probably best left aside unless absolutely necessary.

It's also interesting what is said about Jung, as in the past few weeks I've been given cause to have doubts about him for the first time, although more for accusations of anti-semitism than anything else. As I think you know, I am anything but anti-semitic, so even a hint of anti-semitism is like anathema to me. Anyway, possibly Jung doesn't deserve that criticism, I didn't look any further into it but I was surprised.

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 18:32 said:

details on female psychology!!! you fellas may need some help with that as it is not your strongest point (male psychology isn't my strong point either by the way) talk about a way to start a holy war.... :-))

Avery Morrow on 2012-08-20 at 18:34 said:

I agree about Crowley: he is a charlatan and dangerous only insofar as he will waste people's time with false initiation. The real demons Charlotte should be looking out for are those like Screwtape, the henchmen of the occult war who work on our souls, notwithstanding Guénon's somewhat weird claim that wizards are attacking him.

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 18:57 said:

I'm not looking!!! trying not to anyway. What led me to even try to learn something about AC was a decision I took to somehow resolve – as far as I might be able – the terrible situation so far as magic is concerned that was brought about during and around the World Wars. It seemed very clear to me that the present day spiritual dangers – and especially the impasse – would never be resolved until that particular 'knot' was untied. To say I wasn't prepared for what I saw would be an understatement, Guenon isn't the only one who reckons he's had wizard's past, present and/or future attacking him! (although voodoo, of course, requires compliance on the part of the victim, which is why hypnotism is so widely employed as a dark art). What you say about the henchmen who work on our souls is very true, terrifyingly so, it's important to be protected, the armour of God is necessary. I also should say that certain spiritual states of being make one more vulnerable to 'attack' from 'wizards' with relative degrees of manifestation that can come right through to the physically injurious. In very heightened states thought becomes so much more powerful – what might otherwise be 'undesirable' but 'harmless' thoughts – anger with another, or lust, for example – take on a terrifying potential when you're in astral/etheric realms. If the 'victim' and 'attacker' are both – possibly inadvertently – at a very high stage of spiritual development or psychic awareness then you can quadruple it all again or thereabouts. look into the abyss and it looks back etc....

This is also the reason why 'wizard' or would-be-wizard types, for want of a better term, speak in a certain way about their exploits and or experiences, as if they were as tangibly real in a scientific and objective sense as someone eating an apple. T

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 19:05 said:

To give a more concrete example of what Guenon may be referring to: I know a woman who had a relationship with a Muslim man a few years ago. Unbeknownst to my friend, it turns out there was a Muslim woman vying for his attention, who went to an Imam in her home country and confided to him her problem. If I remember rightly she was given some sort of bracelet, something with three beads, each of which represented a misfortune that was to befall her love rival. Sure enough, my friend duly lost around half her body weight, almost all of her hair and fell into a deep depression that was only alleviated when she converted to Islam (via a different man, who would become her husband) and found her own Imam to lift the spell...

zero is zero on 2012-08-20 at 19:06 said:

Haha good answer Cologero.

Re Crowley it's very obvious that something went wrong somewhere along the road with him, someone who bases his whole philosophy around Will but dies as a heroin addict, I think anyone can see there is a major problem involved. That doesn't mean that nothing worthwhile can be gained from some of his writings. My feeling is that we are doomed to find knowledge in this way, making a collage from scattered sources, finding kernels of truth hidden here and there, there is no unified body of knowledge to act as a whole source in sight.

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 19:24 said:

The only way is by revelation from the Holy Spirit and it's probably best if one can be satisfied with that gift rather than trying to understand from an intellectual point of view. To take the life rather than the knowledge, as it were. However human beings are curious by nature and it appears to be almost impossible for almost anyone to stay firm in this respect (the trouble being that the mind is where doubt can be instilled).

Charlotte on 2012-08-20 at 19:33 said:

By the way I DO think evil tends to appear as it is – just that, Evil – but the trouble is knowing how, when and why it appears. I have never heard evil chattering about love, although I do know someone who often talks about love to mask her own despair. Nobody need be fooled by smiles – in Thailand, for instance, if you get into an argument with someone and they start smiling then watch out, they may be about to kill you.

Cologero on 2012-08-20 at 22:53 said:

Charlotte, with all the time you have allegedly spent reading Gornahoor, you still think it is all about the "mind". Shame on you.

Cologero on 2012-08-20 at 23:01 said:

Au contraire, ma chère Charlotte, I do understand female psychology, inasmuch as I knew you would come back.

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 05:02 said:

I had to give you the pleasure of sticking the knife in one more time, eh! pride thankfully isn't my main vice...you might have been able to judge my reaction, seeing as you know how much I care, but you will never be able to understand the reasons why. Enjoy the Miami sun, it's raining here in England but at least we've not dried out!

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 05:37 said:

By the way, where did I say I thought Gornahoor was 'all about the mind'. it was YOU who suggested it was a mere collection of opinions, I actually gave it more credence than that, but perhaps I shouldn't have?

While I am here, I may as well say I couldn't help noticing that people have been confused about 'Guenon's Western Initiation' and which 'school' it might have been. Well, he may have joined some other organisation in England or wherever – Druidism, perhaps – but at least I can tell you that Sufism IS a fundamental aspect of the western mystery tradition, along with Christianity and Judaism. It's easiest to see them as three interlocking circles if one would like a symbol representing how they fit together.

The 'Eastern' tradition is along the Buddhist lines. The fundamental difference is that the Western mysteries are revealed from the Holy Spirit and keep with the idea of a Creator God that is distinct from the creation, whereas the Eastern view sees Creator and Created as being one, without distinction.

This is a particularly important difference when you start looking at concepts of eternity, of which there are more than one.

Michael on 2012-08-21 at 11:35 said:

By the way Cologero, I second Zero's request for Game posts. It seems that most of the commenters are far along reading works of Tradition, but more practical posts will help novices, such as myself, come up to speed faster.

Cologero on 2012-08-21 at 12:45 said:

Michael, the Board has approved my posts conditionally, provided I file them under "fiction". They may not be what you expect.

The Board also suggested we wait until Charlotte goes away again, lest things get out of hand.

Cologero on 2012-08-21 at 13:03 said:

No, Charlotte, there was a "West" long before Christianity or Islam came on the scene, and Judaism—whatever that is—had no influence on it. Repeating some nonsense from a Karen Armstrong book is not going to cut it here.

Does "the Eastern view sees Creator and Created as being one"? Perhaps in the sense that Nirvana and Samsara are one? How about the Thomist view that for God, Essence and Existence are one?

Either all is one and there are no important differences, or all is not one, which makes one true and the other false.

As for your other point, there is only one concept of eternity, but many ways to misunderstand it.

I am asking you nicely, Charlotte, to focus on what is said here. If anything gets you emotionally worked up, that is because you are experiencing resistance, more precisely, resistance to gnosis. The first task for any reader here is to clear his mind of all personal opinion in order to hear something new.

That is also the requirement of the second Arcana: the mind must be freed of all perturbations, specifically including strong negative emotional reactions, as well as the putrefaction of useless opinions. Only then can the Holy Spirit be heard.

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 15:29 said:

I haven't read a Karen Armstrong book, but you clearly have – what does she write about?

I did focus on what was said here, which was Guenon's point about Crowley. It was YOU who chose to make inaccurate assessments of comments I'd written by wrongly saying I thought Gornahoor was all about the mind – again your assumptions, not my words. You can be as unpleasant towards me as you like – nothing new there – but it won't make what you say true. Your personal dislike of me is clouding your judgment. Far from being over emotional, I was at least capable of rising above my own reservations by agreeing with something that was presented here when I felt it was important enough to merit comment.

The western mystery tradition, having evolved over many years, IS informed by Sufism, Judaism and Christianity. Like it or not.

Go ahead and print your article about women, none are likely to dare comment so yourself and the 'Board' need never by any the wiser. Why don't you become a closed group if you wish to avoid attracting unwanted attentions from those you see as lesser mortals?

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 16:19 said:

Seeing as you wrongly assumed I'd been quoting an author I barely know, here is some pertinent information from Gareth Knight (a living male authority on the western mystery tradition, no less!). He talks more about the difference between West and East so far as mysteries are concerned, it's been up on my blog for ages:

The pendulum has swung back again—or at any rate is about to start its swing. In speaking of 'the unity of the world and all things in it' we must, however, avoid the error of oriental monism which denies the dual existence of Creator and created. According to this view the universe and all the inner worlds therein have been self-created, or at best emanated from a central source.

This means that God is in everything, in the holiest of holies and in the dust on the sandals of the worshipper at the temple gate. As a child of an acquaintance put it with devastating childlike logic. 'When I stamp on the ground am I stamping on God?' To this the monist would rush to reply 'Yes'. but the theist would say 'No'. The monist would go on to say that as God is also in the child's foot, sock and shoe, God was stamping on God. The theist would go on to say

that although God is not in everything He is omniscient as far as the creation is concerned and is therefore aware of the child stamping and in empathy with both the child and the ground.

All this is not academic, theological or philosophical hair splitting, for the consequences of believing one thing or the other are profound. If we are going to build a philosophical or theological edifice we need to be very certain of the rock upon which it is founded. To believe that all things unfurl of their own accord from nothing is to assume that man is capable of expanding his consciousness until he comes eventually as God, comprehending all – and that animals expand their consciousness to become humans, plants likewise to become animals, even minerals to become plants.

This is a theory that is, in fact, held by many students of the occult, based on the monist philosophical assumptions of the East. It has its superficial attraction as a logical sounding kind of arrangement. It takes in the ideas of human progress and general life evolution that were newly formulated and current in the nineteenth century, and it is hardly surprising that these ideas in occult form were first promulgated in the West in the late nineteenth century by the efforts of the newly formed Theosophical Society.

What Madame Blavatsky, its founder, did really was to take nineteenth-century materialist evolutionary theory as formulated by Darwin and stand it on its head as a spiritual evolutionary theory, in much the same way that

Marx had inverted the spiritual dialectic of Hegel to form the dialectical materialism of Marxism. Both Marxism and Theosophy have a great spurious appeal as seeming to answer many questions by this agile topsy-turvydom. Unfortunately both are wrong – though this does not alter the fact that Marxism as a political philosophy came to dominate a third of the world and Theosophical monism dominates much of modern occult thought.

It is not our task to try to judge why certain particular nineteenth-century philosophical ideas should retain such a hold into modern times, though in the case of oriental monism and occultism its influence spread because a whole generation of occult students sat at the feet of Madame Blavatsky and imbibed her principles even if they later rejected some of the superstructure of her philosophy. They later taught others and so the basic assumptions spread – with various modifications to and arguments about the superstructure, but with the entire theological foundations taken for granted and accepted unchallenged.

The whole Western occult tradition, which had followed an underground course for centuries, burst out into the open, only to be thoroughly mixed, swamped and diluted with Eastern ideas deriving from Hinduism and Buddhism. The true occult heritage of the West stems, however, along with the religion of the West, from Christian and Judaic tradition – or rather from revealed as opposed to natural religion.

Gareth Knight, *Experience of the Inner Worlds, The Sphere of Light*

Charlotte on 2012-08-21 at 16:44 said:

Now I will quote you, Cologero:

"Judaism – whatever that is"

Shame on YOU. Avery was right to caution about Screwtapes, casual readers beware.

Cologero on 2012-08-22 at 07:34 said:

Charlotte, Judaism has a long history. At one time there were priests, temples and animal sacrifice. That judaism no longer exists. Rabbinic judaism is different. Orthodox Jews are different from Reformed Jews. And so on.

The same for Christianity ... that word means very little today as a guide to what someone believes or how he acts.

You persist, Dear Charlotte, in finding the worse possible interpretation of what you read. St. Ignatius Loyola recommended the opposite, i.e., first consider the best interpretation of what you read before you judge.

It is time for you to leave us in peace, Charlotte, your sort of cattiness is not welcome here.

harlotte on 2012-08-22 at 07:47 said:

I'm afraid you have again misjudged me Charles, the cattiness and unpleasant comments came from you. The actual decision to repost here, apart from the interesting comment about black sorcerers, was following a family funeral where a conversation with my catholic cousin gave me hope for the first time in months that not all is lost for the church. My tentative venture here proved once again how highly unpleasant and totally unreasonable professed 'traditionalists' can be. I'm sorry you can't handle the truth I bring you.

Cologero on 2012-08-22 at 08:00 said:

Thanks for clearing that up, Charlotte, and I am sorry for your loss.

Should you ever decide to comment on what is actually written here, you will be most welcome.

Charlotte on 2012-08-22 at 08:19 said:

That's alright, you're not expected to know the ins and outs of my life. But please see that I WAS actually commenting on what is written here (Guenon on Crowley), not just turning up to be difficult – you can't seriously imagine I would subject myself to running the gauntlet on a whim, for the sake of being shot down!

The truth is I thought this was something that we were able to agree upon and therefore a 'safe topic'. In my view it was worth highlighting as it touches on matters pertinent to the 'occult war'. I know that email/internet makes it very difficult to judge people's tone or the manner in which comments are intended, but please be assured that cattiness and sarcasm are simply not

my style, although I can't help being ironic at times... i guess what is blatantly obvious to one person (any person), is shrouded in obscurity for another, we all see what we see.

As for 'western initiations'. I will concede that it is fair to say there are a number of takes on what this entails. As far as I'm concerned it encompasses the revealed religion of Judaism, Christianity and Islam, which as you point out have all been through various changes and interpretations over the centuries. However, others see the 'western mysteries' as a more recent phenomena, a Golden Dawn term, or see it primarily in terms of Egypt, for example. So there is potential for confusions, certainly.

It just seemed to me that so much is made of Guenon being Sufi that it was logical to assume this constituted his 'western initiation'. but maybe there was another. Given his feelings on Crowley it seems unlikely it was Golden Dawn or such like, but other may know better. There were plenty of occult societies in those days so I guess it could have been anything...

Andrew on 2012-08-23 at 06:26 said:

I honestly think we should just ban women. This is typical, and it's not Charlotte's fault, but...she is a woman, and we can't expect any better.

Cologero on 2012-08-23 at 08:27 said:

On the other hand, Andrew, there are Buddhist texts, at least in the Vajrayana scriptures, in which women appear as teachers. So I suggest we take this opportunity to recognize and eradicate ignorance, irrationality, and unjustified aggression within ourselves.

Aghorable on 2012-08-23 at 10:02 said:

Were I chief of a bricks-and-mortar club, I would perhaps adopt Andrew's suggestion, tempering it slightly to allow women with special skills to join us on certain nights.

Skills, for instance, belly dancing, harp playing, tea brewing, rhythmic gymnastics etc. They would only be permitted to indulge us in romantic discourse, no crusty erudition or intellectual posturing, but they would need to express a basic familiarity with metaphysical concepts to gain admittance, in order to appreciate the elevated states of our being.

And there would be hashish and opium and wine, and the finest blends of tobacco known to man, and sturdy eunuchs from barbarous corners of the world tending to our vagaries, with water flowing perpetually from a hidden mountain spring, and soft cushions of fine silk sent us by the Thai royal family; juicy fruit and tropical birds tamed into submission by our otherworldly song, and unlimited broadband internet to facilitate our studies, powered by thorium reactors...

Ah, Captain Nemo, my old friend.

Charlotte on 2012-08-23 at 11:02 said:

Oh I forgot to mention the Rishis and Dakinis, that was somewhat remiss of me!

Gosh what a dull world it would be without them...

Matt on 2012-08-23 at 20:00 said:

....Yikes. To bring this back to Guenon's letter (the original topic at hand for this discussion), Guenon's judgement of Palamidessi is rather noteworthy...if only because Palamidessi's writings were the subject of a couple of posts on gornahoor by Logres. If I remember correctly Logres was planning on writing some more posts on this particular figure's writings, though they never materialized.

I wonder if Evola may have eventually come to share Guenon's view on Thomas, though I think Evola wrote a relatively cordial letter to Palamidessi late in his life....so maybe not.

Logres on 2013-07-14 at 10:22 said:

I was doing some rethinking the other day, and realized that Palamidessi's conversion to Christianity was in the 1960s: this letter is from substantially earlier. Is it possible that Tomasso was a charlatan, but one who converted and repented? Not necessarily so, just because he was formally a Christian later in life, but a possibility.

Sy on 2017-06-23 at 08:02 said:

the "article about the deformations of the very idea of Tradition provoked by his theory of the collective unconscious" would be interesting. has anyone found it?

Cologero on 2017-06-23 at 14:53 said:

@Sy, see Chapter 5, "Tradition and the Unconscious" in Guenon's *Symbols of Sacred Science*.

14.3 From Guénon to Guido de Giorgio

14.3.1 First Letter

This is the first of **Rene Guenon's** letters to **Guido de Giorgio**. It shows how things were done prior to Internet blogs and e-mail. The letters were written in French; Guenon was not fluent enough in Italian to write in that language. The criticism of Evola is pretty severe, but Evola was about 27 years old at the time and just transitioning to Guenon style Tradition after several years

studying German philosophy. I have left out the salutations and the flowery, but affectionate, closings common at that time

Paris, 20 November 1925

I was beginning to get a little nervous since I hadn't received anything from you since your postcard in July, and, fearing that you were still suffering, I thought to write you some words to ask you for some news, when your letter reached me. Since then, I put off writing to you from one day to the next, because I was always very busy since my return here, so that it is I who, in turn, am late answering you. I address this letter to you to Varazze where, I think you told me, you must be settled for some time already.

Thanks for the good idea that you had to invite me to go to meet up with you; however, unfortunately, trips are quite costly at the moment; I hope all the same that we will end up meeting some other day.

What you say about Vulliaud's Kabbalah is quite correct, although perhaps a little severe; basically, it is pretty much what I wrote myself in a more attenuated form. I spoke of that work with different persons who had read it; their assessments agree with ours and are even less enthusiastic. I didn't have a chance to read Vulliaud's new book on the "Song of Songs", which appeared three or four months ago; it seems to contain fewer discussions and critiques than the Kabbalah, but still too much.

Thanks for the issue of *Bilychnis* that you sent me; since then, I received from Evola himself a full packet of other reviews containing some of his articles. In acknowledging its reception, I told him that I had several reservations to make on his point of view which seemed to me overly philosophic. He wrote me a rather long and confused letter in which he protested that the philosophical form which he used is for him only a simple means of exposition which does not affect his doctrine itself. I believe none of it, and I persist in thinking that he is really too imbued with philosophy, and especially German philosophy. In an article published by the review *Ultra*, he alluded to me in a note, in regards to East

and West, in terms that prove that he did not understand very much of what I explained; he even went so far as to describe me as a “rationalist”, which is really ridiculous (all the more so since it concerns a book where I expressly asserted the falsity of rationalism!), and that shows clearly that he is one of those who cannot get rid of philosophical labels and who feel the need to apply them wrongly and haphazardly. He told me his intention to write an article on Man and his becoming; I ask myself what that could possibly be; we will certainly see at some point.

Since we are still on Evola, it is still necessary that I tell you that he was hurt by Reghini’s criticisms, however, in a very moderate way. He must be rather vain and would like to have nothing but praise; it is true that he is very young. Vulliaud, who doesn’t have the same excuse, is almost as susceptible; it appears that he also was rather unhappy with my article; he imagines that only he knows the Kabbalah and is capable of speaking about it. It is to be feared that Evola is soon doing as much for the Tantras, of which he is, however, not very qualified to be dealing with them; he sees all that through his philosophy, from where a type of deformation in the German manner; the true conception of Shakti is a completely different thing from “voluntarism”.

I am happy that you are very interested by the articles of Gnose; the inferiority of the first issues come from the time when I had only a nominal direction; I even had some trouble subsequently clearing out some troublesome people; it would be too long to tell you in detail.

What is that recent book which contains some fragments from the Zohar from Jean de Pauly’s translation? I didn’t hear anything about it.

I finally made Massignon’s acquaintance; he talks a lot, and there is in him a certain affectation, which otherwise is revealed also in his style. It is true that his works are rather difficult to read, and on the other hand, if he has assuredly understood certain things, he has not however penetrated the heart of Muslim esoterism. As for Carra de Vaus, he understands still less, and even from the point of view of exoterism, he ends up committing

some gross errors; he is above all a compiler, and the principal utility of his works consists in what in them is brought together of the teachings which are found scattered a little everywhere.

For the Vedanta, up to now, there have not yet been any reviews in the journals; that will always require some time, and furthermore there have been the holidays. Nothing from Masson-Oursel; I don't know if he will speak about it nor what he will say, but I will be quite astonished if it would be better that what he wrote for my earlier book. There were some notes in the journals; I am attaching to this letter copies of the principle ones; you will see that they are not bad. Last month, there was also a long article about me, by Gonzague Truc, in "Candide"; I currently have a single copy; but I will try to get another one to send you.

Don't delay too long this time in sending back to me news about you.

Posted on 2012-06-18 by Cologero

* * *

Audrey on 2012-09-17 at 21:15 said:

You mean there was a time with no internet blogs and e-mail?

Saladin on 2013-02-14 at 21:22 said:

I liked the jab at Massignou but was quite uncomfortable reading his views on Evola. I think later on his impression of Evola somehow improved.

14.3.2 Second Letter

In this letter, **Rene Guenon** chit chats about some of their reading material. He also quotes a long passage from one of **Julius Evola's** essays in which Evola again accused Guenon of rationalism, at least by his own definition. Evola insists the principle of the absolute is Power, or Shakti. It is curious that Evola exalts the

feminine element above the masculine. Guenon seems annoyed about what he regards as a misunderstanding. Evola also distances himself from Guenon by praising science as the consequence of self-assertion.

Paris, 26 January 1926

Dear Sir,

I believe I am getting later and later with my correspondence; I would have rather liked to give you my wishes for better health since, after you told me in your last letter, you were still suffering.

I am happy that you were satisfied with reading about **Milarepa**; besides, the contrary would have certainly astonished me. In the same collection, there is another of Bacot's translations: *Three mysterious Tibetans*: that is also good, but these are texts of a somewhat literary character, therefore of much less interest for us.

I suppose that P. Huc's book that you told me about is the republication which was recently made about his travels in Tibet and China; it contains nothing about doctrines; there are in it some curious descriptions, but that is all.

Boehme's work which was translated into Italian must be *De signature rerum*: it seems to me that the meaning of the title was not made very exactly. As to Campanella's book, I am not familiar with it; I have only read a review in the last issues of "Ignis". The fragments of the Zohar published by Rieder are in effect only extracts from Jean de Pauly's translation; I haven't seen them, but I hear that they were rather well chosen.

As to Mead, his books are so impregnated with Theosophy that I strongly doubt that anything good can be pulled from them.

As for Theosophy, do you know that the solemn proclamation of the new Messiah (Krishnamurti) has to take place very soon with an extraordinary mise en scene? None of that can be taken seriously.

You ask me about the journal "Ultra"; it defines itself as "independent theosophical", that is, it is the organ of a group which has separated from Annie Besant's Theosophical Society. Here is the copy of Evola's note which appeared in that review (in an article titled *The Problem of the East and West*), which is about me.

It is clear here that we speak of the East and the West as two ideal types which, if they belong to the general character of the two cultures, cannot belong to their details. Presently, for example, currents like intuitionism, actual idealism, irrationalism are as a general rule justifiable by the principle of *eros*. We must on the contrary have reservations about pragmatism. Consequently, we can't agree with the thesis held by Rene Guenon (*East and West*), that "scientism" and sensual life are the hidden elements connecting them together.

It is correct that western science is used for practical ends. But it is not necessary to confuse the two things: without simple desires and needs which would have remained such, scientific comprehension of nature would not have advanced one step. The accomplishment of science is linked in fact, as we have already noted, to a first manifestation of the positive principle of domination and assertion of the Self—which constitutes a *metaphysical value*. What was made possible by such a principle superior in itself both to the life of needs and to the sentiment that 'pure intellectuality' which Guenon, as the good rationalist that he is, has as a superstition—whether it was utilized by elements which are alien to it, is a totally different question. In itself it remains a value that confers on western culture its significance and originality. We assert with Guenon that the principle of the absolute has nothing to do with the sentimental, moralist, and abstractly rational element; but we assert against Guenon that it has nothing to do with that "pure intellectually" or 'metaphysic' that he speaks about, and, emphatically, we *know* what it is. It is for that reason precisely that

we dispute, from a higher point of view, that such ‘metaphysic’ can be distinguished from the rational as it was defined by Hegel, for example *Venunft* opposed to *Verstand*. And we assert therefore that the *principle of the absolute is power (Shakti)* and whatever system that in the metaphysical order puts something before or above power is rationalistic (in the pejorative sense used by Guenon) and abstract.

Evola does not lack any pretensions as you can see; but, for my part, I still think that he doesn’t understand at all what we mean by “intellectuality”, “knowledge”, “contemplation”, etc., and he can’t even make the distinction between the “initiatric” and “profane” points of view. It appears that he intends to publish a review of my work on the Vedanta in the journal *L’Idealismo Realistico*; we will see what that will be like. In any case, in spite of everything that we tried to explain to him, he persists in finding “rationalism” in the Vedanta, all while being compelled to recognize that he then takes the word “rationalism” in a rather different sense from what is usually meant by it.

You must have seen that the publication of *Ignis* was interrupted; Reghini could no longer manage to do it all on his own or pretty much so, or it was clearly necessary that he had to be concerned only with that, which is not possible for him with the conditions of current life. There are certainly people who had promised to help him, but who have done nothing; it is often that way, unfortunately. I think that you would have seen, in the last issue, my article on **Joseph de Maistre**, concerning the books of Emile Dermenghem¹¹.

I am going to send you the issue of *Candide* containing the article about me which I told you about in my preceding letter. Apart from that, I don’t have much of anything new to tell you; the reviews in the journals are a long time coming; and then it must be that people feel some

¹¹<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Aissawa>

difficulty speaking of my last book. When I have something which will be worth the trouble, I will tell you.

What you say about the conception of Dharma among the Jains seems to me correct, and I don't believe anymore that we can find an essential difference with orthodox doctrine in it. On the contrary, the meaning they give the words *loka* and *aloka* is rather particular; it seems to be quite exact to translate the first, in this case, by the "world of forms" as you do.

As to *sphota*¹², it is a conception typical of certain grammarians, and whose discussion which you allude to shows its uselessness. Naturally, the point of view of the grammarians can only be exterior and analytic; it relates uniquely to the form of the word, in as much as this is constituted by the assemblage of certain phonetic elements; the word is not taken there in itself and synthetically. It is well that there is something artificial in the point of view which necessitates the intervention of the *sphota*; you are therefore completely correct. It is also certain that this discussion has much more importance than one could believe when envisaged superficially; but it is not to the current philologists that we can hope make that understood; everything that concerns the true nature of the language eludes them entirely.

Last month I lectured on Oriental metaphysics¹³ to a study group which meets at the Sorbonne; I will send it to you when it is published. Before me, Masson-Oursel had made two; he said some implausible things there, and he presented a veritable caricature of Hindu doctrines; if that interests you, I could give you some examples the next time I write you.

Posted on 2012-07-09 by Cologero

* * *

¹²<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Spho%E1%B9%ADa>

¹³<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/OrientalMetaphysics.pdf>

Avery on 2012-07-09 at 08:27 said:

I wonder what Guenon thought when the World-Teacher Krishnamurti turned out to be a genius teacher... mired in powerless existentialism.

<http://www.kinfonet.org/krishnamurti/excerpts/11/parts>

Cologero on 2012-07-09 at 12:16 said:

I don't recall that Guenon ever wrote anything about the mature Krishnamurti. Perhaps, because Krishnamurti did not achieve any influence until years later (than the 1920s). I doubt, in any case, that Guenon would have approved of Krishnamurti due to his rejection of traditional forms.

14.3.3 Third Letter

Looking back from 1949 to 1927, I wonder about some things. De Giorgio and Guenon often complain about health problems. In this case, there is no implication that De Giorgio's illness is the result of sorcery. Actually, Guenon brings up that topic only after having relocated to Cairo. Something was going on with him that he never made clear.

Another point is that Guenon always apologizes for being "busy". Does anyone else wonder about that? I'm sure he was doing a lot of research, working on his books, raising a family, etc.

Once again, the topic of a Western initiatic group comes up. There is no mention of that mysterious group of twelve. Perhaps Guenon discovered them subsequent to 1927.

My comments are inside footnotes.

Paris, 12 June, 1927

What must you be thinking of my silence? I am truly sorry for leaving your last letter without a response, and I blame myself so much more since you have not been feeling well. I want to think that your health will improve before long.

I went to the Bosse bookstore right away as you requested; they couldn't tell me if your money order had arrived, because it appears that that they had failed to do the research. Nevertheless, they tell me that you needn't worry about it and they will issue a refund.

The Italian translation of the King of the World has appeared; I recently received it. I don't know if you know M. Hackin¹⁴; we spoke of you last time that I saw him. He also sent me Stcherbatsky's¹⁵ book, but until now, I never had time to read it. It has been a long time since that translation was made.

I saw Masson-Oursel¹⁶ some time ago; he told me that he has been coming closer and closer to my point of view and that he took account that the orientalist had certainly committed many errors. After all that he has written up until now, I was somewhat surprised by this declaration. I ask myself if he will have the courage to say that publicly someday. He is truly too indecisive and fears being jeopardized by clear-cut affirmations.

Did you ever receive a response from **Tahar Kheireddine**?¹⁷

Here is the explanation that you had asked me on the subject of Avalokitesvara. This name literally means "the Lord (Ishwara) seen from below"; but, in spite of the use of the past participle *lokita*, it is most often interpreted as if it meant "the Lord looking down". In reality, these two interpretations, far from being contradictory or excluding each other, complement each other perfectly, because there is somehow a reciprocity

¹⁴Specialist in Oriental art.

¹⁵https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fyodor_Shcherbatskoy. Probably Stcherbatsky's *The Conception of Buddhist Nirvana*, published in 1927. Guenon took little interest in Buddhism, as this comment shows. However, note below re Avalokitesvara.

¹⁶Masson-Oursel was a positivist in the Comtean tradition. To adopt Guenon's perspective would indeed have been quite a conversion, and its public revelation undoubtedly would have destroyed his reputation.

¹⁷A sheik greatly respected by Guido de Giorgio, and who apparently initiated him into Sufism in Tunisia.

of relationship.

One could speak in this regard to a longing from the lower to the higher, prompting the descent of spiritual influences. It is that descent that represents the symbolism of Avalokitesvara; it is that which can be called "Cosmic Love" (certain Muslim schools also use an expression with that meaning), while employing, of course, this word "love" outside of every sentimental meaning of the word. One of the most used symbols, and which is found again almost everywhere, is the triangle whose apex is pointing down. The comparison which was sometimes made of Avalokitesvara to a feminine principle is also in connection with the same idea and the same symbolism: in India, the inverted or descending triangle is one of the signs of the Shakti.

The Rex Nemorensis which you speak to me about must be the same person who is often called the "priest of Nemi" (I believe that Renan wrote something under that title [true]). I know that there exists a lake of Nemi, but I don't know exactly in what region of Italy it is found. In any case, it is Nemi which is the current name of the locality; but at its origin, that could not be a proper name, because it is simply the Latin word *nemus*, which means "woods", and especially "sacred woods". This word is closely related to the Celtic *nemeton*, and also, by inversion to the Greek *temenos*, which means some "consecrated place". The roots of these words, like those of *templum* and *sacratum* express principally the idea of putting apart, of separating from the profane world.

I haven't had the chance to see Mardrus' translations but based on what I know of him, I mistrust him a little; furthermore, I don't believe that the Koran is truly translatable.¹⁸

Evola always sends me his journal; he would really like me to give him an article, but I have hardly any time for it. There are things in it of

¹⁸The translation was commissioned by the French government. In general, any translation of the Koran is considered an "interpretation" at best. The mistrust probably arises from Mardrus' less than faithful translation of *1001 Nights*.

rather uneven interest, yet there is much less of “philosophy” than I had feared. Moreover, Evola wrote me that he would soon leave aside that “philosophical” form that he had adopted up until this point. I can only applaud that intention, but I fear the influence he underwent will persist in spite of everything, although he defends himself and claims to have had special reasons to adopt this language and mode of exposition.

Everything you tell me on the subject of magic is completely right; it seems that Evola takes this word in a somewhat different sense from what it normally has, and the way he employs it has some drawbacks. In the proper meaning of the word, it is, after all, only a science of the experiential order. It can in effect serve as the point of departure for something else, but that is true of all traditional sciences, such as they are, and I would even say willingly that they are especially made for that. Only the sciences conceived in the modern Western way can lead to nothing else and which are constituted in a way that do not permit the passage to knowledge of a higher order.

As for what Evola wrote you, I agree with him that there used to exist a Western initiatic tradition; but, unfortunately, I strongly doubt that it can be considered as still currently living. I certainly encounter, from time to time, the assertion of the existence of spiritual centres in this or that region of Europe, but, up until now, I have had no proof that that assertion is justifiable.

Posted on 2012-08-27 by Cologero

14.3.4 Fifth letter

In this letter from **Rene Guenon** to **Guido de Giorgio**, we learn:

- Guenon was ignorant of Buddhism, specifically *Vajrayana*¹⁹.

¹⁹<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Vajrayana>

- Initiation is connected to the Kali Yuga.
- **Dante**'s symbolism is equivalent to Eastern symbolism. This explains some observations:
 - Westerners who don't understand Dante are unlikely to understand Eastern religions.
 - Modern scholars are unlikely to understand Dante.
- Hermetic symbolism is close to Oriental symbolism.
- Historic facts have a symbolic value completely different from what they have in themselves.
- Guenon believes Evola is intelligent but his prejudices often prevent him from seeing things truly.

Blois, 15 August, 1927

I am sorry to see from your last letter that your health is still far from being good; I hope however it will improve. Unfortunately, the weather is very bad since we have been here: storms, gales, almost continual rain; it is truly not summer weather. However, here, it typically gets much better, and the sky is not at all the same as in the region of Paris, but this year, the sun is almost always absent. There are neither mountains nor hills, at most some vineyards; but there are forests very close to Blois, and we can go for a number of hikes nearby. This is, I believe, the information that you asked me about; in any case, if you decide to come, don't do it before the first days of September because we are going to be away. I would be very happy to have the chance to finally get acquainted with you, if your health permits you at that time to make the trip without tiring yourself.

Vajra is a thunderbolt, but I must warn you that I myself would be currently at pains to say exactly what *Vajrayana* is. I will have to research that on my return to Paris, not having here the necessary information.

I totally agree with your opinion about the current state of humanity in relation to the Kali Yuga. Moreover, it is what I explain in the book

that I just completed²⁰. Moreover, it is quite certain that “initiation” is understood only by the special conditions of the Kali Yuga, outside of which it would not have its *raison d’être*. It is not less true that it is necessary, in fact, to take these conditions into consideration. That is why, while being perfectly in agreement with you in principle, I must however maintain everything that I said about the role of the elite. This role, moreover, is not at all typical of traditions in their religious form. The example of Taoism is a sufficient proof of it, and the same thing is found everywhere, although sometimes in a way less defined (in India, for example). Since the Kali Yuga, “initiation” exists in the East as well as it used to exist in the West; there it is as a necessity of fact.

Likewise for symbolism: the use of symbols comparable to Hermetic symbols is also totally general, and these symbols are not opposed at all to natural symbols, but, on the contrary, they are connected very normally. Furthermore, the symbolic character of all manifestation permits us to give to historic facts, as well as to all the rest, a value completely different from what they have in themselves. As for what you say about Dante; his symbolism is, if you wish, Western in its exterior form, but it is totally equivalent to Oriental symbolism. Moreover, there arose a true opposition between the East and the West only when the West lost its tradition, including the meaning of symbolism. Hermetism is much closer to the Oriental spirit than to the modern Western spirit. Perhaps we will soon have the opportunity to talk about all of this in more depth.

I received a letter from Evola yesterday, who still insists that I send him something for Ur. I surely believe that I would have to end things by deciding to give him satisfaction. He tells me that he had published the first volume of his *Theory of the Absolute Individual*, but that he didn’t send it to me because of its overly philosophical character, and that he thinks his *Pagan Imperialism*²¹, which is due to appear in the autumn,

²⁰From the date of the letter, this must be *The Crisis of the Modern World*.

²¹<https://www.amazon.com/Pagan-Imperialism-Julius-Evola/dp/0999>

will be liable to interest me more. It is in the same vein of the book I just wrote; I suppose that it is you who spoke to him about it, because I never wrote to anyone else in Italy since I began to prepare it. That is of no importance, since I have already announced it to many other people. I expedited the manuscript to the publisher last week. I am not sorry that this has been completed because until that point, I was unable to take any rest.

It is not Evola, but Reghini, who told me that his attitude toward Catholicism had changed recently. I believe that I explained myself poorly in my last letter, or that perhaps I wrote one name for the other due to a distraction. It is moreover possible, according to what you say, that the same thing is true for both of them. In any case, if you can have any influence on Evola, that would be very felicitous. I believe him to be intelligent, but filled with prejudices of all types. I also think he aspires to a university position and that also can hinder him from many points of view.

Posted on 2012-09-10 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-09-11 at 01:09 said:

"I also think he aspires to a university position and that also can hinder him from many points of view."

I don't know if that guess is correct, but the warning about the limiting nature of the academic mindset is very real. I wonder how Guenon came to this conclusion about Evola.

Jason-Adam on 2012-09-11 at 01:35 said:

The remark Guenon made about opposition between East & West only being a conflict modernity vs Tradition is one to be meditated on. Guenon believes that all traditional civilisations are similar. But do they still conflict with each other ? traditional Catholic Europe contended with traditional Islam. So is it possible there can be a conflict between East & West even when

both are Traditional ? Evola certainly saw the west and east as being different (actions vs contemplation) which Guenon disagreed with.

Mihai on 2012-09-11 at 09:37 said:

They are similar in essence, but different in form.

So even though they may have "internal" unity, the "external" differences still exist on their own level, sometimes having the aspect of an apparent opposition. It is very normal for different civilizations and traditions to be opposed one another, as different persons are opposed one another, otherwise there would be no history and no manifestation.

The symbolism of chess may help here. Even though both armies are, in essence, similar, in order to exist a game they need to be opposed one another.

14.3.5 Sixth letter

This letter was written shortly after **Guido de Giorgio's** visit to **Rene Guenon** in Blois.

Curiously, the sniping against the young Evola continues. Notice that Guenon treats de Giorgio as a peer while in his letters to Evola, he is always lecturing. Guenon indicates he and de Giorgio are totally in accord regarding their understanding of Tradition. Knowing this, it is clearly a mistake to ignore our translations of de Giorgio and *a fortiori* to ignorantly criticize them as some have.

The Tunisian tariqa of Sheik Ahmad al-Alawi has great significance for Tradition. Besides de Giorgio, Frithjof Schuon was also initiated there. Guenon himself, as this letter shows, was also in communication with that tariqa.

Note, too, that Guenon contributed to the Catholic periodical *Regnabit* for two years; these articles eventually were included in his *Symbols of Sacred Science*. Unfortunately, he was forced out by the circle around Jacques Maritain, with whom Guenon had previously engaged in discussions. That has had deleterious consequences for the recovery of Tradition in the West.

Paris, 1 November 1927

We had learned with pleasure, from your card sent on your arrival at Varazze, that your return trip went quite well; but following your letter, which reached us before our departure from Blois, brought us unfortunately much less good news. However, as you don't speak again of your health in your last letter, we like to believe that it has now been restored.

In spite of everything that I know of Evola, especially from you, I was a little surprised by his refusal to use your article²². I ask myself, under these conditions, why he is so insistent that I send him something, because he must certainly think what I would write would also be totally traditional, and consequently, would not satisfy him at all. I see that obviously there is nothing to do with him; also, I am going to write him very gladly in the way that you ask me, all the more reason so that will cut short (at least I think so) a new insistence of his part and will give me a decisive reason to not collaborate in his journal. Besides, I owe him a response, having received from him, about a month ago, a letter in which he asked me for some information on a point which I believe that he had already spoken to you about. I am going to enclose my letter with this one, while asking you to then send it to him from there. I apologize for being unable to stamp it, not having any Italian stamps at my disposal.

I would be happy to read your article if Evola returned it to you and if you want to send it to me; but I am sure in advance that I would be completely in accord with you.

What is the Latin text for which Reghini's translation seems doubtful to you?

I am curious to know what Evola might say about Milarepa; he will certainly be scandalized by the totally inferior place that is given to magic, however well it suits him in reality.

I do not know at all Ashtavakra's poem²³ that you mention. If you

²²For Ur.

²³Ashtavakra Gita

would like, as you tell me, to send me the translation that you have, although it is rather an adaptation, that will interest me and will give me at least an idea of what the poem is about.

Here is the address you asked about:²⁴

The booklet that [Gustave-Henri] Jossot sent me hardly contains anything of interest except the summary of some interviews with Kheiredine and an outline on the doctrine of the Alouites to which he is now associated as I told you. It seems that this brotherhood has been expanding; I just learned that it has a zawiya²⁵ in Paris, on Blvd St Germain, close to here. That makes me fear that it may become too open and deviate just like so many others. It also appears that it is working, in Algeria, to promote a rapprochement between Christians and Muslims, which is definitely very laudable, but will these efforts lead to an appreciable result?

The journal *Parise* alluded to is *Regnabit*. I actually collaborated in it regularly from August 1925 until May 1927, and I had always forgotten to tell you about it. But see how history is told: this journal is as little directed by the Jesuits as they did everything they could to prevent it from appearing. Moreover, I had to end this collaboration following certain machinations which had their origins in [Jacques] Maritain's entourage. It would take too long to tell you about it and moreover rather less interesting *au fond*. I intend to take up again someday the questions of symbolism that I had begun to treat in that journal in order to create a book out of it; but when will I get to it?

I finished correcting the proofs of the *Crisis of the Modern World*. I think that it will appear around mid-November.

Posted on 2012-09-17 by Cologero

²⁴G. provides the Tunisian address of Eugene Taillard, who was affiliated with the tariqa of Sheik Ahmad al-Alawi.

²⁵Islamic religious school.

* * *

Graham on 2012-09-17 at 21:49 said:

"... without forgetting the little piece of perfectly gratuitous sarcasm ..."

His opinion of Evola has been consistent low over the course of this correspondence. But this was during the 20s. Do we know if it changed during the 30s and 40s, and if so, for what reason, or reasons?

Cologero on 2012-09-17 at 22:23 said:

We have documented much of this already. Guenon gave a generally positive review of "Revolt against the modern World" after its publication. After the 1920s, there was limited contact between Evola and Guenon aside from exchanging books or articles. Evola translated Guenon's works in the 30s. Correspondence resumed after Evola's recuperation; we have made several of those letters available. Again, there was some disagreement between them, but relations were cordial.

14.3.6 Eighth Letter

This letter was written by **Rene Guenon** to **Guido de Giorgio** shortly after the death of Guenon's wife. After some personal reflections, Guenon returns to some of the common themes in earlier letters: the Sufis in Tunisia, the *Ashtavakra Gita*, and, of course, some gossip about **Julius Evola**. We see the mutual interest of the two men in **Dante**. We also see that Guenon and de Giorgio were in complete agreements on esoteric topics, even without consulting with each other before hand. This, I hope, demonstrates to everyone the importance of understanding sound principles; once so understood, the rest just follows. As Guenon suggests, "it is not the result of chance." Obviously, he would have no sympathy for the "Infinite Monkey Theorem."

The book that Guenon referred to is most likely *Crisis in the Modern World*, which had just been published in 1927.

Blois, 6 April 1928

I am embarrassed to be so late with you; I had wanted to thank you again sooner for the expression of sympathy that you gave me in these sad circumstances, but I didn't have the energy to write to anyone for a long time. Your last letter arrived in Paris, and I had wanted to respond right away, but I couldn't find even a few minutes, all my time was taken by lessons and other less interesting, although necessary, tasks. I'm benefitting from the few days that we spent here to finally write to you; we were obliged to come to Blois on business, otherwise, we would probably not have decided to leave Paris at this time.

I was going to thank you for your parcel that I received with great pleasure when the misfortune happened, and that in the most sudden and least expected way: a few days of illness at most, but an illness against which they can do nothing, cerebral-spinal meningitis. There was then a veritable epidemic in Paris: some people were taken in a few hours! Since then, my health hasn't been very good, and there is nothing astonishing about that after such a hard blow. However, I needed to take up again almost right away some forced tasks, but there is a little else that I was able to do up until now.

We will return to Paris at the end of next week, that is, the 13th or 14th of April; perhaps it would be better for you to wait until then to send me Taillard's letter which you told me about and which will surely interest me. On my return to Paris, I will have to look again for the summary of the doctrine of the Alawis that he translated, in order to send you a copy of it as I had promised you.

All the same, one of these days I will have to write to Evola whose several letters I have always left without response. As of now, I have not received his *Pagan Imperialism*, although he told me that he would send it to me some time ago. Perhaps he will do it after I write him. In any case, if I receive nothing, I will tell you, and then you will be able to lend me your copy as you suggested.

I was able to read the *Ashtavakra Gita* a little quickly; it seems quite

good to me. Even in this adaptation which is surely imperfect (all the more so that the preface, as I remember, does not show much comprehension by its author); I will have to resume it again more attentively when I have a little free time.

I received the first number of the second year of *Ur*; has another one appeared since? I did not notice, on the whole, a very big change from the first year, except that those histories of the "magical chain" seem to take on more and more importance, and also the "Science of the I" disappeared from the title. Is it the "psychological" interpretation which I had told you about that influenced Evola to suppress that expression, which he nevertheless seemed to be attached to? I considered all the reflections that you made in one of your letters from the beginning of January to be spot on, regarding the subject of the preceding issue. When I write to Evola, you can be sure that I would take account of what you said to me then, for I am convinced that you are totally correct.

Were you able to see the new work on Dante that you had spoken to me about? If yes, you will be quite kind, some time, to tell me a little about what it is and of what type of symbolism is in it.

I carried out, some time ago, the favour which you asked me to do for Bossard; I was going to forget to tell you and to send you the note, postmarked on the payment date.

I was happy to see that you are completely in agreement with everything that I wrote in my last book²⁶; furthermore, the contrary would have really astonished me. The coincidences that you pointed out to me with the things that you yourself had written earlier are actually very remarkable; these agreements are certainly not the result of chance (besides which, I don't believe at all).

I hope that I will have one day the time to take up all your recent letters and respond at least to the most important of the diverse questions that you pose.

²⁶Most likely *Crisis in the Modern World*, published in 1927.

I have at this moment a very disagreeable task: it is the correction of the English translation of *Man and his Becoming*; that translation was horribly done, there are some mistranslations on every page. Furthermore, instead of sending me the manuscript as I had counted on, they typeset it and only sent me the proofs, with the result that the editors were very unhappy when I wrote them that there were many changes to make; that is nevertheless not my fault if they did something silly.

I like to believe that your health is not too bad now and that you haven't had another attack since your last letter.

Posted on 2012-10-08 by Cologero

* * *

Cologero on 2012-10-09 at 12:28 said:

An accessible rendition of the Ashtavakra Gita is "A Duet of One" by Ramesh S. Balsekar, a follower of Nisargadatta. His commentary is antinomian, even somewhat Spinozist.

14.4 From Evola to Eliade

14.5 Letters from Evola to Eliade (II)

Julius Evola was reestablishing his relationship with **Mircea Eliade** after the war and his own health and legal problems. It is clear that Evola had been keeping up with Eliade's published works. Knowing Eliade's true interests and background, Evola questions Eliade's failure to quote Rene Guenon, and, by implication, his own work. Beside the obvious desire to avoid professional suicide, Eliade intended his works to be scientific, in the objective sense of being free of political or religious partisanship. It is curious that Evola had never read Georges Dumezil before and it seems to have had little influence on his later work. That is unfortunate.

15 Dec 1951

Enough time has passed since I received your last letter and our relation was reestablished after the war. In this period I often heard talk about you and your activity. Naturally I read, with interest, the works that you courteously sent me and I did not miss notifying my friends who could be interested in them and probably they have also written to you.

Recently a newly revised and expanded edition of my *Revolt against the Modern World* appeared and I think it was mentioned in it your *Treatise on the History of Religions*²⁷. But about this, and I say it a little tongue in cheek, one should employ some *Vergeltungen*²⁸. The fact is striking that your works are so overly concerned to not mention any author who does not strictly belong to the official university literature; in your works, e.g., that lovable good man Pettazzoni²⁹ is abundantly cited, while not a single word is found about Guenon, and not even other authors whose ideas are much closer to those that permit you to certainly orient yourself in the material that you write about. It stands to reason that this is something that concerns only you, but it would be the chance to ask yourself if, all things considered, if imposing these “academic” limitations is a game that is worth the candle. I hope that you will not resent these friendly observations.

I’ve been told that some difficulties arose for Einaudi³⁰ about your translations due to a ridiculous communist veto. Is it true? If so, will these translations be sold again? (I believe they are the *Treatise* and *Yoga*.) It is possible that in this case I can be useful, even if you are already arranging with sufficiently effective relations, like those around Giuseppe Tucci and over Pettazzoni’s objection.

²⁷Not true.

²⁸Revenge.

²⁹Italian professor of religion.

³⁰The Italian publisher.

As far as it concerns me, in your letter of last year you were so kind to give me the address of a man of your acquaintance, who, you said, could be useful for marketing the French translations of my books. To tell the truth, I wrote him once, but without receiving a response. Now I would like to make other attempts for the same goal. While some relations were already able to be established with other countries, for France still nothing; Mr. Gallimard had taken himself the initiative to ask Laterza for the rights for two of my books after the war, but I have not heard anything more from him since. I permit myself to ask you, dear sir, if you could and would give me some advice in this regard. I would value especially the translation of *Revolt* which was already accepted by De Noel), and I wondered if the same publisher of your *Treatise* could be interested in it. Possibly you could introduce me to Mr. Dumézil, who is one of your friends and must exercise an important role with this publisher. Moreover, I now intend to learn more about the work of this author, whom I have read little, because I've been told that he made some interesting contributions to a line of research in which I myself am particularly interested (warrior initiation).

I've also been told that one of your new books, on Shamanism, was just published; if the publisher is still distributing some samples via post, perhaps you will have the courtesy to provide them with my address. Where is your work on sacred orgies found? I have been gathering some material for an essay on sex magic.

I have returned to Rome for good³¹ at my old address. Should you ever come to Italy, I hope that we will be able to meet each other here.

Posted on 2012-12-17 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-12-18 at 18:25 said:

³¹After his convalescence and brief imprisonment.

Guenon has some amusing things to say about the “academic” in *Traditional Forms & Cosmic Cycles*. Unfortunately he does not explicitly explain the main problem with modern humanities studies: writers obsess over making their subject a product of their circumstances, and refuse to admit the influence of anything that could stand above history. In order to fit into that model, Eliade thus made a devilish parody of the Traditionalist thesis, castrating the work of Guenon and Evola by turning it into a psychiatric complex.

Mihai on 2012-12-19 at 04:17 said:

Actually, Eliade stood his position quite well inside the academic community, to the extent that he could be considered a trojan horse. Though he never directly admitted a supra-human origin of Tradition (obviously), he did quite a nice job in proving that religion is irreducible to factors such as sociology and psychology- see the opening part of his *Traité d'histoire des religions*.

His work suffered an obvious decline in quality after he became involved with the University of Chicago, but his works published until then offer a great many insights and introductory keys of understanding to various traditional cosmologies, symbols and rites.

The depth of his work is, of course, limited because of the academical environment, but it is no “devilish parody”

Mihai on 2012-12-19 at 04:18 said:

By the way, Guenon's review from TFACC is by no means negative (though, true, it isn't very enthusiastic either).

Ea Lord of the Deeps on 2013-09-29 at 19:35 said:

Evola actually read and used Dumezil original thesis source is in this book: <http://edicionesnuevarepublica.wordpress.com/2013/09/29/misterio-hiperboreo-escritos-sobre-los-indoeuropeos-1934-1970%C2%BB/>

14.5.1 Third Letter

This letter was written at the end of 1951, the year of Guenon's death. It is clear that the several letters between Evola and Guenon in the preceding months had changed little in the disagreements between them.

At the beginning of the letter, Evola is referring to Eliade's response to Evola's previous question about Eliade's lack of refer-

ences to Evola or Guenon in his books. At his post at the Sorbonne, Eliade seems to be hiding his past association with esotericism and right wing movements. Evola is concerned about the negative psychic forces in this choice, but assumes Eliade is still involved in some groups that would prevent that. In contrast, Evola was invited to teach courses on race at two Italian universities, although Evola did not like academic life. If Eliade was truly acting as a Trojan horse to inject certain ideas into Academia, its effects have been nil.

After 25 years, we see Evola is still attached to his system of Absolute Idealism. That system is not fully compatible with Guenon's metaphysical system derived from the Vedanta and other Traditional sources. Those differences affect their respective worldviews in significant ways. Both Evola and Guenon want to "move beyond" philosophy; for Guenon, that means the Intellect, but for Evola, that is the Will. I should remind readers that 20 years earlier, the young Eliade had written an unpublished commentary on Evola's philosophical system of Absolute Idealism.

Evola's closing to the letter is interesting and out of character. Perhaps it was related to the time of year the letter was written ... the Unconquered Sun was celebrated on Christmas Day.

31 Dec 1951

Many thanks for your courteous letter and thanks also for having arranged the sending of your new book [*Shamanism*], that I will read with particular interest. Then I will tell you what are the possibilities at Laterza [a publisher]; it stands to reason that I will do my best to be useful.

Regarding your clarifications about your relations with academic "masonry", I find them somewhat satisfactory. It would therefore be less a question about methodology than pure tactic, and there would be nothing to say against the attempt to introduce any Trojan horse into the

university citadel. The important thing would be to not let yourself take part, in any way, in a deception, because a sort of “psychic current” meets in academic circles, with the possibility of a subtle deforming and contaminating influence. But I think that, both as the interior foundation, and through your probable relations with circles qualified in a different way, you can defend yourself from this danger.

As to “methodology”, you well know that I seek to follow a middle way since, differently from most “esoterists”, I am also concerned to produce research satisfactory from the “scientific” point of view. What you undertake in the fields of the science of religions and mythology, I undertook many years ago, but in the field of academic philosophy that was then absolute idealism. The direction was the same: to show that the most important problems of this philosophy cannot be resolved, if it does not go beyond “philosophy” *tout court*. But after this contribution, expressed in three books (I recently revised one, the *Theory of the Absolute Individual*, and I think it useful for have it republished as an account of it), I had enough of it. I don’t know the environment of the Sorbonne. As it concerns Italy, at least until recently it was not necessary to disguise oneself too much, since I myself had received the assignment to teach some courses in the universities of Milan and Florence. But my conclusion was that the game is not worth the candle; and the repulsion for the types and the cabals of the university world is for me physiological.

Since you mention Mr. Guenon in particular, I think that a useful action would consist in developing certain aspects of his doctrine that suffer from a fundamentally arbitrary dogmatism since, all things considered, the mixing of traditional data with individual points of view was inevitable even in his case. So much more in France, but also in Italy, groups were formed that follow the master as though the “head of the class”, redoubling the dogmatic certainty and claiming to be the only ones to administer “orthodoxy”; that thing is somewhat tiresome and can only be harmful to what is best in Guenon.

I am very obligated to you for your intention to help me get some of my books published in French. With Gallimard and De Noel the thing is only interrupted; as for the latter publisher, the person who mediated and had already begun the translation of *Revolt* has vanished. Regarding the former, after the attempt he made at Leterza, no one any longer knows what happened and although I had written myself, they gave no response. In any case, I think that Payot has some book series in which the two books you mention (*Revolt against the Modern World* and *Doctrine of Awakening*) would fit in rather well, since they would be among the works that are certainly no more “scientific” than mine. The important thing is that they do not encounter prejudices of principle; these, moreover, could be reduced through the fact that the German and English translations appeared in very “respectable” publishers. In any case, I think that the best thing is to wait for your return to Paris, before making any attempts and before I send the books. Consequently, I ask you to write me a few words when you return to Paris.

It pleases me to learn that you will come again to Italy. Since I would not want to lose the opportunity for a meeting, I ask you to alert me when your plans are definitive, so I can adjust my schedule, since it is possible that I will leave Rome in the spring for a certain period.

With my best wishes – *in signo solis invicti* – for the new cycle, very cordially yours ...

Posted on 2012-10-01 by Cologero

* * *

Avery on 2012-10-01 at 11:20 said:

FWIW:

Doctrine of Awakening was published in 1948 by the orientalist publisher “Luzac & Co.” in London.

Revolt was first published in German by the mainstream house Deutsche Verlags-Anstalt of Stuttgart in 1935.

Revolt against the Modern World was first published in English by IT.

Doctrine has never been published in German: <http://www.oocities.org/capitolhill/6890/evolabib.html>.

cosmodromium on 2012-10-01 at 11:41 said:

Excellent! Thank You. My Bollingen English trans. of Eliade's YOGA (1958, originally 1954 in French) includes Evola in the index with 5 entries, all footnotes, to Evola's Doctrine of Awakening; Yoga of Power; and The Hermetic Tradition. With the exception of the first, the notes are concentrated in Eliade's chapter on Tantra.

Izak on 2012-10-02 at 18:23 said:

Thanks for the translation.

Evola's point about wanting to convey tradition through a means which is valid from the aspect of the "sciences" is pretty interesting.

I don't know a lick of Italian, but I'm assuming that the language distinguishes between "sciences" (as just general knowledge disciplines) and "natural sciences" the same way that German does, which is why Evola then goes on to discuss his philosophy.

But does Evola's claim mean that he is still deeply attached to his brand of magical idealism, or that he just agrees with its very basic purpose, from a more superficial stance?

It seems to me that the chief distinction here is that Evola wants to find a way to translate the language of tradition into a more contemporary language of disciplined discourse, so the real question is one more of language than content.

Cologero on 2012-10-02 at 19:19 said:

It's possible to a certain extent, Izak. Yes, by "scientific", he means in the university sense of an organized body of objective knowledge. That is how he identifies Eliade's approach, although he knows Eliade is holding back. Obviously, Evola's system is not strictly speaking mere philosophy, because it requires a certain spiritual attainment to understand. Keep in mind, too, as we have documented previously, the young Eliade wrote a never-published commentary on Evola's magical idealism.

It is also the case that Evola developed his philosophical system before his encounter with Guenon and tradition. Italy was the center of philosophical idealism at the time and Evola had done an intense study of German and Italian idealism. Now I don't know what the original system was because Evola had revised it for later publications. I have the final edition which does, indeed, contain references to more traditional persons who are not typically found in philosophical treatises. So perhaps, over time, he sought to create a Western philosophical system compatible with Traditional metaphysics.

I agree that is something that needs to be done. I could point out that from a personal point of view, based on my background and education, I am actually closer to Evola's approach. Guenon's metaphysics often seems alien; however, it is necessary to meditate on it to make it come alive.

If there is sufficient interest, I will try to extract relevant passages from Evola's philosophical works for translation. As you can imagine, that is not a trivial task. In the meantime, our translation and commentaries on his *The Individual and the Becoming of the World* will provide an entry point into his thought.

Izak on 2012-10-02 at 20:43 said:

Yes, if you're up for the challenge of translating Evola's more idealist-oriented stuff, that would be great!

My only exposure to his "idealist" period has been in his autobiography, and in a discussion by the scholar Paul Furlong (Avery reviewed that book over at Amerika.org, so I read it shortly afterward). Furlong's depiction of Evola's early days is interesting, and he admirably understands both idealistic philosophy as a whole and Evola's relationship to Gentile and Croce. But he also makes some claims/insinuations which I'm not terribly sure about.

I also wonder about the degree to which his theory of the "absolute individual" does permeate his later work, and the exact moment at which it begins to break off, if ever. Both *The Hermetic Tradition* and *The Yoga of Power* do both seem fairly close to what little I know of his school-philosophy days, that is if his ideas have been portrayed accurately in the scholarship.

In the meantime, I'll check out *The Individual and the Becoming of the World*.

Cologero on 2012-10-02 at 20:57 said:

In the Gornahoor Forum, Graham has made available our commentaries on IABW. If you do a search here on the *Individual and the Becoming of the World*, you can find most of it translated. I don't know if the Rune Guild is still selling the pdf version of it.

Although I assert the right to offer my own commentaries, unlike "scholars", I try to also provide translations. That way readers can judge for themselves.

The books you mentioned were certainly early works. As you see from this letter, as late as 1951, after years of correspondence with Guenon, he still regarded absolute idealism as fundamental to his world view. Shortly before his death, he republished the texts in 1973 after extensive revisions. So, the inference must be that he still considered it valid. The only book that Evola did renounce was "Pagan Imperialism".

Izak on 2012-10-02 at 22:32 said:

Yes, and I've been wondering for a while just what his revisions are like, especially considering that *The Yoga of Power* was originally called *Man as Power*, so even the titles have

different implications (and I'll add that upon your recommendation, I've read Woodroffe's *The World As Power*, so I at least have that point of reference).

If mainstream academics like the guy I mentioned were really worth their salt, they would provide translated editions of these books with commentaries containing extensive footnotes, maybe describing the differences between the first edition and later editions, or pointing out factual errors, providing exegetical notes, noting manuscript changes, or whatever else might be relevant. After all, they're getting paid to do this stuff! But I guess they are put in a strange political position, where they must assume no prior knowledge of his work, and to posture themselves as people who are there to put Evola to rest once and for all, often fairly clumsily, for the ideologically innocent academic community of moral do-gooders. This is all quite funny to me, because in the last year, there've been more scholarly attempts in English to grapple with his work than there ever have been before.

But that guy's view and yours seem to be the same, which is that Evola didn't change too much from his original philosophical position. And the letter seems to suggest as much, too.

Thanks for the info!

14.6 From Evola to Carl Schmitt

14.6.1 First Letter

Among the 19,000 pieces of correspondence found in **Carl Schmitt's** personal library, there were eight letters from Julius Evola over a period of several years. There were none found in the opposite direction. From the letters, it is obvious that Evola was very interested in Schmitt's book on **Donoso Cortes**, whom they both regarded quite highly. As a public service, we have made available Donoso's book, *Essays on Catholicism, Liberalism, and Socialism*³². Since it is hardly likely that Evola was interested in Donoso's take on Catholicism, we can assume the other essays are more pertinent. At the very least, they are a counter-balance to the absurd meme floated by the Nouvelle Droite regarding the intellectual source of liberalism. More likely, Evola and Schmitt were impressed by Donoso's defense of authoritarianism.

³²<https://www.gornahoor.net/library/CortesEssays.pdf>

The letters were written in German, using the polite form of “you”. The translations here derive from an Italian translation of the original. Evola’s first letter to Schmitt follows:

15 December 1951

Dear Professor!

I owe your address to Dr. Mohler; therefore, I am able to take the initiative—which I gave been thinking about for some time — *après le déluge*. I have often requested news about you:

primarily, our common friend, Prince Rohan, has assured me that you have at least physically moved beyond the period of the fall. Subsequently, I learned of your controversial “reappearance” and new works. Regarding this, I thank you very much for the booklet “Recht und Raum”, that I received here in Rome.

As far as my own person, things have not always gone the best for me: a war wound prevents me from walking and I can remain seated only for a few hours a day. I returned to Italy in 1948, but I’ve had to stay in nursing homes, so that I returned to my former home in Rome only last May. Subsequently a strange thing happened: I was ... arrested. At the margins of so-called “neofascism” (MSI — **Movimento Sociale Italiano**) groups were formed that committed some foolish acts (bombings). Since my writings were read in those circles with great frequency and my person was rather highly regarded as a “spiritual father”, they wanted to attribute to me the responsibility of a movement of which I knew almost nothing, and they accused me of the alleged defense of “fascist” ideas (“apologist for Fascism”). The story ended last month with my complete innocence; the only consequences were free publicity in my favour and a bad impression for the imposing, farsighted state police.

Apart from this, after my return I took up again unchanged my old activity in the teaching and politico-cultural fields (conservative revolutionary, as Dr. Mohler would say). Nevertheless, the situation here is not very easy and not only because of the Christian-social democracy, but

also for the heavy legacy of the so-called “second Fascism” (republican and “social”) of the neo-Fascists.

A short time ago *Revolt against the Modern World* was published in a new and expanded edition. The same for my works of a spiritual and “esoteric” character that had gone out of print and in the meantime other translations were published in English (*The Doctrine of Awakening*). It is a way of trifling the time.

After having briefly told you about me, I would be happy to know something of you and your projects, since I would give great value to remaining in contact with you. I would also have to ask you one thing: could you possibly procure for me a copy of your new writing on Donoso Cortes? I myself, in fact, am interested in this author and intend to deal with him in an essay — *Menschen und Trummer* — on which I am currently working.

Well, I offer you my best wishes for the upcoming Holiday.

I remain with old friendship.

P.S. Did something happen to your old house in Dahlem?

I will send you a pamphlet, *Orientamenti Orientations*, which constituted the principle *corpus delicti* body of the crime, evidence of my trial.

Posted on 2012-06-25 by Cologero

14.7 Other letters

14.7.1 Julius Evola and Lourdes

Letter to Fr. Clemente Rebora (May 14, 1949)

I thank you sincerely both for the trouble that you took in coming to visit me and for the concern that your offer of a visit to Lourdes shows me. About the visit, I don’t believe that it makes any sense, not because there

are prejudices on my part, but for reasons, let us say, so technical that whoever takes the point of view not only of faith but moreover of knowledge could easily recognize. I will point out that at Lourdes I would have to go to ask, in the state of grace, that the physical disability be removed. Now, I have already told you how little this thing means to me, and even if the illness were more serious, a man worthy of this name should not turn to the supernatural for things of this type.

First of all, the basic premise, which is that of a burning desire for a healing, is lacking. If you have to ask for a favour, it should instead be that of understanding the *meaning* of what happened in the spiritual realm – the thing remains or it does not; furthermore, there is the favour of understanding the reason for my continuing to live. I have already noted that the accident was like an enigmatic answer to my asking – through exposing myself to danger – if my earthly life could come to an end.

In the second place, I must say that among the symbols of Christianity even that of the “Mother of God” is among those that speak the least to me, that are the most strange to me; finally, that all my psychic constitution leaves precious few possibilities to processes that involve emotional and affective factors, starting with those that stand at the base of the very element of “believing” in general. Given these circumstances, at Lourdes what would have to happen is something similar to a mechanical action, completely external, that is barely conceivable in itself – and moreover – how much of the spiritual design that always accompanies every true “miracle”. *Being “cured” in such a manner would change nothing in me; the true problem, that is the increase of interior light, would not result.* In my gift, of being absolutely sincere with myself, Father, this is what I must tell you. In every way, for the disposition that your proposal reveals, I am grateful to you.

Sincerely,
J. Evola

Subsequently Fr. Rivora wrote to Pittoni: A supernatural ten-

derness for him grows in my heart. He told me of an inner fact necessary for him in the bombardment at Vienna and he added that his ongoing test still remained mysterious to him. I believe instead I notice a decisive and providential act for his soul. He thinks that this morning I wrote to him suggesting that he come to Lourdes with the hospital train ...

Posted on 2009-03-19 by Cologero

14.8 Letter to Palamidessi

Rome, January 20, 1972

Dear Dr. Palamidessi,

I got your letter, for which I thank you.

I already told you that a treatise on initiatic astrology would be an important work and would fill a gap; and it would also be interesting to treat, in accordance with its aim, a typology of inner races with the utilization of the astrological element. In my book, there is only a sketch of it that needs to be adequately developed. A publisher in Germany had encouraged me to dedicate myself to this research, but I had to pass it up. Moreover, it would, above all, be about an *a priori* morphology, not on an empirical base. Because of that, whether pure types currently exist, conformed completely to that fundamental structure, has no importance, and even lacks practical value. So, for example, the defining of the absolute woman and the absolute man, who are almost non-existent empirically, is of great utility for the analysis of those women and men who are such only approximately, and with admixtures (Weininger).

The temperamental knowledge of oneself in the deepest states would be an important possibility offered by such investigations. I don't see, on the other hand, possible connections to that "awakening of the European race", which you noted. An earlier work, although without utilizing any astrological contributions, could be my friend L. W. Clauss'

Rassenseeekunde racial psychology (the study of the soul or the souls of race); I believe that I mentioned him in my book. If you want, you can include me in those figure sketches that you intend to treat, provided that you exclude every exaggeration, as the English would say. One of my accounts of the “absolute individual”, for example, would only be humorous.

Unfortunately, I forgot to give you directly, on the occasion of your visit, the book *L'Arco e la Clava*. We will see how it can be done: either on the next meeting or if the publisher provides the service of sending right to a private home, the postal services particularly for the stamps have become infamous. However, a copy is reserved for you.

Another thing. One of my (female) friends, belonging to my faithful guard-house, having known of your visit and knowing your name, makes my life impossible because she would like to have from you an astrological chart of her character and her “destiny”. If, by chance, you have a little time to waste for a little more than summary investigation, the dates are: born February 25, 1945 at 15:20 in Venice.

Cordially yours,
J. Evola

Posted on 2012-04-30 by Cologero

* * *

Angolmois on 2012-04-30 at 01:48 said:

Thanks for this one, it made my day, haha!

Seriously, when reading Evola and Guénon and others of their ilk only from their theoretical writings, one gets easily the impression that they are some kind of mythological heroes who perhaps never even lived in the first place. When one sees Evola discussing postal costs of stamps and talking in an embarrassing way about astrological charts etc., it kind of brings him as a human being more down to earth without making his writings any less lofty. I can only imagine him trading tapes of rare traditionalist BM bands with his UG friends. :-)

Matt on 2012-04-30 at 07:10 said:

Yes, I thought the same thing when I watched the video of Evola being interviewed on the history of Italy's Dada movement. Evola the author comes across as being aloof and distant, but Evola in-person comes across as quite friendly and close.

Cologero on 2012-04-30 at 07:28 said:

Yes, Angolmois, every man puts on his pants, one leg at a time. The caretaker story is curious, too, that he would make the effort to get a private astrological reading for her.

But it also shows his consistency over the course of his life, unlike many men I know who go through a major conversion every few years. He still refers, in a positive way, to Weininger's *Sex and Character*³³, which was one of his earliest influences. I know Evola "scholars" who prefer to ignore Weininger.

We get an insight, too, about Evola's method and way of thinking. The Absolute Man or Woman is an *a priori* metaphysical category; actually existing men and women are to be compared to that standard. This is the opposite approach of empirical science, which would first do a study of men and women as they are; then, they would formulate a theory of what is a man or a woman. It seems to me that post-modern science has brought much more confusion than clarity to that question.

The methods are clearly incompatible and lead to much different results. Note, too, that those on the "right wing" today try to employ biological arguments to demonstrate intrinsic differences between men and women. This approach has proved less than effective as it falls far short of an intellectual conversion to a metaphysical and transcendental world view.

There are other questions, if you read between the lines. Why would Evola be embarrassed by his writings on the absolute individual, one of very earliest conceptions? There is also the reference in passing to the relationship of astrology to race; was Evola thinking that had something to do with the problem of births?

Perhaps Logres can shed some light on these questions:

1. Did P. ever publish his sketch of Evola?
2. Did P. ever publish anything on "awakening the European race"?

Angolmois on 2012-05-01 at 05:41 said:

Good points, both of you. The concept of the absolute man brought to my mind Guénon's "nickname" which was 'an intellectual function'. What is man and how we should judge him according to his accidental traits is certainly a lost call, yet in differentiated men it does also shed some light upon the personality behind the reflection and the mask / per-sona.

³³<http://www.gornahoor.net/library/SexAndCharacter.pdf>

Evola liked talking about his 'personal equation' although he scorned his own personality to the borders of sanity. Quite telling again, isn't it? We all have our shadows to deal with.

logres on 2012-05-01 at 08:14 said:

This is probably the book of interest: *Astrologia mondiale: il destino dei popoli rivelato dal corso degli astri*, Turin: T. Palamidessi, 1941 (2nd ed. Archeosofica 1985).

(The destiny of people revealed by the course of the stars, I think). I'll have to look for more. Many thanks to Cologero for translating this letter, which has piqued an interest in some of his posts on cosmology and the zodiac (although there are fewer of them). "We are underlings to the stars", except for our will, if it awakens.

Charlotte on 2012-05-01 at 08:27 said:

the astrological tangent puts me in mind of the words of a truly catholic author along the lines of Justin or Origen, who wrote something along the lines of (quoted in MoTT) – 'When we were children, under compulsion from the stars'.

This has always struck me as one of the most poignant phrases I've read in any book anywhere – the innocence of the child who is both protected and controlled by these cosmic forces, while the adult man or woman must master those same forces in order to attain the truth contained in another wonderful phrase from MoTT – the stars incline, they do not compel.

That probably tells us all we need to know about astrological sciences, which certainly doesn't stop me gazing at the planets and stars as often as possible, especially Venus, which is monumentally huge right now – the biggest it will EVER appear to us in fact, so far as I know (last night) :-)

Angolmois on 2012-05-03 at 01:35 said:

Charlotte: I think that the two influences of Venus and Jupiter, and later on Saturn, can be traced to the beginnings of the new age in astrological terms. The conjunction of Venus and Jupiter marks the birth of the Christ, and they have both been active during this year. There is also the issue of the comet that stroke the sky into the direction of the constellation Draco which marked the birth of the year of the Dragon. We are currently witnessing the inauguration of the reign of Saturn and the age of Aquarius; this is the very thing in which the new agers are certainly right, only their conclusions and the applications seem to be often quite fantastic and utopian. The major star Betelgeuse has also activated, which can be linked to the emergence of 'the true will' in highly developed humanity.

Personally I have found the Bailey book on esoteric astrology quite helpful, although I can't be completely in agreement with Bailey's conclusions or theories.

As regards the 'enslavement under the stars', this is mostly a problem for mass minded humanity. For every disciple and initiate the birth chart and astrological researches must be

made according to their point in the path of return together with other issues to be examined, to be able to tell one's exact point.

In whole I think that the (esoteric) teachings and interpretations of Jesus Christ are the most helpful in "surmounting the archons", especially the teachings found from the apocryphic writings and Pistis Sophia, which might just be the most neglected "christic" work of all times.

Charlotte on 2012-05-03 at 06:30 said:

yes Angolmois, I spent a fascinating month in the highlands of Guatemala, from a wonderful natural observatory, watching the conjunctions, comets and other incredible astronomical phenomena you mention. Betelgeuse does indeed appear very red nowadays (all the more obvious in a clear sky) and it struck me for the first time that it might indeed go (or already be going) supernova as expected. Imagine Orion without his left arm! I totally agree that the cosmos has been behaving in an unusual way – or a way not seen in my lifetime before – since at least last September, when I saw Jupiter looking so enormous it stunned me. Now Venus is doing the same, and as you pointed out, they have already conjuncted. I have mentioned to people a few times that early in October I saw literally the most amazing night sky I've ever witnessed in my life, it had both myself and my neighbour out on the balcony with our jaws on the floor. It only lasted for about 10 minutes, but for that time every single star and planet seemed about 10 times closer, you could see every colour – red, blue, green, orange – and they weren't just twinkling in the usual fashion, Jupiter for instance was slowly pulsating as if it was actually turning on and off. Anyone who denies there are signs in the skies these days either hasn't been looking up or they live in a zone where there's too much ambient light and air pollution to see properly. What it all means, as you also rightly pointed out, is a matter of interpretation. Clearly this IS the start of the age of Aquarius, that's just a fact connected with our cosmos... I am also with you 100% on the Pistis Sophia and often recommend it to people. I broke my foot last January (over a year ago), tripping over in towering heels on a slippery floor, and it gave me perfect occasion to contemplate the fall of man and womankind with the most tragic of attitudes, I can tell you! Joking aside, this was a very dark and difficult period of my life that caused me to examine myself thoroughly and face up to things that hitherto I'd been unwilling or unable to deal with, but reading the Pistis Sophia for the first time was definitely a silver lining in this cloud... it is an incredible work, it is of so much help to anyone contemplating the problem of the Fall, a truly magical text. I posted this extract on my blog at the time – looking back now I can see that I began reading it about 3 days after my tumble, something must have been guiding me for me to have found it so soon after!

<http://alchemical-weddings.com/alchemical-weddings/the-ineffable>

Back to the sky for a moment, we have a red supermoon in Scorpio coming on Saturday, I'd say that's a biggie. It's the Beltane full moon and also around the time of Buddha's

enlightenment... ..got to be a good time to meditate by any estimation?! Cx

Charlotte on 2012-05-03 at 06:35 said:

yes it is curious that Pistis Sophia has been so neglected... ..just like Mary Magdalene in exoteric religion

Angolmois on 2012-05-03 at 13:27 said:

The neglect of Pistis Sophia among 'orthodox' believers and exoteric christianity must have something to do with the 'egyptian' and other influences in it. Amenti etc. Early Christians around the years 100-300 did quite a good job of kicking off almost all universal esoterism and twisting the words of Jesus, if I'm right. It all started from 'Paul the theologian' and 'Peter the denier'. Origen and few others are quite good, but even they saw gnosticism as their enemy because they thought it leads men towards over-blown intellectual pride. On the other hand they were right, but on the other hand they were quite wrong.

AS regarding Mary Magdalene, I think this neglect has to do with too much Solarism understood in a unilateral way among the early christians and the desert fathers. The Eternal Feminine has certainly been neglected in the exoteric monotheism, yet its resurgence can be seen in the 'wholly pagan' worship of the black virgin.

<http://www.sophiaperennis.com/books/christianity/the-black-virgin/>

Charlotte on 2012-05-03 at 15:14 said:

Yes... .

The book sounds very interesting thank you for the link. In fact I was thinking of the Black Virgin in the bath earlier today, wondering if I should mention this. I had tended to see her as more equivalent to Mary Magdalene, but who knows?

The negation of Mary Magdalene – or marginalisation, perhaps – is definitely one of the main reasons I have felt unable to fully sign up to the catholic church. Peter and Paul have an awful lot of truth between them, but not a monopoly, although catholicism does more for the divine feminine than most other exoteric Christian denominations.

Funny you mentioned Amenti... ..you know I keep on discovering things that are meant to be taboo! It reminds me of a poem or something else I have read, would that be the Emerald Tablet perhaps. Could be. Halls of Amenti. We've been there haven't we, isn't that where one of the schoolrooms is?!

14.8.1 Letter from Guenon to AKC 24VI1935

In 1935, **Rene Guenon** and **Ananda Coomaraswamy** began a correspondence that lasted 12 years. This letter shows their common mind, although their respective intellectual paths were quite different. An important point he makes regards the relationship between historical events and metaphysical principles; neither necessarily excludes the other. He also alludes what is called the “Aryan Invasion Theory” which brought the Primordial Tradition from the Arctic region to India in the form of Hinduism. To avoid confusion, keep in mind that Guenon emphasizes that the word “Aryan” does not designate a race.³⁴

Cairo, 24 June 1935

Thank you for your letter and your shipment, which reached me at the same time.

There are some very interesting indications in “The Darker Side of the Dawn”, which suggest many parallels with those found also in other traditions; it would be desirable if you get the opportunity to further develop these considerations later. As for your study of medieval aesthetics, the ideas you express fully coincide with what I think myself.

I am pleased to see that we are also in full agreement on the meaning of the words “Aryan” and “non-Aryan”, which I could never consider as designating races.

As for the “pre-Hindu” traditions in India, without doubt, I have not sufficiently explained myself. It is well understood that all people are or have been in possession of traditions derived from a single source, but in a more or less distinct way. The Sumerian, Dravidian traditions, etc., seem to be based on forms most especially coming from certain secondary centers, whereas the “Hindu” tradition, which came from the north, is the one that comes most directly from the Primordial Tradition.

³⁴The essay, “The Darker Side of the Dawn”, can be found online.

tion (for our Manvantara), shown everywhere as “polar” in origin. This of course has a direct link with the question of the “Terrestrial Paradise” which you alluded to, and which I mentioned in my book “The King of the World”; this won’t stop me from coming back to this topic again as you suggest. Concerning the analogy of historical events with the principles from which come their symbolic value (which does not exclude at all their factual reality), I often insisted on it; this is something that Westerners seem to have much difficulty in understanding in general.

I’m sorry to answer so briefly today but I hope now that our correspondence does not stay there.

Thank you again for what you tell me of my works and for making my works known in your circles.

Please accept, dear sir, my best wishes.

Posted on 2013-08-05 by Cologero

* * *

Avery Morrow on 2013-08-06 at 05:59 said:

Here we are.

<http://www.scribd.com/doc/87506844/Coomaraswamy-The-Darker-Side-of-Dawn>

Whatever parallels Guenon was thinking of are beyond me on this early morning.

John Curley on 2013-08-06 at 06:23 said:

Thank you for this link, Avery.

15.1 The Beautiful Old Man

For it is the venerable and mysterious Hermit who was master of the most intimate and most cherished dreams of my youth, as moreover he is the master of dreams for all youth in every country, who are enamoured by the call to seek the narrow gate and the hard way to the Divine. Name for me a country or a time for which the youth—who are truly “young”, i.e. living for the Ideal—has not had its imagination haunted by the figure of a wise and good father, a spiritual father, a hermit, who has passed through the narrow gate and who walks the hard way—**someone whom one could trust without reserve and whom one could venerate and love without limit.** Which young Russian man, for example, would not have undertaken a journey, no matter how long and of what duration, in order to meet a staretz, i.e. a wise and good father, a spiritual father, a hermit? Which young Jewish man from Poland, Lithuania, White Russia, Ukraine or Romania would not have done as much to meet a Hassidic tsadik, i.e. a wise

and good father, a spiritual father, a hermit? Which young man in India would refuse to make every possible effort to find and meet a chela or guru, i.e. a wise and good father, a spiritual father, a hermit?

Meditations on the Tarot

In Memoriam to Charles “Cologero” Salvo

Almost two years ago, on the feast day of the Ascension, **Cologero**, the founder, authority, and genius behind Gornahoor left us behind¹. His death was sudden, shocking, and unexpected. For many of us, myself included, Charles was not only a wise voice in the wilderness, but a true sage, a hermetic “spiritual director”, even a “spiritual father”. He was the kind of precious and rare teacher who taught his students not only how to understand metaphysics intellectually, but how to actually experience the higher states of being and achieve real metaphysical knowledge.



More than this, Charles taught the transformation of earthly love into spiritual Love, the kind of Love can fuel the rapid and almost vertiginous ascent of the Lover through the Alchemical Marriage².

In the **Fedeli d'Amore**³, novices were under a rule of silence for nine years, after which they would write a poem⁴ in order to be initiated. This was the model Charles followed with those he taught personally.

The style of Charles' teaching was unique, and almost “martial”. He was not a follower of the modern platitude that “there are no stupid questions”; holding discussion with him on the matters that concerned us was

¹<https://www.gpanochfunerals.com/obituary/Charles-Salvo>

²<https://gornahoor.net/?p=13814>

³<https://gornahoor.net/?p=10164>

⁴<https://gornahoor.net/?p=17046>

an exercise in rigor and challenge. Like a fencing master calmly dismantling the tentative, feeble strikes of his pupils, Charles swiftly cut through thoughtless, bombastic, or shallow remarks that lacked real understanding. In a way that was stern, but not hostile, Charles used the edge of his saturnine personality to make you instantly feel your own weakness with just a few choice words, or even a pregnant pause. For me (and my experience is not unique), the many years spent striving to engage him on the highest truths, faltering repeatedly, having my own ignorance and errors laid bare; all of this was a crucible essential to my own growth.

* * *

Beyond this inner mission of passing on the Hermetic tradition to individual successors, Charles had an outer mission with Gornahoor: **to return to the foundations of the Western Tradition and chart a path for its renewal**. Gornahoor's has always maintained that this Western Tradition, the "religion of the Middle Ages", is the manifestation of the Primordial Tradition, the same Tradition that manifested in the Vedic civilization and in Ancient Greece. The esoteric core of this tradition is called "The Church of John's" and Gornahoor has demonstrated its unbroken (if tumultuous) continuity across centuries.

Charles' vision for a reinvigorated Western Tradition was a glorious one. What Julius Evola doubted, Charles, with Guido de Giorgio, dared to hope for:

A Catholicism that is raised up to the level of a truly universal, unanimous, and perennial tradition where faith can be integrated into a metaphysical realization, the symbol integrated into the path to awakening, the rites and sacraments into acts of power, dogmas into expressions of an absolute and infallible consciousness because it is beyond human and, as such, alive in beings

⁵<https://gornahoor.net/?p=16881>

unbound from terrestrial chains through an ascesis, and where the pontificate recovers its primal mediating function — such a Catholicism could supplant every “spiritualism”, both present and future.

JULIUS EVOLA, *Mask and Face of Contemporary Spirituality*

* * *

This work is not completed. Charles wished for the next generation to carry on his work, and **there are those of us who are prepared to do so.** In 2025 and beyond, Gornahoor will continue Charles’ mission in the following ways:

- New translations of authors like **Luigi Valli**⁶ and **Guido de Giorgio**⁷, beginning with Valli’s *Key to the Divine Comedy* and *Secret Language of the Fedeli d’Amore*.
- New articles
- Expansion to new formats (X, Substack⁸)
- Compilation, preservation, and republication of Cologero’s most important writings

* * *

In Greek, *kalogeros* means “beautiful elder”, and originally referred to monks or hermits, men who aged gracefully in wisdom and holiness. Hence “Cologero”, the form the word took when it was adopted in Sicily, the land of Charles’ ancestors. The pseudonym was an exact fit for the man behind it.

⁶<https://gornahoor.net/?p=6215>

⁷<https://gornahoor.net/?p=5828>

⁸<https://gornahoorpress.substack.com/>

**Exegi monumentum aere perennius
Regalique situ pyramidum altius,
Quod non imber edax, non Aquilo inpotens
possit diruere aut innumerabilis
annorum series et fuga temporum.**

HORACE, *Odes* III: XXX

Requiescat in Pace.

Posted on 2025-03-30 by Tannheuser

* * *

T. Freitas on 2025-03-30 at 06:40 said:
What a thoughtful message! A very well deserved tribute to C.

oiar on 2025-03-30 at 10:22 said:
Are there ways of sponsoring the community he envisioned?

Emanuel Venator on 2025-03-31 at 13:00 said:
It's good to see Cologero's work continuing. In a very real sense I owe my life to this blog.

Daft on 2025-04-02 at 02:01 said:
Wow, nice tribute. As a longtime reader I never knew the face of the mystery person who was so wise and wild to me.

Sibylle on 2025-04-02 at 03:17 said:
„Non omnis moriar, multaque pars mei vitabit Libitinam.“
Thank you very much – and God bless.

Aria Veritas on 2025-04-10 at 12:50 said:
I wanted to understand the Red Work and thought he might help out.
The dreams he talked about in his last few months made us both think he would soon go either literally as he did, or metaphysically (which he may also have done).

I'd stopped emailing him (he knew why) six weeks before I heard he'd died. He died two weeks after what was to be our final correspondence.

I thought he was being stubborn in not emailing to apologise. It was a stupid game but I kept wondering if he had died because he was openly, psychically "buzzing" me to go to Gornahoor but I refused. He was so gloriously, hilariously RUDE! Lmao... I also refused to believe he could have *actually* died, because he was buzzing me so consciously.

Quite the blow.

Nevertheless, Zoroastrianism was the first, and it is that which we ought to investigate along with plasma physics before trying to build another crutch for the limping church because if one can grasp the nature of Fire, sacrifice and the meanings of the Arc, we're in business again as a global culture with a unified doctrine.

The following 8 years are integral – the bridge is wide open right now.

C answered my deepest, most long-held question, answered in (a series of posts on Selene and) a very specific Guénon chapter in *Man and His Becoming*.

That my question could even BE answered even by Guénon was extraordinary; Charles knew what I was asking, and thanks to his knowledge/strange love I got The Keys. The question was like a God-given, pre-ordained memory code.

I Realised (pun) what had happened via Sufi poetry he sent by Ibn Arabi. I could hardly believe... but had no choice but to believe in all of it, then figure out the mechanics of it. Electrical engineering and plasma physics have never looked so beautiful and perfect.

He teased/tempted publishing some of my writing on his page like Naida if I agreed with him on certain points, but the plasma physics connection and the dodgy nature of western medicine/church are not things to be compromised.

He was one of the few most valuable people I've ever met.

Juliano on 2025-04-10 at 14:34 said:

I'm happy that his work will be continued. This site is a constant companion for many years and in a few interactions Charles helped me a lot. God bless you.

Petter on 2025-04-15 at 09:51 said:

Thank you for continuing Cologero's work!

Where can I follow it on Substack and X?

Zebulon Goertzel on 2025-04-16 at 19:24 said:

Life ain't the same without you Bro

Tannheuser on 2025-04-30 at 18:56 said:

Hi Petter,

Substack is <https://gornahoorpress.substack.com/>, and my personal X account is on <https://x.com/EndymionMk4>, which I'm using primarily for Gornahoor related info/posts.

Bill on 2025-05-31 at 23:10 said:

Have you considered reviewing the works of Silvano Panunzio or Attilio Mordini?

Tannheuser on 2025-06-04 at 13:17 said:

I haven't, but it could be worthwhile. Thanks for the suggestion.

Auld Wat on 2025-07-09 at 10:54 said:

Glad to here Cologero's work is being continued. I will keep you in my prayers as I pray for him.

Luka Markovic on 2025-10-08 at 18:14 said:

Thank you for this tribute. Cologero is missed greatly

Noctael on 2025-11-04 at 14:24 said:

It could be very useful to have an index to organize the content

Jean M.M. Bernard on 2025-11-21 at 08:43 said:

Beautiful tribute.

I had, regrettably, been out of touch with this site and its mastermind for a while, and did not learn about Cologero's passing away before today. I was compelled to check in here after Cologero seemed to appear to me in a dream this morning, communicating certain things which included giving me some kind of old clock in purple. He said that he loves all of you: emphasis on all.

May Our Lord bless him and keep him in His Sacred Heart.

And may his writings endure and inspire great works for the future spiritualization of Mankind.